Tamil, Step by Step, Root by Root

An etymology-driven curriculum, built one word at a time

Adhithya Rajasekaran

This edition compiled incrementally — new chapters added as they are written.

Copyright © Adhithya Rajasekaran. Licensed under Creative Commons Attribution-ShareAlike 4.0 International (CC BY-SA 4.0). Tamil set in Noto Sans Tamil (SIL Open Font License).

Preface

This book teaches Tamil one word at a time, and it teaches each word by taking it apart. It is written for someone starting from zero — who may not read a single Tamil letter — so the script is taught *inside the word lessons themselves*: each word introduces exactly the letters it needs, so you learn to read வணக்கம் *and* learn that it means "greetings" in the same few minutes. There is no alphabet drill to sit through first.

Many readers will not be starting from zero at all. If you grew up speaking Tamil at home and never studied it — fluent in the language, hesitant with the letters, never once told *why* any of it works the way it does — this book is written for you as well. Skim the "letters in this word" notes for the handful of shapes you are unsure of, and read the rest for the grammar and the history nobody sat you down and explained.

Tamil rewards this depth more than most languages. It is the oldest-attested of the **Dravidian** tongues — a family entirely separate from the Indo-European one that gave us English, Latin, and Sanskrit — and it is famously protective of its own word-stock. Again and again you will find Tamil keeping a home-grown word (வணக்கம் *vaṇakkam*, "hello"; நன்றி *naṉṟi*, "thanks") where its sisters Kannada, Telugu, and Malayalam reached for a Sanskrit one. So each lesson sets the word beside its cousins across the family — English always, and Sanskrit, Hindi, and the other Dravidian languages where they illuminate — every form supplied in full, so no prior knowledge of any of them is assumed.

How to use this book

Every numbered section is one word, or one small phrase, and takes a few minutes — the length of a queue, an errand, or the walk to the bus. Read them in order the first time through: each section stands on the ones before it, and nothing is used before it has been taught. After that the book becomes reference, and you can open it anywhere.

Say the Tamil out loud wherever you can. The prompts under *Your turn* are written to be spoken, and saying a word is most of what makes it stay. The questions under *Before you move on* carry their own answers in brackets: cover them, answer from memory, then look.

Nothing here is gated behind the alphabet. Each lesson introduces exactly the letters and sounds its own word needs, so you are reading real words from the first page rather than drilling a chart. The whole script is gathered in a reference at the back of the book — somewhere to look things up when you are curious, never a chapter to sit through first.

Released under CC BY-SA 4.0 — share it, adapt it, teach from it.

Contents

Preface **iii**

1 Greetings **1**
1.1 வணக்கம் (vaṇakkam) 1
1.2 வ (va) 3
1.3 வணக்கம் / நமஸ்காரம் (vaṇakkam / namaskāram) 4
1.4 ஆம் (ām) 5
1.5 இல்லை (illai) 6
1.6 நன்றி (na$\underline{n}$ri) 8
1.7 நன்றி / ನಂದಿ (na$\underline{n}$ri / nandi) 9
1.8 சரி (sari) 11
1.9 ஆம் / இல்லை / சரி (ām / illai / sari) 12
1.10 Practice 14

2 Introducing Yourself **17**
2.1 பெயர் (peyar) 17
2.2 என் (e$\underline{n}$) 19
2.3 என் பெயர் … (e$\underline{n}$ peyar …) 19
2.4 நீ / நீங்கள் (nī / nīṅgaḷ) 21
2.5 என்ன (e$\underline{nn}$a) 22
2.6 உங்கள் பெயர் என்ன? (uṅgaḷ peyar e$\underline{nn}$a?) 22
2.7 மகிழ்ச்சி (magi$\underline{l}$cci) 24
2.8 Practice 25

3 How Are You? **27**
3.1 எப்படி (eppaḍi) 27
3.2 நீங்கள் எப்படி … (nīṅgaḷ eppaḍi …) 28
3.3 நான் (nā$\underline{n}$) 30
3.4 நலம் (nalam) 31
3.5 பரவாயில்லை (paravāyillai) 32

3.6 Practice 33

4 Farewells **35**
4.1 போ (pō) 35
4.2 போய் வருகிறேன் (pōy varugiṟēṉ) 36
4.3 நாளை பார்க்கலாம் (nāḷai pārkkalām) 37
4.4 மீண்டும் சந்திப்போம் (mīṇḍum sandippōm) 38
4.5 தமிழ் எழுத்து (tamiḻ eḻuttu) 40
4.6 Practice 41

5 The First Verbs **43**
5.1 பேசு (pēsu) 43
5.2 நான் தமிழ் பேசுகிறேன் (nāṉ tamiḻ pēsugiṟēṉ) . . 44
5.3 வ, க (va, ka) 45
5.4 வாழ் (vāḻ) 47
5.5 வேலை செய் (vēlai sey) 48
5.6 Practice 49

6 Dative Case and Dative Subjects **51**
6.1 -உக்கு (-ukku) 51
6.2 வ (va) 53
6.3 ம, ண (ma, ṇa) 54
6.4 பெயர் + உக்கு (peyar + ukku) 56
6.5 எனக்குத் தமிழ் … (enakkut tamiḻ …) 57
6.6 எனக்கு / నాకు … (enakku / nāku …) 59
6.7 ண (ṇa) 61
6.8 ந, ன, ண (na, ṉa, ṇa) 63
6.9 ப (pa) 64

7 Numbers One to Ten **67**
7.1 onru irantu muunru naanku aintu 67
7.2 க உ ஈ (one, two, three) 68
7.3 ச ரு (four, five) 69
7.4 ஒன்று இரண்டு மூன்று … (onru irantu …) 69
7.5 க உ ஈ ச ரு (one to five) 70
7.6 க உ ஈ ச ரு (one to five) 70
7.7 க உ ஈ ச ரு (one to five) 71
7.8 இரண்டு மூன்று … (iraṇṭu mūṉṟu …) 71
7.9 aaru eezhu ettu onpatu pattu 72
7.10 சு எ அ (six, seven, eight) 73

7.11 கூ ய (nine, ten) 74
7.12 ஆறு ஏழு எட்டு … (aaru eezhu ettu …) 74
7.13 சூ எ அ கூ ய (six to ten) 75
7.14 ன (n̲a) 75
7.15 ஏழு எ (eezhu, seven) 77
7.16 ஏழு எ (eezhu, seven) 77
7.17 ◌் (pul̲l̲i) 78
7.18 ஆறு ஏழு பத்து (ār̲u ēl̲u pattu) 80
7.19 ோ (ō) 81
7.20 Practice 82

8 Please **85**
8.1 சொந்தம் (sontham) 85
8.2 தயவுசெய்து (tayavu seytu) 86
8.3 solluṅgaḷ 88
8.4 சொ (so) 88
8.5 சொல்லுங்கள் (solluṅgaḷ) 90
8.6 சொல்லுங்கள் (solluṅgaḷ) 90
8.7 சொல்லுங்கள் (solluṅgaḷ) 90
8.8 தயவுசெய்து / -உங்கள் (tayavu seytu / uṅgaḷ) . . 91
8.9 ந (na) 92
8.10 வணக்கம் (vaṇakkam) 94
8.11 எ (e) 95
8.12 உ (u) 97

9 Sorry **99**
9.1 மன்னிக்கவும் (man̲n̲ikkavum) 99
9.2 மன்னிக்கவும் / sorry (man̲n̲ikkavum / sorry) 101
9.3 ல (la) 102

10 Days of the Week **105**
10.1 திங்கள்–ஞாயிறு (thiṅgaḷ–ñāyi̲r̲u) 105
10.2 ற (r̲a) 107
10.3 ந, ன, ற (na, n̲a, r̲a) 109
10.4 ◌ா (ā) 111
10.5 Practice 113

11 Colours **115**
11.1 கருப்பு வெள்ளை … (karuppu vel̲l̲ai …) 115
11.2 ழ (lla) 117

12 Family **119**
12.1 அப்பா அம்மா அண்ணன் … (appā ammā aṇṇaṉ …) 119
12.2 ச (ca) 121

13 Body Parts **123**
13.1 தலை கை (talai kai) 123
13.2 க (ka) 124
13.3 ி, நன்றி (i, naṉṟi / nandri) 126
13.4 ர (ra) 128
13.5 Practice 129

14 Seasons **131**
14.1 வசந்த காலம் கோடைக் … (vasantha kaalam …) . . 131
14.2 ட (tta) 133

15 Water and Rice **137**
15.1 தண்ணீர் அரிசி சாதம் (taṇṇīr arisi sātam) 137
15.2 அ (a) 139

16 Tamil Months **143**
16.1 சித்திரை வைகாசி … (Chithirai …) 143
16.2 ம (ma) 145
16.3 ஆம் (ām) 146
16.4 ஆ (ā) 149
16.5 Practice 151

17 Noon and Midnight **153**
17.1 நண்பகல் நள்ளிரவு (naṇpakal naḷḷiravu) 153
17.2 நடுப்பகல், நடு இரவு (naṭuppakal, naṭu …) 155
17.3 ு (u) 156

18 Telling Time **159**
18.1 மணி (maṇi) 159
18.2 ் (puḷḷi) 160
18.3 இல்லை (illai) 162
18.4 மணி / மணி (maṇi / maṇi) 165
18.5 த (ta) 166

19 Asking Someone's Age **169**
19.1 உனக்கு எத்தனை வயது … (unakku ettanai …) . . 169
19.2 உன் வயசு என்ன? … (un vayasu enna? …) 170
19.3 ி (i sign) 171
19.4 சரி (sari) 173
19.5 ே (ē) 174
19.6 Practice 176

20 Numbers Eleven to Twenty and Weather **179**
20.1 பதினொன்று — இருபது (patiṉoṉṟu …) 179
20.2 வானிலை (vāṉilai) 181
20.3 ய (ya) 183

21 Dog and Cat **185**
21.1 நாய், பூனை (nāy, pūnai) 185
21.2 என் (eṉ) 187

22 Green and Yellow **191**
22.1 பச்சை, மஞ்சள் (paccai mañcaḷ) 191

23 Day **195**
23.1 நாள் (nāḷ) 195
23.2 நாள் / தினம் (nāḷ / tiṉam) 196
23.3 பெயர் (peyar) 197

24 Night **201**
24.1 இரவு (iravu) 201
24.2 இரவு / ராத்திரி … (iravu / rāttiri …) 202

25 Good Night **205**
25.1 இனிய இரவு (iṉiya iravu) 205
25.2 நான் (nāṉ) 207
25.3 நல்ல இரவு / இரவு … (nalla iravu …) 209

26 Morning **211**
26.1 காலை (kālai) 211

27 Evening **213**
27.1 மாலை (mālai) 213
27.2 நீங்கள் (nīṅgaḷ) 215
27.3 Practice 217

28 Afternoon **219**
28.1 பிற்பகல் (piṟpakal) 219
28.2 நடுப்பகல் / மதியம் (naṭuppakal / matiyam) 221

29 Good Morning **223**
29.1 காலை வணக்கம் (kālai vaṇakkam) 223
29.2 எப்படி (eppaḍi) 225

30 Good Evening **227**
30.1 மாலை வணக்கம் (mālai vaṇakkam) 227

31 Good Afternoon **231**
31.1 மதிய வணக்கம் (matiya vaṇakkam) 231
31.2 மதிய (matiya) 233
31.3 இருக்கிறீர்கள் (irukkiṟīrgaḷ) 234

32 The Core Verbs **237**
32.1 இரு (iru) 237
32.2 போ (pō) 239
32.3 வா (vā) 241
32.4 சாப்பிடு (sāppiḍu) 243
32.5 பார் (pār) 244
32.6 தெரி (teri) 246

33 Four Verbs of the Mind **249**
33.1 நினை (ninai) 249
33.2 புரி (puri) 251
33.3 படி (paḍi) 253
33.4 தமிழ் (tamiḻ) 255
33.5 எழுது (eḻudu) 257

34 Four Verbs Between People **261**
34.1 எடு (eḍu) 261
34.2 கேள் (kēḷ) 263
34.3 பேசு (pēsu) 265
34.4 உதவு (udavu) 267
34.5 பிடி (piḍi) 268

35 Arriving at a House **271**
35.1 வீடு (vīḍu) 271
35.2 போ (pō) 273
35.3 கதவு (kadavu) 275
35.4 அறை (aṟai) 277
35.5 நாற்காலி (nāṟkāli) 279

36 What You Are Offered **283**
36.1 தேநீர் (tēnīr) 283
36.2 பால் (pāl) 285
36.3 உணவு (uṇavu) 287
36.4 உணவு (uṇavu) 289
36.5 தவறு (tavaṟu) 290

37 Your Town, Your Friend **293**
37.1 ஊர் (ūr) 293
37.2 நண்பன் (naṇbaṉ) 295
37.3 ஊர் (ūr) 297
37.4 இவர் (ivar) 299
37.5 அவர் (avar) 301
37.6 இவர் என் நண்பர் (ivar eṉ naṇbar) 302

38 Keeping Well, and Leaving **305**
38.1 உடம்பு (uḍambu) 305
38.2 சுகம் (sugam) 307
38.3 விடை (viḍai) 309
38.4 மூன்று (mūṉṟu) 311

39 Asking for What You Want **313**
39.1 வேண்டும் (vēṇḍum) 313
39.2 எவ்வளவு (evvaḷavu) 315
39.3 ஒரு (oru) 317
39.4 ஒன்று (oṉṟu) 319

40 Pointing, and Asking **321**
40.1 இது (idu) 321
40.2 அது (adu) 322
40.3 இங்கே (iṅgē) 323
40.4 அங்கே (aṅgē) 324
40.5 யார் (yār) 325

40.6 எங்கே (eṅgē) . . . 326
40.7 i- / a- / e- . . . 327

41 Describing Things 329
41.1 பெரிய (periya) . . . 329
41.2 சிறிய (siṟiya) . . . 330
41.3 நல்ல (nalla) . . . 331
41.4 புதிய (pudiya) . . . 332
41.5 பழைய (paḻaiya) . . . 333
41.6 before the noun, unchanged . . . 334

42 More Everyday Verbs 337
42.1 வா (vā) . . . 337
42.2 உட்கார் (uṭkār) . . . 338
42.3 படி (paṭi) . . . 339
42.4 கொடு (koṭu) . . . 340

43 The Household 343
43.1 குழந்தை (kuḻandai) . . . 343
43.2 மகன் (makaṉ) . . . 344
43.3 மகள் (makaḷ) . . . 345
43.4 குடும்பம் (kuṭumbam) . . . 346

44 Things You Ask For 349
44.1 பழம் (paḻam) . . . 349
44.2 துணி (tuṇi) . . . 350
44.3 விளக்கு (viḷakku) . . . 351
44.4 உப்பு (uppu) . . . 353
44.5 புத்தகம் (puttakam) . . . 354

45 More of the Body 355
45.1 கண் (kaṇ) . . . 355
45.2 காது (kādu) . . . 356
45.3 மூக்கு (mūkku) . . . 357
45.4 பல் (pal) . . . 358
45.5 வயிறு (vayiṟu) . . . 359

46 Who Somebody Is 361
46.1 ஆசிரியர் (āsiriyar) . . . 361
46.2 மாணவன் (māṇavaṉ) . . . 362
46.3 மருத்துவர் (maruttuvar) . . . 363

46.4 விவசாயி (vivasāyi) 364
46.5 விருந்தாளி (viruntāḷi) 365

47 Short Replies 369
47.1 உண்மை (uṇmai) 369
47.2 போதும் (pōdum) 370
47.3 நிச்சயமாக (niccayamāka) 371
47.4 ஒருவேளை (oruvēḷai) 372
47.5 அப்படியே (appaḍiyē) 373

48 Setting Out 375
48.1 இப்போது (ippōdu) 375
48.2 நேரம் (nēram) 376
48.3 பயணம் (payaṇam) 377
48.4 பிறகு (piṟaku) 378
48.5 புறப்படு (puṟappaḍu) 379

49 Courtesy 383
49.1 அன்பு (aṉbu) 383
49.2 மரியாதை (mariyādai) 384
49.3 சந்தோஷம் (santōṣam) 385
49.4 வாழ்த்து (vāḻttu) 386
49.5 மிக்க நன்றி (mikka naṉṟi) 387

50 At the Doorway 389
50.1 வாசல் (vāsal) 389
50.2 கோலம் (kōlam) 390
50.3 மலர் (malar) 391
50.4 வெற்றிலை (veṟṟilai) 392
50.5 வரவேற்பு (varavēṟpu) 393

51 Overhead 395
51.1 ஆகாயம் (ākāyam) 395
51.2 சூரியன் (sūriyaṉ) 396
51.3 நிலா (nilā) 397
51.4 விண்மீன் (viṇmīṉ) 398
51.5 மேகம் (mēkam) 400

52 A Tree **401**
52.1 மரம் (maram) 401
52.2 கிளை (kiḷai) 402
52.3 தளிர் (taḷir) 403
52.4 வேர் (vēr) 404
52.5 விதை (vitai) 405

53 The Land **407**
53.1 நதி (nadi) 407
53.2 மலை (malai) 408
53.3 வயல் (vayal) 409
53.4 பாதை (pātai) 410
53.5 கிராமம் (kirāmam) 411

54 Things in the House **413**
54.1 பாய் (pāy) 413
54.2 கூடை (kūṭai) 414
54.3 கத்தி (katti) 415
54.4 கிண்ணம் (kiṇṇam) 416
54.5 பெட்டி (peṭṭi) 417

55 The Rest of You **419**
55.1 கழுத்து (kaḻuttu) 419
55.2 முதுகு (mutuku) 420
55.3 உதடு (utaṭu) 421
55.4 நகம் (nakam) 422
55.5 எலும்பு (elumbu) 424

56 How Much **427**
56.1 சிறிது (siṟitu) 427
56.2 நிறைய (niṟaiya) 428
56.3 குறைவு (kuṟaivu) 429
56.4 தேவையில்லை (tēvaiyillai) 430
56.5 ஆகட்டும் (ākaṭṭum) 431

57 Wind and Fire **433**
57.1 காற்று (kāṟṟu) 433
57.2 மணல் (maṇal) 434
57.3 சேறு (sēṟu) 435
57.4 புகை (pukai) 436

57.5 கனல் (kaṉal) 437

58 Around the Yard **439**
58.1 பசு (pasu) 439
58.2 ஆடு (āṭu) 440
58.3 கோழி (kōḻi) 441
58.4 காக்கை (kākkai) 443
58.5 பறவை (paṟavai) 444

59 In the Kitchen **447**
59.1 தயிர் (tayir) 447
59.2 நெய் (ney) 448
59.3 எண்ணெய் (eṇṇey) 449
59.4 வெல்லம் (vellam) 450
59.5 சர்க்கரை (sarkkarai) 452

60 Things People Make **453**
60.1 ஊசி (ūsi) 453
60.2 கயிறு (kayiṟu) 454
60.3 குடை (kuṭai) 455
60.4 துடைப்பம் (tuṭaippam) 456
60.5 சீப்பு (sīppu) 458

61 How the Body Feels **461**
61.1 பசி (pasi) 461
61.2 தாகம் (tākam) 462
61.3 தூக்கம் (tūkkam) 463
61.4 காய்ச்சல் (kāyccal) 464
61.5 வலி (vali) 465

62 Only and Still **467**
62.1 மட்டும் (maṭṭum) 467
62.2 இன்னும் (iṉṉum) 468
62.3 சீக்கிரம் (sīkkiram) 469
62.4 உடனே (uṭaṉē) 470
62.5 முதலில் (mutalil) 471

63 Asking Well **473**
63.1 வேண்டுகோள் (vēṇḍukōḷ) 473
63.2 அனுமதி (aṉumati) 474
63.3 தயக்கம் (tayakkam) 475

63.4 நம்பிக்கை (nambikkai) 476
63.5 பணிவு (paṇivu) 478

64 The Harvest **479**
64.1 நெல் (nel) 479
64.2 புல் (pul) 480
64.3 பயிர் (payir) 481
64.4 களம் (kaḷam) 482
64.5 அறுவடை (aṟuvaṭai) 484

65 Doing, and Undoing **487**
65.1 குடி (kuḍi) 487
65.2 நட (naḍa) 488
65.3 குடி (kuḍi) 490
65.4 நிறுத்து (niṟuttu) 491
65.5 திற (tiṟa) 492
65.6 மூடு (mūḍu) 493
65.7 Practice 494

66 Which Way **497**
66.1 மேலே (mēlē) 497
66.2 கீழே (kīḻē) 498
66.3 மேலே (mēlē) 499
66.4 உள்ளே (uḷḷē) 501
66.5 வெளியே (veḷiyē) 502
66.6 வலது (valadu) 504
66.7 இடது (iḍadu) 505
66.8 Practice 506

67 What You Wear **509**
67.1 சட்டை (saṭṭai) 509
67.2 வேட்டி (vēṭṭi) 510
67.3 சட்டை (saṭṭai) 511
67.4 புடவை (puḍavai) 513
67.5 செருப்பு (seruppu) 514
67.6 தொப்பி (toppi) 515

68 At the Shop **517**
68.1 கடை (kaḍai) 517
68.2 விலை (vilai) 518

68.3 கடை (kaḍai) 519
68.4 பணம் (paṇam) 521
68.5 வாங்கு (vāṅgu) 522
68.6 பை (pai) 523

69 Getting There **525**
69.1 வண்டி (vaṇḍi) 525
69.2 பேருந்து (pērundu) 526
69.3 வண்டி (vaṇḍi) 527
69.4 ரயில் (rayil) 528
69.5 சாலை (sālai) 530
69.6 நிலையம் (nilaiyam) 531

70 The Room You Are In **533**
70.1 மேசை (mēsai) 533
70.2 கட்டில் (kaṭṭil) 534
70.3 மேசை (mēsai) 535
70.4 சுவர் (suvar) 537
70.5 தரை (tarai) 538
70.6 கூரை (kūrai) 539

71 Through the Day **541**
71.1 எழு (eḻu) 541
71.2 தூங்கு (tūṅgu) 542
71.3 ஓ (ō) 543
71.4 ஓடு (ōḍu) 545
71.5 கழுவு (kaḻuvu) 546
71.6 விளையாடு (viḷaiyāḍu) 547

72 How It Feels **549**
72.1 கோபம் (kōpam) 549
72.2 பயம் (payam) 550
72.3 பயம் (payam) 551
72.4 வருத்தம் (varuttam) 553
72.5 சிரி (siri) 554
72.6 அழு (aḻu) 555

73 Today, Yesterday, and the Year **559**
73.1 இன்று (inṟu) 559
73.2 நேற்று (nēṟṟu) 560

73.3 இன்று (in̲ṟu) 561
73.4 முன்பு (mu̲n̲bu) 562
73.5 மாதம் (mādam) 564
73.6 ஆண்டு (āṇḍu) 565

74 And, and Also **567**
74.1 -உம் … -உம் (-um … -um) 567
74.2 -உம் (-um) 568
74.3 பாலும் (pālum) 569
74.4 -உம் … -உம் இல்லை (-um … -um illai) 570

75 Yes or No **573**
75.1 -ஆ (-ā) 573
75.2 ஆம் / இல்லை (ām / illai) 574
75.3 சரியா (sariyā) 576
75.4 நான் உள்ளே வரலாமா? (nā̲n̲ uḷḷē varalāmā?) . . . 577

76 But, and Or **581**
76.1 ஆனால் (ā̲n̲āl) 581
76.2 அல்லது (alladu) 583
76.3 ஆனால் (ā̲n̲āl) 584
76.4 பால் வேண்டுமா … (pāl vēṇḍumā …) 586

77 Saying, and Thinking **589**
77.1 சொல் (sol) 589
77.2 என்று (en̲̲ṟu) 590
77.3 சொல் (sol) 592
77.4 … என்று நினைக்கிறேன் (… en̲̲ṟu nin̲aikkir̲ēn̲) . . . 593

78 Why, and Because **597**
78.1 ஏன் (ēn̲) 597
78.2 ஏனென்றால் (ēn̲en̲̲ṟāl) 599
78.3 ஏன் (ēn̲) 600
78.4 அதனால் (adan̲āl) 602
78.5 -க்காக (-kkāga) 603

79 When **605**
79.1 எப்போது (eppōdu) 605
79.2 அப்போது (appōdu) 606
79.3 எப்போது (eppōdu) 608
79.4 -உம் போது (-um pōdu) 609

80 One, the Other, and the Price 611
80.1 மற்றது (marradu) 611
80.2 ஒன்று … மற்றது (onru … marradu) 613
80.3 மற்றது (marradu) 614
80.4 விலை எவ்வளவு? (vilai evvaḷavu?) 615

81 Two Tamils 617
81.1 ஆனால் / ஆனா (ānāl / ānā) 617
81.2 என்று / -ன்னு (enru / -nnu) 618

82 Which One in the Line 621
82.1 முதல் (mutal) 621
82.2 இரண்டாவது (iraṇḍāvadu) 623
82.3 முதலாவது (mutalāvadu) 624
82.4 மூன்றாவது (mūnrāvadu) 626
82.5 நான்காவது (nāṉkāvadu) 627
82.6 ஐந்தாவது (aindāvadu) 628

83 All the Way Up, and On a Calendar 631
83.1 ஆறாவது (ārāvadu) 631
83.2 ஏழாவது (ēḻāvadu) 632
83.3 எட்டாவது (eṭṭāvadu) 633
83.4 ஒன்பதாவது (onpadāvadu) 634
83.5 பத்தாவது (pattāvadu) 635
83.6 பதினொன்றாவது (patiṉonrāvadu) 637
83.7 தேதி (tēdi) 638
83.8 Practice 639

84 Reading — Words, Lines, and a First Passage 641
84.1 (reading) 641
84.2 (reading) 642
84.3 (reading) 643
84.4 (twelve consonants, four confusable … 644
84.5 (three vowels, five signs, one dot) 645
84.6 (seven words you learned to read … 647
84.7 (உ ஊ ு ூ — and the two that open o) 648

85 The People Not Here 651
85.1 அவன் / அவள் (avaṉ / avaḷ) 651
85.2 அவர்கள் (avarkaḷ) 653

85.3 நாம் / நாங்கள் (nām / nāṅgaḷ) 654
85.4 (the people not here) 656
85.5 (வணக்கம், நன்றி, சரி — and the how-are-you) . . 657
85.6 (உங்கள் பெயர் என்ன?) 658
85.7 (போய் வருகிறேன் — and the first four … 660

86 The One It Is Done To 663
86.1 -ஐ (-ai) 663
86.2 என்னை / உன்னை (enn̲ai / unn̲ai) 665
86.3 தேநீர் / தேநீரை (tēnīr / tēnīrai) 666
86.4 (the one it is done to) 668
86.5 (இவர், விடை, and the two we-words) 669
86.6 (the fifteen that came once) 670

87 Not Feeling Well 673
87.1 களைப்பு (kaḷaippu) 673
87.2 சளி (caḷi) 674
87.3 இருமல் (irumal) 675
87.4 சோர்வு (cōrvu) 676
87.5 ஓய்வு (ōyvu) 677

88 At the Hospital 679
88.1 மருத்துவமனை (maruttuvaman̲ai) 679
88.2 வாந்தி (vānti) 680
88.3 தலைவலி (talaivali) 681
88.4 உடல்நலம் (uṭalnalam) 682
88.5 வியர்வை (viyarvai) 683

89 Sad, Worried, Calm 685
89.1 சோகம் (cōkam) 685
89.2 கவலை (kavalai) 686
89.3 பதற்றம் (patar̲r̲am) 687
89.4 அமைதி (amaiti) 688
89.5 நடுக்கம் (naṭukkam) 689

90 Laughter and Tears 691
90.1 சிரிப்பு (sirippu) 691
90.2 அழுகை (aḻukai) 692
90.3 கண்ணீர் (kaṇṇīr) 693
90.4 தனியாக (taṉiyāka) 694

90.5 பசிக்கிறது (pasikkiṟatu) 695

91 Sun, Heat, and Sleep 697
91.1 வெயில் (veyil) 697
91.2 சூடு (cūṭu) 698
91.3 தூக்கம் வருகிறது (tūkkam varukiṟatu) 699
91.4 நன்றாக (naṉṟāka) 700

92 Slowly, Again, Louder 703
92.1 மெதுவாக (metuvāka) 703
92.2 மறுபடியும் (maṟupaṭiyum) 704
92.3 சத்தமாக (cattamāka) 705
92.4 ஒரு நிமிடம் (oru nimiṭam) 706
92.5 காத்திருங்கள் (kāttiruṅkaḷ) 708

93 How Do You Say It? 711
93.1 அர்த்தம் (arttam) 711
93.2 தமிழில் (tamiḻil) 712
93.3 எப்படிச் சொல்வது? (eppaṭic colvatu?) 713
93.4 காட்டுங்கள் (kāṭṭuṅkaḷ) 714
93.5 கேட்கவில்லை (kēṭkavillai) 715

94 When You Are Lost 717
94.1 புரியவில்லை (puriyavillai) 717
94.2 எழுதுங்கள் (eḻutuṅkaḷ) 718
94.3 இன்னொரு முறை (iṉṉoru muṟai) 719
94.4 என்ன சொன்னீர்கள்? (eṉṉa coṉṉīrkaḷ?) 720

95 Exactly, Really, Nothing 723
95.1 சரியாக (cariyāka) 723
95.2 உண்மையா? (uṇmaiyā?) 724
95.3 ஒன்றுமில்லை (oṉṟumillai) 725
95.4 இன்னும் இல்லை (iṉṉum illai) 726
95.5 அதே (atē) 727

96 Not at All, Is That So? 729
96.1 இல்லவே இல்லை (illavē illai) 729
96.2 அப்படியா? (appaṭiyā?) 730
96.3 அடடா (aṭaṭā) 731
96.4 சரிதான் (caritāṉ) 732
96.5 தெரியாது (teriyātu) 733

97 Definitely, and Why Not **735**
97.1 கண்டிப்பாக (kaṇṭippāka) 735
97.2 அப்படித்தான் (appaṭittāṉ) 736
97.3 ஏன் இல்லை? (ēṉ illai?) 737

98 Come, Eat, Drink **739**
98.1 வாழ்த்துகள் (vāḻttukaḷ) 739
98.2 அழைப்பு (aḻaippu) 740
98.3 பரிசு (paricu) 741
98.4 வாருங்கள் (vāruṅkaḷ) 742
98.5 சாப்பிடுங்கள் (cāppiṭuṅkaḷ) 743

99 Gifts, Welcomes, Apologies **745**
99.1 குடியுங்கள் (kuṭiyuṅkaḷ) 745
99.2 அன்பளிப்பு (aṉpaḷippu) 746
99.3 நல்வரவு (nalvaravu) 747
99.4 மன்னித்துவிடுங்கள் (maṉṉittuviṭuṅkaḷ) 748
99.5 கவலைப்படாதீர்கள் (kavalaippaṭātīrkaḷ) 749

100 Children, Husbands, Wives **751**
100.1 குழந்தைகள் (kuḻantaikaḷ) 751
100.2 பையன் (paiyaṉ) 752
100.3 கணவர் (kaṇavar) 753
100.4 மனைவி (maṉaivi) 754
100.5 உறவினர் (uṟaviṉar) 755

101 Grandparents, Aunts and Uncles **757**
101.1 தாத்தா (tāttā) 757
101.2 பாட்டி (pāṭṭi) 758
101.3 மாமா (māmā) 759
101.4 அத்தை (attai) 760
101.5 சித்தப்பா (cittappā) 761

102 Elders and In-Laws **763**
102.1 பெரியப்பா (periyappā) 763
102.2 பெரியம்மா (periyammā) 764
102.3 மாமியார் (māmiyār) 765
102.4 மருமகள் (marumakaḷ) 766
102.5 மருமகன் (marumakaṉ) 767

103 Grandchildren, Neighbours, Names **769**
103.1 பேரன் (pēraṉ) 769
103.2 பேத்தி (pētti) 770
103.3 பக்கத்து வீட்டுக்காரர் (pakkattu vīṭṭukkārar) . . . 771
103.4 குடும்பப் பெயர் (kuṭumpap peyar) 772
103.5 செல்லப்பெயர் (cellappeyar) 773

104 Language, Wedding, Birthday **775**
104.1 மொழி (moḻi) 775
104.2 ஆங்கிலம் (āṅkilam) 776
104.3 திருமணம் (tirumaṇam) 777
104.4 முகவரி (mukavari) 778
104.5 பிறந்தநாள் (piṟantanāḷ) 779

105 Signature, Work, School **781**
105.1 கையெழுத்து (kaiyeḻuttu) 781
105.2 தொழில் (toḻil) 782
105.3 கல்லூரி (kallūri) 783
105.4 பள்ளி (paḷḷi) 784

106 Take Care, Go Safely **787**
106.1 பார்த்துக்கொள்ளுங்கள் (pārttukkoḷḷuṅkaḷ) 787
106.2 பத்திரமாக (pattiramāka) 788
106.3 நேரமாகிவிட்டது (nēramākiviṭṭatu) 789
106.4 போகலாம் (pōkalām) 790
106.5 விடுமுறை (viṭumuṟai) 791

107 See You Later **793**
107.1 விடைபெறுகிறேன் (viṭaipeṟukiṟēṉ) 793
107.2 கிளம்பலாமா? (kiḷampalāmā?) 794
107.3 அப்புறம் பார்க்கலாம் (appuṟam pārkkalām) 795
107.4 இனிய பயணம் (iṉiya payaṇam) 796
107.5 மீண்டும் வாருங்கள் (mīṇṭum vāruṅkaḷ) 797

108 Greetings People Actually Say **799**
108.1 சாப்பிட்டீர்களா? (cāppiṭṭīrkaḷā?) 799
108.2 ரொம்ப நாளாச்சு (rompa nāḷāccu) 800
108.3 என்ன விசேஷம்? (eṉṉa vicēṣam?) 801
108.4 நல்லா இருக்கீங்களா? (nallā irukkīṅkaḷā?) 802
108.5 எப்படி இருக்கீங்க? (eppaṭi irukkīṅka?) 804

108.6 (dialogue) . . . 805
108.7 (dialogue) . . . 806

109 Letters From Your First Words 807
109.1 இ (i) . . . 807
109.2 ை (ai) . . . 809
109.3 ஸ (sa) . . . 811

110 Letters From You and Your Name 813
110.1 ங (ṅa) . . . 813
110.2 ள (ḷa) . . . 815
110.3 ீ (ī) . . . 816
110.4 ெ (e) . . . 818

111 Letters From Counting 821
111.1 ஐ (ai) . . . 821
111.2 ூ (ū) . . . 823
111.3 ஏ (ē) . . . 824

112 Letters From Days, Towns and Gladness 827
112.1 ஞ (ña) . . . 827
112.2 ஊ (ū) . . . 829
112.3 ஒ (o) . . . 831
112.4 ஷ (ṣa) . . . 832
112.5 (fourteen letters) . . . 834
112.6 (fourteen letters) . . . 835

113 Straight ahead, Near, Distance, Behind, In front 837
113.1 நேராக (nērāka) . . . 837
113.2 அருகில் (arukil) . . . 838
113.3 தூரம் (tūram) . . . 839
113.4 பின்னால் (piṉṉāl) . . . 840
113.5 முன்னால் (muṉṉāl) . . . 841

114 In the middle, Street, Bridge, Park, Temple 843
114.1 நடுவில் (naṭuvil) . . . 843
114.2 தெரு (teru) . . . 844
114.3 பாலம் (pālam) . . . 845
114.4 பூங்கா (pūṅkā) . . . 846
114.5 கோயில் (kōyil) . . . 847

115 Library, Bank, Market, Beach, Office **849**
115.1 நூலகம் (nūlakam) 849
115.2 வங்கி (vaṅki) 850
115.3 சந்தை (cantai) 851
115.4 கடற்கரை (kaṭaṟkarai) 852
115.5 அலுவலகம் (aluvalakam) 853

116 Garden, Corner, Turn, Can, Skill **855**
116.1 தோட்டம் (tōṭṭam) 855
116.2 மூலை (mūlai) 856
116.3 திருப்பம் (tiruppam) 857
116.4 முடியும் (muṭiyum) 858
116.5 திறமை (tiṟamai) 859

117 Ability, Right, Chance, Tool, Possession **861**
117.1 வல்லமை (vallamai) 861
117.2 உரிமை (urimai) 862
117.3 வாய்ப்பு (vāyppu) 863
117.4 கருவி (karuvi) 864
117.5 உடைமை (uṭaimai) 865

118 Stove, Vessel, Plate, Cup, Spoon **867**
118.1 அடுப்பு (aṭuppu) 867
118.2 பாத்திரம் (pāttiram) 868
118.3 தட்டு (taṭṭu) 869
118.4 கோப்பை (kōppai) 870
118.5 கரண்டி (karaṇṭi) 871

119 Key, Lock, Towel, Pillow, Blanket **873**
119.1 சாவி (cāvi) 873
119.2 பூட்டு (pūṭṭu) 874
119.3 துண்டு (tuṇṭu) 875
119.4 தலையணை (talaiyaṇai) 876
119.5 போர்வை (pōrvai) 877

120 Mirror, Soap, Bucket, Pen, Paper **879**
120.1 கண்ணாடி (kaṇṇāṭi) 879
120.2 சோப்பு (cōppu) 880
120.3 வாளி (vāḷi) 881
120.4 பேனா (pēṉā) 882

120.5 காகிதம் (kāgitam) 883

121 Clock, Skirt, Sari, Lentils, Curry 885
121.1 கடிகாரம் (kaṭikāram) 885
121.2 பாவாடை (pāvāṭai) 886
121.3 சேலை (cēlai) 887
121.4 பருப்பு (paruppu) 888
121.5 குழம்பு (kuḻambu) 889
121.6 (dialogue) 890
121.7 (dialogue) 891

122 Rasam, Butter, Egg, Fish, Meat 893
122.1 ரசம் (rasam) 893
122.2 வெண்ணெய் (veṇṇey) 894
122.3 முட்டை (muṭṭai) 895
122.4 மீன் (mīṉ) 896
122.5 இறைச்சி (iṟaicci) 897

123 Vegetables, Banana, Mango, Coconut, Onion 899
123.1 காய்கறி (kāykaṟi) 899
123.2 வாழைப்பழம் (vāḻaippaḻam) 900
123.3 மாம்பழம் (māmpaḻam) 901
123.4 தேங்காய் (tēṅkāy) 902
123.5 வெங்காயம் (veṅkāyam) 903

124 Tomato, Chilli, Ginger, Garlic, Honey 905
124.1 தக்காளி (takkāḷi) 905
124.2 மிளகாய் (milakāy) 906
124.3 இஞ்சி (iñci) 907
124.4 பூண்டு (pūṇṭu) 908
124.5 தேன் (tēṉ) 909

125 Idli, Dosa, Vadai, Coffee, Sea 911
125.1 இட்லி (iṭli) 911
125.2 தோசை (tōcai) 912
125.3 வடை (vaṭai) 913
125.4 காபி (kāpi) 914
125.5 கடல் (kaṭal) 915

126 Lake, Pond, Forest, Leaf, Soil **917**
126.1 ஏரி (ēri) 917
126.2 குளம் (kuḷam) 918
126.3 காடு (kāṭu) 919
126.4 இலை (ilai) 920
126.5 மண் (maṇ) 921

127 Star, Dew, Thunder, Lightning, Storm **923**
127.1 நட்சத்திரம் (naṭcattiram) 923
127.2 பனி (paṉi) 924
127.3 இடி (iṭi) 925
127.4 மின்னல் (miṉṉal) 926
127.5 புயல் (puyal) 927

128 Wave, Buffalo, Horse, Elephant, Tiger **929**
128.1 அலை (alai) 929
128.2 எருமை (erumai) 930
128.3 குதிரை (kutirai) 931
128.4 யானை (yāṉai) 932
128.5 புலி (puli) 933

129 Lion, Bear, Monkey, Rabbit, Deer **935**
129.1 சிங்கம் (ciṅkam) 935
129.2 கரடி (karaṭi) 936
129.3 குரங்கு (kuraṅku) 937
129.4 முயல் (muyal) 938
129.5 மான் (māṉ) 939

130 Fox, Snake, Rat, Frog, Tortoise **941**
130.1 நரி (nari) 941
130.2 பாம்பு (pāmpu) 942
130.3 எலி (eli) 943
130.4 தவளை (tavaḷai) 944
130.5 ஆமை (āmai) 945
130.6 (dialogue) 946
130.7 (dialogue) 947

131 Parrot, Pigeon, Owl, Peacock, Ant **949**
131.1 கிளி (kiḷi) 949
131.2 புறா (puṟā) 950

131.3 ஆந்தை (āntai) 951
131.4 மயில் (mayil) 952
131.5 எறும்பு (eṟumpu) 953

132 Mosquito, Face, Mouth, Tongue, Finger 955
132.1 கொசு (kocu) 955
132.2 முகம் (mukam) 956
132.3 வாய் (vāy) 957
132.4 நாக்கு (nākku) 958
132.5 விரல் (viral) 959

133 Shoulder, Chest, Knee, Hair, Skin 961
133.1 தோள் (tōḷ) 961
133.2 மார்பு (mārpu) 962
133.3 முழங்கால் (muḻaṅkāl) 963
133.4 முடி (muṭi) 964
133.5 தோல் (tōl) 965

134 Curtain, Mattress, Television, Mobile phone, Computer 967
134.1 திரைச்சீலை (tiraiccīlai) 967
134.2 மெத்தை (mettai) 968
134.3 தொலைக்காட்சி (tolaikkāṭci) 969
134.4 கைப்பேசி (kaippēci) 970
134.5 கணினி (kaṇiṉi) 971

135 Electric fan, Scissors, Hammer, Nail, Ladder 973
135.1 மின்விசிறி (miṉviciṟi) 973
135.2 கத்தரிக்கோல் (kattarikkōl) 974
135.3 சுத்தியல் (cuttiyal) 975
135.4 ஆணி (āṇi) 976
135.5 ஏணி (ēṇi) 977

136 Bottle, Ball, Kite, Doll, Purse 979
136.1 குப்பி (kuppi) 979
136.2 பந்து (pantu) 980
136.3 பட்டம் (paṭṭam) 981
136.4 பொம்மை (pommai) 982
136.5 பணப்பை (paṇappai) 983

137 Ring, Bangle, Sock, Glove, Class **985**
137.1 மோதிரம் (mōtiram) 985
137.2 வளையல் (vaḷaiyal) 986
137.3 காலுறை (kāluṟai) 987
137.4 கையுறை (kaiyuṟai) 988
137.5 வகுப்பு (vakuppu) 989

138 Exam, Answer, Tamarind, Pepper, Mustard seed **991**
138.1 தேர்வு (tērvu) 991
138.2 பதில் (patil) 992
138.3 புளி (puḷi) 993
138.4 மிளகு (miḷaku) 994
138.5 கடுகு (kaṭuku) 995

139 Cumin, Leafy greens, Jackfruit, Guava, Lemon **997**
139.1 சீரகம் (cīrakam) 997
139.2 கீரை (kīrai) 998
139.3 பலாப்பழம் (palāppaḻam) 999
139.4 கொய்யா (koyyā) 1000
139.5 எலுமிச்சை (elumiccai) 1001
139.6 (dialogue) 1002
139.7 (dialogue) 1002

140 Grapes, Pomegranate, Pickle, Waterfall, Hill **1005**
140.1 திராட்சை (tirāṭcai) 1005
140.2 மாதுளை (mātuḷai) 1006
140.3 ஊறுகாய் (ūṟukāy) 1007
140.4 அருவி (aruvi) 1008
140.5 குன்று (kuṉṟu) 1009

141 Island, Insect, Spider, Pig, Donkey **1011**
141.1 தீவு (tīvu) 1011
141.2 பூச்சி (pūcci) 1012
141.3 சிலந்தி (cilanti) 1013
141.4 பன்றி (paṉṟi) 1014
141.5 கழுதை (kaḻutai) 1015

142 Camel, Duck, Cheek, Wrist, Elbow **1017**
142.1 ஒட்டகம் (ottakam) 1017
142.2 வாத்து (vāttu) 1018

142.3 கன்னம் (kaṉṉam) 1019
142.4 மணிக்கட்டு (maṇikkaṭṭu) 1020
142.5 முழங்கை (muḻaṅkai) 1021

143 Thumb, Bad, Beautiful, Long, Short 1023
143.1 கட்டைவிரல் (kaṭṭaiviral) 1023
143.2 கெட்ட (keṭṭa) 1024
143.3 அழகான (aḻakāṉa) 1025
143.4 நீளமான (nīḷamāṉa) 1026
143.5 குட்டையான (kuṭṭaiyāṉa) 1027

144 Tall, Hot, Cold, Heavy, Light 1029
144.1 உயரமான (uyaramāṉa) 1029
144.2 சூடான (cūṭāṉa) 1030
144.3 குளிர்ந்த (kuḷirnta) 1031
144.4 கனமான (kaṉamāṉa) 1032
144.5 லேசான (lēcāṉa) 1033

145 Soft, Hard, Clean, Dirty, Fast 1035
145.1 மென்மையான (meṉmaiyāṉa) 1035
145.2 கடினமான (kaṭiṉamāṉa) 1036
145.3 சுத்தமான (cuttamāṉa) 1037
145.4 அழுக்கான (aḻukkāṉa) 1038
145.5 வேகமான (vēkamāṉa) 1039

146 Bitter, Sour, Spicy, Rich, Poor 1041
146.1 கசப்பு (kacappu) 1041
146.2 புளிப்பு (puḷippu) 1042
146.3 காரம் (kāram) 1043
146.4 பணக்கார (paṇakkāra) 1044
146.5 ஏழை (ēḻai) 1045

147 Young, Old, Clever, Lazy, Brave 1047
147.1 இளைய (iḷaiya) 1047
147.2 வயதான (vayatāṉa) 1048
147.3 புத்திசாலி (putticāli) 1049
147.4 சோம்பேறி (cōmpēṟi) 1050
147.5 தைரியமான (tairiyamāṉa) 1051

148 Deep, Wide, Narrow, Dry, Wet **1053**
148.1 ஆழமான (āḻamāṉa) 1053
148.2 அகலமான (akalamāṉa) 1054
148.3 குறுகிய (kuṟukiya) 1055
148.4 காய்ந்த (kāynta) 1056
148.5 நனைந்த (naṉainta) 1057
148.6 (dialogue) 1058
148.7 (dialogue) 1059

149 Famous, Dangerous, Safe, True, False **1061**
149.1 பிரபலமான (pirapalamāṉa) 1061
149.2 ஆபத்தான (āpattāṉa) 1062
149.3 பாதுகாப்பான (pātukāppāṉa) 1063
149.4 உண்மையான (uṇmaiyāṉa) 1064
149.5 பொய்யான (poyyāṉa) 1065

150 Purple, Grey, To sing, To cook, To cut **1067**
150.1 ஊதா (ūtā) 1067
150.2 சாம்பல் (cāmpal) 1068
150.3 பாடு (pāṭu) 1069
150.4 சமை (camai) 1070
150.5 வெட்டு (veṭṭu) 1071

151 To break, To put, To send, To look for, To teach **1073**
151.1 உடை (uṭai) 1073
151.2 வை (vai) 1074
151.3 அனுப்பு (anuppu) 1075
151.4 தேடு (tēṭu) 1076
151.5 கற்பி (kaṟpi) 1077

152 To forget, To jump, To swim, To fly, To fall **1079**
152.1 மற (maṟa) 1079
152.2 குதி (kuti) 1080
152.3 நீந்து (nīntu) 1081
152.4 பற (paṟa) 1082
152.5 விழு (viḻu) 1083

153 To climb, To get down, To turn, To join, To bathe **1085**
153.1 ஏறு (ēṟu) 1085
153.2 இறங்கு (iṟaṅku) 1086

153.3 திரும்பு (tirumpu) 1087
153.4 சேர் (cēr) 1088
153.5 குளி (kuḷi) 1089

154 To wear, To call, To grow, To count, To shout 1091
154.1 அணி (aṇi) 1091
154.2 அழை (aḻai) 1092
154.3 வளர் (vaḷar) 1093
154.4 எண்ணு (eṇṇu) 1094
154.5 கத்து (kattu) 1095

155 To push, To pull, To put, To tie, To wash 1097
155.1 தள்ளு (taḷḷu) 1097
155.2 இழு (iḻu) 1098
155.3 போடு (pōṭu) 1099
155.4 கட்டு (kaṭṭu) 1100
155.5 துவை (tuvai) 1101

156 To wipe, To sweep, To learn, To win, To find 1103
156.1 துடை (tuṭai) 1103
156.2 பெருக்கு (perukku) 1104
156.3 கற்றுக்கொள் (kaṟṟukkoḷ) 1105
156.4 வெல் (vel) 1106
156.5 கண்டுபிடி (kaṇṭupiṭi) 1107

157 To hide, To save, To blow, To burn, To put out 1109
157.1 மறை (maṟai) 1109
157.2 காப்பாற்று (kāppāṟṟu) 1110
157.3 ஊது (ūtu) 1111
157.4 எரி (eri) 1112
157.5 அணை (aṇai) 1113
157.6 (dialogue) 1114
157.7 (dialogue) 1114

158 Recently, Already, Last, Once, To Spend (Time) 1117
158.1 சமீபத்தில் (camīpattil) 1117
158.2 ஏற்கனவே (ēṟkaṉavē) 1118
158.3 போன (pōṉa) 1119
158.4 ஒரு காலத்தில் (oru kālattil) 1120
158.5 கழி (kaḻi) 1121

159 Next, From Now On, a Plan, To Decide, To Expect 1123
159.1 அடுத்த (aṭutta) 1123
159.2 இனிமேல் (iṉimēl) 1124
159.3 திட்டம் (tiṭṭam) 1125
159.4 முடிவு செய் (muṭivu cey) 1126
159.5 எதிர்பார் (etirpār) 1126

160 A Timetable, a Notice, the Rent, an Advert, a Receipt 1129
160.1 கால அட்டவணை (kāla aṭṭavaṇai) 1129
160.2 அறிவிப்பு (aṟivippu) 1130
160.3 வாடகை (vāṭakai) 1131
160.4 விளம்பரம் (viḷamparam) 1132
160.5 ரசீது (racītu) 1133
160.6 (dialogue) 1134
160.7 (dialogue) 1134

161 To sell, To boil, To fry, To grind, To mix 1135
161.1 வில் (vil) 1135
161.2 கொதி (koti) 1136
161.3 வறு (vaṟu) 1137
161.4 அரை (arai) 1137
161.5 கலக்கு (kalakku) 1138

162 To cross, To stay, To go around, To move, To lift 1141
162.1 கட (kaṭa) 1141
162.2 தங்கு (taṅku) 1142
162.3 சுற்று (cuṟṟu) 1143
162.4 நகர் (nakar) 1143
162.5 தூக்கு (tūkku) 1144

163 To prepare, To serve, To share, To bargain, To check 1147
163.1 தயார் செய் (tayār cey) 1147
163.2 பரிமாறு (parimāṟu) 1148
163.3 பகிர் (pakir) 1149
163.4 பேரம் பேசு (pēram pēcu) 1149
163.5 சரிபார் (caripār) 1150

164 To describe, To hand over, To practise, To pass, To pay attention 1153
164.1 விவரி (vivari) 1153

164.2 ஒப்படை (oppaṭai) 1154
164.3 பயிற்சி செய் (payiṟci cey) 1155
164.4 தேர்ச்சி பெறு (tērcci peṟu) 1156
164.5 கவனி (kavaṉi) 1156

165 To get to know, To celebrate, To decorate, To dance, To worship 1159
165.1 பழகு (paḻaku) 1159
165.2 கொண்டாடு (koṇṭāṭu) 1160
165.3 அலங்கரி (alaṅkari) 1161
165.4 நடனமாடு (naṭaṉamāṭu) 1162
165.5 வணங்கு (vaṇaṅku) 1162

166 To light a lamp, To burst, To put up with, To make peace, To consider 1165
166.1 விளக்கேற்று (viḷakkēṟṟu) 1165
166.2 வெடி (veṭi) 1166
166.3 பொறுத்துக்கொள் (poṟuttukkoḷ) 1167
166.4 சமாதானம் செய் (camātāṉam cey) 1168
166.5 யோசி (yōci) 1169

167 To continue, To operate, To stick, To hang, To roll 1171
167.1 தொடர் (toṭar) 1171
167.2 இயக்கு (iyakku) 1172
167.3 ஒட்டு (oṭṭu) 1173
167.4 தொங்கு (toṅku) 1174
167.5 உருட்டு (uruṭṭu) 1174

168 To plough, To dig, To stretch out, To slip, To yawn 1177
168.1 உழு (uḻu) 1177
168.2 தோண்டு (tōṇṭu) 1178
168.3 நீட்டு (nīṭṭu) 1179
168.4 வழுக்கு (vaḻukku) 1179
168.5 கொட்டாவி விடு (koṭṭāvi viṭu) 1180

169 Ankle, Waist, Throat, Heart, Blood 1183
169.1 கணுக்கால் (kaṇukkāl) 1183
169.2 இடுப்பு (iṭuppu) 1184
169.3 தொண்டை (toṇṭai) 1185
169.4 இதயம் (itayam) 1185

169.5 இரத்தம் (irattam) 1186
169.6 (dialogue) 1187
169.7 (dialogue) 1188

170 Allergy, Infection, Scar, Diarrhoea, Brain 1191
170.1 ஒவ்வாமை (ovvāmai) 1191
170.2 தொற்று (to͟r͟ru) 1192
170.3 தழும்பு (ta͟lumpu) 1193
170.4 வயிற்றுப்போக்கு (vaẏi͟r͟ruppōkku) 1194
170.5 மூளை (mūḷai) 1194

171 Often, Sometimes, Always, Never, Delay 1197
171.1 அடிக்கடி (aṭikkaṭi) 1197
171.2 சில நேரங்களில் (cila nēraṅkaḷil) 1198
171.3 எப்போதும் (eppōtum) 1199
171.4 ஒருபோதும் (orupōtum) 1200
171.5 தாமதம் (tāmatam) 1200

172 Future, Tonight, Suddenly, In advance, Calendar 1203
172.1 எதிர்காலம் (etirkālam) 1203
172.2 இன்றிரவு (i͟n͟riravu) 1204
172.3 திடீரென்று (tiṭīre͟n͟ru) 1205
172.4 முன்கூட்டியே (mu͟n͟kūṭṭiyē) 1206
172.5 நாட்காட்டி (nāṭkāṭṭi) 1206

173 Kitchen, Bathroom, Bedroom, Toilet, Window 1209
173.1 சமையலறை (camaiyala͟r͟ai) 1209
173.2 குளியலறை (kuḷiyala͟r͟ai) 1210
173.3 படுக்கையறை (paṭukkaiya͟r͟ai) 1211
173.4 கழிப்பறை (ka͟lippa͟r͟ai) 1212
173.5 சன்னல் (ca͟n͟nal) 1212

174 Boat, Bicycle, Car, Auto-rickshaw, Passenger 1215
174.1 படகு (paṭaku) 1215
174.2 மிதிவண்டி (mitivaṇṭi) 1216
174.3 கார் (kār) 1217
174.4 ஆட்டோ (āṭṭō) 1217
174.5 பயணி (payaṇi) 1218

175 Desert, Cave, Stream, Farm, Zoo 1221
175.1 பாலைவனம் (pālaivaṉam) 1221
175.2 குகை (kukai) 1222
175.3 ஓடை (ōṭai) 1223
175.4 பண்ணை (paṇṇai) 1223
175.5 மிருகக்காட்சிசாலை (mirukakkāṭcicālai) 1224

176 However, Even though, Moreover, For example, Otherwise 1227
176.1 ஆனாலும் (āṉālum) 1227
176.2 இருந்தாலும் (iruntālum) 1228
176.3 மேலும் (mēlum) 1229
176.4 உதாரணமாக (utāraṇamāka) 1230
176.5 இல்லாவிட்டால் (illāviṭṭāl) 1230

177 Result, Problem, Solution, Purpose, Experience 1233
177.1 விளைவு (viḷaivu) 1233
177.2 பிரச்சினை (piracciṉai) 1234
177.3 தீர்வு (tīrvu) 1235
177.4 நோக்கம் (nōkkam) 1236
177.5 அனுபவம் (aṉupavam) 1236

178 Tasty, Cheap, Expensive, Free of charge, Ripe 1239
178.1 சுவையான (cuvaiyāṉa) 1239
178.2 மலிவான (malivāṉa) 1240
178.3 விலையுயர்ந்த (vilaiyuyarnta) 1241
178.4 இலவசம் (ilavacam) 1242
178.5 பழுத்த (paḻutta) 1242
178.6 (dialogue) 1243
178.7 (dialogue) 1244

179 Useful, Local, Foreign, Clear, Feeling 1247
179.1 பயனுள்ள (payaṉuḷḷa) 1247
179.2 உள்ளூர் (uḷḷūr) 1248
179.3 வெளிநாட்டு (veḷināṭṭu) 1249
179.4 தெளிவான (teḷivāṉa) 1249
179.5 உணர்ச்சி (uṇarcci) 1250

180 Active, Naughty, Stubborn, Funny, Interesting 1253
180.1 சுறுசுறுப்பான (cuṟucuṟuppāṉa) 1253
180.2 குறும்பான (kuṟumpāṉa) 1254
180.3 பிடிவாதமான (piṭivātamāṉa) 1255
180.4 நகைச்சுவையான (nakaiccuvaiyāṉa) 1256
180.5 சுவாரசியமான (cuvāraciyamāṉa) 1256

181 Favourite, Terrible, Many, Everything, Thick 1259
181.1 பிடித்தமான (piṭittamāṉa) 1259
181.2 மோசமான (mōcamāṉa) 1260
181.3 பல (pala) 1261
181.4 எல்லாம் (ellām) 1261
181.5 தடிமனான (taṭimaṉāṉa) 1262

182 Refrigerator, Tap, Tumbler, Pan, Lid 1265
182.1 குளிர்சாதனப் பெட்டி (kuḷircātaṉap peṭṭi) 1265
182.2 குழாய் (kuḻāy) 1266
182.3 டம்ளர் (ṭamḷar) 1267
182.4 சட்டி (caṭṭi) 1268
182.5 மூடி (mūṭi) 1268

183 Pongal, Upma, Sambar, Chutney, Dry stir-fried vegetable dish 1271
183.1 பொங்கல் (poṅkal) 1271
183.2 உப்புமா (uppumā) 1272
183.3 சாம்பார் (cāmpār) 1273
183.4 சட்னி (caṭṉi) 1274
183.5 பொரியல் (poriyal) 1275

184 Ice, Breakfast, Lunch, Dinner, Notebook 1277
184.1 பனிக்கட்டி (paṉikkaṭṭi) 1277
184.2 காலை உணவு (kālai uṇavu) 1278
184.3 மதிய உணவு (matiya uṇavu) 1279
184.4 இரவு உணவு (iravu uṇavu) 1280
184.5 குறிப்பேடு (kuṟippēṭu) 1280

185 Queue, Number, Text message, News, Email 1283
185.1 வரிசை (varicai) 1283
185.2 எண் (eṇ) 1284
185.3 குறுஞ்செய்தி (kuṟuñceyti) 1285

185.4 செய்தி (ceyti) 1286
185.5 மின்னஞ்சல் (min̲n̲añcal) 1286

186 Father-in-law, Boyfriend, Girlfriend, Romantic love, Friendship 1289
186.1 மாமனார் (māman̲ār) 1289
186.2 காதலன் (kātalan̲) 1290
186.3 காதலி (kātali) 1291
186.4 காதல் (kātal) 1292
186.5 நட்பு (naṭpu) 1292

187 Pet, Bull, Calf, Wolf, Leopard 1295
187.1 செல்லப்பிராணி (cellappirāṇi) 1295
187.2 காளை (kāḷai) 1296
187.3 கன்று (kan̲ru) 1297
187.4 ஓநாய் (ōnāy) 1297
187.5 சிறுத்தை (ci̲ruttai) 1298
187.6 (dialogue) 1299
187.7 (dialogue) 1300

188 Thorn, Lotus, Jasmine, Neem tree, Coconut palm 1303
188.1 முள் (muḷ) 1303
188.2 தாமரை (tāmarai) 1304
188.3 மல்லிகை (mallikai) 1305
188.4 வேப்பமரம் (vēppamaram) 1305
188.5 தென்னைமரம் (ten̲n̲aimaram) 1306

189 Glue, Candle, Website, App, Screen 1309
189.1 பசை (pacai) 1309
189.2 மெழுகுவர்த்தி (me̲ḻukuvartti) 1310
189.3 இணையதளம் (iṇaiyataḷam) 1311
189.4 செயலி (ceyali) 1312
189.5 திரை (tirai) 1312

190 Idea, Matchbox, Clay pot, Grinding stone, Tank 1315
190.1 யோசனை (yōcan̲ai) 1315
190.2 தீப்பெட்டி (tīppeṭṭi) 1316
190.3 பானை (pān̲ai) 1317
190.4 அம்மி (ammi) 1318
190.5 தொட்டி (toṭṭi) 1318

191 Shopkeeper, Customer, Cashier, Tailor, Small change 1321
191.1 கடைக்காரர் (kaṭaikkārar) 1321
191.2 வாடிக்கையாளர் (vāṭikkaiyāḷar) 1322
191.3 காசாளர் (kācāḷar) 1323
191.4 தையல்காரர் (taiyalkārar) 1324
191.5 சில்லறை (cillaṟai) 1324

192 Police officer, Driver, Postman, Trader, Colleague 1327
192.1 காவலர் (kāvalar) 1327
192.2 ஓட்டுநர் (ōṭṭunar) 1328
192.3 தபால்காரர் (tapālkārar) 1329
192.4 வியாபாரி (viyāpāri) 1330
192.5 சக ஊழியர் (caka ūḻiyar) 1330

193 Spectator, Actor, Singer, Coach, Carpenter 1333
193.1 பார்வையாளர் (pārvaiyāḷar) 1333
193.2 நடிகர் (naṭikar) 1334
193.3 பாடகர் (pāṭakar) 1335
193.4 பயிற்சியாளர் (payiṟciyāḷar) 1336
193.5 தச்சர் (taccar) 1336
193.6 (dialogue) 1337
193.7 (dialogue) 1338

194 To pour, To chop, To peel, To deep-fry, To knead 1339
194.1 ஊற்று (ūṟṟu) 1339
194.2 நறுக்கு (naṟukku) 1340
194.3 உரி (uri) 1341
194.4 பொரி (pori) 1341
194.5 பிசை (picai) 1342

195 To bring, To give back, To drive, To use, To try 1345
195.1 கொண்டு வா (koṇṭu vā) 1345
195.2 திருப்பிக் கொடு (tiruppik koṭu) 1346
195.3 ஓட்டு (ōṭṭu) 1347
195.4 பயன்படுத்து (payaṉpaṭuttu) 1348
195.5 முயற்சி செய் (muyaṟci cey) 1348

196 To tear, To lose, To press, To feel, To soak 1351
196.1 கிழி (kiḻi) 1351
196.2 இழ (iḻa) 1352

196.3 அழுத்து (aḻuttu) 1353
196.4 உணர் (uṇar) 1353
196.5 ஊற வை (ūṟa vai) 1354

197 To remind, To earn, To avoid, To move house, To contact 1357
197.1 நினைவூட்டு (niṉaivūṭṭu) 1357
197.2 சம்பாதி (campāti) 1358
197.3 தவிர் (tavir) 1359
197.4 குடிபெயர் (kuṭipeyar) 1360
197.5 தொடர்பு கொள் (toṭarpu koḷ) 1360

198 To pray, To cheat, To tell a lie, To quarrel, To tease 1363
198.1 பிரார்த்தனை செய் (pirārttaṉai cey) 1363
198.2 ஏமாற்று (ēmāṟṟu) 1364
198.3 பொய் சொல் (poy col) 1365
198.4 சண்டை போடு (caṇṭai pōṭu) 1366
198.5 கேலி செய் (kēli cey) 1366

199 To believe, To agree, To refuse, To discuss, To compare 1369
199.1 நம்பு (nampu) 1369
199.2 ஒத்துக்கொள் (ottukkoḷ) 1370
199.3 மறு (maṟu) 1371
199.4 விவாதி (vivāti) 1372
199.5 ஒப்பிடு (oppiṭu) 1372

200 To pinch, To bend, To paint, To collect, To suck 1375
200.1 கிள்ளு (kiḷḷu) 1375
200.2 வளை (vaḷai) 1376
200.3 பூசு (pūcu) 1377
200.4 சேகரி (cēkari) 1378
200.5 உறிஞ்சு (uṟiñcu) 1378

201 Forehead, Beard, Moustache, Palm of the hand, Stomach ache 1381
201.1 நெற்றி (neṟṟi) 1381
201.2 தாடி (tāṭi) 1382
201.3 மீசை (mīcai) 1383
201.4 உள்ளங்கை (uḷḷaṅkai) 1383
201.5 வயிற்றுவலி (vayiṟṟuvali) 1384

202 Weekend, Up to, Temple festival, Deepavali, New Year 1387
202.1 வார இறுதி (vāra iṟuti) 1387
202.2 வரை (varai) 1388
202.3 திருவிழா (tiruviḻā) 1389
202.4 தீபாவளி (tīpāvaḷi) 1390
202.5 புத்தாண்டு (puttāṇṭu) 1390
202.6 (dialogue) 1391
202.7 (dialogue) 1392

203 Century, Until now, Deadline, Until then, Childhood 1395
203.1 நூற்றாண்டு (nūṟṟāṇṭu) 1395
203.2 இதுவரை (ituvarai) 1396
203.3 காலக்கெடு (kālakkeṭu) 1397
203.4 அதுவரை (atuvarai) 1398
203.5 குழந்தைப் பருவம் (kuḻantaip paruvam) 1398

204 Stairs, Pharmacy, Restaurant, Supermarket, Clothes shop 1401
204.1 படிக்கட்டு (paṭikkaṭṭu) 1401
204.2 மருந்துக்கடை (maruntukkaṭai) 1402
204.3 உணவகம் (uṇavakam) 1403
204.4 பல்பொருள் அங்காடி (palporuḷ aṅkāṭi) 1404
204.5 துணிக்கடை (tuṇikkaṭai) 1404

205 Tour, Cinema, Building, Upper floor, Police station 1407
205.1 சுற்றுலா (cuṟṟulā) 1407
205.2 திரையரங்கம் (tiraiyaraṅkam) 1408
205.3 கட்டிடம் (kaṭṭiṭam) 1409
205.4 மாடி (māṭi) 1410
205.5 காவல் நிலையம் (kāval nilaiyam) 1410

206 Church, Mosque, Hall, Playground, Swimming pool 1413
206.1 தேவாலயம் (tēvālayam) 1413
206.2 மசூதி (macūti) 1414
206.3 கூடம் (kūṭam) 1415
206.4 மைதானம் (maitāṉam) 1416
206.5 நீச்சல் குளம் (nīccal kuḷam) 1416

207 In that case, Almost, Actually, In general, Usually 1419
207.1 அப்படியானால் (appaṭiyāṉāl) 1419
207.2 கிட்டத்தட்ட (kiṭṭattaṭṭa) 1420
207.3 உண்மையில் (uṇmaiyil) 1421
207.4 பொதுவாக (poṭuvāka) 1422
207.5 வழக்கமாக (vaḻakkamāka) 1422

208 Knowledge, Duty, Freedom, Information, Secret 1425
208.1 அறிவு (aṟivu) 1425
208.2 கடமை (kaṭamai) 1426
208.3 சுதந்திரம் (cutantiram) 1427
208.4 தகவல் (takaval) 1427
208.5 ரகசியம் (rakaciyam) 1428

209 Spoiled, Full, Empty, Tight, Loose 1431
209.1 கெட்டுப்போன (keṭṭuppōṉa) 1431
209.2 நிறைந்த (niṟainta) 1432
209.3 காலியான (kāliyāṉa) 1433
209.4 இறுக்கமான (iṟukkamāṉa) 1433
209.5 தளர்வான (taḷarvāṉa) 1434

210 Mind, Character, Jealousy, Shyness, Surprise 1437
210.1 மனம் (maṉam) 1437
210.2 குணம் (kuṇam) 1438
210.3 பொறாமை (poṟāmai) 1439
210.4 வெட்கம் (veṭkam) 1440
210.5 ஆச்சரியம் (āccariyam) 1440

211 Pleasant, Friendly, Fool, Pink, Brown 1443
211.1 இனிமையான (iṉimaiyāṉa) 1443
211.2 நட்பான (naṭpāṉa) 1444
211.3 முட்டாள் (muṭṭāḷ) 1445
211.4 இளஞ்சிவப்பு (iḷañcivappu) 1445
211.5 பழுப்பு (paḻuppu) 1446
211.6 (dialogue) 1447
211.7 (dialogue) 1448

212 Weak, Selfish, Generous, Well-behaved, Ugly 1451
212.1 பலவீனமான (palavīṉamāṉa) 1451
212.2 சுயநலமான (cuyanalamāṉa) 1452

212.3 பெருந்தன்மையான (peruntaṉmaiyāṉa) 1453
212.4 ஒழுக்கமான (oḻukkamāṉa) 1454
212.5 அசிங்கமான (aciṅkamāṉa) 1454

213 Cupboard, Electricity, Rubbish, Toothpaste, Toothbrush 1457
213.1 அலமாரி (alamāri) 1457
213.2 மின்சாரம் (miṉcāram) 1458
213.3 குப்பை (kuppai) 1459
213.4 பற்பசை (paṟpacai) 1459
213.5 பல்துலக்கி (paltulakki) 1460

214 Buttermilk, Fruit juice, Tender coconut water, Flour, Bread 1463
214.1 மோர் (mōr) 1463
214.2 பழச்சாறு (paḻaccāṟu) 1464
214.3 இளநீர் (iḷanīr) 1465
214.4 மாவு (māvu) 1465
214.5 ரொட்டி (roṭṭi) 1466

215 Pencil, Dictionary, Fee, Letter, Envelope 1469
215.1 பென்சில் (peṉcil) 1469
215.2 அகராதி (akarāti) 1470
215.3 கட்டணம் (kaṭṭaṇam) 1471
215.4 கடிதம் (kaṭitam) 1471
215.5 உறை (uṟai) 1472

216 Internet, Password, Newspaper, Ticket, Map 1475
216.1 இணையம் (iṇaiyam) 1475
216.2 கடவுச்சொல் (kaṭavuccol) 1476
216.3 நாளிதழ் (nāḷitaḻ) 1477
216.4 சீட்டு (cīṭṭu) 1477
216.5 வரைபடம் (varaipaṭam) 1478

217 Bride, Bridegroom, Engagement, Feast, Festival 1481
217.1 மணமகள் (maṇamakaḷ) 1481
217.2 மணமகன் (maṇamakaṉ) 1482
217.3 நிச்சயதார்த்தம் (niccayatārttam) 1483
217.4 விருந்து (viruntu) 1484
217.5 விழா (viḻā) 1484

218 Giraffe, Zebra, Crocodile, Butterfly, Bee 1487
218.1 ஒட்டகச்சிவிங்கி (oṭṭakacciviṅki) 1487
218.2 வரிக்குதிரை (varikkutirai) 1488
218.3 முதலை (mutalai) 1489
218.4 பட்டாம்பூச்சி (paṭṭāmpūcci) 1490
218.5 தேனீ (tēṉī) 1490

219 Bamboo, Rainbow, Fog, Gentle breeze, Flood 1493
219.1 மூங்கில் (mūṅkil) 1493
219.2 வானவில் (vāṉavil) 1494
219.3 மூடுபனி (mūṭupaṉi) 1495
219.4 தென்றல் (teṉṟal) 1495
219.5 வெள்ளம் (veḷḷam) 1496

220 Keyboard, Camera, Radio, Programme, Film 1499
220.1 விசைப்பலகை (vicaippalakai) 1499
220.2 கேமரா (kēmarā) 1500
220.3 வானொலி (vāṉoli) 1501
220.4 நிகழ்ச்சி (nikaḻcci) 1502
220.5 திரைப்படம் (tiraippaṭam) 1502
220.6 (dialogue) 1503
220.7 (dialogue) 1504

221 Helmet, Wheel, Blackboard, Eraser, Uniform 1507
221.1 தலைக்கவசம் (talaikkavacam) 1507
221.2 சக்கரம் (cakkaram) 1508
221.3 கரும்பலகை (karumpalakai) 1509
221.4 அழிப்பான் (aḻippāṉ) 1510
221.5 சீருடை (cīruṭai) 1510

222 Discount, Rupee, Coin, Expense, Salary 1513
222.1 தள்ளுபடி (taḷḷupaṭi) 1513
222.2 ரூபாய் (rūpāy) 1514
222.3 நாணயம் (nāṇayam) 1515
222.4 செலவு (celavu) 1515
222.5 சம்பளம் (campaḷam) 1516

223 Interview, Company, Factory, Lesson, Homework 1519
223.1 நேர்காணல் (nērkāṇal) 1519
223.2 நிறுவனம் (niṟuvaṉam) 1520

223.3 தொழிற்சாலை (toḻiṟcālai) 1521
223.4 பாடம் (pāṭam) 1522
223.5 வீட்டுப்பாடம் (vīṭṭuppāṭam) 1522

224 Fisherman, Potter, Barber, Mason, Scientist 1525
224.1 மீனவர் (mīṉavar) 1525
224.2 குயவர் (kuyavar) 1526
224.3 முடிதிருத்துபவர் (muṭitiruttupavar) 1527
224.4 கொத்தனார் (kottaṉār) 1528
224.5 விஞ்ஞானி (viññāṉi) 1528
224.6 (dialogue) 1529
224.7 (dialogue) 1530

225 To taste, To fill, To fold, To take off, To change 1531
225.1 சுவை பார் (cuvai pār) 1531
225.2 நிரப்பு (nirappu) 1532
225.3 மடி (maṭi) 1533
225.4 கழற்று (kaḻaṟṟu) 1534
225.5 மாற்று (māṟṟu) 1534

226 To begin, To touch, To sneeze, To swallow, To chew 1537
226.1 ஆரம்பி (ārampi) 1537
226.2 தொடு (toṭu) 1538
226.3 தும்மு (tummu) 1539
226.4 விழுங்கு (viḻuṅku) 1539
226.5 மெல் (mel) 1540

227 To correct, To enquire, To register, To book in advance, To apply 1543
227.1 திருத்து (tiruttu) 1543
227.2 விசாரி (vicāri) 1544
227.3 பதிவு செய் (pativu cey) 1545
227.4 முன்பதிவு செய் (muṉpativu cey) 1546
227.5 விண்ணப்பி (viṇṇappi) 1546

228 To type, To translate, To cancel, To hurry, To love 1549
228.1 தட்டச்சு செய் (taṭṭaccu cey) 1549
228.2 மொழிபெயர் (moḻipeyar) 1550
228.3 ரத்து செய் (rattu cey) 1551
228.4 அவசரப்படு (avacarappaṭu) 1552

228.5 நேசி (nēci) 1552

229 To praise, To scold, To dream, To separate, To throw 1555
229.1 பாராட்டு (pārāṭṭu) 1555
229.2 திட்டு (tiṭṭu) 1556
229.3 கனவு காண் (kaṉavu kāṇ) 1557
229.4 பிரி (piri) 1557
229.5 வீசு (vīcu) 1558

230 To imagine, To doubt, To complain, To download, To upload 1561
230.1 கற்பனை செய் (kaṟpaṉai cey) 1561
230.2 சந்தேகப்படு (cantēkappaṭu) 1562
230.3 குறை சொல் (kuṟai col) 1563
230.4 பதிவிறக்கு (pativiṟakku) 1564
230.5 பதிவேற்று (pativēṟṟu) 1564

231 To faint, To wilt, To warn, To beg, To manage 1567
231.1 மயங்கு (mayaṅku) 1567
231.2 வாடு (vāṭu) 1568
231.3 எச்சரி (eccari) 1569
231.4 கெஞ்சு (keñcu) 1569
231.5 சமாளி (camāḷi) 1570

232 Toothache, Wound, Tablet, Patient, Nurse 1573
232.1 பல்வலி (palvali) 1573
232.2 காயம் (kāyam) 1574
232.3 மாத்திரை (māttirai) 1575
232.4 நோயாளி (nōyāḷi) 1576
232.5 செவிலியர் (ceviliyar) 1576

233 Every year, Dawn, Day after tomorrow, Day before yesterday, Second 1579
233.1 ஆண்டுதோறும் (āṇṭutōṟum) 1579
233.2 விடியல் (viṭiyal) 1580
233.3 நாளை மறுநாள் (nāḷai maṟunāḷ) 1581
233.4 நேற்று முன்தினம் (nēṟṟu muṉtiṉam) 1582
233.5 விநாடி (vināṭi) 1583
233.6 (dialogue) 1583
233.7 (dialogue) 1584

234 Post office, City, Country, Capital city, Crossroads 1587
234.1 அஞ்சலகம் (añcalakam) 1587
234.2 நகரம் (nakaram) 1588
234.3 நாடு (nāṭu) 1589
234.4 தலைநகரம் (talainakaram) 1590
234.5 நாற்சந்தி (nāṟcanti) 1590

235 Direction, North, South, East, West 1593
235.1 திசை (ticai) 1593
235.2 வடக்கு (vaṭakku) 1594
235.3 தெற்கு (teṟku) 1595
235.4 கிழக்கு (kiḻakku) 1595
235.5 மேற்கு (mēṟku) 1596

236 Museum, Lane, Harbour, Fort, Palace 1599
236.1 அருங்காட்சியகம் (aruṅkāṭciyakam) 1599
236.2 சந்து (cantu) 1600
236.3 துறைமுகம் (tuṟaimukam) 1601
236.4 கோட்டை (kōṭṭai) 1602
236.5 அரண்மனை (araṇmaṉai) 1602

237 Especially, Instead, Not only, Together, Carefully 1605
237.1 குறிப்பாக (kuṟippāka) 1605
237.2 அதற்குப் பதிலாக (ataṟkup patilāka) 1606
237.3 மட்டுமல்லாமல் (maṭṭumallāmal) 1607
237.4 ஒன்றாக (onṟāka) 1608
237.5 கவனமாக (kavaṉamāka) 1608

238 Colour, Size, Weight, Healthy, Thin 1611
238.1 நிறம் (niṟam) 1611
238.2 அளவு (aḷavu) 1612
238.3 எடை (eṭai) 1613
238.4 ஆரோக்கியமான (ārōkkiyamāṉa) 1614
238.5 ஒல்லியான (olliyāṉa) 1614

239 Disappointment, Pride, Satisfaction, Pity, Loneliness 1617
239.1 ஏமாற்றம் (ēmāṟṟam) 1617
239.2 பெருமை (perumai) 1618
239.3 திருப்தி (tirupti) 1619
239.4 இரக்கம் (irakkam) 1619

239.5 தனிமை (taṉimai) 1620

240 Firm, Round, Square, Sharp, Wonderful 1623
240.1 உறுதியான (uṟutiyāṉa) 1623
240.2 வட்டமான (vaṭṭamāṉa) 1624
240.3 சதுரமான (caturamāṉa) 1625
240.4 கூர்மையான (kūrmaiyāṉa) 1625
240.5 அருமையான (arumaiyāṉa) 1626

241 Ordinary, Rare, Equal, Rough, Lukewarm 1629
241.1 சாதாரணமான (cātāraṇamāṉa) 1629
241.2 அபூர்வமான (apūrvamāṉa) 1630
241.3 சமமான (camamāṉa) 1631
241.4 கரடுமுரடான (karaṭumuraṭāṉa) 1632
241.5 வெதுவெதுப்பான (vetuvetuppāṉa) 1632

242 Clothing, Trousers, Pocket, Button, Blouse 1635
242.1 ஆடை (āṭai) 1635
242.2 கால்சட்டை (kālcaṭṭai) 1636
242.3 சட்டைப்பை (caṭṭaippai) 1637
242.4 பொத்தான் (pottāṉ) 1637
242.5 ரவிக்கை (ravikkai) 1638
242.6 (dialogue) 1639
242.7 (dialogue) 1640

243 Wheat, Potato, Aubergine, Fragrance, Cucumber 1643
243.1 கோதுமை (kōtumai) 1643
243.2 உருளைக்கிழங்கு (uruḷaikkiḻaṅku) 1644
243.3 கத்தரிக்காய் (kattarikkāy) 1645
243.4 வாசனை (vācaṉai) 1646
243.5 வெள்ளரிக்காய் (veḷḷarikkāy) 1647

244 Postage stamp, Parcel, Form, Document, Passport 1649
244.1 அஞ்சல் தலை (añcal talai) 1649
244.2 பொட்டலம் (poṭṭalam) 1650
244.3 படிவம் (paṭivam) 1651
244.4 ஆவணம் (āvaṇam) 1652
244.5 கடவுச்சீட்டு (kaṭavuccīṭṭu) 1652

245 Load, Voice, Conversation, Man, Woman 1655
245.1 சுமை (cumai) 1655
245.2 குரல் (kural) 1656
245.3 உரையாடல் (uraiyāṭal) 1657
245.4 ஆண் (āṇ) 1658
245.5 பெண் (peṇ) 1658

246 Celebration, Firecrackers, Culture, Habit, Tradition 1661
246.1 கொண்டாட்டம் (koṇṭāṭṭam) 1661
246.2 பட்டாசு (paṭṭācu) 1662
246.3 கலாச்சாரம் (kalāccāram) 1663
246.4 பழக்கம் (paḻakkam) 1664
246.5 பாரம்பரியம் (pārampariyam) 1664

247 Sparrow, Eagle, Puppy, Squirrel, Worm 1667
247.1 குருவி (kuruvi) 1667
247.2 கழுகு (kaḻuku) 1668
247.3 நாய்க்குட்டி (nāykkuṭṭi) 1669
247.4 அணில் (aṇil) 1669
247.5 புழு (puḻu) 1670

248 Drought, Earthquake, Nature, Rock, Fire 1673
248.1 வறட்சி (vaṟaṭci) 1673
248.2 நிலநடுக்கம் (nilanaṭukkam) 1674
248.3 இயற்கை (iyaṟkai) 1675
248.4 பாறை (pāṟai) 1676
248.5 நெருப்பு (neruppu) 1676
248.6 (dialogue) 1677
248.7 (dialogue) 1678

249 Game, Football, Cricket, Chess, Competition 1679
249.1 விளையாட்டு (viḷaiyāṭṭu) 1679
249.2 கால்பந்து (kālpantu) 1680
249.3 கிரிக்கெட் (kiriket) 1681
249.4 சதுரங்கம் (cataraṅkam) 1681
249.5 போட்டி (pōṭṭi) 1682

250 Tent, Swing, Banyan tree, Pair of scales, Straw 1685
250.1 கூடாரம் (kūṭāram) 1685
250.2 ஊஞ்சல் (ūñcal) 1686

250.3 ஆலமரம் (ālamaram) 1687
250.4 தராசு (tarācu) 1687
250.5 வைக்கோல் (vaikkōl) 1688

251 Total, List, Thing, Sale, Employer 1691
251.1 மொத்தம் (mottam) 1691
251.2 பட்டியல் (paṭṭiyal) 1692
251.3 பொருள் (poruḷ) 1693
251.4 விற்பனை (viṟpaṉai) 1693
251.5 முதலாளி (mutalāḷi) 1694

252 Mark, University, Education, Mathematics, Science 1697
252.1 மதிப்பெண் (matippeṇ) 1697
252.2 பல்கலைக்கழகம் (palkalaikkaḻakam) 1698
252.3 கல்வி (kalvi) 1699
252.4 கணிதம் (kaṇitam) 1700
252.5 அறிவியல் (aṟiviyal) 1700

253 Artist, Officer, Judge, Pension, Certificate 1703
253.1 கலைஞர் (kalaiñar) 1703
253.2 அதிகாரி (atikāri) 1704
253.3 நீதிபதி (nītipati) 1705
253.4 ஓய்வூதியம் (ōyvūtiyam) 1706
253.5 சான்றிதழ் (cāṉṟiteḻ) 1706
253.6 (dialogue) 1707
253.7 (dialogue) 1708

254 To borrow, To pay, To choose, To enter, To exit 1709
254.1 கடன் வாங்கு (kaṭaṉ vāṅku) 1709
254.2 செலுத்து (celuttu) 1710
254.3 தேர்ந்தெடு (tērnteṭu) 1711
254.4 நுழை (nuḻai) 1711
254.5 வெளியேறு (veḷiyēṟu) 1712

255 To breathe, To recover, To swell, To wake, To brush one's teeth 1715
255.1 சுவாசி (cuvāci) 1715
255.2 குணமாகு (kuṇamāku) 1716
255.3 வீங்கு (vīṅku) 1717
255.4 எழுப்பு (eḻuppu) 1718

255.5 பல் துலக்கு (pal tulakku) 1718

256 To accept, To follow, To miss, To erase, To print 1721
256.1 ஏற்றுக்கொள் (ēr̲r̲ukkoḷ) 1721
256.2 பின்பற்று (piṉpar̲r̲u) 1722
256.3 தவறவிடு (tavar̲aviṭu) 1723
256.4 அழி (al̲i) 1724
256.5 அச்சிடு (acciṭu) 1724

257 To hate, To be surprised, To feel shy, To be jealous, To kiss 1727
257.1 வெறு (ver̲u) 1727
257.2 ஆச்சரியப்படு (āccariyappaṭu) 1728
257.3 வெட்கப்படு (veṭkappaṭu) 1729
257.4 பொறாமைப்படு (por̲āmaippaṭu) 1730
257.5 முத்தமிடு (muttamiṭu) 1730

258 To melt, To pick, To bark, To comfort, To shake hands 1733
258.1 உருகு (uruku) 1733
258.2 பறி (par̲i) 1734
258.3 குரை (kurai) 1735
258.4 தேற்று (tēr̲r̲u) 1735
258.5 கை குலுக்கு (kai kulukku) 1736

259 To take a photo, To act, To enjoy, To repair, To tidy up 1739
259.1 படம் எடு (paṭam eṭu) 1739
259.2 நடி (naṭi) 1740
259.3 ரசி (raci) 1741
259.4 பழுது பார் (pal̲utu pār) 1741
259.5 ஒழுங்குபடுத்து (ol̲uṅkupaṭuttu) 1742

260 To increase, To spread, To sink, To float, To squeeze 1745
260.1 அதிகரி (atikari) 1745
260.2 பரவு (paravu) 1746
260.3 மூழ்கு (mūl̲ku) 1747
260.4 மித (mita) 1748
260.5 பிழி (pil̲i) 1748

261 Diabetes, Exercise, Yoga, Itch, Dizziness 1751
261.1 சர்க்கரை நோய் (carkkarai nōy) 1751
261.2 உடற்பயிற்சி (uṭaṟpayiṟci) 1752
261.3 யோகா (yōkā) 1753
261.4 அரிப்பு (arippu) 1753
261.5 தலைச்சுற்றல் (talaiccuṟṟal) 1754

262 Now and then, Every week, Late, Finally, These days 1757
262.1 அவ்வப்போது (avvappōtu) 1757
262.2 வாரந்தோறும் (vārantōṟum) 1758
262.3 தாமதமாக (tāmatamāka) 1759
262.4 கடைசியாக (kaṭaiciyāka) 1760
262.5 இப்போதெல்லாம் (ippōtellām) 1760
262.6 (dialogue) 1761
262.7 (dialogue) 1762

263 Traffic, Footpath, Aeroplane, Airport, Ship 1765
263.1 போக்குவரத்து (pōkkuvarattu) 1765
263.2 நடைபாதை (naṭaipātai) 1766
263.3 விமானம் (vimāṉam) 1767
263.4 விமான நிலையம் (vimāṉa nilaiyam) 1768
263.5 கப்பல் (kappal) 1768

264 Opposite, Between, Way, Land, Valley 1771
264.1 எதிரே (etirē) 1771
264.2 இடையில் (iṭaiyil) 1772
264.3 வழி (vaḻi) 1773
264.4 நிலம் (nilam) 1773
264.5 பள்ளத்தாக்கு (paḷḷattākku) 1774

265 District, Hut, Tower, Prison, World 1777
265.1 மாவட்டம் (māvaṭṭam) 1777
265.2 குடிசை (kuṭicai) 1778
265.3 கோபுரம் (kōpuram) 1779
265.4 சிறை (ciṟai) 1780
265.5 உலகம் (ulakam) 1780

266 Easily, On purpose, By chance, Luckily, Reason 1783
266.1 எளிதாக (eḷitāka) 1783
266.2 வேண்டுமென்றே (vēṇṭumeṉṟē) 1784

266.3 தற்செயலாக (taṟceyalāka) 1785
266.4 அதிர்ஷ்டவசமாக (atirṣṭavacamāka) 1786
266.5 காரணம் (kāraṇam) 1786

267 Fat, Important, Urgent, Crowded, Easy 1789
267.1 குண்டான (kuṇṭāṉa) 1789
267.2 முக்கியமான (mukkiyamāṉa) 1790
267.3 அவசரமான (avacaramāṉa) 1791
267.4 நெரிசலான (nericalāṉa) 1792
267.5 எளிதான (eḷitāṉa) 1792

268 Enthusiasm, Confusion, Smile, Gentle, Honest 1795
268.1 உற்சாகம் (uṟcākam) 1795
268.2 குழப்பம் (kuḻappam) 1796
268.3 புன்னகை (puṉṉakai) 1797
268.4 கனிவான (kaṉivāṉa) 1797
268.5 நேர்மையான (nērmaiyāṉa) 1798

269 Best, Different, Boring, Simple, Comfortable 1801
269.1 சிறந்த (ciṟanta) 1801
269.2 வித்தியாசமான (vittiyācamāṉa) 1802
269.3 சலிப்பான (calippāṉa) 1803
269.4 எளிய (eḷiya) 1804
269.5 வசதியான (vacatiyāṉa) 1804

270 Handkerchief, Earring, Chain, Chapati, Puri 1807
270.1 கைக்குட்டை (kaikkuṭṭai) 1807
270.2 தோடு (tōṭu) 1808
270.3 சங்கிலி (caṅkili) 1809
270.4 சப்பாத்தி (cappātti) 1809
270.5 பூரி (pūri) 1810

271 Coriander, Curry leaves, Apple, Orange, Papaya 1813
271.1 கொத்தமல்லி (kottamalli) 1813
271.2 கறிவேப்பிலை (kaṟivēppilai) 1814
271.3 ஆப்பிள் (āppiḷ) 1815
271.4 ஆரஞ்சு (ārañcu) 1816
271.5 பப்பாளி (pappāḷi) 1816
271.6 (dialogue) 1817
271.7 (dialogue) 1818

272 Identity card, Tax, Application, Photograph, Copy 1821
272.1 அடையாள அட்டை (aṭaiyāḷa aṭṭai) 1821
272.2 வரி (vari) 1822
272.3 விண்ணப்பம் (viṇṇappam) 1823
272.4 புகைப்படம் (pukaippaṭam) 1824
272.5 நகல் (nakal) 1824

273 Person, Parents, Sibling, Twins, Brother-in-law 1827
273.1 ஆள் (āḷ) 1827
273.2 பெற்றோர் (per̲r̲ōr) 1828
273.3 உடன்பிறந்தவர் (uṭaṉpiṟantavar) 1829
273.4 இரட்டையர் (iraṭṭaiyar) 1830
273.5 மைத்துனன் (maittuṉaṉ) 1830

274 Music, Song, Story, God, Animal 1833
274.1 இசை (icai) 1833
274.2 பாடல் (pāṭal) 1834
274.3 கதை (katai) 1835
274.4 கடவுள் (kaṭavuḷ) 1835
274.5 விலங்கு (vilaṅku) 1836

275 Feather, Tail, Nest, Plant, Creeper 1839
275.1 இறகு (iṟaku) 1839
275.2 வால் (vāl) 1840
275.3 கூடு (kūṭu) 1841
275.4 செடி (ceṭi) 1841
275.5 கொடி (koṭi) 1842

276 Darkness, Shade, Machine, Sofa, Screwdriver 1845
276.1 இருட்டு (iruṭṭu) 1845
276.2 நிழல் (niḻal) 1846
276.3 இயந்திரம் (iyantiram) 1847
276.4 சோபா (cōpā) 1847
276.5 திருப்புளி (tiruppuḷi) 1848

277 Team, Victory, Defeat, Hobby, Opinion 1851
277.1 குழு (kuḻu) 1851
277.2 வெற்றி (ver̲r̲i) 1852
277.3 தோல்வி (tōlvi) 1853
277.4 பொழுதுபோக்கு (poḻutupōkku) 1854

277.5 **கருத்து** (karuttu) 1854

278 Sugarcane, Okra, Peanut, Watermelon, Murukku 1857
278.1 **கரும்பு** (karumpu) 1857
278.2 **வெண்டைக்காய்** (veṇṭaikkāy) 1858
278.3 **நிலக்கடலை** (nilakkaṭalai) 1859
278.4 **தர்பூசணி** (tarpūcaṇi) 1860
278.5 **முறுக்கு** (mu̱rukku) 1861

279 Worker, Meeting, Manager, Engineer, Lawyer 1863
279.1 **தொழிலாளி** (to̱lilāḷi) 1863
279.2 **கூட்டம்** (kūṭṭam) 1864
279.3 **மேலாளர்** (mēlāḷar) 1865
279.4 **பொறியாளர்** (po̱riyāḷar) 1866
279.5 **வழக்கறிஞர்** (va̱lakka̱riñar) 1866

280 Government, Rule, Fine, Complaint, Athlete 1869
280.1 **அரசு** (aracu) 1869
280.2 **விதி** (viti) 1870
280.3 **அபராதம்** (aparātam) 1871
280.4 **புகார்** (pukār) 1871
280.5 **வீரர்** (vīrar) 1872
280.6 (dialogue) 1873
280.7 (dialogue) 1874

The Tamil script (reference) 1877

Glossary 1879

Review Questions 1975

Answer Key 1977

Index 1979

Chapter 1

Greetings

Modes: **voice** (8) **pen** (2) **Hands-free start:** the first of 10 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can greet someone, say yes, no and thank you, agree with sari, hold a short exchange out loud, and copy my first Tamil shape with a visible model.
>
> *Hold the whole exchange out loud, say back where vaṇakkam and naṉṟi come from and how Tamil answers yes, then copy* வ *once beside the visible model and compare only that shape.*

1.1 Vaṇakkam — "greetings"

> The first Tamil word, and the one you will use most. One word, one lesson. Say it, and you have greeted someone.

You'll want to know: vaṇakkam

vaṇakkam — **"greetings."**

Say it *va-ṇak-kam*, with the *kk* held a beat longer than a single *k*.

It is what you say walking into a room, answering a phone, or meeting anyone at all. It does not change for morning or evening, and it does not change for one person or many.

> Its root is the verb *vaṇaṅku*, "to bow." *Vaṇakkam* is the act of bowing, turned into a word — and it is native Tamil, not borrowed from Sanskrit.

In the family, and next door

	word
Kannada	ನಮಸ್ಕಾರ (*namaskāra*)
Telugu	నమస్కారం (*namaskāram*)
Malayalam	നമസ്കാരം (*namaskāram*)
Hindi (neighbour)	नमस्ते (*namaste*)
English	hello / greetings (vaṇakkam

The letters in this word

Say it *va-ṇak-kam*. The ṇ is a **retroflex** *n* — curl the tongue back to the roof of the mouth, further back than an English *n*, and Tamil writes it with its own letter, ண. The *kk* is **held**, a beat longer than a single *k*, and that length is doing real work: Tamil distinguishes words by it.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

Vaṇakkam comes from the verb *vaṇaṅku*, "to bow, to pay homage." Turned into a noun of the action, it means "a bowing, an act of reverence" — the idea of *namaste*, but from a **native Tamil** root, not a Sanskrit one. That is Tamil's whole personality: an old language that keeps its home-grown words where its neighbours borrowed.

Why it's said this way

Said with the palms pressed together and a small bow — the gesture *is* the word. It serves as both **hello and goodbye**, any time, to almost anyone, respectful without being stiff.

Writing — let your finger meet one shape

Here is the first printed shape of the greeting's written form: வ. Follow that shape once with your finger while you say the whole greeting.

Do not write it yet; the next lesson shows the whole written greeting and asks for one supported copy of this shape. A later script lesson will teach how Tamil letters are formed; tracing a typeface here does not claim a handwriting stroke order.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "vaṇakkam" — hold the *kk*
- it to someone arriving
- it to someone leaving — the same word does both

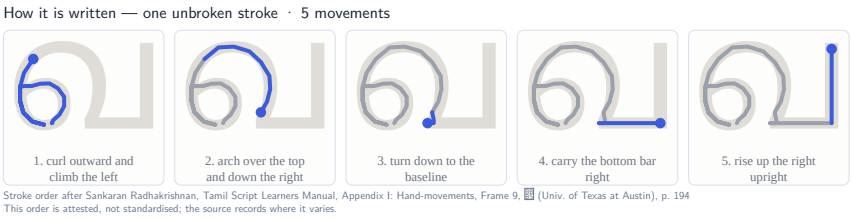
Before you move on

Say *vaṇakkam*. Does it change between morning and evening? (**No** — one greeting, all day.) Does it change for one person or a crowd? (**No**.) Next: the same greeting across the Dravidian family.

1.2 வ (va) — copy one visible shape with help

Here is the whole greeting, written: **வணக்கம்**. Point to it and say *vaṇakkam* once. Keep the model on the page. Find the first shape, **வ** (*va*), which your finger just followed.

Writing — one supported copy



How **வ** *is written, stroke by stroke*

Copy **வ** once beside the model. Look back as often as you need. Your copy can be large and slow; it does not need to look like a font.

This is shape familiarity, not a stroke-order test. Do not hide the model, do not copy the rest of **வணக்கம்**, and do not add a second new shape today. The later Tamil writing sequence will teach letter construction explicitly.

Before you move on

Compare your one copy with வ (*va*) while both remain visible. Repair one curve if you want, then stop. Say *vaṇakkam* once more: one known greeting, one tiny hand movement.

1.3 வணக்கம் — one bow, two lexical loyalties

Vaṇakkam names a bow. Neighboring languages name the same gesture with a different inherited or borrowed root.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

Language	"Hello"	Source
Tamil	*vaṇakkam*	**native Dravidian** *vaṇaṅku*
Kannada	*namaskāra*	Sanskrit
Telugu	*namaskāram*	Sanskrit
Malayalam	*namaskāram*	Sanskrit
Hindi	*namaste*	Sanskrit
English	*hello*	Germanic hailing-call

Four tracks use Sanskrit *namas-*, "bow." Tamil kept its own verb. The gesture and social meaning match; the lexical loyalty differs.

Why it's said this way

Vaṇakkam is said with pressed palms or a small head-bow: the gesture is the word. It works as **hello and goodbye**, at any time, to almost anyone. It is respectful without being stiff; cinema and formal speech can also use it as a ringing one-word salutation to a whole room.

Your turn

- *Say it:* "vaṇakkam", the word that names the bow
- *Contrast:* Tamil *vaṇaṅku* · neighbors Sanskrit *namas-*
- *Choose:* greeting or parting → வணக்கம் works

Before you move on

Which Dravidian language kept its native bow-word? (**Tamil**.) What did the neighbors borrow? (Sanskrit ***namas-***.) Can *vaṇakkam* greet and part? (**Yes** — it is an all-day respectful salutation.)

1.4 ஆம் (ām) — "yes"

The plain yes. One word, and then we will put these together.

You'll want to know: ஆம்

ஆம் — *ām* — **"yes."**

One beat, with a long opening *aa*.

Stretch it and you get ***āmām*** — "yes, indeed; that's right." Tamil doubles words for warmth and certainty, the way *sari sari* does.

> *Ām* is a worn-down form of *āgum*, "it becomes, it will be" — a yes that started life as a verb, which is a very Tamil way to agree.

In the family, and next door

	word
Kannada	ಹೌದು (*haudu*)
Telugu	అవును (*avunu*)
Malayalam	അതെ (*athe*)
Hindi (neighbour)	हाँ (*hāṃ*)
English	yes

The letters in this word

Say it *ām* — a **long** *a*, held about twice as long as the short one, closing on a plain *m*. Vowel length is meaningful in Tamil, so the length is not decoration.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

ஆம் (*ām*) is the plain "yes." Doubled for emphasis it becomes *āmām*, "yes, indeed." It is native Dravidian, worn down from *ākum*, "it will be" (DEDR 333).

Grammar lens

Tamil often says "yes" by **echoing the verb**: asked *vandāyā?* ("did you come?"), a natural yes is *vandēṉ* ("I came"). Bank *ām* as the simple word, but expect a "yes" to come back as a whole verb.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "ām" — one long *aa*, closed on the *m*
- "āmām" — the emphatic double
- "ām" then "sari" — yes, and alright

Before you move on

Say ஆம். What does ***āmām*** add? (**Emphasis** — "yes, indeed.") Next: the word for no.

1.5 இல்லை (illai) — "no"

The other half of the pair. One word, and then the lesson that puts all five together.

You'll want to know: இல்லை

இல்லை — *illai* — **"no."**

Two beats: *il-lai*, with the *l* held across the join.

On its own it is the everyday **no**. But it is not really the adjective "no" — it is a small statement meaning **"is not."** That will matter when we put the five words together.

Its root is *il*, the idea of *not-being*. Its positive twin is *uṇḍu*, "there is."

In the family, and next door

	word	same root
Kannada	ಇಲ್ಲ (*illa*)	yes
Telugu	లేదు (*lēdu*)	
Malayalam	ഇല്ല (*illa*)	yes
Hindi (neighbour)	नहीं (*nahīṃ*)	
English	no / there isn't (illai	

The letters in this word

Say it *il-lai*, with the *l* **held** across the join — the same doubling you met in *vaṇak-kam*. The ending is the diphthong *ai*, as in English "eye," not two separate vowels.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

இல்லை (*illai*) is built on இல் (*il*), "not-being, absence" — so it is not really the adjective "no" but the statement **"[it] is not, [there] is not."** Its positive twin is *uṇḍu*, "there is."

Grammar lens

Tamil negates by *being*, not with a "not"-word. Where English inserts *not*/*no*, Tamil swaps in the negative verb of existence: *puttakam* ***uṇḍu*** ("there *is* a book") → *puttakam* ***illai*** ("there *is not* a book"). So *illai* is both the everyday "no" and the word that makes a whole sentence negative — a deeply Dravidian habit, unlike English or Hindi.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "illai" — two beats, the *l* held across the join
- the pair — "ām" … "illai"
- it alone, as a complete answer

Before you move on

Say இல்லை. Is it closer to English *no*, or to *is not*? (**Is not** — it is a statement, not a label.) Next: the word for thank you.

1.6 Nan̲r̲i — "thank you"

One word again. This is the one you will reach for second-most, and Tamil says it with a noun rather than a verb.

You'll want to know: nan̲r̲i

nan̲r̲i — **"thank you."**

Two beats: *nan̲-r̲i*. The *n̲* and the *r̲* are both made further back than English *n* and *r*; copy the sound rather than the spelling.

It works on its own, with no verb around it. Someone hands you something; you say *nan̲r̲i*, and that is a whole sentence.

Its root is *nal*, "good" — the same *nal-* inside *nalla* ("good") and *nanmai* ("a good deed"). Saying *nan̲r̲i* names the good someone did you.

In the family, and next door

	word	same root
Kannada	ಧನ್ಯವಾದ (*dhanyavāda*)	
Telugu	ధన్యవాదములు (*dhanyavādamulu*)	
Malayalam	നന്ദി (*nandi*)	yes
Hindi (neighbour)	धन्यवाद (*dhanyavād*)	
English	thank you (nan̲r̲i	

The letters in this word

Say it *nan̲-r̲i*. Tamil hears **three** different *n* sounds and this word uses two of them: a **dental** *n* (tongue on the teeth) to open, written ந, then an **alveolar** *n̲* (on the ridge just behind them), written ன. The *r̲* is its own sound again, not the English *r*, and it has its own letter too: ற. English ears flatten all of this to "nandri," which is close enough to be understood. The whole written word joins these three letters in the next lesson.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

Nan̲r̲i grows from the root *nal* (DEDR 3610), "good" — so it literally means **"goodness."** To thank, in Tamil, is naming the good done to you.

Grammar lens

Tamil hears three of every *n*, *l*, and *r*. You have now heard two of the three *n*s inside this one word: a dental *n* (tongue on the teeth) and an alveolar *n̲* (on the ridge behind them). There is a third, the retroflex *ṉ* you met in *vaṇakkam* — curled back. Tamil does the same for *l* (*l*, *l̲*, *ḷ*) and for *r* (*r*, *r̲*). English fuses each set into one letter; Tamil keeps them apart, and the differences *change meaning*.
Each of those sounds has its own letter, and you will meet the letters one at a time later, spelling words you already say. Learn the sounds word by word, not as a chart.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "nan̲̲ri" — two beats, both consonants far back
- "vaṇakkam" then "nan̲̲ri" — greeting, then thanks
- it on its own, with nothing around it

Before you move on

Say *nan̲̲ri*. Does it need a verb to be a complete reply? (**No** — it stands alone.) Next: how thanks travels across the family.

1.7 நன்றி — a native family word with a register edge

Nan̲̲ri literally names goodness. Its family distribution mirrors the greeting split you just saw.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

Language	"Thanks"	Source
Tamil	*nan̲r̲i*	native *nal*, "good"
Malayalam	*nandi*	the **same Dravidian word**
Kannada	*dhanyavāda*	Sanskrit
Telugu	*dhanyavādamulu*	Sanskrit
Hindi	*dhanyavād / shukriyā*	Sanskrit / Perso-Arabic

Tamil and its closest sister Malayalam kept the native word. Kannada and Telugu borrowed Sanskrit *dhanyavāda*, repeating the split seen with "hello."

Why it's said this way

Spoken *nan̲r̲i* can feel a little formal. Everyday warmth may live in a smile or nod; among close family an explicit thank-you can sound oddly distant. Use **romba nan̲r̲i**, "many thanks," when you want to mark gratitude strongly.
This is a register tendency, not a ban: the relationship and moment determine whether naming the gratitude feels warm or ceremonious.

Your turn

- *Say it:* Tamil *nan̲r̲i* · Malayalam *nandi*
- *Say it:* "romba nan̲r̲i" — many thanks
- *Choose:* close-family routine favor → warmth may be nonverbal

Before you move on

Which sister shares Tamil's native gratitude word? (**Malayalam**.)
What did Kannada and Telugu borrow? (Sanskrit ***dhanyavāda***.)
Why can explicit *nan̲r̲i* sound marked? (Among intimates, gratitude may be assumed; the word can feel **formal**.)

1.8 சரி (sari) — “okay”

The most useful small word in the language, and the easiest to say.

You’ll want to know: சரி

சரி — *sari* — **“okay, alright, correct.”**

Two beats: *sa-ri*.

It is the verbal nod of Tamil. Someone proposes a plan and the whole reply is one warm *sari*. Doubled — *sari, sari* — it means “yes yes, fine, go on.”

It began as “correct, even, level,” and slid from *that is right* to *alright* the way English *right* did.

In the family, and next door

	word	same root
Kannada	ಸರಿ (*sari*)	yes
Telugu	సరే (*sarē*)	yes
Malayalam	ശരി (*śari*)	yes
English	okay / alright / correct	

The letters in this word

Say it *sari*, two light syllables, stress even. The opening sound sits between English *s* and *ch*, and Tamil treats that whole range as one sound chosen by **position** in the word rather than by a separate spelling — the same economy that lets one *k*-sound also be heard as *g* or a soft *h*.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

சரி (*sari*) means “correct, even, level,” and so “okay, agreed.” Its origin is uncertain: DEDR has no entry for it, and the usual guess is Sanskrit *sadṛśa*, “like, equal,” through a Prakrit form such as *sarisa* (CDIAL 13120). It is the verbal nod of the language: propose a plan, hear a warm *sari*; doubled, *sari sari* = “alright, alright.”

Grammar lens

One letter, several sounds. For its stop-consonants Tamil writes *one* letter per mouth-position and lets rules of position fill in the voicing (*k*/*g*, *s*/*ch*). The payoff is a strikingly *small* alphabet; the price is that the exact sound isn't always predictable from the letter alone — you pick it up by ear, word by word.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "sari"
- "sari, sari" — the doubled, hurry-along version
- agree to something with nothing but this word

Before you move on

Say சரி. What does doubling it add? (**Hurry, or easy agreement** — "yes yes, fine.") Next: putting the five words together.

1.9 Putting the five together — how Tamil answers

Five words, one at a time. Now they go into a conversation, and two habits show up that English does not have.

The exchange — built from the five words

A whole exchange, built only from the five words:

> — ***vaṇakkam.*** — ***vaṇakkam.*** — ***sari?*** — ***ām.*** — ***naṉṟi.*** — ***sari.***
>
> — *Hello.* — *Hello.* — *Alright?* — *Yes.* — *Thank you.* — *Alright.*

Every reply is one word. Tamil is comfortable with that in a way English is not.

Say the exchange, don't read it. Each of these five words is printed in Tamil in its own lesson, and the letters arrive later, one at a time.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

In ஆம் / இல்லை / சரி (*ām / illai / sari*), *ām* is worn down from *ākum*, "it will be", a form of the native verb "to become" (DEDR 333), and *illai* is native "not being" (DEDR 2559). DEDR compares Sanskrit *ām*, "yes". The origin of *sari* is uncertain, and its own lesson gives the usual guess.

Grammar Lens: two habits behind the answers

One — Tamil often answers by echoing the verb.
Ām is correct, but a speaker will often say yes by **repeating the verb of the question**. Asked "did you come?", a natural yes is *vandēṉ* — "I came." Keep *ām* as your word, and expect a yes to come back as a whole verb.

Two — Tamil negates by *being*, not with a "not"-word.
English makes a sentence negative by inserting *not*. Tamil swaps in the negative verb of existence:

puttakam ***uṇḍu***	"there **is** a book"
puttakam ***illai***	"there **is not** a book"

So *illai* does double duty: alone it is the everyday **no**; inside a sentence it is what makes the whole thing negative. Learn it as *is not* and both uses fall out.

Your turn

- *Say it:* the exchange above, both parts
- *Hear:* "puttakam uṇḍu" … "puttakam illai" — only the last word changed

Before you move on

Give a one-word reply to *sari?* and to *naṉṟi*. (**ām** / **sari**.) Besides *ām*, what else is a natural yes? (**Repeating the verb**.) What does *illai* do inside a sentence? (**Makes it negative** — it is the "is not" verb.) Next: the chapter's own recap, and then names.

1.10 Chapter 1 — a five-word recap

Five spoken words, plus the one visible shape your hand has copied. Let's gather only what you have already learned and make it feel easy.

What you've built — say them back

Say each one before you check the meaning:

Say this	Meaning
vaṇakkam	hello / greetings
naṉṟi	thank you
ām	yes
illai	no / there isn't
sari	okay / correct

These are sounds to say, not text to decode. The one shape your hand has met is வ, the opening of வணக்கம்; the copy below keeps that model in view. The letters arrive later, one at a time, each spelling a word you already say.

Your turn — what the words carry

Each word brought a story or a habit with it. Answer aloud first.

- *Vaṇakkam* comes from which verb? (*Vaṇaṅku*, **"to bow"** — native Tamil, where the neighbours borrowed Sanskrit ***namas-***.)
- How do you thank someone strongly? (***Romba naṉṟi.***) Which sister shares *naṉṟi*? (**Malayalam**, *nandi.*) Among close family it can sound **formal**: gratitude there may be assumed.
- An emphatic yes? (***Āmām.***) Besides *ām*, a natural yes **echoes the verb**: asked "did you come", *vandēṉ*, "I came."

Why it's said this way

Tamil avoids a blunt goodbye: a bare "I am leaving" sounds final, even ill-omened, so the everyday farewell promises **a return** instead. That exchange needs two verbs you have not met, so it gets a chapter of its own.
Until then, வணக்கம் is your farewell. It parts as well as it meets,

with the same respect both ways.

Your turn

- *Say it:* all five — vaṇakkam · nan̲ri · ām · illai · sari
- *Say it:* greet and thank — “vaṇakkam!” … “nan̲ri.”
- *Copy:* வ once beside the visible model, large and slowly

Before you move on

Say all five words aloud. Which one works both to meet someone and to part from them? (வணக்கம்.) *Check:* your one copied வ against the model — repair one curve if you want, then stop
Next chapter starts introducing yourself, one short possession form at a time.

Chapter 2

Introducing Yourself

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (8) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 8 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can introduce myself in Tamil, give my name, and understand the other person's name.
>
> *Hold the whole introduction out loud — give your name, ask for theirs, and answer that you are pleased to meet them — using only the possession forms this chapter built.*

2.1 பெயர் (peyar) — "name," where the family is *not* Indo-European

"Name" — and a word that shows Tamil at its most itself.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

பெயர் (*peyar*, "name") is **native Dravidian**, from Proto-Dravidian ***peyar / *pēr** — and it is *not* related to Sanskrit *nāma* (Hindi *nām*, English *name*). Here the two great families part: Indo-European shares one word for "name" from Ireland to North India, but the Dravidian south kept its own.
Across the family:

Language	**"Name"**	**Source**
Tamil	*peyar*	**native Dravidian** (*peyar)
Malayalam	*pēr*	the *same* Dravidian root
Telugu	*pēru*	the *same* Dravidian root
Kannada	*hesaru*	Dravidian (*pesar, with $p \to h$)
Hindi	*nām*	Sanskrit *nāman* (Indo-European)
English	*name*	Indo-European

Four Dravidian tongues share *peyar/pēru*; only the Indo-European languages have *name/nām*.

In the family, and next door

	word	**same root**
Kannada	ಹೆಸರು (*hesaru*)	yes
Telugu	పేరు (*pēru*)	yes
Malayalam	പേര് (*pēr*)	yes
Hindi (neighbour)	नाम (*nām*)	
English	name	

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "peyar"
- the Dravidian cousins — *peyar* / *pēr* / *pēru*
- what it is *not* — not *nām*, not *name*

Before you move on

Is பெயர் related to English *name*? (No — it's native Dravidian, **peyar*; *name/nām* are Indo-European.) Which languages share *peyar/pēru*? (Tamil, Malayalam, Telugu — and Kannada's *hesaru*.)

2.2 என் (en̲) — "my"

"My" — and, like *peyar*, a word with no European cousin at all.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

என் (*en̲*) means "my." It belongs to Tamil's native Dravidian first-person family, not to the Indo-European family behind English *I/ my*. You will meet the related word for "I" in its own lesson; today you only need *en̲*.

In the family, and next door

	word	same root
Kannada	ನನ್ನ (*nanna*)	
Telugu	నా (*nā*)	
Malayalam	എന്റെ (*en̲re*)	yes
Hindi (neighbour)	मेरा (*merā*)	
English	my	

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "en̲"
- *en̲* once with its meaning, "my"

Before you move on

What does என் mean? ("My.") Does it share a root with English *my*? (No — it is native Dravidian.)

2.3 என் பெயர் ... (en̲ peyar ...) — "my name is...," with no "is"

Assemble the two atoms — *en̲* and *peyar* — and notice a whole word English needs that Tamil doesn't.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

- en̲ (my) + peyar (name) + your name.

  என் பெயர் ... = "my name ..." → **"my name is..."**

En̲ peyar Arun. → "My name is Arun."
Both words are native Dravidian: *en̲* (DEDR 5160) and *peyar* (DEDR 4410).

In the family, and next door

	word	same root
Kannada	ನನ್ನ ಹೆಸರು ... (*nanna hesaru ...*)	
Telugu	నా పేరు ... (*nā pēru ...*)	
Malayalam	എന്റെ പേര് ... ആണ് (*en̲re pēr ... āṇŭ*)	yes
Hindi (neighbour)	मेरा नाम ... है (*merā nām ... hai*)	
English	my name is...	

Grammar Lens: Tamil has no word for "is" here

Look at what's missing: there is **no verb**. Tamil sets "my name" beside "Arun" — *en̲ peyar Arun* — and the "is" is simply understood. This is the **zero copula**: for equational sentences (X is Y), Dravidian needs no "to be" at all — where English needs *is*, Hindi needs *hai*, Arabic (you'll see) also drops it. Tamil says only "my name Arun."

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "en̲ peyar ..." with your name
- notice — no word for "is"

Before you move on

Give your name in Tamil. (*En̲ peyar ....*) What does Tamil leave out that English requires? (The verb "is" — the zero copula.)

2.4 நீ / நீங்கள் (nī / nīṅgaḷ) — "you," familiar and respectful

To ask a name you need "you" — and Tamil makes respect the same way French does.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

நீ (*nī*, familiar "you") ← Proto-Dravidian ***nīn*** — native, unrelated to the European "you" words (from **tū*). நீங்கள் (*nīṅgaḷ*) is *nī* + the plural ending **-kaḷ**.

In the family, and next door

	word	same root
Kannada	నీను (*nīnu*)	yes
Telugu	నువ్వు (*nuvvu*)	
Malayalam	നീ (*nī*)	yes
Hindi (neighbour)	आप (*āp*)	
English	you	

Grammar Lens: respect by the plural — again

Tamil grades "you" in two: **nī** (familiar — friends, children) and **nīṅgaḷ** (respectful — and literally the **plural**, "you-all"). This is the *same* politeness-by-plural as French *vous*: address one respected person as "you all." For a first meeting, always **nīṅgaḷ**.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "nī" (familiar), "nīṅgaḷ" (respectful)
- nīṅgaḷ = nī + plural -kaḷ

Before you move on

How does Tamil make "you" respectful, and which European language uses the same trick? (By the plural — *nīṅgaḷ*; French *vous*.)

2.5 என்ன (en̲n̲a) — "what"

The last piece of the question: "what."

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

என்ன (*en̲n̲a*, "what") is native Dravidian, on the interrogative stem ***yā- / *e-** that heads Tamil's whole question family: *en̲n̲a* (what), *yār* (who), *eppo* (when), *enge* (where), *ēn̲* (why). Like Hindi's *k-* words and English's *wh-* words — but from a *different*, Dravidian root.

In the family, and next door

	word	same root
Kannada	ಏನು (*ēnu*)	yes
Telugu	ఏమిటి (*ēmiṭi*)	
Malayalam	എന്ത് (*entŭ*)	yes
Hindi (neighbour)	क्या (*kyā*)	
English	what	

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "en̲n̲a"
- the Tamil question family — en̲n̲a, yār, enge

Before you move on

What stem heads Tamil's question-words, and is it the same as English's *wh-*? (**yā-/*e-*; same *idea*, different — Dravidian — root.)

2.6 உங்கள் பெயர் என்ன? (uṅgaḷ peyar en̲n̲a?) — "what's your name?"

Assemble the question — your + name + what — and note, again, no "is."

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

- **உங்கள்** (*uṅgaḷ*, "your") = the possessive of *nīṅgaḷ* ("you," respectful).

  உங்கள் பெயர் என்ன? = literally "**your name what?**" = "what's your name?"

Three words, **no verb** — the zero copula holds for questions too. Tamil never adds an "is." All three words are native Dravidian: *uṅgaḷ* (DEDR 3688), *peyar* (DEDR 4410) and *eṉṉa* (DEDR 5151).

In the family, and next door

	word
Kannada	ನಿಮ್ಮ ಹೆಸರು ಏನು? (*nimma hesaru ēnu?*)
Telugu	మీ పేరు ఏమిటి? (*mī pēru ēmiṭi?*)
Malayalam	നിന്റെ പേര് എന്താണ്? (*niṉṟe pēr entāṇŭ?*)
Hindi (neighbour)	आपका नाम क्या है? (*āpkā nām kyā hai?*)
English	what's your name?

Grammar Lens: answer, and the familiar version

Answer with the sentence you built: **Eṉ peyar Arun.** The familiar "your" swaps *uṅgaḷ* for **uṉ** (from *nī*): *uṉ peyar eṉṉa?*

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "uṅgaḷ peyar eṉṉa?"
- ask, then answer — "uṅgaḷ peyar eṉṉa?" / "eṉ peyar …"

Before you move on

What does **உங்கள் பெயர் என்ன?** literally say, and what's missing versus English? ("Your name what?"; no "is" — zero copula.)

2.7 மகிழ்ச்சி (magiḻcci) — "joy," and "pleased to meet you"

The warm close — and a sound almost unique to Tamil.

You'll want to know: மகிழ்ச்சி

The full form is ***uṅgaḷai sandittatil magiḻcci*** — "**in having met you, joy**." Say it; the extra two words are longer than you need today, and மகிழ்ச்சி on its own already carries the whole meaning.

In the family, and next door

	word
Kannada	ಸಂತೋಷ (*santōṣa*)
Telugu	సంతోషం (*santōṣam*)
Malayalam	സന്തോഷം (*santōṣaṁ*)
Hindi (neighbour)	आपसे मिलकर ख़ुशी हुई (*āpse milkar khushī huī*)
English	joy / pleased to meet you

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

மகிழ்ச்சி (*magiḻcci*, "joy, gladness") is native Dravidian, from **magiḻ** ("to rejoice"). It carries the letter ழ (*ḻ*) — a retroflex glide almost unique to Tamil, with no English equivalent (the same sound in the name *Tamiḻ* itself). In casual speech, a smile or the English "nice to meet you" also does the job.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "magiḻcci" — feel the ழ (*ḻ*) glide
- the fuller form — "uṅgaḷai sandittatil magiḻcci"

Before you move on

What does மகிழ்ச்சி mean and from what verb? ("Joy," from *magiḻ*, "to rejoice.") What rare Tamil sound does it contain? (ழ, *ḻ* — also in *Tamiḻ*.)

2.8 Chapter 2 — the introduction, whole

Every atom built, and every one of them native Dravidian.

The exchange — the whole introduction

Say this	English
en̲ peyar Mira.	My name is Mira.
uṅgaḷ peyar enn̲a?	What's your name?
en̲ peyar Arun.	My name is Arun.
magi̲lcci.	Pleased to meet you.

Every atom native and traced:

- **peyar** ← Dravidian **peyar* (*not* English *name*)
- **en̲** ← *nān̲* ("I")
- **enn̲a** ← Dravidian question-stem **yā-/*e-*
- **magi̲lcci** ← *magi̲l* ("to rejoice")

And the Tamil habit to keep: the **zero copula** — an equational sentence ("X is Y") needs *no* word for "is" at all. Where Hindi added *hai* and English needs *is*, Tamil says only "my name Arun."

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- the whole exchange, both voices
- your own introduction — "en̲ peyar …"
- ask it back — "uṅgaḷ peyar enn̲a?"

Before you move on

Give your name, ask someone else's, say you're pleased. (*En̲ peyar …. / Uṅgaḷ peyar enn̲a? / Magi̲lcci.*) What does Tamil leave out that English and Hindi require? (The verb "is" — zero copula.) Next chapter: *eppaḍi irukkīṅgaḷ?* ("how are you?") and answering with *nallā* — the responding cycle.

Chapter 3

How Are You?

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (6) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 6 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can ask how someone is in Tamil, answer naturally, and return the question.
>
> *Take the how-are-you exchange both ways out loud: ask it respectfully, answer that you are well, thank them, and wave the thanks away.*

3.1 எப்படி (eppaḍi) — "how," another of the e- questions

You met ***e<u>ṉ</u>ṉa*** ("what") in Chapter 2. Here is its sibling — and, like all of Tamil's question-words, it begins with **e-**.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

எப்படி (*eppaḍi*, "how") is native Dravidian, built on the interrogative base **எ-** (*e-*) + *paḍi* ("manner, way") — literally "in what manner." Notice the pattern: Tamil's questions nearly all start with this **e-** — *e<u>ṉ</u>ṉa* (what), *eppaḍi* (how), *eppōdu* (when), *eṅgē* (where), *ē<u>ṉ</u>* (why), and *yār* (who). Where Hindi and English gather their questions under *k-* / *wh-*, Tamil gathers its own under **e-** — a separate, older family, evolved on its own.

In the family, and next door

	word
Kannada	ಹೇಗೆ (*hēge*)
Telugu	ఎలా (*elā*)
Malayalam	എങ്ങനെ (*eṅṅane*)
Hindi (neighbour)	कैसा (*kaisā*)
English	how

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "eppaḍi"
- the e- question family — *e<u>n</u>na, eppaḍi, eppōdu, eṅgē, ē<u>n</u>*
- what it's built from (*e-* "what" + *paḍi* "manner")

Before you move on

What base do Tamil's question-words share, and how is it different from Hindi's? (The interrogative *e-*; it is native Dravidian, unrelated to Hindi's *k-* / English's *wh-*.)

3.2 நீங்கள் எப்படி இருக்கிறீர்கள்? (nīṅgaḷ eppaḍi irukki<u>r</u>īrgaḷ?)

The everyday "how are you?" — and the first time Tamil actually *needs* a verb "to be."

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

நீங்கள் எப்படி இருக்கிறீர்கள்? = நீங்கள் (*nīṅgaḷ*, "you," respectful) + எப்படி (*eppaḍi*, "how") + இருக்கிறீர்கள் (*irukki<u>r</u>īrgaḷ*, "are/exist") — "you how are?" The verb comes **last**, as in every Tamil sentence.
The verb is இரு (*iru*), "to be, to exist, to stay" — native Dravidian. Inside *irukki<u>r</u>īrgaḷ* that stem carries two endings: *iru* + *-kki<u>r</u>-* (present) + *-īrgaḷ* ("you," respectful/plural) — the three run together exactly as written. A long word, but built of clean pieces, and you can hear all

three.

In the family, and next door

	word
Kannada	ನೀವು ಹೇಗಿದ್ದೀರಾ? (*nīvu hēgiddīrā*)
Telugu	మీరు ఎలా ఉన్నారు? (*mīru elā unnāru?*)
Malayalam	സുഖമാണോ? (*sukhamāṇō?*)
Hindi (neighbour)	आप कैसे हैं? (*āp kaise haiṁ?*)
English	how are you?

Grammar Lens: now the copula returns

In Chapter 2 you learned Tamil drops "is" entirely: *eṉ peyar Arun* ("my name Arun"). That **zero copula** works for *equations* (X is Y). But "how are you?" is about a **state** — how you *exist* right now — and for that Tamil does use a verb, "to be, to exist," the *iru-* at the front of *irukkiṟīrgaḷ*. So: no verb for "my name is Arun," but a real verb for "how are you." The verb ending **-ீர்கள்** (*-īrgaḷ*) already means "you (respectful)," so *nīṅgaḷ* can even be dropped.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- the respectful question — *nīṅgaḷ eppaḍi irukkiṟīrgaḷ?*
- the verb and its meaning (*iru* — "to be / exist / stay")
- why here Tamil needs a verb but "my name is Arun" doesn't (state vs. equation)

Before you move on

What verb does "how are you?" use, and why does this sentence need one when "my name is Arun" didn't? (*Iru*, "to be/exist"; because it describes a state, not an equation — the zero copula only covers X is Y.)

3.3 நான் (nāṉ) — "I," the Dravidian first person

To answer "how are you?" you first need "I." In Chapter 2 you learned *eṉ* ("my"); here is its owner.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

நான் (*nāṉ*, "I") ← Proto-Dravidian ***yāṉ / *nāṉ** — a native first-person word, and (unlike Hindi's *maiṁ*, cousin of English *me*) **not** related to the European "I/me" family at all. Its possessive is the ***eṉ*** ("my") you already met: *nāṉ* "I," *eṉ* "my" — the same root, one standing, one leaning on a noun. Tamil's "I" is one of the clearest markers that Dravidian grew up entirely apart from the Indo-European world around it.

In the family, and next door

	word	same root
Kannada	ನಾನು (*nānu*)	yes
Telugu	నేను (*nēnu*)	yes
Malayalam	ഞാൻ (*ñān*)	yes
Hindi (neighbour)	मैं (*maiṁ*)	
English	I	

Grammar Lens: "I" you can drop

Tamil verbs carry the person in their ending — *irukk-iṟēṉ* already means "**I** am" — so *nāṉ* is often left out once it's clear. You will still learn it first, because the answer to *eppaḍi irukkiṟīrgaḷ?* begins with it.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "nāṉ"
- the pair — *nāṉ* (I), *eṉ* (my)
- is it related to English *me*? (No — Dravidian, a separate family)

Before you move on

What is *nāṉ*'s possessive, and is it cousin to English *me*? (*Eṉ*, "my"; no — it is native Dravidian, unrelated to the Indo-European pronouns.)

3.4 நலம் (nalam) — "well," and how to answer

The word that answers "how are you?" — and a whole family of Tamil "good" grows from it.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

நலம் (*nalam*, "wellness, good, welfare") is native Dravidian, from the root *nal-* ("good") — the same root behind *nalla* ("good," an everyday adjective) and *naṉṟi* ("thanks" — literally "goodness," which you met in Chapter 1). So "thank you" and "I'm well" in Tamil share a root: both are *nal-*, "good." A purely Dravidian word, with no Sanskrit or European cousin — Tamil answering in its own voice.

In the family, and next door

	word
Kannada	ಚೆನ್ನಾಗಿ (*cennāgi*)
Telugu	బాగా (*bāgā*)
Malayalam	സുഖം (*sukham*)
Hindi (neighbour)	ठीक (*ṭhīk*)
English	well, wellness, good

You'll want to know: நலம்

Assemble it: ***nāṉ nalamāga irukkiṟēṉ*** — "**I am well**." The piece *nalam* + *-āga* ("in a … way") makes the adverb *nalamāga* ("well-ly"); *irukkiṟēṉ* is "I am/exist" (the *iru* verb, first person). The whole exchange:

> — *nīṅgaḷ eppaḍi irukkiṟīrgaḷ?* ("How are you?") — *nāṉ nalamāga irukkiṟēṉ, naṉṟi.* ("I'm well, thank you.")

Casually, Tamils shorten it to *nallā irukkēṉ* ("I'm good").

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "nalam"
- the full reply — *nāṉ nalamāga irukkiṟēṉ*
- the root it shares with "thanks" (*nal-* "good," as in *naṉṟi*)

Before you move on

Give the full reply to "how are you?", and name the Chapter-1 word that shares *nalam*'s root. (*Nāṉ nalamāga irukkiṟēṉ*; *naṉṟi*, "thanks" — both from *nal-*, "good.")

3.5 பரவாயில்லை (paravāyillai) — "no problem"

When someone thanks you — or apologises — this is the easy, gracious reply, and it hides one of the most Tamil words there is.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

பரவாயில்லை literally means "**there is no concern**" — *paravāy* ("care, concern") + *illai* ("is-not, there-is-not"). It serves as "it's okay / no worries / never mind / you're welcome." *Paravāy* is a loan: Persian *parvā*, "care, concern," which reached Tamil through Hindustani. The key atom, *illai*, you already met in Chapter 1 — the Tamil word for negation and non-existence, the mirror of *iru* ("to be"). Where *iru* says "it is," *illai* says "it is not." This one word is shared, in almost the same shape, across Tamil, Kannada, and Malayalam (*illa*) — one of the deep bonds of the Dravidian south. (Telugu's *lēdu* looks different, but DEDR 2559 files it with them.)

In the family, and next door

	word	same root
Kannada	ಪರವಾಗಿಲ್ಲ (*paravāgilla*)	yes
Telugu	పరవాలేదు (*paravālēdu*)	yes
Malayalam	സാരമില്ല (*sāramilla*)	
Hindi (neighbour)	आपका स्वागत है (*āpkā svāgat hai*)	
English	it's okay / no problem / you're welcome	

Grammar Lens: *illai*, the all-purpose "no"

Illai negates existence and equations alike: *nāṉ illai* ("it's not me"), *paṇam illai* ("there's no money"). It is also, on its own, one way to say plain "no." Learn *iru* / *illai* together — "is" and "is-not" — and you can already affirm or deny almost anything.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "paravāyillai"
- what it literally means ("there is no harm")
- the *iru* / *illai* pair — "is" and "is-not"

Before you move on

What does *paravāyillai* literally say, and which Dravidian languages share its *illai*? ("There is no harm"; Tamil, Kannada, Malayalam — Telugu uses *lēdu* instead.)

3.6 Chapter 3 — The how-are-you exchange

No new words. The whole responding cycle, from atoms you now own.

The exchange

Say these aloud:

- "How are you?" (respectful) — *nīṅgaḷ eppaḍi irukkiṟīrgaḷ?*
- "I'm well, thank you." — *nāṉ nalamāga irukkiṟēṉ, naṉṟi.*
- "No problem / you're welcome." — *paravāyillai.*
- the casual version — *nallā irukkēṉ.*

Your turn — the atoms

Say these aloud:

- the e- question-word for "how" (*eppaḍi*)
- "I" and the verb "to be" (*nāṉ*, *iru*)
- the "is / is-not" pair (*iru* / *illai*)

What you've built — roots you now carry

- *eppaḍi* ← the interrogative *e-* (native Dravidian, not Hindi's *k-*)
- *nāṉ* ← Proto-Dravidian **nāṉ* (unrelated to English *me*); possessive *eṉ*
- *nalam* ← *nal-* "good" — the same root as *naṉṟi* ("thanks")
- *iru* / *illai* — "to be" and "to be-not"; *illai* shared with Kannada & Malayalam

Grammar lens — what you now hold

- *Say it:* when Tamil needs the verb *iru* and when it drops the copula (state vs. equation)

Before you move on

A stranger asks *nīṅgaḷ eppaḍi irukkiṟīrgaḷ?* — give a full, polite reply, and answer their thanks. (*Nāṉ nalamāga irukkiṟēṉ, naṉṟi* — and to thanks, *paravāyillai.*)

Chapter 4

Farewells

Modes: **voice** (5) **pen** (1) **Hands-free start:** the first 4 of 6 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can end a Tamil conversation politely and choose a farewell that fits the situation.
>
> *Close a conversation the Tamil way out loud: promise to go and come back, answer the same promise, and choose between tomorrow and next-time.*

4.1 ഉപോ (pō) — "go," and *vā* (come)

Two of the shortest, oldest verbs in Tamil — and together they make the Tamil goodbye.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

ഉപോ (*pō*, "to go") and ***vā*** ("to come") are native Dravidian verbs of the deepest layer — single syllables, unchanged for millennia. As bare commands they are already whole words: *pō!* ("go!"), *vā!* ("come!"). You need both for the next lesson, because Tamil does not say a plain "goodbye" — it says "I go, and I **come back**."

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "pō" (go) and "vā" (come)
- the commands — *pō!* / *vā!*

Before you move on

What do *pō* and *vā* mean, and why will you need them both to say goodbye? ("Go" and "come"; the Tamil farewell is "I go and come back," not "I leave.")

4.2 போய் வருகிறேன் (pōy varugiṟēṉ) — "I'll go and come back"

The everyday Tamil goodbye — and it is, quite literally, a promise to return.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

போய் வருகிறேன் = போய் (*pōy*, "having gone") + வருகிறேன் (*varugiṟēṉ*, "I come") — literally "**having gone, I come**," i.e. "**I'll go and come back**." A Tamil speaker never signs off with a bare "I'm leaving" — that sounds final, even ill-omened. Instead they promise return. The reply is warm: ***pōy vā*** ("go and come [back]").

The same promise, in each language's own words:

Language	**"go and come back" (goodbye)**
Tamil	*pōy varugiṟēṉ*
Kannada	*hōgi baruttēne*
Telugu	*veḷḷi vastānu*
Malayalam	*pōyi varāṁ*
Bengali (Indo-Aryan)	*āshi* ("I come")
Hindi (Indo-Aryan)	*phir milenge* ("we'll meet again")

The whole subcontinent, Dravidian and Indo-Aryan alike, prefers a promise of return to a blunt farewell.

Varugiṟēṉ itself is built in three parts: *varu* ("come") + a present-tense marker + *-ēṉ* ("I"). Chapter 5 makes that stem-tense-person pattern explicit; here it is enough to hear the three pieces. Both verbs are native Dravidian: *pō*, "go" (DEDR 4572), and *varu*, "come" (DEDR 5270).

In the family, and next door

	word	same root
Kannada	ಹೋಗಿ ಬರುತ್ತೇನೆ (*hōgi baruttēne*)	yes
Telugu	వెళ్ళి వస్తాను (*veḷḷi vastānu*)	
Malayalam	പോയി വരാം (*pōyi varāṁ*)	yes
Hindi (neighbour)	अलविदा (*alvidā*)	
English	goodbye	

Grammar Lens: the "having ...d" participle

Pōy is Tamil's way of chaining actions: "having gone, (then) I come." Tamil strings verbs like beads — one in the participle "-y" form, the last one fully conjugated. You will see this chaining everywhere.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- the goodbye — *pōy varugiṟēṉ*
- its literal meaning ("having gone, I come" → "I'll come back")
- the warm reply — *pōy vā*

Before you move on

What does the Tamil goodbye literally promise, and how do you answer it? ("I'll go and come back"; reply *pōy vā*, "go and come [back]".)

4.3 நாளை பார்க்கலாம் (nāḷai pārkkalām) — "see you tomorrow"

A goodbye with a date on it — built on the Tamil word for "day."

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

நாளை (*nāḷai*, "tomorrow") is native Dravidian, from நாள் (*nāḷ*, "day") — the same *nāḷ* in *iṉṟu* / *nāḷ* counting and in *nal-vāḻttukkaḷ* ("good [day]-wishes"). பார்க்கலாம் (*pārkkalām*) is "let's see / we may see" — *pār* ("to see, to look") plus the ending *-kkalām*, "let's / we may" — so the whole phrase is "**tomorrow, let's see [each other]**," the Tamil "see you tomorrow." Note the retroflex ள் (*ḷ*) — a sound English lacks entirely, made with the tongue-tip curled up and back.

In the family, and next door

	word
Kannada	ನಾಳೆ ಸಿಗೋಣ (*nāḷe sigōṇa*)
Telugu	రేపు కలుద్దాం (*rēpu kaluddām*)
Malayalam	നാളെ കാണാം (*nāḷe kāṇām*)
Hindi (neighbour)	कल मिलते हैं (*kal milte haiṁ*)
English	see you tomorrow

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "nāḷai pārkkalām"
- the word for "day" inside "tomorrow" (*nāḷ*)
- the verb "to see" (*pār*)

Before you move on

What does *nāḷai* come from, and what does *pārkkalām* add? (*Nāḷ*, "day"; "let's see" — from *pār*, "to see" — so "tomorrow, let's see each other.")

4.4 மீண்டும் சந்திப்போம் (mīṇḍum sandippōm) — "we'll meet again"

A warmer, open-ended goodbye — and a chance to see Tamil's two vocabularies side by side.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

மீண்டும் சந்திப்போம் = மீண்டும் (*mīṇṭum*, "again") + சந்திப்போம் (*sandippōm*, "we will meet") — "**we'll meet again**." Two vocabularies meet in these two words:

- மீண்டும் (*mīṇṭum*, "again") is **native Dravidian**, from *mīḷ* ("to return"). Say it *mīṇ-ṭum*: the *ṇṭ* in the middle is a retroflex pair, both halves made with the tongue curled back, and it is one gesture rather than two.
- சந்தி (*sandi*, "to meet, a junction") is a **Sanskrit** loan — from *sandhi* ("a joining, union"), the very word Sanskrit grammar uses for how sounds join at a word-boundary. The ending on it is *-ppōm*, "we will," so *sandippōm* is "we will meet."

So even a goodbye shows Tamil's balance: an ancient Dravidian core (*mīṇṭum*) beside a Sanskrit borrowing (*sandi*) — the recurring thread of this whole track.

In the family, and next door

	word
Kannada	ಮತ್ತೆ ಸಿಗೋಣ (*matte sigōṇa*)
Telugu	మళ్ళీ కలుద్దాం (*maḷḷī kaluddām*)
Malayalam	വീണ്ടും കാണാം (*vīṇṭuṁ kāṇāṁ*)
Hindi (neighbour)	फिर मिलेंगे (*phir milenge*)
English	we'll meet again

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "mīṇṭum sandippōm"
- which word is native Dravidian and which is Sanskrit (*mīṇṭum* / *sandi*)

Before you move on

What does the phrase mean, and which of its two words is the Sanskrit loan? ("We'll meet again"; *sandi* "to meet" ← Sanskrit

sandhi — while *mīṇḍum* "again" is native Dravidian.)

4.5 Tamil's curves — the writing surface leaves a trace

Before the first letter, look at a line of Tamil and notice what isn't there:

வணக்கம்

Nothing joins the letters together, and there are far fewer corners than in Devanagari — no hanging head-line, and a great deal of curve. (Straight strokes do exist: most of these letters have a flat bar across the top.) The roundness has a usual explanation, and it is the best story in this chapter.

Script you'll notice: The script is the shape of its writing surface

Tamil was written for centuries on **palm leaves**, scratched with a metal stylus and then rubbed with soot to make the scratches show.

A palm leaf has a **grain**, like wood. Draw a long straight line along that grain and the stylus can **split the leaf**. The usual account is that scribes bent their strokes in response: a curve crosses the fibres at an angle instead of running with them.

Treat that as **the standard explanation rather than a settled fact.** The earliest Tamil writing — Tamil-Brahmi, cut into stone and pottery — is noticeably *angular*; the rounding came later, through the Vaṭṭeḻuttu ("round script") stage. And Devanagari was written on the same leaves without going round. So the leaf is one pressure among several, not a complete answer.

It is still worth carrying, because it makes the right general point: **the tool leaves fingerprints on the letters.** Latin's straight strokes suit a wax tablet and a chisel; Tamil's curves suit a stylus and a leaf.

Script you'll notice: The vowel you get for free

Tamil is an **abugida**, like Devanagari: a consonant already contains a vowel.

க is not "k". க is "ka".

Every consonant carries a built-in **a** until a later mark removes or replaces it.

Your turn

- *Say it:* "a consonant carries a built-in **a**"
- *Trace it:* a curve crossing the imagined grain of a palm leaf
- *Contrast:* angular Tamil-Brahmi · later rounded Vaṭṭeḻuttu
- *Say it:* the usual reason for the curves — "a straight line can **split the leaf**"

Before you move on

Why is Tamil round? (The **usual** explanation: it was incised on **palm leaves**, where a straight stroke along the grain can **split** them — though early Tamil-Brahmi was angular, so it is not the whole story.) What broader point does the account teach? (**Tools and surfaces leave fingerprints on scripts.**) Next: the chapter's own recap of the farewells.

4.6 Chapter 4 — The farewells

No new words. Three ways to part — none of them a blunt "goodbye."

Your turn — the farewells

Say these aloud:

- the everyday goodbye — *pōy varugiṟēṉ* ("I'll go and come back")
- the warm reply — *pōy vā* ("go and come back")
- "see you tomorrow" — *nāḷai pārkkalām*
- "we'll meet again" — *mīṇḍum sandippōm*

Your turn — the atoms

Say these aloud:

- the two oldest verbs (*pō* go, *vā* come)
- "day" hidden in "tomorrow" (*nāḷ*)
- which farewell-word is a Sanskrit loan (*sandi* ← *sandhi*)

What you've built — roots you now carry

- *pōy varugiṟēṉ* — "having gone, I come"; the Dravidian promise-of-return goodbye
- *nāḷai* ← *nāḷ* "day"; *pār* "to see"
- *mīṇḍum* (native "again") + *sandi* (Sanskrit "to meet") — the two vocabularies

Before you move on

Why does Tamil never say a plain "I'm leaving," and what does its everyday goodbye promise instead? (It sounds final/ill-omened; *pōy varugiṟēṉ* promises "I'll go and come back.")

Chapter 5

The First Verbs

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) ✓ **pen** (1) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** the first 2 of 6 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can build short present-tense Tamil sentences with the chapter's first verbs.
>
> *Build a short present-tense sentence about yourself out loud — speak, live, work — by putting the stem, the present marker and the person ending together.*

5.1 பேசு (pēsu) — "to speak," your first full verb

So far, "to be." Here is a verb that *does* something — and it shows how Tamil builds "I do X."

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

பேசு (*pēsu*, "to speak") is native Dravidian. The bare stem *pēsu* is also the command "speak!" To say "**I speak**," Tamil adds a two-part ending to the stem: **tense** + **person**:

> *pēsu-* (speak) + *-gi̲r-* (present) + *-ē̲n* ("I") → ***pēsugi̲r̲ē̲n̲***, "I speak."

The ***-ē̲n̲*** ending *is* "I" — so, as with *irukki̲r̲ē̲n̲*, you rarely need the word *nā̲n̲*. Change the ending, change the person: *pēsugi̲r̲ā̲n̲* ("he speaks"), *pēsugi̲r̲ā̲ḷ* ("she speaks"), *pēsugi̲r̲ārgaḷ* ("they/you-respectful speak").

In the family, and next door

	word
Kannada	ಮಾತನಾಡು (*mātanāḍu*)
Telugu	మాట్లాడు (*māṭlāḍu*)
Malayalam	സംസാരിക്കുക (*saṁsārikkuka*)
Hindi (neighbour)	बोलना (*bolnā*)
English	to speak

Grammar Lens: stem + tense + person

Every Tamil verb is built this way — a stem, a tense-marker, a person-ending, stacked in that order and glued together. Learn the pattern once and every verb follows it.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "pēsu" (speak!)
- "I speak" — *pēsugiṟēṉ*
- the three stacked pieces (stem *pēsu* + present *-giṟ-* + "I" *-ēṉ*)

Before you move on

Build "I speak" from *pēsu*, and name the three pieces of a Tamil verb. (*Pēsugiṟēṉ*; stem + tense + person.)

5.2 நான் தமிழ் பேசுகிறேன் (nāṉ tamiḻ pēsugiṟēṉ) — "I speak Tamil"

Your first full, moving sentence — and it names the language itself, with a sound almost no other language has.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

நான் தமிழ் பேசுகிறேன் = நான் (*nāṉ*, "I") + தமிழ் (*tamiḻ*, "Tamil," the object) + பேசுகிறேன் (*pēsugiṟēṉ*, "speak") — "**I Tamil speak**," the verb last as always. The name தமிழ் (*tamiḻ*) is

native (DEDR 3080), of disputed but clearly Dravidian origin (often linked to a sense of "sweetness / one's own speech"); it names one of the oldest living literary languages in the world, with poetry two thousand years old still read today.
That final sound is worth dwelling on. The *ḻ* of *tamiḻ* is a curled retroflex sitting somewhere between an *r*, an *l* and a *zh* — rare enough among the world's languages that Tamil is sometimes called "the *ḻ* language." Getting it approximately right matters more than getting it perfect; nobody will mistake what you mean.

Grammar Lens: no gender on "I speak"

Notice *pēsugiṟēṉ* is the same whether a man or a woman says it — Tamil marks **no gender in the first or second person** (only the third: *pēsugiṟāṉ* he / *pēsugiṟāḷ* she). This is unlike Hindi, where even "I speak" changes for a male or female speaker (*boltā/boltī*). Tamil saves gender for "he/she/it."

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "nāṉ tamiḻ pēsugiṟēṉ"
- the special Tamil sound in *tamiḻ* (the retroflex *ḻ*)
- does "I speak" change for a man vs. a woman? (No — Tamil marks no gender in the 1st person)

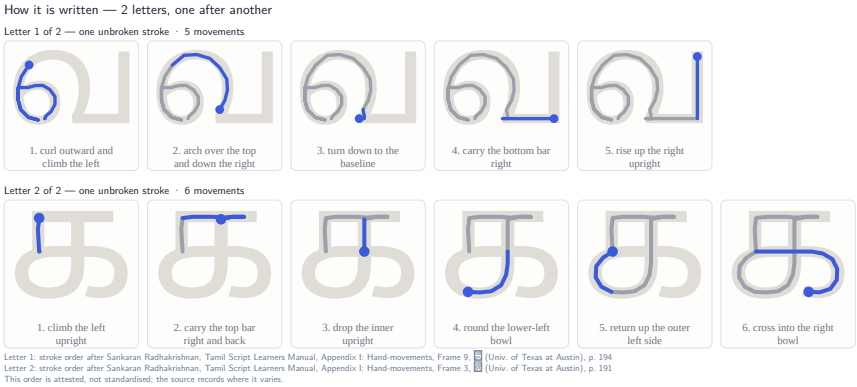
Before you move on

Say "I speak Tamil," and name the rare sound in the word *tamiḻ*. (*Nāṉ tamiḻ pēsugiṟēṉ*; the retroflex *ḻ* — ழ.)

5.3 வ and க — the vowel inside each consonant

Tamil's letters do not join and they carry many curves. Now learn the sound that arrives for free inside every consonant.

Script you'll notice: The vowel you get for free



How these letters are written, one after another, stroke by stroke: வ, க

The last lesson showed that Tamil is an **abugida**: a consonant already carries a built-in **a**. Here are the first two consonants that carry it.

Script you'll notice: வ — "va"

1. **a near-closed loop on the left**
2. **a full-height arm across the top, ending in a descender on the right**

Script you'll notice: க — "ka"

1. **a straight horizontal top bar**
2. **a bowl hanging from its left end**
3. **a short right stroke that hooks left below**

The letters in this word

Devanagari separates क, ख, ग, घ. Tamil uses க across that space: *k* at the start of a word and when doubled (க்க), *g* after a nasal (ங்க), and a softer *h*-like sound between vowels. **Position**, not a new spelling, selects the sound.
Tamil therefore needs only 18 consonant letters where Devanagari needs 33; its native words do not depend on those written distinctions.

Grammar lens

One letter, three sounds — now on the page. Chapter~1 said Tamil picks this sound by position rather than by spelling; here is the letter that does it. Devanagari spells *ka*, *kha*, *ga* and *gha* with four separate letters. Tamil writes க for all of them: *k* at the start of a word and when doubled (க்க), *g* after a nasal (ங்க), and a softer *h*-like sound between vowels. That is why Tamil needs only 18 consonant letters where Devanagari needs 33 — its native words do not depend on those written distinctions.

Your turn

- *Write it:* வ — "left loop, top arm, descender"
- *Write it:* க — "top bar, left bowl, hooking right stroke"
- *Say it:* "க is **ka**, not k"
- *Contrast:* initial *k* · after a nasal *g* · between vowels soft *h*

Before you move on

What does க say alone? (**Ka** — the vowel is inherent.) What kind of script is this? (An **abugida**.) Which sounds can க spell? (*k*, *g*, and a softer *h*-like sound, chosen by **position**.) Draw வ and க.

5.4 வாழ் (vāḻ) — "to live, to flourish"

A second verb — and one of the most beloved words in the language, the one Tamils use to bless.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

வாழ் (*vāḻ*, "to live, to flourish, to thrive") is native Dravidian, and carries more warmth than a plain "to reside." From it grow *vāḻkkai* ("life") and the blessing *vāḻga* ("may you live / long live"), heard in *vāḻga tamiḻ* ("long live Tamil"). To say "I live," add the familiar ending: ***nāṉ ... vāḻgiṟēṉ***, stem + present *-giṟ-* + "I" *-ēṉ*, exactly like *pēsugiṟēṉ*.

Grammar Lens: same engine, new verb

You already know the machine: *vāḻ-* (stem) + *-giṟ-* (present) + *-ēṉ* ("I") → *vāḻgiṟēṉ* ("I live"). Every verb you learn slots into the same three-part frame — that is the reward for learning *pēsu* carefully.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "vāḻ" — feel the retroflex *ḻ*
- "I live" — *nāṉ vāḻgiṟēṉ*
- the blessing — *vāḻga!* ("long live / may you flourish")

Before you move on

Build "I live" from *vāḻ*, and give the blessing made from it. (*Vāḻgiṟēṉ*; *vāḻga!*, "may you live / long live.")

5.5 வேலை செய் (vēlai sey) — "to work"

The last verb of the chapter — and, like Hindi's *karnā*, it is a "do" verb that builds a hundred others.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

செய் (*sey*, "to do, to make") is a core native Dravidian verb, and Tamil — like Hindi with *karnā* — builds compound verbs by putting a noun in front of it:

- வேலை செய் (*vēlai sey*) = "work-do" = "**to work**" (*vēlai*, "work")
- சமையல் செய் (*samaiyal sey*) = "to cook"
- ***udavi sey*** = "to help"

So "I work" is ***nāṉ vēlai seygiṟēṉ*** — *sey-* + *-giṟ-* + *-ēṉ*, "I do work." Master *sey* and a whole grammar of "do-verbs" opens up.

In the family, and next door

	word
Kannada	ಕೆಲಸ ಮಾಡು (*kelasa māḍu*)
Telugu	పని చేయు (*pani cēyu*)
Malayalam	ജോലി ചെയ്യുക (*jōli ceyyuka*)
English	to work

Grammar Lens: noun + செய் = a new verb

This "noun + *sey*" pattern is the exact twin of Hindi's "noun + *karnā*" (*kām karnā*, "to work"). Two unrelated language families — Dravidian and Indo-Aryan — landed on the same clever trick: make an all-purpose "do" verb, then bolt nouns onto it. Living side by side for millennia, Tamil and Hindi have quietly traded habits like this.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "vēlai sey" (to work)
- "I work" — *nāṉ vēlai seygiṟēṉ*
- the Hindi twin of this trick (noun + *karnā*)

Before you move on

How does Tamil turn "work" into "to work," and what Hindi verb works the same way? (*Vēlai* + *sey* = "work-do"; Hindi's *karnā*, as in *kām karnā*.)

5.6 Chapter 5 — The first verbs

No new words. Three verbs, one engine — build real sentences about yourself.

Your turn — build the sentences

Say these aloud:

- "I speak Tamil" — *nāṉ tamiḻ pēsugiṟēṉ*

- "I live in Chennai" — *nāṉ Cheṉṉaiyil vāḻgiṟēṉ*
- "I work" — *nāṉ vēlai seygiṟēṉ*
- "he speaks" vs. "she speaks" — *pēsugiṟāṉ* / *pēsugiṟāḷ*

Grammar lens — the engine

Say these aloud:

- the three stacked pieces of every Tamil verb (stem + tense + person)
- the ending that means "I" (*-ēṉ*)
- where Tamil marks gender — and where it doesn't (3rd person only)

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

All four words in this recap are native Dravidian, and each has a cousin in Malayalam: *pēsu*, "to speak" (DEDR 4430; Malayalam pēcuka), *vāḻ*, "to live" (DEDR 5372; Malayalam vāḻuka), *sey*, "to do" (DEDR 1957; Malayalam ceyka), and *vēlai*, "work" (DEDR 5540; Malayalam vēla).

What you've built — roots you now carry

- *pēsu* "to speak" (native Dravidian)
- *vāḻ* "to live/flourish" → *vāḻkkai* "life," *vāḻga* "long live"
- *sey* "to do" → *vēlai sey* "to work" (the twin of Hindi's *karnā*)
- *tamiḻ* — the language, and its signature retroflex *ḻ*

Before you move on

In one breath, say your language and your work in Tamil, then bless someone with the *vāḻ* verb. (*Nāṉ tamiḻ pēsugiṟēṉ. Nāṉ vēlai seygiṟēṉ. Vāḻga!*)

Chapter 6

Dative Case and Dative Subjects

Modes: **voice** (3) **eyes** (1) **pen** (5) **Hands-free start:** the first of 9 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can attach -உக்கு to a noun in either of its surface forms and say why "I know Tamil" puts the experiencer in the dative instead of giving the sentence a subject.
>
> *Line up* எனக்கு, నాకు, ನನಗೆ *and* എനിക്ക്, *point to the experiencer in each, and paraphrase* எனக்குத் தமிழ் தெரியும் *as "the language is known to me"; rebuild peyarukku, vēlaikku and enakku, say how -ukku stacks where Latin fuses, then point to* வ, ண *and* ம *in* வணக்கம் *and say the retroflex ṇ.*

6.1 -உக்கு (-ukku) — "to, for"

Your first **case ending**. English says "**to** me" with a separate word in front. Tamil says it with a piece **stuck on the back** — and that small difference is the biggest structural fact about the language.

Grammar Lens: Adding it on

Take a noun you know and add **-உக்கு**:

word	**+ the dative**	**meaning**
peyar — name	*peyar**ukku***	to/for the name
vēlai — work	*vēlai**kku***	for work

The suffix has two shapes — **-உக்கு** *-ukku* and **-க்கு** *-kku* — chosen by

the sound the noun ends in. One case, two forms; the seam still shows. And with "I" — this one is irregular and worth memorising, because you'll use it constantly:

nāṉ ("I") → *enakku* ("to me")

The pronoun changes its body (*nāṉ* → *en-*) before the suffix lands. Nouns don't — they just take the ending.

In the family, and next door

	word	**same root**
Kannada	-ಗೆ (*-ge*)	
Telugu	-కు (*-ku*)	yes
Malayalam	-ിക്ക് (*-ikkŭ*)	yes
English	the dative suffix -ukku, 'to / for,' including its two surface forms and irregular enakku	

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

-உக்கு (*-ukku*) is the native Dravidian dative, and the sister languages keep their own forms of it: Malayalam *-kku*, Kannada *-ge* and *-kke*, Telugu *-ku*. It is an ending, not a word, so the etymological dictionary gives it no entry of its own; the match across the family is the evidence.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "*peyar* … *peyarukku*"
- "*nāṉ* … *enakku*" — "I" … "to me"
- "*vēlaikku*" — "for work," from Ch. 5's *vēlai*

Before you move on

What does **-உக்கு** mean? ("**To**" or "**for**.") Where does it go? (**On the end** of the noun — Tamil adds, it doesn't put a word in front.)

What is “to me”? (***enakku*** — the pronoun’s body changes to *en-* first.) Why does the suffix show up as *-ukku* and *-kku*? (**One case, two shapes**, chosen by the noun’s ending.) Next: two more letters — மம and retroflex ண.

6.2 வ — one spiral, one motion

One letter this time. Just one.

It is the first letter of the first word you learned, and it is the easiest one in this book to write: the pen never leaves the paper.

Script you’ll notice: வ

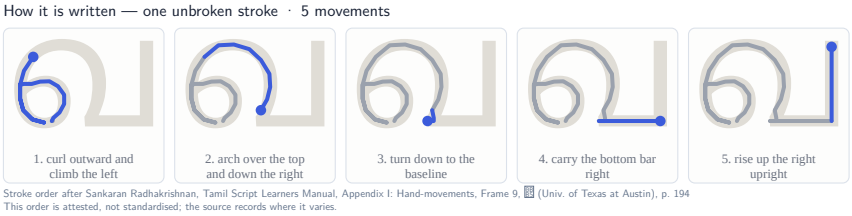
வ — *va*.

What it is made of:

- a spiral loop on the left
- a bottom bar
- a tall right upright

வணக்கம் starts with it, and so does வாழ் — *to live*.

Writing: வ



How வ *is written, stroke by stroke*

- **1.** start at the inner curl and spiral outward, climbing the left side
- **2.** without lifting, arch over the top and descend on the right
- **3.** without lifting, turn down to the baseline

- **4.** without lifting, carry the bottom bar to the right
- **5.** without lifting, rise up the right upright — and only now lift

Pen lifts: 0. The pen never leaves the paper.

Stroke order is one attested teaching order, not a national standard — Tamil handwriting is taught with school-to-school variation. Source: Sankaran Radhakrishnan, Tamil Script Learners Manual, Appendix I: Hand-movements, Frame 9, வ (Univ. of Texas at Austin), p. 194.

Your turn

- *Trace it:* வ once, slowly, following the steps above
- *Say it:* "va" as you finish it
- *Trace it:* it twice more, without looking back at the steps

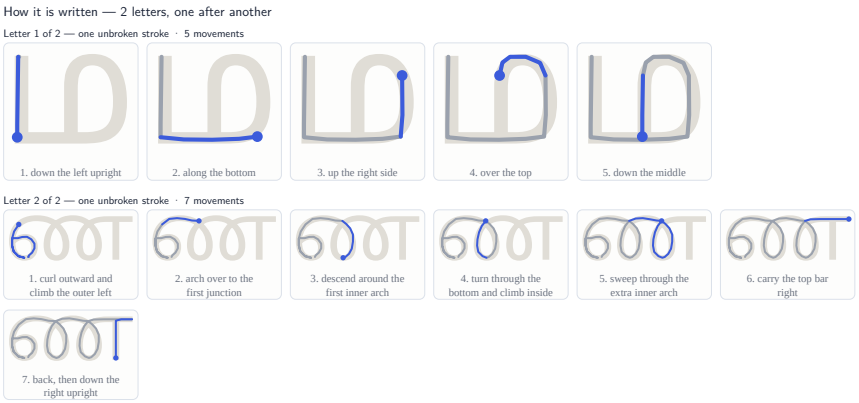
Before you move on

How many times does the pen lift while writing வ? (**None** — one unbroken motion.) What sound does it carry on its own? (**va**.)

6.3 ம and ண — a loop, and a curled tongue

Two more letters, and with them you'll have every letter of this book's first word. One is easy. The other is a sound you may not be able to hear yet.

Script you'll notice: ம



How these letters are written, one after another, stroke by stroke: ம, ணா

1. **a straight vertical stroke on the LEFT**
2. **a horizontal along the bottom**
3. **a rounded arch closing it on the RIGHT**

Get the sides the right way round. The **upright is on the left** and the **curve on the right** — which is the reverse of what most people guess, and the reverse of the Devanagari habit of hanging a shape off a right-hand spine.

Script you'll notice: ணா

1. **a straight top bar**
2. **a loop on the left**
3. **two arches**
4. **a straight vertical on the right, down to the baseline**

The dot under the romanization — **ṇ**, not plain *n* — is doing real work.

The letters in this word

Say English **n**. Your tongue touches just behind your teeth.
Now curl the tip of your tongue **up and back** toward the roof of your mouth, and say it again. That is **ṇ**, and it is a different letter in Tamil. English has no such sound and no way to write one, which is why an English speaker typically **cannot hear the difference at first**. That is expected. The ear learns it after the hand does, which is one good argument for writing the letters rather than only reading them.
Retroflex sounds are a signature of the languages of India — they show up across Tamil, Telugu, Kannada, Malayalam, Hindi and Sanskrit alike, in families that are otherwise unrelated to each other. It's one of the features that makes South Asia a *linguistic area*: neighbouring languages that borrowed a sound from each other rather than inheriting it.

Your turn

- *Write it:* ம — "left upright, bottom, **right** arch"
- *Write it:* ண — "top bar, left loop, **two** arches, straight vertical"
- *Say it:* plain *n*, then curl the tongue back — **ṇ**

Before you move on

Draw ம — which side is the upright on? (**The left**; the arch closes it on the right.) Draw ண — what makes it *not* ன? (**One extra arch**: ண has **two** arches where ன has one. Both end in the same straight vertical.) What does the dot in **ṇ** mean? (**Retroflex** — the tongue curls **back** to the roof of the mouth.) Why can't you hear it yet? (**English has no such sound**; the ear learns it after the hand.) Next: stacking that dative suffix where Latin would fuse several meanings.

6.4 -உக்கு — one carriage in a suffix train

You can point to *peyar* and *-ukku* separately. That visible seam is the structural lesson.

Grammar Lens: Stacking versus fusion

	Tamil -ukku	**Latin -īs**
fixes the case?	**dative**, always	dative **or** ablative
carries number?	no; another suffix can	plural is baked in
carries declension?	no	first/second class is baked in
visible seam?	**peyar + ukku**	one fused ending

Tamil **stacks**. Each suffix contributes one meaning in a fixed order, like a train carriage. Latin **fuses** case, number, and class into an indivisible ending, and *-īs* does not even identify one case by itself. This is **agglutinative** structure: long words remain buildable because their pieces stay legible. The comparison is not about simplicity; it is about where the grammatical information lives.

Your turn

- *Break apart: peyar + ukku*
- *Say it:* "one suffix, one meaning, visible seam"
- *Contrast:* Tamil stacks · Latin fuses

Before you move on

What does *-ukku* contribute? (**Dative to/for**, one meaning.) What does Latin *-īs* fuse? (**Case, plural number, and declension class**.) Which system leaves the seam visible? (**Tamil's agglutinative stack**.)

6.5 எனக்குத் தமிழ் தெரியும் — "I know Tamil"

In Chapter 5 you said ***nāṉ tamiḻ pēsugiṟēṉ*** — "**I** speak Tamil," with *nāṉ* as the subject. Now say "I **know** Tamil." Tamil will not let you use *nāṉ*.

You'll want to know: The sentence

எனக்குத் தமிழ் தெரியும். *enakku tamiḻ teriyum.* literally: "**to-me** Tamil is-known."

Word by word:

piece	
எனக்கு(த்) *enakku(t)*	"to me" — the dative from the last lesson
தமிழ் *tamiḻ*	Tamil (Ch. 5)
தெரியும் *teriyum*	"is known / is apparent"

Enakku and *teriyum* are Dravidian (DEDR 5160, 3419).

That extra த் on *enakku* is **sandhi** — a joining consonant Tamil inserts between certain words to smooth the seam. It belongs to neither word on its own; it exists only because they are next to each other. Nothing to learn yet; you will see it constantly.

You are not the subject. *Nāṉ* is gone — the person has been moved into the dative. What's left in the plain, unmarked form is *tamiḻ*: the sentence is now about **the language**, and you are merely the one it is known **to**.

(Grammarians call *enakku* the **dative subject**, because it behaves like the subject even though it isn't in the subject case. The odd feeling of the sentence is exactly that split.)

In the family, and next door

	word
Kannada	ನನಗೆ ಕನ್ನಡ ಗೊತ್ತು (*nanage kannaḍa gottu*)
Telugu	నాకు తెలుగు వచ్చు (*nāku telugu vaccu*)
Malayalam	എനിക്ക് മലയാളം അറിയാം (*enikkŭ malayāḷaṁ aṟiyāṁ*)
English	'I know Tamil'

Grammar Lens: Why: things that happen *to* you

Tamil sorts verbs by whether you **do** something or something **happens to** you. Speaking is something you do — so Ch. 5 used *nāṉ*. But knowing, liking, wanting, being hungry, being cold: these arrive at you. Tamil marks that by putting the person in the **dative**.

English frames it as	Tamil frames it as
I **know** Tamil	Tamil is known **to me**
I **like** it	it is pleasing **to me**
I **am** cold	cold is **to me**

English does this occasionally and archaically — "**methinks**" is exactly it (*me* is dative: "it seems **to me**"). Tamil made it a rule.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "*enakku tamiḻ teriyum*"
- the contrast — "*nāṉ tamiḻ pēsugiṟēṉ*" (I speak) … "*enakku tamiḻ teriyum*" (known to me)
- the literal — "to-me Tamil is-known"

Before you move on

What does எனக்குத் தமிழ் தெரியும் literally say? ("**To-me** Tamil **is-known**.") Which word has English got that Tamil hasn't? (A nominative "**I**" — *nāṉ* is replaced by the dative *enakku*.) Why does Tamil use the dative here? (Because knowing **happens to** you; you don't **do** it.) Which English word preserves the same idea? (**Methinks** — "it seems **to me**".) Next: watch all four Dravidian sisters use the same experiencer shape.

6.6 -ukku, -ku, -ge, -ikku — the family shows its bones

Tamil says knowing happens **to** you. Its three closest sisters make the same grammatical choice.

Grammar Lens: Four sentences, one construction

language	"I know [the language]"	dative
Tamil	*enakku tamiḻ teriyum*	**-ukku**
Telugu	*nāku telugu vaccu*	**-ku**
Kannada	*nanage kannaḍa gottu*	**-ge**
Malayalam	*enikku malayāḷam aṟiyām*	**-ikku**

The verbs differ, but the experiencer sits in a dative whose forms visibly belong together: *-ukku / -ku / -ge / -ikku*. This is family evidence, just as *blanc/bianco/branco* exposes Romance kinship. The comparison also makes cross-language practice useful: once you recognize "to me," you can search for the known or apparent thing rather than forcing an English subject onto the sentence.

Your turn

- *Say it:* "-ukku · -ku · -ge · -ikku"
- *Point to:* the experiencer in each sentence
- *Put it another way:* "the language is known to me"

Your turn — the ending underneath

- Say "for the name", then "for work". (***peyarukku***, ***vēlaikku*** — one case, two shapes, picked by the noun's ending.) And "to me"? (***enakku*** — *nāṉ* changes its body to *en-* first.)
- How is *-ukku* unlike Latin *-īs*? (**One** meaning, seam visible — Tamil **stacks**; Latin **fuses** case, number and class.)
- Why the dative for knowing? (Knowing **happens to** you; speaking you **do**.)

Script — வ, ம and ண

வணக்கம்

- *Point to:* வ, then ண, then ம

- *Say it:* plain *n*, then curl the tongue back — **ṇ**

(வ: *va*, one motion, no pen lift. ம: upright on the **left**, arch on the right. ண: **two** arches; its dot-*ṇ* is **retroflex**, tongue curled back.)

Before you move on

Do the four sisters agree on dative experiencers? (**Yes**.) Which four suffix shapes reveal the relationship? (***-ukku, -ku, -ge, -ikku***.) What stays plain in the sentence? (The thing **known or experienced**.)

6.7 ண — the first of three n's

Before the new one: say the sound of வ.

One letter this time. Just one.

Tamil has three different letters for sounds English hears as one *n*. This is the first, and the dot under its romanization — **ṇ**, not plain *n* — is doing real work: the tongue curls back to the roof of the mouth. Words genuinely differ by it.

Script you'll notice: ண

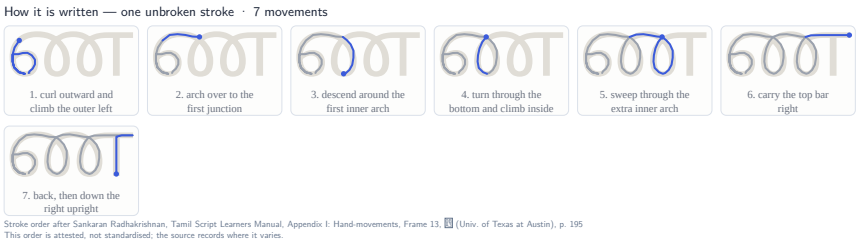
ண — *ṇa*.

What it is made of:

- a spiral loop on the left
- TWO rounded inner arches
- a straight top bar
- a straight vertical on the right, hanging from the bar down to the baseline

It is the second letter of வணக்கம்.

Writing: ணா



How ணா is written, stroke by stroke

- **1.** start in the lower-left curl and spiral outward, climbing the outer left side
- **2.** without lifting, arch over the top of the left loop to the first junction
- **3.** without lifting, descend around the outside of the first inner arch
- **4.** without lifting, turn through its bottom and climb the inside back to the first junction
- **5.** without lifting, sweep through the extra inner arch — over its top, around its outside and bottom, then up its inside to the right junction
- **6.** without lifting, carry the top bar to the right edge
- **7.** without lifting, come back along the bar to the right upright and draw it straight down — and only now lift

Pen lifts: 0. The pen never leaves the paper.

Stroke order is one attested teaching order, not a national standard — Tamil handwriting is taught with school-to-school variation. Source: Sankaran Radhakrishnan, Tamil Script Learners Manual, Appendix I: Hand-movements, Frame 13, ணா (Univ. of Texas at Austin), p. 195.

Your turn

- *Trace it:* ணா once, slowly, following the steps above
- *Say it:* "ṇa" as you finish it
- *Trace it:* it twice more, without looking back at the steps

Before you move on

Where does the tongue go for ணா? (**Curled back**, to the roof of the mouth.) How many pen lifts? (**None** — the bar runs back into the upright.)

6.8 ந, ன, ண — three stops on one tongue-map

English writes one *n*. Tamil keeps three tongue positions apart.

Script you'll notice: The backward walk



How these letters are written, one after another, stroke by stroke: ந, ன, ண

letter	sound	tongue
ந	*na*	against the **teeth** (dental)
ன	*n̲a*	on the **ridge** behind the teeth (alveolar)
ண	*ṇa*	**curled back** to the roof (retroflex)

Move backward: teeth → ridge → curled roof. English spells all three with one letter and initially hears them as the same sound; Tamil uses separate letters because its words depend on the contrast.

You will draw ந and ன when *nandri* needs them. For now compare the last pair: **ண is ன with one extra arch**. Both open with a top bar and loop and finish with the same vertical. ன has one middle arch; ண has two.

Retroflex sounds occur across unrelated South Asian language families. That shared geography makes the region a **linguistic area**: neighbors can borrow a sound pattern without inheriting it from one ancestor.

Your turn

- *Say it:* dental ந at the teeth
- *Say it:* alveolar ன at the ridge
- *Say it:* retroflex ண with the tongue curled back
- *Trace it:* one arch in ன · two arches in ண

Before you move on

How many n-letters does Tamil have? (**Three**.) What separates them? (Tongue position: **dental, alveolar, retroflex**.) Which two differ by one arch? (ன has one; ண has two.) Next: the numbers one to five.

6.9 ⊔ — one character, met inside words you already say

Curvy and loopy with flat top-bars on many letters, repeated arches, and no continuous head-line.

One character this time. Just one — and you have been saying it for pages without knowing which mark on the page it was.

Script you'll notice: ப

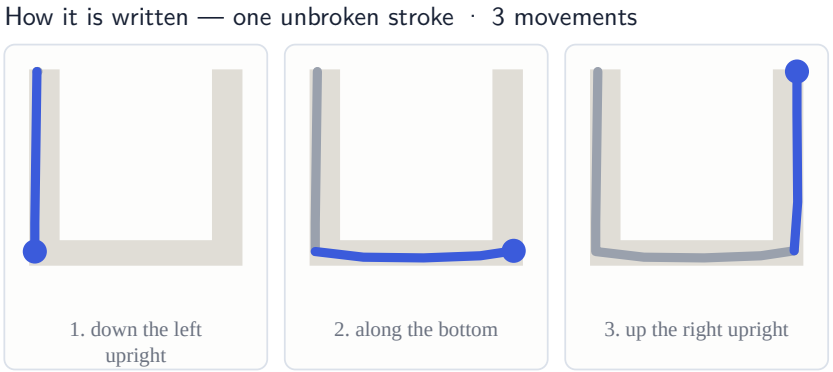
ப — *pa*.

It is a **consonant**, and in this script a consonant is never bare: it comes with an *a* already in it. So it is not *p*, it is **pa**.

You already say these, and every one of them has ப somewhere inside it:

- பெயர் *peyar* — name
- என் பெயர் **...** *en̲ peyar* … — my name is… (with no "is")
- எப்படி *eppaḍi* — how
- பரவாயில்லை *paravāyillai* — it's okay / no problem / you're welcome

Writing: ப — follow the numbered strip



Stroke order after Sankaran Radhakrishnan, Tamil Script Learners Manual, Frame 1, (University of Texas at Austin, 2009)
This order is attested, not standardised; the source records where it varies.

How ப is written, stroke by stroke

Follow the numbered strip: start where movement 1 begins, and let each panel show you the next movement before your pen makes it. Then write ப yourself — slowly, and larger than it is printed.

The strip shows **where to start the character and which way to travel**, in one attested order. That is taught with real variation from school to school, so the strip names its source beneath it: treat it as a sound way in, not the only one.

Your turn

- *Look:* at these words, and find ப in the ones that have it

  பெயர் · வணக்கம்

- *Trace it:* ப three times, saying *pa* as you finish each one
- *Look:* back at any page of this chapter and find ப once more

Before you move on

Which character is this — ப? What sound does it carry? (***pa***.) Name one word you already say that contains it.

Chapter 7

Numbers One to Ten

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (4) ✓ **pen** (16) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** the first of 20 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can hear, say, read, and write representative numbers from one to ten in Tamil and recognize their Dravidian family history.
>
> *Count onru to pattu, read all ten Tamil numeral shapes out of order, write eezhu with its numeral from sound alone, and recall the pattu/hattu relationship.*

7.1 One to five — voice first

Keep your pencil down. Hear five Tamil number words, attach each to a quantity, and say them before your eyes meet Tamil writing.

The letters in this word

quantity	said
1	***onru***
2	***irantu***
3	***muunru***
4	***naanku***
5	***aintu***

Count up aloud, one word to each beat: *onru, irantu, muunru, naanku, aintu. Twice through:*
These are inherited Dravidian words, not borrowed Sanskrit number

names. The family history can wait until the sounds and quantities feel secure.

Your turn

- *Hear: muunru*, then say the number — three
- *Hear: aintu*, then say the number — five
- *Say it: onru* through *aintu*, one number to each beat

Before you move on

Count from one to five without looking. Which word means two? (***Irantu.***) Are these forms borrowed from Sanskrit? (**No.**) Next, only three numeral shapes arrive.

7.2 க · ஒ · ரு — three numeral shapes

Say *onru, irantu, muunru*. The meanings and sounds are familiar; this lesson adds only their three numeral shapes.

Script

- க means 1: *onru*.
- ஒ means 2: *irantu*.
- ரு means 3: *muunru*.

Point in order, then out of order: ரு க ஒ.

Writing — observe and trace

Keep the models visible. Finger-trace க, ஒ, and ரு once each. Say the number word only after your finger stops. Do not copy from memory yet.

Before you move on

Point to ஒ and say it. (***Irantu.***) Which shape means three? (ரு.) How many new shapes arrived? (**Three.**)

7.3 சா · ஞ — finish the first five numerals

Read க உ ங. Two shapes remain in the first group.

Script

- சா means 4: *naanku*.
- ஞ means 5: *aintu*.

Point through க உ ங சா ஞ once.

Writing — observe and trace

Keep both models visible. Trace சா once and ஞ once. Then circle the one you hear: *Hear: aintu*. (ஞ.)

Before you move on

Which shape means four? (சா.) Read ஞ. (***Aintu.***) This lesson added two shapes, not five.

7.4 Five familiar words — now in Tamil script

Say one to five, then read க உ ங சா ஞ. No new numeral shape appears below.

Script

numeral	word	said
க	ஒன்று	*onru*
உ	இரண்டு	*irantu*
ங	மூன்று	*muunru*
சா	நான்கு	*naanku*
ஞ	ஐந்து	*aintu*

Follow each word with your finger while saying it. The letters have appeared earlier; this step only joins familiar pieces.

Writing — observe and trace

Trace ஒன்று — க once with the model visible. Read the other four rows; do not copy the whole table yet.

Before you move on

Read ங — மூன்று. (***Muunru**, three.*) Which word belongs to ஞ? (ஐந்து, *aintu.*) No new shape was added.

7.5 க உ ங ச ஞ — one visible copy

Point through க உ ங ச ஞ and say the five words. Keep the row visible.

Writing — guided copy

Copy the row once beneath its model. Look back after every shape if needed. Say *onru* through *aintu* as you check. Repair only one shape.

Before you move on

Read ச. (***Naanku.***) No new shape was added here.

7.6 Five numerals — hide, then write

Study க உ ங ச ஞ for five seconds. Say each number, then cover the row.

Writing — delayed copy

Write the five numerals in order while the model is hidden. Peek once if one will not come, cover it again, and continue. Uncover and repair one place.

Before you move on

What changed from the previous lesson? (**The model was hidden before writing.**)

7.7 Three heard numbers — write their numerals

Cover the answer line. You will hear familiar words, never an untaught form.

Writing — dictation

Hear: irantu — aintu — muunru

Write the three numeral shapes from sound alone. Then uncover: ೭ ൫ ൱. Repair one shape if needed; do not rewrite the line.

Before you move on

Write the numeral for *naanku* from sound alone. (൪.) Now the Dravidian family lesson can deepen forms you can already hear and read.

7.8 Two to five — one family in four regional coats

Hindi's number forms are Sanskrit worn smooth. Tamil's are native Dravidian, so their sister-language shapes reveal the family directly.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

number	Tamil	Kannada / Telugu / Malayalam
2	*iraṇṭu*	*eraḍu* / *reṇḍu* / *raṇṭu*
3	*mūṉṟu*	*mūru* / *mūḍu* / *mūnnu*
4	*nāṉku*	*nālku* / *nālugu* / *nālu*
5	*aintu*	*aidu* / *aidu* / *añcu*

Each row is one word in four regional coats. That shared skeleton is why one Dravidian language gives you a running start on another. **One** is less tidy: Tamil *oṉṟu*, Kannada *ondu*, and Malayalam *onnu* share old *oṉ-*, while Telugu uses the separate formation *okaṭi*. The family agrees more neatly on 2–5 than on 1.

The letters in this word

In *on̲ṟu* and *mūn̲ṟu*, ன்ற is alveolar *n* running into hard *ṟ*, almost one knock: *on-ru, muun-ru*. Puḷḷi on ன் removes its vowel before the cluster.

Your turn

- *Say it:* "iraṇṭu · eraḍu · reṇḍu · raṇṭu"
- *Say it: on̲ṟu* and *mūn̲ṟu*, holding ன்ற together
- *Identify:* Telugu *okaṭi* as the different "one"

Before you move on

Are these forms borrowed? (**No**, native Dravidian.) Which numbers stay tidiest across the family? (**Two through five**.) Which language forms "one" differently? (**Telugu**, *okaṭi*.)

7.9 Six to ten — voice first

Count *onru* through *aintu*. Keep your pencil down: five new meanings and sounds come before their shapes.

The letters in this word

quantity	said
6	***aaru***
7	***eezhu***
8	***ettu***
9	***onpatu***
10	***pattu***

Say the row once slowly, then once at counting speed. *Twice through.*

Why it's said this way

The middle of *eezhu*, seven, has Tamil's characteristic curled *zh*. Practise the sound now; its letter waits.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

Nine, *onpatu*, is usually read as one plus ten: one short of *pattu*. Say *on-patu*, then *onpatu*. The word is native Dravidian (DEDR 1025), and how it was built is uncertain: DEDR sets it beside both "one" and an older word for nine.

Your turn

- *Say it: aaru, eezhu, ettu, onpatu, pattu*
- *Hear: eezhu*, then say the number — seven
- *Hear: onpatu*, then say the number — nine

Before you move on

Count six to ten. Which word keeps the curled *zh*? (***Eezhu.***) Which word leans on ten? (***Onpatu****, nine.*) Next, three numeral shapes.

7.10 சஊ · எ · அ — three more numeral shapes

Say *aaru, eezhu, ettu.* Only their shapes are new.

Script

- சஊ means 6: *aaru.*
- எ means 7: *eezhu.*
- அ means 8: *ettu.*

Point out of order: அ சஊ எ.

Writing — observe and trace

Trace சஊ, எ, and அ once each with the models visible. Say the word after each trace. Memory writing waits.

Before you move on

Which shape means seven? (எ.) Read அ. (***Ettu.***) Three new shapes arrived.

7.11 கூ · ய — nine and ten

Read சூ எ அ. Two shapes finish the row.

Script

- கூ means 9: *onpatu*.
- ய means 10: *pattu*.

Point through சூ எ அ கூ ய once.

Writing — observe and trace

Trace கூ once and ய once with their models visible. Circle the one you hear: *Hear: onpatu*. (கூ.)

Before you move on

Which shape means ten? (ய.) Read கூ. (***Onpatu.***) Two new shapes arrived.

7.12 Six to ten — now in Tamil script

Say six to ten, then read சூ எ அ கூ ய. No new numeral shape appears below.

Script

numeral	word	said
சூ	ஆறு	*aaru*
எ	ஏழு	*eezhu*
அ	எட்டு	*ettu*
கூ	ஒன்பது	*onpatu*
ய	பத்து	*pattu*

The curled sound you heard in *eezhu* is ழ. Follow ஏழு with your finger while saying it; every shape has had earlier support.

Writing — observe and trace

Trace ஏழு — எ once with the model visible. Read the remaining rows without copying the whole table.

Before you move on

Which letter carries the curled sound? (ழ.) Read எ — ஏழு. (***Eezhu**, seven.*) No new shape was added.

7.13 சூ எ அ கூ யி — one supported copy

Read சூ எ அ கூ யி. Keep both models below visible.

Writing — guided copy

Copy சூ எ அ கூ யி once. Then copy ஏழு — எ once. Look back whenever you need. Check only one place, then stop.

Before you move on

Read your copied word. (***Eezhu**, seven.*) Which numeral belongs beside it? (எ.)

7.14 ன — the second n, and how to tell it from ண

Before the new one: say the sound of ண.

One letter this time. Just one.

Look at ண and ன side by side. Same spiral loop, same top bar, same upright on the right. The whole difference is **how many arches sit inside**: ண has two, ன has one. That is the entire distinction, and it is why these two are learned together rather than a chapter apart.

Script you'll notice: ன

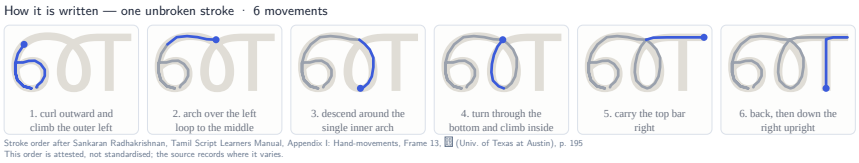
ன — *n̲a*.

What it is made of:

- a spiral loop on the left
- ONE rounded inner arch
- a straight top bar
- a straight vertical on the right, hanging from the bar down to the baseline

It ends நான் — *I* — and நன்றி's second syllable.

Writing: ன



How ன *is written, stroke by stroke*

- **1.** start in the lower-left curl and spiral outward, climbing the outer left side
- **2.** without lifting, arch over the top of the left loop to the middle junction
- **3.** without lifting, descend around the outside of the single inner arch
- **4.** without lifting, turn through its bottom and climb the inside back to the top junction
- **5.** without lifting, carry the top bar to the right edge
- **6.** without lifting, come back along the bar to the right upright and draw it straight down — and only now lift

Pen lifts: 0. The pen never leaves the paper.

Stroke order is one attested teaching order, not a national standard — Tamil handwriting is taught with school-to-school variation. Source: Sankaran Radhakrishnan, Tamil Script Learners Manual, Appendix I: Hand-movements, Frame 13, ன (Univ. of Texas at Austin), p. 195.

Your turn

- *Trace it:* ன once, slowly, following the steps above
- *Say it:* "n̲a" as you finish it
- *Trace it:* it twice more, without looking back at the steps

Before you move on

What separates ண from ன? (**Two inner arches against one.**) Which one is this? (ன, one arch.)

7.15 ஏழு — hide, then write

Study ஏழு — ஏ for five seconds. Say *eezhu*, then cover both forms.

Writing — delayed copy

Write the word and numeral while the model is hidden. Peek once if needed, cover again, and finish. Uncover and repair one shape.

Before you move on

Which letter carries the curled sound? (ழ.) What changed from guided copy? (**The model was hidden before writing.**)

7.16 Heard numbers — write without a model

Cover the answer line. Every sound and shape has had a supported turn.

Writing — dictation and transcription

Hear: aaru — eezhu — onpatu

Write the three numerals from sound alone. For *eezhu*, also write the word. Then uncover: ௬ — ௭ ஏழு — ௯. Repair one place.

Before you move on

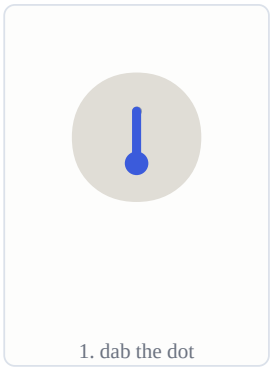
Write the numeral for *pattu*. (൰.) Write seven. (ஏழு.) Next, compare only forms you can already hear and read.

7.17 ◌் — the dot that leaves both letters visible

Every consonant carries a built-in **a**. So how do you write a consonant with **no** vowel — the *k* in *vaṇakkam*, or the *m* at the end?

One dot.

Script you'll notice: The puḷḷi



Stroke order after Abhinaya Rajarajan, Varai (Swift Student Challenge 2026), reference drawings recorded by hand for the 18 Tamil consonants with pulli, [illegible] to [illegible] (repository commit 952294fa, no licence: facts only)
This order is attested, not standardised; the source records where it varies.

How ◌் is written, stroke by stroke

க = *ka* → க் = *k*

புள்ளி (*puḷḷi*) means simply **"the dot."** Written above a letter, it removes the inherent vowel. That's the whole rule.

A standing note for this whole track. These lessons quote real Tamil words and examples, and most of them contain letters the track has not taught you to draw yet — *puḷḷi*'s own name uses ப, ள and the ◌ள sign, and the comparisons below reach for others again. **Read anything printed here; only draw the letters a lesson has actually broken into strokes.** The data file behind this track covers 11 letters so far and says so (`complete: false`) — it grows as the chapters need it.

Script you'll notice: What Tamil does *not* do

If you have done the Devanagari track, this is the moment to notice a real divergence.

In Devanagari, killing the vowel makes the bare consonant **fuse** with the next one into a squeezed **conjunct** — स् + त becomes स्त, and the first letter loses its spine. The virama usually disappears into the ligature.

Tamil doesn't do that. The dot stays visible, and both letters keep their full shape:

Devanagari	स् + त → स्त — a new fused shape
Tamil	க் + க → க்க — two letters, dot intact

The consequence is arithmetic. Tamil's whole set is **247 characters**: 12 vowels + 18 consonants + the 216 consonant-vowel combinations + the **āytam** ஃ. That is genuinely all of them. Devanagari's conjuncts run to many hundreds of ligature shapes on top of its letters, each to be learned or at least recognised.

(One honest exception: Tamil does have a few **ligatures borrowed with Sanskrit words** — க்ஷ *kṣa* and ஸ்ரீ *śrī*. They sit outside the 18 native consonants and outside the 247.)

Your turn

Write these out:

- க் — "க, then the dot above"
- க்க — two full letters, dot intact, **no fusing**

Before you move on

What does the **puḷḷi** do, and what does the word mean? (Removes the **inherent vowel**; *puḷḷi* is simply "**the dot**".) What does Devanagari do that Tamil doesn't? (**Fuses** the letters into a **conjunct** — Tamil keeps both shapes and the dot.) What does Tamil get in exchange? (A **much smaller character set** — 247, with **almost** no ligatures: only the borrowed ஶ and ஸ்ரீ.) Next: six, seven and ten across the family.

7.18 Six to ten — family resemblances and one Kannada shift

The Tamil forms are learned. Now use their sister shapes as evidence for inheritance and regular sound change.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

Six and seven remain close: Tamil *āṟu*, Kannada *āru*, Malayalam *āṟu*; Tamil *ēḻu*, Kannada *ēḷu*, Malayalam *ēḻu*. Tamil and Malayalam also keep eight and nine nearly identical: *eṭṭu* and *oṉpatu/onpatu*.
Telugu wanders on eight and nine with *enimidi* and *tommidi*, so those forms are less reliable as family-wide recognition anchors.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

Tamil and Malayalam say **pattu**, while Kannada says **hattu**. The initial $p \rightarrow h$ is a regular Kannada shift, not a random replacement. Compare Tamil *pāl*, "milk," with Kannada *hālu*.
A correspondence lets differences prove relationship: repeated *p/h* pairs are stronger evidence than one accidental resemblance.

Your turn

- *Say it:* Tamil *pattu* · Kannada *hattu*
- *Say it:* Tamil *pāl* · Kannada *hālu*
- *Identify:* *ēḻu* / *ēḷu* / *ēḻu* as one inherited seven

Before you move on

What happens to Tamil *pattu* in Kannada? (*P* regularly softens to ***h***: *hattu*.) Which second pair confirms the pattern? (*Pāl / hālu*, "milk.") Which language diverges most on eight and nine? (**Telugu**.)

7.19 ோ — one character, met inside words you already say

Before the new one: ப — what does it do?

One character this time. Just one — and you have been saying it for pages without knowing which mark on the page it was.

Script you'll notice: ோ

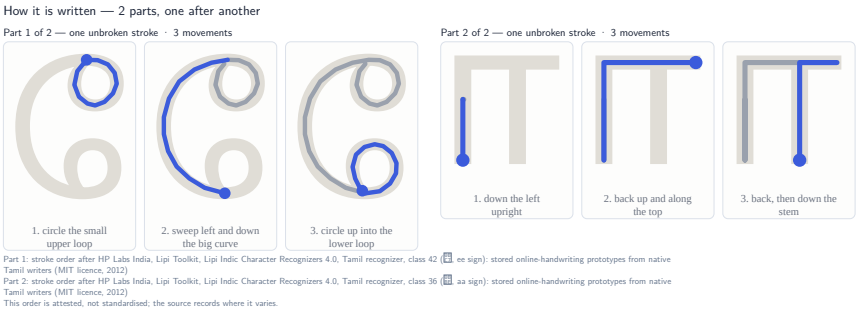
ோ — *ō*.

It is a **vowel sign**. It is not a letter and never stands alone: it attaches to a consonant and **replaces** the *a* built into it with *ō*. Replaces, not adds — the *a* is gone.

You already say these, and every one of them has ோ somewhere inside it:

- போய் வருகிறேன் *pōy varugiṟēṉ* — goodbye (lit. "I'll go and come back")
- மீண்டும் சந்திப்போம் *mīṇḍum sandippōm* — we'll meet again

Writing: ோ — follow the numbered strip



Part 1: stroke order after HP Labs India, Lipi Toolkit, Lipi Indic Character Recognizers 4.0, Tamil recognizer, class 42 (ே ee sign): stored online-handwriting prototypes from native Tamil writers (MIT licence, 2012)
Part 2: stroke order after HP Labs India, Lipi Toolkit, Lipi Indic Character Recognizers 4.0, Tamil recognizer, class 36 (ா aa sign): stored online-handwriting prototypes from native Tamil writers (MIT licence, 2012)
This order is attested, not standardised; the source records where it varies.

How ோ is written, part by part, stroke by stroke

Follow the numbered strip: it writes ோ in two parts, the left part first, each drawn movement by movement. Then write ோ yourself — slowly, and larger than it is printed.

> The strip shows **where to start the character and which way to travel**, in one attested order. That is taught with real variation from school to school, so the strip names its source beneath it: treat it as a sound way in, not the only one.

Your turn

- *Look:* at these words, and find ோ in the ones that have it

  வணக்கம்

- *Trace it:* ோ three times, saying *ō* as you finish each one
- *Look:* back at any page of this chapter and find ோ once more

Before you move on

Which character is this — ோ? What vowel does it put on the consonant it attaches to — and what does it take off? (**Puts *ō* on; takes the built-in *a* off.**) Name one word you already say that contains it.

7.20 One to ten — the cumulative payoff

> Count from *onru* to *pattu* once without looking. No new word or shape appears in this lesson.

Your turn — read, not recite

Read these shuffled numerals:

- First row: எ உ ஐ ரு அ
- Second row: ஙூ சூ கூ சூ சூ

Now check against க உ ஙூ சூ ரு சூ எ அ சூ ஐ.

Why it's said this way

- Which forms are inherited rather than borrowed? (**The Tamil number words.**)
- Which word is usually read as one short of ten? (ஒன்பது, *onpatu*, nine.)
- Which Kannada shift links Tamil *pattu* to Kannada *hattu*? (***p* to *h*.**)

Writing — independent dictation

Cover the answer. *Hear: eezhu* Write its numeral and word. Uncover: ஏ — ஏழு. Repair one shape if needed.

Before you move on

Count one to ten, then read கூ சு ஏ out of order. You can now hear, say, read, and write a representative part of the sequence.

Chapter 8

Please

Modes: **voice** (3) **eyes** (1) **pen** (8) **Hands-free start:** the first 3 of 12 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can tell an emphatic தயவுசெய்து from the everyday courtesy that lives in the -உங்கள் verb ending, and I can write சொல்லுங்கள் from hearing.
>
> *Ask for something twice — தயவுசெய்து when the request needs weight, plain* உட்காருங்கள் *when it does not — read the join in* செய்து*, and write* சொல்லுங்கள் *from hearing.*

8.1 சொந்தம் (sontham) — one's own; a relative

> Before the new word: say the last thing you learned, once, out loud.

You'll want to know: சொந்தம்

சொந்தம் — *sontham* — "one's own; a relative".

Say it: *sontham*. *Look:* at its shape as you say it. The next lesson takes one piece of it, சொ, and writes it on its own.

In the family, and next door

	word
Hindi (neighbour)	अपना (*apnā*)
English	one's own

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

சொந்தம் (*sontham*) is not native, but its route is not settled. It is usually derived from Sanskrit *svānta*, "one's own", built on *sva*, "self", probably through Telugu *sonta*, "own". Treat the route as likely, not proven.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- *sontham*
- *sontham*, and what it means

Before you move on

What is "one's own; a relative"? (சொந்தம், *sontham*.)

8.2 தயவுசெய்து (tayavu seytu) — please (do the kindness)

Across a whole band of Asia, the word for *please* is really the word **compassion**, dressed as a small request. Tamil says it most literally of all: "**do** the kindness."

You'll want to know: The phrase

தயவுசெய்து = **please**, literally "**do the kindness / grace**." It is two pieces snapped together:

- தயவு (*tayavu*) = **kindness, compassion, grace** — from Sanskrit **daya** "compassion."
- செய்து (*seytu*) = "**having done**," from the verb செய் (*sey*) "to do."

So *tayavu seytu* is an invitation: *do me the kindness (of…).* You place it in front of a request the way English puts "please" in front of one.

This is the same instinct as **Arabic** *min faḍlik* ("from your **grace**") and **Hindi** *kṛpayā* (from *kṛpā*, "**compassion**"). Naming the kindness you hope

for is one of the great strategies of politeness — different from French's "if it **pleases** you," and from Latin/German's "I **ask**."

In the family, and next door

	word	**same root**
Kannada	ದಯವಿಟ್ಟು (*dayaviṭṭu*)	yes
Telugu	దయచేసి (*dayacēsi*)	
Malayalam	ദയവായി (*dayavāyi*)	yes
Hindi (neighbour)	कृपया (*kṛpayā*)	
English	please (tayavu seytu	

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

All four Dravidian cousins build *please* the very same way — **daya** plus a light verb "do / place / become":

- Tamil தயவுசெய்து *tayavu* ***seytu*** — kindness + **do**
- Kannada ದಯವಿಟ್ಟು *daya**viṭṭu*** — compassion + **having placed**
- Telugu దయచేసి *daya**cēsi*** — compassion + **having done**
- Malayalam ദയവായി *daya**vāyi*** — compassion + **as / having become**

One idea, four scripts. Learn one and you can almost read the others.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "tayavu" — the kindness — then "seytu," having done
- the whole phrase — "tayavu seytu" = please, do the kindness

Before you move on

What is the Tamil phrase for please? (தயவுசெய்து *tayavu seytu.*) What do its two pieces mean? ("**Kindness**" *tayavu* + "**having done**" *seytu — do the kindness.*) Which languages ask the same way? (**Kannada, Telugu, Malayalam** with *daya*, and further off **Arabic** *faḍl* and **Hindi** *kṛpā.*) Next: decide when the standalone phrase is natural and when the verb carries the courtesy.

8.3 Solluṅgaḷ — please tell me

You know *tayavu seytu*, the weightier "do me the kindness." Now learn one ordinary respectful request by ear before meeting its written shape.

You'll want to know: one useful request

Solluṅgaḷ means **please tell me**. The ending *-uṅgaḷ* makes the request respectful. For now, keep the whole expression together: one sound, one useful meaning.

Say it in three easy pulses: *sol* · *luṅ* · *gaḷ*. Then say it smoothly once: *solluṅgaḷ*.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

Solluṅgaḷ is native Dravidian: the verb *sol*, "to say" (DEDR 2855), with the respectful ending. Malayalam *colluka* and Kannada *sollu* are the same verb.

Your turn

- *Hear: solluṅgaḷ* → YOU CHOOSE: "please tell me"
- *Say it: sol* · *luṅ* · *gaḷ* — then *solluṅgaḷ*

Before you move on

How do you respectfully ask someone to tell you? (***Solluṅgaḷ.***) Keep that sound and meaning in mind. Next you will uncover just one new written sign inside this already-familiar request.

8.4 ഛഊ — one new sign in a familiar request

Say *solluṅgaḷ*: **please tell me**. Its first sound is *so*. You already know the sound and meaning; today only its written vowel sign is new.

Script you'll notice: ഛൊ

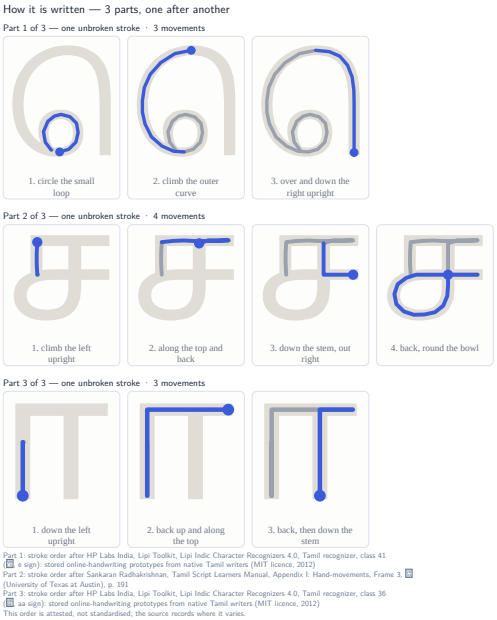
The consonant ഊ begins with *ca*. Add the short-*o* sign ഛൊ, and it reads *so*:

ச + ொ → சொ

The short-*o* sign reaches around its consonant. Part appears on the left and part on the right, but together they are one vowel sign. Read the whole joined shape as one syllable: சொ, *so*.

Do not invent a stroke order from the printed font: the strip gives a sourced one, in written order — the left part of ொ, then ச, then the right part.

Writing — observe and trace



How சொ *is written, part by part, stroke by stroke*

Trace சொ once with the model visible. Say *so* as your finger reaches the vowel sign. Then point to the first syllable in சொல்லுங்கள் and say the whole familiar request, *solluṅgaḷ*.

Before you move on

Read சொ. (***So.***) What does the whole spoken request *solluṅgaḷ* mean? (**Please tell me.**) One new sign is enough for today.

8.5 சொல்லுங்கள் — one visible copy

Point to சொ at the start of சொல்லுங்கள். Read *so*, then say the whole request: *solluṅgaḷ*, **please tell me**.

Writing — guided copy

Copy சொல்லுங்கள் once beneath its visible model. Pause after சொ and check that the short-*o* sign reaches around ச. Look back after every piece if needed. Say the request once when you finish.

Before you move on

Point to the short-*o* syllable in சொல்லுங்கள். (சொ.) What does the word ask? (**Please tell me.**)

8.6 Solluṅgaḷ — hide, then write

Study சொல்லுங்கள் for five seconds. Point to சொ, say *solluṅgaḷ*, then cover the model.

Writing — delayed copy

Write சொ while the model is hidden. If that feels secure, continue and write the whole request. Peek once if needed, cover it again, and finish. Then uncover the model and repair only the short-*o* syllable.

Before you move on

What changed from the previous step? (**The model was hidden before writing.**) Say what your word means. (**Please tell me.**)

8.7 One heard request — write it

Cover every Tamil model. You will hear the same useful request you have already said, traced, copied, and retrieved.

Writing — dictation

Hear: solluṅgaḷ — **please tell me**

Write the request from sound alone. Then uncover சொல்லுங்கள். Check சொ first: the short-*o* sign should reach around ச. Repair one place if needed; do not rewrite the whole word.

Before you move on

Without looking, write only the opening syllable of *solluṅgaḷ*. (சொ.) You are ready to compare this ordinary respectful request with the weightier *tayavu seytu*.

8.8 தயவுசெய்து or -உங்கள்? — politeness in phrase or verb

Tamil has a phrase meaning "do the kindness," but everyday courtesy often sits somewhere English speakers do not expect: inside the verb.

Why it's said this way

A standalone தயவுசெய்து is more emphatic and formal than English "please." Ordinary polite commands use respectful **-உங்கள்** (*-uṅgaḷ*):

- உட்காருங்கள் *uṭkāruṅgaḷ* — please sit
- சொல்லுங்கள் *solluṅgaḷ* — please tell me — the request you can now say, read, and write from hearing

Use *tayavu seytu* to mark "please, do me the kindness" warmly or formally. Let the verb ending carry routine courtesy.

Script you'll notice: Read the join in செய்து

செ is *ca* with the ெ sign for *e*. ய் is *ya* shut off by puḷḷi, a bare *y*, before து *tu*. The same dot that built numbers now makes the consonant seam in *seytu* visible.

Your turn

- *Choose:* emphatic request → தயவுசெய்து
- *Choose:* ordinary "please sit" → உட்காருங்கள்
- *Read it:* சொல்லுங்கள் — and point to சொ, the short-*o* syllable
- *Break apart:* செ + ய் + து → செய்து

Before you move on

What carries everyday "please"? (The respectful verb ending ***-uṅgaḷ***.) When is *tayavu seytu* especially useful? (A **markedly polite or emphatic** request.) What silences *y* in ய்? (The **puḷḷi**.)

8.9 ந — the third n, and the only one built from uprights

Before the new one: say the sound of **ன**.

One letter this time. Just one.

The third n, and the one that finally looks different: no spiral loop at all. ந is built from a top bar and two uprights, with a right stroke that curls below the baseline. If you can see that it has no loop, you can already tell it from the other two.

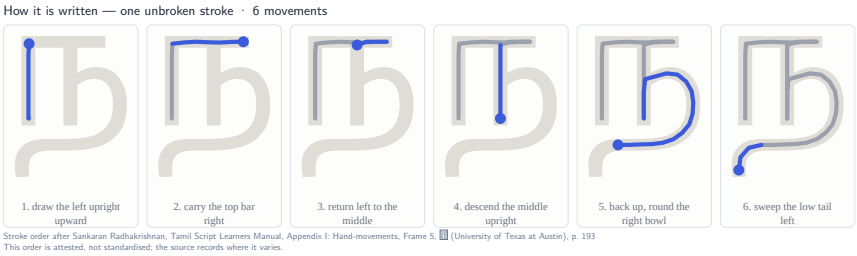
Script you'll notice: ந

ந — *na*.
What it is made of:

- a left upright joined to the top bar
- a middle upright hanging from the top bar
- a right bowl that leaves the middle upright, curls below the baseline, and sweeps left into a descender

நன்றி — *thank you* — opens with it, and so does நான்.

Writing: ந



How ந *is written, stroke by stroke*

- **1.** start at the lower left and draw the left upright upward
- **2.** without lifting, carry the top bar to the right
- **3.** without lifting, make the short return left to the middle upright
- **4.** without lifting, draw the middle upright straight down
- **5.** without lifting, climb back up to the junction and descend around the outside of the right bowl
- **6.** without lifting, turn through the bottom and sweep left into the below-baseline tail — and only now lift

Pen lifts: 0. The pen never leaves the paper.

Stroke order is one attested teaching order, not a national standard — Tamil handwriting is taught with school-to-school variation. Module 5 notes that the extended final curve may be omitted. Source: Sankaran Radhakrishnan, Tamil Script Learners Manual, Appendix I: Hand-movements, Frame 5, ந (University of Texas at Austin), p. 193.

Your turn

- *Trace it:* ந once, slowly, following the steps above
- *Say it:* "na" as you finish it
- *Trace it:* it twice more, without looking back at the steps

Before you move on

Which of the three n's has no spiral loop? (ந.) How many pen lifts does it take? (**None**.)

8.10 வணக்கம் — the first whole written word

You know the four letter bodies and the vowel-killing dot. Assemble them left to right.

Script you'll notice: Build the word



How வணக்கம் *is written, part by part, stroke by stroke*

piece		
வ	*va*	Lesson 1
ண	*ṇa*	Lesson 2
க்	*k* — க with the dot	last lesson
க	*ka*	Lesson 1
ம்	*m* — ம with the dot	this lesson

வ · ண · க் · க · ம் → வணக்கம்

Hear two details. **க்க** is a **doubled** consonant: hold it, *vaṇak-kam*, not *vaṇakam*. Tamil distinguishes single from double consonants. Final **ம்** is a bare *m*, so the word closes instead of trailing into *ma*.

That is the first word of this book, written by hand.

Your turn

- *Write it:* **க்** — **க** with the dot
- *Write it:* **க்க** — two full letters, dot intact
- *Write it:* **வணக்கம்** — five pieces, left to right
- *Say it:* "vaṇa**k-k**am" — hold the middle

Before you move on

Write **வணக்கம்**. What is special about **க்க**? (It is **doubled** and held.) Why does the word end in *m*, not *ma*? (Final **ம்** carries a **puḷḷi**.) Next: the formal way to say *please forgive me*.

8.11 எ — one character, met inside words you already say

Before the new one: **ே** — what does it do?

One character this time. Just one — and you have been saying it for pages without knowing which mark on the page it was.

Script you'll notice: எ

எ — *e*.

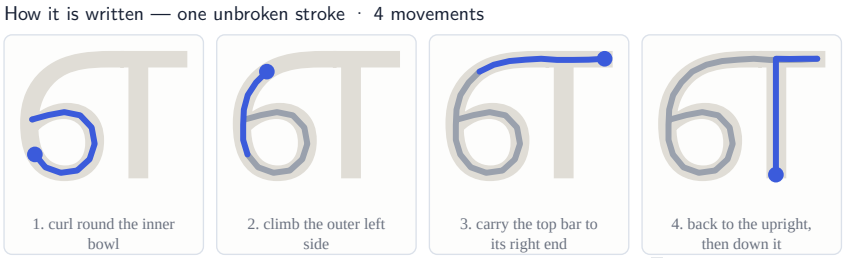
It is an **independent vowel** — the shape the vowel *e* takes when a word begins with it, rather than the sign it becomes inside a word.

You already say these, and every one of them has **எ** somewhere inside it:

- **என்** *en̲* — my
- **என் பெயர் ...** *en̲ peyar …* — my name is… (with no "is")

- என்ன *enṉa* — what
- எப்படி *eppaḍi* — how

Writing: எ — follow the numbered strip



Stroke order after Sankaran Radhakrishnan, Tamil Script Learners Manual, Appendix I: Hand-movements, Frame 5, (University of Texas at Austin), p. 193; reordered, and drawn in one stroke, after HP Labs India, Lipi Toolkit, Lipi Indic Character Recognizers 4.0, Tamil recognizer, class 6 (எ): stored online-handwriting prototypes from native writers (MIT licence, 2012)
This order is attested, not standardised; the source records where it varies.

How எ *is written, stroke by stroke*

Follow the numbered strip: start where movement 1 begins, and let each panel show you the next movement before your pen makes it. Then write எ yourself — slowly, and larger than it is printed.

> The strip shows **where to start the character and which way to travel**, in one attested order. That is taught with real variation from school to school, so the strip names its source beneath it: treat it as a sound way in, not the only one.

Your turn

- *Look:* at these words, and find எ in the ones that have it

  என் · வணக்கம்

- *Trace it:* எ three times, saying *e* as you finish each one
- *Look:* back at any page of this chapter and find எ once more

Before you move on

Which character is this — எ? What sound does it carry? (***e***.)
Name one word you already say that contains it.

8.12 உ — the letter behind a sign you have used for chapters

Before the new one: எ — what sound does it carry?

One character again. This one closes a gap you have been walking past since Chapter 4.

Script you'll notice: உ

உ — *u*.

You already know its **sign**, ு, the little tail that hangs off a consonant inside a word. This is the other half of the same vowel: the **independent** shape, used when a word *begins* with the sound.

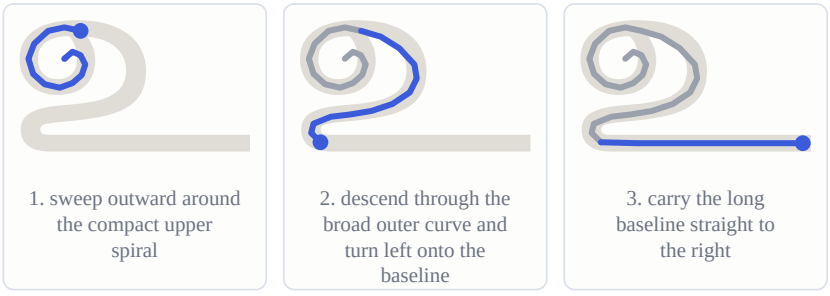
That is the whole Tamil pattern, met once more. Every vowel has two bodies — a free-standing letter for the front of a word, and a sign for inside one — and you have been using this vowel's sign for chapters without ever meeting the letter it belongs to.

Every one of these begins with it, and every other shape in them you can already read:

- உங்கள் *uṅgaḷ* — your, which you have been saying for a while
- உம் *um* — the "also / and" ending, which the next apology needs
- உண் *uṇ* — the old verb "to eat", waiting in the verbs to come

Writing: உ — follow the numbered strip

How it is written — one unbroken stroke · 3 movements



Stroke order after Sankaran Radhakrishnan, Tamil Script Learners Manual, Appendix I: Hand-movements, Frame 16, (University of Texas at Austin), p. 196
This order is attested, not standardised; the source records where it varies.

How உ is written, stroke by stroke

Follow the numbered strip: start where movement 1 begins, and let each panel show you the next movement before your pen makes it. Then write உ yourself — slowly, and larger than it is printed.

> The strip shows **where to start the character and which way to travel**, in one attested order. That is taught with real variation from school to school, so the strip names its source beneath it: treat it as a sound way in, not the only one.

Your turn

- *Look:* at these two, and say which is the letter and which is the sign

  உ · ு

- *Trace it:* உ three times, saying *u* as you finish each one
- *Read it:* உங்கள் — every shape in it is one you have met

Before you move on

Which character is this — உ? What sound does it carry? (***u***.) Where does the letter go, and where does the sign ு go? (**Letter** at the start of a word; **sign** on a consonant inside one.)

Chapter 9

Sorry

Modes: **voice** (1) **eyes** (1) **pen** (1) **Hands-free start:** the first 2 of 3 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can apologise with மன்னிக்கவும் where its register fits, and say plainly where colloquial Tamil varies by region instead of pretending one form is standard.
>
> *Say man̲-n̲i-kkavum holding both doubled consonants, use it for a considered apology, and qualify the casual alternatives rather than asserting one.*

9.1 மன்னிக்கவும் (man̲n̲ikkavum) — please forgive

You already know தயவுசெய்து, "please." Tamil's "sorry" gives you something its Dravidian cousins don't: a forgiveness-word that's Tamil through and through, not borrowed from Sanskrit.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

மன்னிக்கவும் is built from three pieces:

- மன்னி (*man̲n̲i*) = "**to forgive, excuse, pardon**" — and unlike the words Kannada, Telugu, and Malayalam reach for, this is Tamil's **own** native verb, not borrowed from Sanskrit **kṣamā**.
- **-க்க** (*-kka*) = an infinitive-forming ending.

- **-உம்** (*-um*) = a formal, written-register particle used to make a soft, general request or permission — the same particle you'd see on a sign asking visitors to **வரவும்** ("please come" / "you may come").

So **மன்னிக்கவும்** reads as something like "**may [one] forgive**" — a polite, slightly formal way of asking for forgiveness, more at home in writing or a considered apology than tossed off in passing.

In the family, and next door

	word
Kannada	**ಕ್ಷಮಿಸಿ** (*kṣamisi*)
Telugu	**క్షమించండి** (*kṣamiñcaṇḍi*)
Malayalam	**ക്ഷമിക്കണം** (*kṣamikkaṇaṁ*)
Hindi (neighbour)	**माफ़ कीजिए** (*māf kījiye*)
English	please forgive (maṉṉikkavum

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

Where Kannada, Telugu, and Malayalam all reach for the Sanskrit noun **kṣamā** ("patience, forgiveness") and turn it into a verb, **Tamil uses its own root**:

- Tamil **மன்னிக்கவும்** *maṉṉi**kkavum*** — from Tamil **மன்னி** *maṉṉi*
- Kannada **ಕ್ಷಮಿಸಿ** *kṣami**si*** — from Sanskrit **kṣamā**
- Telugu **క్షమించండి** *kṣamiñ**caṇḍi*** — from Sanskrit **kṣamā**
- Malayalam **ക്ഷമിക്കണം** *kṣami**kkaṇam*** — from Sanskrit **kṣamā**

Where "please" showed the whole family sharing one Sanskrit-derived idea (*daya*), "sorry" shows the opposite: Tamil kept its own word while its cousins borrowed the same Sanskrit one.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "maṉṉi" — forgive — the Tamil root, not from Sanskrit

- the whole word — "mannikkavum" = please forgive
- contrast — Kannada, Telugu, Malayalam all use kṣamā instead

Before you move on

What does மன்னிக்கவும் mean, and what is it built from? (**"Please forgive"** — *maṉṉi* "to forgive" + *-kkavum*, a formal request ending.) What's different about Tamil's forgiveness-word compared to Kannada, Telugu, and Malayalam? (**It's Tamil's own native root** — the other three borrow Sanskrit *kṣamā* instead.) Next: place the word in its real register and read the doubled alveolar n.

9.2 மன்னிக்கவும் — formal forgiveness and a doubled n

The root is native Tamil. Its everyday conversational fit is less simple than a one-to-one dictionary entry suggests.

Why it's said this way

மன்னிக்கவும் leans formal: a "please forgive" on a notice or in a considered apology. Spoken Tamil may use shorter regional forms or borrow English "sorry." Colloquial variation is real, so treat formal/written as a reliable center, not a claim that one casual form covers every region.

Script you'll notice: Read ன்னி

In ன்னி, alveolar ன is first silenced by puḷḷi and then repeated before the vowel. The spelling holds the consonant across the syllable boundary:

ன் + னி → ன்னி — *ṉ-ṉi*

This is the same gemination-by-repetition principle used elsewhere in Tamil; the sound is doubled without inventing a new ligature.

Your turn

- *Say it:* "ma<u>n</u>-<u>n</u>i-kkavum," holding both doubled consonants
- *Choose:* considered/formal apology → மன்னிக்கவும்
- *Qualify:* casual alternatives vary by region

Before you move on

What is the reliable register center of *ma<u>nn</u>ikkavum*? (**Formal/ written or considered apology**.) Must every region use it casually? (**No**.) How does ன்னி show a doubled *<u>n</u>*? (Pul̤l̤i stops the first ன், then full னி follows.)

9.3 ல — one character, met inside words you already say

Before the new one: எ — what does it do?

One character this time. Just one — and you have been saying it for pages without knowing which mark on the page it was.

Script you'll notice: ல

ல — *la*.

It is a **consonant**, and in this script a consonant is never bare: it comes with an *a* already in it. So it is not *l*, it is **la**.

What it is made of:

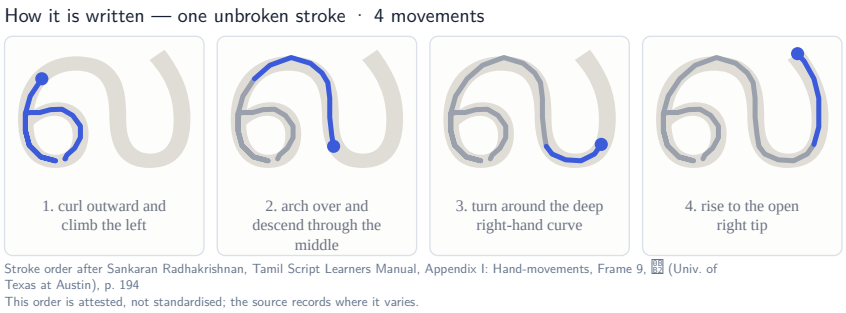
- a spiral loop on the left
- a deep U-shaped turn
- an open rising tip on the right

You already say these, and every one of them has ல somewhere inside it:

- இல்லை *illai* — no / there isn't (illai — the negative)
- ஆம் / இல்லை / சரி *ām / illai / sari* — answering in Tamil

- நலம் *nalam* — well, wellness, good — and the reply ”நான் நலமாக இருக்கிறேன்
- பரவாயில்லை *paravāyillai* — it’s okay / no problem / you’re welcome

Writing: ல



How ல *is written, stroke by stroke*

- **1.** start at the inner curl and spiral outward, climbing the left side
- **2.** without lifting, arch over the top and descend through the middle
- **3.** without lifting, turn around the deep right-hand curve
- **4.** without lifting, rise to the open right tip — and only now lift

Pen lifts: 0. The pen never leaves the paper.

One unbroken stroke — four joined movements, no pen lift; cited to Radhakrishnan, Tamil Script Learners Manual, Frame 9, ல.

This is one attested teaching order and not a national standard — handwriting here is taught with school-to-school variation. Source: Sankaran Radhakrishnan, Tamil Script Learners Manual, Appendix I: Hand-movements, Frame 9, ல (Univ. of Texas at Austin), p. 194.

Your turn

- *Look:* at these words, and find ல in the ones that have it

  இல்லை · வணக்கம்

- *Trace it:* ல three times, saying *la* as you finish each one
- *Look:* back at any page of this chapter and find ல once more

Before you move on

Which character is this — ல? What sound does it carry? (***la***.)
Name one word you already say that contains it.

Chapter 10

Days of the Week

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (1) ✓ **pen** (4) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** the first of 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can name the seven weekdays, take each apart as planet plus கிழமை, and say which are Tamil's own words and which arrived from Sanskrit.
>
> *Complete TA-C10-checkpoint, the chapter's closing checkpoint: run the week from thiṅgaḷ to ñāyiṟu with kizhamai, sort the four native planet-words from the three Sanskrit ones, tell* ந *from* ன *and name* ற*, find* ◌ா *in* நான்*, then write* ந*,* ன*,* ற *and* நா *from sound.*

10.1 திங்கள்–ஞாயிறு — a home-grown and borrowed week

Hindi's week is built entirely from Sanskrit deity-names plus वार (*vār*). Tamil's week tells a richer story: it uses its **own** word for "day," and **some** of its planet-names are Tamil's own too — while others are borrowed, just like Hindi's.

Grammar Lens: The pattern: [planet] + கிழமை, "day"

Every Tamil weekday ends in கிழமை (*kizhamai*), "**day**" — a native Dravidian word, not the Sanskrit வாரம் (*vāram*) that Hindi, Kannada, and Telugu build on (though Tamil also keeps a more formal, Sanskritic *-vāram* set alongside this everyday one):

Tamil weekday	**planet-word, meaning, and source**
திங்கள்கிழமை	*thiṅgaḷ*, "**Moon**" — Tamil's **own** word
செவ்வாய்க்கிழமை	*cevvāy*, traditionally "**the red one**" — likely Tamil's **own** descriptive name
புதன்கிழமை	*pudhaṉ*, **Mercury** — borrowed from Sanskrit **Budha**
வியாழக்கிழமை	*viyāzhaṉ*, **Jupiter** — likely from Sanskrit, via a name for **Bṛhaspati**
வெள்ளிக்கிழமை	*veḷḷi*, traditionally "**silver**" — likely Tamil's **own** descriptive name
சனிக்கிழமை	*saṉi*, **Saturn** — borrowed from Sanskrit **Śani**
ஞாயிற்றுக்கிழமை	*ñāyiṟu*, "**Sun**" — Tamil's **own** word

Why it's said this way

Notice the pattern: **Moon, Mars, Venus, and Sun** all carry Tamil's own descriptive or native words, while **Mercury, Jupiter, and Saturn** carry Sanskrit ones. This isn't Tamil "failing" to have its own full week — it's a genuine **blend**, native Dravidian vocabulary standing right alongside Sanskrit loans, in the same list. (Note for the Tamil-speaking reviewer: this lesson spells Monday திங்கள்கிழமை, the common form — the more traditional sandhi-shifted spelling திங்கட்கிழமை may be preferred and should be swapped in on review if so. The *cevvāy* "red one" and *viyāzhaṉ* Jupiter-name derivations in particular are worth treating as the traditional, commonly-given account rather than settled certainty — exact planet-name histories this old are not always fully nailed down.)

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "thiṅgaḷ" — moon, Tamil's own word — then "kizhamai," day
- the borrowed ones — "pudhaṉ, viyāzhaṉ, saṉi" — Mercury, Jupiter, Saturn from Sanskrit
- the native ones — "thiṅgaḷ, cevvāy, veḷḷi, ñāyiṟu" — moon, Mars, Venus, sun

Before you move on

What does every Tamil weekday end in, and where does that word come from? (கிழமை *kizhamai*, "day" — Tamil's **own** word, not Sanskrit *vāra*.) Which four planet-names are Tamil's own, and which three are Sanskrit borrowings? (**Moon, Mars, Venus, Sun are native**; **Mercury, Jupiter, Saturn are Sanskrit** — *Budha, Bṛhaspati, Śani*.)

10.2 ற — the last of the family, and the one that drops below the line

Before the new one: say the sound of ந.

One letter this time. Just one.

The fourth member of this top-bar family, and the one with a habit none of the others have: its right leg keeps going **below the baseline** and sweeps left into a long descender. Tamil letters mostly sit on the line. This one hangs off it.

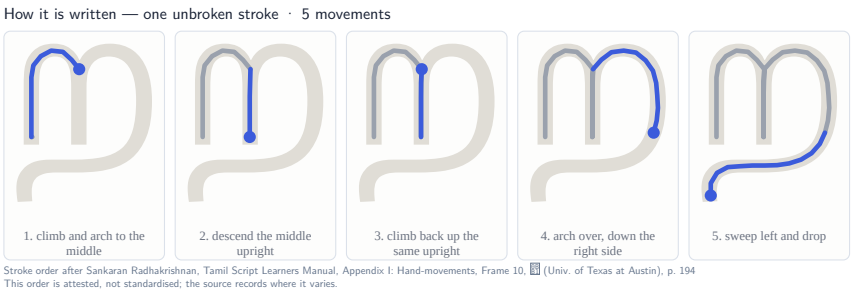
Script you'll notice: ற

ற — *ṟa*.
What it is made of:

- two arches side by side, giving three legs down to the baseline
- the right leg continues BELOW the baseline, sweeps left, and drops into a long descender

It is the ṟ in நன்றி — and with it, every consonant of *thank you*.

Writing: ഈ



How ഈ is written, stroke by stroke

- **1.** start at the lower left, climb the left side, and arch to the middle
- **2.** without lifting, descend the middle upright
- **3.** without lifting, climb back up the same upright
- **4.** without lifting, arch over and descend the right side
- **5.** without lifting, sweep left below the baseline and drop into the long descender — and only now lift

Pen lifts: 0. The pen never leaves the paper.

Stroke order is one attested teaching order, not a national standard — Tamil handwriting is taught with school-to-school variation. Source: Sankaran Radhakrishnan, Tamil Script Learners Manual, Appendix I: Hand-movements, Frame 10, ഈ (Univ. of Texas at Austin), p. 194.

Your turn

- *Trace it:* ഈ once, slowly, following the steps above
- *Say it:* "ṟa" as you finish it
- *Trace it:* it twice more, without looking back at the steps

Before you move on

What does ற do that ண, ன and ந do not? (**Drops below the baseline.**) Which word have you now met all the consonants of? (நன்றி.)

10.3 ந, ன, ற — the letter bodies inside நன்றி

Lesson 2 showed you that Tamil has **three** n-letters and promised you'd draw the other two when a word needed them. Chapter 1's *thank you* needs both.

Script you'll notice: The two remaining n's



How these letters are written, one after another, stroke by stroke: ந, ன, ற

ந — *na*, the **dental** n, tongue against the teeth:

1. **a straight top bar**
2. **a vertical on the left**

3. **a second vertical in the middle**
4. **a right stroke that curls below the baseline** and sweeps left into a descender

ன — *n̲a*, the **alveolar** n, tongue on the ridge behind the teeth:

1. **a straight top bar**
2. **a loop on the left**
3. **one arch**
4. **a straight vertical on the right, down to the baseline**

Compare it with Lesson 2's ண: same top bar, same loop, same closing vertical. **ண simply has a second arch inserted before that vertical.** So **ன is ண minus one arch** — one arch for ன, two for ண. That is the whole contrast, and it is the cheapest way to keep them apart.

With Lesson 2's ண (retroflex), that completes the set. Same consonant to an English ear; three letters, three tongue positions, in Tamil.

Script you'll notice: ற — "r̲a", the hard r

1. **two arches side by side** — giving it three legs down to the baseline
2. **the right leg keeps going below the baseline**, sweeps **left**, and drops into a long descender

It is the tallest thing you have drawn: most Tamil letters sit on the baseline, and ற hangs well beneath it.

The dot under **r̲** marks it as the *hard* or trilled r, distinct from Tamil's other r. You'll meet the contrast properly later; for now, learn the shape.

Your turn

Write these out:

- ற — "top bar, **two** verticals, then the curl that sweeps left"
- ன — "top bar, left loop, **one** arch, straight vertical"
- ற — "two arches, then the leg that sweeps left and drops"

Before you move on

Name Tamil's three n-letters and their tongue positions. (ந dental, ன alveolar, ண retroflex.) What are a consonant's three possibilities so far? (Keep the built-in **a** or **remove** it with the puḷḷi.) Which letter hangs below the baseline? (ற, the hard *r̲*.) Next: the colours — black, white, red and blue.

10.4 ◌ா — one character, met inside words you already say

Before the new one: ல — what does it do?

One character this time. Just one — and you have been saying it for pages without knowing which mark on the page it was.

Script you'll notice: ◌ா

◌ா — *ā*.

It is a **vowel sign**. It is not a letter and never stands alone: it attaches to a consonant and **replaces** the *a* built into it with *ā*. Replaces, not adds — the *a* is gone.

Where it sits: a vertical stroke with a small top hook, written after the consonant.

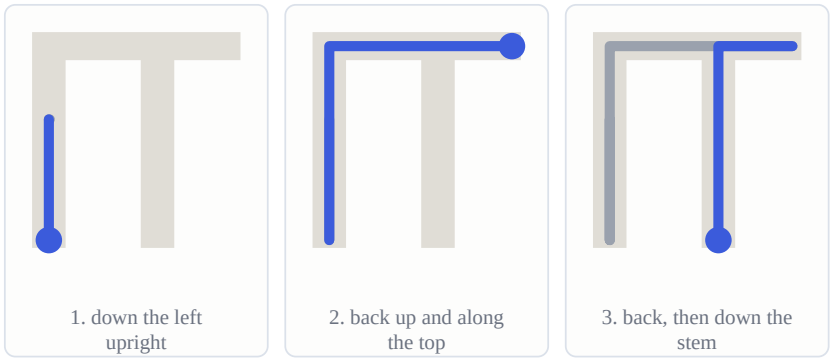
Worked through: ம + ◌ா = மா — *mā*.

You already say these, and every one of them has ◌ா somewhere inside it:

- வணக்கம் / நமஸ்காரம் *vaṇakkam / namaskāram* — Tamil kept a native bow-word where its neighbors borrowed Sanskrit
- நான் *nāṉ* — I
- பரவாயில்லை *paravāyillai* — it's okay / no problem / you're welcome
- நாளை பார்க்கலாம் *nāḷai pārkkalām* — see you tomorrow

Writing: ◌ா — follow the numbered strip

How it is written — one unbroken stroke · 3 movements



Stroke order after HP Labs India, Lipi Toolkit, Lipi Indic Character Recognizers 4.0, Tamil recognizer, class 36 (▦, aa sign): stored online-handwriting prototypes from native Tamil writers (MIT licence, 2012)
This order is attested, not standardised; the source records where it varies.

How ◌ா is written, stroke by stroke

Follow the numbered strip: start where movement 1 begins, and let each panel show you the next movement before your pen makes it. Then write ◌ா yourself — slowly, and larger than it is printed.

> The strip shows **where to start the character and which way to travel**, in one attested order. That is taught with real variation from school to school, so the strip names its source beneath it: treat it as a sound way in, not the only one.

Your turn

- *Look:* at these words, and find ◌ா in the ones that have it

  நான் · வணக்கம்

- *Trace it:* ◌ா three times, saying *ā* as you finish each one
- *Look:* back at any page of this chapter and find ◌ா once more

Before you move on

Which character is this — ◌ா? What vowel does it put on the consonant it attaches to — and what does it take off? (**Puts *ā* on; takes the built-in *a* off.**) Name one word you already say that contains it.

10.5 Chapter 10 checkpoint — the week, three letters and a sign

Nothing new here. The week out loud first, then the letters and the sign this chapter put on the page.

Your turn — the week

- *Say it:* the seven planet-words, Monday to Sunday, each followed by *kizhamai*

(*Thiṅgaḷ, cevvāy, pudhaṉ, viyāzhaṉ, veḷḷi, saṉi, ñāyiṟu.*)

- What does *kizhamai* mean, and whose word is it? ("Day": Tamil's own, not the Sanskrit *vāram*.)
- Which four planet-words are Tamil's own, and which three came from Sanskrit? (Moon, Mars, Venus and Sun are native: *thiṅgaḷ, cevvāy, veḷḷi, ñāyiṟu*. Mercury, Jupiter and Saturn are borrowed: *pudhaṉ, viyāzhaṉ, saṉi*.)

Script — ந, ன, ற and ◌ா

- Which n is ந, and which is ன? (ந is the dental *n*: top bar, two verticals, the curl that sweeps left. ன is the alveolar *ṉ*: ண minus one arch.)
- Which letter hangs below the baseline, and whose consonants does it complete? (ற, the hard *ṟ*; with it you have every consonant of நன்றி.)
- In நான், which mark turns the *a* of ந into *ā*, and where does it sit? (◌ா, written after the consonant.)

Read it: நான் aloud, and point to the ◌ா in it

Writing — from sound

Cover: the Script block above, so no model stays in view
Write it: one letter each for the dental *n*, the alveolar *ṉ* and the hard *ṟ*
Write it: *nā* — the dental *n* carrying the *ā* sign
Check: against the key — நா, னா, மா, றா
Write it: one repaired shape, then stop

Before you move on

Say today's day in Tamil, then say whether its planet-word is Tamil's own or borrowed. That is the chapter: a week that blends two sources, and the letters that finish *thank you*.
Next chapter: the colours.

Chapter 11

Colours

Modes: **voice** (1) **pen** (1) **Hands-free start:** the first of 2 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can name black, white, red, and blue in Tamil and say which three are native and which one is the Sanskrit loan.
>
> *Say karuppu, veḷḷai and sivappu as the native three, nīlam as the borrowed one, and hear veḷḷai echo veḷḷi from last chapter.*

11.1 கருப்பு, வெள்ளை, சிவப்பு, நீலம் — three of Tamil's own, one borrowed

You've already seen Tamil mix native and Sanskrit words in its day-names. Colors tell a **cleaner** version of the same story: three colors are Tamil's own, and the fourth is the one color that keeps showing up borrowed, in language after language.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

- கருப்பு (*karuppu*) = "**black**" — native Tamil/Dravidian.
- வெள்ளை (*veḷḷai*) = "**white**" — native Tamil/Dravidian, and built on the very same வெள் (*veḷ-*, "bright, silvery") root you already met in வெள்ளி (*veḷḷi*), "Venus/silver," from the days-of-the-week lesson.
- சிவப்பு (*sivappu*) = "**red**" — native Tamil/Dravidian.

In the family, and next door

	word	same root
Kannada	ಕಪ್ಪು ಬಿಳಿ ಕೆಂಪು ನೀಲಿ (*kappu biḷi kempu nīli*)	
Telugu	నలుపు తెలుపు ఎరుపు నీలం (*nalupu telupu erupu nīlam*)	
Malayalam	കറുപ്പ് വെള്ള ചുവപ്പ് നീല (*karuppŭ veḷḷa cuvappŭ nīla*)	yes
English	black, white, red, blue	

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

நீலம் (*nīlam*) = "**blue**" — from **Sanskrit** नील (*nīla*), "dark blue," the very same root behind Hindi's नीला (*nīlā*). This *nīla* is also the name of the indigo plant and its dye — part of why blue dye is so historically linked to India — but be careful: the English word **indigo** itself is a *separate*, Greek-derived word (describing where the dye was imported *from*, not descended from *nīla* by sound change; the Hindi color lesson draws that careful distinction).

Why it's said this way

This isn't random. **"Blue"** is, across many of the world's languages, one of the **last** basic colors to settle into its own fixed word — often arriving late, or borrowed, compared to black, white, and red. Tamil's colors look like exactly this pattern in miniature: three old, native words, and one — blue — reaching outside the language for a Sanskrit loan.

(Note for the Tamil-speaking reviewer: please confirm *karuppu, veḷḷai, sivappu, nīlam* are the forms you'd teach first — regional/colloquial Tamil may prefer different everyday variants, and this lesson would benefit from your check the way the day-names lesson did.)

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- the three native ones — “karuppu, veḷḷai, sivappu” — black, white, red
- the borrowed one — “nīlam” — blue, from Sanskrit
- the echo — “veḷḷai” and “veḷḷi” share the same veḷ- root

Before you move on

Which three Tamil colors are native, and which one is borrowed? (**Karuppu, veḷḷai, sivappu** (black/white/red) are native; **nīlam** (blue) is a **Sanskrit** loan.) What root does *veḷḷai* share with a word you already know? (**Veḷ-** “bright/silvery” — the same root as *veḷḷi*, “Venus/silver.”) Why might blue be the one borrowed color? (**Blue is often one of the last basic colors** to settle into a fixed word across many languages — the same pattern Latin’s *caeruleus* showed.)

11.2 ழ — one character, met inside words you already say

Before the new one: ◌ா — what does it do?

One character this time. Just one — and you have been saying it for pages without knowing which mark on the page it was.

Script you’ll notice: ழ

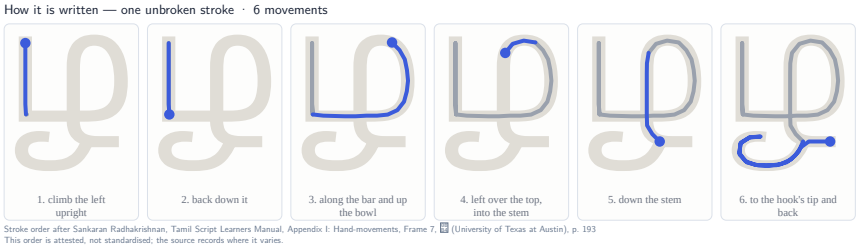
ழ — *lḷa*.

It is a **consonant**, and in this script a consonant is never bare: it comes with an *a* already in it. So it is not *lll*, it is **lḷa**.

You already say these, and every one of them has ழ somewhere inside it:

- தமிழ் எழுத்து *tamiḻ eḻuttu* — why Tamil writing is so round
- நான் தமிழ் பேசுகிறேன் *nāṉ tamiḻ pēsugiṟēṉ* — I speak Tamil
- வாழ் *vāḻ* — to live, to flourish
- எனக்குத் தமிழ் தெரியும் *enakkut tamiḻ teriyum* — ’I know Tamil’

Writing: ழ — follow the numbered strip



How ழ is written, stroke by stroke

Follow the numbered strip: start where movement 1 begins, and let each panel show you the next movement before your pen makes it. Then write ழ yourself — slowly, and larger than it is printed.

> The strip shows **where to start the character and which way to travel**, in one attested order. That is taught with real variation from school to school, so the strip names its source beneath it: treat it as a sound way in, not the only one.

Your turn

- *Look:* at these words, and find ழ in the ones that have it

  வணக்கம்

- *Trace it:* ழ three times, saying *llla* as you finish each one
- *Look:* back at any page of this chapter and find ழ once more

Before you move on

Which character is this — ழ? What sound does it carry? (***llla***.) Name one word you already say that contains it.

Chapter 12

Family

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (1) ✓ **pen** (1) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** the first of 2 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can use Tamil's four sibling words correctly, settling relative age before gender — the question English never makes you answer.
>
> *Name appā and ammā, then place aṇṇaṉ, tambi, akkā and tangai by asking "older, or younger?" before you can say "brother" at all.*

12.1 அப்பா, அம்மா, and four sibling words

You've learned Spanish *hermano* and *hermana*, plus French *frère* and *sœur* — one word each for "brother" and "sister." Tamil asks a question those languages never do: **is this sibling older or younger than you?**

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

- அப்பா (*appā*) = "**father**"
- அம்மா (*ammā*) = "**mother**"

Both are native Dravidian words, of the same simple, worldwide "baby-talk" shape (a repeated consonant plus a vowel) found across unrelated language families everywhere — not borrowed from Sanskrit, not a coincidence with any one language in particular, just how small children's mouths tend to form their first words for parents.

You'll want to know: Siblings — split by age, not just gender

Here's the real lesson: Tamil doesn't have one word for "brother" and one for "sister." It has **four**:

Tamil	meaning
அண்ணன் (*aṇṇaṉ*)	**older** brother
தம்பி (*tambi*)	**younger** brother
அக்கா (*akkā*)	**older** sister
தங்கை (*tangai*)	**younger** sister

There is no single Tamil word that just means "brother" the way Spanish *hermano* does — you're expected to know, and say, **whether they're older or younger than you** every time you refer to a sibling. This isn't a small detail: it reflects how central **relative age and seniority** are in South Asian family structure and address — the same instinct that makes "older sibling" versus "younger sibling" a live, spoken distinction, not just something you *could* mention if you wanted to.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "appā, ammā" — father, mother
- the four siblings — "aṇṇaṉ, tambi" (older/younger brother), "akkā, tangai" (older/younger sister)
- the key question — "older, or younger?" — before you can even say "brother" or "sister" in Tamil

Before you move on

How many Tamil words mean "brother" or "sister," and why? (**Four** — அண்ணன்/தம்பி for older/younger brother, அக்கா/தங்கை for older/younger sister — Tamil requires knowing the sibling's **age relative to you**.) Are அப்பா and அம்மா borrowed from Sanskrit? (**No** — native Dravidian baby-talk-type words, of a shape found across unrelated languages worldwide.)

12.2 ச — one character, met inside words you already say

Before the new one: ழ — what does it do?

One character this time. Just one — and you have been saying it for pages without knowing which mark on the page it was.

Script you'll notice: ச

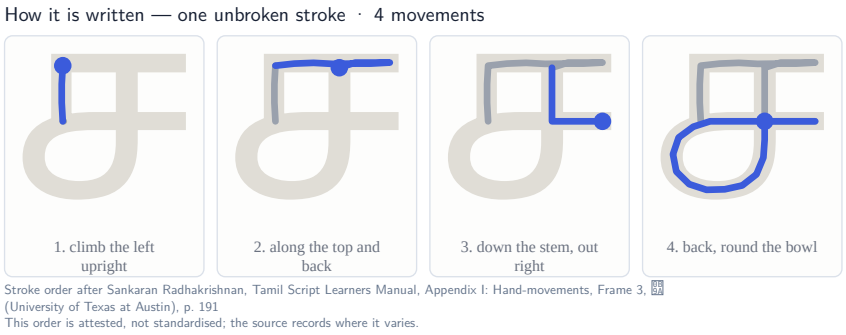
ச — *ca*.

It is a **consonant**, and in this script a consonant is never bare: it comes with an *a* already in it. So it is not *c*, it is **ca**.

You already say these, and every one of them has ச somewhere inside it:

- சரி *sari* — okay / alright / correct (sari)
- ஆம் / இல்லை / சரி *ām / illai / sari* — answering in Tamil
- மீண்டும் சந்திப்போம் *mīṇḍum sandippōm* — we'll meet again
- பேசு *pēsu* — to speak

Writing: ச — follow the numbered strip



How ச is written, stroke by stroke

Follow the numbered strip: start where movement 1 begins, and let each panel show you the next movement before your pen makes it. Then write ச yourself — slowly, and larger than it is printed.

The strip shows **where to start the character and which way to travel**, in one attested order. That is taught with real variation from school to school, so the strip names its source beneath it: treat it as a sound way in, not the only one.

Your turn

- *Look:* at these words, and find **ச** in the ones that have it

  சரி · வணக்கம்

- *Trace it:* **ச** three times, saying *ca* as you finish each one
- *Look:* back at any page of this chapter and find **ச** once more

Before you move on

Which character is this — **ச**? What sound does it carry? (***ca***.) Name one word you already say that contains it.

Chapter 13

Body Parts

Modes: **voice** (1) **pen** (4) **Hands-free start:** the first of 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say head and hand in Tamil, account for why both stayed native here where Hindi's pair came from Sanskrit, and write நன்றி from its pieces.
>
> *Complete TA-C13-checkpoint, the chapter's closing checkpoint: say talai and kai as native words, explain the d in nandri, describe* க *and where* ி *attaches, find* ர *in* சரி*, then write* க*,* ர*,* றி *and* நன்றி *from sound.*

13.1 தலை, கை — head and hand, both Tamil's own

> You've seen Hindi's *sir* and *hāth* trace all the way back to Sanskrit. Tamil's words for the same two body parts tell a simpler story: **both are native.**

You'll want to know: The words

- தலை (*talai*) = "**head**" — native Dravidian.
- கை (*kai*) = "**hand**" — native Dravidian.

Neither is borrowed from Sanskrit, unlike Hindi's *sir* (< Sanskrit *śiras*) or *hāth* (< Sanskrit *hasta*). Tamil simply kept its own words for two of the most basic parts of the body.

In the family, and next door

	word	**same root**
Kannada	ತಲೆ ಕೈ (*tale kai*)	yes
Telugu	తల చెయ్యి (*tala ceyyi*)	yes
Malayalam	തല കൈ (*tala kai*)	yes
English	head and hand	

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "talai" — head
- "kai" — hand
- the contrast — Hindi borrowed these from Sanskrit; Tamil didn't

Before you move on

What are Tamil's words for head and hand? (தலை *talai*, கை *kai*.) Are either of these Sanskrit loans? (**No** — both native Dravidian, unlike Hindi's Sanskrit-descended *sir* and *hāth*.)

13.2 க — the letter that is three bowls

Before the new one: say the sound of ற.

One letter this time. Just one.

The most-used consonant in Tamil, and the most built: a square frame on top, then two bowls hanging under it. One continuous stroke, and a long one. Take it slowly — the pen climbs, crosses, drops and goes round both bowls before it lifts.

Script you'll notice: க

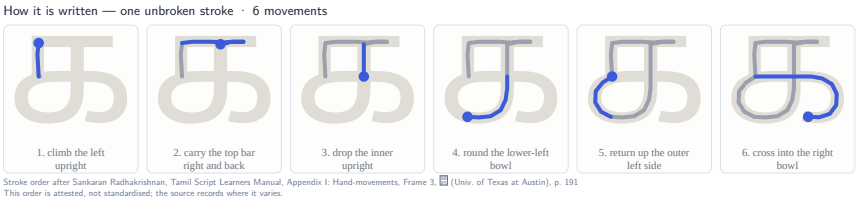
க — *ka*.
What it is made of:

- an upper square frame
- a large lower-left bowl

- a lower-right bowl with an open foot

வணக்கம் has it twice, doubled in the middle.

Writing: க



How **க** *is written, stroke by stroke*

- **1.** start at the middle left and climb the left upright
- **2.** without lifting, carry the top bar to the right and return along it to the inner corner
- **3.** without lifting, drop the inner upright to the inner crossing
- **4.** without lifting, curve down and around the lower-left bowl
- **5.** without lifting, return up its outer left side to the middle left
- **6.** without lifting, cross the middle bar and turn around the lower-right bowl — and only now lift

Pen lifts: 0. The pen never leaves the paper.

Stroke order is one attested teaching order, not a national standard — Tamil handwriting is taught with school-to-school variation. Source: Sankaran Radhakrishnan, Tamil Script Learners Manual, Appendix I: Hand-movements, Frame 3, **க** (Univ. of Texas at Austin), p. 191.

Your turn

- *Trace it:* **க** once, slowly, following the steps above
- *Say it:* "ka" as you finish it
- *Trace it:* it twice more, without looking back at the steps

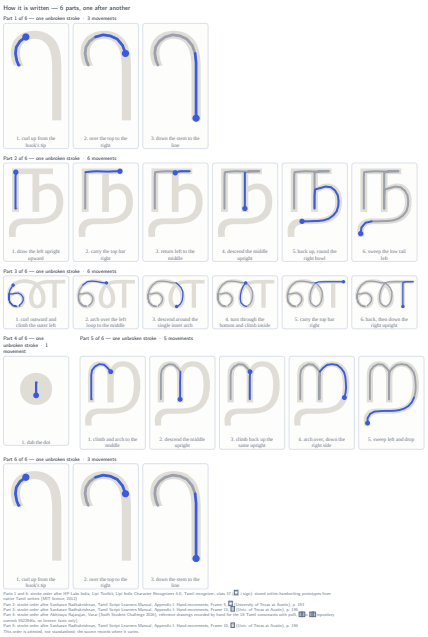
Before you move on

How many pen lifts does க take? (**None** — it is one continuous stroke.) What are the three parts? (**Upper frame, lower-left bowl, lower-right bowl.**)

13.3 ி and நன்றி — replace the vowel, then hear *ndr*

A consonant can keep *a* or lose it under a pu̲l̲li. The third option is to replace it with a vowel sign.

Script you'll notice: The first vowel sign



How ி, நன்றி *is written, part by part, stroke by stroke*

ற = *r̲a* → றி = *r̲i*

ி is a hook above and to the right. The consonant keeps its shape; the sign hangs from it. Later, ை (*ai*) will appear before its consonant on the page but after it in speech, the same eye/ear trap as Devanagari ि.

Script you'll notice: Assemble நன்றி

நன்றி

piece		
ந	*na* — dental	last lesson
ன்	*n̲* — alveolar, with puḷḷi	Lessons 3–4
றி	*r̲i* — ற plus the i-sign	this lesson

The letters in this word

ன் + ற is pronounced close to **ndr**. This follows a broader Tamil rule: a **nasal voices the stop after it**.

ந் + த	*nd*	வந்து *vandu*
ண் + ட	*ṇḍ*	retroflex pair
ன் + ற	*ndr*	நன்றி

Each n-letter creates its own cluster. That payoff explains both the three spellings and the common English romanization **nandri**, whose *d* is heard but not separately written.

Your turn

- *Write it:* றி — ற plus the hook above right
- *Write it:* நன்றி — three pieces
- *Say it:* "ன் + ற = **ndr**"

Before you move on

What are a consonant's three vowel choices? (Keep inherent **a**, **remove** it with puḷḷi, or **replace** it with a vowel sign.) Where does ி attach? (**Above and right**.) Why is *nan̲r̲i* often written *nandri*? (ன் + ற is pronounced *ndr* because a nasal voices the following stop.)

13.4 ர — one character, met inside words you already say

Before the new one: ச — what does it do?

One character this time. Just one — and you have been saying it for pages without knowing which mark on the page it was.

Script you'll notice: ர

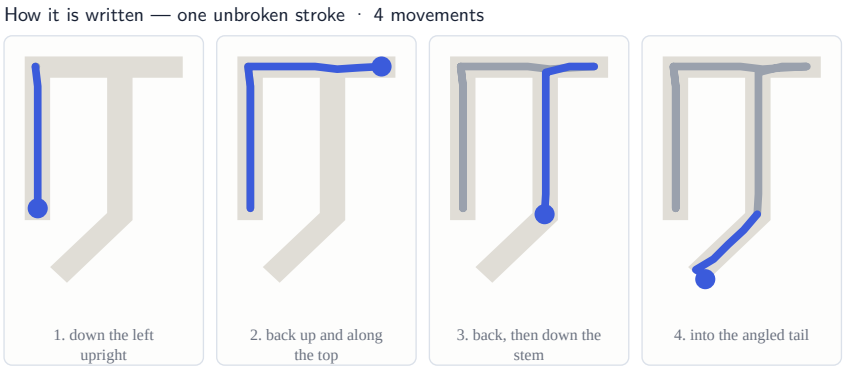
ர — *ra*.

It is a **consonant**, and in this script a consonant is never bare: it comes with an *a* already in it. So it is not *r*, it is **ra**.

You already say these, and every one of them has ர somewhere inside it:

- வணக்கம் / நமஸ்காரம் *vaṇakkam / namaskāram* — Tamil kept a native bow-word where its neighbors borrowed Sanskrit
- சரி *sari* — okay / alright / correct (sari)
- ஆம் / இல்லை / சரி *ām / illai / sari* — answering in Tamil
- பெயர் *peyar* — name

Writing: ர — follow the numbered strip



How ர is written, stroke by stroke

Follow the numbered strip: start where movement 1 begins, and let each panel show you the next movement before your pen makes it. Then write ர yourself — slowly, and larger than it is printed.

> The strip shows **where to start the character and which way to travel**, in one attested order. That is taught with real variation from school to school, so the strip names its source beneath it: treat it as a sound way in, not the only one.

Your turn

- *Look:* at these words, and find ர in the ones that have it

  சரி · வணக்கம்

- *Trace it:* ர three times, saying *ra* as you finish each one
- *Look:* back at any page of this chapter and find ர once more

Before you move on

Which character is this — ர? What sound does it carry? (***ra***.)
Name one word you already say that contains it.

13.5 Chapter 13 checkpoint — head, hand, and நன்றி from sound

Nothing new here. The two body words out loud first, then two letters, a vowel sign and the word *thank you* on the page.

And one from the colour chapter: which of the four colours is borrowed, and from where? (*Nīlam*, blue — Sanskrit *nīla*.) Is English *indigo* descended from *nīla*? (**No** — it is a separate word, from Greek.)

Your turn — head and hand

- *Say it:* "head", then "hand", in Tamil

(*Talai*; *kai*.)

- Are either of them Sanskrit loans, the way Hindi's *sir* and *hāth* are? (No: both are native Dravidian.)
- Why do people spell *thank you* as *nandri* when no *d* is written? (The nasal voices the stop after it: *n* plus *r* is said close to *ndr*.)

Script — க, ர and the i-sign

- What are the three parts of க, and how many times does the pen lift? (An upper frame, a lower-left bowl, a lower-right bowl; no lift at all.)
- Where does ி attach, and what does it do to the consonant's *a*? (Above and to the right; it replaces the *a*, so ற becomes றி.)
- Which three pieces build நன்றி? (ந · ன் · றி.)
- சரி is *okay*. Which letter in it carries *ra*? (ர.)

Read it: நன்றி and சரி aloud, and point to the ர

Writing — from sound

Cover: the Script block above, so no model stays in view
Write it: the letter for *ka*, then the letter for *ra*
Write it: *ri*, then the whole of *nanri*, "thank you"
Check: against the key — க, ர, றி, நன்றி
Write it: one repaired shape, then stop

Before you move on

Touch your head and say its word, then your hand and say its word. That is the chapter: two native words, and *thank you* written from its pieces.
Next chapter: the seasons.

Chapter 14

Seasons

Modes: **voice** (1) **pen** (1) **Hands-free start:** the first of 2 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can name the four seasons in Tamil and say honestly which one is locally central instead of repeating a Western four-way split.
>
> *Build kodai/mazhai/kulir onto kaalam, name mazhai kaalam as the season that actually organises the year, and flag vasantha as the one loanword.*

14.1 வசந்த காலம், கோடை, மழை, குளிர் — the four words, and the real season underneath

Tamil has words that line up with Spanish's four seasons — but, just like Hindi's ऋतु, forcing them into a clean four-way split hides what actually matters on the ground.

You'll want to know: The four words

Tamil	meaning	source
வசந்த காலம் (*vasantha kaalam*)	"spring"	*vasantham* is a **Sanskrit** loan
கோடைக் காலம் (*kodai kaalam*)	"summer"	கோடை *kodai* is **native** Tamil for "heat"
மழைக் காலம் (*mazhai kaalam*)	"rainy season"	மழை *mazhai*, native Tamil for "rain"
குளிர் காலம் (*kulir kaalam*)	"winter/cold season"	குளிர் *kulir*, native Tamil for "cold"

Every one of these is built the same way: a word for the **feel** of the season (heat, rain, cold — or the borrowed *vasantham*) plus காலம் (*kaalam*), "**time/season**." Be honest about *kaalam* itself, too: it's ultimately from Sanskrit काल (*kāla*, "time") — but it was assimilated into Tamil so long ago and so thoroughly that it functions as completely ordinary vocabulary today, quite unlike a fresh, still-foreign-feeling loan like *vasantham*.

In the family, and next door

	word
Malayalam	വസന്തകാലം വേനൽക്കാലം മഴക്കാലം ശൈത്യകാലം (*vasantakālaṁ venalkkālaṁ maḻakkālaṁ śaityakālaṁ*)
English	spring, summer, monsoon, winter

Why it's said this way

Just as Hindi's traditional calendar makes the monsoon (*varṣā*) its own central season rather than a footnote, Tamil Nadu's actual climate is shaped far more by மழைக்காலம் (*mazhai kaalam*, "the rains") than by any crisp four-way Western split. There's no dramatic autumn leaf-fall in a tropical climate, and "spring" as a distinct, keenly-felt season is a much weaker idea here than in temperate Europe. The four words above are real and used — but the rains, not a European four-season year, are what actually organizes agricultural and everyday life across much of Tamil Nadu.

(Note for the Tamil-speaking reviewer: please check whether these are

the words and register you'd teach first, and whether there's more to say about how Tamil Nadu's own seasonal year is actually divided in practice.)

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "kodai" — heat/summer, native — then "kaalam," time/season
- "mazhai kaalam" — the rains, the real central season
- "kulir kaalam" — the cold season
- the one loanword — "vasantha kaalam," spring, from Sanskrit

Before you move on

Which of the four season-words is a Sanskrit loan, and which are native Tamil? (வசந்தம் *vasantham* is Sanskrit; கோடை, மழை, குளிர் are all native.) What season actually shapes life in Tamil Nadu the most, and why doesn't the four-season frame capture that? (மழைக்காலம், the **rains** — Tamil Nadu's tropical climate doesn't have a sharp four-way split the way temperate Europe does.)

14.2 ட — one character, met inside words you already say

Before the new one: ற — what does it do?

One character this time. Just one — and you have been saying it for pages without knowing which mark on the page it was.

Script you'll notice: ட

ட — *tta*.

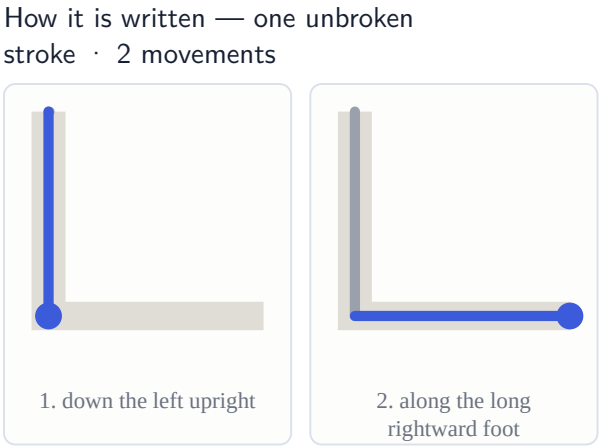
It is a **consonant**, and in this script a consonant is never bare: it comes with an *a* already in it. So it is not *tt*, it is **tta**.

You already say these, and every one of them has ட somewhere inside it:

- எப்படி *eppaḍi* — how

- நீங்கள் எப்படி இருக்கிறீர்கள்? — how are you? (respectful)
- மீண்டும் சந்திப்போம் *mīṇḍum sandippōm* — we'll meet again
- இரண்டு மூன்று நான்கு ஐந்து *iraṇṭu mūṉṟu nāṉku aintu* — two through five remain visible cousins across the Dravidian family while one is less tidy

Writing: ㄴ — follow the numbered strip



Stroke order after Sankaran Radhakrishnan, Tamil Script Learners Manual, Appendix I: Hand-movements, Frame 1, (University of Texas at Austin), p. 190
This order is attested, not standardised; the source records where it varies.

How ㄴ is written, stroke by stroke

Follow the numbered strip: start where movement 1 begins, and let each panel show you the next movement before your pen makes it. Then write ㄴ yourself — slowly, and larger than it is printed.

> The strip shows **where to start the character and which way to travel**, in one attested order. That is taught with real variation from school to school, so the strip names its source beneath it: treat it as a sound way in, not the only one.

Your turn

- *Look:* at these words, and find ㄴ in the ones that have it

எப்படி · வணக்கம்

- *Trace it:* ட three times, saying *tta* as you finish each one
- *Look:* back at any page of this chapter and find ட once more

Before you move on

Which character is this — ட? What sound does it carry? (***tta***.)
Name one word you already say that contains it.

Chapter 15

Water and Rice

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (1) ✓ **pen** (1) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** the first of 2 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can ask for water and keep raw அரிசி apart from cooked சாதம், and state how far the arisi-to-"rice" claim can honestly be pushed.
>
> *Assemble taṇ plus nīr into taṇṇīr, switch between arisi and sātam by whether it is cooked, and label the English "rice" link as contested.*

15.1 தண்ணீர், அரிசி, சாதம் — water, and rice, the real staple

> European languages teach "bread" as the staple food. Here, that would be **dishonest** — bread isn't the everyday staple in Tamil food culture. **Rice** is, and it comes with one of the most famous (if contested) etymological journeys of any food-word.

You'll want to know: தண்ணீர் — water, literally "cool water"

தண்ணீர் (*taṇṇīr*) = "**water**" — built from தண் (*taṇ*, "**cool**") + நீர் (*nīr*, "**water**"). Everyday Tamil doesn't just say "water" — it says, quite literally, "**cool water**."

In the family, and next door

	word
Kannada	ನೀರು ಅಕ್ಕಿ ಅನ್ನ (*nīru akki anna*)
Telugu	నీళ్ళు బియ్యం అన్నం (*nīḷḷu biyyam annam*)
Malayalam	വെള്ളം അരി ചോറ് (*veḷḷam ari cōṟŭ*)
Hindi (neighbour)	पानी रोटी (*pānī roṭī*)
English	water, and rice

You'll want to know: அரிசி and சாதம் — rice, raw and cooked

Tamil, like most of South India, distinguishes the **uncooked grain** from the **cooked dish** with two separate words, not one:

- அரிசி (*arisi*) = "**rice**" (the raw, husked grain) — native Dravidian.
- சாதம் (*sātam*) = "**cooked rice**" (the meal itself, what's actually eaten) — likely Sanskrit-influenced. Tamil also keeps a native word for the same idea, சோறு (*cōṟu*) — the two sit side by side as everyday near-synonyms.

Why it's said this way

Here's the exciting part, held with appropriate care: many etymologists connect அரிசி (*arisi*) to the **English word "rice" itself** — the proposed chain runs Dravidian *arisi* → **Greek** *óryza* → Latin *oryza* → Old French *ris* → English **rice**. If true, English speakers have been saying a Dravidian word for centuries without knowing it. But be honest: standard etymological dictionaries mark Greek *óryza*'s origin as **genuinely uncertain** — a Dravidian source is one widely cited hypothesis among others (an Indo-Aryan *vrīhi*-related source is also proposed), not a settled, universally agreed fact.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "taṇ" — cool — then "nīr," water — then "taṇṇīr," cool water
- "arisi" — raw rice — then "sātam," cooked rice

- the famous (contested) link — "arisi" → possibly English "rice"

Before you move on

What does தண்ணீர் literally mean? (**"Cool water"** — *taṇ* "cool" + *nīr* "water.") What two words does Tamil use for rice, and why two? (அரிசி *arisi*, raw grain; சாதம் *sātam*, cooked rice — the raw grain and the cooked meal get separate words.) Is it certain that English "rice" comes from Tamil *arisi*? (**Not certain** — it's a widely cited hypothesis via Greek *óryza*, but that Greek word's origin is genuinely disputed among etymologists.)

15.2 அ — one character, met inside words you already say

Before the new one: ட — what does it do?

One character this time. Just one — and you have been saying it for pages without knowing which mark on the page it was.

Script you'll notice: அ

அ — *a*.

It is an **independent vowel** — the shape the vowel *a* takes when a word begins with it, rather than the sign it becomes inside a word.

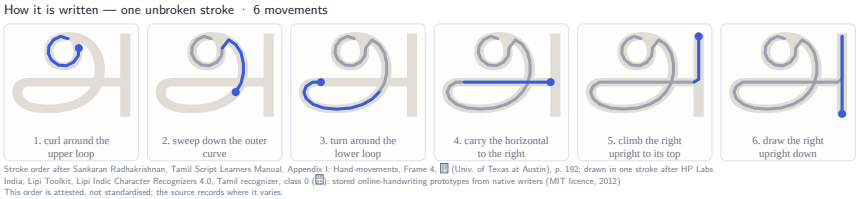
What it is made of:

- a curl at the upper left
- a long horizontal stroke
- a straight vertical on the right

You already say these, and every one of them has அ somewhere inside it:

- அப்பா அம்மா அண்ணன் தம்பி அக்கா தங்கை — father, mother, and FOUR sibling words
- தண்ணீர் அரிசி சாதம் — water, and rice — the actual staple food here, not bread — with a widely-cited

Writing: அ



How அ is written, stroke by stroke

- **1.** start inside the upper curl and sweep around it
- **2.** without lifting, continue down the outer curve
- **3.** without lifting, turn around the lower loop
- **4.** without lifting, carry the horizontal to the right edge
- **5.** without lifting, climb the right upright from there to its top
- **6.** without lifting, draw the upright straight down over that ink — and only now lift

Pen lifts: 0. The pen never leaves the paper.

One continuous stroke — six joined movements, no pen lift; it goes up the right upright from the horizontal and back down it; order from Radhakrishnan, Tamil Script Learners Manual, Frame 4, அ, with the stroke count from native writers' pen traces in HP Labs India's LipiTk Tamil recognizer, class 0.

This is one attested teaching order and not a national standard — handwriting here is taught with school-to-school variation. Source: Sankaran Radhakrishnan, Tamil Script Learners Manual, Appendix I: Hand-movements, Frame 4, அ (Univ. of Texas at Austin), p. 192. The stroke count comes from native writers' pen traces in HP Labs India's LipiTk Tamil recognizer: most of them write அ without lifting the pen.

Your turn

- *Look:* at these words, and find அ in the ones that have it

  வணக்கம்

- *Trace it:* அ three times, saying *a* as you finish each one
- *Look:* back at any page of this chapter and find அ once more

Before you move on

Which character is this — அ? What sound does it carry? (***a***.)
Name one word you already say that contains it.

Chapter 16

Tamil Months

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (1) ✓ **pen** (4) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** the first of 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can name the twelve months of the Tamil solar calendar and place Tamil New Year and Pongal inside it.
>
> *Complete TA-C16-checkpoint, the chapter's closing checkpoint: say the twelve months from Chithirai to Panguṉi, place Tamil New Year and Pongal, say why* ஆம் *opens on a full vowel letter, then write* ம, ஆ *and* ஆம் *from sound.*

16.1 சித்திரை to பங்குனி — Tamil's own solar calendar

By now you've seen Arabic and Hindi each juggle two calendars. Tamil adds a **third distinct system** to the mix — one still actively used for Tamil New Year and Pongal, not a historical curiosity.

You'll want to know: The twelve Tamil months

சித்திரை, வைகாசி, ஆனி, ஆடி, ஆவணி, புரட்டாசி, ஐப்பசி, கார்த்திகை, மார்கழி, தை, மாசி, பங்குனி (*Chithirai, Vaikāsi, Āṉi, Āḍi, Āvaṇi, Puraṭṭāsi, Aippasi, Kārthigai, Mārgazhi, Thai, Māsi, Panguṉi*).

This is the **Tamil solar calendar** — a real, independent civil calendar, distinct from both the Gregorian calendar and the Hindu lunisolar (Vikram Samvat–style) calendar. Its months are traditionally tied to **nakshatras** (the 27 lunar-mansion star groups): each month is named for the nakshatra

the **moon** sits near on the **full-moon (pournami) day** that falls within that month — the moon's position, not the sun's, and tied to that month's full moon specifically, not simply the month's start.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

Most of the twelve names are Sanskrit star names in Tamil dress: *Chithirai* from *Citrā*, *Vaikāsi* from *Viśākhā*, *Kārthigai* from *Kṛttikā*, *Māsi* from *Māgha*. Tamil gave them its own sounds and endings.

Why it's said this way

You've now met three genuinely separate calendar traditions: the Gregorian solar calendar (borrowed names, everyday civil use in most of the world), the pan-Indian Hindu lunisolar calendar (Chaitra, Vaishākh... tied to the six *ṛtu*), and now Tamil's **own** solar calendar, following neither. **சித்திரை 1** (the 1st of Chithirai) is **Tamil New Year**; **தை 1** (the 1st of Thai) is **Pongal**, one of Tamil Nadu's most important harvest festivals. These dates are fixed by the Tamil solar calendar, and only shift slightly against the Gregorian calendar (rather than drifting widely, the way lunar/lunisolar festival dates do) because it's solar too — just a different solar calendar, starting its year at a different point and naming its months differently.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- the twelve — "Chithirai, Vaikāsi, Āṉi, Āḍi, Āvaṇi, Puraṭṭāsi, Aippasi, Kārthigai, Mārgazhi, Thai, Māsi, Paṅguṉi"
- "Chithirai 1" — Tamil New Year
- "Thai 1" — Pongal

Before you move on

What kind of calendar is the Tamil month system — solar, lunar, or lunisolar? (**Solar** — a genuinely separate calendar from both Gregorian and Hindu lunisolar.) What are the twelve months traditionally named for? (**Nakshatras**, lunar-mansion star groups.) What two important occasions are dated by this calendar? (**Tamil**

New Year (Chithirai 1) and **Pongal** (Thai 1).)

16.2 ம — upright on the left, curve on the right

Before the new one: say the sound of க.

One letter this time. Just one.

One unbroken stroke again, like வ. The only thing to get right is which way round it goes: the **upright is on the LEFT** and the **curve on the right**. Most people guess the reverse, because that is the habit Devanagari teaches — hanging a shape off a right-hand spine.

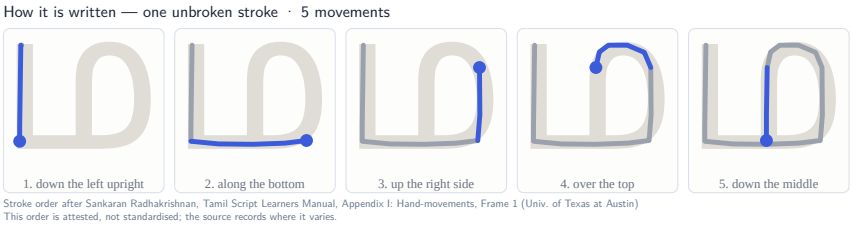
Script you'll notice: ம

ம — *ma*.
What it is made of:

- a straight vertical stroke on the LEFT
- a horizontal along the bottom
- a rounded arch closing it on the RIGHT

It is the last consonant of வணக்கம்.

Writing: ம



How ம *is written, stroke by stroke*

- **1.** start at the top left and draw the left upright straight DOWN to the baseline

- **2.** without lifting, turn right and run along the bottom to the far right
- **3.** without lifting, turn up and rise up the right side
- **4.** without lifting, curve over the top and back towards the left
- **5.** without lifting, come down the middle to the bottom bar — and only now lift

Pen lifts: 0. The pen never leaves the paper.

Stroke order is one attested teaching order, not a national standard — Tamil handwriting is taught with school-to-school variation. Source: Sankaran Radhakrishnan, Tamil Script Learners Manual, Appendix I: Hand-movements, Frame 1 (Univ. of Texas at Austin).

Your turn

- *Trace it:* மா once, slowly, following the steps above
- *Say it:* "ma" as you finish it
- *Trace it:* it twice more, without looking back at the steps

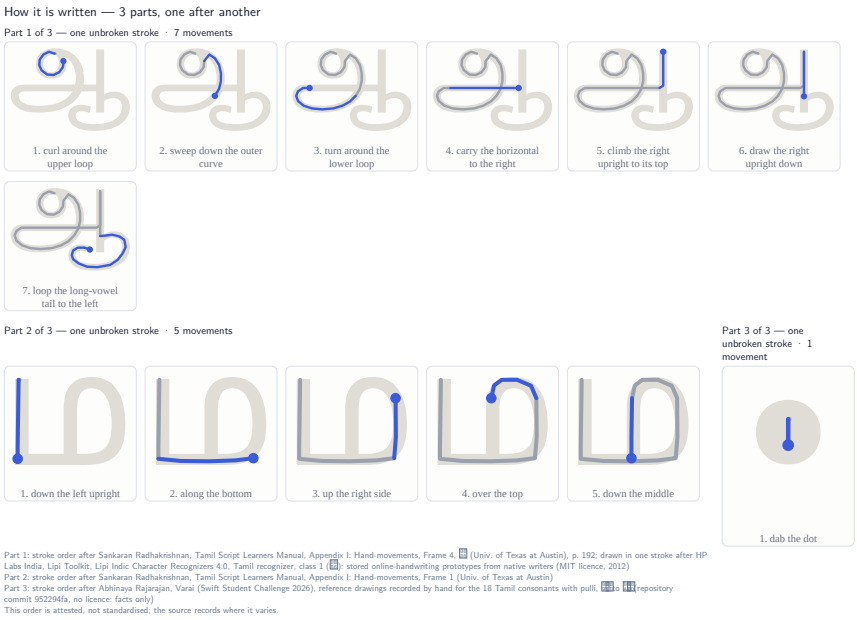
Before you move on

Which side is the upright on? (**The left.**) How many pen lifts? (**None.**)

16.3 ஆம் — writing a word that starts with a vowel

Every vowel *sign* so far has hooked onto a consonant — the ◌ா on ம. This word has no consonant to hook onto.

Script you'll notice: a vowel standing alone



How ஆம் is written, part by part, stroke by stroke

Tamil writes a vowel two ways, and which one you use depends on **where it sits**:

inside a word, after a consonant	a small **sign** — ி in றி
starting a word, with nothing before it	a full **independent letter**

ஆ is the independent letter for long *ā*. It is not a sign and never hangs off anything; it is a letter in its own right.

Long *ā* is short அ plus a tail, so அ is where it starts — and you have not been shown that one yet. Its parts, then the tail:

1. **a curl at the upper left**
2. **a long horizontal stroke**
3. **a straight vertical on the right** — that is அ
4. **a tail added on the right** — and now it is ஆ

Those are the parts in writing order. Where the pen lifts is not settled: Tamil handwriting varies by region and by school, and this book only claims a pen path where it has a sourced one.

That is a rule, not a special case: any Tamil word that opens on a vowel opens with a full vowel letter.

Script you'll notice: build the word

piece		
ஆ	$\bar{a}$	this lesson — independent
ம்	m — ம with the puḷḷi	the dot you already know

ஆ · ம் → ஆம்

Two pieces only. The puḷḷi on ம் closes the word on a bare m, exactly as it did at the end of வணக்கம்.

Your turn

Write these out:

- அ — curl, horizontal, right vertical
- ஆ — the same three parts, then the right-hand tail
- ம் — ம with the dot
- ஆம் — two pieces, left to right

Before you move on

Write ஆம். When does a Tamil vowel get a full letter instead of a sign? (**When it starts a word** — nothing precedes it to hook onto.) What closes the word? (ம் — the puḷḷi on ம.) Next: noon and midnight.

16.4 ஆ — one character, met inside words you already say

Before the new one: அ — what does it do?

One character this time. Just one — and you have been saying it for pages without knowing which mark on the page it was.

Script you'll notice: ஆ

ஆ — *ā*.

It is an **independent vowel** — the shape the vowel *ā* takes when a word begins with it, rather than the sign it becomes inside a word.

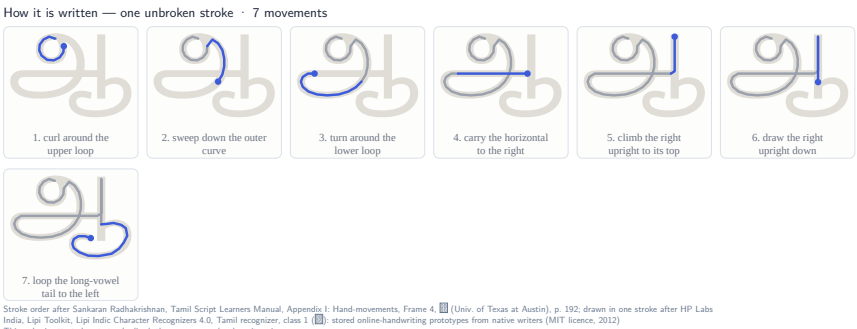
What it is made of:

- the whole of அ
- a tail added on the right

You already say these, and every one of them has ஆ somewhere inside it:

- ஆம் — yes (ām)
- ஆம் / இல்லை / சரி *ām / illai / sari* — answering in Tamil
- ஆறு ஏழு பத்து *āṟu ēḻu pattu* — six, seven, and ten stay family cousins while Kannada regularly softens p to h
- ஆம் *ām* — a word that begins with a vowel gets a full vowel letter

Writing: ஆ



Stroke order after Sankaran Radhakrishnan, Tamil Script Learners Manual, Appendix I: Hand-movements, Frame 4, (Univ. of Texas at Austin), p. 192; drawn in one stroke after HP Labs India, Lipi Toolkit, Lipi Indic Character Recognizers 4.0. Tamil recognizer, class 1 (): stored online-handwriting prototypes from native writers (MIT licence, 2012)
This order is attested, not standardised; the source records where it varies.

How ஆ is written, stroke by stroke

- **1.** start inside the upper curl and sweep around it
- **2.** without lifting, continue down the outer curve
- **3.** without lifting, turn around the lower loop
- **4.** without lifting, carry the horizontal to the right edge
- **5.** without lifting, climb the right upright from there to its top
- **6.** without lifting, draw the upright down over that ink
- **7.** without lifting, continue into the long-vowel loop, curve right and around the bottom, then finish inside — and only now lift

Pen lifts: 0. The pen never leaves the paper.

One continuous stroke — seven joined movements, no pen lift; it goes up the right upright from the horizontal and back down it into the long-vowel loop; order from Radhakrishnan, Tamil Script Learners Manual, Frame 4, ஆ, with the stroke count from native writers' pen traces in HP Labs India's LipiTk Tamil recognizer, class 1.

This is one attested teaching order and not a national standard — handwriting here is taught with school-to-school variation. Source: Sankaran Radhakrishnan, Tamil Script Learners Manual, Appendix I: Hand-movements, Frame 4, ஆ (Univ. of Texas at Austin), p. 192. The stroke count comes from native writers' pen traces in HP Labs India's LipiTk Tamil recognizer: most of them write ஆ without lifting the pen.

Your turn

- *Look:* at these words, and find ஆ in the ones that have it

  ஆம் · வணக்கம்

- *Trace it:* ஆ three times, saying *ā* as you finish each one
- *Look:* back at any page of this chapter and find ஆ once more

Before you move on

Which character is this — ஆ? What sound does it carry? (*ā*.)
Name one word you already say that contains it.

16.5 Chapter 16 checkpoint — the months, ம, ஆ and ஆம்

Nothing new here. The months out loud first, then a letter, a vowel and the word *yes* on the page.

Your turn — the months

- *Say it:* the twelve Tamil months, from the first

(*Chithirai, Vaikāsi, Āṉi, Āḍi, Āvaṇi, Puraṭṭāsi, Aippasi, Kārthigai, Mārgazhi, Thai, Māsi, Paṅguṉi.*)

- Is this a variant of the Hindu lunisolar calendar? (No: it is Tamil's own solar calendar, a third system beside that one and the Gregorian.)
- Which day is Tamil New Year, and which is Pongal? (*Chithirai* 1; *Thai* 1.)

Script — ம, ஆ and ஆம்

- Which side of ம is the upright on? (The left, with the curve on the right.)
- Why does ஆம் open with ஆ rather than the sign ◌ா? (The word starts on a vowel, so the vowel takes its full letter; the sign needs a consonant to hang from.)
- What is ஆ made of? (The whole of அ, plus a tail on the right.)
- Which two pieces build ஆம்? (ஆ · ம்: the puḷḷi closes it on a bare *m*.)

Read it: ஆம் aloud, and point to the ஆ and the puḷḷi

Writing — from sound

Cover: the Script block above, so no model stays in view
Write it: the letter for *ma*, then *ā* as it stands at the start of a word
Write it: *ām*, "yes"
Check: against the key — மா, ஆ, ஆம்
Write it: one repaired shape, then stop

Before you move on

Which month opens the Tamil year, and which month opens with Pongal? (*Chithirai*; *Thai*.) That is the chapter: a calendar of Tamil's own, and the first word you can write that opens on a vowel. Next chapter: noon and midnight.

Chapter 17

Noon and Midnight

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (2) ✓ **pen** (1) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** the first 2 of 3 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can use both the fused and the transparent Tamil words for noon and midnight, and point to the நடு "middle" that makes one pair readable on sight.
>
> *Say naṇpakal beside naṭuppakal and naḷḷiravu beside naṭu iravu, pointing at naṭu as the everyday "middle" still visible in the second of each pair.*

17.1 நண்பகல், நள்ளிரவு — one old "middle" root, two survival stories

You've just watched Kannada and Telugu each reach for Sanskrit's *madhya* to name noon. Tamil doesn't reach for Sanskrit at all here — it reaches into its own, much older layer of vocabulary instead.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

Both of today's words trace back to the same root: நள் (*naḷ*), a **Proto-Dravidian** word for "**middle, centre**" — a genuine synonym of the everyday நடு (*naṭu*, "middle") you already know, just from an older layer of the vocabulary. நள் didn't disappear from Tamil; it survives today mainly in **literary/poetic** compounds — நள்ளிருள் (*naḷḷiruḷ*, "thick darkness") and நள்ளென் கங்குல் (*naḷḷeṉ kaṅkul*, "deep night") — rather than in everyday colloquial speech.

In the family, and next door

	word
Kannada	ಮಧ್ಯಾಹ್ನ ಮಧ್ಯರಾತ್ರಿ (*madhyāhna madhyarātri*)
Telugu	మధ్యాహ్నం అర్ధరాత్రి (*madhyāhnam ardharātri*)
Hindi (neighbour)	दोपहर आधी रात (*dopahar ādhī rāt*)
English	noon and midnight

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

நள்ளிரவு (*naḷḷiravu*) = "**midnight**" = நள் (*naḷ*, "middle") + இரவு (*iravu*, "**night**," a word every Tamil speaker still uses on its own) — நள் shows up here exactly as you'd expect. நண்பகல் (*naṇpakal*) = "**noon, midday**" traces to the **same** நள் root, fused with பகல் (*pakal*, "**daytime**") — but here it surfaces as **நண்-** rather than **நள்-**, a sandhi-driven surface change before the following ப. Same root, two different faces, depending on what it's fused to.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "naḷ" — an old word for "middle" — then "naḷḷiravu," midnight
- "naṇpakal" — noon, the same naḷ root, resurfacing as naṇ-

Before you move on

What old Proto-Dravidian root do நண்பகல் and நள்ளிரவு both trace back to, and what does it mean? (நள் *naḷ*, "middle" — surviving mainly in literary compounds like *naḷḷiruḷ*, "thick darkness.") Why does it surface as **naṇ-** in *naṇpakal*? (A sandhi change before following **p**.) Does Tamil reach for Sanskrit here? (**No**.) Next: meet the transparent *naṭu* synonyms Tamil kept beside these older compounds.

17.2 நடுப்பகல் and நடு இரவு — the transparent twins

Naṇpakal and *naḷḷiravu* preserve an older middle-root in fused forms. Tamil also kept versions whose pieces remain obvious today.

You'll want to know: The living synonyms

- நடுப்பகல் (*naṭuppakal*) — "middle-daytime," a dictionary synonym of *naṇpakal*
- நடு இரவு (*naṭu iravu*) — "middle night," the transparent synonym of *naḷḷiravu*

Both use நடு (*naṭu*, "middle"), the everyday word still heard in *naṭuvē*, "in the middle."

Latin daughter languages often inherit one fate for an old compound: eroded or transparent. Tamil kept **both fates inside one language**—old fused forms and fresh transparent synonyms side by side.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

All three parts are native Dravidian: *naṭu*, "middle" (DEDR 3584; Malayalam *naṭu*, Kannada *naḍu*), *pakal*, "daytime" (DEDR 3805; Malayalam *pakal*), and *iravu*, "night" (DEDR 2552; Malayalam *iravu*).

Your turn

- *Say it:* "naṇpakal · naṭuppakal" — two noon forms
- *Say it:* "naḷḷiravu · naṭu iravu" — two midnight forms
- *Point to: naṭu* as the visible everyday "middle"

Before you move on

Which everyday word builds the transparent forms? (நடு, *naṭu*, "middle.") What did Tamil keep simultaneously? (**Older fused compounds and transparent synonyms**.) Are any pieces Sanskrit loans? (**No**.)

17.3 ◌ூ — one character, met inside words you already say

Before the new one: ஆ — what does it do?

One character this time. Just one — and you have been saying it for pages without knowing which mark on the page it was.

Script you'll notice: ◌ூ

◌ூ — *u*.

It is a **vowel sign**. It is not a letter and never stands alone: it attaches to a consonant and **replaces** the *a* built into it with *u*. Replaces, not adds — the *a* is gone.

You already say these, and every one of them has ◌ூ somewhere inside it:

- போய் வருகிறேன் *pōy varugiṟēṉ* — goodbye (lit. "I'll go and come back")
- மீண்டும் சந்திப்போம் *mīṇḍum sandippōm* — we'll meet again
- தமிழ் எழுத்து *tamiḻ eḻuttu* — why Tamil writing is so round
- பேசு *pēsu* — to speak

Writing: ◌ூ — copy what you see

Put your pen on ◌ூ and follow its line. Copy the shape you can see — slowly, and larger than it is printed.

> This book does not yet tell you **where to start the character or which way to travel**. That is a real thing, taught with real variation from school to school, and it is not written down here until it can be written down with a source. Copying what is in front of you needs no such source, and it is how the shape gets into your hand in the meantime.

Your turn

- *Look:* at these words, and find ◌ூ in the ones that have it

  வணக்கம்

- *Trace it:* ◌ु three times, saying *u* as you finish each one
- *Look:* back at any page of this chapter and find ◌ु once more

Before you move on

Which character is this — ◌ु? What vowel does it put on the consonant it attaches to — and what does it take off? (**Puts *u* on; takes the built-in *a* off.**) Name one word you already say that contains it.

Chapter 18

Telling Time

Modes: **voice** (1) **eyes** (1) **pen** (3) **Hands-free start:** the first of 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can tell the time on the hour in Tamil and keep the hour-word மணி apart from the unrelated Sanskrit gem-word spelled exactly the same way.
>
> *Say oru maṇi and iraṇṭu maṇi for one and two o'clock, then choose hour or gem by the context the word sits in; write* இல்லை *piece by piece and say what the puḷḷi and the left-standing ai sign do.*

18.1 மணி — Tamil's native "bell," and a real homophone trap

You've watched Kannada and Telugu both borrow Sanskrit's "bell" word for "hour," matching Hindi exactly. Tamil goes its own way again here — with a genuinely tricky twist along the way.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

மணி (*maṇi*) = "**hour, o'clock**" — and it also means "**bell, gong**," the same double duty you've now seen several times. Wiktionary's Tamil entry gives this *maṇi* its **own etymology**, separate from a Sanskrit-loan entry of the same spelling — most likely a **native Dravidian** word, not the Sanskrit घण्टा (*ghaṇṭā*) behind Kannada's *gaṇṭe*, Telugu's *ganṭa*, and Hindi's *ghanṭā*. On this account, Tamil underwent the **same** "a bell announces the hour, so the bell-word

becomes the hour-word" shift on its own, from a different starting point — though even the comparative Dravidian dictionary (DEDR 4672) flags a possible Sanskrit connection for this whole word-family as unresolved, so hold "native" as the best current account rather than a settled fact.

In the family, and next door

	word	**same root**
Kannada	ಗಂಟೆ (*gaṇṭe*)	
Telugu	గంట (*ganṭa*)	
Malayalam	മണി (*maṇi*)	yes
Hindi (neighbour)	घंटा (*ghaṇṭā*)	
English	hour	

Your turn

- *Say it:* "maṇi" — hour, also "bell" — native, NOT from Sanskrit ghaṇṭā
- *Read it:* ൬ மணி — the numeral from chapter seven and the hour word you have met, side by side

Before you move on

Is Tamil's மணி ("hour") from the same Sanskrit root as Kannada/Telugu/Hindi's hour-words? (**Most likely no** — it's treated as a native Dravidian "bell" word that independently reached "hour" the same way, though even DEDR flags this as not fully settled.) What semantic path links the meanings? (A **bell announces the hour**.) Next: writing இல்லை — a second independent vowel, ல, and the ai sign.

18.2 ◌் — the dot that takes the vowel away

Not a letter this time — a mark that changes the letter under it.

Script you'll notice: ◌்

Every Tamil consonant you have written so far carries a hidden *a*. வ is not *v*, it is **va**. ம is **ma**. That is what an abugida is: the vowel is built in.

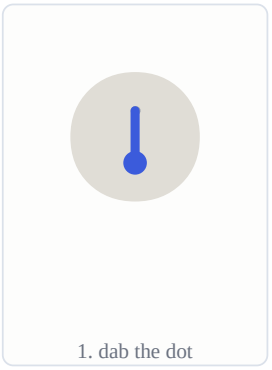
The puḷḷi is how you take it back. One dot above the letter, and வ becomes plain **v**.

Here is what Tamil does that Devanagari does not: **the dot stays visible and both letters keep their full shape.** Devanagari fuses two consonants into a single new conjunct you have to learn separately. Tamil just writes the dot. There is nothing extra to memorise.

Where it sits: a DOT written above the letter, removing the inherent vowel; unlike Devanagari's virama it does not trigger a conjunct — both letters keep their full shape and the dot stays visible

Writing: ◌்

How it is written — one unbroken stroke · 1 movement



Stroke order after Abhinaya Rajarajan, Varai (Swift Student Challenge 2026), reference drawings recorded by hand for the 18 Tamil consonants with pulli, □□ to □□ (repository commit 952294fa, no licence: facts only)
This order is attested, not standardised; the source records where it varies.

How ◌் is written, stroke by stroke

With this you can write வணக்கம் — every letter, in order:

வ + ண + க + ◌் + க + ம + ◌்

Seven marks on the page, and you have written *hello*.

Your turn

- *Trace it:* the mark on a letter you already know
- *Say it:* the letter's sound with the mark, then without it
- *Write it:* the whole word above, one mark at a time

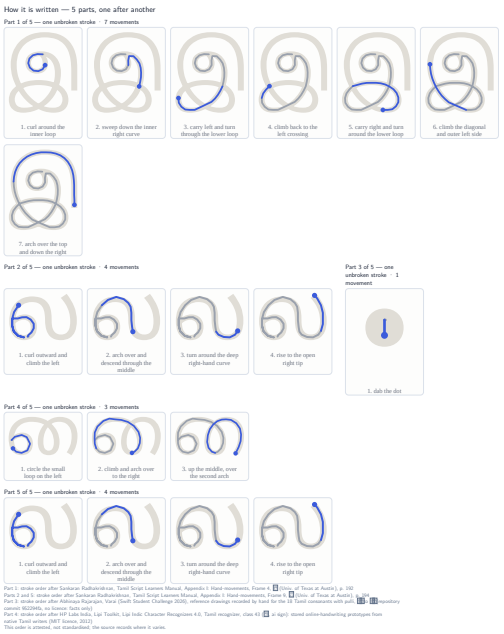
Before you move on

What does the puḷḷi do? (**Removes the built-in vowel.**) What is வ with a puḷḷi? (**v**, not *va*.) What does Tamil NOT do that Devanagari does? (**Fuse the letters into a new shape.**)

18.3 இல்லை — a vowel in front, a vowel sign behind

Last lesson gave you the rule: a word opening on a vowel opens with a full letter. Here is the same rule with a different vowel, plus one new sign.

Script you'll notice: இ and ல



How இல்லை *is written, part by part, stroke by stroke*

இ is the independent letter for short *i* — the same job ஆ did, one vowel over. Its parts, in writing order:

1. **a crossing spiral on the left**
2. **a tall straight vertical on the right**

ல is *la*, with its built-in *a* like every consonant:

1. **a curl that turns back on itself**
2. **a stroke rising to the right**

Put the puḷḷi on it and you get ல், a bare *l*.

The new mark is ை, the sign for *ai*, and it does something ி did not. **It is written to the LEFT of its consonant, but pronounced after it.**

ல + ை → லை, and on the page the hook stands *before* the ல — yet you say *lai*, not *ail*.

Your eye meets the vowel first and your mouth says it second. Devanagari does the same thing with ि, and it catches everyone once.

> Tamil keeps **three** *l*-letters (ல ள ழ) and **two** *r*-letters (ர ற), the same way it keeps three *n*'s. This is the first of the *l*'s.

Script you'll notice: build the word

piece		
இ	*i*	independent — the word opens on a vowel
ல்	*l* — ல with the puḷḷi	bare consonant
லை	*lai* — ல with the ai sign	this lesson

இ · ல் · லை → இல்லை

The ல் + லை is a doubled *l*, held like the க்க of *vaṇakkam*: *il-lai*, not *ilai*.

Your turn

- *Write it:* இ — spiral, then the right-hand vertical
- *Write it:* ல — curl, then rising stroke
- *Write it:* லை — the ai hook goes on the LEFT
- *Write it:* இல்லை — three pieces
- *Say it:* "il-lai" — hold the doubled *l*

Before you move on

Write இல்லை. Why does it open with இ rather than a sign? (**The word starts on a vowel**.) Which side of its consonant does ை sit on? (**The left** — written first, spoken second.) Next: the gem-word homophone, and telling clock time.

18.4 மணி — hour or jewel? Context decides

The likely native bell/hour word shares its spelling and sound with a clear Sanskrit loan meaning something entirely different.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

Tamil dictionaries list a second மணி from Sanskrit मणि (*maṇi*), "gem, jewel." On that analysis, bell/hour and gem are **homophones**: one likely native, one borrowed, identical on the page. Context separates clock time from a jewel or personal name.
The comparative Dravidian dictionary lists the bell/hour word with Malayalam *maṇi*, "little bells, gong, hour", and Kota, Toda and Tulu bell words (DEDR 4672). It adds a query about a source in Sanskrit *maṇi*, "jewel", and leaves it open.

Grammar Lens: Tell the time

இரண்டு மணி. — two o'clock, literally "two hour/bell"

மூன்று மணி. — three o'clock

The number comes first; *maṇi* supplies the clock unit.

Your turn

- *Say it:* "iraṇṭu maṇi" — two o'clock
- *Say it:* "mūn̲ru maṇi" — three o'clock
- *Choose by context:* clock → hour · jewelry/name → gem

Script — the puḷḷi and இல்லை

- *Write it:* இல்லை — இ, then ல், then லை
- *Point to:* the puḷḷi, then the ai hook

What does the puḷḷi do to ல? (**Removes its built-in *a*** — bare *l*.) Why open on இ? (**The word starts on a vowel**.) Which side does ை sit on? (**The left** — written first, spoken second.)

Before you move on

What is the homophone trap? (A likely separate Sanskrit-borrowed **மணி** means **gem**.) Does Malayalam analyze the same forms identically? (**No**.) How do you say two o'clock? (**இரண்டு மணி**, *iraṇṭu maṇi*.)

18.5 த — one character, met inside words you already say

Before the new one: ◌ை — what does it do?

One character this time. Just one — and you have been saying it for pages without knowing which mark on the page it was.

Script you'll notice: த

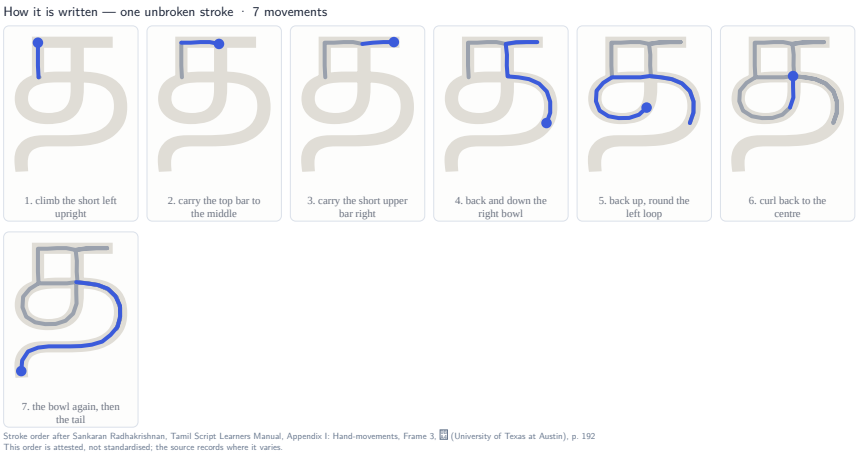
த — *ta*.

It is a **consonant**, and in this script a consonant is never bare: it comes with an *a* already in it. So it is not *t*, it is **ta**.

You already say these, and every one of them has த somewhere inside it:

- மீண்டும் சந்திப்போம் *mīṇḍum sandippōm* — we'll meet again
- தமிழ் எழுத்து *tamiḻ eḻuttu* — why Tamil writing is so round
- நான் தமிழ் பேசுகிறேன் *nāṉ tamiḻ pēsugiṟēṉ* — I speak Tamil
- எனக்குத் தமிழ் தெரியும் *enakkut tamiḻ teriyum* — 'I know Tamil'

Writing: த — follow the numbered strip



How த *is written, stroke by stroke*

Follow the numbered strip: start where movement 1 begins, and let each panel show you the next movement before your pen makes it. Then write த yourself — slowly, and larger than it is printed.

> The strip shows **where to start the character and which way to travel**, in one attested order. That is taught with real variation from school to school, so the strip names its source beneath it: treat it as a sound way in, not the only one.

Your turn

- *Look:* at these words, and find த in the ones that have it

  வணக்கம்

- *Trace it:* த three times, saying *ta* as you finish each one
- *Look:* back at any page of this chapter and find த once more

Before you move on

Which character is this — த? What sound does it carry? (***ta***.)
Name one word you already say that contains it.

Chapter 19

Asking Someone's Age

Modes: **voice** (2) **pen** (4) **Hands-free start:** the first 2 of 6 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can ask someone's age in both the casual possessive shape and the formal dative-plus-become shape, and answer with my own.
>
> *Complete TA-C19-checkpoint, the chapter's closing checkpoint: ask an age casually and formally and answer in the formal shape, place vayathu in Sanskrit vayas, say what ி and ச do, find ே in பேசு, then write றி, சரி and ே from sound.*

19.1 உனக்கு எத்தனை வயது ஆகிறது? (unakku ettanai vayathu aakirathu?) — Tamil actually has BOTH shapes

> Same Sanskrit word one more time — but be careful here: Tamil isn't locked into just one of the two grammatical shapes you've now seen. It has both, in different registers.

You'll want to know: வயது — the same Sanskrit "vigor/ age" word, a fourth time

வயது (*vayathu*) = "**age**" — the same Sanskrit वयस् (*vayas*, "age, vigor," PIE cousin of Latin **vīs**) you've now met four times across Kannada, Telugu, Malayalam, and Tamil. All four Dravidian languages borrowed this exact Sanskrit word for "age" — none of them built a native alternative for this particular concept, the way they did for so many others.

In the family, and next door

	word
Kannada	ನಿನ್ನ ವಯಸ್ಸು ಎಷ್ಟು? (*ninna vayassu eṣṭu?*)
Telugu	నీ వయసెంత? (*nī vayasenta*)
Malayalam	നിങ്ങൾക്ക് എത്ര വയസ്സുണ്ട്? (*niṅṅaḷkkŭ etra vayassuṇṭŭ?*)
English	how old are you?

Your turn

- *Say it:* "vayathu" — age — then the whole formal question, "unakku ettanai vayathu aakirathu?"
- *Connect:* Sanskrit *vayas* · Tamil *vayathu* · Latin *vīs*

Before you move on

Is Tamil's வயது the same Sanskrit word borrowed by all four Dravidian languages here? (**Yes** — none built a native alternative for this concept.) What did *vayas* originally include besides age? (**Vigor**.) Next: choose between Tamil's casual possessive and formal dative-plus-become shapes.

19.2 Your age what? / To you how many years becomes?

Tamil did not choose one age construction. Register selects between two shapes already visible elsewhere in the family.

Grammar Lens: Casual possessive

உன் வயசு என்ன? — "your age what?"

Casual speech uses a plain possessive with no dative and no verb, like Kannada and Telugu.

Grammar Lens: Formal dative plus "become"

> **உனக்கு எத்தனை வயது ஆகிறது?** — "to you how many years is becoming?"
>
> **எனக்குப் பத்து வயது ஆகிறது.** — "to me ten years is becoming."

Formal/written Tamil uses the dative experiencer plus **ஆகிறது** (*aakirathu*, "is becoming," from *aaku*). Written Tamil also doubles the ப of *pattu* back onto *enakku* as ப்: *enakkup pattu*. Malayalam uses a similar dative shape but chooses "exists" instead.
Do not compress these into "Tamil's one grammar." Both live in the language; setting and register choose between them.

Your turn

- *Say it:* "un vayasu enna?" — casual
- *Say it:* "unakku ettanai vayathu aakirathu?" — formal
- *Answer:* "enakkup pattu vayathu aakirathu"

Before you move on

Which shape is casual? (**Possessive**: "your age what?") Which is formal? (**Dative + aakirathu**, "become.") Does Malayalam use the same verb? (**No** — it uses "exists.")

19.3 ி — the first vowel sign

> Not a letter this time — a mark that changes the letter under it.

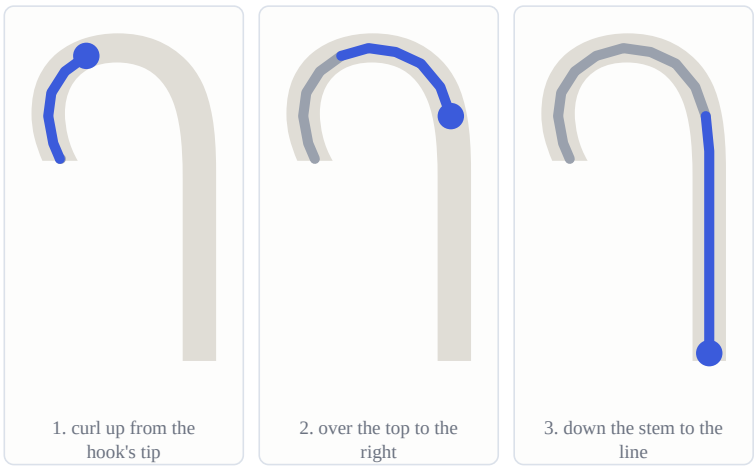
Script you'll notice: ி

A consonant carries *a*. To make it carry a different vowel you add a **sign** — and the sign replaces the built-in vowel rather than sitting beside it.

The i-sign is a hook written above and to the right. ற is *ṟa*; றி is **ṟi**.
Where it sits: a hook written above and to the right of the consonant

Writing: ி

How it is written — one unbroken stroke · 3 movements



Stroke order after HP Labs India, Lipi Toolkit, Lipi Indic Character Recognizers 4.0, Tamil recognizer, class 37 (, i sign): stored online-handwriting prototypes from native Tamil writers (MIT licence, 2012)
This order is attested, not standardised; the source records where it varies.

How ி is written, stroke by stroke

And with that: நன்றி.

ந + ன + ் + ற + ி

Thank you — the second word you can write.

Your turn

- *Trace it:* the mark on a letter you already know
- *Say it:* the letter's sound with the mark, then without it
- *Write it:* the whole word above, one mark at a time

Before you move on

Does a vowel sign add a vowel or replace one? (**Replace** — the built-in *a* is gone.) What is ற with an i-sign? (**ri**.)

19.4 சரி — one letter, several sounds

You have seen க cover *k*, *g* and a soft *h* depending on where it sits. Here is the same economy on a second letter.

Script you'll notice: ச and ர



How சரி *is written, part by part, stroke by stroke*

ச is written once and does the work English splits between **s**, **ch** and **j**. Position picks which:

where	**sound**
starting a word	*s* or *ch*
between vowels	softened
after a nasal, as in ஞ்ச	*j*

That is exactly the pattern க showed — *k* at the start, *g* after a nasal, a soft *h* between vowels. One letter per position of the mouth, and context fills in the rest.

ர is *ra*, with its built-in *a*. It is the other of Tamil's **two** *r*-letters, alongside the ற you met in நன்றி.

Read both letters here. The strip writes ச, ர and then the ி sign, numbered movement by movement, with each source beneath it.

Script you'll notice: build the word

piece		
ச	*sa* here	this lesson
ரி	*ri* — ர with the ி sign	the sign from நன்றி

ச · ரி → சரி

Two pieces, and both parts are things you already hold: a consonant, and the vowel sign you first hooked onto ற.

Your turn

- *Read it:* ச — then சரி
- *Say it:* "sari"
- *Contrast:* ரி and லை — the ி sign follows its letter, the ை sign precedes it
- *Write it:* ஆம் and இல்லை again, from memory — yes and no, the two you will reach for most

Before you move on

Read சரி. Which English sounds does ச cover on its own? (***s*** or ***ch*** at the start, softened between vowels, ***j*** after a nasal.) How many *r*-letters does Tamil keep? (**Two** — ர and ற.) In லை, which side of the ல does the ai sign sit on? (**The left**.) And why does இல்லை open with இ rather than a sign? (**It starts on a vowel**.) Next: the numbers eleven to twenty.

19.5 ே — one character, met inside words you already say

Before the new one: த — what does it do?

> One character this time. Just one — and you have been saying it for pages without knowing which mark on the page it was.

Script you'll notice: ே

ே — *ē*.

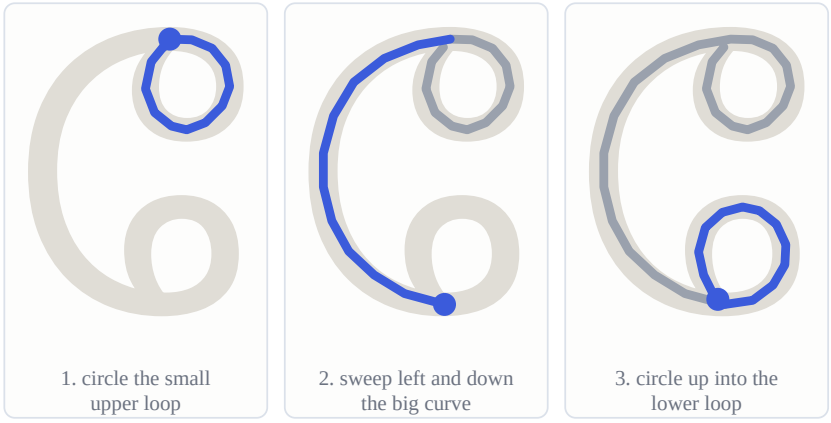
It is a **vowel sign**. It is not a letter and never stands alone: it attaches to a consonant and **replaces** the *a* built into it with *ē*. Replaces, not adds — the *a* is gone.

You already say these, and every one of them has ே somewhere inside it:

- போய் வருகிறேன் *pōy varugiṟēṉ* — goodbye (lit. "I'll go and come back")
- பேசு *pēsu* — to speak
- நான் தமிழ் பேசுகிறேன் *nāṉ tamiḻ pēsugiṟēṉ* — I speak Tamil
- வேலை செய் *vēlai sey* — to work (lit. "work-do")

Writing: ே — follow the numbered strip

How it is written — one unbroken stroke · 3 movements



Stroke order after HP Labs India, Lipi Toolkit, Lipi Indic Character Recognizers 4.0, Tamil recognizer, class 42 (ே, ee sign): stored online-handwriting prototypes from native Tamil writers (MIT licence, 2012)
This order is attested, not standardised; the source records where it varies.

How ே is written, stroke by stroke

Follow the numbered strip: start where movement 1 begins, and let each panel show you the next movement before your pen makes it. Then write ே yourself — slowly, and larger than it is printed.

> The strip shows **where to start the character and which way to travel**, in one attested order. That is taught with real variation from school to school, so the strip names its source beneath it: treat it as a sound way in, not the only one.

Your turn

- *Look:* at these words, and find ே in the ones that have it

  பேசு · வணக்கம்

- *Trace it:* ே three times, saying *ē* as you finish each one
- *Look:* back at any page of this chapter and find ே once more

Before you move on

Which character is this — ே? What vowel does it put on the consonant it attaches to — and what does it take off? (**Puts *ē* on; takes the built-in *a* off.**) Name one word you already say that contains it.

19.6 Chapter 19 checkpoint — two ways to ask an age, and சரி from sound

> Nothing new here. The age question in both its shapes first, then a vowel sign, a word and one more sign on the page.

Your turn — the age question

- *Say it:* the casual question, to a friend
- *Say it:* the formal question, to someone you would address with care
- *Answer:* in the formal shape, giving twenty as the age

(*Un vayasu enna? — Unakku ettanai vayathu aakirathu? — Enakku irupathu vayathu aakirathu.*)

- Where does *vayathu* come from? (Sanskrit *vayas*, "age, vigor", which all four Dravidian languages here borrowed.)
- Which shape uses the dative and *aakirathu*, "becomes"? (The formal one; the casual one is a plain possessive with no verb.)

Script — ◌ி, ச and ே◌

- Does ◌ி add a vowel or replace one? (It replaces the built-in *a*: ற is *ṟa*, றி is *ṟi*.)
- Which sounds does ச cover on its own? (*s* or *ch* at the start of a word, softened between vowels, *j* after a nasal.)
- Which two pieces build சரி? (ச · ரி: ர carrying the i-sign.)
- In பேசு, *pēsu*, "to speak", which mark gives the first consonant its *ē*? (ே◌.)

Read it: சரி and பேசு aloud, and point to the ே◌

Writing — from sound

Cover: the Script block above, so no model stays in view
Write it: *ṟi*, then *sari*, "okay"
Write it: the sign that turns a consonant's *a* into *ē*
Check: against the key — றி, சரி, ே◌
Write it: one repaired shape, then stop

Before you move on

A friend asks your age, then an elder does. Which shape does each one use? (The possessive for the friend; the dative with *aakirathu* for the elder.) That is the chapter: one borrowed word, two grammars, and *okay* written from sound.
Next chapter: the numbers eleven to twenty.

Chapter 20

Numbers Eleven to Twenty and Weather

Modes: **voice** (2) **pen** (1) **Hands-free start:** the first 2 of 3 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can count eleven to twenty as the transparent compounds they are, and say what the weather is doing.
>
> *Count 11 and 12 as ten-plus-a-digit and take irupathu apart as "two-tens", then take vāṉilai apart into vāṉam plus nilai and report the weather with mazhai peykiRathu.*

20.1 பதினொன்று–இருபது — shared Dravidian patterns

> Here's how this arc closes: four completely different approaches to "twenty" across Sanskrit, Latin, Arabic — and then all four Dravidian languages quietly agreeing on the exact same compositional idea.

You'll want to know: பதினொன்று–பத்தொன்பது — "ten" + digit

Tamil's teens echo பத்து (*pathu*, "**ten**") plus each digit — பதினொன்று (*patiṉoṉṟu*, 11), பன்னிரண்டு (*paṉṉiraṇṭu*, 12), and onward through பத்தொன்பது (*pattoṉbatu*, 19) — the same digit-plus- ten-echo compounding you've now seen across Kannada, Telugu, and Malayalam.

In the family, and next door

	word	same root
Kannada	ಹನ್ನೊಂದು — ఇప్పత్తు (*hannondu — ippattu*)	yes
Telugu	పదకొండు — ఇరవై (*padakoṇḍu — iravai*)	yes
Malayalam	പതിനൊന്ന് — ഇരുപത് (*patinonnŭ — irupatŭ*)	yes
English	11-20	

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

Both halves are native Dravidian. *Pattu*, "ten", is DEDR 3918, with Malayalam *pattu*, Kannada *pattu* and Telugu *padi*. The bound *iru*, "two", is DEDR 474, and that entry lists Malayalam *iru-patu* and Kannada *irpattu*, "twenty", built the same way.

You'll want to know: இருபது — transparently "two-tens"

இரு + பத்து → இருபது (*irupathu*, "**twenty**"): an older word for "**two**," alongside the everyday இரண்டு *iraṇḍu*, plus *pathu*, "**ten**" — fully transparent as "**two-tens**," matching **Malayalam's** own *irupathu* almost letter-for-letter.

Why it's said this way

This closes the numbers arc with a genuinely clean pattern. All four major Dravidian languages build "twenty" the **same** compositional way — some (Tamil, Malayalam) keeping it fully transparent on the surface today, some (Kannada) with the same compositional origin but no longer visibly matching the modern standalone words for "two" and "ten," some (Telugu) worn down further but most likely from the same root. Compare that to the other three families you've met: Sanskrit's विंशति (*vimshati*), Latin's **vīgintī**, and Arabic's عشرون (*ʿishrūn*) are each their **own** special, non-compositional word for twenty — none built transparently from "two" and "ten" the way Tamil, Telugu, Kannada, and Malayalam all do.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "patinon̲d̲ru, pan̲n̲iraṇḍu" — 11, 12
- "iru" — an older word for two, "pathu" — ten
- "irupathu" — twenty, "two-tens," transparent

Before you move on

What two pieces build இருபது (twenty)? (இரு + பத்து → இருபது: "two" and "ten" — "**two-tens**.") Do all four major Dravidian languages build "twenty" the same compositional way? (**Yes** — Tamil and Malayalam keep it fully transparent today; Kannada shares the same compositional origin but its modern "two"/"ten" words no longer visibly match; Telugu's is worn down further but most likely the same root.) Do Sanskrit, Latin, or Arabic build their word for twenty this way? (**No** — each has its own special, non-compositional standalone word instead.)

20.2 வானிலை — "the standing of the sky," most likely all native

You've now seen a Persian+Sanskrit hybrid (Kannada), a pure Sanskrit compound (Telugu), and a Sanskrit compound echoing "time" (Malayalam). Tamil most likely breaks the pattern one more time — with a word built entirely from native pieces.

You'll want to know: வானிலை — vaanam + nilai

வானிலை (*vān̲ilai*) = "**weather**" — built from:

- வானம் (*vān̲am*, "**sky**") — most likely a **native Dravidian** word, with confirmed cognates in **Kannada** ಬಾನು (*bānu*, "sky") and **Telugu** వాన (*vāna*, "rain," from the same sky/rain-cloud root) — distinct from the Sanskrit sky word *ākāśa* that those same two languages use elsewhere.
- நிலை (*nilai*, "**state, standing, condition**") — from நில் (*nil*, "**to stand**"), one of Tamil's most basic native verb roots.

So *vāṉilai* literally means "**the standing of the sky**" — and unlike its three Dravidian cousins, neither piece is a Sanskrit or Persian/Arabic loan. ("Native" is the best current account, not a settled fact — but both pieces are well-attested as old Dravidian vocabulary.)

In the family, and next door

	word
Kannada	ಹವಾಮಾನ (*havāmāna*)
Telugu	వాతావరణం (*vātāvaraṇam*)
Malayalam	കാലാവസ്ഥ (*kālāvastha*)
Hindi (neighbour)	मौसम (*mausam*)
English	weather

You'll want to know: மழை பெய்கிறது — "rain is falling"

> **மழை பெய்கிறது.** — "It's raining." — literally "**rain is falling**." (*mazhai peykiRathu* — from **பெய்** *pey*, "to fall/pour," specifically used for rain.)

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "vāṉilai" — weather, "the standing of the sky"
- "vāṉam" — sky, "nilai" — state, from "nil," to stand
- "mazhai peykiRathu" — it's raining, "rain is falling"

Your turn — eleven to twenty

- Say 11, then 12. (***patiṉoṉṟu***, ***paṉṉiraṇḍu*** — **பத்து**, ten, echoed plus a digit.)
- Say twenty and take it apart. (***irupathu*** — *iru*, an older "two," + **பத்து**, "ten": "**two-tens**.")
- Do Sanskrit, Latin or Arabic build twenty that way? (**No** — each has its own special word; all four Dravidian sisters compose it.)

Before you move on

What are the two pieces of வானிலை, and what does the whole word literally mean? (வானம், "sky," + நிலை, "state/standing" — "**the standing of the sky**.") Is either piece a Sanskrit or Persian/Arabic loan, unlike Kannada, Telugu, or Malayalam's weather words? (**Most likely not** — both pieces are native Dravidian.) What Tamil word does Malayalam's *mazha* match for "rain"? (மழை, *mazhai*.)

20.3 ய — one character, met inside words you already say

Before the new one: ே — what does it do?

One character this time. Just one — and you have been saying it for pages without knowing which mark on the page it was.

Script you'll notice: ய

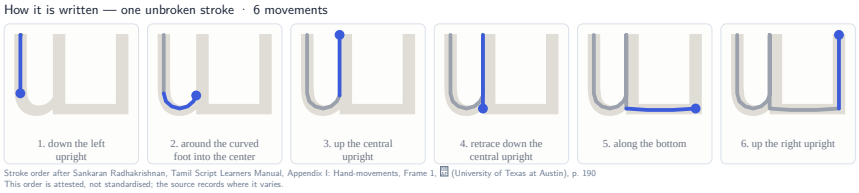
ய — *ya*.

It is a **consonant**, and in this script a consonant is never bare: it comes with an *a* already in it. So it is not *y*, it is **ya**.

You already say these, and every one of them has ய somewhere inside it:

- பெயர் *peyar* — name
- என் பெயர் **...** *en̲ peyar …* — my name is… (with no "is")
- பரவாயில்லை *paravāyillai* — it's okay / no problem / you're welcome
- போய் வருகிறேன் *pōy varugi̲rēn̲* — goodbye (lit. "I'll go and come back")

Writing: ய — follow the numbered strip



How ய *is written, stroke by stroke*

Follow the numbered strip: start where movement 1 begins, and let each panel show you the next movement before your pen makes it. Then write ய yourself — slowly, and larger than it is printed.

> The strip shows **where to start the character and which way to travel**, in one attested order. That is taught with real variation from school to school, so the strip names its source beneath it: treat it as a sound way in, not the only one.

Your turn

- *Look:* at these words, and find ய in the ones that have it

  பெயர் · வணக்கம்

- *Trace it:* ய three times, saying *ya* as you finish each one
- *Look:* back at any page of this chapter and find ய once more

Before you move on

Which character is this — ய? What sound does it carry? (***ya***.)
Name one word you already say that contains it.

Chapter 21

Dog and Cat

Modes: **voice** (1) **pen** (1) **Hands-free start:** the first of 2 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say dog and cat in Tamil and say which of the two rests on an undisputed Dravidian root and which sits inside a three-way family split.
>
> *Say nāy and pūnai, then place Kannada's bekku and Telugu's pilli as two other roots entirely rather than variants of the same word.*

21.1 நாய், பூனை — solid ground to close the arc, and an honest three-way split

> This whole ANIMALS arc kept finding mystery dog-words — Spanish's *perro*, English's *dog*, Hindi's *kuttā*, each one an unsolved puzzle displacing an older, expected word. Tamil's dog-word closes the arc on the complete opposite footing: total, undisputed solid ground.

You'll want to know: நாய் — no mystery, anywhere

நாய் (*nāy*, "**dog**") is a solid, native **Proto-Dravidian** root — the exact same one behind Kannada's ನಾಯಿ (*nāyi*) and Malayalam's നായ (*nāya*). There is no debate about its origin, no substrate mystery, nothing like the *perro*/*dog*/*kuttā* pattern that ran through Spanish, English, and Hindi. Three unrelated language families each lost their expected word for "dog" to an unexplained newcomer — and right here, in the Dravidian family, the expected word simply **survived**, plainly and solidly, across (at least) three of its languages.

In the family, and next door

	word	same root
Kannada	ನಾಯಿ, ಬೆಕ್ಕು (*nāyi, bekku*)	
Telugu	కుక్క, పిల్లి (*kukka, pilli*)	
Malayalam	നായ, പൂച്ച (*nāya, pūcca*)	yes
Hindi (neighbour)	कुत्ता (*kuttā*)	
English	dog and cat	

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

பூனை (*pūnai*, "**cat**") is Tamil's own everyday word, matching Malayalam's പൂച്ച (*pūcha*) closely — but be honest that "cat" splits Dravidian in a way "dog" doesn't. Kannada's everyday word, ಬೆಕ್ಕು (*bekku*), comes from a **different** ancient root (related to the word for "wildcat"); Telugu's, పిల్లి (*pilli*), comes from yet **another** separate Proto-Dravidian root, most likely the very source behind Sanskrit's *biḍāla* and Hindi's *billī*. Tamil itself even keeps **rarer, alternate** cat-words — பில்லி and வெருகு — cognate with Telugu's and Kannada's everyday choices respectively, showing that all three roots were once available across the family; each language just settled on a different one as its everyday word.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "nāy" — dog, solid native Dravidian, no mystery anywhere
- "pūnai" — cat, Tamil's everyday word, matching Malayalam
- the honest split — Kannada's bekku and Telugu's pilli come from two other, separate ancient roots

Before you move on

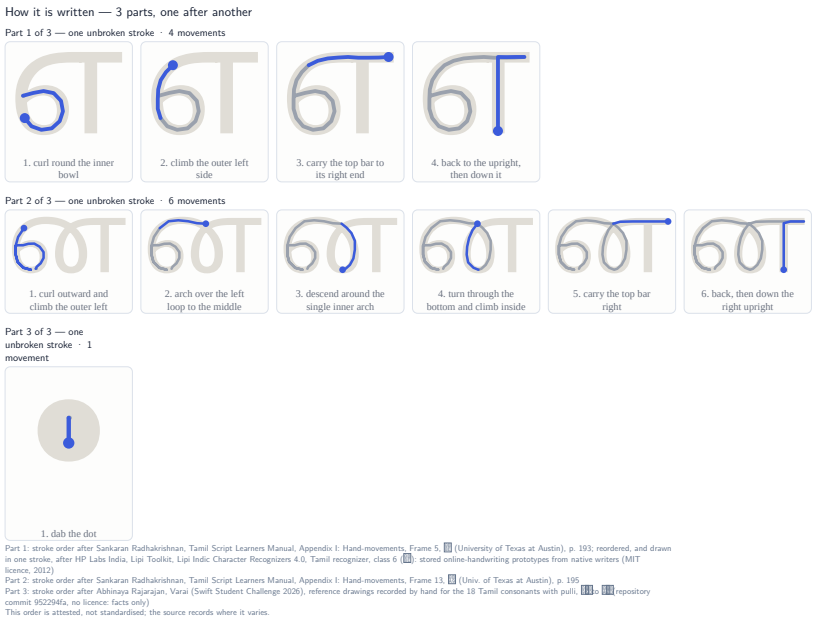
Is நாய் a mystery word, like Spanish's *perro*, English's *dog*, or Hindi's *kuttā*? (**No** — a solid, undisputed native Dravidian root, shared with Kannada and Malayalam.) Does பூனை share a root with Kannada's *bekku* or Telugu's *pilli*? (**No** — all three are

genuinely separate ancient Dravidian roots; Tamil even keeps rarer alternate cat-words, *pilli* and *veruku*, echoing both of them.) Which Dravidian cat-word is most likely the source of Sanskrit's *biḍāla* and Hindi's *billī*? (**Telugu's pilli**.)

21.2 என் — the third vowel that opens a word

You know the rule already: a Tamil word that opens on a vowel opens with a **full vowel letter**, never a sign. You have seen it twice — ஆ in *ām*, இ in *illai*. Here is the third, in a word you have been saying since chapter 2.

Script you'll notice: எ



How என் *is written, part by part, stroke by stroke*

எ is the independent letter for short *e*. Same job as ஆ and இ, one more vowel along.

ஆ	opens *ām*
இ	opens *illai*
எ	opens *en̲*

Three words, three different vowels, one rule doing the work each time. That is what makes the rule worth having: you did not need to be told about எ separately, only that word-initial vowels get a full letter.

> Read எ. The strip writes எ, ன and the pul̤l̤i in turn, numbered movement by movement, with each source beneath it.

Script you'll notice: build the word

piece		
எ	*e*	independent — the word opens on a vowel
ன்	bare *n̲* — ன under a pul̤l̤i	the alveolar *n*, from நன்றி

எ · ன் → என்

Two pieces, and you have met both halves before: the alveolar ன is the middle one of Tamil's three *n*'s, and the dot on top is the same pul̤l̤i that closes வணக்கம்.

Your turn

- *Read it:* எ — then என்
- *Say it:* "en̲" — "my"
- *Contrast:* ஆம் · இல்லை · என் — three words, three opening vowels

Before you move on

Read என். Why does it open with a full எ rather than a sign? (**The word starts on a vowel** — there is no consonant to hook onto.) Which vowel opens இல்லை? (இ.) What is the dot doing on ன்? (**Removing the built-in *a***, leaving a bare *n̲*.) Next: green

and yellow, and a colour word the whole Dravidian family shares.

Chapter 22

Green and Yellow

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (1) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** its only lesson.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say green and yellow in Tamil, recognise பசுப்பு as a rarer doublet, and keep the pan-Dravidian root separate from the independent one.
>
> *Say* பச்சை *as the pan-Dravidian green,* மஞ்சள் *as a separate native yellow, and* பசுப்பு *as the rarer doublet beside them.*

22.1 பச்சை, மஞ்சள் — closing the Dravidian arc, holding both patterns at once

> You've now seen three different Dravidian answers to "how do green and yellow relate": Kannada split them apart, Telugu fused them into one root, Malayalam kept them as two separate native words. Tamil, it turns out, quietly contains a trace of **both** of the last two patterns.

You'll want to know: பச்சை — the familiar pan-Dravidian green

பச்சை (**paccai**, "**green**") ← **Proto-Dravidian **pac-*** — the same root you've now met four times: Kannada's *hasiru*, Telugu's *pacca*, Malayalam's *paccha*, and now Tamil's own *paccai*.

In the family, and next door

	word	same root
Kannada	ಹಸಿರು, ಹಳದಿ (*hasiru haḷadi*)	
Telugu	పచ్చ, పసుపు (*pacca pasupu*)	
Malayalam	പച്ച, മഞ്ഞ (*pacca, mañña*)	yes
Hindi (neighbour)	हरा (*harā*)	
English	green and yellow	

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

மஞ்சள் (**mañcaḷ**, "**yellow, turmeric**") is Tamil's actual, everyday word for yellow — and it comes from a **completely separate** native Dravidian root, matching Malayalam's മഞ്ഞ/മഞ്ഞൾ (*mañña*/*mañña*ḷ) closely. Like Malayalam's pair, this root has no Sanskrit involvement — it sits alongside *paccai*, not descended from it.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

The **Tamil Lexicon** also records பசுப்பு (**pacuppu**, "**greenish yellow**") — a genuine **doublet** of *paccai* itself, from the same ****pac-*** root, matching Telugu's *pasupu* closely. Unlike Telugu, though, this doublet is **not** Tamil's everyday word for yellow — that job belongs to *mañcaḷ*; *pacuppu* survives mainly as a dictionary-recorded shade word. So Tamil alone holds a trace of **both** patterns at once: a *pac-* doublet sitting quietly in the dictionary (Telugu's pattern), next to a separate, dominant root doing the everyday work (Malayalam's pattern).
(Note for the Tamil-speaking reviewer: *pacuppu*'s everyday currency is the part I'm least certain of — please confirm whether it's a word you'd recognize as "greenish yellow," or whether it reads as archaic/purely literary in the Tamil you'd teach first.)

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "பச்சை" — green, the pan-Dravidian *pac- word*
- "மஞ்சள்" — yellow, Tamil's real everyday word, a separate root

- "பசுப்பு" — a rarer doublet of paccai, echoing Telugu's pattern

Before you move on

What is Tamil's everyday word for yellow, and is it related to **paccai**? (மஞ்சள், *mañcaḷ* — **no**, a completely separate native root, matching Malayalam's *mañña/mañña*ḷ.) What rarer Tamil word IS a doublet of *paccai*, from the same *pac-* root? (பசுப்பு, *pacuppu*, "greenish yellow" — echoing Telugu's *pacca/pasupu* pattern.) Does any one pattern hold across all four major Dravidian languages? (**No** — Kannada splits native/loan, Telugu fuses one root, Malayalam keeps two separate roots, and Tamil turns out to hold traces of both Telugu's and Malayalam's patterns at once.)

Chapter 23

Day

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (2) ✓ **pen** (1) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** the first 2 of 3 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can use நாள் as the everyday word for day and keep தினம் for the formal compounds where it actually belongs.
>
> *Say mūṉṟu nāḷ for three days and sutantira tiṉam for Independence Day, classifying each as everyday-native or formal-Sanskrit.*

23.1 நாள் (nāḷ) — "day," the one this arc's Dravidian languages didn't lose

Two from the animal and colour lessons first. Is everyday *mañcaḷ*, yellow, borrowed from Sanskrit? (**No** — it is its own native root; the rare *pacuppu* is the one that shares *paccai*'s root.) Do Kannada and Telugu name the cat with Tamil's *pūnai*? (**No** — *bekku* and *pilli* come from separate roots.)

You've now seen three Dravidian languages reach for a loanword — Sanskrit, twice, and Persian once — to name their everyday word for "day." Tamil doesn't. This lesson is about the one that didn't.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

நாள் (**nāḷ**) — "**day**" — is native **Dravidian**, from **Proto-Dravidian** ****nāḷ***. You've already met it, hiding inside நாளை (*nāḷai*, "tomorrow," Chapter 4). But here's the honest headline of this lesson:

நாள் isn't a survivor clinging to one narrow sense the way some native Dravidian words are — it is simply Tamil's **plain, everyday, unmarked** word for counting a day, as ordinary as மூன்று நாள் (*mūnṟu nāḷ*, "**three days**").

In the family, and next door

	word
Kannada	ದಿನ (*dina*)
Telugu	రోజు (*rōju*)
Malayalam	ദിവസം (*divasaṁ*)
Hindi (neighbour)	दिन (*din*)
English	day

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "nāḷ" — "day," native Dravidian, already met inside "tomorrow"
- "mūnṟu nāḷ" — three days

Before you move on

Where did you already meet நாள் before this lesson? (Inside நாளை, *nāḷai*, "tomorrow," Chapter 4.) Is Tamil's everyday day-word a loanword? (**No** — நாள் is native Dravidian.) Is it marginal or literary? (**No** — it is the plain everyday counting word.) Next: compare the other sisters' borrowed day-words and Tamil's formal *tiṉam*.

23.2 நாள் and தினம் — everyday native, formal borrowed

Nāḷ is plainly native and everyday. Put that lexical choice beside the other Dravidian tracks.

You'll want to know: Four everyday day-words

- Kannada **dina** — Sanskrit tatsama

- Telugu **rōju** — Persian loan
- Malayalam **divasam** — Sanskrit tatsama
- Tamil **nāḷ** — native Dravidian

Tamil is the only one here whose unmarked everyday counting word remains native.

You'll want to know: Tamil still has தினம்

தினம் (*tiṉam*) is the same Sanskrit *dina* as Kannada/Malayalam, ultimately from PIE ***dyew-***, "shine," also behind Latin *diēs*. Tamil assigns it formal and compound work: சுதந்திர தினம், "Independence Day," and தினசரி, "daily." Casual counting remains *nāḷ*.

The language did not reject the loan; it gave native and borrowed forms different jobs.

Your turn

- *Say it:* "mūṉṟu nāḷ" — three days
- *Say it:* "sutantira tiṉam" — Independence Day
- *Sort:* everyday native · formal/compound Sanskrit

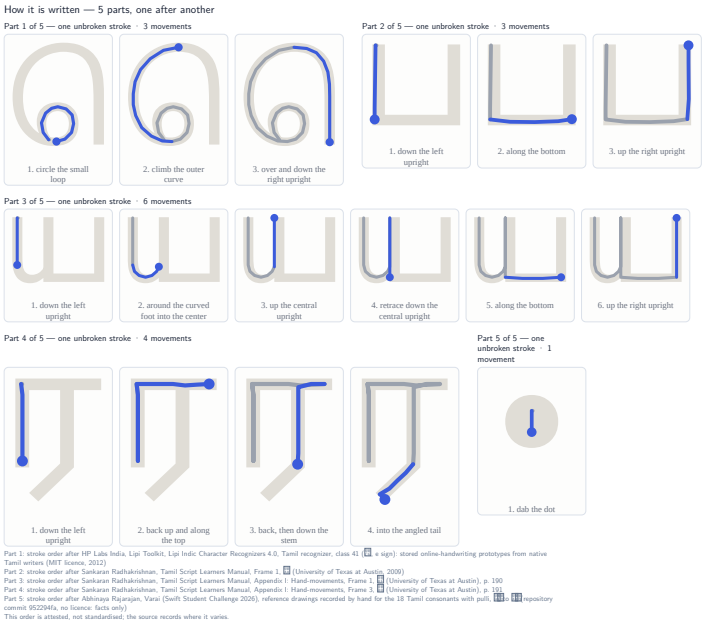
Before you move on

Which track alone keeps a native everyday day-word? (**Tamil**.) Where does *tiṉam* appear? (**Formal compounds**.) Is it unrelated to Kannada *dina*? (**No** — it is the same Sanskrit tatsama.)

23.3 பெயர் — a sign that waits on the left

One vowel sign you have met does something strange: ை stands to the **left** of its consonant and is spoken **after** it. That was not a one-off. Here is a second sign with the same habit.

Script you'll notice: ப and ய



How பயர் *is written, part by part, stroke by stroke*

Two consonants, each carrying its built-in *a* like every other:

ப	*pa*
ய	*ya*

Read both. The strip writes the whole word in written order, பி first, numbered movement by movement, with each source beneath it.

Script you'll notice: the பி sign

பி is the sign for *e*, and **it is written to the LEFT of its consonant and pronounced after it** — exactly what னை does.

ப + பி → பப, and on the page the hook stands *before* the ப — yet you say *pe*, not *ep*.

So the left-standing signs are a family, not an exception you have to remember one member at a time. Compare the three vowel signs you now hold:

sign	sound	where it sits
◌ி	*i*	above and to the right
◌ை	*ai*	to the **left**, spoken after
◌ெ	*e*	to the **left**, spoken after

Both halves of that are sourced. The description of ◌ை reads *"a double hook written BEFORE (to the left of) the consonant, though pronounced after it"*, and ◌ெ has its own entry, cited to a Tamil script manual: the sign for short *e* is always placed before the letter it belongs to.

Script you'll notice: build the word

piece		
பெ	*pe* — ப with the ◌ெ sign on its left	this lesson
ய	*ya*	this lesson
ர்	bare *r* — ர under a puḷḷi	ர from சரி

பெ · ய · ர் → பெயர்

Three pieces for a word you have used since chapter 2 without once needing to read it. That is the point of the order: the word came first, and the letters are catching up to a word you already own.

Your turn

- *Read it:* ப · ய — then பெ — then பெயர்
- *Say it:* "peyar" — "name"
- *Read it:* என் பெயர் — "my name," both words, straight off the page
- *Contrast:* றி and பெ — the ◌ி sign follows, the ◌ெ sign precedes

Before you move on

Read பெயர். Which side of its consonant does ெ sit on, and when is it spoken? (**The left**, and **after** — like னை.) Name the other left-standing sign you know. (னை, as in இல்லை.) Read என் பெயர் and say what it means. (**"My name"** — எ opens on a vowel, ர் closes on a bare *r*.) Next: the word for night.

Chapter 24

Night

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (2) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** both lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can use இரவு for night and இருள் for darkness without collapsing the two, and treat the claim that ராத்திரி is the more colloquial word as a claim still to be tested.
>
> *State the source's rāttiri claim with its hedge intact, set it against native regional usage, and hold iravu and iruḷ apart.*

24.1 இரவு (iravu) — "night," and a register question worth a native speaker's ear

> Last lesson, Tamil's native day-word had no real competition. This lesson's honest twist, hedged carefully, is that "night" may not tell the same story — and this is exactly the kind of claim worth checking against your own ear, not just a dictionary's.

You'll want to know: இரவு — already standing on its own, inside "midnight"

இரவு (**iravu**) — "**night**" — is native **Dravidian**, from **Proto-Dravidian** ****cira*** ("darkness"). You've technically already met it standing fully on its own: Chapter 17, while explaining நள்ளிரவு (*naḷḷiravu*, "midnight," நள் + இரவு), noted directly that இரவு itself is a word every Tamil speaker still uses on its own. This lesson gives it its own full chapter.

In the family, and next door

	word
Kannada	ರಾತ್ರಿ (*rātri*)
Telugu	రాత్రి (*rātri*)
Malayalam	രാത്രി (*rātri*)
Hindi (neighbour)	रात (*raat*)
English	night

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

Tamil also keeps ராத்திரி (**rāttiri**), a Sanskrit **tatsama** from रात्रि (*rātri*) — the same word that surfaces, as a tatsama, in Kannada's *ratri* and Telugu's *ratri*. It traces to **Proto-Indo-European **h₁reh₁-*** ("**to rest**"), a **completely different** root from Latin *nox*'s ****nókʷts*** — the same specific comparison already drawn for Hindi's *raat* and Malayalam's *rāthri*, now a third confirmation, same false-cognate pattern, same honest non-relationship to *nox*.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "iravu" — "night," native, already met inside naḷḷiravu
- "rāttiri" — Sanskrit loan, same PIE *h₁reh₁- already drawn for Hindi and Malayalam, NOT related to Latin nox*

Before you move on

Where did you already meet இரவு before this lesson? (Inside நள்ளிரவு, *naḷḷiravu*, "midnight," Chapter 17.) Does ராத்திரி's PIE root match Latin *nox*'s? (**No** — ****h₁reh₁-*** "to rest," the same false-cognate pattern already drawn for Hindi and Malayalam.) Next: treat the proposed register split as a hypothesis and keep "darkness" separate from "night."

24.2 Night words — a register hypothesis and a semantic boundary

Iravu is native and *rāttiri* borrowed. That alone does not tell you which one conversational Tamil prefers.

Why it's said this way

At least one dictionary says ராத்திரி is more common colloquially, implying native இரவு may lean literary/written. If accurate, this reverses the day story, where native *nāḷ* is uncontested everyday speech. But the evidence is limited and dictionary-level. Treat this as a prompt for a native speaker's ear, not settled fact. Register judgments require real usage, region, and setting—not a purity assumption about native versus borrowed words.

You'll want to know: Darkness is a different word

இருள் (*iruḷ*) means **darkness**, from Proto-Dravidian ***cirVḷ*** and cognate with Kannada, Telugu, and Malayalam forms. It is not *iravu* "night as a time period", but the two are not strangers: DEDR 2552 files *iruḷ* and *iravu* in one entry.

Your turn

- *Qualify:* "one source says *rāttiri* is more colloquial"
- *Ask:* compare that claim with native regional usage
- *Contrast: iravu* night · *iruḷ* darkness

Before you move on

Is the *rāttiri* register claim settled? (**No** — limited sourcing, worth checking against native usage.) Is இருள் interchangeable with இரவு? (**No** — darkness versus a time period, though DEDR files them in one entry.)

Chapter 25

Good Night

Modes: **voice** (1) **eyes** (1) **pen** (1) **Hands-free start:** the first of 3 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say good night in Tamil out of roots I already own, and trace every one of those forms back to நல்.
>
> *Say nalla iravu and iravu vaṇakkam, run nal- forward into nalam, naṉṟi and nalla, say which shared Sanskrit good-night phrase Tamil does without, then read* நான் *and say where the* ◌ா *sign sits.*

25.1 இனிய இரவு (iṉiya iravu) — "good night," and Tamil breaking the pattern one more time

Hindi, Kannada, Telugu, and Malayalam all reached for the same Sanskrit phrase to say "good night." This lesson closes the arc with the one that didn't — and it's a pattern you've actually seen from Tamil before, all the way back in Chapter 1.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

இனிய இரவு (**iṉiya iravu**) — "**good night**" — literally "**sweet, pleasant night**." இனிய (*iṉiya*, "sweet, pleasant, dear") is native **Dravidian**, from **Proto-Dravidian **in-*** ("sweet") — the same root behind இனிப்பு (*iṉippu*, "sweet, dessert"). Paired with இரவு (*iravu*, "night," already met last lesson), the whole phrase is built from Tamil's own word-stock, start to finish.

In the family, and next door

	word
Kannada	ಶುಭ ರಾತ್ರಿ (*śubha rātri*)
Telugu	శుభ రాత్రి (*śubha rātri*)
Malayalam	ശുഭ രാത്രി (*śubha rātri*)
Hindi (neighbour)	शुभ रात्रि (*śubh rātri*)
English	good night

Why it's said this way

Tamil's Dravidian sisters and Hindi all reached for the **same** Sanskrit phrase: Hindi's शुभ रात्रि, Kannada's ಶುಭ ರಾತ್ರಿ, Telugu's శుభ రాత్రి, Malayalam's ശുഭ രാത്രി — all four built from the identical tatsama pair, **śubh** ("to be beautiful") + **rātri** ("night"). Tamil's standard phrase reaches for **none** of that — no śubha-descended "good night" turned up as a commonly used Tamil form in the phrasebook sources checked for this lesson. Instead, Tamil built its own phrase from its own vocabulary.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "iniya iravu" — "good night," literally "sweet night," fully native
- the pattern it breaks — every other language this arc shares one Sanskrit śubh(a) rātri phrase; Tamil doesn't

Before you move on

What does இனிய இரவு literally mean, and what root does இனிய come from? ("**Sweet/pleasant night**" — Proto-Dravidian ***in-***, "sweet.") Does Tamil's "good night" share the same Sanskrit śubha rātri phrase as Hindi, Kannada, Telugu, and Malayalam? (**No** — no such form turned up in the sources checked for this lesson; Tamil's standard phrase is fully native, breaking the pattern shared by all four other languages.) Next: the ◌ா sign, and reading நான் off the page.

25.2 நான் — the sign that stands after

Two places a vowel sign has sat so far: ி goes above and to the right, ை and ெ go to the left. Here is the third place, and it is the one you would have guessed first.

Script you'll notice: the ா sign



How நான் *is written, part by part, stroke by stroke*

ா is the sign for long *ā*, and this book's script data describes it plainly: **a vertical stroke with a small top hook, written after the consonant.**

ம + ா → மா, said *mā*.

That pairing is the example the data itself gives, on a letter you can already draw.

So the three positions, all seen now:

sign	sound	where it sits
◌ா	*ā*	**after** the consonant
◌ி	*i*	above and to the right
ை◌	*ai*	to the left, spoken after
ெ◌	*e*	to the left, spoken after

Notice also that ஆ, the independent long *ā* that opens a word, and ◌ா, the sign, carry the same lengthening. One is a letter standing on its own; the other hangs off a consonant.

Script you'll notice: build the word

piece		
நா	*nā* — ந with the ◌ா sign after it	ந drawn in நன்றி
ன்	bare *n̲* — ன under a puḷḷi	ன drawn there too, the alveolar *n*

நா · ன் → நான்

Two pieces and one new mark. நான் is "I," and its possessive is the என் ("my") you read in chapter 21 — so *nān̲* and *en̲* now both come off the page.

Your turn

- *Read it:* மா — then நா — then நான்
- *Say it:* "nān̲" — "I"
- *Contrast:* நா · றி · பெ — a sign after, a sign above-right, a sign before
- *Contrast:* ஆம் and நான் — the same long *ā*, once as a letter and once as a sign

Before you move on

Read நான். Where does ◌ா sit relative to its consonant? (**After it** — a vertical stroke with a small top hook.) Which of Tamil's three *n*-letters closes the word, and what is the dot doing? (ன, the

alveolar one; the pul̤l̤i **removes its built-in *a***.) Next: good night, out of roots you already own.

25.3 நல்ல இரவு and இரவு வணக்கம் — old roots recombined

Tamil's native "sweet night" repeats the lexical choice that opened this book: build greetings from its own roots rather than the shared Sanskrit formula.

You'll want to know: The Chapter 1 echo

வணக்கம் comes from native *vaṇaṅku*, "bow," while neighboring greetings use Sanskrit *namas-*. At the other end of the day, இனிய இரவு is native while the same neighbors share Sanskrit *śubha rātri*.

Tamil also keeps two transparent alternatives:

- நல்ல இரவு — "good night," using *nalla*, from the **nal-** "good" root already inside *nalam* and *naṉṟi*
- இரவு வணக்கம் — "night greetings," especially for close friends/ family, recombining two fully known words

The learner does not memorize isolated formulas; known roots generate options.

Your turn

- *Say it:* "nalla iravu" — good night
- *Say it:* "iravu vaṇakkam" — night greetings
- *Trace it: nal- → nalam / naṉṟi / nalla*

Your turn — the pattern it breaks

- Hindi, Kannada, Telugu and Malayalam share one "good night." Which? (***śubha rātri*** — Sanskrit *śubh* + *rātri*.) Does Tamil's standard phrase use it? (**No** — none turned up in the sources checked; Tamil built its own.)

Script — ◌ா and நான்

- *Read it:* மா — then நா — then நான்
- *Point to:* the ◌ா sign, then the pul̤l̤i

Where does ◌ா sit? (**After** its consonant.) Which *n* closes நான்? (ன, the alveolar one, its *a* removed by the pul̤l̤i.)

Before you move on

Which root builds நல்ல? (**Nal-**, good.) What two known words make இரவு வணக்கம்? (**Night + greetings**.) What lexical pattern connects Chapter 1 and this chapter? (**Tamil keeps native greeting roots where neighbors share Sanskrit formulas**.)

Chapter 26

Morning

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (1) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** its only lesson.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say காலை for morning and state accurately that its origin is uncertain, rather than asserting a Sanskrit source the dictionary itself only hedges at.
>
> *Say kālai, repeat the source's own "possibly" instead of dropping it, and read atikaalai as a transparent ati- plus kālai compound.*

26.1 காலை (kālai) — "morning," an honestly uncertain etymology

Tamil's neighbours each had a confidently-sourced story for their "morning" word — Sanskrit, or clearly native. Tamil's own word for morning is different: even Wiktionary itself isn't sure where it comes from.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

காலை (**kālai**) — "**morning**" — has an etymology that Wiktionary itself only hedges at: "**possibly** from Sanskrit काल्य (*kālya*)." That's a real hedge from the source itself, not one this lesson is adding for caution's sake. Complicating things further: the related word கால் (*kāl*) carries **six** entirely distinct etymologies in Tamil — "leg/foot," "irrigation channel," "forest," "wind," a Sanskrit-derived "time" sense, and a conjunction meaning "if, when" — and காலை may be an accusative-type form built on the "time" sense specifically, or may not be. Be honest: this is genuinely **less settled** than Kannada's

confidently-native morning word or Telugu's confidently-Sanskrit one. Don't manufacture certainty the primary source itself doesn't have.

In the family, and next door

	word
Kannada	ಬೆಳಗ್ಗೆ (*beḷagge*)
Telugu	ఉదయం (*udayam*)
Malayalam	രാവിലെ (*rāvile*)
Hindi (neighbour)	सुबह (*subah*)
English	morning

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

Wiktionary does confirm one solid fact: **பகல்** (already met, Chapter 17, "**daytime**") is listed as **காலை**'s **coordinate term** — the two words sit side by side in the same semantic field, whatever **காலை**'s deeper root turns out to be. And **அதிகாலை** ("**early dawn**") is confirmed, per the Tamil Lexicon, as a fully transparent compound: **ati-** ("excessive, very") + **காலை**, glossed simply as "early dawn" by the Tamil Lexicon.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "kālai" — "morning," an honestly uncertain etymology
- the hedge itself — Wiktionary says "possibly" Sanskrit kālya, not a confident claim
- "atikaalai" — "early dawn," a transparent ati- + kālai compound

Before you move on

Is **காலை**'s etymology as confidently sourced as Kannada's or Telugu's morning words? (**No** — Wiktionary itself only says "possibly" Sanskrit kālya; genuinely uncertain, not settled.) What coordinate term does Wiktionary list alongside **காலை**? (**பகல்**, "daytime," already met in Chapter 17.) What does **அதிகாலை** literally build on? (**ati-** ("very") + **காலை** — a transparent compound for "early dawn.")

Chapter 27

Evening

Modes: **voice** (1) **pen** (2) **Hands-free start:** the first of 3 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say மாலை for evening and keep it apart from the identically spelled garland word, which is a separate etymology rather than a second sense.
>
> *Complete TA-C27-checkpoint, the chapter's closing checkpoint: say mālai for evening, keep the garland mālai apart as a separate etymology and mark the darkness link as unproven, read* நீங்கள் *from its pieces, then write* நீ, நீங்கள் *and* மாலை *from sound.*

27.1 மாலை (mālai) — "evening," and a garland that only looks like the same word

Last lesson's morning word had an uncertain origin. This evening word is different — confidently native — but it comes with its own honest twist: it looks exactly like a completely unrelated word.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

மாலை (**mālai**) — "**evening**" — happens to be spelled identically to another, completely **unrelated** Tamil word: மாலை meaning "**garland, wreath, necklace**." Wiktionary treats these as **two separate etymologies**, not one word with two senses. The garland sense traces to Old Tamil and is compared to Sanskrit माला (*mālā*) — with a genuinely interesting note: it's "**probably borrowed FROM Dravidian languages**" **into** Sanskrit, not the other way around. A

rare reverse-direction loan, worth noticing against this whole project's usual Sanskrit-into-Dravidian pattern.

In the family, and next door

	word
Kannada	ಸಂಜೆ (*sañje*)
Telugu	సాయంత్రం (*sāyantram*)
Malayalam	വൈകുന്നേരം (*vaikunnēraṁ*)
Hindi (neighbour)	शाम (*shaam*)
English	evening

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

The **evening** sense of மாலை is a **separate** Old Tamil word entirely, compared instead to மால் (*māl*) — which Wiktionary traces to **Proto-Dravidian **mā/*māl***, with senses including "கருமை" ("**blackness, darkness**"), plus archaic senses of "illusion, confusion" and, as a proper noun, the Hindu deity **Vishnu**. Be honest about the exact mechanism here: Wiktionary's own etymology for "evening" only says "**compare māl**" — it does **not** explicitly state that "evening" derives specifically from the **darkness** sense rather than some other sense of this multi-meaning root. The connection (evening = the time it grows dark) is natural and plausible, but not nailed down with full certainty by the source itself. What IS certain: this is confidently **native** Dravidian vocabulary, a genuine contrast with TA-C26's uncertain காலை.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "mālai" — "evening," confidently native Dravidian vocabulary
- the homonym twist — a completely separate word, mālai, means "garland," probably borrowed INTO Sanskrit from Dravidian
- the honest hedge — "evening" plausibly connects to māl's "darkness" sense, but Wiktionary doesn't spell out that exact link

Before you move on

Are evening-mālai and garland-mālai the same word with two meanings? (**No** — Wiktionary treats them as two entirely separate etymologies; a genuine homonym, not one word stretched.) Which direction did the garland sense's Sanskrit connection likely travel? (**Dravidian into Sanskrit** — a reverse-direction loan, per Wiktionary's own "probably borrowed from Dravidian languages" note.) Is it fully certain that "evening" derives from māl's "darkness" sense specifically? (**No** — plausible and natural, but Wiktionary only says "compare māl," without spelling out that exact mechanism.)

27.2 நீங்கள் — two old promises, paid

This book owes you two letters: the nasal in ங்க, printed before you knew what it was, and one of the three *l*-letters it promised. Both come due in one word.

Script you'll notice: ங and ள



ங	*ṅa* — the nasal made where க is made, the *ng* of "sing"
ள	*ḷa* — the retroflex *l*

ங is the reason க softens: in ங்க the nasal comes first — the "after a nasal" rule from your first writing lesson, with a face on it.

ள is the retroflex one of Tamil's three *l*-letters — ல ள ழ. You met ல in இல்லை; ழ still lies ahead. Retroflex: the tongue curls back, as for ண.

> Read both. The strip writes the whole word, numbered movement by movement, with each source beneath it. ள's own entry gives the tongue curled back; ங's place is this lesson's own, since the data says nothing about where க is made.

Script you'll notice: the ீ sign

ீ is the long partner of the ி you hooked onto ற in நன்றி — the same short/long pairing அ and ஆ have.

> ந + ீ → நீ, said *nī*, the familiar "you."

The data describes ி and has no entry for ீ, so the pairing is stated from the pattern, not from a source.

Script you'll notice: build the word

piece		
நீ	*nī* — ந with the ீ sign	"you," familiar
ங்	bare *ṅ* — ங under a puḷḷi	this lesson
க	*ka*, softened to *ga* by the nasal in front of it	from வணக்கம்
ள்	bare *ḷ* — ள under a puḷḷi	this lesson

> நீ · ங் · க · ள் → நீங்கள்

The middle two are the ங்க you were shown when க was new and ங unreadable. நீங்கள் is the respectful "you" — நீ plus a plural ending — so the shorter word sits inside the longer one.

Your turn

- *Read it:* நீ — then ங்க — then நீங்கள்
- *Say it:* "nī" … "nīṅgaḷ" — familiar, then respectful
- *Contrast:* றி and நீ — the short *i* sign and the long *ī* sign
- *Contrast:* ல and ள — the first two of the three *l*-letters

Before you move on

Read நீங்கள், then find the shorter நீ inside it. Why does the க in the middle sound like *g*? (ங் stands in front of it — a nasal.) How many *l*-letters does Tamil keep, and which is ள? (**Three** — ல ள ழ; the **retroflex** one.) What are the two dots doing? (**Removing the built-in *a*** from ங and ள.) Next: the afternoon word.

27.3 Chapter 27 checkpoint — evening, and நீங்கள் from sound

Nothing new here. The evening word out loud first, then the respectful *you* and the evening word on the page.

And one from the morning lesson: what is *atikālai* built from? (*Ati-*, "very," plus *kālai* — **early dawn**.)

Your turn — the evening word

- *Say it:* "evening" in Tamil

(*Mālai.*)

- Is the garland *mālai* the same word with a second meaning? (No: two separate etymologies that happen to be spelled alike.)
- Which way did the garland word likely travel? (From Dravidian into Sanskrit *mālā*: a loan in the reverse of the usual direction.)

- Is it certain that evening *mālai* comes from *māl*'s "darkness" sense? (No: it is plausible, but the source only says "compare *māl*".)

Script — ங, ள and ீ

- Which four pieces build நீங்கள்? (நீ · ங் · க · ள்.)
- Why does the க in the middle sound like *g*? (ங், a nasal, stands in front of it.)
- Which of the three *l*-letters is ள? (The retroflex one, tongue curled back.)
- How does ீ differ from ி? (It is the long *ī*: நீ is *nī*, where றி is *ṟi*.)

Read it: நீங்கள் aloud, then find நீ inside it

Writing — from sound

Cover: the Script block above, so no model stays in view

Write it: *nī*, then *nīṅgaḷ*, the respectful "you"

Write it: *mālai*, "evening" — the ai sign goes before its letter on the page

Check: against the key — நீ, நீங்கள், மாலை

Write it: one repaired shape, then stop

Before you move on

You have written மாலை. Can the page alone tell you whether it means evening or garland? (No: only the context can.) That is the chapter: one spelling, two words, and the respectful *you* read from its pieces.

Next chapter: the afternoon word.

Chapter 28

Afternoon

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (2) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** both lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say பிற்பகல் for afternoon, read it as "after" plus "daytime," and name exactly where the dictionary's own noon and afternoon labels overlap.
>
> *Show naṭuppakal straddling noon and afternoon, place matiyam as a Sanskrit noon-word, and label the unsourced moon claim unsupported.*

28.1 பிற்பகல் (pir̲pakal) — "afternoon," a similar sandhi trick to நண்பகல்

You already met a sandhi-driven surface change in Chapter 17 — நள் resurfacing as நண். This lesson's afternoon word does a similar kind of trick, with a different word — though be honest that the two changes aren't identical.

You'll want to know: பிற்பகல் — பின் (after) + பகல் (daytime), a similar sandhi story

பிற்பகல் (**pir̲pakal**) — "**afternoon**" — is a transparent compound: பின் (*piṉ*, "**after**") plus பகல் (*pakal*, "**daytime**," already met inside நண்பகல், TA-C17 — though be aware the பிற்பகல் Wiktionary page itself glosses பகல் as "noon" in its own etymology line, a small inconsistency across Wiktionary's own entries, not something this lesson introduces). Here's the familiar pattern: பின் doesn't stay பின் in this compound — it surfaces as பிற்- before the following ப — a **similar** kind of consonant

sandhi to the one already taught in Chapter 17, where நள் became நண் before its own following ப. Be honest, though: Wiktionary's own etymology for பிற்பகல் doesn't discuss this mechanism at all, and the two changes move in different phonetic directions (nasal→stop here, lateral→nasal there) — this is the lesson's own observation, not a sourced equivalence. Wiktionary labels this word **formal register**.

In the family, and next door

	word
Kannada	ಅಪರಾಹ್ನ (*aparāhna*)
Telugu	మధ్యాహ్నం (*madhyāhnam*)
Malayalam	ഉച്ചകഴിഞ്ഞ് (*uccakaḻiññŭ*)
Hindi (neighbour)	दोपहर (*dopahar*)
English	afternoon

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

பிற்பகல் (*piṟpakal*) is a native compound of *piṉ*, "after, behind" (DEDR 4205; Malayalam *pin*, Kannada *pin*), and *pakal*, "daytime" (DEDR 3805; Malayalam *pakal*).

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "piṟpakal" — "afternoon," piṉ ("after") + pakal ("daytime")
- the sandhi echo — piṉ surfaces as piṟ-, a similar kind of change to TA-C17's naḷ→naṇ, though not phonetically identical

Before you move on

What does பிற்பகல் literally build from, and what sandhi change happens to the first piece? (பின் "after" + பகல் "daytime" — பின் surfaces as பிற்-, a similar kind of sandhi to TA-C17's naḷ→naṇ, though the two changes move in different phonetic directions, not identical mechanisms.) What register does the fetched page label? (**Formal**.) Next: inspect the real noon/afternoon boundary blur and the separate *matiyam* root.

28.2 Noon or afternoon? — let the sources keep their blur

Pi̱rpakal transparently says after-daytime. Dictionaries still do not draw a perfectly hard semantic boundary around its synonyms.

You'll want to know: நடுப்பகல் overlaps

Wiktionary's *pi̱rpakal* page lists நடுப்பகல் as an afternoon synonym, while the earlier noon lesson documents the same word as a synonym of நண்பகல், "noon." This is genuine noon/afternoon boundary blur, not an inconsistency to erase. Time-period categories can widen differently across speakers and sources.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

மதியம் (*matiyam*) is a Sanskrit tatsama from *madhya*, "middle," the same root used by Kannada and Telugu. The fetched entry gives it **noon**, a synonym of *naṇpakal*, not a dedicated afternoon meaning. An initial search summary claimed *matiyam* once meant "moon," but that claim is absent from the actual fetched page. It is therefore **not asserted**. Source inspection outranks a search snippet.

Your turn

- *Say it: naṭuppakal* can overlap noon and afternoon
- *Say it: matiyam* — Sanskrit *madhya*, "middle," listed as noon
- *Label:* the moon claim unsupported

Before you move on

Does the source draw a hard noon/afternoon line? (**No**.) What is *matiyam*'s sourced root and sense? (Sanskrit ***madhya***, "middle," and **noon**.) Is "originally moon" confirmed? (**No**.)

Chapter 29

Good Morning

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (1) ↙ **pen** (1) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** the first of 2 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can greet someone with காலை வணக்கம் before mid-morning and see it as காலை plus the வணக்கம் I already had, with no borrowed blessing-word in it.
>
> *Greet with kālai vaṇakkam from sunrise to about 11, naming its two known pieces and the borrowed word that is absent.*

29.1 காலை வணக்கம் — "morning greetings"

> Tamil's neighbours each built "good morning" on a word meaning "good" or "auspicious." Tamil does something completely different: it just puts its everyday greeting word after its word for "morning."

You'll want to know: காலை வணக்கம் — literally, "morning greetings"

காலை வணக்கம் (**kālai vaṇakkam**) — "**good morning**" — is confirmed, by two independently-fetched sources, as Tamil's standard greeting for this time of day, used "**from sunrise until around 11 AM**." It's built from two words you already have: காலை (already met, Chapter 26, "**morning**") plus வணக்கம் (already met, Chapter 1, "**reverence, homage**" — Tamil's everyday word for "hello"). Literally: "**morning salutations**."

In the family, and next door

	word
Kannada	ಶುಭೋದಯ (*śubhōdaya*)
Telugu	శుభోదయం (*śubhōdayam*)
Malayalam	സുപ്രഭാതം (*suprabhātam*)
Hindi (neighbour)	सुप्रभात (*suprabhāt*)
English	good morning

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

Vaṇakkam is native, from the verb "to bow" (DEDR 5236). *Kālai*, "morning", looks native too, but DEDR has no entry for it, and its origin is uncertain.

Why it's said this way

Here's the honest structural surprise: Hindi, Kannada, Telugu, and Malayalam each build their morning greeting on a **śubha**-equivalent word ("good, auspicious") plus a time-word. Tamil does something genuinely **different** — there's no "good/auspicious" word here at all. It's simply வணக்கம், Tamil's own general greeting, specified with காலை in front of it to mean "morning" greetings specifically. Also be honest about a claim that didn't hold up: an initial search summary suggested a Sanskrit-borrowed word, "suprabhatham," serves as a casual alternative — but that claim appears on **neither** of the two pages actually fetched, so it's deliberately **not** asserted here.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "kālai vaṇakkam" — "good morning," literally "morning greetings"
- the honest structural surprise — no śubha-equivalent word here at all, unlike Tamil's neighbours
- the two pieces you already know — kālai (Chapter 26) + vaṇakkam (Chapter 1)

Before you move on

- What two known words build காலை வணக்கம்? (காலை, "morning" + வணக்கம், "reverence/hello.")
- Does it follow the śubha-equivalent + time-word pattern used by Hindi, Kannada, Telugu, and Malayalam? (**No** — காலை simply specifies Tamil's own general greeting, வணக்கம்.)
- Is "suprabhatham" confirmed as a casual alternative? (**No** — neither fetched source supports that claim, so this lesson does not assert it.)

29.2 எப்படி — the retroflex stop

You can read the first word of the question you have been asking since chapter 3. Here is the second, and it needs one new consonant.

Script you'll notice: ட

ட is *ṭa*, the retroflex *t* — the tongue curled back to the roof of the mouth. That is the same curl that makes ண a retroflex *n*, so hold the pair together: ட is that position stopped, ண is that position hummed through the nose.

Between vowels it softens toward *ḍ*, which is why டி in எப்படி is said *ḍi*. That is the position-picks-the-sound economy க and ச already showed you, now on a third letter.

Read it; do not draw it yet. ட has no entry in this book's script data, so it gets no stroke order — and both claims above are stated from sourced neighbours rather than from ட itself: the retroflex description leans on ண's, and the softening leans on the position-picks-the-sound note the data carries for க.

Script you'll notice: build the word

piece		
எ	*e*	the question vowel, from என்
ப்	bare *p* — ப under a puḷḷi	ப from பெயர்
ப	*pa*	the same letter again
டி	*ḍi* — ட with the ி sign	this lesson

எ · ப் · ப · டி → எப்படி

The doubled ப் + ப is held, like the க்க of *vaṇakkam* and the ல் + லை of *illai*. Tamil marks a long consonant by writing it twice, with the puḷḷi on the first.

Your turn

- *Read it:* டி — then எப்படி
- *Say it:* "eppaḍi" — "how"
- *Read it:* நீங்கள் எப்படி — two words of the question, straight off the page

Before you move on

Read எப்படி. Which letter you already knew shares ட's tongue position? (ண — the same curl back, stopped rather than nasal.) How does Tamil write the doubled *p*? (ப் + ப — the letter twice, puḷḷi on the first.) Read நீங்கள் again. Next: good evening.

Chapter 30

Good Evening

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (1) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** its only lesson.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can greet someone with மாலை வணக்கம் from late afternoon through nightfall, built on the same two-piece pattern as the morning greeting.
>
> *Greet with mālai vaṇakkam, assembling mālai plus vaṇakkam, and note the pattern was re-checked rather than assumed to carry over.*

30.1 மாலை வணக்கம் — "evening greetings"

> Last chapter's morning greeting followed its own pattern. This lesson checks whether the evening greeting follows the same one — rather than assuming it automatically does.

You'll want to know: மாலை வணக்கம் — the same compositional pattern, independently confirmed

மாலை வணக்கம் (**mālai vaṇakkam**) — "**good evening**" — is confirmed, by two independently-fetched sources, as a real, standard Tamil evening greeting, used roughly from **afternoon through nightfall** (the two sources give slightly different exact windows — "after noon through evening" versus "late afternoon until nightfall" — a small, unsurprising looseness, matching the noon/afternoon boundary-blur already seen in TA-C28). It's built exactly the same way as TA-C29's morning greeting: மாலை (already met, Chapter 27, "**evening**") plus வணக்கம் (already met, Chapter 1, Tamil's general greeting). Literally: "**evening salutations**."

In the family, and next door

	word
Kannada	ಶುಭ ಸಂಜೆ (*śubha sañje*)
Telugu	శుభ సాయంత్రం (*śubha sāyantram*)
Malayalam	ശുഭ സായാഹ്നം (*śubha sāyāhnam*)
Hindi (neighbour)	शुभ संध्या (*shubh sandhyā*)
English	good evening

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

Both words are native. *Mālai*, "evening", sits in DEDR 4781 among words for black and dark, beside Malayalam *māla*, "night, darkness"; *vaṇakkam* is from the verb "to bow" (DEDR 5236). The *mālai* that means "garland" is a different word.

Why it's said this way

Here's the honest methodological point: just because TA-C29's morning greeting followed the "time-word + vaṇakkam" pattern doesn't mean this evening greeting was assumed to follow it automatically. This arc has repeatedly found that greeting formation doesn't reliably generalize, even within the very same language — Malayalam's own morning greeting broke from the śubha+time-word pattern its afternoon and evening greetings both share, so "the pattern probably repeats" was never a safe assumption on its own. So this greeting was independently verified via direct fetch before confirming the pattern really does repeat here — and it does, cleanly: no śubha-equivalent word appears in Tamil's evening greeting either, same as the morning one.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "mālai vaṇakkam" — "good evening," literally "evening greetings"
- the two pieces you already know — mālai (Chapter 27) + vaṇakkam (Chapter 1)
- the honest methodological point — this pattern was re-verified, not assumed to carry over automatically

Before you move on

What two already-known words does மாலை வணக்கம் build from? (மாலை, "evening" + வணக்கம், "greetings.") Was it assumed that the evening greeting would follow the same pattern as the morning one, or was it independently checked? (**Independently checked** — via direct fetch, not assumed, since this arc has learned that greeting patterns don't reliably generalize.) Does மாலை வணக்கம் use a śubha-equivalent word, like Hindi/Kannada/Telugu/Malayalam's evening greetings do? (**No** — same as Tamil's morning greeting, no śubha-equivalent word appears here either.)

Chapter 31

Good Afternoon

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (2) ✓ **pen** (1) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** the first 2 of 3 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can greet someone with மதிய வணக்கம் around midday and say which word the மதிய inside it actually comes from — noon, not afternoon.
>
> *Greet with matiya vaṇakkam, trace matiyam back to madhya "middle," and keep pirpakal as the separate after-plus-daytime word.*

31.1 மதிய வணக்கம் (matiya vaṇakkam) — a sourced afternoon greeting

You already know that Tamil's noon and afternoon boundaries can blur. Now learn one afternoon greeting without pretending that all speakers or teaching sources divide the day in exactly the same way.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

மதிய வணக்கம் (**matiya vaṇakkam**) — "**good afternoon**" — is confirmed, by two independently-fetched sources, as Tamil's afternoon greeting, used roughly "**noon to around 4 PM**." A third source, already used for the morning and evening greetings, doesn't list a distinct afternoon greeting at all — it only covers "before noon" and "after noon through evening," implicitly treating those two as bookending the whole day. This is an honest extension of TA-C28's own noon/afternoon boundary-blur into the greeting layer, not a new

problem to worry about.
Use மதிய வணக்கம் when that afternoon slot fits the people and setting around you. Treat "noon to 4" as a useful learning window, not as a universal clock rule. The two words come from different places: *matiya* from Sanskrit *madhya*, "middle" (CDIAL 9804), and *vaṇakkam*, native, from the verb "to bow" (DEDR 5236).

In the family, and next door

	word
Kannada	ಶುಭ ಮಧ್ಯಾಹ್ನ (*śubha madhyāhna*)
Telugu	శుభ మధ్యాహ్నం (*śubha madhyāhnam*)
Malayalam	ശുഭ മധ്യാഹ്നം (*śubha madhyāhnaṁ*)
Hindi (neighbour)	शुभ दोपहर (*shubh dopahar*)
English	good afternoon, confirmed by two sources for roughly noon to 4 PM, while a third source does not teach a separate afternoon greeting

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "matiya vaṇakkam" — "good afternoon," confirmed real, used roughly noon to 4 PM
- the honest qualification — one source does not teach a separate afternoon greeting at all

Before you move on

What is one sourced Tamil greeting for "good afternoon"? (**மதிய வணக்கம், matiya vaṇakkam**.) Do all three fetched sources agree on a distinct "afternoon" greeting slot? (**No** — two confirm மதிய வணக்கம் directly; a third doesn't list a separate afternoon greeting at all, treating morning and evening as bookending the day.) What clock window is a useful guide rather than a universal rule? (**Roughly noon to 4 PM**.)

31.2 மதிய — the greeting takes a different root

You can now say மதிய வணக்கம். This final step explains why its first word is not the ordinary afternoon word பிற்பகல்.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

The greeting begins with மதிய (**matiya**). It is the adjectival form of மதியம் (**matiyam**), "noon." That noun entered Tamil from Sanskrit **madhya**, "middle": noon is the middle of the day.
The adjective மதிய can be glossed "of or pertaining to afternoon." That lets Tamil build மதிய வணக்கம் even though the dedicated word you learned for "afternoon" was பிற்பகல், the native compound from **piṉ** (after) + **pakal** (daytime).
Keep the two paths separate:

- பிற்பகல்: after + daytime → afternoon
- மதிய வணக்கம்: middle/noon adjective + greeting → good afternoon

The time word and the greeting do not have to share a root. That is one more reason not to manufacture a greeting by translating its pieces from another language.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- matiyam — "noon," ultimately from Sanskrit madhya, "middle"
- pirpakal — "afternoon," built from "after" + "daytime"
- matiya vaṇakkam — the afternoon greeting, built on matiya

Before you move on

Does மதிய வணக்கம் begin with பிற்பகல்? (**No.**) What noun is மதிய related to? (**மதியம், "noon."**) What older root lies behind it? (**Sanskrit madhya, "middle."**) Why should you learn the whole greeting rather than construct it from the time word? (**Tamil uses a different root in the greeting.**)

31.3 இருக்கிறீர்கள் — the last sign, and the whole question

Two words of the question already come off the page. One vowel sign stands between you and the third.

Script you'll notice: the ◌ூ sign

◌ூ is the sign for short *u*. It is not left-standing — but it does not stand beside its letter the way ◌ா does either: it joins on below and to the right, and the pair is usually drawn as one shape.

Careful with "after": *every* vowel sign is **spoken** after its consonant, ◌ை and ◌ொ included. The signs differ in where the mark sits, not when you say it.

ர + ◌ூ → ரு, said *ru*.

The script data behind this book carries entries for ◌ா, ◌ி, ◌ை and the puḷḷi, and none for ◌ூ — so everything here, the joined shape included, is this lesson's own statement of ordinary Tamil, not something it can cite.

Script you'll notice: build the word

Every piece is now yours:

piece		
இ	*i*	independent — the word opens on a vowel
ரு	*ru* — ர with the ◌ூ sign	this lesson
க்	bare *k*	க under a puḷḷi
கி	*ki* — க with the ◌ி sign	
றீ	*r̲ī* — ற with the ◌ீ sign	ற from நன்றி
ர்	bare *r*	ர from சரி
க	*ka*	
ள்	bare *l̤*	from நீங்கள்

இ · ரு · க் · கி · றீ · ர் · க · ள் → இருக்கிறீர்கள்

And the whole question:

நீங்கள் எப்படி இருக்கிறீர்கள்?

Nothing in it is new to say. You have asked it since chapter 3; the letters took until now to catch up.

Your turn

- *Read it:* ரு — then இருக்கிறீர்கள்
- *Read it:* the whole question — நீங்கள் எப்படி இருக்கிறீர்கள்?
- *Say it:* "nīṅgaḷ eppaḍi irukkiṟīrgaḷ?" — "how are you?"
- *Contrast:* நான் and நீங்கள் — the *I* of the answer, the *you* of the question

Before you move on

Read நீங்கள் எப்படி இருக்கிறீர்கள்? aloud. Is ◌ர written before its consonant or after? (**After** — ◌ை and ◌ெ are the ones written before.) When is a vowel sign *spoken*? (**Always after**, wherever it sits.) Which word did you learn to read first? (நீங்கள்.) Next: the verb இரு on its own.

Chapter 32

The Core Verbs

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (6) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 6 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can build a Tamil verb as stem plus tense plus person, swap the tense bead for past or future, tell a strong verb from a weak one by its doubled consonant, and say why தெரியும் carries no person at all.
>
> *Say* எனக்குத் தமிழ் தெரியும், *name the three slots that built irukkiṟēṉ, pōgiṟēṉ and pārkkiṟēṉ, and explain which slot* தெரியும் *leaves empty and where its person went instead.*

32.1 இரு (iru) — "to be," and the machine inside every Tamil verb

> Thirty-one chapters of words. Now the engine room. Tamil builds a verb the way you thread beads on a string, and this first verb carries the whole string.

You'll want to know: இரு

> **இரு** — *iru* — **to be, to exist, to stay**

It is native Dravidian, from an old root meaning "be, remain, stay put." Kannada kept the very same word, ಇರು (*iru*), and Malayalam has ഇരിക്കുക (*irikkuka*); Telugu went its own way with ఉండు (*uṇḍu*).

Iru is about **existing** or **being somewhere**, not about linking two nouns. Tamil says "I am at home" with *iru*, and says "I am a teacher" with no verb at all, just the two words side by side.

Its everyday first-person form is இருக்கிறேன் (*irukkiṟēṉ*), "I am." You have already heard it: the question *eppaḍi irukkiṟīrgaḷ?* — "how are you?" — is this verb wearing a different ending.

In the family, and next door

	word	**same root**
Kannada	ಇರು (*iru*)	yes
Telugu	ఉండు (*uṇḍu*)	
Malayalam	ഉണ്ട് (*uṇṭŭ*)	
Hindi (neighbour)	हूँ (*hūṁ*)	
English	to be, to exist, to stay	

The letters in this word

இ (the standing vowel *i*) + ரு (*ru*) → இரு. Both shapes turned up in இரவு (*iravu*, "night").
In *irukkiṟēṉ* the க்க is held long — *i-ruk-ki*, with a catch in the middle. That length is not decoration; a later lesson turns it into a rule.

Grammar Lens: stem, then tense, then person

English changes a verb by putting words **around** it: *I am, I was, I will be.* Tamil changes it by gluing pieces **onto the end** of it, always in the same order:

இரு + க்கிற் + ஏன் → இருக்கிறேன்

iru (be) + *-kkiṟ-* (happening now) + *-ēṉ* (I) → *irukkiṟēṉ*

Left to right, the word says **be** — **present** — **I**. Three slots, filled in that order, welded into one word. Languages built this way are called **agglutinative**, from Latin *glutinare*, "to glue."
Two payoffs arrive at once. The last piece already means "I," so *nāṉ* is optional. And nothing here belongs to *iru* alone: every verb in this chapter is the same three slots with a new first bead.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "iru" — be, exist, stay

- "irukkiṟēṉ" — I am
- the three beads in order — "iru … kkiṟ … ēṉ"

Before you move on

What are the three pieces of *irukkiṟēṉ*, in order? (**Stem, tense, person** — *iru*, *-kkiṟ-*, *-ēṉ*.) Which piece carries "I"? (**The last one**, *-ēṉ* — which is why *nāṉ* can be dropped.) Which sister language kept the same verb? (**Kannada**, *iru*.) Next: the same machine, with the tense bead swapped.

32.2 போ (pō) — "to go," and the bead that carries time

From the afternoon greeting first: which road is *matiya* on — native *piṉ* plus *pakal*, or Sanskrit? (**Sanskrit** *madhya*, "middle" — noon, then afternoon.)

You have the three slots — stem, tense, person. Keep the first and last beads still, and swap only the middle one. That is the whole of Tamil tense.

You'll want to know: போ

போ — *pō* — to go

Two letters, ப (*pa*) with the long-*ō* sign, and a word so old it has barely moved. It is native Dravidian: Telugu పోవు (*pōvu*) and Malayalam പോകുക (*pōkuka*) are the same verb.

Kannada's everyday word for "go" is ಹೋಗು (*hōgu*) — and that *h* is not a different root. It is the same softening of an old *p* that turned Tamil *pattu* ("ten") into Kannada *hattu*. One sound-law, met once with numbers, now paying off with a verb.

You met the bare stem in the farewell chapter, where *pō!* is already a whole command: "go!"

In the family, and next door

	word	**same root**
Kannada	ಹೋಗು (*hōgu*)	yes
Telugu	వెళ్ళు (*veḷḷu*)	
Malayalam	പോകുക (*pōkuka*)	yes
Hindi (neighbour)	जाना (*jānā*)	
English	to go	

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

போ (*pō*) is native Dravidian. DEDR 4572 lists Malayalam *pōka*, Kannada *pōgu* (and *hōgu*) and Telugu *pōvu*.

Grammar Lens: past, present, future — one bead each

Hold the stem *pō-* and the person-ending *-ēṉ* ("I") fixed, and let the middle piece do the work:

when	**Tamil**	**the middle bead**
now	*pōgiṟēṉ*	*-giṟ-*
already	*pōṉēṉ*	*-ṉ-*
not yet	*pōvēṉ*	*-v-*

"I go," "I went," "I will go" — one syllable of difference, sitting between two pieces that never moved. English needs a new word (*will*) or a whole new shape (*went*); Tamil needs one bead.

The tense bead voices to *-giṟ-* after a vowel, which is why it sounds like *pō-gi-ṟēṉ* here but *iruk-ki-ṟēṉ* after the doubled *k* of *iru*.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "pō" — go
- the three times — "pōgiṟēṉ … pōṉēṉ … pōvēṉ"
- the pair that shares one sound-law — "pattu … hattu", "pō … hōgu"
- "irukkiṟēṉ" and "pōgiṟēṉ" — one machine, two stems

Before you move on

Which of the three beads changes for tense? (**The middle one**.) Say "I will go." (*Pōvēṉ*.) Is Kannada's *hōgu* a different root from *pō*? (**No** — the same old *p* softened to *h*, exactly as in *pattu* and *hattu*.) Next: a verb whose stem refuses to sit still.

32.3 വാ (vā) — "to come," and a stem with two shapes

Pō threads its beads on without a fuss. Its partner *vā* does not — and the farewell you learned long ago has been hiding the reason.

You'll want to know: വാ

വാ — *vā* — to come

വ (*va*) with the long-*ā* sign, and, like *pō*, a whole command on its own: *vā!*, "come!" Native Dravidian, and the family keeps it: Malayalam വരുക (*varuka*), Kannada ಬಾ (*bā*), Telugu రా (*rā*). Kannada's *b* and Telugu's *r* are two regular reshapings of the same old word, not three separate verbs.

In the family, and next door

	word	same root
Kannada	ಬಾ (*bā*)	yes
Telugu	రా (*rā*)	
Malayalam	വരുക (*varuka*)	yes
Hindi (neighbour)	आना (*ānā*)	
English	to come	

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

വാ (*vā*) is native Dravidian. DEDR 5270 files it under *varu*, with Malayalam *varuka*, Kannada *bā* and Telugu *rā*.

Grammar Lens: the word you say it by is not the word you build on

Thread the beads onto *vā-* and you get nothing a Tamil speaker says. The suffixes attach to **வரு-** (*varu-*) instead:

varu- + *-gi̲r-* + *-ē̲n* → **வருகிறேன்** (*varugi̲rē̲n*), "I come."

Past: **வந்தேன்** (*vantē̲n*), "I came." Future: **வருவேன்** (*varuvē̲n*). So a Tamil verb has a form you **call** it by — the bare command, the form a dictionary lists — and a form the beads actually **attach** to. For most verbs those are the same shape. For a handful of very common ones, of which *vā* is the commonest, they are not, and the pair simply has to be learned together: *vā*, *varu-*.
You have said this word already. The farewell **போய் வருகிறேன்** (*pōy varugi̲rē̲n*) — "I go and come back" — is *pō* and *varu-* standing side by side, and that *varugi̲rē̲n* is the very form above.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- the command — "vā!"
- the pair that must be learned together — "vā … varu-"
- "varugi̲rē̲n … vantē̲n … varuvē̲n"
- the farewell you now understand — "pōy varugi̲rē̲n"

Before you move on

What shape do the beads attach to for "come"? (**வரு-**, *varu-*, not *vā-*.) Say "I come." (*Varugi̲rē̲n*.) Which two verbs are standing in *pōy varugi̲rē̲n*? (**போ** and **வா** — go, and come back.) Are Kannada *bā* and Telugu *rā* different verbs? (**No** — the same Dravidian word, reshaped.) Next: a verb Tamil built for itself.

32.4 சாப்பிடு (sāppiḍu) — "to eat," a verb built out of two words

Iru, *pō*, *vā* — three single syllables inherited whole from the oldest layer of Dravidian. The everyday word for "eat" is nothing of the kind. It was assembled.

You'll want to know: சாப்பிடு

சாப்பிடு — *sāppiḍu* — **to eat**

Four beats: *sāp-pi-ḍu*, with the **ப்ப** held long, the same doubling you heard in *irukkiṟēṉ*. Threaded up, it is **சாப்பிடுகிறேன்** (*sāppiḍugiṟēṉ*), "I eat" — stem, then *-giṟ-*, then *-ēṉ*, with no surprises. Past: **சாப்பிட்டேன்** (*sāppiṭṭēṉ*).

In the family, and next door

	word
Kannada	**ತಿನ್ನು** (*tinnu*)
Telugu	**తిను** (*tinu*)
Malayalam	**തിന്നുക** (*tinnuka*)
English	to eat

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

The word comes apart cleanly into two Tamil words:

- **சாப்பு** (*sāppu*) — food, a meal; the everyday **சாப்பாடு** (*sāppāḍu*, "a meal") is built from it.
- **இடு** (*iḍu*) — to put, to place.

Put food. That is all *sāppiḍu* literally says. **இடு** is what grammarians call a **light verb**: a plain, hard-working verb that lends its endings to a noun so the pair can act as one verb. Tamil builds a great many verbs this way, so *iḍu* is worth knowing on its own. (Where *sāppu* itself came from is not settled; treat the compound as transparent and the deeper root as open.)

Then the honest part. The inherited Dravidian word for eating is ***tiṉ-***, and it is thriving next door: Telugu **తిను** (*tinu*), Kannada **ತಿನ್ನು** (*tinnu*), Malayalam **തിന്നുക** (*tinnuka*). Tamil kept it too, as **தின்** (*tiṉ*) — now narrowed to chewing and snacking — and kept the old

literary உண் (*uṇ*), Malayalam's ഉണ്ണുക (*uṇṇuka*), besides. So Tamil did not lose the ancient eat-verbs. It built a new one and let them keep their smaller jobs.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "sāppiḍu" — eat
- "sāppiḍugiṟēṉ" — I eat — then "sāppiṭṭēṉ", I ate
- the two halves — "sāppu" (food) + "iḍu" (put)
- the inherited root next door — "tinu … tinnu … tinnuka"

Before you move on

What two words is *sāppiḍu* made of? (சாப்பு, food, and இடு, to put.) What is a light verb doing there? (**Lending its endings** to a noun so the pair works as one verb.) Did Tamil lose the inherited eat-root? (**No** — *tiṉ* narrowed to chewing, *uṇ* stayed literary, and the cousins kept *tinu*, *tinnu*, *tinnuka*.) Next: the verb that splits Tamil's verbs into two classes.

32.5 பார் (pār) — "to see," and Tamil's two kinds of verb

Four verbs in, one small thing has been inconsistent. *Pōgiṟēṉ* has a single *k*. *Irukkiṟēṉ* has a doubled one. That is not sloppiness — it is a sorting rule, and this verb is where it gets a name.

You'll want to know: பார்

பார் — *pār* — **to see, to watch**

ப with the long-*ā* sign, then ர் with a puḷḷi to strip its vowel: *pār*, one syllable ending on the *r*. From it comes the noun பார்வை (*pārvai*), "sight, vision."

Each Dravidian sister settled on a different everyday word for seeing — Kannada ನೋಡು (*nōḍu*), Telugu చూడు (*cūḍu*), Malayalam കാണുക

(*kāṇuka*) — so *pār* is Tamil's own choice, not the family's. But the family's shared root is here too: Tamil keeps காண் (*kāṇ*), "to see," for formal and literary use, and that is the same word as Malayalam's *kāṇuka* and Kannada's ಕಾಣು (*kāṇu*). Four sisters, one inherited root, four everyday preferences.

In the family, and next door

	word
Kannada	ನೋಡು (*nōḍu*)
Telugu	చూడు (*cūḍu*)
Malayalam	കാണുക (*kāṇuka*)
English	to see, to look

Grammar Lens: strong verbs and weak verbs

Every Tamil verb belongs to one of two camps, and the tense bead tells you which:

camp	**present**	**past**
weak — *pō*	*pōgiṟēṉ*	*pōṉēṉ*
strong — *pār*	*pārkkiṟēṉ*	*pārttēṉ*

Weak verbs take the tense bead lightly: a single *k*, softened to *g*. **Strong** verbs double it — *-kkiṟ-*, held long — and take a doubled *t* in the past. *Iru* is strong, which is why "I am" was *irukkiṟēṉ* and never *irugiṟēṉ*. *Sāppiḍu* is weak, like *pō*.

There is no rule you can hear in the bare stem that tells you which camp a verb is in, so it is learned with the verb, the way a noun's gender is learned in other languages. Two camps, though — not twenty. Meet a verb once in its present form and it is settled forever.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "pār" — see, watch
- the contrast, holding the long *kk* — "pōgiṟēṉ … pārkkiṟēṉ"
- the past pair — "pōṉēṉ … pārttēṉ"
- which camp each verb sits in — "iru strong, pō weak, sāppiḍu weak, pār strong"

Before you move on

What separates a strong verb from a weak one? (**The doubled consonant** in the tense bead — *pārkkiṟēṉ* against *pōgiṟēṉ*.) Which camp is *iru* in, and how do you know? (**Strong** — *irukkiṟēṉ* holds the *kk*.) Which Tamil verb for "see" is shared with Malayalam and Kannada? (காண், *kāṇ* — kept for formal use beside everyday *pār*.) Next: a verb with no person on the end at all.

32.6 தெரி (teri) — "to know," the verb that drops the person

Five verbs, and every one ended on -*ēṉ*, the bead that means "I." The last verb of the chapter refuses that bead — and Chapter 6 already gave you the sentence it makes.

You'll want to know: தெரி

தெரி — *teri* — to know; to be apparent, to be visible

த (*ta*) with the short-*e* sign, then ரி (*ri*). Its base sense is not "know" but "**show up, be clear**" — a thing *teri*-s to you the way a shape resolves out of fog. The everyday form is தெரியும் (*teriyum*): "it is known," "it is apparent."

Tamil keeps a second know-verb, அறி (*aṟi*), for knowing by learning — the same word as Kannada ಅರಿ (*ari*) and Malayalam അറിയുക (*aṟiyuka*). *Teri* has an exact cousin too: Telugu's తెలుసు (*telusu*), from తెలియు (*teliyu*).

In the family, and next door

	word	same root
Kannada	ಗೊತ್ತು (*gottu*)	
Telugu	తెలుసు (*telusu*)	yes
Malayalam	അറിയുക (*aṟiyuka*)	
Hindi (neighbour)	मैं जानता हूँ (*maiṁ jāntā hūṁ*)	
English	to know, to be apparent	

Grammar Lens: no person on the verb, so the person moves

> **எனக்குத் தமிழ் தெரியும்.** — *enakkut tamiḻ teriyum* — "I know Tamil."

Chapter 6 gave you that sentence whole; here is the verb inside it. **தெரியும்** has no person bead, and stays the same shape no matter who knows:

- *enakku teriyum* — it is known **to me**
- *uṉakku teriyum* — it is known **to you**
- *avaṉukku teriyum* — it is known **to him**

Only the little dative word in front changes. Tamil treats knowing as something that **happens to** you rather than something you **do**, so the knower is not the subject and cannot climb into the verb's last slot. That is the chapter's closing symmetry. Five verbs carried the person in the ending, and *nāṉ* could be dropped. Here the ending carries no person, so the dative word is the one thing you cannot drop. Telugu builds it identically: **నాకు తెలుసు** (*nāku telusu*), "to me it is known."

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "teri" — be apparent — then "teriyum", it is known
- "enakkut tamiḻ teriyum" — I know Tamil
- the three knowers, one verb — "enakku … uṉakku … avaṉukku teriyum"
- the five that carried the person — "irukkiṟēṉ, pōgiṟēṉ, varugiṟēṉ, sāppiḍugiṟēṉ, pārkkiṟēṉ"

Before you move on

What does *teri* mean underneath "know"? (**To be apparent, to show up**.) Which bead is missing from *teriyum*? (**The person** — so the knower sits in the dative word instead.) Say "I know Tamil."

(*Enakkut tamiḻ teriyum.*) Name the three slots one last time, with a strong verb in them. (**Stem, tense, person** — *pār* + *-kkiṟ-* + *-ēṉ.*) Which sister builds the knowing-sentence the same way? (**Telugu**, *nāku telusu.*)

Chapter 33

Four Verbs of the Mind

Modes: 👁 **eyes** (4) ✓ **pen** (1) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** the first 3 of 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say I think, I understand, I read and I write in Tamil with the same three slots, tell a strong verb from a weak one by its held consonant, explain why எனக்குப் புரிகிறது has no I in it, and make the ழ in எழுது.
>
> *Say* நான் தமிழ் எழுதுகிறேன், *run the chapter's four verbs in the present and sort them into strong and weak, produce* ழ *without letting the tongue touch, and name the one word here whose origin is unsettled.*

33.1 நினை (ninai) — "to think," which is also "to remember"

> *Teri* refused to carry a person: *enakku teriyum*, "it is known to me." Say *enakkut tamil̲ teriyum* once. This verb takes the person back.

You'll want to know: நினை

> **நினை** — *ninai* — **to think; to think of, to remember**

Two light beats, *ni-nai*. Threaded up: நினைக்கிறேன் (*ninaikkir̲ēn̲*), "I think" — stem, tense, person, with nothing new in the machine.

In the family, and next door

	word
Kannada	ಯೋಚಿಸು (*yōcisu*)
Telugu	అనుకో (*anukō*)
Malayalam	ചിന്തിക്കുക (*cintikkuka*)
Hindi (neighbour)	सोचना (*sochnā*)
English	to think

The letters in this word

நி is the **dental** ந with the *i* sign ி; னை is the **alveolar** ன with the *ai* sign ை. Two of Tamil's three n-letters in one word, and not interchangeable: the first sits on the teeth, the second on the ridge behind them. Chapter 6's three-n lesson mapped all three — ந, ன, ண.

Grammar Lens: it doubles, so it is strong

The **k** in *ninaikkiṟēṉ* is held long — *ninaik-ki* — as it was in *irukkiṟēṉ* and *pārkkiṟēṉ*, and not as it was in *pōgiṟēṉ*. So **நினை is strong**, and its past is நினைத்தேன் (*ninaittēṉ*), with the strong verb's doubled *t*. One held consonant answers a question you would otherwise ask of every new verb. You are not learning a machine per verb: you learn which of two camps a stem sits in, then reuse the same three slots forever.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

நினை is native Dravidian and does two English jobs at once: *ninaikkiṟēṉ* is "I think" and equally "I remember." The noun says so — நினைவு (*ninaivu*) is **memory**. Kannada agrees with ನೆನೆ (*nene*), "remember," and ನೆನಪು (*nenapu*), "memory"; Malayalam has നിനയ്ക്കുക (*ninaykkuka*).
One honest note for this chapter and the next: English took real words from Tamil — *catamaran*, *mango*, *curry*, *pariah* — but **none from these verbs**. Inventing a cousin would be worse than having none.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "ninai" — think, remember — then "ninaikkiṟēṉ"

- the strong pair — "irukkiṟēṉ … ninaikkiṟēṉ"
- the noun — "ninaivu", memory — then Kannada "nenapu"
- the two shapes — "enakku teriyum … nāṉ ninaikkiṟēṉ"

Before you move on

What two English verbs does *ninai* cover, and which camp is it in? (**Think** and **remember**; **strong**, from the held *kk*.) What is *ninaivu*, and which sister keeps the root? (**Memory**; **Kannada**, *nene / nenapu*.) Which two n's does *ninai* use, in order? (**Dental** ந, then **alveolar** ன.) And why does *teriyum* carry no *-ēṉ*? (**Knowing happens to you** — its person sits in the dative instead.)

33.2 புரி (puri) — "to become clear," and who it becomes clear to

Two shapes. *Nāṉ ninaikkiṟēṉ* — I do the thinking. *Enakku teriyum* — the knowing happens to me. Say both.

You'll want to know: புரி

புரி — *puri* — **to be understood; to become clear**

The everyday form is புரிகிறது (*purigiṟadu*):

எனக்குத் தமிழ் புரிகிறது. — *enakkut tamiḻ purigiṟadu* — "I understand Tamil."

Word for word, "**to me** Tamil is becoming clear." The verb is weak: the softened *-giṟ-* of *pōgiṟēṉ*, not the long *-kkiṟ-* of *ninaikkiṟēṉ*.

In the family, and next door

	word
Kannada	ಅರ್ಥಮಾಡಿಕೊ (*arthamāḍiko*)
Telugu	అర్థం చేసుకో (*artham cēsukō*)
Malayalam	മനസ്സിലാക്കുക (*manassilākkuka*)
Hindi (neighbour)	समझना (*samajhnā*)
English	to be understood, to become clear

The letters in this word

பு is ப carrying the *u* sign, which fuses into the letter's shape rather than hanging off it; ரி is ர with the *i* sign ி.

Grammar Lens: the last slot can say "it"

Teriyum had no person slot at all. *Purigi̲radu* **fills** it, with **-அது** (*-adu*), "**it**."

புரி + கிற் + அது → புரிகிறது

So the thing becoming clear is *it*, and the understander is pushed out of the verb into the dative word **எனக்கு** (*enakku*) that Chapter 6 built for this job. Change the understander and only that word moves:

- *enakku purigi̲radu* — I understand
- *u̲nakku purigi̲radu* — you understand
- *ava̲nukku purigi̲radu* — he understands

Two verbs, two mechanisms, one result: **the experiencer sits in the dative.** Not an exception — the ordinary way to report what happens inside a person.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

Tamil's dictionaries keep more than one **புரி**: an old literary one, "to do, to perform," and this everyday one. Whether they are one root is **not settled**. Certain is the verbal noun in **-தல்**: **புரிதல்** (*puridal*), "understanding."
The family evidence is stronger. Each sister chose a different verb, and every one puts the understander in the dative:

- Kannada **ನನಗೆ ಅರ್ಥವಾಯಿತು** — *nanage arthavāyitu*
- Telugu **నాకు అర్థమైంది** — *nāku arthamaindi*
- Malayalam **എനിക്ക് മനസ്സിലായി** — *enikku manassilāyi*, "it entered my mind"

Different words, one grammar. Chapter 6 showed the four dative endings were cousins; here they do the same job in the same sentence.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "enakkut tamil̲ purigi̲radu" — I understand Tamil
- three understanders, one verb — "enakku … una̲kku … avan̲ukku purigi̲radu"
- the pair that share a shape — "enakku teriyum … enakku purigi̲radu"
- the sisters' datives — "enakku … nanage … nāku … enikku"

Before you move on

What does *puri* mean underneath "understand," and what fills its person slot? (**To become clear**; **-அது**, "it".) So where does the understander go? (**Into the dative** — *enakku.*) Name the other verb that puts you there. (***Teri*** — *enakku teriyum.*) And which verb from this chapter keeps the person on the ending? (***Ninai*** — *nān̲ ninaikkiṟēn̲.*)

33.3 படி (paḍi) — "to read," and the letter that is two sounds

Say *enakkut tamil̲ purigi̲radu* — Tamil becomes clear to me. Now the verb for the work that gets you there.

You'll want to know: படி

படி — *paḍi* — **to read; to study, to learn**

படிக்கிறேன் (*paḍikkiṟēn̲*), "I read, I study." The *kk* is held, so **படி is strong**, like *ninai* and *pār*; its past is **படித்தேன்** (*paḍittēn̲*).

நான் தமிழ் படிக்கிறேன். — *nān̲ tamil̲ paḍikkiṟēn̲* — "I study Tamil."

Tamil does not split reading from studying: **படிப்பு** (*paḍippu*) is both "reading" and "an education."

In the family, and next door

	word	**same root**
Kannada	ಓದು (*ōdu*)	
Telugu	చదువు (*caduvu*)	
Malayalam	വായിക്കുക (*vāyikkuka*)	
Hindi (neighbour)	पढ़ना (*paṛhnā*)	yes
English	to read, to study	

The letters in this word

ப (*pa*) + டி, which is ட wearing the *i* sign ி.

Now a mystery worth clearing up. The letter is ட, named *ṭa*, yet the word is written here *paḍi*, with a **d**. Nothing is inconsistent: **Tamil marks no voicing.** One letter covers both sounds and **position decides** — hard word-initially or doubled, soft between vowels. That is Chapter 5's rule for க, which spells *k*, *g* and a soft *h* without changing shape.

So ட is soft between the vowels of *paḍi* and hard in the doubled ட்ட of *paḍittēṉ*. It is why *pō* becomes *pōgiṟēṉ*, why *sāppiḍu* has a *ḍ*, and why every romanization here softens where a speaker softens.

ட is also **retroflex**, made where ண is: tongue tip curled back to the roof of the mouth. That curl matters more than the *d*-versus-*t*.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

Tamil's own dictionaries list படி as native. Others connect it to Sanskrit पठ् (*paṭh*), "to recite, to read aloud" — not a silly idea, because **Tamil has no aspirated consonants**, so a borrowed *paṭh* would arrive as *paṭi* automatically, with no letter to carry the puff of breath.

Next door the evidence is split. Malayalam says പഠിക്കുക (*paṭhikkuka*) and **keeps the aspirate**, in the Sanskrit-series letter ഠ; Kannada and Telugu use ಓದು (*ōdu*) and చదువు (*caduvu*), unrelated to either candidate.

Carry away the certain part: **an aspirate cannot survive into Tamil**, so a stripped-down look-alike is never by itself proof of borrowing.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "nāṉ tamiḻ paḍikkiṟēṉ" — I study Tamil
- the soft and the hard ட — "paḍi … paḍittēṉ"
- the strong three — "ninaikkiṟēṉ, paḍikkiṟēṉ, pārkkiṟēṉ"
- the weak one beside them — "purigiṟadu"

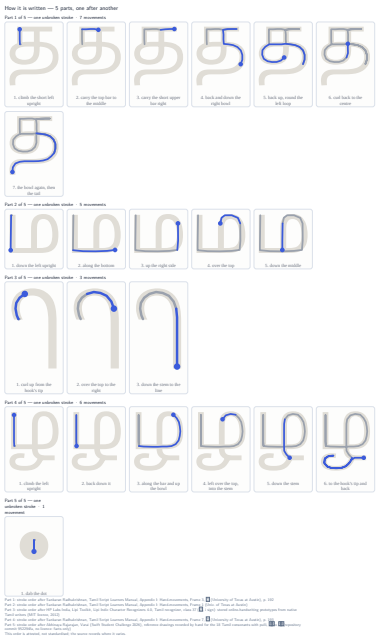
Before you move on

Why is ட written one way and heard two ways, and where is it made? (**Tamil marks no voicing** — position decides, as with க; and it is **retroflex**, made where ண is.) Is *paḍi* borrowed from Sanskrit *paṭh*, and what can Tamil never keep from a Sanskrit word? (**Unsettled**; **the aspiration**.) Say "I study Tamil." (*Nāṉ tamiḻ paḍikkiṟēṉ.*)

33.4 தமிழ் — the letter the language is named for

This book has said more than once that Tamil keeps three *l*-letters, and the strand has shown you two: ல in இல்லை, ள in நீங்கள். The third has been outstanding since chapter 18. Here it is, in the word it matters most in.

Script you'll notice: த and ழ



How தமிழ் *is written, part by part, stroke by stroke*

த	*ta* — the dental *t*, tongue on the teeth
ழ	*ḻ* — the third *l*-letter, curled far back

த is the dental partner of the retroflex ட you read in எப்படி: same kind of stop, different place in the mouth. Tamil keeps the pair apart in writing, so த and ட are never interchangeable.

ழ is the one Tamil is known for. It is made further back than ள, and its sound sits somewhere between an *r*, an *l* and a *zh* — rare enough in the world's languages that Tamil is sometimes called the ḻ language. That is why the word for the language itself ends in it.

> Read both. The strip writes the whole word, numbered movement by movement, with each source beneath it. The script data calls த dental and ழ retroflex; the finer mouth positions above are this lesson's own.

Script you'll notice: build the word

piece		
த	*ta*	this lesson
மி	*mi* — ம with the ி sign	ம from வணக்கம், ி from நன்றி
ழ்	bare *l̲* — ழ under a pul̲li	this lesson

த · மி · ழ் → தமிழ்

Three pieces, and you can now read the name of the language you have been speaking since page one. That was the plan: the word first, the letters when they can be earned.

Your turn

- *Read it:* த · ழ — then தமிழ்
- *Say it:* "tamil̲" — and hold that last sound
- *Contrast:* த and ட — dental and retroflex, teeth and roof
- *Contrast:* ல · ள · ழ — all three *l*-letters, at last

Before you move on

Read தமிழ். Which letter is த's retroflex partner? (ட, from எப்படி.) Which of the three *l*-letters ends the word, and what is the dot doing? (ழ; the pul̲li **removes its built-in *a***.) Next: the verb for writing — spelled with the ழ you just met.

33.5 எழுது (el̲udu) — "to write," and the sound Tamil is named for

Ninaikkir̲ēn̲, *purigir̲adu*, *paḍikkir̲ēn̲* — think, understand, read. Say all three. The fourth is reading's other half.

You'll want to know: எழுது

எழுது — *e̲ludu* — **to write; to draw**

எழுதுகிறேன் (*e̲ludugiṟēn̲*), "I write." The tense bead is the **single softened *-giṟ-***, so **எழுது is weak**, like *pō* and *sāppiḍu*.

நான் தமிழ் எழுதுகிறேன். — *nān̲ tamiḻ̲ e̲ludugiṟēn̲* — "I write Tamil."

In the family, and next door

	word	same root
Kannada	ಬರೆ (*bare*)	
Telugu	రాయు (*rāyu*)	
Malayalam	എഴുതുക (*e̲lutuka*)	yes
Hindi (neighbour)	लिखना (*likhnā*)	
English	to write	

The letters in this word

எ is the standing vowel *e*; ழு is ழ with the *u* sign and து is த with the same sign.

The dot returns in the noun எழுத்து (*e̲luttu*), "**a letter of the alphabet**," spelled எ ழு த் து: a **puḷḷi** strips the vowel from the first த் and the second து stands whole beside it. Two full letters and a visible dot, never a fused shape: the puḷḷi lesson's bargain.

The letters in this word

ழ — written *l̲* — is the sound in தமிழ் (*tamiḻ̲*) itself and in வாழ் (*vāḻ̲*), "to live," and is reputed to be the language's hardest.
Curl the tongue tip back as for ட or ண, then **do not let it touch**. Leave a gap and voice through it: what comes out sits between an American *r* and an *l*, and it is a **glide**, not a stop.
Two honest notes. Many fluent speakers merge ழ with ள and are understood everywhere. And the family already voted — Chapter 7 gave you Tamil **ē̲lu** against Kannada **ēḷu**. Kannada and Telugu each had a letter for it and let it go; **Tamil and Malayalam kept it.**

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

எழுது looks like எழு (*e̱lu*), "**to rise**," but DEDR keeps them as **separate entries**. Native Dravidian (DEDR 853), unlike *paḍi*'s open question. Beside it sits எழுத்தாளர் (*e̱luttāḷar*), a writer.
The cousin is exact: Malayalam എഴുതുക (*e̱lutuka*), same verb, same ഴ. Kannada and Telugu write with other verbs.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- the three ழ words — "tami̱l … vā̱l … e̱ludu"
- "nā̱n tami̱l e̱ludugi̱rē̱n" — I write Tamil
- the chapter — "ninaikki̱rē̱n, purigi̱radu, paḍikki̱rē̱n, e̱ludugi̱rē̱n"
- the split — "Tamil ē̱lu … Kannada ēḷu"

Before you move on

Say the chapter's four verbs and name the two weak ones. (*Ninaikki̱rē̱n, purigi̱radu, paḍikki̱rē̱n, e̱ludugi̱rē̱n*; ***puri*** and ***e̱ludu***.) How is ழ made, and who kept it? (**Curled back, not touching**; **Malayalam** did, **Kannada** and **Telugu** dropped it.) What keeps the two த's of *e̱luttu* apart, and which word here has an unsettled origin? (**The puḷḷi**; ***paḍi***.)

Chapter 34

Four Verbs Between People

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (1) 👁 **eyes** (3) ✓ **pen** (1) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** the first 2 of 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say I take, I ask, I help and I like in Tamil, hear கேள் doing the work of both asking and hearing, choose between பிடிக்கும் and விரும்பு, and say எனக்குப் பிடிக்கும் knowing why the liker sits in the dative exactly as with தெரியும்.
>
> *Say* எனக்குத் தமிழ் பிடிக்கும் *and unpack it as "to me, Tamil catches"; name the three dative-experiencer verbs* தெரியும் / புரிகிறது / பிடிக்கும், *contrast* விரும்பு*'s ordinary subject, and place Kannada* ಹಿಡಿ *on the p→h shift met in Chapter 7.*

34.1 எடு (eḍu) — "to take," beside the "put" you already own

The last chapter's verbs happened inside your head. These four happen between you and somebody else. Say *paḍikkiṟēṉ* and *eṟudugiṟēṉ* once more, then put your hands back in the world.

You'll want to know: எடு

எடு — *eḍu* — to take; to pick up, to lift, to remove

எடுக்கிறேன் (*eḍukkiṟēṉ*), "I take." The *kk* is held, so **எடு is strong**; past எடுத்தேன் (*eḍuttēṉ*). Two sentences you can already build in full:

நான் தண்ணீர் எடுக்கிறேன். — *nāṉ taṇṇīr eḍukkiṟēṉ* — "I take water."

நான் அரிசி எடுக்கிறேன். — *nāṉ arisi eḍukkiṟēṉ* — "I take rice."

In the family, and next door

	word
Kannada	ತೆಗೆದುಕೊ (*tegeduko*)
Telugu	తీసుకో (*tīsukō*)
Malayalam	എടുക്കുക (*eṭukkuka*)
Hindi (neighbour)	लेना (*lenā*)
English	to take, to pick up

The letters in this word

எ is the standing vowel *e*, from எழுது; டு is ட with the *u* sign, and ட came apart in படி. Nothing here is new — the first time in this book that has been true of a whole headword. The *ḍ* you hear is the same positional softening: ட goes soft between vowels and hard when doubled, as in *eḍuttēṉ*.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

You have met this verb's near-twin already, hiding inside a meal. சாப்பிடு (*sāppiḍu*), "to eat," is *sāppu* (food) plus இடு (*iḍu*), "**to put**" — the light verb that lends its endings to a noun.

verb	**what it does**
இடு *iḍu*	put it **down**
எடு *eḍu*	pick it **up**

One standing vowel apart — இ against எ — pointing opposite ways. That is a gift to your memory and **not** an etymology: Tamil's dictionaries keep them as **separate roots**, and a tidy pair of opposites is exactly the resemblance that fools people. Use it to remember; never as evidence.

What *is* inherited is *eḍu* itself. Malayalam has എടുക്കുക (*eṭukkuka*), the same verb; the etymological dictionary files them together. Kannada and Telugu ఎత్తు / ಎತ್ತು (*ettu*), "to lift," look close but are filed under a **separate root**: perhaps a cousin, not a proven one.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- the opposed pair — "iḍu, put … eḍu, take"
- "nāṉ taṇṇīr eḍukkiṟēṉ" — I take water
- "nāṉ arisi eḍukkiṟēṉ" — I take rice
- the true cousin, then the look-alike — "eṭukkuka … ettu"

Before you move on

What does *eḍu* mean, and which camp is it in? (**To take**; **strong** — *eḍukkiṟēṉ* holds the *kk*.) Which verb is one vowel away, and where did you meet it? (இடு, "to put" — inside சாப்பிடு.) Is that pair related? (**No** — the dictionaries keep them apart; it is a memory hook, not evidence.) Say "I take water," then "I take rice." (*Nāṉ taṇṇīr eḍukkiṟēṉ*; *nāṉ arisi eḍukkiṟēṉ*.)

34.2 கேள் (kēḷ) — one verb for asking and for hearing

Eḍukkiṟēṉ — I take. Name the verb it is one vowel away from. Now a verb doing two English jobs at once.

You'll want to know: கேள்

கேள் — *kēḷ* — **to ask; to hear, to listen**

One syllable, ending on retroflex ள். The everyday form surprises:

நான் கேட்கிறேன். — *nāṉ kēṭkiṟēṉ* — "I ask." (Also: "I hear.")

The ள் has hardened to ட் — வா's trick a second time: you say it *vā*, but the endings attach to *varu-*. Here they attach to **கேட்-** (*kēṭ-*), and the past is **கேட்டேன்** (*kēṭṭēṉ*), a strong verb's doubled consonant. Two verbs with two stems apiece.

In the family, and next door

	word	**same root**
Kannada	ಕೇಳು (*kēḷu*)	yes
Telugu	అడుగు (*aḍugu*)	
Malayalam	ചോദിക്കുക (*cōdikkuka*)	
Hindi (neighbour)	पूछना (*pūchnā*)	
English	to ask	

The letters in this word

கே is க with the long-*ē* sign ே; ள் is retroflex ள shut off by a **puḷḷi** — the dot Chapter 8 pointed at inside செய்து. In கேட்கிறேன் the seam is ட்க.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

English keeps *ask* and *hear* apart. Tamil does not, and neither does its noun: கேள்வி (*kēḷvi*) is **"a question"** and also "a hearing." The family splits down the middle:

- Kannada ಕೇಳು (*kēḷu*) does **both** jobs, as Tamil does.
- Malayalam കേൾക്കുക (*kēḷkkuka*) kept only "hear."
- Telugu splits them: విను (*vinu*), hear; అడుగు (*aḍugu*), ask.

The verb is inherited, but four languages cannot settle which arrangement came first; treat the fusion as Tamil's and Kannada's shared habit alone.

Why it's said this way

Tamil is **diglossic**: its literary variety and the variety people speak have drifted far apart. This verb makes that impossible to ignore.

- கேள் is the dictionary and literary form.
- கேட்கிறேன் is standard spoken Tamil — **the register these lessons teach**, as every lesson's variety line has said.
- Relaxed speech says கேக்கிறேன் (*kēkkiṟēṉ*) and கேக்க (*kēkka*). Recognise them; you need not say them.

For a polite request use Chapter 8's respectful ending: கேளுங்கள் (*kēḷungaḷ*), "please ask." Keep தயவுசெய்து for emphasis.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- the two shifting stems — "vā … varugiṟēṉ" then "kēḷ … kēṭkiṟēṉ"
- "kēḷvi" — a question — then the polite "kēḷungaḷ"
- the family split — "Kannada kēḷu, both … Telugu vinu and aḍugu, two"

Before you move on

What two English verbs is *kēḷ*, and what happens to its ள் before an ending? (**Ask** and **hear**; it hardens to ட்.) Which verb taught you to expect a second stem, and what is *kēḷvi*? (வா, built on *varu-*; **a question**.) Which register do these lessons teach, and how do you ask politely? (**Standard spoken** *kēṭkiṟēṉ*; ***kēḷungaḷ***.)

34.3 பேசு — the long partner of ெ

Twice now a Tamil vowel has come in a short and a long version: அ and ஆ, ி and ீ. For அ/ஆ the script data even says the long one is the short one plus a tail; for ி/ீ it says nothing, and the pairing is the lesson's. Here is a third pair.

Script you'll notice: the ே sign

ே is the sign for long *ē*, and it is the long partner of the ெ you met in பெயர். Like ெ, it is written to the **left** of its consonant and spoken after it.

ப + ே → பே, said *pē*.

sign	sound	where it is written
ெ	short *e*	to the left
ே	long *ē*	to the left
ை	*ai*	to the left

Three left-standing signs now. The evidence is the same as it was for ெ: the script data describes ை and has no entry for ெ or ே at all, so both the shared position **and** the short/long pairing are stated from the pattern these signs share, not from a source for either one.

Script you'll notice: build the word

piece		
பே	*pē* — ப with the ே sign on its left	ப from பெயர்
சு	*su* — ச with the ு sign	ச from சரி, ு from இருக்கிறீர்கள்

பே · சு → பேசு

Two pieces, one new sign, and its two signs pull in opposite directions on the page: ே stands before its letter, ு joins after it. பேசு is "speak" — the verb every lesson so far has been in service of.

Your turn

- *Read it:* பே — then பேசு
- *Say it:* "pēsu" — "speak"
- *Contrast:* பெ and பே — the short sign and the long one, both on the left
- *Contrast:* பே and சு — a sign before, a sign after, inside one word
- *Read it:* தமிழ் பேசு — "speak Tamil," both words off the page

Before you move on

Read பேசு. Which side of its consonant is ே written on? (**The left** — like ெ and ை.) Which sign is its short partner? (ெ, as in பெயர்.) What is the ச doing here — is it *s* or *ch*? (**Either**; one letter covers both, and position picks.) Next: the verb for helping.

34.4 உதவு (udavu) — "to help," and a word Tamil did not borrow

Kēṭkiṟēṉ — I ask. *Kēḷungaḷ* — please ask. Say both, and keep that polite ending in your ear; it is about to arrive on a second verb unchanged.

You'll want to know: உதவு

உதவு — *udavu* — **to help; to be of use**

உதவுகிறேன் (*udavugiṟēṉ*), "I help." The single softened *-giṟ-* puts **உதவு** in the **weak** camp with *pō* and *eḻudu*, and the noun is one step away: **உதவி** (*udavi*), "**help**."

நான் உங்களுக்கு உதவுகிறேன். — *nāṉ ungaḷukku udavugiṟēṉ* — "I help you."

The person helped takes the dative **-உக்கு** from Chapter 6, and the polite form needs nothing new: **உதவுங்கள்** (*udavungaḷ*), "please help" — the same respectful **-உங்கள்** you just put on *kēḷ*.

In the family, and next door

	word
Kannada	**ಸಹಾಯ ಮಾಡು** (*sahāya māḍu*)
Telugu	**సహాయం చేయు** (*sahāyaṁ cēyu*)
Malayalam	**സഹായിക്കുക** (*sahāyikkuka*)
Hindi (neighbour)	**मदद करना** (*madad karnā*)
English	to help, to be of use

The letters in this word

உ is the standing vowel *u*, used when a word begins with it; then **த** and **வு**, which is **வ** with the *u* sign. The *d* you hear is **த** between two vowels, softening exactly as **ட** did in *paḍi* and **க** does in *pōgiṟēṉ*.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

Tamil turns verbs into nouns with a small ending, and you have collected three without being told to: **புரி** → **புரிதல்** (*puridal*), understanding; **கேள்** → **கேள்வி** (*kēḷvi*), a question; **உதவு** →

உதவி (*udavi*), help.
Now the part worth keeping. For "help," the neighbours nearly all reach for Sanskrit सहाय (*sahāya*): Telugu సహాయం, Kannada ಸಹಾಯ, Malayalam സഹായം, Hindi सहायता. Tamil's everyday word is உதவி, its own.
Hold that against Chapter 8, where *please* went the other way: **all four** sisters built it on Sanskrit दया (*daya*) plus a light verb — *tayavuseytu*, *dayaviṭṭu*, *dayacēsi*, *dayavāyi*. Same four languages, opposite outcome. So the rule is not "Tamil refuses to borrow"; it is that **borrowing happens word by word**, and the only way to know is to check each one.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "nāṉ ungaḷukku udavugiṟēṉ" — I help you
- the two polite forms — "kēḷungaḷ … udavungaḷ"
- the three nouns — "puridal … kēḷvi … udavi"
- the borrowed one and the kept one — "tayavuseytu … udavi"

Before you move on

Which camp is *udavu* in, and what is *udavi*? (**Weak**, by the single softened bead; **help**, the noun.) Say "I help you," then "please help." (*Nāṉ ungaḷukku udavugiṟēṉ*; *udavungaḷ*.) Which word do the neighbours borrow from Sanskrit where Tamil keeps its own? (**Help** — *sahāya* against *udavi*.) And which word did all four sisters borrow together? (***Please*** — *daya* plus a light verb.)

34.5 பிடி (piḍi) — "to catch," and therefore "to like"

Say this chapter's three verbs — *eḍukkiṟēṉ*, *kēṭkiṟēṉ*, *udavugiṟēṉ* — then the two sentences with no *nāṉ*: *enakku teriyum*, *enakku purigiṟadu*.

You'll want to know: பிடி

பிடி — *piḍi* — **to catch, to seize, to hold**

பிடிக்கிறேன் (*piḍikkiṟēṉ*) is "I catch, I hold," and the held *kk* puts it in the **strong** camp with *ninai*, *paḍi* and *eḍu*.

In the family, and next door

	word
Kannada	**ನನಗೆ ಕನ್ನಡ ಇಷ್ಟ** (*nanage kannaḍa iṣṭa*)
Telugu	**నాకు తెలుగు ఇష్టం** (*nāku telugu iṣṭaṁ*)
Malayalam	**എനിക്ക് മലയാളം ഇഷ്ടമാണ്** (*enikkŭ malayāḷaṁ iṣṭamāṇŭ*)
Hindi (neighbour)	**मुझे … पसंद है** (*mujhe … pasand hai*)
English	to catch, to hold

Grammar Lens: எனக்குப் பிடிக்கும்

எனக்குத் தமிழ் பிடிக்கும். — *enakkut tamiḻ piḍikkum* — "I like Tamil."

Word for word: "**to me**, Tamil catches." The Tamil does the catching; you are caught. **பிடிக்கும்** carries **no person at all** — the person-less ending of **தெரியும்** — so only the dative word changes: *enakku piḍikkum*, *uṉakku piḍikkum*, *avaṉukku piḍikkum*.
That makes three: **தெரியும்**, **புரிகிறது**, **பிடிக்கும்** — knowing, understanding, liking. Three endings; each puts the experiencer in the dative and the thing in the subject. Chapter 6's **dative subject** was never an exception.

You'll want to know: விரும்பு

விரும்பு — *virumbu* — **to want, to like, to love**

An ordinary verb with an ordinary subject: **நான் விரும்புகிறேன்** (*nāṉ virumbugiṟēṉ*), "I want." Weak; its noun is **விருப்பம்** (*viruppam*), a wish. Not a synonym: **பிடிக்கும்** is taste, which you had no say in; **விரும்பு** is choice.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

The grasp-verb is native and shared (DEDR 4148): Malayalam പിടിക്കുക (*piṭikkuka*) and Telugu పట్టు (*paṭṭu*) both mean "catch, hold." Kannada's is ಹಿಡಿ (*hiḍi*) — not a different word: Old Kannada wrote *piḍi*, and the **p** → **h** shift behind *pattu / hattu* and *pāl / hālu* turned it into *hiḍi*. A third instance of a rule you know.
The wider point: Spanish says *me gusta*, Italian *mi piace*, Hindi *mujhe pasand hai* — each putting the liker in the dative and the liked thing in the subject, exactly as *enakkut tamiḻ piḍikkum* does, and none of them related to Tamil. **Two unrelated families reached the same design independently.**

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- the three dative sentences — "enakku teriyum … purigiṟadu … piḍikkum"
- the other design — "nāṉ virumbugiṟēṉ", I want
- the chapter — "eḍukkiṟēṉ, kēṭkiṟēṉ, udavugiṟēṉ, piḍikkum"
- the Kannada shift — "piḍi … hiḍi", as "pattu … hattu"

Before you move on

Say "I like Tamil" and name its subject. (*Enakkut tamiḻ piḍikkum*, "to me, Tamil catches"; the subject is **Tamil**.) Name the three verbs built that way, and what *virumbu* does differently. (***Teriyum***, ***purigiṟadu***, ***piḍikkum***; *virumbu* takes an **ordinary subject**.)
Why is Kannada's *hiḍi* the same word as *piḍi*, and which unrelated language builds "I like" this way? (**The p → h shift**; **Spanish** *me gusta*.)

Chapter 35

Arriving at a House

Modes: 👁 **eyes** (4) ✓ **pen** (1) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** the first of 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can name a Tamil house, its door, a room and a chair, take நாற்காலி apart into 'four' and 'leg', place வீடு against Kannada ಬೀಡು on the v-to-b shift, and say why கதவு stayed everyday while Sanskrit-derived கபாடம் stayed in books.
>
> *Walk a guest from* வீடு *through* கதவு *into* அறை *and offer a* நாற்காலி*; split the chair into* நால் *and* கால் *and hear* ல் *harden to* ற் *at the join; hold the hard* ற *at the ridge rather than the roof; and name what the pu̱lli does at* ற்கா *and what Tamil refuses to do there.*

35.1 வீடு (vīḍu) — "house," and the place the greeting happens

> Three verbs from the chapter you have just finished: *pidi*, "to like"; *uḍavu*, "to help"; *kēḷ*, "to ask." Say them. Now a noun, and the one a conversation usually starts inside.

You'll want to know: வீடு

> **வீடு** — *vīḍu* — **house; home**

One word covers both. Tamil does not split the building from the belonging: **என் வீடு** (*en̲ vīḍu*) is "my house" and "my home" at once, and choosing between them is the translator's problem.

With the dative you already own:

வீட்டுக்கு — *vīṭṭukku* — **to the house**

The soft *ḍ* hardens and doubles to *ṭṭ* — the **படி** / **படித்தேன்** rule.

In the family, and next door

	word	**same root**
Kannada	**ಮನೆ** (*mane*)	
Malayalam	**വീട്** (*vīṭŭ*)	yes
Hindi (neighbour)	**घर** (*ghar*)	
English	house, home	

The letters in this word

வீ is **வ**, the first letter you learned, wearing the long *ī* sign ீ. Then **டு**: **ட** with the *u* sign.

You are at a door about to say **வணக்கம்**, so read that word while you are here: **வ** + **ண** + **க்** + **க** + **ம்**. The **வ** that opens *vaṇakkam* is the **வ** that opens *vīḍu*.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

வீடு is inherited, not borrowed:

the cousin	**language and sense**
വീട് *vīḍ*	Malayalam, "house"
వీడు *vīḍu*	Telugu, "town, camp"
ಬೀಡು *bīḍu*	Kannada, "abode, encampment"

Kannada has changed the front of the word: Tamil says **v**, Kannada says **b**. Not a slip — Kannada alone among its neighbours turned inherited word-initial *v-* into *b-*, and the inscriptions show it from about the seventh century. Store the correspondence — it keeps paying.

The **sense** has drifted where the form has not: Telugu's *vīḍu* is a town, Kannada's *bīḍu* an encampment. Tamil and Malayalam kept it on the dwelling.

One more thing, not a coincidence to explain away. Tamil has a second **வீடு** meaning "**release, deliverance**," as in **வீடுபேறு**. The Dravidian dictionary files house and release under **one entry**, headed by **விடு** (*viḍu*), "to let go." A house is where you are let go.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "vīḍu" — house and home in one word
- "en̲ vīḍu," then the hardening — "vīṭṭukku"
- the cousins, ending on the front-swap — "vīḍ … vīḍu … bīḍu"
- the root under the house — "viḍu, to let go"

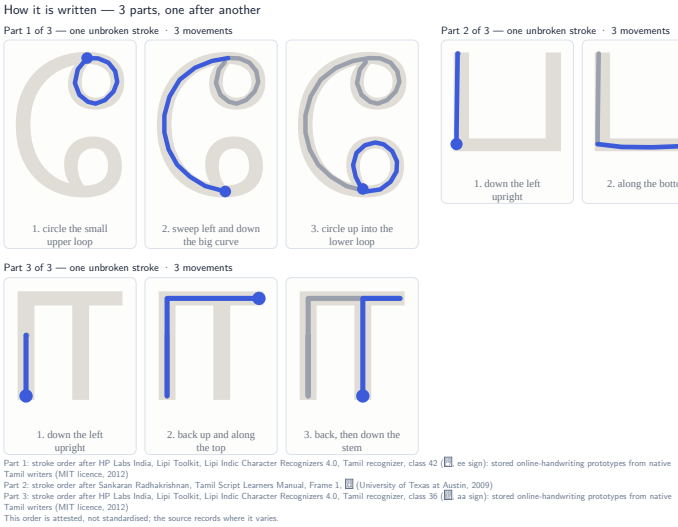
Before you move on

Why does one Tamil word do two English jobs here, and which letter opens both *vīḍu* and *vaṇakkam*? (**House** and **home** are not split; and வ.) What does Kannada put at the front instead of *v*, and is it a one-off? (**b** — *bīḍu*; **regular**, from the seventh century on.) Is the Tamil word for "release" the same root as the house? (**Yes** — both under விடு, "to let go.")

35.2 ᮔᮥᮀ — one sign, two marks

Every vowel sign so far has been one mark in one place: before the consonant, above it, or after it. This one is in two places at once, and you already own both halves.

Script you'll notice: the ஓ sign



How ஓ is written, part by part, stroke by stroke

ஓ is the sign for long *ō*, and it **wraps** its consonant: a hook on the left, a stroke on the right, one vowel.

Those two halves are not a guess. The Unicode Character Database gives ஓ a canonical decomposition, and it is exactly the two signs you have:

> ஓ = ஒ (the long-*ē* hook, written left) + ா (the long-*ā* stroke, written right)

So this is not one more mark to memorise. It is the sign you learned last lesson and the sign you learned in நான், put around the same letter — read the letter in the middle, and say the vowel once.

> Be exact about what that citation settles. A canonical decomposition says the character is **composed of** those two, for text processing; it says nothing about how either half is drawn or where it lands. `tamil.json` has no entry for ஓ at all. So take the composition from Unicode and the placement — hook left, stroke right — from the page in front of you.

Script you'll notice: build the word

piece		
ப	*pa*	from பெயர்
ோ	long *ō*, wrapped around it	this lesson

ப + ோ → போ

One letter and one wrapped sign, and the whole word is two marks on the page. போ is "go" — the போ inside *pōy varugiṟēṉ*, "I'll go and come back," the farewell chapter 1 closes on and chapter 4 takes apart.

Your turn

- *Read it:* பே — then போ — the hook alone, then the hook with the stroke
- *Say it:* "pō" — "go"
- *Contrast:* பே · பா · போ — left only, right only, both at once
- *Read it:* பேசு again, and notice its ே is the same hook

Before you move on

Read போ. Which two signs is ோ made of, and where does each one sit? (ே on the **left**, ா on the **right**.) How many vowels do you say when you read it? (**One** — the two marks are one sign.) Which of its halves did you meet in நான்? (ா.) Next: the word for a door.

35.3 கதவு (kadavu) — "door," and a word Tamil never gave up

Vīḍu — house. Say the cousin that swaps the front letter. (*Bīḍu*, Kannada.) Now the part of the house you actually stand at.

You'll want to know: கதவு

கதவு — *kadavu* — **door**

The leaf that swings, and the thing somebody opens when you arrive.

வீட்டுக் கதவு — *vīṭṭuk kadavu* — **the house door**

Two nouns in a row, the first leaning on the second. Tamil builds a great deal this way, and you have seen it inside a single word: **தண்ணீர்** is *taṇ* plus *nīr*, "cool" plus "water."

In the family, and next door

	word
Kannada	**ಬಾಗಿಲು** (*bāgilu*)
Telugu	**తలుపు** (*talupu*)
Malayalam	**വാതിൽ** (*vātil*)
Hindi (neighbour)	**दरवाज़ा** (*darvāzā*)
English	door

The letters in this word

க + **த** + **வு**. The first letter is the one that taught you Tamil marks no voicing: **க** spells a hard *k*, a soft *g* and even an *h*, and **position decides**. Here it opens the word, so it is hard — *ka*, not *ga*.

The same rule then lands on the second letter. **த** is named *ta*, but it sits between two vowels, so it softens. That is why this book writes *ka**d**avu* and not *katavu*. One rule, two letters, one word.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

கதவு is inherited Dravidian. Kannada's **ಕದ** (*kada*) is the same word with less on the end; Malayalam's **കതവ്** (*katavu*) matches Tamil closely.

Tamil also owns a second word for a door-leaf: **கபாடம்** (*kabāḍam*), taken from Sanskrit **कपाट** (*kapāṭa*). It exists, it is correct, and almost nobody says it. It lives in poetry and temple description; **கதவு** lives in the house.

That split is this language's habit. Where a neighbour borrowed a Sanskrit word and let the inherited one fade, Tamil often kept both and gave them different jobs — the inherited word for the everyday thing, the borrowed one for the elevated register. Do not turn that into

a rule that Tamil never borrows. It borrows; it rarely evicts.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "kadavu" — door
- "vīṭṭuk kadavu" — the house door
- the hard one and the soft one in one word — "ka … da"
- the everyday word, then the bookish one — "kadavu … kabāḍam"

Before you move on

Say "the house door," then explain why the க is hard and the த soft when neither changed shape. (*Vīṭṭuk kadavu*; **Tamil marks no voicing** — position decides.) Which of *kadavu* and *kabāḍam* would you hear at somebody's house, and where did the other come from? (***Kadavu***; *kabāḍam* is **Sanskrit**, and stays literary.) Does keeping both mean Tamil refuses to borrow? (**No** — it borrows without evicting.)

35.4 அறை (aṟai) — "room," and Tamil's second r

Vīḍu, house. *Kadavu*, door — the everyday word Tamil kept while the Sanskrit one stayed in books. Open that door and you are in this word.

You'll want to know: அறை

அறை — *aṟai* — **room**

Any room: in a house, in a hotel, a cell. Put it behind *vīḍu* the way you put *kadavu* there:

வீட்டு அறை — *vīṭṭu aṟai* — **a room of the house**

And with the dative, அறைக்கு (*aṟaikku*), “to the room.”

In the family, and next door

	word
Malayalam	മുറി (*muṟi*)
Hindi (neighbour)	कमरा (*kamrā*)
English	room

The letters in this word

அ is the standing vowel *a* — a letter in its own right, not a sign hung on a consonant. Then ற, then the *ai* sign ை, which wraps around the front of its consonant: ற + ை → றை.

ற is the hard *r* you first met inside நன்றி. It is not ர. Tamil keeps two r-letters and uses both.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

அறை is inherited. Malayalam’s അറ (*aṟa*) is the same word, used for a chamber or an inner store-room, and it keeps the same hard r. So this is *kadavu*’s situation over: an everyday inherited word with a Sanskrit-derived alternative sitting unused in the higher register.

The letters in this word

Say the English word *hurry* and stop on the middle sound. That flick of the tongue against the ridge behind your teeth is close to Tamil ர (*ra*). Now make it stronger and longer, with real contact: that is ற (*ṟa*). Two cautions. **Do not curl your tongue back** — retroflex belongs to ண and ட; ற is made at the ridge. And **do not soften it into the English r of *red***, which is the wrong shape for both Tamil letters. Many Tamil speakers merge ர and ற in casual speech, so you will be understood either way. Learn the difference anyway: the **spelling** depends on it, and a word written with the wrong r is simply misspelled.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- “aṟai” — room, on the hard r

- the two r's apart — "ra … r̲a"
- "vīṭṭu ar̲ai" — a room of the house
- the three so far — "vīḍu, kadavu, ar̲ai"

Before you move on

Say "a room of the house," and name which of Tamil's two r-letters is in *ar̲ai* and where else you have read it. (*Vīṭṭu ar̲ai*; ற, the hard one, in நன்றி.) Where is ற made, and what must your tongue not do? (At the **ridge** behind the teeth — **do not curl it back**.) If many speakers merge the two r's, why bother? (Because the **spelling** does not merge.)

35.5 நாற்காலி (nār̲kāli) — "chair," counted out in legs

Three words in the order you meet them arriving: *vīḍu*, *kadavu*, *ar̲ai*. Hold the hard r in *ar̲ai* at the ridge, not the roof. Now the one thing in that room a guest is always pointed at.

You'll want to know: நாற்காலி

நாற்காலி — *nār̲kāli* — **chair**

Five syllables for a chair, which sounds extravagant until you find out what it is made of.

நான் நாற்காலி எடுக்கிறேன். — *nān̲ nār̲kāli eḍukkir̲ēn̲* — **I take a chair.**

In the family, and next door

	word
Kannada	ಕುರ್ಚಿ (*kurci*)
Telugu	కుర్చీ (*kurcī*)
Malayalam	കസേര (*kasēra*)
Hindi (neighbour)	कुर्सी (*kursī*)
English	chair

The letters in this word

நா + ற் + கா + லி. Every piece is one you have handled.

ந is the dental *n*, first of Tamil's three n-letters, wearing the long *ā* sign ா. ற் is the hard r of *aṟai* under a **puḷḷi**, the dot that switches off the built-in vowel. கா is க with that same long *ā*. லி is ல with the *i* sign ி, the first vowel sign you learned, on the way to spelling நன்றி.

Now what does **not** happen at ற்கா. Two consonants meet, and Tamil keeps them as two letters with a dot between, rather than fusing them into a stacked shape as the scripts to the north do. That refusal is why a word this long stays readable one piece at a time.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

The word is a compound, and both halves are yours:

the piece	what it is
நால் *nāl*	"four" — the form four takes in compounds
கால் *kāl*	"leg, foot; a support"

Four plus **leg**: a chair is a four-legged thing, said out loud. English cannot do that with *chair*, which travels through French and Latin to a Greek word for "seat" without ever showing a leg.

The seam is audible. நான்கு (*nāṉku*) is the counting word; in a compound four appears as நால், and before க that ல் hardens to ற். Hence நாற்காலி, and hence நாற்பது (*nāṟpadu*), "forty." Malayalam builds the chair from the same two pieces: നാൽക്കാലി.

Both halves are inherited Dravidian. Nothing in this chapter was borrowed.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- the seam — "nāṉku … nāl … kāl … nāṟkāli"
- "nāṉ nāṟkāli eḍukkiṟēṉ" — I take a chair
- the arrival, in order — "vīḍu, kadavu, aṟai, nāṟkāli"
- the Kannada front-swap on the first of them — "vīḍu … bīḍu"

Before you move on

Take *nāṟkāli* apart, then walk somebody into your house four nouns deep. (நால், "four," plus கால், "leg"; *vīḍu, kadavu, aṟai, nāṟkāli.*) What does the dot in ற் do, and what does Tamil refuse to do at that join? (**Switches off the built-in vowel**; Tamil **does not stack** the two consonants.) Which of this chapter's words was borrowed? (**None.**)

Chapter 36

What You Are Offered

Modes: 👁 **eyes** (4) ✓ **pen** (1) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** the first 3 of 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can ask for தேநீர், பால் or உணவு in Tamil, say என் தவறு with no verb in it, find நீர் inside both தண்ணீர் and தேநீர், and state which of this chapter's words was borrowed and which the dictionaries cannot account for.
>
> *Repair a wrong order —* மன்னிக்கவும், என் தவறு *— and account for the chapter honestly:* பால் *and* உண் *inherited,* தேநீர் *half a loan through a Malay port,* சாப்பிடு *with no entry in the Dravidian dictionary at all, and* மன்னி *native where the neighbours took Sanskrit kṣamā.*

36.1 தேநீர் (tēnīr) — "tea," half of it already yours

Nāṟkāli, and what its halves mean. (Four, and leg.) You are in the *aṟai* with the chair, and the next thing in a Tamil house is this.

You'll want to know: தேநீர்

தேநீர் — *tēnīr* — **tea**

The second half is yours from the water lesson: நீர் (*nīr*), "water," the plain older word inside தண்ணீர் (*taṇṇīr*) — *taṇ*, "cool," plus *nīr*. So தேநீர் is, literally, **tea water**.

தேநீர், தயவுசெய்து. — *tēnīr, tayavuseytu* — **Tea, please.**

In speech you will also hear plain டீ (*ṭī*), straight from English *tea*. தேநீர் is the fuller word — a sign, a menu, a formal host.

In the family, and next door

	word
Kannada	ಚಹಾ (*cahā*)
Telugu	దయచేసి టీ (*dayacēsi ṭī*)
Malayalam	ചായ (*cāya*)
Hindi (neighbour)	एक चाय दीजिए (*ek chāy dījie*)
English	tea

The letters in this word

தே is த with the *ē* sign ே, which stands in front of its consonant. நீ is ந with the long *ī* sign; ர் is ர shut by a puḷḷi — the soft r, not the hard ற.

Two words beside it are worth reading. நன்றி is ந + ன் + றி, what you say when the tea arrives. In தயவுசெய்து, செய் is *ce* plus ய் shut by that same dot before து.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

நீர் is inherited and very old. தே is not Tamil at all: it is the combining form of தேய் (*tēy*), borrowed from Malay **teh**, which took it from the Hokkien of the southern Chinese coast, where the leaf is *tê*. The world's words for tea come in two shapes, decided by **how the tea reached each language**. The southern Chinese coast carried *te*: Dutch *thee*, and through Dutch, English *tea* and French *thé* — and by the Malay ports, Tamil's தே. The overland routes carried *cha*: Persian and Hindi *chāy*, Russian *chay*. Portuguese says **chá** despite being a sea power, because its traders worked out of Macau. Where the ship docked decided the word.

Tamil then did what the European *te*-languages did not: rather than take the loan whole, it welded it to நீர் — a word that has travelled outward as well, since English **mulligatawny** is Tamil மிளகுத்தண்ணீர், "pepper water."

Weigh that against the rice word. அரிசி *may* stand behind English *rice* through Greek, and the dictionaries hedge. The tea routes are documented. **Different histories, different confidence.**

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- the shared half — "nīr … taṇṇīr … tēnīr"
- "tēnīr, tayavuseytu" — tea, please
- the two routes — "te … cha"
- the pepper water in an English soup — "miḷagut taṇṇīr"

Before you move on

Name the second half of *tēnīr* and the word that shares it, then ask for tea politely. (**நீர்**, inside **தண்ணீர்**; *tēnīr, tayavuseytu*.) Why do some languages say *te* and others *cha*, and which is better established — the tea split or *arisi*-to-*rice*? (**The route the tea travelled**; and **the tea split**.)

36.2 பால் (pāl) — "milk," and a p that becomes an h next door

Tēnīr. Which half is borrowed, and which is the old Tamil word for water? (*Tē* is the traveller; *nīr* is Tamil's own.) Here is what goes into it.

You'll want to know: பால்

பால் — *pāl* — **milk**

One syllable, one long *ā*, a final **ல்** with no vowel after it. Say it short and closed: *pāl*, never *pāla*.

பால் தேநீர் — *pāl tēnīr* — **milk tea**

With **தண்ணீர்** (*taṇṇīr*, cool water) already in hand, you can now name what a Tamil household is likely to put in front of a guest.

In the family, and next door

	word	**same root**
Kannada	ಹಾಲು (*hālu*)	yes
Telugu	పాలు (*pālu*)	yes
Malayalam	പാൽ (*pāl*)	yes
Hindi (neighbour)	दूध (*dūdh*)	
English	milk	

The letters in this word

பா is ப with the long *ā* sign ◌ா. Then ல்: ல with the **puḷḷi**, the dot that removes the built-in *a* and leaves a bare consonant.

That dot is the whole reason the word ends where it does. Without it, பால would be *pāla*, two syllables. A single dot carries the difference between a word and a non-word.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

பால் is inherited Dravidian, and its relatives are close:

the cousin	**language**
പാൽ *pāl*	Malayalam
పాలు *pālu*	Telugu
ಹಾಲು *hālu*	Kannada, modern

Kannada has changed the front of the word once more, this time **p** into **h** — the textbook example of the best-known sound change in the family. **Old Kannada said *pālu***, exactly as Tamil does; the *p-* began turning into *h-* around the tenth century and the change had run through the whole vocabulary by the fourteenth.

Put it beside the change you met at the house. Tamil **v**, Kannada **b**, in *vīḍu / bīḍu*. Tamil **p**, Kannada **h**, in *pāl / hālu*. Both are regular correspondences at the front of a word, and between them they let you recognise a Kannada word as a relative rather than a stranger. Telugu and Malayalam did neither: they keep the *p*, as Tamil does.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- “pāl” — stopped by the dot, not *pāla*
- “pāl tēnīr” — milk tea

- the two front-swaps together — "vīḍu, bīḍu … pāl, hālu"
- what you can be offered — "taṇṇīr, tēnīr, pāl"

Before you move on

Say "milk tea," then say what the dot on ல் is doing and what the word would be without it. (*Pāl tēnīr*; it **removes the built-in vowel**, and without it, *pāla.*) What does Kannada put at the front instead of *p*, and is it a one-off? (**h** — *hālu*; **regular**, from the tenth century to the fourteenth.) Name the other Kannada front-swap. (**v** to **b** — *vīḍu*, *bīḍu.*)

36.3 உணவு (uṇavu) — "food," from the verb underneath it

Pāl — milk — and the Kannada shape of it. (*Hālu.*) Drink is settled. Now the word for everything else on the plate.

You'll want to know: உணவு

உணவு — *uṇavu* — **food**

The general word: food as a category, not a dish. It covers the rice words you have — அரிசி (*arisi*), the raw grain, and சாதம் (*sātam*), the cooked meal — and all that is served beside them.

உணவு, தயவுசெய்து. — *uṇavu, tayavuseytu* — **Food, please.**

Note the register. உணவு is the careful, written word — a menu, a sign. Around a family table people say சாப்பாடு (*sāppāḍu*).

In the family, and next door

	word
Malayalam	ഭക്ഷണം (*bhakṣaṇam*)
English	food

The letters in this word

உ is a standing vowel — a full letter, not a sign. Then ண, then வு, which is வ with the *u* sign underneath. ண is the retroflex n you first wrote alongside ம, and the letter inside தண்ணீர்.

The letters in this word

Curl the tip of your tongue **back** to the roof of your mouth and release into the vowel. That is ண, and *uṇavu* gives it a clean run because the letter sits between two vowels. Contrast the ன of நன்றி and the ந of நீர், both made near the teeth.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

உணவு is உண் (*uṇ*), "to eat," with a noun-forming ending. Food is literally *the eating*. Tamil has two eating verbs, of different ages:

the verb	**where it lives**
உண் *uṇ*	old, inherited, literary now
சாப்பிடு *sāppiḍu*	the everyday spoken verb

உண் is a bare inherited root, and the Dravidian dictionary lists *uṇavu* inside its entry.

சாப்பிடு is where the ground softens, so hold Chapter 32's earlier account loosely. You were shown *sāppu*, "food," plus இடு (*iḍu*), "to put." The இடு is visible in the spelling; the first half is the problem. The great Tamil lexicon records no plain word *sāppu* meaning "food," and the Dravidian etymological dictionary has **no entry for this verb at all**. It is not Sanskrit — Telugu and Malayalam have their own forms — but its origin is open. The word you would use at a table has the weaker paperwork.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- the root and the noun — "uṇ … uṇavu"
- the retroflex, tongue curled back — "uṇavu"
- the documented one, then the everyday one — "uṇ … sāppiḍu"
- raw grain, then cooked meal — "arisi … sātam"

Before you move on

What verb is *uṇavu* built on, and where does your tongue go for ண? (உண்; **curled back**.) Which eating verb would you use at a table, and how sure is anyone where it came from? (சாப்பிடு — **not at all**: the Dravidian dictionary has no entry.) Give the raw grain and the cooked meal. (*Arisi*; *sātam*.)

36.4 உணவு — the same vowel, twice, two ways

You have the ◌ு sign — the *u* that hangs off a consonant, as in ரு. But a word that *starts* on *u* has no consonant to hang it from, and by now you know what Tamil does about that.

Script you'll notice: உ

உ is the standing letter for short *u*. It is the rule you met with ஆ in ஆம், working again: a vowel that opens a word is written as a **full letter**, never as a sign.

உ	the letter — opens a word
◌ு	the sign — rides a consonant

The word you already say holds both. That is the whole lesson.

Read it; do not draw it yet. உ has no entry in this book's script data, so it gets no stroke order here.

Script you'll notice: build the word

piece		
உ	*u*	independent — the word opens on a vowel
ண	*ṇa*, the retroflex *n*	first met beside ம
வு	*vu* — வ with the ◌ு sign	வ was your first letter

உ · ண · வு → உணவு

Three pieces, and the first and last are the same vowel doing its two jobs: once standing on its own, once hanging off வ. The page keeps them apart so your eye can.

Your turn

- *Read it:* உ — then உணவு
- *Say it:* "uṇavu" — "food"
- *Contrast:* உ and வு — the letter that opens, the sign that rides
- *Contrast:* ஆம் and உணவு — the same opening rule, two vowels apart

Before you move on

Read உணவு. Why does it open with உ rather than the ◌ sign? (**The word starts on a vowel** — there is nothing for a sign to hang on.) Where else in the same word does that vowel appear, and in which form? (**On** வு, as the ◌ sign.) Which earlier word set this rule? (ஆம்.) Next: the word for a mistake.

36.5 தவறு (tava̲ru) — "a mistake," and the rest of the apology

The chapter back: *tēnīr*, *pāl*, *uṇavu*. Suppose one arrives and it is not what you asked for. You have "sorry," but not the word for what went wrong.

You'll want to know: தவறு

தவறு — *tava̲ru* — **a mistake, an error, a fault**

With என் (*e̲n*), "my," and no verb — Tamil needs none:

மன்னிக்கவும், என் தவறு. பால் இல்லை, தேநீர்.

ma̲n̲nikkavum, e̲n tava̲ru. pāl illai, tēnīr.

Sorry, my mistake. Not milk — tea.

மன்னிக்கவும் is the careful, written-leaning apology; in speech many Tamil speakers simply say *sorry*, in English. என் தவறு suits either.

In the family, and next door

	word
Telugu	తప్పు (*tappu*)
English	a mistake

The letters in this word

த + வ + று. The last piece is ற, the hard r of *a*r̲*ai*, with the *u* sign — made at the ridge behind the teeth, tongue flat, not curled.

The apology in front of it does something this word does not. மன்னிக்கவும் has ன்னி: the alveolar ன switched off by a dot, then written a second time with the *i* sign. Tamil doubles a consonant by **repeating the letter with a dot on the first**, never by inventing a joined shape — the க்க of வணக்கம் over.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

தவறு is inherited Dravidian, a verb and a noun in one shape: "to slip, to fail," and "a slip, a mistake." The dictionary files it beside தப்பு (*tappu*); its cousins are everywhere.

Now the chapter in a line. மன்னிக்கவும் was the showpiece: Tamil kept its own மன்னி where Kannada, Telugu and Malayalam reached for Sanskrit **kṣamā**. தவறு is inherited too, and so is உண் inside *uṇavu*, and பால். But தேநீர் is half a loan from a Malay port, and சாதம் was flagged as Sanskrit-influenced when you met it.

So the honest statement is not "Tamil does not borrow." It is that **Tamil borrows without evicting**: the inherited word stays, and the loan takes a different job or register.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "e*n*̲ tava*r*̲*u*" — my mistake, with no verb in it
- the whole repair — "ma*nn*̲*i*kkavum, e*n*̲ tava*r*̲*u*"
- the two words for a mistake — "tava*r*̲*u* … tappu"

- the borrowed one among this chapter's words — "tēnīr"

Before you move on

Apologise, name the fault, and say why there is no word for "is" in it. (*Maṉṉikkavum, eṉ tavaṟu*; **Tamil needs none**.) How does Tamil write a doubled consonant, as in **ன்னி** and **க்க**? (**The letter a second time**, dot on the first.) Which apology verb is native where the neighbours took Sanskrit, and does that make Tamil a language that never borrows? (**மன்னி**, against **kṣamā**; **no** — it **borrows without evicting**.)

Chapter 37

Your Town, Your Friend

Modes: 👁 **eyes** (5) ✓ **pen** (1) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** the first 2 of 6 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can ask உங்கள் ஊர் என்ன? and introduce someone with இவர் என் நண்பர், choose between நண்பன், நண்பி and நண்பர், run Tamil's இ / அ / எ pointing series, and hear ண் voice the ப that follows it.
>
> *Say* இவர் என் நண்பர் *with no verb in it, pick the ending by respect rather than by habit, name the -ūr inside Tanjore and Bengaḷūru, and state what Tamil forces you to decide for a sibling that it does not force for a friend.*

37.1 ஊர் (ūr) — "town," and the question Tamil asks early

> *En̲ tavaṟu* — my mistake, a word that is a verb and a noun at once. Then the general word for food. (*Uṇavu.*) Now back to meeting somebody.

You'll want to know: ஊர்

> **ஊர்** — *ūr* — **town, village; the place you are from**

That last sense matters most. **உங்கள் ஊர்** is your **native place**, where your family is from, which may be somewhere you have never lived.

> **உங்கள் ஊர் என்ன** — *uṅgaḷ ūr en̲n̲a* — **What is your town**

It lands early in a Tamil conversation and is not nosiness — the slot English fills with "what do you do.

In the family, and next door

	word	same root
Kannada	ಊರು (*ūru*)	yes
Telugu	పట్టణం (*paṭṭaṇaṁ*)	
Malayalam	ഊര് (*ūrŭ*)	yes
English	town, village	

The letters in this word

�set is a standing vowel — long *ū*, partner of the உ that opens *uṇavu*. ர் is ர, the soft r, shut by a puḷḷi. Hold the vowel: *ūr*, not *ur*. Vowel length is part of a word's identity here.

Grammar Lens: the two registers, side by side

You met this choice on the age question:

the question	who you say it to
உன் ஊர் என்ன *uṉ ūr eṉṉa*	a friend, a child, a peer
உங்கள் ஊர் என்ன *uṅgaḷ ūr eṉṉa*	a stranger, an elder, anyone senior

Both are possessive plus noun plus question word, with **no verb** — the shape you learned for உன் வயசு என்ன. Only the possessive changes, and with it the social temperature. When unsure, use உங்கள்.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

ஊர் is inherited Dravidian, and welded into city names you know in English:

the English name	what it is
Tanjore	Tamil தஞ்சாவூர் *Tañjāvūr*
Vellore	Tamil வேலூர் *Vēlūr*
Bangalore	Kannada ಬೆಂಗಳೂರು *Bengaḷūru*

Every one of those *-ore* endings is this word: the British ear turned *-ūr* into *-ore*, and the cities have taken their own names back.

Two exactnesses. Bangalore is a **Kannada** town, so its *-ūru* is Kannada's form of the inherited word — the family's, not Tamil's alone. And the *first* halves are not all settled; *Vēl-* in Vellore is argued over. The ending is the certain part.
Weigh that against the rice word. அரிசி *may* stand behind English *rice* through Greek, and the dictionaries hedge. Nobody hedges about *-ūr*.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- the long vowel — "ūr," not "ur"
- to a stranger — "uṅgaḷ ūr eṉṉa"
- to a friend — "uṉ ūr eṉṉa"
- the ending inside the map — "Tañjāvūr … Vēlūr … Bengaḷūru"

Before you move on

Ask a stranger where they are from, then a friend, and say what ஊர் means beyond "town." (*Uṅgaḷ ūr eṉṉa*; *uṉ ūr eṉṉa*; **your native place**.) Which earlier question has this shape, and is *-ore* in Tanjore really this word? (உன் வயசு என்ன; **yes**.) How sure are we there, next to *arisi* and *rice*? (**Much surer.**)

37.2 நண்பன் (naṇbaṉ) — "friend," with the ending doing the work

A stranger's native place, then the ending inside Tanjore. (*Uṅgaḷ ūr eṉṉa*; *-ūr*.) Now the person you would introduce.

You'll want to know: நண்பன்

நண்பன் — *naṇbaṉ* — **friend** (a man)

Tamil will not let you say a bare "friend" any more than a bare "brother." The stem is நண்ப-; the ending decides.

the form	who it is
நண்பன் *naṇbaṉ*	a male friend
நண்பி *naṇbi*	a female friend
நண்பர் *naṇbar*	a friend spoken of with respect

The **-அர்** is the respectful plural that turns நீ into நீங்கள், applied to a person.

This is a different axis from the family words. அண்ணன் and தம்பி split brothers by **age**; the friend words split by **sex**, நண்பர் by **respect**.

In the family, and next door

	word
Kannada	ಸ್ನೇಹಿತ (*snēhita*)
Telugu	స్నేహితుడు (*snēhituḍu*)
Malayalam	സുഹൃത്ത് (*suhṛttŭ*)
Hindi (neighbour)	दोस्त (*dost*)
English	friend

The letters in this word

ந + ண்ண + ப + ன் — every one of Tamil's n-letters inside one word. ந opens it, dental, at the teeth. ண்ண is retroflex, tongue curled back, closed by a puḷḷi. ன் ends it, the alveolar n from நன்றி. The writing lesson gave them to you one at a time; here they arrive together.

The letters in this word

The letter after ண்ண is ப, named *pa*. This book writes *naṇ**b**aṉ* because of the நன்றி rule: a nasal in front of a stop **voices it**. A Tamil reader supplies the voicing, as an English reader supplies the *sh* in *sugar*.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

Behind நண்பன் is நண்பு (*naṇbu*), "friendship, closeness," which belongs to the root family of நண்ணு (*naṇṇu*), "**to draw near**." A friend, in Tamil's own accounting, is someone who came close.

Be precise. DEDR 3588 files *naṇbu* and *naṇbaṉ* in the same entry as *naṇṇu*; the Tamil lexicon prefers **நள்-**, making them siblings rather than parent and child. They differ on the line of descent, not on the household.

Set it beside அப்பா and அம்மா, not built out of anything — the repeated-syllable shape children produce for parents worldwide. நண்பன் is assembled, from a root you can point at.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- the three endings — "naṇban̲, naṇbi, naṇbar"
- the voicing after the nasal — "nan̲̲ri … naṇban̲"
- the root it came from — "naṇṇu, to draw near"
- the family words that split on age instead — "aṇṇan̲, tambi"

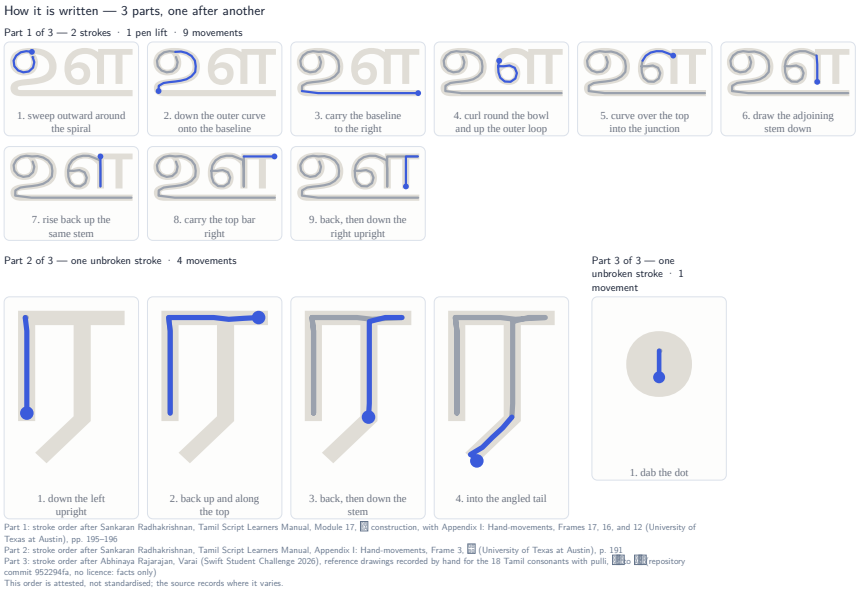
Before you move on

Give the friend-word for a woman, a man, and someone you respect. (*Naṇbi*; *naṇban̲*; *naṇbar*.) Which axis do the friend words split on, and which do the brother words? (**Sex and respect**; **age**.) Why is ப heard as *b*, and are அப்பா and அம்மா built from a root the way *naṇban̲* is? (**A nasal voices the stop after it**; **no**.)

37.3 ஊர் — the long partner

ஊ opened உணவு last chapter. Tamil writes its long vowels as separate letters from the short ones, so *ū* gets a letter of its own.

Script you'll notice: உள



How உளர் *is written, part by part, stroke by stroke*

உள is the standing letter for long *ū*, and it is the long partner of உ — the fourth short-and-long pair the strand has handed you, after அ/ஆ, ி/ீ and ெ/ே.

உ	short *u*
உள	long *ū*

Read it. The strip writes உள, ர and the puḷḷi in turn, numbered movement by movement. Its source for உள builds the letter as the page suggests: உ first, then the ள form written over it.

Script you'll notice: build the word

piece		
உள	*ū*	independent — the word opens on a vowel
ர்	bare *r* — ர under a puḷḷi	ர from சரி

உள · ர் → **உளர்**

Two pieces, and both were waiting for you. **உளர்** is the word for your own town, and holding it against **உணவு** shows the length doing real work: change the vowel and you change the word.

Your turn

- *Read it:* **உள** — then **உளர்**
- *Say it:* "ūr" — "town"
- *Contrast:* **உ** and **உள** — short and long, two letters
- *Read it:* **உணவு** and **உளர்** together — the pair, side by side

Before you move on

Read **உளர்**. Which letter is **உள**'s short partner, and where did you read it? (**உ**, opening **உணவு**.) Why is the vowel a full letter here rather than a sign? (**The word starts on it**.) What is the dot on **ர்** doing? (**Removing the built-in *a***.) Next: pointing someone out politely.

37.4 இவர் (ivar) — "this person," and Tamil's pointing system

Naṇbaṉ, *naṇbi*, *naṇbar* — and the root behind them. (*Naṇṇu*, to draw near.) You have the word for a friend, but cannot point at one.

You'll want to know: இவர்

இவர் — *ivar* — **this person** (near me, spoken of respectfully)

Not "he" and not "she": **இவர்** is what you say about a person standing here whom you are treating with respect, and it does not commit you to their sex. It is built on **இவன்** (*ivaṉ*) and **இவள்** (*ivaḷ*), with the same **-அர்** that gave you **நண்பர்**.

One caution about speech: **இவர்** is heard mostly of men, and **இவங்க** (*ivaṅga*) does the same respectful job for a woman.

The letters in this word

இ + வ + ர். இ is the standing vowel *i* — the letter, not the ி sign that hangs on a consonant. வ is the *va* opening வணக்கம் and வீடு. ர் is the soft r with a pulḷi.

A word this short is almost all arc. Recall the usual explanation for that roundness: Tamil was scratched into palm leaf, and a straight stroke along the grain can split the leaf. Hold it as the writing lesson asked — **the standard account, not a settled fact**, since the earliest Tamil writing was cut into stone and is angular. What survives is the useful part: **the tool leaves fingerprints on the letters**.

Grammar Lens: near, far, and which

இவர் is one cell of a system inherited from Dravidian (DEDR 410), and the system is a single letter at the front:

the front letter	what it does
இ-	points **near** — this one, here
அ-	points **away** — that one, there
எ-	**asks** — which one

So இவர் is "this person"; the other two fronts give "that" and "which person." You have been using one front already: என்ன (*enna*), "what," is the எ- of asking.

Two honest notes. எ- is the **question**, not a third distance. And Old Tamil had a genuine third distance, உ-, for something visible but far off; modern Tamil has retired it.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- the three fronts — "i- … a- … e-"
- the row they build — "ivar, avar, evar"
- the question word you already had — "enna"
- the respectful ending on both — "naṉbar … ivar"

Before you move on

What do இ-, அ- and எ- do at the front of a word, and which question word you already knew is built on எ-? (**Near**; **away**; **asks** — and என்ன.) Does இவர் tell you whether the person is a man or a woman? (**No** — it marks **respect**; spoken Tamil leans இவங்க for a woman.) How firmly should you hold the palm-leaf explanation for the curves? (As **the standard account, not a settled fact**.)

37.5 அவர் (avar) — the far half of a table you already have

Two words from a few chapters back. *Ninai* does which two English jobs? (**Think** and **remember** — *ninaivu* is memory.) And is *eḻudu*, to write, filed under *eḻu*, to rise? (**No** — the dictionary keeps them as two separate entries.)

Say the word for *this person*, the respectful one.

Now say which front letter points **near** and which points **away**. You were given both. **The lesson before this one filled in only the near half.**

You'll want to know: அவர்

அவர் — *avar* — **that person** (away from you, spoken of respectfully)

One letter is the whole change. இவர் becomes அவர், and *this person here* becomes *that person there* — or, far more often, plain **he** or **she** about somebody who is not in the room.

Like இவர், it does not commit you to their sex, and like இவர் it carries respect. The caution is the same one the earlier lesson gave: அவர் is heard mostly of men, and அவங்க (*avaṅga*) does the same respectful job for a woman in speech.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

அவர் (*avar*) is native Dravidian: the far base *a-* with the respectful *-ar* (DEDR 1). Malayalam and Kannada have *avar* too.

Grammar Lens: the column that was empty

	near	far
a person, respectfully	இவர்	அவர்

The pointing system arrived a long way back, and it arrived as a **rule about a front letter** with only the near column filled in. A reader could say *this person* and could say what அ- would mean, and had no அ- word to say.

That is the ordinary way a gap survives: the pattern gets taught, the pattern is correct, and nobody notices that half of what it predicts was never handed over.

Filling it costs one letter, and from here அவர் is the word you reach for whenever you talk about somebody who is not present — which is most of the talking anybody does.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- அவர்
- the near partner of it
- which single letter is the difference
- whether அவர் tells you the person is a man or a woman (it does not)

Before you move on

What does அவர் mean? (*That person*, respectfully — or plain *he* or *she* about somebody elsewhere.) Which front letter does it carry, and what does that letter do? (அ-, which points away.)

37.6 இவர் என் நண்பர் — "this is my friend"

Ivar, avar, evar — near, away, the question. Then *naṇban̲, naṇbi, naṇbar*. Everything this lesson needs is in your mouth; what is left is the order.

You'll want to know: the introduction

இவர் என் நண்பர். — *ivar eṉ naṇbar* — **This is my friend.**

Three words, all inherited from Dravidian, and **not one of them is a verb**. Tamil links two nouns by setting them beside each other, as in என் பெயர் **...** and என் தவறு.

The pieces in order: இவர், the person here; என், my; நண்பர், friend-with-respect. Then stop.

The whole meeting:

— வணக்கம். இவர் என் நண்பர்.

— வணக்கம். உங்கள் ஊர் என்ன.

The letters in this word

என் is எ with ன், the alveolar n dotted shut. நண்பர் opens on dental ந, turns on retroflex ண், closes on ர். So one line makes you produce ன் and ண் within a breath of each other — one at the ridge, the other with the tongue curled back. Hear that difference and the three-way n is no longer theory.

Why it's said this way

நண்பர் rather than நண்பன் is a decision, not a default.

- இவர் என் நண்பன். — a male friend, plainly stated; warm among peers.
- இவர் என் நண்பி. — a female friend, the matching plain form.
- இவர் என் நண்பர். — the respectful ending; safe with anyone, and right when either party is older or senior.

If unsure, take நண்பர். Over-respect is invisible; under-respect is not. Notice how differently Tamil makes you think from one word to the next. For a **sibling** it forces **age**: there is no bare "brother" — you must choose அண்ணன் or தம்பி, அக்கா or தங்கை, and say whether they are older or younger than you before you can say anything at all. For a **friend** it forces **sex or respect**. For **parents**, nothing: அப்பா and அம்மா came into the language whole. Tamil rarely lets you be vague about a relationship.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- the introduction — “ivar eṉ naṇbar”
- the same line to a peer about a male friend — “ivar eṉ naṇbaṉ”
- the greeting and the question around it — “vaṇakkam … uṅgaḷ ūr eṉṉa”
- what a sibling word forces you to decide — “aṇṇaṉ, older; tambi, younger”

Before you move on

Introduce a friend respectfully, and say how many verbs the sentence has. (*Ivar eṉ naṇbar*; **none**.) What does a sibling word force you to decide that a friend word does not? (**Whether they are older or younger** — *aṇṇaṉ* against *tambi*.) Which friend ending is safe when unsure, and what does இ- tell your listener? (நண்பர்; that the person is **near**.)

Chapter 38

Keeping Well, and Leaving

Modes: 👁 **eyes** (3) ✓ **pen** (1) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** the first 3 of 4 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can ask உங்கள் உடம்பு எப்படி இருக்கு?, recognise சுகமா? and place it as the Sanskrit-derived option beside native நலம், say விடை பெறுகிறேன், and show that விடு, வீடு and விடை are one root while ஊர் and நண்பன் are not.
>
> *Close the visit with* நன்றி. விடை பெறுகிறேன்.*, put* விடு*,* வீடு *and* விடை *in one dictionary entry, refuse the second* விடை *that means 'bull' and came from Sanskrit, and refuse to join* ஊர் *and* நண்பன் *to the pattern just because they are nearby.*

38.1 உடம்பு (uḍambu) — "body," and how Tamil asks after your health

> Introduce a friend respectfully and name the ending. (*Ivar en̲ naṇbar* — the respectful **-அர்**.) Next you would ask how they are.

You'll want to know: உடம்பு

> **உடம்பு** — *uḍambu* — **body**

The whole of it, not a part. You have **தலை** (*talai*) and **கை** (*kai*) already; this is what they belong to, and the word inside the question Tamil speakers actually ask:

> உங்கள் உடம்பு எப்படி இருக்கு — *uṅgaḷ uḍambu eppaḍi irukku* — **how is your body**, that is, **how are you keeping**

Every piece is yours: உங்கள், எப்படி, and இருக்கு from இரு. What is new is that the health question hangs on a **noun** rather than on you.

Tamil has a second way to ask it, through உணவு — the noun standing on உண், "to eat." Asking whether somebody has eaten is asking whether they are all right.

In the family, and next door

	word
Telugu	ఒళ్ళు (*oḷḷu*)
English	body

The letters in this word

உ + ட + ம் + பு: the standing vowel *u*, ட, then ம் — ம shut by the puḷḷi you have used since வணக்கம் — and பு. ம was one of the first letters you formed with a pen, alongside retroflex ண.

The letters in this word

The letters say *u-ṭa-m-pu*; your mouth says *u**ḍ**a**mb**u*. ட sits between vowels, so it softens — the *paḍi* rule. ப follows the nasal ம், so it voices — the *naṉ̲ṟi* rule that also made *naṇba*ṉ̲. Two rules, one short word, neither written down.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

Tamil has another word for the body, உடல் (*uḍal*), and DEDR 586 does not treat them as rivals: உடல், உடம்பு and உடலம் sit in the **same entry**, with Kannada's ಒಡಲು beside them. Usage has divided them: உடல் leans literary, உடம்பு is what you say aloud about someone unwell.

Grammar Lens: where the person goes in a health question

Two shapes Tamil uses to ask about a state:

the question	where the person sits
உங்கள் உடம்பு எப்படி இருக்கு	as a **possessor**
உனக்கு எத்தனை வயது ஆகிறது	in the **dative**

The formal age question does not make you the subject at all — "**to you**, how many years are becoming." The body question makes உடம்பு the subject.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- the two softenings — "uṭampu … uḍambu"
- the question — "uṅgaḷ uḍambu eppaḍi irukku"
- the parts, the whole, and the two forms of one root — "talai, kai … uḍambu … uḍal"

Before you move on

Ask someone respectfully how they are keeping, through the body, and name the two sound rules inside *uḍambu*. (*Uṅgaḷ uḍambu eppaḍi irukku*; ட softens **between vowels**, ப voices **after a nasal**.) Are உடல் and உடம்பு different words, and where does the person sit in the formal age question? (**No**, same entry; **in the dative**.)

38.2 சுகம் (sugam) — "ease," the word Tamil did borrow

Health through the body, and the other body-word in its entry. (*Uṅgaḷ uḍambu eppaḍi irukku*; *uḍal*.) A second answer came from abroad.

You'll want to know: சுகம்

சுகம் — *sugam* — **wellbeing, ease, comfort**

The க is doing its old trick: the letter is *ka*, but between vowels it comes out **g**. *Su-**g**-am*, not *su-ka-m*.

சுகமா — *sugamā* — **keeping well**

It is **not** the ordinary Tamil "how are you," which is **நல்லா இருக்கீங்களா**. **சுகமா** is warmer and more Sanskritic, and which you hear depends on somebody's **ஊர்** — the native place whose name so often ends in *-ūr*.

In the family, and next door

	word
Telugu	**క్షేమం** (*kṣēmaṁ*)
English	wellbeing, ease

The letters in this word

சு + **க** + **ம்**: **ச** with the *u* sign, a bare **க**, **ம** closed by the puḷḷi. Nothing is doubled — hold that against **மன்னிக்கவும்**, where **ன்னி** has **ன** dotted shut and written a second time, and **க்க** does the same to **க**.

Grammar Lens: where the dative is required

சுகமா has no dative in it, and a family of Tamil states demands one: **எனக்குத் தமிழ் தெரியும்**, "to me, Tamil is known." Put a noun there and the shapes part:

the phrase	**what happened**
நான் to **எனக்கு**	the pronoun **changes its body**
நண்பர் to **நண்பருக்கு**	the noun just **takes -உக்கு**

So **நண்பருக்குத் தமிழ் தெரியும்**, and the formal age question does the same: **உனக்கு எத்தனை வயது ஆகிறது**. **சுகமா** does not: knowing and ageing come *to* a person; being well is what a person **is**.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

சுகம் is Sanskrit **सुख** (*sukha*), "ease" — the apology lesson in reverse. There, **மன்னிக்கவும்** stood on Tamil's own **மன்னி** while the neighbours built their "sorry" on Sanskrit **kṣamā**. Here Tamil borrowed *sukha* and **kept** **நலம்** as the everyday word; Malayalam took the same loan, **സുഖം**, as its ordinary greeting.

The old parse of *sukha* is *su-* "good" plus *kha* "aperture" — a chariot's axle-hole. **Treat that as contested**: the standard Sanskrit dictionary hedges it with "said to be," and offers *su-stha*.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- the softened க — "sugam," not "sukam"
- the state that needs a dative — "naṇbarukkut tamiḻ teriyum"
- the state that does not, and the word kept beside it — "sugamā … nalam"

Before you move on

Why is க heard as *g*, and what did the noun do that நான் does not? (**Between vowels**; it **takes -உக்கு**, while நான் becomes எனக்கு.) Which word did Tamil borrow, which did it keep, and how firm is the "good axle-hole" story? (சுகம்; நலம்; **contested**.)

38.3 விடை (viḍai) — "leave," and the root under the house

Sugam — which language it came from, and which Tamil word stayed beside it. (Sanskrit; நலம்.) You came through the door, took the நாற்காலி — four legs, counted out — were given tea, said என் தவறு when the wrong cup arrived, and introduced a friend. One thing is left.

You'll want to know: விடை

விடை — *viḍai* — **leave; permission to depart**

Not the act of going — you have போய் வருகிறேன் for that — but the **leave itself**, taken with பெறு (*peṟu*), "to obtain":

நன்றி. விடை பெறுகிறேன். — *naṉṟi. viḍai peṟugiṟēṉ.* — **Thank you. I take my leave.**

It is **formal and slightly literary**; leaving a friend's house you would say போய் வருகிறேன்.

The தயவுசெய்து you learned for asking has a family across the Dravidian languages, all built on the same *daya*, "kindness," plus a light verb. Leaving is not.

The letters in this word

வி + டை. வி is வ with the ி sign — the first vowel sign you learned, which made நன்றி possible. டை is ட with the *ai* sign ை, which wraps around the front.

நன்றி stands beside it above, so read it once more: ந + ன் + றி — dental n, alveolar n dotted shut, hard ற with that same ி. And பெறுகிறேன் has a க between vowels, so it softens.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

விடை is inherited Dravidian, and belongs to விடு (*viḍu*), "to let go." Leave is what you are *let go* with.

Now the first word of these lessons. வீடு, "house," is filed by the Dravidian dictionary in the **same entry as** விடு — and விடை is in it too:

the word	**what it is**
விடு *viḍu*	to let go, to release
வீடு *vīḍu*	the house — and, in the old sense, final release
விடை *viḍai*	leave to depart

You walked in through வீடு and walk out through விடை, one word in different clothes. Kannada's ಬೀಡು, the same house with its *b*-, sits on that root as well.

Two cautions, because a neat pattern is when to slow down. A second விடை means "bull," a Sanskrit borrowing from *vṛṣa*; and ஊர் — the settlement inside Tanjore — and நண்பன் are outside this root entirely.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- the departure — "na<u>n</u>ri. viḍai pe<u>r</u>ugi<u>r</u>ē<u>n</u>."

- the one root, three ways — "viḍu … vīḍu … viḍai"
- the two that do not join it — "ūr … naṇbaṉ"

Before you move on

Take your leave formally, thanks in front of it, and name the earlier word that shares this root. (*Naṉri. viḍai peṟugiṟēṉ.*; வீடு, from விடு, "to let go.") Do ஊர் and நண்பன் belong to that root? (**No** — a settlement and a closeness; not everything joins up.)

38.4 மூன்று — the fourth corner of the u-family

Three corners of one family are already yours: உ and ஊ, the letters that open a word, and ◌ு, the short sign that rides a consonant. One corner is missing, and you can guess what it does.

Script you'll notice: the ◌ூ sign

◌ூ is the sign for long *ū* — the long partner of ◌ு, exactly as ஊ is the long partner of உ. Both members of each pair, in both jobs:

	opens a word	**rides a consonant**
short *u*	உ	◌ு
long *ū*	ஊ	◌ூ

ம + ◌ூ → மூ, said *mū*.

The four corners are a pattern, not the whole system. Short **a** is the vowel with no sign at all: the data says a consonant carries a built-in *a* until a mark replaces it, which is why க needs nothing to be *ka*. Nor do signs all sit in one place — the ◌ை you met in இல்லை is written to the LEFT of its consonant, which the data does say; where ◌ு and ◌ூ sit is this lesson's own description, since the data has no entry for either.

Read it; do not draw it yet. None of உ, ஊ, ◌ு or ◌ூ has an entry in this book's script data, so none of them gets a stroke order, and the pairing above is what the page shows rather than something the data states.

Script you'll notice: build the word

piece		
மூ	*mū* — ம with the ீ sign	ம from வணக்கம்
ன்	bare *n̲* — ன under a pul̤li	the alveolar *n*
று	*r̲u* — ற, the hard *r*, with the ு sign	ற from நன்றி

மூ · ன் · று → மூன்று

Three pieces, one new sign. மூன்று is "three" — a word you have counted with since chapter 7, and now one you can read. It joins இரண்டு, நான்கு, ஆறு, எட்டு and பத்து, whose letters the strand has already given you; ஐந்து and ஏழு still wait on letters this book has not taught, and ஒன்று and ஒன்பது wait on one it is about to.

Your turn

- *Read it:* மூ — then மூன்று
- *Say it:* "mūn̲r̲u" — "three"
- *Contrast:* று and மூ — the short sign and the long one, both riding
- *Contrast:* ஊர் and மூன்று — long *ū* standing, then long *ū* riding

Before you move on

Read மூன்று. Which sign is ீ's short partner, and which letter is its standing form? (ு, and ஊ.) Name the four corners of that family. (உ ஊ standing, ு ீ riding.) What is the dot on ன் doing? (**Removing the built-in *a***.) Next: asking for what you want.

Chapter 39

Asking for What You Want

Modes: 👁 **eyes** (3) ✓ **pen** (1) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** the first 3 of 4 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say எனக்குத் … வேண்டும் with myself in the dative and no subject at all, decline with வேண்டாம் rather than இல்லை, ask a price with எவ்வளவு and say why age took எத்தனை instead, put ஒரு in front of a noun where ஒன்று cannot go, and read ஒ in both shapes of "one".
>
> *Order one tea end to end — ask* தேநீர் எவ்வளவு*?, say* ஒரு தேநீர் வேண்டும்*, decline the second with* வேண்டாம் *— and say why* ஒன்று *cannot stand in front of the noun.*

39.1 வேண்டும் (vēṇḍum) — "I want," with no I in it

Say "I know Tamil" and name what is missing. (*Enakkut tamil teriyum* — **no subject**; knowing happens **to** you.) You have met that shape with தெரியும், புரிகிறது and பிடிக்கும். Here it is on the verb that asks for things.

You'll want to know: வேண்டும்

வேண்டும் — *vēṇḍum* — **is wanted**, that is, **I want / I need**

எனக்குத் தண்ணீர் வேண்டும் — *enakkut taṇṇīr vēṇḍum* — **to me, water is wanted**

English makes wanting something you do. Tamil does not: the thing wanted is the subject, and you sit in the **dative** — எனக்கு, the irregular one whose pronoun changes body before the suffix lands. Swap it and you change who wants it, with nothing else touched: உங்களுக்குத் தண்ணீர் வேண்டும் — the joining த் survives the swap, because it is the **dative** that licenses it. Compare நான் தமிழ் பேசுகிறேன்: same hard த in front, no dative behind, no doubling.

In the family, and next door

	word
Kannada	ನನಗೆ ಚಹಾ ಬೇಕು (*nanage cahā bēku*)
Hindi (neighbour)	चाहना (*chāhnā*)
English	want, need

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

வேண்டும் (*vēṇḍum*) is native Dravidian, from the verb *vēṇṭu*, "to want" (DEDR 5528). Malayalam *vēṇam* and Kannada *bēku* say "it must" in the same way.

The letters in this word

வே + ண் + டு + ம்: வ with the ே of பேசு, retroflex ண under a pulḷi, ட from எப்படி with the ு of இருக்கிறீர்கள், and ம under a pulḷi — a four-piece word the strand owes you nothing for.

The letters in this word

The letters say *vē-ṇ-ṭu-m*; your mouth says *vēṇḍum*. ட follows the nasal ண், so it voices — the நன்றி rule, as in *naṇbaṉ*.

Grammar Lens: the negative comes from somewhere else

You have negated with இல்லை since chapter 1. This verb refuses it.

I want it	வேண்டும்
I don't want it	வேண்டாம்

Not *vēṇḍum illai*. Tamil supplies a **separate negative word** on the same வேண்ட- stem. வேண்டாம் declines politely; இல்லை is understood, but sounds translated.

Your turn

- *Say it:* "enakkut taṇṇīr vēṇḍum" — and hear that no *I* is doing anything
- *Read it:* தண்ணீர் — the word from the rice-and-water pair, unchanged
- *Say it:* yours, then theirs — "enakkut taṇṇīr vēṇḍum" … "uṅgaḷukkut taṇṇīr vēṇḍum"
- *Read it:* வேண்டும் — four pieces, no new letters

Before you move on

Ask for water, and say where you sit in it. (*Enakkut taṇṇīr vēṇḍum*; **in the dative**.) Why not இல்லை to decline? (வேண்டாம் — a **separate negative word**.) Why does ட sound like *ḍ*? (A **nasal** in front.) Next: how to ask what it costs.

39.2 எவ்வளவு (evvaḷavu) — "how much," and the question it is not

Ask for water, with yourself in the right case. (*Enakkut taṇṇīr vēṇḍum.*) Now you need the other half of any transaction: what it costs.

You'll want to know: எவ்வளவு

எவ்வளவு — *evvaḷavu* — **how much**

தேநீர் எவ்வளவு? — *tēnīr evvaḷavu?* — **how much is the tea?**

It opens with the **எ-** that starts every Tamil question word you have met — எப்படி, எத்தனை, என்ன, எவர். That does not run the other way — என், எனக்கு and எட்டு open with it too — but no question word you have met starts anywhere else. Both parts, *e-* and *aḷavu*, "measure", are Dravidian.

In the family, and next door

	word
Hindi (neighbour)	कितना (*kitnā*)
English	how much

Grammar Lens: measure or count

English has two phrases for this too, and lets you slide between them. Tamil does not: the choice is lexical, and the line falls in the same place:

	asks about	**example**
எத்தனை	things you count, one by one	எத்தனை வயது — how many years
எவ்வளவு	quantity, extent, price	தேநீர் எவ்வளவு — how much is the tea

You already used எத்தனை for age, because years are counted. Money is not counted that way — you ask எவ்வளவு for a price even when the answer comes back as a number of rupees.
The test is not whether an answer has digits in it. It is whether the language treats the thing as a **heap** or as a **row**.

The letters in this word

எ + வ் + வ + ள + வு: the standing எ from என், then வ shut by a puḷḷi and வ again, the retroflex ள from நீங்கள், and வ a third time carrying the ு sign.

Three வs in a five-piece word. The doubled வ்வ at the front is what makes it sound clipped rather than drawled.

Your turn

- *Say it:* "tēnīr evvaḷavu?" — then answer yourself with a number
- *Contrast:* "ettanai vayathu" and "tēnīr evvaḷavu" — counted, measured
- *Read it:* எவ்வளவு — find all three வ
- *Read it:* க உ ங சு ரு — then answer *evvaḷavu?* by pointing at one

Before you move on

Ask what the tea costs. (*Tēnīr evvaḷavu?*) Which question word did age take, and why is price different? (எத்தனை — years are **counted**; price asks about **quantity**.) What do all these question words share at the front? (எ-.) Next: how Tamil says "one" when it is not counting.

39.3 ஒரு (oru) — "one," when it is not counting

Ask what the tea costs, then ask for it. (*Tēnīr evvaḷavu? … Enakku … vēṇḍum.*) One word is missing from the middle of that: how many.

You'll want to know: ஒரு

ஒரு — *oru* — **a, one**

ஒரு தேநீர் வேண்டும் — *oru tēnīr vēṇḍum* — **one tea, please**

You learned ஒன்று in chapter 7 as the number one. ஒரு is the same word in the shape it takes when it leans on a noun. Tamil will not let you say *on̲ṟu tēnīr*.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

ஒரு (*oru*) is native Dravidian. DEDR 990 lists Malayalam *oru* and Kannada *or*, also used before a noun.

Grammar Lens: the counting form and the leaning form

	shape	where it stands
the number itself	ஒன்று	alone — counting, answering "how many"
in front of a noun	ஒரு	ஒரு தேநீர், ஒரு நாள்

Other numbers have paired shapes of their own. This book does not set out to list them — meet ஒரு here, and expect the pattern rather

than a rule.
This is also how Tamil manages without the word "a." There is no article in the language; ஒரு does that work when you want it done, and nothing does it when you do not. தேநீர் வேண்டும் is perfectly good — it just does not specify one.

The letters in this word

ஒ + ரு: a standing vowel, then ர — one of the two *r*-letters, from சரி — carrying the ◌ு sign.

ஒ is one of three standing vowels the book still owes you; ஏ and ஐ are the others, and they are still outstanding. ஒ goes first because it opens both ஒரு and ஒன்று, and the next lesson pays it.

Your turn

Order something, start to finish.

- *Say it:* "tēnīr evvaḷavu?"
- *Say it:* "oru tēnīr vēṇḍum"
- *Say it:* decline a second one — "vēṇḍām"
- *Contrast:* "onṟu" alone, "oru tēnīr" in front of a noun
- *Recall:* say *ūr*
- *Read it:* நண்பன்
- *Recall:* say *ivar*

Before you move on

Order one tea and refuse a second. (*Oru tēnīr vēṇḍum … vēṇḍām.*) Why not *onṟu tēnīr*? (ஒன்று is the **counting** shape; in front of a noun the word **leans** and becomes ஒரு.) Does Tamil have a word for "a"? (**No** — ஒரு does that work when you want it.) Next: the letter both shapes begin with.

39.4 ஒன்று — the letter under both shapes of "one"

You have just used ஒரு in front of a noun and ஒன்று on its own. Both begin with the same letter — one this book has printed since chapter 7 and the writing strand has never once opened up.

Script you'll notice: ஒ

ஒ — *o* — a standing vowel: the form that opens a word, rather than a sign that rides a consonant

It joins the standing vowels you already read: அ ஆ இ உ ஊ எ. Those seven do not exhaust Tamil's twelve — this book teaches the ones its own words need. ஒ goes first of the three because it opens the most words in this book: ஒரு, ஒன்று, and ஒன்பது, which chapter 7 showed you carrying the same ஒன்- at its front.

Read it; do not draw it yet. ஒ has no entry in this book's script data, so it gets no stroke order, and nothing here describes how the pen moves.

Script you'll notice: build the word

piece		
ஒ	*o*	this lesson
ன்	bare *n̲* — ன under a pul̲l̲i	the alveolar *n*
று	*r̲u* — ற with the ு sign	ற from நன்றி

ஒ · ன் · று → ஒன்று

The last two pieces are the ones you built மூன்று from, in the same order. Three and one differ only in what stands in front of ன்று.

Script you'll notice: the same letter, the shorter word

ஒ + ரு → ஒரு

Two pieces, and you can read the form that leans on a noun as well as the form that counts. ஒரு தேநீர் is now a line you can order aloud and read off a board.

Your turn

- *Read it:* ஒ — then ஒரு — then ஒன்று
- *Contrast:* ஒன்று and மூன்று — same ன்று, and மூ carries the ூ sign where ஒ stands alone
- *Say it:* "oru … onru" — the leaning shape, then the counting one

Before you move on

Read ஒன்று, then ஒரு. What do ஒன்று and மூன்று share, and where do they differ? (They share ன்று at the end; they differ in the piece that opens them.) What is the dot on ன் doing? (**Removing the built-in *a***.)

Chapter 40

Pointing, and Asking

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (7) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 7 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can point at something in Tamil and ask who or where it is — and I can say what the six words have in common.
>
> *Say the near word, the far word and the question word in a row, and name the part that changed.*

40.1 இது (idu) — this one — the thing near me

You can already name things. This is how you POINT at them.

You'll want to know: இது

இது — *idu* — this one — the thing near me.

Say it, and picture the thing it lands on as you say it. That is the whole word: it does not mean anything on its own, it means whatever the speaker is pointing at.

Its partner, the far one, comes in the next lesson. The two of them differ by one sound at the front — **i-** for near — and that is not a coincidence. It is the whole system, and the last lesson of this chapter says so.

In the family, and next door

	word	same root
Kannada	ಇದು (*idu*)	yes
Telugu	ఇది (*idi*)	yes
Malayalam	ഇത് (*itŭ*)	yes
Hindi (neighbour)	यह (*yah*)	
English	this one	

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

இது (*idu*) is native Dravidian: the near base *i-* (DEDR 410). Malayalam has *itu* and Kannada *idu*.

Your turn

- *Say it:* "இது" three times, picturing something different each time
- *Say it:* it once with a word you already know after it
- *Recall:* say *uḍambu*

Before you move on

What is *idu*? (this one — the thing near me.) What sound does it start with, and does that sound mean near, far, or a question? (**i-** — near.)

40.2 அது (adu) — that one — the thing over there

You can already name things. This is how you POINT at them.

You'll want to know: அது

அது — *adu* — that one — the thing over there.

Say it, and picture the thing it lands on as you say it. That is the whole word: it does not mean anything on its own, it means whatever the speaker is pointing at.

Its partner is இது *idu*, which you have just met. The two of them differ by one sound at the front — **a-** for far — and that is not a coincidence. It is the whole system, and the last lesson of this chapter says so.

In the family, and next door

	word	same root
Kannada	ಅದು (*adu*)	yes
Telugu	అది (*adi*)	yes
Malayalam	അത് (*atŭ*)	yes
Hindi (neighbour)	वह (*vah*)	
English	that one	

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

அது (*adu*) is native Dravidian: the far base *a-* (DEDR 1). Malayalam has *atu* and Kannada *adu*.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "அது" three times, picturing something different each time
- it once with a word you already know after it

Before you move on

What is *adu*? (that one — the thing over there.) What sound does it start with, and does that sound mean near, far, or a question? (**a-** — far.)

40.3 இங்கே (iṅgē) — here — where I am

You can already name things. This is how you POINT at them.

You'll want to know: இங்கே

இங்கே — *iṅgē* — here — where I am.

Say it, and picture the thing it lands on as you say it. That is the whole word: it does not mean anything on its own, it means whatever the speaker is pointing at.

Its partner, the far one, comes in the next lesson. The two of them differ by one sound at the front — **i-** for near — and that is not a coincidence. It is the whole system, and the last lesson of this chapter says so.

In the family, and next door

	word
Kannada	ಇಲ್ಲಿ (*illi*)
Telugu	ఇక్కడ (*ikkaḍa*)
Malayalam	ഇവിടെ (*iviṭe*)
Hindi (neighbour)	यहाँ (*yahā̃*)
English	here

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

இங்கே (*iṅgē*) is native Dravidian: the near base *i-* with a place ending. DEDR 410 lists it under the same base as "this".

Your turn

- *Say it:* "இங்கே" three times, picturing something different each time
- *Say it:* it once with a word you already know after it
- *Recall:* say *sugam*
- *Read it:* எவ்வளவு

Before you move on

What is *iṅgē*? (here — where I am.) What sound does it start with, and does that sound mean near, far, or a question? (**i-** — near.)

40.4 அங்கே (aṅgē) — there — where I am not

You can already name things. This is how you POINT at them.

You'll want to know: அங்கே

அங்கே — *aṅgē* — there — where I am not.

Say it, and picture the thing it lands on as you say it. That is the whole word: it does not mean anything on its own, it means whatever the speaker is pointing at.

Its partner is இங்கே *iṅgē*, which you have just met. The two of them differ by one sound at the front — **a-** for far — and that is not a coincidence. It is the whole system, and the last lesson of this chapter says so.

In the family, and next door

	word
Kannada	ಅಲ್ಲಿ (*alli*)
Telugu	అక్కడ (*akkaḍa*)
Malayalam	അവിടെ (*aviṭe*)
Hindi (neighbour)	वहाँ (*vahā̃*)
English	there

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

அங்கே (*aṅgē*) is native Dravidian: the far base *a-* with a place ending. DEDR 1 lists it under the same base as "that".

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "அங்கே" three times, picturing something different each time
- it once with a word you already know after it

Before you move on

What is *aṅgē*? (there — where I am not.) What sound does it start with, and does that sound mean near, far, or a question? (**a-** — far.)

40.5 யார் (yār) — who? — asking about a person

You can already name things. This is how you ASK about them.

You'll want to know: யார்

யார் — *yār* — who? — asking about a person.

Say it with an asking voice. It points at no one: it asks your listener to name the person.

yār opens with **yā-**, not with the **i-** of near or the **a-** of far that the four words before it share. It is the one word in this chapter outside that pattern, so learn it as itself: the asking word for people.

In the family, and next door

	word	**same root**
Kannada	ಯಾರು (*yāru*)	yes
Telugu	ఎవరు (*evaru*)	yes
Malayalam	ആര് (*ārŭ*)	yes
Hindi (neighbour)	कौन (*kaun*)	
English	who?	

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

யார் (*yār*) is native Dravidian, on the question base *yā-* (DEDR 5151). Malayalam has *yār* and *ār*, and Kannada *yār*.

Your turn

- *Say it:* "யார்" three times, asking about a different person each time
- *Say it:* it once with a word you already know after it
- *Recall:* say *viḍai*
- *Read it:* ஒரு

Before you move on

What is *yār*? (who? — asking about a person.) What sound does it start with: the i- of near, the a- of far, or neither? (**Neither** — **yā-**; it asks about a person.)

40.6 எங்கே (eṅgē) — where? — asking about a place

You can already name things. This is how you ASK about them.

You'll want to know: எங்கே

எங்கே — *eṅgē* — where? — asking about a place.

Say it with an asking voice. It points at no place: it asks your listener to point one out.

Its partners are **இங்கே** *iṅgē* and **அங்கே** *aṅgē*, which you have already met. The three differ by one sound at the front — **e-** for ask — and that is not a coincidence. It is the whole system, and the last lesson of this chapter says so.

In the family, and next door

	word
Kannada	ಎಲ್ಲಿ (*elli*)
Telugu	ఎక్కడ (*ekkaḍa*)
Malayalam	എവിടെ (*eviṭe*)
Hindi (neighbour)	कहाँ (*kahā̃*)
English	where?

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

எங்கே (*eṅgē*) is native Dravidian: the question base *e-* with a place ending (DEDR 5151).

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "**எங்கே**" three times, asking about a different place each time
- it once with a word you already know after it

Before you move on

What is *eṅgē*? (where? — asking about a place.) What sound does it start with, and does that sound mean near, far, or a question? (**e-** — ask.)

40.7 i- / a- / e- — six words, one machine

Say the six words from this chapter out loud, in order. Listen to how they begin.

Grammar lens: one slot changes

Five of these six words are **three beginnings**, reused; only the person question stands apart.

meaning	**word**
near	இங்கே *iṅgē*
far	அங்கே *aṅgē*
question	எங்கே *eṅgē*

Tamil shows the system at its cleanest: இங்கே, அங்கே, எங்கே differ in one letter.
Change the front, and the meaning walks from **near** to **far** to **a question**. Nothing else in the word moves.
The same three beginnings run the thing-words too: இது *idu* and அது *adu* start exactly like the first two rows. This chapter did not teach you the matching question word for things — that one arrives later, and when it does you will already know what it has to start with. This is worth more than the six words are. When you meet a new word in this family later, you will not have to be taught all three of it — you will be taught one and work out the others.

Your turn

- *Say it:* the near word, then the far word, then the question word
- *Say it:* them again for place, not for things
- *Notice:* the part that did NOT change

Before you move on

Which beginning means near? (**i-**) Far? (**a-**) And which one turns the word into a question? (**e-**)

Chapter 41

Describing Things

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (6) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 6 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can point at something in Tamil and ask who or where it is — and I can say what the six words have in common.
>
> *Say the near word, the far word and the question word in a row, and name the part that changed.*

41.1 பெரிய (periya) — big

You can already name things. This is how you DESCRIBE them.

You'll want to know: பெரிய

பெரிய — *periya* — big.

Put it in front of a word you already know and you have said something new. That is all an adjective does in this language.

The last lesson of this chapter gives the one rule that governs every adjective you will ever meet here.

In the family, and next door

	word
Kannada	ದೊಡ್ಡ (*doḍḍa*)
Telugu	పెద్ద (*pedda*)
Malayalam	വലിയ (*valiya*)
Hindi (neighbour)	बड़ा (*baṛā*)
English	big

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

பெரிய (*periya*) is native Dravidian. DEDR 4411 lists Malayalam *periya* and Kannada *pēr*.

Your turn

- *Say it:* "பெரிய" three times, picturing something different each time
- *Say it:* it once with a word you already know after it
- *Recall:* say *vēṇḍum*
- *Read it:* இது
- *Recall:* say *adu*

Before you move on

What is *periya*? (**big**.) Where does it go — before the word it describes, or after? (**Before.**)

41.2 சிறிய (siṟiya) — small

You can already name things. This is how you DESCRIBE them.

You'll want to know: சிறிய

சிறிய — *siṟiya* — small.

Put it in front of a word you already know and you have said something new. That is all an adjective does in this language.

You met பெரிய *periya* a moment ago. Put them side by side and nothing about either one changes.

The last lesson of this chapter gives the one rule that governs every adjective you will ever meet here.

In the family, and next door

	word	same root
Kannada	ಚಿಕ್ಕ (*cikka*)	
Telugu	చిన్న (*cinna*)	
Malayalam	ചെറിയ (*ceṟiya*)	yes
Hindi (neighbour)	छोटा (*choṭā*)	
English	small	

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

சிறிய (*siṟiya*) is native Dravidian. DEDR 1594 lists Malayalam *ciṟṟu*, Kannada *kiṟu* and Telugu *ciṟu*.

Your turn

- *Say it:* "சிறிய" three times, picturing something different each time
- *Say it:* it once with a word you already know after it
- *Read it:* எவ்வளவு
- *Recall:* say *iṅgē*

Before you move on

What is *siṟiya*? (**small.**) Where does it go — before the word it describes, or after? (**Before.**)

41.3 நல்ல (nalla) — good

You can already name things. This is how you DESCRIBE them.

You'll want to know: நல்ல

நல்ல — *nalla* — good.

Put it in front of a word you already know and you have said something new. That is all an adjective does in this language.

You met சிறிய *siṟiya* a moment ago. Put them side by side and nothing about either one changes.

The last lesson of this chapter gives the one rule that governs every adjective you will ever meet here.

In the family, and next door

	word	same root
Kannada	ಒಳ್ಳೆಯ (*oḷḷeya*)	
Telugu	మంచి (*manci*)	
Malayalam	നല്ല (*nalla*)	yes
Hindi (neighbour)	अच्छा (*acchā*)	
English	good	

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

நல்ல (*nalla*) is native Dravidian. DEDR 3610 lists Malayalam *nal* and Kannada *nal*, "goodness". It is the same *nal* that is inside *na<u>n</u><u>r</u>i*, "thank you".

Your turn

- *Say it:* "நல்ல" three times, picturing something different each time
- *Say it:* it once with a word you already know after it
- *Recall:* say *aṅgē*

Before you move on

What is *nalla*? (**good**.) Where does it go — before the word it describes, or after? (**Before.**)

41.4 புதிய (pudiya) — new

You can already name things. This is how you DESCRIBE them.

You'll want to know: புதிய

புதிய — *pudiya* — new.

Put it in front of a word you already know and you have said something new. That is all an adjective does in this language.

You met நல்ல *nalla* a moment ago. Put them side by side and nothing about either one changes.

The last lesson of this chapter gives the one rule that governs every adjective you will ever meet here.

In the family, and next door

	word	same root
Kannada	ಹೊಸ (*hosa*)	
Telugu	కొత్త (*kotta*)	
Malayalam	പുതിയ (*putiya*)	yes
Hindi (neighbour)	नया (*nayā*)	
English	new	

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

புதிய (*pudiya*) is native Dravidian. DEDR 4275 lists Malayalam *putu* and Kannada *hosa*.

Your turn

- *Say it:* "புதிய" three times, picturing something different each time
- *Say it:* it once with a word you already know after it
- *Read it:* ஒரு
- *Recall:* say *yār*

Before you move on

What is *pudiya*? (**new**.) Where does it go — before the word it describes, or after? (**Before.**)

41.5 பழைய (paḻaiya) — old — of a thing, not of a person

You can already name things. This is how you DESCRIBE them.

You'll want to know: பழைய

பழைய — *paḻaiya* — old — of a thing, not of a person.

Put it in front of a word you already know and you have said something new. That is all an adjective does in this language.

You met புதிய *pudiya* a moment ago. Put them side by side and nothing about either one changes.

The last lesson of this chapter gives the one rule that governs every adjective you will ever meet here.

In the family, and next door

	word	**same root**
Kannada	ಹಳೆಯ (*haḷeya*)	yes
Telugu	పాత (*pāta*)	
Malayalam	പഴയ (*paḻaya*)	yes
Hindi (neighbour)	पुराना (*purānā*)	
English	old	

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

பழைய (*paḻaiya*) is native Dravidian. DEDR 3999 lists Malayalam *paḻa*, Kannada *paḻa* and Telugu *prā-*.

Your turn

- *Say it:* "பழைய" three times, picturing something different each time
- *Say it:* it once with a word you already know after it
- *Recall:* say *eṅgē*

Before you move on

What is *paḻaiya*? (**old — of a thing, not of a person.**) Where does it go — before the word it describes, or after? (**Before.**)

41.6 before the noun, unchanged — five words, one rule

Say the five words from this chapter out loud, then say each one in front of a noun you already know.

Grammar lens: where an adjective goes

You did not learn five separate words. You learned **where an adjective goes**, and five words that go there.

meaning	**word**
big	பெரிய *periya*
small	சிறிய *si̱riya*
good	நல்ல *nalla*

Every one of them ends in -a and none of them ever changes.
This is worth more than the five words are. Every noun you already know — your name, the house, the water, the day — can now take any of them in front, and every adjective you meet from here goes in the same place.

Your turn

- *Say it:* each of the five in front of a noun you already know
- *Say it:* two of them with the same noun, one after the other
- *Notice:* whether the adjective changed shape when the noun did

Before you move on

Where does an adjective go in this language? (**In front of the noun.**) Does it change shape to match the noun? (unchanged.)

Chapter 42

More Everyday Verbs

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (4) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 4 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can tell someone to come, sit, read and give in Tamil.
>
> *Complete TA-C42-give and say all four verbs in order.*

42.1 வா (vā) — come

A short run of everyday verbs, one at a time.

You'll want to know: வா

வா (*vā*) — "come".

You met it beside its partner *varu-*; here it opens the run. One syllable, and a complete sentence: the first thing said at a doorway. It is the bare command, with nothing added, and the old warning still holds: the tense endings attach to *varu-*, not to *vā*.

In the family, and next door

	word	same root
Telugu	రా (*rā*)	
Malayalam	വരുക (*varuka*)	yes
Hindi (neighbour)	आना (*ānā*)	
English	come	

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

வா (*vā*) is native Dravidian. DEDR 5270 lists Malayalam *varuka*, Kannada *bā* and Telugu *rā*.

What you've built

One more everyday action. Three follow, and each reuses the ones before.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- *vā*
- it once more, slowly

Before you move on

What does வா mean? ("come".) Say it once more.

42.2 உட்கார் (uṭkār) — sit

Before the new one: what did *vā* mean?

You'll want to know: உட்கார்

உட்கார் (*uṭkār*) — "sit".

Built from *uḷ*, 'inside', and *kār* — to settle oneself in. Tamil often builds a verb from a place-word plus an action this way.

In the family, and next door

	word
Kannada	ಕುಳಿತುಕೋ (*kuḷitukō*)
Telugu	కూర్చో (*kūrcō*)
Hindi (neighbour)	बैठना (*baiṭhnā*)
English	sit

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

உட்கார் (*uṭkār*) looks like a compound whose first part is *uḷ*, "inside", the native word for being within (DEDR 698), and it is usually taken that way. But DEDR has no entry for the verb itself, and the second part is not clear, so its origin is uncertain.

What you've built

One more everyday action. Three follow, and each reuses the ones before.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- *uṭkār*
- it once more, slowly
- it after *vā*, so the two sit together

Before you move on

What does உட்கார் mean? ("sit".) Say it once more.

42.3 படி (paṭi) — read

Before the new one: what did *uṭkār* mean?

You'll want to know: படி

படி (*paṭi*) — "read".

Also 'to study'. The same word covers reading a page and studying a subject, so a student *paṭikkiṟār* whether they are holding a book or not.

In the family, and next door

	word
Kannada	ಓದು (*ōdu*)
Telugu	చదువు (*caduvu*)
Malayalam	വായിക്കുക (*vāyikkuka*)
Hindi (neighbour)	पढ़ना (*paṛhnā*)
English	read

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

The origin of படி (*paṭi*) is the open question met in an earlier lesson: Tamil's own dictionaries list it as native, while others connect it to Sanskrit *paṭh*, "to recite". Tamil has no aspirated consonants, so a borrowed *paṭh* would arrive as *paṭi* either way.

What you've built

One more everyday action. Three follow, and each reuses the ones before.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- *paṭi*
- it once more, slowly
- it after *uṭkār*, so the two sit together

Before you move on

What does படி mean? ("read".) Say it once more.

42.4 கொடு (koṭu) — give

Before the new one: what did *paṭi* mean?

You'll want to know: கொடு

கொடு (*koṭu*) — "give".

The everyday 'give'. Tamil distinguishes giving away from giving toward the speaker; this is the giving-away one.

In the family, and next door

	word	same root
Kannada	ಕೊಡು (*koḍu*)	yes
Telugu	ఇవ్వు (*ivvu*)	
Malayalam	തരൂ (*tarū*)	
Hindi (neighbour)	देना (*denā*)	
English	give	

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

கொடு (*koṭu*) is native Dravidian. DEDR 2053 lists Malayalam *koṭukka* and Kannada *koḍu*.

What you've built

That closes the run: four more actions, each met on its own.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- *koṭu*
- it once more, slowly
- it after *paṭi*, so the two sit together

Before you move on

What does கொடு mean? ("give".) Say it once more.

Chapter 43

The Household

Modes: **voice** (4) **Hands-free start:** all 4 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can name a child, a son, a daughter and the family in Tamil.
>
> *Complete TA-C43-family and say all four words in order.*

43.1 குழந்தை (kuḻandai) — child

Before the new one: what did *koṭu* mean?

You'll want to know: குழந்தை

குழந்தை (*kuḻandai*) — "child".

Take it apart and the stem is *kuḻa-*, 'young, tender', closed off into a noun by *-ndai*. The same stem stands behind *kuḻavi*, 'infant'. Nothing in the word says boy or girl: it names the age, not the sex.

In the family, and next door

	word
Malayalam	കുട്ടി (*kuṭṭi*)
English	child

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

குழந்தை (*kuḻandai*) is native Dravidian. DEDR 2149 files it with words for young and tender things: Malayalam *koḻuntu*, "tender twig", and Telugu *koḍuku*, "son". The entry compares Sanskrit *kuḍaka*,

"child" (CDIAL 3245).

What you've built

The first of four words for the people in a house. Three follow, and each reuses the ones before.

Your turn

- *Say it: kuḻandai*
- *Say it:* it once more, slowly
- *Say it:* it after *koṭu*, so the two sit together
- *Recall:* say *periya*
- *Read it:* சிறிய

Before you move on

What does குழந்தை mean? ("child".) Say it once more.

43.2 மகன் (makaṉ) — son

Before the new one: what did *kuḻandai* mean?

You'll want to know: மகன்

மகன் (*makaṉ*) — "son".

The stem is *maka-*, an old Dravidian word for offspring, and *-aṉ* is the ending Tamil puts on a male person — the same *-aṉ* already sitting on *naṇbaṉ*, 'friend'. So the word assembles in front of you: offspring, then male.

In the family, and next door

	word	same root
Kannada	ಮಗ (*maga*)	yes
Telugu	కొడుకు (*koḍuku*)	
Malayalam	മകൻ (*makan*)	yes
Hindi (neighbour)	बेटा (*beṭā*)	
English	son	

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

மகன் (*makaṉ*) is native Dravidian. DEDR 4616 lists Malayalam *makan*, Kannada *maga* and Telugu *maga*, "male".

What you've built

A second word for the house, and an ending you had already met elsewhere.

Your turn

- *Say it: makaṉ*
- *Say it:* it once more, slowly
- *Say it:* it after *kuḻandai*, so the two sit together
- *Read it:* நல்ல

Before you move on

What does மகன் mean? ("son".) Say it once more.

43.3 மகள் (makaḷ) — daughter

Before the new one: what did *makaṉ* mean?

You'll want to know: மகள்

மகள் (*makaḷ*) — "daughter".

The same *maka-* stem as the last lesson, with *-aḷ* where that word had *-aṉ*: one ending marks a woman, the other a man. The sibling words you met earlier needed four separate forms to split brother from sister by age; here a single stem does the work of two. Malayalam's *makan* and *makaḷ* match Tamil almost letter for letter.

In the family, and next door

	word	same root
Kannada	ಮಗಳು (*magaḷu*)	yes
Telugu	కూతురు (*kūturu*)	
Malayalam	മകൾ (*makaḷ*)	yes
Hindi (neighbour)	बेटी (*beṭī*)	
English	daughter	

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

மகள் (*makaḷ*) is native Dravidian. DEDR 4616 lists Malayalam *mōḷ*. It is the feminine of the same word as *makaṉ*, "son". The entry compares Sanskrit (lexicons) *mālikā*, "daughter".

What you've built

One stem, two endings, two people. One more word closes the chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: makaḷ*
- *Say it:* it once more, slowly
- *Say it:* it after *makaṉ*, and hear only the ending move
- *Recall:* say *pudiya*

Before you move on

What does மகள் mean? ("daughter".) Say it once more.

43.4 குடும்பம் (kuṭumbam) — family

Before the new one: what did *makaḷ* mean?

You'll want to know: குடும்பம்

குடும்பம் (*kuṭumbam*) — "family".

The collective word the family lesson never needed, because அப்பா, அம்மா and the four sibling words each named one particular person. It comes from Sanskrit *kuṭumba*, 'household' — which Sanskrit itself appears

to have taken from a Dravidian source before handing it back — and the *-am* on the end is what Tamil gives such borrowings.

In the family, and next door

	word	**same root**
Kannada	ಕುಟುಂಬ (*kuṭumba*)	yes
Telugu	కుటుంబం (*kuṭumbaṁ*)	yes
Malayalam	കുടുംബം (*kuṭumbaṁ*)	yes
Hindi (neighbour)	परिवार (*parivār*)	
English	family	

What you've built

That closes the run: child, son, daughter, and the word for all of them together.

Your turn

- *Say it: kuṭumbam*
- *Say it:* it once more, slowly
- *Say it:* it after *makaḷ*, so the two sit together
- *Read it:* பழைய

Before you move on

What does குடும்பம் mean? ("family".) Say it once more.

Chapter 44

Things You Ask For

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can name five everyday things I might ask somebody for in Tamil, and say which of them Tamil has held all along and which arrived from elsewhere.
>
> *Complete TA-C44-book and say all five words in order.*

44.1 பழம் (pa̲lam) — a fruit

> Before the new run of words: what did *makaḷ* mean, and what did *kuṭumbam* mean?

You'll want to know: பழம்

பழம் (*pa̲lam*) — "a fruit".

Underneath it is a root about ripening. Proto-Dravidian ***pa̲l***, 'to ripen, to grow old', handed this family both a fruit and an age, and Tamil kept the pair close enough to hear: *pa̲laiya*, the "old" from the run of describing words, is that same root wearing a different ending. Ripe and old are one idea seen twice.

Malayalam says പഴം, very nearly the identical word — the ordinary state of affairs between the two closest sisters. Telugu went to పండు (*paṇḍu*) and Kannada to ಹಣ್ಣು (*haṇṇu*), and the Kannada form has lost its opening *p-* to a shift Tamil sat out entirely.

The ழ in the middle is the letter this book has already spent a writing lesson on, the one only these two sisters still write.

In the family, and next door

	word	same root
Kannada	ಹಣ್ಣು (*haṇṇu*)	yes
Telugu	పండు (*paṇḍu*)	yes
Malayalam	പഴം (*pa̲lam*)	yes
Hindi (neighbour)	फल (*phal*)	
English	a fruit	

What you've built

The first of five things you might ask somebody for.

Your turn

- *Say it: pa̲lam*
- *Say it:* it once more, slowly
- *Say it: pa̲lam*, then *tayavu seytu pa̲lam koṭuṅgaḷ* — "please give a fruit"
- *Recall:* say *vā*

Before you move on

What does பழம் mean? ("a fruit".) Say it once more.

44.2 துணி (tuṇi) — cloth

Before the new one: what did *pa̲lam* mean?

You'll want to know: துணி

துணி (*tuṇi*) — "cloth".

One shape, two jobs. *tuṇi* is the cloth you wear or wipe your hands on, and *tuṇi* is also 'to dare, to resolve'. Nothing joins them but sound, and the sentence around them settles which is meant — the ordinary way a language carries two words in one skin.

Malayalam keeps തുണി unchanged. Telugu and Kannada reach for something else here, so this is one of the places where the two closest sisters agree and the other two go their own way.

In the family, and next door

	word	same root
Kannada	ಬಟ್ಟೆ (*baṭṭe*)	
Telugu	బట్ట (*baṭṭa*)	
Malayalam	തുണി (*tuṇi*)	yes
Hindi (neighbour)	कपड़ा (*kapṛā*)	
English	cloth	

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

துணி (*tuṇi*) is native Dravidian. DEDR 3307 lists Malayalam *tuṇi*.

What you've built

Two: something to eat and something to wear.

Your turn

- *Say it: tuṇi*
- *Say it:* it once more, slowly
- *Say it: pa̲lam*, then *tuṇi*, so the two sit together
- *Read it:* உட்கார்
- *Recall:* say *ku̲landai*

Before you move on

What does துணி mean? ("cloth".) Say it once more.

44.3 விளக்கு (viḷakku) — a lamp

Before the new one: what did *tuṇi* mean?

You'll want to know: விளக்கு

விளக்கு (*viḷakku*) — "a lamp".

It stands on *viḷaṅgu*, 'to shine, to be clear', so the lamp is named for what it does rather than for what it is made of.

The same stem gives *viḷakkam*, 'clarity', and *viḷakku* on its own can mean 'to make something plain'. A lamp and an explanation are the same word in Tamil, which is a better picture of teaching than most languages get for free.

A Tamil house lights one at dusk, at the doorway, and the word turns up wherever that habit does.

In the family, and next door

	word	**same root**
Kannada	ದೀಪ (*dīpa*)	
Telugu	దీపం (*dīpaṁ*)	
Malayalam	വിളക്ക് (*viḷakkŭ*)	yes
Hindi (neighbour)	दीया (*dīyā*)	
English	a lamp	

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

விளக்கு (*viḷakku*) is native Dravidian, from the verb *viḷakku*, "to make clear, to brighten". DEDR 5496 files it among words for white and shining, with Malayalam *viḷakku*, "lamp", and *veḷiccam*, "light".

What you've built

Three, and the third one shines.

Your turn

- *Say it: viḷakku*
- *Say it:* it once more, slowly
- *Say it: tuṇi*, then *viḷakku*, and hear the doubled letter in the second
- *Recall:* say *paṭi*
- *Read it:* மகன்

Before you move on

What does விளக்கு mean? ("a lamp".) Say it once more.

44.4 உப்பு (uppu) — salt

Before the new one: what did *viḷakku* mean?

You'll want to know: உப்பு

உப்பு (*uppu*) — "salt".

Proto-Dravidian ***upp-**, and none of the four sisters did much to it: Malayalam ഉപ്പ്, Telugu ఉప్పు, Kannada ಉಪ್ಪು. Set them beside உப்பு and you are looking at one word in four hands.

A word that stable is usually a word nobody could do without. Salt is also how Tamil talks about savour in general — food with no *uppu* in it is food with nothing in it at all.

In the family, and next door

	word	same root
Kannada	ಉಪ್ಪು (*uppu*)	yes
Telugu	ఉప్పు (*uppu*)	yes
Malayalam	ഉപ്പ് (*uppŭ*)	yes
Hindi (neighbour)	नमक (*namak*)	
English	salt	

What you've built

Four, and this one has not changed in a very long time.

Your turn

- *Say it: uppu*
- *Say it:* it once more, slowly
- *Say it: viḷakku*, then *uppu*, and let the second one stop short
- *Read it:* கொடு
- *Recall:* say *makaḷ*

Before you move on

What does உப்பு mean? ("salt".) Say it once more.

44.5 புத்தகம் (puttakam) — a book

Before the new one: what did *uppu* mean?

You'll want to know: புத்தகம்

புத்தகம் (*puttakam*) — "a book".

Sanskrit *pustaka*, taken in whole, with the *-am* Tamil puts on the end of such arrivals — the same *-am* already sitting on *kuṭumbam*. Malayalam **പുസ്തകം**, Telugu **పుస్తకం** and Kannada **ಪುಸ್ತಕ** are the same borrowing, so the four agree here for a different reason than they agree about salt: not descent, but a shared debt.

Tamil kept its own word alongside. **நூல்** (*nūl*) is a thread, and thread is what bound palm leaves into a book before there was paper; the same *nūl* still names a written work. The borrowed word and the inherited one divide the job between them rather than fighting over it.

In the family, and next door

	word	same root
Kannada	**ಪುಸ್ತಕ** (*pustaka*)	yes
Telugu	**పుస్తకం** (*pustakaṁ*)	yes
Malayalam	**പുസ്തകം** (*pustakaṁ*)	yes
Hindi (neighbour)	**किताब** (*kitāb*)	
English	a book	

What you've built

Five, and the run is closed: a fruit, cloth, a lamp, salt, a book.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- *puttakam*
- it once more, slowly
- all five in order — *pa̲lam*, *tuṇi*, *viḷakku*, *uppu*, *puttakam*

Before you move on

What does **புத்தகம்** mean? ("a book".) Say it once more.

Chapter 45

More of the Body

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can name five more parts of the body in Tamil, and point to the sound changes that separate them from their Malayalam, Telugu and Kannada cousins.
>
> *Complete TA-C45-stomach and say all five words in order.*

45.1 கண் (kaṇ) — an eye

> Before the new run of words: what did *uppu* mean, and what did *puttakam* mean?

You'll want to know: கண்

கண் (*kaṇ*) — "an eye".

Proto-Dravidian ***kaṇ**, held almost still everywhere it went: Malayalam **കണ്ണ്**, Telugu **కన్ను**, Kannada **ಕಣ್ಣು**. Tamil's is the shortest of the four, one syllable and done.

It reaches well past the face. A *kaṇ* is the joint on a stalk of sugarcane and the mesh of a net — wherever a thing has an opening or a knot, Tamil is willing to call it an eye.

talai and *kai*, the head and the hand, came earlier. The face gets its own turn now, one piece at a time.

In the family, and next door

	word	same root
Kannada	ಕಣ್ಣು (*kaṇṇu*)	yes
Telugu	కన్ను (*kannu*)	yes
Malayalam	കണ്ണ് (*kaṇṇŭ*)	yes
Hindi (neighbour)	आँख (*āṁkh*)	
English	an eye	

What you've built

The first of five more parts of the body.

Your turn

- *Say it: kaṇ*
- *Say it:* it once more, slowly
- *Say it: kaṇ*, then *talai*, so the part and the whole sit together
- *Recall:* say *kuḻandai*
- *Read it:* பழம்

Before you move on

What does கண் mean? ("an eye".) Say it once more.

45.2 காது (kādu) — an ear

Before the new one: what did *kaṇ* mean?

You'll want to know: காது

காது (*kādu*) — "an ear".

Here it is Tamil that stands apart. *kādu* is the ear a Tamil speaker has, and the other three sisters built their everyday word on a different root altogether: Malayalam ചെവി, Telugu చెవి, Kannada ಕಿವಿ.

Tamil owns that root as well. செவி (*sevi*) names the same organ and is kept for poetry and formal speech — so the word the sisters use over breakfast is the one Tamil holds back for its high register. Two words, one ear, and the occasion decides which.

In the family, and next door

	word
Kannada	ಕಿವಿ (*kivi*)
Telugu	చెవి (*cevi*)
Malayalam	ചെവി (*cevi*)
Hindi (neighbour)	कान (*kān*)
English	an ear

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

காது (*kādu*) is native Dravidian. DEDR 1448 lists Malayalam *kātu*.

What you've built

Two: an eye and an ear.

Your turn

- *Say it: kādu*
- *Say it:* it once more, slowly
- *Say it: kaṇ*, then *kādu*, and hear the long *ā* arrive in the second
- *Read it:* மகன்
- *Recall:* say *tuṇi*

Before you move on

What does காது mean? ("an ear".) Say it once more.

45.3 மூக்கு (mūkku) — a nose

Before the new one: what did *kādu* mean?

You'll want to know: மூக்கு

மூக்கு (*mūkku*) — "a nose".

Another word the family barely touched: Malayalam മൂക്ക്, Telugu ముక్కు, Kannada ಮೂಗು. Only the ending moves.

mūkku also names the point of a thing — the prow of a boat, the tip of a pen. Whatever sticks out in front is the nose of it.

In the family, and next door

	word	same root
Kannada	ಮೂಗು (*mūgu*)	yes
Telugu	ముక్కు (*mukku*)	yes
Malayalam	മൂക്ക് (*mūkkŭ*)	yes
Hindi (neighbour)	नाक (*nāk*)	
English	a nose	

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

மூக்கு (*mūkku*) is native Dravidian. DEDR 5024 lists Malayalam *mūkku*, Kannada *mūgu* and Telugu *mukku*.

What you've built

Three, and all three are on the face.

Your turn

- *Say it: mūkku*
- *Say it:* it once more, slowly
- *Say it: kādu*, then *mūkku*, and let the second start long
- *Recall:* say *makaḷ*
- *Read it:* விளக்கு

Before you move on

What does மூக்கு mean? ("a nose".) Say it once more.

45.4 பல் (pal) — a tooth

Before the new one: what did *mūkku* mean?

You'll want to know: பல்

பல் (*pal*) — "a tooth".

Proto-Dravidian ***pal***, and the sisters pulled it three ways. Malayalam പല്ല്, Kannada ಹಲ್ಲು, Telugu పన్ను. Kannada is the odd one again, with the same *p-* to *h-* shift the fruit-word showed; Telugu turned the *l* into an *n*. Tamil stops the word dead on its *l* and adds nothing.

In everyday speech it often comes out *pallu*, with the *l* doubled — which is exactly the shape Malayalam and Kannada put on the page.

In the family, and next door

	word	**same root**
Kannada	ಹಲ್ಲು (*hallu*)	yes
Telugu	పన్ను (*pannu*)	yes
Malayalam	പല്ല് (*pallŭ*)	yes
Hindi (neighbour)	दाँत (*danta*)	
English	a tooth	

What you've built

Four, and the first one you can bite with.

Your turn

- *Say it: pal*
- *Say it:* it once more, slowly
- *Say it: mūkku*, then *pal*, and cut the second one short
- *Read it:* குடும்பம்
- *Recall:* say *uppu*

Before you move on

What does பல் mean? ("a tooth".) Say it once more.

45.5 வயிறு (vayi̲ru) — the stomach

Before the new one: what did *pal* mean?

You'll want to know: വയിറു

വയിറു (*vayiṟu*) — "the stomach".

The റ in the middle is the hard *ṟ* this book met at *aṟai*, 'a room' — not the soft *r* of *peyar*. Malayalam says **വയറ്**, the same word; Telugu and Kannada went elsewhere entirely for this one.

Where an English speaker says they are hungry, Tamil is happy to talk about the *vayiṟu* and leave the person out of it: the belly is what is empty, and you merely own it. That is the same habit behind *uṅgaḷ uḍambu eppaḍi irukku*, where the health question hangs on the body rather than on you.

In the family, and next door

	word	same root
Kannada	**ಹೊಟ್ಟೆ** (*hoṭṭe*)	
Telugu	**కడుపు** (*kaḍupu*)	
Malayalam	**വയറ്** (*vayaṟŭ*)	yes
Hindi (neighbour)	**पेट** (*peṭ*)	
English	the stomach	

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

വയിറു (*vayiṟu*) is native Dravidian. DEDR 5259 lists Malayalam *vayaṟu* and Kannada *basaṟ*.

What you've built

That closes the run: an eye, an ear, a nose, a tooth, and what holds the food.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- *vayiṟu*
- it once more, slowly
- all five in order — *kaṇ*, *kādu*, *mūkku*, *pal*, *vayiṟu*

Before you move on

What does **വയിറു** mean? ("the stomach".) Say it once more.

Chapter 46

Who Somebody Is

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say what somebody's work is in Tamil, and recognise the endings that mark a man, a woman and respect.
>
> *Complete TA-C46-guest and say all five words in order.*

46.1 ஆசிரியர் (āsiriyar) — a teacher

> Before the new run of words: what did *pal* mean, and what did *vayi̲ru* mean?

You'll want to know: ஆசிரியர்

ஆசிரியர் (*āsiriyar*) — "a teacher".

Sanskrit *ācārya*, one who teaches by how they behave, arriving in Tamil with *-ar* on the end — the respectful ending already met on *ivar* and *naṇbar*. So the word is polite before it is anything else: there is no way to say it that does not show regard.

Tamil keeps the older and plainer **ஆசான்** (*āsā̲n*) beside it, and that one is what a student of an art calls a master.

In the family, and next door

	word
Kannada	ಶಿಕ್ಷಕ (*śikṣaka*)
Telugu	గురువు (*guruvu*)
Malayalam	അധ്യാപകൻ (*adhyāpakan*)
Hindi (neighbour)	शिक्षक (*śikṣak*)
English	a teacher

What you've built

The first of five ways to say who somebody is.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *āsiriyar*
- *Say it:* it once more, slowly
- *Say it:* *āsiriyar*, then *naṇbar*, and hear the same ending on both
- *Recall:* say *pa̲lam*
- *Read it:* கண்

Before you move on

What does ஆசிரியர் mean? ("a teacher".) Say it once more.

46.2 மாணவன் (māṇava̲n) — a student

Before the new one: what did *āsiriyar* mean?

You'll want to know: மாணவன்

மாணவன் (*māṇava̲n*) — "a student".

Sanskrit *māṇava*, 'a young person', with the *-a̲n* Tamil puts on a male — the same *-a̲n* as *maka̲n* and *naṇba̲n*.

Change the ending and the person changes with it: *māṇavi* is a girl studying, *māṇavar* is said with respect or of more than one. One stem, three endings, and you already had all three.

In the family, and next door

	word
Kannada	ವಿದ್ಯಾರ್ಥಿ (*vidyārthi*)
Telugu	విద్యార్థి (*vidyārthi*)
Malayalam	വിദ്യാർത്ഥി (*vidyārtthi*)
Hindi (neighbour)	छात्र (*chātra*)
English	a student

What you've built

Two: the one who teaches and the one who is taught.

Your turn

- *Say it: māṇavaṉ*
- *Say it:* it once more, slowly
- *Say it: āsiriyar*, then *māṇavaṉ*, so the pair sit together
- *Read it:* துணி
- *Recall:* say *kādu*

Before you move on

What does மாணவன் mean? ("a student".) Say it once more.

46.3 மருத்துவர் (maruttuvar) — a doctor

Before the new one: what did *māṇavaṉ* mean?

You'll want to know: மருத்துவர்

மருத்துவர் (*maruttuvar*) — "a doctor".

This one is Tamil's own. It stands on மருந்து (*marundu*), 'medicine', and takes the same respectful *-ar*: the person who deals in medicine.

Beside it sits *vaittiyar*, from Sanskrit *vaidya*, doing the same work with borrowed material. Where a language has both, it usually has a preference, and modern Tamil leans on *maruttuvar* — the signboard on the hospital says so.

In the family, and next door

	word
Kannada	ವೈದ್ಯ (*vaidya*)
Telugu	వైద్యుడు (*vaidyuḍu*)
Malayalam	വൈദ്യൻ (*vaidyan*)
Hindi (neighbour)	डाक्टर (*ḍākṭar*)
English	a doctor

What you've built

Three, and the third one you hope to need rarely.

Your turn

- *Say it: maruttuvar*
- *Say it:* it once more, slowly
- *Say it: māṇavaṉ*, then *maruttuvar*, and hear the ending change
- *Recall:* say *viḷakku*
- *Read it:* மூக்கு

Before you move on

What does மருத்துவர் mean? ("a doctor".) Say it once more.

46.4 விவசாயி (vivasāyi) — a farmer

Before the new one: what did *maruttuvar* mean?

You'll want to know: விவசாயி

விவசாயி (*vivasāyi*) — "a farmer".

The ending is *-i*, which Tamil hangs on somebody by their work rather than by their sex, so the one word covers a man and a woman alike.

The stem is borrowed. The inherited word is உழவன் (*uḻavaṉ*), built straight on *uḻu*, 'to plough', and it carries an older weight — Tamil poetry praises the *uḻavaṉ*, while a form at an office asks for the *vivasāyi*. Two words, one occupation, two registers.

In the family, and next door

	word
Kannada	ರೈತ (*raita*)
Telugu	రైతు (*raitu*)
Malayalam	കർഷകൻ (*karṣakan*)
Hindi (neighbour)	किसान (*kisān*)
English	a farmer

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

விவசாயி (*vivasāyi*) is built on *vivasāyam*, "farming", a loan from Sanskrit *vyavasāya*, "effort, undertaking", with *-i* for the person who does it. In Tamil the word narrowed from any undertaking to the work of the fields.

What you've built

Four, and the fourth one feeds the other three.

Your turn

- *Say it: vivasāyi*
- *Say it:* it once more, slowly
- *Say it: maruttuvar*, then *vivasāyi*, and let the second end on *-i*
- *Read it:* உப்பு
- *Recall:* say *pal*

Before you move on

What does விவசாயி mean? ("a farmer".) Say it once more.

46.5 விருந்தாளி (viruntāḷi) — a guest

Before the new one: what did *vivasāyi* mean?

You'll want to know: விருந்தாளி

விருந்தாளி (*viruntāḷi*) — "a guest".

Take it apart and the guest is named after the meal. The first half is *virundu*, a feast laid on for somebody; the second is *āḷi*, from *āḷ*, 'a person'. A guest, in Tamil, is the person a feast is for — the obligation is inside the word, not added to it afterwards.

There is an older form too, *viruntiṉar*, carrying the *-ar* you now know well. Both say the same thing: somebody has arrived, and there will be food.

In the family, and next door

	word
Kannada	**ಅತಿಥಿ** (*atithi*)
Telugu	**అతిథి** (*atithi*)
Malayalam	**അതിഥി** (*atithi*)
Hindi (neighbour)	**मेहमान** (*mehmān*)
English	a guest

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

விருந்தாளி (*viruntāḷi*) is native: *viruntu*, "feast, guest" (DEDR 5415; Malayalam *virunnu*), and *āḷ*, "person". The guest is the one the feast is for.

What you've built

That closes the run: a teacher, a student, a doctor, a farmer, a guest.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *viruntāḷi*
- *Say it:* it once more, slowly
- *Say it:* all five in order — *āsiriyar*, *māṇavaṉ*, *maruttuvar*, *vivasāyi*, *viruntāḷi*
- *Recall:* say *puttakam*
- *Read it:* **வயிறு**

Before you move on

What does **விருந்தாளி** mean? (“a guest”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 47

Short Replies

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can answer with five short replies in Tamil, from a flat agreement to a hedge.
>
> *Complete TA-C47-just-so and say all five words in order.*

47.1 உண்மை (uṇmai) — the truth

> Before the new run of words: what did *vivasāyi* mean, and what did *viruntāḷi* mean?

You'll want to know: உண்மை

உண்மை (*uṇmai*) — "the truth".

It is built out of *uḷ*, 'to be, to exist', and the *-mai* Tamil adds to turn a quality into something you can name. The truth, then, is is-ness: what is the case.

As a reply it stands on its own. Somebody tells you something surprising and *uṇmai* means "true" — and *uṇmaiyā?*, with the question fixed to the end, means "really?".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

உண்மை (*uṇmai*) is native Dravidian. DEDR 697 lists Malayalam *uḷ*, "to be there". It is the noun of *uḷ*, "to be, to exist": the truth is what is.

What you've built

The first of five short replies.

Your turn

- *Say it: uṇmai*
- *Say it:* it once more, slowly
- *Say it: uṇmai*, then *sari*, so the two agreements sit together
- *Recall:* say *kaṇ*
- *Read it:* ஆசிரியர்

Before you move on

What does **உண்மை** mean? ("the truth".) Say it once more.

47.2 போதும் (pōdum) — that is enough

Before the new one: what did *uṇmai* mean?

You'll want to know: போதும்

போதும் (*pōdum*) — "that is enough".

It grows out of *pōdu*, 'to suffice', and it is the polite full stop of a Tamil meal: your host is serving, your plate is filling, and *pōdum* stops it without giving offence. Said twice — *pōdum pōdum* — it means you are serious.

It has nothing to do with *pō*, 'to go', though the two look alike at a glance. Different roots, similar clothes.

In the family, and next door

	word
Telugu	సరిపోతుంది (*saripōtundi*)
English	that is enough

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

போதும் (*pōdum*) is native Dravidian. DEDR 4594 lists Malayalam *pōruka*, "to suffice".

What you've built

Two: agreeing, and calling a halt.

Your turn

- *Say it: pōdum*
- *Say it:* it once more, slowly
- *Say it: uṇmai*, then *pōdum*, and let the second land firmly
- *Read it:* காது
- *Recall:* say *māṇavaṉ*

Before you move on

What does போதும் mean? ("that is enough".) Say it once more.

47.3 நிச்சயமாக (niccayamāka) — certainly

Before the new one: what did *pōdum* mean?

You'll want to know: நிச்சயமாக

நிச்சயமாக (*niccayamāka*) — "certainly".

Sanskrit *niścaya*, 'a settled thing', plus -*āka*, the ending Tamil adds when a word is to describe how something is done. *niccayam* on its own is the certainty; *niccayamāka* is doing the thing certainly.

That same -*āka* is inside *nalamāka*, from the answer about being well, so the shape is already in your ear.

In the family, and next door

	word
Telugu	తప్పకుండా (*tappakuṇḍā*)
Malayalam	തീർച്ചയായും (*tīrccayāyuṁ*)
Hindi (neighbour)	ज़रूर (*zarūr*)
English	certainly

What you've built

Three, and the third leaves no room for doubt.

Your turn

- *Say it: niccayamāka*
- *Say it:* it once more, slowly
- *Say it: pōdum*, then *niccayamāka*, and feel how much longer the second is
- *Recall:* say *mūkku*
- *Read it:* மருத்துவர்

Before you move on

What does நிச்சயமாக mean? ("certainly".) Say it once more.

47.4 ஒருவேளை (oruvēḷai) — perhaps

Before the new one: what did *niccayamāka* mean?

You'll want to know: ஒருவேளை

ஒருவேளை (*oruvēḷai*) — "perhaps".

Two pieces welded together: *oru*, 'one', which you have, and *vēḷai*, 'an occasion, a time', which you have not. One occasion out of the several that could happen — which is exactly the claim "perhaps" makes.

Tamil builds its hedge out of counting. English does the same trick with "maybe", which is a "may" and a "be" pushed against each other until they stuck.

In the family, and next door

	word
Kannada	ಬಹುಶಃ (*bahuśaḥ*)
Telugu	ఏమో (*ēmō*)
Malayalam	ഒരുപക്ഷേ (*orupakṣē*)
Hindi (neighbour)	शायद (*śāyad*)
English	perhaps

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

ஒருவேளை (*oruvēḷai*) is "one time, at one moment": *oru*, "one", native (DEDR 990), and *vēḷai*, "time", a loan from Sanskrit *velā*, "limit, time" (CDIAL 12115). CDIAL adds that *velā* itself probably came from Dravidian.

What you've built

Four, and the fourth one steps back from the other three.

Your turn

- *Say it: oruvēḷai*
- *Say it:* it once more, slowly
- *Say it: niccayamāka*, then *oruvēḷai*, and hear the certainty drain out
- *Read it:* பல்
- *Recall:* say *vivasāyi*

Before you move on

What does ஒருவேளை mean? ("perhaps".) Say it once more.

47.5 அப்படியே (appaḍiyē) — just so

Before the new one: what did *oruvēḷai* mean?

You'll want to know: அப்படியே

அப்படியே (*appaḍiyē*) — "just so".

The front of it is the far pointer *a-* from *adu* and *aṅgē*; *appaḍi* is 'in that manner'; and the *-ē* on the end is how Tamil presses down on a word. In that manner, precisely.

Move the pointer and the whole set follows: *ippaḍi*, 'like this', and *eppaḍi*, 'how' — which you have been saying since you first asked somebody how they were. One pattern, three words, and only the front letter moves.

In the family, and next door

	word
Telugu	అలాగే (*alāgē*)
English	just so

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

அப்படியே (*appaḍiyē*) is native: the far base *a-* (DEDR 1, which lists *appaṭi*, "thus") with *paṭi*, "manner", and the stressing *-ē*: "in just that way".

What you've built

That closes the run: true, enough, certainly, perhaps, just so.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *appaḍiyē*
- *Say it:* it once more, slowly
- *Say it:* all five in order — *uṇmai*, *pōdum*, *niccayamāka*, *oruvēḷai*, *appaḍiyē*
- *Recall:* say *vayi̲ru*
- *Read it:* விருந்தாளி

Before you move on

What does அப்படியே mean? ("just so".) Say it once more.

Chapter 48

Setting Out

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say that it is time, that I have a journey, and that I am setting out in Tamil.
>
> *Complete TA-C48-set-out and say all five words in order.*

48.1 இப்போது (ippōdu) — now

> Before the new run of words: what did *oruvēḷai* mean, and what did *appaḍiyē* mean?

You'll want to know: இப்போது

இப்போது (*ippōdu*) — "now".

The same pattern as the word that closed the run before, wearing the near pointer instead of the far one: *i-* and *pōdu*, 'a time'. This time. And *appōdu* is that time, then.

In speech it usually shortens to *ippō*, the way English lets "going to" collapse into "gonna". The full form is what you write; the short one is what you hear.

In the family, and next door

	word	same root
Kannada	ಈಗ (*īga*)	
Telugu	ఇప్పుడు (*ippuḍu*)	yes
Malayalam	ഇപ്പോൾ (*ippōḷ*)	yes
Hindi (neighbour)	अब (*ab*)	
English	now	

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

இப்போது (*ippōdu*) is native: the near base *i-* (DEDR 410) and *pōtu*, "time" (DEDR 4559; Malayalam *pōtu*). "This time" is "now".

What you've built

The first of five words for going.

Your turn

- *Say it: ippōdu*
- *Say it:* it once more, slowly
- *Say it: appaḍiyē*, then *ippōdu*, and hear the pointer swap ends
- *Recall:* say *āsiriyar*
- *Read it:* உண்மை

Before you move on

What does இப்போது mean? ("now".) Say it once more.

48.2 நேரம் (nēram) — time

Before the new one: what did *ippōdu* mean?

You'll want to know: நேரம்

நேரம் (*nēram*) — "time".

Not the hour on the clock — that is *maṇi*, which you already have — but time as a quantity of it: whether there is any, whether this is the right one, whether it has run out.

nēram āccu is how a Tamil speaker says the moment has come, and it is very often the sentence that ends a visit. Nobody has to be rude about leaving if the clock can be blamed.

In the family, and next door

	word
Malayalam	സമയം (*samayam*)
English	time

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

நேரம் (*nēram*) is native Dravidian. DEDR 3774 lists Malayalam *nēram*.

What you've built

Two: this moment, and the stuff moments are made of.

Your turn

- *Say it: nēram*
- *Say it:* it once more, slowly
- *Say it: ippōdu*, then *nēram*, so the two sit together
- *Read it:* மாணவன்
- *Recall:* say *pōdum*

Before you move on

What does நேரம் mean? ("time".) Say it once more.

48.3 பயணம் (payaṇam) — a journey

Before the new one: what did *nēram* mean?

You'll want to know: பயணம்

பயணம் (*payaṇam*) — "a journey".

Beside it Tamil also keeps *pirayāṇam*, straight from Sanskrit *prayāṇa*, and the pair divides the work the way *nalam* and *sugam* did: the shorter word is the everyday one, the longer is what goes into writing.

Somebody travelling is a *payaṇi*, with the same *-i* ending that made the farmer out of his field.

In the family, and next door

	word	same root
Kannada	ಪ್ರಯಾಣ (*prayāṇa*)	yes
Telugu	ప్రయాణం (*prayāṇaṁ*)	yes
Malayalam	യാത്ര (*yātra*)	
Hindi (neighbour)	सफ़र (*safar*)	
English	a journey	

What you've built

Three, and the third one takes you somewhere.

Your turn

- *Say it: payaṇam*
- *Say it:* it once more, slowly
- *Say it: nēram*, then *payaṇam*, and hear both endings agree
- *Recall:* say *maruttuvar*
- *Read it:* நிச்சயமாக

Before you move on

What does பயணம் mean? ("a journey".) Say it once more.

48.4 பிறகு (piṟaku) — afterwards

Before the new one: what did *payaṇam* mean?

You'll want to know: பிறகு

பிறகு (*piṟaku*) — "afterwards".

Underneath it is *piṉ*, 'behind'. What sits behind you in space becomes what comes after you in time, and Tamil made that move so long ago that nobody hears it any more. English did the same thing with "before", which began as a word about the front of things.

As a way of parting it is gentle and slightly vague: *piṟaku pārkkalām*, "we'll see each other later", promises nothing and closes the conversation kindly.

In the family, and next door

	word
Kannada	ಆಮೇಲೆ (*āmēle*)
English	afterwards

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

பிறகு (*piṟaku*) is native Dravidian. DEDR 4205 lists Malayalam *pin*, Kannada *pin* and Telugu *piṟu*. The entry lists *piṟaku* among the words built on *piṉ*, "behind, after".

What you've built

Four, and the fourth one puts off the parting.

Your turn

- *Say it: piṟaku*
- *Say it:* it once more, slowly
- *Say it: payaṇam*, then *piṟaku*, and let the hard *ṟ* land in the second
- *Read it:* விவசாயி
- *Recall:* say *oruvēḷai*

Before you move on

What does பிறகு mean? ("afterwards".) Say it once more.

48.5 புறப்படு (puṟappaḍu) — to set out

Before the new one: what did *piṟaku* mean?

You'll want to know: புறப்படு

புறப்படு (*puṟappaḍu*) — "to set out".

Two pieces, both still visible. *puṟam* is the outside, and *paḍu* is the all-purpose ending Tamil uses when something happens to you. To *puṟappaḍu* is to come to be outside — which is what leaving a house actually consists of.

nāṉ puṟappaḍugiṟēṉ announces your departure with none of the weight of *pōy varugiṟēṉ*. It is what you say at the door with your bag already in your hand.

In the family, and next door

	word	same root
Kannada	ಹೊರಡು (*horaḍu*)	yes
Telugu	బయలుదేరు (*bayaludēru*)	
Malayalam	പുറപ്പെടുക (*puṟappeṭuka*)	yes
Hindi (neighbour)	निकलना (*nikalnā*)	
English	to set out	

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

புறப்படு (*puṟappaḍu*) is native: *puṟam*, "outside" (DEDR 4333; Malayalam *puṟam*), and *paṭu*, "to become" (DEDR 3853). To set out is "to get outside".

What you've built

That closes the run: now, time, a journey, afterwards, and getting up to go.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *puṟappaḍu*
- *Say it:* it once more, slowly
- *Say it:* all five in order — *ippōdu*, *nēram*, *payaṇam*, *piṟaku*, *puṟappaḍu*
- *Recall:* say *viruntāḷi*
- *Read it:* அப்படியே

Before you move on

What does புறப்படு mean? (“to set out”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 49

Courtesy

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can thank somebody warmly in Tamil, show respect, and wish them well.
>
> *Complete TA-C49-many-thanks and say all five words in order.*

49.1 அன்பு (aṉbu) — affection

Before the new run of words: what did *piṟaku* mean, and what did *puṟappaḍu* mean?

You'll want to know: அன்பு

அன்பு (*aṉbu*) — "affection".

This is the warm, ordinary love — for a family, for a friend, for a place. *kādal* is the other kind, the one the poems are about, and Tamil keeps the two apart where English makes one word do both.

A letter opens *aṉbuḷḷa*, "dear", which is literally 'having affection'. Put the endings you know on the stem and you get *aṉbaṉ* and *aṉbar*, somebody who loves — the same two endings, doing the same work, on new material.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

அன்பு (*aṉbu*) is native Dravidian. DEDR 330 lists Malayalam *anpu* and Kannada *aṇpu*, "friendship".

What you've built

The first of five courtesies.

Your turn

- *Say it: aṉbu*
- *Say it:* it once more, slowly
- *Say it: aṉbu*, then *aṉbuḷḷa*, and hear the stem stay put
- *Recall:* say *uṇmai*
- *Read it:* இப்போது

Before you move on

What does அன்பு mean? ("affection".) Say it once more.

49.2 மரியாதை (mariyādai) — respect

Before the new one: what did *aṉbu* mean?

You'll want to know: மரியாதை

மரியாதை (*mariyādai*) — "respect".

Sanskrit *maryādā*, which started life as a boundary mark — the line at the edge of a field. Respect, in that picture, is knowing where the line runs and not stepping over it.

Tamil shows it in its endings as much as in its words. You have been doing it since *nīṅgaḷ*, where the ending meant for many is aimed at one person on purpose: *mariyādai* built out of shape rather than out of vocabulary.

In the family, and next door

	word
Kannada	ಗೌರವ (*gaurava*)
Telugu	గౌరవం (*gauravaṁ*)
Malayalam	ബഹുമാനം (*bahumānaṁ*)
Hindi (neighbour)	आदर (*ādar*)
English	respect

What you've built

Two: what you feel, and what you show.

Your turn

- *Say it: mariyādai*
- *Say it:* it once more, slowly
- *Say it: aṉbu*, then *mariyādai*, so the warm one and the formal one sit together
- *Read it:* போதும்
- *Recall:* say *nēram*

Before you move on

What does மரியாதை mean? ("respect".) Say it once more.

49.3 சந்தோஷம் (santōṣam) — gladness

Before the new one: what did *mariyādai* mean?

You'll want to know: சந்தோஷம்

சந்தோஷம் (*santōṣam*) — "gladness".

Sanskrit *santoṣa*, 'contentment', sitting beside the native *magiḻcci* you met when somebody was pleased to see you. Both are in daily use and neither has driven the other out — the same arrangement as *nalam* and *sugam*.

santōṣam is what you reach for when you accept an invitation. On its own, in reply, it means "gladly".

What you've built

Three, and the third one is an answer as much as a feeling.

Your turn

- *Say it: santōṣam*
- *Say it:* it once more, slowly
- *Say it: mariyādai*, then *santōṣam*, and let the second one lift
- *Recall:* say *niccayamāka*
- *Read it:* பயணம்

Before you move on

What does சந்தோஷம் mean? ("gladness".) Say it once more.

49.4 வாழ்த்து (vāḻttu) — a good wish

Before the new one: what did *santōṣam* mean?

You'll want to know: வாழ்த்து

வாழ்த்து (*vāḻttu*) — "a good wish".

Straight off *vāḻ*, 'to live, to flourish', which you had early. To give somebody a *vāḻttu* is to wish them a life — not luck, not success, but the thing itself.

vāḻttukkaḷ is what a Tamil speaker says where English says "congratulations", and it is the kinder sentence of the two: flourishing, offered in the plural, rather than a nod at what you managed to pull off.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

வாழ்த்து (*vāḻttu*) is native Dravidian. DEDR 5372 lists Malayalam *vāḻttuka*, "to bless". It is the noun of *vāḻ*, "to live": a good wish says "may you live well".

What you've built

Four, and the fourth one is given rather than felt.

Your turn

- *Say it: vāḻttu*
- *Say it:* it once more, slowly
- *Say it: santōṣam*, then *vāḻttu*, and feel the ழ glide in the second
- *Read it:* ஒருவேளை
- *Recall:* say *piṟaku*

Before you move on

What does வாழ்த்து mean? ("a good wish".) Say it once more.

49.5 மிக்க நன்றி (mikka naṉṟi) — thank you very much

Before the new one: what did *vāḻttu* mean?

You'll want to know: மிக்க நன்றி

மிக்க நன்றி (*mikka naṉṟi*) — "thank you very much".

naṉṟi has been with you since the very beginning. *mikka* is the new piece in front of it: from *migu*, 'to exceed', so it means abundant, more than the usual measure.

Tamil does not raise its voice to be warm. It puts *mikka* at the front and leaves everything else exactly where it was. Set this beside *tayavu seytu* and *maṉṉikkavum* and the courtesy kit is complete.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

மிக்க நன்றி (*mikka naṉṟi*) is two native words: *mikka*, "great, much", from *miku*, "to exceed" (DEDR 4838; Malayalam *mikka*), and *naṉṟi*, "goodness" (DEDR 3610).

What you've built

That closes the run: affection, respect, gladness, a good wish, and thanks with weight behind it.

Your turn

- *Say it: mikka na<u>n</u><u>r</u>i*
- *Say it:* it once more, slowly
- *Say it:* all five in order — *a<u>n</u>bu*, *mariyādai*, *santōṣam*, *vā<u>l</u>ttu*, *mikka na<u>n</u><u>r</u>i*
- *Recall:* say *appaḍiyē*
- *Read it:* புறப்படு

Before you move on

What does மிக்க நன்றி mean? ("thank you very much".) Say it once more.

Chapter 50

At the Doorway

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can name the five things a guest meets at a Tamil doorway, and welcome them.
>
> *Complete TA-C50-welcome and say all five words in order.*

50.1 வாசல் (vāsal) — a doorway

> Before the new run of words: what did *vāḻttu* mean, and what did *mikka naṉṟi* mean?

You'll want to know: வாசல்

வாசல் (*vāsal*) — "a doorway".

Tamil separates the opening from the thing that shuts it. *kadavu*, which you have, is the door itself — the plank on its hinges. *vāsal* is the doorway: the gap, the step, and the strip of ground in front of it.

Almost everything that happens when a guest arrives happens at the *vāsal* rather than inside it, which is why the word carries more than architecture.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

வாசல் (*vāsal*) is native Dravidian. DEDR 5354 lists Malayalam *vātil*, Kannada *bāgil* and Telugu *vākili*. The entry lists *vāyil* and *vācal* side by side.

What you've built

The first of five things a guest meets at a Tamil door.

Your turn

- *Say it: vāsal*
- *Say it:* it once more, slowly
- *Say it: kadavu*, then *vāsal*, so the door and its opening sit together
- *Recall:* say *ippōdu*
- *Read it:* அன்பு

Before you move on

What does வாசல் mean? ("a doorway".) Say it once more.

50.2 கோலம் (kōlam) — the design at a doorway

Before the new one: what did *vāsal* mean?

You'll want to know: கோலம்

கோலம் (*kōlam*) — "the design at a doorway".

Rice flour, drawn freehand on the ground each morning, usually by the woman of the house and usually before the sun is up. It is decoration and welcome at once — and because the flour feeds ants and birds, it is a small daily gift to whatever comes past.

The older sense of the word is 'form, appearance, the shape a thing takes'. A *kōlam* is the shape the house puts on to receive the day.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

கோலம் (*kōlam*) is native Dravidian. DEDR 2240 lists Malayalam *kōlam*, "form, figure" and Kannada *kōla*, "ornament". The word first meant beauty, form and shape, and the drawing at the door is one of its senses.

What you've built

Two: the doorway, and what is drawn in front of it.

Your turn

- *Say it: kōlam*
- *Say it:* it once more, slowly
- *Say it: vāsal*, then *kōlam*, and let the long *ō* open the second
- *Read it:* நேரம்
- *Recall:* say *mariyādai*

Before you move on

What does கோலம் mean? ("the design at a doorway".) Say it once more.

50.3 மலர் (malar) — a flower

Before the new one: what did *kōlam* mean?

You'll want to know: மலர்

மலர் (*malar*) — "a flower".

The everyday word is *pū*, short and plain. *malar* is its fuller partner, the one that goes into names and poems and careful speech.

It also says what a flower does: *malar* means 'to open, to blossom'. One shape names the act and the result of it, and Tamil saw no reason to invent a second word for the second thing.

In the family, and next door

	word
Telugu	పువ్వు (*puvvu*)
Malayalam	പൂവ് (*pūvŭ*)
Hindi (neighbour)	फूल (*phūl*)
English	a flower

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

மலர் (*malar*) is native Dravidian. DEDR 4739 lists Malayalam *malar* and Kannada *malar*. It is also a verb, *malar*, "to open as a flower, to bloom".

What you've built

Three, and the third one arrives in somebody's hand.

Your turn

- *Say it: malar*
- *Say it:* it once more, slowly
- *Say it: kōlam*, then *malar*, and hear the soft *r* close the second
- *Recall:* say *payaṇam*
- *Read it:* சந்தோஷம்

Before you move on

What does மலர் mean? ("a flower".) Say it once more.

50.4 வெற்றிலை (ve̲r̲rilai) — betel leaf

Before the new one: what did *malar* mean?

You'll want to know: வெற்றிலை

வெற்றிலை (*ve̲r̲rilai*) — "betel leaf".

The end of the word is plain once you have the pieces: *-ilai* is *ilai*, 'a leaf'.

Betel leaf and areca nut, handed over together, are how a Tamil household says the visit mattered and the guest is owed something — at a wedding, at a farewell, at anything that counts. The leaf costs almost nothing and means a great deal, which is the usual arrangement for the things a culture puts at its centre.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

வெற்றிலை (*ve̱r̲rilai*) is native Dravidian. DEDR 5515 lists Malayalam *ve̱r̲r̲-ila*. The second half is the native word for "leaf".

What you've built

Four, and the fourth is the one you are sent home with.

Your turn

- *Say it: ve̱r̲rilai*
- *Say it:* it once more, slowly
- *Say it: malar*, then *ve̱r̲rilai*, and let the hard *r̲* double in the second
- *Read it:* பிறகு
- *Recall:* say *vā̱lttu*

Before you move on

What does வெற்றிலை mean? ("betel leaf".) Say it once more.

50.5 வரவேற்பு (varavē̱rpu) — a welcome

Before the new one: what did *ve̱r̲rilai* mean?

You'll want to know: வரவேற்பு

வரவேற்பு (*varavē̱rpu*) — "a welcome".

Two pieces you can almost hear coming apart. *vara* is the coming, from *vā*, the word for 'come' you already have; *ē̱rpu* is the accepting, from *ē̱r̲r̲u*, 'to receive'. A welcome, in Tamil, is the acceptance of somebody's arrival, and the word says that and nothing more.

varavē̱rkire̱n is "I welcome you". At the *vāsal*, over the *kōlam*, with a *malar* and a *ve̱r̲rilai* in hand, it is the last thing left to say at a door — and it sets you back down exactly where this book began, at a door, with *vaṇakkam*.

In the family, and next door

	word
Kannada	ಸ್ವಾಗತ (*svāgata*)
Telugu	స్వాగతం (*svāgatam*)
Malayalam	സ്വാഗതം (*svāgatam*)
English	a welcome

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

வரவேற்பு (*varavēr̲pu*) is native: *varavu*, "coming", from *varu*, "to come" (DEDR 5270), and *ēr̲pu*, "receiving", from *ēl*, "to receive, to welcome" (DEDR 905). A welcome is "receiving someone's coming".

What you've built

That closes the run: a doorway, a design, a flower, a leaf, and the word for taking somebody in.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *varavēr̲pu*
- *Say it:* it once more, slowly
- *Say it:* all five in order — *vāsal*, *kōlam*, *malar*, *ver̲r̲ilai*, *varavēr̲pu*
- *Recall:* say *pur̲appaḍu*
- *Read it:* மிக்க நன்றி

Before you move on

What does வரவேற்பு mean? ("a welcome".) Say it once more.

Chapter 51

Overhead

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can name the sky, the sun, the moon, the stars and a cloud in Tamil.
>
> *Complete TA-C51-cloud and say all five words in order.*

51.1 ஆகாயம் (ākāyam) — the sky

Before the new run of words: what did *veṟṟilai* mean, and what did *varavēṟpu* mean?

You'll want to know: ஆகாயம்

ஆகாயம் (*ākāyam*) — "the sky".

Sanskrit *ākāśa*, the open lit space. Malayalam and Telugu both keep the *ś* their letters can write and say *ākāśaṁ*. Tamil has no letter for that sound, so the word arrives softened, with a ய standing where the *ś* was, and settles as **ஆகாயம்**.

Tamil's own inherited word for the same overhead space is *vāṉ*, which you have already met inside *vāṉilai*, the weather — the standing of the sky. **ஆகாயம்** took the wider and emptier sense: not the weather over your head but the space itself.

In the family, and next door

	word	same root
Kannada	ಆಕಾಶ (*ākāśa*)	yes
Telugu	ఆకాశం (*ākāśaṁ*)	yes
Malayalam	ആകാശം (*ākāśaṁ*)	yes
Hindi (neighbour)	आसमान (*āsmān*)	
English	the sky	

What you've built

The first of five things above you.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *ākāyam*
- *Say it:* it once more, slowly
- *Say it:* *vaṇakkam*, then *ākāyam*, as you would greet somebody out of doors
- *Recall:* say *aṉbu*
- *Read it:* வாசல்

Before you move on

What does ஆகாயம் mean? ("the sky".) Say it once more.

51.2 சூரியன் (sūriyaṉ) — the sun

Before the new one: what did *ākāyam* mean?

You'll want to know: சூரியன்

சூரியன் (*sūriyaṉ*) — "the sun".

Sanskrit *sūrya*, and the three sisters differ only in what they hang on the end of it. Telugu makes సూర్యుడు (*sūryuḍu*), Malayalam *sūryan*, Tamil சூரியன். The ending is the part each language owns; the sun is shared.

Tamil's inherited sun is *ñāyiṟu*, the word standing behind the name of the first day of the week you already count through. It stepped back into the calendar and into poetry and left the daily sun to சூரியன்.

In the family, and next door

	word	same root
Kannada	ಸೂರ್ಯ (*sūrya*)	yes
Telugu	సూర్యుడు (*sūryuḍu*)	yes
Malayalam	സൂര്യൻ (*sūryan*)	yes
Hindi (neighbour)	सूरज (*sūraj*)	yes
English	the sun	

What you've built

Two: the space, and the thing that lights it.

Your turn

- *Say it: sūriyaṉ*
- *Say it:* it once more, slowly
- *Say it: ākāyam*, then *sūriyaṉ*, the sky first and then what is in it
- *Read it:* மரியாதை
- *Recall:* say *kōlam*

Before you move on

What does சூரியன் mean? ("the sun".) Say it once more.

51.3 நிலா (nilā) — the moon

Before the new one: what did *sūriyaṉ* mean?

You'll want to know: நிலா

நிலா (*nilā*) — "the moon".

Where both sisters took the Sanskrit moon — *candran* in Malayalam, *candruḍu* in Telugu — Tamil's everyday moon is its own. நிலா is inherited, and it is the moon as light rather than as a body: *nilā* is what lies on a courtyard at night, the moonlight and the moon in one word. Tamil has *cantiraṉ* as well, from the same Sanskrit its sisters took, and saves it for almanacs and for verse.

Let the ஆ at the end run long. It is the length that makes the word.

In the family, and next door

	word
Kannada	ಚಂದ್ರ (*candra*)
Telugu	చంద్రుడు (*candruḍu*)
Malayalam	ചന്ദ്രൻ (*candran*)
Hindi (neighbour)	चाँद (*chā̃d*)
English	the moon

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

நிலா (*nilā*) is native Dravidian. DEDR 3754 lists Malayalam *nilā* and Telugu *nela*. The entry glosses it "moonlight, moon".

What you've built

Three: the space, the day light, and the night one.

Your turn

- *Say it: nilā*
- *Say it:* it once more, slowly
- *Say it: sūriyan̲*, then *nilā*, and let the second one end long
- *Recall:* say *santōṣam*
- *Read it:* மலர்

Before you move on

What does நிலா mean? ("the moon".) Say it once more.

51.4 விண்மீன் (viṇmīn̲) — a star

Before the new one: what did *nilā* mean?

You'll want to know: விண்மீன்

விண்மீன் (*viṇmīṉ*) — "a star".

Two pieces, and they come apart cleanly. *viṇ* is the sky as height, the open air above; *mīṉ* is a fish, and from the oldest Tamil poetry onward it is a star as well. A star, in Tamil, is a fish in the sky — a shoal of small bright things moving in something you cannot walk on.

The sisters went other ways. Malayalam takes the Sanskrit **നക്ഷത്രം** (*nakṣatraṁ*); Telugu says **చుక్క** (*cukka*), which is also its word for a dot.

In the family, and next door

	word
Kannada	**ಚುಕ್ಕಿ** (*cukki*)
Telugu	**చుక్క** (*cukka*)
Malayalam	**നക്ഷത്രം** (*nakṣatraṁ*)
Hindi (neighbour)	**तारा** (*tārā*)
English	a star

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

விண்மீன் (*viṇmīṉ*) is native: *viṇ*, "sky" (DEDR 5396; Malayalam *viṇṇu*), and *mīṉ*, "star", from the family of words for flashing and shining (DEDR 4876). A star is "the shining one of the sky".

What you've built

Four, and this one is a picture rather than a name.

Your turn

- *Say it: viṇmīṉ*
- *Say it:* it once more, slowly
- *Say it: nilā*, then *viṇmīṉ*, the big light and then the small ones
- *Read it:* **வாழ்த்து**
- *Recall:* say *verrilai*

Before you move on

What does **விண்மீன்** mean? ("a star".) Say it once more.

51.5 மேகம் (mēkam) — a cloud

Before the new one: what did *viṇmīṉ* mean?

You'll want to know: மேகம்

மேகம் (*mēkam*) — "a cloud".

Sanskrit *megha*, taken in whole. Tamil has inherited cloud-words too — *mukil* and *kār*, both still alive in names and in verse — but **மேகம்** is the one doing the daily work.

Telugu did not borrow here at all: its cloud is *mabbu*, its own. Which words a language takes and which it keeps is rarely tidy. On the sky the two of them borrowed together; on the cloud they part.

In the family, and next door

	word
Kannada	ಮೋಡ (*mōḍa*)
Telugu	మబ్బు (*mabbu*)
Hindi (neighbour)	बादल (*bādal*)
English	a cloud

What you've built

That is the whole sky: the space, the sun, the moon, the small lights, and the thing that hides them.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *mēkam*
- *Say it:* it once more, slowly
- *Say it:* all five in order — *ākāyam*, *sūriyaṉ*, *nilā*, *viṇmīṉ*, *mēkam*
- *Recall:* say *mikka naṉṟi*
- *Read it:* வரவேற்பு

Before you move on

What does **மேகம்** mean? ("a cloud".) Say it once more.

Chapter 52

A Tree

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can name a tree, its branch, its new shoot, its root and its seed in Tamil.
>
> *Complete TA-C52-seed and say all five words in order.*

52.1 மரம் (maram) — a tree

> Before the new run of words: what did *viṇmīṉ* mean, and what did *mēkam* mean?

You'll want to know: மரம்

மரம் (*maram*) — "a tree".

Proto-Dravidian ***mar-**, and Malayalam did not lay a finger on it: മരം, the same word letter for letter. Telugu went somewhere else entirely, to చెట్టు (*ceṭṭu*) — the ordinary arrangement in this family, where the two closest sisters agree and the third has its own.

maram is the tree standing and the timber cut out of it. A carpenter works in *maram*; so does a forest.

In the family, and next door

	word	**same root**
Kannada	ಮರ (*mara*)	yes
Telugu	చెట్టు (*ceṭṭu*)	
Malayalam	മരം (*maram*)	yes
Hindi (neighbour)	पेड़ (*peṛ*)	
English	a tree	

What you've built

The first of five pieces of one tree.

Your turn

- *Say it: maram*
- *Say it:* it once more, slowly
- *Say it: mēkam*, then *maram*, the cloud and what stands under it
- *Recall:* say *vāsal*
- *Read it:* ஆகாயம்

Before you move on

What does மரம் mean? ("a tree".) Say it once more.

52.2 கிளை (kiḷai) — a branch

Before the new one: what did *maram* mean?

You'll want to know: கிளை

கிளை (*kiḷai*) — "a branch".

Both sisters reach for a word of a different shape here — Malayalam *kompŭ*, Telugu *komma* — where Tamil says **கிளை**.

And a **கிளை** is not only what grows off a tree. A family has them: the branch of a house, the people who come off one trunk. When Tamil calls somebody your *kiḷai*, it is the tree word doing the work, and a bank branch is a *kiḷai* too.

In the family, and next door

	word
Kannada	**ಕೊಂಬೆ** (*kombe*)
Telugu	**కొమ్మ** (*komma*)
Malayalam	**കൊമ്പ്** (*kompŭ*)
English	a branch

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

கிளை (*kiḷai*) is native Dravidian. DEDR 1583 lists Malayalam *kiḷa*, "bud, sprout". The entry gathers words for rising and shooting up: a branch is what shoots out.

What you've built

Two: the trunk, and what comes off it.

Your turn

- *Say it: kiḷai*
- *Say it:* it once more, slowly
- *Say it: maram*, then *kiḷai*, the tree and then what comes off it
- *Read it:* கோலம்
- *Recall:* say *sūriyaṉ*

Before you move on

What does கிளை mean? ("a branch".) Say it once more.

52.3 தளிர் (taḷir) — a tender shoot

Before the new one: what did *kiḷai* mean?

You'll want to know: தளிர்

தளிர் (*taḷir*) — "a tender shoot".

The new growth at the end of a branch: the pale soft leaf before it hardens and goes green. Tamil keeps a word of its own for it rather than calling it a small leaf, which tells you how much attention the thing has had.

taḷirkka is what a tree does after the first rains. Tamil says it of people as well — somebody who has been ill and is picking up again has *taḷirttu*, put out new growth.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

தளிர் (*taḷir*) is native Dravidian. DEDR 3131 lists Malayalam *taḷir* and Kannada *taḷi*, "to sprout".

What you've built

Three: the tree, the branch, and the newest thing on it.

Your turn

- *Say it: taḷir*
- *Say it:* it once more, slowly
- *Say it: kiḷai*, then *taḷir*, the branch and the new thing on the end of it
- *Recall:* say *malar*
- *Read it:* நிலா

Before you move on

What does தளிர் mean? ("a tender shoot".) Say it once more.

52.4 வேர் (vēr) — a root

Before the new one: what did *taḷir* mean?

You'll want to know: வேர்

வேர் (*vēr*) — "a root".

One word in three hands. Malayalam വേര് (*vēruŭ*), Telugu వేరు (*vēru*), Tamil வேர். Set them beside each other and there is nothing left to choose between them.

It is the root of a plant and the bottom of anything else: a tooth has a வேர், and so does a word.

In the family, and next door

	word	same root
Kannada	ಬೇರು (*bēru*)	yes
Telugu	వేరు (*vēru*)	yes
Malayalam	വേര് (*vēruṟ*)	yes
Hindi (neighbour)	जड़ (*jaṛ*)	
English	a root	

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

வேர் (*vēr*) is native Dravidian. DEDR 5535 lists Malayalam *vēr* and Kannada *bēr*.

What you've built

Four: everything above ground, and now the part under it.

Your turn

- *Say it: vēr*
- *Say it:* it once more, slowly
- *Say it: taḷir*, then *vēr*, the top of the tree and the bottom of it
- *Read it:* வெற்றிலை
- *Recall:* say *viṇmīṉ*

Before you move on

What does வேர் mean? ("a root".) Say it once more.

52.5 விதை (vitai) — a seed

Before the new one: what did *vēr* mean?

You'll want to know: விதை

விதை (*vitai*) — "a seed".

Malayalam വിത്ത് (*vittŭ*) and Telugu విత్తనం (*vittanam*) are the same root wearing different endings, and Tamil keeps a *vittu* of its own beside விதை.

விதை is the seed and the sowing of it at once: *vitaikka* is to sow. The thing and what you do with it share one shape, which saves Tamil a word.

In the family, and next door

	word	same root
Kannada	ಬೀಜ (*bīja*)	
Telugu	విత్తనం (*vittanam*)	yes
Malayalam	വിത്ത് (*vittŭ*)	yes
Hindi (neighbour)	बीज (*bīj*)	
English	a seed	

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

விதை (*vitai*) is native Dravidian. DEDR 5401 lists Malayalam *vittu*, Kannada *bittu* and Telugu *vittu*. The verb *vitai* means "to sow".

What you've built

A whole tree, from the seed under it to the softest thing on the end of a branch.

Your turn

- *Say it: vitai*
- *Say it:* it once more, slowly
- *Say it:* all five in order — *maram*, *kiḷai*, *taḷir*, *vēr*, *vitai*
- *Recall:* say *varavēr̲pu*
- *Read it:* மேகம்

Before you move on

What does விதை mean? ("a seed".) Say it once more.

Chapter 53

The Land

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can name a river, a hill, a paddy field, a path and a village in Tamil.
>
> *Complete TA-C53-village and say all five words in order.*

53.1 நதி (nadi) — a river

> Before the new run of words: what did *vēr* mean, and what did *vitai* mean?

You'll want to know: நதி

நதி (*nadi*) — "a river".

Sanskrit *nadī*, and Telugu prints it identically: నది. Malayalam did not take it for the everyday river and says പുഴ (*puḻa*) instead, which is its own.

Tamil's inherited river is ஆறு — the same shape as the six you already count with. Which of the two is meant comes out of what sits around it, and நதி is the one that leaves no room for doubt.

In the family, and next door

	word	same root
Kannada	ನದಿ (*nadi*)	yes
Telugu	నది (*nadi*)	yes
Malayalam	പുഴ (*puḻa*)	
Hindi (neighbour)	नदी (*nadī*)	yes
English	a river	

What you've built

The first of five things in a stretch of country.

Your turn

- *Say it: nadi*
- *Say it:* it once more, slowly
- *Say it: vitai*, then *nadi*, the seed and the water that reaches it
- *Recall:* say *ākāyam*
- *Read it:* மரம்

Before you move on

What does நதி mean? ("a river".) Say it once more.

53.2 மலை (malai) — a hill

Before the new one: what did *nadi* mean?

You'll want to know: மலை

மலை (*malai*) — "a hill".

Proto-Dravidian, and it covers a hill and a mountain both — Tamil does not split them the way English does. Telugu keeps a small hill of its own, గుట్ట (*guṭṭa*).

You have been reading this word all along without being told. The name *Malayāḷam* begins with it: the language of the hill country, named for its hills.

In the family, and next door

	word
Kannada	బెట్ట (*beṭṭa*)
Telugu	గుట్ట (*guṭṭa*)
English	a hill

What you've built

Two: the water, and what it comes down from.

Your turn

- *Say it: malai*
- *Say it:* it once more, slowly
- *Say it: nadi*, then *malai*, the water and the high ground behind it
- *Read it:* சூரியன்
- *Recall:* say *kiḻai*

Before you move on

What does மலை mean? ("a hill".) Say it once more.

53.3 വയൽ (vayal) — a paddy field

Before the new one: what did *malai* mean?

You'll want to know: വയൽ

വയൽ (*vayal*) — "a paddy field".

A wet field: the flooded one that grows rice, not a dry one. Malayalam writes വയൽ and means the same thing by it.

The dry field is a *kollai*, a different word altogether, and the split earns its keep. A farmer telling you which of the two he has is telling you what he can grow on it and when.

In the family, and next door

	word	same root
Kannada	ಹೊಲ (*hola*)	
Telugu	పొలం (*polaṁ*)	
Malayalam	വയൽ (*vayal*)	yes
Hindi (neighbour)	खेत (*khet*)	
English	a paddy field	

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

வயல் (*vayal*) is native Dravidian. DEDR 5258 lists Malayalam *vayal* and Kannada *bayal*.

What you've built

Three: high ground, and now the flat wet ground under it.

Your turn

- *Say it: vayal*
- *Say it:* it once more, slowly
- *Say it: malai*, then *vayal*, the high ground and the flat
- *Recall:* say *nilā*
- *Read it:* தளிர்

Before you move on

What does வயல் mean? ("a paddy field".) Say it once more.

53.4 பாதை (pātai) — a path

Before the new one: what did *vayal* mean?

You'll want to know: பாதை

பாதை (*pātai*) — "a path".

Something you can put your foot on: a track worn into the ground, a lane, a road.

Tamil has *vaḻi* as well, and the two overlap less than they look as though they should. *vaḻi* is the way — the route, the means, the manner of going about something. பாதை stays physical. Malayalam's everyday path-word is വഴി, the same one; Telugu's is *bāṭa*.

In the family, and next door

	word	same root
Telugu	బాట (*bāṭa*)	yes
English	a path	

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

பாதை (*pātai*) is probably a loan from Sanskrit *patha*, "path" (CDIAL 7743), with the Tamil *-ai* ending. DEDR has no native entry for it.

What you've built

Four: three places, and now something joining them.

Your turn

- *Say it: pātai*
- *Say it:* it once more, slowly
- *Say it: vayal*, then *pātai*, the field and the way to it
- *Read it:* விண்மீன்
- *Recall:* say *vēr*

Before you move on

What does பாதை mean? ("a path".) Say it once more.

53.5 கிராமம் (kirāmam) — a village

Before the new one: what did *pātai* mean?

You'll want to know: கிராமம்

கிராமம் (*kirāmam*) — "a village".

Sanskrit *grāma*, and Telugu takes it whole: గ్రామం. Tamil does not begin a word on two held-together sounds, so it let a vowel into the middle of the cluster and the word came out *ki-rā-mam*.

You already have *ūr* for the place you belong to. *ūr* is yours — your town, the one you name when somebody asks where you are from. கிராமம் is the word on the form and on the signboard at the edge of the road.

In the family, and next door

	word	**same root**
Kannada	ಹಳ್ಳಿ (*haḷḷi*)	
Telugu	గ్రామం (*grāmaṁ*)	yes
Malayalam	ഗ്രാമം (*grāmaṁ*)	yes
Hindi (neighbour)	गाँव (*gā̃v*)	
English	a village	

What you've built

Water, high ground, a wet field, a way across it, and the place at the end of the way.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *kirāmam*
- *Say it:* it once more, slowly
- *Say it:* all five in order — *nadi*, *malai*, *vayal*, *pātai*, *kirāmam*
- *Recall:* say *mēkam*
- *Read it:* விதை

Before you move on

What does கிராமம் mean? ("a village".) Say it once more.

Chapter 54

Things in the House

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can name the mat, basket, knife, bowl and box a Tamil house sets out for a guest.
>
> *Complete TA-C54-box and say all five words in order.*

54.1 பாய் (pāy) — a mat

> Before the new run of words: what did *pātai* mean, and what did *kirāmam* mean?

You'll want to know: பாய்

பாய் (*pāy*) — "a mat".

The woven mat that is unrolled to sleep on and unrolled again for a guest to sit on. Malayalam says **പായ** (*pāya*) and Telugu **చాప** (*cāpa*).

பாய் is also 'to leap'. Nothing joins the two but the sound, and what sits around the word settles which is meant — the same one-shape-two-jobs arrangement *tuṇi* already showed you.

In the family, and next door

	word	same root
Kannada	**ಚಾಪೆ** (*cāpe*)	
Telugu	**చాప** (*cāpa*)	
Malayalam	**പായ** (*pāya*)	yes
English	a mat	

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

பாய் (*pāy*) is native Dravidian (DEDR 4088). The entry's verb *pāy* means "to spread", and the noun is "spreading, a mat, a sail": a mat is the thing spread out.

What you've built

The first of five things a house puts in front of you.

Your turn

- *Say it: pāy*
- *Say it:* it once more, slowly
- *Say it: kirāmam*, then *pāy*, the village and what is unrolled for you in it
- *Recall:* say *maram*
- *Read it:* நதி

Before you move on

What does பாய் mean? ("a mat".) Say it once more.

54.2 கூடை (kūṭai) — a basket

Before the new one: what did *pāy* mean?

You'll want to know: கூடை

கூடை (*kūṭai*) — "a basket".

Woven, usually of palm leaf or split bamboo. Malayalam's basket is *koṭṭa* and Telugu's is *buṭṭa*; Tamil's is கூடை.

It is the word for the basket a vendor sets down in front of you on the pavement, and for the one that goes up onto a head to be carried home.

In the family, and next door

	word
Kannada	ಬುಟ್ಟಿ (*buṭṭi*)
Telugu	బుట్ట (*buṭṭa*)
Malayalam	കൊട്ട (*koṭṭa*)
Hindi (neighbour)	टोकरी (*ṭokrī*)
English	a basket

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

கூடை (*kūṭai*) is native Dravidian. DEDR 1884 lists Malayalam *kūṭa*, Kannada *gūḍe* and Telugu *gūḍa*.

What you've built

Two: something to sit on, and something to carry in.

Your turn

- *Say it: kūṭai*
- *Say it:* it once more, slowly
- *Say it: pāy*, then *kūṭai*, and let the long ஊ open the second
- *Read it:* கிளை
- *Recall:* say *malai*

Before you move on

What does கூடை mean? ("a basket".) Say it once more.

54.3 கத்தி (katti) — a knife

Before the new one: what did *kūṭai* mean?

You'll want to know: கத்தி

கத்தி (*katti*) — "a knife".

Three sisters and one word. Malayalam കത്തി, Telugu కత్తి, Tamil கத்தி. Not merely close — the same word three times, which happens with things every household has had for as long as there have been households.

The doubled த in the middle carries the whole difficulty. Hold it: *ka-t-ti*, with the tongue staying where it is between the two.

In the family, and next door

	word	same root
Kannada	ಚಾಕು (*cāku*)	
Telugu	కత్తి (*katti*)	yes
Malayalam	കത്തി (*katti*)	yes
Hindi (neighbour)	छुरी (*churī*)	
English	a knife	

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

கத்தி (*katti*) is native Dravidian. DEDR 1204 lists Malayalam *katti*, Kannada *katti* and Telugu *katti*.

What you've built

Three, and this one is shared right across the family.

Your turn

- *Say it: katti*
- *Say it:* it once more, slowly
- *Say it: kūṭai*, then *katti*, and hold the doubled த
- *Recall:* say *taḷir*
- *Read it:* வயல்

Before you move on

What does கத்தி mean? ("a knife".) Say it once more.

54.4 கிண்ணம் (kiṇṇam) — a bowl

Before the new one: what did *katti* mean?

You'll want to know: கிண்ணம்

கிண்ணம் (*kiṇṇam*) — "a bowl".

The small round one that holds a helping, rather than the pot the food was cooked in. Telugu's గిన్నె (*ginne*) is close enough to hear the same word underneath.

Malayalam reaches past both and takes the Sanskrit പാത്രം (*pātraṁ*), a vessel of any sort. Tamil has that one as well and keeps it general; **கிண்ணம்** stays small.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

கிண்ணம் (*kiṇṇam*) is native Dravidian. DEDR 1543 lists Malayalam *kiṇṇam* and Telugu *ginne*.

What you've built

Four: to sit on, to carry in, to cut with, and to eat from.

Your turn

- *Say it: kiṇṇam*
- *Say it:* it once more, slowly
- *Say it: katti*, then *kiṇṇam*, and let the ண double this time
- *Read it:* வேர்
- *Recall:* say *pātai*

Before you move on

What does **கிண்ணம்** mean? ("a bowl".) Say it once more.

54.5 பெட்டி (peṭṭi) — a box

Before the new one: what did *kiṇṇam* mean?

You'll want to know: பெட்டி

பெட்டி (*peṭṭi*) — "a box".

Malayalam പെട്ടി, Telugu పెట్టె, Tamil பெட்டி — the family agrees again, down to the doubled ட in the middle. Two words in one short run where all three sisters say the same thing is worth noticing.

A பெட்டி is a box of any size: the tin trunk clothes live in, a matchbox, and the carriage of a train, which Tamil calls a *rayil peṭṭi*.

In the family, and next door

	word	same root
Kannada	ಪೆಟ್ಟಿಗೆ (*peṭṭige*)	yes
Telugu	పెట్టె (*peṭṭe*)	yes
Malayalam	പെട്ടി (*peṭṭi*)	yes
Hindi (neighbour)	डिब्बा (*ḍibbā*)	
English	a box	

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

பெட்டி (*peṭṭi*) is native Dravidian. DEDR 4388 lists Malayalam *peṭṭi*, Kannada *peṭṭi* and Telugu *peṭṭe*. The entry compares Sanskrit *peṭaka*, "box" (CDIAL 8164).

What you've built

Five things a house sets out: something to sit on, to carry in, to cut with, to eat from, and to keep it all in.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *peṭṭi*
- *Say it:* it once more, slowly
- *Say it:* all five in order — *pāy*, *kūṭai*, *katti*, *kiṇṇam*, *peṭṭi*
- *Recall:* say *vitai*
- *Read it:* கிராமம்

Before you move on

What does பெட்டி mean? ("a box".) Say it once more.

Chapter 55

The Rest of You

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can name my neck, my back, a lip, a nail and a bone in Tamil.
>
> *Complete TA-C55-bone and say all five words in order.*

55.1 கழுத்து (ka̲luttu) — the neck

> Before the new run of words: what did *kiṇṇam* mean, and what did *peṭṭi* mean?

You'll want to know: கழுத்து

கழுத்து (*ka̲luttu*) — "the neck".

Malayalam **കഴുത്ത്** (*ka̲luttŭ*) is the same word, **ഴ** and all — that letter again, the one only these two sisters still write. Telugu went its own way here, to **మెడ** (*meḍa*).

It is the neck outside and the throat inside, both in one word. A garland goes round the **கழுத்து**, and so does the thread tied at a wedding.

In the family, and next door

	word	same root
Kannada	**ಕುತ್ತಿಗೆ** (*kuttige*)	
Telugu	**మెడ** (*meḍa*)	
Malayalam	**കഴുത്ത്** (*ka̲luttŭ*)	yes
Hindi (neighbour)	**गर्दन** (*gardan*)	
English	the neck	

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

கழுத்து (*kaḻuttu*) is native Dravidian. DEDR 1366 lists Malayalam *kaḻuttu* and Kannada *kattu*. The entry compares Sanskrit *kaṇṭha*, "neck" (CDIAL 2680).

What you've built

The first of five more pieces of you.

Your turn

- *Say it: kaḻuttu*
- *Say it:* it once more, slowly
- *Say it: peṭṭi*, then *kaḻuttu*, and hold the ழ in the middle
- *Recall:* say *nadi*
- *Read it:* பாய்

Before you move on

What does கழுத்து mean? ("the neck".) Say it once more.

55.2 முதுகு (mutuku) — the back

Before the new one: what did *kaḻuttu* mean?

You'll want to know: முதுகு

முதுகு (*mutuku*) — "the back".

Malayalam has മുതുക് (*mutukŭ*), letter for letter until the last one. Telugu takes వీపు (*vīpu*) and shares nothing with either.

To show somebody your முதுகு is to turn away from them, in Tamil much as in English — and the phrase is meant as unkindly in one language as in the other.

In the family, and next door

	word	same root
Kannada	ಬೆನ್ನು (*bennu*)	
Telugu	వీపు (*vīpu*)	
Malayalam	മുതുക് (*mutukŭ*)	yes
Hindi (neighbour)	पीठ (*pīṭh*)	
English	the back	

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

முதுகு (*mutuku*) is native Dravidian. DEDR 4955 lists Malayalam *mutuku*.

What you've built

Two: what a garland goes round, and what you turn on somebody.

Your turn

- *Say it: mutuku*
- *Say it:* it once more, slowly
- *Say it: kaluttu*, then *mutuku*, the top of you and the length below it
- *Read it:* மலை
- *Recall:* say *kūṭai*

Before you move on

What does முதுகு mean? ("the back".) Say it once more.

55.3 உதடு (utaṭu) — a lip

Before the new one: what did *mutuku* mean?

You'll want to know: உதடு

உதடு (*utaṭu*) — "a lip".

This is where the family stops agreeing. Malayalam says ചുണ്ട് (*cuṇṭŭ*), Telugu పెదవి (*pedavi*), Tamil உதடு — three words with nothing in common

but the thing they name. It happens: a part of the body every language has a name for is not therefore a part every language named at the same time.

The ட in the middle is the one made with the tongue curled back. Keep it curled and the word comes out right.

In the family, and next door

	word	same root
Kannada	ತುಟಿ (*tuṭi*)	yes
Telugu	పెదవి (*pedavi*)	
Malayalam	ചുണ്ട് (*cuṇṭŭ*)	
Hindi (neighbour)	होंठ (*hoṇṭh*)	
English	a lip	

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

உதடு (*utaṭu*) is native Dravidian. DEDR 606 lists Malayalam *utaṭu* and Kannada *odaḍu*.

What you've built

Three, and this one the three sisters worked out separately.

Your turn

- *Say it: utaṭu*
- *Say it:* it once more, slowly
- *Say it: mutuku*, then *utaṭu*, and curl the tongue back for the ட
- *Recall:* say *vayal*
- *Read it:* கத்தி

Before you move on

What does உதடு mean? ("a lip".) Say it once more.

55.4 நகம் (nakam) — a nail

Before the new one: what did *utaṭu* mean?

You'll want to know: நகம்

நகம் (*nakam*) — "a nail".

The nail on a finger and the claw on an animal, in one word. Malayalam writes നഖം (*nakham*), with a breathed letter in the middle that Tamil's own set does not carry, so Tamil prints it plain: நகம். The two words are heard as one and written as two.

Telugu holds on to something else entirely, గోరు (*gōru*).

In the family, and next door

	word	same root
Kannada	ಮೊಳೆ (*moḷe*)	
Telugu	మేకు (*mēku*)	
Malayalam	നഖം (*nakham*)	yes
Hindi (neighbour)	कील (*kīl*)	
English	a nail	

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

நகம் (*nakam*) is a loan from Sanskrit *nakha*, "nail, claw" (CDIAL 6914).

What you've built

Four: neck, back, lip, and the hard thing on the end of a finger.

Your turn

- *Say it: nakam*
- *Say it:* it once more, slowly
- *Say it: utaṭu*, then *nakam*, the softest part of you and the hardest
- *Read it:* பாதை
- *Recall:* say *kiṇṇam*

Before you move on

What does நகம் mean? ("a nail".) Say it once more.

55.5 எலும்பு (elumbu) — a bone

Before the new one: what did *nakam* mean?

You'll want to know: எலும்பு

எலும்பு (*elumbu*) — "a bone".

Malayalam എല്ല് (*ellŭ*) and Telugu ఎముక (*emuka*) sit either side of Tamil's எலும்பு: the same opening, and then three different amounts of word after it.

elumbum tōlum — "bone and skin" — is what Tamil says of somebody who has gone very thin. English says the same two things in the other order.

In the family, and next door

	word	same root
Kannada	ಮೂಳೆ (*mūḷe*)	
Telugu	ఎముక (*emuka*)	
Malayalam	എല്ല് (*ellŭ*)	yes
English	a bone	

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

எலும்பு (*elumbu*) is native Dravidian. DEDR 839 lists Malayalam *elumpu*, Kannada *elubu* and Telugu *emuka*. The entry compares Sanskrit *eḍūka*, "a monument holding bones".

What you've built

Five more of you: neck, back, lip, nail, and what holds the whole lot up.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *elumbu*
- *Say it:* it once more, slowly
- *Say it:* all five in order — *kaḻuttu*, *mutuku*, *utaṭu*, *nakam*, *elumbu*
- *Recall:* say *kirāmam*
- *Read it:* பெட்டி

Before you move on

What does எலும்பு mean? (“a bone”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 56

How Much

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say how much I want in Tamil, from a little to a lot, and turn an offer down politely.
>
> *Complete TA-C56-let-it-be and say all five words in order.*

56.1 சிறிது (siṟitu) — a little

Before the new run of words: what did *nakam* mean, and what did *elumbu* mean?

You'll want to know: சிறிது

சிறிது (*siṟitu*) — "a little".

You already have *siṟiya*, "small". **சிறிது** is the same root turned into an amount: not a small thing but a small quantity of something. Held a dish and asked how much, you say *siṟitu* and you get a little.

Tamil has a *koñcam* as well, which is the one you will hear across a table, and which Telugu shares as *koñcem*. **சிறிது** is the more formal of the two, and the one you would write down.

In the family, and next door

	word
Kannada	**ಸ್ವಲ್ಪ** (*svalpa*)
Telugu	**కొంచెం** (*koñcem*)
Malayalam	**കുറച്ച്** (*kuṟaccŭ*)
English	a little

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

சிறிது (*si̱ritu*) is native Dravidian (DEDR 1594). It is the noun of *si̱riya*, "small": "that which is small".

What you've built

The first of five answers to "how much?".

Your turn

- *Say it: si̱ritu*
- *Say it:* it once more, slowly
- *Say it: elumbu*, then *si̱ritu*, and keep the second one short
- *Recall:* say *pāy*
- *Read it:* கழுத்து

Before you move on

What does சிறிது mean? ("a little".) Say it once more.

56.2 நிறைய (ni̱raiya) — a lot

Before the new one: what did *si̱ritu* mean?

You'll want to know: நிறைய

நிறைய (*ni̱raiya*) — "a lot".

The other end of the same question. நிறைய is built on *ni̱rai*, to fill, so a lot in Tamil is a fullness: as much as the thing will hold and no argument about it.

Telugu says ఎక్కువ (*ekkuva*) and builds it out of nothing to do with filling — a reminder that two languages can land on the same everyday answer by two quite different routes.

In the family, and next door

	word
Malayalam	ഒരുപാട് (*orupāṭŭ*)
Hindi (neighbour)	ज़्यादा (*zyādā*)
English	a lot

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

நிறைய (*niṟaiya*) is native Dravidian. DEDR 3682 lists Malayalam *niṟa*, "fullness" and Kannada *neṟe*, "to become full". It comes from *niṟai*, "to become full".

What you've built

Two, and they are opposite ends of one question.

Your turn

- *Say it: niṟaiya*
- *Say it:* it once more, slowly
- *Say it: siṟitu*, then *niṟaiya*, the little and the lot
- *Read it:* கூடை
- *Recall:* say *mutuku*

Before you move on

What does நிறைய mean? ("a lot".) Say it once more.

56.3 குறைவு (kuṟaivu) — a shortage, less than there should be

Before the new one: what did *niṟaiya* mean?

You'll want to know: குறைவு

குறைவு (*kuṟaivu*) — "a shortage, less than there should be".

kuṟai is to fall short, and குறைவு is the falling-short itself. That makes it a narrower word than the English "less": it does not merely compare two

amounts, it says one of them did not come up to the mark. There is a small complaint folded inside it.

Telugu's word for the same ground is తక్కువ (*takkuva*).

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

குறைவு (*kuṟaivu*) is native Dravidian. DEDR 1851 lists Malayalam *kuṟu*, "short, little" and Kannada *kuṟu*, "smallness".

What you've built

Three: a little, a lot, and not as much as there ought to be.

Your turn

- *Say it: kuṟaivu*
- *Say it:* it once more, slowly
- *Say it: niṟaiya*, then *kuṟaivu*, plenty and then not enough
- *Recall:* say *katti*
- *Read it:* உதடு

Before you move on

What does குறைவு mean? ("a shortage, less than there should be".) Say it once more.

56.4 தேவையில்லை (tēvaiyillai) — there is no need

Before the new one: what did *kuṟaivu* mean?

You'll want to know: தேவையில்லை

தேவையில்லை (*tēvaiyillai*) — "there is no need".

Two pieces, and the second one has been yours since the early writing lessons: *tēvai* is a need, *illai* is the no you learned to put on paper. Together they are how Tamil turns something down without turning the person down.

A flat *illai* refuses the thing. தேவையில்லை says there is no call for it, which leaves everybody their footing. Telugu does the same work in one shorter piece, వద్దు (*vaddu*).

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

தேவையில்லை (*tēvaiyillai*) is two native words: *tēvai*, "need" (DEDR 3469; Malayalam *tēva*), and *illai*, "there is not" (DEDR 2559).

What you've built

Four, and this one is the polite way out.

Your turn

- *Say it: tēvaiyillai*
- *Say it:* it once more, slowly
- *Say it: kuṟaivu*, then *tēvaiyillai*, and let the whole of the second run as one word
- *Read it:* கிண்ணம்
- *Recall:* say *nakam*

Before you move on

What does தேவையில்லை mean? ("there is no need".) Say it once more.

56.5 ஆகட்டும் (ākaṭṭum) — let it be so

Before the new one: what did *tēvaiyillai* mean?

You'll want to know: ஆகட்டும்

ஆகட்டும் (*ākaṭṭum*) — "let it be so".

āku is to become, to come about. ஆகட்டும் is "let it come about" — what you say when somebody proposes something and you are content to let it happen. It agrees without promising to do anything.

The *ām* you have been saying for yes is that same *āku* worn down by a great deal of use, which is why the two sit so alike in the mouth. Telugu's nearest of these is అలాగే (*alāgē*), "just so, alright then".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

ஆகட்டும் (*ākaṭṭum*) is native Dravidian. DEDR 333 lists Malayalam *ākuka*. It is the native verb "to become" with the ending that says "let it".

What you've built

Five answers to an offer: a little, a lot, not enough, no need, and yes — let it happen.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *ākaṭṭum*
- *Say it:* it once more, slowly
- *Say it:* all five in order — *si̱ritu*, *ni̱raiya*, *ku̱raivu*, *tēvaiyillai*, *ākaṭṭum*
- *Recall:* say *peṭṭi*
- *Read it:* எலும்பு

Before you move on

What does ஆகட்டும் mean? ("let it be so".) Say it once more.

Chapter 57

Wind and Fire

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can name the wind, sand, mud, smoke and an ember in Tamil.
>
> *Complete TA-C57-ember and say all five words in order.*

57.1 காற்று (kāṟṟu) — the wind

> Before the new run of words: what did *tēvaiyillai* mean, and what did *ākaṭṭum* mean?

You'll want to know: காற்று

காற்று (*kāṟṟu*) — "the wind".

Malayalam കാറ്റ് (*kāṟṟŭ*) is the same word with its ending worn shorter. Telugu takes గాలి (*gāli*), which covers air as much as wind.

Tamil's word covers both too: the breeze coming through a doorway and the air inside a tyre are one word. What English splits into wind and air, Tamil leaves whole and lets the sentence decide.

In the family, and next door

	word	same root
Kannada	ಗಾಳಿ (*gāḷi*)	
Telugu	గాలి (*gāli*)	
Malayalam	കാറ്റ് (*kāṟṟŭ*)	yes
Hindi (neighbour)	हवा (*havā*)	
English	the wind	

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

காற்று (*kāṟṟu*) is native Dravidian. DEDR 1481 lists Malayalam *kāṟṟu*.

What you've built

The first of five things you can point at outdoors.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *kāṟṟu*
- *Say it:* it once more, slowly
- *Say it:* *ākaṭṭum*, then *kāṟṟu*, and let the doubled ற hold
- *Recall:* say *kaluttu*
- *Read it:* சிறிது

Before you move on

What does காற்று mean? ("the wind".) Say it once more.

57.2 மணல் (maṇal) — sand

Before the new one: what did *kāṟṟu* mean?

You'll want to know: மணல்

மணல் (*maṇal*) — "sand".

Malayalam മണൽ (*maṇal*), letter for letter and sound for sound. Telugu goes somewhere else, to *isuka*.

The ண is the one made with the tongue curled back — the same letter you have just been doubling in *kiṇṇam*. Here there is only one of them, so touch it once and move on.

In the family, and next door

	word	same root
Kannada	ಮರಳು (*maraḷu*)	yes
Telugu	ఇసుక (*isuka*)	
Malayalam	മണൽ (*maṇal*)	yes
Hindi (neighbour)	रेत (*ret*)	
English	sand	

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

மணல் (*maṇal*) is native Dravidian. DEDR 4666 lists Malayalam *maṇal*. The entry sets it beside the native word for earth and soil.

What you've built

Two: what moves, and one of the things it moves.

Your turn

- *Say it: maṇal*
- *Say it:* it once more, slowly
- *Say it: kāṟṟu*, then *maṇal*, the wind and what it carries
- *Read it:* முதுகு
- *Recall:* say *niṟaiya*

Before you move on

What does மணல் mean? ("sand".) Say it once more.

57.3 சேறு (sēṟu) — mud

Before the new one: what did *maṇal* mean?

You'll want to know: சேறு

சேறு (*sēṟu*) — "mud".

Wet earth churned up: the mud of a paddy field after rain, not dust and not clay. Here the three sisters go three ways — Malayalam *ceḷi*, Telugu *burada*, Tamil சேறு.

Tamil keeps *cakati* as well, for the thicker and dirtier kind. சேறு is the working mud, the sort somebody walks into on purpose with a plough behind him.

In the family, and next door

	word	same root
Kannada	ಕೆಸರು (*kesaru*)	yes
Telugu	బురద (*burada*)	
Malayalam	ചെളി (*ceḷi*)	
English	mud	

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

சேறு (*sēṟu*) is native Dravidian. DEDR 2020 lists Malayalam *cēṟu* and Kannada *kesaṟ*. The entry compares Sanskrit *kedāra*, "a field under water" (CDIAL 3463).

What you've built

Three: air, dry ground, and wet ground.

Your turn

- *Say it: sēṟu*
- *Say it:* it once more, slowly
- *Say it: maṇal*, then *sēṟu*, dry ground and wet
- *Recall:* say *utaṭu*
- *Read it:* குறைவு

Before you move on

What does சேறு mean? ("mud".) Say it once more.

57.4 புகை (pukai) — smoke

Before the new one: what did *sēṟu* mean?

You'll want to know: புகை

புகை (*pukai*) — "smoke".

Malayalam പുക (*puka*) is the same word one step shorter. Tamil's ends in the *-ai* that so many of its everyday things end in: *kiḷai*, *kūṭai*, *vitai*, and now this one.

புகை is the smoke and also what somebody does over a cigarette. And when trains reached the Tamil country they were called *pukaivaṇṭi*, the smoke vehicle, which is still what a great many people call them.

In the family, and next door

	word	same root
Malayalam	പുക (*puka*)	yes
English	smoke	

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

புகை (*pukai*) is native Dravidian. DEDR 4240 lists Malayalam *puka*, Kannada *poge* and Telugu *poga*.

What you've built

Four, and this one you can only see because of what it comes off.

Your turn

- *Say it: pukai*
- *Say it:* it once more, slowly
- *Say it: sēṟu*, then *pukai*, and let the *-ai* open at the end
- *Read it:* நகம்
- *Recall:* say *tēvaiyillai*

Before you move on

What does புகை mean? ("smoke".) Say it once more.

57.5 கனல் (kaṉal) — an ember

Before the new one: what did *pukai* mean?

You'll want to know: கனல்

கனல் (*kaṉal*) — "an ember".

The live coal under the ash: fire with no flame on it. Malayalam has the word unchanged, **കനൽ** (*kanal*). Telugu's **నిప్పు** (*nippu*) covers this and open fire together.

It is the word Tamil reaches for when it means heat held rather than heat let go. A *kaṉal* in somebody's eye is anger they are keeping to themselves, and everyone in the room can tell.

In the family, and next door

	word	same root
Malayalam	**കനൽ** (*kanal*)	yes
English	an ember	

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

கனல் (*kaṉal*) is native Dravidian. DEDR 1406 lists Malayalam *kanal*, "live coals" and Kannada *kanal*, "to glow". The entry compares Sanskrit *kanala*, "shining".

What you've built

Wind, sand, mud, smoke, and the coal under the ash.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *kaṉal*
- *Say it:* it once more, slowly
- *Say it:* all five in order — *kāṟṟu*, *maṇal*, *sēṟu*, *pukai*, *kaṉal*
- *Recall:* say *elumbu*
- *Read it:* **ஆகட்டும்**

Before you move on

What does **கனல்** mean? ("an ember".) Say it once more.

Chapter 58

Around the Yard

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can name a cow, a goat, a hen, a crow and a bird in Tamil.
>
> *Complete TA-C58-bird and say all five words in order.*

58.1 பசு (pasu) — a cow

> Before the new one: what did *pukai* mean, and what did *kaṉal* mean?

You'll want to know: பசு

பசு (*pasu*) — "a cow".

The animal a Tamil household is built around. Kannada says ಹಸು (*hasu*): the same word, with the *p*-for-*h* trade Kannada makes right through its old words — the one this book pointed out when the numbers were lined up side by side. Tamil keeps the *p*.

It belongs to a விவசாயி before it belongs to anybody, and in a கிராமம் it stands tied in the yard rather than shut in a shed, near enough to the வாசல் that you step around it going in.

In the family, and next door

	word	same root
Kannada	ಹಸು (*hasu*)	yes
Telugu	ఆవు (*āvu*)	
Malayalam	പശു (*paśu*)	yes
Hindi (neighbour)	गाय (*gāy*)	
English	a cow	

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

பசு (*pasu*) is a loan from Sanskrit *paśu*, "domestic animal" (CDIAL 7984). Tamil narrowed it to the cow.

What you've built

The first of five animals.

Your turn

- *Say it: pasu*
- *Say it:* it once more, slowly
- *Say it: pasu*, then *kirāmam*, and put the one inside the other
- *Recall:* say *si̱ritu*
- *Read it:* காற்று

Before you move on

What does பசு mean? ("a cow".) Say it once more.

58.2 ஆடு (āṭu) — a goat

Before the new one: what did *pasu* mean?

You'll want to know: ஆடு

ஆடு (*āṭu*) — "a goat".

Smaller, cheaper, and kept by houses with no land for a பசு. It eats what it finds and needs nobody to cut for it.

Start it long — ஆ, held — and put the ட of கூடை in the middle. That keeps it clear of அது, which starts short and is a different word entirely. Kannada parts company here and says ಮೇಕೆ (*mēke*).

In the family, and next door

	word	same root
Kannada	ಮೇಕೆ (*mēke*)	
Telugu	మేక (*mēka*)	
Malayalam	ആട് (*āṭŭ*)	yes
Hindi (neighbour)	बकरी (*bakrī*)	
English	a goat	

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

ஆடு (*āṭu*) is native Dravidian. DEDR 5152 lists Malayalam *āṭu* and Kannada *āḍu*. The entry compares Sanskrit *eḍa*, "a kind of sheep" (CDIAL 2512).

What you've built

Two.

Your turn

- *Say it: āṭu*
- *Say it:* it once more, slowly
- *Say it: pasu*, then *āṭu*, and say which one a house keeps when it has no land
- *Read it:* நிறைய
- *Recall:* say *maṇal*

Before you move on

What does ஆடு mean? ("a goat".) Say it once more.

58.3 கோழி (kō̲li) — a hen

Before the new one: what did *āṭu* mean?

You'll want to know: கோழி

கோழி (*kōḻi*) — "a hen".

Hen or cock alike; the word does not split them, and where the difference matters a second word goes in front. Kannada **ಕೋಳಿ** (*kōḷi*) and Telugu **కోడి** (*kōḍi*) are the same word three ways, and the middle letter is where they separate: Tamil's **ழ**, Kannada's **ಳ**, Telugu's **డ**.

It is the clock of a **கிராமம்**. A **கோழி** has a house awake well before anybody there needs to know the **மணி**.

In the family, and next door

	word	same root
Kannada	**ಕೋಳಿ** (*kōḷi*)	yes
Telugu	**కోడి** (*kōḍi*)	yes
Malayalam	**കോഴി** (*kōḻi*)	yes
Hindi (neighbour)	**मुर्गी** (*murgī*)	
English	a hen	

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

கோழி (*kōḻi*) is native Dravidian. DEDR 2248 lists Malayalam *kōḻi*, Kannada *kōḷi* and Telugu *kōḍi*.

What you've built

Three.

Your turn

- *Say it: kōḻi*
- *Say it:* it once more, slowly
- *Say it: kōḻi*, then *maṇi*, and say which one comes first in the morning
- *Recall:* say *kuṟaivu*
- *Read it:* **சேறு**

Before you move on

What does **கோழி** mean? ("a hen".) Say it once more.

58.4 காக்கை (kākkai) — a crow

Before the new one: what did *kōḻi* mean?

You'll want to know: காக்கை

காக்கை (*kākkai*) — "a crow".

Named off the noise it makes, and the sisters landed on the same trick from the same starting point: Kannada **ಕಾಗೆ** (*kāge*). Say it once and you have the etymology.

Of everything with wings around a Tamil house this is the one the house deals with daily. **சாதம்** set out on the **வாசல்** step is put there for the **காக்கை**, and it comes down within the minute.

In the family, and next door

	word	same root
Kannada	**ಕಾಗೆ** (*kāge*)	yes
Telugu	**కాకి** (*kāki*)	yes
Malayalam	**കാക്ക** (*kākka*)	yes
Hindi (neighbour)	**कौआ** (*kauā*)	
English	a crow	

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

காக்கை (*kākkai*) is native Dravidian. DEDR 1425 lists Malayalam *kākka*, Kannada *kāge* and Telugu *kāki*. The word imitates the bird's call, and the entry gives the cry too. It compares Sanskrit *kāka*, "crow", and notes that some forms may be borrowed back from Indo-Aryan.

What you've built

Four.

Your turn

- *Say it: kākkai*
- *Say it:* it once more, slowly
- *Say it: kākkai*, then *kōḻi*, and say which one is kept and which one turns up

- *Read it:* தேவையில்லை
- *Recall:* say *pukai*

Before you move on

What does காக்கை mean? ("a crow".) Say it once more.

58.5 பறவை (paṟavai) — a bird

Before the new one: what did *kākkai* mean?

You'll want to know: பறவை

பறவை (*paṟavai*) — "a bird".

The wide word. Whatever flies is a பறவை, the கோழி and the காக்கை taken in along with everything that was never given a name of its own.

Here the three go three ways: Kannada ಹಕ್ಕಿ (*hakki*), Telugu పక్షి (*pakṣi*) off the Sanskrit, and Tamil's own பறவை. The ற in the middle is the hard one, the same ற standing in ஆறு.

In the family, and next door

	word
Kannada	ಹಕ್ಕಿ (*hakki*)
Telugu	పక్షి (*pakṣi*)
Malayalam	പക്ഷി (*pakṣi*)
Hindi (neighbour)	चिड़िया (*chiṛiyā*)
English	a bird

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

பறவை (*paṟavai*) is native Dravidian. DEDR 4020 lists Malayalam *paṟava*. It comes from *paṟa*, "to fly": a bird is "the flyer".

What you've built

Five, and the run is closed: a cow, a goat, a hen, a crow, and the word for everything that flies.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *pa̲ravai*
- *Say it:* it once more, slowly
- *Say it:* all five in order — *pasu*, *āṭu*, *kō̲li*, *kākkai*, *pa̲ravai*
- *Recall:* say *ākaṭṭum*
- *Read it:* கனல்

Before you move on

What does பறவை mean? (“a bird”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 59

In the Kitchen

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can name curd, ghee, oil, jaggery and sugar in Tamil.
>
> *Complete TA-C59-sugar and say all five words in order.*

59.1 தயிர் (tayir) — curd

Before the new one: what did *kākkai* mean, and what did *paṟavai* mean?

You'll want to know: தயிர்

தயிர் (*tayir*) — "curd".

Set **பால்**, soured overnight in a covered pot. It is what a Tamil meal finishes on, turned through the last of the **சாதம்**, and it is the thing a hot afternoon is survived with.

The sisters do not agree here at all: Kannada **ಮೊಸರು** (*mosaru*), Telugu **పెరుగు** (*perugu*), Tamil **தயிர்**. Three households, three words, one pot.

In the family, and next door

	word	same root
Kannada	**ಮೊಸರು** (*mosaru*)	
Telugu	**పెరుగు** (*perugu*)	
Malayalam	**തൈര്** (*tairŭ*)	yes
English	curd	

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

தயிர் (*tayir*) is listed in DEDR 3088 with Malayalam *tayir*. The entry asks, with a question mark, whether it comes from Sanskrit *takra*, "buttermilk", so its origin is not settled.

What you've built

The first of five kitchen words.

Your turn

- *Say it: tayir*
- *Say it:* it once more, slowly
- *Say it: tayir*, then *sādam*, and say which one goes on top of the other
- *Recall:* say *kāṟṟu*
- *Read it:* பசு

Before you move on

What does தயிர் mean? ("curd".) Say it once more.

59.2 நெய் (ney) — ghee

Before the new one: what did *tayir* mean?

You'll want to know: நெய்

நெய் (*ney*) — "ghee".

Butter cooked down until the water has gone and only the fat and the smell are left. Short, old, and Tamil's own. Telugu keeps it as నెయ్యి (*neyyi*); Kannada walked off to ತುಪ್ಪ (*tuppa*).

A spoon of it goes over hot சாதம் at the start of a meal on a day that matters, which is most of what it does.

In the family, and next door

	word	same root
Kannada	ತುಪ್ಪ (*tuppa*)	
Telugu	నెయ్యి (*neyyi*)	yes
Hindi (neighbour)	घी (*ghī*)	
English	ghee	

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

நெய் (*ney*) is native Dravidian. DEDR 3746 lists Malayalam *ney*, Kannada *ney* and Telugu *neyyi*.

What you've built

Two.

Your turn

- *Say it: ney*
- *Say it:* it once more, slowly
- *Say it: tayir*, then *ney*, and say which one ends a meal and which one opens it
- *Read it:* மணல்
- *Recall:* say *āṭu*

Before you move on

What does நெய் mean? ("ghee".) Say it once more.

59.3 எண்ணெய் (eṉṉey) — oil

Before the new one: what did *ney* mean?

You'll want to know: எண்ணெய்

எண்ணெய் (*eṉṉey*) — "oil".

The end of it is நெய், standing there unchanged. The front piece is an old name for the sesame seed, so the whole thing began as sesame-fat — and then it widened until it covered every oil a kitchen has, sesame or not.

Kannada kept the same word as ಎಣ್ಣೆ (*eṇṇe*); Telugu went to నూనె (*nūne*). The doubled ண் in the middle is the one made with the tongue curled back, held twice as long.

In the family, and next door

	word	same root
Kannada	ಎಣ್ಣೆ (*eṇṇe*)	yes
Telugu	నూనె (*nūne*)	
Malayalam	എണ്ണ (*eṇṇa*)	yes
Hindi (neighbour)	तेल (*tel*)	
English	oil	

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

எண்ணெய் (*eṇṇey*) is native: *eḷ*, "sesame", and *ney*, "ghee, oil". DEDR 854 lists it as "gingelly oil", with Malayalam *eṇṇa* and Kannada *eṇṇe*, "oil". Oil was first sesame oil.

What you've built

Three, and the third is built out of the second.

Your turn

- *Say it: eṇṇey*
- *Say it:* it once more, slowly
- *Say it: ney*, then *eṇṇey*, and hear the first one still sitting inside the second
- *Recall:* say *sēṟu*
- *Read it:* கோழி

Before you move on

What does எண்ணெய் mean? ("oil".) Say it once more.

59.4 வெல்லம் (vellam) — jaggery

Before the new one: what did *eṇṇey* mean?

You'll want to know: வெல்லம்

வெல்லம் (*vellam*) — "jaggery".

Cane juice boiled down and left alone — no bleaching, no crystals — and sold as a dark heavy lump you break a piece off. Kannada has the same word as **ಬೆಲ್ಲ** (*bella*), with *v* softened to *b*.

In an older Tamil kitchen sweetness meant this before it meant anything white, and **வெல்லம்** still goes into the food that has to taste the way it used to.

In the family, and next door

	word	same root
Kannada	**ಬೆಲ್ಲ** (*bella*)	yes
Malayalam	**ശർക്കര** (*śarkkara*)	
English	jaggery	

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

வெல்லம் (*vellam*) is native Dravidian. DEDR 5494 lists Malayalam *vellam*, Kannada *bella* and Telugu *bellamu*.

What you've built

Four.

Your turn

- *Say it: vellam*
- *Say it:* it once more, slowly
- *Say it: vellam*, then *ney*, and say which of the two a sweet needs
- *Read it:* **புகை**
- *Recall:* say *kākkai*

Before you move on

What does **வெல்லம்** mean? ("jaggery".) Say it once more.

59.5 சர்க்கரை (sarkkarai) — sugar

Before the new one: what did *vellam* mean?

You'll want to know: சர்க்கரை

சர்க்கரை (*sarkkarai*) — "sugar".

The refined white kind, beside **வெல்லம்** rather than in place of it. Kannada **ಸಕ್ಕರೆ** (*sakkare*), Telugu **చక్కెర** (*cakkera*): one word, lightly redressed three times.

It has travelled further than any other word in this run. Sanskrit *śarkarā* went out through Arabic, Greek and Latin and came back into English as *sugar*, so **சர்க்கரை** and the English word are one word wearing different clothes.

In the family, and next door

	word	same root
Kannada	**ಸಕ್ಕರೆ** (*sakkare*)	yes
Telugu	**చక్కెర** (*cakkera*)	yes
Malayalam	**പഞ്ചസാര** (*pañcasāra*)	
Hindi (neighbour)	**चीनी** (*chīnī*)	
English	sugar	

What you've built

Five, and the run is closed: curd, ghee, oil, jaggery, and sugar.

Your turn

- *Say it: sarkkarai*
- *Say it:* it once more, slowly
- *Say it:* all five in order — *tayir*, *ney*, *eṇṇey*, *vellam*, *sarkkarai*
- *Recall:* say *kaṉal*
- *Read it:* **பறவை**

Before you move on

What does **சர்க்கரை** mean? ("sugar".) Say it once more.

Chapter 60

Things People Make

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can name a needle, a rope, an umbrella, a broom and a comb in Tamil.
>
> *Complete TA-C60-comb and say all five words in order.*

60.1 ஊசி (ūsi) — a needle

> Before the new one: what did *vellam* mean, and what did *sarkkarai* mean?

You'll want to know: ஊசி

ஊசி (*ūsi*) — "a needle".

The sewing needle, and whatever else is that shape. It is the tool **துணி** is repaired with, which is most of what **துணி** asks for.

Kannada **ಸೂಜಿ** (*sūji*) and Telugu **సూది** (*sūdi*) hold on to a sound at the front that Tamil let go of, so Tamil's is the shortest of the three. Open it on a long **ஊ**.

In the family, and next door

	word	same root
Kannada	**ಸೂಜಿ** (*sūji*)	
Telugu	**సూది** (*sūdi*)	
Malayalam	**സൂചി** (*sūci*)	
Hindi (neighbour)	**सूई** (*sūī*)	yes
English	a needle	

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

ஊசி (*ūsi*) is a loan from Sanskrit *sūcī*, "needle" (CDIAL 13551). Tamil dropped the first *s-*.

What you've built

The first of five made things.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *ūsi*
- *Say it:* it once more, slowly
- *Say it:* *ūsi*, then *tuṇi*, and say which one repairs the other
- *Recall:* say *pasu*
- *Read it:* தயிர்

Before you move on

What does **ஊசி** mean? ("a needle".) Say it once more.

60.2 கயிறு (kayiṟu) — a rope

Before the new one: what did *ūsi* mean?

You'll want to know: கயிறு

கயிறு (*kayiṟu*) — "a rope".

Twisted up out of coconut fibre, which is what a coast with that many palms was going to make rope out of. Thin ones tie a bundle; thick ones draw water.

The ற at the end is the hard one — the same ற standing in **ஆறு** and in **பறவை**. A **பசு** in a yard is at the end of a **கயிறு**, which is the commonest place to meet the word.

In the family, and next door

	word	same root
Kannada	ಹಗ್ಗ (*hagga*)	
Telugu	తాడు (*tāḍu*)	
Malayalam	കയർ (*kayaṟ*)	yes
Hindi (neighbour)	रस्सी (*rassī*)	
English	a rope	

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

கயிறு (*kayiṟu*) is native Dravidian. DEDR 1254 lists Malayalam *kayaṟu* and Telugu *cēru*, "string".

What you've built

Two.

Your turn

- *Say it: kayiṟu*
- *Say it:* it once more, slowly
- *Say it: kayiṟu*, then *pasu*, and say which one holds the other
- *Read it:* ஆடு
- *Recall:* say *ney*

Before you move on

What does கயிறு mean? ("a rope".) Say it once more.

60.3 குடை (kuṭai) — an umbrella

Before the new one: what did *kayiṟu* mean?

You'll want to know: குடை

குடை (*kuṭai*) — "an umbrella".

Against மழை and against the சூரியன் equally, and in Tamil country the second job is the larger one. It is carried in a month with no rain in it without anybody thinking that odd.

Kannada ಕೊಡೆ (*koḍe*) is the same word. It ends on the ◌ೆ you already put on கூடை and on விதை.

In the family, and next door

	word	same root
Kannada	ಕೊಡೆ (*koḍe*)	
Telugu	గొడుగు (*goḍugu*)	
Malayalam	കുട (*kuṭa*)	yes
Hindi (neighbour)	छाता (*chātā*)	
English	an umbrella	

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

குடை (*kuṭai*) is native Dravidian. DEDR 1663 lists Malayalam *kuṭa*, Kannada *koḍe* and Telugu *goḍugu*. The entry compares Sanskrit (lexicons) *utkūṭa*, "umbrella".

What you've built

Three.

Your turn

- *Say it: kuṭai*
- *Say it:* it once more, slowly
- *Say it: kuṭai*, then *maḻai*, and say which one you take out for the other
- *Recall:* say *kōḻi*
- *Read it:* எண்ணெய்

Before you move on

What does குடை mean? ("an umbrella".) Say it once more.

60.4 துடைப்பம் (tuṭaippam) — a broom

Before the new one: what did *kuṭai* mean?

You'll want to know: துடைப்பம்

துடைப்பம் (*tuṭaippam*) — "a broom".

Coconut ribs bound at one end, held short, swung low. It is the first thing that touches a **வாசல்** in the morning: the ground is swept, then wetted, and only then does the **கோலம்** go down on it.

Three houses, three words again — Kannada **ಪೊರಕೆ** (*porake*), Telugu **చీపురు** (*cīpuru*), Tamil **துடைப்பம்**. The doubled **ப்ப** in the middle is the one you have been holding since **பெட்டி** taught you to hold a letter twice.

In the family, and next door

	word
Kannada	**ಪೊರಕೆ** (*porake*)
Telugu	**చీపురు** (*cīpuru*)
Malayalam	**ചൂല്** (*cūlŭ*)
Hindi (neighbour)	**झाड़ू** (*jhāṛū*)
English	a broom

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

துடைப்பம் (*tuṭaippam*) is native Dravidian. DEDR 3301 lists Malayalam *tuṭeppam*. It comes from *tuṭai*, "to wipe, to sweep".

What you've built

Four.

Your turn

- *Say it: tuṭaippam*
- *Say it:* it once more, slowly
- *Say it: tuṭaippam*, then *kōlam*, and say which one comes first
- *Read it:* **காக்கை**
- *Recall:* say *vellam*

Before you move on

What does **துடைப்பம்** mean? ("a broom".) Say it once more.

60.5 சீப்பு (sīppu) — a comb

Before the new one: what did *tuṭaippam* mean?

You'll want to know: சீப்பு

சீப்பு (*sīppu*) — "a comb".

A comb, and nothing borrowed about it. The ீ at the front is held long, and then the doubled ப்ப comes again, so it lands in the same shape as துடைப்பம் and பெட்டி.

A சீப்பு and a மலர் are what go into hair on a morning that is being made something of, and the two turn up in the same sentence often enough to be worth learning together.

In the family, and next door

	word	same root
Kannada	ಬಾಚಣಿಗೆ (*bācaṇige*)	
Telugu	దువ్వెన (*duvvena*)	
Malayalam	ചീപ്പ് (*cīppŭ*)	yes
Hindi (neighbour)	कंघी (*kaṅghī*)	
English	a comb	

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

சீப்பு (*sīppu*) is native Dravidian. DEDR 1610 lists Malayalam *cīppi* and Telugu *cīpu*.

What you've built

Five, and the run is closed: a needle, a rope, an umbrella, a broom, and a comb.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *sīppu*
- *Say it:* it once more, slowly
- *Say it:* all five in order — *ūsi*, *kayiṟu*, *kuṭai*, *tuṭaippam*, *sīppu*
- *Recall:* say *paṟavai*
- *Read it:* சர்க்கரை

Before you move on

What does சீப்பு mean? (“a comb”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 61

How the Body Feels

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say I am hungry, thirsty, sleepy, feverish or in pain in Tamil.
>
> *Complete TA-C61-pain and say all five words in order.*

61.1 பசி (pasi) — hunger

> Before the new one: what did *tuṭaippam* mean, and what did *sīppu* mean?

You'll want to know: பசி

பசி (*pasi*) — "hunger".

Hunger as a thing that arrives, rather than something you are. Kannada makes it **ಹಸಿವು** (*hasivu*) — the *p* traded for *h* one more time, exactly as it was between **ಪಸು** and **ಹಸು**. Telugu went elsewhere, to **ఆకలి** (*ākali*).

Set **பசி** beside **பசு** and only the last mark separates them: one ends on the **ி**, the other on the **ா**. They are not related, and the difference is worth practising until it stops needing thought.

In the family, and next door

	word	same root
Kannada	**ಹಸಿವು** (*hasivu*)	yes
Telugu	**ఆకలి** (*ākali*)	
Malayalam	**വിശപ്പ്** (*viśappŭ*)	
Hindi (neighbour)	**भूख** (*bhūkh*)	
English	hunger	

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

பசி (*pasi*) is native Dravidian. DEDR 3825 lists Malayalam *pai* and Kannada *pasi*.

What you've built

The first of five feelings.

Your turn

- *Say it: pasi*
- *Say it:* it once more, slowly
- *Say it: pasu*, then *pasi*, and hold the two endings apart
- *Recall:* say *tayir*
- *Read it:* ஊசி

Before you move on

What does பசி mean? ("hunger".) Say it once more.

61.2 தாகம் (tākam) — thirst

Before the new one: what did *pasi* mean?

You'll want to know: தாகம்

தாகம் (*tākam*) — "thirst".

Thirst. Sanskrit-descended, unlike பசி beside it, and taken in whole with the *-am* Tamil hangs on such arrivals — the same *-am* already sitting on புத்தகம்.

It is answered with தண்ணீர் and with nothing else in particular, and a Tamil house offers the தண்ணீர் before it is asked for.

In the family, and next door

	word
Kannada	ಬಾಯಾರಿಕೆ (*bāyārike*)
Telugu	దాహం (*dāhaṁ*)
Malayalam	ദാഹം (*dāhaṁ*)
Hindi (neighbour)	प्यास (*pyās*)
English	thirst

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

தாகம் (*tākam*) is a loan from Sanskrit *dāha*, "burning, fever" (CDIAL 6321). The burning in the throat became Tamil's word for thirst.

What you've built

Two.

Your turn

- *Say it: tākam*
- *Say it:* it once more, slowly
- *Say it: pasi*, then *tākam*, and say what each of the two is answered with
- *Read it:* நெய்
- *Recall:* say *kayiṟu*

Before you move on

What does தாகம் mean? ("thirst".) Say it once more.

61.3 தூக்கம் (tūkkam) — sleep

Before the new one: what did *tākam* mean?

You'll want to know: தூக்கம்

தூக்கம் (*tūkkam*) — "sleep".

Sleep as a state — the sleep you get, lose, or need more of. Kannada ನಿದ್ದೆ (*nidde*) and Telugu నిద్ర (*nidra*) both took the Sanskrit word; Tamil kept its own and stayed out of it.

Open it on a long **ஊ**, the same long **ஊ** that opens **ஊசி**, and then hold the **க்க** twice.

In the family, and next door

	word
Kannada	ನಿದ್ದೆ (*nidde*)
Telugu	నిద్ర (*nidra*)
Hindi (neighbour)	नींद (*nīnd*)
English	sleep

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

தூக்கம் (*tūkkam*) is native Dravidian. DEDR 3376 lists Malayalam *tūṅṅuka*, "to hang, be drowsy". It comes from *tūṅku*, "to hang, to droop, to sleep": sleep is the head drooping.

What you've built

Three.

Your turn

- *Say it: tūkkam*
- *Say it:* it once more, slowly
- *Say it: tūkkam*, then *ūsi*, and hear the same long vowel open both
- *Recall:* say *eṇṇey*
- *Read it:* **குடை**

Before you move on

What does **தூக்கம்** mean? ("sleep".) Say it once more.

61.4 காய்ச்சல் (kāyccal) — a fever

Before the new one: what did *tūkkam* mean?

You'll want to know: காய்ச்சல்

காய்ச்சல் (*kāyccal*) — "a fever".

The body running hot. Tamil built the word on its own idea of heating rather than importing one, which is why it looks nothing like Kannada's **ಜ್ವರ** (*jvara*), taken straight from the Sanskrit.

It is the first thing anybody tells a **மருத்துவர்**, and it is said flatly, the way you would report weather.

In the family, and next door

	word
Kannada	**ಜ್ವರ** (*jvara*)
Telugu	**జ్వరం** (*jvaram*)
Malayalam	**പനി** (*pani*)
Hindi (neighbour)	**बुख़ार** (*bukhār*)
English	a fever

What you've built

Four.

Your turn

- *Say it: kāyccal*
- *Say it:* it once more, slowly
- *Say it: kāyccal*, then *maruttuvar*, and say which one you take to the other
- *Read it:* **வெல்லம்**
- *Recall:* say *tuṭaippam*

Before you move on

What does **காய்ச்சல்** mean? ("a fever".) Say it once more.

61.5 வலி (vali) — pain

Before the new one: what did *kāyccal* mean?

You'll want to know: வலி

வலி (*vali*) — "pain".

Pain, plainly: the ache itself, wherever it sits. Kannada says **ನೋವು** (*nōvu*). Put it with what you already have for the body and it does its work at once — a **வலி** in the **முதுகு**, a **வலி** in the **பல்**.

Keep it away from *va̲li*, the way or the route, which came up beside **பாதை**. **வலி** takes the plain **ல**; *va̲li* takes the **ழ** you learned to curl the tongue back for. Two letters English would spell alike, and Tamil holds them apart.

In the family, and next door

	word
Kannada	**ನೋವು** (*nōvu*)
Telugu	**నొప్పి** (*noppi*)
Malayalam	**വേദന** (*vēdana*)
Hindi (neighbour)	**दर्द** (*dard*)
English	pain

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

வலி (*vali*) is native Dravidian. DEDR 5281 lists Malayalam *valayuka*, "to be distressed".

What you've built

Five, and the run is closed: hunger, thirst, sleep, a fever, and pain.

Your turn

- *Say it: vali*
- *Say it:* it once more, slowly
- *Say it:* all five in order — *pasi*, *tākam*, *tūkkam*, *kāyccal*, *vali*
- *Recall:* say *sarkkarai*
- *Read it:* **சீப்பு**

Before you move on

What does **வலி** mean? ("pain".) Say it once more.

Chapter 62

Only and Still

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say only, still, soon, at once and first of all in Tamil.
>
> *Complete TA-C62-first-of-all and say all five words in order.*

62.1 மட்டும் (maṭṭum) — only

Before the new one: what did *kāyccal* mean, and what did *vali* mean?

You'll want to know: மட்டும்

மட்டும் (*maṭṭum*) — "only".

This and nothing beside it. Where English puts *only* in front of the thing it limits, Tamil hangs மட்டும் on the end of it: தண்ணீர் மட்டும் — water, and nothing else.

Telugu does the same job with మాత్రమే (*mātramē*). The doubled ట్ట in the middle is the one held twice, as in ஆகட்டும்.

In the family, and next door

	word
Telugu	మాత్రమే (*mātramē*)
Malayalam	മാത്രം (*mātraṁ*)
English	only

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

மட்டும் (*maṭṭum*) is native, from the family of *maṭṭam*, "measure, limit, extent" (DEDR 4660): "only" is "up to the limit". DEDR does not list *maṭṭum* itself, so the link is the usual reading rather than a recorded one.

What you've built

The first of five.

Your turn

- *Say it: maṭṭum*
- *Say it:* it once more, slowly
- *Say it: maṭṭum*, then *taṉṉīr*, and put them in the Tamil order
- *Recall:* say *ūsi*
- *Read it:* பசி

Before you move on

What does மட்டும் mean? ("only".) Say it once more.

62.2 இன்னும் (in̲n̲um) — still, yet

Before the new one: what did *maṭṭum* mean?

You'll want to know: இன்னும்

இன்னும் (*in̲n̲um*) — "still, yet".

For something that has not finished, and for a bit more of it: இன்னும் சிறிது, a little more still. Kannada ಇನ್ನೂ (*innū*) is the same word; Telugu says ఇంకా (*iṅkā*).

The ன் doubled in the middle is the soft one — the alveolar ன, not the curled ண you have in கிண்ணம். Tamil keeps three of these apart and this word wants the middle one twice.

In the family, and next door

	word	same root
Kannada	ಇನ್ನೂ (*innū*)	yes
Telugu	ఇంకా (*iṅkā*)	yes
English	still, yet	

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

இன்னும் (*iṉṉum*) is native Dravidian (DEDR 410). The entry lists *iṉṉum*, "still, yet, more", among the words built on the near base *i-*.

What you've built

Two.

Your turn

- *Say it: iṉṉum*
- *Say it:* it once more, slowly
- *Say it: iṉṉum*, then *siṟitu*, and say the two together
- *Read it:* கயிறு
- *Recall:* say *tākam*

Before you move on

What does இன்னும் mean? ("still, yet".) Say it once more.

62.3 சீக்கிரம் (sīkkiram) — soon

Before the new one: what did *iṉṉum* mean?

You'll want to know: சீக்கிரம்

சீக்கிரம் (*sīkkiram*) — "soon".

Soon, and quickly — Tamil lets one word carry nearness in நேரம் and speed of doing together, and which one is meant comes out of the sentence around it.

Set it against பிறகு and the pair covers the whole span: சீக்கிரம் is the near end, பிறகு the loose one that promises nothing. Kannada says ಬೇಗ (*bēga*).

In the family, and next door

	word
Kannada	ಬೇಗ (*bēga*)
Malayalam	ഉടനെ (*uṭane*)
English	soon

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

சீக்கிரம் (*sīkkiram*) is a loan from Sanskrit *śīghra*, "quick" (CDIAL 12484).

What you've built

Three.

Your turn

- *Say it: sīkkiram*
- *Say it:* it once more, slowly
- *Say it: sīkkiram*, then *piṟaku*, and say which of the two commits you
- *Recall:* say *kuṭai*
- *Read it:* தூக்கம்

Before you move on

What does சீக்கிரம் mean? ("soon".) Say it once more.

62.4 உடனே (uṭaṉē) — at once

Before the new one: what did *sīkkiram* mean?

You'll want to know: உடனே

உடனே (*uṭaṉē*) — "at once".

Tighter than **சீக்கிரம்**: not soon but now, with nothing allowed in between. It is the word that answers an instruction you intend to obey.

Say it ending long, on the **ே**. That final length is doing the work — it is what makes the word press rather than merely inform.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

உடனே (*uṭaṉē*) is native Dravidian. DEDR 945 lists Malayalam *uṭan*, "at once". The entry glosses *uṭaṉ* "together with, immediately after, at once", and *-ē* stresses it.

What you've built

Four, and the fourth pushes harder than the third.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *uṭaṉē*
- *Say it:* it once more, slowly
- *Say it:* *sīkkiram*, then *uṭaṉē*, and say which one leaves you no room
- *Read it:* **துடைப்பம்**
- *Recall:* say *kāyccal*

Before you move on

What does **உடனே** mean? ("at once".) Say it once more.

62.5 முதலில் (mutalil) — first of all

Before the new one: what did *uṭaṉē* mean?

You'll want to know: முதலில்

முதலில் (*mutalil*) — "first of all".

Before anything else. It puts an order on things that had none: **முதலில் தண்ணீர்**, **பிறகு சாதம்** — water to begin with, and the rice after.

With this one you can lay out a sequence end to end: முதலில், then உடனே or சீக்கிரம் for what follows fast, then பிறகு for what can wait.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

முதலில் (*mutalil*) is native: *mutal*, "beginning, first" (DEDR 4950), with the locative *-il*, "in": "in the first place".

What you've built

Five, and the run is closed: only, still, soon, at once, and first of all.

Your turn

- *Say it: mutalil*
- *Say it:* it once more, slowly
- *Say it:* all five in order — *maṭṭum*, *iṉṉum*, *sīkkiram*, *uṭaṉē*, *mutalil*
- *Recall:* say *sīppu*
- *Read it:* வலி

Before you move on

What does முதலில் mean? ("first of all".) Say it once more.

Chapter 63

Asking Well

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can name a request, permission, hesitancy, trust and humility in Tamil.
>
> *Complete TA-C63-humility and say all five words in order.*

63.1 வேண்டுகோள் (vēṇḍukōḷ) — a request

Before the new one: what did *uṭaṉē* mean, and what did *mutalil* mean?

You'll want to know: வேண்டுகோள்

வேண்டுகோள் (*vēṇḍukōḷ*) — "a request".

A request as a thing you make and hand over, rather than the asking itself. It stands beside **வேண்டும்**, which you already have, and you can hear that word at the front of it.

Kannada **ವಿನಂತಿ** (*vinanti*) and Telugu **మనవి** (*manavi*) both went their own way. A **வேண்டுகோள்** is what **தயவுசெய்து** is put in front of when the asking has to be formal.

In the family, and next door

	word
Kannada	**ವಿನಂತಿ** (*vinanti*)
Telugu	**మనవి** (*manavi*)
Malayalam	**അപേക്ഷ** (*apēkṣa*)
English	a request

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

வேண்டுகோள் (*vēṇḍukōḷ*) is native: *vēṇṭu*, "to want, to ask for" (DEDR 5528), and *kōḷ*, a noun from *koḷ*, "to take, to hold" (DEDR 2151). A request is "a wanting put forward".

What you've built

The first of five.

Your turn

- *Say it: vēṇḍukōḷ*
- *Say it:* it once more, slowly
- *Say it: vēṇḍukōḷ*, then *tayavu seytu*, and say which one dresses the other
- *Recall:* say *pasi*
- *Read it:* மட்டும்

Before you move on

What does வேண்டுகோள் mean? ("a request".) Say it once more.

63.2 அனுமதி (aṉumati) — permission

Before the new one: what did *vēṇḍukōḷ* mean?

You'll want to know: அனுமதி

அனுமதி (*aṉumati*) — "permission".

Permission to do a thing — asked for, given, refused. Here all three sisters took the same Sanskrit word and did not even change its shape: Kannada ಅನುಮತಿ (*anumati*), Telugu అనుమతి (*anumati*), Tamil அனுமதி.

Hold it apart from விடை, which you already have. விடை is permission to go, taken formally at a door. அனுமதி is the wider one and covers everything else you might be allowed.

In the family, and next door

	word	same root
Kannada	ಅನುಮತಿ (*anumati*)	yes
Telugu	అనుమతి (*anumati*)	yes
Malayalam	അനുവാദം (*anuvādam*)	
Hindi (neighbour)	अनुमति (*anumati*)	yes
English	permission	

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

அனுமதி (*a̲numati*) is a well-established loan from Sanskrit *anumati*, "assent, permission".

What you've built

Two.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *a̲numati*
- *Say it:* it once more, slowly
- *Say it:* *a̲numati*, then *viḍai*, and say which of the two is only about leaving
- *Read it:* தாகம்
- *Recall:* say *i̲n̲num*

Before you move on

What does அனுமதி mean? ("permission".) Say it once more.

63.3 தயக்கம் (tayakkam) — hesitancy

Before the new one: what did *a̲numati* mean?

You'll want to know: தயக்கம்

தயக்கம் (*tayakkam*) — "hesitancy".

The holding back before you ask: the half-step not taken, the sentence begun and dropped. Kannada carries the same idea in **ಸಂಕೋಚ** (*saṅkōca*).

The **தயவு** inside **தயவுசெய்து** opens the same way and is a different word — that one is kindness given, this one is a foot kept back. Tamil puts them next to each other and expects you to hear the difference.

In the family, and next door

	word
Kannada	**ಸಂಕೋಚ** (*saṅkōca*)
English	hesitancy

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

தயக்கம் (*tayakkam*) is the noun of *tayaṅku*, "to hesitate". It looks native, but DEDR has no entry for it, so its origin is uncertain. DEDR 3454 has a near neighbour, *tiyaṅku*, "to be confused", without linking the two.

What you've built

Three.

Your turn

- *Say it: tayakkam*
- *Say it:* it once more, slowly
- *Say it: tayakkam*, then *tayavu seytu*, and say which one is a giving
- *Recall:* say *tūkkam*
- *Read it:* **சீக்கிரம்**

Before you move on

What does **தயக்கம்** mean? ("hesitancy".) Say it once more.

63.4 நம்பிக்கை (nambikkai) — trust

Before the new one: what did *tayakkam* mean?

You'll want to know: நம்பிக்கை

நம்பிக்கை (*nambikkai*) — "trust".

Trust, and the confidence that comes with it. All three are off the same old stem: Kannada **ನಂಬಿಕೆ** (*nambike*), Telugu **నమ్మకం** (*nammakaṁ*), Tamil **நம்பிக்கை**.

A **விருந்தாளி** is given this before anything else is given, which is the whole of what a Tamil house means by hospitality.

In the family, and next door

	word	same root
Kannada	**ನಂಬಿಕೆ** (*nambike*)	yes
Telugu	**నమ్మకం** (*nammakaṁ*)	yes
Malayalam	**വിശ്വാസം** (*viśvāsaṁ*)	
Hindi (neighbour)	**भरोसा** (*bharosā*)	
English	trust	

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

நம்பிக்கை (*nambikkai*) is native Dravidian. DEDR 3600 lists Malayalam *nampuka*, Kannada *nambu* and Telugu *nammu*. It is the noun of *nampu*, "to trust".

What you've built

Four.

Your turn

- *Say it: nambikkai*
- *Say it:* it once more, slowly
- *Say it: nambikkai*, then *viruntāḷi*, and say who is given which
- *Read it:* **காய்ச்சல்**
- *Recall:* say *uṭaṉē*

Before you move on

What does **நம்பிக்கை** mean? ("trust".) Say it once more.

63.5 பணிவு (paṇivu) — humility

Before the new one: what did *nambikkai* mean?

You'll want to know: பணிவு

பணிவு (*paṇivu*) — "humility".

The bending: humility, deference, a manner rather than an act. Set it against மரியாதை, which you already have — மரியாதை is respect paid outward to somebody, பணிவு is the carriage you keep in yourself.

Telugu's మర్యాద (*maryāda*) is the same word as your மரியாதை, which makes the pair easy to keep straight across the two.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

பணிவு (*paṇivu*) is native Dravidian. DEDR 3888 lists Malayalam *paṇiyuka*, "to bow, salute". It is the noun of *paṇi*, "to be low, to bow".

What you've built

Five, and the run is closed: a request, permission, hesitancy, trust, and humility.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *paṇivu*
- *Say it:* it once more, slowly
- *Say it:* all five in order — *vēṇḍukōḷ*, *aṉumati*, *tayakkam*, *nambikkai*, *paṇivu*
- *Recall:* say *vali*
- *Read it:* முதலில்

Before you move on

What does பணிவு mean? ("humility".) Say it once more.

Chapter 64

The Harvest

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can name paddy, grass, a standing crop, a threshing floor and the harvest in Tamil.
>
> *Complete TA-C64-harvest and say all five words in order.*

64.1 நெல் (nel) — paddy

> Before the new one: what did *nambikkai* mean, and what did *paṇivu* mean?

You'll want to know: நெல்

நெல் (*nel*) — "paddy".

Rice still in its husk — standing in the வயல், cut, carried, stored, but not yet அரிசி. The two words do not trade places: நெல் goes into the field and அரிசி comes out of the kitchen, and the husking is the border between them.

Kannada ಭತ್ತ (*bhatta*) and Telugu వరి (*vari*) each have their own word for it, so this is one the three do not share.

In the family, and next door

	word
Kannada	ಭತ್ತ (*bhatta*)
Telugu	వరి (*vari*)
English	paddy

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

நெல் (*nel*) is native Dravidian. DEDR 3753 lists Malayalam *nel* and Kannada *nel*.

What you've built

The first of five field words.

Your turn

- *Say it: nel*
- *Say it:* it once more, slowly
- *Say it: nel*, then *arisi*, and say which one the husk is still on
- *Recall:* say *maṭṭum*
- *Read it:* வேண்டுகோள்

Before you move on

What does நெல் mean? ("paddy".) Say it once more.

64.2 புல் (pul) — grass

Before the new one: what did *nel* mean?

You'll want to know: புல்

புல் (*pul*) — "grass".

Grass, of the kind cut and carried home. Kannada makes it ಹುಲ್ಲು (*hullu*) — the *p*-for-*h* trade a third time, and by now you can guess a Kannada word before you meet it. Telugu went elsewhere, to గడ్డి (*gaḍḍi*).

புல் and பல் sit one mark apart, and the mark is the whole difference: keep the உ round and low and the word stays grass. A பசு and an ஆடு are put out for புல்.

In the family, and next door

	word	same root
Kannada	ಹುಲ್ಲು (*hullu*)	yes
Telugu	గడ్డి (*gaḍḍi*)	
Malayalam	പുല്ല് (*pullŭ*)	yes
Hindi (neighbour)	घास (*ghās*)	
English	grass	

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

புல் (*pul*) is native Dravidian. DEDR 4300 lists Malayalam *pul*, Kannada *pul* and Telugu *pullu*.

What you've built

Two.

Your turn

- *Say it: pul*
- *Say it:* it once more, slowly
- *Say it: pul*, then *pal*, and hold the two vowels apart
- *Read it:* இன்னும்
- *Recall:* say *a̲numati*

Before you move on

What does புல் mean? ("grass".) Say it once more.

64.3 பயிர் (payir) — a standing crop

Before the new one: what did *pul* mean?

You'll want to know: பயிர்

பயிர் (*payir*) — "a standing crop".

What is growing in the வயல் at this moment, green and still rooted. It is not the வயல், which stays there when nothing is on it, and it is not the நெல் in the sack, which has stopped growing.

So the run has three separate things now where English leans on one word: the ground, the standing green, and the grain. Kannada calls the standing green ಬೆಳೆ (*beḷe*).

In the family, and next door

	word
Kannada	ಬೆಳೆ (*beḷe*)
Hindi (neighbour)	फ़सल (*fasal*)
English	a standing crop

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

பயிர் (*payir*) is native Dravidian. DEDR 3821 lists Malayalam *payir*, "green corn". The entry gathers words for green and fresh: a crop is what grows green.

What you've built

Three, and the three are carefully apart.

Your turn

- *Say it: payir*
- *Say it:* it once more, slowly
- *Say it: vayal*, then *payir*, then *nel*, in that order
- *Recall:* say *sīkkiram*
- *Read it:* தயக்கம்

Before you move on

What does பயிர் mean? ("a standing crop".) Say it once more.

64.4 களம் (kaḷam) — a threshing floor

Before the new one: what did *payir* mean?

You'll want to know: களம்

களம் (*kaḷam*) — "a threshing floor".

The beaten flat ground at the edge of a village where cut **நெல்** is spread, trodden and winnowed. Telugu has the same word as **కల్లం** (*kallaṁ*), which makes it old.

It is not **காலம்**, the season word you already have. This one is short at the front and takes the **ள**; **காலம்** opens long and takes the **ல**. One mark and one letter, and they are unrelated.

In the family, and next door

	word	same root
Telugu	**కల్లం** (*kallaṁ*)	yes
English	a threshing floor	

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

களம் (*kaḷam*) is native Dravidian. DEDR 1376 lists Malayalam *kaḷam* and Kannada *kaḷa*. The entry compares Sanskrit *khala*, "threshing floor" (CDIAL 3834).

What you've built

Four.

Your turn

- *Say it: kaḷam*
- *Say it:* it once more, slowly
- *Say it: kaḷam*, then *nel*, and say what is brought to which
- *Read it:* **உடனே**
- *Recall:* say *nambikkai*

Before you move on

What does **களம்** mean? ("a threshing floor".) Say it once more.

64.5 அறுவடை (aṟuvaṭai) — the harvest

Before the new one: what did *kaḷam* mean?

You'll want to know: அறுவடை

அறுவடை (*aṟuvaṭai*) — "the harvest".

The cutting and the gathering together, and the stretch of the year named after them. Kannada ಸುಗ್ಗಿ (*suggi*) and Telugu పంట (*paṇṭa*) each named the same weeks their own way.

The front of it is the reaping, not the ஆறு you counted with: this one opens short on அ and takes the hard ற straight away, where six opens long on ஆ. Close together on the page, far apart in the mouth.

In the family, and next door

	word
Kannada	ಸುಗ್ಗಿ (*suggi*)
Telugu	పంట (*paṇṭa*)
Malayalam	കൊയ്ത്ത് (*koyttŭ*)
English	the harvest

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

அறுவடை (*aṟuvaṭai*) is native Dravidian. DEDR 315 lists Malayalam *aṟukka*, "to cut". The entry lists *aṟuvaṭai* under *aṟu*, "to cut": the harvest is the cutting.

What you've built

Five, and the run is closed: paddy, grass, a standing crop, a threshing floor, and the harvest.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *aṟuvaṭai*
- *Say it:* it once more, slowly
- *Say it:* all five in order — *nel*, *pul*, *payir*, *kaḷam*, *aṟuvaṭai*
- *Recall:* say *mutalil*
- *Read it:* பணிவு

Before you move on

What does அறுவடை mean? (“the harvest”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 65

Doing, and Undoing

Modes: **voice** (6) **pen** (1) **Hands-free start:** the first 2 of 7 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say drink, walk, stop, open and close in Tamil, and name the action that undoes each one.
>
> *Complete TA-C65-doing-recall and produce each of the five doings from the act that undoes it, out of order.*

65.1 குடி (kuḍi) — drink

Before the new one: what did *aṟuvaḍai* mean?

You'll want to know: குடி

குடி (*kuḍi*) — "drink".

You already have சாப்பிடு (*sāppiḍu*) for what you chew. குடி is what you do to a liquid, and Tamil keeps the two apart the way English does: rice is சாப்பிடு, தண்ணீர் is குடி.

Say what is being drunk, and say it in front of the verb: தண்ணீர் குடி (*taṇṇīr kuḍi*), தேநீர் குடி (*tēnīr kuḍi*), பால் குடி (*pāl kuḍi*). Naming the liquid is not decoration. On its own, without anything in front of it, குடி is also the everyday noun for the drinking *habit* — a man described as being given to குடி is being described as a drinker. So a speaker who wants the plain, ordinary sense puts the drink in the sentence, and there is nothing left to misread.

Across the family: Kannada uses ಕುಡಿ (*kuḍi*) and Malayalam കുടിക്കുക (*kuṭikkuka*) — the same word, worn a little differently. Telugu reached for something else entirely and drinks with త్రాగు (*trāgu*).

In the family, and next door

	word	same root
Kannada	ಕುಡಿ (*kuḍi*)	yes
English	drink	

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

குடி (*kuḍi*) is native Dravidian. DEDR 1654 lists Malayalam *kuṭi* and Kannada *kuḍi*, and compares Sanskrit *kuṭī*, "liquor".

What you've built

The first of five everyday doings, and the one that completes the pair you had half of.

Your turn

- *Say it: kuḍi*
- *Say it: taṇṇīr kuḍi* — "drink water"
- *Say it: tēnīr kuḍi*, then *pāl kuḍi*
- *Say it:* which of *sāppiḍu* and *kuḍi* takes *sādam*, and which takes *taṇṇīr*
- *Recall:* say *vēṇḍukōḷ*
- *Read it:* நெல்

Before you move on

What does குடி mean? ("drink".) And what does a speaker put in front of it, every time? (The drink itself.)

65.2 நட (naḍa) — walk

What did *kuḍi* mean, and what does a speaker name in front of it?

You'll want to know: நட

நட (*naḍa*) — "walk".

You have போ (*pō*) for going. போ says nothing about how — by bus, by train, on foot. நட names the feet. Where போ leaves the manner open, நட fills it in, so the two sit side by side rather than competing: *pō* to leave, *naḍa* to leave on foot.

One neighbour worth hearing apart. You have met நடு (*naṭu*, "middle"), inside the words for midday and midnight. நட and நடு differ by the little ு hook at the end and by nothing else, and they are two separate words: one is an action, one is a position.

Across the family: this one all four sisters kept. Kannada ನಡೆ (*naḍe*), Telugu నడుచు (*naḍucu*), Malayalam നടക്കുക (*naṭakkuka*) — and Tamil நட. Where the drinking word split Telugu off, the walking word holds the family together.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

நட (*naḍa*) is native Dravidian. DEDR 3582 lists Malayalam *naṭakka*, Kannada *naḍe* and Telugu *naḍa*.

What you've built

Two doings. One of them fills in what the other leaves open.

Your turn

- *Say it: naḍa*
- *Say it: pō*, then *naḍa*, and say which one names the feet
- *Say it: naḍa*, then *naṭu*, and hear the hook arrive
- *Say it: kuḍi*, then *naḍa*
- *Read it:* அனுமதி
- *Recall:* say *pul*

Before you move on

What does நட mean? ("walk".) Which of போ and நட tells you the feet were doing it? (நட.)

65.3 குடி — a word with nothing new in it

> Two lessons ago you learned to say *kuḍi*, and a walking word came between. Now look at it on the page.

Script you'll notice: nothing new

Every lesson in this strand so far has arrived carrying a letter you had not met. This one arrives carrying none. All four pieces of குடி are already yours, and the work is putting them together.

piece		
கு	*ku* — க with the ு sign	க from the very first writing lesson; the ு hook from *uṇavu*
டி	*ḍi* — ட with the ி sign	ட from *eppaḍi*; the ி sign from *naṉṟi*

கு · டி → குடி

Two letters, two signs riding them, and a word you have been saying since the drinking lesson. Nothing here is a new shape; the only new thing is that these four now sit together.

Script you'll notice: the letter you can hear moving

ட is the letter this book writes as *ḍ* here and as *ṭ* elsewhere, because Tamil does not mark the difference on the page — the position in the word decides it. Inside எப்படி you say *eppaḍi*, and inside குடி you say *kuḍi*: in both, ட sits between vowels and softens. The same shape, read by where it stands.

Your turn

- *Read it:* கு — then டி — then குடி
- *Contrast:* குடி and எப்படி — find the ட in each
- *Say it: kuḍi*, and name the drink you would put in front of it

Before you move on

Read குடி. How many letters carry a vowel sign in it? (Both of them.) What decides whether ட comes out *ṭ* or *ḍ*? (Where it stands in the word.)

65.4 நிறுத்து (niṟuttu) — stop

Read it: குடி off the page once

Then: what did *naḍa* mean?

You'll want to know: நிறுத்து

நிறுத்து (*niṟuttu*) — "stop".

This is what undoes நட. Feet moving is *naḍa*; நிறுத்து**!** called across a street brings them to a halt, and it is the word for stopping a bus, a song, a clock or an argument as readily as a person.

It is a long word for a short act, and it comes apart. Inside it is the standing-family that gave you நிலை (*nilai*, "a state, a standing") — the piece you already met welded into வானிலை (*vāṉilai*, "weather"), the sky's *standing*. Where நிலை names the state, நிறுத்து is the making of it: bring the thing to a stand. The weather word and the stopping word are cousins, and knowing that is why *niṟuttu* has somewhere to sit in your memory rather than four syllables to survive on.

Across the family: Kannada ನಿಲ್ಲಿಸು (*nillisu*) and Malayalam നിർത്തുക (*nirttuka*) are built the same way, from the same standing-verb.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

நிறுத்து (*niṟuttu*) is native Dravidian. DEDR 3675 lists Malayalam *niṟuttuka*, "to make to stand". It is the causative of *nil*, "to stand": to stop something is "to make it stand".

What you've built

Three doings, and the first pair that undoes itself: *naḍa* against *niṟuttu*.

Your turn

- *Say it: niṟuttu*
- *Say it: naḍa*, then *niṟuttu* — moving, then halted
- *Say it: niṟuttu* the way you would call it across a street
- *Say it: vāṉilai*, and name the piece of it this verb is related to
- *Recall:* say *tayakkam*
- *Read it:* பயிர்

Before you move on

What does நிறுத்து mean? ("stop".) Which everyday word already carried its family? (வானிலை — the sky's *standing*.)

65.5 திற (tiṟa) — open

What did *niṟuttu* mean, and which walking word does it undo?

You'll want to know: திற

திற (*tiṟa*) — "open".

You have கதவு (*kadavu*), the door. திற is what you do to it. The ற in the middle is the hard, tapped *ṟ* you first met in நன்றி (*naṉṟi*) — the same letter, in a word where nothing hides it.

Tamil joins a verb to the thing it acts on with an ending this chapter does not open yet, so hold *kadavu* and *tiṟa* as two words you can say in sequence rather than a sentence you can build. The pair is worth having early even without the joint: a door and the act of opening it are two of the first things anyone needs at somebody else's house.

Across the family, one old word in four shapes: Kannada has తೆರೆ (*tere*), Telugu has తెరుచు (*terucu*), and Malayalam has തുറക്കുക (*tuṟakkuka*). Tamil's keeps the tapped ற the others softened away.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

திற (*tiṟa*) is native Dravidian. DEDR 3259 lists Malayalam *tuṟakka*, Kannada *teṟa*, "an opening" and Telugu *teṟa*.

What you've built

Four doings, and a verb that belongs to a noun you already carry.

Your turn

- *Say it: tiṟa*
- *Say it: kadavu*, then *tiṟa* — the thing, then the act
- *Say it: naṉṟi*, then *tiṟa*, and hear the same ற twice
- *Say it: niṟuttu*, then *tiṟa*
- *Read it:* நம்பிக்கை
- *Recall:* say *kaḷam*

Before you move on

What does திற mean? ("open".) Which door word does it go with? (கதவு.)

65.6 மூடு (mūḍu) — close

What did *tiṟa* mean, and which noun does it belong beside?

You'll want to know: மூடு

மூடு (*mūḍu*) — "close", "shut".

The verb that undoes திற. A கதவு you have opened is a கதவு you can மூடு, and the two travel together the way *naḍa* and *niṟuttu* do.

The long ூ at its front is the same sign you read in மூன்று (*mūṉṟu*, "three"). Two words, one sign, no relation between their meanings — worth noticing so the shape stops being a surprise.

Across the family, this one did not travel. Kannada shuts a door with ಮುಚ್ಚು (*muccu*), Telugu with మూయు (*mūyu*), and Malayalam with അടയ്ക്കുക (*aṭaykkuka*). Four sisters, three different words — after two verbs the family held in common, a reminder that the sharing is real but never guaranteed.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

மூடு (*mūḍu*) is native Dravidian. DEDR 5034 lists Malayalam *mūṭuka*, "to cover".

What you've built

Five everyday doings, in pairs: *sāppiḍu* with *kuḍi*, *naḍa* with *niṟuttu*, *tiṟa* with *mūḍu*. Each one arrived beside the act that undoes it, which is the cheapest way there is to hold two words instead of one.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *mūḍu*
- *Say it:* *tiṟa*, then *mūḍu*
- *Say it:* all five in order — *kuḍi*, *naḍa*, *niṟuttu*, *tiṟa*, *mūḍu*
- *Say it:* for each of *naḍa* and *tiṟa*, the word that undoes it
- *Say it:* *taṇṇīr kuḍi*, then *kadavu*, then *mūḍu*
- *Read it:* குடி — the one word of the five you have spelled out
- *Recall:* say *paṇivu*
- *Read it:* அறுவடை

Before you move on

Say the five doings in order. Which two of them make a pair with a door? (திற and மூடு.) Which drink word did you put in front of குடி? (*taṇṇīr*, or *tēnīr*, or *pāl*.)

65.7 The five doings, retrieved

Reach back one chapter first: what did *kaḷam* mean, and what did *aṟuvaḍai* mean? Nothing new arrives in this lesson.

Your turn — retrieve, do not recite

Say these aloud:

- the word for drinking, and a drink to put in front of it
- the word for walking, and then the word that stops it
- what you do to a **கதவு**, and then the act that undoes that
- all five, in the order you met them
- all five again, fastest you can hold them

Your turn — the pairs, out of order

Each prompt names one half. Say the other.

- *mūḍu* → (*tiṟa*)
- *naḍa* → (*niṟuttu*)
- *sāppiḍu* → (*kuḍi*)
- *niṟuttu* → (*naḍa*)
- *tiṟa* → (*mūḍu*)
- *Read it:* **குடி**, then say what goes in front of it

Before you move on

Which of the five has no partner among the other four, and where does its partner live instead? (**குடி** — its partner is **சாப்பிடு**, from the eating lesson.)

Chapter 66

Which Way

Modes: **voice** (7) **pen** (1) **Hands-free start:** the first 2 of 8 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say up, down, inside, outside, right and left in Tamil, and put each one in front of a verb or a noun I already know.
>
> *Complete TA-C66-whichway-recall and produce each of the six directions from its opposite, then sort all six by the ending they take.*

66.1 மேலே (mēlē) — up, above

One word back from last chapter first: what did *mūḍu* mean?

You'll want to know: மேலே

மேலே (*mēlē*) — "up, above".

It sits in front of the verb, where every Tamil adverb sits: மேலே பார் (*mēlē pār*) — "look up". You already have பார் from the seeing lesson, so this is one new word buying you a whole instruction.

Underneath it is மேல் (*mēl*), the bare word for "the top", a native Dravidian positional word. Kannada says ಮೇಲೆ (*mēle*) for the same idea, and it is the same word, worn the same way.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

மேலே (*mēlē*) is native Dravidian. DEDR 5086 lists Malayalam *mē*, "over". The entry lists *mēl*, "that which is over or above", and -*ē* turns it into "up there".

Why it's said this way

Listen to the end of the word, and then say the two pointing words you already have. இங்கே (*iṅgē*, "here") and அங்கே (*aṅgē*, "there") end the same way. That **-ஏ** is Tamil's way of turning a bare place-word into "**at** that place, **to** that place" — and மேல் plus **-ஏ** is மேலே, "at the top, upward".
So this is not a new machine. It is a machine you already own, running on a new word.

Your turn

- *Say it: mēlē*
- *Say it: mēlē pār* — "look up"
- *Say it: iṅgē, aṅgē, mēlē* — three words, one ending
- *Recall:* say *nel*
- *Read it:* குடி

Before you move on

What does மேலே mean? ("Up, above".) What two pointing words end the same way, and what does that ending do? (இங்கே and அங்கே — the **-ஏ** makes a place-word mean "at, or to, that place".)

66.2 கீழே (kīḻē) — down, below

Say the word for "up", and the instruction you built with it.

You'll want to know: கீழே

கீழே (*kīḻē*) — "down, below". The other half of the pair, and built by the same two pieces: **கீழ்** (*kīḻ*, "the bottom") plus the **-ஏ** you met one lesson ago.

கீழே பார் (*kīḻē pār*) — "look down". Same slot, same verb, opposite direction.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

கீழே (*kīḻē*) is native Dravidian. DEDR 1619 lists Malayalam *kīḻ*, "place below".

The letters in this word

The middle of this word is **ழ** (*ḻ*), the retroflex glide you first met inside **மகிழ்ச்சி** and again in **தமிழ்** itself. Curl the tongue back and let the air pass beside it; it is not an English *l* and it is not an English *r*. The vowel in front of it is **long**: *kīḻ*, not *kiḻ*. Tamil separates words by vowel length, so the length is doing work here, not decoration.

Your turn

- *Say it: kīḻē* — feel the **ழ**
- *Say it: mēlē pār*, then *kīḻē pār*
- *Say it:* both bare words, *mēl* and *kīḻ*, then both with the ending
- *Read it:* **புல்**
- *Recall:* say *naḍa*

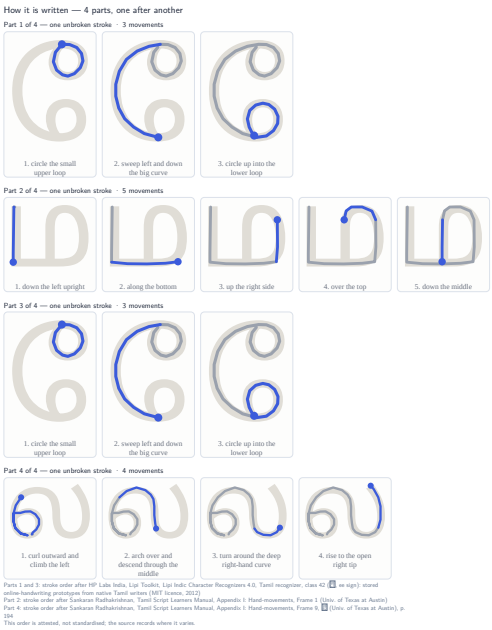
Before you move on

What does **கீழே** mean, and what two pieces build it? ("Down, below" — **கீழ்** plus **-ஏ**.) Which rare Tamil letter sits in the middle of it? (**ழ**, the same one in *tamiḻ*.)

66.3 மேலே — the same sign twice

Two lessons ago you learned to say *mēlē*, and *kīḻē* came between. Now look at it on the page.

Script you'll notice: two letters, one sign, used twice



How மேலே *is written, part by part, stroke by stroke*

Like குடி before it, மேலே brings no new shape. It brings something better: the same vowel sign riding two different letters, one after the other.

piece		
மே	*mē* — ம with the ே sign	ம from the letter-*ma* lesson; the ே sign from the vowel-sign lesson, and again inside *pēsu*
லே	*lē* — ல with the ே sign	ல from the letter-*la* lesson; the **same** ே again

மே · லே → மேலே

Read it once as two beats. Both beats are long, and both are long for the same reason: the ே hook in front of each letter.

Script you'll notice: the hook goes in front, the sound comes after

The ே sits to the **left** of the letter it belongs to, and is said **after** it. மே is written hook-then-ம and read *mē*. That is not a quirk of this word — it is how this sign has always worked, and மேலே shows it twice in a row so you can watch the eye do it.

Your turn

- *Read it:* மே — then லே — then மேலே
- *Point to:* the ே in each of the two beats
- *Read it:* மேலே, then say the instruction you built from it

Before you move on

Read மேலே. How many times does the ே appear, and on which side of its letter does it sit? (**Twice**; on the **left**, though it is said after.)

66.4 உள்ளே (uḷḷē) — inside

Say the opposite of மேலே. *Read it:* மேலே off the page

You'll want to know: உள்ளே

உள்ளே (*uḷḷē*) — "inside, in".

The same shape a third time: உள் (*uḷ*, "the inside") plus the **-ஏ** that turns a place-word into a place you can go to.

And now it earns its keep. உள்ளே வா (*uḷḷē vā*) — "**come in**." That is what a Tamil household says at the door, and you have had வா since the coming-and-going lesson. One new word, and you can answer a doorway.

In the family, and next door

	word
Telugu	లోపల (*lōpala*)
Malayalam	അകത്ത് (*akattŭ*)
English	inside, in

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

உள்ளே (*uḷḷē*) is native Dravidian. DEDR 698 lists Malayalam *uḷḷu*, "inside".

Why it's said this way

Written out, உள் ends in the retroflex ள், and the ending brings a second one: உள் + ஏ → உள்ளே, with ள்ளே doubled in the middle. Hold it a beat longer than a single ள, the way you already hold the *kk* in வணக்கம்.
You have met that doubling before without being told it was the same thing: வெள்ளை (*veḷḷai*, "white") carries it too.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *uḷḷē* — hold the doubled ள
- *Say it:* *uḷḷē vā* — "come in"
- *Say it:* *mēlē*, *kīḻē*, *uḷḷē* — three place-words, one ending
- *Recall:* say *payir*
- *Read it:* நிறுத்து

Before you move on

What does உள்ளே mean, and what do you say at a door with it? ("Inside" — உள்ளே வா, "come in".) What happens to the ள when the ending arrives? (It **doubles**.)

66.5 வெளியே (veḷiyē) — outside

What do you say at a door to bring someone in?

You'll want to know: வெளியே

வெளியே (*veḷiyē*) — "outside, out". The answer to உள்ளே, and the fourth word built the same way: வெளி (*veḷi*, "the open, the outside") plus -ஏ.

வெளியே போ (*veḷiyē pō*) — "go out". Put it beside உள்ளே வா and you have a matched pair of instructions, each one an old verb with a new word in front of it.

In the family, and next door

	word
Kannada	ಹೊರಗೆ (*horage*)
Telugu	బయట (*bayaṭa*)
English	outside, out

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

வெளியே (*veḷiyē*) is native Dravidian. DEDR 5498 lists Malayalam *veḷi*, "outside". The entry glosses *veḷi* "outside, open space".

Why it's said this way

உள் ends in a consonant, so -ஏ doubled it. வெளி ends in a vowel, and two vowels cannot sit against each other, so Tamil slides a ய் (*y*) between them: வெளி + ஏ → வெளியே.
Tamil grammar has a name for that sliding letter: உடம்படுமெய் (*uḍambaḍumey*), the "body-joining consonant". Its whole job is to stand between two vowels that would otherwise meet, and it is either ய் or வ். Once you know it is there, you stop hearing வெளியே as a word with a strange extra letter and start hearing it as வெளி with an ending on it.

Your turn

- *Say it: veḷiyē*
- *Say it: uḷḷē vā*, then *veḷiyē pō*
- *Say it:* the bare pair — *uḷ* and *veḷi* — then both with the ending
- *Read it:* களம்
- *Recall:* say *tiṟa*

Before you move on

What two instructions does this pair give you at a door? (உள்ளே வா, "come in", and வெளியே போ, "go out".) Why is there a ய inside வெளியே and not inside உள்ளே? (வெளி ends in a **vowel**, so a ய slides in to keep two vowels apart.)

66.6 வலது (valadu) — the right side

Say the pair you can use at a door.

You'll want to know: வலது

வலது (*valadu*) — "the right side, the right-hand one".

It does not take the **-ஏ** ending, because it is not that kind of word. It goes straight in front of a noun: வலது கை (*valadu kai*) — "the right hand". You have had கை since the head-and-hand lesson, so again the new word is the only new thing.

Why it's said this way

Listen to how it ends, and say the two pointing words again — this time the pair that names things rather than places. இது (*idu*, "this one") and அது (*adu*, "that one") end in the same **-து**. That ending means "**the one that is**" — so வலது is, quite literally, "the right one".

Two endings from the same stretch of the book, and now you can hear the machine from both sides: **-ஏ** makes a **place** you can move to, **-து** makes a **thing** you can point at.

> Tamil's word for the right side sits close to வலி (*vali*), "strength" — the strong hand naming the side, a link many languages make (English gets *dexterity* from the Latin for "right"). Take that as the usual account rather than a settled derivation.

Your turn

- *Say it: valadu*
- *Say it: valadu kai* — "the right hand"

- *Say it: idu, adu, valadu* — three words, one ending
- *Recall:* say *aṟuvaṭai*
- *Read it:* மூடு

Before you move on

What does வலது mean, and what does it not take that மேலே does? ("The right side"; it takes **no -ஏ**.) Which two pointing words share its ending? (இது and அது.)

66.7 இடது (iḍadu) — the left side

Which hand is the வலது கை? Say which: right or left.

You'll want to know: இடது

இடது (*iḍadu*) — "the left side, the left-hand one". The last of the six, and it behaves exactly like வலது: no -ஏ, straight in front of the noun. இடது கை (*iḍadu kai*) — "the left hand".

Both hands, in two words you can now hold up and check against each other.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

இடது (*iḍadu*) is native Dravidian. DEDR 449 lists Malayalam *iṭam* and Kannada *eḍa*. The entry gives *iṭam*, "left side", and compares Indo-Aryan **ḍāva*, "left" (CDIAL 5539), which CDIAL counts as non-Aryan.

Why it's said this way

Written out, இடது carries ட between two vowels — and you learned in the reading lesson for குடி that a ட in that position softens. So the book writes this word *iḍadu*, not *iṭadu*, for the same reason it writes *kuḍi* and *eppaḍi*. One letter, read by where it stands.

> Tamil's word for the left side looks a great deal like இடம் (*iḍam*), "place, room" — and dictionaries do connect them. Treat that as the usual account rather than a settled fact; it is the kind of link that is easy to see and hard to prove.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- *iḍadu*
- *valadu kai*, then *iḍadu kai* — and say *right* or *left* after each
- all four of the **-ஏ** words, then both of the **-து** words

Before you move on

What does இடது mean? ("The left side".) Why is its ட read as a soft *ḍ*? (Because it sits **between two vowels**, the same rule as in *kuḍi*.)

66.8 The six directions, retrieved

> Reach back one chapter first: what did *tiṟa* mean, and what did *mūḍu* mean? Nothing new arrives in this lesson.

Your turn — retrieve, do not recite

Say these aloud:

- the word for "up", and the instruction that sends the eyes there
- the word for "down", and the same instruction pointed the other way
- what you call at a door to bring someone in
- all four of the **-ஏ** words, in the order you met them
- all four again, fastest you can hold them

Your turn — the pairs, out of order

Each prompt names one half. Say the other.

- *kīḻē* → (*mēlē*)
- *veḷiyē* → (*uḷḷē*)
- *iḍadu* → (*valadu*)

- *uḷḷē vā* → (*veḷiyē pō*)
- *mēlē pār* → (*kīḻē pār*)
- *Read it:* மேலே, then say the verb that goes after it

Your turn — sort the six

Two endings, and every word in this chapter takes one of them.

- *Sort:* which four take **-ஏ**, and which two take **-து**
- *Say it:* why the four go in front of a **verb** and the two go in front of a **noun**
- *Say it:* வலது கை, then இடது கை, saying *right* or *left* after each

Before you move on

Which two of the six never take **-ஏ**, and what do they take instead? (வலது and இடது — the **-து** of இது and அது.)

Chapter 67

What You Wear

Modes: **voice** (5) **pen** (1) **Hands-free start:** the first 2 of 6 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can name a shirt, a veshti, a sari, sandals and a cap in Tamil, and run the five from the head down to the floor.
>
> *Complete TA-C67-cap and say all five words of the chapter in order.*

67.1 சட்டை (saṭṭai) — a shirt

> Before the new one: one word back from last chapter: what did *iḍadu* mean?

You'll want to know: சட்டை

சட்டை (*saṭṭai*) — "a shirt".

The ordinary word for a shirt — the thing that goes over the top half of you, in a shop or on a washing line.

You already own துணி (*tuṇi*), cloth. The two are one step apart: துணி is the material, and சட்டை is the thing cut and sewn out of it. Ask for துணி and you get a length of fabric; ask for a சட்டை and you get a garment.

Say the middle hard. The doubled ட்ட in சட்டை is the same doubled ட you already hear in பெட்டி (*peṭṭi*), a box — and it is what keeps this word *saṭṭai* rather than a softer *saḍai*.

In the family, and next door

	word
Kannada	ಅಂಗಿ (*aṅgi*)
Telugu	చొక్కా (*cokkā*)
Malayalam	ഷർട്ട് (*ṣarṭṭŭ*)
Hindi (neighbour)	कमीज़ (*kamīz*)
English	a shirt

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

சட்டை (*saṭṭai*) is native Dravidian. DEDR 2310 lists Malayalam *caṭṭa*, Kannada *caṭṭe* and Telugu *caṭṭa*.

What you've built

The first of five things you can wear.

Your turn

- *Say it: saṭṭai*
- *Say it: tuṇi*, then *saṭṭai* — and say which one is still just cloth
- *Recall:* say *valadu*, then say *iḍadu*, then say *saṭṭai*
- *Recall:* say *mēlē*
- *Read it:* கீழே

Before you move on

Say it once more, holding the doubled ட.

67.2 வேட்டி (vēṭṭi) — a veshti, the cloth a man wraps at the waist

Before the new one: what did *saṭṭai* mean?

You'll want to know: வேட்டி

வேட்டி (*vēṭṭi*) — "a veshti, the cloth a man wraps at the waist".

Not a sewn garment at all. A வேட்டி is a single uncut length of துணி, wrapped round the waist and tucked — which is why the cloth word sits so close behind it.

English borrowed the northern word *dhoti* for the same idea. In Tamil Nadu the word you will hear, and the word to say, is வேட்டி.

Its middle is the doubled ட you met one lesson ago in சட்டை, riding a long ே this time.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

வேட்டி (*vēṭṭi*) is probably from Sanskrit *veṣṭ-*, "to wrap": CDIAL 12130 gives *veṣṭa*, "band, enclosure", and its family. A veshti is the cloth wrapped round.

What you've built

Two garments, and the same doubled consonant in both.

Your turn

- *Say it: vēṭṭi*
- *Say it: saṭṭai*, then *vēṭṭi* — and say which one was never cut
- *Recall:* say *iḍadu*, then say *saṭṭai*, then say *vēṭṭi*
- *Read it:* உள்ளே

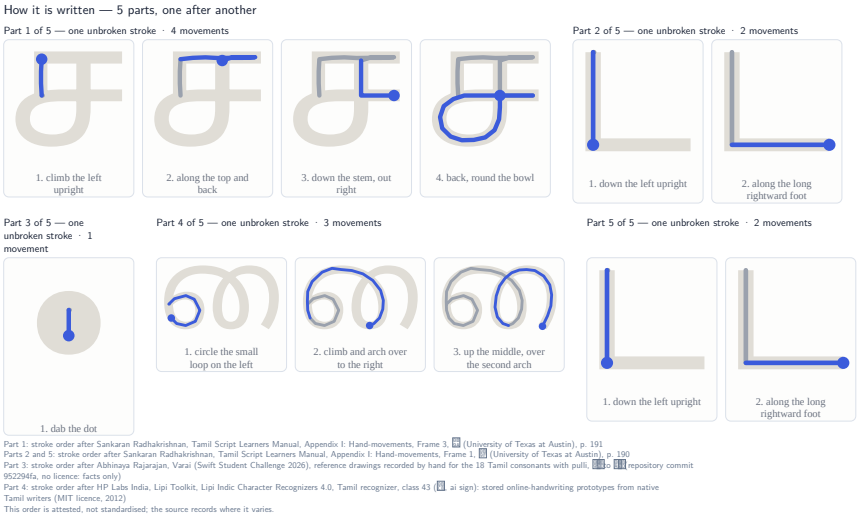
Before you move on

Which of the two is one uncut length of cloth? (வேட்டி.)

67.3 சட்டை — what a doubled letter looks like

Before the page: you have said *saṭṭai* and *vēṭṭi* aloud. Now look at the first one on the page.

Script you'll notice: சட்டை — what a doubled letter looks like



How சட்டை is written, part by part, stroke by stroke

சட்டை brings no new shape. It brings a familiar one used twice in a row, which is worth watching once slowly.

piece		
ச	*sa*	the letter on its own, with its own built-in *a*
ட்	the ட with a புள்ளி on top	the dot that takes the vowel away, so nothing is said after it
டை	*ṭai*	the same ட again, this time with the ை sign

ச · ட் · டை → சட்டை

The dot in the middle is doing the whole job. Without it you would have ச-ட-டை, three open beats. With it, the first ட closes and leans on the second, and the word comes out hard in the middle: *saṭṭai*.

Your turn

- *Read it:* ச — then ட் — then டை

- *Point to:* the புள்ளி, and say what it takes away
- *Read it:* சட்டை, then say what it means
- *Recall:* say *saṭṭai*, then say *vēṭṭi*, then read சட்டை

Before you move on

Read சட்டை. Which mark makes the middle hard? (The புள்ளி on the first ட.)

67.4 புடவை (puḍavai) — a sari

Before the new one, say what சட்டை means. *Read it:* சட்டை once

You'll want to know: புடவை

புடவை (*puḍavai*) — "a sari".

The everyday Tamil word for the draped cloth a woman wears.

English took **sari** in from the north. Tamil's own word is புடவை, and it is the one that works in a Tamil shop: say புடவை and you will be shown exactly what you asked for.

It ends in the ை you have now met three times over — in தலை (*talai*), the head, and twice inside சட்டை.

In the family, and next door

	word
Kannada	ಸೀರೆ (*sīre*)
Telugu	చీర (*cīra*)
Malayalam	സാരി (*sāri*)
Hindi (neighbour)	साड़ी (*sāṛī*)
English	a sari

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

புடவை (*puḍavai*) is native Dravidian. DEDR 4256 lists Malayalam *puṭava* and Kannada *puṭṭige*. The entry compares Sanskrit *phuṭṭikā*, "a kind of cloth".

What you've built

Three garments, and a Tamil word English never borrowed.

Your turn

- *Say it: puḍavai*
- *Say it: talai, saṭṭai, puḍavai* — three words, one ending
- *Recall:* say *vēṭṭi*
- *Read it:* சட்டை
- *Recall:* say *puḍavai*
- *Recall:* say *veḷiyē*

Before you move on

Which ending do தலை, சட்டை and புடவை share? (The ை.)

67.5 செருப்பு (seruppu) — a sandal, footwear

Before the new one: what did *puḍavai* mean?

You'll want to know: செருப்பு

செருப்பு (*seruppu*) — "a sandal, footwear".

Footwear — and in Tamil it is really a doorway word.

செருப்பு comes off at the வாசல் (*vāsal*) before anyone steps உள்ளே. So the thing you have just named is the one thing that stays வெளியே: three words from earlier chapters, and this one is the reason they get used every day.

In the family, and next door

	word	same root
Malayalam	ചെരുപ്പ് (*ceruppŭ*)	yes
Hindi (neighbour)	चप्पल (*cappal*)	
English	a sandal, footwear	

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

செருப்பு (*seruppu*) is native Dravidian. DEDR 1963 lists Malayalam *cerippu*, Kannada *kera* and Telugu *ceppu*.

What you've built

Four, and the run has reached the floor.

Your turn

- *Say it: seruppu*
- *Say it: seruppu*, then *vāsal* — and say which side of the door each one is on
- *Read it:* சட்டை
- *Recall:* say *puḍavai*, then say *seruppu*
- *Read it:* வலது

Before you move on

Where does the செருப்பு stay — உள்ளே or வெளியே? (வெளியே.)

67.6 தொப்பி (toppi) — a cap, a hat

Before the new one: what did *seruppu* mean, and what did *puḍavai* mean?

You'll want to know: தொப்பி

தொப்பி (*toppi*) — "a cap, a hat".

The last of the five, and the highest one: a தொப்பி sits மேலே, on the தலை.

Its ொ is the short o sign you met long before this chapter, and its doubled ப்ப works exactly like the doubled ட you took apart in சட்டை — a புள்ளி closing the first letter onto the second.

With this one the run has both ends: தொப்பி at the top, செருப்பு at the floor.

In the family, and next door

	word	same root
Kannada	ಟೋಪಿ (*ṭōpi*)	yes
Telugu	టోపీ (*ṭōpī*)	yes
Malayalam	തൊപ്പി (*toppi*)	yes
Hindi (neighbour)	टोपी (*ṭopī*)	yes
English	a cap, a hat	

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

தொப்பி (*toppi*) is a loan from Hindustani *ṭopī*, "cap". CDIAL 5481 sets the North Indian forms under *ṭōppa*, "hat, covering", whose own origin is unclear.

What you've built

Five things to wear, top to bottom.

Your turn

- *Say it: toppi*
- *Say it:* all five from the head down — *toppi*, *saṭṭai*, *vēṭṭi*, *puḍavai*, *seruppu*
- *Recall:* say *puḍavai*, then say *seruppu*, then say *toppi*
- *Recall:* say *iḍadu*

Before you move on

Which of the five sits highest, and which stays வெளியே? (தொப்பி; செருப்பு.)

Chapter 68

At the Shop

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) ✓ **pen** (1) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** the first 2 of 6 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can name a shop, a price, money, buying and a bag in Tamil, and ask what something costs.
>
> *Complete TA-C68-bag and say all five words of the chapter in order.*

68.1 கடை (kaḍai) — a shop

Before the new one: what did *toppi* mean?

You'll want to know: கடை

கடை (*kaḍai*) — "a shop".

Any shop at all: the tea shop, the cloth shop, the one at the end of the street. Tamil does not split the word by what is sold — a **கடை** is a **கடை**, and what is inside it is said separately.

It ends in the same **ை** as **தலை** and **சட்டை**, and it is where every garment of the last chapter came from.

In the family, and next door

	word	same root
Kannada	**ಅಂಗಡಿ** (*aṅgaḍi*)	
Telugu	**అంగడి** (*aṅgaḍi*)	
Malayalam	**കട** (*kaṭa*)	yes
Hindi (neighbour)	**दुकान** (*dukān*)	
English	a shop	

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

கடை (*kaḍai*) is native Dravidian. DEDR 1142 lists Malayalam *kaṭa*, "market".

What you've built

The place the next four words happen in.

Your turn

- *Say it: kaḍai*
- *Say it: kaḍai*, then name one thing from last chapter you would go there for
- *Recall:* say *seruppu*, then say *toppi*, then say *kaḍai*
- *Recall:* say *mēlē*
- *Read it:* கீழே
- *Recall:* say *saṭṭai*

Before you move on

Say it once more.

68.2 விலை (vilai) — a price

Before the new one: what did *kaḍai* mean?

You'll want to know: விலை

விலை (*vilai*) — "a price".

The number the shopkeeper says back to you.

This one word turns a question you already own into a whole sentence. You have எவ்வளவு (*evvaḷavu*), "how much". Put them together and you have விலை எவ்வளவு? — "the price, how much?"

Notice what is not there: no verb, and no word for "is". Tamil names the thing, then asks about it, and stops.

In the family, and next door

	word	**same root**
Kannada	ಬೆಲೆ (*bele*)	yes
Telugu	ధర (*dhara*)	
Hindi (neighbour)	दाम (*dām*)	
English	a price	

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

விலை (*vilai*) is native Dravidian. DEDR 5421 lists Malayalam *vila* and Kannada *bele*. It belongs with the native verb "to sell".

What you've built

Two words, and a question you can already ask.

Your turn

- *Say it: vilai*
- *Say it: vilai evvaḷavu?*
- *Say it: kaḍai*, then *vilai*, then the whole question
- *Recall:* say *toppi*, then say *kaḍai*, then say *vilai*
- *Read it:* உள்ளே
- *Recall:* say *vēṭṭi*

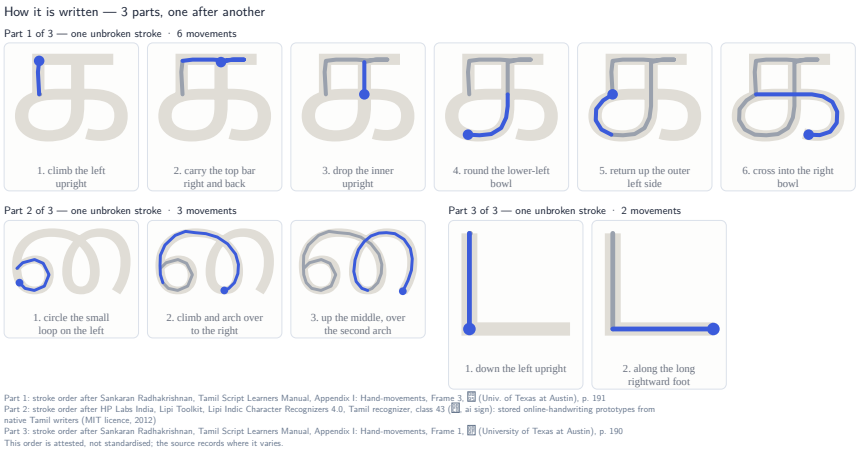
Before you move on

How do you ask what something costs? (விலை எவ்வளவு?)

68.3 கடை — a sign that wraps the letter

Before the page: you can already say *kaḍai* and *vilai*. Now read the first one.

Script you'll notice: கடை — a sign that wraps the letter



How கடை *is written, part by part, stroke by stroke*

கடை is as short as a Tamil word gets: two letters, one sign, nothing new.

piece		
க	*ka*	the letter with its own built-in *a*
டை	*ṭai*	ட with the ை sign, the same one you read at the end of சட்டை

க · டை → கடை

Look at where the ை sits. It is drawn to the **left** of its letter but said **after** it, which is the habit you first met on the ே of மேலே. Two signs now, both hanging in front of the letter they belong to.

And notice what the same two letters do without the sign: கடு, கடி and கடை are three different words with the same skeleton. In Tamil the sign is not decoration.

Your turn

- *Read it:* க — then டை — then கடை
- *Point to:* the ை, and say which side of its letter it is drawn on

- *Read it:* சட்டை, then கடை, and find the ending they share
- *Recall:* say *kaḍai*, then say *vilai*, then read கடை

Before you move on

Read கடை. On which side of ட is the ை drawn, and when is it said? (Drawn on the **left**; said **after**.)

68.4 பணம் (paṇam) — money

Before the new one, say what கடை means. *Read it:* கடை

You'll want to know: பணம்

பணம் (*paṇam*) — "money".

Money, in the plain everyday sense — what is in your hand, not what is in a bank.

The ண in the middle is the curled-back one, the same ண you have been saying since வணக்கம் on the very first page. And it closes with ம், the ending that finishes so many Tamil nouns: வணக்கம், தூக்கம், and now பணம்.

In the family, and next door

	word
Telugu	డబ్బు (*ḍabbu*)
Hindi (neighbour)	पैसा (*paisā*)
English	money

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

பணம் (*paṇam*) is a loan from Sanskrit *paṇa*, "a coin" (CDIAL 7715).

What you've built

Three: the shop, the price, and what you pay it with.

Your turn

- *Say it: paṇam*

- *Say it:* *vaṇakkam*, then *paṇam* — and say what the two have in common
- *Recall:* say *vilai*
- *Read it:* கடை
- *Recall:* say *paṇam*
- *Recall:* say *veḷiyē*
- *Read it:* புடவை

Before you move on

What does பணம் mean? (“Money”.)

68.5 வாங்கு (vāṅgu) — to buy, to get

Before the new one: what did *paṇam* mean?

You’ll want to know: வாங்கு

வாங்கு (*vāṅgu*) — “to buy, to get”.

The verb that makes a shop work.

It is also the ordinary Tamil verb for **receiving**. Buying something and being handed something are the same act here, and one word covers both — so வாங்கு is as useful at a doorway as at a counter.

Set it against கொடு (*koṭu*), “give”, which you already have. One hand out, one hand in, and the pair covers most of what happens over a counter.

In the family, and next door

	word	same root
Malayalam	വാങ്ങുക (*vāṅṅuka*)	yes
Hindi (neighbour)	ख़रीदना (*kharīdnā*)	
English	to buy, to get	

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

வாங்கு (*vāṅgu*) is native Dravidian. DEDR 5336 lists Malayalam *vāṅṅuka*, “to take, receive”.

What you've built

Four, and now something can change hands.

Your turn

- *Say it: vāṅgu*
- *Say it: koṭu*, then *vāṅgu* — and say which way each hand is moving
- *Read it:* கடை
- *Recall:* say *paṇam*, then say *vāṅgu*
- *Read it:* வலது
- *Recall:* say *seruppu*

Before you move on

What two jobs does வாங்கு do? (**Buying**, and **receiving**.)

68.6 பை (pai) — a bag

Before the new one: what did *vāṅgu* mean, and what did *paṇam* mean?

You'll want to know: பை

பை (*pai*) — "a bag".

One of the shortest words in this book: ப with the ை sign, and that is all of it.

A பை is what everything you வாங்கு goes into. It is the last piece of the shop, and the one you carry home.

Five words now stand in a row you can walk through in order: the கடை you go to, the விலை you ask for, the பணம் you hand over, the வாங்கு that does it, and the பை it all leaves in.

In the family, and next door

	word
Kannada	ಚೀಲ (*cīla*)
Telugu	సంచి (*sañci*)
Malayalam	ബാഗ് (*bāgŭ*)
Hindi (neighbour)	थैला (*thailā*)
English	a bag

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

பை (*pai*) is native Dravidian. DEDR 4450 lists Malayalam *pai*.

What you've built

Five, and the shop is closed.

Your turn

- *Say it: pai*
- *Say it:* all five in the order they happen — *kaḍai*, *vilai*, *paṇam*, *vāṅgu*, *pai*
- *Recall:* say *paṇam*, then say *vāṅgu*, then say *pai*
- *Recall:* say *iḍadu*
- *Read it:* தொப்பி

Before you move on

What does பை mean, and which sign is on it? ("A bag"; the ை.)

Chapter 69

Getting There

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) ✓ **pen** (1) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** the first 2 of 6 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can name a vehicle, a bus, a train, a road and a station in Tamil.
>
> *Complete TA-C69-station and say all five words of the chapter in order.*

69.1 வண்டி (vaṇḍi) — a vehicle, a cart

Before the new one: what did *pai* mean?

You'll want to know: வண்டி

வண்டி (*vaṇḍi*) — "a vehicle, a cart".

The general word for a thing with wheels. A bullock cart is a **வண்டி**; so is a bicycle, and so is a car. Tamil starts here and adds a word in front when it needs to be exact.

In the middle sits **ண்ட** — the curled-back **ண** closed by a **புள்ளி** and leaning on **ட**. That pair is one of the most common shapes in the language, and you will now start seeing it everywhere.

In the family, and next door

	word	same root
Malayalam	**വണ്ടി** (*vaṇṭi*)	yes
Hindi (neighbour)	**गाड़ी** (*gāṛī*)	
English	a vehicle, a cart	

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

வண்டி (*vaṇḍi*) is filed in DEDR's appendix of Indo-Aryan loans (DEDR App. 50), beside Malayalam *vaṇṭi*, Kannada *baṇḍi* and Telugu *baṇḍi*. The entry traces it to Sanskrit *bhāṇḍa*, "goods, wares": the cart was the thing that carried them.

What you've built

The word the rest of this chapter is built on.

Your turn

- *Say it: vaṇḍi*
- *Say it:* it once more, curling the tongue back for the ண
- *Recall:* say *vāṅgu*, then say *pai*, then say *vaṇḍi*
- *Recall:* say *saṭṭai*
- *Read it:* கடை

Before you move on

What does வண்டி mean? ("A vehicle, a cart".)

69.2 பேருந்து (pērundu) — a bus

Before the new one: what did *vaṇḍi* mean?

You'll want to know: பேருந்து

பேருந்து (*pērundu*) — "a bus".

A made word, and you can take it apart. பேர்- is the big-word பெரு, and உந்து is "to push along". A big pushed thing.

This is the printed and announced word: it is what stands on the board at the stop and in the newspaper. In the street you will also hear the English "bus" said plainly, and both are understood — but only one of them is written on the board you have to read.

In the family, and next door

	word
Kannada	ಬಸ್ (*bas*)
Telugu	బస్సు (*bassu*)
Malayalam	ബസ് (*bas*)
English	a bus

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

பேருந்து (*pērundu*) is a modern Tamil coinage from native parts: *pēr*, "big" (DEDR 4411), and *untu*, a word for a motor vehicle, from the verb *untu*, "to push, to drive" (DEDR 625). A bus is "the big vehicle".

What you've built

Two, and one of them you can take apart.

Your turn

- *Say it: pērundu*
- *Say it:* the two pieces, then the whole word
- *Recall:* say *pai*, then say *vaṇḍi*, then say *pērundu*
- *Read it:* வேட்டி
- *Recall:* say *vilai*

Before you move on

What are the two pieces inside பேருந்து? ("**Big**", and "**push along**".)

69.3 வண்டி — a dot joining two letters

Before the page: you can say *vaṇḍi* and *pērundu*. Now look at the first one on the page.

Script you'll notice: வண்டி — a dot joining two letters

வண்டி brings no new shape either. What it brings is the புள்ளி doing its job **between** two different letters, where சட்டை showed it between two of the same one.

piece		
வ	*va*	the letter with its built-in *a*
ண்	ண with a புள்ளி	closed — nothing said after it
டி	*ḍi*	ட with the ி sign

வ · ண் · டி → வண்டி

Read the middle two as one movement rather than two beats. That is what the புள்ளி is asking for: ண் has no vowel of its own left, so it has nowhere to go except onto the letter after it.

Your turn

- *Read it:* வ — then ண் — then டி
- *Point to:* the புள்ளி, and say which letter it has emptied
- *Read it:* சட்டை, then வண்டி — the same dot, two different jobs
- *Recall:* say *vaṇḍi*, then say *pērundu*, then read வண்டி

Before you move on

Read வண்டி. What has the புள்ளி done to the ண? (Taken its vowel away, so it leans on the ட.)

69.4 ரயில் (rayil) — a train

Before the new one, say what வண்டி means. *Read it:* வண்டி

You'll want to know: ரயில்

ரயில் (*rayil*) — "a train".

A borrowed word, and it wears the borrowing openly: English "rail", written straight out in Tamil letters.

There is a clue in the very first letter. Tamil words do not normally **begin** with ர, so a word that starts that way has almost always come in from somewhere else. You now have a small test you can run on a word before anyone tells you where it is from.

In the family, and next door

	word	**same root**
Kannada	ರೈಲು (*railu*)	yes
Telugu	రైలు (*railu*)	yes
Hindi (neighbour)	ट्रेन (*ṭren*)	
English	a train	

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

ரயில் (*rayil*) is a loan from English *rail*, as in *railway*.

What you've built

Three, and one of them is a visitor.

Your turn

- *Say it: rayil*
- *Say it: vaṇḍi*, then *rayil* — and say which one is Tamil's own
- *Recall:* say *pērundu*
- *Read it:* வண்டி
- *Recall:* say *rayil*
- *Recall:* say *puḍavai*
- *Read it:* பணம்

Before you move on

What does the ர at the front tell you about ரயில்? (That it is a **borrowed** word.)

69.5 சாலை (sālai) — a road

Before the new one: what did *rayil* mean?

You'll want to know: சாலை

சாலை (*sālai*) — "a road".

A made road, wide enough for a வண்டி to go down.

Set it beside பாதை (*pātai*), the path you already have. A பாதை is walked; a சாலை is driven. The difference is not size so much as what it was made for.

Both end in the same ை, which by now you have read four times.

In the family, and next door

	word
Kannada	ರಸ್ತೆ (*rastē*)
Telugu	రోడ్డు (*rōḍḍu*)
Hindi (neighbour)	सड़क (*saṛak*)
English	a road

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

சாலை (*sālai*) is native Dravidian. DEDR 2471 lists Malayalam *cāl*, "track, furrow". The entry lists *cālai*, "street, road", beside *cāl*, "furrow, track".

What you've built

Four, and the vehicles have somewhere to run.

Your turn

- *Say it: sālai*
- *Say it: pātai*, then *sālai* — and say which one you drive down

- *Read it:* வண்டி
- *Recall:* say *rayil*, then say *sālai*
- *Read it:* செருப்பு
- *Recall:* say *vāṅgu*

Before you move on

What is the difference between a பாதை and a சாலை? (One is **walked**; one is **driven**.)

69.6 நிலையம் (nilaiyam) — a station

Before the new one: what did *sālai* mean, and what did *rayil* mean?

You'll want to know: நிலையம்

நிலையம் (*nilaiyam*) — "a station".

The place where the vehicle stands still.

Inside it is நிலை (*nilai*) — "standing, state" — and you have met that piece before without being told. It is sitting inside வானிலை (*vāṉilai*), the weather, which is literally the sky's *state*. One small piece, two words that could hardly be further apart.

That is worth more than the word itself: Tamil builds long words out of short ones you already own, and from here on you can start looking for the pieces.

In the family, and next door

	word	**same root**
Kannada	ನಿಲ್ದಾಣ (*nildāṇa*)	yes
Telugu	స్టేషన్ (*sṭēṣan*)	
Malayalam	സ്റ്റേഷൻ (*sṟṟēṣan*)	
Hindi (neighbour)	स्टेशन (*sṭeshan*)	
English	a station	

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

நிலையம் (*nilaiyam*) is a modern use of a native word: *nilai*, "standing, place", from *nil*, "to stand" (DEDR 3675). A station is where things stand and stop.

What you've built

Five, and the chapter runs end to end.

Your turn

- *Say it: nilaiyam*
- *Say it: vāṉilai*, then *nilaiyam*, and name the piece they share
- *Say it:* all five — *vaṇḍi*, *pērundu*, *rayil*, *sālai*, *nilaiyam*
- *Recall:* say *rayil*, then say *sālai*, then say *nilaiyam*
- *Recall:* say *toppi*
- *Read it:* பை

Before you move on

Which piece do வானிலை and நிலையம் share, and what does it mean? (நிலை — "standing, state".)

Chapter 70

The Room You Are In

Modes: **voice** (5) **pen** (1) **Hands-free start:** the first 2 of 6 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can name a table, a bed, a wall, the floor and a roof in Tamil, and place each one against a direction I already know.
>
> *Complete TA-C70-roof and say all five words of the chapter in order.*

70.1 மேசை (mēsai) — a table

Before the new one: what did *nilaiyam* mean?

You'll want to know: மேசை

மேசை (*mēsai*) — "a table".

The table you eat at, or write at.

Put it beside **நாற்காலி** (*nāṟkāli*), the chair you already have — the word you could take apart into "four" and "leg". A **மேசை** and a **நாற்காலி** are the pair a room is furnished with, and now you can name both.

Its two signs are old friends: the **ே** in front of **ம**, and the **ை** at the end.

In the family, and next door

	word	same root
Kannada	**ಮೇಜು** (*mēju*)	yes
Telugu	**టేబుల్** (*ṭēbul*)	
Hindi (neighbour)	**मेज़** (*mez*)	yes
English	a table	

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

மேசை (*mēsai*) is a loan from Portuguese *mesa*, "table".

What you've built

The first thing in the room.

Your turn

- *Say it: mēsai*
- *Say it: nāṟkāli*, then *mēsai* — the pair, in the order you sit down to them
- *Recall:* say *sālai*, then say *nilaiyam*, then say *mēsai*
- *Recall:* say *kaḍai*
- *Read it:* வண்டி

Before you move on

What does மேசை mean? ("A table".)

70.2 கட்டில் (kaṭṭil) — a bed

Before the new one: what did *mēsai* mean?

You'll want to know: கட்டில்

கட்டில் (*kaṭṭil*) — "a bed".

A bed — and in Tamil it is named as a **made thing**: a frame with cords or webbing tied across it.

You already have தூக்கம் (*tūkkam*), sleep. The pair is easy to hold: the தூக்கம் happens on the கட்டில்.

Its middle is the doubled ட்ட you took apart in சட்டை, and it closes on ல் — a letter with the vowel taken off, exactly like the ண் in வண்டி, except that here there is nothing after it to lean on.

In the family, and next door

	word
Kannada	ಮಂಚ (*mañca*)
Telugu	మంచం (*mañcaṁ*)
English	a bed

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

கட்டில் (*kaṭṭil*) is native Dravidian. DEDR 1145 lists Malayalam *kaṭṭil* and Telugu *kaṭli*, "litter". The entry compares Sanskrit *khaṭvā*, "cot" (CDIAL 3781).

What you've built

Two, and you can now name where you sleep.

Your turn

- *Say it: kaṭṭil*
- *Say it: tūkkam*, then *kaṭṭil* — the thing and the place
- *Recall:* say *nilaiyam*, then say *mēsai*, then say *kaṭṭil*
- *Read it:* விலை
- *Recall:* say *pērundu*

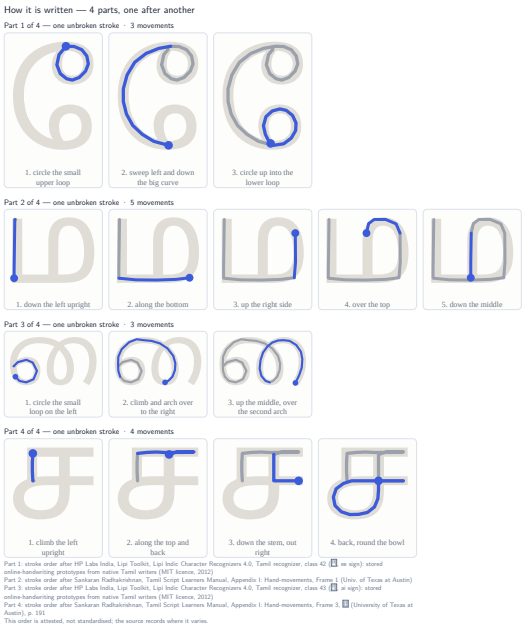
Before you move on

Where does the தூக்கம் happen? (On the கட்டில்.)

70.3 மேசை — two front-hanging signs in one word

Before the page: you can say *mēsai* and *kaṭṭil*. Now read the first one.

Script you'll notice: மேசை — two front-hanging signs in one word



How மேசை *is written, part by part, stroke by stroke*

மேசை is the first word you have read that carries a front-hanging sign on **each** of its two letters.

piece		
மே	*mē*	ம with the ே sign, the one you read twice in மேலே
சை	*sai*	ச with the ை sign, the one you read at the end of சட்டை and கடை

மே · சை → மேசை

Both signs are drawn to the **left** of their letter and said **after** it. So the eye moves left-to-right across four marks while the mouth says only two beats, and the order of the two is not the order they were printed in. Read it slowly once and let that happen on purpose.

Your turn

- *Read it:* மே — then சை — then மேசை
- *Point to:* both signs, and say which side of their letters they sit on
- *Read it:* மேலே, then மேசை, and find the sign they share
- *Recall:* say *mēsai*, then say *kaṭṭil*, then read மேசை

Before you move on

Read மேசை. How many signs does it carry, and are they said before or after their letters? (**Two**; **after**.)

70.4 சுவர் (suvar) — a wall

Before the new one, say what மேசை means. *Read it:* மேசை

You'll want to know: சுவர்

சுவர் (*suvar*) — "a wall".

The wall of a room or a house.

It is short and it is bare — two letters and a closing ர், no vowel signs hanging off the front of anything. Words shaped this plainly are usually old ones, and this is one of them.

It is also the surface that makes உள்ளே and வெளியே mean anything: a சுவர் is what there is an inside and an outside of.

In the family, and next door

	word
Telugu	గోడ (*gōḍa*)
Malayalam	ഭിത്തി (*bhitti*)
Hindi (neighbour)	दीवार (*dīvār*)
English	a wall

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

சுவர் (*suvar*) is native Dravidian. DEDR 1975 lists Malayalam *cuvar* and Kannada *kēr*.

What you've built

Three, and the room has an edge.

Your turn

- *Say it: suvar*
- *Say it: suvar*, then *uḷḷē* and *veḷiyē* — the wall, and its two sides
- *Recall:* say *kaṭṭil*
- *Read it:* மேசை
- *Recall:* say *suvar*
- *Recall:* say *paṇam*
- *Read it:* ரயில்

Before you move on

What does சுவர் mean? ("A wall".)

70.5 தரை (tarai) — the floor

Before the new one: what did *suvar* mean?

You'll want to know: தரை

தரை (*tarai*) — "the floor".

The floor — and also the ground outside. Tamil does not need two words for it; what is under your feet is தரை wherever you are standing.

This is where the கோலம் (*kōlam*) is drawn each morning, just inside the வாசல். Both of those words are already yours, and this is the one that was missing to put them in a place.

It ends in the ை again — the fifth word in three chapters to do so.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

தரை (*tarai*) is usually traced to Sanskrit *dharā*, "the earth" (CDIAL 6748). DEDR has no native entry for it.

What you've built

Four, and the room has a bottom.

Your turn

- *Say it: tarai*
- *Say it: kōlam*, then *vāsal*, then *tarai* — and say where the design is drawn
- *Read it:* மேசை
- *Recall:* say *suvar*, then say *tarai*
- *Read it:* வாங்கு
- *Recall:* say *sālai*

Before you move on

Where is the கோலம் drawn? (On the தரை.)

70.6 கூரை (kūrai) — a roof

Before the new one: what did *tarai* mean, and what did *suvar* mean?

You'll want to know: கூரை

கூரை (*kūrai*) — "a roof".

The roof over you.

With தரை under your feet and கூரை over your head, the room has both ends — and you already have the two words for the space between them: மேலே and கீழே. Picture the கூரை up above, the தரை down below, and every word in that sentence is one you have been taught.

Its ூ is the long u sign, and it ends, like தரை, in ை.

In the family, and next door

	word	same root
Telugu	కప్పు (*kappu*)	
Malayalam	മേൽക്കൂര (*mēlkkūra*)	yes
Hindi (neighbour)	छत (*chat*)	
English	a roof	

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

கூரை (*kūrai*) is native Dravidian. DEDR 1904 lists Malayalam *kūra*, "hut, thatch".

What you've built

Five: a table, a bed, a wall, a floor and a roof.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *kūrai*
- *Say it:* *mēlē*, then *kūrai*; *kīḻē*, then *tarai*
- *Say it:* all five — *mēsai*, *kaṭṭil*, *suvar*, *tarai*, *kūrai*
- *Recall:* say *suvar*, then say *tarai*, then say *kūrai*
- *Recall:* say *pai*
- *Read it:* நிலையம்

Before you move on

Which of the five is மேலே, and which is கீழே? (கூரை; தரை.)

Chapter 71

Through the Day

Modes: **voice** (5) **pen** (1) **Hands-free start:** the first 2 of 6 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say get up, sleep, run, wash and play in Tamil, and read the letter ஓ.
>
> *Complete TA-C71-play and say all five words of the chapter in order.*

71.1 எழு (eḻu) — to get up, to rise

Before the new one: what did *kūrai* mean?

You'll want to know: எழு

எழு (*eḻu*) — "to get up, to rise".

The first verb of the morning: to get up, off the கட்டில் you named last chapter. It is also what the sun does.

Be careful with it, because you have met these two letters before with one more on the end. எழுது (*eḻudu*) is "to write". எழு is "to rise". The Dravidian etymological dictionary does not connect them: it files them as two separate entries. What matters is that they are two different verbs, they are one letter apart, and swapping them changes what you said.

In the family, and next door

	word	same root
Telugu	లేచు (*lēcu*)	
Malayalam	എഴുന്നേൽക്കുക (*eḻunnēlkkuka*)	yes
Hindi (neighbour)	उठना (*uṭhnā*)	
English	to get up, to rise	

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

எழு (*e̱lu*) is native Dravidian. DEDR 851 lists Malayalam *e̱luka* and Kannada *e̱l*.

What you've built

The first of five things a day is made of.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *e̱lu*
- *Say it:* *e̱lu*, then *e̱ludu* — and say which one is "write"
- *Recall:* say *tarai*, then say *kūrai*, then say *e̱lu*
- *Recall:* say *vaṇḍi*
- *Read it:* மேசை

Before you move on

What does எழு mean, and which longer verb starts the same way? ("To get up"; எழுது.)

71.2 தூங்கு (tūṅgu) — to sleep

Before the new one: what did *e̱lu* mean?

You'll want to know: தூங்கு

தூங்கு (*tūṅgu*) — "to sleep".

The other end of the day — and the verb behind a noun you already own.

தூக்கம் (*tūkkam*) is sleep, the thing. தூங்கு is sleeping, the doing. Tamil makes that pair again and again, and once you can hear it you get two words for the price of one: the noun தூக்கம் sits still, and the verb தூங்கு does something.

Its ங்க is the same nasal-plus-க you say inside வாங்கு.

In the family, and next door

	word
Kannada	ಮಲಗು (*malagu*)
Telugu	నిద్రపో (*nidrapō*)
Malayalam	ഉറങ്ങുക (*uṟaṅṅuka*)
Hindi (neighbour)	सोना (*sonā*)
English	to sleep

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

தூங்கு (*tūṅgu*) is native Dravidian. DEDR 3376 lists Malayalam *tūṅṅuka* and Kannada *tūgu*. The verb first meant "to hang, to droop": sleep is the head drooping.

What you've built

Two verbs, and the day has both ends.

Your turn

- *Say it: tūṅgu*
- *Say it: tūkkam*, then *tūṅgu* — the thing, then the doing
- *Say it: vāṅgu*, then *tūṅgu*, and find the sound they share
- *Recall:* say *kūrai*, then say *e̱lu*, then say *tūṅgu*
- *Read it:* பேருந்து
- *Recall:* say *kaṭṭil*

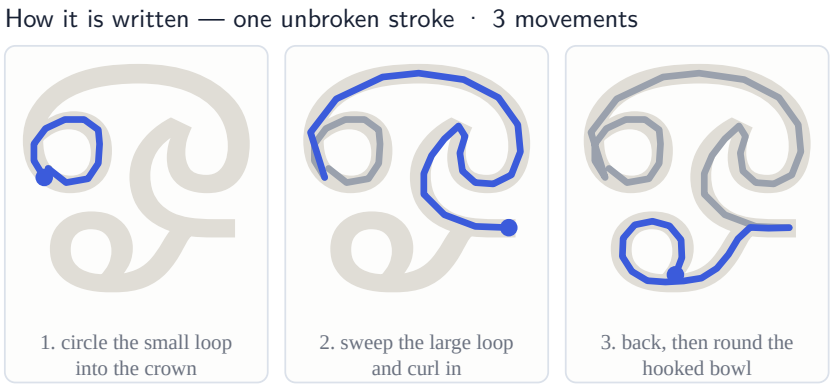
Before you move on

Which is the verb and which is the noun — தூங்கு or தூக்கம்? (தூங்கு is the verb.)

71.3 ஓ — the letter behind a sign you already read

Before the page: before the new shape: which letter did உ turn out to be the free-standing half of?

Script you'll notice: ஓ — the letter behind a sign you already read



Stroke order after Sankaran Radhakrishnan, Tamil Script Learners Manual, Module 15, 88, with Appendix I: Hand-movements, Frame 15 (University of Texas at Austin), p. 196
This order is attested, not standardised; the source records where it varies.

How ஓ is written, stroke by stroke

ஓ — *ō*.

You have been reading its **sign**, ோ, for a long time: it is the hook on போ (*pō*), "go", and it is in கோலம் too. This is the other half of the same vowel — the **independent** shape, used when a word *begins* with the sound.

That is the Tamil pattern you already know from உ, met once more. Every vowel has two bodies: a free-standing letter for the front of a word, and a sign for inside one.

The next lesson opens with this letter, which is why it arrives here and not later.

Your turn

- *Look:* at these two, and say which is the letter and which is the sign

  ஓ · ோ

- *Trace it:* ஓ three times, saying *ō* as you finish each one
- *Read it:* போ — and point at the sign of this same vowel inside it
- *Recall:* say *e̱lu*, then say *tūṅgu*, then name the letter ஓ

Before you move on

Which character is this — ஓ? Where does the letter go, and where does the sign ோ go? (**Letter** at the start of a word; **sign** on a consonant inside one.)

71.4 ஓடு (ōḍu) — to run

Before the new one: what did *tūṅgu* mean, and which letter did you meet after it?

You'll want to know: ஓடு

ஓடு (*ōḍu*) — "to run".

"To run" — and the first word in this book that **begins** with the letter you met one lesson ago.

It is not only for people. Water runs, and so does a வண்டி on a சாலை: Tamil uses this same verb for all three, where English would want "flow" for one of them.

Two letters, one sign, and you can read every part of it.

In the family, and next door

	word	same root
Kannada	ಓಡು (*ōḍu*)	yes
Telugu	పరిగెత్తు (*parigettu*)	
Malayalam	ഓടുക (*ōṭuka*)	
Hindi (neighbour)	दौड़ना (*dauṛnā*)	
English	to run	

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

ஓடு (*ōḍu*) is native Dravidian. DEDR 1041 lists Malayalam *ōṭuka*, Kannada *ōḍu* and Telugu *ōḍu*.

What you've built

Three, and something is moving.

Your turn

- *Say it: ōḍu*

- *Read it:* ஓடு, and point at the letter you learned last lesson
- *Say it:* *ōḍu*, then name two things other than a person that can do it
- *Recall:* say *tūṅgu*, then name the letter ஓ, then say *ōḍu*
- *Recall:* say *rayil*
- *Read it:* சுவர்

Before you move on

Say what ஓடு means. ("To run".) *Read it:* ஓடு

71.5 கழுவு (kaḻuvu) — to wash

Before the new one: what did *ōḍu* mean?

You'll want to know: கழுவு

கழுவு (*kaḻuvu*) — "to wash".

To wash: hands, a கிண்ணம், the தரை.

It carries ழ, the curled glide that Tamil kept and named itself with — the ழ at the end of தமிழ். You have met it inside எழுது and at the front of கீழே, and here it sits between two *u* sounds, which is the hardest place to hear it and the best place to practise it.

In the family, and next door

	word	same root
Kannada	ತೊಳೆ (*toḷe*)	
Telugu	కడుగు (*kaḍugu*)	yes
Malayalam	കഴുകുക (*kaḻukuka*)	yes
Hindi (neighbour)	धोना (*dhonā*)	
English	to wash	

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

கழுவு (*kaḻuvu*) is native Dravidian. DEDR 1369 lists Malayalam *kaḻukuka* and Telugu *kaḍugu*.

What you've built

Four, and the day has some housework in it.

Your turn

- *Say it: kaḻuvu*
- *Say it: tamiḻ*, then *kaḻuvu* — the same letter, twice
- *Say it: kaḻuvu*, then name one thing in this book you could wash
- *Recall:* name the letter ஓ, then say *ōḍu*, then say *kaḻuvu*
- *Read it:* சாலை
- *Recall:* say *tarai*

Before you move on

Which letter is in the middle of கழுவு, and where else have you met it? (ழ — in தமிழ் and எழுது.)

71.6 விளையாடு (viḷaiyāḍu) — to play

Before the new one: what did *kaḻuvu* mean, and what did *ōḍu* mean?

You'll want to know: விளையாடு

விளையாடு (*viḷaiyāḍu*) — "to play".

The longest word in this chapter, and it is two words welded together.

The back half is ஆடு, which on its own means "to move, to sway, to play". And you already know a completely different ஆடு: the goat, from the animal chapter. Same letters, same sound, two unrelated words — Tamil lets them share the spelling and lets the sentence sort it out.

That is the last thing this chapter teaches, and it is bigger than the word: a long Tamil word usually has a short one you already own hiding at one end of it.

In the family, and next door

	word
Kannada	ಆಡು (*āḍu*)
Malayalam	കളിക്കുക (*kaḷikkuka*)
Hindi (neighbour)	बजाना (*bajānā*)
English	to play

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

விளையாடு (*viḷaiyāḍu*) is native Dravidian. DEDR 5438 lists Malayalam *viḷay-āṭuka*. The second half is *āṭu*, "to move, to dance". DEDR compares, with a query, Sanskrit *vilāsa*, "play".

What you've built

Five verbs — get up, sleep, run, wash, play — and one new letter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *viḷaiyāḍu*
- *Say it:* *āḍu* on its own, and name the two things it can mean
- *Say it:* all five — *e̱lu*, *tūṅgu*, *ōḍu*, *ka̱luvu*, *viḷaiyāḍu*
- *Recall:* say *ōḍu*, then say *ka̱luvu*, then say *viḷaiyāḍu*
- *Recall:* say *nilaiyam*
- *Read it:* கூரை

Before you move on

What word is hiding at the end of விளையாடு, and what else does it mean? (ஆடு — and it is also the **goat**.)

Chapter 72

How It Feels

Modes: **voice** (5) **pen** (1) **Hands-free start:** the first 2 of 6 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can name anger, fear and sorrow in Tamil, and say to laugh and to cry.
>
> *Complete TA-C72-cry and say all five words of the chapter in order.*

72.1 கோபம் (kōpam) — anger

Before the new one: what did *viḷaiyāḍu* mean?

You'll want to know: கோபம்

கோபம் (*kōpam*) — "anger".

Anger — the ordinary everyday word for it, not a literary one.

You can read all of it already, and one part of it you only just learned: **கோ** is **க** with the **ோ** sign, the sign whose free-standing letter **ஓ** you met last chapter.

It ends in **ம்**, like **வணக்கம்**, **தூக்கம்** and **பணம்** before it. That ending is now four words deep, and it is a good bet for a Tamil noun.

In the family, and next door

	word	same root
Kannada	ಕೋಪ (*kōpa*)	yes
Telugu	కోపం (*kōpaṁ*)	yes
Malayalam	ദേഷ്യം (*dēṣyaṁ*)	
Hindi (neighbour)	गुस्सा (*gussā*)	
English	anger	

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

கோபம் (*kōpam*) is a loan from Sanskrit *kopa*, "anger" (CDIAL 3516).

What you've built

The first of five feelings.

Your turn

- *Say it: kōpam*
- *Read it:* கோபம், and point at the sign of the letter you met last chapter
- *Say it: paṇam*, then *kōpam*, and name the ending they share
- *Recall:* say *kaḻuvu*, then say *viḷaiyāḍu*, then say *kōpam*
- *Recall:* say *mēsai*
- *Read it:* எழு

Before you move on

What does கோபம் mean, and which sign is on its first letter? ("Anger"; the கோ.)

72.2 பயம் (payam) — fear

Before the new one: what did *kōpam* mean?

You'll want to know: பயம்

பயம் (*payam*) — "fear".

Fear.

Three letters and not one vowel sign anywhere: ப, ய, and ம with a புள்ளி. Every letter is carrying its own built-in *a*, which is the plainest a Tamil word can possibly be written.

It ends in the same ம் as கோபம், which is not a coincidence — Tamil keeps a whole shelf of feeling-nouns with that ending.

In the family, and next door

	word	same root
Kannada	ಭಯ (*bhaya*)	yes
Telugu	భయం (*bhayaṁ*)	yes
Malayalam	പേടി (*pēṭi*)	
Hindi (neighbour)	डर (*ḍar*)	
English	fear	

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

பயம் (*payam*) is a loan from Sanskrit *bhaya*, "fear, peril" (CDIAL 9390). Tamil wrote the *bh* as a plain *p*.

What you've built

Two, and both of them end the same way.

Your turn

- *Say it: payam*
- *Say it: kōpam*, then *payam* — and say what both endings have in common
- *Recall:* say *viḷaiyāḍu*, then say *kōpam*, then say *payam*
- *Read it:* கட்டில்
- *Recall:* say *tūṅgu*

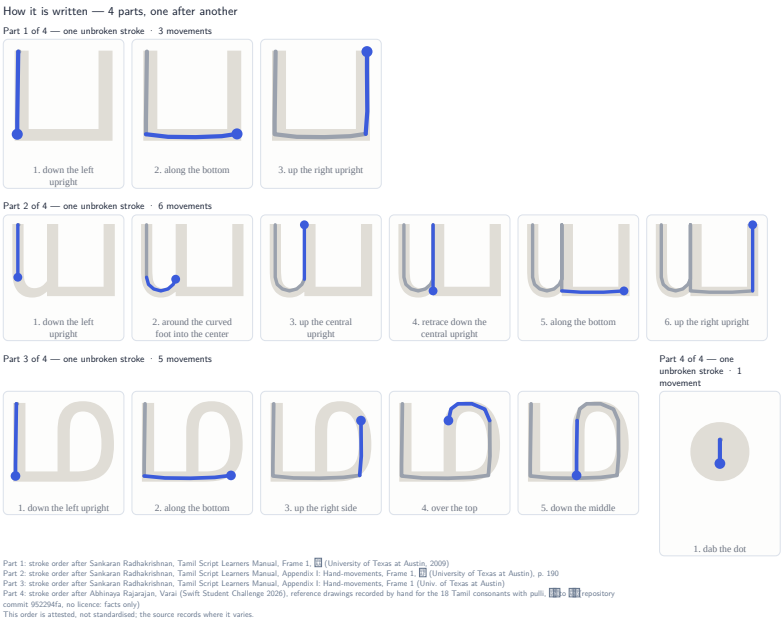
Before you move on

How many vowel signs does பயம் carry? (**None** — every letter keeps its built-in *a*.)

72.3 பயம் — a word with no vowel signs

Before the page: you can say *kōpam* and *payam*. Now read the second one.

Script you'll notice: பயம் — a word with no vowel signs



How பயம் *is written, part by part, stroke by stroke*

Every word you have read so far carried at least one sign. பயம் carries none, and that makes it the clearest possible demonstration of what a bare Tamil letter is worth.

piece

ப	*pa*	no sign — the letter's own built-in *a* is the vowel
ய	*ya*	the same again
ம்	*m*	ம with a புள்ளி, so no vowel at all

ப · ய · ம் → பயம்

So a Tamil consonant is never really silent by default. It says *a* unless something stops it, and the only thing that stops it is the dot. Read the word once and hear the two *a* sounds you were never told about.

Your turn

- *Read it:* ப — then ய — then ம்
- *Point to:* the one mark in the whole word, and say what it does
- *Read it:* பயம், then கடை, and say which one needed a sign
- *Recall:* say *kōpam*, then say *payam*, then read பயம்

Before you move on

Read பயம். Which vowel do ப and ய carry, and why is none written? (***a*** — it is built into the letter.)

72.4 வருத்தம் (varuttam) — sorrow, regret

Before the new one, say what பயம் means. *Read it:* பயம்

You'll want to know: வருத்தம்

வருத்தம் (*varuttam*) — "sorrow, regret".

One word for both kinds of sorry: sad **about** something, and sorry **for** something.

This is the word that finishes an apology in ordinary speech. You already have தவறு (*tavaṟu*), the mistake, and மன்னிக்கவும் (*maṉṉikkavum*), which asks formally to be forgiven. வருத்தம் sits between them: it names the feeling rather than making the request, and it is the one you can say to a friend without sounding like a letter.

Its middle is a doubled த்த, the same closing-and-leaning you read in சட்டை and வண்டி.

In the family, and next door

	word
Telugu	బాధ (*bādha*)
Hindi (neighbour)	दुख (*dukh*)
English	sorrow, regret

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

வருத்தம் (*varuttam*) is native Dravidian. DEDR 5272 lists Malayalam *varuttam*, "trouble, affliction". It is the noun of *varuntu*,

"to suffer, to grieve".

What you've built

Three feelings, and one of them is an apology.

Your turn

- *Say it: varuttam*
- *Say it: tava_ru*, then *varuttam* — the mistake, then the feeling about it
- *Say it: man_nikkavum*, then *varuttam*, and say which is the formal one
- *Recall:* say *payam*
- *Read it:* பயம்
- *Recall:* say *varuttam*
- *Recall:* say *suvar*
- *Read it:* ஓடு

Before you move on

Which of the two would you say to a friend — மன்னிக்கவும் or வருத்தம்? (வருத்தம்.)

72.5 சிரி (siri) — to laugh

Before the new one: what did *varuttam* mean?

You'll want to know: சிரி

சிரி (*siri*) — "to laugh".

To laugh.

Two letters, both wearing the same ி sign — ச and ர, each with the short *i*. Words that repeat a sign like that are easy to read and easy to say, and this is a good one to read aloud before you meet its opposite.

After three nouns, this is a verb: something a person **does**, not something they have.

In the family, and next door

	word
Malayalam	ചിരിക്കുക (*cirikkuka*)
Hindi (neighbour)	हँसना (*hãsnā*)
English	to laugh

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

சிரி (*siri*) is native Dravidian. DEDR 1562 lists Malayalam *cirikka* and Kannada *kiri*, "to grin".

What you've built

Four, and the feelings start doing something.

Your turn

- *Say it: siri*
- *Read it:* சிரி, and point at the sign that appears twice
- *Say it: kōpam*, then *siri* — and say which one is a verb
- *Read it:* பயம்
- *Recall:* say *varuttam*, then say *siri*
- *Read it:* தரை
- *Recall:* say *kaluvu*

Before you move on

What does சிரி mean, and which sign does it carry twice? ("To laugh"; the ◌ி.)

72.6 அழு (a̲lu) — to cry

Before the new one: what did *siri* mean, and what did *payam* mean?

You'll want to know: அழு

அழு (*a̲lu*) — "to cry".

To cry — the mirror of the verb before it, and just as short.

It opens on அ, the free-standing letter, because the word begins with that vowel: the same pattern you saw when ஓ opened ஓடு. And in the middle is ழ again, the third time you have met it after தமிழ் and கழுவு.

Five feelings now: three you can have — கோபம், பயம், வருத்தம் — and two you can do, சிரி and அழு.

In the family, and next door

	word	same root
Kannada	ಅಳು (*aḷu*)	yes
Telugu	ఏడ్చు (*ēḍcu*)	
Malayalam	കരയുക (*karayuka*)	
Hindi (neighbour)	रोना (*ronā*)	
English	to cry	

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

அழு (*a̲lu*) is native Dravidian. DEDR 282 lists Malayalam *a̲luka* and Kannada *a̲l*.

What you've built

Five: three nouns and two verbs.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *a̲lu*
- *Say it:* *siri*, then *a̲lu* — the pair, one after the other
- *Say it:* all five — *kōpam*, *payam*, *varuttam*, *siri*, *a̲lu*
- *Recall:* say *varuttam*, then say *siri*, then say *a̲lu*
- *Recall:* say *kūrai*
- *Read it:* விளையாடு

Before you move on

Which three of the five are things you **have**, and which two are things you **do**? (**கோபம்**, **பயம்**, **வருத்தம்**; **சிரி**, **அழு**.)

Chapter 73

Today, Yesterday, and the Year

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) ✓ **pen** (1) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** the first 2 of 6 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say today, yesterday and before in Tamil, and name a month and a year.
>
> *Complete TA-C73-year and say all five words of the chapter in order.*

73.1 இன்று (in̲r̲u) — today

Before the new one: what did *a̲l̲u* mean?

You'll want to know: இன்று

இன்று (*in̲r̲u*) — "today".

"Today".

You already have நாள் (*nāḷ*), the day itself, and நாளை (*nāḷai*), tomorrow. இன்று is the day you are standing in, and it completes the middle of that little set.

This is the careful, written form, and it is the one printed on a page. In fast speech you will also hear இன்னைக்கு (*in̲n̲aikku*) for the same thing — worth recognising, but இன்று is the one to say.

In the family, and next door

	word	same root
Kannada	ಇವತ್ತು (*ivattu*)	
Telugu	ఇవాళ (*ivāḷa*)	
Malayalam	ഇന്ന് (*innŭ*)	yes
Hindi (neighbour)	आज (*āj*)	
English	today	

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

இன்று (*in̲ru*) is native Dravidian. DEDR 410 lists Malayalam *innu*. It is the near base *i-*: "this day".

What you've built

The day you are standing in.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *in̲ru*
- *Say it:* *nāḷ*, then *in̲ru*, then *nāḷai*
- *Recall:* say *siri*, then say *a̲lu*, then say *in̲ru*
- *Recall:* say *e̲lu*
- *Read it:* கோபம்

Before you move on

What does இன்று mean, and which word already gave you "tomorrow"? ("Today"; நாளை.)

73.2 நேற்று (nēr̲r̲u) — yesterday

Before the new one: what did *in̲ru* mean?

You'll want to know: நேற்று

நேற்று (*nēr̲r̲u*) — "yesterday".

"Yesterday" — the third corner of the same triangle: நேற்று, இன்று, நாளை.

The middle is a doubled ற்ற, the hard r held long, and it is the sound that most often catches a new speaker out. Say it slowly: the first ற has a புள்ளி and no vowel, so it leans straight onto the second.

With three words you can now place any day against the one you are in.

In the family, and next door

	word
Telugu	నిన్న (*ninna*)
Malayalam	ഇന്നലെ (*innale*)
English	yesterday

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

நேற்று (*nēṟṟu*) is native. DEDR 3758 gives the older Tamil forms *nerunal* and *nerunaṟṟu*, "yesterday", with Kannada *ninne* and Telugu *ninna*. Modern *nēṟṟu* is most likely the shortened form.

What you've built

Two, and the days on either side of today are named.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *nēṟṟu*
- *Say it:* *nēṟṟu*, *iṉṟu*, *nāḷai* — the three, in order
- *Say it:* *nēṟṟu* once more, holding the doubled ற
- *Recall:* say *alu*, then say *iṉṟu*, then say *nēṟṟu*
- *Read it:* தூங்கு
- *Recall:* say *payam*

Before you move on

Say the three days in order, starting with yesterday. (நேற்று, இன்று, நாளை.)

73.3 இன்று — a word that opens on a vowel

Before the page: you can say *iṉṟu* and *nēṟṟu*. Now read the first one.

Script you'll notice: இன்று — a word that opens on a vowel

இன்று puts together two things you have read separately: a word that **begins** with an independent vowel, and a புள்ளி making one consonant lean on the next.

piece		
இ	*i*	the free-standing letter, because the word opens on the vowel
ன்	*n̲*	ன with a புள்ளி — no vowel of its own
று	*r̲u*	ற with the ு sign

இ · ன் · று → இன்று

This is why the letters ஓ and உ were taught on their own. A vowel at the **front** of a word cannot be a sign — there is nothing for it to sit on — so Tamil keeps a separate shape for exactly this job, and இன்று is that shape doing it.

Your turn

- *Read it:* இ — then ன் — then று
- *Point to:* the letter that could only ever be a free-standing one, and say why
- *Read it:* இன்று, then ஓடு — two words that open on a vowel
- *Recall:* say *in̲r̲u*, then say *nēr̲r̲u*, then read இன்று

Before you move on

Read இன்று. Why is the first shape a letter and not a sign? (Because the word **begins** with the vowel, so there is no consonant for a sign to sit on.)

73.4 முன்பு (mun̲bu) — before, earlier

Before the new one, say what இன்று means. *Read it:* இன்று

You'll want to know: முன்பு

முன்பு (*mu̲nbu*) — "before, earlier".

"Before" — the general one, for anything earlier than the moment you are standing in.

You already have பிறகு (*pi̲raku*), "afterwards". முன்பு is its opposite, and between them the two put events in order without your needing a single verb tense to do it.

The ன் in its middle is closed by a புள்ளி and leans on the ப after it — the same joint you read a moment ago inside இன்று.

In the family, and next door

	word	same root
Telugu	ముందు (*mundu*)	yes
Malayalam	മുൻപ് (*munpŭ*)	yes
English	before, earlier	

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

முன்பு (*mu̲nbu*) is native Dravidian. DEDR 5020 lists Malayalam *mun*, Kannada *mun* and Telugu *muni*, "first, former".

What you've built

Before and after, and a day on each side of today.

Your turn

- *Say it: mu̲nbu*
- *Say it: pi̲raku*, then *mu̲nbu* — the two directions in time
- *Say it: nēr̲r̲u*, then *mu̲nbu* — one is a day, one is any earlier moment
- *Recall:* say *nēr̲r̲u*
- *Read it:* இன்று
- *Recall:* say *mu̲nbu*
- *Recall:* say *ōḍu*
- *Read it:* வருத்தம்

Before you move on

Which word is the opposite of பிறகு? (முன்பு.)

73.5 மாதம் (mādam) — a month

Before the new one: what did *muṉbu* mean?

You'll want to know: மாதம்

மாதம் (*mādam*) — "a month".

A month.

You already know twelve of them by name — the Tamil months you met in their own chapter. This is the word for the unit itself, the one you need to say "one month" rather than to name a particular one.

And another ம் ending — like கோபம், பயம் and பணம் before it — on a word whose middle vowel is the long ◌ா.

In the family, and next door

	word	same root
Malayalam	മാസം (*māsaṁ*)	yes
English	a month	

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

மாதம் (*mādam*) is a loan from Sanskrit *māsa*, "moon, month" (CDIAL 10104). Tamil wrote the *s* as *t*.

What you've built

Above the day: the month.

Your turn

- *Say it: mādam*
- *Say it: nāḷ*, then *mādam* — smaller, then bigger
- *Read it:* இன்று
- *Recall:* say *muṉbu*, then say *mādam*

- *Read it:* கழுவு
- *Recall:* say *siri*

Before you move on

What does மாதம் mean? ("A month".)

73.6 ஆண்டு (āṇḍu) — a year

Before the new one: what did *mādam* mean, and what did *muṉbu* mean?

You'll want to know: ஆண்டு

ஆண்டு (*āṇḍu*) — "a year".

A year — and it is the unit hiding inside a question you can already ask.

When you ask about someone's வயது (*vayathu*), their age, what is being counted is ஆண்டு. The question was yours a long time ago; this is the word for what the answer is made of.

It opens on the free-standing ஆ, because the word begins with that vowel — the same reason இன்று opens on இ. In the middle is the ண்ட you first read in வண்டி.

Three sizes now, each holding the one before it: நாள், மாதம், ஆண்டு.

In the family, and next door

	word
Telugu	సంవత్సరం (*saṁvatsaraṁ*)
Malayalam	വർഷം (*varṣaṁ*)
English	a year

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

ஆண்டு (*āṇḍu*) is native Dravidian. DEDR 5153 lists Malayalam *āṇṭu* and Kannada *ēḍu*.

What you've built

Five: today, yesterday, and the three units above the day.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *āṇḍu*
- *Say it:* *vayathu*, then *āṇḍu* — the question, and what the answer counts
- *Say it:* the three sizes in order — *nāḷ*, *mādam*, *āṇḍu*
- *Recall:* say *muṉbu*, then say *mādam*, then say *āṇḍu*
- *Recall:* say *viḷaiyāḍu*
- *Read it:* அழு

Before you move on

What is counted when someone answers about their வயது? (ஆண்டு — years.)

Chapter 74

And, and Also

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (3) ✓ **pen** (1) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** the first 2 of 4 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can join two things with -um, say that one more thing applies too, and deny both at once.
>
> *Complete TA-C74-neither and say a two-item list, then the same list denied.*

74.1 -உம் ... -உம் — how Tamil says "and"

Before the new one: what did *mādam* mean, and what did *āṇḍu* mean?

Grammar lens: no word goes between them

-உம் ... -உம் (*-um … -um*) — "both … and".
English drops a word *between* two things. Tamil puts an ending on **each** of them and leaves the space between them empty.
பால் (*pāl*) is milk. தேநீர் (*tēnīr*) is tea. Milk and tea:

பாலும் தேநீரும் — *pālum tēnīrum*

Both words are still there, in the same order, and nothing new sits between them. Each one has grown a tail instead.
The tail is always **-உம்**, and it lands on every item in the list — the last one included. Two things, two tails.

you have	you say
பால், தேநீர்	பாலும் தேநீரும்
மேசை, கட்டில்	மேசையும் கட்டிலும்

மேசை ends in a vowel, so a light ய் slides in before the ending: மேசையும்.

What you've built

The first thing so far that joins two words you already had.

Your turn

- *Say it: pālum tēnīrum*
- *Say it: mēsaiyum kaṭṭilum*
- *Count:* how many tails a list of two carries
- *Recall:* say *mādam*, then say *āṇḍu*, then join the two — *mādamum āṇḍum*
- *Return to:* say *nēṟṟu*, *kuṭai* and *tarai* — three distances back — then join two of them with -உம்

Before you move on

Where does Tamil keep its "and"? (**On the end of every item, as -உம் — never between them.**)

74.2 -உம் on its own — "also", "too"

Say milk and tea in Tamil. How many -உம் endings did that take?

Grammar lens: one tail, not two

Put -உம் on two words and you have joined them. Put it on **one** word and it means something else: *that one too.*
நான் (*nāṉ*) is "I". நான் with the tail:

நானும் — *nāṉum* — "me too"

Somebody says they are going. You say நானும் and you are going with them. One word, one ending, a whole reply.
The same tail on the things around you:

word	with -உம்	it means
நீங்கள்	நீங்களும்	you too
இது	இதுவும்	this one too

இது ends in a vowel, so வ் slides in the way ய் did after மேசை. This is one of the most-used endings in the language, and you have now met both of its jobs.

What you've built

One ending, two jobs: on two words it joins, on one word it adds.

Your turn

- *Say it: nāṉum*
- *Say it: nīṅgaḷum*, then *iduvum*
- *Contrast: pālum tēnīrum* against *pālum* alone — two tails join, one tail adds
- *Recall:* say *āṇḍu*, then say *pālum tēnīrum*, then say *nāṉum*
- *Read it:* இன்று
- *Return to:* say *tuṭaippam* and say *kūrai* — three distances back — then join two of them with -உம்

Before you move on

Someone says they are leaving and you are leaving too. One word. (நானும்.)

74.3 பாலும் — an ending you can now see

Before the page: say *pālum tēnīrum*, then say *nāṉum*.

Script you'll notice: பாலும் — where the tail begins

You have read பால் already. Adding the joining ending changes one thing on the page, and it is worth seeing exactly where.

piece		
பா	*pā*	ப with the long-ா sign
லு	*lu*	ல with the ு sign
ம்	*m*	ம with a புள்ளி

பா · லு · ம் → பாலும்

Look at what happened to the middle. In பால் the ல carried a புள்ளி and had no vowel of its own. The ending brings a உ, the ல takes it, and the புள்ளி moves along to the ம் that arrived with it.

Nothing was inserted between two words. The seam is inside the word.

The same seam in தேநீரும்: ர picks up ு, and ம் closes the word.

Your turn

- *Read it:* பா — then லு — then ம்
- *Read it:* பாலும் தேநீரும்
- *Point to:* the letter that lost its புள்ளி, and say where the புள்ளி went
- *Recall:* say *pālum tēnīrum*, then say *nāṉum*, then read பாலும்
- *Return to:* say *muṉbu*, *sīppu* and *eṉlu* — three distances back — then join two of them with -உம்

Before you move on

Read பாலும். Which letter changed when the ending arrived? (ல — **it took the உ the ending brought.**)

74.4 -உம் ... -உம் இல்லை — neither one nor the other

Say *nāṉum*. *Read it:* பாலும் aloud

Grammar lens: the list stays, the end changes

English swaps the whole join to say the opposite: *both … and* becomes *neither … nor*. Tamil keeps the join it already has and puts இல்லை after it.

> பாலும் தேநீரும் இல்லை — *pālum tēnīrum illai* — "neither milk nor tea"

இல்லை is the very first word of chapter one, the one that means *no, there isn't*. It has been waiting for a list to stand at the end of.
Say the shop has neither:

you say	it means
பாலும் தேநீரும்	milk and tea
பாலும் தேநீரும் இல்லை	neither milk nor tea

One word longer, and the meaning has turned over. Nothing inside the list moved.

What you've built

Four things in this chapter and only one ending: joining, adding, reading the seam, denying the lot.

Your turn

- *Say it: pālum tēnīrum illai*
- *Say it: mēsaiyum kaṭṭilum illai*
- *Turn:* say the list, then say it again with இல்லை on the end
- *Recall:* say *nāṉum*
- *Read it:* பாலும்
- *Recall:* say *pālum tēnīrum illai*
- *Return to:* say *mādam*, *pasi* and *tūṅgu* — three distances back — then join two of them with -உம்

Before you move on

The shop has neither milk nor tea. Say it. (பாலும் தேநீரும் இல்லை.)

Chapter 75

Yes or No

Modes: **voice** (3) **pen** (1) **Hands-free start:** the first 2 of 4 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can turn any sentence I know into a yes-or-no question, answer one, and ask permission.
>
> *Complete TA-C75-permission and ask to be let in, then grant the same request.*

75.1 -ஆ — the question you can build yourself

Read it: பாலும்

Then say: neither milk nor tea.

Grammar lens: one letter on the end

Every question you have been given so far came ready-made: எப்படி, என்ன, யார், எங்கே, எவ்வளவு. Each one asks about a thing you name in advance.
-ஆ (*-ā*) asks about the whole sentence, and it is yours to attach to anything.
Take a statement. Put **-ஆ** on its last word. It is now a question that wants *yes* or *no*.

statement	question
நீங்கள் நலம் — you are well	நீங்கள் நலமா? — are you well?
இது பால் — this is milk	இது பாலா? — is this milk?
சரி — okay	சரியா? — okay?

Word order does not move. Nothing is added at the front. The ending goes on the **last** word, and the last word is the one being asked about.

What you've built

Every sentence you already own can now be a question.

Your turn

- *Say it: sariyā?*
- *Say it: nīṅgaḷ nalamā?*
- *Turn:* say *idu pāl*, then ask *idu pālā?*
- *Read it:* பாலும்
- *Recall:* say *pālum tēnīrum illai*, then ask *sariyā?*
- *Return to:* say *āṇḍu* and say *tākam* — three distances back
- *Read it:* ஓ
- *Return to:* ask about one of them with -ஆ

Before you move on

Which word in the sentence carries **-ஆ**? (**The last one — and that is the word the question is about.**)

75.2 ஆம், இல்லை — and the answer Tamil likes better

Ask, in Tamil: is this milk? Then say: neither milk nor tea.

Grammar lens: two answers, and a third

You have had ஆம் and இல்லை since chapter one. Now there is something to answer.

இது பாலா? — *idu pālā?*

ஆம். / இல்லை.

Both work, and both are correct. But listen to how Tamil speakers actually reply, because they often reach for neither: they **repeat the word that was asked about**.

இது பாலா? — பால்.

சரியா? — சரி.

The echo is the everyday answer. ஆம் is a shade more formal, and it is the one to use when the question was long and you want to be plain. இல்லை has no echo version. To deny, you say இல்லை.

What you've built

You can ask a yes-or-no question and answer one, in the two shapes a speaker will hear.

Your turn

- *Answer: idu pālā?* — with the echo
- *Answer: idu pālā?* — with இல்லை
- *Ask and answer: sariyā?* — then *sari*
- *Recall:* say *pālum tēnīrum illai*, then ask *nīṅgaḷ nalamā?*, then answer *nalam*
- *Return to:* say *-um … -um*, *tūkkam* and *ōḍu* — three distances back — then ask about one of them with -ஆ

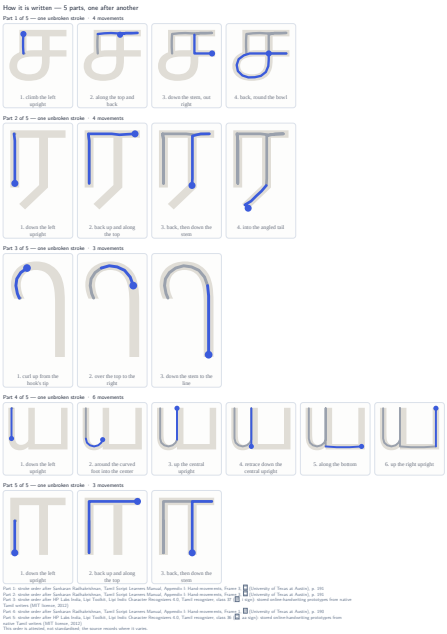
Before you move on

Somebody asks **சரியா?** and you agree. What is the everyday reply? (**சரி** — the echo, not **ஆம்**.)

75.3 சரியா — a question you can see

Before the page: ask *sariyā?*, then give the echo answer.

Script you'll notice: சரியா — the ending is a sign, not a letter



How **சரியா** *is written, part by part, stroke by stroke*

சரி was the third word in this book, and you wrote it in chapter nineteen. The question ending adds one shape to it.

piece		
ச	*ca*	the letter for a whole family of sounds
ரி	*ri*	ர with the ி sign
யா	*yā*	ய with the long ா sign

ச · ரி · யா → சரியா

A ய appeared that was not in சரி. That is the same slide you saw in மேசையும்: சரி ends in a vowel, so a light ய் carries the ending on.

And the ending itself is the sign ா, sitting after ய the way it sits after ப in பா. A question mark closes the line on the page, but the question is already in that sign.

Your turn

- *Read it:* ச — then ரி — then யா
- *Read it:* சரி, then சரியா — a statement, then a question
- *Point to:* the shape that does the asking
- *Recall:* ask *sariyā?*, then answer *sari*, then read சரியா
- *Return to:* say *-um*, *kāyccal* and *kaḻuvu* — three distances back — then ask about one of them with -ஆ

Before you move on

Read சரியா. Which single shape turned it into a question? (**The long ா on the end.**)

75.4 நான் உள்ளே வரலாமா? — may I come in?

Read it: சரியா, then answer it

You'll want to know: வரலாமா?

நான் உள்ளே வரலாமா? (*nāṉ uḷḷē varalāmā?*) — "may I come in?"

Three pieces you have, and one you half-have. **நான்** is "I". **உள்ளே** is "inside", from the six directions. **வா** is "come".

The half-known piece is **-லாம்**. It has been in your goodbye since chapter four: **நாளை பார்க்கலாம்** — "we may see each other tomorrow". On a verb, **-லாம்** means *it is allowed*.

வா becomes **வரலாம்** — "may come". Then chapter seventy-five's ending arrives:

வரலாம் → வரலாமா? — "may I come?"

Permission is a yes-or-no question, so it takes the yes-or-no ending. Nothing new to learn about the asking.

To grant it, you have both answers already:

ஆம், வரலாம். or, at a doorway, plainly: **சரி.**

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

நான் உள்ளே வரலாமா? (*nāṉ uḷḷē varalāmā?*) is all native: *nāṉ*, "I" (DEDR 5160), *uḷḷē*, "inside" (DEDR 698), and *varu*, "to come" (DEDR 5270), with the ending that asks "may I?".

What you've built

A doorway you can stand in and be let through.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *nāṉ uḷḷē varalāmā?*
- *Grant:* *ām, varalām*
- *Grant again:* *sari*
- *Recall:* answer *sariyā?*
- *Read it:* **சரியா**
- *Recall:* ask *varalāmā?*
- *Read it:* **பாலும்**

- *Return to:* say *vali* and say *viḷaiyāḍu* — three distances back — then ask about one of them with -ஆ

Before you move on

You are at a door and want to be let in. Say it. (நான் உள்ளே வரலாமா?)

Chapter 76

But, and Or

Modes: **voice** (2) **eyes** (1) **pen** (1) **Hands-free start:** the first of 4 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can set one statement against another, offer a choice between two, and take the answer.
>
> *Complete TA-C76-choice and offer two drinks, in the long form and the short one.*

76.1 ஆனால் (āṉāl) — but

> *Read it:* சரியா
>
> Then ask to be let inside.

You'll want to know: ஆனால்

ஆனால் (*āṉāl*) — "but".

Chapter seventy-four joined two **things**. This joins two **statements**, and unlike **-உம்** it is a word of its own, standing between them.

> **தேநீர் வேண்டும், ஆனால் பால் வேண்டாம்.**
>
> *tēnīr vēṇḍum, āṉāl pāl vēṇḍām.*
>
> "I want tea, but I don't want milk."

Both halves are sentences you could already say. ஆனால் sets the second against the first.

The word is built out of ஆகு, "to become": ஆனால் began as "if that is so". A sentence that starts by granting the first half and then turns is exactly what *but* does.

In everyday speech the tail wears down and you will hear ஆனா. It is the same word.

In the family, and next door

	word	same root
Kannada	ಆದರೆ (*ādare*)	yes
Telugu	కానీ (*kānī*)	
Malayalam	എന്നാൽ (*ennāl*)	
Hindi (neighbour)	लेकिन (*lekin*)	
English	but	

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

ஆனால் (*āṉāl*) is native: a form of *ā*, "to become, to be" (DEDR 333), meaning "if it is so". "But" grew out of "be that as it may".

What you've built

Two sentences held together, with the second one pushing back.

Your turn

- *Say it: āṉāl*
- *Say it: tēnīr vēṇḍum, āṉāl pāl vēṇḍām*
- *Build: idu nalla vīḍu, āṉāl siṟiya vīḍu*
- *Read it:* சரியா
- *Recall:* ask *varalāmā?*, then say *āṉāl*
- *Return to:* say *-um … -um illai*, *maṭṭum* and *kōpam* — three distances back — then set two of them against each other with ஆனால்
- *Recall:* say *iṉṟu*
- *Read it:* நேற்று

- *Recall:* say *muṉbu*

Before you move on

What sits between the two halves, and what does the second half do? (ஆனால் — **and the second half turns against the first.**)

76.2 அல்லது (alladu) — or

Ask to be let inside. Then say *but* in Tamil.

You'll want to know: அல்லது

அல்லது (*alladu*) — "or".

Like ஆனால், it is a word of its own and it stands between the two things it offers.

பால் அல்லது தேநீர்.

pāl alladu tēnīr.

"Milk or tea."

Look at the shape of the word. அது is "that one", which you have had since chapter forty; அல்ல is a denial. அல்லது is "it is not that" — and a list that says *this, or if not that* is an offer of a choice.

So Tamil's *and* is an ending, and Tamil's *or* is a small denial. Neither one is the word English would have led you to expect.

It works on two statements as well as two things:

நீங்கள் வரலாம், அல்லது நான் வருகிறேன்.

"You may come, or I will come."

In the family, and next door

	word
Kannada	ಅಥವಾ (*athavā*)
Telugu	లేదా (*lēdā*)
Hindi (neighbour)	… या … (… *yā* …)
English	or

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

அல்லது (*alladu*) is native: "if it is not that". It is built on *al-*, the native verb of not-being (DEDR 234), which lists *allatu*, "or else".

What you've built

Two joins in two lessons: one that sets things against each other, one that offers a choice.

Your turn

- *Say it: alladu*
- *Say it: pāl alladu tēnīr*
- *Contrast: pālum tēnīrum* against *pāl alladu tēnīr* — both, then either
- *Recall:* ask *varalāmā?*, then say *āṉāl*, then say *alladu*
- *Return to:* say *-ā*, *iṉṉum* and *payam* — three distances back — then offer two of them with அல்லது
- *Recall:* read மாதம், then say *āṇḍu*

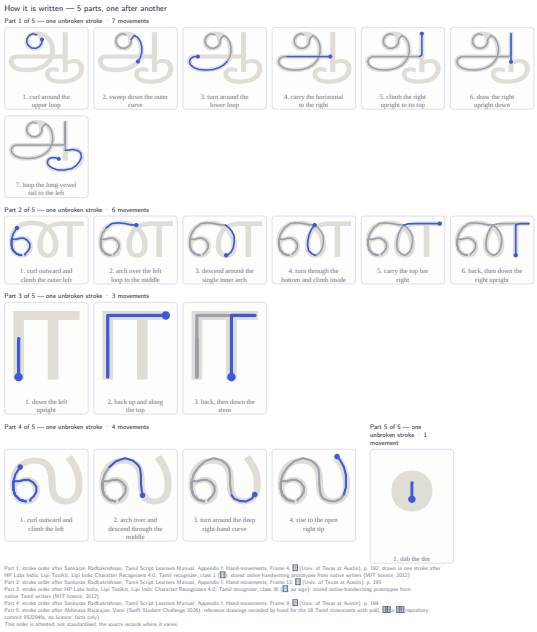
Before you move on

Offer somebody milk or tea. (பால் அல்லது தேநீர்.)

76.3 ஆனால் — three shapes, all of them old

Before the page: say *but*, then say *or*.

Script you'll notice: ஆனால் — the same long sound, written two ways



How ஆனால் *is written, part by part, stroke by stroke*

Read it in three pieces.

piece		
ஆ	*ā*	the free-standing long vowel, because the word opens on it
னா	*n̄ā*	ன with the long ◌ா sign
ல்	*l*	ல with a புள்ளி, so it carries no vowel

ஆ · னா · ல் → ஆனால்

One word, and the long *ā* appears twice in it — first as a whole letter, then as a sign. That is the rule from இன்று and ஆம் shown twice inside a single word: at the front of a word a vowel needs its own shape, and anywhere after a consonant it becomes a mark.

The word ends on a புள்ளி, and that closing ல் is the piece everyday speech drops when it says ஆனா.

Your turn

- *Read it:* ஆ — then னா — then ல்
- *Read it:* ஆனால்
- *Point to:* the two places the long ā is written, and say why they differ
- *Recall:* say *āṉāl*, then say *alladu*, then read ஆனால்
- *Return to:* say *ām / illai*, say *sīkkiram* and read பயம் — three distances back — then offer two of them with அல்லது

Before you move on

Why is the first ā a letter and the second a sign? (**Because the word begins with the first one, and the second sits on ன.**)

76.4 பால் வேண்டுமா, அல்லது தேநீர் வேண்டுமா? — offering a choice

Read it: ஆனால்

Then say *or*.

You'll want to know: two questions, one offer

பால் வேண்டுமா, அல்லது தேநீர் வேண்டுமா? *pāl vēṇḍumā, alladu tēnīr vēṇḍumā?* — "Would you like milk, or would you like tea?"

Every piece is yours. வேண்டும் is "want", from chapter thirty-nine. The **-ஆ** on the end of each half is last chapter's question ending. அல்லது sits between them.

Notice what Tamil does not do: it does not ask one question with two answers in it. It asks **two whole questions** and puts *or* between them. Each half could stand alone.

The shorter form drops the second verb, and a host at a doorway will say it that way:

பால் அல்லது தேநீர்?

Answer it with the echo you learned for any yes-or-no question — name the one you want:

தேநீர்.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

பால் வேண்டுமா, அல்லது தேநீர் வேண்டுமா? (*pāl vēṇḍumā, alladu tēnīr vēṇḍumā?*) is built from words met before, all native except one: *pāl*, "milk", *vēṇḍum*, "is wanted" (DEDR 5528), and *alladu*, "or" (DEDR 234). The one loan is *tēnīr*: *tē*, the travelling word for tea, on native *nīr*, "water".

What you've built

You can put a choice in front of somebody and take their answer.

Your turn

- *Offer:* *pāl vēṇḍumā, alladu tēnīr vēṇḍumā?*
- *Offer short:* *pāl alladu tēnīr?*
- *Answer:* name one of them
- *Recall:* say *alladu*
- *Read it:* ஆனால்
- *Recall:* make the full offer
- *Read it:* சரியா
- *Return to:* say *uṭaṉē* and say *varuttam* — three distances back — then offer two of them with அல்லது

Before you move on

How many questions does Tamil ask when it offers two things? (**Two — one for each, with அல்லது between.**)

Chapter 77

Saying, and Thinking

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (3) ✓ **pen** (1) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** the first 2 of 4 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can report what was said and give an opinion, by putting a whole sentence inside another.
>
> *Complete TA-C77-opinion and give an opinion about two different things.*

77.1 சொல் (sol) — to say, to tell

Read it: ஆனால்

Then offer somebody milk or tea.

You'll want to know: சொல்

சொல் (*sol*) — "to say, to tell".

You have been using this verb since chapter eight without being told its name. சொல்லுங்கள் — "please tell me" — is சொல் with the respectful ending you met in the same chapter.

Now it stands on its own, the way போ and வா and சாப்பிடு do.

சொல் — say it

சொல்லுங்கள் — please say it

சொல் also means *a word*. The same three letters name the thing and the act, and no Tamil speaker finds that odd: a word is what saying produces.

You will need this verb for the next lesson, because Tamil has a particular way of handing somebody else's words to it.

In the family, and next door

	word
Kannada	ಹೇಳು (*hēḷu*)
Malayalam	പറയുക (*paṟayuka*)
English	to say, to tell

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

சொல் (*sol*) is native Dravidian. DEDR 2855 lists Malayalam *colluka* and Kannada *sol*.

What you've built

A verb you have been saying since chapter eight, now yours to use.

Your turn

- *Say it: sol*
- *Say it: sol*, then *solluṅgaḷ* — the bare verb, then the polite one
- *Notice:* the second meaning, *a word*
- *Read it:* ஆனால்
- *Recall:* offer *pāl alladu tēnīr?*, then say *sol*
- *Return to:* say *nāṉ uḷḷē varalāmā?*, *mutalil* and *siri* — three distances back — then quote one of them with என்று

Before you move on

Which word you already knew is this verb wearing a polite ending? (சொல்லுங்கள்.)

77.2 என்று (enṟu) — the end of a quotation

Offer somebody a choice of two drinks. Then say the verb *to say*.

Grammar lens: the quotation carries its own closing word

English opens a quotation with *that* or with a comma. Tamil closes it, with என்று.

> “சரி” என்று சொல்லுங்கள்.
>
> *“sari” en̲ṟu solluṅgaḷ.* — ’Say “okay”.’

The words being reported come first, whole and unchanged. என்று then marks where they end, and the verb of saying comes last, where every Tamil verb goes.

> “பால் வேண்டும்” என்று சொல்லுங்கள்.
>
> ’Say “I want milk”.’

என்று is itself made from an old verb meaning *to say*, so what you are doing is saying that something was said. Two sayings, one sentence — and that is why nothing needs to be added at the front.
Everyday speech shortens it to -ன்னு, stuck straight onto the quotation: *sari-n̲n̲u solluṅgaḷ*. You will hear that far more often than the full word.

What you’ve built

A way to put a whole sentence inside another one.

Your turn

- *Say it: en̲ṟu*
- *Say it: “sari” en̲ṟu solluṅgaḷ*
- *Build: “pāl vēṇḍum” en̲ṟu solluṅgaḷ*
- *Recall:* offer *pāl alladu tēnīr?*, then say *sol*, then say the whole quoted line
- *Return to:* say *āṉ̲āl*, *vēṇḍukōḷ* and *a̲lu* — three distances back — then quote one of them with என்று

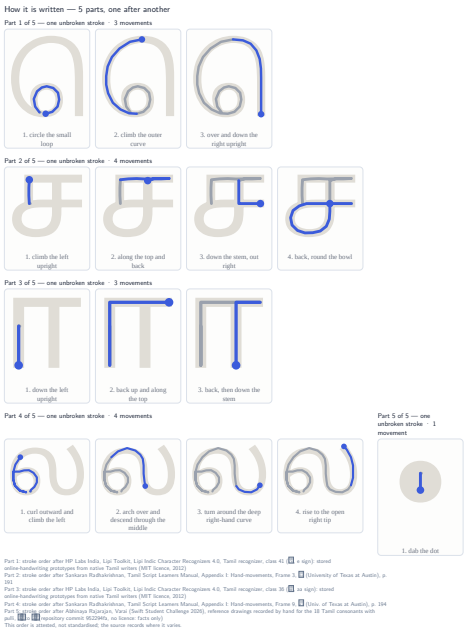
Before you move on

Where does என்று stand — before the quoted words or after them? (**After. It closes them, and the verb follows.**)

77.3 சொல் — a sign on both sides of one letter

Before the page: say the verb *to say*, then close a quotation with என்று.

Script you'll notice: சொல் — two letters, and a sign that surrounds one



How சொல் *is written, part by part, stroke by stroke*

piece		
சொ	*so*	ச with the ொ sign
ல்	*l*	ல with a புள்ளி

சொ · ல் → சொல்

The ொ sign is the one you first met inside சொல்லுங்கள் in chapter eight, and it is unusual: it puts one piece **before** its letter and another **after** it. The letter sits in the middle of its own vowel.

Compare it with ோ in போ, which does the same thing for the long *ō*. Tamil has a small family of signs that wrap around, and both of them are in words you already say.

The word ends the way ஆனால் did, on a ல் carrying a புள்ளி.

Your turn

- *Read it:* சொ — then ல்
- *Read it:* சொல், then போ — two wrapping signs, one short and one long
- *Point to:* the two halves of the ொ sign, and the letter caught between them
- *Recall:* say *sol*, then say *"sari" enṟu solluṅgaḷ*, then read சொல்
- *Return to:* say *alladu*, *aṉumati* and *iṉṟu* — three distances back — then quote one of them with என்று

Before you move on

What is unusual about the ொ sign? (**It wraps around its letter — part before, part after.**)

77.4 ... என்று நினைக்கிறேன் — I think that ...

Read it: சொல்

Then say: 'Say "okay"'

You'll want to know: what என்று hands to நினை

நினை (*ninai*) has been in the book since chapter thirty-three: "to think". Until now it had nothing to think **about**, because a thought is a whole sentence and nothing could carry one.

என்று carries one.

இது நல்ல வீடு என்று நினைக்கிறேன்.

idu nalla vīḍu eṉṟu niṉaikkiṟēṉ.

"I think this is a good house."

The opinion comes first and stands whole — இது நல்ல வீடு, a sentence you could say on its own. என்று closes it. Then the verb, built the way பேசுகிறேன் was in chapter five: நினை, the middle piece for *now*, and -ஏன் for *I*.

Swap the front half for anything you can say:

இது சிறிய கடை என்று நினைக்கிறேன்.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

... என்று நினைக்கிறேன் (*... eṉṟu niṉaikkiṟēṉ*) is native: *eṉṟu*, "having said", from *eṉ*, "to say" (DEDR 868), and *niṉai*, "to think" (DEDR 3683). "I think that ..." is "saying '...', I think".

What you've built

An opinion, which is the first thing here that is yours rather than a fact.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *niṉaikkiṟēṉ*
- *Say it:* *idu nalla vīḍu eṉṟu niṉaikkiṟēṉ*
- *Swap:* put *idu siṟiya kaḍai* in the front half and say the whole thing
- *Recall:* say *"sari" eṉṟu solluṅgaḷ*
- *Read it:* சொல்
- *Recall:* give your opinion
- *Read it:* ஆனால்
- *Return to:* say *tayakkam* and say *nēṟṟu* — three distances back — then quote one of them with என்று

Before you move on

What stands between your opinion and the verb நினைக்கிறேன்? (என்று.)

Chapter 78

Why, and Because

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (4) ✓ **pen** (1) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** the first 2 of 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can ask for a reason and give one, before or after the thing it explains.
>
> *Complete TA-C78-for-the-sake-of and answer one why three different ways.*

78.1 ஏன் (ēn̲) — why

Read it: சொல்

Then say: I think this is a good house.

You'll want to know: ஏன்

ஏன் (*ēn̲*) — "why".

Chapter forty gave you the shape of every Tamil question word: they begin on an **e-**. என்ன, எங்கே, எப்படி, எவ்வளவு. **ஏன்** belongs to the same family, and it is the one that asks for a reason.

It holds a long **ஏ** where the others hold a short **எ**. The family is real; the length is part of this particular member.

On its own it is a whole question:

ஏன்? — "Why?"

Or in front of a sentence:

ஏன் தேநீர் வேண்டும்? — "Why do you want tea?"

This is the first question in the book that cannot be answered by naming a thing. Its answer is a sentence, and the next lesson is the word that lets you give one.

In the family, and next door

	word	same root
Telugu	ఎందుకు (*enduku*)	yes
Malayalam	എന്തുകൊണ്ട് (*entukoṇṭŭ*)	yes
Hindi (neighbour)	क्यों (*kyom*)	
English	why	

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

ஏன் (*ēṉ*) is native Dravidian (DEDR 5151). It is built on the native question base *e-*, "what".

What you've built

The sixth member of a question family whose pattern you have known since chapter forty.

Your turn

- *Say it: ēṉ*
- *Say it:* the question words in a row — *eṉṉa, eṅgē, eppaḍi, evvaḷavu, ēṉ*
- *Ask: ēṉ tēnīr vēṇḍum?*
- *Read it:* சொல்
- *Recall:* say *idu nalla vīḍu eṉṟu niṉaikkiṟēṉ*, then ask *ēṉ?*
- *Return to:* say *pāl vēṇḍumā, alladu tēnīr vēṇḍumā?* and say *nambikkai* — three distances back
- *Read it:* இன்று
- *Return to:* ask ஏன் about one of them
- *Recall:* say *āṉāl*

Before you move on

What does every Tamil question word begin with, and what is different about this one? (**An e- — and this one's is long: ஏ.**)

78.2 ஏனென்றால் (ēṉeṉṟāl) — because

Give an opinion about a house. Then ask *why*.

You'll want to know: ஏனென்றால்

ஏனென்றால் (*ēṉeṉṟāl*) — "because".

It is long, and it is long for a reason you can already read. Take it apart:

piece		
ஏன்	*ēṉ*	why — last lesson
என்றால்	*eṉṟāl*	if it is said

"If you ask why —". That is the whole word. Tamil answers a *why* by repeating the question and then going on.

என்றால் is the same verb you met one chapter ago in என்று. There it closed a quotation; here it closes a question and turns it into a hinge.

தேநீர் வேண்டும், ஏனென்றால் எனக்குத் தாகம்.

tēnīr vēṇḍum, ēṉeṉṟāl enakkut tākam.

"I want tea, because I am thirsty."

The second half is a whole sentence — the dative one from chapter six, *to me, thirst*. ஏனென்றால் joins it on without changing either side.

Everyday speech shortens it to ஏன்னா, the same wearing-down that made ஆனால் into ஆனா.

In the family, and next door

	word
Telugu	ఎందుకంటే (*endukaṇṭē*)
English	because

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

ஏனென்றால் (*ēṉeṉṟāl*) is native: *ēṉ*, "why" (DEDR 5151), and *eṉṟāl*, "if one says", from *eṉ*, "to say" (DEDR 868). "Because" is "if you say why".

What you've built

You can ask for a reason and give one.

Your turn

- *Say it: ēṉeṉṟāl*
- *Say it: tēnīr vēṇḍum, ēṉeṉṟāl enakkut tākam*
- *Split:* say the two halves apart, then join them
- *Recall:* say your opinion of a house, then ask *ēṉ?*, then answer with *ēṉeṉṟāl*
- *Return to:* say *sol*, *paṇivu* and *muṉbu* — three distances back — then ask ஏன் about one of them
- *Read it:* அல்லது
- *Recall:* say *sol*

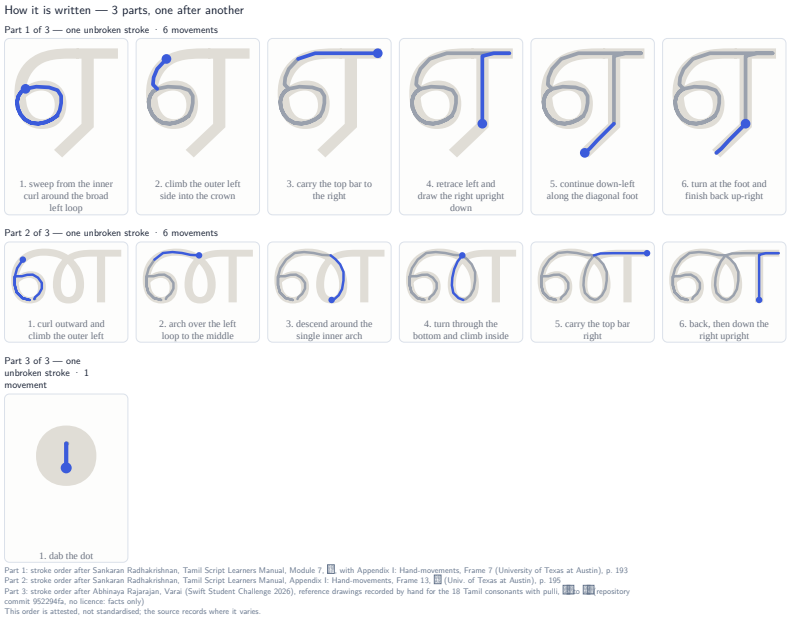
Before you move on

Which question word is hiding at the front of ஏனென்றால்? (ஏன்.)

78.3 ஏன் — the shortest question in the book

Before the page: ask *why*, then answer with *because*.

Script you'll notice: ஏன் — two shapes, and one of them is a whole letter



How ஏன் *is written, part by part, stroke by stroke*

piece		
ஏ	*ē*	the free-standing long e, because the word opens on it
ன்	*n̲*	ன with a புள்ளி

ஏ · ன் → ஏன்

Two shapes. Nothing else in this book is shorter and still a question. Now set it beside the question word you read in chapter twenty-nine:

எப்படி opens on எ · ஏன் opens on ஏ

Same family, different length, and Tamil gives each length its own letter rather than a mark on one shape. That is why both had to be learnt separately, and why a reader who has both can now tell an *eppaḍi* from an *ēn̲* before hearing either.

The closing ன் is the alveolar n you first wrote in chapter seven, the same one that ends நான்.

Your turn

- *Read it:* ஏ — then ன்
- *Read it:* ஏன், then எப்படி — long, then short
- *Point to:* the two letters that hold the two lengths
- *Recall:* ask *ēṉ?*, then answer with *ēṉeṉṟāl*, then read ஏன்
- *Return to:* say *eṉṟu*, *nel* and *mādam* — three distances back — then ask ஏன் about one of them

Before you move on

Read ஏன். How does the page tell it apart from எப்படி? (**A different letter for the long e.**)

78.4 அதனால் (adaṉāl) — because of that, so

Read it: ஏன்

Then say *because*.

You'll want to know: அதனால்

அதனால் (*adaṉāl*) — "because of that", "so".

ஏனென்றால் puts the reason **after** the result. அதனால் puts it **before**, and points back at it.

> எனக்குத் தாகம். அதனால் தேநீர் வேண்டும்.
>
> *enakkut tākam. adaṉāl tēnīr vēṇḍum.*
>
> "I am thirsty. So I want tea."

Same two facts as the last lesson, in the other order. Both are ordinary Tamil, and which one you reach for depends on which half you want to lead with.

The word is அது — "that one", from chapter forty — carrying an ending that means *by*. *By that.* It can only point backwards, which is why it never opens a conversation.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

அதனால் (*adaṉāl*) is native: *atu*, "that" (DEDR 1), in its joining form *ataṉ-*, with *-āl*, "by": "by that".

What you've built

The reason can now go on either side of the result.

Your turn

- *Say it: adaṉāl*
- *Say it: enakkut tākam. adaṉāl tēnīr vēṇḍum.*
- *Flip:* say the same two facts with *ēṉeṉṟāl* instead
- *Recall:* say *ēṉeṉṟāl*
- *Read it:* ஏன்
- *Recall:* say *adaṉāl*
- *Read it:* சொல்
- *Return to:* say *pul* and say *āṇḍu* — three distances back — then ask ஏன் about one of them

Before you move on

Which of the two joins puts the reason first? (அதனால் — it points back at a reason already given.)

78.5 -க்காக — what a thing is for

Read it: ஏன்

Then say: I am thirsty, so I want tea.

Grammar lens: a reason that is not a sentence

ஏனென்றால் and அதனால் both join a whole sentence. Sometimes the reason is not a sentence at all — it is a person, or a thing.
-க்காக (*-kkāga*) is the ending for that. It grows on the dative -உக்கு

you have had since chapter six.

word	with the ending	it means
உங்கள்	உங்களுக்காக	for you
நண்பன்	நண்பனுக்காக	for a friend

> **உங்களுக்காக தேநீர்.** — *uṅgaḷukkāga tēnīr.* — "Tea for you."

Hear the **-உக்கு** still inside it. Chapter six taught that ending as *to* or *for*; **-க்காக** sharpens it into *for the sake of*, which is purpose rather than direction.
This is the third answer to **ஏன்** in one chapter: a following sentence, a preceding sentence, and now a single word.

What you've built

A whole chapter about reasons: asking for one, giving one after, giving one before, and naming who a thing is for.

Your turn

- *Say it: uṅgaḷukkāga*
- *Say it: uṅgaḷukkāga tēnīr*
- *Build: naṇbaṉukkāga*
- *Answer:* ask *ēṉ?* and answer it three ways — with *ēṉeṉṟāl*, with *adaṉāl*, and with *uṅgaḷukkāga*
- *Return to:* say *payir*, *-um … -um* and *… eṉṟu niṉaikkiṟēṉ* — three distances back — then ask **ஏன்** about one of them

Before you move on

Which older ending is inside **-க்காக**? (**-உக்கு**, the dative from chapter six.)

Chapter 79

When

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (3) ✓ **pen** (1) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** the first 2 of 4 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can ask when, point at a time already named, and say that two things happen together.
>
> *Complete TA-C79-when-clause and say the three time-words, then a when-clause.*

79.1 எப்போது (eppōdu) — when?

Say *so, therefore.* Then say: tea for you.

You'll want to know: எப்போது

எப்போது (*eppōdu*) — "when?"

You have had **இப்போது**, "now", since chapter forty-eight, and you have had the pattern behind it since chapter forty: **i-** for near, **a-** for far, **e-** for a question.

So this word was already half yours:

word		
இப்போது	*ippōdu*	now — this time
எப்போது	*eppōdu*	when? — which time

The shared piece is **போது**, a word meaning *a time, an occasion.* Change only the front and you have walked from a statement to a question, exactly as **இங்கே** walked to **எங்கே**.

எப்போது வேண்டும்? — "When do you want it?"

In the family, and next door

	word	same root
Kannada	ಯಾವಾಗ (*yāvāga*)	
Telugu	ఎప్పుడు వస్తారు? (*eppuḍu vastāru?*)	
Malayalam	എപ്പോൾ (*eppōḷ*)	yes
English	when?	

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

எப்போது (*eppōdu*) is native: the question base *e-* (DEDR 5151) and *pōtu*, "time" (DEDR 4559). DEDR 5151 lists *eppōtu* itself.

What you've built

The question word for time, and the small word போது that sits inside it.

Your turn

- *Say it: eppōdu*
- *Say it: ippōdu*, then *eppōdu* — the statement, then the question
- *Ask: eppōdu vēṇḍum?*
- *Recall:* say *adaṉāl*, then say *uṅgaḷukkāga*, then ask *eppōdu?*
- *Return to:* say *-um*, *kaḷam* and *ēṉ* — three distances back — then say when one of them happens
- *Recall:* say *sol*

Before you move on

What is the piece these two words share, and what does it mean? (போது — **a time.**)

79.2 அப்போது (appōdu) — then, at that time

Say *for you.* Then ask *when?*

You'll want to know: அப்போது

அப்போது (*appōdu*) — "then, at that time".

The third seat was empty and now it is filled:

இப்போது	*ippōdu*	now
அப்போது	*appōdu*	then
எப்போது	*eppōdu*	when?

Near, far, question — the same three fronts you first met on இங்கே, அங்கே, எங்கே.

Then in Tamil means a time somebody has already named. It looks backwards, the way அதனால் does, and for the same reason: both begin on the **a-** that means *that one, over there*.

> நாளை. அப்போது சொல்லுங்கள். — "Tomorrow. Tell me then."

In the family, and next door

	word
Malayalam	പിന്നെ (*pinne*)
English	then, at that time

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

அப்போது (*appōdu*) is native: the far base *a-* (DEDR 1) and *pōtu*, "time" (DEDR 4559): "that time".

What you've built

A complete set of three, from a pattern you were given nearly forty chapters ago.

Your turn

- *Say it: appōdu*
- *Say it:* all three in order — *ippōdu, appōdu, eppōdu*
- *Notice:* the front that means *that one*, in அப்போது and in அதனால்

- *Recall:* say *uṅgaḷukkāga*, then ask *eppōdu?*, then answer *appōdu*
- *Return to:* say *aṟuvaṭai*
- *Read it:* பாலும்
- *Return to:* say *ēṉeṉṟāl* — three distances back — then say when one of them happens

Before you move on

Why can அப்போது never open a conversation? (**Because *a-* points at a time somebody has already named.**)

79.3 எப்போது — the doubled letter, read across a seam

Before the page: say *now*, *then*, *when?* in that order.

Script you'll notice: எப்போது — one letter, twice, on either side of a புள்ளி

piece		
எ	*e*	the free-standing short e, because the word opens on it
ப்	*p*	ப with a புள்ளி
போ	*pō*	ப with the wrapping ோ sign
து	*du*	த with the ு sign

எ · ப் · போ · து → எப்போது

The middle is the shape you first read in சட்டை: the same letter written twice, the first one wearing a புள்ளி and leaning on the second. Here it is ப, and the doubling is exactly what makes the *pp* you hear.

Read the seam and the word divides itself: எ is the question front from chapter forty, and போது is the time-word. அப்போது is the same page with one letter changed at the start.

Your turn

- *Read it:* எ — then ப் — then போ — then து
- *Read it:* எப்போது, then அப்போது
- *Point to:* the two ப shapes, and say which one carries no vowel
- *Recall:* ask *eppōdu?*, then answer *appōdu*, then read எப்போது
- *Return to:* say *-um … -um illai*, say *kuḍi* and read ஏன் — three distances back — then say when one of them happens

Before you move on

Read எப்போது. Which one letter would you change to read *then* instead? (**The first — எ becomes அ.**)

79.4 -உம் போது — when one thing happens, so does another

Read it: எப்போது

Then say *then, at that time.*

Grammar lens: the time-word does the joining

எப்போது asks about a time. போது on its own can pin one, and when a verb stands in front of it the whole thing becomes *when that happens.*
The verb takes **-உம்** first:

> வா → வரும் → வரும் போது — "at the coming time" — "when [you] come"
>
> நீங்கள் வரும் போது, சொல்லுங்கள்.
>
> *nīṅgaḷ varum pōdu, solluṅgaḷ.* — "When you come, tell me."

Two things happening at once, held together by a word that means *time.* No word for *when* is needed, because போது already is one.
One warning, because it would otherwise mislead you. The **-உம்** here is **not** the joining ending from chapter seventy-four. That one sat on

nouns and meant *and*. This one sits on verbs and marks a happening. Same two letters, two different jobs — and the word in front of them tells you which.
Everyday speech runs it together and clips it, so you will hear *varumbōdu* as one word.

What you've built

The last of this chapter's three: a time you ask about, a time you point at, and a time you build out of a verb.

Your turn

- *Say it: varum pōdu*
- *Say it: nīṅgaḷ varum pōdu, solluṅgaḷ*
- *Separate:* say *pālum* and then *varum* — the same ending, two different jobs
- *Recall:* answer *appōdu*
- *Read it:* எப்போது
- *Recall:* say the whole *varum pōdu* line
- *Return to:* say *-ā*, *naḍa* and *adaṉāl* — three distances back — then say when one of them happens

Before you move on

Two words end in -உம்: பாலும் and வரும். What tells them apart? (**What they sit on — a naming word joins, a doing word marks a happening.**)

Chapter 80

One, the Other, and the Price

Modes: **voice** (3) **pen** (1) **Hands-free start:** the first 2 of 4 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can tell two things apart, choose between them, and ask what one costs.
>
> *Complete TA-C80-price and run the whole counter exchange, from choosing to asking.*

80.1 மற்றது (ma̲r̲radu) — the other one

> *Read it:* எப்போது
>
> Then say: when you come, tell me.

You'll want to know: மற்றது

மற்றது (*ma̲r̲radu*) — "the other one".

இது and அது name a thing by where it stands: near me, over there. மற்றது names it by what it is not — the one that is *left*, once you have picked one up.

> இது வேண்டும். மற்றது வேண்டாம்.
>
> *idu vēṇḍum. ma̲r̲radu vēṇḍām.* — "I want this one. Not the other."

The tail of the word is அது, the same *that one* that ends அதனால். Tamil builds a surprising amount out of that small word, and once you hear it inside a longer one you can usually guess what the longer one is doing.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

மற்றது (*maṟṟadu*) is native Dravidian. DEDR 4766 lists Malayalam *maṟṟavan*, "the other (man)" and Kannada *maru*, "other". The entry lists *maṟṟu*, "other", and *-atu* makes it "the other one".

What you've built

A third way to point at a thing, once two of them are on the table.

Your turn

- *Say it: maṟṟadu*
- *Say it: idu vēṇḍum. maṟṟadu vēṇḍām.*
- *Notice:* the அது at the end of மற்றது and at the start of அதனால்
- *Read it:* எப்போது
- *Recall:* say *varum pōdu*, then say *maṟṟadu*
- *Return to:* say *ām / illai*
- *Read it:* குடி
- *Return to:* say *-kkāga* — three distances back — then set two of them against each other, one and the other
- *Recall:* say *ēṉ*
- *Read it:* ஏனென்றால்
- *Recall:* say *adaṉāl*

Before you move on

இது names a thing by where it is. What does மற்றது name it by? (**By being the one left over.**)

80.2 ஒன்று … மற்றது — one here, the other there

Say: when you come, tell me. Then say *the other one.*

Grammar lens: a pair, split across two halves

ஒன்று has been the number *one* since chapter seven. Put மற்றது opposite it and the number stops counting and starts distributing.

> ஒன்று இங்கே, மற்றது அங்கே.
>
> *oṉṟu iṅgē, maṟṟadu aṅgē.* — "One is here, the other is there."

Two halves, no joining word between them, and no verb in either. Tamil sets them side by side and the pairing does the work — the same silence you first met in இவர் என் நண்பர்.
It works with any two facts you can already state:

> ஒன்று பெரிய வீடு, மற்றது சிறிய வீடு.

Chapter seventy-four joined two things into one list. This does the opposite: it takes two things and holds them apart.

What you've built

Both directions now: a way to put two things together, and a way to tell them apart.

Your turn

- *Say it: oṉṟu iṅgē, maṟṟadu aṅgē*
- *Build: oṉṟu periya vīḍu, maṟṟadu siṟiya vīḍu*
- *Contrast: pālum tēnīrum* against *oṉṟu … maṟṟadu* — held together, then held apart
- *Recall:* say *varum pōdu*, then say *maṟṟadu*, then say the whole pair
- *Return to:* say *niṟuttu*

- *Read it:* சரியா
- *Return to:* say *eppōdu* — three distances back — then set two of them against each other, one and the other

Before you move on

How many joining words stand between the two halves? (**None — the pair itself is the join.**)

80.3 மற்றது — a doubling you have read twice before

Before the page: say *one here, the other there.*

Script you'll notice: மற்றது — ற standing on ற

piece		
ம	*ma*	the letter on its own
ற்	*r̲*	ற with a புள்ளி
ற	*r̲a*	ற again, this time carrying its vowel
து	*du*	த with the ◌ு sign

ம · ற் · ற · து → மற்றது

The middle is the doubling you read in சட்டை with ட and in எப்போது with ப. A third letter, the same shape of seam: one wearing a புள்ளி, leaning on its twin.

Once you have seen it three times it stops being a thing to work out. It is a shape.

The last two letters spell து, and the word they close is அது — the *that one* the lesson before pointed out. On the page you can see the whole word being built out of things you have.

Your turn

- *Read it:* ம — then ற் — then ற — then து

- *Read it:* மற்றது, then எப்போது, then சட்டை — three doublings, three letters
- *Point to:* the letter carrying the புள்ளி in each one
- *Recall:* say *maṟṟadu*, then say *oṉṟu iṅgē, maṟṟadu aṅgē*, then read மற்றது
- *Return to:* say *tiṟa*, *nāṉ uḷḷē varalāmā?* and *appōdu* — three distances back — then set two of them against each other, one and the other

Before you move on

Read மற்றது. Which letter is written twice? (ற — **the first one with a புள்ளி.**)

80.4 விலை எவ்வளவு? — how much does it cost?

Read it: மற்றது

Then say: one here, the other there.

You'll want to know: the question the shop is for

விலை எவ்வளவு? (*vilai evvaḷavu?*) — "How much does it cost?"

Both words have been yours for a long time. **எவ்வளவு** came in chapter thirty-nine and **விலை** in chapter sixty-eight. Standing side by side they are the question a shop exists for, and until now nothing put them side by side.

No verb, and no word for *is*. Tamil names the thing and asks about it:

விலை எவ்வளவு? — the price, how much?

இது எவ்வளவு? — this one, how much?

Then chapter seventy-five lets you check what you heard, or push back on it:

விலை குறைவா? — *vilai kuṟaivā?* — "Is the price low?"

குறைவு is the shortfall word from chapter fifty-six, and the **-ஆ** on the end is the question ending. Two chapters, one sentence you can say across a counter.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

விலை எவ்வளவு? (*vilai evvaḷavu?*) is two native words: *vilai*, "price" (DEDR 5421), and *evvaḷavu*, "how much", the question base *e-* with *aḷavu*, "measure" (DEDR 295).

What you've built

A whole shop exchange: choose one of two, ask the price, question the answer.

Your turn

- *Ask: vilai evvaḷavu?*
- *Ask: idu evvaḷavu?*
- *Push back: vilai kuṟaivā?*
- *Recall:* say *oṉṟu iṅgē, maṟṟadu aṅgē*
- *Read it:* மற்றது
- *Recall:* ask the price
- *Return to:* say *mūḍu* and say *āṉāl* — three distances back
- *Read it:* எப்போது
- *Return to:* set two of them against each other, one and the other

Before you move on

How many words does it take to ask a price in Tamil, and how many verbs? (**Two words, and no verb.**)

Chapter 81

Two Tamils

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (2) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** both lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say why written Tamil and spoken Tamil differ, and move between them.
>
> *Complete TA-C81-which-tamil and say three joining words in both forms.*

81.1 ஆனால் / ஆனா — the two Tamils

Read it: மற்றது

Then ask a shopkeeper the price.

Grammar lens: one language, two forms, and everybody uses both

Something has been happening quietly in the last eight chapters, and it is time it was said plainly.

Tamil comes in two forms. One is written — in books, on signs, in the news. The other is spoken — at home, in a shop, on a bus. They are not an accent apart. Words differ, and endings differ, and a page of one is not a recording of the other.

Every Tamil speaker uses both and knows which is which. Nobody chooses one and abandons the other.

You have already met three pairs, one per chapter:

written	spoken
ஆனால்	ஆனா
ஏனென்றால்	ஏன்னா
என்று	-ன்னு

That is not a coincidence of these particular words. Joining words are where the split shows most, because they are said constantly and worn down fastest — the same reason an English speaker says *cos* far more often than *because*.
It reaches ordinary words too: இன்று, the written *today*, is இன்னிக்கி in speech.

What you've built

The single most important fact about Tamil, and a reason the last eight chapters gave you two forms of everything.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *āṉāl*, then *āṉā*
- *Say it:* *ēṉeṉṟāl*, then *ēṉṉā*
- *Listen:* for the piece that is dropped each time — a closing consonant
- *Read it:* மற்றது
- *Recall:* ask *vilai evvaḷavu?*, then say both forms of *but*
- *Return to:* say *alladu* and *-um pōdu* — two distances back — then say which of the two Tamils each one belongs to

Before you move on

Does a Tamil speaker pick one of the two forms and keep to it? (**No — everyone uses both, in different places.**)

81.2 என்று / -ன்னு — which one you are being taught

Ask a price. Then say *but* twice — the written way, then the spoken way.

Grammar lens: the headword is the written one, on purpose

In every lesson of this book, the big word at the top is the **written** form, and the spoken clip is named beside it in the text. That choice is worth explaining, because it is not obvious.
The written form is the one on the page you will read, the sign you will pass and the form your dictionary will list. It is also understood everywhere Tamil is spoken, which no single spoken variety is.
And it runs one way. From என்று you can predict -ன்னு; from -ன்னு alone you could not have rebuilt என்று. Learn the longer one and the shorter one comes free.

> “சரி” என்று சொல்லுங்கள். — written
>
> “சரி”ன்னு சொல்லுங்கள். — spoken

Same sentence. The quotation does not move, the verb does not move; the joining word shrinks onto the word in front of it.
So: say either. Expect to **hear** the clipped one nearly always, and read the full one nearly always.

What you’ve built

You know which Tamil is in front of you, and you can get from one to the other.

Your turn

- *Say it: “sari” enṟu solluṅgaḷ*
- *Say it: “sari”-ṉṉu solluṅgaḷ*
- *Convert:* take *ēṉeṉṟāl* and say the clip; take *ēṉṉā* and rebuild the full word
- *Read it:* மற்றது
- *Recall:* ask *vilai evvaḷavu?*, then say both forms of the quotation line
- *Return to:* say *mēlē*
- *Read it:* ஆனால்

- *Return to:* say *mar̲r̲adu* — three distances back — then say which of the two Tamils each one belongs to

Before you move on

Why does this book put the written form at the top? (**Because the spoken form follows from it, and not the other way round.**)

Chapter 82

Which One in the Line

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (6) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 6 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say first to fifth in Tamil, and make an ordinal from any number by adding -aavadhu.
>
> *The five said in order, four of them built by the ending and the fifth a word the learner had been saying since chapter 62 without knowing it was one.*

82.1 முதல் (mutal) — first, and you have had it all along

A new kind of number word starts here, so the recalls come first, at the four growing distances this book measures.

- *Recall:* say *enṟu* and then its spoken *-ṉṉu* — **R1**, one lesson back
- *Recall:* say *oṉṟu … maṟṟadu* — **R2**, five lessons back
- *Recall:* offer a choice with *alladu* — **R3**, twenty lessons back
- *Recall:* say *kīḻē* — **R4**, eighty lessons back

You'll want to know: முதல்

முதல் (*mutal*) — "**first**".

You already know this word. Think of முதலில் (*mutalil*), "first of all", which this book already taught as a way of putting one thing before another:

முதல் + இல் → முதலில்

இல் is the ending that means "in" or "at". Take it off and what is left is **முதல்**, first — and it was standing there in your mouth the whole time, carrying the meaning, without ever being named.

முதல் நாள் (*mutal nāḷ*), the first day. **முதல் பாதை** (*mutal pātai*), the first road.

In the family, and next door

	word
Kannada	**ಮೊದಲನೆಯ** (*modalaneya*)
Telugu	**మొదటి** (*modaṭi*)
Malayalam	**ഒന്നാം** (*onnāṁ*)
Hindi (neighbour)	**पहला** (*pahlā*)
English	first

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

முதல் (*mutal*) is native Dravidian: *mutal*, "beginning, first" (DEDR 4950).

Across the family: the word four languages built on

முதல் is one of the oldest words in this family, and its sisters did four different things with it:

language	**what it did with *mutal***	**its word for "first"**
Tamil	kept the meaning outright	**முதல்** *mutal*
Kannada	built an ordinal on it	**ಮೊದಲನೆಯ** *modalaneya*
Telugu	built an ordinal on it	**మొదటి** *modaṭi*
Malayalam	kept the word, changed the sense to "from"	uses **ഒന്നാം** *onnāṁ* instead

None of the four builds "first" on its own word for **one**, and three of them build it on this word. Tamil is where it still simply *means* first.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- *mutalil*, then take the *-il* off and say *mutal*
- *mutal nāḷ* — the first day
- *onṟu* is how many, *mutal* is which one

Before you move on

What word is inside முதலில்? (முதல் — first.) Is it built on ஒன்று? (**No** — and neither is Kannada's or Telugu's.)
Sources: learntamil.com, Ordinal Numbers / Dates; Omniglot, Tamil numbers.

82.2 இரண்டாவது (iraṇḍāvadu) — second

- *Recall:* say *mutal*, and say what word it came out of — **R1**
- *Read it:* மற்றது — **R2**
- *Recall:* say *sol* — **R3**
- *Read it:* மேலே — **R4**

You'll want to know: இரண்டாவது

இரண்டாவது (*iraṇḍāvadu*) — "**second**".

இரண்டு answers *how many*. இரண்டாவது answers *which one in the line*.

இரண்டாவது நாள் (*iraṇḍāvadu nāḷ*), the second day. இரண்டாவது கதவு (*iraṇḍāvadu kadavu*), the second door.

In the family, and next door

	word	same root
Kannada	ಎರಡನೆಯ (*eraḍaneya*)	
Telugu	రెండవ (*reṇḍava*)	yes
Malayalam	രണ്ടാം (*raṇṭāṁ*)	
Hindi (neighbour)	दूसरा (*dūsrā*)	
English	second	

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

இரண்டாவது (*iraṇḍāvadu*) is native: *iraṇṭu*, "two" (DEDR 474), with the ordinal ending *-āvatu*. That ending is usually analysed as *ā*,

"to become" (DEDR 333), with *-atu*, "the one": "the one that became two".

Grammar Lens: one ending, and one word that does not take it

cardinal	ordinal
இரண்டு (*iraṇḍu*)	இரண்டாவது (*iraṇḍāvadu*)

Add **-ஆவது** (*-āvadu*) to a number and you have its ordinal. That is the rule, and it works on every number Tamil has.
There is exactly **one** exception in the whole set, and you met it last lesson: you do not say *oṉṟāvadu* for **first**. Tamil reaches for முதல் instead.
So the one word a learner would have to memorise here is the one word this book did not have to teach you.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- *iraṇḍu*, then *iraṇḍāvadu*
- *mutal*, then *iraṇḍāvadu*
- *iraṇḍāvadu kadavu* — the second door

Before you move on

What do you add to a number to make its ordinal? (**-ஆவது**.)
Which number refuses it? (**One** — that one is முதல்.)
Source: learntamil.com, Ordinal Numbers / Dates.

82.3 முதலாவது (mutalāvadu) — first, taking the ending after all

- *Recall:* say *iraṇḍāvadu*, and say what you added to *iraṇḍu* — **R1**
- *Recall:* ask *vilai evvaḷavu?* — **R2**
- *Recall:* use *eṉṟu* to report what somebody said — **R3**
- *Recall:* say *uḷḷē* — **R4**

You'll want to know: முதலாவது

முதலாவது (*mutalāvadu*) — "**first**", said the long way.

Look at what happened:

முதல் + ஆவது → முதலாவது

The ending is the *same* ending. **முதல்** takes **-ஆவது** exactly as **இரண்டு** did. So the exception is narrower than it looked a lesson ago: *first* does not refuse **-ஆவது** at all. It simply takes it on **முதல்** rather than on **ஒன்று**.

The **stem** is the exception. The **ending** is not.

Both forms are current: **முதல் நாள்** and **முதலாவது நாள்** are both the first day, and **முதல்** is the shorter and commoner of the two in front of a noun.

In the family, and next door

	word
Kannada	**ಮೊದಲನೆಯ** (*modalaneya*)
Telugu	**మొదటి** (*modaṭi*)
Malayalam	**ഒന്നാം** (*onnāṁ*)
Hindi (neighbour)	**पहले** (*pahle*)
English	first, with the ending on it

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

முதலாவது (*mutalāvadu*) is native: *mutal*, "first" (DEDR 4950), with the ordinal ending *-āvatu*, from *ā*, "to become" (DEDR 333).

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- *mutal*, then *mutalāvadu*
- *mutalāvadu, iraṇḍāvadu*
- which part of *mutalāvadu* is the same as in *iraṇḍāvadu*

Before you move on

Which part of முதலாவது is irregular, the stem or the ending? (**The stem** — the ending is the ordinary one.)
Source: learntamil.com, Ordinal Numbers / Dates.

82.4 மூன்றாவது (mūn̲r̲āvadu) — third

- *Recall:* say *mutalāvadu*, and say which part of it is irregular — **R1**
- *Recall:* say *ān̲āl*, then its spoken *ān̲ā* — **R2**
- *Read it:* சொல் — **R3**
- *Recall:* say *veḷiyē* — **R4**

You'll want to know: மூன்றாவது

மூன்றாவது (*mūn̲r̲āvadu*) — "**third**". மூன்று (mūn̲r̲u) takes **-ஆவது**, and nothing else changes.

Three is the number the Dravidian family never quarrelled over — Tamil *mūn̲r̲u*, Malayalam *mūnnŭ*, Kannada *mūru*, Telugu *mūḍu*, all keeping the long **ū** at the front. The ordinal keeps it too, because the ending only touches the end of the word.

மூன்றாவது கதவு (*mūn̲r̲āvadu kadavu*), the third door.

In the family, and next door

	word	same root
Kannada	ಮೂರನೆಯ (*mūraneya*)	yes
Telugu	మూడవ (*mūḍava*)	yes
Malayalam	മൂന്നാം (*mūnnāṁ*)	yes
Hindi (neighbour)	तीसरा (*tīsrā*)	
English	third	

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

மூன்றாவது (*mūn̲r̲āvadu*) is native: *mūn̲r̲u*, "three" (DEDR 5052; Malayalam *mūnnu*), with the ordinal ending *-āvatu*, from *ā*, "to become" (DEDR 333).

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- *mūṉṟu*, then *mūṉṟāvadu*
- the ordinal before this one, then *mūṉṟāvadu*
- *mūṉṟāvadu nāḷ* — the third day

Before you move on

Say the first three in order. (முதல், இரண்டாவது, மூன்றாவது.)
Source: learntamil.com, Ordinal Numbers / Dates.

82.5 நான்காவது (nāṉkāvadu) — fourth

- *Recall:* say *mūṉṟāvadu* — **R1**
- *Recall:* say *eṉṟu* and its spoken *-ṉṉu* — **R2**
- *Recall:* say what you think, with … *eṉṟu niṉaikkiṟēṉ* — **R3**
- *Recall:* say *valadu* — **R4**

You'll want to know: நான்காவது

நான்காவது (*nāṉkāvadu*) — "**fourth**". நான்கு (nāṉku) takes **-ஆவது**, and nothing else changes.

நான்காவது நாற்காலி (*nāṉkāvadu nāṟkāli*), the fourth chair.

In the family, and next door

	word	same root
Kannada	ನಾಲ್ಕನೆಯ (*nālkaneya*)	yes
Telugu	నాలుగవ (*nālugava*)	yes
Malayalam	നാലാം (*nālāṁ*)	
Hindi (neighbour)	चौथा (*cauthā*)	
English	fourth	

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

நான்காவது (*nāṉkāvadu*) is native: *nāṉku*, "four" (DEDR 3655), with the ordinal ending *-āvatu*, from *ā*, "to become" (DEDR 333).

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- *nāṉku*, then *nāṉkāvadu*
- the ordinal before this one, then *nāṉkāvadu*
- *nāṉkāvadu nāḷ* — the fourth day

Before you move on

Say the fourth, then the third. (நான்காவது, மூன்றாவது.)
Source: learntamil.com, Ordinal Numbers / Dates.

82.6 ஐந்தாவது (aindāvadu) — fifth

- *Recall:* say *nāṉkāvadu* — **R1**
- *Recall:* say *mutal*, and say what word it came out of — **R2**
- *Recall:* ask *ēṉ?* — **R3**
- *Recall:* say *iḍadu* — **R4**

You'll want to know: ஐந்தாவது

ஐந்தாவது (*aindāvadu*) — "**fifth**". ஐந்து (aindu) takes **-ஆவது**, and nothing else changes.

That is the first five. Count the work: **four of them were built** from numbers you already count with, and the fifth — முதல் — was a word you had been saying since you learned *mutalil*, without knowing it was a number word.

Nothing in this chapter was a word you had to learn.

இடது பக்கம் முதல் பாதை is now sayable in its useful half: முதல் பாதை, the first road, with இடது for which side of the street.

In the family, and next door

	word	same root
Telugu	ఐదవ (*aidava*)	yes
Hindi (neighbour)	पाँचवाँ (*pā̃cvā̃*)	
English	fifth	

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

ஐந்தாவது (*aindāvadu*) is native: *aintu*, "five" (DEDR 2826), with the ordinal ending -*āvatu*, from *ā*, "to become" (DEDR 333).

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- *aindu*, then *aindāvadu*
- the ordinal before this one, then *aindāvadu*
- *aindāvadu nāḷ* — the fifth day

Before you move on

Say first to fifth. (முதல், இரண்டாவது, மூன்றாவது, நான்காவது, ஐந்தாவது.)
Source: learntamil.com, Ordinal Numbers / Dates.

Chapter 83

All the Way Up, and On a Calendar

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (8) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 8 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say sixth to eleventh in Tamil, make the ordinal of any number I know, and say a date with the ending a calendar uses.
>
> *Eleven ordinals and two endings retrieved out of order, with three ordinals made for numbers no lesson taught and three dates said with the calendar ending.*

83.1 ஆறாவது (ārāvadu) — sixth

- *Recall:* say *aindāvadu* — **R1**
- *Recall:* say *iraṇḍāvadu* — **R2**
- *Recall:* give a reason with *ēṉeṉṟāl* — **R3**

You'll want to know: ஆறாவது

ஆறாவது (*ārāvadu*) — "**sixth**". ஆறு (āṟu) takes **-ஆவது**, and nothing else changes.

Six to ten were a separate lesson from one to five when you learned to count, because the words themselves had to be learned. For ordering they are not a separate anything: the same ending, on the next number.

In the family, and next door

	word	same root
Kannada	ಆರನೆಯ (*āraneya*)	yes
Telugu	ఆరవ (*ārava*)	yes
Malayalam	ആറാം (*ārāṁ*)	yes
Hindi (neighbour)	छठा (*chaṭhā*)	
English	sixth	

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

ஆறாவது (*āṟāvadu*) is native: *āṟu*, "six" (DEDR 2485), with the ordinal ending *-āvatu*, from *ā*, "to become" (DEDR 333).

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- *āṟu*, then *āṟāvadu*
- the ordinal before this one, then *āṟāvadu*
- *āṟāvadu nāḷ* — the sixth day

Before you move on

Did the ending change above five? (**No**.)
Source: learntamil.com, Ordinal Numbers / Dates.

83.2 ஏழாவது (ēḻāvadu) — seventh

- *Recall:* say *āṟāvadu* — **R1**
- *Recall:* say *mutalāvadu* — **R2**
- *Read it:* ஏன் — **R3**
- *Recall:* say *saṭṭai* — **R4**

You'll want to know: ஏழாவது

ஏழாவது (*ēḻāvadu*) — "**seventh**". ஏழு (ēḻu) takes **-ஆவது**, and nothing else changes.

ஏழு carries the curled ள, the sound in the name *Tamiḻ* itself and the one this language shares with Malayalam while Kannada and Telugu hardened it away. Adding the ending does not soften it: ஏழாவது, tongue still curled.

In the family, and next door

	word	same root
Kannada	ಏಳನೆಯ (*ēḷaneya*)	yes
Telugu	ఏడవ (*ēḍava*)	yes
Hindi (neighbour)	सातवाँ (*sātvā̃*)	
English	seventh	

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

ஏழாவது (*ēḻāvadu*) is native: *ēḻu*, "seven" (DEDR 910), with the ordinal ending *-āvatu*, from *ā*, "to become" (DEDR 333).

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- *ēḻu*, then *ēḻāvadu*
- the ordinal before this one, then *ēḻāvadu*
- *ēḻāvadu nāḷ* — the seventh day

Before you move on

What happens to the ழ when the ending goes on? (**Nothing**.)
Source: learntamil.com, Ordinal Numbers / Dates.

83.3 எட்டாவது (eṭṭāvadu) — eighth

- *Recall:* say *ēḻāvadu* — **R1**
- *Recall:* say *mūṉṟāvadu* — **R2**
- *Recall:* say *adaṉāl* — **R3**
- *Recall:* say *vēṭṭi* — **R4**

You'll want to know: எட்டாவது

எட்டாவது (*eṭṭāvadu*) — "**eighth**". **எட்டு** (eṭṭu) takes **-ஆவது**, and nothing else changes.

எட்டு has the doubled retroflex **ṭṭ**. The ending lands after all of it, so the doubling is untouched: **எட்டாவது**.

In the family, and next door

	word	same root
Kannada	ಎಂಟನೆಯ (*eṇṭaneya*)	
Telugu	ఎనిమిదవ (*enimidava*)	
Malayalam	എട്ടാം (*eṭṭāṁ*)	yes
Hindi (neighbour)	आठवाँ (*āṭhvā̃*)	
English	eighth	

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

எட்டாவது (*eṭṭāvadu*) is native: *eṭṭu*, "eight" (DEDR 784), with the ordinal ending *-āvatu*, from *ā*, "to become" (DEDR 333).

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- *eṭṭu*, then *eṭṭāvadu*
- the ordinal before this one, then *eṭṭāvadu*
- *eṭṭāvadu nāḷ* — the eighth day

Before you move on

Did the doubled ட்ட change? (**No**.)
Source: learntamil.com, Ordinal Numbers / Dates.

83.4 ஒன்பதாவது (oṉpadāvadu) — ninth

- *Recall:* say *eṭṭāvadu* — **R1**
- *Recall:* say *nāṉkāvadu* — **R2**
- *Recall:* say why you are doing something with *-kkāga* — **R3**
- *Read it:* சட்டை — **R4**

You'll want to know: ஒன்பதாவது

ஒன்பதாவது (*o̲npadāvadu*) — "**ninth**". **ஒன்பது** (o̲npadu) takes **-ஆவது**, and nothing else changes.

ஒன்பது was already a built word when you learned it: an old **ஒன்**, one, in front of **பது**, ten — usually read as one short of ten. The ordinal ending goes on top of that, and none of the machinery underneath reacts to it.

In the family, and next door

	word
Kannada	ಒಂಬತ್ತನೆಯ (*ombattaneya*)
Telugu	తొమ్మిదవ (*tommidava*)
Malayalam	ഒമ്പതാം (*ompathām*)
Hindi (neighbour)	नौवाँ (*nauvā̃*)
English	ninth

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

ஒன்பதாவது (*o̲npadāvadu*) is native: *o̲npatu*, "nine" (DEDR 1025; Malayalam *ompatu*), with the ordinal ending *-āvatu*, from *ā*, "to become" (DEDR 333).

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- *o̲npadu*, then *o̲npadāvadu*
- the ordinal before this one, then *o̲npadāvadu*
- *o̲npadāvadu nāḷ* — the ninth day

Before you move on

What two numbers are inside **ஒன்பது**? (**One** and **ten** — usually read as one short of ten.)
Source: learntamil.com, Ordinal Numbers / Dates.

83.5 பத்தாவது (pattāvadu) — tenth

- *Recall:* say *o̲npadāvadu* — **R1**

- *Recall:* say *aindāvadu* — **R2**
- *Recall:* ask *eppōdu?* — **R3**
- *Recall:* say *puḍavai* — **R4**

You'll want to know: பத்தாவது

பத்தாவது (*pattāvadu*) — "**tenth**". பத்து (pattu) takes **-ஆவது**, and nothing else changes.

பத்தாவது நாள் (*pattāvadu nāḷ*), the tenth day, and the ten are done.

In the family, and next door

	word	same root
Kannada	ಹತ್ತನೆಯ (*hattaneya*)	yes
Telugu	పదవ (*padava*)	yes
Malayalam	പത്താം (*pathāṁ*)	yes
Hindi (neighbour)	दसवाँ (*dasvā̃*)	
English	tenth	

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

பத்தாவது (*pattāvadu*) is native: *pattu*, "ten" (DEDR 3918), with the ordinal ending *-āvatu*, from *ā*, "to become" (DEDR 333).

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- *pattu*, then *pattāvadu*
- the ordinal before this one, then *pattāvadu*
- *pattāvadu nāḷ* — the tenth day

Before you move on

Count the ordinals from one to ten. How many of them were words you had to learn? (**None** — ten of them were built by one ending on numbers you already count with, and முதல் you already had.) Source: learntamil.com, Ordinal Numbers / Dates.

83.6 பதினொன்றாவது (patiṉoṉṟāvadu) — eleventh, and the edge that is not there

- *Recall:* say *pattāvadu* — **R1**
- *Recall:* say *āṟāvadu* — **R2**
- *Recall:* say *appōdu* — **R3**
- *Recall:* say *seruppu* — **R4**

You'll want to know: பதினொன்றாவது

பதினொன்றாவது (*patiṉoṉṟāvadu*) — "**eleventh**".

பதினொன்று was itself a built word: *patiṉ-*, the joining shape of ten, with *oṉṟu* welded on. Now the ordinal ending goes on top of *that*, and the result is a word of three parts, none of which had to be learned as a whole.

In the family, and next door

	word	same root
Kannada	ಹನ್ನೊಂದನೆಯ (*hannondaneya*)	yes
Malayalam	പതിനൊന്നാം (*patinonnāṁ*)	yes
English	eleventh	

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

பதினொன்றாவது (*patiṉoṉṟāvadu*) is native: *patiṉ-*, the joining form of "ten" (DEDR 3918), *oṉṟu*, "one" (DEDR 990), and the ordinal ending *-āvatu*.

Grammar Lens: the ending is a fact about numbers, not about ten

Most books stop an ordinal chapter at *tenth*, and a learner reasonably concludes that those ten words were the set. In Tamil there is no set. **-ஆவது** attaches to a **number**, so every number you learn from here on arrives with its ordinal already made: இருபது gives இருபதாவது (*irupadāvadu*), twentieth, without a lesson.

That is why this book taught the ending in the second lesson of the previous chapter rather than after ten examples. The examples were never the content.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- *patiṉoṉṟu*, then *patiṉoṉṟāvadu*
- *pattāvadu, patiṉoṉṟāvadu*
- take *irupadu* and make its ordinal yourself

Before you move on

Do you need a lesson for *twentieth*? (**No** — the ending goes on any number.)
Source: learntamil.com, Ordinal Numbers / Dates.

83.7 தேதி (tēdi) — the date, and the ending a calendar uses

- *Recall:* say *patiṉoṉṟāvadu*, and say why *irupadāvadu* needs no lesson — **R1**
- *Recall:* say *ēḻāvadu* — **R2**
- *Read it:* எப்போது — **R3**
- *Recall:* say *toppi* — **R4**

You'll want to know: தேதி

தேதி (*tēdi*) — "**a date**", the day-number on a calendar.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

தேதி (*tēdi*) is a loan from Sanskrit *tithi*, "a lunar day" (CDIAL 5810).

Grammar Lens: a second ending, for one job

Tamil has a **second** ordinal ending, and it is not a free alternative to the first: **-ஆம்** (*-ām*) is what a **date** takes.

said of a place in a line	said of a date
இரண்டாவது *iraṇṭāvadu*	இரண்டாம் தேதி *iraṇṭām tēdi*
மூன்றாவது *mūṉṟāvadu*	மூன்றாம் தேதி *mūṉṟām tēdi*

Same number, same job in the world, two endings — and the calendar keeps the older, shorter one.
You already have the months. சித்திரை இரண்டாம் தேதி (*Chithirai iraṇḍām tēdi*) is the second of Chithirai, and that is a date you can now write down.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- *iraṇḍāvadu*, then *iraṇḍām tēdi*, and say which one is the date
- *Chithirai iraṇḍām tēdi*
- today's day-number with the ending a calendar uses

Before you move on

Which ending does a date take, **-ஆவது** or **-ஆம்**? (**-ஆம்**.) Say "the third of the month". (**மூன்றாம் தேதி**.)
Sources: learntamil.com, Ordinal Numbers / Dates; Omniglot, Tamil numbers.

83.8 The ordinals, at a distance

- *Recall:* say *iraṇḍām tēdi*, and say which ending a date takes — **R1**
- *Recall:* say *eṭṭāvadu* — **R2**
- *Recall:* build a when-clause with *-um pōdu* — **R3**
- *Recall:* say *kaḍai* — **R4**

Your turn

Eleven ordinals, two endings and one word that was never new. Run it four ways.

1. Say first to eleventh straight through, once slowly and once fast.
2. Hear six of them out of order; say each back and say the one above it.

3. Take three numbers you were **not** taught an ordinal for and make theirs.

4. Say three dates with the month names you already have, using the ending a calendar takes rather than the ordinary one.

Then answer aloud: which of the eleven is not built by the ending on its own number, what is it built on instead, and where in this book did you first say it?

Before you move on

Which word for **first** was already inside a word you knew? (முதல், inside முதலில்.) Which ending does a date take? (-ஆம்.) Sources: learntamil.com, Ordinal Numbers / Dates; Omniglot, Tamil numbers.

Chapter 84

Reading — Words, Lines, and a First Passage

Modes: **eyes** (7) **Hands-free start:** none of the 7 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can read a Tamil word as shapes rather than sounds, recognise a question by its last word, and hold a whole passage without translating it word by word.
>
> *Thirty words of Tamil with no new word in them, four of whose lines have no verb at all because Tamil needs no word for is.*

84.1 (reading) — six words, counted in shapes

Every word below you have written. Not one is new.

What is new is that nobody says them first.

Read this

வீடு புத்தகம் தண்ணீர் பால் அம்மா அப்பா

Read it: down the list once, without stopping
Read it: the list again, and this time count the shapes in each word rather than the sounds

What to know first

They do not match. Tamil joins a consonant and its vowel into one shape, so வீடு is four sounds and two shapes.

That is the thing a reader has to stop fighting. You learned these words as sounds and wrote them as shapes, and reading asks you to take the shape whole rather than to unpack it back into sounds.

அம்மா and அப்பா are the clearest pair: same length, same rhythm, one shape different in the middle.

Your turn

- *Say it:* the six words down the list, once, without stopping

Twice through:

Before you move on

How many of the six were new? (**None.**)
Does a Tamil word have as many shapes as sounds? (**No** — fewer.)

84.2 (reading) — six lines, and a question that ends where it asks

The last lesson gave you words. These are things you would say.

You have said every one of them.

Read this

வணக்கம். நன்றி. ஆம். இல்லை. உன் பெயர் என்ன? இங்கே.

Read it: the six lines down once, without stopping
Read it: the six lines again, and notice where the question word sits in the fifth line

What to know first

At the end. **உன் பெயர் என்ன?** — *your name what?* English puts the question word first and Tamil puts it last, so a reader does not know a line is a question until the line is over.

That is worth meeting on a page, where you can look again. In speech the intonation gives it away early; in writing only the final word does.

வணக்கம் is a bowing, from the verb to bend — the same idea as namaste and namaskar, except Tamil kept the noun.

Your turn

- *Say it:* the six lines, once, in order, without stopping

Twice through:

Before you move on

When do you find out a Tamil line is a question? (**At its last word.**)
What is வணக்கம், literally? (**A bowing.**)

84.3 (reading) — the first passage

Six words, then six lines. Now twelve of them together.

Thirty words, and not one of them is new.

Read this

வணக்கம். நான் நல்லா இருக்கிறேன். இது என் வீடு. வீடு பெரிய. நான் புத்தகம் படிக்கிறேன். புத்தகம் நல்ல, ஆனால் பெரிய. அம்மா இங்கே. அப்பா அங்கே. தண்ணீர், பால், தேநீர். இன்று நான் படிக்கிறேன். உன் பெயர் என்ன? நன்றி.

Read it: the passage once without stopping; do not translate as you go — let the sentences arrive
Read it: the passage again, and notice which lines have no verb at all

What to know first

Four of them. வீடு பெரிய. அம்மா இங்கே. Tamil does not need a word for *is*, so a noun and what you are saying about it stand side by side and the sentence is finished.

A reader has to accept that a line can end without anything that looks like a verb. English cannot do it; Tamil does it constantly.

The one joiner here is ஆனால். The lesson that taught it also taught ஆனா, the same word as people say it — this passage sits on the written side of that split, which is where reading lives.

This is the first whole passage the book has asked you to hold at once, and it works because everything in it was paid for.

Your turn

- *Say it:* the passage aloud, once, without stopping

Twice through:

Before you move on

How many words in that passage were new? (**None.**)
What does Tamil not need in அம்மா இங்கே? (**A verb.**)

84.4 (twelve consonants, four confusable sets) — sorted by ear, not by date

Read வ, then க, and name each.

Script: the three that are all n

letter	sound	where the tongue goes
ந	*na*	teeth — the soft one
ண	*ṇa*	curled back, on the roof
ன	*n̲a*	the ridge behind the teeth

They arrived one per chapter, pages apart, and no page has put them side by side. That is the whole reason this set is hard: **Tamil hears three different letters where English hears one sound.** The difference is in where the tongue lands, and the shapes carry no hint of it.

Script: two l-letters and two r-letters

pair	letters
the l-sounds	ல *la*, ordinary · ழ the curled one Tamil is named for
the r-sounds	ர *ra*, a tap · ற *r̲a*, harder and further back

ழ deserves the pause. It is the sound in the language's own name, it has no English equivalent, and a reader who met it once, thirty chapters ago, will not place it cold now.

Script: five that stand alone

No confusable twin, no set to belong to: வ *va* · ப *pa* · ம *ma* · க *ka* · ச *ca*.

Each one carries a built-in *a*, as every bare Tamil consonant does. Reading one aloud means saying two things — the consonant and the vowel inside it.

Your turn

Cover the tables.

- *Read it:* ந, ண, ன — and say where the tongue goes for each
- *Read it:* ல, then ழ — and say which one names the language
- *Read it:* ர, then ற — and say which is the harder one
- *Read it:* வ, ப, ம, க, ச — five in a row, no hesitating
- *Say it:* the vowel hiding inside a bare Tamil consonant

Before you move on

How many n-letters does Tamil write, and which of them curls the tongue back? (**Three;** ண.) Which letter gives the language its name?

84.5 (three vowels, five signs, one dot) — the same vowel, standing or hanging

Read அ. Then look at ◌் and say what it does to the letter it sits on.

Script: standing, or hanging

vowel	on its own	hanging on a consonant
long *ā*	ஆ	◌ா
u	உ	◌ு
short *a*	அ	nothing — it is already inside

That table is the whole system. A Tamil vowel gets a **full-size letter** when nothing comes before it, and a **hanging sign** when a consonant does. Short *a* is the exception that proves it: every bare consonant already contains one, so it needs no sign at all.

Script: the three signs with no standing partner here

◌ி *i* · ◌ே *ē* · ◌ோ *ō* — met one per chapter, and each one replaces the built-in *a* of whatever letter it lands on.

Read them as a set and the shapes stop being arbitrary: ◌ே and ◌ோ share the same upward stroke, because ◌ோ is that stroke with a tail. Learning one buys most of the other.

Script: the dot that removes a vowel

Three consonants were never gathered with the rest: ட *ṭa* · த *ta* · ய *ya*. Each carries its built-in *a*, and ◌் takes it away.

So one mark and one letter give you two readings — த is *ta*, த் is a bare *t*. Everything the signs above do is a swap; this is the only one that subtracts.

Your turn

Cover the tables.

- *Read it:* ஆ and ◌ா — and say what the difference between them is
- *Read it:* உ and ◌ு — the same question
- *Read it:* ◌ி, ◌ே, ◌ோ — name each
- *Read it:* ட, த, ய — and say the vowel inside each
- *Say it:* what ◌் does
- *Write it:* ஸ, the first shape this book ever asked you to copy

Before you move on

When does a Tamil vowel take a full-size letter rather than a hanging sign? (**When no consonant comes before it.**) Which mark subtracts a vowel instead of swapping one?

84.6 (seven words you learned to read before you learned to spell them)

Read சரி, then என். You have said both since the first two chapters.

Read this

word	what it means	what it was really teaching
இல்லை	no, there is not	the **ai** sign, which stands to the LEFT
சரி	fine, all right	ச, one letter for a whole family of sounds
என்	my	a word-initial vowel, reached by a rule you had
பெயர்	name	a second sign that stands to the left of its letter
எப்படி	how	the retroflex ட
இருக்கிறீர்கள்	are you (respectful)	the ◌ீ sign, in a word of eight pieces
தமிழ்	Tamil	ழ, and the name of the language

Every one was a word you could already say. The writing pages never asked you to decode something unfamiliar — they put a known word in front of you and let the shapes attach to a sound you owned.

Script: the signs that sit on the wrong side

Two of the seven carry the same surprise. In இல்லை and in பெயர், a vowel sign is written **before** the consonant it is pronounced after.

That is worth holding because it breaks the habit every reader brings: the order on the page is not the order in the mouth. A Tamil reader takes in the group and then says it.

Script: த and ழ

தமிழ் is two letters worth stopping on. த is the soft dental *t*, the one made against the teeth. ழ is the curled sound with no English partner, and the language wears it in its own name.

Reading the name correctly is the single clearest proof that the script has stopped being decoration.

Your turn

Cover the table and work from the left column only.

- *Read it:* இல்லை, சரி, என் — three in a row
- *Read it:* பெயர், then எப்படி
- *Read it:* இருக்கிறீர்கள் — slowly, group by group
- *Read it:* தமிழ், and name its last letter
- *Say it:* which two of the seven write a vowel sign to the left of its letter

Before you move on

Which letter gives Tamil its name, and which side of its consonant does the **ai** sign sit on? (ழ; the left.) Which of the seven is the longest on the page?

84.7 (உ உள ◌ு ◌ூ — and the two that open o)

Read உணவு, then உளர். Say what the first letter of each is doing differently.

Script: the square the u-family always formed

Four pieces, arriving in four separate chapters, and they were a grid the whole time:

	standing alone	**hanging on a consonant**
short u	உ	◌ு
long ū	உள	◌ூ

உணவு holds both columns of the top row — it opens with the standing உ and closes with the hanging ◌ை, the same vowel wearing two shapes in one word. That word is the argument for the grid, and it is the reason this page exists: no chapter could show the square, because no chapter had all four corners.

Read this

word	means	the piece it brought
உணவு	food	standing உ against hanging ◌ை
ஊர்	town, home place	standing ஊ, the long partner
மூன்று	three	the hanging ◌ென, closing the family
பேசு	speak	the long-e sign ◌ே

Script: o, standing and hanging

ஒன்று ("one") opens with ஒ, the standing short o. போ ("go") carries ◌ோ, the hanging long one — and ◌ொ is the odd shape of the set, because it is built from **two** marks, one placed before its consonant and one after.

So a single vowel can be written on both sides of the letter it belongs to at once. Reading it means taking the whole group in before saying anything.

Your turn

Cover the grid.

- *Say it:* the four corners of the u-square, and which corner each shape is
- *Read it:* உணவு — and point to both u's in it
- *Read it:* ஊர், மூன்று, பேசு
- *Read it:* ஒன்று, then போ
- *Say it:* which sign is built from two marks, and where each mark sits

Before you move on

Which word on this page shows the same vowel standing and hanging at once? (உணவு.) And which sign wraps around its consonant on both sides?

Chapter 85

The People Not Here

Modes: **voice** (3) **eyes** (4) **Hands-free start:** the first of 7 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can talk about somebody who is not in the room, choosing between the familiar and respectful words, and I can say we in the two ways Tamil requires.
>
> *From cold: the four third-person and we-words, the front letter that marks distance, and the question each choice answers.*

85.1 அவன் / அவள் — the pair underneath the respectful word

Say the respectful word for a person who is not here. Say whether it tells you anything about their sex. (It does not.)

Today's two words do.

You'll want to know: அவன் and அவள்

அவன் — *avaṉ* — **he** **அவள்** — *avaḷ* — **she**

These are the plain, familiar words, and **அவர்** was built on top of them: the lesson that taught **இவர்** said so in passing, that it comes from **இவன்** and **இவள்** with the same **-அர்** that makes **நண்பர்** out of **நண்பன்**.

So the ending you met on a word for *friend* is the same ending that turns a familiar *he* into a respectful *that person*. **One suffix, three words, and it does the same job in all of them.**

In the family, and next door

	word	same root
Malayalam	അവൻ (*avan*)	yes
English	he and she, the familiar pair the respectful word was built out of	

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

அவன் / அவள் (*avaṉ / avaḷ*) is native: the far base *a-* (DEDR 1) with *-aṉ* for a man and *-aḷ* for a woman. DEDR 1 lists both, with Malayalam *avan* and *avaḷ*.

Grammar Lens: choosing between them

about	you say
a man, familiarly	அவன்
a woman, familiarly	அவள்
either, respectfully	அவர்

The choice is about the relationship, not about the grammar. அவன் and அவள் go with somebody younger, a close friend, a child — the people you would use the familiar நீ with rather than நீங்கள். Reaching for அவன் about a stranger or an elder lands the way the familiar *you* would.

A learner in doubt is safer with அவர். Being a shade too polite passes without comment; the other direction does not.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- அவன், அவள்
- which of the three words hides the person's sex
- which one you would use about somebody's grandmother
- the ending that அவர் and நண்பர் have in common

Before you move on

Which word is *she*? (அவள்.) Which is *he*? (அவன்.) Which one would you choose if you were unsure of the relationship? (அவர்.)

85.2 அவர்கள் — they, and an ending hiding in a word you already say

Say the polite word for *you*. Look at its last syllable.

You have been carrying a plural ending around since chapter two without being told it was one.

You'll want to know: அவர்கள்

அவர்கள் — *avarkaḷ* — **they**

It is அவர் with **-கள்** on the end, and **-கள்** is Tamil's plural. The same piece is sitting on the end of நீங்கள், which is why that word does double duty as a polite singular *you* and a plain plural *you*.

one	more than one
நீ	நீங்கள்
அவர்	அவர்கள்

The ending you have been pronouncing for eighty chapters turns out to be a word-building piece, and now it builds something for you rather than arriving pre-attached.

In the family, and next door

	word	same root
Malayalam	അവർ (*avar*)	yes
Hindi (neighbour)	वे (*ve*)	
English	they	

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

அவர்கள் (*avarkaḷ*) is native: *avar*, "that person", from the far base *a-* (DEDR 1, which lists *avarkaḷ*), with the plural ending *-kaḷ*.

Grammar Lens: the same double duty

அவர்கள் carries the same ambiguity as நீங்கள். About several people it is plainly *they*; about one person it is a step more respectful still than அவர் — the way some languages use a plural to raise the register.
Context settles which, and context usually settles it easily: a room with three people in it needs no disambiguation.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- அவர்கள்
- the two pieces it is made of
- the word for polite *you*, and point at the same piece inside it
- what அவர்கள் can mean about a single person

Before you move on

What is Tamil's plural ending? (-கள்.) What is அவர்கள் built from? (அவர் plus that ending.) Which other word you already say carries it? (நீங்கள்.)

85.3 நாம் / நாங்கள் — two words for "we", and you have to choose

Say the word for *I*.

Now say *we*. Tamil will ask you a question first, and English never has.

You'll want to know: நாம் and நாங்கள்

நாம் — *nām* — **we**, counting the person you are talking to
நாங்கள் — *nāṅgaḷ* — **we**, not counting them

English has one *we* and hides which it means. Tamil has two and makes you decide every time.

you mean	**you say**
you and me	நாம்
me and them, but not you	நாங்கள்

"Shall we go?" said to a friend is நாம் — the invitation is the point. **"We went yesterday"** said to somebody who stayed behind is நாங்கள், and using நாம் there would tell them they had been present when they were not.

In the family, and next door

	word	**same root**
Malayalam	ഞങ്ങൾ (*ñaṅṅaḷ*)	yes
English	the two words for we	

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

நாம் / நாங்கள் (*nām / nāṅgaḷ*) is native Dravidian. DEDR 3647 lists Malayalam *nām*. The entry lists both *nām*, "we", and *nāṅkaḷ*, "we (not you)".

Grammar Lens: the piece you can already see

நாங்கள் ends in the plural **-கள்** met in the lesson before this one. நாம் does not, and that is a useful shape to hold on to: the shorter word is the one that gathers everybody in.

This distinction has no English equivalent to lean on, so it is worth practising as a question rather than as a pair of words. Before saying *we*, ask whether the person listening is inside it. The answer picks the word for you.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- நாம், நாங்கள்
- which one you would use to invite a friend somewhere
- which one you would use telling a friend about a trip they missed
- which of the two carries the plural ending

Before you move on

Which *we* includes the listener? (நாம்.) Which leaves them out? (நாங்கள்.) What question do you ask yourself before choosing? (Whether the person listening is inside the *we*.)

85.4 (the people not here) — four words, from cold

Close the four lessons before this one. Say the word for *this person*, the one you have had since chapter thirty-seven.

Grammar Lens: the table, filled in

	near	far
respectfully	இவர்	அவர்
he / she	—	அவன் / அவள்
more than one	—	அவர்கள்

The far column was empty and its pattern had been taught. That is the shape of this chapter: the pointing system arrived long ago, correct and complete as a rule, with only half its cells ever handed over.

Grammar Lens: the question behind each choice

before you say	ask yourself
he or she	how close is this person to me
we	is my listener inside it

Both questions are ones English lets a speaker skip. Tamil asks them every time, and neither has a safe default you can lean on forever — though a learner in doubt about the first is better off one shade too polite.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- the four words this chapter taught, from memory

- which front letter all but one of them carry
- which *we* invites the listener along
- the plural ending, and two words you know that carry it

Before you move on

Which word is respectful and hides the person's sex? (அவர்.) Which is *they*? (அவர்கள்.) Which *we* leaves the listener out? (நாங்கள்.)

85.5 (வணக்கம், நன்றி, சரி — and the how-are-you)

Greet someone. Then say the one word that means *fine*, *correct*, and *all right* at the same time.

You'll want to know: two facts about Tamil courtesy

Both of the opening words carry a claim the book made once and never returned to.

வணக்கம் is **native**. Neighbouring languages reached for a Sanskrit borrowing for the same bow; Tamil kept its own word and uses it across every setting, formal to casual. That is unusual enough in the region to be worth knowing.

நன்றி is native too — built on the word for *goodness* — and it comes with a pragmatic warning: among people who are close, saying thanks out loud can sound **marked**, a small distance opening where none was wanted. The word is correct; the question is whether the moment calls for it.

Grammar Lens: answering, and how few words it takes

you mean	you say
yes	ஆம்
no	இல்லை
fine, agreed, got it	சரி

சரி is the one that does the most work, because it answers three different questions — *is that right?*, *will you?*, *understood?* — with one

syllable pair and no change.

The exchange — how are you, both sides

- நீங்கள் எப்படி இருக்கிறீர்கள்? — how are you, respectfully
- நலம் — the answer, and the whole reply is *nāṉ nalamāga irukkiṟēṉ*
- எப்படி on its own — *how*, the question word inside it
- பரவாயில்லை — *no problem*, and also the Tamil for *you're welcome*

That last one is the pair worth holding: English keeps *no problem* and *you're welcome* apart, and Tamil hands you one phrase for both.

Your turn

Page covered, both sides out loud.

Say these aloud:

- the greeting, and say whether it is native or borrowed
- yes, no, and the agreeing word
- the whole how-are-you question, respectfully
- the answer, in full
- what you reply when somebody thanks you
- when saying thanks out loud might land badly

Before you move on

Which single Tamil phrase covers both *no problem* and *you're welcome*? (பரவாயில்லை.) And what is the risk of thanking a close friend out loud?

85.6 (உங்கள் பெயர் என்ன?) — four words, and the one that is missing

Say the word for *my*. Then the word for *what*.

Grammar Lens: the sentence with no verb in it

என் பெயர் ... is *my name …*, and there the sentence stops. No word stands where English puts **is**.
That is not an abbreviation or a casual drop. Tamil **does not need a verb to link two things**: put the two nouns side by side and the link is understood. The same silence sits inside the question — **உங்கள் பெயர் என்ன?** is *your name what?*, three words doing what English needs four to do.
Once you have seen it here, you have seen it everywhere it happens.

The exchange — both sides, end to end

move	what you say
ask	உங்கள் பெயர் என்ன?
answer	என் பெயர் ...
close it warmly	மகிழ்ச்சி

மகிழ்ச்சி is worth its own moment: the word is *joy*, and nothing more. It is not a built phrase meaning *pleased to meet you* — it is one noun, offered, and the occasion supplies the rest.

Your turn

Cover the table. Take both parts.

Say these aloud:

- the question, respectfully
- your own answer, with your name in it
- the warm word that closes a first meeting
- what **மகிழ்ச்சி** means on its own
- where English would put a word that Tamil leaves out

Before you move on

How many words does Tamil need for *what is your name?*, and which English word has no Tamil counterpart in it? (**Three; is**.)

85.7 (போய் வருகிறேன் — and the first four verbs)

Say the verb for *go*. Then the verb for *speak*.

Why it's said this way

போய் வருகிறேன் is what a Tamil speaker says on leaving, and it does not mean *goodbye*. It means **I will go and come back**.

what you say	what it literally says
போய் வருகிறேன்	I will go and come back
மீண்டும் சந்திப்போம்	we will meet once more
நாளை பார்க்கலாம்	tomorrow, let us see

Read the right-hand column down and the pattern is unmistakable: **not one of the three names the parting**. Each one names the next meeting instead. A language can decline to have a word for goodbye, and this one does.

Grammar Lens: four verbs, two shapes

போ *go* · பேசு *speak* · வாழ் *live, flourish* — three plain stems. Then வேலை செய், which is not one word but two: *work* plus *do*. That second shape is worth naming, because Tamil uses it constantly. A noun parked in front of செய் makes a verb out of it, which is how the language keeps borrowing things to do without borrowing verbs to do them with.

And நான் தமிழ் பேசுகிறேன் shows what the stem does under pressure: பேசு takes a tense piece and then a person piece, in that order, and the speaker is named at both ends of the sentence.

Your turn

Cover both tables.

Say these aloud:

- all three farewells, and what each one literally promises
- the four verbs
- which of the four is built from a noun plus a doing-word

- *I speak Tamil*, whole
- the two pieces that attach to a stem, in order

Before you move on

What does the everyday Tamil leave-taking literally say? (**I will go and come back**.) And which verb on this page is two words wearing one job?

Chapter 86

The One It Is Done To

Modes: **voice** (3) **eyes** (3) **Hands-free start:** the first of 6 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can mark the object of a verb with -ai, say me and you as objects, and tell when the ending is compulsory and when it is a choice that means 'the'.
>
> *From cold: the accusative ending and which end of the word it sits on, the two pronoun objects and the changed bodies they stand on, and the one question — is the object a person — that decides whether the ending may be left off.*

86.1 -ஐ — your second case ending

> Your first case ending was **-உக்கு**, and what it taught was bigger than its meaning: English puts a word in front, Tamil sticks a piece on the back.
>
> Here is the second piece, and it goes on the same end.

You'll want to know: -ஐ

> **-ஐ** — *-ai* — **marks the one the verb is done to**

A sentence can have two people in it, and something has to say which of them is doing and which is being done to. **English uses position**: *the teacher saw the child* and *the child saw the teacher* are built from the same three words and mean opposite things, and the only signal is the order.

Tamil marks the one being done to, and then the order stops carrying the weight:

நான் அவரை நினைக்கிறேன்

nāṉ ***avarai*** *ninaikkiṟēṉ* — “I think of them”

அவர் became அவரை. Nothing else moved. The verb you already know from the thinking chapter did not change, and *nāṉ* is still optional because the *-ēṉ* on the end is already saying “I”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

-ஐ (*-ai*) is the native Dravidian accusative ending. It is a suffix, not a word, so the etymological dictionary gives it no entry of its own; Malayalam marks the same case with *-e*.

Grammar Lens: where the two endings sit

the word	+ ending	what it says
அவர்	அவர்உக்கு → அவருக்கு	to them, for them
அவர்	அவர்ஐ → அவரை	them, as the one it is done to

Two endings, one place to put them, and the noun underneath is the same word both times. **A case ending in Tamil is a seam you can see**, which is the thing the dative chapter said was the biggest structural fact about the language — and this is the second piece of evidence for it rather than a new idea.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- “avar … avarai”
- “nāṉ avarai ninaikkiṟēṉ”
- which word in that sentence is the one being thought of, and how you can tell
- “avarukku” and “avarai” one after the other, and what each of them does

Before you move on

What does **-ஐ** mark? (**The one the verb is done to**.) Where does it go? (**On the end of the word**, like every Tamil case ending.) What is *avar* as the one it is done to? (***Avarai***.) And what does English use instead of an ending here? (**Position** — which word comes first.)

86.2 என்னை / உன்னை — the body you already changed once

Say "to me". Then say the word for "I" on its own.

They do not look like each other, and the dative chapter told you why: the pronoun changes its body before an ending lands on it.

You'll want to know: என்னை and உன்னை

என்னை — *eṉṉai* — **me**, as the one it is done to **உன்னை** — *uṉṉai* — **you**, as the one it is done to

These cost you nothing new. You changed *nāṉ* into *eṉ-* to build *enakku* chapters ago. That changed body is the same one **-ஐ** lands on:

the word	to / for	the one it is done to
நான் *nāṉ* — I	எனக்கு *enakku*	என்னை *eṉṉai*
நீ *nī* — you	உனக்கு *unakku*	உன்னை *uṉṉai*

Read down the middle column and then down the right one. **The left part of each word never changes once you have it.** Learning the body is the work; the endings are the cheap part, and there are only so many of them.

என்னை நினை

eṉṉai ninai — "think of me"

A bare verb stem is already a command — you met that with *pō!* in the farewell chapter — so this is a whole sentence with no machinery you have not used.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

என்னை / உன்னை (*en̲n̲ai / un̲n̲ai*) are the native pronouns with the accusative *-ai*: *en̲-*, the joining form of "I" (DEDR 5160), and *un̲-*, the joining form of "you" (DEDR 3684).

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "enakku … en̲n̲ai"
- "unakku … un̲n̲ai"
- the part of those four words that never changes
- "en̲n̲ai ninai" — think of me

Before you move on

What is *me*, as the one it is done to? (***En̲n̲ai***.) And *to me*? (***Enakku***.) What do those two have in common? (**The changed body *en̲-***.) Which of the two endings would you put on it to say "for you"? (**-உக்கு**, on *un̲-*.)

86.3 தேநீர் / தேநீரை — when the ending is a choice

Say "I think of them". Say which piece of that sentence marks the one being thought of.

Now the part nobody tells you: that piece is not always required.

Grammar Lens: a person must have it, a thing need not

அவரை நினைக்கிறேன் — I think of **them**

தேநீர் வாங்குகிறேன் — I buy tea

தேநீரை வாங்குகிறேன் — I buy **the** tea

On a person the ending is obligatory. Leaving it off does not make a casual sentence; it makes a broken one.

On a thing it is a choice, and the choice carries meaning. Bare தேநீர் is tea in general, the kind of thing you buy. தேநீரை is *that* tea, a particular one already in view. Tamil has no word for *the*, and this is one of the places the job gets done instead.

the object is	**the ending**
a person	required
a thing, in general	usually left off
a thing, a particular one	put on

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

தேநீர் / தேநீரை (*tēnīr / tēnīrai*) is *tēnīr*, "tea", with the accusative *-ai*. *Tēnīr* is the travelling word *tē*, "tea", and native *nīr*, "water" (DEDR 3690; it compares Sanskrit *nīra*).

Across the family: the same line, drawn at the other end

Spanish draws this line too, and a Spanish learner has met it: *veo la casa* ("I see the house") against *veo* ***a*** *María* ("I see María"). A human object gets a marker; a thing does not.
Spanish puts that marker in front of the word as a separate piece. Tamil sticks it on the back. Same distinction between a person and a thing, opposite end of the word — which is the difference the dative chapter opened with, now showing up in a second place.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "avarai ninaikkiṟēṉ"
- "tēnīr vāṅgugiṟēṉ" and then "tēnīrai vāṅgugiṟēṉ"
- which of those two is about a particular tea
- which of the three objects could not drop the ending, and why

Before you move on

When is **-ஐ** obligatory? (**When the object is a person**.) What does putting it on a thing add? (**That it is a particular one** — Tamil has no word for *the*.) And where does Spanish put its marker for a human object? (**In front**, as a separate word, where Tamil puts it on the back.)

86.4 (the one it is done to) — from cold

Close the lessons before this one. Say the ending that marks the one a verb is done to, and say which end of the word it goes on.

Grammar Lens: one ending, one question

the object	with the ending	required?
அவர் — that person	அவரை	yes
நான் — I	என்னை	yes
நீ — you	உன்னை	yes
தேநீர் — tea	தேநீரை	only for a particular one

Three of the four rows are people, and people have no choice. The question to ask of an object is not *is this the subject or the object* — the ending answers that — but **is this a person**.

Two things carry over from earlier chapters rather than being new here. The pronouns stand on the changed bodies **en̲-** and **un̲-** that the dative built. And the ending sits on the back of the word, which is what your first case ending taught and what separates this language from the one that would put a word in front.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- the four objects in the table, each with its ending
- “avarai ninaikkir̲ēn̲” and “en̲n̲ai ninai”
- which row of the table lets you choose, and what choosing adds

- the two words that share the body en-

Before you move on

What is *them*, as the one it is done to? (***Avarai***.) What is *me*? (***Eṉṉai***.) When may the ending be left off? (**On a thing, when it is not a particular one**.) And what has to be true before it is compulsory? (**The object is a person**.)

86.5 (இவர், விடை, and the two we-words) — one idea in four places

Introduce the person standing beside you as your friend.

Grammar Lens: the two words for we

word	who it covers
நாம்	me, and **you too**
நாங்கள்	me and my people, **but not you**

English has one *we* and leaves the listener guessing. Tamil makes you choose before you open your mouth, and the choice is audible to everyone in the room.
Getting it wrong is not a grammar slip — it either includes somebody you meant to exclude or shuts out somebody standing right there.

You'll want to know: இவர், and the ending that judges

இவர் என் நண்பர் — *this is my friend* — is three words with no verb in the middle, the same silence the name sentence had.

What it adds is a **choice of ending**. நண்பர் carries respect; a plainer ending would not. Introducing someone in Tamil therefore states your regard for them out loud, in front of them, whether or not you meant to say anything about it.

You'll want to know: விடை

விடை is *leave to depart* — a noun for the act of taking your leave, sharing a root with வீடு, the house.

Set it beside the farewells: the everyday one promises a return, and this word names the departure itself. Tamil has both, and it reserves the naming one for the heavier moment.

Your turn

Page covered.

Say these aloud:

- which we-word takes the listener in
- which one shuts them out
- *this is my friend*, respectfully
- what the ending on that last word tells the listener
- the noun for taking your leave, and the house-word it is related to

Before you move on

You are talking to a colleague about a plan the two of you share — which we-word do you reach for? (நாம்.) And which noun names the act of leaving rather than promising a return?

86.6 (the fifteen that came once) — the last page

Read �உ, then ய.

What you've built, and what this page does with it

Everything here has come round twice in your reading: once where it was taught, once on a retrieval page in this last stretch. A second pass is where memory starts holding without the book, and the widest gap on offer runs from the opening pages to this one.

Script: three pieces, one of them yours to draw

உ standing · ◌ி hanging · ய a consonant · ஒ standing o · ◌ொ the sign built from two marks.

Read these aloud:

- உ, and say whether it is a letter or a sign
- ி, and say what it replaces
- ஓ and ோ — the same vowel standing, then hanging

Read this

சரி · பெயர் · இருக்கிறீர்கள் · போ · ஒன்று
No glosses this time. Read each one and say what it means before moving on. The long one in the middle is the test: eight pieces, and you have met every piece.

The exchange — five of them, unprompted

The book opened with five, and an examiner opens with the same ones:

1. greet, and answer a thank-you
2. trade names, both sides, closing warmly
3. ask after the person, and reply in full
4. take your leave, promising the next meeting
5. say what you speak, and what you do

Your turn

Page covered.

- *Say it:* exchange 2 above, both sides
- *Say it:* exchange 3 above, both sides
- *Say it:* exchange 1, then exchange 4, back to back
- *Say it:* exchange 5, about yourself
- *Write it:* சரி

Before you move on

Which sign on this page wraps around its consonant on both sides? (𑄢𑄧𑄇.) And which of the five exchanges would you want one more run at before somebody asks for it cold?

Chapter 87

Not Feeling Well

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say I am tired or weary, have a cold or a cough, and tell someone to rest.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 87: I can say I am tired or weary, have a cold or a cough, and tell someone to rest.*

87.1 களைப்பு (kaḷaippu) — tiredness

> Before the new one: say the Tamil for hunger, then the Tamil for sleep.

You'll want to know: களைப்பு

களைப்பு (*kaḷaippu*) — "tiredness".

எனக்குக் களைப்பாக இருக்கிறது — "I feel tired", literally "to me it is tired-ly". The person sits in எனக்கு, "to me".

In the family, and next door

	word
Kannada	ಆಯಾಸ (*āyāsa*)
Telugu	అలసట (*alasaṭa*)
Malayalam	ക്ഷീണം (*kṣīṇaṁ*)
Hindi (neighbour)	थकान (*thakān*)
English	tiredness

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

களைப்பு (*kaḷaippu*) is the noun of *kaḷai*, "to be weary". It looks native, but DEDR has no entry for this verb (its *kaḷai* means "to weed"), so the origin is uncertain.

What you've built

A first word for how the body feels.

Your turn

- *Say it: kaḷaippu*
- *Say it: kaḷaippu*, once more
- *Say it:* say *eṉakkuk kaḷaippāka irukkiṟatu*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for hunger, then the Tamil for sleep, then say *kaḷaippu* again

Before you move on

What does களைப்பு mean? ("Tiredness".) Say it once more.

87.2 சளி (caḷi) — a cold, a runny nose

Before the new one: say the Tamil for sleep, then the Tamil for tiredness.

You'll want to know: சளி

சளி (*caḷi*) — "a cold", the kind with a runny nose.

எனக்குச் சளி பிடித்திருக்கிறது — "I have caught a cold", literally "a cold has caught me".

In the family, and next door

	word
Kannada	ಶೀತ (*śīta*)
Malayalam	ജലദോഷം (*jaladōṣaṁ*)
Hindi (neighbour)	ज़ुकाम (*zukām*)
English	a cold, a runny nose

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

சளி (*caḷi*) is native Dravidian. DEDR 2409 lists Malayalam *caḷi*, "mucus".

What you've built

An illness that catches you.

Your turn

- *Say it: caḷi*
- *Say it: caḷi*, once more
- *Say it:* say *eṉakkuc caḷi piṭittirukkiṟatu*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for sleep, then the Tamil for tiredness, then say *caḷi* again

Before you move on

What does சளி mean? ("A cold, a runny nose".) Say it once more.

87.3 இருமல் (irumal) — a cough

Before the new one: say the Tamil for tiredness, then the Tamil for a cold.

You'll want to know: இருமல்

இருமல் (*irumal*) — "a cough".

இருமல் இருக்கிறது — "there is a cough", the plain way to tell a doctor.

In the family, and next door

	word
Kannada	ಕೆಮ್ಮು (*kemmu*)
Telugu	దగ్గు (*daggu*)
Malayalam	ചുമ (*cuma*)
Hindi (neighbour)	खाँसी (*khā̃sī*)
English	a cough

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

இருமல் (*irumal*) is native Dravidian. DEDR 489 lists Malayalam *irumal*, "a cough". The entry also lists the verb *irumu*, "to cough".

What you've built

A second complaint.

Your turn

- *Say it: irumal*
- *Say it: irumal*, once more
- *Say it:* say *irumal irukkiṟatu*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for tiredness, then the Tamil for a cold, then say *irumal* again

Before you move on

What does இருமல் mean? ("A cough".) Say it once more.

87.4 சோர்வு (cōrvu) — weariness, fatigue

Before the new one: say the Tamil for a cold, then the Tamil for a cough.

You'll want to know: சோர்வு

சோர்வு (*cōrvu*) — "weariness", the drained feeling after an illness.

களைப்பு is the tiredness of a long day; சோர்வு lasts longer. சோர்வாக இருக்கிறது — "I feel worn out".

In the family, and next door

	word
Kannada	ಸುಸ್ತು (*sustu*)
English	weariness, fatigue

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

சோர்வு (*cōrvu*) is native Dravidian (DEDR 2884). It is the noun of *cōr*, "to grow slack, to droop".

What you've built

Two kinds of tired.

Your turn

- *Say it: cōrvu*
- *Say it: cōrvu*, once more
- *Say it:* say *cōrvāka irukkiṟatu*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for a cold, then the Tamil for a cough, then say *cōrvu* again

Before you move on

What does சோர்வு mean? ("Weariness, fatigue".) Say it once more.

87.5 ஓய்வு (ōyvu) — rest

Before the new one: say the Tamil for a cough, then the Tamil for weariness.

You'll want to know: ஓய்வு

ஓய்வு (*ōyvu*) — "rest".

ஓய்வு எடுங்கள் — "please take some rest", what you say to someone who is unwell.

In the family, and next door

	word
Kannada	ವಿಶ್ರಾಂತಿ (*viśrānti*)
Telugu	విశ్రాంతి (*viśrānti*)
Malayalam	വിശ്രമം (*viśramaṁ*)
Hindi (neighbour)	आराम (*ārām*)
English	rest

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

ஓய்வு (*ōyvu*) is native Dravidian (DEDR 1057). It is the noun of *ōy*, "to cease, to grow tired, to rest".

What you've built

Tired, a cold, a cough, weary, and rest.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *ōyvu*
- *Say it:* *ōyvu*, once more
- *Say it:* say *ōyvu eṭuṅkaḷ*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for a cough, then the Tamil for weariness, then say *ōyvu* again

Before you move on

What does ஓய்வு mean? ("Rest".) Say it once more.

Chapter 88

At the Hospital

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can ask for the hospital, say I feel sick or have a headache, and talk about health and sweat.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 88: I can ask for the hospital, say I feel sick or have a headache, and talk about health and sweat.*

88.1 மருத்துவமனை (maruttuvamaṉai) — a hospital

Before the new one: say the Tamil for weariness, then the Tamil for rest.

You'll want to know: மருத்துவமனை

மருத்துவமனை (*maruttuvamaṉai*) — "a hospital", literally "medicine-house".

மனை is "a house, a dwelling". **மருத்துவமனை எங்கே?** — "where is the hospital?".

In the family, and next door

	word
Kannada	ಆಸ್ಪತ್ರೆ (*āspatre*)
Telugu	ఆసుపత్రి (*āsupatri*)
Malayalam	ആശുപത്രി (*āśupatri*)
Hindi (neighbour)	अस्पताल (*aspatāl*)
English	a hospital

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

மருத்துவமனை (*maruttuvamaṉai*) is native: *maruttuvam*, "medicine" (DEDR 4719), and *maṉai*, "house" (DEDR 4776). A hospital is "the house of medicine".

What you've built

A place to ask the way to.

Your turn

- *Say it: maruttuvamaṉai*
- *Say it: maruttuvamaṉai*, once more
- *Say it:* ask *maruttuvamaṉai eṅkē?*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for weariness, then the Tamil for rest, then say *maruttuvamaṉai* again

Before you move on

What does மருத்துவமனை mean? ("A hospital".) Say it once more.

88.2 வாந்தி (vānti) — vomiting, nausea

Before the new one: say the Tamil for rest, then the Tamil for a hospital.

You'll want to know: வாந்தி

வாந்தி (*vānti*) — "vomiting".

வாந்தி வருகிறது — "I feel sick", literally "vomiting is coming".

In the family, and next door

	word	same root
Kannada	ವಾಂತಿ (*vānti*)	yes
Malayalam	ഛർദ്ദി (*chardi*)	
English	vomiting, nausea	

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

வாந்தி (*vānti*) is a loan from Sanskrit *vānti*, "vomiting" (CDIAL 11518).

What you've built

A symptom a doctor will ask about.

Your turn

- *Say it: vānti*
- *Say it: vānti*, once more
- *Say it:* say *vānti varukiṟatu*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for rest, then the Tamil for a hospital, then say *vānti* again

Before you move on

What does வாந்தி mean? ("Vomiting, nausea".) Say it once more.

88.3 தலைவலி (talaivali) — a headache

Before the new one: say the Tamil for a hospital, then the Tamil for vomiting.

You'll want to know: தலைவலி

தலைவலி (*talaivali*) — "a headache".

It is தலை, "head", and வலி, "pain", written as one word. எனக்குத் தலைவலி — "I have a headache".

In the family, and next door

	word
Kannada	ತಲೆನೋವು (*talenōvu*)
Malayalam	തലവേദന (*talavēdana*)
Hindi (neighbour)	सिरदर्द (*sirdard*)
English	a headache

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

தலைவலி (*talaivali*) is native: *talai*, "head" (DEDR 3103), and *vali*, "pain" (DEDR 5281).

What you've built

Head and pain, joined.

Your turn

- *Say it: talaivali*
- *Say it: talaivali*, once more
- *Say it:* say *eṉakkut talaivali*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for a hospital, then the Tamil for vomiting, then say *talaivali* again

Before you move on

What does தலைவலி mean? ("A headache".) Say it once more.

88.4 உடல்நலம் (uṭalnalam) — health

Before the new one: say the Tamil for vomiting, then the Tamil for a headache.

You'll want to know: உடல்நலம்

உடல்நலம் (*uṭalnalam*) — "health", literally "body-wellbeing".
நலம் is the wellbeing of your first greetings; உடல் is "the body".

In the family, and next door

	word
Kannada	ಆರೋಗ್ಯ (*ārōgya*)
Telugu	ఆరోగ్యం (*ārōgyaṁ*)
Hindi (neighbour)	सेहत (*sehat*)
English	health

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

உடல்நலம் (*uṭalnalam*) is native: *uṭal*, "body" (DEDR 586), and *nalam*, "wellness" (DEDR 3610).

What you've built

Health, built from a word you already use.

Your turn

- *Say it: uṭalnalam*
- *Say it: uṭalnalam*, once more
- *Say it:* say *uṭalnalam*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for vomiting, then the Tamil for a headache, then say *uṭalnalam* again

Before you move on

What does உடல்நலம் mean? ("Health".) Say it once more.

88.5 வியர்வை (viyarvai) — sweat

Before the new one: say the Tamil for a headache, then the Tamil for health.

You'll want to know: வியர்வை

வியர்வை (*viyarvai*) — "sweat".

வியர்வை வருகிறது — "I am sweating", literally "sweat is coming", like வாந்தி.

In the family, and next door

	word	same root
Kannada	ಬೆವರು (*bevaru*)	yes
Malayalam	വിയർപ്പ് (*viyarppŭ*)	yes
Hindi (neighbour)	पसीना (*pasīnā*)	
English	sweat	

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

வியர்வை (*viyarvai*) is native Dravidian. DEDR 5486 lists Malayalam *viyarppu* and Kannada *bemaru*.

What you've built

A hospital, feeling sick, a headache, health, and sweat.

Your turn

- *Say it: viyarvai*
- *Say it: viyarvai*, once more
- *Say it:* say *viyarvai varukiṟatu*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for a headache, then the Tamil for health, then say *viyarvai* again

Before you move on

What does வியர்வை mean? ("Sweat".) Say it once more.

Chapter 89

Sad, Worried, Calm

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say I am sad, worried, nervous or shivering, and ask someone to stay calm.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 89: I can say I am sad, worried, nervous or shivering, and ask someone to stay calm.*

89.1 சோகம் (cōkam) — sadness, grief

> Before the new one: say the Tamil for health, then the Tamil for sweat.

You'll want to know: சோகம்

சோகம் (*cōkam*) — "sadness, grief".

சோகமாக இருக்கிறேன் — "I am sad". The **-ஆக** ending turns a feeling into how you are.

In the family, and next door

	word
Kannada	ದುಃಖ (*duḥkha*)
Malayalam	സങ്കടം (*saṅkaṭaṁ*)
English	sadness, grief

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

சோகம் (*cōkam*) is a loan from Sanskrit *śoka*, "heat, pain, sorrow" (CDIAL 12619).

What you've built

The first feeling.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *cōkam*
- *Say it:* *cōkam*, once more
- *Say it:* say *cōkamāka irukkiṟēṉ*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for health, then the Tamil for sweat, then say *cōkam* again

Before you move on

What does சோகம் mean? ("Sadness, grief".) Say it once more.

89.2 கவலை (kavalai) — worry, anxiety

Before the new one: say the Tamil for sweat, then the Tamil for sadness.

You'll want to know: கவலை

கவலை (*kavalai*) — "worry".

கவலை வேண்டாம் — "no need to worry", literally "worry is not wanted".

In the family, and next door

	word
Kannada	ಚಿಂತೆ (*cinte*)
Malayalam	ആശങ്ക (*āśaṅka*)
Hindi (neighbour)	चिंता (*cintā*)
English	worry, anxiety

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

கவலை (*kavalai*) is native Dravidian (DEDR 1328). The entry glosses *kavalai* "care, anxiety, distress".

What you've built

A worry, and a way to wave it off.

Your turn

- *Say it: kavalai*
- *Say it: kavalai*, once more
- *Say it:* say *kavalai vēṇṭām*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for sweat, then the Tamil for sadness, then say *kavalai* again

Before you move on

What does கவலை mean? ("Worry, anxiety".) Say it once more.

89.3 பதற்றம் (pata̲r̲ram) — nervousness, tension

Before the new one: say the Tamil for sadness, then the Tamil for worry.

You'll want to know: பதற்றம்

பதற்றம் (*pata̲r̲ram*) — "nervousness, tension, a flutter".
பதற்றமாக இருக்கிறது — "I feel nervous".

In the family, and next door

	word
Hindi (neighbour)	घबराहट (*ghabrāhaṭ*)
English	nervousness, tension

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

பதற்றம் (*patarram*) is native Dravidian (DEDR 3910). It is the noun of *pataru*, "to be flurried, to hurry".

What you've built

The opposite of calm.

Your turn

- *Say it: patarram*
- *Say it: patarram*, once more
- *Say it:* say *patarramāka irukkiratu*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for sadness, then the Tamil for worry, then say *patarram* again

Before you move on

What does பதற்றம் mean? ("Nervousness, tension".) Say it once more.

89.4 அமைதி (amaiti) — calm, peace, quiet

Before the new one: say the Tamil for worry, then the Tamil for nervousness.

You'll want to know: அமைதி

அமைதி (*amaiti*) — "calm, peace", and "quiet".

அமைதியாக இருங்கள் — "please stay calm", or in a library, "please be quiet".

In the family, and next door

	word
Malayalam	ശാന്തമായ (*śāntamāya*)
Hindi (neighbour)	शांत (*śānt*)
English	calm, peace, quiet

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

அமைதி (*amaiti*) is native Dravidian (DEDR 161). The entry lists *amaiti*, "calmness", with *amar*, "to become tranquil, to rest".

What you've built

Calm, and a polite request for it.

Your turn

- *Say it: amaiti*
- *Say it: amaiti*, once more
- *Say it:* say *amaitiyāka iruṅkaḷ*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for worry, then the Tamil for nervousness, then say *amaiti* again

Before you move on

What does அமைதி mean? ("Calm, peace, quiet".) Say it once more.

89.5 நடுக்கம் (naṭukkam) — shivering, trembling

Before the new one: say the Tamil for nervousness, then the Tamil for calm.

You'll want to know: நடுக்கம்

நடுக்கம் (*naṭukkam*) — "shivering, trembling", from cold, fever or fear.
குளிரில் நடுக்கம் — "shivering in the cold".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

நடுக்கம் (*naṭukkam*) is native Dravidian (DEDR 3585). It is the noun of *naṭuṅku*, "to shake, to tremble".

What you've built

Sad, worried, nervous, calm, shivering.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *naṭukkam*
- *Say it:* *naṭukkam*, once more
- *Say it:* say *naṭukkam*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for nervousness, then the Tamil for calm, then say *naṭukkam* again

Before you move on

What does நடுக்கம் mean? ("Shivering, trembling".) Say it once more.

Chapter 90

Laughter and Tears

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can talk about laughter, crying and tears, say I am alone, and say I am hungry.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 90: I can talk about laughter, crying and tears, say I am alone, and say I am hungry.*

90.1 சிரிப்பு (sirippu) — laughter

> Before the new one: say the Tamil for calm, then the Tamil for shivering.

You'll want to know: சிரிப்பு

சிரிப்பு (*sirippu*) — "laughter", and "a smile".

சிரிப்பு வருகிறது — "I feel like laughing", literally "laughter is coming".

In the family, and next door

	word
Kannada	ನಗು (*nagu*)
Malayalam	ചിരി (*ciri*)
Hindi (neighbour)	हँसी (*hãsī*)
English	laughter

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

சிரிப்பு (*sirippu*) is native Dravidian. DEDR 1562 lists Malayalam *ciri*, "laughter".

What you've built

Laughter, which comes to you.

Your turn

- *Say it: sirippu*
- *Say it: sirippu*, once more
- *Say it:* say *sirippu varukiṟatu*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for calm, then the Tamil for shivering, then say *sirippu* again

Before you move on

What does சிரிப்பு mean? ("Laughter".) Say it once more.

90.2 அழுகை (aḻukai) — crying

Before the new one: say the Tamil for shivering, then the Tamil for laughter.

You'll want to know: அழுகை

அழுகை (*aḻukai*) — "crying".

அழுகை வருகிறது — "I feel like crying", on the same frame as laughter.

In the family, and next door

	word
Telugu	ఏడుపు (*ēḍupu*)
English	crying

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

அழுகை (*aḻukai*) is native Dravidian (DEDR 282). It is the noun of *aḻu*, "to cry".

What you've built

Crying, in the same frame.

Your turn

- *Say it: aḻukai*
- *Say it: aḻukai*, once more
- *Say it:* say *aḻukai varukiṟatu*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for shivering, then the Tamil for laughter, then say *aḻukai* again

Before you move on

What does அழுகை mean? ("Crying".) Say it once more.

90.3 கண்ணீர் (kaṇṇīr) — tears

Before the new one: say the Tamil for laughter, then the Tamil for crying.

You'll want to know: கண்ணீர்

கண்ணீர் (*kaṇṇīr*) — "tears", literally "eye-water".
It is கண், "eye", and நீர், "water".

In the family, and next door

	word	same root
Kannada	ಕಣ್ಣೀರು (*kaṇṇīru*)	yes
Telugu	కంటినీరు (*kaṇṭinīru*)	yes
Hindi (neighbour)	आँसू (*ām̃sū*)	
English	tears	

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

கண்ணீர் (*kaṇṇīr*) is native: *kaṇ*, "eye" (DEDR 1159), and *nīr*, "water" (DEDR 3690). DEDR 1159 lists *kaṇṇīr* itself; DEDR 3690 compares Sanskrit *nīra*, "water".

What you've built

Tears, made of eye and water.

Your turn

- *Say it: kaṇṇīr*
- *Say it: kaṇṇīr*, once more
- *Say it:* say *kaṇṇīr*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for laughter, then the Tamil for crying, then say *kaṇṇīr* again

Before you move on

What does **கண்ணீர்** mean? ("Tears".) Say it once more.

90.4 தனியாக (taṉiyāka) — alone

Before the new one: say the Tamil for crying, then the Tamil for tears.

You'll want to know: தனியாக

தனியாக (*taṉiyāka*) — "alone".

நான் தனியாக இருக்கிறேன் — "I am alone". **தனி** is "single, separate".

In the family, and next door

	word
Telugu	ఒంటరిగా (*oṇṭarigā*)
Hindi (neighbour)	अकेला (*akelā*)
English	alone

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

தனியாக (*taṉiyāka*) is native Dravidian (DEDR 3196). The entry lists *taṉi*, "singleness, solitude", beside *tāṉ*, "oneself"; *-āka* makes it "alone".

What you've built

Alone.

Your turn

- *Say it: taṉiyāka*
- *Say it: taṉiyāka*, once more
- *Say it:* say *nāṉ taṉiyāka irukkiṟēṉ*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for crying, then the Tamil for tears, then say *taṉiyāka* again

Before you move on

What does தனியாக mean? ("Alone".) Say it once more.

90.5 பசிக்கிறது (pasikkiṟatu) — (I) am hungry

Before the new one: say the Tamil for tears, then the Tamil for alone.

You'll want to know: பசிக்கிறது

பசிக்கிறது (*pasikkiṟatu*) — "I am hungry", literally "it hungers".

It is பசி, "hunger", made into a verb. எனக்குப் பசிக்கிறது — "I'm hungry".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

பசிக்கிறது (*pasikkiṟatu*) is native Dravidian (DEDR 3825). It is *paci*, "to be hungry", in the form that says "it is happening".

What you've built

Laughter, crying, tears, alone, and hunger as a verb.

Your turn

- *Say it: pasikkiṟatu*
- *Say it: pasikkiṟatu*, once more
- *Say it:* say *eṉakkup pasikkiṟatu*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for tears, then the Tamil for alone, then say *pasikkiṟatu* again

Before you move on

What does பசிக்கிறது mean? ("(I) am hungry".) Say it once more.

Chapter 91

Sun, Heat, and Sleep

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (4) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 4 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say it is sunny or hot, that I am sleepy, and that I am well.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 91: I can say it is sunny or hot, that I am sleepy, and that I am well.*

91.1 வெயில் (veyil) — sunshine, the heat of the sun

> Before the new one: say the Tamil for alone, then the Tamil for I am hungry.

You'll want to know: வெயில்

வெயில் (*veyil*) — "sunshine", the heat of the sun.

வெயில் அதிகம் — "the sun is strong", literally "the sunshine is much".

In the family, and next door

	word	same root
Kannada	ಬಿಸಿಲು (*bisilu*)	yes
Malayalam	വെയിൽ (*veyil*)	yes
English	sunshine, the heat of the sun	

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

வெயில் (*veyil*) is native Dravidian (DEDR 5517). The entry lists *veyil*, "heat of the sun", under *vē*, "to burn, to be hot".

What you've built

The sun's heat.

Your turn

- *Say it: veyil*
- *Say it: veyil*, once more
- *Say it:* say *veyil atikam*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for alone, then the Tamil for I am hungry, then say *veyil* again

Before you move on

What does வெயில் mean? ("Sunshine, the heat of the sun".) Say it once more.

91.2 சூடு (cūṭu) — heat; hot

Before the new one: say the Tamil for I am hungry, then the Tamil for sunshine.

You'll want to know: சூடு

சூடு (*cūṭu*) — "heat", and of a thing, "hot".

சூடாக இருக்கிறது — "it is hot". Tea, a pan, a forehead: anything can be சூடு.

In the family, and next door

	word	same root
Telugu	వేడి (*vēḍi*)	
Malayalam	ചൂട് (*cūṭŭ*)	yes
English	heat	

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

சூடு (*cūṭu*) is native Dravidian. DEDR 2654 lists Malayalam *cuṭuka*, "to be hot" and Kannada *suḍu*, "to burn". The entry lists *cūṭu*, "heat, burning", under *cuṭu*, "to be hot", and compares Sanskrit *cūḍ-*, "to singe".

What you've built

Heat, of a day or a thing.

Your turn

- *Say it: cūṭu*
- *Say it: cūṭu*, once more
- *Say it:* say *cūṭāka irukkiṟatu*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for I am hungry, then the Tamil for sunshine, then say *cūṭu* again

Before you move on

What does சூடு mean? ("Heat; hot".) Say it once more.

91.3 தூக்கம் வருகிறது (tūkkam varukiṟatu) — (I) am sleepy

Before the new one: say the Tamil for sunshine, then the Tamil for heat.

You'll want to know: தூக்கம் வருகிறது

தூக்கம் வருகிறது (*tūkkam varukiṟatu*) — "I am sleepy", literally "sleep is coming".

தூக்கம் is the sleep you know, on the coming frame of laughter and tears.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

தூக்கம் வருகிறது (*tūkkam varukiṟatu*) is native: *tūkkam*, "sleep" (DEDR 3376), and *varu*, "to come" (DEDR 5270). In Tamil, sleep comes to you.

What you've built

Sleep, which comes to you.

Your turn

- *Say it: tūkkam varukiṟatu*
- *Say it: tūkkam varukiṟatu*, once more
- *Say it:* say *tūkkam varukiṟatu*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for sunshine, then the Tamil for heat, then say *tūkkam varukiṟatu* again

Before you move on

What does தூக்கம் வருகிறது mean? ("(I) am sleepy".) Say it once more.

91.4 நன்றாக (naṉṟāka) — well, fine

Before the new one: say the Tamil for heat, then the Tamil for I am sleepy.

You'll want to know: நன்றாக

நன்றாக (*naṉṟāka*) — "well, fine".

நான் நன்றாக இருக்கிறேன் — "I am well", the everyday answer to how are you.

In the family, and next door

	word
Kannada	ಚೆನ್ನಾಗಿ (*cennāgi*)
Telugu	బాగా (*bāgā*)
Hindi (neighbour)	कुआँ (*kuā̃*)
English	well, fine

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

நன்றாக (*nan̲r̲āka*) is native Dravidian (DEDR 3610). It is *nan̲r̲u*, "that which is good", with *-āka*, "in the manner of".

What you've built

Sun, heat, sleepy, and an answer for good days.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *nan̲r̲āka*
- *Say it:* *nan̲r̲āka*, once more
- *Say it:* say *nān̲ nan̲r̲āka irukkir̲ēn̲*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for heat, then the Tamil for I am sleepy, then say *nan̲r̲āka* again

Before you move on

What does நன்றாக mean? ("Well, fine".) Say it once more.

Chapter 92

Slowly, Again, Louder

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can ask someone to speak slowly, say it again, speak louder, and wait a minute.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 92: I can ask someone to speak slowly, say it again, speak louder, and wait a minute.*

92.1 மெதுவாக (metuvāka) — slowly

> Before the new one: say the Tamil for I am sleepy, then the Tamil for well.

You'll want to know: மெதுவாக

மெதுவாக (*metuvāka*) — "slowly".

மெதுவாகப் பேசுங்கள் — "please speak slowly", with the verb பேசு you read long ago.

In the family, and next door

	word
Kannada	ನಿಧಾನವಾಗಿ (*nidhānavāgi*)
Telugu	నెమ్మదిగా (*nemmadigā*)
Malayalam	പതുക്കെ (*patukke*)
Hindi (neighbour)	धीरे (*dhīre*)
English	slowly

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

மெதுவாக (*metuvāka*) is native Dravidian (DEDR 5070). The entry glosses *metu* "softness, gentleness, slowness"; *-āka* makes it "slowly".

What you've built

The repair a beginner needs most.

Your turn

- *Say it: metuvāka*
- *Say it: metuvāka*, once more
- *Say it:* say *metuvākap pēcuṅkaḷ*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for I am sleepy, then the Tamil for well, then say *metuvāka* again

Before you move on

What does மெதுவாக mean? ("Slowly".) Say it once more.

92.2 மறுபடியும் (maṟupaṭiyum) — again

Before the new one: say the Tamil for well, then the Tamil for slowly.

You'll want to know: மறுபடியும்

மறுபடியும் (*maṟupaṭiyum*) — "again".
மறுபடியும் சொல்லுங்கள் — "please say it again".

In the family, and next door

	word
Hindi (neighbour)	दोबारा (*dobārā*)
English	again

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

மறுபடியும் (*maṟupaṭiyum*) is native: *maṟu*, "other, next" (DEDR 4766), and *paṭi*, "manner, time", with *-um*, "also": "once more, another time".

What you've built

Slowly, and again.

Your turn

- *Say it: maṟupaṭiyum*
- *Say it: maṟupaṭiyum*, once more
- *Say it:* say *maṟupaṭiyum colluṅkaḷ*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for well, then the Tamil for slowly, then say *maṟupaṭiyum* again

Before you move on

What does மறுபடியும் mean? ("Again".) Say it once more.

92.3 சத்தமாக (cattamāka) — loudly

Before the new one: say the Tamil for slowly, then the Tamil for again.

You'll want to know: சத்தமாக

சத்தமாக (*cattamāka*) — "loudly".

சத்தம் is "a noise, a sound". கொஞ்சம் சத்தமாகப் பேசுங்கள் — "please speak a little louder".

In the family, and next door

	word
Kannada	ಜೋರಾಗಿ (*jōrāgi*)
Telugu	గట్టిగా (*gaṭṭigā*)
Malayalam	ഉറക്കെ (*uṟakke*)
Hindi (neighbour)	ज़ोर से (*zor se*)
English	loudly

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

சத்தமாக (*cattamāka*) is a loan from Sanskrit *śabda*, "sound, noise" (CDIAL 12298). The noun *cattam*, "sound, noise", takes *-āka*, "in the manner of".

What you've built

Slowly, again, louder.

Your turn

- *Say it: cattamāka*
- *Say it: cattamāka*, once more
- *Say it:* say *koñcam cattamākap pēcuṅkaḷ*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for slowly, then the Tamil for again, then say *cattamāka* again

Before you move on

What does **சத்தமாக** mean? ("Loudly".) Say it once more.

92.4 ஒரு நிமிடம் (oru nimiṭam) — one minute, a moment

Before the new one: say the Tamil for again, then the Tamil for loudly.

You'll want to know: ஒரு நிமிடம்

ஒரு நிமிடம் (*oru nimiṭam*) — "one minute", said the way English says "a moment".

ஒரு is "one"; நிமிடம் is "a minute".

In the family, and next door

	word	same root
Kannada	ಒಂದು ನಿಮಿಷ (*ondu nimiṣa*)	yes
Telugu	ఒక్క నిమిషం (*okka nimiṣam*)	yes
Hindi (neighbour)	एक मिनट (*ek minaṭ*)	
English	one minute, a moment	

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

ஒரு நிமிடம் (*oru nimiṭam*) is native *oru*, "one" (DEDR 990), and *nimiṭam*, "minute", from Sanskrit *nimeṣa*, "a wink, a moment" (CDIAL 7243).

What you've built

A way to buy time.

Your turn

- *Say it: oru nimiṭam*
- *Say it: oru nimiṭam*, once more
- *Say it:* say *oru nimiṭam*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for again, then the Tamil for loudly, then say *oru nimiṭam* again

Before you move on

What does **ஒரு நிமிடம்** mean? ("One minute, a moment".) Say it once more.

92.5 காத்திருங்கள் (kāttiruṅkaḷ) — please wait

Before the new one: say the Tamil for loudly, then the Tamil for one minute.

You'll want to know: காத்திருங்கள்

காத்திருங்கள் (*kāttiruṅkaḷ*) — "please wait".
காத்திருங்கள், ஒரு நிமிடம் — "please wait, one minute".

In the family, and next door

	word	same root
Kannada	ಕಾಯಿರಿ (*kāyiri*)	yes
Telugu	ఆగండి (*āgaṇḍi*)	
Malayalam	കാത്തിരിക്കൂ (*kāttirikkū*)	yes
Hindi (neighbour)	रुकिए (*rukie*)	
English	please wait	

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

காத்திருங்கள் (*kāttiruṅkaḷ*) is native: *kā*, "to watch, to wait" (DEDR 1416; Malayalam *kākkuka*), and *iru*, "to be" (DEDR 480): "be waiting".

What you've built

Slowly, again, louder, one minute, wait.

Your turn

- *Say it: kāttiruṅkaḷ*
- *Say it: kāttiruṅkaḷ*, once more
- *Say it:* say *kāttiruṅkaḷ, oru nimiṭam*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for loudly, then the Tamil for one minute, then say *kāttiruṅkaḷ* again

Before you move on

What does **காத்திருங்கள்** mean? (“Please wait”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 93

How Do You Say It?

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can ask what something means and how to say it in Tamil, ask to be shown, and say I did not hear.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 93: I can ask what something means and how to say it in Tamil, ask to be shown, and say I did not hear.*

93.1 அர்த்தம் (arttam) — meaning

> Before the new one: say the Tamil for one minute, then the Tamil for please wait.

You'll want to know: அர்த்தம்

அர்த்தம் (*arttam*) — "meaning".

இதன் அர்த்தம் என்ன? — "what does this mean?", the question that turns anyone into a teacher.

In the family, and next door

	word	same root
Kannada	ಅರ್ಥ (*artha*)	yes
Malayalam	അർത്ഥം (*artham*)	yes
Hindi (neighbour)	मतलब (*matlab*)	
English	meaning	

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

அர்த்தம் (*arttam*) is a loan from Sanskrit *artha*, "aim, thing, meaning" (CDIAL 638).

What you've built

The question that unlocks a word.

Your turn

- *Say it: arttam*
- *Say it: arttam*, once more
- *Say it:* ask *itaṉ arttam eṉṉa?*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for one minute, then the Tamil for please wait, then say *arttam* again

Before you move on

What does அர்த்தம் mean? ("Meaning".) Say it once more.

93.2 தமிழில் (tamiḻil) — in Tamil

Before the new one: say the Tamil for please wait, then the Tamil for meaning.

You'll want to know: தமிழில்

தமிழில் (*tamiḻil*) — "in Tamil".

-இல் is "in", added to the name of the language. ஆங்கிலத்தில் would be "in English".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

தமிழில் (*tamiḻil*) is *tamiḻ*, native (DEDR 3080, which compares Sanskrit *draviḍa*), with the locative *-il*, "in".

What you've built

A way to name the language you want.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *tamiḻil*
- *Say it:* *tamiḻil*, once more
- *Say it:* say *tamiḻil*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for please wait, then the Tamil for meaning, then say *tamiḻil* again

Before you move on

What does **தமிழில்** mean? (“In Tamil”.) Say it once more.

93.3 எப்படிச் சொல்வது? (eppaṭic colvatu?) — how do you say it?

Before the new one: say the Tamil for meaning, then the Tamil for in Tamil.

You’ll want to know: எப்படிச் சொல்வது?

எப்படிச் சொல்வது? (*eppaṭic colvatu?*) — “how does one say it?”.

தமிழில் இதை எப்படிச் சொல்வது? — “how do you say this in Tamil?”. **எப்படி** is the “how” you know.

In the family, and next door

	word
Telugu	**ఎలా అంటారు**? (*elā aṇṭāru?*)
Hindi (neighbour)	**कैसे कहते हैं**? (*kaise kahte haiṁ?*)
English	how do you say it?

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

எப்படிச் சொல்வது? (*eppaṭic colvatu?*) is native: *eppaṭi*, “how” (DEDR 5151), and *colvatu*, “saying”, from *col*, “to say” (DEDR 2855).

What you’ve built

The question that lets you learn from anyone.

Your turn

- *Say it: eppaṭic colvatu?*
- *Say it: eppaṭic colvatu?*, once more
- *Say it:* ask *tamiḻil itai eppaṭic colvatu?*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for meaning, then the Tamil for in Tamil, then say *eppaṭic colvatu?* again

Before you move on

What does எப்படிச் சொல்வது? mean? ("How do you say it?".) Say it once more.

93.4 காட்டுங்கள் (kāṭṭuṅkaḷ) — please show me

Before the new one: say the Tamil for in Tamil, then the Tamil for how do you say it.

You'll want to know: காட்டுங்கள்

காட்டுங்கள் (*kāṭṭuṅkaḷ*) — "please show me".

When a word will not come, point and say காட்டுங்கள்.

In the family, and next door

	word
Kannada	తోరిసి (*tōrisi*)
Telugu	చూపించండి (*cūpiñcaṇḍi*)
Hindi (neighbour)	दिखाइए (*dikhāie*)
English	please show me

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

காட்டுங்கள் (*kāṭṭuṅkaḷ*) is native Dravidian. DEDR 1443 lists Malayalam *kāṭṭuka*, "to show". The verb *kāṭṭu*, "to show", is "to make see", from *kāṇ*, "to see".

What you've built

A request for when words run out.

Your turn

- *Say it: kāṭṭuṅkaḷ*
- *Say it: kāṭṭuṅkaḷ*, once more
- *Say it:* say *kāṭṭuṅkaḷ*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for in Tamil, then the Tamil for how do you say it, then say *kāṭṭuṅkaḷ* again

Before you move on

What does காட்டுங்கள் mean? ("Please show me".) Say it once more.

93.5 கேட்கவில்லை (kēṭkavillai) — I did not hear it

Before the new one: say the Tamil for how do you say it, then the Tamil for please show me.

You'll want to know: கேட்கவில்லை

கேட்கவில்லை (*kēṭkavillai*) — "I did not hear (it)".

It ends in இல்லை, the "no" of your first chapter. Pair it with சத்தமாக.

In the family, and next door

	word
Telugu	వినిపించలేదు (*vinipiñcalēdu*)
Hindi (neighbour)	सुनाई नहीं दिया (*sunāī nahīṁ diyā*)
English	I did not hear it

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

கேட்கவில்லை (*kēṭkavillai*) is native: *kēḷ*, "to hear" (DEDR 2017), and *illai*, "not" (DEDR 2559).

What you've built

Meaning, in Tamil, how to say it, show me, I did not hear.

Your turn

- *Say it: kēṭkavillai*
- *Say it: kēṭkavillai*, once more
- *Say it:* say *kēṭkavillai, cattamākap pēcuṅkaḷ*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for how do you say it, then the Tamil for please show me, then say *kēṭkavillai* again

Before you move on

What does **கேட்கவில்லை** mean? (“I did not hear it”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 94

When You Are Lost

Modes: **voice** (3) **eyes** (1) **Hands-free start:** the first of 4 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say I do not understand, ask someone to write it down, ask for one more time, and ask what they said.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 94: I can say I do not understand, ask someone to write it down, ask for one more time, and ask what they said.*

94.1 புரியவில்லை (puriyavillai) — I don't understand

Before the new one: say the Tamil for please show me, then the Tamil for I did not hear it.

You'll want to know: புரியவில்லை

புரியவில்லை (*puriyavillai*) — "I don't understand", literally "it did not become clear".

The most useful sentence a learner owns. It also ends in இல்லை.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

புரியவில்லை (*puriyavillai*) is *puri*, "to become clear", with native *illai*, "not" (DEDR 2559). As an earlier lesson said, whether this *puri* is one root with an older *puri*, "to do", is not settled.

What you've built

The honest sentence every learner needs.

Your turn

- *Say it: puriyavillai*
- *Say it: puriyavillai*, once more
- *Say it:* say *puriyavillai*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for please show me, then the Tamil for I did not hear it, then say *puriyavillai* again

Before you move on

What does புரியவில்லை mean? ("I don't understand".) Say it once more.

94.2 எழுதுங்கள் (eḻutuṅkaḷ) — please write it

Before the new one: say the Tamil for I did not hear it, then the Tamil for I don't understand.

You'll want to know: எழுதுங்கள்

எழுதுங்கள் (*eḻutuṅkaḷ*) — "please write (it)".

It shares its root with எழுத்து, "a letter of the script". இங்கே எழுதுங்கள் — "please write it here".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

எழுதுங்கள் (*eḻutuṅkaḷ*) is native Dravidian. DEDR 853 lists Malayalam *eḻutuka*. The ending *-uṅkaḷ* makes it a polite request.

What you've built

A request to see the word.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *e̲luṭuṅkaḷ*
- *Say it:* *e̲luṭuṅkaḷ*, once more
- *Say it:* say *iṅkē e̲luṭuṅkaḷ*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for I did not hear it, then the Tamil for I don't understand, then say *e̲luṭuṅkaḷ* again

Before you move on

What does எழுதுங்கள் mean? ("Please write it".) Say it once more.

94.3 இன்னொரு முறை (in̲n̲oru mu̲rai) — one more time

Before the new one: say the Tamil for I don't understand, then the Tamil for please write it.

You'll want to know: இன்னொரு முறை

இன்னொரு முறை (*in̲n̲oru mu̲rai*) — "one more time".
இன்னொரு is "another", and முறை is "a time, a turn".

In the family, and next door

	word
Hindi (neighbour)	एक बार और (*ek bār aur*)
English	one more time

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

இன்னொரு முறை (*in̲n̲oru mu̲rai*) is native: *in̲n̲oru*, "one more", from *in̲n̲um*, "more" (DEDR 410), and *oru*, "one"; and *mu̲rai*, "order, turn, time" (DEDR 5015).

What you've built

Once more, politely.

Your turn

- *Say it: iṉṉoru muṟai*
- *Say it: iṉṉoru muṟai*, once more
- *Say it:* say *iṉṉoru muṟai colluṅkaḷ*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for I don't understand, then the Tamil for please write it, then say *iṉṉoru muṟai* again

Before you move on

What does இன்னொரு முறை mean? ("One more time".) Say it once more.

94.4 என்ன சொன்னீர்கள்? (enna conṉīrkaḷ?) — what did you say?

Before the new one: say the Tamil for please write it, then the Tamil for one more time.

You'll want to know: என்ன சொன்னீர்கள்?

என்ன சொன்னீர்கள்? (*enna conṉīrkaḷ?*) — "what did you say?".
என்ன is "what"; சொன்னீர்கள் is "you said", respectfully.

In the family, and next door

	word
Hindi (neighbour)	क्या कहा? (*kyā kahā?*)
English	what did you say?

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

என்ன சொன்னீர்கள்? (*enna conṉīrkaḷ?*) is native: *enna*, "what" (DEDR 5151), and *conṉīrkaḷ*, "you said", the past of *col*, "to say" (DEDR 2855).

What you've built

Don't understand, write it, one more time, what did you say.

Your turn

- *Say it: e̲n̲na co̲n̲n̄īrkaḷ?*
- *Say it: e̲n̲na co̲n̲n̄īrkaḷ?*, once more
- *Say it:* ask *e̲n̲na co̲n̲n̄īrkaḷ?*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for please write it, then the Tamil for one more time, then say *e̲n̲na co̲n̲n̄īrkaḷ?* again

Before you move on

What does **என்ன சொன்னீர்கள்**? mean? (“What did you say?”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 95

Exactly, Really, Nothing

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say exactly, ask really?, answer nothing and not yet, and say the same one.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 95: I can say exactly, ask really?, answer nothing and not yet, and say the same one.*

95.1 சரியாக (cariyāka) — exactly, correctly

> Before the new one: say the Tamil for one more time, then the Tamil for what did you say.

You'll want to know: சரியாக

சரியாக (*cariyāka*) — "exactly, correctly".

It is the சரி of "okay", with -ஆக. சரியாகச் சொன்னீர்கள் — "you said it exactly".

In the family, and next door

	word
Telugu	సరిగ్గా (*sariggā*)
English	exactly, correctly

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

சரியாக (*cariyāka*) is *sari*, "correct", with *-āka*, "in the manner of". As its own lesson said, the origin of *sari* is uncertain; the usual guess is

Sanskrit *sadṛśa*, “like” (CDIAL 13120).

What you’ve built

Okay, made into exactly.

Your turn

- *Say it: cariyāka*
- *Say it: cariyāka*, once more
- *Say it:* say *cariyāka!*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for one more time, then the Tamil for what did you say, then say *cariyāka* again

Before you move on

What does **சரியாக** mean? (“Exactly, correctly”.) Say it once more.

95.2 உண்மையா? (uṇmaiyā?) — really? is it true?

Before the new one: say the Tamil for what did you say, then the Tamil for exactly.

You’ll want to know: உண்மையா?

உண்மையா? (*uṇmaiyā?*) — “really?”, literally “is it the truth?”.
உண்மை is “truth”, and **-ஆ** makes the question.

In the family, and next door

	word
Hindi (neighbour)	**सच में?** (*sac mem?*)
English	really? is it true?

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

உண்மையா? (*uṇmaiyā?*) is *uṇmai*, “truth” (DEDR 697), with the question ending *-ā*: “is it true?”

What you've built

A way to show surprise.

Your turn

- *Say it: uṇmaiyā?*
- *Say it: uṇmaiyā?*, once more
- *Say it:* ask *uṇmaiyā?*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for what did you say, then the Tamil for exactly, then say *uṇmaiyā?* again

Before you move on

What does உண்மையா? mean? ("Really? is it true?".) Say it once more.

95.3 ஒன்றுமில்லை (onrumillai) — nothing, it's nothing

Before the new one: say the Tamil for exactly, then the Tamil for really.

You'll want to know: ஒன்றுமில்லை

ஒன்றுமில்லை (*onrumillai*) — "nothing", "it's nothing".
ஒன்று is "one", and இல்லை is "no": *not even one.*
In the family, and next door

	word	same root
Kannada	ಏನೂ ಇಲ್ಲ (*ēnū illa*)	
Telugu	ఏమీ లేదు (*ēmī lēdu*)	
Malayalam	ഒന്നുമില്ല (*onnumilla*)	yes
Hindi (neighbour)	कुछ नहीं (*kuch nahīṁ*)	
English	nothing, it's nothing	

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

ஒன்றுமில்லை (*onrumillai*) is native: *onrum*, "even one" (DEDR 990), and *illai*, "there is not" (DEDR 2559).

What you've built

An answer that closes a question kindly.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *onrumillai*
- *Say it:* *onrumillai*, once more
- *Say it:* say *onrumillai*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for exactly, then the Tamil for really, then say *onrumillai* again

Before you move on

What does ஒன்றுமில்லை mean? ("Nothing, it's nothing".) Say it once more.

95.4 இன்னும் இல்லை (innum illai) — not yet

Before the new one: say the Tamil for really, then the Tamil for nothing.

You'll want to know: இன்னும் இல்லை

இன்னும் இல்லை (*innum illai*) — "not yet".
இன்னும் is "still"; with இல்லை, "still no".

In the family, and next door

	word
Telugu	ఇంకా లేదు (*iṅkā lēdu*)
Hindi (neighbour)	अभी नहीं (*abhī nahīṁ*)
English	not yet

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

இன்னும் இல்லை (*iṉṉum illai*) is native: *iṉṉum*, "still, yet" (DEDR 410), and *illai*, "not" (DEDR 2559).

What you've built

Not yet.

Your turn

- *Say it: iṉṉum illai*
- *Say it: iṉṉum illai*, once more
- *Say it:* say *iṉṉum illai*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for really, then the Tamil for nothing, then say *iṉṉum illai* again

Before you move on

What does இன்னும் இல்லை mean? ("Not yet".) Say it once more.

95.5 அதே (atē) — the same, that very one

Before the new one: say the Tamil for nothing, then the Tamil for not yet.

You'll want to know: அதே

அதே (*atē*) — "the same", "that very one".

It is அது, "that", with **-ஏ**, "exactly". When someone names what you meant: **அதே!**

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

அதே (*atē*) is native: the far base *a-* (DEDR 1) with the stressing *-ē*: "that very one".

What you've built

Exactly, really, nothing, not yet, the same.

Your turn

- *Say it: atē*
- *Say it: atē*, once more
- *Say it:* say *atē!*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for nothing, then the Tamil for not yet, then say *atē* again

Before you move on

What does அதே mean? ("The same, that very one".) Say it once more.

Chapter 96

Not at All, Is That So?

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say not at all, react with is that so and really, agree that's right, and say I don't know.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 96: I can say not at all, react with is that so and really, agree that's right, and say I don't know.*

96.1 இல்லவே இல்லை (illavē illai) — not at all

> Before the new one: say the Tamil for not yet, then the Tamil for the same.

You'll want to know: இல்லவே இல்லை

இல்லவே இல்லை (*illavē illai*) — "not at all".

It is இல்லை said twice, the first time with the **-ஏ** that says *exactly*: no, and no again.

In the family, and next door

	word
Hindi (neighbour)	बिलकुल नहीं (*bilkul nahīṁ*)
English	not at all

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

இல்லவே இல்லை (*illavē illai*) is native *illai*, "not" (DEDR 2559), said twice, the first time with the stressing -*ē*.

What you've built

The strongest no.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *illavē illai*
- *Say it:* *illavē illai*, once more
- *Say it:* say *illavē illai*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for not yet, then the Tamil for the same, then say *illavē illai* again

Before you move on

What does இல்லவே இல்லை mean? ("Not at all".) Say it once more.

96.2 அப்படியா? (appaṭiyā?) — is that so?

Before the new one: say the Tamil for the same, then the Tamil for not at all.

You'll want to know: அப்படியா?

அப்படியா? (*appaṭiyā?*) — "is that so?", "oh, really?".
அப்படி is "like that", and **-ஆ** makes it a question.

In the family, and next door

	word
Kannada	ಹೌದಾ (*haudā*)
Hindi (neighbour)	अच्छा जी (*acchā jī*)
English	is that so?

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

அப்படியா? (*appaṭiyā?*) is native: *appaṭi*, "thus" (DEDR 1), with the question ending *-ā*: "like that?"

What you've built

A way to show you are listening.

Your turn

- *Say it: appaṭiyā?*
- *Say it: appaṭiyā?*, once more
- *Say it:* ask *appaṭiyā?*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for the same, then the Tamil for not at all, then say *appaṭiyā?* again

Before you move on

What does அப்படியா? mean? ("Is that so?".) Say it once more.

96.3 அடடா (aṭaṭā) — oh dear!, wow!

Before the new one: say the Tamil for not at all, then the Tamil for is that so.

You'll want to know: அடடா

அடடா (*aṭaṭā*) — "oh dear!", or "wow!", by tone.

Said to bad news it is sympathy; said to good news it is delight. **அடடா, அப்படியா?** — "oh dear, is that so?".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

அடடா (*aṭaṭā*) is an exclamation, a sound of surprise or pity rather than a word built from parts. DEDR has no entry for it; the nearest is the exclamation *aṭā* (DEDR 70). Its origin is uncertain.

What you've built

A cry of surprise that can go either way.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *aṭaṭā*
- *Say it:* *aṭaṭā*, once more
- *Say it:* say *aṭaṭā!*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for not at all, then the Tamil for is that so, then say *aṭaṭā* again

Before you move on

What does அடடா mean? ("Oh dear!, wow!".) Say it once more.

96.4 சரிதான் (caritāṉ) — that's right

Before the new one: say the Tamil for is that so, then the Tamil for oh dear.

You'll want to know: சரிதான்

சரிதான் (*caritāṉ*) — "that's right", "quite so".
சரி with -தான், "that and no other".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

சரிதான் (*caritāṉ*) is *sari*, "correct", with *tāṉ*, "just, indeed", from the native word for "oneself" (DEDR 3196). The origin of *sari* is uncertain, as its own lesson said.

What you've built

Agreement.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *caritāṉ*
- *Say it:* *caritāṉ*, once more
- *Say it:* say *caritāṉ*

- *Recall:* say the Tamil for is that so, then the Tamil for oh dear, then say *caritāṉ* again

Before you move on

What does **சரிதான்** mean? ("That's right".) Say it once more.

96.5 தெரியாது (teriyātu) — (I) don't know

Before the new one: say the Tamil for oh dear, then the Tamil for that's right.

You'll want to know: தெரியாது

தெரியாது (*teriyātu*) — "don't know".

எனக்குத் தெரியாது — "I don't know", literally "to me it is not known".

In the family, and next door

	word
Hindi (neighbour)	मालूम नहीं (*mālūm nahīṁ*)
English	don't know

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

தெரியாது (*teriyātu*) is native Dravidian. DEDR 3419 lists Malayalam *teriyuka*, "to understand". It is *teri*, "to become clear", with the negative ending: "it is not clear (to me)".

What you've built

Not at all, is that so, oh dear, that's right, I don't know.

Your turn

- *Say it: teriyātu*
- *Say it: teriyātu*, once more
- *Say it:* say *eṉakkut teriyātu*

- *Recall:* say the Tamil for oh dear, then the Tamil for that's right, then say *teriyātu* again

Before you move on

What does தெரியாது mean? ("(I) don't know".) Say it once more.

Chapter 97

Definitely, and Why Not

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (3) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 3 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say definitely, that's how it is, and why not.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 97: I can say definitely, that's how it is, and why not.*

97.1 கண்டிப்பாக (kaṇṭippāka) — definitely

Before the new one: say the Tamil for that's right, then the Tamil for I don't know.

You'll want to know: கண்டிப்பாக

கண்டிப்பாக (*kaṇṭippāka*) — "definitely", "for sure".
கண்டிப்பாக வருகிறேன் — "I'll definitely come".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

கண்டிப்பாக (*kaṇṭippāka*) is built on *kaṇṭippu*, "strictness, firmness", which is usually traced to Sanskrit *khaṇḍ-*, "to break, to cut, to settle" (CDIAL 3797, *khaṇḍita*, "broken"). *-āka* makes it "definitely".

What you've built

A firm yes.

Your turn

- *Say it: kaṇṭippāka*
- *Say it: kaṇṭippāka*, once more
- *Say it:* say *kaṇṭippāka*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for that's right, then the Tamil for I don't know, then say *kaṇṭippāka* again

Before you move on

What does **கண்டிப்பாக** mean? ("Definitely".) Say it once more.

97.2 அப்படித்தான் (appaṭittāṉ) — that's how it is

Before the new one: say the Tamil for I don't know, then the Tamil for definitely.

You'll want to know: அப்படித்தான்

அப்படித்தான் (*appaṭittāṉ*) — "that's how it is", "quite so".

அப்படி, "like that", with **-தான்**, the same "that and no other" as **சரிதான்**.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

அப்படித்தான் (*appaṭittāṉ*) is native: *appaṭi*, "thus" (DEDR 1), and *tāṉ*, "just, indeed" (DEDR 3196).

What you've built

A shrug that agrees.

Your turn

- *Say it: appaṭittāṉ*
- *Say it: appaṭittāṉ*, once more
- *Say it:* say *appaṭittāṉ*

- *Recall:* say the Tamil for I don't know, then the Tamil for definitely, then say *appaṭittāṉ* again

Before you move on

What does **அப்படித்தான்** mean? ("That's how it is".) Say it once more.

97.3 ஏன் இல்லை? (ēṉ illai?) — why not?

Before the new one: say the Tamil for definitely, then the Tamil for that's how it is.

You'll want to know: ஏன் இல்லை?

ஏன் இல்லை? (*ēṉ illai?*) — "why not?".

ஏன் is "why"; with **இல்லை**, "why not?" — as a question, or as a cheerful yes.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

ஏன் இல்லை? (*ēṉ illai?*) is native: *ēṉ*, "why" (DEDR 5151), and *illai*, "not" (DEDR 2559).

What you've built

Definitely, that's how it is, why not.

Your turn

- *Say it: ēṉ illai?*
- *Say it: ēṉ illai?*, once more
- *Say it:* say *ēṉ illai?*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for definitely, then the Tamil for that's how it is, then say *ēṉ illai?* again

Before you move on

What does **ஏன் இல்லை**? mean? ("Why not?".) Say it once more.

Chapter 98

Come, Eat, Drink

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can welcome a guest, offer food and drink, congratulate, and talk about gifts and invitations.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 98: I can welcome a guest, offer food and drink, congratulate, and talk about gifts and invitations.*

98.1 வாழ்த்துகள் (vāl̲ttukaḷ) — congratulations, good wishes

Before the new one: say the Tamil for that's how it is, then the Tamil for why not.

You'll want to know: வாழ்த்துகள்

வாழ்த்துகள் (*vāl̲ttukaḷ*) — "congratulations", "good wishes".
It is built on **வாழ்**, "to live": to wish someone well is to wish them life.

In the family, and next door

	word
Kannada	**ಅಭಿನಂದನೆಗಳು** (*abhinandanegaḷu*)
Telugu	**అభినందనలు** (*abhinandanalu*)
Malayalam	**അഭിനന്ദനങ്ങൾ** (*abhinandanaṅṅaḷ*)
Hindi (neighbour)	**बधाई** (*badhāī*)
English	congratulations, good wishes

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

வாழ்த்துகள் (*vāḻttukaḷ*) is native Dravidian. DEDR 5372 lists Malayalam *vāḻttuka*, "to bless". It is *vāḻttu*, "a good wish", with the plural *-kaḷ*.

What you've built

Wishes for someone's good news.

Your turn

- *Say it: vāḻttukaḷ*
- *Say it: vāḻttukaḷ*, once more
- *Say it:* say *vāḻttukaḷ!*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for that's how it is, then the Tamil for why not, then say *vāḻttukaḷ* again

Before you move on

What does வாழ்த்துகள் mean? ("Congratulations, good wishes".) Say it once more.

98.2 அழைப்பு (aḻaippu) — an invitation, a call

Before the new one: say the Tamil for why not, then the Tamil for congratulations.

You'll want to know: அழைப்பு

அழைப்பு (*aḻaippu*) — "an invitation", and "a call".

அழைப்புக்கு நன்றி — "thank you for the invitation", with the நன்றி you know.

In the family, and next door

	word
Kannada	ಆಹ್ವಾನ (*āhvāna*)
Telugu	ఆహ్వానం (*āhvānaṁ*)
Malayalam	ക്ഷണം (*kṣaṇaṁ*)
Hindi (neighbour)	निमंत्रण (*nimantraṇ*)
English	an invitation, a call

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

அழைப்பு (*a̲laippu*) is native Dravidian (DEDR 282). The entry lists *a̲lai*, "to call", beside *a̲lu*, "to cry": an invitation is "a calling".

What you've built

An invitation, and thanks for it.

Your turn

- *Say it: a̲laippu*
- *Say it: a̲laippu*, once more
- *Say it:* say *a̲laippukku na̲n̲ri*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for why not, then the Tamil for congratulations, then say *a̲laippu* again

Before you move on

What does அழைப்பு mean? ("An invitation, a call".) Say it once more.

98.3 பரிசு (paricu) — a gift, a prize

Before the new one: say the Tamil for congratulations, then the Tamil for an invitation.

You'll want to know: பரிசு

பரிசு (*paricu*) — "a gift", and "a prize".
உங்களுக்கு ஒரு பரிசு — "a gift for you".

In the family, and next door

	word
Kannada	ಉಡುಗೊರೆ (*uḍugore*)
Telugu	బహుమతి (*bahumati*)
Malayalam	സമ്മാനം (*sammānaṁ*)
English	a gift, a prize

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

பரிசு (*paricu*) belongs with *paricil*, "gift, present", in DEDR 3970, beside Malayalam *pariyam*, "a token given to the bride". The entry notes a proposal to derive the family from Sanskrit *sparśa*, "touch"; that is not settled.

What you've built

Something to bring.

Your turn

- *Say it: paricu*
- *Say it: paricu*, once more
- *Say it:* say *uṅkaḷukku oru paricu*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for congratulations, then the Tamil for an invitation, then say *paricu* again

Before you move on

What does பரிசு mean? ("A gift, a prize".) Say it once more.

98.4 வாருங்கள் (vāruṅkaḷ) — please come (in)

Before the new one: say the Tamil for an invitation, then the Tamil for a gift.

You'll want to know: வாருங்கள்

வாருங்கள் (*vāruṅkaḷ*) — "please come", "come in".

It is the verb **வா**, "come", with the respectful **-ங்கள்**. At the door, it is the welcome.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

வாருங்கள் (*vāruṅkaḷ*) is native Dravidian. DEDR 5270 lists Malayalam *varuka*. It is *vā*, "come", with the polite ending *-uṅkaḷ*.

What you've built

A welcome at the door.

Your turn

- *Say it: vāruṅkaḷ*
- *Say it: vāruṅkaḷ*, once more
- *Say it:* say *vāruṅkaḷ*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for an invitation, then the Tamil for a gift, then say *vāruṅkaḷ* again

Before you move on

What does **வாருங்கள்** mean? ("Please come (in)".) Say it once more.

98.5 சாப்பிடுங்கள் (cāppiṭuṅkaḷ) — please eat

Before the new one: say the Tamil for a gift, then the Tamil for please come in.

You'll want to know: சாப்பிடுங்கள்

சாப்பிடுங்கள் (*cāppiṭuṅkaḷ*) — "please eat".

A host says it, and says it again. **சாப்பிடு** is Tamil's everyday verb for eating.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

சாப்பிடுங்கள் (*cāppiṭuṅkaḷ*) is *sāppiḍu*, "to eat", with the polite ending. As an earlier lesson showed, *sāppiḍu* is *sāppu*, "food", with *iḍu*, "to put" (DEDR 442).

What you've built

Congratulations, an invitation, a gift, come in, please eat.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *cāppiṭuṅkaḷ*
- *Say it:* *cāppiṭuṅkaḷ*, once more
- *Say it:* say *cāppiṭuṅkaḷ*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for a gift, then the Tamil for please come in, then say *cāppiṭuṅkaḷ* again

Before you move on

What does சாப்பிடுங்கள் mean? ("Please eat".) Say it once more.

Chapter 99

Gifts, Welcomes, Apologies

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can offer a drink, name a gift given with affection, welcome formally, ask forgiveness, and say don't worry.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 99: I can offer a drink, name a gift given with affection, welcome formally, ask forgiveness, and say don't worry.*

99.1 குடியுங்கள் (kuṭiyuṅkaḷ) — please drink

> Before the new one: say the Tamil for please come in, then the Tamil for please eat.

You'll want to know: குடியுங்கள்

குடியுங்கள் (*kuṭiyuṅkaḷ*) — "please drink".

தண்ணீர் குடியுங்கள் — "please have some water".

Notice தண்ணீர்: it is the thing being drunk, and it carries no **-ஐ**. A thing can do without the ending that a person must have.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

குடியுங்கள் (*kuṭiyuṅkaḷ*) is native Dravidian. DEDR 1654 lists Malayalam *kuṭi* and Kannada *kuḍi*. It is *kuḍi*, "drink", with the polite ending. DEDR compares Sanskrit *kuṭī*, "liquor".

What you've built

Food, and now drink.

Your turn

- *Say it: kuṭiyuṅkaḷ*
- *Say it: kuṭiyuṅkaḷ*, once more
- *Say it:* say *taṇṇīr kuṭiyuṅkaḷ*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for please come in, then the Tamil for please eat, then say *kuṭiyuṅkaḷ* again

Before you move on

What does குடியுங்கள் mean? ("Please drink".) Say it once more.

99.2 அன்பளிப்பு (aṉpaḷippu) — a gift given with affection

Before the new one: say the Tamil for please eat, then the Tamil for please drink.

You'll want to know: அன்பளிப்பு

அன்பளிப்பு (*aṉpaḷippu*) — "a present", literally "a giving of love".

அன்பு is "love"; அளிப்பு is "a giving". பரிசு can be a prize; அன்பளிப்பு is always from the heart.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

அன்பளிப்பு (*aṉpaḷippu*) is native: *aṉpu*, "affection" (DEDR 330), and *aḷippu*, "giving", from *aḷi*, "to show favour, to bestow" (DEDR 301). A gift given out of love.

What you've built

A second word for gift, with love in it.

Your turn

- *Say it: a̲npaḷippu*
- *Say it: a̲npaḷippu*, once more
- *Say it:* say *a̲npaḷippu*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for please eat, then the Tamil for please drink, then say *a̲npaḷippu* again

Before you move on

What does அன்பளிப்பு mean? ("A gift given with affection".) Say it once more.

99.3 நல்வரவு (nalvaravu) — welcome (formal)

Before the new one: say the Tamil for please drink, then the Tamil for a present.

You'll want to know: நல்வரவு

நல்வரவு (*nalvaravu*) — "welcome", the formal word, literally "good arrival".

You will see it on banners and doorways; வாருங்கள் is what you say aloud.

In the family, and next door

	word
Kannada	ಸ್ವಾಗತ (*svāgata*)
Telugu	స్వాగతం (*svāgatam̐*)
Malayalam	സ്വാഗതം (*svāgatam̐*)
English	welcome

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

நல்வரவு (*nalvaravu*) is native: *nal*, "good" (DEDR 3610), and *varavu*, "coming" (DEDR 5270): "a good coming".

What you've built

The written welcome.

Your turn

- *Say it: nalvaravu*
- *Say it: nalvaravu*, once more
- *Say it:* say *nalvaravu*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for please drink, then the Tamil for a present, then say *nalvaravu* again

Before you move on

What does நல்வரவு mean? ("Welcome (formal)".) Say it once more.

99.4 மன்னித்துவிடுங்கள் (maṉṉittuviṭuṅkaḷ) — please forgive me

Before the new one: say the Tamil for a present, then the Tamil for a formal welcome.

You'll want to know: மன்னித்துவிடுங்கள்

மன்னித்துவிடுங்கள் (*maṉṉittuviṭuṅkaḷ*) — "please forgive me".

It is fuller and more earnest than மன்னிக்கவும்: for a real mistake, not a bumped elbow.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

மன்னித்துவிடுங்கள் (*maṉṉittuviṭuṅkaḷ*) is *maṉṉi*, "to pardon", with *viṭu*, "to let go" (DEDR 5393), and the polite ending. The origin of *maṉṉi* is uncertain: DEDR has no entry for it.

What you've built

A fuller apology.

Your turn

- *Say it: maṉṉittuviṭuṅkaḷ*
- *Say it: maṉṉittuviṭuṅkaḷ*, once more

- *Say it:* say *maṉṉittuviṭuṅkaḷ*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for a present, then the Tamil for a formal welcome, then say *maṉṉittuviṭuṅkaḷ* again

Before you move on

What does மன்னித்துவிடுங்கள் mean? ("Please forgive me".) Say it once more.

99.5 கவலைப்படாதீர்கள் (kavalaippaṭātīrkaḷ) — don't worry

Before the new one: say the Tamil for a formal welcome, then the Tamil for please forgive me.

You'll want to know: கவலைப்படாதீர்கள்

கவலைப்படாதீர்கள் (*kavalaippaṭātīrkaḷ*) — "please don't worry".
It is **கவலை**, "worry", with **படு**, "to suffer", and the respectful don't.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

கவலைப்படாதீர்கள் (*kavalaippaṭātīrkaḷ*) is native: *kavalai*, "worry" (DEDR 1328), and *paṭu*, "to experience, to undergo" (DEDR 3853), with the polite negative: "do not undergo worry".

What you've built

Drink, a present, a welcome, forgiveness, and don't worry.

Your turn

- *Say it: kavalaippaṭātīrkaḷ*
- *Say it: kavalaippaṭātīrkaḷ*, once more
- *Say it:* say *kavalaippaṭātīrkaḷ*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for a formal welcome, then the Tamil for please forgive me, then say *kavalaippaṭātīrkaḷ* again

Before you move on

What does **கவலைப்படாதீர்கள்** mean? (“Don’t worry”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 100

Children, Husbands, Wives

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can talk about children, a boy, a husband or wife, and a relative.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 100: I can talk about children, a boy, a husband or wife, and a relative.*

100.1 குழந்தைகள் (kuḻantaikaḷ) — children

> Before the new one: say the Tamil for please forgive me, then the Tamil for don't worry.

You'll want to know: குழந்தைகள்

குழந்தைகள் (*kuḻantaikaḷ*) — "children".

-கள் is the plural. உங்களுக்குக் குழந்தைகள் இருக்கிறார்களா? — "do you have children?".

In the family, and next door

	word
Telugu	పిల్లలు (*pillalu*)
Hindi (neighbour)	बच्चे (*bacce*)
English	children

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

குழந்தைகள் (*kuḻantaikaḷ*) is native Dravidian (DEDR 2149). It is *kuḻandai*, "child", with the plural *-kaḷ*. DEDR compares Sanskrit *kuḍaka*, "child".

What you've built

The question that follows a name.

Your turn

- *Say it: kuḻantaikaḷ*
- *Say it: kuḻantaikaḷ*, once more
- *Say it:* ask about children
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for please forgive me, then the Tamil for don't worry, then say *kuḻantaikaḷ* again

Before you move on

What does குழந்தைகள் mean? ("Children".) Say it once more.

100.2 பையன் (paiyaṉ) — a boy; a son

Before the new one: say the Tamil for don't worry, then the Tamil for children.

You'll want to know: பையன்

பையன் (*paiyaṉ*) — "a boy", and in a family, "a son".
என் பையன் — "my boy", "my son".

In the family, and next door

	word
Telugu	అబ్బాయి (*abbāyi*)
Hindi (neighbour)	लड़का (*laṛkā*)
English	a boy

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

பையன் (*paiyaṉ*) is native Dravidian. DEDR 3939 lists Malayalam *paital* and Telugu *paida*.

What you've built

A boy.

Your turn

- *Say it: paiyaṉ*
- *Say it: paiyaṉ*, once more
- *Say it:* say *eṉ paiyaṉ*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for don't worry, then the Tamil for children, then say *paiyaṉ* again

Before you move on

What does பையன் mean? ("A boy; a son".) Say it once more.

100.3 கணவர் (kaṇavar) — a husband

Before the new one: say the Tamil for children, then the Tamil for a boy.

You'll want to know: கணவர்

கணவர் (*kaṇavar*) — "a husband", in its respectful form.
என் கணவர் — "my husband".

In the family, and next door

	word
Kannada	ಗಂಡ (*gaṇḍa*)
Telugu	భర్త (*bharta*)
Malayalam	ഭർത്താവ് (*bharttāvŭ*)
Hindi (neighbour)	पति (*pati*)
English	a husband

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

கணவர் (*kaṇavar*) is native Dravidian (DEDR 1173). The entry lists *kaṇavaṉ*, "husband"; *-ar* is the respectful ending. DEDR compares Sanskrit (lexicons) *gaṇḍa*, "hero".

What you've built

A husband.

Your turn

- *Say it: kaṇavar*
- *Say it: kaṇavar*, once more
- *Say it:* say *eṉ kaṇavar*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for children, then the Tamil for a boy, then say *kaṇavar* again

Before you move on

What does **கணவர்** mean? ("A husband".) Say it once more.

100.4 மனைவி (maṉaivi) — a wife

Before the new one: say the Tamil for a boy, then the Tamil for a husband.

You'll want to know: மனைவி

மனைவி (*maṉaivi*) — "a wife".

It shares its start with **மனை**, "a house", from the hospital word: the wife is named from the home.

In the family, and next door

	word
Kannada	ಹೆಂಡತಿ (*heṇḍati*)
Telugu	భార్య (*bhārya*)
Malayalam	ഭാര്യ (*bhārya*)
Hindi (neighbour)	पत्नी (*patnī*)
English	a wife

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

மனைவி (*maṉaivi*) is native Dravidian. DEDR 4776 lists Malayalam *mana*, "house" and Kannada *mane*. The entry glosses *maṉai* both "house" and "wife": the wife is named from the home.

What you've built

Husband and wife.

Your turn

- *Say it: maṉaivi*
- *Say it: maṉaivi*, once more
- *Say it:* say *eṉ maṉaivi*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for a boy, then the Tamil for a husband, then say *maṉaivi* again

Before you move on

What does மனைவி mean? ("A wife".) Say it once more.

100.5 உறவினர் (uṟaviṉar) — a relative

Before the new one: say the Tamil for a husband, then the Tamil for a wife.

You'll want to know: உறவினர்

உறவினர் (*uṟaviṉar*) — "a relative".
உறவு is "a tie, a relationship"; a relative is one who has one with you.

In the family, and next door

	word
Kannada	ಸಂಬಂಧಿಕ (*sambandhika*)
Telugu	బంధువు (*bandhuvu*)
Malayalam	ബന്ധു (*bandhu*)
Hindi (neighbour)	रिश्तेदार (*riśtedār*)
English	a relative

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

உறவினர் (*uṟaviṉar*) is native Dravidian (DEDR 710). It is built on *uṟavu*, "relationship", from *uṟu*, "to be joined, to be close".

What you've built

Children, boy, husband, wife, relative.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *uṟaviṉar*
- *Say it:* *uṟaviṉar*, once more
- *Say it:* say *avar eṉ uṟaviṉar*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for a husband, then the Tamil for a wife, then say *uṟaviṉar* again

Before you move on

What does உறவினர் mean? ("A relative".) Say it once more.

Chapter 101

Grandparents, Aunts and Uncles

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can name grandparents, an uncle and an aunt, and my father's younger brother.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 101: I can name grandparents, an uncle and an aunt, and my father's younger brother.*

101.1 தாத்தா (tāttā) — a grandfather

Before the new one: say the Tamil for a wife, then the Tamil for a relative.

You'll want to know: தாத்தா

தாத்தா (*tāttā*) — "grandfather".
என் தாத்தா — "my grandfather".

In the family, and next door

	word	same root
Kannada	ಅಜ್ಜ (*ajja*)	
Telugu	తాత (*tāta*)	yes
Malayalam	മുത്തച്ഛൻ (*muttacchan*)	
English	a grandfather	

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

தாத்தா (*tāttā*) is native Dravidian. DEDR 3160 lists Malayalam *tātan*, "father", Kannada *tāta* and Telugu *tāta*. The entry compares Sanskrit *tāta*, "father".

What you've built

A grandfather.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *tāttā*
- *Say it:* *tāttā*, once more
- *Say it:* say *en̲ tāttā*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for a wife, then the Tamil for a relative, then say *tāttā* again

Before you move on

What does தாத்தா mean? ("A grandfather".) Say it once more.

101.2 பாட்டி (pāṭṭi) — a grandmother

Before the new one: say the Tamil for a relative, then the Tamil for a grandfather.

You'll want to know: பாட்டி

பாட்டி (*pāṭṭi*) — "grandmother".
பாட்டி வீடு — "grandmother's house".

In the family, and next door

	word
Kannada	అజ్జి (*ajji*)
Telugu	అమ్మమ్మ (*ammamma*)
Malayalam	മുത്തശ്ശി (*muttaśśi*)
English	a grandmother

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

பாட்டி (*pāṭṭi*) is native Dravidian. DEDR 4066 lists Malayalam *pāṭṭan*, "grandfather". The entry lists *pāṭṭi*, "grandmother", beside *pāṭṭāṉ*, "grandfather".

What you've built

Both grandparents.

Your turn

- *Say it: pāṭṭi*
- *Say it: pāṭṭi*, once more
- *Say it:* say *eṉ tāttā, eṉ pāṭṭi*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for a relative, then the Tamil for a grandfather, then say *pāṭṭi* again

Before you move on

What does பாட்டி mean? ("A grandmother".) Say it once more.

101.3 மாமா (māmā) — uncle, the mother's brother

Before the new one: say the Tamil for a grandfather, then the Tamil for a grandmother.

You'll want to know: மாமா

மாமா (*māmā*) — "uncle", above all your mother's brother; also "father-in-law".

Tamil kinship names the side of the family, not only the generation.

In the family, and next door

	word	same root
Kannada	ಮಾವ (*māva*)	yes
Telugu	మామ (*māma*)	yes
Malayalam	അമ്മാവൻ (*ammāvan*)	
English	uncle, the mother's brother	

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

மாமா (*māmā*) is native Dravidian. DEDR 4813 lists Malayalam *māman*, Kannada *māma* and Telugu *māma*. The entry compares Sanskrit *māma*, "maternal uncle" (CDIAL 10055).

What you've built

An uncle, named by side.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *māmā*
- *Say it:* *māmā*, once more
- *Say it:* say *eṉ māmā*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for a grandfather, then the Tamil for a grandmother, then say *māmā* again

Before you move on

What does மாமா mean? ("Uncle, the mother's brother".) Say it once more.

101.4 அத்தை (attai) — aunt, the father's sister

Before the new one: say the Tamil for a grandmother, then the Tamil for an uncle.

You'll want to know: அத்தை

அத்தை (*attai*) — "aunt", your father's sister; also "mother-in-law".
மாமா and அத்தை pair up across the two sides of the family.

In the family, and next door

	word	same root
Telugu	అత్త (*atta*)	yes
English	aunt, the father's sister	

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

அத்தை (*attai*) is native Dravidian. DEDR 142 lists Malayalam *atta*, "mother", Kannada *atte*, "mother-in-law" and Telugu *atta*, "mother-in-law, father's sister". The entry compares Sanskrit (lexicons) and Prakrit *attā*, "mother".

What you've built

An aunt, named by side.

Your turn

- *Say it: attai*
- *Say it: attai*, once more
- *Say it:* say *en attai*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for a grandmother, then the Tamil for an uncle, then say *attai* again

Before you move on

What does அத்தை mean? ("Aunt, the father's sister".) Say it once more.

101.5 சித்தப்பா (cittappā) — the father's younger brother

Before the new one: say the Tamil for an uncle, then the Tamil for an aunt.

You'll want to know: சித்தப்பா

சித்தப்பா (*cittappā*) — your father's younger brother.
It ends in **அப்பா**, "father": he is the *little father*.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

சித்தப்பா (*cittappā*) is native: *citta-*, "small, younger", from *cir̲u*, "small" (DEDR 1594), and *appā*, "father" (DEDR 156). The father's younger brother is "the small father".

What you've built

Grandparents, uncle, aunt, and a little father.

Your turn

- *Say it: cittappā*
- *Say it: cittappā*, once more
- *Say it:* say *en̲ cittappā*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for an uncle, then the Tamil for an aunt, then say *cittappā* again

Before you move on

What does **சித்தப்பா** mean? ("The father's younger brother".) Say it once more.

Chapter 102

Elders and In-Laws

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can name my father's elder brother and his wife, a mother-in-law, and a daughter- or son-in-law.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 102: I can name my father's elder brother and his wife, a mother-in-law, and a daughter- or son-in-law.*

102.1 பெரியப்பா (periyappā) — the father's elder brother

Before the new one: say the Tamil for an aunt, then the Tamil for the father's younger brother.

You'll want to know: பெரியப்பா

பெரியப்பா (*periyappā*) — your father's elder brother, the *big father*.
பெரிய is "big". Beside சித்தப்பா, the little father.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

பெரியப்பா (*periyappā*) is native: *periya*, "big" (DEDR 4411), and *appā*, "father" (DEDR 156): "the big father".

What you've built

Big father and little father.

Your turn

- *Say it: periyappā*
- *Say it: periyappā*, once more
- *Say it:* say *en periyappā*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for an aunt, then the Tamil for the father's younger brother, then say *periyappā* again

Before you move on

What does பெரியப்பா mean? ("The father's elder brother".) Say it once more.

102.2 பெரியம்மா (periyammā) — the big mother (an elder aunt)

Before the new one: say the Tamil for the father's younger brother, then the Tamil for the father's elder brother.

You'll want to know: பெரியம்மா

பெரியம்மா (*periyammā*) — the *big mother*: your mother's elder sister, or the wife of your பெரியப்பா.

அம்மா is the mother you know.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

பெரியம்மா (*periyammā*) is native: *periya*, "big" (DEDR 4411), and *ammā*, "mother" (DEDR 183, which compares Sanskrit *ambā*, "mother"): "the big mother".

What you've built

The big mother.

Your turn

- *Say it: periyammā*

- *Say it:* *periyammā*, once more
- *Say it:* say *en periyammā*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for the father's younger brother, then the Tamil for the father's elder brother, then say *periyammā* again

Before you move on

What does பெரியம்மா mean? ("The big mother (an elder aunt)".) Say it once more.

102.3 மாமியார் (māmiyār) — a mother-in-law

Before the new one: say the Tamil for the father's elder brother, then the Tamil for the big mother.

You'll want to know: மாமியார்

மாமியார் (*māmiyār*) — "a mother-in-law", the respectful word. It is built on the same மாமா root as the uncle.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

மாமியார் (*māmiyār*) is native Dravidian (DEDR 4813). The entry lists *māmi*, "mother-in-law", beside *māmā*, "uncle", which it compares with Sanskrit *māma*; *-yār* is the respectful ending.

What you've built

An in-law.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *māmiyār*
- *Say it:* *māmiyār*, once more
- *Say it:* say *en māmiyār*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for the father's elder brother, then the Tamil for the big mother, then say *māmiyār* again

Before you move on

What does மாமியார் mean? ("A mother-in-law".) Say it once more.

102.4 மருமகள் (marumakaḷ) — a daughter-in-law

Before the new one: say the Tamil for the big mother, then the Tamil for a mother-in-law.

You'll want to know: மருமகள்

மருமகள் (*marumakaḷ*) — "a daughter-in-law".
மகள் is "daughter"; மரு- marks the relation by marriage.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

மருமகள் (*marumakaḷ*) is native Dravidian. DEDR 4715 lists Malayalam *marumakan*. The entry lists the masculine form, "nephew, son-in-law"; here *maru-* is joined to *makaḷ*, "daughter".

What you've built

A daughter by marriage.

Your turn

- *Say it: marumakaḷ*
- *Say it: marumakaḷ*, once more
- *Say it:* say *en marumakaḷ*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for the big mother, then the Tamil for a mother-in-law, then say *marumakaḷ* again

Before you move on

What does மருமகள் mean? ("A daughter-in-law".) Say it once more.

102.5 மருமகன் (marumakaṉ) — a son-in-law

Before the new one: say the Tamil for a mother-in-law, then the Tamil for a daughter-in-law.

You'll want to know: மருமகன்

மருமகன் (*marumakaṉ*) — "a son-in-law".
மகன் is "son"; the same **மரு-** makes him family by marriage.
In the family, and next door

	word
Telugu	అల్లుడు (*alluḍu*)
English	a son-in-law

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

மருமகன் (*marumakaṉ*) is native Dravidian. DEDR 4715 lists Malayalam *marumakan*, "sister's son" and Telugu *manumāḍu*, "grandson".

What you've built

Elders and in-laws.

Your turn

- *Say it: marumakaṉ*
- *Say it: marumakaṉ*, once more
- *Say it:* say *eṉ marumakaṉ*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for a mother-in-law, then the Tamil for a daughter-in-law, then say *marumakaṉ* again

Before you move on

What does **மருமகன்** mean? ("A son-in-law".) Say it once more.

Chapter 103

Grandchildren, Neighbours, Names

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can name a grandson and granddaughter, a neighbour, a family name and a pet name.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 103: I can name a grandson and granddaughter, a neighbour, a family name and a pet name.*

103.1 பேரன் (pēraṉ) — a grandson

> Before the new one: say the Tamil for a daughter-in-law, then the Tamil for a son-in-law.

You'll want to know: பேரன்

பேரன் (*pēraṉ*) — "a grandson".
-அன் marks a man, as in மருமகன்.
In the family, and next door

	word
Kannada	ಮೊಮ್ಮಗ (*mommaga*)
English	a grandson

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

பேரன் (*pēraṉ*) is native Dravidian (DEDR 4410). The entry glosses *pēraṉ* "grandson (as bearing the grandfather's name)": the grandson carries the name, *peyar*.

What you've built

A grandson.

Your turn

- *Say it: pēraṉ*
- *Say it: pēraṉ*, once more
- *Say it:* say *eṉ pēraṉ*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for a daughter-in-law, then the Tamil for a son-in-law, then say *pēraṉ* again

Before you move on

What does பேரன் mean? ("A grandson".) Say it once more.

103.2 பேத்தி (pētti) — a granddaughter

Before the new one: say the Tamil for a son-in-law, then the Tamil for a grandson.

You'll want to know: பேத்தி

பேத்தி (*pētti*) — "a granddaughter".
It pairs with பேரன் the way பாட்டி pairs with தாத்தா.

In the family, and next door

	word
Kannada	ಮೊಮ್ಮಗಳು (*mommagaḷu*)
English	a granddaughter

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

பேத்தி (*pētti*) is the feminine of *pēraṉ*, "grandson", which DEDR 4410 files with *peyar*, "name": the grandchild carries the grandparent's name.

What you've built

Grandson and granddaughter.

Your turn

- *Say it: pētti*
- *Say it: pētti*, once more
- *Say it:* say *eṉ pēraṉ, eṉ pētti*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for a son-in-law, then the Tamil for a grandson, then say *pētti* again

Before you move on

What does பேத்தி mean? ("A granddaughter".) Say it once more.

103.3 பக்கத்து வீட்டுக்காரர் (pakkattu vīṭṭukkārar) — a neighbour

Before the new one: say the Tamil for a grandson, then the Tamil for a granddaughter.

You'll want to know: பக்கத்து வீட்டுக்காரர்

பக்கத்து வீட்டுக்காரர் (*pakkattu vīṭṭukkārar*) — "a neighbour", literally "the person of the house beside".

பக்கம் is "side"; வீடு is "house".

In the family, and next door

	word
Hindi (neighbour)	पड़ोसी (*paṛosī*)
English	a neighbour

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

பக்கத்து வீட்டுக்காரர் (*pakkattu vīṭṭukkārar*) is "the people of the house at the side": *pakkam*, "side", from Sanskrit *pakṣa*, "wing, side" (CDIAL 7627), *vīṭu*, "house", native (DEDR 5393), and *-kārar*, "the

ones who belong to".

What you've built

A neighbour, spelled out as the house beside.

Your turn

- *Say it: pakkattu vīṭṭukkārar*
- *Say it: pakkattu vīṭṭukkārar*, once more
- *Say it:* say *pakkattu vīṭṭukkārar*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for a grandson, then the Tamil for a granddaughter, then say *pakkattu vīṭṭukkārar* again

Before you move on

What does பக்கத்து வீட்டுக்காரர் mean? ("A neighbour".) Say it once more.

103.4 குடும்பப் பெயர் (kuṭumpap peyar) — a family name

Before the new one: say the Tamil for a granddaughter, then the Tamil for a neighbour.

You'll want to know: குடும்பப் பெயர்

குடும்பப் பெயர் (*kuṭumpap peyar*) — "a family name".

பெயர் is the "name" of your first introductions; குடும்பம் is "family". Many Tamil names use a father's initial where English uses a surname.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

குடும்பப் பெயர் (*kuṭumpap peyar*) is *kuṭumbam*, "family", from Sanskrit *kuṭumba* (CDIAL 3233), and native *peyar*, "name" (DEDR 4410).

What you've built

A family name, and what often stands in for it.

Your turn

- *Say it: kuṭumpap peyar*
- *Say it: kuṭumpap peyar*, once more
- *Say it:* say *kuṭumpap peyar*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for a granddaughter, then the Tamil for a neighbour, then say *kuṭumpap peyar* again

Before you move on

What does குடும்பப் பெயர் mean? ("A family name".) Say it once more.

103.5 செல்லப்பெயர் (cellappeyar) — a pet name, a nickname

Before the new one: say the Tamil for a neighbour, then the Tamil for a family name.

You'll want to know: செல்லப்பெயர்

செல்லப்பெயர் (*cellappeyar*) — "a pet name", literally "darling-name". செல்லம் is "darling, pet".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

செல்லப்பெயர் (*cellappeyar*) is native: *cellam*, "treasure, darling", which DEDR 2786 files among words for wealth, and *peyar*, "name" (DEDR 4410).

What you've built

Grandchildren, a neighbour, a family name, a pet name.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *cellappeyar*
- *Say it:* *cellappeyar*, once more
- *Say it:* say *en cellappeyar …*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for a neighbour, then the Tamil for a family name, then say *cellappeyar* again

Before you move on

What does செல்லப்பெயர் mean? (“A pet name, a nickname”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 104

Language, Wedding, Birthday

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can talk about languages and English, a wedding, an address and a birthday.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 104: I can talk about languages and English, a wedding, an address and a birthday.*

104.1 மொழி (mo̲li) — a language

> Before the new one: say the Tamil for a family name, then the Tamil for a pet name.

You'll want to know: மொழி

மொழி (*mo̲li*) — "a language".

தமிழ் என் மொழி — "Tamil is my language". தாய்மொழி is "mother tongue".

In the family, and next door

	word
Kannada	ಭಾಷೆ (*bhāṣe*)
Telugu	భాష (*bhāṣa*)
Malayalam	ഭാഷ (*bhāṣa*)
Hindi (neighbour)	भाषा (*bhāshā*)
English	a language

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

மொழி (*mo̱li*) is native Dravidian. DEDR 4989 lists Malayalam *mo̱li*, "word". The entry glosses *mo̱li* "to say, to speak; word, language".

What you've built

A language.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *mo̱li*
- *Say it:* *mo̱li*, once more
- *Say it:* say *tami̱l e̱n mo̱li*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for a family name, then the Tamil for a pet name, then say *mo̱li* again

Before you move on

What does மொழி mean? ("A language".) Say it once more.

104.2 ஆங்கிலம் (āṅkilam) — English, the language

Before the new one: say the Tamil for a pet name, then the Tamil for a language.

You'll want to know: ஆங்கிலம்

ஆங்கிலம் (*āṅkilam*) — "English".
எனக்கு ஆங்கிலம் தெரியும் — "I know English".

In the family, and next door

	word
Kannada	ಇಂಗ್ಲಿಷ್ (*iṅgliṣ*)
Telugu	ఇంగ్లీషు (*iṅglīṣu*)
Malayalam	ഇംഗ്ലീഷ് (*iṁglīṣ*)
Hindi (neighbour)	अंग्रेज़ी (*angrezī*)
English	English, the language

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

ஆங்கிலம் (*āṅkilam*) usually comes from *Āṅgla*, the Sanskrit-style name for the English, which itself goes back to the English people's own name, the Angles (as in *Anglo-*). Tamil added its *-am*.

What you've built

English.

Your turn

- *Say it: āṅkilam*
- *Say it: āṅkilam*, once more
- *Say it:* say *eṉakku āṅkilam teriyum*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for a pet name, then the Tamil for a language, then say *āṅkilam* again

Before you move on

What does ஆங்கிலம் mean? ("English, the language".) Say it once more.

104.3 திருமணம் (tirumaṇam) — a wedding, marriage

Before the new one: say the Tamil for a language, then the Tamil for English.

You'll want to know: திருமணம்

திருமணம் (*tirumaṇam*) — "a wedding", "marriage".
திரு- is "sacred, honoured", as in the title திரு, "Mr".
In the family, and next door

	word
Kannada	ಮದುವೆ (*maduve*)
Telugu	పెళ్ళి (*peḷḷi*)
Malayalam	കല്യാണം (*kalyāṇam*)
Hindi (neighbour)	शादी (*śādī*)
English	a wedding, marriage

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

திருமணம் (*tirumaṇam*) is *tiru*, "holy, auspicious", usually traced to Sanskrit *śrī* (CDIAL 12708), and native *maṇam*, "union, marriage" (DEDR 4667; Malayalam *maṇam*).

What you've built

A wedding.

Your turn

- *Say it: tirumaṇam*
- *Say it: tirumaṇam*, once more
- *Say it:* say *tirumaṇam*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for a language, then the Tamil for English, then say *tirumaṇam* again

Before you move on

What does திருமணம் mean? ("A wedding, marriage".) Say it once more.

104.4 முகவரி (mukavari) — an address

Before the new one: say the Tamil for English, then the Tamil for a wedding.

You'll want to know: முகவரி

முகவரி (*mukavari*) — "an address", literally "face-line".

உங்கள் முகவரி என்ன? — "what is your address?".

In the family, and next door

	word
Kannada	ವಿಳಾಸ (*viḷāsa*)
Telugu	చిరునామా (*cirunāmā*)
Malayalam	വിലാസം (*vilāsam*)
English	an address

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

முகவரி (*mukavari*) is "face-line": *mukam*, "face", from Sanskrit *mukha* (CDIAL 10158), and native *vari*, "line, writing" (DEDR 5263).

What you've built

An address.

Your turn

- *Say it: mukavari*
- *Say it: mukavari*, once more
- *Say it:* ask *uṅkaḷ mukavari eṉṉa?*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for English, then the Tamil for a wedding, then say *mukavari* again

Before you move on

What does **முகவரி** mean? ("An address".) Say it once more.

104.5 பிறந்தநாள் (piṟantanāḷ) — a birthday

Before the new one: say the Tamil for a wedding, then the Tamil for an address.

You'll want to know: பிறந்தநாள்

பிறந்தநாள் (*piṟantanāḷ*) — "a birthday", literally "the day one was born".

பிறந்தநாள் வாழ்த்துகள் — "happy birthday", with the wishes you know.

In the family, and next door

	word
Kannada	ಹುಟ್ಟುಹಬ್ಬ (*huṭṭuhabba*)
Telugu	పుట్టినరోజు (*puṭṭinarōju*)
Hindi (neighbour)	जन्मदिन (*janmdin*)
English	a birthday

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

பிறந்தநாள் (*piṟantanāḷ*) is native: *piṟanta*, "on which one was born", from *piṟa*, "to be born" (DEDR 4422), and *nāḷ*, "day" (DEDR 3656).

What you've built

Language, English, wedding, address, birthday.

Your turn

- *Say it: piṟantanāḷ*
- *Say it: piṟantanāḷ*, once more
- *Say it:* say *piṟantanāḷ vāḻttukaḷ*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for a wedding, then the Tamil for an address, then say *piṟantanāḷ* again

Before you move on

What does பிறந்தநாள் mean? ("A birthday".) Say it once more.

Chapter 105

Signature, Work, School

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (4) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 4 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can sign my name, say what my work is, and talk about college and school.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 105: I can sign my name, say what my work is, and talk about college and school.*

105.1 கையெழுத்து (kaiyeḻuttu) — a signature; handwriting

> Before the new one: say the Tamil for an address, then the Tamil for a birthday.

You'll want to know: கையெழுத்து

கையெழுத்து (*kaiyeḻuttu*) — "a signature", and "handwriting", literally "hand-writing".

கை is "hand"; எழுத்து is "writing". இங்கே கையெழுத்துப் போடுங்கள் — "please sign here".

In the family, and next door

	word
Telugu	సంతకం (*santakam̐*)
Hindi (neighbour)	हस्ताक्षर (*hastākṣar*)
English	a signature

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

கையெழுத்து (*kaiyeḻuttu*) is native: *kai*, "hand" (DEDR 2023), and *eḻuttu*, "writing" (DEDR 853): "hand-writing".

What you've built

A signature, built from hand and writing.

Your turn

- *Say it: kaiyeḻuttu*
- *Say it: kaiyeḻuttu*, once more
- *Say it:* say *iṅkē kaiyeḻuttup pōṭuṅkaḷ*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for an address, then the Tamil for a birthday, then say *kaiyeḻuttu* again

Before you move on

What does கையெழுத்து mean? ("A signature; handwriting".) Say it once more.

105.2 தொழில் (toḻil) — an occupation, a trade

Before the new one: say the Tamil for a birthday, then the Tamil for a signature.

You'll want to know: தொழில்

தொழில் (*toḻil*) — "an occupation", "a trade".
உங்கள் தொழில் என்ன? — "what is your occupation?".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

தொழில் (*toḻil*) is native Dravidian. DEDR 3524 lists Malayalam *toḻil*, "business" and Kannada *tuḻil*, "work".

What you've built

The question after a name.

Your turn

- *Say it: to̲li̲l*
- *Say it: to̲li̲l*, once more
- *Say it:* ask *uṅkaḷ to̲li̲l e̲nn̲a?*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for a birthday, then the Tamil for a signature, then say *to̲li̲l* again

Before you move on

What does தொழில் mean? ("An occupation, a trade".) Say it once more.

105.3 கல்லூரி (kallūri) — a college

Before the new one: say the Tamil for a signature, then the Tamil for an occupation.

You'll want to know: கல்லூரி

கல்லூரி (*kallūri*) — "a college".
It is built on **கல்**, "to learn": a college is a *learning-place*.

In the family, and next door

	word
Kannada	**ಕಾಲೇಜು** (*kālēju*)
English	a college

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

கல்லூரி (*kallūri*) is a modern coinage built on native *kal*, "to learn" (DEDR 1297): "the place of learning".

What you've built

Where a student studies.

Your turn

- *Say it: kallūri*
- *Say it: kallūri*, once more
- *Say it:* say *kallūri*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for a signature, then the Tamil for an occupation, then say *kallūri* again

Before you move on

What does கல்லூரி mean? ("A college".) Say it once more.

105.4 பள்ளி (paḷḷi) — a school

Before the new one: say the Tamil for an occupation, then the Tamil for a college.

You'll want to know: பள்ளி

பள்ளி (*paḷḷi*) — "a school".

பள்ளிக்கூடம் is the fuller word; பள்ளி alone is what people say.

In the family, and next door

	word	same root
Kannada	ಶಾಲೆ (*śāle*)	
Telugu	బడి (*baḍi*)	
Malayalam	പള്ളിക്കൂടം (*paḷḷikkūṭaṁ*)	yes
English	a school	

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

பள்ளி (*paḷḷi*) is native Dravidian. DEDR 4018 lists Malayalam *paḷḷi*, Kannada *haḷḷi*, "village" and Telugu *palli*, "village". It first meant a hamlet, then a hermitage or temple, where children were taught. The entry compares Sanskrit *pallī*, "small village" (CDIAL 7972).

What you've built

Signature, occupation, college, school.

Your turn

- *Say it: paḷḷi*
- *Say it: paḷḷi*, once more
- *Say it:* say *paḷḷi*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for an occupation, then the Tamil for a college, then say *paḷḷi* again

Before you move on

What does பள்ளி mean? ("A school".) Say it once more.

Chapter 106

Take Care, Go Safely

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can tell someone to take care and go safely, say it is late, suggest we go, and talk about a holiday.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 106: I can tell someone to take care and go safely, say it is late, suggest we go, and talk about a holiday.*

106.1 பார்த்துக்கொள்ளுங்கள் (pārttukkoḷḷuṅkaḷ) — take care

Before the new one: say the Tamil for a college, then the Tamil for a school.

You'll want to know: பார்த்துக்கொள்ளுங்கள்

பார்த்துக்கொள்ளுங்கள் (*pārttukkoḷḷuṅkaḷ*) — "take care", literally "look after (yourself)".

It is built on **பார்**, "to see, to look".

In the family, and next door

	word
Kannada	ಹುಷಾರು (*huṣāru*)
Malayalam	സൂക്ഷിക്കണേ (*sūkṣikkaṇē*)
Hindi (neighbour)	ध्यान रखिए (*dhyān rakhie*)
English	take care

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

பார்த்துக்கொள்ளுங்கள் (*pārttukkoḷḷuṅkaḷ*) is native: *pār*, "to look" (DEDR 4091), and *koḷ*, "to take, to keep" (DEDR 2151): "look after (yourself)".

What you've built

The kindest goodbye.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *pārttukkoḷḷuṅkaḷ*
- *Say it:* *pārttukkoḷḷuṅkaḷ*, once more
- *Say it:* say *pārttukkoḷḷuṅkaḷ*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for a college, then the Tamil for a school, then say *pārttukkoḷḷuṅkaḷ* again

Before you move on

What does பார்த்துக்கொள்ளுங்கள் mean? ("Take care".) Say it once more.

106.2 பத்திரமாக (pattiramāka) — safely

Before the new one: say the Tamil for a school, then the Tamil for take care.

You'll want to know: பத்திரமாக

பத்திரமாக (*pattiramāka*) — "safely".
பத்திரமாகப் போங்கள் — "go safely".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

பத்திரமாக (*pattiramāka*) is *pattiram*, "safety, care", from Sanskrit *bhadra*, "fortunate, good" (CDIAL 9377), with *-āka*, "in the manner of".

What you've built

A wish for the road.

Your turn

- *Say it: pattiramāka*
- *Say it: pattiramāka*, once more
- *Say it:* say *pattiramākap pōṅkaḷ*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for a school, then the Tamil for take care, then say *pattiramāka* again

Before you move on

What does பத்திரமாக mean? ("Safely".) Say it once more.

106.3 நேரமாகிவிட்டது (nēramākiviṭṭatu) — it has got late

Before the new one: say the Tamil for take care, then the Tamil for safely.

You'll want to know: நேரமாகிவிட்டது

நேரமாகிவிட்டது (*nēramākiviṭṭatu*) — "it has got late", literally "it has become time".

நேரம் is "time". The first reason to leave.

In the family, and next door

	word
Hindi (neighbour)	देर हो गई (*der ho gaī*)
English	it has got late

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

நேரமாகிவிட்டது (*nēramākiviṭṭatu*) is native: *nēram*, "time" (DEDR 3774), *ā*, "to become" (DEDR 333), and *viṭu*, "to let go", which marks the thing as done (DEDR 5393): "time has become (late)".

What you've built

A reason to go.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *nēramākiviṭṭatu*
- *Say it:* *nēramākiviṭṭatu*, once more
- *Say it:* say *nēramākiviṭṭatu*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for take care, then the Tamil for safely, then say *nēramākiviṭṭatu* again

Before you move on

What does நேரமாகிவிட்டது mean? ("It has got late".) Say it once more.

106.4 போகலாம் (pōkalām) — let's go

Before the new one: say the Tamil for safely, then the Tamil for it has got late.

You'll want to know: போகலாம்

போகலாம் (*pōkalām*) — "let's go", "we can go".
It is **போ**, "go", with **-லாம்**, "may, let us".

In the family, and next door

	word	same root
Kannada	ಹೋಗೋಣ (*hōgōṇa*)	
Telugu	పదండి (*padaṇḍi*)	
Malayalam	പോകാം (*pōkāṁ*)	yes
Hindi (neighbour)	चलिए (*calie*)	
English	let's go	

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

போகலாம் (*pōkalām*) is native Dravidian. DEDR 4572 lists Malayalam *pōka*. It is *pō*, "to go", with *-kalām*, "let us".

What you've built

Late, so let's go.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *pōkalām*
- *Say it:* *pōkalām*, once more
- *Say it:* say *pōkalām*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for safely, then the Tamil for it has got late, then say *pōkalām* again

Before you move on

What does போகலாம் mean? ("Let's go".) Say it once more.

106.5 விடுமுறை (viṭumuṟai) — a holiday

Before the new one: say the Tamil for it has got late, then the Tamil for let's go.

You'll want to know: விடுமுறை

விடுமுறை (*viṭumuṟai*) — "a holiday", "leave".
இன்று விடுமுறை — "today is a holiday".

In the family, and next door

	word
Kannada	ರಜೆ (*raje*)
Malayalam	അവധി (*avadhi*)
Hindi (neighbour)	छुट्टी (*chuṭṭī*)
English	a holiday

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

விடுமுறை (*viṭumuṟai*) is native: *viṭu*, "to leave, to free" (DEDR 5393), and *muṟai*, "turn, time" (DEDR 5015): "a time of release".

What you've built

Take care, safely, it's late, let's go, a holiday.

Your turn

- *Say it: viṭumuṟai*
- *Say it: viṭumuṟai*, once more
- *Say it:* say *iṉṟu viṭumuṟai*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for it has got late, then the Tamil for let's go, then say *viṭumuṟai* again

Before you move on

What does விடுமுறை mean? ("A holiday".) Say it once more.

Chapter 107

See You Later

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can take my leave, ask if we should go, say see you later, wish a good journey and ask someone to come again.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 107: I can take my leave, ask if we should go, say see you later, wish a good journey and ask someone to come again.*

107.1 விடைபெறுகிறேன் (viṭaipe̱rukiṟēn̲) — I take my leave

> Before the new one: say the Tamil for let's go, then the Tamil for a holiday.

You'll want to know: விடைபெறுகிறேன்

விடைபெறுகிறேன் (*viṭaipe̱rukiṟēn̲*) — "I take my leave", literally "I receive leave".

விடை is "leave, permission". The formal goodbye.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

விடைபெறுகிறேன் (*viṭaipe̱rukiṟēn̲*) is native: *viṭai*, "leave, permission to go" (DEDR 5393), and *pe̱ru*, "to get" (DEDR 4422): "I get my leave".

What you've built

A formal way out of a room.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *viṭaipeṟukiṟēṉ*
- *Say it:* *viṭaipeṟukiṟēṉ*, once more
- *Say it:* say *viṭaipeṟukiṟēṉ*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for let's go, then the Tamil for a holiday, then say *viṭaipeṟukiṟēṉ* again

Before you move on

What does விடைபெறுகிறேன் mean? ("I take my leave".) Say it once more.

107.2 கிளம்பலாமா? (kiḷampalāmā?) — shall we leave?

Before the new one: say the Tamil for a holiday, then the Tamil for I take my leave.

You'll want to know: கிளம்பலாமா?

கிளம்பலாமா? (*kiḷampalāmā?*) — "shall we leave?".
கிளம்பு is "to set out"; **-லாமா** asks "shall we?".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

கிளம்பலாமா? (*kiḷampalāmā?*) is native Dravidian. DEDR 1583 lists Malayalam *kiḷampuka*, "to rise". The entry lists *kiḷampu*, "to rise, to start up": to leave is to get up and go.

What you've built

A gentle nudge to go.

Your turn

- *Say it: kiḻampalāmā?*
- *Say it: kiḻampalāmā?*, once more
- *Say it:* ask *kiḻampalāmā?*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for a holiday, then the Tamil for I take my leave, then say *kiḻampalāmā?* again

Before you move on

What does கிளம்பலாமா? mean? ("Shall we leave?".) Say it once more.

107.3 அப்புறம் பார்க்கலாம் (appuṟam pārkkalām) — see you later

Before the new one: say the Tamil for I take my leave, then the Tamil for shall we leave.

You'll want to know: அப்புறம் பார்க்கலாம்

அப்புறம் பார்க்கலாம் (*appuṟam pārkkalām*) — "see you later".

அப்புறம் is "afterwards"; பார்க்கலாம் is "we can see (each other)". To one friend: உன்னை அப்புறம் பார்க்கிறேன் — "I'll see you later", with உன்னை, "you" as the one it is done to.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

அப்புறம் பார்க்கலாம் (*appuṟam pārkkalām*) is native: *appuṟam*, "after that", from the far base *a-* (DEDR 1) and *puṟam*, "side" (DEDR 4333), and *pārkkalām*, "let us see", from *pār* (DEDR 4091).

What you've built

A casual goodbye.

Your turn

- *Say it: appu̲ram pārkkalām*
- *Say it: appu̲ram pārkkalām*, once more
- *Say it:* say *appu̲ram pārkkalām*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for I take my leave, then the Tamil for shall we leave, then say *appu̲ram pārkkalām* again

Before you move on

What does அப்புறம் பார்க்கலாம் mean? ("See you later".) Say it once more.

107.4 இனிய பயணம் (i̲niya payaṇam) — have a good journey

Before the new one: say the Tamil for shall we leave, then the Tamil for see you later.

You'll want to know: இனிய பயணம்

இனிய பயணம் (*i̲niya payaṇam*) — "have a good journey", literally "a sweet journey".

இனிய is "sweet, pleasant".

In the family, and next door

	word
Hindi (neighbour)	शुभ यात्रा (*śubh yātrā*)
English	have a good journey

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

இனிய பயணம் (*i̲niya payaṇam*) is native *i̲niya*, "sweet, pleasant" (DEDR 530), and *payaṇam*, "journey", from Sanskrit *prayāṇa* (CDIAL 8732).

What you've built

A wish for someone setting off.

Your turn

- *Say it: iṉiya payaṇam*
- *Say it: iṉiya payaṇam*, once more
- *Say it:* say *iṉiya payaṇam!*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for shall we leave, then the Tamil for see you later, then say *iṉiya payaṇam* again

Before you move on

What does இனிய பயணம் mean? (“Have a good journey”.) Say it once more.

107.5 மீண்டும் வாருங்கள் (mīṇṭum vāruṅkaḷ) — please come again

Before the new one: say the Tamil for see you later, then the Tamil for a good journey.

You’ll want to know: மீண்டும் வாருங்கள்

மீண்டும் வாருங்கள் (*mīṇṭum vāruṅkaḷ*) — “please come again”.
மீண்டும் is “again”, with the welcome வாருங்கள்.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

மீண்டும் வாருங்கள் (*mīṇṭum vāruṅkaḷ*) is native: *mīṇṭum*, “again”, from *mīḷ*, “to return” (DEDR 4883), and *vā*, “come” (DEDR 5270), with the polite ending.

What you’ve built

Take leave, shall we go, see you, a good journey, come again.

Your turn

- *Say it: mīṇṭum vāruṅkaḷ*
- *Say it: mīṇṭum vāruṅkaḷ*, once more

- *Say it:* say *mīṇṭum vāruṅkaḷ*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for see you later, then the Tamil for a good journey, then say *mīṇṭum vāruṅkaḷ* again

Before you move on

What does மீண்டும் வாருங்கள் mean? (“Please come again”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 108

Greetings People Actually Say

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (7) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 7 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can greet someone the way Tamil speakers do day to day: have you eaten, long time, what's new, are you well, how are you.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 108: I can greet someone the way Tamil speakers do day to day: have you eaten, long time, what's new, are you well, how are you.*

108.1 சாப்பிட்டீர்களா? (cāppiṭṭīrkaḷā?) — have you eaten?

> Before the new one: say the Tamil for a good journey, then the Tamil for come again.

You'll want to know: சாப்பிட்டீர்களா?

சாப்பிட்டீர்களா? (*cāppiṭṭīrkaḷā?*) — "have you eaten?".

Around a mealtime it is a greeting and a kindness, built on **சாப்பிடு**, "eat".

In the family, and next door

	word
Kannada	**ಊಟ ಆಯ್ತಾ** (*ūṭa āytā*)
Telugu	**భోంచేశారా?** (*bhōñcēśārā?*)
Hindi (neighbour)	**खाना खाया?** (*khānā khāyā?*)
English	have you eaten?

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

சாப்பிட்டீர்களா? (*cāppiṭṭīrkaḷā?*) is the past of *sāppiḍu*, "to eat" (*sāppu*, "food", with *iḍu*, "to put", DEDR 442), with the question ending *-ā*.

What you've built

A greeting about food.

Your turn

- *Say it: cāppiṭṭīrkaḷā?*
- *Say it: cāppiṭṭīrkaḷā?*, once more
- *Say it:* ask *cāppiṭṭīrkaḷā?*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for a good journey, then the Tamil for come again, then say *cāppiṭṭīrkaḷā?* again

Before you move on

What does சாப்பிட்டீர்களா? mean? ("Have you eaten?".) Say it once more.

108.2 ரொம்ப நாளாச்சு (rompa nāḷāccu) — it's been a long time

Before the new one: say the Tamil for come again, then the Tamil for have you eaten.

You'll want to know: ரொம்ப நாளாச்சு

ரொம்ப நாளாச்சு (*rompa nāḷāccu*) — "it's been a long time", in everyday speech.

ரொம்ப is spoken "very"; நாள் is "day".

In the family, and next door

	word
Kannada	ತುಂಬಾ ದಿನ ಆಯ್ತು (*tumbā dina āytu*)
Telugu	చాలా రోజులైంది (*cālā rōjulaindi*)
Hindi (neighbour)	बहुत दिन हो गए (*bahut din ho gae*)
English	it's been a long time

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

ரொம்ப நாளாச்சு (*rompa nāḷāccu*) is native: *rompa*, "very", the spoken form of *nirampa*, "fully", from *nira*, "to be full" (DEDR 3672), and *nāḷ*, "day" (DEDR 3656), with *āccu*, "it has become": "it has been many days".

What you've built

A greeting for someone you have not seen.

Your turn

- *Say it: rompa nāḷāccu*
- *Say it: rompa nāḷāccu*, once more
- *Say it:* say *rompa nāḷāccu!*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for come again, then the Tamil for have you eaten, then say *rompa nāḷāccu* again

Before you move on

What does ரொம்ப நாளாச்சு mean? ("It's been a long time".) Say it once more.

108.3 என்ன விசேஷம்? (enna vicēṣam?) — what's new?

Before the new one: say the Tamil for have you eaten, then the Tamil for it's been a long time.

You'll want to know: என்ன விசேஷம்?

என்ன விசேஷம்? (*ennā vicēṣam?*) — "what's new?", literally "what's special?".

In the family, and next door

	word
Kannada	**ಏನು ಸಮಾಚಾರ** (*ēnu samācāra*)
Telugu	**ఏంటి సంగతి**? (*ēṇṭi saṅgati?*)
English	what's new?

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

என்ன விசேஷம்? (*ennā vicēṣam?*) is native *ennā*, "what" (DEDR 5151), and *vicēṣam*, "news, something special", a well-established loan from Sanskrit *viśeṣa*, "distinction, something particular".

What you've built

A friendly opener.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *ennā vicēṣam?*
- *Say it:* *ennā vicēṣam?*, once more
- *Say it:* ask *ennā vicēṣam?*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for have you eaten, then the Tamil for it's been a long time, then say *ennā vicēṣam?* again

Before you move on

What does **என்ன விசேஷம்**? mean? ("What's new?".) Say it once more.

108.4 நல்லா இருக்கீங்களா? (nallā irukkīṅkaḷā?) — are you well? (spoken)

Before the new one: say the Tamil for it's been a long time, then the Tamil for what's new.

You'll want to know: நல்லா இருக்கீங்களா?

நல்லா இருக்கீங்களா? (*nallā irukkīṅkaḷā?*) — "are you well?", as people say it.

நல்லா is spoken நன்றாக, "well".

In the family, and next door

	word
Kannada	ಕ್ಷೇಮವೇ (*kṣēmavē*)
Telugu	బాగున్నారా? (*bāgunnārā?*)
English	are you well?

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

நல்லா இருக்கீங்களா? (*nallā irukkīṅkaḷā?*) is native: *nallā*, spoken for *nallāka*, "well", from *nal*, "good" (DEDR 3610), and *iru*, "to be" (DEDR 480).

What you've built

The spoken shape of a question you know.

Your turn

- *Say it: nallā irukkīṅkaḷā?*
- *Say it: nallā irukkīṅkaḷā?*, once more
- *Say it:* ask *nallā irukkīṅkaḷā?*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for it's been a long time, then the Tamil for what's new, then say *nallā irukkīṅkaḷā?* again

Before you move on

What does நல்லா இருக்கீங்களா? mean? ("Are you well? (spoken)".) Say it once more.

108.5 எப்படி இருக்கீங்க? (eppaṭi irukkīṅka?) — how are you? (spoken)

Before the new one: say the Tamil for what's new, then the Tamil for are you well.

You'll want to know: எப்படி இருக்கீங்க?

எப்படி இருக்கீங்க? (*eppaṭi irukkīṅka?*) — "how are you?", the everyday spoken form.

It is the written **எப்படி இருக்கிறீர்கள்?** worn short in speech.

In the family, and next door

	word
Kannada	ನೀವು ಹೇಗಿದ್ದೀರಾ? (*nīvu hēgiddīrā*)
Telugu	మీరు ఎలా ఉన్నారు? (*mīru elā unnāru?*)
Malayalam	സുഖമാണോ? (*sukhamāṇō?*)
Hindi (neighbour)	आप कैसे हैं? (*āp kaise haiṁ?*)
English	how are you?

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

எப்படி இருக்கீங்க? (*eppaṭi irukkīṅka?*) is native: *eppaṭi*, "how" (DEDR 5151), and *iru*, "to be" (DEDR 480), in its spoken form.

What you've built

Five greetings people actually use.

Your turn

- *Say it: eppaṭi irukkīṅka?*
- *Say it: eppaṭi irukkīṅka?*, once more
- *Say it:* ask *eppaṭi irukkīṅka?*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for what's new, then the Tamil for are you well, then say *eppaṭi irukkīṅka?* again

Before you move on

What does எப்படி இருக்கீங்க? mean? ("How are you? (spoken)".) Say it once more.

108.6 Hello and goodbye, the everyday way — a second pass

You meet an old friend around lunchtime. Say two things.

Grammar Lens: written and spoken

spoken	written
நல்லா இருக்கீங்க	நன்றாக இருக்கிறீர்கள்

Spoken Tamil wears the written forms short. Both are right; they are for different places.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- ask a friend how they are, the spoken way; then what's new
- at the door: shall we leave? see you later
- wish a traveller a good journey; ask them to come again
- take your leave formally

Before you move on

I take my leave? (விடைபெறுகிறேன்.) Shall we leave? (கிளம்பலாமா?) See you later? (அப்புறம் பார்க்கலாம்.) A good journey? (இனிய பயணம்.) Come again? (மீண்டும் வாருங்கள்.) Have you eaten? (சாப்பிட்டீர்களா?) Long time? (ரொம்ப நாளாச்சு.) What's new? (என்ன விசேஷம்?) Are you well? (நல்லா இருக்கீங்களா?) How are you? (எப்படி இருக்கீங்க?)

108.7 Leaving well — a second pass

It has got late. Say so, and suggest you all go.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- tell your host to take care; they tell you to go safely
- say tomorrow is a holiday
- next week, greet the same host: are you well? how are you?

Before you move on

Take care? (பார்த்துக்கொள்ளுங்கள்.) Safely? (பத்திரமாக.) It's late? (நேரமாகிவிட்டது.) Let's go? (போகலாம்.) A holiday? (விடுமுறை.) Are you well? (நல்லா இருக்கீங்களா?) How are you? (எப்படி இருக்கீங்க?)

Chapter 109

Letters From Your First Words

Modes: ✓ **pen** (3) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** none of the 3 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can write the letters i and sa and the vowel sign ai, and find each one in a word I have said since chapter 1.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 109: I can write the letters i and sa and the vowel sign ai, and find each one in a word I have said since chapter 1.*

109.1 இ — the letter that opens இல்லை

Before the new one: read உ and ஓ aloud, and write each once.

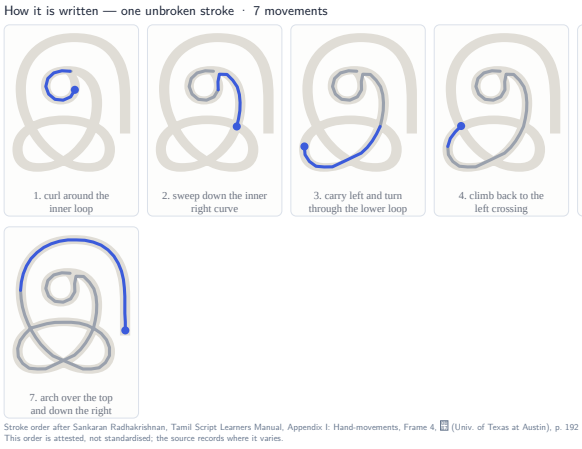
Now say இல்லை (*illai*), "no". You have read it for a long time. This lesson takes one character out of it and puts it in your hand.

Script you'll notice: இ

இ — *i*.

It is the letter at the front of இல்லை (*illai*), "no", one of the first words in this book. You have been writing its **sign**, ி, since நன்றி. This is the **independent** shape of the same vowel: the one a word uses when it *begins* with the sound.

Writing: ஹ



How ஹ is written, stroke by stroke

- **1.** start inside the upper curl and sweep around it
- **2.** without lifting, sweep down the inner right curve
- **3.** without lifting, carry left down the lower diagonal and turn around the lower-left loop
- **4.** without lifting, climb the loop's outer side back to the left crossing
- **5.** without lifting, carry right across the middle and turn around the lower-right loop
- **6.** without lifting, climb the other diagonal back across the middle and on up the outer left side
- **7.** without lifting, arch over the top and down the far right — and only now lift

Pen lifts: 0. The pen never leaves the paper.

Stroke order is one attested teaching order, not a national standard — Tamil handwriting is taught with school-to-school variation. Source: Sankaran Radhakrishnan, Tamil Script Learners Manual, Appendix I: Hand-movements, Frame 4, ஹ (Univ. of Texas at Austin), p. 192.

Your turn

- *Look:* at இல்லை and point at இ inside it
- *Trace it:* இ three times, saying *i* as you finish each one
- *Write it:* ஓ, then இ, from memory
- *Read it:* இல்லை aloud once more

Before you move on

Which character is this — இ? (**i**.) Which word did it come from? (இல்லை, *illai*, "no".)

109.2 ை — the sign that ends இல்லை

Before the new one: read ஓ and இ aloud, and write each once.

Now say இல்லை (*illai*), "no". You have read it for a long time. This lesson takes one character out of it and puts it in your hand.

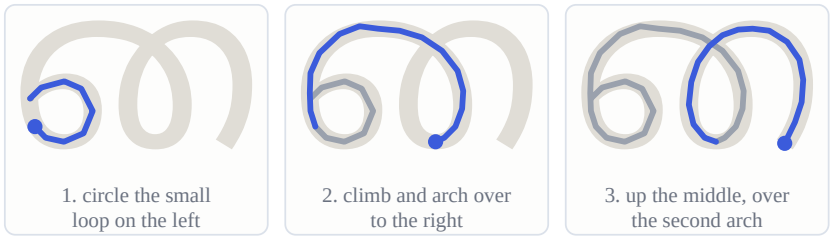
Script you'll notice: ை

ை — *ai*.

It is a **vowel sign**, not a letter. It attaches to a consonant and replaces the built-in *a* with *ai*. Look at the end of இல்லை: the sign sits on the **left** of ல, although you say it after. Tamil writes this sign first and sounds it second.

Writing: ை

How it is written — one unbroken stroke · 3 movements



Stroke order after HP Labs India, Lipi Toolkit, Lipi Indic Character Recognizers 4.0, Tamil recognizer, class 43 (ஐ, ai sign): stored online-handwriting prototypes from native Tamil writers (MIT licence, 2012)
This order is attested, not standardised; the source records where it varies.

How ை is written, stroke by stroke

Follow the numbered strip: start where movement 1 begins, and let each panel show you the next movement before your pen makes it. Then write ை yourself — slowly, and larger than it is printed.

> The strip shows **where to start the character and which way to travel**, in one attested order. That is taught with real variation from school to school, so the strip names its source beneath it: treat it as a sound way in, not the only one.

Your turn

- *Look:* at இல்லை and point at ை inside it
- *Trace it:* ை three times, saying *ai* as you finish each one
- *Write it:* இ, then ை, from memory
- *Read it:* இல்லை aloud once more

Before you move on

Which character is this — ை? (**ai**.) Which word did it come from? (இல்லை, *illai*, "no".)

109.3 ஸ — the letter inside நமஸ்காரம்

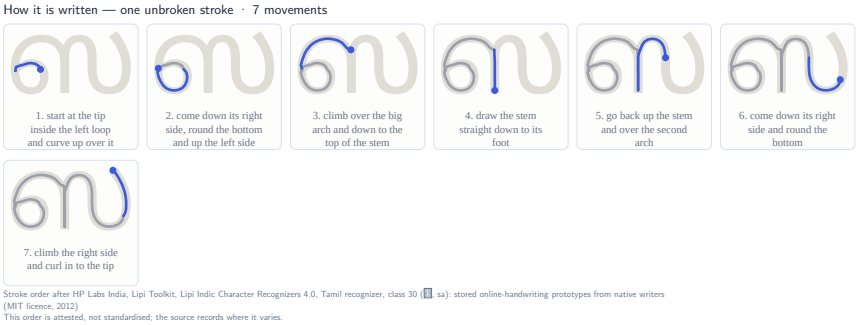
> Before the new one: read இ and ஸ aloud, and write each once.
>
> Now say நமஸ்காரம் (*namaskāram*), "the borrowed bow-word". You have read it for a long time. This lesson takes one character out of it and puts it in your hand.

Script you'll notice: ஸ

ஸ — *sa*.

It is inside நமஸ்காரம் (*namaskāram*), the borrowed bow-word you met beside வணக்கம். ஸ is a **Grantha** letter: Tamil added it to write words that came from Sanskrit, so you will see it mostly in borrowed words.

Writing: ஸ



How ஸ *is written, stroke by stroke*

Follow the numbered strip: start where movement 1 begins, and let each panel show you the next movement before your pen makes it. Then write ஸ yourself — slowly, and larger than it is printed.

> The strip shows **where to start the character and which way to travel**, in one attested order. That is taught with real variation from school to school, so the strip names its source beneath it: treat it as a sound way in, not the only one.

Your turn

- *Look:* at நமஸ்காரம் and point at ஸ inside it

- *Trace it:* ஸ three times, saying *sa* as you finish each one
- *Write it:* ஸ◌, then ஸ, from memory
- *Read it:* நமஸ்காரம் aloud once more

Before you move on

Which character is this — ஸ? (**sa**.) Which word did it come from? (நமஸ்காரம், *namaskāram*, "the borrowed bow-word".)

Chapter 110

Letters From You and Your Name

Modes: ✓ **pen** (4) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** none of the 4 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can write the letters nga and lla and the vowel signs ii and e, and find each one in niingal or peyar.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 110: I can write the letters nga and lla and the vowel signs ii and e, and find each one in niingal or peyar.*

110.1 ங — the nasal before the க in நீங்கள்

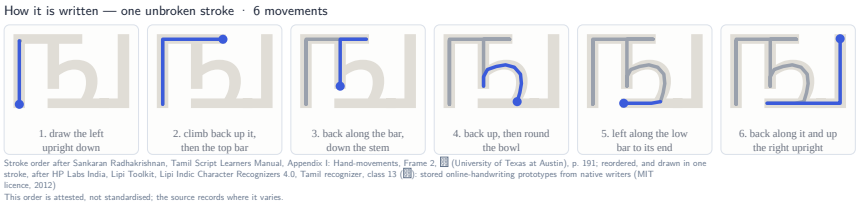
> Before the new one: read னீ and ஸ aloud, and write each once.
>
> Now say நீங்கள் (*nīṅgaḷ*), "you (respectful)". You have read it for a long time. This lesson takes one character out of it and puts it in your hand.

Script you'll notice: ங

ங — *ṅa*.

It is the nasal in the middle of நீங்கள் (*nīṅgaḷ*), the respectful "you". Say *nīṅgaḷ* slowly: the *ṅ* is made at the back of the mouth, where *k* is made, which is why ங nearly always stands right before க.

Writing: ஈ



How ஈ is written, stroke by stroke

- **1.** start at the top of the left upright and draw it straight down
- **2.** without lifting, climb back up it and carry the top bar to its right end
- **3.** without lifting, come back along the bar to the inner stem and draw it down to its foot
- **4.** without lifting, go back up the stem and round the bowl down to the low bar
- **5.** without lifting, run left along the low bar to its end
- **6.** without lifting, come back along the low bar and climb the right upright — and only now lift

Pen lifts: 0. The pen never leaves the paper.

Stroke order is one attested order, not a national standard — Tamil handwriting is taught with school-to-school variation. The order and the stroke count follow native writers' pen traces in HP Labs India's LipiTk Tamil recognizer: most of them write ஈ without lifting the pen, and draw its right upright last, upward. Sankaran Radhakrishnan, Tamil Script Learners Manual, Appendix I: Hand-movements, Frame 2, ஈ (University of Texas at Austin), p. 191, draws that upright first, as a separate part.

Your turn

- *Look:* at நீங்கள் and point at ஈ inside it
- *Trace it:* ஈ three times, saying *ṉa* as you finish each one

- *Write it:* ஸ, then ங, from memory
- *Read it:* நீங்கள் aloud once more

Before you move on

Which character is this — ங? (**ṅa**.) Which word did it come from? (நீங்கள், *nīṅgaḷ*, "you (respectful)".)

110.2 ள — the l at the end of நீங்கள்

Before the new one: read ஸ and ங aloud, and write each once.

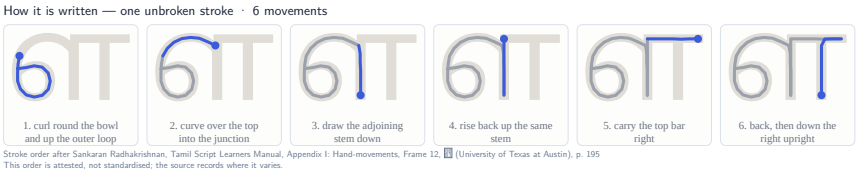
Now say நீங்கள் (*nīṅgaḷ*), "you (respectful)". You have read it for a long time. This lesson takes one character out of it and puts it in your hand.

Script you'll notice: ள

ள — *ḷa*.

It closes நீங்கள் (*nīṅgaḷ*). This is the Tamil *l* made with the tongue curled back. You already write ல (*la*) and ழ (*ḻa*); ள is the third *l*, and the dot under the romanization (*ḷ*) is how the book tells them apart.

Writing: ள



How ள *is written, stroke by stroke*

- **1.** start inside the loop, curl round its inner bowl, and climb the large outer loop
- **2.** without lifting, curve over the top and into the junction with the middle upright
- **3.** without lifting, draw the adjoining stem straight down

- **4.** without lifting, rise back up the same stem to the top
- **5.** without lifting, carry the top bar to the right edge
- **6.** without lifting, return along the bar to the right upright and draw it straight down — and only now lift

Pen lifts: 0. The pen never leaves the paper.

Stroke order is one attested teaching order, not a national standard — Tamil handwriting is taught with school-to-school variation. Source: Sankaran Radhakrishnan, Tamil Script Learners Manual, Appendix I: Hand-movements, Frame 12, ள (University of Texas at Austin), p. 195.

Your turn

- *Look:* at நீங்கள் and point at ள inside it
- *Trace it:* ள three times, saying *ḷa* as you finish each one
- *Write it:* ங, then ள, from memory
- *Read it:* நீங்கள் aloud once more

Before you move on

Which character is this — ள? (**ḷa**.) Which word did it come from? (நீங்கள், *nīṅgaḷ*, "you (respectful)".)

110.3 ீ — the long i on நீ

Before the new one: read ங and ள aloud, and write each once.

Now say நீ (*nī*), "you (familiar)". You have read it for a long time. This lesson takes one character out of it and puts it in your hand.

Script you'll notice: ீ

ீ — *ī*.

It is the sign on நீ (*nī*), "you". You already write its short partner ி (*i*), the hook from நன்றி. The long sign ீ ends in a curl instead of an open hook. One curl more, one beat longer.

Writing: ீ

How it is written — one unbroken stroke · 3 movements



Stroke order after HP Labs India, Lipi Toolkit, Lipi Indic Character Recognizers 4.0, Tamil recognizer, class 38 (ீ ii sign): stored online-handwriting prototypes from native Tamil writers (MIT licence, 2012)
This order is attested, not standardised; the source records where it varies.

How ீ is written, stroke by stroke

Follow the numbered strip: start where movement 1 begins, and let each panel show you the next movement before your pen makes it. Then write ீ yourself — slowly, and larger than it is printed.

> The strip shows **where to start the character and which way to travel**, in one attested order. That is taught with real variation from school to school, so the strip names its source beneath it: treat it as a sound way in, not the only one.

Your turn

- *Look:* at நீ and point at ீ inside it
- *Trace it:* ீ three times, saying *ī* as you finish each one
- *Write it:* னா, then ீ, from memory
- *Read it:* நீ aloud once more

Before you move on

Which character is this — ீ? (ī.) Which word did it come from? (நீ, *nī*, "you (familiar)".)

110.4 ெ — the short e in பெயர்

Before the new one: read ன and ீ aloud, and write each once.

Now say பெயர் (*peyar*), "name". You have read it for a long time. This lesson takes one character out of it and puts it in your hand.

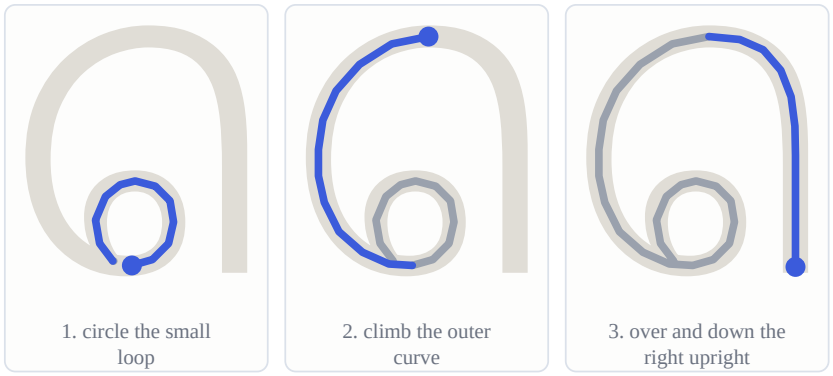
Script you'll notice: ெ

ெ — *e*.

It is the sign on the first syllable of பெயர் (*peyar*), "name". Like னை, it is written on the **left** of its consonant and sounded after it. You already know its long partner ே (*ē*) from பேசு. Put the two side by side and compare the shapes: that difference is the difference between *pe* and *pē*.

Writing: ெ

How it is written — one unbroken stroke · 3 movements



Stroke order after HP Labs India, Lipi Toolkit, Lipi Indic Character Recognizers 4.0, Tamil recognizer, class 41 (, e sign): stored online-handwriting prototypes from native Tamil writers (MIT licence, 2012)
This order is attested, not standardised; the source records where it varies.

How ெ is written, stroke by stroke

Follow the numbered strip: start where movement 1 begins, and let each panel show you the next movement before your pen makes it. Then write ெ yourself — slowly, and larger than it is printed.

The strip shows **where to start the character and which way to travel**, in one attested order. That is taught with real

variation from school to school, so the strip names its source beneath it: treat it as a sound way in, not the only one.

Your turn

- *Look:* at பெயர் and point at ெ inside it
- *Trace it:* ெ three times, saying *e* as you finish each one
- *Write it:* ீ, then ெ, from memory
- *Read it:* பெயர் aloud once more

Before you move on

Which character is this — ெ? (**e**.) Which word did it come from? (பெயர், *peyar*, "name".)

Chapter 111

Letters From Counting

Modes: ✓ **pen** (3) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** none of the 3 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can write the letters ai and ee and the vowel sign uu, and find each one in the numbers I count with.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 111: I can write the letters ai and ee and the vowel sign uu, and find each one in the numbers I count with.*

111.1 ஐ — the letter that opens ஐந்து

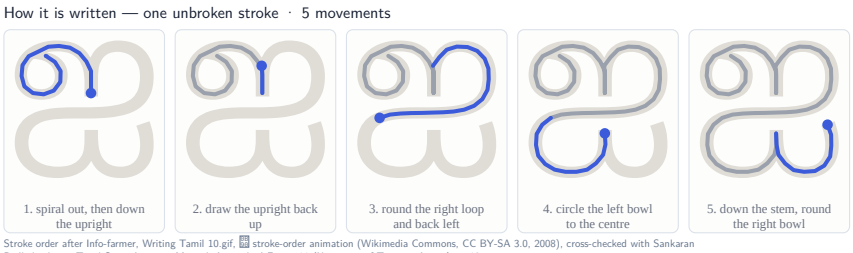
> Before the new one: read ீ and ெ aloud, and write each once.
>
> Now say ஐந்து (*aintu*), "five". You have read it for a long time. This lesson takes one character out of it and puts it in your hand.

Script you'll notice: ஐ

ஐ — *ai*.

It opens ஐந்து (*aintu*), "five". You wrote its sign ை two chapters ago, on the end of இல்லை. This is the **independent** shape of the same vowel, for a word that begins with *ai*.

Writing: ஐ



How ஐ is written, stroke by stroke

- **1.** start inside the upper-left spiral, curl outward round it, and run down the central upright to its foot
- **2.** without lifting, draw the central upright back up
- **3.** without lifting, sweep around the upper-right loop and return left across the middle
- **4.** without lifting, circle the lower-left bowl back up to the centre
- **5.** without lifting, come back down the centre stem and circle through the lower-right bowl — and only now lift

Pen lifts: 0. The pen never leaves the paper.

Stroke order is one attested teaching order, not a national standard — Tamil handwriting is taught with school-to-school variation. Source: Info-farmer, Writing Tamil 10.gif, ஐ stroke-order animation (Wikimedia Commons, CC BY-SA 3.0, 2008), cross-checked with Sankaran Radhakrishnan, Tamil Script Learners Manual, Appendix I Frame 11 (University of Texas at Austin), p. 194.

Your turn

- *Look:* at ஐந்து and point at ஐ inside it
- *Trace it:* ஐ three times, saying *ai* as you finish each one
- *Write it:* ◌ை, then ஐ, from memory

- *Read it:* ஐந்து aloud once more

Before you move on

Which character is this — ஐ? (**ai**.) Which word did it come from? (ஐந்து, *aintu*, "five".)

111.2 ூ — the long u on மூன்று

Before the new one: read ி and ஐ aloud, and write each once.

Now say மூன்று (*mūṉṟu*), "three". You have read it for a long time. This lesson takes one character out of it and puts it in your hand.

Script you'll notice: ூ

ூ — *ū*.

It is the long *ū* on மூன்று (*mūṉṟu*), "three". Like its short partner ு, which you already write, this sign changes shape with the consonant it joins, so copy it as it sits on மூ, the form you already read.

Writing: ூ

Put your pen on ூ and follow its line. Copy the shape you can see — slowly, and larger than it is printed.

This book does not yet tell you **where to start the character or which way to travel**. That is a real thing, taught with real variation from school to school, and it is not written down here until it can be written down with a source. Copying what is in front of you needs no such source, and it is how the shape gets into your hand in the meantime.

Your turn

- *Look:* at மூன்று and point at ூ inside it
- *Trace it:* ூ three times, saying *ū* as you finish each one
- *Write it:* ஐ, then ூ, from memory

- *Read it:* மூன்று aloud once more

Before you move on

Which character is this — ூ? (**ū**.) Which word did it come from? (மூன்று, *mūn̲ru*, "three".)

111.3 ஏ — the letter that opens ஏழு

Before the new one: read ஐ and ை aloud, and write each once.

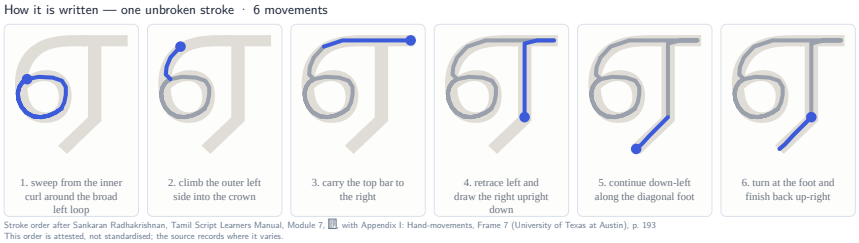
Now say ஏழு (*ēḻu*), "seven". You have read it for a long time. This lesson takes one character out of it and puts it in your hand.

Script you'll notice: ஏ

ஏ — *ē*.

It opens ஏழு (*ēḻu*), "seven". You already write its sign ே from பேசு; ஏ is the independent shape of the same long vowel, for the front of a word.

Writing: ஏ



How ஏ *is written, stroke by stroke*

- **1.** start here: sweep from the inner curl around the broad left loop
- **2.** without lifting, climb the outer left side into the crown
- **3.** without lifting, carry the top bar to the right
- **4.** without lifting, retrace left and draw the right upright down
- **5.** without lifting, continue down-left along the diagonal foot

- **6.** without lifting, turn at the foot and finish back up-right — and only now lift

Pen lifts: 0. The pen never leaves the paper.

Stroke order is one attested teaching order, not a national standard — Tamil handwriting is taught with school-to-school variation. Source: Sankaran Radhakrishnan, Tamil Script Learners Manual, Module 7, ஏ, with Appendix I: Hand-movements, Frame 7 (University of Texas at Austin), p. 193.

Your turn

- *Look:* at ஏழு and point at ஏ inside it
- *Trace it:* ஏ three times, saying *ē* as you finish each one
- *Write it:* ◌ே, then ஏ, from memory
- *Read it:* ஏழு aloud once more

Before you move on

Which character is this — ஏ? (ē.) Which word did it come from? (ஏழு, *ēḻu*, "seven".)

Chapter 112

Letters From Days, Towns and Gladness

Modes: **eyes** (2) **pen** (4) **Hands-free start:** none of the 6 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can write the letters nya, uu, o and ssa, and find each one in a word I already say.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 112: I can write the letters nya, uu, o and ssa, and find each one in a word I already say.*

112.1 ஞ — the letter that opens ஞாயிறு

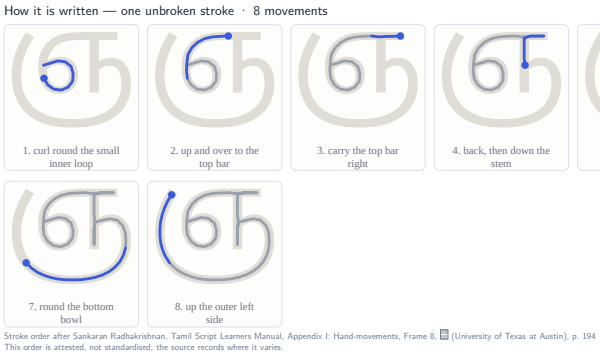
> Before the new one: read ஈ and ஏ aloud, and write each once.
>
> Now say ஞாயிறு (*ñāyi̱ru*), "Sunday". You have read it for a long time. This lesson takes one character out of it and puts it in your hand.

Script you'll notice: ஞ

ஞ — *ña.*

It opens ஞாயிறு (*ñāyi̱ru*), "Sunday", the last day in the week you learned. ஞ is a rare letter: few everyday words use it, and Sunday is the one you will see most.

Writing: ஹ



How ஹ is written, stroke by stroke

- **1.** start inside the compact left body and curl round its small inner loop
- **2.** without lifting, climb its outer left side and curve over into the long top bar
- **3.** without lifting, carry the long top bar straight to the right
- **4.** without lifting, come back along the bar to the central upright and start down it
- **5.** without lifting, descend the central upright to its lower end
- **6.** without lifting, climb back up the upright and sweep around the broad outer-right curve
- **7.** without lifting, continue around the bottom bowl toward the far left
- **8.** without lifting, return up the outer-left side and finish below the top bar — and only now lift

Pen lifts: 0. The pen never leaves the paper.

Stroke order is one attested teaching order, not a national standard — Tamil handwriting is taught with school-to-school variation. Source: Sankaran Radhakrishnan, Tamil Script Learners Manual, Appendix I: Hand-movements, Frame 8, ஹ (University of Texas at Austin), p. 194.

Your turn

- *Look:* at ஞாயிறு and point at ஞ inside it
- *Trace it:* ஞ three times, saying *ña* as you finish each one
- *Write it:* ஏ, then ஞ, from memory
- *Read it:* ஞாயிறு aloud once more

Before you move on

Which character is this — ஞ? (**ña**.) Which word did it come from? (ஞாயிறு, *ñāyiṟu*, "Sunday".)

112.2 உள — the letter that opens உளர்

Before the new one: read ஏ and ஞ aloud, and write each once.

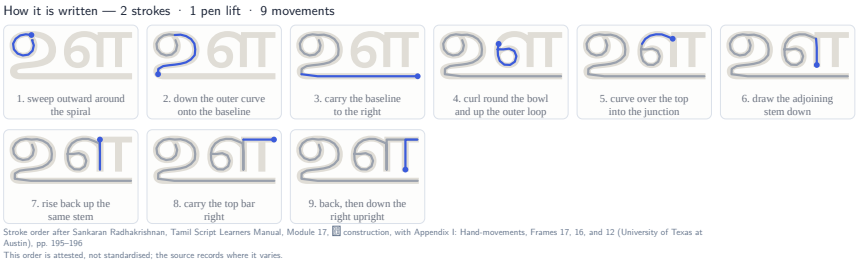
Now say **உளர்** (*ūr*), "town, home place". You have read it for a long time. This lesson takes one character out of it and puts it in your hand.

Script you'll notice: உள

உள — *ū*.

It opens **உளர்** (*ūr*), "town", the place a Tamil introduction asks you about. It is built on **உ** (*u*), which you already write, with a second part added to its right: short vowel, then more pen for the long one.

Writing: உள



How **உள** *is written, stroke by stroke*

- **1.** write உ first: start inside its compact upper spiral and sweep outward around it
- **2.** without lifting, descend through its broad outer curve and turn left onto the baseline
- **3.** without lifting, carry the long baseline straight to the right — then lift once
- **4.** write ள over that base: start inside its loop, curl round its inner bowl, and climb the outer loop
- **5.** without lifting, curve over the top and into the junction with the middle upright
- **6.** without lifting, draw the adjoining stem straight down
- **7.** without lifting, rise back up the same stem to the top
- **8.** without lifting, carry the top bar to the right edge
- **9.** without lifting, return along the bar to the right upright and draw it straight down — and only now lift

Pen lifts: 1. The pen comes up 1 time and no more.

Stroke order is one attested teaching order, not a national standard — Tamil handwriting is taught with school-to-school variation. Source: Sankaran Radhakrishnan, Tamil Script Learners Manual, Module 17, உள construction, with Appendix I: Hand-movements, Frames 17, 16, and 12 (University of Texas at Austin), pp. 195–196.

Your turn

- *Look:* at உள்ர் and point at உள inside it
- *Trace it:* உள three times, saying *ū* as you finish each one
- *Write it:* ஞ, then உள, from memory
- *Read it:* உள்ர் aloud once more

Before you move on

Which character is this — ஊ? (**ū**.) Which word did it come from? (ஊர், *ūr*, "town, home place".)

112.3 ஒ — the letter that opens ஒரு

Before the new one: read ஞ and ஊ aloud, and write each once.

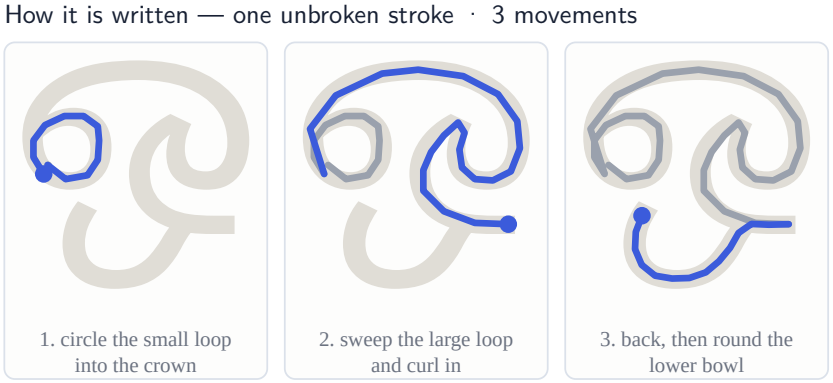
Now say ஒரு (*oru*), "a, one". You have read it for a long time. This lesson takes one character out of it and puts it in your hand.

Script you'll notice: ஒ

ஒ — *o*.

It opens ஒரு (*oru*), "a, one", the form ஒன்று takes in front of a noun. You already read its long partner ஓ (*ō*). Put them side by side: the long one carries more at its foot.

Writing: ஒ



Stroke order after Sankaran Radhakrishnan, Tamil Script Learners Manual, Module 14, pp. 92, with Appendix I: Hand-movements, Frame 14 (University of Texas at Austin), p. 195
This order is attested, not standardised; the source records where it varies.

How ஒ is written, stroke by stroke

- **1.** circle the small left loop and climb into the crown

- **2.** without lifting, sweep through the large right loop, curl inward, and run out along the tail
- **3.** without lifting, come back along the tail to the lower bowl, draw it down and around, and return left — and only now lift

Pen lifts: 0. The pen never leaves the paper.

Stroke order is one attested teaching order, not a national standard — Tamil handwriting is taught with school-to-school variation. Source: Sankaran Radhakrishnan, Tamil Script Learners Manual, Module 14, ஒ, with Appendix I: Hand-movements, Frame 14 (University of Texas at Austin), p. 195.

Your turn

- *Look:* at ஒரு and point at ஒ inside it
- *Trace it:* ஒ three times, saying *o* as you finish each one
- *Write it:* உ, then ஒ, from memory
- *Read it:* ஒரு aloud once more

Before you move on

Which character is this — ஒ? (**o**.) Which word did it come from? (ஒரு, *oru*, "a, one".)

112.4 ஷ — the letter inside சந்தோஷம்

Before the new one: read உ and ஒ aloud, and write each once.

Now say சந்தோஷம் (*santōṣam*), "gladness". You have read it for a long time. This lesson takes one character out of it and puts it in your hand.

Script you'll notice: ஷ

ஷ — *ṣa*.

It is inside சந்தோஷம் (*santōṣam*), "gladness". Like ஸ, it is a **Grantha** letter, kept for words Tamil took from Sanskrit.

Writing: ஷ



How ஷ *is written, stroke by stroke*

- **1.** start at the tip inside the small loop and curl clockwise round it
- **2.** without lifting, go on round the bottom and up the outer left side
- **3.** without lifting, arch over the top and come down to the bar
- **4.** without lifting, carry the bar to the right
- **5.** without lifting, go up the bar's right end and back over to the right loop
- **6.** without lifting, go round the loop and down the tail — and only now lift

Pen lifts: 0. The pen never leaves the paper.

Stroke order is one attested teaching order, not a national standard — Tamil handwriting is taught with school-to-school variation. Source: Ratnakar Narale, Learn Tamil Through English/Hindi, Reading and Writing Tamil Granthakshars, Third Tamil Granthakshar ஷ, Sanskrit Hindi Research Institute, p. 13. The chart numbers four parts; native writers draw them without lifting the pen (HP Labs India's LipiTk Tamil recognizer: most of its pen traces of ஷ are one stroke).

Your turn

- *Look:* at சந்தோஷம் and point at ஷ inside it
- *Trace it:* ஷ three times, saying *ṣa* as you finish each one
- *Write it:* ஓ, then ஷ, from memory
- *Read it:* சந்தோஷம் aloud once more

Before you move on

Which character is this — ஷ? (**ṣa**.) Which word did it come from? (சந்தோஷம், *santōṣam*, "gladness".)

112.5 (fourteen letters) — Fourteen letters, fourteen words — a first pass

Write the letter that opens இல்லை, then the sign that ends it.

Your turn

letter	sound	the word it came from
இ	*i*	இல்லை *illai*
ை	*ai*	இல்லை *illai*
ஸ	*sa*	நமஸ்காரம் *namaskāram*
ங	*ṅa*	நீங்கள் *nīṅgaḷ*
ள	*ḷa*	நீங்கள் *nīṅgaḷ*
ீ	*ī*	நீ *nī*
ெ	*e*	பெயர் *peyar*
ஐ	*ai*	ஐந்து *aintu*
ூ	*ū*	மூன்று *mūṉṟu*
ஏ	*ē*	ஏழு *ēḻu*
ஞ	*ña*	ஞாயிறு *ñāyiṟu*
உள	*ū*	உளர் *ūr*
ஒ	*o*	ஒரு *oru*
ஷ	*ṣa*	சந்தோஷம் *santōṣam*

- *Write it:* each letter in the table from memory, then check it
- *Say it:* the word each one came from
- *Write it:* the four vowel signs on their own: ை ீ ெ ூ

Before you move on

Which two letters are Grantha, kept for borrowed words? (ஸ and ஷ.)

112.6 (fourteen letters) — From the word back to the letter — a second pass

Say *nīṅgaḷ*, then write the two new letters it holds.

Your turn

letter	sound	the word it came from
இ	*i*	இல்லை *illai*
ை	*ai*	இல்லை *illai*
ஸ	*sa*	நமஸ்காரம் *namaskāram*
ங	*ṅa*	நீங்கள் *nīṅgaḷ*
ள	*ḷa*	நீங்கள் *nīṅgaḷ*
ீ	*ī*	நீ *nī*
ெ	*e*	பெயர் *peyar*
ஐ	*ai*	ஐந்து *aintu*
ூ	*ū*	மூன்று *mūṉṟu*
ஏ	*ē*	ஏழு *ēḻu*
ஞ	*ña*	ஞாயிறு *ñāyiṟu*
உள	*ū*	உளர் *ūr*
ஒ	*o*	ஒரு *oru*
ஷ	*ṣa*	சந்தோஷம் *santōṣam*

- *Say it:* each word in the table, then write the letter it gave you without looking
- *Write it:* ஒ beside ஓ, and உள beside ஊ, and say how each pair differs
- *Write it:* ெ beside ே, and ீ beside ி

Before you move on

Which letters open a word, and which signs sit inside one? (இ ஐ ஏ உள ஒ open words; ◌ா ◌ீ ◌ெ ◌ை sit on a consonant.)

Chapter 113

Straight ahead, Near, Distance, Behind, In front

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say straight ahead, near, distance, behind and in front.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 113: I can say straight ahead, near, distance, behind and in front.*

113.1 நேராக (nērāka) — straight ahead

> Before the new one: say the Tamil for are you well? (spoken), then the Tamil for how are you? (spoken).

You'll want to know: நேராக

நேராக — *nērāka* — "straight ahead".

In the family, and next door

	word
Telugu	తిన్నగా (*tinnagā*)
English	straight ahead

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

நேராக (*nērāka*) is native Dravidian (DEDR 3772). It is *nēr*, "straightness", with *-āka*, "in the manner of".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *nērāka*
- *Say it:* *nērāka*, once more
- *Say it:* say *nērāka*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for are you well? (spoken), then the Tamil for how are you? (spoken), then say *nērāka* again

Before you move on

What does நேராக mean? ("Straight ahead".) Say it once more.

113.2 அருகில் (arukil) — near, close by

Before the new one: say the Tamil for how are you? (spoken), then the Tamil for straight ahead.

One slot changes: இங்கே, அங்கே, எங்கே. Here, there, where?

You'll want to know: அருகில்

அருகில் — *arukil* — "near, close by".

In the family, and next door

	word
Kannada	ಹತ್ತಿರ (*hattira*)
Telugu	దగ్గర (*daggara*)
Malayalam	അടുത്ത് (*aṭuttŭ*)
English	near, close by

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

அருகில் (*arukil*) is native Dravidian (DEDR 222). It is *aruku*, "nearness, vicinity", with the locative *-il*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: arukil*
- *Say it: arukil*, once more
- *Say it:* say *arukil*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for how are you? (spoken), then the Tamil for straight ahead, then say *arukil* again

Before you move on

What does அருகில் mean? ("Near, close by".) Say it once more.

113.3 தூரம் (tūram) — distance; far

Before the new one: say the Tamil for straight ahead, then the Tamil for near.

You'll want to know: தூரம்

தூரம் — *tūram* — "distance; far".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

தூரம் (*tūram*) is a loan from Sanskrit *dūra*, "distant, distance" (CDIAL 6495).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: tūram*
- *Say it: tūram*, once more

- *Say it:* say *tūram*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for straight ahead, then the Tamil for near, then say *tūram* again

Before you move on

What does தூரம் mean? (“Distance; far”.) Say it once more.

113.4 பின்னால் (piṉṉāl) — behind

Before the new one: say the Tamil for near, then the Tamil for distance; far.

You’ll want to know: பின்னால்

பின்னால் — *piṉṉāl* — “behind”.

In the family, and next door

	word
Telugu	వెనక (*venaka*)
Hindi (neighbour)	के पीछे (*ke pīche*)
English	behind

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

பின்னால் (*piṉṉāl*) is native Dravidian. DEDR 4205 lists Malayalam *pin.* It is *piṉ*, “back, behind”, with *-āl.*

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: piṉṉāl*
- *Say it: piṉṉāl*, once more
- *Say it:* say *piṉṉāl*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for near, then the Tamil for distance; far, then say *piṉṉāl* again

Before you move on

What does பின்னால் mean? ("Behind".) Say it once more.

113.5 முன்னால் (mun̲n̲āl) — in front

Before the new one: say the Tamil for distance; far, then the Tamil for behind.

You'll want to know: முன்னால்

முன்னால் — *mun̲n̲āl* — "in front".

In the family, and next door

	word	same root
Kannada	ಮುಂದೆ (*munde*)	yes
English	in front	

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

முன்னால் (*mun̲n̲āl*) is native Dravidian. DEDR 5020 lists Malayalam *mun* and Kannada *mun*. It is *mun̲*, "front", with *-āl*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *mun̲n̲āl*
- *Say it:* *mun̲n̲āl*, once more
- *Say it:* say *mun̲n̲āl*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for distance; far, then the Tamil for behind, then say *mun̲n̲āl* again

Before you move on

What does முன்னால் mean? ("In front".) Say it once more.

Chapter 114

In the middle, Street, Bridge, Park, Temple

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say in the middle, a street, a bridge, a park and a temple.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 114: I can say in the middle, a street, a bridge, a park and a temple.*

114.1 நடுவில் (naṭuvil) — in the middle

Before the new one: say the Tamil for behind, then the Tamil for in front.

You'll want to know: நடுவில்

நடுவில் — *naṭuvil* — "in the middle".

In the family, and next door

	word	same root
Kannada	ನಡುವೆ (*naḍuve*)	yes
Telugu	మధ్యలో (*madhyalō*)	
English	in the middle	

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

நடுவில் (*naṭuvil*) is native Dravidian. DEDR 3584 lists Malayalam *naṭu* and Kannada *naḍu*. It is *naṭu*, "middle", with the locative *-il*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: naṭuvil*
- *Say it: naṭuvil*, once more
- *Say it:* say *naṭuvil*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for behind, then the Tamil for in front, then say *naṭuvil* again

Before you move on

What does நடுவில் mean? ("In the middle".) Say it once more.

114.2 தெரு (teru) — a street

Before the new one: say the Tamil for in front, then the Tamil for in the middle.

You'll want to know: தெரு

தெரு — *teru* — "a street".

In the family, and next door

	word	same root
Kannada	ಬೀದಿ (*bīdi*)	
Telugu	వీధి (*vīdhi*)	
Malayalam	തെരുവ് (*teruvŭ*)	yes
English	a street	

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

தெரு (*teru*) is native Dravidian. DEDR 3422 lists Malayalam *teru* and Telugu *teruvu*, "way".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: teru*
- *Say it: teru*, once more
- *Say it:* say *teru*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for in front, then the Tamil for in the middle, then say *teru* again

Before you move on

What does தெரு mean? ("A street".) Say it once more.

114.3 பாலம் (pālam) — a bridge

Before the new one: say the Tamil for in the middle, then the Tamil for a street.

You'll want to know: பாலம்

பாலம் — *pālam* — "a bridge".

In the family, and next door

	word	same root
Kannada	ಸೇತುವೆ (*sētuve*)	
Telugu	వంతెన (*vantena*)	
Malayalam	പാലം (*pālaṁ*)	yes
Hindi (neighbour)	पुल (*pul*)	
English	a bridge	

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

பாலம் (*pālam*) is native Dravidian. DEDR 4099 lists Malayalam *pālam* and Kannada *pāla*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *pālam*
- *Say it:* *pālam*, once more
- *Say it:* say *pālam*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for in the middle, then the Tamil for a street, then say *pālam* again

Before you move on

What does பாலம் mean? ("A bridge".) Say it once more.

114.4 பூங்கா (pūṅkā) — a park

Before the new one: say the Tamil for a street, then the Tamil for a bridge.

You'll want to know: பூங்கா

பூங்கா — *pūṅkā* — "a park".

In the family, and next door

	word
Kannada	ಉದ್ಯಾನ (*udyāna*)
Telugu	పార్కు (*pārku*)
English	a park

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

பூங்கா (*pūṅkā*) is native: *pū*, "flower" (DEDR 4345), and *kā*, "grove, garden" (DEDR 1418): "flower-garden". DEDR compares Sanskrit *kānana*, "forest", and, with a query, *puṣpa*, "flower".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *pūṅkā*
- *Say it:* *pūṅkā*, once more
- *Say it:* say *pūṅkā*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for a street, then the Tamil for a bridge, then say *pūṅkā* again

Before you move on

What does பூங்கா mean? ("A park".) Say it once more.

114.5 கோயில் (kōyil) — a temple

Before the new one: say the Tamil for a bridge, then the Tamil for a park.

Name a Tamil month, சித்திரை or தை, then give a தேதி, with the date ending *-ām*.

You'll want to know: கோயில்

கோயில் — *kōyil* — "a temple".

In the family, and next door

	word
Kannada	ದೇವಸ್ಥಾನ (*dēvasthāna*)
Telugu	గుడి (*guḍi*)
Malayalam	ക്ഷേത്രം (*kṣētraṁ*)
Hindi (neighbour)	मंदिर (*mandir*)
English	a temple

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

கோயில் (*kōyil*) is native Dravidian. DEDR 2177 lists Malayalam *kōyil*, "palace, temple" and Telugu *kōyila*. The entry lists *kōyil*, "palace, temple", under *kō*, "king": the house of a king, and of a god.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: kōyil*
- *Say it: kōyil*, once more
- *Say it:* say *kōyil*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for a bridge, then the Tamil for a park, then say *kōyil* again

Before you move on

What does கோயில் mean? ("A temple".) Say it once more.

Chapter 115

Library, Bank, Market, Beach, Office

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say a library, a bank, a market, a beach and an office.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 115: I can say a library, a bank, a market, a beach and an office.*

115.1 நூலகம் (nūlakam) — a library

Before the new one: say the Tamil for a park, then the Tamil for a temple.

You'll want to know: நூலகம்

நூலகம் — *nūlakam* — "a library".

In the family, and next door

	word
Kannada	ಗ್ರಂಥಾಲಯ (*granthālaya*)
Telugu	గ్రంథాలయం (*granthālayaṁ*)
Malayalam	ഗ്രന്ഥശാല (*granthaśāla*)
Hindi (neighbour)	पुस्तकालय (*pustakālay*)
English	a library

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

நூலகம் (*nūlakam*) is native: *nūl*, "thread, treatise, book" (DEDR 3726), and *akam*, "house, inside" (DEDR 7): "the house of books".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: nūlakam*
- *Say it: nūlakam*, once more
- *Say it:* say *nūlakam*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for a park, then the Tamil for a temple, then say *nūlakam* again

Before you move on

What does நூலகம் mean? ("A library".) Say it once more.

115.2 வங்கி (vaṅki) — a bank

Before the new one: say the Tamil for a temple, then the Tamil for a library.

Say திங்கள் through ஞாயிறு. Each day ends in *kiḻamai*; some days carry Tamil words, some Sanskrit ones.

You'll want to know: வங்கி

வங்கி — *vaṅki* — "a bank".

In the family, and next door

	word	same root
Kannada	ಬ್ಯಾಂಕು (*byāṅku*)	yes
Telugu	బ్యాంకు (*byāṅku*)	yes
Malayalam	ബാങ്ക് (*bāṅkŭ*)	yes
Hindi (neighbour)	बैंक (*baiṅk*)	yes
English	a bank	

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

வங்கி (*vaṅki*) is a loan from English *bank*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: vaṅki*
- *Say it: vaṅki*, once more
- *Say it:* say *vaṅki*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for a temple, then the Tamil for a library, then say *vaṅki* again

Before you move on

What does வங்கி mean? ("A bank".) Say it once more.

115.3 சந்தை (cantai) — a market

Before the new one: say the Tamil for a library, then the Tamil for a bank.

One slot changes: இங்கே, அங்கே, எங்கே. Here, there, where?

You'll want to know: சந்தை

சந்தை — *cantai* — "a market".

In the family, and next door

	word	same root
Kannada	ಸಂತೆ (*sante*)	yes
Telugu	సంత (*santa*)	yes
Malayalam	ചന്ത (*canta*)	yes
Hindi (neighbour)	बाज़ार (*bāzār*)	
English	a market	

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

The origin of சந்தை (*cantai*) is uncertain. DEDR has no entry for it, and no well-established account of where it came from is available.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *cantai*
- *Say it:* *cantai*, once more
- *Say it:* say *cantai*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for a library, then the Tamil for a bank, then say *cantai* again

Before you move on

What does சந்தை mean? ("A market".) Say it once more.

115.4 கடற்கரை (kaṭaṟkarai) — a beach

Before the new one: say the Tamil for a bank, then the Tamil for a market.

You'll want to know: கடற்கரை

கடற்கரை — *kaṭaṟkarai* — "a beach".

In the family, and next door

	word
Kannada	ಕಡಲತೀರ (*kaḍalatīra*)
Malayalam	കടപ്പുറം (*kaṭappuṟaṁ*)
English	a beach

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

கடற்கரை (*kaṭaṟkarai*) is native: *kaṭal*, "sea" (DEDR 1118), and *karai*, "shore, bank" (DEDR 1293).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: kaṭaṟkarai*
- *Say it: kaṭaṟkarai*, once more
- *Say it:* say *kaṭaṟkarai*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for a bank, then the Tamil for a market, then say *kaṭaṟkarai* again

Before you move on

What does கடற்கரை mean? ("A beach".) Say it once more.

115.5 அலுவலகம் (aluvalakam) — an office

Before the new one: say the Tamil for a market, then the Tamil for a beach.

You'll want to know: அலுவலகம்

அலுவலகம் — *aluvalakam* — "an office".

In the family, and next door

	word
Kannada	ಕಚೇರಿ (*kacēri*)
Telugu	కార్యాలయం (*kāryālayaṁ*)
Malayalam	ഓഫീസ് (*ōphīs*)
Hindi (neighbour)	दफ़्तर (*daftar*)
English	an office

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

அலுவலகம் (*aluvalakam*) is native: *aluval*, "business, affair" (DEDR 236), and *akam*, "house, place" (DEDR 7): "the place of business".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *aluvalakam*
- *Say it:* *aluvalakam*, once more
- *Say it:* say *aluvalakam*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for a market, then the Tamil for a beach, then say *aluvalakam* again

Before you move on

What does அலுவலகம் mean? ("An office".) Say it once more.

Chapter 116

Garden, Corner, Turn, Can, Skill

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say a garden, a corner, a turn, can and a skill.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 116: I can say a garden, a corner, a turn, can and a skill.*

116.1 தோட்டம் (tōṭṭam) — a garden

> Before the new one: say the Tamil for a beach, then the Tamil for an office.

You'll want to know: தோட்டம்

தோட்டம் — *tōṭṭam* — "a garden".

In the family, and next door

	word	same root
Kannada	ತೋಟ (*tōṭa*)	yes
Telugu	తోట (*tōṭa*)	yes
Malayalam	പൂന്തോട്ടം (*pūntōṭṭaṁ*)	yes
Hindi (neighbour)	बगीचा (*bagīcā*)	
English	a garden	

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

தோட்டம் (*tōṭṭam*) is native Dravidian (DEDR 3549). The entry lists *tōṭṭam*, "garden, orchard", under the native verb "to dig": a garden is dug ground.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: tōṭṭam*
- *Say it: tōṭṭam*, once more
- *Say it:* say *tōṭṭam*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for a beach, then the Tamil for an office, then say *tōṭṭam* again

Before you move on

What does தோட்டம் mean? ("A garden".) Say it once more.

116.2 மூலை (mūlai) — a corner

Before the new one: say the Tamil for an office, then the Tamil for a garden.

You'll want to know: மூலை

மூலை — *mūlai* — "a corner".

In the family, and next door

	word	same root
Kannada	ಮೂಲೆ (*mūle*)	yes
Telugu	మూల (*mūla*)	yes
English	a corner	

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

மூலை (*mūlai*) is native Dravidian. DEDR 5044 lists Malayalam *mūla*, Kannada *mūle* and Telugu *mūla*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *mūlai*
- *Say it:* *mūlai*, once more
- *Say it:* say *mūlai*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for an office, then the Tamil for a garden, then say *mūlai* again

Before you move on

What does மூலை mean? ("A corner".) Say it once more.

116.3 திருப்பம் (tiruppam) — a turn

Before the new one: say the Tamil for a garden, then the Tamil for a corner.

You'll want to know: திருப்பம்

திருப்பம் — *tiruppam* — "a turn".

In the family, and next door

	word	same root
Kannada	తిరువు (*tiruvu*)	yes
Telugu	మలుపు (*malupu*)	
English	a turn	

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

திருப்பம் (*tiruppam*) is native Dravidian. DEDR 3246 lists Kannada *tiri*, "to turn round". It is the noun of *tiruppu*, "to turn", from *tiri*, "to turn, to revolve".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: tiruppam*
- *Say it: tiruppam*, once more
- *Say it:* say *tiruppam*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for a garden, then the Tamil for a corner, then say *tiruppam* again

Before you move on

What does திருப்பம் mean? ("A turn".) Say it once more.

116.4 முடியும் (muṭiyum) — can, it is possible

Before the new one: say the Tamil for a corner, then the Tamil for a turn.

You'll want to know: முடியும்

முடியும் — *muṭiyum* — "can, it is possible".

In the family, and next door

	word
Malayalam	കഴിയും (*kaḻiyum*)
English	can, it is possible

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

முடியும் (*muṭiyum*) is native Dravidian (DEDR 4923). The entry gives the verb "to appear, to be possible, capable", and *-um* makes it "it can be".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: muṭiyum*
- *Say it: muṭiyum*, once more
- *Say it:* say *muṭiyum*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for a corner, then the Tamil for a turn, then say *muṭiyum* again

Before you move on

What does முடியும் mean? ("Can, it is possible".) Say it once more.

116.5 திறமை (tiṟamai) — a skill, talent

Before the new one: say the Tamil for a turn, then the Tamil for can.

You'll want to know: திறமை

திறமை — *tiṟamai* — "a skill, talent".

In the family, and next door

	word
Kannada	ಕೌಶಲ್ಯ (*kauśalya*)
Telugu	నైపుణ్యం (*naipuṇyaṁ*)
English	a skill, talent

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

திறமை (*tiṟamai*) is native Dravidian. DEDR 3260 lists Kannada *teṟa*, "way, manner".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: tiṟamai*
- *Say it: tiṟamai*, once more
- *Say it:* say *tiṟamai*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for a turn, then the Tamil for can, then say *tiṟamai* again

Before you move on

What does திறமை mean? ("A skill, talent".) Say it once more.

Chapter 117

Ability, Right, Chance, Tool, Possession

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say ability, a right, a chance, a tool and a possession.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 117: I can say ability, a right, a chance, a tool and a possession.*

117.1 வல்லமை (vallamai) — ability, strength

> Before the new one: say the Tamil for can, then the Tamil for a skill.

You'll want to know: வல்லமை

வல்லமை — *vallamai* — "ability, strength".

In the family, and next door

	word
Kannada	**ಸಾಮರ್ಥ್ಯ** (*sāmarthya*)
Telugu	**సామర్థ్యం** (*sāmarthyam*)
Malayalam	**കഴിവ്** (*kaḻivŭ*)
English	ability, strength

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

வல்லமை (*vallamai*) is native Dravidian. DEDR 5276 lists Malayalam *val*, "strong" and Kannada *bal*, "to grow strong". The entry lists *vallamai*, "strength", under *val*, "strong".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: vallamai*
- *Say it: vallamai*, once more
- *Say it:* say *vallamai*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for can, then the Tamil for a skill, then say *vallamai* again

Before you move on

What does **வல்லமை** mean? ("Ability, strength".) Say it once more.

117.2 உரிமை (urimai) — a right

Before the new one: say the Tamil for a skill, then the Tamil for ability.

You'll want to know: உரிமை

உரிமை — *urimai* — "a right".

In the family, and next door

	word
Malayalam	**അവകാശം** (*avakāśaṁ*)
Hindi (neighbour)	**सही** (*sahī*)
English	a right

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

உரிமை (*urimai*) is native Dravidian. DEDR 654 lists Malayalam *uriyan*, "suitable, one who has rights".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: urimai*
- *Say it: urimai*, once more
- *Say it:* say *urimai*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for a skill, then the Tamil for ability, then say *urimai* again

Before you move on

What does உரிமை mean? ("A right".) Say it once more.

117.3 வாய்ப்பு (vāyppu) — a chance, an opportunity

Before the new one: say the Tamil for ability, then the Tamil for a right.

You'll want to know: வாய்ப்பு

வாய்ப்பு — *vāyppu* — "a chance, an opportunity".

In the family, and next door

	word
Kannada	ಅವಕಾಶ (*avakāśa*)
Telugu	అవకాశం (*avakāśam*)
English	a chance, an opportunity

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

வாய்ப்பு (*vāyppu*) is native Dravidian. DEDR 5351 lists Malayalam *vāykka*, "to fit, to be what may be". It is the noun of a native verb "to succeed, to come about".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *vāyppu*
- *Say it:* *vāyppu*, once more
- *Say it:* say *vāyppu*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for ability, then the Tamil for a right, then say *vāyppu* again

Before you move on

What does வாய்ப்பு mean? ("A chance, an opportunity".) Say it once more.

117.4 கருவி (karuvi) — a tool

Before the new one: say the Tamil for a right, then the Tamil for a chance.

You'll want to know: கருவி

கருவி — *karuvi* — "a tool".

In the family, and next door

	word
Kannada	ಸಾಧನ (*sādhana*)
Telugu	పరికరం (*parikaram*)
Malayalam	ഉപകരണം (*upakaraṇam*)
English	a tool

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

கருவி (*karuvi*) is native Dravidian. DEDR 1290 lists Malayalam *karuvi*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: karuvi*
- *Say it: karuvi*, once more
- *Say it:* say *karuvi*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for a right, then the Tamil for a chance, then say *karuvi* again

Before you move on

What does கருவி mean? ("A tool".) Say it once more.

117.5 உடைமை (uṭaimai) — a possession

Before the new one: say the Tamil for a chance, then the Tamil for a tool.

You'll want to know: உடைமை

உடைமை — *uṭaimai* — "a possession".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

உடைமை (*uṭaimai*) is native Dravidian. DEDR 593 lists Kannada *oḍame*, "possession, wealth".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: uṭaimai*
- *Say it: uṭaimai*, once more
- *Say it:* say *uṭaimai*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for a chance, then the Tamil for a tool, then say *uṭaimai* again

Before you move on

What does **உடைமை** mean? ("A possession".) Say it once more.

Chapter 118

Stove, Vessel, Plate, Cup, Spoon

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say a stove, a vessel, a plate, a cup and a spoon.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 118: I can say a stove, a vessel, a plate, a cup and a spoon.*

118.1 அடுப்பு (aṭuppu) — a stove

Before the new one: say the Tamil for a tool, then the Tamil for a possession.

You'll want to know: அடுப்பு

அடுப்பு — *aṭuppu* — "a stove".

In the family, and next door

	word	same root
Kannada	ಒಲೆ (*ole*)	
Telugu	పొయ్యి (*poyyi*)	
Malayalam	അടുപ്പ് (*aṭuppŭ*)	yes
English	a stove	

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

அடுப்பு (*aṭuppu*) is native Dravidian. DEDR 76 lists Malayalam *aṭuppu*. It comes from *aṭu*, "to cook": the stove is the cooking place.

The entry compares Sanskrit *aṭṭa*, "dried".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: aṭuppu*
- *Say it: aṭuppu*, once more
- *Say it:* say *aṭuppu*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for a tool, then the Tamil for a possession, then say *aṭuppu* again

Before you move on

What does அடுப்பு mean? ("A stove".) Say it once more.

118.2 பாத்திரம் (pāttiram) — a vessel, a pot

Before the new one: say the Tamil for a possession, then the Tamil for a stove.

You'll want to know: பாத்திரம்

பாத்திரம் — *pāttiram* — "a vessel, a pot".

In the family, and next door

	word	same root
Kannada	ಪಾತ್ರೆ (*pātre*)	yes
Malayalam	പാത്രം (*pātram*)	yes
English	a vessel, a pot	

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

பாத்திரம் (*pāttiram*) is a loan from Sanskrit *pātra*, "drinking vessel, dish" (CDIAL 8055).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *pāttiram*
- *Say it:* *pāttiram*, once more
- *Say it:* say *pāttiram*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for a possession, then the Tamil for a stove, then say *pāttiram* again

Before you move on

What does பாத்திரம் mean? ("A vessel, a pot".) Say it once more.

118.3 தட்டு (taṭṭu) — a plate

Before the new one: say the Tamil for a stove, then the Tamil for a vessel.

Count with care: *oṉṟu*, *mūṉṟu*, with the hard *ṉṟ*; *onpatu*, one short of *pattu*; then பதினொன்று to இருபது, two tens.

You'll want to know: தட்டு

தட்டு — *taṭṭu* — "a plate".

In the family, and next door

	word	same root
Kannada	ತಟ್ಟೆ (*taṭṭe*)	yes
Malayalam	പ്ലേറ്റ് (*plēṟṟŭ*)	
English	a plate	

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

தட்டு (*taṭṭu*) is native Dravidian. DEDR 3035 lists Malayalam *taṭṭu*, "a flat plate". The entry compares Pali *taṭṭaka*, "a flat bowl".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: taṭṭu*
- *Say it: taṭṭu*, once more
- *Say it:* say *taṭṭu*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for a stove, then the Tamil for a vessel, then say *taṭṭu* again

Before you move on

What does தட்டு mean? ("A plate".) Say it once more.

118.4 கோப்பை (kōppai) — a cup

Before the new one: say the Tamil for a vessel, then the Tamil for a plate.

You'll want to know: கோப்பை

கோப்பை — *kōppai* — "a cup".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

கோப்பை (*kōppai*) is a loan from Portuguese *copo*, "cup, glass".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: kōppai*
- *Say it: kōppai*, once more
- *Say it:* say *kōppai*

- *Recall:* say the Tamil for a vessel, then the Tamil for a plate, then say *kōppai* again

Before you move on

What does கோப்பை mean? ("A cup".) Say it once more.

118.5 கரண்டி (karaṇṭi) — a spoon

Before the new one: say the Tamil for a plate, then the Tamil for a cup.

You'll want to know: கரண்டி

கரண்டி — *karaṇṭi* — "a spoon".

In the family, and next door

	word
Kannada	ಚಮಚ (*camaca*)
Telugu	చెంచా (*cemcā*)
Malayalam	സ്പൂൺ (*spūṇ*)
Hindi (neighbour)	चम्मच (*chammach*)
English	a spoon

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

கரண்டி (*karaṇṭi*) is native Dravidian. DEDR 1267 lists Malayalam *karaṇṭi*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: karaṇṭi*
- *Say it: karaṇṭi*, once more
- *Say it:* say *karaṇṭi*

- *Recall:* say the Tamil for a plate, then the Tamil for a cup, then say *karaṇṭi* again

Before you move on

What does **கரண்டி** mean? (“A spoon”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 119

Key, Lock, Towel, Pillow, Blanket

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say a key, a lock, a towel, a pillow and a blanket.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 119: I can say a key, a lock, a towel, a pillow and a blanket.*

119.1 சாவி (cāvi) — a key

Before the new one: say the Tamil for a cup, then the Tamil for a spoon.

You'll want to know: சாவி

சாவி — *cāvi* — "a key".

In the family, and next door

	word
Telugu	తాళంచెవి (*tāḷaṁcevi*)
Malayalam	താക്കോൽ (*tākkōl*)
English	a key

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

சாவி (*cāvi*) is a loan from Portuguese *chave*, "key".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *cāvi*
- *Say it:* *cāvi*, once more
- *Say it:* say *cāvi*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for a cup, then the Tamil for a spoon, then say *cāvi* again

Before you move on

What does சாவி mean? ("A key".) Say it once more.

119.2 பூட்டு (pūṭṭu) — a lock

Before the new one: say the Tamil for a spoon, then the Tamil for a key.

You'll want to know: பூட்டு

பூட்டு — *pūṭṭu* — "a lock".

In the family, and next door

	word
Kannada	ಬೀಗ (*bīga*)
Telugu	తాళం (*tāḷaṁ*)
Hindi (neighbour)	ताला (*tālā*)
English	a lock

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

பூட்டு (*pūṭṭu*) is native Dravidian (DEDR 4361). The entry lists *pūṭṭu*, "to lock, to fasten", under *pūṇ*, "to put on, to be fastened".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *pūṭṭu*
- *Say it:* *pūṭṭu*, once more
- *Say it:* say *pūṭṭu*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for a spoon, then the Tamil for a key, then say *pūṭṭu* again

Before you move on

What does பூட்டு mean? ("A lock".) Say it once more.

119.3 துண்டு (tuṇṭu) — a towel; a piece

Before the new one: say the Tamil for a key, then the Tamil for a lock.

You'll want to know: துண்டு

துண்டு — *tuṇṭu* — "a towel; a piece".

In the family, and next door

	word
Kannada	ಟವೆಲ್ (*ṭavel*)
Telugu	తువ్వాలు (*tuvvālu*)
Malayalam	തോർത്ത് (*tōrttŭ*)
Hindi (neighbour)	तौलिया (*tauliyā*)
English	a towel

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

துண்டு (*tuṇṭu*) is native Dravidian (DEDR 3310). The entry glosses *tuṇṭu* "piece, bit, strip": the towel is a strip of cloth.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *tuṇṭu*
- *Say it:* *tuṇṭu*, once more
- *Say it:* say *tuṇṭu*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for a key, then the Tamil for a lock, then say *tuṇṭu* again

Before you move on

What does துண்டு mean? ("A towel; a piece".) Say it once more.

119.4 தலையணை (talaiyaṇai) — a pillow

Before the new one: say the Tamil for a lock, then the Tamil for a towel; a piece.

You'll want to know: தலையணை

தலையணை — *talaiyaṇai* — "a pillow".

In the family, and next door

	word	same root
Kannada	ದಿಂಬು (*dimbu*)	
Telugu	దిండు (*diṇḍu*)	
Malayalam	തലയണ (*talayaṇa*)	yes
Hindi (neighbour)	तकिया (*takiyā*)	
English	a pillow	

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

தலையணை (*talaiyaṇai*) is native: *talai*, "head" (DEDR 3103), and *aṇai*, "support, prop" (DEDR 123; Malayalam *aṇa*, "support, pillow"): "the head's support".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: talaiyaṇai*
- *Say it: talaiyaṇai*, once more
- *Say it:* say *talaiyaṇai*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for a lock, then the Tamil for a towel; a piece, then say *talaiyaṇai* again

Before you move on

What does தலையணை mean? ("A pillow".) Say it once more.

119.5 போர்வை (pōrvai) — a blanket

Before the new one: say the Tamil for a towel; a piece, then the Tamil for a pillow.

Say the day words, நாள் and the formal தினம், then the night words, இரவு, ராத்திரி, and இருள், darkness.

You'll want to know: போர்வை

போர்வை — *pōrvai* — "a blanket".

In the family, and next door

	word
Kannada	ಕಂಬಳಿ (*kambaḷi*)
Telugu	దుప్పటి (*duppaṭi*)
Malayalam	പുതപ്പ് (*putappŭ*)
Hindi (neighbour)	कंबल (*kambal*)
English	a blanket

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

போர்வை (*pōrvai*) is native Dravidian. DEDR 4590 lists Malayalam *pōrkkuka*, "to wrap". It is the noun of *pōr*, "to wrap oneself in".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: pōrvai*
- *Say it: pōrvai*, once more
- *Say it:* say *pōrvai*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for a towel; a piece, then the Tamil for a pillow, then say *pōrvai* again

Before you move on

What does போர்வை mean? ("A blanket".) Say it once more.

Chapter 120

Mirror, Soap, Bucket, Pen, Paper

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say a mirror, soap, a bucket, a pen and paper.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 120: I can say a mirror, soap, a bucket, a pen and paper.*

120.1 கண்ணாடி (kaṇṇāṭi) — a mirror; glasses

Before the new one: say the Tamil for a pillow, then the Tamil for a blanket.

You'll want to know: கண்ணாடி

கண்ணாடி — *kaṇṇāṭi* — "a mirror; glasses".

In the family, and next door

	word	same root
Kannada	ಕನ್ನಡಿ (*kannaḍi*)	yes
Telugu	అద్దం (*addaṁ*)	
Malayalam	കണ്ണാടി (*kaṇṇāṭi*)	yes
Hindi (neighbour)	शीशा (*śīśā*)	
English	a mirror	

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

கண்ணாடி (*kaṇṇāṭi*) is native Dravidian. DEDR 1182 lists Malayalam *kaṇṇāṭi* and Kannada *kannaḍi*. The entry points back to *kaṇ*, "eye" (DEDR 1159).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: kaṇṇāṭi*
- *Say it: kaṇṇāṭi*, once more
- *Say it:* say *kaṇṇāṭi*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for a pillow, then the Tamil for a blanket, then say *kaṇṇāṭi* again

Before you move on

What does கண்ணாடி mean? ("A mirror; glasses".) Say it once more.

120.2 சோப்பு (cōppu) — soap

Before the new one: say the Tamil for a blanket, then the Tamil for a mirror; glasses.

You'll want to know: சோப்பு

சோப்பு — *cōppu* — "soap".

In the family, and next door

	word	same root
Kannada	ಸಾಬೂನು (*sābūnu*)	
Telugu	సబ్బు (*sabbu*)	
Malayalam	സോപ്പ് (*sōppŭ*)	yes
Hindi (neighbour)	साबुन (*sābun*)	
English	soap	

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

சோப்பு (*cōppu*) is a loan from English *soap*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *cōppu*
- *Say it:* *cōppu*, once more
- *Say it:* say *cōppu*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for a blanket, then the Tamil for a mirror; glasses, then say *cōppu* again

Before you move on

What does சோப்பு mean? ("Soap".) Say it once more.

120.3 வாளி (vāḷi) — a bucket

Before the new one: say the Tamil for a mirror; glasses, then the Tamil for soap.

You'll want to know: வாளி

வாளி — *vāḷi* — "a bucket".

In the family, and next door

	word	same root
Malayalam	ബക്കറ്റ് (*bakkaṟṟŭ*)	
Hindi (neighbour)	बाल्टी (*bāḷṭī*)	yes
English	a bucket	

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

வாளி (*vāḷi*) is a loan from Portuguese *balde*, "bucket".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: vāḷi*
- *Say it: vāḷi*, once more
- *Say it:* say *vāḷi*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for a mirror; glasses, then the Tamil for soap, then say *vāḷi* again

Before you move on

What does வாளி mean? ("A bucket".) Say it once more.

120.4 பேனா (pēṉā) — a pen

Before the new one: say the Tamil for soap, then the Tamil for a bucket.

Say தமிழ், curling the tongue back for ழ, then எழுது.

You'll want to know: பேனா

பேனா — *pēṉā* — "a pen".

In the family, and next door

	word	same root
Kannada	ಲೇಖನಿ (*lēkhani*)	
Telugu	కలం (*kalami*)	
Malayalam	പേന (*pēna*)	yes
English	a pen	

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

பேனா (*pēṉā*) is a loan from English *pen*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *pēṉā*
- *Say it:* *pēṉā*, once more
- *Say it:* say *pēṉā*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for soap, then the Tamil for a bucket, then say *pēṉā* again

Before you move on

What does பேனா mean? ("A pen".) Say it once more.

120.5 காகிதம் (kāgitam) — paper

Before the new one: say the Tamil for a bucket, then the Tamil for a pen.

Read it: the lines aloud as one run — **வணக்கம். இது என் வீடு. அம்மா இங்கே.**

You'll want to know: காகிதம்

காகிதம் — *kāgitam* — "paper".

In the family, and next door

	word	same root
Kannada	ಕಾಗದ (*kāgada*)	yes
Telugu	కాగితం (*kāgitaṁ*)	yes
Malayalam	കടലാസ് (*kaṭalās*)	
English	paper	

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

காகிதம் (*kāgitam*) is a loan from Persian *kāghaz*, "paper", through Hindustani.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *kāgitam*
- *Say it:* *kāgitam*, once more
- *Say it:* say *kāgitam*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for a bucket, then the Tamil for a pen, then say *kāgitam* again

Before you move on

What does **காகிதம்** mean? ("Paper".) Say it once more.

Chapter 121

Clock, Skirt, Sari, Lentils, Curry

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (7) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 7 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say a clock, a skirt, a sari, lentils and a curry.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 121: I can say a clock, a skirt, a sari, lentils and a curry.*

121.1 கடிகாரம் (kaṭikāram) — a clock

Before the new one: say the Tamil for a pen, then the Tamil for paper.

Tell the time, ஒரு மணி, இரண்டு மணி, then name the afternoon three ways: நடுப்பகல், மதியம், பிற்பகல்.

You'll want to know: கடிகாரம்

கடிகாரம் — *kaṭikāram* — "a clock".

In the family, and next door

	word	same root
Kannada	ಗಡಿಯಾರ (*gaḍiyāra*)	yes
Telugu	గడియారం (*gaḍiyāraṁ*)	yes
English	a clock	

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

கடிகாரம் (*kaṭikāram*) is built on Sanskrit *ghaṭikā*, "water-clock, a period of 24 minutes" (CDIAL 4406, under *ghaṭa*, "pot"). How the ending *-āram* was formed is not clear.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: kaṭikāram*
- *Say it: kaṭikāram*, once more
- *Say it:* say *kaṭikāram*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for a pen, then the Tamil for paper, then say *kaṭikāram* again

Before you move on

What does கடிகாரம் mean? ("A clock".) Say it once more.

121.2 பாவாடை (pāvāṭai) — a skirt

Before the new one: say the Tamil for paper, then the Tamil for a clock.

You'll want to know: பாவாடை

பாவாடை — *pāvāṭai* — "a skirt".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

The origin of பாவாடை (*pāvāṭai*) is uncertain. DEDR has no entry for it, and the parts of the word are not settled.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: pāvāṭai*
- *Say it: pāvāṭai*, once more
- *Say it:* say *pāvāṭai*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for paper, then the Tamil for a clock, then say *pāvāṭai* again

Before you move on

What does பாவாடை mean? (“A skirt”.) Say it once more.

121.3 சேலை (cēlai) — a sari

Before the new one: say the Tamil for a clock, then the Tamil for a skirt.

Say the colours: கருப்பு, வெள்ளை, சிவப்பு, நீலம், பச்சை, மஞ்சள். Blue is the one many languages named last.

You’ll want to know: சேலை

சேலை — *cēlai* — “a sari”.

In the family, and next door

	word
Kannada	ಸೀರೆ (*sīre*)
Telugu	చీర (*cīra*)
Malayalam	സാരി (*sāri*)
Hindi (neighbour)	साड़ी (*sāṛī*)
English	a sari

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

சேலை (*cēlai*) is usually taken as a form of *cīlai*, “cloth, woman’s garment”, which is native: DEDR 2629 lists Malayalam *cīla* and Kannada *sīre*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *cēlai*
- *Say it:* *cēlai*, once more
- *Say it:* say *cēlai*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for a clock, then the Tamil for a skirt, then say *cēlai* again

Before you move on

What does சேலை mean? ("A sari".) Say it once more.

121.4 பருப்பு (paruppu) — lentils, dal

Before the new one: say the Tamil for a skirt, then the Tamil for a sari.

You'll want to know: பருப்பு

பருப்பு — *paruppu* — "lentils, dal".

In the family, and next door

	word
Hindi (neighbour)	दाल (*dāl*)
English	lentils, dal

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

பருப்பு (*paruppu*) is native Dravidian. DEDR 3978 lists Malayalam *parippu*, Kannada *pappu* and Telugu *pappu*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: paruppu*
- *Say it: paruppu*, once more
- *Say it:* say *paruppu*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for a skirt, then the Tamil for a sari, then say *paruppu* again

Before you move on

What does பருப்பு mean? ("Lentils, dal".) Say it once more.

121.5 குழம்பு (kuḻambu) — a curry, a gravy

Before the new one: say the Tamil for a sari, then the Tamil for lentils.

You'll want to know: குழம்பு

குழம்பு — *kuḻambu* — "a curry, a gravy".

In the family, and next door

	word
Telugu	కూర (*kūra*)
Malayalam	കറി (*kaṟi*)
English	a curry, a gravy

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

குழம்பு (*kuḻambu*) is native Dravidian. DEDR 1817 lists Malayalam *kuḻampu*, "thickened fluid". It comes from *kuḻampu*, "to become mixed, thick".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: kuḻambu*
- *Say it: kuḻambu*, once more
- *Say it:* say *kuḻambu*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for a sari, then the Tamil for lentils, then say *kuḻambu* again

Before you move on

What does குழம்பு mean? ("A curry, a gravy".) Say it once more.

121.6 Places and what you can do — a first pass

Say the words for lentils and a curry.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- straight ahead, near, distance; far, behind, in front
- in the middle, a street, a bridge, a park, a temple
- a library, a bank, a market, a beach, an office
- a garden, a corner, a turn, can, a skill

Before you move on

Straight ahead? (நேராக, *nērāka.*) Near? (அருகில், *arukil.*) Distance; far? (தூரம், *tūram.*) Behind? (பின்னால், *piṉṉāl.*) In front? (முன்னால், *muṉṉāl.*) In the middle? (நடுவில், *naṭuvil.*) A street? (தெரு, *teru.*) A bridge? (பாலம், *pālam.*) A park? (பூங்கா, *pūṅkā.*) A temple? (கோயில், *kōyil.*) A library? (நூலகம், *nūlakam.*) A bank? (வங்கி, *vaṅki.*) A market? (சந்தை, *cantai.*) A beach? (கடற்கரை, *kaṭaṟkarai.*) An office? (அலுவலகம், *aluvalakam.*) A garden? (தோட்டம், *tōṭṭam.*) A corner? (மூலை, *mūlai.*) A turn? (திருப்பம், *tiruppam.*) Can?

(முடியும், *muṭiyum.*) A skill? (திறமை, *tiṟamai.*)

121.7 Things in the house — a second pass

Say the words for ability and a right.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- ability, a right, a chance, a tool, a possession
- a stove, a vessel, a plate, a cup, a spoon
- a key, a lock, a towel; a piece, a pillow, a blanket
- a mirror; glasses, soap, a bucket, a pen, paper
- a clock, a skirt, a sari, lentils, a curry

Before you move on

Ability? (வல்லமை, *vallamai.*) A right? (உரிமை, *urimai.*) A chance? (வாய்ப்பு, *vāyppu.*) A tool? (கருவி, *karuvi.*) A possession? (உடைமை, *uṭaimai.*) A stove? (அடுப்பு, *aṭuppu.*) A vessel? (பாத்திரம், *pāttiram.*) A plate? (தட்டு, *taṭṭu.*) A cup? (கோப்பை, *kōppai.*) A spoon? (கரண்டி, *karaṇṭi.*) A key? (சாவி, *cāvi.*) A lock? (பூட்டு, *pūṭṭu.*) A towel; a piece? (துண்டு, *tuṇṭu.*) A pillow? (தலையணை, *talaiyaṇai.*) A blanket? (போர்வை, *pōrvai.*) A mirror; glasses? (கண்ணாடி, *kaṇṇāṭi.*) Soap? (சோப்பு, *cōppu.*) A bucket? (வாளி, *vāḷi.*) A pen? (பேனா, *pēṉā.*) Paper? (காகிதம், *kāgitam.*) A clock? (கடிகாரம், *kaṭikāram.*) A skirt? (பாவாடை, *pāvāṭai.*) A sari? (சேலை, *cēlai.*) Lentils? (பருப்பு, *paruppu.*) A curry? (குழம்பு, *kuḻambu.*)

Chapter 122

Rasam, Butter, Egg, Fish, Meat

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say rasam, butter, an egg, a fish and meat.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 122: I can say rasam, butter, an egg, a fish and meat.*

122.1 ரசம் (rasam) — rasam

Before the new one: say the Tamil for lentils, dal, then the Tamil for a curry, a gravy.

You'll want to know: ரசம்

ரசம் — *rasam* — "rasam".

In the family, and next door

	word	same root
Kannada	ಸಾರು (*sāru*)	
Telugu	రసం (*rasaṁ*)	yes
English	rasam	

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

ரசம் (*rasam*) is a loan from Sanskrit *rasa*, "juice, taste" (CDIAL 10650).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *rasam*
- *Say it:* *rasam*, once more
- *Say it:* say *rasam*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for lentils, dal, then the Tamil for a curry, a gravy, then say *rasam* again

Before you move on

What does ரசம் mean? ("Rasam".) Say it once more.

122.2 வெண்ணெய் (veṇṇey) — butter

Before the new one: say the Tamil for a curry, a gravy, then the Tamil for rasam.

You'll want to know: வெண்ணெய்

வெண்ணெய் — *veṇṇey* — "butter".

In the family, and next door

	word
Hindi (neighbour)	मक्खन (*makkhan*)
English	butter

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

வெண்ணெய் (*veṇṇey*) is native: *veṇ*, "white" (DEDR 5496), and *ney*, "ghee" (DEDR 3746): "white ghee", butter before it is melted.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *veṇṇey*
- *Say it:* *veṇṇey*, once more
- *Say it:* say *veṇṇey*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for a curry, a gravy, then the Tamil for rasam, then say *veṇṇey* again

Before you move on

What does வெண்ணெய் mean? (“Butter”.) Say it once more.

122.3 முட்டை (muṭṭai) — an egg

Before the new one: say the Tamil for rasam, then the Tamil for butter.

You’ll want to know: முட்டை

முட்டை — *muṭṭai* — “an egg”.

In the family, and next door

	word	same root
Kannada	ಮೊಟ್ಟೆ (*moṭṭe*)	yes
Telugu	గుడ్డు (*guḍḍu*)	
Malayalam	മുട്ട (*muṭṭa*)	yes
Hindi (neighbour)	अंडा (*aṇḍā*)	
English	an egg	

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

முட்டை (*muṭṭai*) is native Dravidian. DEDR 4939 lists Malayalam *muṭṭa* and Kannada *moṭṭe*.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *muṭṭai*
- *Say it:* *muṭṭai*, once more
- *Say it:* say *muṭṭai*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for rasam, then the Tamil for butter, then say *muṭṭai* again

Before you move on

What does முட்டை mean? ("An egg".) Say it once more.

122.4 மீன் (mīṉ) — a fish

Before the new one: say the Tamil for butter, then the Tamil for an egg.

You'll want to know: மீன்

மீன் — *mīṉ* — "a fish".

In the family, and next door

	word	same root
Kannada	మీను (*mīnu*)	yes
Telugu	చేప (*cēpa*)	
Malayalam	മീൻ (*mīn*)	yes
Hindi (neighbour)	मछली (*machhlī*)	
English	a fish	

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

மீன் (*mīṉ*) is native Dravidian. DEDR 4885 lists Malayalam *mīn*, Kannada *mīn* and Telugu *mīnu*. The entry compares Sanskrit *mīna*, "fish".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *mīṉ*
- *Say it:* *mīṉ*, once more
- *Say it:* say *mīṉ*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for butter, then the Tamil for an egg, then say *mīṉ* again

Before you move on

What does மீன் mean? (“A fish”.) Say it once more.

122.5 இறைச்சி (iṟaicci) — meat

Before the new one: say the Tamil for an egg, then the Tamil for a fish.

You’ll want to know: இறைச்சி

இறைச்சி — *iṟaicci* — “meat”.

In the family, and next door

	word	same root
Kannada	ಮಾಂಸ (*māṁsa*)	
Telugu	మాంసం (*māṁsaṁ*)	
Malayalam	ഇറച്ചി (*iṟacci*)	yes
Hindi (neighbour)	गोश्त (*gośt*)	
English	meat	

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

இறைச்சி (*iṟaicci*) is native Dravidian. DEDR 529 lists Malayalam *iṟacci* and Telugu *eṟaci*. The entry spells it *iṟacci*, “flesh”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: iṟaicci*
- *Say it: iṟaicci*, once more
- *Say it:* say *iṟaicci*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for an egg, then the Tamil for a fish, then say *iṟaicci* again

Before you move on

What does இறைச்சி mean? (“Meat”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 123

Vegetables, Banana, Mango, Coconut, Onion

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say vegetables, a banana, a mango, a coconut and an onion.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 123: I can say vegetables, a banana, a mango, a coconut and an onion.*

123.1 காய்கறி (kāykaṟi) — vegetables

Before the new one: say the Tamil for a fish, then the Tamil for meat.

You'll want to know: காய்கறி

காய்கறி — *kāykaṟi* — "vegetables".

In the family, and next door

	word
Kannada	ತರಕಾರಿ (*tarakāri*)
Telugu	కూరగాయలు (*kūragāyalu*)
Malayalam	പച്ചക്കറി (*paccakkaṟi*)
English	vegetables

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

காய்கறி (*kāykaṟi*) is native: *kāy*, "unripe fruit" (DEDR 1459, which compares Indo-Aryan **kacca*, "raw"), and *kaṟi*, "vegetables, curry" (DEDR 1391; Malayalam *kaṟi*).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: kāykaṟi*
- *Say it: kāykaṟi*, once more
- *Say it:* say *kāykaṟi*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for a fish, then the Tamil for meat, then say *kāykaṟi* again

Before you move on

What does காய்கறி mean? ("Vegetables".) Say it once more.

123.2 வாழைப்பழம் (vāḻaippaḻam) — a banana

Before the new one: say the Tamil for meat, then the Tamil for vegetables.

You'll want to know: வாழைப்பழம்

வாழைப்பழம் — *vāḻaippaḻam* — "a banana".

In the family, and next door

	word	same root
Kannada	ಬಾಳೆಹಣ್ಣು (*bāḷehaṇṇu*)	
Telugu	అరటిపండు (*araṭipaṇḍu*)	
Malayalam	വാഴപ്പഴം (*vāḻappaḻaṁ*)	yes
Hindi (neighbour)	केला (*kelā*)	
English	a banana	

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

வாழைப்பழம் (*vāḻaippaḻam*) is native: *vāḻai*, "plantain" (DEDR 5373; Malayalam *vāḻa*, Kannada *bāḻe*), and *paḻam*, "fruit" (DEDR 4004). DEDR compares Sanskrit (lexicons) *vārabuṣā*, "plantain", and *phala*, "fruit".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *vāḻaippaḻam*
- *Say it:* *vāḻaippaḻam*, once more
- *Say it:* say *vāḻaippaḻam*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for meat, then the Tamil for vegetables, then say *vāḻaippaḻam* again

Before you move on

What does வாழைப்பழம் mean? ("A banana".) Say it once more.

123.3 மாம்பழம் (māmpaḻam) — a mango

Before the new one: say the Tamil for vegetables, then the Tamil for a banana.

Say எனக்குத் தமிழ் பிடிக்கும், then the plain verb for wanting, விரும்பு.

You'll want to know: மாம்பழம்

மாம்பழம் — *māmpaḻam* — "a mango".

In the family, and next door

	word	same root
Kannada	ಮಾವಿನಹಣ್ಣು (*māvinahaṇṇu*)	
Telugu	మామిడిపండు (*māmiḍipaṇḍu*)	yes
Hindi (neighbour)	आम (*ām*)	
English	a mango	

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

மாம்பழம் (*māmpaḻam*) is native: *mā*, "mango" (DEDR 4782; Malayalam *mā*), and *paḻam*, "fruit" (DEDR 4004). DEDR compares Sanskrit *mākanda*, "mango tree", and *phala*, "fruit". English *mango* came, through Portuguese, from the Malayalam form *māṅṅa*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *māmpaḻam*
- *Say it:* *māmpaḻam*, once more
- *Say it:* say *māmpaḻam*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for vegetables, then the Tamil for a banana, then say *māmpaḻam* again

Before you move on

What does மாம்பழம் mean? ("A mango".) Say it once more.

123.4 தேங்காய் (tēṅkāy) — a coconut

Before the new one: say the Tamil for a banana, then the Tamil for a mango.

You'll want to know: தேங்காய்

தேங்காய் — *tēṅkāy* — "a coconut".

In the family, and next door

	word	same root
Kannada	తేంగు (*teṅgu*)	yes
Telugu	కొబ్బరి (*kobbari*)	
Malayalam	തെങ്ങ (*tēṅṅa*)	yes
Hindi (neighbour)	नारियल (*nāriyal*)	
English	a coconut	

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

தேங்காய் (*tēṅkāy*) is native Dravidian. DEDR 3408 lists Malayalam *teṅṅu*, "coconut tree", Kannada *teṅgu* and Telugu *teṅkāya*. It is *teṅ*, "coconut palm", with *kāy*, "fruit".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *tēṅkāy*
- *Say it:* *tēṅkāy*, once more
- *Say it:* say *tēṅkāy*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for a banana, then the Tamil for a mango, then say *tēṅkāy* again

Before you move on

What does தேங்காய் mean? ("A coconut".) Say it once more.

123.5 வெங்காயம் (veṅkāyam) — an onion

Before the new one: say the Tamil for a mango, then the Tamil for a coconut.

You'll want to know: வெங்காயம்

வெங்காயம் — *veṅkāyam* — "an onion".

In the family, and next door

	word
Kannada	ಈರುಳ್ಳಿ (*īruḷḷi*)
Telugu	ఉల్లిపాయ (*ullipāya*)
Malayalam	ഉള്ളി (*uḷḷi*)
Hindi (neighbour)	प्याज़ (*pyāz*)
English	an onion

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

வெங்காயம் (*veṅkāyam*) begins with native *veṇ*, "white" (DEDR 5496). The second part is not settled, so the origin of the whole word is uncertain.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: veṅkāyam*
- *Say it: veṅkāyam*, once more
- *Say it:* say *veṅkāyam*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for a mango, then the Tamil for a coconut, then say *veṅkāyam* again

Before you move on

What does வெங்காயம் mean? ("An onion".) Say it once more.

Chapter 124

Tomato, Chilli, Ginger, Garlic, Honey

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say a tomato, a chilli, ginger, garlic and honey.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 124: I can say a tomato, a chilli, ginger, garlic and honey.*

124.1 தக்காளி (takkāḷi) — a tomato

> Before the new one: say the Tamil for a coconut, then the Tamil for an onion.

You'll want to know: தக்காளி

தக்காளி — *takkāḷi* — "a tomato".

In the family, and next door

	word	same root
Telugu	టమాటా (*ṭamāṭā*)	
Malayalam	തക്കാളി (*takkāḷi*)	yes
Hindi (neighbour)	टमाटर (*ṭamāṭar*)	
English	a tomato	

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

தக்காளி (*takkāḷi*) is native Dravidian. DEDR 3009 lists Malayalam *takkāḷi* and Kannada *takkāḷi*. The entry glosses it "Indian winter cherry, tomato": the name belonged to a related plant before it settled on the tomato.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: takkāḷi*
- *Say it: takkāḷi*, once more
- *Say it:* say *takkāḷi*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for a coconut, then the Tamil for an onion, then say *takkāḷi* again

Before you move on

What does தக்காளி mean? ("A tomato".) Say it once more.

124.2 மிளகாய் (milakāy) — a chilli

Before the new one: say the Tamil for an onion, then the Tamil for a tomato.

You'll want to know: மிளகாய்

மிளகாய் — *milakāy* — "a chilli".

In the family, and next door

	word	same root
Telugu	మిరప (*mirapa*)	yes
Malayalam	മുളക് (*muḷakŭ*)	yes
Hindi (neighbour)	मिर्च (*mirc*)	
English	a chilli	

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

மிளகாய் (*milakāy*) is native: *miḷaku*, "black pepper" (DEDR 4867; Malayalam *miḷaku*), and *kāy*, "fruit". When the chilli arrived from the Americas, Tamil named it "the pepper fruit".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: milakāy*
- *Say it: milakāy*, once more
- *Say it:* say *milakāy*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for an onion, then the Tamil for a tomato, then say *milakāy* again

Before you move on

What does மிளகாய் mean? ("A chilli".) Say it once more.

124.3 இஞ்சி (iñci) — ginger

Before the new one: say the Tamil for a tomato, then the Tamil for a chilli.

You'll want to know: இஞ்சி

இஞ்சி — *iñci* — "ginger".

In the family, and next door

	word	same root
Kannada	ಶುಂಠಿ (*śuṇṭhi*)	
Telugu	అల్లం (*allaṁ*)	
Malayalam	ഇഞ്ചി (*iñci*)	yes
Hindi (neighbour)	अदरक (*adrak*)	
English	ginger	

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

இஞ்சி (*iñci*) is native Dravidian. DEDR 429 lists Malayalam *iñci*. The entry compares Sanskrit *śṛṅgavera*, "ginger", and points to the native word for "root", *vēr*, in its second half.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: iñci*
- *Say it: iñci*, once more
- *Say it:* say *iñci*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for a tomato, then the Tamil for a chilli, then say *iñci* again

Before you move on

What does இஞ்சி mean? ("Ginger".) Say it once more.

124.4 பூண்டு (pūṇṭu) — garlic

Before the new one: say the Tamil for a chilli, then the Tamil for ginger.

You'll want to know: பூண்டு

பூண்டு — *pūṇṭu* — "garlic".

In the family, and next door

	word
Kannada	ಬೆಳ್ಳುಳ್ಳಿ (*beḷḷuḷḷi*)
Telugu	వెల్లుల్లి (*vellulli*)
Malayalam	വെളുത്തുള്ളി (*veḷuttuḷḷi*)
Hindi (neighbour)	लहसुन (*lahsun*)
English	garlic

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

பூண்டு (*pūṇṭu*) is native Dravidian (DEDR 4360). The entry glosses *pūṇṭu* "small plant, herb".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *pūṇṭu*
- *Say it:* *pūṇṭu*, once more
- *Say it:* say *pūṇṭu*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for a chilli, then the Tamil for ginger, then say *pūṇṭu* again

Before you move on

What does பூண்டு mean? ("Garlic".) Say it once more.

124.5 தேன் (tēṉ) — honey

Before the new one: say the Tamil for ginger, then the Tamil for garlic.

You'll want to know: தேன்

தேன் — *tēṉ* — "honey".

In the family, and next door

	word	same root
Kannada	ಜೇನು (*jēnu*)	yes
Telugu	తేనె (*tēne*)	yes
Hindi (neighbour)	शहद (*śahad*)	
English	honey	

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

தேன் (*tēṉ*) is native Dravidian. DEDR 3268 lists Malayalam *tēn*. The entry sets it beside *tīm*, "sweet".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *tēṉ*
- *Say it:* *tēṉ*, once more
- *Say it:* say *tēṉ*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for ginger, then the Tamil for garlic, then say *tēṉ* again

Before you move on

What does தேன் mean? ("Honey".) Say it once more.

Chapter 125

Idli, Dosa, Vadai, Coffee, Sea

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say an idli, a dosa, a vadai, coffee and the sea.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 125: I can say an idli, a dosa, a vadai, coffee and the sea.*

125.1 இட்லி (iṭli) — an idli, a steamed rice cake

Before the new one: say the Tamil for garlic, then the Tamil for honey.

You'll want to know: இட்லி

இட்லி — *iṭli* — "an idli, a steamed rice cake".

In the family, and next door

	word	same root
Kannada	ಇಡ್ಲಿ (*iḍli*)	yes
Telugu	ఇడ్లీ (*iḍlī*)	yes
English	an idli, a steamed rice cake	

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

The origin of இட்லி (*iṭli*) is uncertain, and DEDR has no entry for it. Food historians usually connect it with *iḍḍalige*, a food named in a

Kannada text of the tenth century.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: iṭli*
- *Say it: iṭli*, once more
- *Say it:* say *iṭli*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for garlic, then the Tamil for honey, then say *iṭli* again

Before you move on

What does இட்லி mean? ("An idli, a steamed rice cake".) Say it once more.

125.2 தோசை (tōcai) — a dosa, a thin pancake

Before the new one: say the Tamil for honey, then the Tamil for an idli.

You'll want to know: தோசை

தோசை — *tōcai* — "a dosa, a thin pancake".

In the family, and next door

	word
Kannada	ದೋಸೆ (*dōse*)
Telugu	దోశ (*dōsa*)
Malayalam	ദോശ (*dōśa*)
English	a dosa, a thin pancake

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

தோசை (*tōcai*) is native Dravidian. DEDR 3542 lists Malayalam *dōśa* and Kannada *dōse*. The entry also compares Sanskrit *dhosaka*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *tōcai*
- *Say it:* *tōcai*, once more
- *Say it:* say *tōcai*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for honey, then the Tamil for an idli, then say *tōcai* again

Before you move on

What does தோசை mean? ("A dosa, a thin pancake".) Say it once more.

125.3 வடை (vaṭai) — a vadai, a savoury doughnut

Before the new one: say the Tamil for an idli, then the Tamil for a dosa.

You'll want to know: வடை

வடை — *vaṭai* — "a vadai, a savoury doughnut".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

வடை (*vaṭai*) is a loan from Sanskrit *vaṭaka*, "round cake of pulse fried in oil" (CDIAL 11213).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *vaṭai*
- *Say it:* *vaṭai*, once more
- *Say it:* say *vaṭai*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for an idli, then the Tamil for a dosa, then say *vaṭai* again

Before you move on

What does **வடை** mean? ("A vadai, a savoury doughnut".) Say it once more.

125.4 காபி (kāpi) — coffee

Before the new one: say the Tamil for a dosa, then the Tamil for a vadai.

Greet the day through, in Tamil's own words: **காலை வணக்கம்**, **மாலை வணக்கம்**, **இனிய இரவு**.

You'll want to know: காபி

காபி — *kāpi* — "coffee".

In the family, and next door

	word	same root
Kannada	**ಕಾಫಿ** (*kāphi*)	yes
Telugu	**కాఫీ** (*kāphī*)	yes
Malayalam	**കാപ്പി** (*kāppi*)	yes
English	coffee	

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

காபி (*kāpi*) is a loan from English *coffee*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: kāpi*
- *Say it: kāpi*, once more
- *Say it:* say *kāpi*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for a dosa, then the Tamil for a vadai, then say *kāpi* again

Before you move on

What does காபி mean? ("Coffee".) Say it once more.

125.5 கடல் (kaṭal) — the sea

Before the new one: say the Tamil for a vadai, then the Tamil for coffee.

You'll want to know: கடல்

கடல் — *kaṭal* — "the sea".

In the family, and next door

	word	same root
Kannada	ಸಮುದ್ರ (*samudra*)	
Telugu	సముద్రం (*samudram*)	
Malayalam	കടൽ (*kaṭal*)	yes
Hindi (neighbour)	समुद्र (*samudra*)	
English	the sea	

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

கடல் (*kaṭal*) is native Dravidian. DEDR 1118 lists Malayalam *kaṭal*, Kannada *kaḍal* and Telugu *kaḍali*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: kaṭal*
- *Say it: kaṭal*, once more
- *Say it:* say *kaṭal*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for a vadai, then the Tamil for coffee, then say *kaṭal* again

Before you move on

What does கடல் mean? (“The sea”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 126

Lake, Pond, Forest, Leaf, Soil

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say a lake, a pond, a forest, a leaf and soil.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 126: I can say a lake, a pond, a forest, a leaf and soil.*

126.1 ஏரி (ēri) — a lake

> Before the new one: say the Tamil for coffee, then the Tamil for the sea.

You'll want to know: ஏரி

ஏரி — *ēri* — "a lake".

In the family, and next door

	word
Telugu	సరస్సు (*sarassu*)
Malayalam	തടാകം (*taṭākaṁ*)
Hindi (neighbour)	झील (*jhīl*)
English	a lake

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

ஏரி (*ēri*) is native Dravidian. DEDR 901 lists Kannada *ēri*, "the bank of a tank, a tank".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *ēri*
- *Say it:* *ēri*, once more
- *Say it:* say *ēri*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for coffee, then the Tamil for the sea, then say *ēri* again

Before you move on

What does ஏரி mean? ("A lake".) Say it once more.

126.2 குளம் (kuḷam) — a pond

Before the new one: say the Tamil for the sea, then the Tamil for a lake.

You'll want to know: குளம்

குளம் — *kuḷam* — "a pond".

In the family, and next door

	word	same root
Malayalam	കുളം (*kuḷam*)	yes
English	a pond	

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

குளம் (*kuḷam*) is native Dravidian. DEDR 1828 lists Malayalam *kuḷam*, Kannada *koḷa* and Telugu *kolanu*. The entry compares Sanskrit *kūla*, "pond".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *kuḷam*
- *Say it:* *kuḷam*, once more
- *Say it:* say *kuḷam*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for the sea, then the Tamil for a lake, then say *kuḷam* again

Before you move on

What does குளம் mean? (“A pond”.) Say it once more.

126.3 காடு (kāṭu) — a forest

Before the new one: say the Tamil for a lake, then the Tamil for a pond.

You’ll want to know: காடு

காடு — *kāṭu* — “a forest”.

In the family, and next door

	word	same root
Kannada	ಕಾಡು (*kāḍu*)	yes
Telugu	అడవి (*aḍavi*)	
Hindi (neighbour)	जंगल (*jaṅgal*)	
English	a forest	

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

காடு (*kāṭu*) is native Dravidian. DEDR 1438 lists Malayalam *kāṭu*, Kannada *kāḍu* and Telugu *kāḍu*.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: kāṭu*
- *Say it: kāṭu*, once more
- *Say it:* say *kāṭu*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for a lake, then the Tamil for a pond, then say *kāṭu* again

Before you move on

What does காடு mean? ("A forest".) Say it once more.

126.4 இலை (ilai) — a leaf

Before the new one: say the Tamil for a pond, then the Tamil for a forest.

You'll want to know: இலை

இலை — *ilai* — "a leaf".

In the family, and next door

	word	same root
Kannada	ಎಲೆ (*ele*)	
Telugu	ఆకు (*āku*)	
Malayalam	ഇല (*ila*)	yes
English	a leaf	

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

இலை (*ilai*) is native Dravidian. DEDR 497 lists Malayalam *ila* and Kannada *ele*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: ilai*
- *Say it: ilai*, once more
- *Say it:* say *ilai*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for a pond, then the Tamil for a forest, then say *ilai* again

Before you move on

What does இலை mean? ("A leaf".) Say it once more.

126.5 மண் (maṇ) — soil, earth

Before the new one: say the Tamil for a forest, then the Tamil for a leaf.

You'll want to know: மண்

மண் — *maṇ* — "soil, earth".

In the family, and next door

	word	same root
Kannada	ಮಣ್ಣು (*maṇṇu*)	yes
Telugu	మట్టి (*maṭṭi*)	yes
Malayalam	മണ്ണ് (*maṇṇŭ*)	yes
English	soil, earth	

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

மண் (*maṇ*) is native Dravidian. DEDR 4666 lists Malayalam *maṇ*, Kannada *maṇ* and Telugu *mannu*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *maṇ*
- *Say it:* *maṇ*, once more
- *Say it:* say *maṇ*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for a forest, then the Tamil for a leaf, then say *maṇ* again

Before you move on

What does மண் mean? (“Soil, earth”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 127

Star, Dew, Thunder, Lightning, Storm

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say a star, dew, thunder, lightning and a storm.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 127: I can say a star, dew, thunder, lightning and a storm.*

127.1 நட்சத்திரம் (naṭcattiram) — a star

Before the new one: say the Tamil for a leaf, then the Tamil for soil.

Say the day words, நாள் and the formal தினம், then the night words, இரவு, ராத்திரி, and இருள், darkness.

You'll want to know: நட்சத்திரம்

நட்சத்திரம் — *naṭcattiram* — "a star".

In the family, and next door

	word	same root
Kannada	ಚುಕ್ಕಿ (*cukki*)	
Telugu	చుక్క (*cukka*)	
Malayalam	നക്ഷത്രം (*nakṣatram*)	yes
Hindi (neighbour)	तारा (*tārā*)	
English	a star	

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

நட்சத்திரம் (*naṭcattiram*) is a loan from Sanskrit *nakṣatra*, “star” (CDIAL 6913).

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: naṭcattiram*
- *Say it: naṭcattiram*, once more
- *Say it:* say *naṭcattiram*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for a leaf, then the Tamil for soil, then say *naṭcattiram* again

Before you move on

What does நட்சத்திரம் mean? (“A star”.) Say it once more.

127.2 பனி (pa̲ni) — dew, frost, snow

Before the new one: say the Tamil for soil, then the Tamil for a star.

You’ll want to know: பனி

பனி — *pa̲ni* — “dew, frost, snow”.

In the family, and next door

	word
Hindi (neighbour)	ओस (*os*)
English	dew, frost, snow

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

பனி (*pa̲ni*) is native Dravidian. DEDR 4035 lists Malayalam *pani*, “dew” and Kannada *pani*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: paṉi*
- *Say it: paṉi*, once more
- *Say it:* say *paṉi*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for soil, then the Tamil for a star, then say *paṉi* again

Before you move on

What does பனி mean? ("Dew, frost, snow".) Say it once more.

127.3 இடி (iṭi) — thunder

Before the new one: say the Tamil for a star, then the Tamil for dew.

You'll want to know: இடி

இடி — *iṭi* — "thunder".

In the family, and next door

	word
Kannada	ಗುಡುಗು (*guḍugu*)
Telugu	ఉరుము (*urumu*)
English	thunder

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

இடி (*iṭi*) is native Dravidian. DEDR 438 lists Malayalam *iṭi*, "thunderbolt".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *iṭi*
- *Say it:* *iṭi*, once more
- *Say it:* say *iṭi*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for a star, then the Tamil for dew, then say *iṭi* again

Before you move on

What does இடி mean? (“Thunder”.) Say it once more.

127.4 மின்னல் (min̲n̲al) — lightning

Before the new one: say the Tamil for dew, then the Tamil for thunder.

You’ll want to know: மின்னல்

மின்னல் — *min̲n̲al* — “lightning”.

In the family, and next door

	word
Kannada	మించు (*miṁcu*)
Telugu	మెరుపు (*merupu*)
English	lightning

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

மின்னல் (*min̲n̲al*) is native Dravidian. DEDR 4876 lists Malayalam *minnal*. It is the noun of *min̲n̲u*, “to flash”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *min̲n̲al*

- *Say it: min̲n̲al*, once more
- *Say it:* say *min̲n̲al*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for dew, then the Tamil for thunder, then say *min̲n̲al* again

Before you move on

What does **மின்னல்** mean? ("Lightning".) Say it once more.

127.5 புயல் (puyal) — a storm

Before the new one: say the Tamil for thunder, then the Tamil for lightning.

Say **வானிலை**, then **மழை பெய்கிறது**. Name the rainy season, **மழைக் காலம்**, the one that shapes the year here.

You'll want to know: புயல்

புயல் — *puyal* — "a storm".

In the family, and next door

	word
Kannada	**బిరుగాళి** (*birugāḷi*)
Telugu	**తుపాను** (*tupānu*)
Hindi (neighbour)	**आँधी** (*ā̃dhī*)
English	a storm

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

புயல் (*puyal*) is native Dravidian (DEDR 4407). The entry lists *puyal*, "cloud, rain, gale, storm", under *pey*, "to rain".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: puyal*

- *Say it: puyal*, once more
- *Say it:* say *puyal*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for thunder, then the Tamil for lightning, then say *puyal* again

Before you move on

What does புயல் mean? (“A storm”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 128

Wave, Buffalo, Horse, Elephant, Tiger

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say a wave, a buffalo, a horse, an elephant and a tiger.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 128: I can say a wave, a buffalo, a horse, an elephant and a tiger.*

128.1 அலை (alai) — a wave

> Before the new one: say the Tamil for lightning, then the Tamil for a storm.

You'll want to know: அலை

அலை — *alai* — "a wave".

In the family, and next door

	word	same root
Kannada	ಅಲೆ (*ale*)	yes
Telugu	అల (*ala*)	yes
Hindi (neighbour)	लहर (*lahar*)	
English	a wave	

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

அலை (*alai*) is native Dravidian. DEDR 240 lists Malayalam *ala*, "wave". It belongs with *alaṅku*, "to move, to shake". The entry compares, with a query, Sanskrit *alaka*, "curl".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: alai*
- *Say it: alai*, once more
- *Say it:* say *alai*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for lightning, then the Tamil for a storm, then say *alai* again

Before you move on

What does அலை mean? ("A wave".) Say it once more.

128.2 எருமை (erumai) — a buffalo

Before the new one: say the Tamil for a storm, then the Tamil for a wave.

You'll want to know: எருமை

எருமை — *erumai* — "a buffalo".

In the family, and next door

	word	same root
Kannada	ಎಮ್ಮೆ (*emme*)	yes
Telugu	గేదె (*gēde*)	
Malayalam	പോത്ത് (*pōttŭ*)	
Hindi (neighbour)	भैंस (*bhaĩs*)	
English	a buffalo	

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

எருமை (*erumai*) is native Dravidian. DEDR 816 lists Kannada *emme* and Telugu *enumu*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: erumai*
- *Say it: erumai*, once more
- *Say it:* say *erumai*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for a storm, then the Tamil for a wave, then say *erumai* again

Before you move on

What does எருமை mean? ("A buffalo".) Say it once more.

128.3 குதிரை (kutirai) — a horse

Before the new one: say the Tamil for a wave, then the Tamil for a buffalo.

Say நாய் and பூனை, two animals you already keep.

You'll want to know: குதிரை

குதிரை — *kutirai* — "a horse".

In the family, and next door

	word	same root
Kannada	ಕುದುರೆ (*kudure*)	yes
Telugu	గుర్రం (*gurrami*)	
Malayalam	കുതിര (*kutira*)	yes
Hindi (neighbour)	घोड़ा (*ghoṛā*)	
English	a horse	

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

குதிரை (*kutirai*) is native Dravidian. DEDR 1711 lists Malayalam *kutira*, Kannada *kudire* and Telugu *kudira*. The entry sets it beside the native verb "to leap".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: kutirai*
- *Say it: kutirai*, once more
- *Say it:* say *kutirai*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for a wave, then the Tamil for a buffalo, then say *kutirai* again

Before you move on

What does குதிரை mean? ("A horse".) Say it once more.

128.4 யானை (yāṉai) — an elephant

Before the new one: say the Tamil for a buffalo, then the Tamil for a horse.

You'll want to know: யானை

யானை — *yāṉai* — "an elephant".

In the family, and next door

	word	same root
Kannada	ಆನೆ (*āne*)	yes
Telugu	ఏనుగు (*ēnugu*)	
Malayalam	ആന (*āna*)	yes
Hindi (neighbour)	हाथी (*hāthī*)	
English	an elephant	

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

யானை (*yāṉai*) is native Dravidian. DEDR 5161 lists Malayalam *āna*, Kannada *āne* and Telugu *ēnika*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: yāṉai*
- *Say it: yāṉai*, once more
- *Say it:* say *yāṉai*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for a buffalo, then the Tamil for a horse, then say *yāṉai* again

Before you move on

What does யானை mean? ("An elephant".) Say it once more.

128.5 புலி (puli) — a tiger

Before the new one: say the Tamil for a horse, then the Tamil for an elephant.

You'll want to know: புலி

புலி — *puli* — "a tiger".

In the family, and next door

	word	same root
Kannada	ಹುಲಿ (*huli*)	yes
Telugu	పులి (*puli*)	yes
English	a tiger	

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

புலி (*puli*) is native Dravidian. DEDR 4307 lists Malayalam *puli*, Kannada *puli* and Telugu *puli*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *puli*
- *Say it:* *puli*, once more
- *Say it:* say *puli*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for a horse, then the Tamil for an elephant, then say *puli* again

Before you move on

What does புலி mean? ("A tiger".) Say it once more.

Chapter 129

Lion, Bear, Monkey, Rabbit, Deer

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say a lion, a bear, a monkey, a rabbit and a deer.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 129: I can say a lion, a bear, a monkey, a rabbit and a deer.*

129.1 சிங்கம் (ciṅkam) — a lion

> Before the new one: say the Tamil for an elephant, then the Tamil for a tiger.

You'll want to know: சிங்கம்

சிங்கம் — *ciṅkam* — "a lion".

In the family, and next door

	word
Kannada	ಸಿಂಹ (*siṁha*)
Telugu	సింహం (*siṁhaṁ*)
Malayalam	സിംഹം (*simhaṁ*)
Hindi (neighbour)	शेर (*śer*)
English	a lion

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

சிங்கம் (*ciṅkam*) is a loan from Sanskrit *siṁha*, "lion" (CDIAL 13384). Tamil spells the nasal as *ṅ*, before *k*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: ciṅkam*
- *Say it: ciṅkam*, once more
- *Say it:* say *ciṅkam*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for an elephant, then the Tamil for a tiger, then say *ciṅkam* again

Before you move on

What does சிங்கம் mean? ("A lion".) Say it once more.

129.2 கரடி (karaṭi) — a bear

Before the new one: say the Tamil for a tiger, then the Tamil for a lion.

You'll want to know: கரடி

கரடி — *karaṭi* — "a bear".

In the family, and next door

	word	same root
Kannada	ಕರಡಿ (*karaḍi*)	yes
Telugu	ఎలుగుబంటి (*elugubaṇṭi*)	
Malayalam	കരടി (*karaṭi*)	yes
Hindi (neighbour)	भालू (*bhālū*)	
English	a bear	

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

கரடி (*karaṭi*) is native Dravidian. DEDR 1263 lists Malayalam *karaṭi*, Kannada *karaḍi* and Telugu *karaṭi*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: karaṭi*
- *Say it: karaṭi*, once more
- *Say it:* say *karaṭi*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for a tiger, then the Tamil for a lion, then say *karaṭi* again

Before you move on

What does கரடி mean? ("A bear".) Say it once more.

129.3 குரங்கு (kuraṅku) — a monkey

Before the new one: say the Tamil for a lion, then the Tamil for a bear.

You'll want to know: குரங்கு

குரங்கு — *kuraṅku* — "a monkey".

In the family, and next door

	word	same root
Kannada	കോതി (*kōti*)	
Telugu	కోతి (*kōti*)	
Malayalam	കുരങ്ങ് (*kuraṅṅŭ*)	yes
Hindi (neighbour)	बंदर (*bandar*)	
English	a monkey	

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

குரங்கு (*kuraṅku*) is native Dravidian. DEDR 1769 lists Malayalam *kuraṅṅu*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: kuraṅku*
- *Say it: kuraṅku*, once more
- *Say it:* say *kuraṅku*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for a lion, then the Tamil for a bear, then say *kuraṅku* again

Before you move on

What does குரங்கு mean? ("A monkey".) Say it once more.

129.4 முயல் (muyal) — a rabbit

Before the new one: say the Tamil for a bear, then the Tamil for a monkey.

You'll want to know: முயல்

முயல் — *muyal* — "a rabbit".

In the family, and next door

	word	same root
Kannada	ಮೊಲ (*mola*)	yes
Telugu	కుందేలు (*kundēlu*)	
Malayalam	മുയൽ (*muyal*)	yes
Hindi (neighbour)	खरगोश (*khargoś*)	
English	a rabbit	

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

முயல் (*muyal*) is native Dravidian. DEDR 4968 lists Malayalam *muyal* and Kannada *mola*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: muyal*
- *Say it: muyal*, once more
- *Say it:* say *muyal*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for a bear, then the Tamil for a monkey, then say *muyal* again

Before you move on

What does முயல் mean? ("A rabbit".) Say it once more.

129.5 மான் (mān̲) — a deer

Before the new one: say the Tamil for a monkey, then the Tamil for a rabbit.

You'll want to know: மான்

மான் — *mān̲* — "a deer".

In the family, and next door

	word
Kannada	ಜಿಂಕೆ (*jiṅke*)
Telugu	జింక (*jiṅka*)
Hindi (neighbour)	हिरन (*hiran*)
English	a deer

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

மான் (*mān̲*) is native Dravidian. DEDR 4780 lists Malayalam *mān*, "deer". The entry lists *mā*, "animal, beast", beside *mān̲*, "deer".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *mān̲*
- *Say it:* *mān̲*, once more
- *Say it:* say *mān̲*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for a monkey, then the Tamil for a rabbit, then say *mān̲* again

Before you move on

What does மான் mean? ("A deer".) Say it once more.

Chapter 130

Fox, Snake, Rat, Frog, Tortoise

Modes: **voice** (7) **Hands-free start:** all 7 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say a fox, a snake, a rat, a frog and a tortoise.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 130: I can say a fox, a snake, a rat, a frog and a tortoise.*

130.1 நரி (nari) — a fox

Before the new one: say the Tamil for a rabbit, then the Tamil for a deer.

You'll want to know: நரி

நரி — *nari* — "a fox".

In the family, and next door

	word	same root
Kannada	ನರಿ (*nari*)	yes
Telugu	నక్క (*nakka*)	yes
Malayalam	കുറുക്കൻ (*kuṟukkan*)	
Hindi (neighbour)	लोमड़ी (*lomṛī*)	
English	a fox	

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

நரி (*nari*) is native Dravidian. DEDR 3606 lists Malayalam *nari* and Kannada *nari*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: nari*
- *Say it: nari*, once more
- *Say it:* say *nari*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for a rabbit, then the Tamil for a deer, then say *nari* again

Before you move on

What does நரி mean? ("A fox".) Say it once more.

130.2 பாம்பு (pāmpu) — a snake

Before the new one: say the Tamil for a deer, then the Tamil for a fox.

You'll want to know: பாம்பு

பாம்பு — *pāmpu* — "a snake".

In the family, and next door

	word	same root
Kannada	ಹಾವು (*hāvu*)	yes
Telugu	పాము (*pāmu*)	yes
Malayalam	പാമ്പ് (*pāmpŭ*)	yes
Hindi (neighbour)	साँप (*sā̃p*)	
English	a snake	

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

பாம்பு (*pāmpu*) is native Dravidian. DEDR 4085 lists Malayalam *pāmpu*, Kannada *pāvu* and Telugu *pāmu*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *pāmpu*
- *Say it:* *pāmpu*, once more
- *Say it:* say *pāmpu*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for a deer, then the Tamil for a fox, then say *pāmpu* again

Before you move on

What does பாம்பு mean? ("A snake".) Say it once more.

130.3 எலி (eli) — a rat, a mouse

Before the new one: say the Tamil for a fox, then the Tamil for a snake.

You'll want to know: எலி

எலி — *eli* — "a rat, a mouse".

In the family, and next door

	word	same root
Kannada	ಇಲಿ (*ili*)	yes
Malayalam	എലി (*eli*)	yes
English	a rat, a mouse	

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

எலி (*eli*) is native Dravidian. DEDR 833 lists Malayalam *eli*, Kannada *eli* and Telugu *eluka*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *eli*
- *Say it:* *eli*, once more
- *Say it:* say *eli*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for a fox, then the Tamil for a snake, then say *eli* again

Before you move on

What does எலி mean? ("A rat, a mouse".) Say it once more.

130.4 தவளை (tavaḷai) — a frog

Before the new one: say the Tamil for a snake, then the Tamil for a rat.

You'll want to know: தவளை

தவளை — *tavaḷai* — "a frog".

In the family, and next door

	word	same root
Kannada	ಕಪ್ಪೆ (*kappe*)	
Telugu	కప్ప (*kappa*)	
Malayalam	തവള (*tavaḷa*)	yes
Hindi (neighbour)	मेंढक (*meṇḍhak*)	
English	a frog	

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

தவளை (*tavaḷai*) is native Dravidian. DEDR 3110 lists Malayalam *tavaḷa*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *tavaḷai*
- *Say it:* *tavaḷai*, once more
- *Say it:* say *tavaḷai*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for a snake, then the Tamil for a rat, then say *tavaḷai* again

Before you move on

What does தவளை mean? (“A frog”.) Say it once more.

130.5 ஆமை (āmai) — a tortoise

Before the new one: say the Tamil for a rat, then the Tamil for a frog.

You’ll want to know: ஆமை

ஆமை — *āmai* — “a tortoise”.

In the family, and next door

	word	same root
Kannada	ಆಮೆ (*āme*)	yes
Telugu	తాబేలు (*tābēlu*)	
Malayalam	ആമ (*āma*)	yes
Hindi (neighbour)	कछुआ (*kachuā*)	
English	a tortoise	

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

ஆமை (*āmai*) is native Dravidian. DEDR 5155 lists Malayalam *āma* and Kannada *āme*.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *āmai*
- *Say it:* *āmai*, once more
- *Say it:* say *āmai*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for a rat, then the Tamil for a frog, then say *āmai* again

Before you move on

What does ஆமை mean? ("A tortoise".) Say it once more.

130.6 The house, things you carry and school — a first pass

Say the words for a frog and a tortoise.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- rasam, butter, an egg, a fish, meat
- vegetables, a banana, a mango, a coconut, an onion
- a tomato, a chilli, ginger, garlic, honey
- an idli, a dosa, a vadai, coffee, the sea

Before you move on

Rasam? (ரசம், *rasam.*) Butter? (வெண்ணெய், *veṇṇey.*) An egg? (முட்டை, *muṭṭai.*) A fish? (மீன், *mīṉ.*) Meat? (இறைச்சி, *iṟaicci.*) Vegetables? (காய்கறி, *kāykaṟi.*) A banana? (வாழைப்பழம், *vāḻaippaḻam.*) A mango? (மாம்பழம், *māmpaḻam.*) A coconut? (தேங்காய், *tēṅkāy.*) An onion? (வெங்காயம், *veṅkāyam.*) A tomato? (தக்காளி, *takkāḷi.*) A chilli? (மிளகாய், *milakāy.*) Ginger? (இஞ்சி, *iñci.*) Garlic? (பூண்டு, *pūṇṭu.*) Honey? (தேன், *tēṉ.*) An idli? (இட்லி, *iṭli.*) A

dosa? (தோசை, *tōcai.*) A vadai? (வடை, *vaṭai.*) Coffee? (காபி, *kāpi.*) The sea? (கடல், *kaṭal.*)

130.7 Food — a second pass

Say the words for a lake and a pond.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- a lake, a pond, a forest, a leaf, soil
- a star, dew, thunder, lightning, a storm
- a wave, a buffalo, a horse, an elephant, a tiger
- a lion, a bear, a monkey, a rabbit, a deer
- a fox, a snake, a rat, a frog, a tortoise

Before you move on

A lake? (ஏரி, *ēri.*) A pond? (குளம், *kuḷam.*) A forest? (காடு, *kāṭu.*) A leaf? (இலை, *ilai.*) Soil? (மண், *maṇ.*) A star? (நட்சத்திரம், *naṭcattiram.*) Dew? (பனி, *paṉi.*) Thunder? (இடி, *iṭi.*) Lightning? (மின்னல், *miṉṉal.*) A storm? (புயல், *puyal.*) A wave? (அலை, *alai.*) A buffalo? (எருமை, *erumai.*) A horse? (குதிரை, *kutirai.*) An elephant? (யானை, *yāṉai.*) A tiger? (புலி, *puli.*) A lion? (சிங்கம், *ciṅkam.*) A bear? (கரடி, *karaṭi.*) A monkey? (குரங்கு, *kuraṅku.*) A rabbit? (முயல், *muyal.*) A deer? (மான், *māṉ.*) A fox? (நரி, *nari.*) A snake? (பாம்பு, *pāmpu.*) A rat? (எலி, *eli.*) A frog? (தவளை, *tavaḷai.*) A tortoise? (ஆமை, *āmai.*)

Chapter 131

Parrot, Pigeon, Owl, Peacock, Ant

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say a parrot, a pigeon, an owl, a peacock and an ant.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 131: I can say a parrot, a pigeon, an owl, a peacock and an ant.*

131.1 கிளி (kiḷi) — a parrot

> Before the new one: say the Tamil for a frog, then the Tamil for a tortoise.

You'll want to know: கிளி

கிளி — *kiḷi* — "a parrot".

In the family, and next door

	word	same root
Kannada	ಗಿಳಿ (*giḷi*)	yes
Telugu	చిలక (*cilaka*)	yes
Malayalam	തത്ത (*tatta*)	
Hindi (neighbour)	तोता (*totā*)	
English	a parrot	

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

கிளி (*kiḷi*) is native Dravidian. DEDR 1584 lists Malayalam *kiḷi*, Kannada *giḷi* and Telugu *ciluka*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: kiḷi*
- *Say it: kiḷi*, once more
- *Say it:* say *kiḷi*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for a frog, then the Tamil for a tortoise, then say *kiḷi* again

Before you move on

What does கிளி mean? ("A parrot".) Say it once more.

131.2 புறா (puṟā) — a pigeon

Before the new one: say the Tamil for a tortoise, then the Tamil for a parrot.

You'll want to know: புறா

புறா — *puṟā* — "a pigeon".

In the family, and next door

	word
Kannada	పారివాళ (*pārivāḷa*)
Telugu	పావురం (*pāvuram*)
Hindi (neighbour)	कबूतर (*kabūtar*)
English	a pigeon

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

புறா (*puṟā*) is native Dravidian. DEDR 4334 lists Malayalam *prāvu* and Kannada *poṟasu*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *puṟā*
- *Say it:* *puṟā*, once more
- *Say it:* say *puṟā*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for a tortoise, then the Tamil for a parrot, then say *puṟā* again

Before you move on

What does புறா mean? ("A pigeon".) Say it once more.

131.3 ஆந்தை (āntai) — an owl

Before the new one: say the Tamil for a parrot, then the Tamil for a pigeon.

Greet the day through, in Tamil's own words: காலை வணக்கம், மாலை வணக்கம், இனிய இரவு.

You'll want to know: ஆந்தை

ஆந்தை — *āntai* — "an owl".

In the family, and next door

	word
Kannada	ಗೂಬೆ (*gūbe*)
Telugu	గుడ్లగూబ (*guḍlagūba*)
Malayalam	മൂങ്ങ (*mūṅṅa*)
Hindi (neighbour)	उल्लू (*ullū*)
English	an owl

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

ஆந்தை (*āntai*) is native Dravidian. DEDR 359 lists Kannada *āndega*, "night hawk".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *āntai*
- *Say it:* *āntai*, once more
- *Say it:* say *āntai*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for a parrot, then the Tamil for a pigeon, then say *āntai* again

Before you move on

What does ஆந்தை mean? ("An owl".) Say it once more.

131.4 மயில் (mayil) — a peacock

Before the new one: say the Tamil for a pigeon, then the Tamil for an owl.

You'll want to know: மயில்

மயில் — *mayil* — "a peacock".

In the family, and next door

	word	same root
Kannada	నవిలు (*navilu*)	yes
Telugu	నెమలి (*nemali*)	yes
Malayalam	മയിൽ (*mayil*)	yes
Hindi (neighbour)	मोर (*mor*)	
English	a peacock	

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

மயில் (*mayil*) is native Dravidian. DEDR 4642 lists Malayalam *mayil* and Kannada *mayla*. The entry compares Sanskrit *mayūra*, "peacock" (CDIAL 9865).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: mayil*
- *Say it: mayil*, once more
- *Say it:* say *mayil*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for a pigeon, then the Tamil for an owl, then say *mayil* again

Before you move on

What does மயில் mean? ("A peacock".) Say it once more.

131.5 எறும்பு (eṟumpu) — an ant

Before the new one: say the Tamil for an owl, then the Tamil for a peacock.

You'll want to know: எறும்பு

எறும்பு — *eṟumpu* — "an ant".

In the family, and next door

	word	same root
Kannada	ಇರುವೆ (*iruve*)	
Telugu	చీమ (*cīma*)	
Malayalam	ഉറുമ്പ് (*uṟumpŭ*)	yes
Hindi (neighbour)	चींटी (*cīṇṭī*)	
English	an ant	

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

எறும்பு (*eṟumpu*) is native Dravidian. DEDR 864 lists Malayalam *eṟumpu* and Kannada *iṟumpu*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *eṟumpu*
- *Say it:* *eṟumpu*, once more
- *Say it:* say *eṟumpu*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for an owl, then the Tamil for a peacock, then say *eṟumpu* again

Before you move on

What does எறும்பு mean? ("An ant".) Say it once more.

Chapter 132

Mosquito, Face, Mouth, Tongue, Finger

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say a mosquito, the face, the mouth, the tongue and a finger.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 132: I can say a mosquito, the face, the mouth, the tongue and a finger.*

132.1 கொசு (kocu) — a mosquito

> Before the new one: say the Tamil for a peacock, then the Tamil for an ant.

You'll want to know: கொசு

கொசு — *kocu* — "a mosquito".

In the family, and next door

	word	same root
Kannada	ಸೊಳ್ಳೆ (*soḷḷe*)	
Telugu	దోమ (*dōma*)	
Malayalam	കൊതുക് (*kotukŭ*)	yes
Hindi (neighbour)	मच्छर (*macchar*)	
English	a mosquito	

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

கொசு (*kocu*) is native Dravidian. DEDR 2086 lists Malayalam *kotuku*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: kocu*
- *Say it: kocu*, once more
- *Say it:* say *kocu*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for a peacock, then the Tamil for an ant, then say *kocu* again

Before you move on

What does கொசு mean? ("A mosquito".) Say it once more.

132.2 முகம் (mukam) — the face

Before the new one: say the Tamil for an ant, then the Tamil for a mosquito.

You'll want to know: முகம்

முகம் — *mukam* — "the face".

In the family, and next door

	word	same root
Kannada	ముఖ (*mukha*)	yes
Telugu	ముఖం (*mukham*)	yes
English	the face	

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

முகம் (*mukam*) is native Dravidian. DEDR 4889 lists Malayalam *mukam* and Kannada *moga*. Sanskrit *mukha*, "face" (CDIAL 10158), is close in sound and sense, but DEDR files the Dravidian word as an entry of its own.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: mukam*
- *Say it: mukam*, once more
- *Say it:* say *mukam*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for an ant, then the Tamil for a mosquito, then say *mukam* again

Before you move on

What does முகம் mean? ("The face".) Say it once more.

132.3 வாய் (vāy) — the mouth

Before the new one: say the Tamil for a mosquito, then the Tamil for the face.

You'll want to know: வாய்

வாய் — *vāy* — "the mouth".

In the family, and next door

	word	same root
Kannada	బాయి (*bāyi*)	yes
Telugu	నోరు (*nōru*)	
Malayalam	വായ് (*vāy*)	yes
English	the mouth	

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

வாய் (*vāy*) is native: DEDR 5352 is the entry for *vāy*, "mouth", and DEDR 1480 points to it for the compound *kāl-vāy*, "irrigation channel". Malayalam has *vāy* too.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: vāy*
- *Say it: vāy*, once more
- *Say it:* say *vāy*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for a mosquito, then the Tamil for the face, then say *vāy* again

Before you move on

What does வாய் mean? ("The mouth".) Say it once more.

132.4 நாக்கு (nākku) — the tongue

Before the new one: say the Tamil for the face, then the Tamil for the mouth.

You'll want to know: நாக்கு

நாக்கு — *nākku* — "the tongue".

In the family, and next door

	word	same root
Kannada	ನಾಲಿಗೆ (*nālige*)	
Telugu	నాలుక (*nāluka*)	yes
Malayalam	നാവ് (*nāvŭ*)	yes
Hindi (neighbour)	जीभ (*jībh*)	
English	the tongue	

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

நாக்கு (*nākku*) is native Dravidian. DEDR 3633 lists Malayalam *nākku*, Kannada *nālige* and Telugu *nāluka*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *nākku*
- *Say it:* *nākku*, once more
- *Say it:* say *nākku*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for the face, then the Tamil for the mouth, then say *nākku* again

Before you move on

What does நாக்கு mean? ("The tongue".) Say it once more.

132.5 விரல் (viral) — a finger

Before the new one: say the Tamil for the mouth, then the Tamil for the tongue.

You'll want to know: விரல்

விரல் — *viral* — "a finger".

In the family, and next door

	word	same root
Kannada	ಬೆರಳು (*beraḷu*)	yes
Telugu	వేలు (*vēlu*)	yes
Malayalam	വിരൽ (*viral*)	yes
Hindi (neighbour)	उँगली (*uṅglī*)	
English	a finger	

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

விரல் (*viral*) is native Dravidian. DEDR 5409 lists Malayalam *viral* and Kannada *beral*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: viral*
- *Say it: viral*, once more
- *Say it:* say *viral*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for the mouth, then the Tamil for the tongue, then say *viral* again

Before you move on

What does விரல் mean? ("A finger".) Say it once more.

Chapter 133

Shoulder, Chest, Knee, Hair, Skin

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say a shoulder, the chest, a knee, hair and the skin.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 133: I can say a shoulder, the chest, a knee, hair and the skin.*

133.1 தோள் (tōḷ) — a shoulder

> Before the new one: say the Tamil for the tongue, then the Tamil for a finger.

You'll want to know: தோள்

தோள் — *tōḷ* — "a shoulder".

In the family, and next door

	word	same root
Kannada	ಭುಜ (*bhuja*)	
Telugu	భుజం (*bhujami*)	
Malayalam	തോൾ (*tōḷ*)	yes
Hindi (neighbour)	कंधा (*kandhā*)	
English	a shoulder	

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

தோள் (*tōḷ*) is native Dravidian. DEDR 3564 lists Malayalam *tōḷ* and Kannada *tōḷ*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: tōḷ*
- *Say it: tōḷ*, once more
- *Say it:* say *tōḷ*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for the tongue, then the Tamil for a finger, then say *tōḷ* again

Before you move on

What does தோள் mean? ("A shoulder".) Say it once more.

133.2 மார்பு (mārpu) — the chest

Before the new one: say the Tamil for a finger, then the Tamil for a shoulder.

You'll want to know: மார்பு

மார்பு — *mārpu* — "the chest".

In the family, and next door

	word
Kannada	ಎದೆ (*ede*)
Malayalam	നെഞ്ച് (*neñcŭ*)
Hindi (neighbour)	छाती (*chātī*)
English	the chest

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

மார்பு (*mārpu*) is native Dravidian. DEDR 4818 lists Malayalam *mār*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: mārpu*
- *Say it: mārpu*, once more
- *Say it:* say *mārpu*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for a finger, then the Tamil for a shoulder, then say *mārpu* again

Before you move on

What does மார்பு mean? ("The chest".) Say it once more.

133.3 முழங்கால் (mu̲laṅkāl) — a knee

Before the new one: say the Tamil for a shoulder, then the Tamil for the chest.

You'll want to know: முழங்கால்

முழங்கால் — *mu̲laṅkāl* — "a knee".

In the family, and next door

	word	same root
Kannada	మొణకాలు (*moṇakālu*)	yes
Telugu	మోకాలు (*mōkālu*)	yes
Malayalam	കാൽമുട്ട് (*kālmuṭṭŭ*)	
Hindi (neighbour)	घुटना (*ghuṭnā*)	
English	a knee	

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

முழங்கால் (*mu̲laṅkāl*) is native: DEDR 4990 lists *mu̲laṅkāl*, "knee", built on *mu̲lam*, "cubit, joint", with *kāl*, "leg".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *mu̲laṅkāl*
- *Say it:* *mu̲laṅkāl*, once more
- *Say it:* say *mu̲laṅkāl*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for a shoulder, then the Tamil for the chest, then say *mu̲laṅkāl* again

Before you move on

What does முழங்கால் mean? ("A knee".) Say it once more.

133.4 முடி (muṭi) — hair

Before the new one: say the Tamil for the chest, then the Tamil for a knee.

You'll want to know: முடி

முடி — *muṭi* — "hair".

In the family, and next door

	word	same root
Kannada	ಕೂದಲು (*kūdalu*)	
Telugu	జుట్టు (*juṭṭu*)	
Malayalam	മുടി (*muṭi*)	yes
Hindi (neighbour)	बाल (*bāl*)	
English	hair	

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

முடி (*muṭi*) is native Dravidian. DEDR 4921 lists Malayalam *muṭi*, "knot" and Kannada *muḍi*, "to tie". The entry gives *muṭi*, "to tie", and the noun *muṭi*, "knot, tuft or coil of hair".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: muṭi*
- *Say it: muṭi*, once more
- *Say it:* say *muṭi*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for the chest, then the Tamil for a knee, then say *muṭi* again

Before you move on

What does முடி mean? ("Hair".) Say it once more.

133.5 தோல் (tōl) — the skin

Before the new one: say the Tamil for a knee, then the Tamil for hair.

You'll want to know: தோல்

தோல் — *tōl* — "the skin".

In the family, and next door

	word	same root
Kannada	ಚರ್ಮ (*carma*)	
Telugu	చర్మం (*carmaṁ*)	
Malayalam	തൊലി (*tolī*)	yes
English	the skin	

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

தோல் (*tōl*) is native Dravidian. DEDR 3559 lists Malayalam *tōl*, Kannada *tōl* and Telugu *tokka*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: tōl*
- *Say it: tōl*, once more
- *Say it:* say *tōl*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for a knee, then the Tamil for hair, then say *tōl* again

Before you move on

What does தோல் mean? ("The skin".) Say it once more.

Chapter 134

Curtain, Mattress, Television, Mobile phone, Computer

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say a curtain, a mattress, a television, a mobile phone and a computer.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 134: I can say a curtain, a mattress, a television, a mobile phone and a computer.*

134.1 திரைச்சீலை (tiraiccīlai) — a curtain

> Before the new one: say the Tamil for hair, then the Tamil for the skin.

You'll want to know: திரைச்சீலை

திரைச்சீலை — *tiraiccīlai* — "a curtain".

In the family, and next door

	word
Kannada	ಪರದೆ (*parade*)
Telugu	తెర (*tera*)
Hindi (neighbour)	परदा (*pardā*)
English	a curtain

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

திரைச்சீலை (*tiraiccīlai*) is native: *tirai*, "curtain, screen" (DEDR 3244, which also has Malayalam *tira*), and *cīlai*, "cloth" (DEDR 2629).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: tiraiccīlai*
- *Say it: tiraiccīlai*, once more
- *Say it:* say *tiraiccīlai*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for hair, then the Tamil for the skin, then say *tiraiccīlai* again

Before you move on

What does **திரைச்சீலை** mean? ("A curtain".) Say it once more.

134.2 மெத்தை (mettai) — a mattress

Before the new one: say the Tamil for the skin, then the Tamil for a curtain.

You'll want to know: மெத்தை

மெத்தை — *mettai* — "a mattress".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

மெத்தை (*mettai*) is native Dravidian. DEDR 5068 lists Malayalam *metta*, Kannada *mette* and Telugu *metta*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: mettai*
- *Say it: mettai*, once more
- *Say it:* say *mettai*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for the skin, then the Tamil for a curtain, then say *mettai* again

Before you move on

What does **மெத்தை** mean? ("A mattress".) Say it once more.

134.3 தொலைக்காட்சி (tolaikkāṭci) — a television

Before the new one: say the Tamil for a curtain, then the Tamil for a mattress.

You'll want to know: தொலைக்காட்சி

தொலைக்காட்சி — *tolaikkāṭci* — "a television".

In the family, and next door

	word
Kannada	**ಟೀವಿ** (*ṭīvi*)
Telugu	**టీవీ** (*ṭīvī*)
English	a television

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

தொலைக்காட்சி (*tolaikkāṭci*) is a modern coinage from native parts: *tolai*, "far" (DEDR 3519), and *kāṭci*, "sight", from *kāṇ*, "to see" (DEDR 1443). It is a word-for-word "tele-vision".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: tolaikkāṭci*
- *Say it: tolaikkāṭci*, once more
- *Say it:* say *tolaikkāṭci*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for a curtain, then the Tamil for a mattress, then say *tolaikkāṭci* again

Before you move on

What does தொலைக்காட்சி mean? ("A television".) Say it once more.

134.4 கைப்பேசி (kaippēci) — a mobile phone

Before the new one: say the Tamil for a mattress, then the Tamil for a television.

You'll want to know: கைப்பேசி

கைப்பேசி — *kaippēci* — "a mobile phone".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

கைப்பேசி (*kaippēci*) is a modern coinage from native parts: *kai*, "hand" (DEDR 2023), and *pēci*, "speaker", from *pēsu*, "to speak" (DEDR 4430): "the hand-speaker".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: kaippēci*
- *Say it: kaippēci*, once more
- *Say it:* say *kaippēci*

- *Recall:* say the Tamil for a mattress, then the Tamil for a television, then say *kaippēci* again

Before you move on

What does கைப்பேசி mean? ("A mobile phone".) Say it once more.

134.5 கணினி (kaṇiṉi) — a computer

Before the new one: say the Tamil for a television, then the Tamil for a mobile phone.

You'll want to know: கணினி

கணினி — *kaṇiṉi* — "a computer".

In the family, and next door

	word
Kannada	ಕಂಪ್ಯೂಟರ್ (*kampyūṭar*)
Telugu	కంప్యూటర్ (*kampyūṭar*)
English	a computer

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

கணினி (*kaṇiṉi*) is a modern coinage on *kaṇi*, "to calculate", a Tamil form of Sanskrit *gaṇ-*, "to count" (CDIAL 3988, *gaṇa*): "the calculator".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: kaṇiṉi*
- *Say it: kaṇiṉi*, once more
- *Say it:* say *kaṇiṉi*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for a television, then the Tamil for a mobile phone, then say *kaṇiṉi* again

Before you move on

What does **கணினி** mean? (“A computer”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 135

Electric fan, Scissors, Hammer, Nail, Ladder

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say an electric fan, scissors, a hammer, a nail and a ladder.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 135: I can say an electric fan, scissors, a hammer, a nail and a ladder.*

135.1 மின்விசிறி (miṉviciṟi) — an electric fan

> Before the new one: say the Tamil for a mobile phone, then the Tamil for a computer.

You'll want to know: மின்விசிறி

மின்விசிறி — *miṉviciṟi* — "an electric fan".

In the family, and next door

	word
Malayalam	ഫാൻ (*phān*)
English	an electric fan

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

மின்விசிறி (*miṉviciṟi*) is a modern coinage from native parts: *miṉ*, "lightning, electricity" (DEDR 4876), and *viciṟi*, "fan" (DEDR 5450, which compares Sanskrit *vīj-*, "to fan").

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: miṉviciṟi*
- *Say it: miṉviciṟi*, once more
- *Say it:* say *miṉviciṟi*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for a mobile phone, then the Tamil for a computer, then say *miṉviciṟi* again

Before you move on

What does மின்விசிறி mean? ("An electric fan".) Say it once more.

135.2 கத்தரிக்கோல் (kattarikkōl) — scissors

Before the new one: say the Tamil for a computer, then the Tamil for an electric fan.

You'll want to know: கத்தரிக்கோல்

கத்தரிக்கோல் — *kattarikkōl* — "scissors".

In the family, and next door

	word	same root
Kannada	ಕತ್ತರಿ (*kattari*)	yes
Telugu	కత్తెర (*katterā*)	yes
Malayalam	കത്രിക (*katrika*)	yes
Hindi (neighbour)	कैंची (*kaĩcī*)	
English	scissors	

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

கத்தரிக்கோல் (*kattarikkōl*) is *kattari*, "scissors", from Sanskrit *kartari*, "scissors, knife" (CDIAL 2858), with native *kōl*, "stick, rod"

(DEDR 2237).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: kattarikkōl*
- *Say it: kattarikkōl*, once more
- *Say it:* say *kattarikkōl*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for a computer, then the Tamil for an electric fan, then say *kattarikkōl* again

Before you move on

What does **கத்தரிக்கோல்** mean? ("Scissors".) Say it once more.

135.3 சுத்தியல் (cuttiyal) — a hammer

Before the new one: say the Tamil for an electric fan, then the Tamil for scissors.

You'll want to know: சுத்தியல்

சுத்தியல் — *cuttiyal* — "a hammer".

In the family, and next door

	word	same root
Kannada	**ಸುತ್ತಿಗೆ** (*suttige*)	yes
Telugu	**సుత్తి** (*sutti*)	yes
Malayalam	**ചുറ്റിക** (*cuṟṟika*)	
Hindi (neighbour)	**हथौड़ा** (*hathauṛā*)	
English	a hammer	

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

சுத்தியல் (*cuttiyal*) is native Dravidian. DEDR 2668 lists Malayalam *cutti* and Kannada *suttige*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: cuttiyal*
- *Say it: cuttiyal*, once more
- *Say it:* say *cuttiyal*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for an electric fan, then the Tamil for scissors, then say *cuttiyal* again

Before you move on

What does சுத்தியல் mean? ("A hammer".) Say it once more.

135.4 ஆணி (āṇi) — a nail (to hammer)

Before the new one: say the Tamil for scissors, then the Tamil for a hammer.

You'll want to know: ஆணி

ஆணி — *āṇi* — "a nail (to hammer)".

In the family, and next door

	word
Kannada	ಮೊಳೆ (*moḷe*)
Telugu	మేకు (*mēku*)
Hindi (neighbour)	कील (*kīl*)
English	a nail

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

ஆணி (*āṇi*) is filed in DEDR's appendix of Indo-Aryan loans (DEDR App. 10), beside Malayalam *āṇi*, "peg", and Kannada *āṇi*, "nail". The source is Sanskrit *āṇi*, "linch-pin".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *āṇi*
- *Say it:* *āṇi*, once more
- *Say it:* say *āṇi*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for scissors, then the Tamil for a hammer, then say *āṇi* again

Before you move on

What does ஆணி mean? ("A nail (to hammer)".) Say it once more.

135.5 ஏணி (ēṇi) — a ladder

Before the new one: say the Tamil for a hammer, then the Tamil for a nail.

You'll want to know: ஏணி

ஏணி — *ēṇi* — "a ladder".

In the family, and next door

	word
Malayalam	കോണി (*kōṇi*)
English	a ladder

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

The origin of ஏணி (*ēṇi*) is uncertain. DEDR has an *ēṇi*, "boundary, edge" (DEDR 886), but not this word for a ladder.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *ēṇi*
- *Say it:* *ēṇi*, once more
- *Say it:* say *ēṇi*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for a hammer, then the Tamil for a nail, then say *ēṇi* again

Before you move on

What does ஏணி mean? ("A ladder".) Say it once more.

Chapter 136

Bottle, Ball, Kite, Doll, Purse

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say a bottle, a ball, a kite, a doll and a purse.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 136: I can say a bottle, a ball, a kite, a doll and a purse.*

136.1 குப்பி (kuppi) — a bottle

> Before the new one: say the Tamil for a nail, then the Tamil for a ladder.

You'll want to know: குப்பி

குப்பி — *kuppi* — "a bottle".

In the family, and next door

	word	same root
Kannada	ಬಾಟಲಿ (*bāṭali*)	
Telugu	బాటిలు (*bāṭilu*)	
Malayalam	കുപ്പി (*kuppi*)	yes
Hindi (neighbour)	बोतल (*botal*)	
English	a bottle	

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

குப்பி (*kuppi*) is probably an Indo-Aryan word for a flask: CDIAL 3402 sets North Indian forms for an oil vessel under *kūpa*, "leather oil vessel", and its variant *kuppa*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: kuppi*
- *Say it: kuppi*, once more
- *Say it:* say *kuppi*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for a nail, then the Tamil for a ladder, then say *kuppi* again

Before you move on

What does குப்பி mean? ("A bottle".) Say it once more.

136.2 பந்து (pantu) — a ball

Before the new one: say the Tamil for a ladder, then the Tamil for a bottle.

You'll want to know: பந்து

பந்து — *pantu* — "a ball".

In the family, and next door

	word	same root
Kannada	ಚೆಂಡು (*ceṇḍu*)	
Telugu	బంతి (*banti*)	yes
English	a ball	

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

பந்து (*pantu*) is native Dravidian. DEDR 3925 lists Malayalam *pantu* and Telugu *banti*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: pantu*
- *Say it: pantu*, once more
- *Say it:* say *pantu*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for a ladder, then the Tamil for a bottle, then say *pantu* again

Before you move on

What does பந்து mean? ("A ball".) Say it once more.

136.3 பட்டம் (paṭṭam) — a kite

Before the new one: say the Tamil for a bottle, then the Tamil for a ball.

You'll want to know: பட்டம்

பட்டம் — *paṭṭam* — "a kite".

In the family, and next door

	word	same root
Kannada	గాళిపట (*gāḷipaṭa*)	yes
Telugu	గాలిపటం (*gālipaṭaṁ*)	yes
English	a kite	

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

பட்டம் (*paṭṭam*) is probably the same word as *paṭṭam*, "flat piece", which is native (DEDR 3878). DEDR does not list the "kite" sense, so the link is likely rather than proven.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: paṭṭam*
- *Say it: paṭṭam*, once more
- *Say it:* say *paṭṭam*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for a bottle, then the Tamil for a ball, then say *paṭṭam* again

Before you move on

What does பட்டம் mean? ("A kite".) Say it once more.

136.4 பொம்மை (pommai) — a doll, a toy

Before the new one: say the Tamil for a ball, then the Tamil for a kite.

You'll want to know: பொம்மை

பொம்மை — *pommai* — "a doll, a toy".

In the family, and next door

	word	same root
Kannada	ಬೊಂಬೆ (*bombe*)	
Telugu	బొమ్మ (*bomma*)	yes
English	a doll, a toy	

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

பொம்மை (*pommai*) is native Dravidian. DEDR 4530 lists Malayalam *bomma* and Kannada *bombe*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: pommai*
- *Say it: pommai*, once more
- *Say it:* say *pommai*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for a ball, then the Tamil for a kite, then say *pommai* again

Before you move on

What does பொம்மை mean? ("A doll, a toy".) Say it once more.

136.5 பணப்பை (paṇappai) — a purse, a wallet

Before the new one: say the Tamil for a kite, then the Tamil for a doll.

You'll want to know: பணப்பை

பணப்பை — *paṇappai* — "a purse, a wallet".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

பணப்பை (*paṇappai*) is *paṇam*, "money", from Sanskrit *paṇa*, "a coin" (CDIAL 7715), and native *pai*, "bag" (DEDR 4450).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: paṇappai*
- *Say it: paṇappai*, once more
- *Say it:* say *paṇappai*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for a kite, then the Tamil for a doll, then say *paṇappai* again

Before you move on

What does பணப்பை mean? (“A purse, a wallet”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 137

Ring, Bangle, Sock, Glove, Class

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say a ring, a bangle, a sock, a glove and a class.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 137: I can say a ring, a bangle, a sock, a glove and a class.*

137.1 மோதிரம் (mōtiram) — a ring

Before the new one: say the Tamil for a doll, then the Tamil for a purse.

You'll want to know: மோதிரம்

மோதிரம் — *mōtiram* — "a ring".

In the family, and next door

	word	same root
Kannada	ಉಂಗುರ (*uṅgura*)	
Telugu	ఉంగరం (*uṅgaraṁ*)	
Malayalam	മോതിരം (*mōtiraṁ*)	yes
Hindi (neighbour)	अंगूठी (*aṅgūṭhī*)	
English	a ring	

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

மோதிரம் (*mōtiram*) is a loan from Sanskrit *mudrā*, "seal, signet-ring" (CDIAL 10203). CDIAL adds that the Sanskrit word itself probably came from Iranian.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *mōtiram*
- *Say it:* *mōtiram*, once more
- *Say it:* say *mōtiram*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for a doll, then the Tamil for a purse, then say *mōtiram* again

Before you move on

What does மோதிரம் mean? ("A ring".) Say it once more.

137.2 வளையல் (vaḷaiyal) — a bangle

Before the new one: say the Tamil for a purse, then the Tamil for a ring.

You'll want to know: வளையல்

வளையல் — *vaḷaiyal* — "a bangle".

In the family, and next door

	word	same root
Kannada	ಬಳೆ (*baḷe*)	yes
Malayalam	വള (*vaḷa*)	yes
English	a bangle	

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

வளையல் (*vaḷaiyal*) is native Dravidian. DEDR 5314 lists Malayalam *vaḷayuka*, "to bend". It is "the bent thing", from *vaḷai*, "to bend, to curve".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: vaḷaiyal*
- *Say it: vaḷaiyal*, once more
- *Say it:* say *vaḷaiyal*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for a purse, then the Tamil for a ring, then say *vaḷaiyal* again

Before you move on

What does வளையல் mean? ("A bangle".) Say it once more.

137.3 காலுறை (kāluṟai) — a sock

Before the new one: say the Tamil for a ring, then the Tamil for a bangle.

You'll want to know: காலுறை

காலுறை — *kāluṟai* — "a sock".

In the family, and next door

	word
Hindi (neighbour)	मोज़ा (*mozā*)
English	a sock

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

காலுறை (*kāluṟai*) is native: *kāl*, "leg, foot" (DEDR 1479), and *uṟai*, "sheath, case" (DEDR 723): "the foot-cover".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: kāluṟai*
- *Say it: kāluṟai*, once more
- *Say it:* say *kāluṟai*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for a ring, then the Tamil for a bangle, then say *kāluṟai* again

Before you move on

What does காலுறை mean? ("A sock".) Say it once more.

137.4 கையுறை (kaiyuṟai) — a glove

Before the new one: say the Tamil for a bangle, then the Tamil for a sock.

You'll want to know: கையுறை

கையுறை — *kaiyuṟai* — "a glove".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

கையுறை (*kaiyuṟai*) is native: *kai*, "hand" (DEDR 2023), and *uṟai*, "sheath, case" (DEDR 723): "the hand-cover".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: kaiyuṟai*
- *Say it: kaiyuṟai*, once more
- *Say it:* say *kaiyuṟai*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for a bangle, then the Tamil for a sock, then say *kaiyuṟai* again

Before you move on

What does கையுறை mean? (“A glove”.) Say it once more.

137.5 வகுப்பு (vakuppu) — a class

Before the new one: say the Tamil for a sock, then the Tamil for a glove.

Say திங்கள் through ஞாயிறு. Each day ends in *kiḻamai*; some days carry Tamil words, some Sanskrit ones.

You’ll want to know: வகுப்பு

வகுப்பு — *vakuppu* — “a class”.

In the family, and next door

	word
Malayalam	ക്ലാസ് (*klās*)
English	a class

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

வகுப்பு (*vakuppu*) is native Dravidian. DEDR 5202 lists Malayalam *vakuppu*, “kind, section”. It is the noun of *vaku*, “to divide”: a class is a division.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *vakuppu*
- *Say it:* *vakuppu*, once more
- *Say it:* say *vakuppu*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for a sock, then the Tamil for a glove, then say *vakuppu* again

Before you move on

What does வகுப்பு mean? ("A class".) Say it once more.

Chapter 138

Exam, Answer, Tamarind, Pepper, Mustard seed

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say an exam, an answer, tamarind, pepper and mustard seed.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 138: I can say an exam, an answer, tamarind, pepper and mustard seed.*

138.1 தேர்வு (tērvu) — an exam

Before the new one: say the Tamil for a glove, then the Tamil for a class.

Name a Tamil month, சித்திரை or தை, then give a தேதி, with the date ending *-ām*.

You'll want to know: தேர்வு

தேர்வு — *tērvu* — "an exam".

In the family, and next door

	word
Malayalam	പരീക്ഷ (*parīkṣa*)
English	an exam

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

தேர்வு (*tērvu*) is native Dravidian (DEDR 3419). It is the noun of *tēr*, "to examine, to inquire into", which DEDR files with *teri*, "to become clear".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: tērvu*
- *Say it: tērvu*, once more
- *Say it:* say *tērvu*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for a glove, then the Tamil for a class, then say *tērvu* again

Before you move on

What does தேர்வு mean? ("An exam".) Say it once more.

138.2 பதில் (patil) — an answer

Before the new one: say the Tamil for a class, then the Tamil for an exam.

You'll want to know: பதில்

பதில் — *patil* — "an answer".

In the family, and next door

	word
Kannada	ಉತ್ತರ (*uttara*)
Malayalam	ഉത്തരം (*uttaraṁ*)
English	an answer

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

பதில் (*patil*) is a loan from Arabic *badal*, “exchange, substitute”, through Persian and Hindustani.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: patil*
- *Say it: patil*, once more
- *Say it:* say *patil*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for a class, then the Tamil for an exam, then say *patil* again

Before you move on

What does பதில் mean? (“An answer”.) Say it once more.

138.3 புளி (puḷi) — tamarind

Before the new one: say the Tamil for an exam, then the Tamil for an answer.

You’ll want to know: புளி

புளி — *puḷi* — “tamarind”.

In the family, and next door

	word
Telugu	చింతపండు (*cintapaṇḍu*)
English	tamarind

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

புளி (*puḷi*) is native Dravidian. DEDR 4322 lists Kannada *puḷi*, *huḷi* and Telugu *puli*, “sour”. The tree is named for its sourness.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: puḷi*
- *Say it: puḷi*, once more
- *Say it:* say *puḷi*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for an exam, then the Tamil for an answer, then say *puḷi* again

Before you move on

What does புளி mean? ("Tamarind".) Say it once more.

138.4 மிளகு (miḷaku) — pepper

Before the new one: say the Tamil for an answer, then the Tamil for tamarind.

You'll want to know: மிளகு

மிளகு — *miḷaku* — "pepper".

In the family, and next door

	word
Kannada	ಮೆಣಸು (*menasu*)
English	pepper

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

மிளகு (*miḷaku*) is native Dravidian. DEDR 4867 lists Malayalam *miḷaku* and Kannada *meṇasu*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: miḷaku*
- *Say it: miḷaku*, once more
- *Say it:* say *miḷaku*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for an answer, then the Tamil for tamarind, then say *miḷaku* again

Before you move on

What does மிளகு mean? (“Pepper”.) Say it once more.

138.5 கடுகு (kaṭuku) — mustard seed

Before the new one: say the Tamil for tamarind, then the Tamil for pepper.

You’ll want to know: கடுகு

கடுகு — *kaṭuku* — “mustard seed”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

கடுகு (*kaṭuku*) is native Dravidian. DEDR 1137 lists Malayalam *kaṭuku*. It belongs with *kaṭu*, “pungent”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: kaṭuku*
- *Say it: kaṭuku*, once more
- *Say it:* say *kaṭuku*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for tamarind, then the Tamil for pepper, then say *kaṭuku* again

Before you move on

What does கடுகு mean? (“Mustard seed”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 139

Cumin, Leafy greens, Jackfruit, Guava, Lemon

Modes: **voice** (7) **Hands-free start:** all 7 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say cumin, leafy greens, a jackfruit, a guava and a lemon.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 139: I can say cumin, leafy greens, a jackfruit, a guava and a lemon.*

139.1 சீரகம் (cīrakam) — cumin

Before the new one: say the Tamil for pepper, then the Tamil for mustard seed.

You'll want to know: சீரகம்

சீரகம் — *cīrakam* — "cumin".

In the family, and next door

	word
Kannada	**ಜೀರಿಗೆ** (*jīrige*)
Telugu	**జీలకర్ర** (*jīlakarra*)
English	cumin

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

சீரகம் (*cīrakam*) is a loan from Sanskrit *jīraka*, "cumin seed" (CDIAL 5234).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: cīrakam*
- *Say it: cīrakam*, once more
- *Say it:* say *cīrakam*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for pepper, then the Tamil for mustard seed, then say *cīrakam* again

Before you move on

What does **சீரகம்** mean? ("Cumin".) Say it once more.

139.2 கீரை (kīrai) — leafy greens

Before the new one: say the Tamil for mustard seed, then the Tamil for cumin.

You'll want to know: கீரை

கீரை — *kīrai* — "leafy greens".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

கீரை (*kīrai*) is native Dravidian. DEDR 1617 lists Malayalam *cīra* and Kannada *kīre*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: kīrai*
- *Say it: kīrai*, once more

- *Say it:* say *kīrai*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for mustard seed, then the Tamil for cumin, then say *kīrai* again

Before you move on

What does **கீரை** mean? (“Leafy greens”.) Say it once more.

139.3 பலாப்பழம் (palāppaḻam) — a jackfruit

Before the new one: say the Tamil for cumin, then the Tamil for leafy greens.

Say **எனக்குத் தமிழ் பிடிக்கும்**, then the plain verb for wanting, **விரும்பு**.

You’ll want to know: பலாப்பழம்

பலாப்பழம் — *palāppaḻam* — “a jackfruit”.

In the family, and next door

	word	same root
Kannada	**ಹಲಸು** (*halasu*)	yes
Malayalam	**ചക്ക** (*cakka*)	
English	a jackfruit	

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

பலாப்பழம் (*palāppaḻam*) is native: *palā*, “jack tree” (DEDR 3988; Malayalam *plāvu*), and *paḻam*, “fruit” (DEDR 4004). DEDR compares Sanskrit *panasa*, “jack tree”, and *phala*, “fruit”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: palāppaḻam*
- *Say it: palāppaḻam*, once more

- *Say it:* say *palāppaḻam*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for cumin, then the Tamil for leafy greens, then say *palāppaḻam* again

Before you move on

What does பலாப்பழம் mean? ("A jackfruit".) Say it once more.

139.4 கொய்யா (koyyā) — a guava

Before the new one: say the Tamil for leafy greens, then the Tamil for a jackfruit.

You'll want to know: கொய்யா

கொய்யா — *koyyā* — "a guava".

In the family, and next door

	word
Telugu	జామపండు (*jāmapaṇḍu*)
English	a guava

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

கொய்யா (*koyyā*) is probably a loan from Portuguese *goiaba*, "guava": the fruit came to India from the Americas with the Portuguese.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: koyyā*
- *Say it: koyyā*, once more
- *Say it:* say *koyyā*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for leafy greens, then the Tamil for a jackfruit, then say *koyyā* again

Before you move on

What does கொய்யா mean? ("A guava".) Say it once more.

139.5 எலுமிச்சை (elumiccai) — a lemon

Before the new one: say the Tamil for a jackfruit, then the Tamil for a guava.

You'll want to know: எலுமிச்சை

எலுமிச்சை — *elumiccai* — "a lemon".

In the family, and next door

	word
Kannada	ನಿಂಬೆ (*nimbe*)
Telugu	నిమ్మకాయ (*nimmakāya*)
Malayalam	നാരങ്ങ (*nāraṅṅa*)
English	a lemon

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

எலுமிச்சை (*elumiccai*) is native Dravidian. DEDR 836 lists Malayalam *elumicca*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: elumiccai*
- *Say it: elumiccai*, once more
- *Say it:* say *elumiccai*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for a jackfruit, then the Tamil for a guava, then say *elumiccai* again

Before you move on

What does எலுமிச்சை mean? (“A lemon”.) Say it once more.

139.6 Food and nature — a first pass

Say the words for a guava and a lemon.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- a parrot, a pigeon, an owl, a peacock, an ant
- a mosquito, the face, the mouth, the tongue, a finger
- a shoulder, the chest, a knee, hair, the skin
- a curtain, a mattress, a television, a mobile phone, a computer

Before you move on

A parrot? (கிளி, *kiḷi.*) A pigeon? (புறா, *puṟā.*) An owl? (ஆந்தை, *āntai.*) A peacock? (மயில், *mayil.*) An ant? (எறும்பு, *eṟumpu.*) A mosquito? (கொசு, *kocu.*) The face? (முகம், *mukam.*) The mouth? (வாய், *vāy.*) The tongue? (நாக்கு, *nākku.*) A finger? (விரல், *viral.*) A shoulder? (தோள், *tōḷ.*) The chest? (மார்பு, *mārpu.*) A knee? (முழங்கால், *muḻaṅkāl.*) Hair? (முடி, *muṭi.*) The skin? (தோல், *tōl.*) A curtain? (திரைச்சீலை, *tiraiccīlai.*) A mattress? (மெத்தை, *mettai.*) A television? (தொலைக்காட்சி, *tolaikkāṭci.*) A mobile phone? (கைப்பேசி, *kaippēci.*) A computer? (கணினி, *kaṇiṇi.*)

139.7 Nature and animals — a second pass

Say the words for an electric fan and scissors.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- an electric fan, scissors, a hammer, a nail, a ladder
- a bottle, a ball, a kite, a doll, a purse
- a ring, a bangle, a sock, a glove, a class
- an exam, an answer, tamarind, pepper, mustard seed
- cumin, leafy greens, a jackfruit, a guava, a lemon

Before you move on

An electric fan? (மின்விசிறி, *miṉviciṟi.*) Scissors? (கத்தரிக்கோல், *kattarikkōl.*) A hammer? (சுத்தியல், *cuttiyal.*) A nail? (ஆணி, *āṇi.*) A ladder? (ஏணி, *ēṇi.*) A bottle? (குப்பி, *kuppi.*) A ball? (பந்து, *pantu.*) A kite? (பட்டம், *paṭṭam.*) A doll? (பொம்மை, *pommai.*) A purse? (பணப்பை, *paṇappai.*) A ring? (மோதிரம், *mōtiram.*) A bangle? (வளையல், *vaḷaiyal.*) A sock? (காலுறை, *kāluṟai.*) A glove? (கையுறை, *kaiyuṟai.*) A class? (வகுப்பு, *vakuppu.*) An exam? (தேர்வு, *tērvu.*) An answer? (பதில், *patil.*) Tamarind? (புளி, *puḷi.*) Pepper? (மிளகு, *miḷaku.*) Mustard seed? (கடுகு, *kaṭuku.*) Cumin? (சீரகம், *cīrakam.*) Leafy greens? (கீரை, *kīrai.*) A jackfruit? (பலாப்பழம், *palāppaḻam.*) A guava? (கொய்யா, *koyyā.*) A lemon? (எலுமிச்சை, *elumiccai.*)

Chapter 140

Grapes, Pomegranate, Pickle, Waterfall, Hill

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say grapes, a pomegranate, a pickle, a waterfall and a hill.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 140: I can say grapes, a pomegranate, a pickle, a waterfall and a hill.*

140.1 திராட்சை (tirāṭcai) — grapes

> Before the new one: say the Tamil for a guava, then the Tamil for a lemon.

You'll want to know: திராட்சை

திராட்சை — *tirāṭcai* — "grapes".

In the family, and next door

	word
Kannada	ದ್ರಾಕ್ಷಿ (*drākṣi*)
Telugu	ద్రాక్ష (*drākṣa*)
Malayalam	മുന്തിരി (*muntiri*)
Hindi (neighbour)	अंगूर (*aṅgūr*)
English	grapes

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

திராட்சை (*tirāṭcai*) is a loan from Sanskrit *drākṣā*, "vine, grape" (CDIAL 6628).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: tirāṭcai*
- *Say it: tirāṭcai*, once more
- *Say it:* say *tirāṭcai*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for a guava, then the Tamil for a lemon, then say *tirāṭcai* again

Before you move on

What does திராட்சை mean? ("Grapes".) Say it once more.

140.2 மாதுளை (mātuḷai) — a pomegranate

Before the new one: say the Tamil for a lemon, then the Tamil for grapes.

You'll want to know: மாதுளை

மாதுளை — *mātuḷai* — "a pomegranate".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

மாதுளை (*mātuḷai*) is native Dravidian. DEDR 4809 lists Malayalam *mātaḷam*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: mātuḷai*
- *Say it: mātuḷai*, once more
- *Say it:* say *mātuḷai*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for a lemon, then the Tamil for grapes, then say *mātuḷai* again

Before you move on

What does மாதுளை mean? ("A pomegranate".) Say it once more.

140.3 ஊறுகாய் (ūṟukāy) — a pickle

Before the new one: say the Tamil for grapes, then the Tamil for a pomegranate.

You'll want to know: ஊறுகாய்

ஊறுகாய் — *ūṟukāy* — "a pickle".

In the family, and next door

	word
Kannada	ಉಪ್ಪಿನಕಾಯಿ (*uppinakāyi*)
English	a pickle

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

ஊறுகாய் (*ūṟukāy*) is native: *ūṟu*, "to soak, to be steeped" (DEDR 761), and *kāy*, "unripe fruit" (DEDR 1459, which compares Indo-Aryan **kacca*, "raw"): fruit left to steep.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: ūṟukāy*

- *Say it:* *ūṟukāy*, once more
- *Say it:* say *ūṟukāy*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for grapes, then the Tamil for a pomegranate, then say *ūṟukāy* again

Before you move on

What does ஊறுகாய் mean? ("A pickle".) Say it once more.

140.4 அருவி (aruvi) — a waterfall

Before the new one: say the Tamil for a pomegranate, then the Tamil for a pickle.

Say வானிலை, then மழை பெய்கிறது. Name the rainy season, மழைக் காலம், the one that shapes the year here.

You'll want to know: அருவி

அருவி — *aruvi* — "a waterfall".

In the family, and next door

	word
Kannada	ಜಲಪಾತ (*jalapāta*)
Telugu	జలపాతం (*jalapātaṁ*)
Malayalam	വെള്ളച്ചാട്ടം (*veḷḷaccāṭṭaṁ*)
English	a waterfall

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

அருவி (*aruvi*) is native Dravidian (DEDR 225). The entry glosses *aruvi* "river's mouth".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *aruvi*

- *Say it:* *aruvi*, once more
- *Say it:* say *aruvi*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for a pomegranate, then the Tamil for a pickle, then say *aruvi* again

Before you move on

What does அருவி mean? ("A waterfall".) Say it once more.

140.5 குன்று (kun̲r̲u) — a hill

Before the new one: say the Tamil for a pickle, then the Tamil for a waterfall.

You'll want to know: குன்று

குன்று — *kun̲r̲u* — "a hill".

In the family, and next door

	word	same root
Kannada	ಬೆಟ್ಟ (*beṭṭa*)	
Telugu	కొండ (*koṇḍa*)	yes
English	a hill	

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

குன்று (*kun̲r̲u*) is native Dravidian. DEDR 1864 lists Malayalam *kunnu* and Telugu *koṇḍa*, which Kannada borrowed.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *kun̲r̲u*
- *Say it:* *kun̲r̲u*, once more
- *Say it:* say *kun̲r̲u*

- *Recall:* say the Tamil for a pickle, then the Tamil for a waterfall, then say *kunru* again

Before you move on

What does குன்று mean? ("A hill".) Say it once more.

Chapter 141

Island, Insect, Spider, Pig, Donkey

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say an island, an insect, a spider, a pig and a donkey.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 141: I can say an island, an insect, a spider, a pig and a donkey.*

141.1 தீவு (tīvu) — an island

Before the new one: say the Tamil for a waterfall, then the Tamil for a hill.

You'll want to know: தீவு

தீவு — *tīvu* — "an island".

In the family, and next door

	word	same root
Kannada	ದ್ವೀಪ (*dvīpa*)	
Telugu	దీవి (*dīvi*)	yes
Malayalam	ദ്വീപ് (*dvīpŭ*)	
English	an island	

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

தீவு (*tīvu*) is usually traced to Sanskrit *dvīpa*, "land, island" (CDIAL 6691), worn down in Tamil. DEDR has no native entry for it.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: tīvu*
- *Say it: tīvu*, once more
- *Say it:* say *tīvu*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for a waterfall, then the Tamil for a hill, then say *tīvu* again

Before you move on

What does தீவு mean? ("An island".) Say it once more.

141.2 பூச்சி (pūcci) — an insect

Before the new one: say the Tamil for a hill, then the Tamil for an island.

You'll want to know: பூச்சி

பூச்சி — *pūcci* — "an insect".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

பூச்சி (*pūcci*) is native Dravidian. DEDR 4353 lists Malayalam *pūcci* and Kannada *pūci*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: pūcci*
- *Say it: pūcci*, once more

- *Say it:* say *pūcci*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for a hill, then the Tamil for an island, then say *pūcci* again

Before you move on

What does பூச்சி mean? ("An insect".) Say it once more.

141.3 சிலந்தி (cilanti) — a spider

Before the new one: say the Tamil for an island, then the Tamil for an insect.

You'll want to know: சிலந்தி

சிலந்தி — *cilanti* — "a spider".

In the family, and next door

	word
Kannada	ಜೇಡ (*jēḍa*)
Telugu	సాలీడు (*sālīḍu*)
English	a spider

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

சிலந்தி (*cilanti*) is native Dravidian. DEDR 2562 lists Malayalam *cilanni* and Kannada *selandi*. The entry compares Sanskrit *śalaka*, "spider".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: cilanti*
- *Say it: cilanti*, once more
- *Say it:* say *cilanti*

- *Recall:* say the Tamil for an island, then the Tamil for an insect, then say *cilanti* again

Before you move on

What does சிலந்தி mean? ("A spider".) Say it once more.

141.4 பன்றி (pan̲r̲i) — a pig

Before the new one: say the Tamil for an insect, then the Tamil for a spider.

You'll want to know: பன்றி

பன்றி — *pan̲r̲i* — "a pig".

In the family, and next door

	word	same root
Kannada	ಹಂದಿ (*handi*)	yes
Telugu	పంది (*pandi*)	yes
Malayalam	പന്നി (*panni*)	yes
English	a pig	

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

பன்றி (*pan̲r̲i*) is native Dravidian. DEDR 4039 lists Malayalam *panni*, Kannada *pandi* and Telugu *pandi*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: pan̲r̲i*
- *Say it: pan̲r̲i*, once more
- *Say it:* say *pan̲r̲i*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for an insect, then the Tamil for a spider, then say *pan̲r̲i* again

Before you move on

What does பன்றி mean? ("A pig".) Say it once more.

141.5 கழுதை (kaḻutai) — a donkey

Before the new one: say the Tamil for a spider, then the Tamil for a pig.

You'll want to know: கழுதை

கழுதை — *kaḻutai* — "a donkey".

In the family, and next door

	word	same root
Kannada	ಕತ್ತೆ (*katte*)	yes
Telugu	గాడిద (*gāḍida*)	
Malayalam	കഴുത (*kaḻuta*)	yes
Hindi (neighbour)	गधा (*gadhā*)	
English	a donkey	

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

கழுதை (*kaḻutai*) is native Dravidian. DEDR 1364 lists Malayalam *kaḻuta*, Kannada *katte* and Telugu *gāḍida*. The entry compares Sanskrit *gardabha*, "ass" (CDIAL 4054).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: kaḻutai*
- *Say it: kaḻutai*, once more
- *Say it:* say *kaḻutai*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for a spider, then the Tamil for a pig, then say *kaḻutai* again

Before you move on

What does **கழுதை** mean? (“A donkey”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 142

Camel, Duck, Cheek, Wrist, Elbow

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say a camel, a duck, a cheek, a wrist and an elbow.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 142: I can say a camel, a duck, a cheek, a wrist and an elbow.*

142.1 ஒட்டகம் (ottakam) — a camel

> Before the new one: say the Tamil for a pig, then the Tamil for a donkey.

You'll want to know: ஒட்டகம்

ஒட்டகம் — *ottakam* — "a camel".

In the family, and next door

	word	same root
Kannada	ಒಂಟೆ (*oṇṭe*)	yes
Telugu	ఒంటె (*oṇṭe*)	yes
Malayalam	ഒട്ടകം (*oṭṭakaṁ*)	yes
Hindi (neighbour)	ऊँट (*ũṭ*)	
English	a camel	

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

ஒட்டகம் (*ottakam*) is a loan from Sanskrit *uṣṭra*, "camel" (CDIAL 2387). The word came through a Prakrit form with *-ṭṭ-*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: ottakam*
- *Say it: ottakam*, once more
- *Say it:* say *ottakam*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for a pig, then the Tamil for a donkey, then say *ottakam* again

Before you move on

What does ஒட்டகம் mean? ("A camel".) Say it once more.

142.2 வாத்து (vāttu) — a duck

Before the new one: say the Tamil for a donkey, then the Tamil for a camel.

You'll want to know: வாத்து

வாத்து — *vāttu* — "a duck".

In the family, and next door

	word
Kannada	ಬಾತುಕೋಳಿ (*bātukōḷi*)
Telugu	బాతు (*bātu*)
Malayalam	താറാവ് (*tāṟāvŭ*)
English	a duck

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

வாத்து (*vāttu*) is probably a loan from Hindustani *baṭ*, "duck", which goes back to Persian and Arabic *baṭṭ*. DEDR has no native entry for it.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *vāttu*
- *Say it:* *vāttu*, once more
- *Say it:* say *vāttu*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for a donkey, then the Tamil for a camel, then say *vāttu* again

Before you move on

What does வாத்து mean? ("A duck".) Say it once more.

142.3 கன்னம் (kaṉṉam) — a cheek

Before the new one: say the Tamil for a camel, then the Tamil for a duck.

You'll want to know: கன்னம்

கன்னம் — *kaṉṉam* — "a cheek".

In the family, and next door

	word	same root
Kannada	ಕೆನ್ನೆ (*kenne*)	yes
Telugu	బుగ్గ (*bugga*)	
Malayalam	കവിൾ (*kavil*)	
Hindi (neighbour)	गाल (*gāl*)	
English	a cheek	

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

கன்னம் (*kaṉṉam*) is native Dravidian. DEDR 1413 lists Malayalam *kannam* and Kannada *kanna*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: kaṉṉam*
- *Say it: kaṉṉam*, once more
- *Say it:* say *kaṉṉam*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for a camel, then the Tamil for a duck, then say *kaṉṉam* again

Before you move on

What does **கன்னம்** mean? ("A cheek".) Say it once more.

142.4 மணிக்கட்டு (maṇikkaṭṭu) — a wrist

Before the new one: say the Tamil for a duck, then the Tamil for a cheek.

You'll want to know: மணிக்கட்டு

மணிக்கட்டு — *maṇikkaṭṭu* — "a wrist".

In the family, and next door

	word	same root
Kannada	ಮಣಿಕಟ್ಟು (*maṇikaṭṭu*)	yes
Telugu	మణికట్టు (*maṇikaṭṭu*)	yes
Hindi (neighbour)	कलाई (*kalāī*)	
English	a wrist	

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

மணிக்கட்டு (*maṇikkaṭṭu*) is native Dravidian. DEDR 4673 lists Malayalam *maṇikkeṭṭu* and Kannada *maṇikaṭṭu*. It notes Sanskrit *maṇibandha*, "wrist", whose *bandha* translates *kaṭṭu*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: maṇikkaṭṭu*
- *Say it: maṇikkaṭṭu*, once more
- *Say it:* say *maṇikkaṭṭu*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for a duck, then the Tamil for a cheek, then say *maṇikkaṭṭu* again

Before you move on

What does மணிக்கட்டு mean? ("A wrist".) Say it once more.

142.5 முழங்கை (mu̲ḻaṅkai) — an elbow

Before the new one: say the Tamil for a cheek, then the Tamil for a wrist.

You'll want to know: முழங்கை

முழங்கை — *mu̲ḻaṅkai* — "an elbow".

In the family, and next door

	word	same root
Kannada	ಮೊಣಕೈ (*moṇakai*)	yes
Telugu	మోచేయి (*mōcēyi*)	
Malayalam	കൈമുട്ട് (*kaimuṭṭŭ*)	
Hindi (neighbour)	कोहनी (*kohnī*)	
English	an elbow	

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

முழங்கை (*mu̲laṅkai*) is native: DEDR 4990 lists *mu̲laṅkai*, "elbow, forearm", built on *mu̲lam*, "cubit, joint", with *kai*, "hand, arm".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: mu̲laṅkai*
- *Say it: mu̲laṅkai*, once more
- *Say it:* say *mu̲laṅkai*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for a cheek, then the Tamil for a wrist, then say *mu̲laṅkai* again

Before you move on

What does முழங்கை mean? ("An elbow".) Say it once more.

Chapter 143

Thumb, Bad, Beautiful, Long, Short

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say a thumb, bad, beautiful, long and short.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 143: I can say a thumb, bad, beautiful, long and short.

143.1 கட்டைவிரல் (kaṭṭaiviral) — a thumb

Before the new one: say the Tamil for a wrist, then the Tamil for an elbow.

You'll want to know: கட்டைவிரல்

கட்டைவிரல் — *kaṭṭaiviral* — "a thumb".

In the family, and next door

	word
Kannada	**ಹೆಬ್ಬೆರಳು** (*hebberaḷu*)
Hindi (neighbour)	**अंगूठा** (*aṅgūṭhā*)
English	a thumb

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

கட்டைவிரல் (*kaṭṭaiviral*) is native: *kaṭṭai*, "shortness, short and thick" (DEDR 1151, which compares Indo-Aryan **gāṭṭa*, "short"), and *viral*, "finger" (DEDR 5409).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: kaṭṭaiviral*
- *Say it: kaṭṭaiviral*, once more
- *Say it:* say *kaṭṭaiviral*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for a wrist, then the Tamil for an elbow, then say *kaṭṭaiviral* again

Before you move on

What does கட்டைவிரல் mean? ("A thumb".) Say it once more.

143.2 கெட்ட (keṭṭa) — bad

Before the new one: say the Tamil for an elbow, then the Tamil for a thumb.

An adjective goes before the noun and does not change: பெரிய வீடு, சிறிய வீடு.

You'll want to know: கெட்ட

கெட்ட — *keṭṭa* — "bad".

In the family, and next door

	word	same root
Kannada	ಕೆಟ್ಟ (*keṭṭa*)	yes
Telugu	చెడ్డ (*ceḍḍa*)	
Malayalam	മോശം (*mōśam*)	
Hindi (neighbour)	बुरा (*burā*)	
English	bad	

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

கெட்ட (*keṭṭa*) is native Dravidian. DEDR 1942 lists Malayalam *keṭu*, "ruin". It is "spoiled", from *keṭu*, "to perish, to go bad".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: keṭṭa*
- *Say it: keṭṭa*, once more
- *Say it:* say *keṭṭa*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for an elbow, then the Tamil for a thumb, then say *keṭṭa* again

Before you move on

What does கெட்ட mean? ("Bad".) Say it once more.

143.3 அழகான (a̲lakāṉa) — beautiful

Before the new one: say the Tamil for a thumb, then the Tamil for bad.

You'll want to know: அழகான

அழகான — *a̲lakāṉa* — "beautiful".

In the family, and next door

	word
Kannada	ಸುಂದರ (*sundara*)
Telugu	అందమైన (*andamaina*)
Malayalam	സുന്ദരം (*sundaram*)
English	beautiful

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

அழகான (*a̲lakāṉa*) is native Dravidian. DEDR 274 lists Malayalam *a̲laku*, "beauty". It is *a̲laku*, "beauty", with *-āṉa*, the ending that makes describing words.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *a̲lakāṉa*
- *Say it:* *a̲lakāṉa*, once more
- *Say it:* say *a̲lakāṉa*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for a thumb, then the Tamil for bad, then say *a̲lakāṉa* again

Before you move on

What does அழகான mean? ("Beautiful".) Say it once more.

143.4 நீளமான (nīḷamāṉa) — long

Before the new one: say the Tamil for bad, then the Tamil for beautiful.

You'll want to know: நீளமான

நீளமான — *nīḷamāṉa* — "long".

In the family, and next door

	word	same root
Kannada	ಉದ್ದ (*udda*)	
Malayalam	നീളമുള്ള (*nīḷamuḷḷa*)	yes
English	long	

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

நீளமான (*nīḷamāṉa*) is native Dravidian (DEDR 3692). It is *nīḷam*, "length", with *-āṉa*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *nīḷamāṉa*
- *Say it:* *nīḷamāṉa*, once more
- *Say it:* say *nīḷamāṉa*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for bad, then the Tamil for beautiful, then say *nīḷamāṉa* again

Before you move on

What does நீளமான mean? ("Long".) Say it once more.

143.5 குட்டையான (kuṭṭaiyāṉa) — short

Before the new one: say the Tamil for beautiful, then the Tamil for long.

You'll want to know: குட்டையான

குட்டையான — *kuṭṭaiyāṉa* — "short".

In the family, and next door

	word
Kannada	ಗಿಡ್ಡ (*giḍḍa*)
Telugu	పొట్టి (*poṭṭi*)
Malayalam	കുറിയ (*kuṟiya*)
English	short

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

குட்டையான (*kuṭṭaiyāṉa*) is native Dravidian (DEDR 1670). The entry lists *kuṭṭai*, "shortness", among words for small and young things; *-āṉa* makes it "short".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *kuṭṭaiyāṉa*
- *Say it:* *kuṭṭaiyāṉa*, once more
- *Say it:* say *kuṭṭaiyāṉa*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for beautiful, then the Tamil for long, then say *kuṭṭaiyāṉa* again

Before you move on

What does குட்டையான mean? ("Short".) Say it once more.

Chapter 144

Tall, Hot, Cold, Heavy, Light

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say tall, hot, cold, heavy and light.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 144: I can say tall, hot, cold, heavy and light.*

144.1 உயரமான (uyaramāṉa) — tall

Before the new one: say the Tamil for long, then the Tamil for short.

You'll want to know: உயரமான

உயரமான — *uyaramāṉa* — "tall".

In the family, and next door

	word
Telugu	పొడవు (*poḍavu*)
Hindi (neighbour)	लंबा (*lambā*)
English	tall

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

உயரமான (*uyaramāṉa*) is native Dravidian (DEDR 646). It is *uyaram*, "height", from *uyar*, "to rise", with *-āṉa*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *uyaramāṉa*
- *Say it:* *uyaramāṉa*, once more
- *Say it:* say *uyaramāṉa*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for long, then the Tamil for short, then say *uyaramāṉa* again

Before you move on

What does உயரமான mean? ("Tall".) Say it once more.

144.2 சூடான (cūṭāṉa) — hot

Before the new one: say the Tamil for short, then the Tamil for tall.

Tell the time, ஒரு மணி, இரண்டு மணி, then name the afternoon three ways: நடுப்பகல், மதியம், பிற்பகல்.

You'll want to know: சூடான

சூடான — *cūṭāṉa* — "hot".

In the family, and next door

	word	same root
Malayalam	ചൂടുള്ള (*cūṭuḷḷa*)	yes
Hindi (neighbour)	गरम (*garam*)	
English	hot	

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

சூடான (*cūṭāṉa*) is native Dravidian (DEDR 2654). It is *cūṭu*, "heat", with *-āṉa*. DEDR compares Sanskrit *cūḍ-*, "to singe".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *cūṭāṉa*
- *Say it:* *cūṭāṉa*, once more
- *Say it:* say *cūṭāṉa*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for short, then the Tamil for tall, then say *cūṭāṉa* again

Before you move on

What does சூடான mean? ("Hot".) Say it once more.

144.3 குளிர்ந்த (kuḷirnta) — cold

Before the new one: say the Tamil for tall, then the Tamil for hot.

You'll want to know: குளிர்ந்த

குளிர்ந்த — *kuḷirnta* — "cold".

In the family, and next door

	word
Kannada	ಶೀತ (*śīta*)
English	cold

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

குளிர்ந்த (*kuḷirnta*) is native Dravidian. DEDR 1834 lists Malayalam *kuḷir*, "coldness".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: kuḷirnta*
- *Say it: kuḷirnta*, once more
- *Say it:* say *kuḷirnta*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for tall, then the Tamil for hot, then say *kuḷirnta* again

Before you move on

What does குளிர்ந்த mean? ("Cold".) Say it once more.

144.4 கனமான (kaṉamāṉa) — heavy

Before the new one: say the Tamil for hot, then the Tamil for cold.

You'll want to know: கனமான

கனமான — *kaṉamāṉa* — "heavy".

In the family, and next door

	word
Kannada	ಭಾರ (*bhāra*)
Telugu	బరువు (*baruvu*)
Malayalam	ഭാരമുള്ള (*bhāramuḷḷa*)
Hindi (neighbour)	भारी (*bhārī*)
English	heavy

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

கனமான (*kaṉamāṉa*) is a loan from Sanskrit *ghana*, "compact, firm, dense" (CDIAL 4424). *Kaṉam*, "weight", takes -*āṉa*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *kaṉamāṉa*
- *Say it:* *kaṉamāṉa*, once more
- *Say it:* say *kaṉamāṉa*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for hot, then the Tamil for cold, then say *kaṉamāṉa* again

Before you move on

What does கனமான mean? ("Heavy".) Say it once more.

144.5 லேசான (lēcāṉa) — light (in weight)

Before the new one: say the Tamil for cold, then the Tamil for heavy.

You'll want to know: லேசான

லேசான — *lēcāṉa* — "light (in weight)".

In the family, and next door

	word
Kannada	ಹಗುರ (*hagura*)
Telugu	తేలిక (*tēlika*)
Hindi (neighbour)	हल्का (*halkā*)
English	light

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

The origin of லேசான (*lēcāṉa*) is uncertain. DEDR has no entry for *lēcu*, "light, slight", and its initial *l-* is not native to old Tamil, which points to a loan from a neighbouring language.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *lēcāṉa*
- *Say it:* *lēcāṉa*, once more
- *Say it:* say *lēcāṉa*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for cold, then the Tamil for heavy, then say *lēcāṉa* again

Before you move on

What does **லேசான** mean? (“Light (in weight)”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 145

Soft, Hard, Clean, Dirty, Fast

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say soft, hard, clean, dirty and fast.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 145: I can say soft, hard, clean, dirty and fast.*

145.1 மென்மையான (me̲nmaiyā̲na) — soft

Before the new one: say the Tamil for heavy, then the Tamil for light.

You'll want to know: மென்மையான

மென்மையான — *me̲nmaiyā̲na* — "soft".

In the family, and next door

	word
Kannada	ಮೃದು (*mṛdu*)
Telugu	మెత్తని (*mettani*)
Malayalam	മൃദുവായ (*mṛduvāya*)
Hindi (neighbour)	नरम (*naram*)
English	soft

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

மென்மையான (*meṉmaiyāṉa*) is native Dravidian (DEDR 5078). It is *meṉmai*, "softness", from *mel*, "soft", with *-āṉa*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *meṉmaiyāṉa*
- *Say it:* *meṉmaiyāṉa*, once more
- *Say it:* say *meṉmaiyāṉa*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for heavy, then the Tamil for light, then say *meṉmaiyāṉa* again

Before you move on

What does மென்மையான mean? ("Soft".) Say it once more.

145.2 கடினமான (kaṭiṉamāṉa) — hard, difficult

Before the new one: say the Tamil for light, then the Tamil for soft.

You'll want to know: கடினமான

கடினமான — *kaṭiṉamāṉa* — "hard, difficult".

In the family, and next door

	word	same root
Kannada	ಗಟ್ಟಿ (*gaṭṭi*)	
Telugu	గట్టి (*gaṭṭi*)	
Malayalam	കഠിനമായ (*kaṭhinamāya*)	yes
Hindi (neighbour)	सख़्त (*sakht*)	
English	hard, difficult	

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

கடினமான (*kaṭiṉamāṉa*) is a loan from Sanskrit *kaṭhina*, "hard, stiff" (CDIAL 2650). CDIAL notes a proposal that the Sanskrit word itself came from Dravidian.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: kaṭiṉamāṉa*
- *Say it: kaṭiṉamāṉa*, once more
- *Say it:* say *kaṭiṉamāṉa*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for light, then the Tamil for soft, then say *kaṭiṉamāṉa* again

Before you move on

What does கடினமான mean? ("Hard, difficult".) Say it once more.

145.3 சுத்தமான (cuttamāṉa) — clean

Before the new one: say the Tamil for soft, then the Tamil for hard.

You'll want to know: சுத்தமான

சுத்தமான — *cuttamāṉa* — "clean".

In the family, and next door

	word
Telugu	శుభ్రం (*śubhram*)
Malayalam	വൃത്തിയുള്ള (*vṛttiyuḷḷa*)
Hindi (neighbour)	साफ़ (*sāf*)
English	clean

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

சுத்தமான (*cuttamāṉa*) is a loan from Sanskrit *śuddha*, "clean, pure" (CDIAL 12520).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *cuttamāṉa*
- *Say it:* *cuttamāṉa*, once more
- *Say it:* say *cuttamāṉa*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for soft, then the Tamil for hard, then say *cuttamāṉa* again

Before you move on

What does சுத்தமான mean? ("Clean".) Say it once more.

145.4 அழுக்கான (aḻukkāṉa) — dirty

Before the new one: say the Tamil for hard, then the Tamil for clean.

You'll want to know: அழுக்கான

அழுக்கான — *aḻukkāṉa* — "dirty".

In the family, and next door

	word
Kannada	ಕೊಳಕು (*koḷaku*)
Telugu	మురికి (*murikī*)
Hindi (neighbour)	गंदा (*gandā*)
English	dirty

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

அழுக்கான (*aḻukkāṉa*) is native Dravidian. DEDR 283 lists Malayalam *aḻukku*, "dirt".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *aḻukkāṉa*
- *Say it:* *aḻukkāṉa*, once more
- *Say it:* say *aḻukkāṉa*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for hard, then the Tamil for clean, then say *aḻukkāṉa* again

Before you move on

What does அழுக்கான mean? ("Dirty".) Say it once more.

145.5 வேகமான (vēkamāṉa) — fast

Before the new one: say the Tamil for clean, then the Tamil for dirty.

You'll want to know: வேகமான

வேகமான — *vēkamāṉa* — "fast".

In the family, and next door

	word	same root
Telugu	వేగం (*vēgam*)	
Malayalam	വേഗമുള്ള (*vēgamuḷḷa*)	yes
Hindi (neighbour)	तेज़ (*tez*)	
English	fast	

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

வேகமான (*vēkamāṉa*) is a loan from Sanskrit *vega*, "speed" (CDIAL 12089).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: vēkamāṉa*
- *Say it: vēkamāṉa*, once more
- *Say it:* say *vēkamāṉa*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for clean, then the Tamil for dirty, then say *vēkamāṉa* again

Before you move on

What does வேகமான mean? ("Fast".) Say it once more.

Chapter 146

Bitter, Sour, Spicy, Rich, Poor

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say bitter, sour, spicy, rich and poor.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 146: I can say bitter, sour, spicy, rich and poor.*

146.1 கசப்பு (kacappu) — bitter

Before the new one: say the Tamil for dirty, then the Tamil for fast.

You'll want to know: கசப்பு

கசப்பு — *kacappu* — "bitter".

In the family, and next door

	word
Kannada	ಕಹಿ (*kahi*)
Telugu	చేదు (*cēdu*)
Malayalam	കയ്പുള്ള (*kaypuḷḷa*)
Hindi (neighbour)	कड़वा (*kaṛvā*)
English	bitter

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

கசப்பு (*kacappu*) is native Dravidian. DEDR 1249 lists Malayalam *kaśakka*, "to be bitter". The entry compares Sanskrit *kaṣāya*, "astringent" (CDIAL 2974).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: kacappu*
- *Say it: kacappu*, once more
- *Say it:* say *kacappu*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for dirty, then the Tamil for fast, then say *kacappu* again

Before you move on

What does **கசப்பு** mean? ("Bitter".) Say it once more.

146.2 புளிப்பு (puḷippu) — sour

Before the new one: say the Tamil for fast, then the Tamil for bitter.

You'll want to know: புளிப்பு

புளிப்பு — *puḷippu* — "sour".

In the family, and next door

	word	same root
Kannada	ಹುಳಿ (*huḷi*)	yes
Telugu	పులుపు (*pulupu*)	yes
Malayalam	പുളിയുള്ള (*puḷiyuḷḷa*)	yes
Hindi (neighbour)	खट्टा (*khaṭṭā*)	
English	sour	

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

புளிப்பு (*puḷippu*) is native Dravidian. DEDR 4322 lists Kannada *puḷi*, *huḷi* and Telugu *puli*. It is the noun of *puḷi*, "to turn sour".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *puḷippu*
- *Say it:* *puḷippu*, once more
- *Say it:* say *puḷippu*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for fast, then the Tamil for bitter, then say *puḷippu* again

Before you move on

What does புளிப்பு mean? ("Sour".) Say it once more.

146.3 காரம் (kāram) — spicy

Before the new one: say the Tamil for bitter, then the Tamil for sour.

You'll want to know: காரம்

காரம் — *kāram* — "spicy".

In the family, and next door

	word	same root
Kannada	ಖಾರ (*khāra*)	yes
Telugu	కారమైన (*kāramaina*)	yes
Malayalam	എരിവുള്ള (*erivuḷḷa*)	
Hindi (neighbour)	तीखा (*tīkhā*)	
English	spicy	

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

காரம் (*kāram*) is native Dravidian. DEDR 1466 lists Malayalam *kāram*, "caustic". The entry adds that the word was probably influenced by Sanskrit *kṣāra*, "caustic".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: kāram*
- *Say it: kāram*, once more
- *Say it:* say *kāram*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for bitter, then the Tamil for sour, then say *kāram* again

Before you move on

What does காரம் mean? ("Spicy".) Say it once more.

146.4 பணக்கார (paṇakkāra) — rich

Before the new one: say the Tamil for sour, then the Tamil for spicy.

You'll want to know: பணக்கார

பணக்கார — *paṇakkāra* — "rich".

In the family, and next door

	word
Kannada	ಶ್ರೀಮಂತ (*śrīmanta*)
Hindi (neighbour)	अमीर (*amīr*)
English	rich

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

பணக்கார (*paṇakkāra*) is *paṇam*, "money", from Sanskrit *paṇa*, "a coin" (CDIAL 7715), with *-kāra*, "the one who has": "moneyed".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: paṇakkāra*
- *Say it: paṇakkāra*, once more
- *Say it:* say *paṇakkāra*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for sour, then the Tamil for spicy, then say *paṇakkāra* again

Before you move on

What does பணக்கார mean? ("Rich".) Say it once more.

146.5 ஏழை (ēḻai) — poor

Before the new one: say the Tamil for spicy, then the Tamil for rich.

You'll want to know: ஏழை

ஏழை — *ēḻai* — "poor".

In the family, and next door

	word
Kannada	ಬಡ (*baḍa*)
Telugu	పేద (*pēda*)
Hindi (neighbour)	ग़रीब (*ġarīb*)
English	poor

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

ஏழை (*ēḻai*) is native Dravidian. DEDR 911 lists Malayalam *ēḻa*, "a poor person".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *ēḻai*
- *Say it:* *ēḻai*, once more
- *Say it:* say *ēḻai*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for spicy, then the Tamil for rich, then say *ēḻai* again

Before you move on

What does ஏழை mean? ("Poor".) Say it once more.

Chapter 147

Young, Old, Clever, Lazy, Brave

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say young, old, clever, lazy and brave.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 147: I can say young, old, clever, lazy and brave.*

147.1 இளைய (iḷaiya) — young, younger

Before the new one: say the Tamil for rich, then the Tamil for poor.

An adjective goes before the noun and does not change: பெரிய வீடு, சிறிய வீடு.

You'll want to know: இளைய

இளைய — *iḷaiya* — "young, younger".

In the family, and next door

	word
Hindi (neighbour)	जवान (*javān*)
English	young, younger

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

இளைய (*iḷaiya*) is native Dravidian. DEDR 513 lists Malayalam *iḷa*, "tender, young".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *iḷaiya*
- *Say it:* *iḷaiya*, once more
- *Say it:* say *iḷaiya*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for rich, then the Tamil for poor, then say *iḷaiya* again

Before you move on

What does இளைய mean? ("Young, younger".) Say it once more.

147.2 வயதான (vayatāṉa) — old (of people)

Before the new one: say the Tamil for poor, then the Tamil for young.

You'll want to know: வயதான

வயதான — *vayatāṉa* — "old (of people)".

In the family, and next door

	word
Kannada	ಹಳೆಯ (*haḷeya*)
Malayalam	പഴയ (*paḻaya*)
English	old

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

வயதான (*vayatāṉa*) is *vayatu*, "age", a Tamil form of Sanskrit *vayas*, "prime of life, age" (CDIAL 11305), with *-āṉa*: "aged".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: vayatāṉa*
- *Say it: vayatāṉa*, once more
- *Say it:* say *vayatāṉa*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for poor, then the Tamil for young, then say *vayatāṉa* again

Before you move on

What does **வயதான** mean? ("Old (of people)".) Say it once more.

147.3 புத்திசாலி (putticāli) — clever; a clever person

Before the new one: say the Tamil for young, then the Tamil for old.

You'll want to know: புத்திசாலி

புத்திசாலி — *putticāli* — "clever; a clever person".

In the family, and next door

	word
Kannada	**ಜಾಣ** (*jāṇa*)
Telugu	**తెలివైన** (*telivaina*)
Malayalam	**ബുദ്ധിയുള്ള** (*buddhiyuḷḷa*)
Hindi (neighbour)	**होशियार** (*hośiyār*)
English	clever

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

புத்திசாலி (*putticāli*) is *putti*, "intelligence", from Sanskrit *buddhi* (CDIAL 9277), with *-cāli*, "one who has", itself from Sanskrit *śālin*, "possessing".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: putticāli*
- *Say it: putticāli*, once more
- *Say it:* say *putticāli*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for young, then the Tamil for old, then say *putticāli* again

Before you move on

What does புத்திசாலி mean? ("Clever; a clever person".) Say it once more.

147.4 சோம்பேறி (cōmpēṟi) — lazy; a lazy person

Before the new one: say the Tamil for old, then the Tamil for clever; a clever person.

You'll want to know: சோம்பேறி

சோம்பேறி — *cōmpēṟi* — "lazy; a lazy person".

In the family, and next door

	word	same root
Kannada	సోమారి (*sōmāri*)	yes
Telugu	సోమరి (*sōmari*)	yes
Malayalam	മടിയുള്ള (*maṭiyuḷḷa*)	
English	lazy	

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

சோம்பேறி (*cōmpēṟi*) is native Dravidian. DEDR 2882 lists Kannada *sōmāri*, "sluggard", and *jompisu*, "to be stupefied". It is built on *cōmpu*, "to be idle, sluggish".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *cōmpēṟi*
- *Say it:* *cōmpēṟi*, once more
- *Say it:* say *cōmpēṟi*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for old, then the Tamil for clever; a clever person, then say *cōmpēṟi* again

Before you move on

What does சோம்பேறி mean? ("Lazy; a lazy person".) Say it once more.

147.5 தைரியமான (tairiyamāṉa) — brave

Before the new one: say the Tamil for clever; a clever person, then the Tamil for lazy; a lazy person.

You'll want to know: தைரியமான

தைரியமான — *tairiyamāṉa* — "brave".

In the family, and next door

	word	same root
Kannada	ಧೈರ್ಯವಂತ (*dhairyavanta*)	yes
Malayalam	ധൈര്യമുള്ള (*dhairyamuḷḷa*)	yes
English	brave	

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

தைரியமான (*tairiyamāṉa*) is *tairiyam*, "courage", a well-established loan from Sanskrit *dhairya*, "steadiness, courage", with *-āṉa*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: tairiyamāṉa*
- *Say it: tairiyamāṉa*, once more
- *Say it:* say *tairiyamāṉa*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for clever; a clever person, then the Tamil for lazy; a lazy person, then say *tairiyamāṉa* again

Before you move on

What does **தைரியமான** mean? (“Brave”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 148

Deep, Wide, Narrow, Dry, Wet

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (7) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 7 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say deep, wide, narrow, dry and wet.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 148: I can say deep, wide, narrow, dry and wet.*

148.1 ஆழமான (āḻamāṉa) — deep

Before the new one: say the Tamil for lazy; a lazy person, then the Tamil for brave.

You'll want to know: ஆழமான

ஆழமான — *āḻamāṉa* — "deep".

In the family, and next door

	word	same root
Kannada	ಆಳ (*āḷa*)	yes
Telugu	లోతు (*lōtu*)	
Malayalam	ആഴമുള്ള (*āḻamuḷḷa*)	yes
Hindi (neighbour)	गहरा (*gahrā*)	
English	deep	

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

ஆழமான (*ā̲lamāṉa*) is native Dravidian. DEDR 396 lists Malayalam *ā̲lam*, "depth". It is *ā̲lam*, "depth", from *ā̲l*, "to sink, to be deep", with *-āṉa*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *ā̲lamāṉa*
- *Say it:* *ā̲lamāṉa*, once more
- *Say it:* say *ā̲lamāṉa*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for lazy; a lazy person, then the Tamil for brave, then say *ā̲lamāṉa* again

Before you move on

What does ஆழமான mean? ("Deep".) Say it once more.

148.2 அகலமான (akalamāṉa) — wide

Before the new one: say the Tamil for brave, then the Tamil for deep.

You'll want to know: அகலமான

அகலமான — *akalamāṉa* — "wide".

In the family, and next door

	word	same root
Kannada	ಅಗಲ (*agala*)	yes
Telugu	వెడల్పు (*veḍalpu*)	
Malayalam	വീതിയുള്ള (*vītiyuḷḷa*)	
Hindi (neighbour)	चौड़ा (*cauṛā*)	
English	wide	

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

அகலமான (*akalamāṉa*) is native Dravidian. DEDR 8 lists Malayalam *akaluka*, "to become extended". It is *akalam*, "width", from *akal*, "to spread, to widen", with *-āṉa*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: akalamāṉa*
- *Say it: akalamāṉa*, once more
- *Say it:* say *akalamāṉa*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for brave, then the Tamil for deep, then say *akalamāṉa* again

Before you move on

What does அகலமான mean? ("Wide".) Say it once more.

148.3 குறுகிய (kuṟukiya) — narrow

Before the new one: say the Tamil for deep, then the Tamil for wide.

You'll want to know: குறுகிய

குறுகிய — *kuṟukiya* — "narrow".

In the family, and next door

	word
Kannada	ಕಿರಿದು (*kiridu*)
Telugu	ఇరుకు (*iruku*)
Malayalam	ഇടുങ്ങിയ (*iṭuṅṅiya*)
English	narrow

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

குறுகிய (*kuṟukiya*) is native Dravidian. DEDR 1851 lists Malayalam *kuṟu*, "short, little". It comes from *kuṟuku*, "to become short, narrow".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: kuṟukiya*
- *Say it: kuṟukiya*, once more
- *Say it:* say *kuṟukiya*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for deep, then the Tamil for wide, then say *kuṟukiya* again

Before you move on

What does குறுகிய mean? ("Narrow".) Say it once more.

148.4 காய்ந்த (kāynta) — dry

Before the new one: say the Tamil for wide, then the Tamil for narrow.

You'll want to know: காய்ந்த

காய்ந்த — *kāynta* — "dry".

In the family, and next door

	word
Kannada	ಒಣ (*oṇa*)
Telugu	పొడి (*poḍi*)
Malayalam	ഉണങ്ങിയ (*uṇaṅṅiya*)
Hindi (neighbour)	सूखा (*sūkhā*)
English	dry

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

காய்ந்த (*kāynta*) is native Dravidian. DEDR 1458 lists Malayalam *kāyuka*, "to grow dry". It comes from *kāy*, "to grow hot, to dry up". The entry compares Sanskrit (lexicons) *kāhala*, "dry".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: kāynta*
- *Say it: kāynta*, once more
- *Say it:* say *kāynta*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for wide, then the Tamil for narrow, then say *kāynta* again

Before you move on

What does காய்ந்த mean? ("Dry".) Say it once more.

148.5 நனைந்த (naṉainta) — wet

Before the new one: say the Tamil for narrow, then the Tamil for dry.

You'll want to know: நனைந்த

நனைந்த — *naṉainta* — "wet".

In the family, and next door

	word	same root
Kannada	ಒದ್ದೆ (*odde*)	
Telugu	తడి (*taḍi*)	
Malayalam	നനവുള്ള (*nanavuḷḷa*)	yes
Hindi (neighbour)	गीला (*gīlā*)	
English	wet	

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

நனைந்த (*naṉainta*) is native Dravidian. DEDR 3630 lists Malayalam *nanayuka*, "to become wet". It comes from *naṉai*, "to become wet".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *naṉainta*
- *Say it:* *naṉainta*, once more
- *Say it:* say *naṉainta*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for narrow, then the Tamil for dry, then say *naṉainta* again

Before you move on

What does நனைந்த mean? ("Wet".) Say it once more.

148.6 Animals and the body — a first pass

Say the words for dry and wet.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- grapes, a pomegranate, a pickle, a waterfall, a hill
- an island, an insect, a spider, a pig, a donkey
- a camel, a duck, a cheek, a wrist, an elbow
- a thumb, bad, beautiful, long, short

Before you move on

Grapes? (திராட்சை, *tirāṭcai.*) A pomegranate? (மாதுளை, *mātuḷai.*) A pickle? (ஊறுகாய், *ūṟukāy.*) A waterfall? (அருவி, *aruvi.*) A hill? (குன்று, *kuṉṟu.*) An island? (தீவு, *tīvu.*) An insect? (பூச்சி, *pūcci.*) A spider? (சிலந்தி, *cilanti.*) A pig? (பன்றி, *paṉṟi.*) A donkey? (கழுதை, *kaḻutai.*) A camel? (ஒட்டகம், *ottakam.*) A duck? (வாத்து, *vāttu.*) A cheek? (கன்னம், *kaṉṉam.*) A wrist? (மணிக்கட்டு, *maṇikkaṭṭu.*) An elbow? (முழங்கை, *muḻaṅkai.*) A thumb? (கட்டைவிரல், *kaṭṭaiviral.*) Bad? (கெட்ட, *keṭṭa.*) Beautiful? (அழகான, *aḻakāṉa.*) Long? (நீளமான, *nīḷamāṉa.*) Short? (குட்டையான, *kuṭṭaiyāṉa.*)

148.7 The body and describing words — a second pass

Say the words for tall and hot.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- tall, hot, cold, heavy, light
- soft, hard, clean, dirty, fast
- bitter, sour, spicy, rich, poor
- young, old, clever; a clever person, lazy; a lazy person, brave
- deep, wide, narrow, dry, wet

Before you move on

Tall? (உயரமான, *uyaramāṉa.*) Hot? (சூடான, *cūṭāṉa.*) Cold? (குளிர்ந்த, *kuḷirnta.*) Heavy? (கனமான, *kaṉamāṉa.*) Light? (லேசான, *lēcāṉa.*) Soft? (மென்மையான, *meṉmaiyāṉa.*) Hard? (கடினமான, *kaṭiṉamāṉa.*) Clean? (சுத்தமான, *cuttamāṉa.*) Dirty? (அழுக்கான, *aḻukkāṉa.*) Fast? (வேகமான, *vēkamāṉa.*) Bitter? (கசப்பு, *kacappu.*) Sour? (புளிப்பு, *puḷippu.*) Spicy?

(காரம், *kāram.*) Rich? (பணக்கார, *paṇakkāra.*) Poor? (ஏழை, *ēḻai.*) Young? (இளைய, *iḷaiya.*) Old? (வயதான, *vayatāṉa.*) Clever; a clever person? (புத்திசாலி, *putticāli.*) Lazy; a lazy person? (சோம்பேறி, *cōmpēṟi.*) Brave? (தைரியமான, *tairiyamāṉa.*) Deep? (ஆழமான, *āḻamāṉa.*) Wide? (அகலமான, *akalamāṉa.*) Narrow? (குறுகிய, *kuṟukiya.*) Dry? (காய்ந்த, *kāynta.*) Wet? (நனைந்த, *naṉainta.*)

Chapter 149

Famous, Dangerous, Safe, True, False

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say famous, dangerous, safe, true and false.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 149: I can say famous, dangerous, safe, true and false.*

149.1 பிரபலமான (pirapalamāṉa) — famous

> Before the new one: say the Tamil for dry, then the Tamil for wet.

You'll want to know: பிரபலமான

பிரபலமான — *pirapalamāṉa* — "famous".

In the family, and next door

	word
Kannada	ಪ್ರಸಿದ್ಧ (*prasiddha*)
Telugu	ప్రసిద్ధ (*prasiddha*)
English	famous

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

பிரபலமான (*pirapalamāṉa*) is a loan from Sanskrit *prabala*, "strong" (CDIAL 8696). Tamil shifted it from "strong" to "widely known", and *-āṉa* makes it a describing word.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: pirapalamāṉa*
- *Say it: pirapalamāṉa*, once more
- *Say it:* say *pirapalamāṉa*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for dry, then the Tamil for wet, then say *pirapalamāṉa* again

Before you move on

What does பிரபலமான mean? ("Famous".) Say it once more.

149.2 ஆபத்தான (āpattāṉa) — dangerous

Before the new one: say the Tamil for wet, then the Tamil for famous.

You'll want to know: ஆபத்தான

ஆபத்தான — *āpattāṉa* — "dangerous".

In the family, and next door

	word
Kannada	ಅಪಾಯಕಾರಿ (*apāyakāri*)
English	dangerous

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

ஆபத்தான (*āpattāṉa*) is a loan from Sanskrit *āpad*, "misfortune" (CDIAL 1196). *Āpattu*, "danger", takes *-āṉa*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *āpattāṉa*
- *Say it:* *āpattāṉa*, once more
- *Say it:* say *āpattāṉa*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for wet, then the Tamil for famous, then say *āpattāṉa* again

Before you move on

What does ஆபத்தான mean? ("Dangerous".) Say it once more.

149.3 பாதுகாப்பான (pātukāppāṉa) — safe

Before the new one: say the Tamil for famous, then the Tamil for dangerous.

You'll want to know: பாதுகாப்பான

பாதுகாப்பான — *pātukāppāṉa* — "safe".

In the family, and next door

	word
Kannada	ಸುರಕ್ಷಿತ (*surakṣita*)
Telugu	సురక్షితం (*surakṣitaṁ*)
English	safe

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

பாதுகாப்பான (*pātukāppāṉa*) ends in native *kāppu*, "protection", from *kā*, "to guard" (DEDR 1416). The first part, *pātu*, is not settled, so the origin of the whole word is uncertain.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *pātukāppāṉa*
- *Say it:* *pātukāppāṉa*, once more
- *Say it:* say *pātukāppāṉa*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for famous, then the Tamil for dangerous, then say *pātukāppāṉa* again

Before you move on

What does பாதுகாப்பான mean? ("Safe".) Say it once more.

149.4 உண்மையான (uṇmaiyāṉa) — true

Before the new one: say the Tamil for dangerous, then the Tamil for safe.

You'll want to know: உண்மையான

உண்மையான — *uṇmaiyāṉa* — "true".

In the family, and next door

	word
Kannada	ನಿಜ (*nija*)
Telugu	నిజం (*nijaṁ*)
Malayalam	സത്യം (*satyaṁ*)
Hindi (neighbour)	सच (*sac*)
English	true

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

உண்மையான (*uṇmaiyāṉa*) is native Dravidian (DEDR 697). It is *uṇmai*, "truth", with *-āṉa*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *uṇmaiyāṉa*
- *Say it:* *uṇmaiyāṉa*, once more
- *Say it:* say *uṇmaiyāṉa*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for dangerous, then the Tamil for safe, then say *uṇmaiyāṉa* again

Before you move on

What does உண்மையான mean? ("True".) Say it once more.

149.5 பொய்யான (poyyāṉa) — false

Before the new one: say the Tamil for safe, then the Tamil for true.

You'll want to know: பொய்யான

பொய்யான — *poyyāṉa* — "false".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

பொய்யான (*poyyāṉa*) is native Dravidian. DEDR 4531 lists Malayalam *poy*, "a lie". It is the native word for "a lie" with *-āṉa*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: poyyāṉa*
- *Say it: poyyāṉa*, once more
- *Say it:* say *poyyāṉa*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for safe, then the Tamil for true, then say *poyyāṉa* again

Before you move on

What does பொய்யான mean? ("False".) Say it once more.

Chapter 150

Purple, Grey, To sing, To cook, To cut

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say purple, grey, to sing, to cook and to cut.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 150: I can say purple, grey, to sing, to cook and to cut.*

150.1 ஊதா (ūtā) — purple

Before the new one: say the Tamil for true, then the Tamil for false.

You'll want to know: ஊதா

ஊதா — *ūtā* — "purple".

In the family, and next door

	word
Kannada	**ನೇರಳೆ** (*nēraḷe*)
English	purple

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

ஊதா (*ūtā*) is a loan from Hindustani *ūdā*, "purple". DEDR has no native entry for it.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *ūtā*
- *Say it:* *ūtā*, once more
- *Say it:* say *ūtā*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for true, then the Tamil for false, then say *ūtā* again

Before you move on

What does ஊதா mean? ("Purple".) Say it once more.

150.2 சாம்பல் (cāmpal) — grey; ash

Before the new one: say the Tamil for false, then the Tamil for purple.

Say the colours: கருப்பு, வெள்ளை, சிவப்பு, நீலம், பச்சை, மஞ்சள். Blue is the one many languages named last.

You'll want to know: சாம்பல்

சாம்பல் — *cāmpal* — "grey; ash".

In the family, and next door

	word
Kannada	ಬೂದು (*būdu*)
Telugu	బూడిద (*būḍida*)
English	grey

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

சாம்பல் (*cāmpal*) is native Dravidian (DEDR 2453). The entry lists *cāmpal*, "ashes, withered flower", under *cāmpu*, "to wither, to grow dim".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *cāmpal*
- *Say it:* *cāmpal*, once more
- *Say it:* say *cāmpal*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for false, then the Tamil for purple, then say *cāmpal* again

Before you move on

What does சாம்பல் mean? ("Grey; ash".) Say it once more.

150.3 பாடு (pāṭu) — to sing

Before the new one: say the Tamil for purple, then the Tamil for grey; ash.

You'll want to know: பாடு

பாடு — *pāṭu* — "to sing".

In the family, and next door

	word	same root
Kannada	ಹಾಡು (*hāḍu*)	yes
Telugu	పాడు (*pāḍu*)	yes
Malayalam	പാടുക (*pāṭuka*)	yes
English	to sing	

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

பாடு (*pāṭu*) is native Dravidian. DEDR 4065 lists Malayalam *pāṭuka*, Kannada *pāḍu* and Telugu *pāḍu*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *pāṭu*
- *Say it:* *pāṭu*, once more
- *Say it:* say *pāṭu*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for purple, then the Tamil for grey; ash, then say *pāṭu* again

Before you move on

What does பாடு mean? ("To sing".) Say it once more.

150.4 சமை (camai) — to cook

Before the new one: say the Tamil for grey; ash, then the Tamil for to sing.

You'll want to know: சமை

சமை — *camai* — "to cook".

In the family, and next door

	word
Telugu	వండు (*vaṇḍu*)
Malayalam	വേവിക്കുക (*vēvikkuka*)
Hindi (neighbour)	पकाना (*pakānā*)
English	to cook

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

சமை (*camai*) is native Dravidian (DEDR 2342). The entry glosses *camai* "to be made, to get ready, to prepare": cooking is preparing.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: camai*
- *Say it: camai*, once more
- *Say it:* say *camai*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for grey; ash, then the Tamil for to sing, then say *camai* again

Before you move on

What does சமை mean? ("To cook".) Say it once more.

150.5 வெட்டு (veṭṭu) — to cut

Before the new one: say the Tamil for to sing, then the Tamil for to cook.

You'll want to know: வெட்டு

வெட்டு — *veṭṭu* — "to cut".

In the family, and next door

	word
Kannada	ಕತ್ತರಿಸು (*kattarisu*)
Telugu	కోయు (*kōyu*)
Hindi (neighbour)	काटना (*kāṭnā*)
English	to cut

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

வெட்டு (*veṭṭu*) is native Dravidian. DEDR 5478 lists Malayalam *veṭṭuka* and Kannada *beṭṭu*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: veṭṭu*
- *Say it: veṭṭu*, once more
- *Say it:* say *veṭṭu*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for to sing, then the Tamil for to cook, then say *veṭṭu* again

Before you move on

What does வெட்டு mean? ("To cut".) Say it once more.

Chapter 151

To break, To put, To send, To look for, To teach

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say to break, to put, to send, to look for and to teach.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 151: I can say to break, to put, to send, to look for and to teach.*

151.1 உடை (uṭai) — to break

> Before the new one: say the Tamil for to cook, then the Tamil for to cut.

You'll want to know: உடை

உடை — *uṭai* — "to break".

In the family, and next door

	word
Kannada	ಒಡೆ (*oḍe*)
Telugu	పగలగొట్టు (*pagalagoṭṭu*)
Hindi (neighbour)	तोड़ना (*toṛnā*)
English	to break

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

உடை (*uṭai*) is native Dravidian. DEDR 946 lists Malayalam *oṭiyuka*, "to break". The entry lists *uṭai*, "to break as a pot, to crack", beside *oṭi*, "to break".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: uṭai*
- *Say it: uṭai*, once more
- *Say it:* say *uṭai*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for to cook, then the Tamil for to cut, then say *uṭai* again

Before you move on

What does உடை mean? ("To break".) Say it once more.

151.2 வை (vai) — to put, to keep

Before the new one: say the Tamil for to cut, then the Tamil for to break.

You'll want to know: வை

வை — *vai* — "to put, to keep".

In the family, and next door

	word
Hindi (neighbour)	रखना (*rakhnā*)
English	to put, to keep

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

வை (*vai*) is native Dravidian. DEDR 5549 lists Kannada *bay*, "to deposit, put aside".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: vai*
- *Say it: vai*, once more
- *Say it:* say *vai*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for to cut, then the Tamil for to break, then say *vai* again

Before you move on

What does வை mean? ("To put, to keep".) Say it once more.

151.3 அனுப்பு (anuppu) — to send

Before the new one: say the Tamil for to break, then the Tamil for to put.

You'll want to know: அனுப்பு

அனுப்பு — *anuppu* — "to send".

In the family, and next door

	word
Kannada	ಕಳಿಸು (*kaḷisu*)
Telugu	పంపు (*pampu*)
Malayalam	അയയ്ക്കുക (*ayaykkuka*)
Hindi (neighbour)	भेजना (*bhejnā*)
English	to send

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

அனுப்பு (*anuppu*) is native Dravidian. DEDR 329 lists Malayalam *anuppuka*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *anuppu*
- *Say it:* *anuppu*, once more
- *Say it:* say *anuppu*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for to break, then the Tamil for to put, then say *anuppu* again

Before you move on

What does அனுப்பு mean? ("To send".) Say it once more.

151.4 தேடு (tēṭu) — to look for

Before the new one: say the Tamil for to put, then the Tamil for to send.

You'll want to know: தேடு

தேடு — *tēṭu* — "to look for".

In the family, and next door

	word
Kannada	ಹುಡುಕು (*huḍuku*)
Telugu	వెతుకు (*vetuku*)
Hindi (neighbour)	ढूँढना (*ḍhū̃ḍhnā*)
English	to look for

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

தேடு (*tēṭu*) is native Dravidian. DEDR 3456 lists Malayalam *tēṭuka*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: tēṭu*
- *Say it: tēṭu*, once more
- *Say it:* say *tēṭu*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for to put, then the Tamil for to send, then say *tēṭu* again

Before you move on

What does தேடு mean? ("To look for".) Say it once more.

151.5 கற்பி (kaṟpi) — to teach

Before the new one: say the Tamil for to send, then the Tamil for to look for.

Read it: அப்பா அங்கே. அம்மா இங்கே. இது என் வீடு. aloud as one run

You'll want to know: கற்பி

கற்பி — *kaṟpi* — "to teach".

In the family, and next door

	word
Kannada	ಕಲಿಸು (*kalisu*)
Telugu	నేర్పు (*nērpu*)
Malayalam	പഠിപ്പിക്കുക (*paṭhippikkuka*)
Hindi (neighbour)	सिखाना (*sikhānā*)
English	to teach

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

கற்பி (*kaṟpi*) is native Dravidian. DEDR 1297 lists Malayalam *kalkka*, "to learn". It is the causative of *kal*, "to learn": to teach is "to make learn".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: kaṟpi*
- *Say it: kaṟpi*, once more
- *Say it:* say *kaṟpi*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for to send, then the Tamil for to look for, then say *kaṟpi* again

Before you move on

What does கற்பி mean? ("To teach".) Say it once more.

Chapter 152

To forget, To jump, To swim, To fly, To fall

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say to forget, to jump, to swim, to fly and to fall.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 152: I can say to forget, to jump, to swim, to fly and to fall.*

152.1 മറ (maṟa) — to forget

> Before the new one: say the Tamil for to look for, then the Tamil for to teach.

You'll want to know: മറ

മറ — *maṟa* — "to forget".

In the family, and next door

	word	same root
Telugu	మరచిపో (*maracipō*)	yes
Malayalam	മറക്കുക (*maṟakkuka*)	yes
Hindi (neighbour)	भूलना (*bhūlnā*)	
English	to forget	

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

മറ (*maṟa*) is native Dravidian. DEDR 4760 lists Kannada *maṟe*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *maṟa*
- *Say it:* *maṟa*, once more
- *Say it:* say *maṟa*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for to look for, then the Tamil for to teach, then say *maṟa* again

Before you move on

What does மற mean? ("To forget".) Say it once more.

152.2 குதி (kuti) — to jump

Before the new one: say the Tamil for to teach, then the Tamil for to forget.

You'll want to know: குதி

குதி — *kuti* — "to jump".

In the family, and next door

	word
Kannada	ಜಿಗಿ (*jigi*)
Telugu	దూకు (*dūku*)
Malayalam	ചാടുക (*cāṭuka*)
English	to jump

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

குதி (*kuti*) is native Dravidian. DEDR 1705 lists Malayalam *kuti*, "leap" and Kannada *gudi*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: kuti*
- *Say it: kuti*, once more
- *Say it:* say *kuti*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for to teach, then the Tamil for to forget, then say *kuti* again

Before you move on

What does குதி mean? ("To jump".) Say it once more.

152.3 நீந்து (nīntu) — to swim

Before the new one: say the Tamil for to forget, then the Tamil for to jump.

You'll want to know: நீந்து

நீந்து — *nīntu* — "to swim".

In the family, and next door

	word	same root
Malayalam	നീന്തുക (*nīntuka*)	yes
Hindi (neighbour)	तैरना (*tairnā*)	
English	to swim	

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

நீந்து (*nīntu*) is native Dravidian. DEDR 3687 lists Malayalam *nīntuka*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *nīntu*
- *Say it:* *nīntu*, once more
- *Say it:* say *nīntu*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for to forget, then the Tamil for to jump, then say *nīntu* again

Before you move on

What does நீந்து mean? ("To swim".) Say it once more.

152.4 பற (para) — to fly

Before the new one: say the Tamil for to jump, then the Tamil for to swim.

You'll want to know: பற

பற — *para* — "to fly".

In the family, and next door

	word
Telugu	ఎగురు (*egiru*)
Hindi (neighbour)	उड़ना (*uṛnā*)
English	to fly

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

பற (*para*) is native Dravidian. DEDR 4020 lists Malayalam *parakka*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *para*
- *Say it:* *para*, once more

- *Say it:* say *paṟa*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for to jump, then the Tamil for to swim, then say *paṟa* again

Before you move on

What does பற mean? ("To fly".) Say it once more.

152.5 விழு (viḻu) — to fall

Before the new one: say the Tamil for to swim, then the Tamil for to fly.

You'll want to know: விழு

விழு — *viḻu* — "to fall".

In the family, and next door

	word	same root
Malayalam	വീഴുക (*vīḻuka*)	yes
Hindi (neighbour)	गिरना (*girnā*)	
English	to fall	

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

விழு (*viḻu*) is native Dravidian. DEDR 5430 lists Malayalam *vīḻuka*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: viḻu*
- *Say it: viḻu*, once more
- *Say it:* say *viḻu*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for to swim, then the Tamil for to fly, then say *viḻu* again

Before you move on

What does விழு mean? ("To fall".) Say it once more.

Chapter 153

To climb, To get down, To turn, To join, To bathe

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say to climb, to get down, to turn, to join and to bathe.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 153: I can say to climb, to get down, to turn, to join and to bathe.*

153.1 ஏறு (ēṟu) — to climb, to get on

Before the new one: say the Tamil for to fly, then the Tamil for to fall.

You'll want to know: ஏறு

ஏறு — *ēṟu* — "to climb, to get on".

In the family, and next door

	word
Malayalam	കയറുക (*kayaṟuka*)
English	to climb, to get on

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

ஏறு (*ēṟu*) is native Dravidian. DEDR 916 lists Malayalam *ēṟuka* and Kannada *ēṟu*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *ēṟu*
- *Say it:* *ēṟu*, once more
- *Say it:* say *ēṟu*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for to fly, then the Tamil for to fall, then say *ēṟu* again

Before you move on

What does ஏறு mean? ("To climb, to get on".) Say it once more.

153.2 இறங்கு (iṟaṅku) — to get down, to get off

Before the new one: say the Tamil for to fall, then the Tamil for to climb.

You'll want to know: இறங்கு

இறங்கு — *iṟaṅku* — "to get down, to get off".

In the family, and next door

	word	same root
Kannada	ಇಳಿ (*iḷi*)	
Telugu	దిగు (*digu*)	
Malayalam	ഇറങ്ങുക (*iṟaṅṅuka*)	yes
English	to get down, to get off	

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

இறங்கு (*iṟaṅku*) is native Dravidian. DEDR 516 lists Malayalam *iṟaṅṅuka*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: iṟaṅku*
- *Say it: iṟaṅku*, once more
- *Say it:* say *iṟaṅku*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for to fall, then the Tamil for to climb, then say *iṟaṅku* again

Before you move on

What does இறங்கு mean? ("To get down, to get off".) Say it once more.

153.3 திரும்பு (tirumpu) — to turn, to return

Before the new one: say the Tamil for to climb, then the Tamil for to get down.

Say வா, then build on *varu-*: வருகிறேன். Then பார் and கேள்.

You'll want to know: திரும்பு

திரும்பு — *tirumpu* — "to turn, to return".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

திரும்பு (*tirumpu*) is native Dravidian. DEDR 3246 lists Kannada *tiri*, "to turn round". The entry lists *tirumpu*, "to turn, to return", with *tiri*, "to turn".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *tirumpu*
- *Say it:* *tirumpu*, once more
- *Say it:* say *tirumpu*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for to climb, then the Tamil for to get down, then say *tirumpu* again

Before you move on

What does திரும்பு mean? ("To turn, to return".) Say it once more.

153.4 சேர் (cēr) — to join, to reach

Before the new one: say the Tamil for to get down, then the Tamil for to turn.

You'll want to know: சேர்

சேர் — *cēr* — "to join, to reach".

In the family, and next door

	word	same root
Kannada	ಸೇರು (*sēru*)	yes
English	to join, to reach	

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

சேர் (*cēr*) is native Dravidian. DEDR 2814 lists Malayalam *cēruka*, "to join, to come close".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *cēr*
- *Say it:* *cēr*, once more

- *Say it:* say *cēr*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for to get down, then the Tamil for to turn, then say *cēr* again

Before you move on

What does சேர் mean? ("To join, to reach".) Say it once more.

153.5 குளி (kuḷi) — to bathe

Before the new one: say the Tamil for to turn, then the Tamil for to join.

You'll want to know: குளி

குளி — *kuḷi* — "to bathe".

In the family, and next door

	word	same root
Malayalam	കുളിക്കുക (*kuḷikkuka*)	yes
Hindi (neighbour)	नहाना (*nahānā*)	
English	to bathe	

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

குளி (*kuḷi*) is native Dravidian. DEDR 1832 lists Malayalam *kuḷikka*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: kuḷi*
- *Say it: kuḷi*, once more
- *Say it:* say *kuḷi*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for to turn, then the Tamil for to join, then say *kuḷi* again

Before you move on

What does குளி mean? (“To bathe”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 154

To wear, To call, To grow, To count, To shout

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say to wear, to call, to grow, to count and to shout.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 154: I can say to wear, to call, to grow, to count and to shout.*

154.1 அணி (aṇi) — to wear

Before the new one: say the Tamil for to join, then the Tamil for to bathe.

You'll want to know: அணி

அணி — *aṇi* — "to wear".

In the family, and next door

	word
Kannada	ತೊಡು (*toḍu*)
Hindi (neighbour)	पहनना (*pahannā*)
English	to wear

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

அணி (*aṇi*) is native Dravidian. DEDR 116 lists Malayalam *aṇiyuka*, "to wear (jewels)".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: aṇi*
- *Say it: aṇi*, once more
- *Say it:* say *aṇi*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for to join, then the Tamil for to bathe, then say *aṇi* again

Before you move on

What does அணி mean? ("To wear".) Say it once more.

154.2 அழை (a̲lai) — to call, to invite

Before the new one: say the Tamil for to bathe, then the Tamil for to wear.

You'll want to know: அழை

அழை — *a̲lai* — "to call, to invite".

In the family, and next door

	word
Kannada	ಕರೆ (*kare*)
Telugu	పిలుచు (*pilucu*)
Malayalam	വിളിക്കുക (*viḷikkuka*)
Hindi (neighbour)	बुलाना (*bulānā*)
English	to call, to invite

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

அழை (*a̲lai*) is native Dravidian (DEDR 282). The entry lists *a̲lai*, "to call", beside *a̲lu*, "to cry".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: a̲lai*
- *Say it: a̲lai*, once more
- *Say it:* say *a̲lai*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for to bathe, then the Tamil for to wear, then say *a̲lai* again

Before you move on

What does அழை mean? ("To call, to invite".) Say it once more.

154.3 வளர் (vaḷar) — to grow

Before the new one: say the Tamil for to wear, then the Tamil for to call.

You'll want to know: வளர்

வளர் — *vaḷar* — "to grow".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

வளர் (*vaḷar*) is native Dravidian. DEDR 5304 lists Malayalam *vaḷaruka*, "to grow".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: vaḷar*
- *Say it: vaḷar*, once more

- *Say it:* say *vaḻar*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for to wear, then the Tamil for to call, then say *vaḻar* again

Before you move on

What does வளர் mean? ("To grow".) Say it once more.

154.4 எண்ணு (eṇṇu) — to count

Before the new one: say the Tamil for to call, then the Tamil for to grow.

Count with care: *oṉṟu*, *mūṉṟu*, with the hard *ṉṟ*; *onpatu*, one short of *pattu*; then பதினொன்று to இருபது, two tens.

You'll want to know: எண்ணு

எண்ணு — *eṇṇu* — "to count".

In the family, and next door

	word	same root
Kannada	ಎಣಿಸು (*eṇisu*)	yes
Telugu	లెక్కపెట్టు (*lekkapeṭṭu*)	
Hindi (neighbour)	गिनना (*ginnā*)	
English	to count	

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

எண்ணு (*eṇṇu*) is native Dravidian. DEDR 793 lists Malayalam *eṇṇuka*, "to count".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: eṇṇu*
- *Say it: eṇṇu*, once more

- *Say it:* say *eṇṇu*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for to call, then the Tamil for to grow, then say *eṇṇu* again

Before you move on

What does **எண்ணு** mean? (“To count”.) Say it once more.

154.5 கத்து (kattu) — to shout

Before the new one: say the Tamil for to grow, then the Tamil for to count.

You’ll want to know: கத்து

கத்து — *kattu* — “to shout”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

கத்து (*kattu*) is native Dravidian. DEDR 1206 lists Kannada *kattu*, “to cry, croak”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: kattu*
- *Say it: kattu*, once more
- *Say it:* say *kattu*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for to grow, then the Tamil for to count, then say *kattu* again

Before you move on

What does **கத்து** mean? (“To shout”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 155

To push, To pull, To put, To tie, To wash

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say to push, to pull, to put, to tie and to wash.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 155: I can say to push, to pull, to put, to tie and to wash.*

155.1 தள்ளு (taḷḷu) — to push

Before the new one: say the Tamil for to count, then the Tamil for to shout.

You'll want to know: தள்ளு

தள்ளு — *taḷḷu* — "to push".

In the family, and next door

	word	same root
Kannada	ತಳ್ಳು (*taḷḷu*)	yes
English	to push	

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

தள்ளு (*taḷḷu*) is native Dravidian. DEDR 3135 lists Malayalam *taḷḷuka* and Kannada *taḷḷu*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: taḷḷu*
- *Say it: taḷḷu*, once more
- *Say it:* say *taḷḷu*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for to count, then the Tamil for to shout, then say *taḷḷu* again

Before you move on

What does தள்ளு mean? ("To push".) Say it once more.

155.2 இழு (iḻu) — to pull

Before the new one: say the Tamil for to shout, then the Tamil for to push.

You'll want to know: இழு

இழு — *iḻu* — "to pull".

In the family, and next door

	word	same root
Kannada	ಎಳೆ (*eḷe*)	yes
English	to pull	

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

இழு (*iḻu*) is native Dravidian. DEDR 504 lists Malayalam *iḻukka*, "to draw".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: i̲lu*
- *Say it: i̲lu*, once more
- *Say it:* say *i̲lu*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for to shout, then the Tamil for to push, then say *i̲lu* again

Before you move on

What does இழு mean? ("To pull".) Say it once more.

155.3 போடு (pōṭu) — to put, to drop

Before the new one: say the Tamil for to push, then the Tamil for to pull.

You'll want to know: போடு

போடு — *pōṭu* — "to put, to drop".

In the family, and next door

	word
Hindi (neighbour)	रखना (*rakhnā*)
English	to put, to drop

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

போடு (*pōṭu*) is native Dravidian. DEDR 4581 lists Malayalam *pōṭuka*, "to strike, to put".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: pōṭu*
- *Say it: pōṭu*, once more

- *Say it:* say *pōṭu*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for to push, then the Tamil for to pull, then say *pōṭu* again

Before you move on

What does போடு mean? ("To put, to drop".) Say it once more.

155.4 கட்டு (kaṭṭu) — to tie, to build

Before the new one: say the Tamil for to pull, then the Tamil for to put.

You'll want to know: கட்டு

கட்டு — *kaṭṭu* — "to tie, to build".

In the family, and next door

	word	same root
Kannada	ಕಟ್ಟು (*kaṭṭu*)	yes
Telugu	కట్టు (*kaṭṭu*)	yes
English	to tie, to build	

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

கட்டு (*kaṭṭu*) is native Dravidian. DEDR 1147 lists Kannada *kaṭṭu*, "to bind, to build".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: kaṭṭu*
- *Say it: kaṭṭu*, once more
- *Say it:* say *kaṭṭu*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for to pull, then the Tamil for to put, then say *kaṭṭu* again

Before you move on

What does கட்டு mean? ("To tie, to build".) Say it once more.

155.5 துவை (tuvai) — to wash (clothes)

Before the new one: say the Tamil for to put, then the Tamil for to tie.

You'll want to know: துவை

துவை — *tuvai* — "to wash (clothes)".

In the family, and next door

	word
Kannada	ತೊಳೆ (*toḷe*)
Telugu	కడుగు (*kaḍugu*)
Malayalam	കഴുകുക (*kaḻukuka*)
Hindi (neighbour)	धोना (*dhonā*)
English	to wash

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

துவை (*tuvai*) is native Dravidian. DEDR 3355 lists Malayalam *tuvekka*, "to steep, soak".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: tuvai*
- *Say it: tuvai*, once more
- *Say it:* say *tuvai*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for to put, then the Tamil for to tie, then say *tuvai* again

Before you move on

What does **துவை** mean? (“To wash (clothes)”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 156

To wipe, To sweep, To learn, To win, To find

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say to wipe, to sweep, to learn, to win and to find.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 156: I can say to wipe, to sweep, to learn, to win and to find.*

156.1 துடை (tuṭai) — to wipe

> Before the new one: say the Tamil for to tie, then the Tamil for to wash.

You'll want to know: துடை

துடை — *tuṭai* — "to wipe".

In the family, and next door

	word
Kannada	ಒರೆಸು (*oresu*)
Telugu	తుడుచు (*tuḍucu*)
English	to wipe

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

துடை (*tuṭai*) is native Dravidian. DEDR 3301 lists Malayalam *tuṭekka*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: tuṭai*
- *Say it: tuṭai*, once more
- *Say it:* say *tuṭai*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for to tie, then the Tamil for to wash, then say *tuṭai* again

Before you move on

What does துடை mean? ("To wipe".) Say it once more.

156.2 பெருக்கு (perukku) — to sweep

Before the new one: say the Tamil for to wash, then the Tamil for to wipe.

You'll want to know: பெருக்கு

பெருக்கு — *perukku* — "to sweep".

In the family, and next door

	word
Kannada	ಗುಡಿಸು (*guḍisu*)
English	to sweep

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

பெருக்கு (*perukku*) is native Dravidian. DEDR 4415 lists Malayalam *perukkuka*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *perukku*
- *Say it:* *perukku*, once more
- *Say it:* say *perukku*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for to wash, then the Tamil for to wipe, then say *perukku* again

Before you move on

What does பெருக்கு mean? ("To sweep".) Say it once more.

156.3 கற்றுக்கொள் (kaṟṟukkoḷ) — to learn

Before the new one: say the Tamil for to wipe, then the Tamil for to sweep.

Say தமிழ், curling the tongue back for ழ, then எழுது.

You'll want to know: கற்றுக்கொள்

கற்றுக்கொள் — *kaṟṟukkoḷ* — "to learn".

In the family, and next door

	word	same root
Kannada	ಕಲಿ (*kali*)	yes
Telugu	నేర్చుకో (*nērcukō*)	
Hindi (neighbour)	सीखना (*sīkhnā*)	
English	to learn	

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

கற்றுக்கொள் (*kaṟṟukkoḷ*) is native: *kaṟṟu*, "having learned", from *kal*, "to learn" (DEDR 1297), and *koḷ*, "to take" (DEDR 2151): "learn and take for oneself".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *kaṟṟukkoḷ*
- *Say it:* *kaṟṟukkoḷ*, once more
- *Say it:* say *kaṟṟukkoḷ*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for to wipe, then the Tamil for to sweep, then say *kaṟṟukkoḷ* again

Before you move on

What does கற்றுக்கொள் mean? ("To learn".) Say it once more.

156.4 வெல் (vel) — to win

Before the new one: say the Tamil for to sweep, then the Tamil for to learn.

You'll want to know: வெல்

வெல் — *vel* — "to win".

In the family, and next door

	word	same root
Kannada	ಗೆಲ್ಲು (*gellu*)	yes
Telugu	గెలుచు (*gelucu*)	yes
Hindi (neighbour)	जीतना (*jītnā*)	
English	to win	

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

வெல் (*vel*) is native Dravidian. DEDR 5493 lists Malayalam *velluka*, "to overcome".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: vel*
- *Say it: vel*, once more
- *Say it:* say *vel*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for to sweep, then the Tamil for to learn, then say *vel* again

Before you move on

What does **வெல்** mean? ("To win".) Say it once more.

156.5 கண்டுபிடி (kaṇṭupiṭi) — to find

Before the new one: say the Tamil for to learn, then the Tamil for to win.

You'll want to know: கண்டுபிடி

கண்டுபிடி — *kaṇṭupiṭi* — "to find".

In the family, and next door

	word	same root
Malayalam	കണ്ടെത്തുക (*kaṇṭettuka*)	yes
English	to find	

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

கண்டுபிடி (*kaṇṭupiṭi*) is native: *kaṇṭu*, "having seen", from *kāṇ*, "to see" (DEDR 1443), and *piṭi*, "to catch" (DEDR 4148): "see and catch".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: kaṇṭupiṭi*

- *Say it: kaṇṭupiṭi*, once more
- *Say it:* say *kaṇṭupiṭi*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for to learn, then the Tamil for to win, then say *kaṇṭupiṭi* again

Before you move on

What does **கண்டுபிடி** mean? (“To find”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 157

To hide, To save, To blow, To burn, To put out

Modes: **voice** (7) **Hands-free start:** all 7 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say to hide, to save, to blow, to burn and to put out.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 157: I can say to hide, to save, to blow, to burn and to put out.

157.1 மறை (ma̲rai) — to hide

Before the new one: say the Tamil for to win, then the Tamil for to find.

You'll want to know: மறை

மறை — *ma̲rai* — "to hide".

In the family, and next door

	word
Kannada	ಬಚ್ಚಿಡು (*bacciḍu*)
Telugu	దాచు (*dācu*)
English	to hide

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

மறை (*maṟai*) is native Dravidian. DEDR 4760 lists Kannada *maṟe*, "to vanish from sight". The entry lists *maṟai*, "to be hidden, to hide", beside *maṟa*, "to forget".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: maṟai*
- *Say it: maṟai*, once more
- *Say it:* say *maṟai*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for to win, then the Tamil for to find, then say *maṟai* again

Before you move on

What does மறை mean? ("To hide".) Say it once more.

157.2 காப்பாற்று (kāppāṟṟu) — to save, to rescue

Before the new one: say the Tamil for to find, then the Tamil for to hide.

You'll want to know: காப்பாற்று

காப்பாற்று — *kāppāṟṟu* — "to save, to rescue".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

காப்பாற்று (*kāppāṟṟu*) is native Dravidian. DEDR 1416 lists Malayalam *kākkuka*, "to keep, defend". The entry lists *kāppāṟṟu*, "to guard, to protect, to save", under *kā*, "to guard".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: kāppāṟṟu*
- *Say it: kāppāṟṟu*, once more
- *Say it:* say *kāppāṟṟu*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for to find, then the Tamil for to hide, then say *kāppāṟṟu* again

Before you move on

What does காப்பாற்று mean? ("To save, to rescue".) Say it once more.

157.3 ஊது (ūtu) — to blow

Before the new one: say the Tamil for to hide, then the Tamil for to save.

You'll want to know: ஊது

ஊது — *ūtu* — "to blow".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

ஊது (*ūtu*) is native Dravidian. DEDR 741 lists Malayalam *ūtuka*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: ūtu*
- *Say it: ūtu*, once more

- *Say it:* say *ūtu*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for to hide, then the Tamil for to save, then say *ūtu* again

Before you move on

What does ஊது mean? ("To blow".) Say it once more.

157.4 எரி (eri) — to burn

Before the new one: say the Tamil for to save, then the Tamil for to blow.

You'll want to know: எரி

எரி — *eri* — "to burn".

In the family, and next door

	word
Kannada	ಸುಡು (*suḍu*)
Telugu	కాల్చు (*kālcu*)
English	to burn

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

எரி (*eri*) is native Dravidian. DEDR 811 lists Malayalam *eriyuka*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: eri*
- *Say it: eri*, once more
- *Say it:* say *eri*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for to save, then the Tamil for to blow, then say *eri* again

Before you move on

What does எரி mean? ("To burn".) Say it once more.

157.5 அணை (aṇai) — to put out; to hug

Before the new one: say the Tamil for to blow, then the Tamil for to burn.

You'll want to know: அணை

அணை — *aṇai* — "to put out; to hug".

In the family, and next door

	word
Kannada	ಆರಿಸು (*ārisu*)
Telugu	ఆర్పు (*ārpu*)
English	to put out

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

அணை (*aṇai*) is native Dravidian. DEDR 121 lists Malayalam *aṇaykkuka*, "to put out". The "hug" sense belongs to a separate entry, *aṇai*, "to approach, to embrace" (DEDR 120).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: aṇai*
- *Say it: aṇai*, once more
- *Say it:* say *aṇai*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for to blow, then the Tamil for to burn, then say *aṇai* again

Before you move on

What does அணை mean? ("To put out; to hug".) Say it once more.

157.6 Describing words — a first pass

Say the words for to burn and to put out; to hug.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- famous, dangerous, safe, true, false
- purple, grey; ash, to sing, to cook, to cut
- to break, to put, to send, to look for, to teach
- to forget, to jump, to swim, to fly, to fall

Before you move on

Famous? (பிரபலமான, *pirapalamāṉa.*) Dangerous? (ஆபத்தான, *āpattāṉa.*) Safe? (பாதுகாப்பான, *pātukāppāṉa.*) True? (உண்மையான, *uṇmaiyāṉa.*) False? (பொய்யான, *poyyāṉa.*) Purple? (ஊதா, *ūtā.*) Grey; ash? (சாம்பல், *cāmpal.*) To sing? (பாடு, *pāṭu.*) To cook? (சமை, *camai.*) To cut? (வெட்டு, *veṭṭu.*) To break? (உடை, *uṭai.*) To put? (வை, *vai.*) To send? (அனுப்பு, *anuppu.*) To look for? (தேடு, *tēṭu.*) To teach? (கற்பி, *kaṟpi.*) To forget? (மற, *maṟa.*) To jump? (குதி, *kuti.*) To swim? (நீந்து, *nīntu.*) To fly? (பற, *paṟa.*) To fall? (விழு, *viḻu.*)

157.7 Verbs — a second pass

Say the words for to climb and to get down.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- to climb, to get down, to turn, to join, to bathe
- to wear, to call, to grow, to count, to shout
- to push, to pull, to put, to tie, to wash
- to wipe, to sweep, to learn, to win, to find
- to hide, to save, to blow, to burn, to put out; to hug

Before you move on

To climb? (ஏறு, *ēṟu.*) To get down? (இறங்கு, *iṟaṅku.*) To turn? (திரும்பு, *tirumpu.*) To join? (சேர், *cēr.*) To bathe? (குளி, *kuḷi.*) To wear? (அணி, *aṇi.*) To call? (அழை, *aḻai.*) To grow? (வளர், *vaḷar.*) To count? (எண்ணு, *eṇṇu.*) To shout? (கத்து, *kattu.*) To push? (தள்ளு, *taḷḷu.*) To pull? (இழு, *iḻu.*) To put? (போடு, *pōṭu.*) To tie? (கட்டு, *kaṭṭu.*) To wash? (துவை, *tuvai.*) To wipe? (துடை, *tuṭai.*) To sweep? (பெருக்கு, *perukku.*) To learn? (கற்றுக்கொள், *kaṟṟukkoḷ.*) To win? (வெல், *vel.*) To find? (கண்டுபிடி, *kaṇṭupiṭi.*) To hide? (மறை, *maṟai.*) To save? (காப்பாற்று, *kāppāṟṟu.*) To blow? (ஊது, *ūtu.*) To burn? (எரி, *eri.*) To put out; to hug? (அணை, *aṇai.*)

Chapter 158

Recently, Already, Last, Once, To Spend (Time)

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say what happened, and when: recently, already, last week.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 158: I can say what happened, and when: recently, already, last week.*

158.1 சமீபத்தில் (camīpattil) — recently

Before the new one: say the Tamil for to burn, then the Tamil for to put out.

You'll want to know: சமீபத்தில்

சமீபத்தில் — *camīpattil* — "recently". Tamil's past for "I" ends in **-ஏன்** after a past stem: **நான் சமீபத்தில் ஒரு புத்தகம் படித்தேன்** — *nāṉ camīpattil oru puttakam paṭittēṉ* — "I recently read a book."

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

சமீபத்தில் (*camīpattil*) is a loan from Sanskrit *samīpa*, "near" (CDIAL 13226). *Camīpam*, "nearness", takes the locative *-il*: "in the near (past)".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: camīpattil*
- *Say it: camīpattil*, once more
- *Say it:* say *camīpattil*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for to burn, then the Tamil for to put out, then say *camīpattil* again

Before you move on

What does **சமீபத்தில்** mean? ("Recently".) Say it once more.

158.2 ஏற்கனவே (ēṟkaṉavē) — already

Before the new one: say the Tamil for to put out, then the Tamil for recently.

You'll want to know: ஏற்கனவே

ஏற்கனவே — *ēṟkaṉavē* — "already". **நான் ஏற்கனவே சாப்பிட்டேன்** — *nāṉ ēṟkaṉavē cāppiṭṭēṉ* — "I have already eaten."

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

The origin of **ஏற்கனவே** (*ēṟkaṉavē*) is uncertain. It may contain *ēṟka*, a form of *ēl*, "to happen, to be fitting" (DEDR 905), but DEDR does not list the word itself.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *ēṟkaṉavē*
- *Say it:* *ēṟkaṉavē*, once more
- *Say it:* say *ēṟkaṉavē*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for to put out, then the Tamil for recently, then say *ēṟkaṉavē* again

Before you move on

What does ஏற்கனவே mean? (“Already”.) Say it once more.

158.3 போன (pōṉa) — last, previous

Before the new one: say the Tamil for recently, then the Tamil for already.

You’ll want to know: போன

போன — *pōṉa* — “last, previous”. It is the past form of போ, “to go”, used before a noun: போன வாரம் — *pōṉa vāram* — “last week”; போன வருடம் — *pōṉa varuṭam* — “last year”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

போன (*pōṉa*) is native Dravidian (DEDR 4572). It is the past of *pō*, “to go”: “the one that has gone”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *pōṉa*
- *Say it:* *pōṉa*, once more
- *Say it:* say *pōṉa*

- *Recall:* say the Tamil for recently, then the Tamil for already, then say *pōṉa* again

Before you move on

What does போன mean? ("Last, previous".) Say it once more.

158.4 ஒரு காலத்தில் (oru kālattil) — once, at one time

Before the new one: say the Tamil for already, then the Tamil for last.

You'll want to know: ஒரு காலத்தில்

ஒரு காலத்தில் — *oru kālattil* — "once, at one time". It points far back: ஒரு காலத்தில் இங்கே ஒரு குளம் இருந்தது — *oru kālattil iṅkē oru kuḷam iruntatu* — "There was once a pond here." இருந்தது is the past of இரு.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

ஒரு காலத்தில் (*oru kālattil*) is native *oru*, "one" (DEDR 990), and *kālam*, "time", from Sanskrit *kāla* (CDIAL 3084), with the locative *-il*: "at one time".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: oru kālattil*
- *Say it: oru kālattil*, once more
- *Say it:* say *oru kālattil*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for already, then the Tamil for last, then say *oru kālattil* again

Before you move on

What does **ஒரு காலத்தில்** mean? ("Once, at one time".) Say it once more.

158.5 கழி (kaḻi) — to spend (time)

Before the new one: say the Tamil for last, then the Tamil for once.

You'll want to know: கழி

கழி — *kaḻi* — "to spend (time)". Said of time: **விடுமுறையைக் கிராமத்தில் கழித்தேன்** — *viṭumuṟaiyaik kirāmattil kaḻittēṉ* — "I spent the holiday in the village."

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

கழி (*kaḻi*) is native Dravidian. DEDR 1356 lists Malayalam *kaḻiyuka*, "to pass, be spent".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: kaḻi*
- *Say it: kaḻi*, once more
- *Say it:* say *kaḻi*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for last, then the Tamil for once, then say *kaḻi* again

Before you move on

What does **கழி** mean? ("To spend (time)".) Say it once more.

Chapter 159

Next, From Now On, a Plan, To Decide, To Expect

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say what will happen, and when: next week, from now on, and what I plan.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 159: I can say what will happen, and when: next week, from now on, and what I plan.*

159.1 அடுத்த (aṭutta) — next, coming

> Before the new one: say the Tamil for once, then the Tamil for to spend.

You'll want to know: அடுத்த

அடுத்த — *aṭutta* — "next, coming". Tamil's future for "I" ends in **-வேன்** or **-ப்பேன்**: அடுத்த வாரம் நான் போவேன் — *aṭutta vāram nāṉ pōvēṉ* — "I will go next week."

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

அடுத்த (*aṭutta*) is native Dravidian. DEDR 79 lists Malayalam *aṭukka*, "to approach". It comes from *aṭu*, "to be next, near".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *aṭutta*
- *Say it:* *aṭutta*, once more
- *Say it:* say *aṭutta*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for once, then the Tamil for to spend, then say *aṭutta* again

Before you move on

What does அடுத்த mean? (“Next, coming”.) Say it once more.

159.2 இனிமேல் (iṉimēl) — from now on

Before the new one: say the Tamil for to spend, then the Tamil for next.

You’ll want to know: இனிமேல்

இனிமேல் — *iṉimēl* — “from now on”. இனிமேல் நான் தினமும் நடப்பேன் — *iṉimēl nāṉ tiṉamum naṭappēṉ* — “From now on I will walk every day.”

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

இனிமேல் (*iṉimēl*) is native: *iṉi*, “from now”, on the near base *i-* (DEDR 410), and *mēl*, “above, after” (DEDR 5086).

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *iṉimēl*
- *Say it:* *iṉimēl*, once more
- *Say it:* say *iṉimēl*

- *Recall:* say the Tamil for to spend, then the Tamil for next, then say *iṉimēl* again

Before you move on

What does இனிமேல் mean? ("From now on".) Say it once more.

159.3 திட்டம் (tiṭṭam) — a plan

Before the new one: say the Tamil for next, then the Tamil for from now on.

You'll want to know: திட்டம்

திட்டம் — *tiṭṭam* — "a plan". எங்களுக்கு ஒரு திட்டம் இருக்கிறது — *eṅkaḷukku oru tiṭṭam irukkiṟatu* — "We have a plan."

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

The origin of திட்டம் (*tiṭṭam*) is uncertain. DEDR has no entry for it.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: tiṭṭam*
- *Say it: tiṭṭam*, once more
- *Say it:* say *tiṭṭam*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for next, then the Tamil for from now on, then say *tiṭṭam* again

Before you move on

What does திட்டம் mean? ("A plan".) Say it once more.

159.4 முடிவு செய் (muṭivu cey) — to decide

Before the new one: say the Tamil for from now on, then the Tamil for a plan.

You'll want to know: முடிவு செய்

முடிவு செய் — *muṭivu cey* — "to decide". நான் தினமும் நடக்க முடிவு செய்தேன் — *nāṉ tiṉamum naṭakka muṭivu ceytēṉ* — "I decided to walk every day."

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

முடிவு செய் (*muṭivu cey*) is native: *muṭivu*, "end, conclusion", from *muṭi*, "to end" (DEDR 4922), and *sey*, "to do" (DEDR 1957): "make an end".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: muṭivu cey*
- *Say it: muṭivu cey*, once more
- *Say it:* say *muṭivu cey*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for from now on, then the Tamil for a plan, then say *muṭivu cey* again

Before you move on

What does முடிவு செய் mean? ("To decide".) Say it once more.

159.5 எதிர்பார் (etirpār) — to expect, to look forward to

Before the new one: say the Tamil for a plan, then the Tamil for to decide.

You'll want to know: எதிர்பார்

எதிர்பார் — *etirpār* — "to expect, to look forward to". **உங்களை நாளை எதிர்பார்க்கிறேன்** — *uṅkaḷai nāḷai etirpārkkiṟēṉ* — "I am expecting you tomorrow."

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

எதிர்பார் (*etirpār*) is native: *etir*, "in front, opposite" (DEDR 795; Malayalam *etir*), and *pār*, "to look" (DEDR 4091): "look ahead".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: etirpār*
- *Say it: etirpār*, once more
- *Say it:* say *etirpār*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for a plan, then the Tamil for to decide, then say *etirpār* again

Before you move on

What does **எதிர்பார்** mean? ("To expect, to look forward to".) Say it once more.

Chapter 160

A Timetable, a Notice, the Rent, an Advert, a Receipt

Modes: **voice** (7) **Hands-free start:** all 7 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can read a timetable, a notice, an advert and a receipt, and act on what they say.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 160: I can read a timetable, a notice, an advert and a receipt, and act on what they say.*

160.1 கால அட்டவணை (kāla aṭṭavaṇai) — a timetable

Before the new one: say the Tamil for to decide, then the Tamil for to expect.

You'll want to know: கால அட்டவணை

கால அட்டவணை — *kāla aṭṭavaṇai* — "a timetable".

Read it: the board

The board says **பேருந்து புறப்படும் நேரம்: காலை எட்டு மணி** — *pēruntu puṟappaṭum nēram: kālai eṭṭu maṇi* — "Bus departure time: 8 a.m." The bus leaves at eight, so be there before eight.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

கால அட்டவணை (*kāla aṭṭavaṇai*) is *kālam*, "time", from Sanskrit *kāla* (CDIAL 3084), and *aṭṭavaṇai*, "table, chart". The origin of

aṭṭavaṇai is uncertain; DEDR has no entry for it.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: kāla aṭṭavaṇai*
- *Say it: kāla aṭṭavaṇai*, once more
- *Say it:* say *kāla aṭṭavaṇai*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for to decide, then the Tamil for to expect, then say *kāla aṭṭavaṇai* again

Before you move on

What does **கால அட்டவணை** mean? ("A timetable".) Say it once more.

160.2 அறிவிப்பு (a̱rivippu) — a notice, an announcement

Before the new one: say the Tamil for to expect, then the Tamil for a timetable.

You'll want to know: அறிவிப்பு

அறிவிப்பு — *a̱rivippu* — "a notice, an announcement".
Read it: the notice
The notice says **ஞாயிறுதோறும் கடை விடுமுறை** — *ñāyi̱ṟutō̱rum kaṭai viṭumu̱rai* — "Shop closed every Sunday." Come on another day.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

அறிவிப்பு (*a̱rivippu*) is native Dravidian. DEDR 314 lists Malayalam *a̱riyuka*, "to know". It is the noun of *a̱rivi*, "to make known", from *a̱ri*, "to know".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: a̲rivippu*
- *Say it: a̲rivippu*, once more
- *Say it:* say *a̲rivippu*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for to expect, then the Tamil for a timetable, then say *a̲rivippu* again

Before you move on

What does அறிவிப்பு mean? ("A notice, an announcement".) Say it once more.

160.3 வாடகை (vāṭakai) — rent; a fare

Before the new one: say the Tamil for a timetable, then the Tamil for a notice.

You'll want to know: வாடகை

வாடகை — *vāṭakai* — "rent; a fare". The money for a room, or for a ride: வீட்டு வாடகை — *vīṭṭu vāṭakai* — "the rent for a house".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

வாடகை (*vāṭakai*) is a well-established loan from Sanskrit *bhāṭaka*, "hire, rent".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: vāṭakai*
- *Say it: vāṭakai*, once more
- *Say it:* say *vāṭakai*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for a timetable, then the Tamil for a notice, then say *vāṭakai* again

Before you move on

What does **வாடகை** mean? ("Rent; a fare".) Say it once more.

160.4 விளம்பரம் (viḷamparam) — an advert

Before the new one: say the Tamil for a notice, then the Tamil for rent; a fare.

You'll want to know: விளம்பரம்

விளம்பரம் — *viḷamparam* — "an advert".

Read it: the advert

The advert says **வீடு வாடகைக்கு விடப்படும்** — *vīṭu vāṭakaikku viṭappaṭum* — "House to let." A house is available to rent.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

விளம்பரம் (*viḷamparam*) is native Dravidian. DEDR 5433 lists Malayalam *viḷamparam*, "proclamation". It comes from *viḷampu*, "to proclaim, to make known".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: viḷamparam*
- *Say it: viḷamparam*, once more

- *Say it:* say *viḷamparam*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for a notice, then the Tamil for rent; a fare, then say *viḷamparam* again

Before you move on

What does **விளம்பரம்** mean? ("An advert".) Say it once more.

160.5 ரசீது (racītu) — a receipt

Before the new one: say the Tamil for rent; a fare, then the Tamil for an advert.

You'll want to know: ரசீது

ரசீது — *racītu* — "a receipt". Ask for it when you pay: **ரசீது கொடுங்கள்** — *racītu koṭuṅkaḷ* — "The receipt, please."

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

ரசீது (*racītu*) is a loan from Persian *rasīd*, "receipt", through Hindustani.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: racītu*
- *Say it: racītu*, once more
- *Say it:* say *racītu*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for rent; a fare, then the Tamil for an advert, then say *racītu* again

Before you move on

What does **ரசீது** mean? ("A receipt".) Say it once more.

160.6 Looking back — a first pass

Say the words for an advert and a receipt.

Your turn

- *Say it:* recently, already, last, once, to spend

Before you move on

Recently? (சமீபத்தில், *camīpattil.*) Already? (ஏற்கனவே, *ērkaṉavē.*) Last? (போன, *pōṉa.*) Once? (ஒரு காலத்தில், *oru kālattil.*) To spend? (கழி, *kaḻi.*)

160.7 Looking ahead and reading signs — a second pass

Say the words for next and from now on.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- next, from now on, a plan, to decide, to expect
- a timetable, a notice, rent; a fare, an advert, a receipt

Before you move on

Next? (அடுத்த, *aṭutta.*) From now on? (இனிமேல், *iṉimēl.*) A plan? (திட்டம், *tiṭṭam.*) To decide? (முடிவு செய், *muṭivu cey.*) To expect? (எதிர்பார், *etirpār.*) A timetable? (கால அட்டவணை, *kāla aṭṭavaṇai.*) A notice? (அறிவிப்பு, *aṟivippu.*) Rent; a fare? (வாடகை, *vāṭakai.*) An advert? (விளம்பரம், *viḷamparam.*) A receipt? (ரசீது, *racītu.*)

Chapter 161

To sell, To boil, To fry, To grind, To mix

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say to sell, to boil, to fry, to grind and to mix.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 161: I can say to sell, to boil, to fry, to grind and to mix.*

161.1 வில் (vil) — to sell

Before the new one: say the Tamil for an advert, then the Tamil for a receipt.

You'll want to know: வில்

வில் — *vil* — "to sell".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

வில் (*vil*) is native Dravidian. DEDR 5421 lists Malayalam *vilkka*, "to sell" and Kannada *bil*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: vil*
- *Say it: vil*, once more
- *Say it:* say *vil*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for an advert, then the Tamil for a receipt, then say *vil* again

Before you move on

What does **வில்** mean? ("To sell".) Say it once more.

161.2 கொதி (koti) — to boil (of liquids)

Before the new one: say the Tamil for a receipt, then the Tamil for to sell.

You'll want to know: கொதி

கொதி — *koti* — "to boil (of liquids)".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

கொதி (*koti*) is native Dravidian. DEDR 2084 lists Kannada *kudi*, "to boil".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: koti*
- *Say it: koti*, once more
- *Say it:* say *koti*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for a receipt, then the Tamil for to sell, then say *koti* again

Before you move on

What does கொதி mean? ("To boil (of liquids)".) Say it once more.

161.3 வறு (va̲ru) — to fry, to roast

Before the new one: say the Tamil for to sell, then the Tamil for to boil.

You'll want to know: வறு

வறு — *va̲ru* — "to fry, to roast".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

வறு (*va̲ru*) is native Dravidian. DEDR 5325 lists Malayalam *va̲rukka*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *va̲ru*
- *Say it:* *va̲ru*, once more
- *Say it:* say *va̲ru*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for to sell, then the Tamil for to boil, then say *va̲ru* again

Before you move on

What does வறு mean? ("To fry, to roast".) Say it once more.

161.4 அரை (arai) — to grind

Before the new one: say the Tamil for to boil, then the Tamil for to fry.

You'll want to know: அரை

அரை — *arai* — "to grind".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

அரை (*arai*) is native Dravidian. DEDR 228 lists Malayalam *arekka*, "to grind to powder".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: arai*
- *Say it: arai*, once more
- *Say it:* say *arai*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for to boil, then the Tamil for to fry, then say *arai* again

Before you move on

What does **அரை** mean? ("To grind".) Say it once more.

161.5 கலக்கு (kalakku) — to mix, to stir

Before the new one: say the Tamil for to fry, then the Tamil for to grind.

You'll want to know: கலக்கு

கலக்கு — *kalakku* — "to mix, to stir".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

கலக்கு (*kalakku*) is native Dravidian. DEDR 1303 lists Malayalam *kalaṅṅuka*, "to be mixed, agitated". It is the causative of *kalaṅku*, "to be stirred up". The entry compares Sanskrit *kaluṣa*, "turbid".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: kalakku*
- *Say it: kalakku*, once more
- *Say it:* say *kalakku*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for to fry, then the Tamil for to grind, then say *kalakku* again

Before you move on

What does **கலக்கு** mean? ("To mix, to stir".) Say it once more.

Chapter 162

To cross, To stay, To go around, To move, To lift

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say to cross, to stay, to go around, to move and to lift.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 162: I can say to cross, to stay, to go around, to move and to lift.*

162.1 கட (kaṭa) — to cross

> Before the new one: say the Tamil for to grind, then the Tamil for to mix.

You'll want to know: கட

கட — *kaṭa* — "to cross".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

கட (*kaṭa*) is native Dravidian. DEDR 1109 lists Malayalam *kaṭakka*, "to pass over" and Kannada *kaḍe*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: kaṭa*
- *Say it: kaṭa*, once more
- *Say it:* say *kaṭa*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for to grind, then the Tamil for to mix, then say *kaṭa* again

Before you move on

What does **கட** mean? (“To cross”.) Say it once more.

162.2 தங்கு (taṅku) — to stay (overnight)

Before the new one: say the Tamil for to mix, then the Tamil for to cross.

You’ll want to know: தங்கு

தங்கு — *taṅku* — “to stay (overnight)”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

தங்கு (*taṅku*) is native Dravidian. DEDR 3014 lists Malayalam *taṅṅuka* and Kannada *taṅgu*.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: taṅku*
- *Say it: taṅku*, once more
- *Say it:* say *taṅku*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for to mix, then the Tamil for to cross, then say *taṅku* again

Before you move on

What does தங்கு mean? ("To stay (overnight)".) Say it once more.

162.3 சுற்று (cu̲r̲ru) — to go around, to wander

Before the new one: say the Tamil for to cross, then the Tamil for to stay.

You'll want to know: சுற்று

சுற்று — *cu̲r̲ru* — "to go around, to wander".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

சுற்று (*cu̲r̲ru*) is native Dravidian. DEDR 2715 lists Malayalam *cu̲r̲ruka* and Kannada *suttu*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: cu̲r̲ru*
- *Say it: cu̲r̲ru*, once more
- *Say it:* say *cu̲r̲ru*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for to cross, then the Tamil for to stay, then say *cu̲r̲ru* again

Before you move on

What does சுற்று mean? ("To go around, to wander".) Say it once more.

162.4 நகர் (nakar) — to move, to shift

Before the new one: say the Tamil for to stay, then the Tamil for to go around.

You'll want to know: நகர்

நகர் — *nakar* — "to move, to shift".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

The origin of நகர் (*nakar*), "to move, to shift", is uncertain. DEDR has no entry for this verb; its *nakar*, "house, town" (DEDR 3568), is a different word.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: nakar*
- *Say it: nakar*, once more
- *Say it:* say *nakar*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for to stay, then the Tamil for to go around, then say *nakar* again

Before you move on

What does நகர் mean? ("To move, to shift".) Say it once more.

162.5 தூக்கு (tūkku) — to lift

Before the new one: say the Tamil for to go around, then the Tamil for to move.

You'll want to know: தூக்கு

தூக்கு — *tūkku* — "to lift".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

தூக்கு (*tūkku*) is native Dravidian. DEDR 3376 lists Malayalam *tūṅṅuka*, "to hang". The entry lists *tūkku*, "to hang up, to take up", beside *tūṅku*, "to hang".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: tūkku*
- *Say it: tūkku*, once more
- *Say it:* say *tūkku*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for to go around, then the Tamil for to move, then say *tūkku* again

Before you move on

What does தூக்கு mean? ("To lift".) Say it once more.

Chapter 163

To prepare, To serve, To share, To bargain, To check

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say to prepare, to serve, to share, to bargain and to check.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 163: I can say to prepare, to serve, to share, to bargain and to check.

163.1 தயார் செய் (tayār cey) — to prepare

Before the new one: say the Tamil for to move, then the Tamil for to lift.

You'll want to know: தயார் செய்

தயார் செய் — *tayār cey* — "to prepare".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

தயார் செய் (*tayār cey*) is *tayār*, "ready", a loan from Arabic *ṭayyār*, "flying, swift", which took the sense "ready" in Persian and Hindustani, with native *sey*, "to do" (DEDR 1957): "make ready".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: tayār cey*
- *Say it: tayār cey*, once more
- *Say it:* say *tayār cey*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for to move, then the Tamil for to lift, then say *tayār cey* again

Before you move on

What does தயார் செய் mean? ("To prepare".) Say it once more.

163.2 பரிமாறு (parimāṟu) — to serve (food)

Before the new one: say the Tamil for to lift, then the Tamil for to prepare.

You'll want to know: பரிமாறு

பரிமாறு — *parimāṟu* — "to serve (food)".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

பரிமாறு (*parimāṟu*) ends in native *māṟu*, "to change, to exchange" (DEDR 4834). The first part, *pari*, is not settled, so the origin of the whole word is uncertain.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: parimāṟu*
- *Say it: parimāṟu*, once more
- *Say it:* say *parimāṟu*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for to lift, then the Tamil for to prepare, then say *parimāṟu* again

Before you move on

What does பரிமாறு mean? ("To serve (food)".) Say it once more.

163.3 பகிர் (pakir) — to share

Before the new one: say the Tamil for to prepare, then the Tamil for to serve.

You'll want to know: பகிர்

பகிர் — *pakir* — "to share".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

பகிர் (*pakir*) is native Dravidian. DEDR 3808 lists Malayalam *pakuka*, "to divide". It belongs with *paku*, "to be divided, to share out".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: pakir*
- *Say it: pakir*, once more
- *Say it:* say *pakir*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for to prepare, then the Tamil for to serve, then say *pakir* again

Before you move on

What does பகிர் mean? ("To share".) Say it once more.

163.4 பேரம் பேசு (pēram pēcu) — to bargain

Before the new one: say the Tamil for to serve, then the Tamil for to share.

You'll want to know: பேரம் பேசு

பேரம் பேசு — *pēram pēcu* — "to bargain".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

பேரம் பேசு (*pēram pēcu*) is *pēram*, "bargain", with native *pēsu*, "to speak" (DEDR 4430): "to talk a bargain". The origin of *pēram* is uncertain; DEDR has no entry for it.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *pēram pēcu*
- *Say it:* *pēram pēcu*, once more
- *Say it:* say *pēram pēcu*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for to serve, then the Tamil for to share, then say *pēram pēcu* again

Before you move on

What does பேரம் பேசு mean? ("To bargain".) Say it once more.

163.5 சரிபார் (caripār) — to check

Before the new one: say the Tamil for to share, then the Tamil for to bargain.

You'll want to know: சரிபார்

சரிபார் — *caripār* — "to check".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

சரிபார் (*caripār*) is *sari*, "correct", and native *pār*, "to look" (DEDR 4091): "look to see it is right". The origin of *sari* is uncertain, as its own lesson said.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: caripār*
- *Say it: caripār*, once more
- *Say it:* say *caripār*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for to share, then the Tamil for to bargain, then say *caripār* again

Before you move on

What does சரிபார் mean? ("To check".) Say it once more.

Chapter 164

To describe, To hand over, To practise, To pass, To pay attention

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say to describe, to hand over, to practise, to pass and to pay attention.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 164: I can say to describe, to hand over, to practise, to pass and to pay attention.

164.1 விவரி (vivari) — to describe, to explain

Before the new one: say the Tamil for to bargain, then the Tamil for to check.

You'll want to know: விவரி

விவரி — *vivari* — "to describe, to explain".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

விவரி (*vivari*) is a verb made from Sanskrit *vivaraṇa*, "explanation, an opening up", a well-established loan.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: vivari*
- *Say it: vivari*, once more
- *Say it:* say *vivari*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for to bargain, then the Tamil for to check, then say *vivari* again

Before you move on

What does விவரி mean? ("To describe, to explain".) Say it once more.

164.2 ஒப்படை (oppaṭai) — to hand over, to hand in

Before the new one: say the Tamil for to check, then the Tamil for to describe.

You'll want to know: ஒப்படை

ஒப்படை — *oppaṭai* — "to hand over, to hand in".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

ஒப்படை (*oppaṭai*) is native: *oppu*, "agreement, consent", from *o*, "to be suited, to agree" (DEDR 924), and *aṭai*, "to deliver, to entrust" (DEDR 79).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: oppaṭai*
- *Say it: oppaṭai*, once more
- *Say it:* say *oppaṭai*

- *Recall:* say the Tamil for to check, then the Tamil for to describe, then say *oppaṭai* again

Before you move on

What does ஒப்படை mean? (“To hand over, to hand in”.) Say it once more.

164.3 பயிற்சி செய் (payi̲rci cey) — to practise

Before the new one: say the Tamil for to describe, then the Tamil for to hand over.

You’ll want to know: பயிற்சி செய்

பயிற்சி செய் — *payi̲rci cey* — “to practise”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

பயிற்சி செய் (*payi̲rci cey*) is native: *payi̲rci*, “training”, from *payil*, “to practise, to learn” (DEDR 3942), and *sey*, “to do” (DEDR 1957).

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: payi̲rci cey*
- *Say it: payi̲rci cey*, once more
- *Say it:* say *payi̲rci cey*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for to describe, then the Tamil for to hand over, then say *payi̲rci cey* again

Before you move on

What does பயிற்சி செய் mean? (“To practise”.) Say it once more.

164.4 தேர்ச்சி பெறு (tērcci pe̱ru) — to pass (an exam)

Before the new one: say the Tamil for to hand over, then the Tamil for to practise.

You'll want to know: தேர்ச்சி பெறு

தேர்ச்சி பெறு — *tērcci pe̱ru* — "to pass (an exam)".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

தேர்ச்சி பெறு (*tērcci pe̱ru*) is native: *tērcci*, "proficiency, a pass", from *tēr*, "to examine, to become skilled" (DEDR 3419), and *pe̱ru*, "to get" (DEDR 4422).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: tērcci pe̱ru*
- *Say it: tērcci pe̱ru*, once more
- *Say it:* say *tērcci pe̱ru*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for to hand over, then the Tamil for to practise, then say *tērcci pe̱ru* again

Before you move on

What does தேர்ச்சி பெறு mean? ("To pass (an exam)".) Say it once more.

164.5 கவனி (kava̱ni) — to pay attention, to notice

Before the new one: say the Tamil for to practise, then the Tamil for to pass.

You'll want to know: கவனி

கவனி — *kavaṉi* — "to pay attention, to notice".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

கவனி (*kavaṉi*) is native Dravidian. DEDR 1328 lists Malayalam *kavanam*, "care" and Kannada *gavana*, "attention". It is a verb made from *kavaṉam*, "care, attention".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: kavaṉi*
- *Say it: kavaṉi*, once more
- *Say it:* say *kavaṉi*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for to practise, then the Tamil for to pass, then say *kavaṉi* again

Before you move on

What does **கவனி** mean? ("To pay attention, to notice".) Say it once more.

Chapter 165

To get to know, To celebrate, To decorate, To dance, To worship

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say to get to know, to celebrate, to decorate, to dance and to worship.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 165: I can say to get to know, to celebrate, to decorate, to dance and to worship.*

165.1 பழகு (pa̲laku) — to get to know, to mix with (people)

> Before the new one: say the Tamil for to pass, then the Tamil for to pay attention.

You'll want to know: பழகு

பழகு — *pa̲laku* — "to get to know, to mix with (people)".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

பழகு (*pa̲laku*) is native Dravidian. DEDR 4000 lists Malayalam *pa̲lakuka*, "to be accustomed, acquainted".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: pa̲laku*
- *Say it: pa̲laku*, once more
- *Say it:* say *pa̲laku*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for to pass, then the Tamil for to pay attention, then say *pa̲laku* again

Before you move on

What does பழகு mean? (“To get to know, to mix with (people)”.) Say it once more.

165.2 கொண்டாடு (koṇṭāṭu) — to celebrate

Before the new one: say the Tamil for to pay attention, then the Tamil for to get to know.

You’ll want to know: கொண்டாடு

கொண்டாடு — *koṇṭāṭu* — “to celebrate”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

கொண்டாடு (*koṇṭāṭu*) is native: *koṇṭu*, “having taken”, from *koḷ*, “to take” (DEDR 2151), and *āṭu*, “to move, to dance, to play” (DEDR 347).

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: koṇṭāṭu*
- *Say it: koṇṭāṭu*, once more
- *Say it:* say *koṇṭāṭu*

- *Recall:* say the Tamil for to pay attention, then the Tamil for to get to know, then say *koṇṭāṭu* again

Before you move on

What does கொண்டாடு mean? ("To celebrate".) Say it once more.

165.3 அலங்கரி (alaṅkari) — to decorate

Before the new one: say the Tamil for to get to know, then the Tamil for to celebrate.

You'll want to know: அலங்கரி

அலங்கரி — *alaṅkari* — "to decorate".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

அலங்கரி (*alaṅkari*) is a verb made from Sanskrit *alaṅkāra*, "ornament", a well-established loan.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: alaṅkari*
- *Say it: alaṅkari*, once more
- *Say it:* say *alaṅkari*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for to get to know, then the Tamil for to celebrate, then say *alaṅkari* again

Before you move on

What does அலங்கரி mean? ("To decorate".) Say it once more.

165.4 நடனமாடு (naṭaṉamāṭu) — to dance

Before the new one: say the Tamil for to celebrate, then the Tamil for to decorate.

You'll want to know: நடனமாடு

நடனமாடு — *naṭaṉamāṭu* — "to dance".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

நடனமாடு (*naṭaṉamāṭu*) is *naṭaṉam*, "dance", a well-established loan from Sanskrit *naṭana*, with native *āṭu*, "to dance, to move" (DEDR 347).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: naṭaṉamāṭu*
- *Say it: naṭaṉamāṭu*, once more
- *Say it:* say *naṭaṉamāṭu*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for to celebrate, then the Tamil for to decorate, then say *naṭaṉamāṭu* again

Before you move on

What does நடனமாடு mean? ("To dance".) Say it once more.

165.5 வணங்கு (vaṇaṅku) — to worship, to bow to

Before the new one: say the Tamil for to decorate, then the Tamil for to dance.

You'll want to know: வணங்கு

வணங்கு — *vaṇaṅku* — "to worship, to bow to".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

வணங்கு (*vaṇaṅku*) is native Dravidian. DEDR 5236 lists Malayalam *vaṇaṅṅuka*, "to bow, salute". It is the verb behind *vaṇakkam*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: vaṇaṅku*
- *Say it: vaṇaṅku*, once more
- *Say it:* say *vaṇaṅku*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for to decorate, then the Tamil for to dance, then say *vaṇaṅku* again

Before you move on

What does வணங்கு mean? ("To worship, to bow to".) Say it once more.

Chapter 166

To light a lamp, To burst, To put up with, To make peace, To consider

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say to light a lamp, to burst, to put up with, to make peace and to consider.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 166: I can say to light a lamp, to burst, to put up with, to make peace and to consider.

166.1 விளக்கேற்று (viḷakkēr̲r̲u) — to light a lamp

Before the new one: say the Tamil for to dance, then the Tamil for to worship.

You'll want to know: விளக்கேற்று

விளக்கேற்று — *viḷakkēr̲r̲u* — "to light a lamp".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

விளக்கேற்று (*viḷakkēr̲r̲u*) is native: *viḷakku*, "lamp" (DEDR 5496), and *ēr̲r̲u*, "to raise, to light", the causative of *ēr̲u*, "to rise" (DEDR 916).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: viḷakkēṟṟu*
- *Say it: viḷakkēṟṟu*, once more
- *Say it:* say *viḷakkēṟṟu*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for to dance, then the Tamil for to worship, then say *viḷakkēṟṟu* again

Before you move on

What does விளக்கேற்று mean? ("To light a lamp".) Say it once more.

166.2 வெடி (veṭi) — to burst, to explode

Before the new one: say the Tamil for to worship, then the Tamil for to light a lamp.

You'll want to know: வெடி

வெடி — *veṭi* — "to burst, to explode".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

வெடி (*veṭi*) is native Dravidian. DEDR 5473 lists Malayalam *veṭi*, "explosion".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: veṭi*
- *Say it: veṭi*, once more

- *Say it:* say *veṭi*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for to worship, then the Tamil for to light a lamp, then say *veṭi* again

Before you move on

What does வெடி mean? ("To burst, to explode".) Say it once more.

166.3 பொறுத்துக்கொள் (poṟuttukkoḷ) — to put up with, to tolerate

Before the new one: say the Tamil for to light a lamp, then the Tamil for to burst.

You'll want to know: பொறுத்துக்கொள்

பொறுத்துக்கொள் — *poṟuttukkoḷ* — "to put up with, to tolerate".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

பொறுத்துக்கொள் (*poṟuttukkoḷ*) is native: *poṟuttu*, "having borne", from *poṟu*, "to bear, to tolerate" (DEDR 4565; Malayalam *poṟukka*), and *koḷ*, "to take" (DEDR 2151).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: poṟuttukkoḷ*
- *Say it: poṟuttukkoḷ*, once more
- *Say it:* say *poṟuttukkoḷ*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for to light a lamp, then the Tamil for to burst, then say *poṟuttukkoḷ* again

Before you move on

What does பொறுத்துக்கொள் mean? ("To put up with, to tolerate".) Say it once more.

166.4 சமாதானம் செய் (camātāṉam cey) — to make peace, to calm someone down

Before the new one: say the Tamil for to burst, then the Tamil for to put up with.

You'll want to know: சமாதானம் செய்

சமாதானம் செய் — *camātāṉam cey* — "to make peace, to calm someone down".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

சமாதானம் செய் (*camātāṉam cey*) is *camātāṉam*, "peace, reconciliation", from Sanskrit *samādhāna*, "putting together, reconciliation" (CDIAL 13210), with native *sey*, "to do" (DEDR 1957).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: camātāṉam cey*
- *Say it: camātāṉam cey*, once more
- *Say it:* say *camātāṉam cey*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for to burst, then the Tamil for to put up with, then say *camātāṉam cey* again

Before you move on

What does சமாதானம் செய் mean? ("To make peace, to calm someone down".) Say it once more.

166.5 யோசி (yōci) — to consider, to think something over

Before the new one: say the Tamil for to put up with, then the Tamil for to make peace.

You'll want to know: யோசி

யோசி — *yōci* — "to consider, to think something over".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

யோசி (*yōci*) is a verb made from *yōcaṉai*, "thought, consideration", a loan from Sanskrit *yojanā*, "a joining, an arranging".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: yōci*
- *Say it: yōci*, once more
- *Say it:* say *yōci*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for to put up with, then the Tamil for to make peace, then say *yōci* again

Before you move on

What does யோசி mean? ("To consider, to think something over".) Say it once more.

Chapter 167

To continue, To operate, To stick, To hang, To roll

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say to continue, to operate, to stick, to hang and to roll.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 167: I can say to continue, to operate, to stick, to hang and to roll.*

167.1 தொடர் (toṭar) — to continue

Before the new one: say the Tamil for to make peace, then the Tamil for to consider.

You'll want to know: தொடர்

தொடர் — *toṭar* — "to continue".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

தொடர் (*toṭar*) is native Dravidian. DEDR 3480 lists Malayalam *toṭuka*, "to touch". The entry lists *toṭar*, "to follow, to be connected", under *toṭu*, "to touch".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: toṭar*
- *Say it: toṭar*, once more
- *Say it:* say *toṭar*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for to make peace, then the Tamil for to consider, then say *toṭar* again

Before you move on

What does தொடர் mean? (“To continue”.) Say it once more.

167.2 இயக்கு (iyakku) — to operate, to run (a machine)

Before the new one: say the Tamil for to consider, then the Tamil for to continue.

You’ll want to know: இயக்கு

இயக்கு — *iyakku* — “to operate, to run (a machine)”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

இயக்கு (*iyakku*) is native Dravidian. DEDR 469 lists Malayalam *iyakkuka*, “to cause to move”. It is the causative of *iyaṅku*, “to move”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: iyakku*
- *Say it: iyakku*, once more
- *Say it:* say *iyakku*

- *Recall:* say the Tamil for to consider, then the Tamil for to continue, then say *iyakku* again

Before you move on

What does இயக்கு mean? (“To operate, to run (a machine)”.) Say it once more.

167.3 ஒட்டு (oṭṭu) — to stick, to paste

Before the new one: say the Tamil for to continue, then the Tamil for to operate.

You’ll want to know: ஒட்டு

ஒட்டு — *oṭṭu* — “to stick, to paste”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

ஒட்டு (*oṭṭu*) is native Dravidian. DEDR 958 lists Malayalam *oṭṭuka*, “to adhere” and Kannada *oṭṭu*.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: oṭṭu*
- *Say it: oṭṭu*, once more
- *Say it:* say *oṭṭu*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for to continue, then the Tamil for to operate, then say *oṭṭu* again

Before you move on

What does ஒட்டு mean? (“To stick, to paste”.) Say it once more.

167.4 தொங்கு (toṅku) — to hang (intransitive), to dangle

Before the new one: say the Tamil for to operate, then the Tamil for to stick.

You'll want to know: தொங்கு

தொங்கு — *toṅku* — "to hang (intransitive), to dangle".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

தொங்கு (*toṅku*) is native Dravidian. DEDR 3478 lists Malayalam *toṅkuka*, Kannada *toṅgu* and Telugu *toṅgu*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: toṅku*
- *Say it: toṅku*, once more
- *Say it:* say *toṅku*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for to operate, then the Tamil for to stick, then say *toṅku* again

Before you move on

What does தொங்கு mean? ("To hang (intransitive), to dangle".) Say it once more.

167.5 உருட்டு (uruṭṭu) — to roll (something)

Before the new one: say the Tamil for to stick, then the Tamil for to hang.

You'll want to know: உருட்டு

உருட்டு — *uruṭṭu* — "to roll (something)".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

உருட்டு (*uruṭṭu*) is native Dravidian. DEDR 664 lists Malayalam *uruḷuka*, "to roll". It is the causative of *uruḷ*, "to roll".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: uruṭṭu*
- *Say it: uruṭṭu*, once more
- *Say it:* say *uruṭṭu*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for to stick, then the Tamil for to hang, then say *uruṭṭu* again

Before you move on

What does உருட்டு mean? ("To roll (something)".) Say it once more.

Chapter 168

To plough, To dig, To stretch out, To slip, To yawn

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say to plough, to dig, to stretch out, to slip and to yawn.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 168: I can say to plough, to dig, to stretch out, to slip and to yawn.*

168.1 உழு (uḻu) — to plough

> Before the new one: say the Tamil for to hang, then the Tamil for to roll.

You'll want to know: உழு

உழு — *uḻu* — "to plough".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

உழு (*uḻu*) is native Dravidian. DEDR 688 lists Malayalam *uḻuka*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *u̲lu*
- *Say it:* *u̲lu*, once more
- *Say it:* say *u̲lu*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for to hang, then the Tamil for to roll, then say *u̲lu* again

Before you move on

What does உழு mean? ("To plough".) Say it once more.

168.2 தோண்டு (tōṇṭu) — to dig

Before the new one: say the Tamil for to roll, then the Tamil for to plough.

You'll want to know: தோண்டு

தோண்டு — *tōṇṭu* — "to dig".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

தோண்டு (*tōṇṭu*) is native Dravidian. DEDR 3549 lists Malayalam *tōṇṭuka* and Kannada *tōḍu*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *tōṇṭu*
- *Say it:* *tōṇṭu*, once more
- *Say it:* say *tōṇṭu*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for to roll, then the Tamil for to plough, then say *tōṇṭu* again

Before you move on

What does தோண்டு mean? ("To dig".) Say it once more.

168.3 நீட்டு (nīṭṭu) — to stretch out, to extend

Before the new one: say the Tamil for to plough, then the Tamil for to dig.

You'll want to know: நீட்டு

நீட்டு — *nīṭṭu* — "to stretch out, to extend".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

நீட்டு (*nīṭṭu*) is native Dravidian. DEDR 3692 lists Malayalam *nīḷuka*, "to grow long" and Kannada *nīḷ*. It is the causative of *nīḷ*, "to be long".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: nīṭṭu*
- *Say it: nīṭṭu*, once more
- *Say it:* say *nīṭṭu*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for to plough, then the Tamil for to dig, then say *nīṭṭu* again

Before you move on

What does நீட்டு mean? ("To stretch out, to extend".) Say it once more.

168.4 வழுக்கு (va̱lukku) — to slip

Before the new one: say the Tamil for to dig, then the Tamil for to stretch out.

You'll want to know: வழுக்கு

வழுக்கு — *va̲lukku* — "to slip".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

வழுக்கு (*va̲lukku*) is native Dravidian. DEDR 5299 lists Malayalam *va̲lukku*, "unctuous". The entry glosses *va̲lukku* "slimy substance": to slip is to slide as on slime.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *va̲lukku*
- *Say it:* *va̲lukku*, once more
- *Say it:* say *va̲lukku*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for to dig, then the Tamil for to stretch out, then say *va̲lukku* again

Before you move on

What does வழுக்கு mean? ("To slip".) Say it once more.

168.5 கொட்டாவி விடு (koṭṭāvi viṭu) — to yawn

Before the new one: say the Tamil for to stretch out, then the Tamil for to slip.

You'll want to know: கொட்டாவி விடு

கொட்டாவி விடு — *koṭṭāvi viṭu* — "to yawn".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

கொட்டாவி விடு (*koṭṭāvi viṭu*) is native: *koṭṭāvi*, "a yawn" (DEDR 2172; Malayalam *kōṭṭāvi*), and *viṭu*, "to let out" (DEDR 5393).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: koṭṭāvi viṭu*
- *Say it: koṭṭāvi viṭu*, once more
- *Say it:* say *koṭṭāvi viṭu*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for to stretch out, then the Tamil for to slip, then say *koṭṭāvi viṭu* again

Before you move on

What does கொட்டாவி விடு mean? ("To yawn".) Say it once more.

Chapter 169

Ankle, Waist, Throat, Heart, Blood

Modes: **voice** (7) **Hands-free start:** all 7 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say an ankle, the waist, the throat, the heart and blood.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 169: I can say an ankle, the waist, the throat, the heart and blood.*

169.1 கணுக்கால் (kaṇukkāl) — an ankle

Before the new one: say the Tamil for to slip, then the Tamil for to yawn.

You'll want to know: கணுக்கால்

கணுக்கால் — *kaṇukkāl* — "an ankle".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

கணுக்கால் (*kaṇukkāl*) is native Dravidian. DEDR 1160 lists Malayalam *kaṇu*, "joint". The entry lists *kaṇukkāl*, "ankle": *kaṇu*, "joint", and *kāl*, "leg".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: kaṇukkāl*
- *Say it: kaṇukkāl*, once more
- *Say it:* say *kaṇukkāl*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for to slip, then the Tamil for to yawn, then say *kaṇukkāl* again

Before you move on

What does கணுக்கால் mean? (“An ankle”.) Say it once more.

169.2 இடுப்பு (iṭuppu) — the waist, the hip

Before the new one: say the Tamil for to yawn, then the Tamil for an ankle.

You’ll want to know: இடுப்பு

இடுப்பு — *iṭuppu* — “the waist, the hip”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

இடுப்பு (*iṭuppu*) is native Dravidian. DEDR 448 lists Malayalam *iṭa*, “middle, waist”. The entry lists *iṭuppu*, “waist, hips”, under *iṭai*, “middle”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: iṭuppu*
- *Say it: iṭuppu*, once more
- *Say it:* say *iṭuppu*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for to yawn, then the Tamil for an ankle, then say *iṭuppu* again

Before you move on

What does இடுப்பு mean? ("The waist, the hip".) Say it once more.

169.3 தொண்டை (toṇṭai) — the throat

Before the new one: say the Tamil for an ankle, then the Tamil for the waist.

You'll want to know: தொண்டை

தொண்டை — *toṇṭai* — "the throat".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

தொண்டை (*toṇṭai*) is native Dravidian. DEDR 3498 lists Malayalam *toṇṭa*, "windpipe, throat".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: toṇṭai*
- *Say it: toṇṭai*, once more
- *Say it:* say *toṇṭai*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for an ankle, then the Tamil for the waist, then say *toṇṭai* again

Before you move on

What does தொண்டை mean? ("The throat".) Say it once more.

169.4 இதயம் (itayam) — the heart

Before the new one: say the Tamil for the waist, then the Tamil for the throat.

You'll want to know: இதயம்

இதயம் — *itayam* — "the heart".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

இதயம் (*itayam*) is a loan from Sanskrit *hṛdaya*, "heart" (CDIAL 14152). Tamil dropped the *h*, and *ṛ* became *i*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: itayam*
- *Say it: itayam*, once more
- *Say it:* say *itayam*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for the waist, then the Tamil for the throat, then say *itayam* again

Before you move on

What does இதயம் mean? ("The heart".) Say it once more.

169.5 இரத்தம் (irattam) — blood

Before the new one: say the Tamil for the throat, then the Tamil for the heart.

You'll want to know: இரத்தம்

இரத்தம் — *irattam* — "blood".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

இரத்தம் (*irattam*) is a loan from Sanskrit *rakta*, "red; blood" (CDIAL 10539). Tamil puts a vowel before an initial *r*, so *rakta* became *irattam*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: irattam*
- *Say it: irattam*, once more
- *Say it:* say *irattam*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for the throat, then the Tamil for the heart, then say *irattam* again

Before you move on

What does இரத்தம் mean? ("Blood".) Say it once more.

169.6 Words from chapters 161-164 — a first pass

Say the words for the heart and blood.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- to sell, to boil, to fry, to grind, to mix
- to cross, to stay, to go around, to move, to lift
- to prepare, to serve, to share, to bargain, to check
- to describe, to hand over, to practise, to pass, to pay attention

Before you move on

To sell? (வில், *vil.*) To boil? (கொதி, *koti.*) To fry? (வறு, *vaṟu.*) To grind? (அரை, *arai.*) To mix? (கலக்கு, *kalakku.*) To cross? (கட, *kaṭa.*) To stay? (தங்கு, *taṅku.*) To go around? (சுற்று, *cuṟṟu.*) To move? (நகர், *nakar.*) To lift? (தூக்கு, *tūkku.*) To prepare? (தயார் செய், *tayār cey.*) To serve? (பரிமாறு,

parimāṟu.) To share? (பகிர், *pakir.*) To bargain? (பேரம் பேசு, *pēram pēcu.*) To check? (சரிபார், *caripār.*) To describe? (விவரி, *vivari.*) To hand over? (ஒப்படை, *oppaṭai.*) To practise? (பயிற்சி செய், *payiṟci cey.*) To pass? (தேர்ச்சி பெறு, *tērcci peṟu.*) To pay attention? (கவனி, *kavaṉi.*)

169.7 Words from chapters 165-169 — a second pass

Say the words for to get to know and to celebrate.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- to get to know, to celebrate, to decorate, to dance, to worship
- to light a lamp, to burst, to put up with, to make peace, to consider
- to continue, to operate, to stick, to hang, to roll
- to plough, to dig, to stretch out, to slip, to yawn
- an ankle, the waist, the throat, the heart, blood

Before you move on

To get to know? (பழகு, *paḻaku.*) To celebrate? (கொண்டாடு, *koṇṭāṭu.*) To decorate? (அலங்கரி, *alaṅkari.*) To dance? (நடனமாடு, *naṭaṉamāṭu.*) To worship? (வணங்கு, *vaṇaṅku.*) To light a lamp? (விளக்கேற்று, *viḷakkēṟṟu.*) To burst? (வெடி, *veṭi.*) To put up with? (பொறுத்துக்கொள், *poṟuttukkoḷ.*) To make peace? (சமாதானம் செய், *camātāṉam cey.*) To consider? (யோசி, *yōci.*) To continue? (தொடர், *toṭar.*) To operate? (இயக்கு, *iyakku.*) To stick? (ஒட்டு, *oṭṭu.*) To hang? (தொங்கு, *toṅku.*) To roll? (உருட்டு, *uruṭṭu.*) To plough? (உழு, *uḻu.*) To dig? (தோண்டு, *tōṇṭu.*) To stretch out? (நீட்டு, *nīṭṭu.*) To slip? (வழுக்கு, *vaḻukku.*) To yawn? (கொட்டாவி விடு, *koṭṭāvi viṭu.*) An ankle? (கணுக்கால், *kaṇukkāl.*) The waist? (இடுப்பு, *iṭuppu.*) The throat? (தொண்டை, *toṇṭai.*) The heart? (இதயம், *itayam.*)

Blood? (**இரத்தம்**, *irattam.*)

Chapter 170

Allergy, Infection, Scar, Diarrhoea, Brain

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say an allergy, an infection, a scar, diarrhoea and the brain.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 170: I can say an allergy, an infection, a scar, diarrhoea and the brain.*

170.1 ஒவ்வாமை (ovvāmai) — an allergy

> Before the new one: say the Tamil for the heart, then the Tamil for blood.

You'll want to know: ஒவ்வாமை

ஒவ்வாமை — *ovvāmai* — "an allergy".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

ஒவ்வாமை (*ovvāmai*) is native Dravidian (DEDR 924). It is the negative noun of *o*, "to suit, to agree": "not agreeing".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *ovvāmai*
- *Say it:* *ovvāmai*, once more
- *Say it:* say *ovvāmai*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for the heart, then the Tamil for blood, then say *ovvāmai* again

Before you move on

What does ஒவ்வாமை mean? ("An allergy".) Say it once more.

170.2 தொற்று (to̲r̲ru) — an infection

Before the new one: say the Tamil for blood, then the Tamil for an allergy.

You'll want to know: தொற்று

தொற்று — *to̲r̲ru* — "an infection".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

The origin of தொற்று (*to̲r̲ru*) is uncertain. DEDR has no entry for it.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *to̲r̲ru*
- *Say it:* *to̲r̲ru*, once more
- *Say it:* say *to̲r̲ru*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for blood, then the Tamil for an allergy, then say *to̲r̲ru* again

Before you move on

What does தொற்று mean? (“An infection”.) Say it once more.

170.3 தழும்பு (ta̲lumpu) — a scar

Before the new one: say the Tamil for an allergy, then the Tamil for an infection.

You’ll want to know: தழும்பு

தழும்பு — *ta̲lumpu* — “a scar”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

தழும்பு (*ta̲lumpu*) is native Dravidian. DEDR 3118 lists Malayalam *ta̲lampu*, “scar”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *ta̲lumpu*
- *Say it:* *ta̲lumpu*, once more
- *Say it:* say *ta̲lumpu*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for an allergy, then the Tamil for an infection, then say *ta̲lumpu* again

Before you move on

What does தழும்பு mean? (“A scar”.) Say it once more.

170.4 வயிற்றுப்போக்கு (vayi̱ṟruppōkku) — diarrhoea

Before the new one: say the Tamil for an infection, then the Tamil for a scar.

You'll want to know: வயிற்றுப்போக்கு

வயிற்றுப்போக்கு — *vayi̱ṟruppōkku* — "diarrhoea".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

வயிற்றுப்போக்கு (*vayi̱ṟruppōkku*) is native: *vayi̱ru*, "belly" (DEDR 5259), and *pōkku*, "going, a flow", from *pō*, "to go" (DEDR 4572).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *vayi̱ṟruppōkku*
- *Say it:* *vayi̱ṟruppōkku*, once more
- *Say it:* say *vayi̱ṟruppōkku*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for an infection, then the Tamil for a scar, then say *vayi̱ṟruppōkku* again

Before you move on

What does வயிற்றுப்போக்கு mean? ("Diarrhoea".) Say it once more.

170.5 மூளை (mūḷai) — the brain

Before the new one: say the Tamil for a scar, then the Tamil for diarrhoea.

You'll want to know: மூளை

மூளை — *mūḷai* — "the brain".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

மூளை (*mūḷai*) is native Dravidian. DEDR 5051 lists Malayalam *mūḷa* and Telugu *mūlaga*, "marrow".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: mūḷai*
- *Say it: mūḷai*, once more
- *Say it:* say *mūḷai*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for a scar, then the Tamil for diarrhoea, then say *mūḷai* again

Before you move on

What does மூளை mean? ("The brain".) Say it once more.

Chapter 171

Often, Sometimes, Always, Never, Delay

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say often, sometimes, always, never and a delay.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 171: I can say often, sometimes, always, never and a delay.

171.1 அடிக்கடி (aṭikkaṭi) — often

Before the new one: say the Tamil for diarrhoea, then the Tamil for the brain.

You'll want to know: அடிக்கடி

அடிக்கடி — *aṭikkaṭi* — "often".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

அடிக்கடி (*aṭikkaṭi*) is native Dravidian. DEDR 84 lists Malayalam *aṭikkaṭi*, "repeatedly". It sits beside *aṭi*, "to be on the increase, to abound".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: aṭikkaṭi*
- *Say it: aṭikkaṭi*, once more
- *Say it:* say *aṭikkaṭi*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for diarrhoea, then the Tamil for the brain, then say *aṭikkaṭi* again

Before you move on

What does அடிக்கடி mean? ("Often".) Say it once more.

171.2 சில நேரங்களில் (cila nēraṅkaḷil) — sometimes

Before the new one: say the Tamil for the brain, then the Tamil for often.

You'll want to know: சில நேரங்களில்

சில நேரங்களில் — *cila nēraṅkaḷil* — "sometimes".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

சில நேரங்களில் (*cila nēraṅkaḷil*) is native: *cila*, "some" (DEDR 1571; Malayalam *cila*), and *nēram*, "time" (DEDR 3774), plural and locative: "at some times".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: cila nēraṅkaḷil*
- *Say it: cila nēraṅkaḷil*, once more
- *Say it:* say *cila nēraṅkaḷil*

- *Recall:* say the Tamil for the brain, then the Tamil for often, then say *cila nēraṅkaḷil* again

Before you move on

What does **சில நேரங்களில்** mean? (“Sometimes”.) Say it once more.

171.3 எப்போதும் (eppōtum) — always

Before the new one: say the Tamil for often, then the Tamil for sometimes.

You’ll want to know: எப்போதும்

எப்போதும் — *eppōtum* — “always”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

எப்போதும் (*eppōtum*) is native: *eppōtu*, “when” (DEDR 5151), with *-um*, “also, any”: “at any time”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: eppōtum*
- *Say it: eppōtum*, once more
- *Say it:* say *eppōtum*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for often, then the Tamil for sometimes, then say *eppōtum* again

Before you move on

What does **எப்போதும்** mean? (“Always”.) Say it once more.

171.4 ஒருபோதும் (orupōtum) — never (with a negative verb)

Before the new one: say the Tamil for sometimes, then the Tamil for always.

You'll want to know: ஒருபோதும்

ஒருபோதும் — *orupōtum* — "never (with a negative verb)".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

ஒருபோதும் (*orupōtum*) is native: *oru*, "one" (DEDR 990), and *pōtu*, "time" (DEDR 4559), with *-um*: "not even once".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *orupōtum*
- *Say it:* *orupōtum*, once more
- *Say it:* say *orupōtum*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for sometimes, then the Tamil for always, then say *orupōtum* again

Before you move on

What does ஒருபோதும் mean? ("Never (with a negative verb)".) Say it once more.

171.5 தாமதம் (tāmatam) — a delay

Before the new one: say the Tamil for always, then the Tamil for never.

You'll want to know: தாமதம்

தாமதம் — *tāmatam* — "a delay".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

தாமதம் (*tāmatam*) is usually traced to Sanskrit *tāmasa*, "dark, dull" (CDIAL 5775), from *tamas*, "darkness, inertia": delay as sluggishness.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *tāmatam*
- *Say it:* *tāmatam*, once more
- *Say it:* say *tāmatam*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for always, then the Tamil for never, then say *tāmatam* again

Before you move on

What does தாமதம் mean? ("A delay".) Say it once more.

Chapter 172

Future, Tonight, Suddenly, In advance, Calendar

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say the future, tonight, suddenly, in advance and a calendar.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 172: I can say the future, tonight, suddenly, in advance and a calendar.*

172.1 எதிர்காலம் (etirkālam) — the future

> Before the new one: say the Tamil for never, then the Tamil for a delay.

You'll want to know: எதிர்காலம்

எதிர்காலம் — *etirkālam* — "the future".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

எதிர்காலம் (*etirkālam*) is native *etir*, "in front" (DEDR 795), and *kālam*, "time", from Sanskrit *kāla* (CDIAL 3084): "the time in front".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: etirkālam*
- *Say it: etirkālam*, once more
- *Say it:* say *etirkālam*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for never, then the Tamil for a delay, then say *etirkālam* again

Before you move on

What does **எதிர்காலம்** mean? ("The future".) Say it once more.

172.2 இன்றிரவு (in̲r̲iravu) — tonight

Before the new one: say the Tamil for a delay, then the Tamil for the future.

You'll want to know: இன்றிரவு

இன்றிரவு — *in̲r̲iravu* — "tonight".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

இன்றிரவு (*in̲r̲iravu*) is native: *in̲r̲u*, "today" (DEDR 410), and *iravu*, "night" (DEDR 2552).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: in̲r̲iravu*
- *Say it: in̲r̲iravu*, once more
- *Say it:* say *in̲r̲iravu*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for a delay, then the Tamil for the future, then say *in̲r̲iravu* again

Before you move on

What does இன்றிரவு mean? ("Tonight".) Say it once more.

172.3 திடீரென்று (tiṭīreṉṟu) — suddenly

Before the new one: say the Tamil for the future, then the Tamil for tonight.

You'll want to know: திடீரென்று

திடீரென்று — *tiṭīreṉṟu* — "suddenly".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

திடீரென்று (*tiṭīreṉṟu*) is native: DEDR 3216 lists *tiṭīr-eṉal*, an expression of suddenness: the sound *tiṭīr*, with *eṉṟu*, "saying", from *eṉ*, "to say" (DEDR 868).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: tiṭīreṉṟu*
- *Say it: tiṭīreṉṟu*, once more
- *Say it:* say *tiṭīreṉṟu*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for the future, then the Tamil for tonight, then say *tiṭīreṉṟu* again

Before you move on

What does திடீரென்று mean? ("Suddenly".) Say it once more.

172.4 முன்கூட்டியே (muṉkūṭṭiyē) — in advance, beforehand

Before the new one: say the Tamil for tonight, then the Tamil for suddenly.

You'll want to know: முன்கூட்டியே

முன்கூட்டியே — *muṉkūṭṭiyē* — "in advance, beforehand".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

முன்கூட்டியே (*muṉkūṭṭiyē*) is native: *muṉ*, "before" (DEDR 5020), and *kūṭṭi*, "having gathered", from *kūṭu*, "to come together" (DEDR 1882).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: muṉkūṭṭiyē*
- *Say it: muṉkūṭṭiyē*, once more
- *Say it:* say *muṉkūṭṭiyē*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for tonight, then the Tamil for suddenly, then say *muṉkūṭṭiyē* again

Before you move on

What does முன்கூட்டியே mean? ("In advance, beforehand".) Say it once more.

172.5 நாட்காட்டி (nāṭkāṭṭi) — a calendar

Before the new one: say the Tamil for suddenly, then the Tamil for in advance.

You'll want to know: நாட்காட்டி

நாட்காட்டி — *nāṭkāṭṭi* — "a calendar".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

நாட்காட்டி (*nāṭkāṭṭi*) is native: *nāḷ*, "day" (DEDR 3656), and *kāṭṭi*, "the one that shows", from *kāṭṭu*, "to show" (DEDR 1443): "the day-shower".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: nāṭkāṭṭi*
- *Say it: nāṭkāṭṭi*, once more
- *Say it:* say *nāṭkāṭṭi*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for suddenly, then the Tamil for in advance, then say *nāṭkāṭṭi* again

Before you move on

What does நாட்காட்டி mean? ("A calendar".) Say it once more.

Chapter 173

Kitchen, Bathroom, Bedroom, Toilet, Window

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say a kitchen, a bathroom, a bedroom, a toilet and a window.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 173: I can say a kitchen, a bathroom, a bedroom, a toilet and a window.*

173.1 சமையலறை (camaiyalaṟai) — a kitchen

> Before the new one: say the Tamil for in advance, then the Tamil for a calendar.

You'll want to know: சமையலறை

சமையலறை — *camaiyalaṟai* — "a kitchen".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

சமையலறை (*camaiyalaṟai*) is native: *camaiyal*, "cooking" (DEDR 2342), and *aṟai*, "room" (DEDR 322).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: camaiyalaṟai*
- *Say it: camaiyalaṟai*, once more
- *Say it:* say *camaiyalaṟai*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for in advance, then the Tamil for a calendar, then say *camaiyalaṟai* again

Before you move on

What does சமையலறை mean? (“A kitchen”.) Say it once more.

173.2 குளியலறை (kuḷiyalaṟai) — a bathroom

Before the new one: say the Tamil for a calendar, then the Tamil for a kitchen.

You’ll want to know: குளியலறை

குளியலறை — *kuḷiyalaṟai* — “a bathroom”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

குளியலறை (*kuḷiyalaṟai*) is native: *kuḷiyal*, “bathing” (DEDR 1832), and *aṟai*, “room” (DEDR 322).

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: kuḷiyalaṟai*
- *Say it: kuḷiyalaṟai*, once more
- *Say it:* say *kuḷiyalaṟai*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for a calendar, then the Tamil for a kitchen, then say *kuḷiyalaṟai* again

Before you move on

What does குளியலறை mean? ("A bathroom".) Say it once more.

173.3 படுக்கையறை (paṭukkaiyaṟai) — a bedroom

Before the new one: say the Tamil for a kitchen, then the Tamil for a bathroom.

You'll want to know: படுக்கையறை

படுக்கையறை — *paṭukkaiyaṟai* — "a bedroom".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

படுக்கையறை (*paṭukkaiyaṟai*) is native: *paṭukkai*, "bed, lying down" (DEDR 3852), and *aṟai*, "room" (DEDR 322).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: paṭukkaiyaṟai*
- *Say it: paṭukkaiyaṟai*, once more
- *Say it:* say *paṭukkaiyaṟai*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for a kitchen, then the Tamil for a bathroom, then say *paṭukkaiyaṟai* again

Before you move on

What does படுக்கையறை mean? ("A bedroom".) Say it once more.

173.4 கழிப்பறை (kaḻipparai) — a toilet

Before the new one: say the Tamil for a bathroom, then the Tamil for a bedroom.

You'll want to know: கழிப்பறை

கழிப்பறை — *kaḻipparai* — "a toilet".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

கழிப்பறை (*kaḻipparai*) is native: *kaḻippu*, "discharge, getting rid", from *kaḻi*, "to pass, to go out" (DEDR 1356), and *arai*, "room" (DEDR 322).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: kaḻipparai*
- *Say it: kaḻipparai*, once more
- *Say it:* say *kaḻipparai*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for a bathroom, then the Tamil for a bedroom, then say *kaḻipparai* again

Before you move on

What does கழிப்பறை mean? ("A toilet".) Say it once more.

173.5 சன்னல் (caṉṉal) — a window

Before the new one: say the Tamil for a bedroom, then the Tamil for a toilet.

You'll want to know: சன்னல்

சன்னல் — *caṉṉal* — "a window".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

சன்னல் (*caṉṉal*) is a loan from Portuguese *janela*, “window”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: caṉṉal*
- *Say it: caṉṉal*, once more
- *Say it:* say *caṉṉal*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for a bedroom, then the Tamil for a toilet, then say *caṉṉal* again

Before you move on

What does **சன்னல்** mean? (“A window”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 174

Boat, Bicycle, Car, Auto-rickshaw, Passenger

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say a boat, a bicycle, a car, an auto-rickshaw and a passenger.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 174: I can say a boat, a bicycle, a car, an auto-rickshaw and a passenger.*

174.1 படகு (paṭaku) — a boat

> Before the new one: say the Tamil for a toilet, then the Tamil for a window.

You'll want to know: படகு

படகு — *paṭaku* — "a boat".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

படகு (*paṭaku*) is native Dravidian. DEDR 3838 lists Malayalam *paṭaku*, "ship, large boat" and Kannada *paḍagu*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: paṭaku*
- *Say it: paṭaku*, once more
- *Say it:* say *paṭaku*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for a toilet, then the Tamil for a window, then say *paṭaku* again

Before you move on

What does படகு mean? ("A boat".) Say it once more.

174.2 மிதிவண்டி (mitivaṇṭi) — a bicycle

Before the new one: say the Tamil for a window, then the Tamil for a boat.

You'll want to know: மிதிவண்டி

மிதிவண்டி — *mitivaṇṭi* — "a bicycle".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

மிதிவண்டி (*mitivaṇṭi*) is *miti*, "to tread", native (DEDR 4861), and *vaṇṭi*, "cart", an Indo-Aryan loan (DEDR App. 50): "the treading cart".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: mitivaṇṭi*
- *Say it: mitivaṇṭi*, once more
- *Say it:* say *mitivaṇṭi*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for a window, then the Tamil for a boat, then say *mitivaṇṭi* again

Before you move on

What does **மிதிவண்டி** mean? ("A bicycle".) Say it once more.

174.3 கார் (kār) — a car

Before the new one: say the Tamil for a boat, then the Tamil for a bicycle.

You'll want to know: கார்

கார் — *kār* — "a car".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

கார் (*kār*) is a loan from English *car*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: kār*
- *Say it: kār*, once more
- *Say it:* say *kār*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for a boat, then the Tamil for a bicycle, then say *kār* again

Before you move on

What does **கார்** mean? ("A car".) Say it once more.

174.4 ஆட்டோ (āṭṭō) — an auto-rickshaw

Before the new one: say the Tamil for a bicycle, then the Tamil for a car.

You'll want to know: ஆட்டோ

ஆட்டோ — *āṭṭō* — "an auto-rickshaw".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

ஆட்டோ (*āṭṭō*) is a loan from English *auto*, short for *auto-rickshaw*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *āṭṭō*
- *Say it:* *āṭṭō*, once more
- *Say it:* say *āṭṭō*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for a bicycle, then the Tamil for a car, then say *āṭṭō* again

Before you move on

What does ஆட்டோ mean? ("An auto-rickshaw".) Say it once more.

174.5 பயணி (payaṇi) — a passenger, a traveller

Before the new one: say the Tamil for a car, then the Tamil for an auto-rickshaw.

You'll want to know: பயணி

பயணி — *payaṇi* — "a passenger, a traveller".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

பயணி (*payaṇi*) is *payaṇam*, "journey", from Sanskrit *prayāṇa* (CDIAL 8732), with *-i*, "the one who": "the traveller".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: payaṇi*
- *Say it: payaṇi*, once more
- *Say it:* say *payaṇi*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for a car, then the Tamil for an auto-rickshaw, then say *payaṇi* again

Before you move on

What does பயணி mean? ("A passenger, a traveller".) Say it once more.

Chapter 175

Desert, Cave, Stream, Farm, Zoo

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say a desert, a cave, a stream, a farm and a zoo.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 175: I can say a desert, a cave, a stream, a farm and a zoo.*

175.1 பாலைவனம் (pālaivaṉam) — a desert

> Before the new one: say the Tamil for an auto-rickshaw, then the Tamil for a passenger.

You'll want to know: பாலைவனம்

பாலைவனம் — *pālaivaṉam* — "a desert".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

பாலைவனம் (*pālaivaṉam*) is *pālai*, the dry wasteland of old Tamil poetry, named after a plant of that land (DEDR 4100), and *vaṉam*, "forest, tract", from Sanskrit *vana* (CDIAL 11258).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: pālaivaṉam*
- *Say it: pālaivaṉam*, once more
- *Say it:* say *pālaivaṉam*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for an auto-rickshaw, then the Tamil for a passenger, then say *pālaivaṉam* again

Before you move on

What does பாலைவனம் mean? (“A desert”.) Say it once more.

175.2 குகை (kukai) — a cave

Before the new one: say the Tamil for a passenger, then the Tamil for a desert.

You’ll want to know: குகை

குகை — *kukai* — “a cave”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

குகை (*kukai*) is a loan from Sanskrit *guhā*, “hiding place, cave” (CDIAL 4220).

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: kukai*
- *Say it: kukai*, once more
- *Say it:* say *kukai*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for a passenger, then the Tamil for a desert, then say *kukai* again

Before you move on

What does குகை mean? ("A cave".) Say it once more.

175.3 ஓடை (ōṭai) — a stream, a brook

Before the new one: say the Tamil for a desert, then the Tamil for a cave.

You'll want to know: ஓடை

ஓடை — *ōṭai* — "a stream, a brook".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

ஓடை (*ōṭai*) is native Dravidian. DEDR 1041 lists Malayalam *ōṭuka*, "to run, to flow". It comes from *ōṭu*, "to run": "running water".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *ōṭai*
- *Say it:* *ōṭai*, once more
- *Say it:* say *ōṭai*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for a desert, then the Tamil for a cave, then say *ōṭai* again

Before you move on

What does ஓடை mean? ("A stream, a brook".) Say it once more.

175.4 பண்ணை (paṇṇai) — a farm

Before the new one: say the Tamil for a cave, then the Tamil for a stream.

You'll want to know: பண்ணை

பண்ணை — *paṇṇai* — "a farm".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

பண்ணை (*paṇṇai*) is native Dravidian. DEDR 3891 lists Malayalam *paṇa*, "worked ground".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: paṇṇai*
- *Say it: paṇṇai*, once more
- *Say it:* say *paṇṇai*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for a cave, then the Tamil for a stream, then say *paṇṇai* again

Before you move on

What does **பண்ணை** mean? ("A farm".) Say it once more.

175.5 மிருகக்காட்சிசாலை (mirukakkāṭcicālai) — a zoo

Before the new one: say the Tamil for a stream, then the Tamil for a farm.

You'll want to know: மிருகக்காட்சிசாலை

மிருகக்காட்சிசாலை — *mirukakkāṭcicālai* — "a zoo".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

மிருகக்காட்சிசாலை (*mirukakkāṭcicālai*) is "the hall for showing animals": *mirukam*, "animal", from Sanskrit *mṛga* (CDIAL 10264), native *kāṭci*, "show, sight" (DEDR 1443), and *cālai*, "hall", from

Sanskrit *śālā* (CDIAL 12414).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: mirukakkāṭcicālai*
- *Say it: mirukakkāṭcicālai*, once more
- *Say it:* say *mirukakkāṭcicālai*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for a stream, then the Tamil for a farm, then say *mirukakkāṭcicālai* again

Before you move on

What does மிருகக்காட்சிசாலை mean? ("A zoo".) Say it once more.

Chapter 176

However, Even though, Moreover, For example, Otherwise

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say however, even though, moreover, for example and otherwise.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 176: I can say however, even though, moreover, for example and otherwise.*

176.1 ஆனாலும் (āṉāl̲um) — however, even so

> Before the new one: say the Tamil for a farm, then the Tamil for a zoo.

You'll want to know: ஆனாலும்

ஆனாலும் — *āṉāl̲um* — "however, even so".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

ஆனாலும் (*āṉāl̲um*) is native: *āṉāl̲*, "but", from *ā*, "to become" (DEDR 333), with *-um*, "even": "even so".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *āṉālum*
- *Say it:* *āṉālum*, once more
- *Say it:* say *āṉālum*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for a farm, then the Tamil for a zoo, then say *āṉālum* again

Before you move on

What does ஆனாலும் mean? (“However, even so”.) Say it once more.

176.2 இருந்தாலும் (iruntālum) — even though, although

Before the new one: say the Tamil for a zoo, then the Tamil for however.

You’ll want to know: இருந்தாலும்

இருந்தாலும் — *iruntālum* — “even though, although”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

இருந்தாலும் (*iruntālum*) is native Dravidian. DEDR 480 lists Malayalam *irikkuka*, “to be”. It is *iru*, “to be”, in the form “even if it is”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *iruntālum*
- *Say it:* *iruntālum*, once more
- *Say it:* say *iruntālum*

- *Recall:* say the Tamil for a zoo, then the Tamil for however, then say *iruntālum* again

Before you move on

What does இருந்தாலும் mean? (“Even though, although”.) Say it once more.

176.3 மேலும் (mēlum) — moreover, furthermore

Before the new one: say the Tamil for however, then the Tamil for even though.

You’ll want to know: மேலும்

மேலும் — *mēlum* — “moreover, furthermore”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

மேலும் (*mēlum*) is native Dravidian (DEDR 5086). It is *mēl*, “above, more”, with *-um*, “also”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: mēlum*
- *Say it: mēlum*, once more
- *Say it:* say *mēlum*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for however, then the Tamil for even though, then say *mēlum* again

Before you move on

What does மேலும் mean? (“Moreover, furthermore”.) Say it once more.

176.4 உதாரணமாக (utāraṇamāka) — for example

Before the new one: say the Tamil for even though, then the Tamil for moreover.

You'll want to know: உதாரணமாக

உதாரணமாக — *utāraṇamāka* — "for example".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

உதாரணமாக (*utāraṇamāka*) is *utāraṇam*, "example", a well-established loan from Sanskrit *udāharaṇa*, with *-āka*, "as".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: utāraṇamāka*
- *Say it: utāraṇamāka*, once more
- *Say it:* say *utāraṇamāka*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for even though, then the Tamil for moreover, then say *utāraṇamāka* again

Before you move on

What does **உதாரணமாக** mean? ("For example".) Say it once more.

176.5 இல்லாவிட்டால் (illāviṭṭāl) — otherwise, if not

Before the new one: say the Tamil for moreover, then the Tamil for for example.

You'll want to know: இல்லாவிட்டால்

இல்லாவிட்டால் — *illāviṭṭāl* — "otherwise, if not".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

இல்லாவிட்டால் (*illāviṭṭāl*) is native: *illā*, "not being" (DEDR 2559), and *viṭṭāl*, "if it is left", from *viṭu* (DEDR 5393): "if not".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: illāviṭṭāl*
- *Say it: illāviṭṭāl*, once more
- *Say it:* say *illāviṭṭāl*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for moreover, then the Tamil for for example, then say *illāviṭṭāl* again

Before you move on

What does இல்லாவிட்டால் mean? ("Otherwise, if not".) Say it once more.

Chapter 177

Result, Problem, Solution, Purpose, Experience

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say a result, a problem, a solution, a purpose and an experience.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 177: I can say a result, a problem, a solution, a purpose and an experience.

177.1 விளைவு (viḷaivu) — a result, a consequence

Before the new one: say the Tamil for for example, then the Tamil for otherwise.

You'll want to know: விளைவு

விளைவு — *viḷaivu* — "a result, a consequence".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

விளைவு (*viḷaivu*) is native Dravidian. DEDR 5437 lists Malayalam *viḷa*, "crop". It is the noun of *viḷai*, "to be produced, to result".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: viḷaivu*
- *Say it: viḷaivu*, once more
- *Say it:* say *viḷaivu*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for for example, then the Tamil for otherwise, then say *viḷaivu* again

Before you move on

What does **விளைவு** mean? ("A result, a consequence".) Say it once more.

177.2 பிரச்சினை (piracciṉai) — a problem

Before the new one: say the Tamil for otherwise, then the Tamil for a result.

You'll want to know: பிரச்சினை

பிரச்சினை — *piracciṉai* — "a problem".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

பிரச்சினை (*piracciṉai*) is a loan from Sanskrit *praśna*, "question" (CDIAL 8818). Tamil broke up the *pr-* and the *śn*, and the sense moved from a question to a problem.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: piracciṉai*
- *Say it: piracciṉai*, once more
- *Say it:* say *piracciṉai*

- *Recall:* say the Tamil for otherwise, then the Tamil for a result, then say *piraccin̲ai* again

Before you move on

What does **பிரச்சினை** mean? ("A problem".) Say it once more.

177.3 தீர்வு (tīrvu) — a solution

Before the new one: say the Tamil for a result, then the Tamil for a problem.

You'll want to know: தீர்வு

தீர்வு — *tīrvu* — "a solution".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

தீர்வு (*tīrvu*) is native Dravidian. DEDR 3278 lists Malayalam *tīruka*, "to be settled, finished". It is the noun of *tīr*, "to end, to be settled": a solution ends the problem.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: tīrvu*
- *Say it: tīrvu*, once more
- *Say it:* say *tīrvu*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for a result, then the Tamil for a problem, then say *tīrvu* again

Before you move on

What does **தீர்வு** mean? ("A solution".) Say it once more.

177.4 நோக்கம் (nōkkam) — a purpose, an aim

Before the new one: say the Tamil for a problem, then the Tamil for a solution.

You'll want to know: நோக்கம்

நோக்கம் — *nōkkam* — "a purpose, an aim".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

நோக்கம் (*nōkkam*) is native Dravidian. DEDR 3794 lists Malayalam *nōkkuka*, "to look at". It is the noun of *nōkku*, "to look": an aim is where one looks.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: nōkkam*
- *Say it: nōkkam*, once more
- *Say it:* say *nōkkam*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for a problem, then the Tamil for a solution, then say *nōkkam* again

Before you move on

What does நோக்கம் mean? ("A purpose, an aim".) Say it once more.

177.5 அனுபவம் (a̲nupavam) — an experience

Before the new one: say the Tamil for a solution, then the Tamil for a purpose.

You'll want to know: அனுபவம்

அனுபவம் — *a̲nupavam* — "an experience".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

அனுபவம் (*a̲nupavam*) is a well-established loan from Sanskrit *anubhava*, “experience, perception”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *a̲nupavam*
- *Say it:* *a̲nupavam*, once more
- *Say it:* say *a̲nupavam*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for a solution, then the Tamil for a purpose, then say *a̲nupavam* again

Before you move on

What does அனுபவம் mean? (“An experience”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 178

Tasty, Cheap, Expensive, Free of charge, Ripe

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (7) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 7 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say tasty, cheap, expensive, free of charge and ripe.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 178: I can say tasty, cheap, expensive, free of charge and ripe.*

178.1 சுவையான (cuvaiyāṉa) — tasty

> Before the new one: say the Tamil for a purpose, then the Tamil for an experience.

You'll want to know: சுவையான

சுவையான — *cuvaiyāṉa* — "tasty".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

சுவையான (*cuvaiyāṉa*) is native Dravidian. DEDR 2396 lists Kannada *savi*, "palatable". The entry lists *cuvai*, "to taste", beside *cavi*, "taste"; -*āṉa* makes it "tasty".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *cuvaiyāṉa*
- *Say it:* *cuvaiyāṉa*, once more
- *Say it:* say *cuvaiyāṉa*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for a purpose, then the Tamil for an experience, then say *cuvaiyāṉa* again

Before you move on

What does சுவையான mean? (“Tasty”.) Say it once more.

178.2 மலிவான (malivāṉa) — cheap

Before the new one: say the Tamil for an experience, then the Tamil for tasty.

You’ll want to know: மலிவான

மலிவான — *malivāṉa* — “cheap”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

மலிவான (*malivāṉa*) is native Dravidian (DEDR 4729). It is *malivu*, “abundance”, from *mali*, “to abound”: what is plentiful is cheap.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *malivāṉa*
- *Say it:* *malivāṉa*, once more
- *Say it:* say *malivāṉa*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for an experience, then the Tamil for tasty, then say *malivāṉa* again

Before you move on

What does **மலிவான** mean? ("Cheap".) Say it once more.

178.3 விலையுயர்ந்த (vilaiyuyarnta) — expensive

Before the new one: say the Tamil for tasty, then the Tamil for cheap.

You'll want to know: விலையுயர்ந்த

விலையுயர்ந்த — *vilaiyuyarnta* — "expensive".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

விலையுயர்ந்த (*vilaiyuyarnta*) is native: *vilai*, "price" (DEDR 5421), and *uyarnta*, "risen, high", from *uyar*, "to rise" (DEDR 646).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: vilaiyuyarnta*
- *Say it: vilaiyuyarnta*, once more
- *Say it:* say *vilaiyuyarnta*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for tasty, then the Tamil for cheap, then say *vilaiyuyarnta* again

Before you move on

What does **விலையுயர்ந்த** mean? ("Expensive".) Say it once more.

178.4 இலவசம் (ilavacam) — free of charge

Before the new one: say the Tamil for cheap, then the Tamil for expensive.

You'll want to know: இலவசம்

இலவசம் — *ilavacam* — "free of charge".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

The origin of இலவசம் (*ilavacam*) is uncertain. DEDR has no entry for it, and no source for it is settled.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: ilavacam*
- *Say it: ilavacam*, once more
- *Say it:* say *ilavacam*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for cheap, then the Tamil for expensive, then say *ilavacam* again

Before you move on

What does இலவசம் mean? ("Free of charge".) Say it once more.

178.5 பழுத்த (pa̲lutta) — ripe

Before the new one: say the Tamil for expensive, then the Tamil for free of charge.

You'll want to know: பழுத்த

பழுத்த — *pa̲lutta* — "ripe".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

பழுத்த (*pa̲lutta*) is native Dravidian. DEDR 4004 lists Malayalam *pa̲lukka*, "to grow ripe". It is *pa̲lu*, "to ripen", in the form "that has ripened". The entry compares Sanskrit *phala*, "fruit" (CDIAL 9051).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *pa̲lutta*
- *Say it:* *pa̲lutta*, once more
- *Say it:* say *pa̲lutta*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for expensive, then the Tamil for free of charge, then say *pa̲lutta* again

Before you move on

What does பழுத்த mean? ("Ripe".) Say it once more.

178.6 Words from chapters 170-173 — a first pass

Say the words for free of charge and ripe.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- an allergy, an infection, a scar, diarrhoea, the brain
- often, sometimes, always, never, a delay
- the future, tonight, suddenly, in advance, a calendar
- a kitchen, a bathroom, a bedroom, a toilet, a window

Before you move on

An allergy? (ஒவ்வாமை, *ovvāmai.*) An infection? (தொற்று, *toṟṟu.*) A scar? (தழும்பு, *taḻumpu.*) Diarrhoea? (வயிற்றுப்போக்கு, *vayiṟṟuppōkku.*) The brain? (மூளை, *mūḷai.*) Often? (அடிக்கடி, *aṭikkaṭi.*) Sometimes? (சில நேரங்களில், *cila nēraṅkaḷil.*) Always? (எப்போதும், *eppōtum.*) Never? (ஒருபோதும், *orupōtum.*) A delay? (தாமதம், *tāmatam.*) The future? (எதிர்காலம், *etirkālam.*) Tonight? (இன்றிரவு, *iṉṟiravu.*) Suddenly? (திடீரென்று, *tiṭīreṉṟu.*) In advance? (முன்கூட்டியே, *muṉkūṭṭiyē.*) A calendar? (நாட்காட்டி, *nāṭkāṭṭi.*) A kitchen? (சமையலறை, *camaiyalaṟai.*) A bathroom? (குளியலறை, *kuḷiyalaṟai.*) A bedroom? (படுக்கையறை, *paṭukkaiyaṟai.*) A toilet? (கழிப்பறை, *kaḻippaṟai.*) A window? (சன்னல், *caṉṉal.*)

178.7 Words from chapters 174-178 — a second pass

Say the words for a boat and a bicycle.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- a boat, a bicycle, a car, an auto-rickshaw, a passenger
- a desert, a cave, a stream, a farm, a zoo
- however, even though, moreover, for example, otherwise
- a result, a problem, a solution, a purpose, an experience
- tasty, cheap, expensive, free of charge, ripe

Before you move on

A boat? (படகு, *paṭaku.*) A bicycle? (மிதிவண்டி, *mitivaṇṭi.*) A car? (கார், *kār.*) An auto-rickshaw? (ஆட்டோ, *āṭṭō.*) A passenger? (பயணி, *payaṇi.*) A desert? (பாலைவனம், *pālaivaṉam.*) A cave? (குகை, *kukai.*) A stream? (ஓடை, *ōṭai.*) A farm?

(பண்ணை, *paṇṇai.*) A zoo? (மிருகக்காட்சிசாலை, *mirukakkāṭcicālai.*) However? (ஆனாலும், *āṉālum.*) Even though? (இருந்தாலும், *iruntālum.*) Moreover? (மேலும், *mēlum.*) For example? (உதாரணமாக, *utāraṇamāka.*) Otherwise? (இல்லாவிட்டால், *illāviṭṭāl.*) A result? (விளைவு, *viḷaivu.*) A problem? (பிரச்சினை, *piracciṉai.*) A solution? (தீர்வு, *tīrvu.*) A purpose? (நோக்கம், *nōkkam.*) An experience? (அனுபவம், *aṉupavam.*) Tasty? (சுவையான, *cuvaiyāṉa.*) Cheap? (மலிவான, *malivāṉa.*) Expensive? (விலையுயர்ந்த, *vilaiyuyarnta.*) Free of charge? (இலவசம், *ilavacam.*) Ripe? (பழுத்த, *paḻutta.*)

Chapter 179

Useful, Local, Foreign, Clear, Feeling

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say useful, local, foreign, clear and a feeling.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 179: I can say useful, local, foreign, clear and a feeling.*

179.1 பயனுள்ள (payaṉuḷḷa) — useful

> Before the new one: say the Tamil for free of charge, then the Tamil for ripe.

You'll want to know: பயனுள்ள

பயனுள்ள — *payaṉuḷḷa* — "useful".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

பயனுள்ள (*payaṉuḷḷa*) is *payaṉ*, "use, benefit", with *uḷḷa*, "which has", from native *uḷ*, "to be" (DEDR 697). *Payaṉ* is usually connected with *paya*, "to yield, to bear fruit" (DEDR 3937), but DEDR does not list *payaṉ* itself.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: payaṉuḷḷa*
- *Say it: payaṉuḷḷa*, once more
- *Say it:* say *payaṉuḷḷa*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for free of charge, then the Tamil for ripe, then say *payaṉuḷḷa* again

Before you move on

What does பயனுள்ள mean? ("Useful".) Say it once more.

179.2 உள்ளூர் (uḷḷūr) — local

Before the new one: say the Tamil for ripe, then the Tamil for useful.

You'll want to know: உள்ளூர்

உள்ளூர் — *uḷḷūr* — "local".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

உள்ளூர் (*uḷḷūr*) is native: *uḷ*, "inside" (DEDR 698), and *ūr*, "village, town" (DEDR 752; Malayalam *ūr*): "of the town within".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: uḷḷūr*
- *Say it: uḷḷūr*, once more
- *Say it:* say *uḷḷūr*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for ripe, then the Tamil for useful, then say *uḷḷūr* again

Before you move on

What does **உள்ளூர்** mean? (“Local”.) Say it once more.

179.3 வெளிநாட்டு (veḷināṭṭu) — foreign

Before the new one: say the Tamil for useful, then the Tamil for local.

You’ll want to know: வெளிநாட்டு

வெளிநாட்டு — *veḷināṭṭu* — “foreign”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

வெளிநாட்டு (*veḷināṭṭu*) is native: *veḷi*, “outside” (DEDR 5498), and *nāṭu*, “country” (DEDR 3638; Malayalam *nāṭu*): “of the outside country”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: veḷināṭṭu*
- *Say it: veḷināṭṭu*, once more
- *Say it:* say *veḷināṭṭu*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for useful, then the Tamil for local, then say *veḷināṭṭu* again

Before you move on

What does **வெளிநாட்டு** mean? (“Foreign”.) Say it once more.

179.4 தெளிவான (teḷivāṉa) — clear

Before the new one: say the Tamil for local, then the Tamil for foreign.

You'll want to know: தெளிவான

தெளிவான — *teḷivāṉa* — "clear".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

தெளிவான (*teḷivāṉa*) is native Dravidian. DEDR 3433 lists Malayalam *teḷi*, "clearness". It is *teḷivu*, "clarity", with *-āṉa*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: teḷivāṉa*
- *Say it: teḷivāṉa*, once more
- *Say it:* say *teḷivāṉa*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for local, then the Tamil for foreign, then say *teḷivāṉa* again

Before you move on

What does தெளிவான mean? ("Clear".) Say it once more.

179.5 உணர்ச்சி (uṇarcci) — a feeling, an emotion

Before the new one: say the Tamil for foreign, then the Tamil for clear.

You'll want to know: உணர்ச்சி

உணர்ச்சி — *uṇarcci* — "a feeling, an emotion".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

உணர்ச்சி (*uṇarcci*) is native Dravidian. DEDR 603 lists Malayalam *uṇaruka*, "to wake" and Kannada *oṇar*, "to feel". It is the noun of *uṇar*, "to wake, to perceive, to feel".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *uṇarcci*
- *Say it:* *uṇarcci*, once more
- *Say it:* say *uṇarcci*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for foreign, then the Tamil for clear, then say *uṇarcci* again

Before you move on

What does **உணர்ச்சி** mean? ("A feeling, an emotion".) Say it once more.

Chapter 180

Active, Naughty, Stubborn, Funny, Interesting

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say active, naughty, stubborn, funny and interesting.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 180: I can say active, naughty, stubborn, funny and interesting.

180.1 சுறுசுறுப்பான (cu̲ru̲cu̲ruppā̲na) — active, energetic

Before the new one: say the Tamil for clear, then the Tamil for a feeling.

You'll want to know: சுறுசுறுப்பான

சுறுசுறுப்பான — *cu̲ru̲cu̲ruppā̲na* — "active, energetic".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

சுறுசுறுப்பான (*cu̲ru̲cu̲ruppā̲na*) is native Dravidian (DEDR 2713). The entry lists *cu̲ru̲cu̲ruppu*, "diligence, bustling", under *cu̲rukku*, "quickness"; *-ā̲na* makes it "active".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: cuṟucuṟuppāṉa*
- *Say it: cuṟucuṟuppāṉa*, once more
- *Say it:* say *cuṟucuṟuppāṉa*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for clear, then the Tamil for a feeling, then say *cuṟucuṟuppāṉa* again

Before you move on

What does சுறுசுறுப்பான mean? ("Active, energetic".) Say it once more.

180.2 குறும்பான (kuṟumpāṉa) — naughty, mischievous

Before the new one: say the Tamil for a feeling, then the Tamil for active.

You'll want to know: குறும்பான

குறும்பான — *kuṟumpāṉa* — "naughty, mischievous".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

குறும்பான (*kuṟumpāṉa*) is native Dravidian. DEDR 1856 lists Malayalam *kuṟumpu*, "insolence". It is *kuṟumpu*, "mischief", with *-āṉa*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: kuṟumpāṉa*
- *Say it: kuṟumpāṉa*, once more
- *Say it:* say *kuṟumpāṉa*

- *Recall:* say the Tamil for a feeling, then the Tamil for active, then say *kuṟumpāṉa* again

Before you move on

What does குறும்பான mean? (“Naughty, mischievous”.) Say it once more.

180.3 பிடிவாதமான (piṭivātamāṉa) — stubborn

Before the new one: say the Tamil for active, then the Tamil for naughty.

You’ll want to know: பிடிவாதமான

பிடிவாதமான — *piṭivātamāṉa* — “stubborn”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

பிடிவாதமான (*piṭivātamāṉa*) is *piṭivātam*, “stubbornness”: native *piṭi*, “to seize, to hold” (DEDR 4148), and *vātam*, “argument”, from Sanskrit *vāda*, “speech, dispute” (CDIAL 11507). It is “holding to one’s argument”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: piṭivātamāṉa*
- *Say it: piṭivātamāṉa*, once more
- *Say it:* say *piṭivātamāṉa*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for active, then the Tamil for naughty, then say *piṭivātamāṉa* again

Before you move on

What does பிடிவாதமான mean? (“Stubborn”.) Say it once more.

180.4 நகைச்சுவையான (nakaiccuvaiyāṉa) — funny, humorous

Before the new one: say the Tamil for naughty, then the Tamil for stubborn.

You'll want to know: நகைச்சுவையான

நகைச்சுவையான — *nakaiccuvaiyāṉa* — "funny, humorous".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

நகைச்சுவையான (*nakaiccuvaiyāṉa*) is native: *nakai*, "laughter" (DEDR 3569), and *cuvai*, "taste, flavour" (DEDR 2396), with *-āṉa*: "with the flavour of laughter".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: nakaiccuvaiyāṉa*
- *Say it: nakaiccuvaiyāṉa*, once more
- *Say it:* say *nakaiccuvaiyāṉa*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for naughty, then the Tamil for stubborn, then say *nakaiccuvaiyāṉa* again

Before you move on

What does நகைச்சுவையான mean? ("Funny, humorous".) Say it once more.

180.5 சுவாரசியமான (cuvāraciyamāṉa) — interesting

Before the new one: say the Tamil for stubborn, then the Tamil for funny.

You'll want to know: சுவாரசியமான

சுவாரசியமான — *cuvāraciyamāṉa* — "interesting".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

சுவாரசியமான (*cuvāraciyamāṉa*) is *cuvāraciyam*, "interest, relish", a well-established loan from Sanskrit *svārasya*, "natural flavour, charm", with *-āṉa*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: cuvāraciyamāṉa*
- *Say it: cuvāraciyamāṉa*, once more
- *Say it:* say *cuvāraciyamāṉa*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for stubborn, then the Tamil for funny, then say *cuvāraciyamāṉa* again

Before you move on

What does சுவாரசியமான mean? ("Interesting".) Say it once more.

Chapter 181

Favourite, Terrible, Many, Everything, Thick

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say favourite, terrible, many, everything and thick.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 181: I can say favourite, terrible, many, everything and thick.*

181.1 பிடித்தமான (piṭittamāṉa) — favourite

> Before the new one: say the Tamil for funny, then the Tamil for interesting.

You'll want to know: பிடித்தமான

பிடித்தமான — *piṭittamāṉa* — "favourite".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

பிடித்தமான (*piṭittamāṉa*) is native Dravidian (DEDR 4148). The entry glosses the verb *piṭi* "to grasp" and also "to be pleasing"; what you are fond of is what "takes hold" of you, as in *enakku piṭikkum*, "I like it".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *piṭittamāṉa*
- *Say it:* *piṭittamāṉa*, once more
- *Say it:* say *piṭittamāṉa*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for funny, then the Tamil for interesting, then say *piṭittamāṉa* again

Before you move on

What does பிடித்தமான mean? (“Favourite”.) Say it once more.

181.2 மோசமான (mōcamāṉa) — terrible, awful

Before the new one: say the Tamil for interesting, then the Tamil for favourite.

You’ll want to know: மோசமான

மோசமான — *mōcamāṉa* — “terrible, awful”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

The origin of மோசமான (*mōcamāṉa*) is uncertain. *Mōcam*, “deceit, a bad turn”, has no entry in DEDR; it is probably Sanskrit *mōṣa*, “theft” (CDIAL 10358).

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *mōcamāṉa*
- *Say it:* *mōcamāṉa*, once more
- *Say it:* say *mōcamāṉa*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for interesting, then the Tamil for favourite, then say *mōcamāṉa* again

Before you move on

What does மோசமான mean? ("Terrible, awful".) Say it once more.

181.3 பல (pala) — many, several

Before the new one: say the Tamil for favourite, then the Tamil for terrible.

You'll want to know: பல

பல — *pala* — "many, several".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

பல (*pala*) is native Dravidian. DEDR 3987 lists Malayalam *pala*, Kannada *pala* and Telugu *palu*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: pala*
- *Say it: pala*, once more
- *Say it:* say *pala*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for favourite, then the Tamil for terrible, then say *pala* again

Before you move on

What does பல mean? ("Many, several".) Say it once more.

181.4 எல்லாம் (ellām) — everything, all

Before the new one: say the Tamil for terrible, then the Tamil for many.

You'll want to know: எல்லாம்

எல்லாம் — *ellām* — "everything, all".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

எல்லாம் (*ellām*) is native Dravidian. DEDR 844 lists Malayalam *ellām*, Kannada *ella* and Telugu *ella*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: ellām*
- *Say it: ellām*, once more
- *Say it:* say *ellām*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for terrible, then the Tamil for many, then say *ellām* again

Before you move on

What does **எல்லாம்** mean? ("Everything, all".) Say it once more.

181.5 தடிமனான (taṭimaṉāṉa) — thick

Before the new one: say the Tamil for many, then the Tamil for everything.

You'll want to know: தடிமனான

தடிமனான — *taṭimaṉāṉa* — "thick".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

தடிமனான (*taṭimaṉāṉa*) is *taṭimaṉ*, "thickness", which is probably built on *taṭi*, "stick, club, a thick piece" (DEDR 3030). DEDR does not list *taṭimaṉ* itself, so the link is likely rather than proven.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *taṭimaṉāṉa*
- *Say it:* *taṭimaṉāṉa*, once more
- *Say it:* say *taṭimaṉāṉa*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for many, then the Tamil for everything, then say *taṭimaṉāṉa* again

Before you move on

What does தடிமனான mean? ("Thick".) Say it once more.

Chapter 182

Refrigerator, Tap, Tumbler, Pan, Lid

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say a refrigerator, a tap, a tumbler, a pan and a lid.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 182: I can say a refrigerator, a tap, a tumbler, a pan and a lid.*

182.1 குளிர்சாதனப் பெட்டி (kuḷircātaṉap peṭṭi) — a refrigerator

Before the new one: say the Tamil for everything, then the Tamil for thick.

You'll want to know: குளிர்சாதனப் பெட்டி

குளிர்சாதனப் பெட்டி — *kuḷircātaṉap peṭṭi* — "a refrigerator".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

குளிர்சாதனப் பெட்டி (*kuḷircātaṉap peṭṭi*) is "the cooling-device box": native *kuḷir*, "cold" (DEDR 1834), *cātaṉam*, "device", from Sanskrit *sādhana*, "means, instrument" (CDIAL 13334), and native *peṭṭi*, "box" (DEDR 4388).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: kuḻircātaṉap peṭṭi*
- *Say it: kuḻircātaṉap peṭṭi*, once more
- *Say it:* say *kuḻircātaṉap peṭṭi*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for everything, then the Tamil for thick, then say *kuḻircātaṉap peṭṭi* again

Before you move on

What does குளிர்சாதனப் பெட்டி mean? ("A refrigerator".) Say it once more.

182.2 குழாய் (kuḻāy) — a tap, a pipe

Before the new one: say the Tamil for thick, then the Tamil for a refrigerator.

You'll want to know: குழாய்

குழாய் — *kuḻāy* — "a tap, a pipe".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

குழாய் (*kuḻāy*) is native Dravidian. DEDR 1818 lists Malayalam *kuḻal*, "tube". The entry gathers words for tubes and pipes.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: kuḻāy*
- *Say it: kuḻāy*, once more

- *Say it:* say *kuḻāy*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for thick, then the Tamil for a refrigerator, then say *kuḻāy* again

Before you move on

What does குழாய் mean? ("A tap, a pipe".) Say it once more.

182.3 டம்ளர் (ṭamḷar) — a tumbler, a drinking glass

Before the new one: say the Tamil for a refrigerator, then the Tamil for a tap.

You'll want to know: டம்ளர்

டம்ளர் — *ṭamḷar* — "a tumbler, a drinking glass".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

டம்ளர் (*ṭamḷar*) is a loan from English *tumbler*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: ṭamḷar*
- *Say it: ṭamḷar*, once more
- *Say it:* say *ṭamḷar*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for a refrigerator, then the Tamil for a tap, then say *ṭamḷar* again

Before you move on

What does டம்ளர் mean? ("A tumbler, a drinking glass".) Say it once more.

182.4 சட்டி (caṭṭi) — a pan, a cooking pot

Before the new one: say the Tamil for a tap, then the Tamil for a tumbler.

You'll want to know: சட்டி

சட்டி — *caṭṭi* — "a pan, a cooking pot".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

சட்டி (*caṭṭi*) is native Dravidian. DEDR 2306 lists Malayalam *caṭṭi*, "pot", Kannada *caṭṭi* and Telugu *caṭṭi*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: caṭṭi*
- *Say it: caṭṭi*, once more
- *Say it:* say *caṭṭi*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for a tap, then the Tamil for a tumbler, then say *caṭṭi* again

Before you move on

What does சட்டி mean? ("A pan, a cooking pot".) Say it once more.

182.5 மூடி (mūṭi) — a lid

Before the new one: say the Tamil for a tumbler, then the Tamil for a pan.

You'll want to know: மூடி

மூடி — *mūṭi* — "a lid".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

மூடி (*mūṭi*) is native Dravidian (DEDR 5034). It is "the cover", from *mūṭu*, "to cover, to close".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: mūṭi*
- *Say it: mūṭi*, once more
- *Say it:* say *mūṭi*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for a tumbler, then the Tamil for a pan, then say *mūṭi* again

Before you move on

What does மூடி mean? ("A lid".) Say it once more.

Chapter 183

Pongal, Upma, Sambar, Chutney, Dry stir-fried vegetable dish

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say pongal, upma, sambar, a chutney and a dry stir-fried vegetable dish.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 183: I can say pongal, upma, sambar, a chutney and a dry stir-fried vegetable dish.*

183.1 பொங்கல் (poṅkal) — pongal, a rice and lentil dish

Before the new one: say the Tamil for a pan, then the Tamil for a lid.

You'll want to know: பொங்கல்

பொங்கல் — *poṅkal* — "pongal, a rice and lentil dish".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

பொங்கல் (*poṅkal*) is native Dravidian. DEDR 4469 lists Kannada *poṅgu*, "to boil over" and Telugu *poṅgu*. It is named for *poṅku*, "to boil over": the pot is let boil over at the festival.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: poṅkal*
- *Say it: poṅkal*, once more
- *Say it:* say *poṅkal*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for a pan, then the Tamil for a lid, then say *poṅkal* again

Before you move on

What does பொங்கல் mean? ("Pongal, a rice and lentil dish".) Say it once more.

183.2 உப்புமா (uppumā) — upma, a semolina dish

Before the new one: say the Tamil for a lid, then the Tamil for pongal.

You'll want to know: உப்புமா

உப்புமா — *uppumā* — "upma, a semolina dish".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

உப்புமா (*uppumā*) is native: *uppu*, "salt" (DEDR 2674), and *mā*, "flour, meal" (DEDR 4784): "salted meal".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: uppumā*
- *Say it: uppumā*, once more
- *Say it:* say *uppumā*

- *Recall:* say the Tamil for a lid, then the Tamil for pongal, then say *uppumā* again

Before you move on

What does உப்புமா mean? (“Upma, a semolina dish”.) Say it once more.

183.3 சாம்பார் (cāmpār) — sambar, a lentil and vegetable stew

Before the new one: say the Tamil for pongal, then the Tamil for upma.

You’ll want to know: சாம்பார்

சாம்பார் — *cāmpār* — “sambar, a lentil and vegetable stew”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

The origin of சாம்பார் (*cāmpār*) is not settled. It is usually traced to Sanskrit *saṁbhāra*, “bringing together, materials” (CDIAL 12966), through Marathi *sāmbār*, but that route is not proven.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: cāmpār*
- *Say it: cāmpār*, once more
- *Say it:* say *cāmpār*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for pongal, then the Tamil for upma, then say *cāmpār* again

Before you move on

What does **சாம்பார்** mean? ("Sambar, a lentil and vegetable stew".) Say it once more.

183.4 சட்னி (caṭn̲i) — a chutney

Before the new one: say the Tamil for upma, then the Tamil for sambar.

You'll want to know: சட்னி

சட்னி — *caṭn̲i* — "a chutney".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

சட்னி (*caṭn̲i*) is a loan from Hindustani *caṭnī*, "chutney", the source of English *chutney* too.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: caṭn̲i*
- *Say it: caṭn̲i*, once more
- *Say it:* say *caṭn̲i*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for upma, then the Tamil for sambar, then say *caṭn̲i* again

Before you move on

What does **சட்னி** mean? ("A chutney".) Say it once more.

183.5 பொரியல் (poriyal) — a dry stir-fried vegetable dish

Before the new one: say the Tamil for sambar, then the Tamil for a chutney.

You'll want to know: பொரியல்

பொரியல் — *poriyal* — "a dry stir-fried vegetable dish".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

பொரியல் (*poriyal*) is native Dravidian. DEDR 4537 lists Malayalam *pori*, "what is parched". It comes from *pori*, "to be parched, roasted, fried".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: poriyal*
- *Say it: poriyal*, once more
- *Say it:* say *poriyal*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for sambar, then the Tamil for a chutney, then say *poriyal* again

Before you move on

What does பொரியல் mean? ("A dry stir-fried vegetable dish".) Say it once more.

Chapter 184

Ice, Breakfast, Lunch, Dinner, Notebook

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say ice, breakfast, lunch, dinner and a notebook.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 184: I can say ice, breakfast, lunch, dinner and a notebook.*

184.1 பனிக்கட்டி (paṉikkaṭṭi) — ice

> Before the new one: say the Tamil for a chutney, then the Tamil for a dry stir-fried vegetable dish.

You'll want to know: பனிக்கட்டி

பனிக்கட்டி — *paṉikkaṭṭi* — "ice".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

பனிக்கட்டி (*paṉikkaṭṭi*) is native: *paṉi*, "dew, frost" (DEDR 4035), and *kaṭṭi*, "lump", from *kaṭṭu*, "to harden, to congeal" (DEDR 1148, which compares Sanskrit *kaṭhina*, "hard"): "a lump of frost".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: paṉikkaṭṭi*
- *Say it: paṉikkaṭṭi*, once more
- *Say it:* say *paṉikkaṭṭi*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for a chutney, then the Tamil for a dry stir-fried vegetable dish, then say *paṉikkaṭṭi* again

Before you move on

What does பனிக்கட்டி mean? ("Ice".) Say it once more.

184.2 காலை உணவு (kālai uṇavu) — breakfast

Before the new one: say the Tamil for a dry stir-fried vegetable dish, then the Tamil for ice.

You'll want to know: காலை உணவு

காலை உணவு — *kālai uṇavu* — "breakfast".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

காலை உணவு (*kālai uṇavu*) is *kālai*, "morning", and native *uṇavu*, "food", from *uṇ*, "to eat" (DEDR 600). The origin of *kālai* is uncertain.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: kālai uṇavu*
- *Say it: kālai uṇavu*, once more
- *Say it:* say *kālai uṇavu*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for a dry stir-fried vegetable dish, then the Tamil for ice, then say *kālai uṇavu* again

Before you move on

What does காலை உணவு mean? (“Breakfast”.) Say it once more.

184.3 மதிய உணவு (matiya uṇavu) — lunch

Before the new one: say the Tamil for ice, then the Tamil for breakfast.

You’ll want to know: மதிய உணவு

மதிய உணவு — *matiya uṇavu* — “lunch”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

மதிய உணவு (*matiya uṇavu*) is *matiyam*, “noon”, from Sanskrit *madhya*, “middle” (CDIAL 9804), and native *uṇavu*, “food” (DEDR 600).

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: matiya uṇavu*
- *Say it: matiya uṇavu*, once more
- *Say it:* say *matiya uṇavu*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for ice, then the Tamil for breakfast, then say *matiya uṇavu* again

Before you move on

What does மதிய உணவு mean? (“Lunch”.) Say it once more.

184.4 இரவு உணவு (iravu uṇavu) — dinner

Before the new one: say the Tamil for breakfast, then the Tamil for lunch.

You'll want to know: இரவு உணவு

இரவு உணவு — *iravu uṇavu* — "dinner".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

இரவு உணவு (*iravu uṇavu*) is native: *iravu*, "night" (DEDR 2552), and *uṇavu*, "food" (DEDR 600).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: iravu uṇavu*
- *Say it: iravu uṇavu*, once more
- *Say it:* say *iravu uṇavu*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for breakfast, then the Tamil for lunch, then say *iravu uṇavu* again

Before you move on

What does இரவு உணவு mean? ("Dinner".) Say it once more.

184.5 குறிப்பேடு (kuṟippēṭu) — a notebook

Before the new one: say the Tamil for lunch, then the Tamil for dinner.

You'll want to know: குறிப்பேடு

குறிப்பேடு — *kuṟippēṭu* — "a notebook".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

குறிப்பேடு (*kuṟippēṭu*) is native: *kuṟippu*, "note, memorandum", from *kuṟi*, "to mark, to note" (DEDR 1847), and *ēṭu*, "palm leaf for writing, book" (DEDR 884).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: kuṟippēṭu*
- *Say it: kuṟippēṭu*, once more
- *Say it:* say *kuṟippēṭu*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for lunch, then the Tamil for dinner, then say *kuṟippēṭu* again

Before you move on

What does குறிப்பேடு mean? ("A notebook".) Say it once more.

Chapter 185

Queue, Number, Text message, News, Email

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say a queue, a number, a text message, news and an email.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 185: I can say a queue, a number, a text message, news and an email.

185.1 வரிசை (varicai) — a queue, a row

Before the new one: say the Tamil for dinner, then the Tamil for a notebook.

You'll want to know: வரிசை

வரிசை — *varicai* — "a queue, a row".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

வரிசை (*varicai*) is native Dravidian. DEDR 5269 lists Kannada *varise*, "line, row".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: varicai*
- *Say it: varicai*, once more
- *Say it:* say *varicai*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for dinner, then the Tamil for a notebook, then say *varicai* again

Before you move on

What does **வரிசை** mean? ("A queue, a row".) Say it once more.

185.2 எண் (eṇ) — a number (phone, house, account)

Before the new one: say the Tamil for a notebook, then the Tamil for a queue.

You'll want to know: எண்

எண் — *eṇ* — "a number (phone, house, account)".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

எண் (*eṇ*) is native Dravidian. DEDR 793 lists Malayalam *eṇ*, "number".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: eṇ*
- *Say it: eṇ*, once more
- *Say it:* say *eṇ*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for a notebook, then the Tamil for a queue, then say *eṇ* again

Before you move on

What does **எண்** mean? ("A number (phone, house, account)".) Say it once more.

185.3 குறுஞ்செய்தி (kuṟuñceyti) — a text message

Before the new one: say the Tamil for a queue, then the Tamil for a number.

You'll want to know: குறுஞ்செய்தி

குறுஞ்செய்தி — *kuṟuñceyti* — "a text message".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

குறுஞ்செய்தி (*kuṟuñceyti*) is native: *kuṟu*, "short" (DEDR 1851), and *ceyti*, "news, message", from *cey*, "to do" (DEDR 1957): "a short message".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: kuṟuñceyti*
- *Say it: kuṟuñceyti*, once more
- *Say it:* say *kuṟuñceyti*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for a queue, then the Tamil for a number, then say *kuṟuñceyti* again

Before you move on

What does **குறுஞ்செய்தி** mean? ("A text message".) Say it once more.

185.4 செய்தி (ceyti) — news; a message

Before the new one: say the Tamil for a number, then the Tamil for a text message.

You'll want to know: செய்தி

செய்தி — *ceyti* — "news; a message".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

செய்தி (*ceyti*) is native Dravidian. DEDR 1957 lists Malayalam *ceyti*, "news". The entry lists *ceyti*, "deed, news", under *cey*, "to do": news is what was done.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: ceyti*
- *Say it: ceyti*, once more
- *Say it:* say *ceyti*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for a number, then the Tamil for a text message, then say *ceyti* again

Before you move on

What does செய்தி mean? ("News; a message".) Say it once more.

185.5 மின்னஞ்சல் (min̲n̲añcal) — an email

Before the new one: say the Tamil for a text message, then the Tamil for news; a message.

You'll want to know: மின்னஞ்சல்

மின்னஞ்சல் — *min̲n̲añcal* — "an email".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

மின்னஞ்சல் (*miṉṉañcal*) is a modern coinage from two native words: *miṉ*, "lightning, electricity" (DEDR 4876), and *añcal*, "relay, letter post" (DEDR 54, which lists Malayalam añcal and Telugu ance): "electric post".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: miṉṉañcal*
- *Say it: miṉṉañcal*, once more
- *Say it:* say *miṉṉañcal*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for a text message, then the Tamil for news; a message, then say *miṉṉañcal* again

Before you move on

What does மின்னஞ்சல் mean? ("An email".) Say it once more.

Chapter 186

Father-in-law, Boyfriend, Girlfriend, Romantic love, Friendship

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say a father-in-law, a boyfriend, a girlfriend, romantic love and friendship.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 186: I can say a father-in-law, a boyfriend, a girlfriend, romantic love and friendship.

186.1 மாமனார் (māmaṉār) — a father-in-law

Before the new one: say the Tamil for news; a message, then the Tamil for an email.

You'll want to know: மாமனார்

மாமனார் — *māmaṉār* — "a father-in-law".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

மாமனார் (*māmaṉār*) is native Dravidian. DEDR 4813 lists Telugu *māma*, "father-in-law". The entry glosses *māmaṉ* "maternal uncle, father-in-law", and compares Sanskrit *māma*, "maternal uncle"; *-ār* is respectful.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: māmaṉār*
- *Say it: māmaṉār*, once more
- *Say it:* say *māmaṉār*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for news; a message, then the Tamil for an email, then say *māmaṉār* again

Before you move on

What does மாமனார் mean? ("A father-in-law".) Say it once more.

186.2 காதலன் (kātalaṉ) — a boyfriend, a (male) lover

Before the new one: say the Tamil for an email, then the Tamil for a father-in-law.

You'll want to know: காதலன்

காதலன் — *kātalaṉ* — "a boyfriend, a (male) lover".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

காதலன் (*kātalaṉ*) is native Dravidian. DEDR 1445 lists Kannada *kādala*, "male friend". It is *kātal*, "love", with *-aṉ* for a man.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: kātalaṉ*

- *Say it: kātalaṉ*, once more
- *Say it:* say *kātalaṉ*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for an email, then the Tamil for a father-in-law, then say *kātalaṉ* again

Before you move on

What does **காதலன்** mean? ("A boyfriend, a (male) lover".) Say it once more.

186.3 காதலி (kātali) — a girlfriend, a (female) lover

Before the new one: say the Tamil for a father-in-law, then the Tamil for a boyfriend.

You'll want to know: காதலி

காதலி — *kātali* — "a girlfriend, a (female) lover".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

காதலி (*kātali*) is native Dravidian (DEDR 1445). It is *kātal*, "love", with *-i* for a woman.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: kātali*
- *Say it: kātali*, once more
- *Say it:* say *kātali*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for a father-in-law, then the Tamil for a boyfriend, then say *kātali* again

Before you move on

What does காதலி mean? ("A girlfriend, a (female) lover".) Say it once more.

186.4 காதல் (kātal) — romantic love

Before the new one: say the Tamil for a boyfriend, then the Tamil for a girlfriend.

You'll want to know: காதல்

காதல் — *kātal* — "romantic love".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

காதல் (*kātal*) is native Dravidian. DEDR 1445 lists Malayalam *kātal*, "attachment" and Kannada *kādal*, "affection, love".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: kātal*
- *Say it: kātal*, once more
- *Say it:* say *kātal*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for a boyfriend, then the Tamil for a girlfriend, then say *kātal* again

Before you move on

What does காதல் mean? ("Romantic love".) Say it once more.

186.5 நட்பு (naṭpu) — friendship

Before the new one: say the Tamil for a girlfriend, then the Tamil for romantic love.

You'll want to know: நட்பு

நட்பு — *naṭpu* — "friendship".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

நட்பு (*naṭpu*) is native Dravidian. DEDR 3588 lists Kannada *naṇṭu*, "friendship" and Telugu *naṇṭu*. It is the same family as *naṇbar*, "friend".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: naṭpu*
- *Say it: naṭpu*, once more
- *Say it:* say *naṭpu*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for a girlfriend, then the Tamil for romantic love, then say *naṭpu* again

Before you move on

What does நட்பு mean? ("Friendship".) Say it once more.

Chapter 187

Pet, Bull, Calf, Wolf, Leopard

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (7) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 7 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say a pet, a bull, a calf, a wolf and a leopard.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 187: I can say a pet, a bull, a calf, a wolf and a leopard.*

187.1 செல்லப்பிராணி (cellappirāṇi) — a pet

> Before the new one: say the Tamil for romantic love, then the Tamil for friendship.

You'll want to know: செல்லப்பிராணி

செல்லப்பிராணி — *cellappirāṇi* — "a pet".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

செல்லப்பிராணி (*cellappirāṇi*) is native *cellam*, "treasure, darling" (DEDR 2786), and *pirāṇi*, "creature", from Sanskrit *prāṇin*, "living creature" (CDIAL 8932).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: cellappirāṇi*
- *Say it: cellappirāṇi*, once more
- *Say it:* say *cellappirāṇi*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for romantic love, then the Tamil for friendship, then say *cellappirāṇi* again

Before you move on

What does செல்லப்பிராணி mean? (“A pet”.) Say it once more.

187.2 காளை (kāḷai) — a bull

Before the new one: say the Tamil for friendship, then the Tamil for a pet.

You’ll want to know: காளை

காளை — *kāḷai* — “a bull”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

காளை (*kāḷai*) is native Dravidian. DEDR 1502 lists Malayalam *kāḷa*, “bull”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: kāḷai*
- *Say it: kāḷai*, once more
- *Say it:* say *kāḷai*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for friendship, then the Tamil for a pet, then say *kāḷai* again

Before you move on

What does **காளை** mean? (“A bull”.) Say it once more.

187.3 கன்று (kan̲r̲u) — a calf

Before the new one: say the Tamil for a pet, then the Tamil for a bull.

You’ll want to know: கன்று

கன்று — *kan̲r̲u* — “a calf”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

கன்று (*kan̲r̲u*) is native Dravidian. DEDR 1411 lists Malayalam *kannu*, “young of cattle”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: kan̲r̲u*
- *Say it: kan̲r̲u*, once more
- *Say it:* say *kan̲r̲u*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for a pet, then the Tamil for a bull, then say *kan̲r̲u* again

Before you move on

What does **கன்று** mean? (“A calf”.) Say it once more.

187.4 ஓநாய் (ōnāy) — a wolf

Before the new one: say the Tamil for a bull, then the Tamil for a calf.

You'll want to know: ஓநாய்

ஓநாய் — *ōnāy* — "a wolf".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

ஓநாய் (*ōnāy*) is native Dravidian. DEDR 1026 lists Malayalam *ō-nāy*, "wolf". Its second half is *nāy*, "dog".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *ōnāy*
- *Say it:* *ōnāy*, once more
- *Say it:* say *ōnāy*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for a bull, then the Tamil for a calf, then say *ōnāy* again

Before you move on

What does ஓநாய் mean? ("A wolf".) Say it once more.

187.5 சிறுத்தை (ciṟuttai) — a leopard

Before the new one: say the Tamil for a calf, then the Tamil for a wolf.

You'll want to know: சிறுத்தை

சிறுத்தை — *ciṟuttai* — "a leopard".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

சிறுத்தை (*ciṟuttai*) is native Dravidian. DEDR 2590 lists Kannada *ciṟate* and Telugu *ciṟuta*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: ciṟuttai*
- *Say it: ciṟuttai*, once more
- *Say it:* say *ciṟuttai*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for a calf, then the Tamil for a wolf, then say *ciṟuttai* again

Before you move on

What does சிறுத்தை mean? ("A leopard".) Say it once more.

187.6 Words from chapters 179-182 — a first pass

Say the words for a wolf and a leopard.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- useful, local, foreign, clear, a feeling
- active, naughty, stubborn, funny, interesting
- favourite, terrible, many, everything, thick
- a refrigerator, a tap, a tumbler, a pan, a lid

Before you move on

Useful? (பயனுள்ள, *payaṉuḷḷa.*) Local? (உள்ளூர், *uḷḷūr.*) Foreign? (வெளிநாட்டு, *veḷināṭṭu.*) Clear? (தெளிவான, *teḷivāṉa.*) A feeling? (உணர்ச்சி, *uṇarcci.*) Active? (சுறுசுறுப்பான, *cuṟucuṟuppāṉa.*) Naughty? (குறும்பான, *kuṟumpāṉa.*) Stubborn? (பிடிவாதமான, *piṭivātamāṉa.*) Funny?

(நகைச்சுவையான, *nakaiccuvaiyāṉa.*) Interesting? (சுவாரசியமான, *cuvāraciyamāṉa.*) Favourite? (பிடித்தமான, *piṭittamāṉa.*) Terrible? (மோசமான, *mōcamāṉa.*) Many? (பல, *pala.*) Everything? (எல்லாம், *ellām.*) Thick? (தடிமனான, *taṭimaṉāṉa.*) A refrigerator? (குளிர்சாதனப் பெட்டி, *kuḷircātaṉap peṭṭi.*) A tap? (குழாய், *kuḻāy.*) A tumbler? (டம்ளர், *ṭamḷar.*) A pan? (சட்டி, *caṭṭi.*) A lid? (மூடி, *mūṭi.*)

187.7 Words from chapters 183-187 — a second pass

Say the words for pongal and upma.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- pongal, upma, sambar, a chutney, a dry stir-fried vegetable dish
- ice, breakfast, lunch, dinner, a notebook
- a queue, a number, a text message, news; a message, an email
- a father-in-law, a boyfriend, a girlfriend, romantic love, friendship
- a pet, a bull, a calf, a wolf, a leopard

Before you move on

Pongal? (பொங்கல், *poṅkal.*) Upma? (உப்புமா, *uppumā.*) Sambar? (சாம்பார், *cāmpār.*) A chutney? (சட்னி, *caṭṉi.*) A dry stir-fried vegetable dish? (பொரியல், *poriyal.*) Ice? (பனிக்கட்டி, *paṉikkaṭṭi.*) Breakfast? (காலை உணவு, *kālai uṇavu.*) Lunch? (மதிய உணவு, *matiya uṇavu.*) Dinner? (இரவு உணவு, *iravu uṇavu.*) A notebook? (குறிப்பேடு, *kuṟippēṭu.*) A queue? (வரிசை, *varicai.*) A number? (எண், *eṇ.*) A text message? (குறுஞ்செய்தி, *kuṟuñceyti.*) News; a message? (செய்தி, *ceyti.*) An email? (மின்னஞ்சல், *miṉṉañcal.*) A father-in-law? (மாமனார், *māmaṉār.*) A boyfriend? (காதலன், *kātalaṉ.*) A girlfriend? (காதலி, *kātali.*) Romantic love? (காதல், *kātal.*)

Friendship? (நட்பு, *naṭpu.*) A pet? (செல்லப்பிராணி, *cellappirāṇi.*) A bull? (காளை, *kāḷai.*) A calf? (கன்று, *kaṉṟu.*) A wolf? (ஓநாய், *ōnāy.*) A leopard? (சிறுத்தை, *ciṟuttai.*)

Chapter 188

Thorn, Lotus, Jasmine, Neem tree, Coconut palm

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say a thorn, a lotus, jasmine, a neem tree and a coconut palm.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 188: I can say a thorn, a lotus, jasmine, a neem tree and a coconut palm.

188.1 முள் (muḷ) — a thorn

Before the new one: say the Tamil for a wolf, then the Tamil for a leopard.

You'll want to know: முள்

முள் — *muḷ* — "a thorn".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

முள் (*muḷ*) is native Dravidian. DEDR 4995 lists Malayalam *muḷ*, Kannada *muḷ* and Telugu *mullu*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: muḷ*
- *Say it: muḷ*, once more
- *Say it:* say *muḷ*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for a wolf, then the Tamil for a leopard, then say *muḷ* again

Before you move on

What does முள் mean? (“A thorn”.) Say it once more.

188.2 தாமரை (tāmarai) — a lotus

Before the new one: say the Tamil for a leopard, then the Tamil for a thorn.

You’ll want to know: தாமரை

தாமரை — *tāmarai* — “a lotus”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

தாமரை (*tāmarai*) is native Dravidian. DEDR 3163 lists Malayalam *tāmara*, Kannada *tāvare* and Telugu *tāmara*. The entry compares Sanskrit *tāmarasa*, “lotus”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: tāmarai*
- *Say it: tāmarai*, once more
- *Say it:* say *tāmarai*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for a leopard, then the Tamil for a thorn, then say *tāmarai* again

Before you move on

What does **தாமரை** mean? ("A lotus".) Say it once more.

188.3 மல்லிகை (mallikai) — jasmine

Before the new one: say the Tamil for a thorn, then the Tamil for a lotus.

You'll want to know: மல்லிகை

மல்லிகை — *mallikai* — "jasmine".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

மல்லிகை (*mallikai*) is a loan from Sanskrit *mallikā*, "jasmine" (CDIAL 9913). CDIAL compares Dravidian words for jasmine.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: mallikai*
- *Say it: mallikai*, once more
- *Say it:* say *mallikai*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for a thorn, then the Tamil for a lotus, then say *mallikai* again

Before you move on

What does **மல்லிகை** mean? ("Jasmine".) Say it once more.

188.4 வேப்பமரம் (vēppamaram) — a neem tree

Before the new one: say the Tamil for a lotus, then the Tamil for jasmine.

You'll want to know: வேப்பமரம்

வேப்பமரம் — *vēppamaram* — "a neem tree".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

வேப்பமரம் (*vēppamaram*) is native: *vēmpu*, "neem" (DEDR 5531; Kannada *bēvu*), and *maram*, "tree" (DEDR 4711).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *vēppamaram*
- *Say it:* *vēppamaram*, once more
- *Say it:* say *vēppamaram*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for a lotus, then the Tamil for jasmine, then say *vēppamaram* again

Before you move on

What does வேப்பமரம் mean? ("A neem tree".) Say it once more.

188.5 தென்னைமரம் (te̲n̲n̲aimaram) — a coconut palm

Before the new one: say the Tamil for jasmine, then the Tamil for a neem tree.

You'll want to know: தென்னைமரம்

தென்னைமரம் — *te̲n̲n̲aimaram* — "a coconut palm".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

தென்னைமரம் (*te̲n̲n̲aimaram*) is native: *te̲n̲n̲ai*, "coconut palm" (DEDR 3408), and *maram*, "tree" (DEDR 4711).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *te<u>n</u><u>n</u>aimaram*
- *Say it:* *te<u>n</u><u>n</u>aimaram*, once more
- *Say it:* say *te<u>n</u><u>n</u>aimaram*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for jasmine, then the Tamil for a neem tree, then say *te<u>n</u><u>n</u>aimaram* again

Before you move on

What does தென்னைமரம் mean? ("A coconut palm".) Say it once more.

Chapter 189

Glue, Candle, Website, App, Screen

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say glue, a candle, a website, an app and a screen.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 189: I can say glue, a candle, a website, an app and a screen.*

189.1 பசை (pacai) — glue

> Before the new one: say the Tamil for a neem tree, then the Tamil for a coconut palm.

You'll want to know: பசை

பசை — *pacai* — "glue".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

பசை (*pacai*) is native Dravidian. DEDR 3827 lists Malayalam *paca*, "gum, glue".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *pacai*
- *Say it:* *pacai*, once more
- *Say it:* say *pacai*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for a neem tree, then the Tamil for a coconut palm, then say *pacai* again

Before you move on

What does பசை mean? (“Glue”.) Say it once more.

189.2 மெழுகுவர்த்தி (me̲lukuvartti) — a candle

Before the new one: say the Tamil for a coconut palm, then the Tamil for glue.

You’ll want to know: மெழுகுவர்த்தி

மெழுகுவர்த்தி — *me̲lukuvartti* — “a candle”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

மெழுகுவர்த்தி (*me̲lukuvartti*) is *me̲luku*, “wax”, which DEDR 5082 files with words for smearing and glossing, and *vartti*, “wick”, from Sanskrit *varti* (CDIAL 11359): “the wax wick”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *me̲lukuvartti*
- *Say it:* *me̲lukuvartti*, once more
- *Say it:* say *me̲lukuvartti*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for a coconut palm, then the Tamil for glue, then say *me̲lukuvartti* again

Before you move on

What does மெழுகுவர்த்தி mean? (“A candle”.) Say it once more.

189.3 இணையதளம் (iṇaiyataḷam) — a website

Before the new one: say the Tamil for glue, then the Tamil for a candle.

You’ll want to know: இணையதளம்

இணையதளம் — *iṇaiyataḷam* — “a website”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

இணையதளம் (*iṇaiyataḷam*) is a modern coinage: *iṇaiyam*, “the internet”, from native *iṇai*, “to join, to link” (DEDR 457), and *taḷam*, “surface, platform”, from Sanskrit *tala*, “surface” (CDIAL 5731).

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: iṇaiyataḷam*
- *Say it: iṇaiyataḷam*, once more
- *Say it:* say *iṇaiyataḷam*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for glue, then the Tamil for a candle, then say *iṇaiyataḷam* again

Before you move on

What does இணையதளம் mean? (“A website”.) Say it once more.

189.4 செயலி (ceyali) — an app

Before the new one: say the Tamil for a candle, then the Tamil for a website.

You'll want to know: செயலி

செயலி — *ceyali* — "an app".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

செயலி (*ceyali*) is native Dravidian (DEDR 1957). It is a modern coinage on *ceyal*, "action", from *cey*, "to do", with *-i*: "the thing that does".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: ceyali*
- *Say it: ceyali*, once more
- *Say it:* say *ceyali*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for a candle, then the Tamil for a website, then say *ceyali* again

Before you move on

What does செயலி mean? ("An app".) Say it once more.

189.5 திரை (tirai) — a screen

Before the new one: say the Tamil for a website, then the Tamil for an app.

You'll want to know: திரை

திரை — *tirai* — "a screen".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

திரை (*tirai*) is native Dravidian. DEDR 3244 lists Malayalam *tira*, "curtain" and Telugu *tera*, "screen, curtain".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: tirai*
- *Say it: tirai*, once more
- *Say it:* say *tirai*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for a website, then the Tamil for an app, then say *tirai* again

Before you move on

What does திரை mean? ("A screen".) Say it once more.

Chapter 190

Idea, Matchbox, Clay pot, Grinding stone, Tank

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say an idea, a matchbox, a clay pot, a grinding stone and a tank.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 190: I can say an idea, a matchbox, a clay pot, a grinding stone and a tank.

190.1 யோசனை (yōcaṉai) — an idea, a suggestion

Before the new one: say the Tamil for an app, then the Tamil for a screen.

You'll want to know: யோசனை

யோசனை — *yōcaṉai* — "an idea, a suggestion".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

யோசனை (*yōcaṉai*) is a loan from Sanskrit *yojanā*, "a joining, an arranging": an idea is a putting together.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: yōcaṉai*
- *Say it: yōcaṉai*, once more
- *Say it:* say *yōcaṉai*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for an app, then the Tamil for a screen, then say *yōcaṉai* again

Before you move on

What does யோசனை mean? ("An idea, a suggestion".) Say it once more.

190.2 தீப்பெட்டி (tīppeṭṭi) — a matchbox

Before the new one: say the Tamil for a screen, then the Tamil for an idea.

You'll want to know: தீப்பெட்டி

தீப்பெட்டி — *tīppeṭṭi* — "a matchbox".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

தீப்பெட்டி (*tīppeṭṭi*) is native: *tī*, "fire" (DEDR 3266; Malayalam *tī*), and *peṭṭi*, "box" (DEDR 4388, which compares Sanskrit *peṭaka*): "the fire box".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: tīppeṭṭi*
- *Say it: tīppeṭṭi*, once more
- *Say it:* say *tīppeṭṭi*

- *Recall:* say the Tamil for a screen, then the Tamil for an idea, then say *tīppeṭṭi* again

Before you move on

What does தீப்பெட்டி mean? ("A matchbox".) Say it once more.

190.3 பானை (pāṉai) — a clay pot

Before the new one: say the Tamil for an idea, then the Tamil for a matchbox.

You'll want to know: பானை

பானை — *pāṉai* — "a clay pot".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

பானை (*pāṉai*) is native Dravidian. DEDR 4124 lists Malayalam *pāna* and Kannada *pāne*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: pāṉai*
- *Say it: pāṉai*, once more
- *Say it:* say *pāṉai*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for an idea, then the Tamil for a matchbox, then say *pāṉai* again

Before you move on

What does பானை mean? ("A clay pot".) Say it once more.

190.4 அம்மி (ammi) — a grinding stone

Before the new one: say the Tamil for a matchbox, then the Tamil for a clay pot.

You'll want to know: அம்மி

அம்மி — *ammi* — "a grinding stone".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

அம்மி (*ammi*) is native Dravidian. DEDR 184 lists Malayalam *ammi* and Kannada *ammi*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *ammi*
- *Say it:* *ammi*, once more
- *Say it:* say *ammi*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for a matchbox, then the Tamil for a clay pot, then say *ammi* again

Before you move on

What does அம்மி mean? ("A grinding stone".) Say it once more.

190.5 தொட்டி (toṭṭi) — a tank, a tub

Before the new one: say the Tamil for a clay pot, then the Tamil for a grinding stone.

You'll want to know: தொட்டி

தொட்டி — *toṭṭi* — "a tank, a tub".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

தொட்டி (*toṭṭi*) is native Dravidian. DEDR 3484 lists Malayalam *toṭṭi*, "trough", Kannada *toṭṭi* and Telugu *toṭṭi*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: toṭṭi*
- *Say it: toṭṭi*, once more
- *Say it:* say *toṭṭi*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for a clay pot, then the Tamil for a grinding stone, then say *toṭṭi* again

Before you move on

What does தொட்டி mean? ("A tank, a tub".) Say it once more.

Chapter 191

Shopkeeper, Customer, Cashier, Tailor, Small change

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say a shopkeeper, a customer, a cashier, a tailor and small change.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 191: I can say a shopkeeper, a customer, a cashier, a tailor and small change.*

191.1 கடைக்காரர் (kaṭaikkārar) — a shopkeeper

> Before the new one: say the Tamil for a grinding stone, then the Tamil for a tank.

You'll want to know: கடைக்காரர்

கடைக்காரர் — *kaṭaikkārar* — "a shopkeeper".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

கடைக்காரர் (*kaṭaikkārar*) is *kaṭai*, "shop", native (DEDR 1142), with *-kārar*, "the one in charge of".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: kaṭaikkārar*
- *Say it: kaṭaikkārar*, once more
- *Say it:* say *kaṭaikkārar*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for a grinding stone, then the Tamil for a tank, then say *kaṭaikkārar* again

Before you move on

What does **கடைக்காரர்** mean? ("A shopkeeper".) Say it once more.

191.2 வாடிக்கையாளர் (vāṭikkaiyāḷar) — a customer

Before the new one: say the Tamil for a tank, then the Tamil for a shopkeeper.

You'll want to know: வாடிக்கையாளர்

வாடிக்கையாளர் — *vāṭikkaiyāḷar* — "a customer".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

வாடிக்கையாளர் (*vāṭikkaiyāḷar*) is native Dravidian. DEDR 5341 lists Kannada *vāḍike*, "custom". It is *vāṭikkai*, "habit, custom", with *-āḷar*, "persons": "the regulars".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: vāṭikkaiyāḷar*
- *Say it: vāṭikkaiyāḷar*, once more
- *Say it:* say *vāṭikkaiyāḷar*

- *Recall:* say the Tamil for a tank, then the Tamil for a shopkeeper, then say *vāṭikkaiyāḷar* again

Before you move on

What does **வாடிக்கையாளர்** mean? (“A customer”.) Say it once more.

191.3 காசாளர் (kācāḷar) — a cashier

Before the new one: say the Tamil for a shopkeeper, then the Tamil for a customer.

You’ll want to know: காசாளர்

காசாளர் — *kācāḷar* — “a cashier”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

காசாளர் (*kācāḷar*) is native Dravidian. DEDR 1431 lists Malayalam *kāśu*, “money” and Kannada *kāsu*, “coin”. It is *kācu*, “coin, money”, with *-āḷar*, “the one who handles”. DEDR compares *kācu*, with a query, to Sanskrit *karṣa*, a weight.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: kācāḷar*
- *Say it: kācāḷar*, once more
- *Say it:* say *kācāḷar*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for a shopkeeper, then the Tamil for a customer, then say *kācāḷar* again

Before you move on

What does **காசாளர்** mean? (“A cashier”.) Say it once more.

191.4 தையல்காரர் (taiyalkārar) — a tailor

Before the new one: say the Tamil for a customer, then the Tamil for a cashier.

You'll want to know: தையல்காரர்

தையல்காரர் — *taiyalkārar* — "a tailor".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

தையல்காரர் (*taiyalkārar*) is native Dravidian (DEDR 3473). It is *taiyal*, "sewing", from *tai*, "to sew", with *-kārar*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: taiyalkārar*
- *Say it: taiyalkārar*, once more
- *Say it:* say *taiyalkārar*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for a customer, then the Tamil for a cashier, then say *taiyalkārar* again

Before you move on

What does தையல்காரர் mean? ("A tailor".) Say it once more.

191.5 சில்லறை (cillaṟai) — small change

Before the new one: say the Tamil for a cashier, then the Tamil for a tailor.

You'll want to know: சில்லறை

சில்லறை — *cillaṟai* — "small change".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

சில்லறை (*cillaṟai*) is native Dravidian. DEDR 2574 lists Kannada *cillaṟe*, "fractional quantities".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: cillaṟai*
- *Say it: cillaṟai*, once more
- *Say it:* say *cillaṟai*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for a cashier, then the Tamil for a tailor, then say *cillaṟai* again

Before you move on

What does சில்லறை mean? ("Small change".) Say it once more.

Chapter 192

Police officer, Driver, Postman, Trader, Colleague

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say a police officer, a driver, a postman, a trader and a colleague.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 192: I can say a police officer, a driver, a postman, a trader and a colleague.*

192.1 காவலர் (kāvalar) — a police officer

> Before the new one: say the Tamil for a tailor, then the Tamil for small change.

You'll want to know: காவலர்

காவலர் — *kāvalar* — "a police officer".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

காவலர் (*kāvalar*) is native Dravidian (DEDR 1416). It is *kāval*, "watch, guard", from *kā*, "to guard", with the respectful *-ar*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *kāvalar*
- *Say it:* *kāvalar*, once more
- *Say it:* say *kāvalar*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for a tailor, then the Tamil for small change, then say *kāvalar* again

Before you move on

What does காவலர் mean? ("A police officer".) Say it once more.

192.2 ஓட்டுநர் (ōṭṭunar) — a driver

Before the new one: say the Tamil for small change, then the Tamil for a police officer.

You'll want to know: ஓட்டுநர்

ஓட்டுநர் — *ōṭṭunar* — "a driver".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

ஓட்டுநர் (*ōṭṭunar*) is native Dravidian (DEDR 1041). It is *ōṭṭu*, "to drive", the causative of *ōṭu*, "to run", with *-nar*, "the one who": "the one who makes it run".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *ōṭṭunar*
- *Say it:* *ōṭṭunar*, once more
- *Say it:* say *ōṭṭunar*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for small change, then the Tamil for a police officer, then say *ōṭṭunar* again

Before you move on

What does ஓட்டுநர் mean? ("A driver".) Say it once more.

192.3 தபால்காரர் (tapālkārar) — a postman

Before the new one: say the Tamil for a police officer, then the Tamil for a driver.

You'll want to know: தபால்காரர்

தபால்காரர் — *tapālkārar* — "a postman".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

தபால்காரர் (*tapālkārar*) is *tapāl*, "post", a loan from Hindustani *ṭapāl*, "post, mail", with *-kārar*, "the one who handles".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: tapālkārar*
- *Say it: tapālkārar*, once more
- *Say it:* say *tapālkārar*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for a police officer, then the Tamil for a driver, then say *tapālkārar* again

Before you move on

What does தபால்காரர் mean? ("A postman".) Say it once more.

192.4 வியாபாரி (viyāpāri) — a trader, a merchant

Before the new one: say the Tamil for a driver, then the Tamil for a postman.

You'll want to know: வியாபாரி

வியாபாரி — *viyāpāri* — "a trader, a merchant".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

வியாபாரி (*viyāpāri*) is *viyāpāram*, "trade", from Sanskrit *vyāpāra*, "occupation, business" (CDIAL 12205), with *-i*, "the one who".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: viyāpāri*
- *Say it: viyāpāri*, once more
- *Say it:* say *viyāpāri*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for a driver, then the Tamil for a postman, then say *viyāpāri* again

Before you move on

What does வியாபாரி mean? ("A trader, a merchant".) Say it once more.

192.5 சக ஊழியர் (caka ūḻiyar) — a colleague

Before the new one: say the Tamil for a postman, then the Tamil for a trader.

You'll want to know: சக ஊழியர்

சக ஊழியர் — *caka ūḻiyar* — "a colleague".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

சக ஊழியர் (*caka ūḻiyar*) is *caka*, "fellow", from Sanskrit *saha*, "with", and native *ūḻiyar*, "workers", from *ūḻiyam*, "service" (DEDR 758; Malayalam *ūḻiyam*).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: caka ūḻiyar*
- *Say it: caka ūḻiyar*, once more
- *Say it:* say *caka ūḻiyar*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for a postman, then the Tamil for a trader, then say *caka ūḻiyar* again

Before you move on

What does **சக ஊழியர்** mean? ("A colleague".) Say it once more.

Chapter 193

Spectator, Actor, Singer, Coach, Carpenter

Modes: **voice** (7) **Hands-free start:** all 7 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say a spectator, an actor, a singer, a coach and a carpenter.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 193: I can say a spectator, an actor, a singer, a coach and a carpenter.*

193.1 பார்வையாளர் (pārvaiyāḷar) — a spectator, a viewer

Before the new one: say the Tamil for a trader, then the Tamil for a colleague.

You'll want to know: பார்வையாளர்

பார்வையாளர் — *pārvaiyāḷar* — "a spectator, a viewer".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

பார்வையாளர் (*pārvaiyāḷar*) is native Dravidian (DEDR 4091). It is *pārvai*, "sight", from *pār*, "to look", with *-āḷar*, "persons".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *pārvaiyāḷar*
- *Say it:* *pārvaiyāḷar*, once more
- *Say it:* say *pārvaiyāḷar*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for a trader, then the Tamil for a colleague, then say *pārvaiyāḷar* again

Before you move on

What does பார்வையாளர் mean? ("A spectator, a viewer".) Say it once more.

193.2 நடிகர் (naṭikar) — an actor

Before the new one: say the Tamil for a colleague, then the Tamil for a spectator.

You'll want to know: நடிகர்

நடிகர் — *naṭikar* — "an actor".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

நடிகர் (*naṭikar*) is built on *naṭi*, "to act", from Sanskrit *naṭ-*, "to act, to dance" (as in *naṭana*), with *-kar*, "the one who".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *naṭikar*
- *Say it:* *naṭikar*, once more
- *Say it:* say *naṭikar*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for a colleague, then the Tamil for a spectator, then say *naṭikar* again

Before you move on

What does நடிகர் mean? ("An actor".) Say it once more.

193.3 பாடகர் (pāṭakar) — a singer

Before the new one: say the Tamil for a spectator, then the Tamil for an actor.

You'll want to know: பாடகர்

பாடகர் — *pāṭakar* — "a singer".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

பாடகர் (*pāṭakar*) is native Dravidian (DEDR 4065). It is *pāṭu*, "to sing", with *-akar*, "the one who".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: pāṭakar*
- *Say it: pāṭakar*, once more
- *Say it:* say *pāṭakar*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for a spectator, then the Tamil for an actor, then say *pāṭakar* again

Before you move on

What does பாடகர் mean? ("A singer".) Say it once more.

193.4 பயிற்சியாளர் (payiṟciyāḷar) — a coach, a trainer

Before the new one: say the Tamil for an actor, then the Tamil for a singer.

You'll want to know: பயிற்சியாளர்

பயிற்சியாளர் — *payiṟciyāḷar* — "a coach, a trainer".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

பயிற்சியாளர் (*payiṟciyāḷar*) is native Dravidian. DEDR 3942 lists Malayalam *payiluka*, "to learn". It is *payiṟci*, "training", with *-āḷar*, "the one who".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: payiṟciyāḷar*
- *Say it: payiṟciyāḷar*, once more
- *Say it:* say *payiṟciyāḷar*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for an actor, then the Tamil for a singer, then say *payiṟciyāḷar* again

Before you move on

What does பயிற்சியாளர் mean? ("A coach, a trainer".) Say it once more.

193.5 தச்சர் (taccar) — a carpenter

Before the new one: say the Tamil for a singer, then the Tamil for a coach.

You'll want to know: தச்சர்

தச்சர் — *taccar* — "a carpenter".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

தச்சர் (*taccar*) is a loan from Sanskrit *takṣan*, "carpenter" (CDIAL 5621). Tamil wrote *kṣ* as *cc*, and *-ar* is respectful.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: taccar*
- *Say it: taccar*, once more
- *Say it:* say *taccar*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for a singer, then the Tamil for a coach, then say *taccar* again

Before you move on

What does **தச்சர்** mean? ("A carpenter".) Say it once more.

193.6 Words from chapters 188-190 — a first pass

Say the words for a coach and a carpenter.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- a thorn, a lotus, jasmine, a neem tree, a coconut palm
- glue, a candle, a website, an app, a screen
- an idea, a matchbox, a clay pot, a grinding stone, a tank

Before you move on

A thorn? (முள், *muḷ.*) A lotus? (தாமரை, *tāmarai.*) Jasmine? (மல்லிகை, *mallikai.*) A neem tree? (வேப்பமரம், *vēppamaram.*) A coconut palm? (தென்னைமரம், *teṉṉaimaram.*) Glue? (பசை, *pacai.*) A candle? (மெழுகுவர்த்தி, *meḻukuvartti.*) A website? (இணையதளம், *iṇaiyataḷam.*) An app? (செயலி, *ceyali.*) A screen? (திரை, *tirai.*) An idea? (யோசனை, *yōcaṉai.*) A matchbox? (தீப்பெட்டி, *tīppeṭṭi.*) A clay pot? (பானை, *pāṉai.*) A grinding stone? (அம்மி, *ammi.*) A tank? (தொட்டி, *toṭṭi.*)

193.7 Words from chapters 191-193 — a second pass

Say the words for a shopkeeper and a customer.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- a shopkeeper, a customer, a cashier, a tailor, small change
- a police officer, a driver, a postman, a trader, a colleague
- a spectator, an actor, a singer, a coach, a carpenter

Before you move on

A shopkeeper? (கடைக்காரர், *kaṭaikkārar.*) A customer? (வாடிக்கையாளர், *vāṭikkaiyāḷar.*) A cashier? (காசாளர், *kācāḷar.*) A tailor? (தையல்காரர், *taiyalkārar.*) Small change? (சில்லறை, *cillaṟai.*) A police officer? (காவலர், *kāvalar.*) A driver? (ஓட்டுநர், *ōṭṭunar.*) A postman? (தபால்காரர், *tapālkārar.*) A trader? (வியாபாரி, *viyāpāri.*) A colleague? (சக ஊழியர், *caka ūḻiyar.*) A spectator? (பார்வையாளர், *pārvaiyāḷar.*) An actor? (நடிகர், *naṭikar.*) A singer? (பாடகர், *pāṭakar.*) A coach? (பயிற்சியாளர், *payiṟciyāḷar.*) A carpenter? (தச்சர், *taccar.*)

Chapter 194

To pour, To chop, To peel, To deep-fry, To knead

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say to pour, to chop, to peel, to deep-fry and to knead.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 194: I can say to pour, to chop, to peel, to deep-fry and to knead.*

194.1 ஊற்று (ūr̲r̲u) — to pour

> Before the new one: say the Tamil for a coach, a trainer, then the Tamil for a carpenter.

You'll want to know: ஊற்று

ஊற்று — *ūr̲r̲u* — "to pour".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

ஊற்று (*ūr̲r̲u*) is native Dravidian. DEDR 761 lists Kannada *ūr̲u*, "to spring, ooze". It is the causative of *ūr̲u*, "to flow, to spring": to pour is "to make flow".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *ūṟṟu*
- *Say it:* *ūṟṟu*, once more
- *Say it:* say *ūṟṟu*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for a coach, a trainer, then the Tamil for a carpenter, then say *ūṟṟu* again

Before you move on

What does ஊற்று mean? (“To pour”.) Say it once more.

194.2 நறுக்கு (naṟukku) — to chop

Before the new one: say the Tamil for a carpenter, then the Tamil for to pour.

You’ll want to know: நறுக்கு

நறுக்கு — *naṟukku* — “to chop”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

நறுக்கு (*naṟukku*) is native Dravidian. DEDR 3625 lists Malayalam *naṟukkuka*, “to cut off”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *naṟukku*
- *Say it:* *naṟukku*, once more
- *Say it:* say *naṟukku*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for a carpenter, then the Tamil for to pour, then say *naṟukku* again

Before you move on

What does நறுக்கு mean? ("To chop".) Say it once more.

194.3 உரி (uri) — to peel

Before the new one: say the Tamil for to pour, then the Tamil for to chop.

You'll want to know: உரி

உரி — *uri* — "to peel".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

உரி (*uri*) is native Dravidian. DEDR 652 lists Malayalam *uri*, "skin".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: uri*
- *Say it: uri*, once more
- *Say it:* say *uri*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for to pour, then the Tamil for to chop, then say *uri* again

Before you move on

What does உரி mean? ("To peel".) Say it once more.

194.4 பொரி (pori) — to deep-fry

Before the new one: say the Tamil for to chop, then the Tamil for to peel.

You'll want to know: பொரி

பொரி — *pori* — "to deep-fry".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

பொரி (*pori*) is native Dravidian. DEDR 4537 lists Malayalam *pori*, "what is parched".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: pori*
- *Say it: pori*, once more
- *Say it:* say *pori*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for to chop, then the Tamil for to peel, then say *pori* again

Before you move on

What does பொரி mean? ("To deep-fry".) Say it once more.

194.5 பிசை (picai) — to knead

Before the new one: say the Tamil for to peel, then the Tamil for to deep-fry.

You'll want to know: பிசை

பிசை — *picai* — "to knead".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

பிசை (*picai*) is native Dravidian. DEDR 4135 lists Kannada *pisuku*, "to knead", and compares Sanskrit *picc-*, "to press" (CDIAL 8149).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: picai*
- *Say it: picai*, once more
- *Say it:* say *picai*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for to peel, then the Tamil for to deep-fry, then say *picai* again

Before you move on

What does பிசை mean? ("To knead".) Say it once more.

Chapter 195

To bring, To give back, To drive, To use, To try

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say to bring, to give back, to drive, to use and to try.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 195: I can say to bring, to give back, to drive, to use and to try.*

195.1 கொண்டு வா (koṇṭu vā) — to bring

Before the new one: say the Tamil for to deep-fry, then the Tamil for to knead.

You'll want to know: கொண்டு வா

கொண்டு வா — *koṇṭu vā* — "to bring".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

கொண்டு வா (*koṇṭu vā*) is native: *koṇṭu*, "having taken", from *koḷ*, "to take" (DEDR 2151), and *vā*, "come" (DEDR 5270): "take and come".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: koṇṭu vā*
- *Say it: koṇṭu vā*, once more
- *Say it:* say *koṇṭu vā*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for to deep-fry, then the Tamil for to knead, then say *koṇṭu vā* again

Before you move on

What does கொண்டு வா mean? ("To bring".) Say it once more.

195.2 திருப்பிக் கொடு (tiruppik koṭu) — to give back

Before the new one: say the Tamil for to knead, then the Tamil for to bring.

You'll want to know: திருப்பிக் கொடு

திருப்பிக் கொடு — *tiruppik koṭu* — "to give back".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

திருப்பிக் கொடு (*tiruppik koṭu*) is native: *tiruppi*, "having turned back", from *tiruppu*, "to turn" (DEDR 3246), and *koṭu*, "to give" (DEDR 2053).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: tiruppik koṭu*
- *Say it: tiruppik koṭu*, once more
- *Say it:* say *tiruppik koṭu*

- *Recall:* say the Tamil for to knead, then the Tamil for to bring, then say *tiruppik koṭu* again

Before you move on

What does திருப்பிக் கொடு mean? (“To give back”.) Say it once more.

195.3 ஓட்டு (ōṭṭu) — to drive

Before the new one: say the Tamil for to bring, then the Tamil for to give back.

You’ll want to know: ஓட்டு

ஓட்டு — *ōṭṭu* — “to drive”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

ஓட்டு (*ōṭṭu*) is native Dravidian (DEDR 1041). It is the causative of *ōṭu*, “to run”: to drive is “to make run”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: ōṭṭu*
- *Say it: ōṭṭu*, once more
- *Say it:* say *ōṭṭu*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for to bring, then the Tamil for to give back, then say *ōṭṭu* again

Before you move on

What does ஓட்டு mean? (“To drive”.) Say it once more.

195.4 பயன்படுத்து (payaṉpaṭuttu) — to use

Before the new one: say the Tamil for to give back, then the Tamil for to drive.

You'll want to know: பயன்படுத்து

பயன்படுத்து — *payaṉpaṭuttu* — "to use".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

பயன்படுத்து (*payaṉpaṭuttu*) is *payaṉ*, "use", with *paṭuttu*, "to make become", from *paṭu* (DEDR 3853): "put to use". *Payaṉ* is usually connected with *paya*, "to yield" (DEDR 3937), but DEDR does not list it.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: payaṉpaṭuttu*
- *Say it: payaṉpaṭuttu*, once more
- *Say it:* say *payaṉpaṭuttu*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for to give back, then the Tamil for to drive, then say *payaṉpaṭuttu* again

Before you move on

What does பயன்படுத்து mean? ("To use".) Say it once more.

195.5 முயற்சி செய் (muyaṟci cey) — to try

Before the new one: say the Tamil for to drive, then the Tamil for to use.

You'll want to know: முயற்சி செய்

முயற்சி செய் — *muyaṟci cey* — "to try".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

முயற்சி செய் (*muyaṟci cey*) is native: *muyaṟci*, "effort", from *muyal*, "to strive, to persevere" (DEDR 4967), and *sey*, "to do" (DEDR 1957).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: muyaṟci cey*
- *Say it: muyaṟci cey*, once more
- *Say it:* say *muyaṟci cey*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for to drive, then the Tamil for to use, then say *muyaṟci cey* again

Before you move on

What does முயற்சி செய் mean? ("To try".) Say it once more.

Chapter 196

To tear, To lose, To press, To feel, To soak

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say to tear, to lose, to press, to feel and to soak.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 196: I can say to tear, to lose, to press, to feel and to soak.*

196.1 கிழி (kiḻi) — to tear

> Before the new one: say the Tamil for to use, then the Tamil for to try.

You'll want to know: கிழி

கிழி — *kiḻi* — "to tear".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

கிழி (*kiḻi*) is native Dravidian. DEDR 1581 lists Malayalam *kiḻi*, "piece of cloth".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: kiḻi*
- *Say it: kiḻi*, once more
- *Say it:* say *kiḻi*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for to use, then the Tamil for to try, then say *kiḻi* again

Before you move on

What does கிழி mean? ("To tear".) Say it once more.

196.2 இழ (iḻa) — to lose

Before the new one: say the Tamil for to try, then the Tamil for to tear.

You'll want to know: இழ

இழ — *iḻa* — "to lose".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

இழ (*iḻa*) is native Dravidian. DEDR 501 lists Malayalam *iḻakkuka*, "to lose".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: iḻa*
- *Say it: iḻa*, once more
- *Say it:* say *iḻa*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for to try, then the Tamil for to tear, then say *iḻa* again

Before you move on

What does இழ mean? (“To lose”.) Say it once more.

196.3 அழுத்து (aḻuttu) — to press

Before the new one: say the Tamil for to tear, then the Tamil for to lose.

You’ll want to know: அழுத்து

அழுத்து — *aḻuttu* — “to press”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

அழுத்து (*aḻuttu*) is native Dravidian. DEDR 285 lists Malayalam *aḻuttuka*.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *aḻuttu*
- *Say it:* *aḻuttu*, once more
- *Say it:* say *aḻuttu*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for to tear, then the Tamil for to lose, then say *aḻuttu* again

Before you move on

What does அழுத்து mean? (“To press”.) Say it once more.

196.4 உணர் (uṇar) — to feel

Before the new one: say the Tamil for to lose, then the Tamil for to press.

You'll want to know: உணர்

உணர் — *uṇar* — "to feel".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

உணர் (*uṇar*) is native Dravidian. DEDR 603 lists Malayalam *uṇaruka*, "to wake" and Kannada *oṇar*, "to feel".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: uṇar*
- *Say it: uṇar*, once more
- *Say it:* say *uṇar*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for to lose, then the Tamil for to press, then say *uṇar* again

Before you move on

What does **உணர்** mean? ("To feel".) Say it once more.

196.5 ஊற வை (ūṟa vai) — to soak

Before the new one: say the Tamil for to press, then the Tamil for to feel.

You'll want to know: ஊற வை

ஊற வை — *ūṟa vai* — "to soak".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

ஊற வை (*ūṟa vai*) is native: *ūṟa*, "to soak", from *ūṟu* (DEDR 761), and *vai*, "to put, to keep" (DEDR 5549): "keep it soaking".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: ūṟa vai*
- *Say it: ūṟa vai*, once more
- *Say it:* say *ūṟa vai*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for to press, then the Tamil for to feel, then say *ūṟa vai* again

Before you move on

What does **உறை வை** mean? ("To soak".) Say it once more.

Chapter 197

To remind, To earn, To avoid, To move house, To contact

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say to remind, to earn, to avoid, to move house and to contact.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 197: I can say to remind, to earn, to avoid, to move house and to contact.*

197.1 நினைவூட்டு (niṉaivūṭṭu) — to remind

> Before the new one: say the Tamil for to feel, then the Tamil for to soak.

You'll want to know: நினைவூட்டு

நினைவூட்டு — *niṉaivūṭṭu* — "to remind".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

நினைவூட்டு (*niṉaivūṭṭu*) is native: *niṉaivu*, "memory", from *niṉai*, "to think, to remember" (DEDR 3683), and *ūṭṭu*, "to feed" (DEDR 600): to remind is "to feed the memory".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: niṉaivūṭṭu*
- *Say it: niṉaivūṭṭu*, once more
- *Say it:* say *niṉaivūṭṭu*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for to feel, then the Tamil for to soak, then say *niṉaivūṭṭu* again

Before you move on

What does நினைவூட்டு mean? ("To remind".) Say it once more.

197.2 சம்பாதி (campāti) — to earn

Before the new one: say the Tamil for to soak, then the Tamil for to remind.

You'll want to know: சம்பாதி

சம்பாதி — *campāti* — "to earn".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

சம்பாதி (*campāti*) is a verb made from Sanskrit *sampād-*, "to bring about, to acquire", a well-established loan.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: campāti*
- *Say it: campāti*, once more
- *Say it:* say *campāti*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for to soak, then the Tamil for to remind, then say *campāti* again

Before you move on

What does **சம்பாதி** mean? ("To earn".) Say it once more.

197.3 தவிர் (tavir) — to avoid

Before the new one: say the Tamil for to remind, then the Tamil for to earn.

You'll want to know: தவிர்

தவிர் — *tavir* — "to avoid".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

தவிர் (*tavir*) is native Dravidian. DEDR 3113 lists Malayalam *tavirkka*, "to exclude, omit".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: tavir*
- *Say it: tavir*, once more
- *Say it:* say *tavir*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for to remind, then the Tamil for to earn, then say *tavir* again

Before you move on

What does **தவிர்** mean? ("To avoid".) Say it once more.

197.4 குடிபெயர் (kuṭipeyar) — to move house, to relocate

Before the new one: say the Tamil for to earn, then the Tamil for to avoid.

You'll want to know: குடிபெயர்

குடிபெயர் — *kuṭipeyar* — "to move house, to relocate".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

குடிபெயர் (*kuṭipeyar*) is native: *kuṭi*, "house, home" (DEDR 1655, which compares Sanskrit *kuṭi*, "hut"), and *peyar*, "to move" (DEDR 4409): "move house". The *peyar* that means "name" is a different entry.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: kuṭipeyar*
- *Say it: kuṭipeyar*, once more
- *Say it:* say *kuṭipeyar*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for to earn, then the Tamil for to avoid, then say *kuṭipeyar* again

Before you move on

What does குடிபெயர் mean? ("To move house, to relocate".) Say it once more.

197.5 தொடர்பு கொள் (toṭarpu koḷ) — to contact, to get in touch

Before the new one: say the Tamil for to avoid, then the Tamil for to move house.

You'll want to know: தொடர்பு கொள்

தொடர்பு கொள் — *toṭarpu koḷ* — "to contact, to get in touch".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

தொடர்பு கொள் (*toṭarpu koḷ*) is native: *toṭarpu*, "connection", from *toṭu*, "to touch, to be connected" (DEDR 3480), and *koḷ*, "to take" (DEDR 2151).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: toṭarpu koḷ*
- *Say it: toṭarpu koḷ*, once more
- *Say it:* say *toṭarpu koḷ*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for to avoid, then the Tamil for to move house, then say *toṭarpu koḷ* again

Before you move on

What does தொடர்பு கொள் mean? ("To contact, to get in touch".) Say it once more.

Chapter 198

To pray, To cheat, To tell a lie, To quarrel, To tease

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say to pray, to cheat, to tell a lie, to quarrel and to tease.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 198: I can say to pray, to cheat, to tell a lie, to quarrel and to tease.*

198.1 பிரார்த்தனை செய் (pirārttaṉai cey) — to pray

Before the new one: say the Tamil for to move house, then the Tamil for to contact.

You'll want to know: பிரார்த்தனை செய்

பிரார்த்தனை செய் — *pirārttaṉai cey* — "to pray".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

பிரார்த்தனை செய் (*pirārttaṉai cey*) is *pirārttaṉai*, "prayer", from Sanskrit *prārthana*, "a wish, a request" (CDIAL 8954), with native *sey*, "to do" (DEDR 1957).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: pirārttaṉai cey*
- *Say it: pirārttaṉai cey*, once more
- *Say it:* say *pirārttaṉai cey*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for to move house, then the Tamil for to contact, then say *pirārttaṉai cey* again

Before you move on

What does பிரார்த்தனை செய் mean? ("To pray".) Say it once more.

198.2 ஏமாற்று (ēmāṟṟu) — to cheat, to deceive

Before the new one: say the Tamil for to contact, then the Tamil for to pray.

You'll want to know: ஏமாற்று

ஏமாற்று — *ēmāṟṟu* — "to cheat, to deceive".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

ஏமாற்று (*ēmāṟṟu*) is native Dravidian. DEDR 898 lists Telugu *ēmāṟu*. It is the causative of *ēmāṟu*, "to be deceived".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: ēmāṟṟu*
- *Say it: ēmāṟṟu*, once more
- *Say it:* say *ēmāṟṟu*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for to contact, then the Tamil for to pray, then say *ēmāṟṟu* again

Before you move on

What does ஏமாற்று mean? ("To cheat, to deceive".) Say it once more.

198.3 பொய் சொல் (poy col) — to tell a lie

Before the new one: say the Tamil for to pray, then the Tamil for to cheat.

You'll want to know: பொய் சொல்

பொய் சொல் — *poy col* — "to tell a lie".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

பொய் சொல் (*poy col*) is native: *poy*, "a lie" (DEDR 4531), and *col*, "to say" (DEDR 2855).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: poy col*
- *Say it: poy col*, once more
- *Say it:* say *poy col*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for to pray, then the Tamil for to cheat, then say *poy col* again

Before you move on

What does பொய் சொல் mean? ("To tell a lie".) Say it once more.

198.4 சண்டை போடு (caṇṭai pōṭu) — to quarrel, to fight

Before the new one: say the Tamil for to cheat, then the Tamil for to tell a lie.

You'll want to know: சண்டை போடு

சண்டை போடு — *caṇṭai pōṭu* — "to quarrel, to fight".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

சண்டை போடு (*caṇṭai pōṭu*) is native: *caṇṭai*, "quarrel, fight" (DEDR 2318; Malayalam *caṇṭa*), and *pōṭu*, "to put, to throw" (DEDR 4581).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: caṇṭai pōṭu*
- *Say it: caṇṭai pōṭu*, once more
- *Say it:* say *caṇṭai pōṭu*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for to cheat, then the Tamil for to tell a lie, then say *caṇṭai pōṭu* again

Before you move on

What does சண்டை போடு mean? ("To quarrel, to fight".) Say it once more.

198.5 கேலி செய் (kēli cey) — to tease, to make fun of

Before the new one: say the Tamil for to tell a lie, then the Tamil for to quarrel.

You'll want to know: கேலி செய்

கேலி செய் — *kēli cey* — "to tease, to make fun of".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

கேலி செய் (*kēli cey*) is *kēli*, "jest, mockery", a well-established loan from Sanskrit *keli*, "play, sport", with native *sey*, "to do" (DEDR 1957).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: kēli cey*
- *Say it: kēli cey*, once more
- *Say it:* say *kēli cey*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for to tell a lie, then the Tamil for to quarrel, then say *kēli cey* again

Before you move on

What does கேலி செய் mean? ("To tease, to make fun of".) Say it once more.

Chapter 199

To believe, To agree, To refuse, To discuss, To compare

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say to believe, to agree, to refuse, to discuss and to compare.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 199: I can say to believe, to agree, to refuse, to discuss and to compare.*

199.1 நம்பு (nampu) — to believe

> Before the new one: say the Tamil for to quarrel, then the Tamil for to tease.

You'll want to know: நம்பு

நம்பு — *nampu* — "to believe".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

நம்பு (*nampu*) is native Dravidian. DEDR 3600 lists Malayalam *nampuka*, Kannada *nambu* and Telugu *nammu*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: nampu*
- *Say it: nampu*, once more
- *Say it:* say *nampu*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for to quarrel, then the Tamil for to tease, then say *nampu* again

Before you move on

What does நம்பு mean? ("To believe".) Say it once more.

199.2 ஒத்துக்கொள் (ottukkoḷ) — to agree, to admit

Before the new one: say the Tamil for to tease, then the Tamil for to believe.

You'll want to know: ஒத்துக்கொள்

ஒத்துக்கொள் — *ottukkoḷ* — "to agree, to admit".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

ஒத்துக்கொள் (*ottukkoḷ*) is native: *ottu*, "agreeing", from *o*, "to suit, to agree" (DEDR 924), and *koḷ*, "to take" (DEDR 2151).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: ottukkoḷ*
- *Say it: ottukkoḷ*, once more
- *Say it:* say *ottukkoḷ*

- *Recall:* say the Tamil for to tease, then the Tamil for to believe, then say *ottukkoḷ* again

Before you move on

What does ஒத்துக்கொள் mean? (“To agree, to admit”.) Say it once more.

199.3 மறு (ma̲ru) — to refuse, to deny

Before the new one: say the Tamil for to believe, then the Tamil for to agree.

You’ll want to know: மறு

மறு — *ma̲ru* — “to refuse, to deny”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

மறு (*ma̲ru*) is native Dravidian. DEDR 4765 lists Malayalam *ma̲rukka*, “to resist”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: ma̲ru*
- *Say it: ma̲ru*, once more
- *Say it:* say *ma̲ru*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for to believe, then the Tamil for to agree, then say *ma̲ru* again

Before you move on

What does மறு mean? (“To refuse, to deny”.) Say it once more.

199.4 விவாதி (vivāti) — to discuss, to debate

Before the new one: say the Tamil for to agree, then the Tamil for to refuse.

You'll want to know: விவாதி

விவாதி — *vivāti* — "to discuss, to debate".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

விவாதி (*vivāti*) is a verb made from Sanskrit *vivāda*, "dispute, debate", a well-established loan.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: vivāti*
- *Say it: vivāti*, once more
- *Say it:* say *vivāti*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for to agree, then the Tamil for to refuse, then say *vivāti* again

Before you move on

What does **விவாதி** mean? ("To discuss, to debate".) Say it once more.

199.5 ஒப்பிடு (oppiṭu) — to compare

Before the new one: say the Tamil for to refuse, then the Tamil for to discuss.

You'll want to know: ஒப்பிடு

ஒப்பிடு — *oppiṭu* — "to compare".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

ஒப்பிடு (*oppiṭu*) is native: *oppu*, "likeness", from *o*, "to resemble" (DEDR 924), and *iṭu*, "to put" (DEDR 442): "set side by side".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: oppiṭu*
- *Say it: oppiṭu*, once more
- *Say it:* say *oppiṭu*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for to refuse, then the Tamil for to discuss, then say *oppiṭu* again

Before you move on

What does ஒப்பிடு mean? ("To compare".) Say it once more.

Chapter 200

To pinch, To bend, To paint, To collect, To suck

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say to pinch, to bend, to paint, to collect and to suck.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 200: I can say to pinch, to bend, to paint, to collect and to suck.

200.1 கிள்ளு (kiḷḷu) — to pinch, to nip off

Before the new one: say the Tamil for to discuss, then the Tamil for to compare.

You'll want to know: கிள்ளு

கிள்ளு — *kiḷḷu* — "to pinch, to nip off".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

கிள்ளு (*kiḷḷu*) is native Dravidian. DEDR 1589 lists Malayalam *kiḷḷuka*, Kannada *giṇḍu* and Telugu *gillu*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: kiḷḷu*
- *Say it: kiḷḷu*, once more
- *Say it:* say *kiḷḷu*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for to discuss, then the Tamil for to compare, then say *kiḷḷu* again

Before you move on

What does கிள்ளு mean? ("To pinch, to nip off".) Say it once more.

200.2 வளை (vaḷai) — to bend

Before the new one: say the Tamil for to compare, then the Tamil for to pinch.

You'll want to know: வளை

வளை — *vaḷai* — "to bend".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

வளை (*vaḷai*) is native Dravidian. DEDR 5314 lists Malayalam *vaḷayuka*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: vaḷai*
- *Say it: vaḷai*, once more
- *Say it:* say *vaḷai*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for to compare, then the Tamil for to pinch, then say *vaḷai* again

Before you move on

What does வளை mean? (“To bend”.) Say it once more.

200.3 பூசு (pūcu) — to paint (a wall), to coat, to smear on

Before the new one: say the Tamil for to pinch, then the Tamil for to bend.

You’ll want to know: பூசு

பூசு — *pūcu* — “to paint (a wall), to coat, to smear on”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

பூசு (*pūcu*) is native Dravidian. DEDR 4352 lists Malayalam *pūcuka* and Kannada *pūsu*. The entry compares Sanskrit *pusta*, “plastering, modelling”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: pūcu*
- *Say it: pūcu*, once more
- *Say it:* say *pūcu*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for to pinch, then the Tamil for to bend, then say *pūcu* again

Before you move on

What does பூசு mean? (“To paint (a wall), to coat, to smear on”.) Say it once more.

200.4 சேகரி (cēkari) — to collect, to gather

Before the new one: say the Tamil for to bend, then the Tamil for to paint.

You'll want to know: சேகரி

சேகரி — *cēkari* — "to collect, to gather".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

சேகரி (*cēkari*) is native Dravidian. DEDR 2801 lists Telugu *sēkarincu*, "to collect". DEDR adds that the Malayalam forms look Sanskrit, though Sanskrit has no such word in this sense.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: cēkari*
- *Say it: cēkari*, once more
- *Say it:* say *cēkari*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for to bend, then the Tamil for to paint, then say *cēkari* again

Before you move on

What does சேகரி mean? ("To collect, to gather".) Say it once more.

200.5 உறிஞ்சு (uṟiñcu) — to suck, to sip through a straw

Before the new one: say the Tamil for to paint, then the Tamil for to collect.

You'll want to know: உறிஞ்சு

உறிஞ்சு — *uṟiñcu* — "to suck, to sip through a straw".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

உறிஞ்சு (*uṟiñcu*) is native Dravidian. DEDR 709 lists Malayalam *uṟiñcuka*, "to sip, suck".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *uṟiñcu*
- *Say it:* *uṟiñcu*, once more
- *Say it:* say *uṟiñcu*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for to paint, then the Tamil for to collect, then say *uṟiñcu* again

Before you move on

What does **உறிஞ்சு** mean? ("To suck, to sip through a straw".) Say it once more.

Chapter 201

Forehead, Beard, Moustache, Palm of the hand, Stomach ache

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say the forehead, a beard, a moustache, the palm of the hand and a stomach ache.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 201: I can say the forehead, a beard, a moustache, the palm of the hand and a stomach ache.*

201.1 நெற்றி (ner̲r̲i) — the forehead

Before the new one: say the Tamil for to collect, then the Tamil for to suck.

You'll want to know: நெற்றி

நெற்றி — *ner̲r̲i* — "the forehead".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

நெற்றி (*ner̲r̲i*) is native Dravidian. DEDR 3759 lists Malayalam *ner̲r̲i*, Kannada *netti* and Telugu *netti*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: ne͟rri*
- *Say it: ne͟rri*, once more
- *Say it:* say *ne͟rri*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for to collect, then the Tamil for to suck, then say *ne͟rri* again

Before you move on

What does நெற்றி mean? ("The forehead".) Say it once more.

201.2 தாடி (tāṭi) — a beard

Before the new one: say the Tamil for to suck, then the Tamil for the forehead.

You'll want to know: தாடி

தாடி — *tāṭi* — "a beard".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

தாடி (*tāṭi*) probably comes from Prakrit *dāḍhiā*, "beard" (CDIAL 6250; Pali *dāṭhikā*). DEDR has no entry for it.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: tāṭi*
- *Say it: tāṭi*, once more
- *Say it:* say *tāṭi*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for to suck, then the Tamil for the forehead, then say *tāṭi* again

Before you move on

What does தாடி mean? ("A beard".) Say it once more.

201.3 மீசை (mīcai) — a moustache

Before the new one: say the Tamil for the forehead, then the Tamil for a beard.

You'll want to know: மீசை

மீசை — *mīcai* — "a moustache".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

மீசை (*mīcai*) is native Dravidian. DEDR 4879 lists Malayalam *mīśa* and Kannada *mīse*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: mīcai*
- *Say it: mīcai*, once more
- *Say it:* say *mīcai*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for the forehead, then the Tamil for a beard, then say *mīcai* again

Before you move on

What does மீசை mean? ("A moustache".) Say it once more.

201.4 உள்ளங்கை (uḷḷaṅkai) — the palm of the hand

Before the new one: say the Tamil for a beard, then the Tamil for a moustache.

You'll want to know: உள்ளங்கை

உள்ளங்கை — *uḷḷaṅkai* — "the palm of the hand".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

உள்ளங்கை (*uḷḷaṅkai*) is native: *uḷ*, "inside" (DEDR 698), and *kai*, "hand" (DEDR 2023): "the inside of the hand".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: uḷḷaṅkai*
- *Say it: uḷḷaṅkai*, once more
- *Say it:* say *uḷḷaṅkai*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for a beard, then the Tamil for a moustache, then say *uḷḷaṅkai* again

Before you move on

What does **உள்ளங்கை** mean? ("The palm of the hand".) Say it once more.

201.5 வயிற்றுவலி (vayirruvali) — a stomach ache

Before the new one: say the Tamil for a moustache, then the Tamil for the palm of the hand.

You'll want to know: வயிற்றுவலி

வயிற்றுவலி — *vayirruvali* — "a stomach ache".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

வயிற்றுவலி (*vayirruvali*) is native: *vayiru*, "stomach" (DEDR 5259), and *vali*, "pain" (DEDR 5281).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: vayi<u>rr</u>uvali*
- *Say it: vayi<u>rr</u>uvali*, once more
- *Say it:* say *vayi<u>rr</u>uvali*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for a moustache, then the Tamil for the palm of the hand, then say *vayi<u>rr</u>uvali* again

Before you move on

What does வயிற்றுவலி mean? ("A stomach ache".) Say it once more.

Chapter 202

Weekend, Up to, Temple festival, Deepavali, New Year

Modes: **voice** (7) **Hands-free start:** all 7 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say a weekend, up to, a temple festival, Deepavali and the New Year.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 202: I can say a weekend, up to, a temple festival, Deepavali and the New Year.*

202.1 வார இறுதி (vāra iṟuti) — a weekend

> Before the new one: say the Tamil for the palm of the hand, then the Tamil for a stomach ache.

You'll want to know: வார இறுதி

வார இறுதி — *vāra iṟuti* — "a weekend".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

வார இறுதி (*vāra iṟuti*) is *vāram*, "week", from Sanskrit *vāra*, "one's turn, day of the week" (CDIAL 11547), and native *iṟuti*, "end", from *iṟa*, "to end, to pass away" (DEDR 514).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: vāra iṟuti*
- *Say it: vāra iṟuti*, once more
- *Say it:* say *vāra iṟuti*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for the palm of the hand, then the Tamil for a stomach ache, then say *vāra iṟuti* again

Before you move on

What does வார இறுதி mean? ("A weekend".) Say it once more.

202.2 வரை (varai) — up to, until

Before the new one: say the Tamil for a stomach ache, then the Tamil for a weekend.

You'll want to know: வரை

வரை — *varai* — "up to, until".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

வரை (*varai*) is native Dravidian. DEDR 5261 lists Malayalam *varampu*, "limit". It means "limit, boundary": "up to the limit of".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: varai*
- *Say it: varai*, once more
- *Say it:* say *varai*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for a stomach ache, then the Tamil for a weekend, then say *varai* again

Before you move on

What does **வரை** mean? ("Up to, until".) Say it once more.

202.3 திருவிழா (tiruviḻā) — a temple festival

Before the new one: say the Tamil for a weekend, then the Tamil for up to.

You'll want to know: திருவிழா

திருவிழா — *tiruviḻā* — "a temple festival".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

திருவிழா (*tiruviḻā*) is *tiru*, "holy", usually traced to Sanskrit *śrī* (CDIAL 12708), and native *viḻā*, "festival" (DEDR 5427; Malayalam *viḻā*).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: tiruviḻā*
- *Say it: tiruviḻā*, once more
- *Say it:* say *tiruviḻā*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for a weekend, then the Tamil for up to, then say *tiruviḻā* again

Before you move on

What does **திருவிழா** mean? ("A temple festival".) Say it once more.

202.4 தீபாவளி (tīpāvaḷi) — Deepavali, the festival of lights

Before the new one: say the Tamil for up to, then the Tamil for a temple festival.

You'll want to know: தீபாவளி

தீபாவளி — *tīpāvaḷi* — "Deepavali, the festival of lights".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

தீபாவளி (*tīpāvaḷi*) is Sanskrit *dīpāvalī*, "a row of lamps", built on *dīpa*, "lamp" (CDIAL 6348).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: tīpāvaḷi*
- *Say it: tīpāvaḷi*, once more
- *Say it:* say *tīpāvaḷi*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for up to, then the Tamil for a temple festival, then say *tīpāvaḷi* again

Before you move on

What does தீபாவளி mean? ("Deepavali, the festival of lights".) Say it once more.

202.5 புத்தாண்டு (puttāṇṭu) — the New Year

Before the new one: say the Tamil for a temple festival, then the Tamil for Deepavali.

You'll want to know: புத்தாண்டு

புத்தாண்டு — *puttāṇṭu* — "the New Year".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

புத்தாண்டு (*puttāṇṭu*) is native: *putu*, "new" (DEDR 4275), and *āṇṭu*, "year" (DEDR 5153).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: puttāṇṭu*
- *Say it: puttāṇṭu*, once more
- *Say it:* say *puttāṇṭu*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for a temple festival, then the Tamil for Deepavali, then say *puttāṇṭu* again

Before you move on

What does புத்தாண்டு mean? ("The New Year".) Say it once more.

202.6 Words from chapters 194-197 — a first pass

Say the words for Deepavali and the New Year.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- to pour, to chop, to peel, to deep-fry, to knead
- to bring, to give back, to drive, to use, to try
- to tear, to lose, to press, to feel, to soak
- to remind, to earn, to avoid, to move house, to contact

Before you move on

To pour? (ஊற்று, *ūṟṟu.*) To chop? (நறுக்கு, *naṟukku.*) To peel? (உரி, *uri.*) To deep-fry? (பொரி, *pori.*) To knead? (பிசை, *picai.*) To bring? (கொண்டு வா, *koṇṭu vā.*) To give back? (திருப்பிக் கொடு, *tiruppik koṭu.*) To drive? (ஓட்டு, *ōṭṭu.*) To use? (பயன்படுத்து, *payaṉpaṭuttu.*) To try? (முயற்சி செய், *muyaṟci cey.*) To tear? (கிழி, *kiḻi.*) To lose? (இழ, *iḻa.*) To press? (அழுத்து, *aḻuttu.*) To feel? (உணர், *uṇar.*) To soak? (ஊற வை, *ūṟa vai.*) To remind? (நினைவூட்டு, *niṉaivūṭṭu.*) To earn? (சம்பாதி, *campāti.*) To avoid? (தவிர், *tavir.*) To move house? (குடிபெயர், *kuṭipeyar.*) To contact? (தொடர்பு கொள், *toṭarpu koḷ.*)

202.7 Words from chapters 198-202 — a second pass

Say the words for to pray and to cheat.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- to pray, to cheat, to tell a lie, to quarrel, to tease
- to believe, to agree, to refuse, to discuss, to compare
- to pinch, to bend, to paint, to collect, to suck
- the forehead, a beard, a moustache, the palm of the hand, a stomach ache
- a weekend, up to, a temple festival, Deepavali, the New Year

Before you move on

To pray? (பிரார்த்தனை செய், *pirārttaṉai cey.*) To cheat? (ஏமாற்று, *ēmāṟṟu.*) To tell a lie? (பொய் சொல், *poy col.*) To quarrel? (சண்டை போடு, *caṇṭai pōṭu.*) To tease? (கேலி செய், *kēli cey.*) To believe? (நம்பு, *nampu.*) To agree? (ஒத்துக்கொள்,

ottukkoḷ.) To refuse? (மறு, *maṟu.*) To discuss? (விவாதி, *vivāti.*) To compare? (ஒப்பிடு, *oppiṭu.*) To pinch? (கிள்ளு, *kiḷḷu.*) To bend? (வளை, *vaḷai.*) To paint? (பூசு, *pūcu.*) To collect? (சேகரி, *cēkari.*) To suck? (உறிஞ்சு, *uṟiñcu.*) The forehead? (நெற்றி, *neṟṟi.*) A beard? (தாடி, *tāṭi.*) A moustache? (மீசை, *mīcai.*) The palm of the hand? (உள்ளங்கை, *uḷḷaṅkai.*) A stomach ache? (வயிற்றுவலி, *vayiṟṟuvali.*) A weekend? (வார இறுதி, *vāra iṟuti.*) Up to? (வரை, *varai.*) A temple festival? (திருவிழா, *tiruviḻā.*) Deepavali? (தீபாவளி, *tīpāvaḷi.*) The New Year? (புத்தாண்டு, *puttāṇṭu.*)

Chapter 203

Century, Until now, Deadline, Until then, Childhood

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say a century, until now, a deadline, until then and childhood.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 203: I can say a century, until now, a deadline, until then and childhood.*

203.1 நூற்றாண்டு (nūṟṟāṇṭu) — a century

Before the new one: say the Tamil for Deepavali, the festival of lights, then the Tamil for the New Year.

You'll want to know: நூற்றாண்டு

நூற்றாண்டு — *nūṟṟāṇṭu* — "a century".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

நூற்றாண்டு (*nūṟṟāṇṭu*) is native: *nūṟu*, "hundred" (DEDR 3729), and *āṇṭu*, "year" (DEDR 5153). DEDR lists Malayalam *nūṟṟ-āṇṭu*, "100 years", built the same way.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: nūṟṟāṇṭu*
- *Say it: nūṟṟāṇṭu*, once more
- *Say it:* say *nūṟṟāṇṭu*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for Deepavali, the festival of lights, then the Tamil for the New Year, then say *nūṟṟāṇṭu* again

Before you move on

What does நூற்றாண்டு mean? ("A century".) Say it once more.

203.2 இதுவரை (ituvarai) — until now, so far

Before the new one: say the Tamil for the New Year, then the Tamil for a century.

You'll want to know: இதுவரை

இதுவரை — *ituvarai* — "until now, so far".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

இதுவரை (*ituvarai*) is native: *itu*, "this" (DEDR 410), and *varai*, "up to" (DEDR 5261): "up to this".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: ituvarai*
- *Say it: ituvarai*, once more
- *Say it:* say *ituvarai*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for the New Year, then the Tamil for a century, then say *ituvarai* again

Before you move on

What does **இதுவரை** mean? ("Until now, so far".) Say it once more.

203.3 காலக்கெடு (kālakkeṭu) — a deadline

Before the new one: say the Tamil for a century, then the Tamil for until now.

You'll want to know: காலக்கெடு

காலக்கெடு — *kālakkeṭu* — "a deadline".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

காலக்கெடு (*kālakkeṭu*) is *kālam*, "time", from Sanskrit *kāla* (CDIAL 3084), and native *keṭu*, "fixed time, term", which DEDR 1109 lists among words for passing through and limits of time.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: kālakkeṭu*
- *Say it: kālakkeṭu*, once more
- *Say it:* say *kālakkeṭu*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for a century, then the Tamil for until now, then say *kālakkeṭu* again

Before you move on

What does **காலக்கெடு** mean? ("A deadline".) Say it once more.

203.4 அதுவரை (atuvarai) — until then

Before the new one: say the Tamil for until now, then the Tamil for a deadline.

You'll want to know: அதுவரை

அதுவரை — *atuvarai* — "until then".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

அதுவரை (*atuvarai*) is native: *atu*, "that" (DEDR 1), and *varai*, "up to" (DEDR 5261): "up to that".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: atuvarai*
- *Say it: atuvarai*, once more
- *Say it:* say *atuvarai*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for until now, then the Tamil for a deadline, then say *atuvarai* again

Before you move on

What does அதுவரை mean? ("Until then".) Say it once more.

203.5 குழந்தைப் பருவம் (kuḻantaip paruvam) — childhood

Before the new one: say the Tamil for a deadline, then the Tamil for until then.

You'll want to know: குழந்தைப் பருவம்

குழந்தைப் பருவம் — *kuḻantaip paruvam* — "childhood".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

குழந்தைப் பருவம் (*kuḻantaip paruvam*) is native *kuḻantai*, "child" (DEDR 2149, which compares Sanskrit *kuḍaka*), and *paruvam*, "season, stage of life", from Sanskrit *parvan*, "joint, section" (CDIAL 7947).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: kuḻantaip paruvam*
- *Say it: kuḻantaip paruvam*, once more
- *Say it:* say *kuḻantaip paruvam*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for a deadline, then the Tamil for until then, then say *kuḻantaip paruvam* again

Before you move on

What does குழந்தைப் பருவம் mean? ("Childhood".) Say it once more.

Chapter 204

Stairs, Pharmacy, Restaurant, Supermarket, Clothes shop

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say stairs, a pharmacy, a restaurant, a supermarket and a clothes shop.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 204: I can say stairs, a pharmacy, a restaurant, a supermarket and a clothes shop.

204.1 படிக்கட்டு (paṭikkaṭṭu) — stairs, steps

Before the new one: say the Tamil for until then, then the Tamil for childhood.

You'll want to know: படிக்கட்டு

படிக்கட்டு — *paṭikkaṭṭu* — "stairs, steps".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

படிக்கட்டு (*paṭikkaṭṭu*) is native Dravidian. DEDR 3850 lists Malayalam *paṭi*, "step" and Telugu *paḍi-kaṭṭu*. The entry lists *paṭikkaṭṭu*, "flight of steps", itself.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: paṭikkaṭṭu*
- *Say it: paṭikkaṭṭu*, once more
- *Say it:* say *paṭikkaṭṭu*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for until then, then the Tamil for childhood, then say *paṭikkaṭṭu* again

Before you move on

What does படிக்கட்டு mean? ("Stairs, steps".) Say it once more.

204.2 மருந்துக்கடை (maruntukkaṭai) — a pharmacy

Before the new one: say the Tamil for childhood, then the Tamil for stairs.

You'll want to know: மருந்துக்கடை

மருந்துக்கடை — *maruntukkaṭai* — "a pharmacy".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

மருந்துக்கடை (*maruntukkaṭai*) is native: *maruntu*, "medicine" (DEDR 4719), and *kaṭai*, "shop" (DEDR 1142).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: maruntukkaṭai*
- *Say it: maruntukkaṭai*, once more
- *Say it:* say *maruntukkaṭai*

- *Recall:* say the Tamil for childhood, then the Tamil for stairs, then say *maruntukkaṭai* again

Before you move on

What does **மருந்துக்கடை** mean? ("A pharmacy".) Say it once more.

204.3 உணவகம் (uṇavakam) — a restaurant

Before the new one: say the Tamil for stairs, then the Tamil for a pharmacy.

You'll want to know: உணவகம்

உணவகம் — *uṇavakam* — "a restaurant".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

உணவகம் (*uṇavakam*) is a modern coinage from native parts: *uṇavu*, "food" (DEDR 600), and *akam*, "house" (DEDR 7): "the food house".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: uṇavakam*
- *Say it: uṇavakam*, once more
- *Say it:* say *uṇavakam*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for stairs, then the Tamil for a pharmacy, then say *uṇavakam* again

Before you move on

What does **உணவகம்** mean? ("A restaurant".) Say it once more.

204.4 பல்பொருள் அங்காடி (palporuḷ aṅkāṭi) — a supermarket

Before the new one: say the Tamil for a pharmacy, then the Tamil for a restaurant.

You'll want to know: பல்பொருள் அங்காடி

பல்பொருள் அங்காடி — *palporuḷ aṅkāṭi* — "a supermarket".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

பல்பொருள் அங்காடி (*palporuḷ aṅkāṭi*) is native: *pal*, "many" (DEDR 3987), *poruḷ*, "thing" (DEDR 4544), and *aṅkāṭi*, "bazaar" (DEDR 35; Malayalam *aṅṅāṭi*): "the many-things bazaar". DEDR compares *aṅkāṭi*, with a query, to Sanskrit *aṅgaṇa*, "courtyard".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: palporuḷ aṅkāṭi*
- *Say it: palporuḷ aṅkāṭi*, once more
- *Say it:* say *palporuḷ aṅkāṭi*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for a pharmacy, then the Tamil for a restaurant, then say *palporuḷ aṅkāṭi* again

Before you move on

What does பல்பொருள் அங்காடி mean? ("A supermarket".) Say it once more.

204.5 துணிக்கடை (tuṇikkaṭai) — a clothes shop

Before the new one: say the Tamil for a restaurant, then the Tamil for a supermarket.

You'll want to know: துணிக்கடை

துணிக்கடை — *tuṇikkaṭai* — "a clothes shop".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

துணிக்கடை (*tuṇikkaṭai*) is native: *tuṇi*, "cloth" (DEDR 3307), and *kaṭai*, "shop" (DEDR 1142).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: tuṇikkaṭai*
- *Say it: tuṇikkaṭai*, once more
- *Say it:* say *tuṇikkaṭai*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for a restaurant, then the Tamil for a supermarket, then say *tuṇikkaṭai* again

Before you move on

What does துணிக்கடை mean? ("A clothes shop".) Say it once more.

Chapter 205

Tour, Cinema, Building, Upper floor, Police station

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say a tour, a cinema, a building, an upper floor and a police station.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 205: I can say a tour, a cinema, a building, an upper floor and a police station.*

205.1 சுற்றுலா (cu̲r̲rulā) — a tour, a sightseeing trip

Before the new one: say the Tamil for a supermarket, then the Tamil for a clothes shop.

You'll want to know: சுற்றுலா

சுற்றுலா — *cu̲r̲rulā* — "a tour, a sightseeing trip".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

சுற்றுலா (*cu̲r̲rulā*) is native: *cu̲r̲ru*, "to go around" (DEDR 2715), and *ulā*, "a stroll, a procession" (DEDR 2693).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *cu̲r̲rulā*
- *Say it:* *cu̲r̲rulā*, once more
- *Say it:* say *cu̲r̲rulā*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for a supermarket, then the Tamil for a clothes shop, then say *cu̲r̲rulā* again

Before you move on

What does சுற்றுலா mean? (“A tour, a sightseeing trip”.) Say it once more.

205.2 திரையரங்கம் (tiraiyaraṅkam) — a cinema

Before the new one: say the Tamil for a clothes shop, then the Tamil for a tour.

You’ll want to know: திரையரங்கம்

திரையரங்கம் — *tiraiyaraṅkam* — “a cinema”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

திரையரங்கம் (*tiraiyaraṅkam*) is native *tirai*, “screen” (DEDR 3244), and *araṅkam*, “stage, hall”, from Sanskrit *raṅga*, “arena, stage” (CDIAL 10561), with a vowel put before the *r*.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *tiraiyaraṅkam*
- *Say it:* *tiraiyaraṅkam*, once more
- *Say it:* say *tiraiyaraṅkam*

- *Recall:* say the Tamil for a clothes shop, then the Tamil for a tour, then say *tiraiyaraṅkam* again

Before you move on

What does திரையரங்கம் mean? (“A cinema”.) Say it once more.

205.3 கட்டிடம் (kaṭṭiṭam) — a building

Before the new one: say the Tamil for a tour, then the Tamil for a cinema.

You’ll want to know: கட்டிடம்

கட்டிடம் — *kaṭṭiṭam* — “a building”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

கட்டிடம் (*kaṭṭiṭam*) is native: *kaṭṭu*, “to build” (DEDR 1147), and *iṭam*, “place” (DEDR 434): “the built place”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: kaṭṭiṭam*
- *Say it: kaṭṭiṭam*, once more
- *Say it:* say *kaṭṭiṭam*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for a tour, then the Tamil for a cinema, then say *kaṭṭiṭam* again

Before you move on

What does கட்டிடம் mean? (“A building”.) Say it once more.

205.4 மாடி (māṭi) — an upper floor, a storey

Before the new one: say the Tamil for a cinema, then the Tamil for a building.

You'll want to know: மாடி

மாடி — *māṭi* — "an upper floor, a storey".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

மாடி (*māṭi*) is native Dravidian. DEDR 4796 lists Malayalam *māṭam*, "house with an upper storey". The entry compares Sanskrit and Prakrit words for upper-storeyed houses.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: māṭi*
- *Say it: māṭi*, once more
- *Say it:* say *māṭi*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for a cinema, then the Tamil for a building, then say *māṭi* again

Before you move on

What does மாடி mean? ("An upper floor, a storey".) Say it once more.

205.5 காவல் நிலையம் (kāval nilaiyam) — a police station

Before the new one: say the Tamil for a building, then the Tamil for an upper floor.

You'll want to know: காவல் நிலையம்

காவல் நிலையம் — *kāval nilaiyam* — "a police station".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

காவல் நிலையம் (*kāval nilaiyam*) is native: *kāval*, "guard, watch", from *kā*, "to guard" (DEDR 1416), and *nilaiyam*, "station", from *nil*, "to stand" (DEDR 3675).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: kāval nilaiyam*
- *Say it: kāval nilaiyam*, once more
- *Say it:* say *kāval nilaiyam*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for a building, then the Tamil for an upper floor, then say *kāval nilaiyam* again

Before you move on

What does காவல் நிலையம் mean? ("A police station".) Say it once more.

Chapter 206

Church, Mosque, Hall, Playground, Swimming pool

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say a church, a mosque, a hall, a playground and a swimming pool.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 206: I can say a church, a mosque, a hall, a playground and a swimming pool.*

206.1 தேவாலயம் (tēvālayam) — a church

Before the new one: say the Tamil for an upper floor, then the Tamil for a police station.

You'll want to know: தேவாலயம்

தேவாலயம் — *tēvālayam* — "a church".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

தேவாலயம் (*tēvālayam*) is Sanskrit *deva*, "god", and *ālaya*, "house, abode" (CDIAL 1366): "the house of God".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *tēvālayam*
- *Say it:* *tēvālayam*, once more
- *Say it:* say *tēvālayam*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for an upper floor, then the Tamil for a police station, then say *tēvālayam* again

Before you move on

What does தேவாலயம் mean? ("A church".) Say it once more.

206.2 மசூதி (macūti) — a mosque

Before the new one: say the Tamil for a police station, then the Tamil for a church.

You'll want to know: மசூதி

மசூதி — *macūti* — "a mosque".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

மசூதி (*macūti*) is a loan from Arabic *masjid*, "mosque", through Persian and Hindustani.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *macūti*
- *Say it:* *macūti*, once more
- *Say it:* say *macūti*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for a police station, then the Tamil for a church, then say *macūti* again

Before you move on

What does மசூதி mean? ("A mosque".) Say it once more.

206.3 கூடம் (kūṭam) — a hall, a living room

Before the new one: say the Tamil for a church, then the Tamil for a mosque.

You'll want to know: கூடம்

கூடம் — *kūṭam* — "a hall, a living room".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

The origin of கூடம் (*kūṭam*), "hall", is uncertain. DEDR's *kūṭam* is a different word, "a smith's hammer", filed among Indo-Aryan loans (DEDR App. 29).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: kūṭam*
- *Say it: kūṭam*, once more
- *Say it:* say *kūṭam*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for a church, then the Tamil for a mosque, then say *kūṭam* again

Before you move on

What does கூடம் mean? ("A hall, a living room".) Say it once more.

206.4 மைதானம் (maitāṉam) — a playground, a sports ground

Before the new one: say the Tamil for a mosque, then the Tamil for a hall.

You'll want to know: மைதானம்

மைதானம் — *maitāṉam* — "a playground, a sports ground".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

மைதானம் (*maitāṉam*) is a loan from Persian *maidān*, "open ground", through Hindustani.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: maitāṉam*
- *Say it: maitāṉam*, once more
- *Say it:* say *maitāṉam*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for a mosque, then the Tamil for a hall, then say *maitāṉam* again

Before you move on

What does மைதானம் mean? ("A playground, a sports ground".) Say it once more.

206.5 நீச்சல் குளம் (nīccal kuḷam) — a swimming pool

Before the new one: say the Tamil for a hall, then the Tamil for a playground.

You'll want to know: நீச்சல் குளம்

நீச்சல் குளம் — *nīccal kuḷam* — "a swimming pool".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

நீச்சல் குளம் (*nīccal kuḷam*) is native: *nīccal*, "swimming", from *nīntu*, "to swim" (DEDR 3687), and *kuḷam*, "pond, tank" (DEDR 1828, which compares Sanskrit *kūla*, "pond").

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: nīccal kuḷam*
- *Say it: nīccal kuḷam*, once more
- *Say it:* say *nīccal kuḷam*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for a hall, then the Tamil for a playground, then say *nīccal kuḷam* again

Before you move on

What does நீச்சல் குளம் mean? ("A swimming pool".) Say it once more.

Chapter 207

In that case, Almost, Actually, In general, Usually

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say in that case, almost, actually, in general and usually.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 207: I can say in that case, almost, actually, in general and usually.*

207.1 அப்படியானால் (appaṭiyāṉāl) — in that case

Before the new one: say the Tamil for a playground, then the Tamil for a swimming pool.

You'll want to know: அப்படியானால்

அப்படியானால் — *appaṭiyāṉāl* — "in that case".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

அப்படியானால் (*appaṭiyāṉāl*) is native: *appaṭi*, "thus" (DEDR 1), and *āṉāl*, "if it is", from *ā*, "to become" (DEDR 333): "if it is so".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *appaṭiyāṉāl*
- *Say it:* *appaṭiyāṉāl*, once more
- *Say it:* say *appaṭiyāṉāl*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for a playground, then the Tamil for a swimming pool, then say *appaṭiyāṉāl* again

Before you move on

What does அப்படியானால் mean? (“In that case”.) Say it once more.

207.2 கிட்டத்தட்ட (kiṭṭattaṭṭa) — almost, nearly

Before the new one: say the Tamil for a swimming pool, then the Tamil for in that case.

You’ll want to know: கிட்டத்தட்ட

கிட்டத்தட்ட — *kiṭṭattaṭṭa* — “almost, nearly”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

கிட்டத்தட்ட (*kiṭṭattaṭṭa*) is native Dravidian (DEDR 1538). The entry lists *kiṭṭa*, “near, close by”; *-taṭṭa* is an echo that rounds it off: “near enough”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *kiṭṭattaṭṭa*
- *Say it:* *kiṭṭattaṭṭa*, once more
- *Say it:* say *kiṭṭattaṭṭa*

- *Recall:* say the Tamil for a swimming pool, then the Tamil for in that case, then say *kiṭṭattaṭṭa* again

Before you move on

What does **கிட்டத்தட்ட** mean? ("Almost, nearly".) Say it once more.

207.3 உண்மையில் (uṇmaiyil) — actually, in fact

Before the new one: say the Tamil for in that case, then the Tamil for almost.

You'll want to know: உண்மையில்

உண்மையில் — *uṇmaiyil* — "actually, in fact".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

உண்மையில் (*uṇmaiyil*) is native Dravidian (DEDR 697). It is *uṇmai*, "truth", with the locative *-il*: "in truth".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: uṇmaiyil*
- *Say it: uṇmaiyil*, once more
- *Say it:* say *uṇmaiyil*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for in that case, then the Tamil for almost, then say *uṇmaiyil* again

Before you move on

What does **உண்மையில்** mean? ("Actually, in fact".) Say it once more.

207.4 பொதுவாக (poṭuvāka) — in general, generally

Before the new one: say the Tamil for almost, then the Tamil for actually.

You'll want to know: பொதுவாக

பொதுவாக — *poṭuvāka* — "in general, generally".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

பொதுவாக (*poṭuvāka*) is native Dravidian. DEDR 4507 lists Malayalam *potu*, "common, general". It is *potu*, "common, general", with *-āka*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: poṭuvāka*
- *Say it: poṭuvāka*, once more
- *Say it:* say *poṭuvāka*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for almost, then the Tamil for actually, then say *poṭuvāka* again

Before you move on

What does பொதுவாக mean? ("In general, generally".) Say it once more.

207.5 வழக்கமாக (vaḻakkamāka) — usually, as usual

Before the new one: say the Tamil for actually, then the Tamil for in general.

You'll want to know: வழக்கமாக

வழக்கமாக — *va̲lakkamāka* — "usually, as usual".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

வழக்கமாக (*va̲lakkamāka*) is native Dravidian (DEDR 5292). It is *va̲lakkam*, "custom", from *va̲laṅku*, "to be in use", with *-āka*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *va̲lakkamāka*
- *Say it:* *va̲lakkamāka*, once more
- *Say it:* say *va̲lakkamāka*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for actually, then the Tamil for in general, then say *va̲lakkamāka* again

Before you move on

What does **வழக்கமாக** mean? ("Usually, as usual".) Say it once more.

Chapter 208

Knowledge, Duty, Freedom, Information, Secret

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say knowledge, a duty, freedom, information and a secret.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 208: I can say knowledge, a duty, freedom, information and a secret.

208.1 அறிவு (a̲rivu) — knowledge

Before the new one: say the Tamil for in general, then the Tamil for usually.

You'll want to know: அறிவு

அறிவு — *a̲rivu* — "knowledge".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

அறிவு (*a̲rivu*) is native Dravidian. DEDR 314 lists Malayalam *a̲rivu*, "knowledge".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: a̲ṟivu*
- *Say it: a̲ṟivu*, once more
- *Say it:* say *a̲ṟivu*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for in general, then the Tamil for usually, then say *a̲ṟivu* again

Before you move on

What does அறிவு mean? (“Knowledge”.) Say it once more.

208.2 கடமை (kaṭamai) — a duty

Before the new one: say the Tamil for usually, then the Tamil for knowledge.

You’ll want to know: கடமை

கடமை — *kaṭamai* — “a duty”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

கடமை (*kaṭamai*) is native Dravidian. DEDR 1113 lists Malayalam *kaṭama*, “debt, obligation”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: kaṭamai*
- *Say it: kaṭamai*, once more
- *Say it:* say *kaṭamai*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for usually, then the Tamil for knowledge, then say *kaṭamai* again

Before you move on

What does **கடமை** mean? ("A duty".) Say it once more.

208.3 சுதந்திரம் (cutantiram) — freedom

Before the new one: say the Tamil for knowledge, then the Tamil for a duty.

You'll want to know: சுதந்திரம்

சுதந்திரம் — *cutantiram* — "freedom".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

சுதந்திரம் (*cutantiram*) is a well-established loan from Sanskrit *svatantra*, "self-dependent, independent".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: cutantiram*
- *Say it: cutantiram*, once more
- *Say it:* say *cutantiram*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for knowledge, then the Tamil for a duty, then say *cutantiram* again

Before you move on

What does **சுதந்திரம்** mean? ("Freedom".) Say it once more.

208.4 தகவல் (takaval) — information

Before the new one: say the Tamil for a duty, then the Tamil for freedom.

You'll want to know: தகவல்

தகவல் — *takaval* — "information".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

The origin of **தகவல்** (*takaval*) is uncertain. DEDR has no entry for it, and no source for it is settled.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: takaval*
- *Say it: takaval*, once more
- *Say it:* say *takaval*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for a duty, then the Tamil for freedom, then say *takaval* again

Before you move on

What does **தகவல்** mean? ("Information".) Say it once more.

208.5 ரகசியம் (rakaciyam) — a secret

Before the new one: say the Tamil for freedom, then the Tamil for information.

You'll want to know: ரகசியம்

ரகசியம் — *rakaciyam* — "a secret".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

ரகசியம் (*rakaciyam*) is a loan from Sanskrit *rahasya*, "private, secret" (CDIAL 10669).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: rakaciyam*
- *Say it: rakaciyam*, once more
- *Say it:* say *rakaciyam*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for freedom, then the Tamil for information, then say *rakaciyam* again

Before you move on

What does ரகசியம் mean? ("A secret".) Say it once more.

Chapter 209

Spoiled, Full, Empty, Tight, Loose

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say spoiled, full, empty, tight and loose.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 209: I can say spoiled, full, empty, tight and loose.*

209.1 கெட்டுப்போன (keṭṭuppōṉa) — spoiled, gone off

Before the new one: say the Tamil for information, then the Tamil for a secret.

You'll want to know: கெட்டுப்போன

கெட்டுப்போன — *keṭṭuppōṉa* — "spoiled, gone off".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

கெட்டுப்போன (*keṭṭuppōṉa*) is native: *keṭṭu*, "having spoiled", from *keṭu*, "to perish, to go bad" (DEDR 1942), and *pōṉa*, "gone", from *pō* (DEDR 4572).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: keṭṭuppōṉa*
- *Say it: keṭṭuppōṉa*, once more
- *Say it:* say *keṭṭuppōṉa*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for information, then the Tamil for a secret, then say *keṭṭuppōṉa* again

Before you move on

What does கெட்டுப்போன mean? ("Spoiled, gone off".) Say it once more.

209.2 நிறைந்த (niṟainta) — full

Before the new one: say the Tamil for a secret, then the Tamil for spoiled.

You'll want to know: நிறைந்த

நிறைந்த — *niṟainta* — "full".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

நிறைந்த (*niṟainta*) is native Dravidian (DEDR 3682). It is *niṟai*, "to become full", in the form "that has filled".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: niṟainta*
- *Say it: niṟainta*, once more
- *Say it:* say *niṟainta*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for a secret, then the Tamil for spoiled, then say *niṟainta* again

Before you move on

What does நிறைந்த mean? ("Full".) Say it once more.

209.3 காலியான (kāliyāṉa) — empty

Before the new one: say the Tamil for spoiled, then the Tamil for full.

You'll want to know: காலியான

காலியான — *kāliyāṉa* — "empty".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

காலியான (*kāliyāṉa*) is *kāli*, "empty", a loan from Arabic *khālī*, "empty", through Hindustani, with *-āṉa*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: kāliyāṉa*
- *Say it: kāliyāṉa*, once more
- *Say it:* say *kāliyāṉa*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for spoiled, then the Tamil for full, then say *kāliyāṉa* again

Before you move on

What does காலியான mean? ("Empty".) Say it once more.

209.4 இறுக்கமான (iṟukkamāṉa) — tight

Before the new one: say the Tamil for full, then the Tamil for empty.

You'll want to know: இறுக்கமான

இறுக்கமான — *iṟukkamāṉa* — "tight".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

இறுக்கமான (*iṟukkamāṉa*) is native Dravidian. DEDR 524 lists Malayalam *iṟukuka*, "to become tight". It is *iṟukkam*, "tightness", with *-āṉa*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *iṟukkamāṉa*
- *Say it:* *iṟukkamāṉa*, once more
- *Say it:* say *iṟukkamāṉa*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for full, then the Tamil for empty, then say *iṟukkamāṉa* again

Before you move on

What does இறுக்கமான mean? ("Tight".) Say it once more.

209.5 தளர்வான (taḷarvāṉa) — loose

Before the new one: say the Tamil for empty, then the Tamil for tight.

You'll want to know: தளர்வான

தளர்வான — *taḷarvāṉa* — "loose".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

தளர்வான (*taḷarvāṉa*) is native Dravidian. DEDR 3127 lists Malayalam *taḷaruka*, "to slacken". It is *taḷarvu*, "slackness", with *-āṉa*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: taḷarvāṉa*
- *Say it: taḷarvāṉa*, once more
- *Say it:* say *taḷarvāṉa*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for empty, then the Tamil for tight, then say *taḷarvāṉa* again

Before you move on

What does தளர்வான mean? ("Loose".) Say it once more.

Chapter 210

Mind, Character, Jealousy, Shyness, Surprise

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say the mind, character, jealousy, shyness and surprise.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 210: I can say the mind, character, jealousy, shyness and surprise.

210.1 மனம் (maṉam) — the mind, the heart

Before the new one: say the Tamil for tight, then the Tamil for loose.

You'll want to know: மனம்

மனம் — *maṉam* — "the mind, the heart".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

மனம் (*maṉam*) is a loan from Sanskrit *manas*, "mind" (CDIAL 9822).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *maṉam*
- *Say it:* *maṉam*, once more
- *Say it:* say *maṉam*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for tight, then the Tamil for loose, then say *maṉam* again

Before you move on

What does மனம் mean? (“The mind, the heart”.) Say it once more.

210.2 குணம் (kuṇam) — character, nature (of a person)

Before the new one: say the Tamil for loose, then the Tamil for the mind.

You’ll want to know: குணம்

குணம் — *kuṇam* — “character, nature (of a person)”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

குணம் (*kuṇam*) is a loan from Sanskrit *guṇa*, “strand; quality” (CDIAL 4190).

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *kuṇam*
- *Say it:* *kuṇam*, once more
- *Say it:* say *kuṇam*

- *Recall:* say the Tamil for loose, then the Tamil for the mind, then say *kuṇam* again

Before you move on

What does குணம் mean? ("Character, nature (of a person)".) Say it once more.

210.3 பொறாமை (poṟāmai) — jealousy

Before the new one: say the Tamil for the mind, then the Tamil for character.

You'll want to know: பொறாமை

பொறாமை — *poṟāmai* — "jealousy".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

பொறாமை (*poṟāmai*) is native Dravidian (DEDR 4565). The entry lists *poṟāmai*, "envy", the negative of *poṟu*, "to bear": jealousy is "not bearing" another's good.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: poṟāmai*
- *Say it: poṟāmai*, once more
- *Say it:* say *poṟāmai*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for the mind, then the Tamil for character, then say *poṟāmai* again

Before you move on

What does பொறாமை mean? ("Jealousy".) Say it once more.

210.4 வெட்கம் (veṭkam) — shyness, shame

Before the new one: say the Tamil for character, then the Tamil for jealousy.

You'll want to know: வெட்கம்

வெட்கம் — *veṭkam* — "shyness, shame".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

வெட்கம் (*veṭkam*) is native Dravidian. DEDR 5500 lists Malayalam *veḷkka*, "to be ashamed".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: veṭkam*
- *Say it: veṭkam*, once more
- *Say it:* say *veṭkam*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for character, then the Tamil for jealousy, then say *veṭkam* again

Before you move on

What does வெட்கம் mean? ("Shyness, shame".) Say it once more.

210.5 ஆச்சரியம் (āccariyam) — surprise

Before the new one: say the Tamil for jealousy, then the Tamil for shyness.

You'll want to know: ஆச்சரியம்

ஆச்சரியம் — *āccariyam* — "surprise".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

ஆச்சரியம் (*āccariyam*) is from Sanskrit *āścarya*, "wonderful", through a spoken form *āścariya* (CDIAL 1464).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *āccariyam*
- *Say it:* *āccariyam*, once more
- *Say it:* say *āccariyam*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for jealousy, then the Tamil for shyness, then say *āccariyam* again

Before you move on

What does ஆச்சரியம் mean? ("Surprise".) Say it once more.

Chapter 211

Pleasant, Friendly, Fool, Pink, Brown

Modes: **voice** (7) **Hands-free start:** all 7 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say pleasant, friendly, a fool, pink and brown.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 211: I can say pleasant, friendly, a fool, pink and brown.*

211.1 இனிமையான (iṉimaiyāṉa) — pleasant, sweet (of a voice or manner)

Before the new one: say the Tamil for shyness, then the Tamil for surprise.

You'll want to know: இனிமையான

இனிமையான — *iṉimaiyāṉa* — "pleasant, sweet (of a voice or manner)".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

இனிமையான (*iṉimaiyāṉa*) is native Dravidian (DEDR 530). It is *iṉimai*, "sweetness", with *-āṉa*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: iṉimaiyāṉa*
- *Say it: iṉimaiyāṉa*, once more
- *Say it:* say *iṉimaiyāṉa*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for shyness, then the Tamil for surprise, then say *iṉimaiyāṉa* again

Before you move on

What does இனிமையான mean? ("Pleasant, sweet (of a voice or manner)".) Say it once more.

211.2 நட்பான (naṭpāṉa) — friendly

Before the new one: say the Tamil for surprise, then the Tamil for pleasant.

You'll want to know: நட்பான

நட்பான — *naṭpāṉa* — "friendly".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

நட்பான (*naṭpāṉa*) is native Dravidian. DEDR 3588 lists Kannada *naṇṭu*, "friendship". It is *naṭpu*, "friendship", with *-āṉa*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: naṭpāṉa*
- *Say it: naṭpāṉa*, once more
- *Say it:* say *naṭpāṉa*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for surprise, then the Tamil for pleasant, then say *naṭpāṉa* again

Before you move on

What does நட்பான mean? ("Friendly".) Say it once more.

211.3 முட்டாள் (muṭṭāḷ) — a fool; foolish

Before the new one: say the Tamil for pleasant, then the Tamil for friendly.

You'll want to know: முட்டாள்

முட்டாள் — *muṭṭāḷ* — "a fool; foolish".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

முட்டாள் (*muṭṭāḷ*) is native Dravidian. DEDR 4929 lists Kannada *muṭṭāḷa*, "stupidity".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: muṭṭāḷ*
- *Say it: muṭṭāḷ*, once more
- *Say it:* say *muṭṭāḷ*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for pleasant, then the Tamil for friendly, then say *muṭṭāḷ* again

Before you move on

What does முட்டாள் mean? ("A fool; foolish".) Say it once more.

211.4 இளஞ்சிவப்பு (iḷañcivappu) — pink

Before the new one: say the Tamil for friendly, then the Tamil for a fool; foolish.

You'll want to know: இளஞ்சிவப்பு

இளஞ்சிவப்பு — *iḷañcivappu* — "pink".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

இளஞ்சிவப்பு (*iḷañcivappu*) is native: *iḷam*, "young, tender" (DEDR 513), and *civappu*, "redness" (DEDR 1931): "young red".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: iḷañcivappu*
- *Say it: iḷañcivappu*, once more
- *Say it:* say *iḷañcivappu*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for friendly, then the Tamil for a fool; foolish, then say *iḷañcivappu* again

Before you move on

What does இளஞ்சிவப்பு mean? ("Pink".) Say it once more.

211.5 பழுப்பு (paḻuppu) — brown

Before the new one: say the Tamil for a fool; foolish, then the Tamil for pink.

You'll want to know: பழுப்பு

பழுப்பு — *paḻuppu* — "brown".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

பழுப்பு (*paḻuppu*) is native Dravidian (DEDR 4004). The entry gives *paḻuppu*, "ripeness, the yellowness of ripe fruit": brown is the colour of ripening. The entry compares Sanskrit *phala*, "fruit".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: paluppu*
- *Say it: paluppu*, once more
- *Say it:* say *paluppu*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for a fool; foolish, then the Tamil for pink, then say *paluppu* again

Before you move on

What does பழுப்பு mean? ("Brown".) Say it once more.

211.6 Words from chapters 203-206 — a first pass

Say the words for pink and brown.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- a century, until now, a deadline, until then, childhood
- stairs, a pharmacy, a restaurant, a supermarket, a clothes shop
- a tour, a cinema, a building, an upper floor, a police station
- a church, a mosque, a hall, a playground, a swimming pool

Before you move on

A century? (நூற்றாண்டு, *nūṟṟāṇṭu*.) Until now? (இதுவரை, *ituvarai*.) A deadline? (காலக்கெடு, *kālakkeṭu*.) Until then? (அதுவரை, *atuvarai*.) Childhood? (குழந்தைப் பருவம், *kuḻantaip paruvam*.) Stairs? (படிக்கட்டு, *paṭikkaṭṭu*.) A pharmacy? (மருந்துக்கடை, *maruntukkaṭai*.) A restaurant? (உணவகம்,

uṇavakam.) A supermarket? (பல்பொருள் அங்காடி, *palporuḷ aṅkāṭi.*) A clothes shop? (துணிக்கடை, *tuṇikkaṭai.*) A tour? (சுற்றுலா, *cuṟṟulā.*) A cinema? (திரையரங்கம், *tiraiyaraṅkam.*) A building? (கட்டிடம், *kaṭṭiṭam.*) An upper floor? (மாடி, *māṭi.*) A police station? (காவல் நிலையம், *kāval nilaiyam.*) A church? (தேவாலயம், *tēvālayam.*) A mosque? (மசூதி, *macūti.*) A hall? (கூடம், *kūṭam.*) A playground? (மைதானம், *maitāṉam.*) A swimming pool? (நீச்சல் குளம், *nīccal kuḷam.*)

211.7 Words from chapters 207-211 — a second pass

Say the words for in that case and almost.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- in that case, almost, actually, in general, usually
- knowledge, a duty, freedom, information, a secret
- spoiled, full, empty, tight, loose
- the mind, character, jealousy, shyness, surprise
- pleasant, friendly, a fool; foolish, pink, brown

Before you move on

In that case? (அப்படியானால், *appaṭiyāṉāl.*) Almost? (கிட்டத்தட்ட, *kiṭṭattaṭṭa.*) Actually? (உண்மையில், *uṇmaiyil.*) In general? (பொதுவாக, *poṭuvāka.*) Usually? (வழக்கமாக, *vaḻakkamāka.*) Knowledge? (அறிவு, *aṟivu.*) A duty? (கடமை, *kaṭamai.*) Freedom? (சுதந்திரம், *cutantiram.*) Information? (தகவல், *takaval.*) A secret? (ரகசியம், *rakaciyam.*) Spoiled? (கெட்டுப்போன, *keṭṭuppōṉa.*) Full? (நிறைந்த, *niṟainta.*) Empty? (காலியான, *kāliyāṉa.*) Tight? (இறுக்கமான, *iṟukkamāṉa.*) Loose? (தளர்வான, *taḷarvāṉa.*) The mind? (மனம், *maṉam.*) Character? (குணம், *kuṇam.*) Jealousy? (பொறாமை,

poṟāmai.) Shyness? (வெட்கம், *veṭkam.*) Surprise? (ஆச்சரியம், *āccariyam.*) Pleasant? (இனிமையான, *iṉimaiyāṉa.*) Friendly? (நட்பான, *naṭpāṉa.*) A fool; foolish? (முட்டாள், *muṭṭāḷ.*) Pink? (இளஞ்சிவப்பு, *iḷañcivappu.*) Brown? (பழுப்பு, *paḻuppu.*)

Chapter 212

Weak, Selfish, Generous, Well-behaved, Ugly

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say weak, selfish, generous, well-behaved and ugly.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 212: I can say weak, selfish, generous, well-behaved and ugly.

212.1 பலவீனமான (palavīṉamāṉa) — weak

Before the new one: say the Tamil for pink, then the Tamil for brown.

You'll want to know: பலவீனமான

பலவீனமான — *palavīṉamāṉa* — "weak".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

பலவீனமான (*palavīṉamāṉa*) is *palavīṉam*, "weakness", from Sanskrit *bala*, "strength" (CDIAL 9161), and *hīna*, "lacking" (CDIAL 14124), with -*āṉa*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: palavīṉamāṉa*
- *Say it: palavīṉamāṉa*, once more
- *Say it:* say *palavīṉamāṉa*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for pink, then the Tamil for brown, then say *palavīṉamāṉa* again

Before you move on

What does பலவீனமான mean? ("Weak".) Say it once more.

212.2 சுயநலமான (cuyanalamāṉa) — selfish

Before the new one: say the Tamil for brown, then the Tamil for weak.

You'll want to know: சுயநலமான

சுயநலமான — *cuyanalamāṉa* — "selfish".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

சுயநலமான (*cuyanalamāṉa*) is *cuya*, "self", from Sanskrit *sva*, and native *nalam*, "welfare" (DEDR 3610): "self-welfare".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: cuyanalamāṉa*
- *Say it: cuyanalamāṉa*, once more
- *Say it:* say *cuyanalamāṉa*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for brown, then the Tamil for weak, then say *cuyanalamāṉa* again

Before you move on

What does சுயநலமான mean? ("Selfish".) Say it once more.

212.3 பெருந்தன்மையான (peruntaṉmaiyāṉa) — generous, big-hearted

Before the new one: say the Tamil for weak, then the Tamil for selfish.

You'll want to know: பெருந்தன்மையான

பெருந்தன்மையான — *peruntaṉmaiyāṉa* — "generous, big-hearted".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

பெருந்தன்மையான (*peruntaṉmaiyāṉa*) is native: *perum*, "great" (DEDR 4411), and *taṉmai*, "nature, character" (DEDR 3196): "great-natured".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: peruntaṉmaiyāṉa*
- *Say it: peruntaṉmaiyāṉa*, once more
- *Say it:* say *peruntaṉmaiyāṉa*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for weak, then the Tamil for selfish, then say *peruntaṉmaiyāṉa* again

Before you move on

What does பெருந்தன்மையான mean? ("Generous, big-hearted".) Say it once more.

212.4 ஒழுக்கமான (o̲lukkamā̲na) — well-behaved, disciplined

Before the new one: say the Tamil for selfish, then the Tamil for generous.

You'll want to know: ஒழுக்கமான

ஒழுக்கமான — *o̲lukkamā̲na* — "well-behaved, disciplined".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

ஒழுக்கமான (*o̲lukkamā̲na*) is native Dravidian. DEDR 1011 lists Malayalam *o̲lukkam*, "plainness". The entry glosses *o̲lukkam* "acting according to established rules, good conduct".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *o̲lukkamā̲na*
- *Say it:* *o̲lukkamā̲na*, once more
- *Say it:* say *o̲lukkamā̲na*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for selfish, then the Tamil for generous, then say *o̲lukkamā̲na* again

Before you move on

What does **ஒழுக்கமான** mean? ("Well-behaved, disciplined".) Say it once more.

212.5 அசிங்கமான (aciṅkamā̲na) — ugly

Before the new one: say the Tamil for generous, then the Tamil for well-behaved.

You'll want to know: அசிங்கமான

அசிங்கமான — *aciṅkamāṉa* — "ugly".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

The origin of அசிங்கமான (*aciṅkamāṉa*) is uncertain. *Aciṅkam*, "ugliness", has no entry in DEDR, and its source is not settled.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *aciṅkamāṉa*
- *Say it:* *aciṅkamāṉa*, once more
- *Say it:* say *aciṅkamāṉa*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for generous, then the Tamil for well-behaved, then say *aciṅkamāṉa* again

Before you move on

What does அசிங்கமான mean? ("Ugly".) Say it once more.

Chapter 213

Cupboard, Electricity, Rubbish, Toothpaste, Toothbrush

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say a cupboard, electricity, rubbish, toothpaste and a toothbrush.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 213: I can say a cupboard, electricity, rubbish, toothpaste and a toothbrush.*

213.1 அலமாரி (alamāri) — a cupboard

> Before the new one: say the Tamil for well-behaved, then the Tamil for ugly.

You'll want to know: அலமாரி

அலமாரி — *alamāri* — "a cupboard".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

அலமாரி (*alamāri*) is a loan from Portuguese *armário*, "cupboard".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: alamāri*
- *Say it: alamāri*, once more
- *Say it:* say *alamāri*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for well-behaved, then the Tamil for ugly, then say *alamāri* again

Before you move on

What does அலமாரி mean? ("A cupboard".) Say it once more.

213.2 மின்சாரம் (miṉcāram) — electricity

Before the new one: say the Tamil for ugly, then the Tamil for a cupboard.

You'll want to know: மின்சாரம்

மின்சாரம் — *miṉcāram* — "electricity".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

மின்சாரம் (*miṉcāram*) is a modern coinage: native *miṉ*, "lightning" (DEDR 4876), and *cāram*, "essence, strength", from Sanskrit *sāra* (CDIAL 13355).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: miṉcāram*
- *Say it: miṉcāram*, once more
- *Say it:* say *miṉcāram*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for ugly, then the Tamil for a cupboard, then say *miṉcāram* again

Before you move on

What does மின்சாரம் mean? ("Electricity".) Say it once more.

213.3 குப்பை (kuppai) — rubbish, garbage

Before the new one: say the Tamil for a cupboard, then the Tamil for electricity.

You'll want to know: குப்பை

குப்பை — *kuppai* — "rubbish, garbage".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

குப்பை (*kuppai*) is native Dravidian. DEDR 1731 lists Malayalam *kuppa*, "heap of dirt or refuse".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: kuppai*
- *Say it: kuppai*, once more
- *Say it:* say *kuppai*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for a cupboard, then the Tamil for electricity, then say *kuppai* again

Before you move on

What does குப்பை mean? ("Rubbish, garbage".) Say it once more.

213.4 பற்பசை (parpacai) — toothpaste

Before the new one: say the Tamil for electricity, then the Tamil for rubbish.

You'll want to know: பற்பசை

பற்பசை — *paṟpacai* — "toothpaste".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

பற்பசை (*paṟpacai*) is native: *pal*, "tooth" (DEDR 3986), and *pacai*, "paste" (DEDR 3827).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: paṟpacai*
- *Say it: paṟpacai*, once more
- *Say it:* say *paṟpacai*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for electricity, then the Tamil for rubbish, then say *paṟpacai* again

Before you move on

What does பற்பசை mean? ("Toothpaste".) Say it once more.

213.5 பல்துலக்கி (paltulakki) — a toothbrush

Before the new one: say the Tamil for rubbish, then the Tamil for toothpaste.

You'll want to know: பல்துலக்கி

பல்துலக்கி — *paltulakki* — "a toothbrush".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

பல்துலக்கி (*paltulakki*) is native: *pal*, "tooth" (DEDR 3986), and *tulakki*, "the polisher", from *tulakku*, "to polish, to make shine" (DEDR 3360).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: paltulakki*
- *Say it: paltulakki*, once more
- *Say it:* say *paltulakki*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for rubbish, then the Tamil for toothpaste, then say *paltulakki* again

Before you move on

What does பல்துலக்கி mean? ("A toothbrush".) Say it once more.

Chapter 214

Buttermilk, Fruit juice, Tender coconut water, Flour, Bread

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say buttermilk, fruit juice, tender coconut water, flour and bread.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 214: I can say buttermilk, fruit juice, tender coconut water, flour and bread.

214.1 மோர் (mōr) — buttermilk

Before the new one: say the Tamil for toothpaste, then the Tamil for a toothbrush.

You'll want to know: மோர்

மோர் — *mōr* — "buttermilk".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

மோர் (*mōr*) is native Dravidian. DEDR 4902 lists Malayalam *mōr*. The entry compares Sanskrit *moraṭa*, "sour buttermilk".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *mōr*
- *Say it:* *mōr*, once more
- *Say it:* say *mōr*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for toothpaste, then the Tamil for a toothbrush, then say *mōr* again

Before you move on

What does மோர் mean? (“Buttermilk”.) Say it once more.

214.2 பழச்சாறு (paḻaccāṟu) — fruit juice

Before the new one: say the Tamil for a toothbrush, then the Tamil for buttermilk.

You’ll want to know: பழச்சாறு

பழச்சாறு — *paḻaccāṟu* — “fruit juice”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

பழச்சாறு (*paḻaccāṟu*) is native: *paḻam*, “fruit” (DEDR 4004, which compares Sanskrit *phala*), and *cāṟu*, “juice” (DEDR 2484).

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *paḻaccāṟu*
- *Say it:* *paḻaccāṟu*, once more
- *Say it:* say *paḻaccāṟu*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for a toothbrush, then the Tamil for buttermilk, then say *paḻaccāṟu* again

Before you move on

What does பழச்சாறு mean? ("Fruit juice".) Say it once more.

214.3 இளநீர் (iḷanīr) — tender coconut water

Before the new one: say the Tamil for buttermilk, then the Tamil for fruit juice.

You'll want to know: இளநீர்

இளநீர் — *iḷanīr* — "tender coconut water".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

இளநீர் (*iḷanīr*) is native Dravidian. DEDR 513 lists Malayalam *iḷa-nīr*, "unripe coconut". The entry lists *iḷa-nīr* itself: "young water".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: iḷanīr*
- *Say it: iḷanīr*, once more
- *Say it:* say *iḷanīr*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for buttermilk, then the Tamil for fruit juice, then say *iḷanīr* again

Before you move on

What does இளநீர் mean? ("Tender coconut water".) Say it once more.

214.4 மாவு (māvu) — flour; batter

Before the new one: say the Tamil for fruit juice, then the Tamil for tender coconut water.

You'll want to know: மாவு

மாவு — *māvu* — "flour; batter".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

மாவு (*māvu*) is native Dravidian. DEDR 4784 lists Malayalam *māvu*, "flour".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: māvu*
- *Say it: māvu*, once more
- *Say it:* say *māvu*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for fruit juice, then the Tamil for tender coconut water, then say *māvu* again

Before you move on

What does மாவு mean? ("Flour; batter".) Say it once more.

214.5 ரொட்டி (roṭṭi) — bread

Before the new one: say the Tamil for tender coconut water, then the Tamil for flour; batter.

You'll want to know: ரொட்டி

ரொட்டி — *roṭṭi* — "bread".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

ரொட்டி (*roṭṭi*) is a loan from Hindustani *roṭī*, "bread".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: roṭṭi*
- *Say it: roṭṭi*, once more
- *Say it:* say *roṭṭi*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for tender coconut water, then the Tamil for flour; batter, then say *roṭṭi* again

Before you move on

What does ரொட்டி mean? (“Bread”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 215

Pencil, Dictionary, Fee, Letter, Envelope

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say a pencil, a dictionary, a fee, a letter and an envelope.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 215: I can say a pencil, a dictionary, a fee, a letter and an envelope.

215.1 பென்சில் (pe̲ncil) — a pencil

Before the new one: say the Tamil for flour; batter, then the Tamil for bread.

You'll want to know: பென்சில்

பென்சில் — *pe̲ncil* — "a pencil".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

பென்சில் (*pe̲ncil*) is a loan from English *pencil*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: pe̲ncil*
- *Say it: pe̲ncil*, once more
- *Say it:* say *pe̲ncil*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for flour; batter, then the Tamil for bread, then say *pe̲ncil* again

Before you move on

What does பென்சில் mean? ("A pencil".) Say it once more.

215.2 அகராதி (akarāti) — a dictionary

Before the new one: say the Tamil for bread, then the Tamil for a pencil.

You'll want to know: அகராதி

அகராதி — *akarāti* — "a dictionary".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

அகராதி (*akarāti*) is "from *a* onward": *akaram*, the letter *a*, and *āti*, "beginning", from Sanskrit *ādi* (CDIAL 1152). A dictionary runs from the first letter.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: akarāti*
- *Say it: akarāti*, once more
- *Say it:* say *akarāti*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for bread, then the Tamil for a pencil, then say *akarāti* again

Before you move on

What does **அகராதி** mean? ("A dictionary".) Say it once more.

215.3 கட்டணம் (kaṭṭaṇam) — a fee, a charge

Before the new one: say the Tamil for a pencil, then the Tamil for a dictionary.

You'll want to know: கட்டணம்

கட்டணம் — *kaṭṭaṇam* — "a fee, a charge".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

கட்டணம் (*kaṭṭaṇam*) is native Dravidian (DEDR 1149). The entry lists *kaṭṭaṇam*, "fees, dues", under *kaṭṭu*, "to pay up".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: kaṭṭaṇam*
- *Say it: kaṭṭaṇam*, once more
- *Say it:* say *kaṭṭaṇam*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for a pencil, then the Tamil for a dictionary, then say *kaṭṭaṇam* again

Before you move on

What does **கட்டணம்** mean? ("A fee, a charge".) Say it once more.

215.4 கடிதம் (kaṭitam) — a letter (to post)

Before the new one: say the Tamil for a dictionary, then the Tamil for a fee.

You'll want to know: கடிதம்

கடிதம் — *kaṭitam* — "a letter (to post)".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

கடிதம் (*kaṭitam*) is filed in DEDR's appendix of Indo-Aryan loans (DEDR App. 23): it first meant a cloth covered with paste for writing on, then paper and a letter. The entry compares Sanskrit *kaḍitra*, "a skin for writing on".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: kaṭitam*
- *Say it: kaṭitam*, once more
- *Say it:* say *kaṭitam*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for a dictionary, then the Tamil for a fee, then say *kaṭitam* again

Before you move on

What does **கடிதம்** mean? ("A letter (to post)".) Say it once more.

215.5 உறை (uṟai) — an envelope; a cover

Before the new one: say the Tamil for a fee, then the Tamil for a letter.

You'll want to know: உறை

உறை — *uṟai* — "an envelope; a cover".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

உறை (*uṟai*) is native Dravidian. DEDR 723 lists Malayalam *uṟa*, "sheath, case".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *u̲rai*
- *Say it:* *u̲rai*, once more
- *Say it:* say *u̲rai*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for a fee, then the Tamil for a letter, then say *u̲rai* again

Before you move on

What does உறை mean? ("An envelope; a cover".) Say it once more.

Chapter 216

Internet, Password, Newspaper, Ticket, Map

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say the internet, a password, a newspaper, a ticket and a map.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 216: I can say the internet, a password, a newspaper, a ticket and a map.*

216.1 இணையம் (iṇaiyam) — the internet

> Before the new one: say the Tamil for a letter, then the Tamil for an envelope; a cover.

You'll want to know: இணையம்

இணையம் — *iṇaiyam* — "the internet".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

இணையம் (*iṇaiyam*) is native Dravidian (DEDR 457). It is a modern coinage on *iṇai*, "to join, to link": "the linked thing".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *iṇaiyam*
- *Say it:* *iṇaiyam*, once more
- *Say it:* say *iṇaiyam*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for a letter, then the Tamil for an envelope; a cover, then say *iṇaiyam* again

Before you move on

What does இணையம் mean? ("The internet".) Say it once more.

216.2 கடவுச்சொல் (kaṭavuccol) — a password

Before the new one: say the Tamil for an envelope; a cover, then the Tamil for the internet.

You'll want to know: கடவுச்சொல்

கடவுச்சொல் — *kaṭavuccol* — "a password".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

கடவுச்சொல் (*kaṭavuccol*) is a modern coinage from native parts: *kaṭavu*, "a passing", from *kaṭa*, "to pass" (DEDR 1109), and *col*, "word" (DEDR 2855): "the passing word".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *kaṭavuccol*
- *Say it:* *kaṭavuccol*, once more
- *Say it:* say *kaṭavuccol*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for an envelope; a cover, then the Tamil for the internet, then say *kaṭavuccol* again

Before you move on

What does கடவுச்சொல் mean? ("A password".) Say it once more.

216.3 நாளிதழ் (nāḷitaḻ) — a newspaper

Before the new one: say the Tamil for the internet, then the Tamil for a password.

You'll want to know: நாளிதழ்

நாளிதழ் — *nāḷitaḻ* — "a newspaper".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

நாளிதழ் (*nāḷitaḻ*) is native: *nāḷ*, "day" (DEDR 3656), and *itaḻ*, "petal, leaf" (DEDR 459): "the daily leaf".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *nāḷitaḻ*
- *Say it:* *nāḷitaḻ*, once more
- *Say it:* say *nāḷitaḻ*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for the internet, then the Tamil for a password, then say *nāḷitaḻ* again

Before you move on

What does நாளிதழ் mean? ("A newspaper".) Say it once more.

216.4 சீட்டு (cīṭṭu) — a ticket; a slip of paper

Before the new one: say the Tamil for a password, then the Tamil for a newspaper.

You'll want to know: சீட்டு

சீட்டு — *cīṭṭu* — "a ticket; a slip of paper".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

The origin of சீட்டு (*cīṭṭu*) is uncertain. DEDR has no entry for it.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *cīṭṭu*
- *Say it:* *cīṭṭu*, once more
- *Say it:* say *cīṭṭu*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for a password, then the Tamil for a newspaper, then say *cīṭṭu* again

Before you move on

What does சீட்டு mean? ("A ticket; a slip of paper".) Say it once more.

216.5 வரைபடம் (varaipaṭam) — a map

Before the new one: say the Tamil for a newspaper, then the Tamil for a ticket; a slip of paper.

You'll want to know: வரைபடம்

வரைபடம் — *varaipaṭam* — "a map".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

வரைபடம் (*varaipaṭam*) is native *varai*, "to draw" (DEDR 5263), and *paṭam*, "picture", from Sanskrit *paṭa*, "woven cloth" (CDIAL 7692): "a drawn picture".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: varaipaṭam*
- *Say it: varaipaṭam*, once more
- *Say it:* say *varaipaṭam*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for a newspaper, then the Tamil for a ticket; a slip of paper, then say *varaipaṭam* again

Before you move on

What does வரைபடம் mean? ("A map".) Say it once more.

Chapter 217

Bride, Bridegroom, Engagement, Feast, Festival

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say a bride, a bridegroom, an engagement, a feast and a festival.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 217: I can say a bride, a bridegroom, an engagement, a feast and a festival.

217.1 மணமகள் (maṇamakaḷ) — a bride

Before the new one: say the Tamil for a ticket; a slip of paper, then the Tamil for a map.

You'll want to know: மணமகள்

மணமகள் — *maṇamakaḷ* — "a bride".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

மணமகள் (*maṇamakaḷ*) is native: *maṇam*, "marriage" (DEDR 4667), and *makaḷ*, "daughter, woman" (DEDR 4616, which compares Sanskrit *mālikā*, "daughter").

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *maṇamakaḷ*
- *Say it:* *maṇamakaḷ*, once more
- *Say it:* say *maṇamakaḷ*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for a ticket; a slip of paper, then the Tamil for a map, then say *maṇamakaḷ* again

Before you move on

What does மணமகள் mean? (“A bride”.) Say it once more.

217.2 மணமகன் (maṇamakaṉ) — a bridegroom

Before the new one: say the Tamil for a map, then the Tamil for a bride.

You’ll want to know: மணமகன்

மணமகன் — *maṇamakaṉ* — “a bridegroom”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

மணமகன் (*maṇamakaṉ*) is native: *maṇam*, “marriage” (DEDR 4667), and *makaṉ*, “son, man” (DEDR 4616).

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *maṇamakaṉ*
- *Say it:* *maṇamakaṉ*, once more
- *Say it:* say *maṇamakaṉ*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for a map, then the Tamil for a bride, then say *maṇamakaṉ* again

Before you move on

What does **மணமகன்** mean? (“A bridegroom”.) Say it once more.

217.3 நிச்சயதார்த்தம் (niccayatārttam) — an engagement (betrothal)

Before the new one: say the Tamil for a bride, then the Tamil for a bridegroom.

You’ll want to know: நிச்சயதார்த்தம்

நிச்சயதார்த்தம் — *niccayatārttam* — “an engagement (betrothal)”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

நிச்சயதார்த்தம் (*niccayatārttam*) is built on *niccayam*, “settlement”, from Sanskrit *niścaya*, “conviction” (CDIAL 7439): the engagement is the settling of the match.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: niccayatārttam*
- *Say it: niccayatārttam*, once more
- *Say it:* say *niccayatārttam*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for a bride, then the Tamil for a bridegroom, then say *niccayatārttam* again

Before you move on

What does **நிச்சயதார்த்தம்** mean? (“An engagement (betrothal)”.) Say it once more.

217.4 விருந்து (viruntu) — a feast, a party

Before the new one: say the Tamil for a bridegroom, then the Tamil for an engagement.

You'll want to know: விருந்து

விருந்து — *viruntu* — "a feast, a party".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

விருந்து (*viruntu*) is native Dravidian. DEDR 5415 lists Malayalam *virunnu*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: viruntu*
- *Say it: viruntu*, once more
- *Say it:* say *viruntu*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for a bridegroom, then the Tamil for an engagement, then say *viruntu* again

Before you move on

What does விருந்து mean? ("A feast, a party".) Say it once more.

217.5 விழா (vi̲lā) — a festival, a function, a ceremony

Before the new one: say the Tamil for an engagement, then the Tamil for a feast.

You'll want to know: விழா

விழா — *vi̲lā* — "a festival, a function, a ceremony".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

விழா (*viḻā*) is native Dravidian. DEDR 5427 lists Malayalam *viḻā*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *viḻā*
- *Say it:* *viḻā*, once more
- *Say it:* say *viḻā*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for an engagement, then the Tamil for a feast, then say *viḻā* again

Before you move on

What does விழா mean? ("A festival, a function, a ceremony".) Say it once more.

Chapter 218

Giraffe, Zebra, Crocodile, Butterfly, Bee

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say a giraffe, a zebra, a crocodile, a butterfly and a bee.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 218: I can say a giraffe, a zebra, a crocodile, a butterfly and a bee.

218.1 ஒட்டகச்சிவிங்கி (oṭṭakacciviṅki) — a giraffe

Before the new one: say the Tamil for a feast, then the Tamil for a festival.

You'll want to know: ஒட்டகச்சிவிங்கி

ஒட்டகச்சிவிங்கி — *oṭṭakacciviṅki* — "a giraffe".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

ஒட்டகச்சிவிங்கி (*oṭṭakacciviṅki*) is "the camel-leopard": *oṭṭakam*, "camel", from Sanskrit *uṣṭra* (CDIAL 2387), and native *civiṅki*, "hunting leopard" (DEDR 2579; Malayalam *civiṅṅi*). Greek named the giraffe the same way, *camelopardalis*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: oṭṭakacciviṅki*
- *Say it: oṭṭakacciviṅki*, once more
- *Say it:* say *oṭṭakacciviṅki*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for a feast, then the Tamil for a festival, then say *oṭṭakacciviṅki* again

Before you move on

What does **ஒட்டகச்சிவிங்கி** mean? ("A giraffe".) Say it once more.

218.2 வரிக்குதிரை (varikkutirai) — a zebra

Before the new one: say the Tamil for a festival, then the Tamil for a giraffe.

You'll want to know: வரிக்குதிரை

வரிக்குதிரை — *varikkutirai* — "a zebra".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

வரிக்குதிரை (*varikkutirai*) is native: *vari*, "stripe, line" (DEDR 5263), and *kutirai*, "horse" (DEDR 1711): "the striped horse".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: varikkutirai*
- *Say it: varikkutirai*, once more

- *Say it:* say *varikkutirai*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for a festival, then the Tamil for a giraffe, then say *varikkutirai* again

Before you move on

What does **வரிக்குதிரை** mean? ("A zebra".) Say it once more.

218.3 முதலை (mutalai) — a crocodile

Before the new one: say the Tamil for a giraffe, then the Tamil for a zebra.

You'll want to know: முதலை

முதலை — *mutalai* — "a crocodile".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

முதலை (*mutalai*) is native Dravidian. DEDR 4952 lists Malayalam *mutala*, Kannada *mosaḷe* and Telugu *mosali*. The entry compares Sanskrit (lexicons) *mācala*, "crocodile".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: mutalai*
- *Say it: mutalai*, once more
- *Say it:* say *mutalai*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for a giraffe, then the Tamil for a zebra, then say *mutalai* again

Before you move on

What does **முதலை** mean? ("A crocodile".) Say it once more.

218.4 பட்டாம்பூச்சி (paṭṭāmpūcci) — a butterfly

Before the new one: say the Tamil for a zebra, then the Tamil for a crocodile.

You'll want to know: பட்டாம்பூச்சி

பட்டாம்பூச்சி — *paṭṭāmpūcci* — "a butterfly".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

பட்டாம்பூச்சி (*paṭṭāmpūcci*) is *paṭṭu*, "silk", from Sanskrit *paṭṭa*, "woven silk" (CDIAL 7700), and native *pūcci*, "insect" (DEDR 4353): "the silk insect".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: paṭṭāmpūcci*
- *Say it: paṭṭāmpūcci*, once more
- *Say it:* say *paṭṭāmpūcci*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for a zebra, then the Tamil for a crocodile, then say *paṭṭāmpūcci* again

Before you move on

What does பட்டாம்பூச்சி mean? ("A butterfly".) Say it once more.

218.5 தேனீ (tēṉī) — a bee

Before the new one: say the Tamil for a crocodile, then the Tamil for a butterfly.

You'll want to know: தேனீ

தேனீ — *tēṉī* — "a bee".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

தேனீ (*tēṉī*) is native: *tēṉ*, "honey" (DEDR 3268), and *ī*, "fly, bee" (DEDR 533), which lists *tēṉ-ī*, "honey bee", itself.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: tēṉī*
- *Say it: tēṉī*, once more
- *Say it:* say *tēṉī*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for a crocodile, then the Tamil for a butterfly, then say *tēṉī* again

Before you move on

What does தேனீ mean? ("A bee".) Say it once more.

Chapter 219

Bamboo, Rainbow, Fog, Gentle breeze, Flood

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say bamboo, a rainbow, fog, a gentle breeze and a flood.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 219: I can say bamboo, a rainbow, fog, a gentle breeze and a flood.*

219.1 மூங்கில் (mūṅkil) — bamboo

> Before the new one: say the Tamil for a butterfly, then the Tamil for a bee.

You'll want to know: மூங்கில்

மூங்கில் — *mūṅkil* — "bamboo".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

மூங்கில் (*mūṅkil*) is native Dravidian. DEDR 5028 lists Malayalam *mūṅkil*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: mūṅkil*
- *Say it: mūṅkil*, once more
- *Say it:* say *mūṅkil*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for a butterfly, then the Tamil for a bee, then say *mūṅkil* again

Before you move on

What does மூங்கில் mean? (“Bamboo”.) Say it once more.

219.2 வானவில் (vāṉavil) — a rainbow

Before the new one: say the Tamil for a bee, then the Tamil for bamboo.

You’ll want to know: வானவில்

வானவில் — *vāṉavil* — “a rainbow”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

வானவில் (*vāṉavil*) is native: *vāṉam*, “sky” (DEDR 5381), and *vil*, “bow” (DEDR 5422): “the sky’s bow”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: vāṉavil*
- *Say it: vāṉavil*, once more
- *Say it:* say *vāṉavil*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for a bee, then the Tamil for bamboo, then say *vāṉavil* again

Before you move on

What does வானவில் mean? ("A rainbow".) Say it once more.

219.3 மூடுபனி (mūṭupaṉi) — fog, mist

Before the new one: say the Tamil for bamboo, then the Tamil for a rainbow.

You'll want to know: மூடுபனி

மூடுபனி — *mūṭupaṉi* — "fog, mist".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

மூடுபனி (*mūṭupaṉi*) is native: *mūṭu*, "to cover" (DEDR 5034), and *paṉi*, "dew, mist" (DEDR 4035): "the covering mist".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *mūṭupaṉi*
- *Say it:* *mūṭupaṉi*, once more
- *Say it:* say *mūṭupaṉi*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for bamboo, then the Tamil for a rainbow, then say *mūṭupaṉi* again

Before you move on

What does மூடுபனி mean? ("Fog, mist".) Say it once more.

219.4 தென்றல் (teṉṟal) — a gentle breeze

Before the new one: say the Tamil for a rainbow, then the Tamil for fog.

You'll want to know: தென்றல்

தென்றல் — *te̲n̲ral* — "a gentle breeze".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

தென்றல் (*te̲n̲ral*) is native Dravidian. DEDR 3449 lists Malayalam *tennal*, "southern breeze". It is "the south wind", from *te̲n̲*, "south".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *te̲n̲ral*
- *Say it:* *te̲n̲ral*, once more
- *Say it:* say *te̲n̲ral*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for a rainbow, then the Tamil for fog, then say *te̲n̲ral* again

Before you move on

What does தென்றல் mean? ("A gentle breeze".) Say it once more.

219.5 வெள்ளம் (ve̲l̲lam) — a flood

Before the new one: say the Tamil for fog, then the Tamil for a gentle breeze.

You'll want to know: வெள்ளம்

வெள்ளம் — *ve̲l̲lam* — "a flood".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

வெள்ளம் (*ve̲l̲lam*) is native Dravidian. DEDR 5503 lists Malayalam *ve̲l̲lam*, "water".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: veḷḷam*
- *Say it: veḷḷam*, once more
- *Say it:* say *veḷḷam*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for fog, then the Tamil for a gentle breeze, then say *veḷḷam* again

Before you move on

What does வெள்ளம் mean? ("A flood".) Say it once more.

Chapter 220

Keyboard, Camera, Radio, Programme, Film

Modes: **voice** (7) **Hands-free start:** all 7 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say a keyboard, a camera, the radio, a programme and a film.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 220: I can say a keyboard, a camera, the radio, a programme and a film.

220.1 விசைப்பலகை (vicaippalakai) — a keyboard

Before the new one: say the Tamil for a gentle breeze, then the Tamil for a flood.

You'll want to know: விசைப்பலகை

விசைப்பலகை — *vicaippalakai* — "a keyboard".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

விசைப்பலகை (*vicaippalakai*) is a modern coinage: native *vicai*, "spring, lever" (DEDR 5450), used for "key", and *palakai*, "board", from Sanskrit *phalaka*, "board, bench" (CDIAL 9053).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: vicaippalakai*
- *Say it: vicaippalakai*, once more
- *Say it:* say *vicaippalakai*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for a gentle breeze, then the Tamil for a flood, then say *vicaippalakai* again

Before you move on

What does **விசைப்பலகை** mean? ("A keyboard".) Say it once more.

220.2 கேமரா (kēmarā) — a camera

Before the new one: say the Tamil for a flood, then the Tamil for a keyboard.

You'll want to know: கேமரா

கேமரா — *kēmarā* — "a camera".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

கேமரா (*kēmarā*) is a loan from English *camera*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: kēmarā*
- *Say it: kēmarā*, once more
- *Say it:* say *kēmarā*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for a flood, then the Tamil for a keyboard, then say *kēmarā* again

Before you move on

What does கேமரா mean? ("A camera".) Say it once more.

220.3 வானொலி (vāṉoli) — the radio

Before the new one: say the Tamil for a keyboard, then the Tamil for a camera.

You'll want to know: வானொலி

வானொலி — *vāṉoli* — "the radio".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

வானொலி (*vāṉoli*) is a modern coinage from native parts: *vāṉ*, "sky" (DEDR 5381), and *oli*, "sound" (DEDR 996): "sound from the sky".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *vāṉoli*
- *Say it:* *vāṉoli*, once more
- *Say it:* say *vāṉoli*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for a keyboard, then the Tamil for a camera, then say *vāṉoli* again

Before you move on

What does வானொலி mean? ("The radio".) Say it once more.

220.4 நிகழ்ச்சி (nikaḻcci) — a programme, an event

Before the new one: say the Tamil for a camera, then the Tamil for the radio.

You'll want to know: நிகழ்ச்சி

நிகழ்ச்சி — *nikaḻcci* — "a programme, an event".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

நிகழ்ச்சி (*nikaḻcci*) is native Dravidian. DEDR 3661 lists Kannada *negaḻ*, "to undertake". It is the noun of *nikaḻ*, "to happen".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: nikaḻcci*
- *Say it: nikaḻcci*, once more
- *Say it:* say *nikaḻcci*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for a camera, then the Tamil for the radio, then say *nikaḻcci* again

Before you move on

What does நிகழ்ச்சி mean? ("A programme, an event".) Say it once more.

220.5 திரைப்படம் (tiraippaṭam) — a film, a movie

Before the new one: say the Tamil for the radio, then the Tamil for a programme.

You'll want to know: திரைப்படம்

திரைப்படம் — *tiraippaṭam* — "a film, a movie".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

திரைப்படம் (*tiraippaṭam*) is native *tirai*, "screen" (DEDR 3244), and *paṭam*, "picture", from Sanskrit *paṭa* (CDIAL 7692): "the screen picture".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: tiraippaṭam*
- *Say it: tiraippaṭam*, once more
- *Say it:* say *tiraippaṭam*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for the radio, then the Tamil for a programme, then say *tiraippaṭam* again

Before you move on

What does **திரைப்படம்** mean? ("A film, a movie".) Say it once more.

220.6 Words from chapters 212-215 — a first pass

Say the words for a programme and a film.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- weak, selfish, generous, well-behaved, ugly
- a cupboard, electricity, rubbish, toothpaste, a toothbrush
- buttermilk, fruit juice, tender coconut water, flour; batter, bread
- a pencil, a dictionary, a fee, a letter, an envelope; a cover

Before you move on

Weak? (பலவீனமான, *palavīṉamāṉa.*) Selfish? (சுயநலமான, *cuyanalamāṉa.*) Generous? (பெருந்தன்மையான, *peruntaṉmaiyāṉa.*) Well-behaved? (ஒழுக்கமான, *oḻukkamāṉa.*) Ugly? (அசிங்கமான, *aciṅkamāṉa.*) A cupboard? (அலமாரி, *alamāri.*) Electricity? (மின்சாரம், *miṉcāram.*) Rubbish? (குப்பை, *kuppai.*) Toothpaste? (பற்பசை, *paṟpacai.*) A toothbrush? (பல்துலக்கி, *paltulakki.*) Buttermilk? (மோர், *mōr.*) Fruit juice? (பழச்சாறு, *paḻaccāṟu.*) Tender coconut water? (இளநீர், *iḷanīr.*) Flour; batter? (மாவு, *māvu.*) Bread? (ரொட்டி, *roṭṭi.*) A pencil? (பென்சில், *peṉcil.*) A dictionary? (அகராதி, *akarāti.*) A fee? (கட்டணம், *kaṭṭaṇam.*) A letter? (கடிதம், *kaṭitam.*) An envelope; a cover? (உறை, *uṟai.*)

220.7 Words from chapters 216-220 — a second pass

Say the words for the internet and a password.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- the internet, a password, a newspaper, a ticket; a slip of paper, a map
- a bride, a bridegroom, an engagement, a feast, a festival
- a giraffe, a zebra, a crocodile, a butterfly, a bee
- bamboo, a rainbow, fog, a gentle breeze, a flood
- a keyboard, a camera, the radio, a programme, a film

Before you move on

The internet? (இணையம், *iṇaiyam.*) A password? (கடவுச்சொல், *kaṭavuccol.*) A newspaper? (நாளிதழ், *nāḷitaḻ.*) A ticket; a slip of paper? (சீட்டு, *cīṭṭu.*) A map? (வரைபடம், *varaipaṭam.*) A bride? (மணமகள், *maṇamakaḷ.*) A bridegroom?

(மணமகன், *maṇamakaṉ.*) An engagement? (நிச்சயதார்த்தம், *niccayatārttam.*) A feast? (விருந்து, *viruntu.*) A festival? (விழா, *viḻā.*) A giraffe? (ஒட்டகச்சிவிங்கி, *oṭṭakacciviṅki.*) A zebra? (வரிக்குதிரை, *varikkutirai.*) A crocodile? (முதலை, *mutalai.*) A butterfly? (பட்டாம்பூச்சி, *paṭṭāmpūcci.*) A bee? (தேனீ, *tēṉī.*) Bamboo? (மூங்கில், *mūṅkil.*) A rainbow? (வானவில், *vāṉavil.*) Fog? (மூடுபனி, *mūṭupaṉi.*) A gentle breeze? (தென்றல், *teṉṟal.*) A flood? (வெள்ளம், *veḷḷam.*) A keyboard? (விசைப்பலகை, *vicaippalakai.*) A camera? (கேமரா, *kēmarā.*) The radio? (வானொலி, *vāṉoli.*) A programme? (நிகழ்ச்சி, *nikaḻcci.*) A film? (திரைப்படம், *tiraippaṭam.*)

Chapter 221

Helmet, Wheel, Blackboard, Eraser, Uniform

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say a helmet, a wheel, a blackboard, an eraser and a uniform.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 221: I can say a helmet, a wheel, a blackboard, an eraser and a uniform.

221.1 தலைக்கவசம் (talaikkavacam) — a helmet

Before the new one: say the Tamil for a programme, an event, then the Tamil for a film, a movie.

You'll want to know: தலைக்கவசம்

தலைக்கவசம் — *talaikkavacam* — "a helmet".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

தலைக்கவசம் (*talaikkavacam*) is native *talai*, "head" (DEDR 3103), and *kavacam*, "armour", from Sanskrit *kavaca*, "coat of mail" (CDIAL 2957), which CDIAL notes may itself be Dravidian.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: talaikkavacam*
- *Say it: talaikkavacam*, once more
- *Say it:* say *talaikkavacam*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for a programme, an event, then the Tamil for a film, a movie, then say *talaikkavacam* again

Before you move on

What does **தலைக்கவசம்** mean? (“A helmet”.) Say it once more.

221.2 சக்கரம் (cakkaram) — a wheel

Before the new one: say the Tamil for a film, a movie, then the Tamil for a helmet.

You’ll want to know: சக்கரம்

சக்கரம் — *cakkaram* — “a wheel”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

சக்கரம் (*cakkaram*) is a loan from Sanskrit *cakra*, “wheel” (CDIAL 4538).

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: cakkaram*
- *Say it: cakkaram*, once more
- *Say it:* say *cakkaram*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for a film, a movie, then the Tamil for a helmet, then say *cakkaram* again

Before you move on

What does **சக்கரம்** mean? ("A wheel".) Say it once more.

221.3 கரும்பலகை (karumpalakai) — a blackboard

Before the new one: say the Tamil for a helmet, then the Tamil for a wheel.

You'll want to know: கரும்பலகை

கரும்பலகை — *karumpalakai* — "a blackboard".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

கரும்பலகை (*karumpalakai*) is native *karu*, "black" (DEDR 1278), and *palakai*, "board", from Sanskrit *phalaka* (CDIAL 9053).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: karumpalakai*
- *Say it: karumpalakai*, once more
- *Say it:* say *karumpalakai*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for a helmet, then the Tamil for a wheel, then say *karumpalakai* again

Before you move on

What does **கரும்பலகை** mean? ("A blackboard".) Say it once more.

221.4 அழிப்பான் (a̲lippāṉ̲) — an eraser, a rubber

Before the new one: say the Tamil for a wheel, then the Tamil for a blackboard.

You'll want to know: அழிப்பான்

அழிப்பான் — *a̲lippāṉ̲* — "an eraser, a rubber".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

அழிப்பான் (*a̲lippāṉ̲*) is native Dravidian (DEDR 277). It is "the one that rubs out", from *a̲li*, "to destroy, to wipe out".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *a̲lippāṉ̲*
- *Say it:* *a̲lippāṉ̲*, once more
- *Say it:* say *a̲lippāṉ̲*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for a wheel, then the Tamil for a blackboard, then say *a̲lippāṉ̲* again

Before you move on

What does அழிப்பான் mean? ("An eraser, a rubber".) Say it once more.

221.5 சீருடை (cīruṭai) — a uniform

Before the new one: say the Tamil for a blackboard, then the Tamil for an eraser.

You'll want to know: சீருடை

சீருடை — *cīruṭai* — "a uniform".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

சீருடை (*cīruṭai*) is native: *cīr*, "good condition, what is fitting" (DEDR 2624), and *uṭai*, "clothing" (DEDR 587): "the fitting dress".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: cīruṭai*
- *Say it: cīruṭai*, once more
- *Say it:* say *cīruṭai*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for a blackboard, then the Tamil for an eraser, then say *cīruṭai* again

Before you move on

What does சீருடை mean? ("A uniform".) Say it once more.

Chapter 222

Discount, Rupee, Coin, Expense, Salary

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say a discount, a rupee, a coin, an expense and a salary.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 222: I can say a discount, a rupee, a coin, an expense and a salary.

222.1 தள்ளுபடி (taḷḷupaṭi) — a discount

Before the new one: say the Tamil for an eraser, then the Tamil for a uniform.

You'll want to know: தள்ளுபடி

தள்ளுபடி — *taḷḷupaṭi* — "a discount".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

தள்ளுபடி (*taḷḷupaṭi*) is native: *taḷḷu*, "to push away, to reject" (DEDR 3135), and *paṭi*, probably "measure" (DEDR 3849): "a measure pushed off".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *taḷḷupaṭi*
- *Say it:* *taḷḷupaṭi*, once more
- *Say it:* say *taḷḷupaṭi*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for an eraser, then the Tamil for a uniform, then say *taḷḷupaṭi* again

Before you move on

What does தள்ளுபடி mean? (“A discount”.) Say it once more.

222.2 ரூபாய் (rūpāy) — a rupee

Before the new one: say the Tamil for a uniform, then the Tamil for a discount.

You’ll want to know: ரூபாய்

ரூபாய் — *rūpāy* — “a rupee”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

ரூபாய் (*rūpāy*) is a loan from Sanskrit *rūpya*, “silver” (CDIAL 10805). It came through Hindustani *rupayā*.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *rūpāy*
- *Say it:* *rūpāy*, once more
- *Say it:* say *rūpāy*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for a uniform, then the Tamil for a discount, then say *rūpāy* again

Before you move on

What does ரூபாய் mean? ("A rupee".) Say it once more.

222.3 நாணயம் (nāṇayam) — a coin

Before the new one: say the Tamil for a discount, then the Tamil for a rupee.

You'll want to know: நாணயம்

நாணயம் — *nāṇayam* — "a coin".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

நாணயம் (*nāṇayam*) is a loan from Sanskrit *nāṇaka*, "coin, anything stamped" (CDIAL 7050).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *nāṇayam*
- *Say it:* *nāṇayam*, once more
- *Say it:* say *nāṇayam*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for a discount, then the Tamil for a rupee, then say *nāṇayam* again

Before you move on

What does நாணயம் mean? ("A coin".) Say it once more.

222.4 செலவு (celavu) — an expense, a cost

Before the new one: say the Tamil for a rupee, then the Tamil for a coin.

You'll want to know: செலவு

செலவு — *celavu* — "an expense, a cost".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

செலவு (*celavu*) is native Dravidian (DEDR 2781). The entry lists *celavu*, "going, passing; expense", under *cel*, "to go, to pass (as coin)": spending is money going out.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: celavu*
- *Say it: celavu*, once more
- *Say it:* say *celavu*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for a rupee, then the Tamil for a coin, then say *celavu* again

Before you move on

What does செலவு mean? ("An expense, a cost".) Say it once more.

222.5 சம்பளம் (campaḷam) — a salary

Before the new one: say the Tamil for a coin, then the Tamil for an expense.

You'll want to know: சம்பளம்

சம்பளம் — *campaḷam* — "a salary".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

சம்பளம் (*campaḷam*) is usually traced to Sanskrit *śambala*, "provisions for a journey" (CDIAL 12315): what one is given to live on.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *campaḷam*
- *Say it:* *campaḷam*, once more
- *Say it:* say *campaḷam*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for a coin, then the Tamil for an expense, then say *campaḷam* again

Before you move on

What does சம்பளம் mean? ("A salary".) Say it once more.

Chapter 223

Interview, Company, Factory, Lesson, Homework

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say an interview, a company, a factory, a lesson and homework.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 223: I can say an interview, a company, a factory, a lesson and homework.*

223.1 நேர்காணல் (nērkāṇal) — an interview

Before the new one: say the Tamil for an expense, then the Tamil for a salary.

You'll want to know: நேர்காணல்

நேர்காணல் — *nērkāṇal* — "an interview".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

நேர்காணல் (*nērkāṇal*) is native: *nēr*, "face to face, direct" (DEDR 3772), and *kāṇal*, "seeing", from *kāṇ* (DEDR 1443): "seeing face to face".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *nērkāṇal*
- *Say it:* *nērkāṇal*, once more
- *Say it:* say *nērkāṇal*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for an expense, then the Tamil for a salary, then say *nērkāṇal* again

Before you move on

What does நேர்காணல் mean? ("An interview".) Say it once more.

223.2 நிறுவனம் (niṟuvaṉam) — a company, an organisation

Before the new one: say the Tamil for a salary, then the Tamil for an interview.

You'll want to know: நிறுவனம்

நிறுவனம் — *niṟuvaṉam* — "a company, an organisation".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

நிறுவனம் (*niṟuvaṉam*) is native Dravidian (DEDR 3675). It comes from *niṟuvu*, "to set up, to establish": a company is something set up.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *niṟuvaṉam*
- *Say it:* *niṟuvaṉam*, once more
- *Say it:* say *niṟuvaṉam*

- *Recall:* say the Tamil for a salary, then the Tamil for an interview, then say *niṟuvaṉam* again

Before you move on

What does நிறுவனம் mean? (“A company, an organisation”.) Say it once more.

223.3 தொழிற்சாலை (toḻiṟcālai) — a factory

Before the new one: say the Tamil for an interview, then the Tamil for a company.

You’ll want to know: தொழிற்சாலை

தொழிற்சாலை — *toḻiṟcālai* — “a factory”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

தொழிற்சாலை (*toḻiṟcālai*) is native *toḻil*, “work, trade” (DEDR 3524), and *cālai*, “hall”, from Sanskrit *śālā* (CDIAL 12414): “the hall of work”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: toḻiṟcālai*
- *Say it: toḻiṟcālai*, once more
- *Say it:* say *toḻiṟcālai*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for an interview, then the Tamil for a company, then say *toḻiṟcālai* again

Before you move on

What does தொழிற்சாலை mean? (“A factory”.) Say it once more.

223.4 பாடம் (pāṭam) — a lesson; a school subject

Before the new one: say the Tamil for a company, then the Tamil for a factory.

You'll want to know: பாடம்

பாடம் — *pāṭam* — "a lesson; a school subject".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

பாடம் (*pāṭam*) is a loan from Sanskrit *pāṭha*, "text, study" (CDIAL 8035).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: pāṭam*
- *Say it: pāṭam*, once more
- *Say it:* say *pāṭam*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for a company, then the Tamil for a factory, then say *pāṭam* again

Before you move on

What does பாடம் mean? ("A lesson; a school subject".) Say it once more.

223.5 வீட்டுப்பாடம் (vīṭṭuppāṭam) — homework

Before the new one: say the Tamil for a factory, then the Tamil for a lesson; a school subject.

You'll want to know: வீட்டுப்பாடம்

வீட்டுப்பாடம் — *vīṭṭuppāṭam* — "homework".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

வீட்டுப்பாடம் (*vīṭṭuppāṭam*) is native *vīṭu*, "house" (DEDR 5393), and *pāṭam*, "lesson", from Sanskrit *pāṭha* (CDIAL 8035).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: vīṭṭuppāṭam*
- *Say it: vīṭṭuppāṭam*, once more
- *Say it:* say *vīṭṭuppāṭam*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for a factory, then the Tamil for a lesson; a school subject, then say *vīṭṭuppāṭam* again

Before you move on

What does வீட்டுப்பாடம் mean? ("Homework".) Say it once more.

Chapter 224

Fisherman, Potter, Barber, Mason, Scientist

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (7) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 7 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say a fisherman, a potter, a barber, a mason and a scientist.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 224: I can say a fisherman, a potter, a barber, a mason and a scientist.*

224.1 மீனவர் (mīṉavar) — a fisherman

> Before the new one: say the Tamil for a lesson; a school subject, then the Tamil for homework.

You'll want to know: மீனவர்

மீனவர் — *mīṉavar* — "a fisherman".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

மீனவர் (*mīṉavar*) is native Dravidian (DEDR 4885). It is *mīṉ*, "fish", with the respectful *-avar*: "fish people". DEDR compares Sanskrit *mīna*, "fish".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *mīṉavar*
- *Say it:* *mīṉavar*, once more
- *Say it:* say *mīṉavar*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for a lesson; a school subject, then the Tamil for homework, then say *mīṉavar* again

Before you move on

What does மீனவர் mean? (“A fisherman”.) Say it once more.

224.2 குயவர் (kuyavar) — a potter

Before the new one: say the Tamil for homework, then the Tamil for a fisherman.

You’ll want to know: குயவர்

குயவர் — *kuyavar* — “a potter”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

குயவர் (*kuyavar*) is native Dravidian. DEDR 1762 lists Malayalam *kuyavan*.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *kuyavar*
- *Say it:* *kuyavar*, once more
- *Say it:* say *kuyavar*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for homework, then the Tamil for a fisherman, then say *kuyavar* again

Before you move on

What does குயவர் mean? (“A potter”.) Say it once more.

224.3 முடிதிருத்துபவர் (muṭitiruttupavar) — a barber

Before the new one: say the Tamil for a fisherman, then the Tamil for a potter.

You’ll want to know: முடிதிருத்துபவர்

முடிதிருத்துபவர் — *muṭitiruttupavar* — “a barber”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

முடிதிருத்துபவர் (*muṭitiruttupavar*) is native: *muṭi*, “hair” (DEDR 4921), and *tiruttu*, “to correct, to set right” (DEDR 3251), with *-pavar*, “the one who”: “the one who sets the hair right”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: muṭitiruttupavar*
- *Say it: muṭitiruttupavar*, once more
- *Say it:* say *muṭitiruttupavar*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for a fisherman, then the Tamil for a potter, then say *muṭitiruttupavar* again

Before you move on

What does முடிதிருத்துபவர் mean? (“A barber”.) Say it once more.

224.4 கொத்தனார் (kottaṉār) — a mason, a bricklayer

Before the new one: say the Tamil for a potter, then the Tamil for a barber.

You'll want to know: கொத்தனார்

கொத்தனார் — *kottaṉār* — "a mason, a bricklayer".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

கொத்தனார் (*kottaṉār*) is native Dravidian. DEDR 2091 lists Malayalam *kottuka*, "to dig, carve". It is built on *kottu*, "to hack, to carve": the mason chips stone.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: kottaṉār*
- *Say it: kottaṉār*, once more
- *Say it:* say *kottaṉār*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for a potter, then the Tamil for a barber, then say *kottaṉār* again

Before you move on

What does கொத்தனார் mean? ("A mason, a bricklayer".) Say it once more.

224.5 விஞ்ஞானி (viññāṉi) — a scientist

Before the new one: say the Tamil for a barber, then the Tamil for a mason.

You'll want to know: விஞ்ஞானி

விஞ்ஞானி — *viññāṉi* — "a scientist".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

விஞ்ஞானி (*viññāṉi*) is a loan from Sanskrit *vijñāna*, "act of discerning" (CDIAL 11707). *-i* makes it "the one who has knowledge".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: viññāṉi*
- *Say it: viññāṉi*, once more
- *Say it:* say *viññāṉi*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for a barber, then the Tamil for a mason, then say *viññāṉi* again

Before you move on

What does விஞ்ஞானி mean? ("A scientist".) Say it once more.

224.6 Words from chapters 221-222 — a first pass

Say the words for a mason and a scientist.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- a helmet, a wheel, a blackboard, an eraser, a uniform
- a discount, a rupee, a coin, an expense, a salary

Before you move on

A helmet? (தலைக்கவசம், *talaikkavacam.*) A wheel? (சக்கரம், *cakkaram.*) A blackboard? (கரும்பலகை, *karumpalakai.*) An eraser? (அழிப்பான், *aḻippāṉ.*) A uniform? (சீருடை, *cīruṭai.*) A discount? (தள்ளுபடி, *taḷḷupaṭi.*) A rupee? (ரூபாய், *rūpāy.*) A coin? (நாணயம், *nāṇayam.*) An expense? (செலவு, *celavu.*) A salary? (சம்பளம், *campaḷam.*)

224.7 Words from chapters 223-224 — a second pass

Say the words for an interview and a company.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- an interview, a company, a factory, a lesson; a school subject, homework
- a fisherman, a potter, a barber, a mason, a scientist

Before you move on

An interview? (நேர்காணல், *nērkāṇal.*) A company? (நிறுவனம், *niṟuvaṉam.*) A factory? (தொழிற்சாலை, *toḻiṟcālai.*) A lesson; a school subject? (பாடம், *pāṭam.*) Homework? (வீட்டுப்பாடம், *vīṭṭuppāṭam.*) A fisherman? (மீனவர், *mīṉavar.*) A potter? (குயவர், *kuyavar.*) A barber? (முடிதிருத்துபவர், *muṭitiruttupavar.*) A mason? (கொத்தனார், *kottaṉār.*) A scientist? (விஞ்ஞானி, *viññāṉi.*)

Chapter 225

To taste, To fill, To fold, To take off, To change

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say to taste, to fill, to fold, to take off and to change.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 225: I can say to taste, to fill, to fold, to take off and to change.*

225.1 சுவை பார் (cuvai pār) — to taste

> Before the new one: say the Tamil for a mason, a bricklayer, then the Tamil for a scientist.

You'll want to know: சுவை பார்

சுவை பார் — *cuvai pār* — "to taste".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

சுவை பார் (*cuvai pār*) is native: *cuvai*, "taste" (DEDR 2396), and *pār*, "to see, to try" (DEDR 4091): "see how it tastes".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *cuvai pār*
- *Say it:* *cuvai pār*, once more
- *Say it:* say *cuvai pār*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for a mason, a bricklayer, then the Tamil for a scientist, then say *cuvai pār* again

Before you move on

What does சுவை பார் mean? ("To taste".) Say it once more.

225.2 நிரப்பு (nirappu) — to fill

Before the new one: say the Tamil for a scientist, then the Tamil for to taste.

You'll want to know: நிரப்பு

நிரப்பு — *nirappu* — "to fill".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

நிரப்பு (*nirappu*) is native Dravidian. DEDR 3672 lists Malayalam *nirattuka*, "to level". It is the causative of *nira*, "to be full".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *nirappu*
- *Say it:* *nirappu*, once more
- *Say it:* say *nirappu*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for a scientist, then the Tamil for to taste, then say *nirappu* again

Before you move on

What does நிரப்பு mean? ("To fill".) Say it once more.

225.3 மடி (maṭi) — to fold

Before the new one: say the Tamil for to taste, then the Tamil for to fill.

You'll want to know: மடி

மடி — *maṭi* — "to fold".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

மடி (*maṭi*) is native Dravidian (DEDR 4645). The entry gives *maṭi*, "to be bent, folded", and *maṭippu*, "fold".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: maṭi*
- *Say it: maṭi*, once more
- *Say it:* say *maṭi*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for to taste, then the Tamil for to fill, then say *maṭi* again

Before you move on

What does மடி mean? ("To fold".) Say it once more.

225.4 கழற்று (kaḻaṟṟu) — to take off (clothes, shoes)

Before the new one: say the Tamil for to fill, then the Tamil for to fold.

You'll want to know: கழற்று

கழற்று — *kaḻaṟṟu* — "to take off (clothes, shoes)".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

கழற்று (*kaḻaṟṟu*) is native Dravidian. DEDR 1349 lists Malayalam *kaḻaṟṟuka*, "to slip off".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: kaḻaṟṟu*
- *Say it: kaḻaṟṟu*, once more
- *Say it:* say *kaḻaṟṟu*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for to fill, then the Tamil for to fold, then say *kaḻaṟṟu* again

Before you move on

What does **கழற்று** mean? ("To take off (clothes, shoes)".) Say it once more.

225.5 மாற்று (māṟṟu) — to change

Before the new one: say the Tamil for to fold, then the Tamil for to take off.

You'll want to know: மாற்று

மாற்று — *māṟṟu* — "to change".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

மாற்று (*māṟṟu*) is native Dravidian. DEDR 4834 lists Malayalam *māṟuka*, "to be changed". It is the causative of *māṟu*, "to change".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *māṟṟu*
- *Say it:* *māṟṟu*, once more
- *Say it:* say *māṟṟu*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for to fold, then the Tamil for to take off, then say *māṟṟu* again

Before you move on

What does மாற்று mean? ("To change".) Say it once more.

Chapter 226

To begin, To touch, To sneeze, To swallow, To chew

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say to begin, to touch, to sneeze, to swallow and to chew.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 226: I can say to begin, to touch, to sneeze, to swallow and to chew.

226.1 ஆரம்பி (ārampi) — to begin

Before the new one: say the Tamil for to take off, then the Tamil for to change.

You'll want to know: ஆரம்பி

ஆரம்பி — *ārampi* — "to begin".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

ஆரம்பி (*ārampi*) is a verb made from Sanskrit *ārambha*, "beginning" (CDIAL 1307).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *ārampi*
- *Say it:* *ārampi*, once more
- *Say it:* say *ārampi*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for to take off, then the Tamil for to change, then say *ārampi* again

Before you move on

What does ஆரம்பி mean? ("To begin".) Say it once more.

226.2 தொடு (toṭu) — to touch

Before the new one: say the Tamil for to change, then the Tamil for to begin.

You'll want to know: தொடு

தொடு — *toṭu* — "to touch".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

தொடு (*toṭu*) is native Dravidian. DEDR 3480 lists Malayalam *toṭuka*, "to touch".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *toṭu*
- *Say it:* *toṭu*, once more
- *Say it:* say *toṭu*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for to change, then the Tamil for to begin, then say *toṭu* again

Before you move on

What does தொடு mean? ("To touch".) Say it once more.

226.3 தும்மு (tummu) — to sneeze

Before the new one: say the Tamil for to begin, then the Tamil for to touch.

You'll want to know: தும்மு

தும்மு — *tummu* — "to sneeze".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

தும்மு (*tummu*) is native Dravidian. DEDR 3336 lists Malayalam *tummuka* and Telugu *tummu*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: tummu*
- *Say it: tummu*, once more
- *Say it:* say *tummu*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for to begin, then the Tamil for to touch, then say *tummu* again

Before you move on

What does தும்மு mean? ("To sneeze".) Say it once more.

226.4 விழுங்கு (viḻuṅku) — to swallow

Before the new one: say the Tamil for to touch, then the Tamil for to sneeze.

You'll want to know: விழுங்கு

விழுங்கு — *viḻuṅku* — "to swallow".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

விழுங்கு (*viḻuṅku*) is native Dravidian. DEDR 4866 lists Malayalam *viḻuṅṅuka*, "to swallow". The entry lists *miḻuṅku*, "to gulp", and *viḻukku*, "a swallow".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *viḻuṅku*
- *Say it:* *viḻuṅku*, once more
- *Say it:* say *viḻuṅku*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for to touch, then the Tamil for to sneeze, then say *viḻuṅku* again

Before you move on

What does விழுங்கு mean? ("To swallow".) Say it once more.

226.5 மெல் (mel) — to chew

Before the new one: say the Tamil for to sneeze, then the Tamil for to swallow.

You'll want to know: மெல்

மெல் — *mel* — "to chew".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

மெல் (*mel*) is native Dravidian. DEDR 5077 lists Kannada *mellu*, "to chew".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: mel*
- *Say it: mel*, once more
- *Say it:* say *mel*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for to sneeze, then the Tamil for to swallow, then say *mel* again

Before you move on

What does மெல் mean? ("To chew".) Say it once more.

Chapter 227

To correct, To enquire, To register, To book in advance, To apply

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say to correct, to enquire, to register, to book in advance and to apply.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 227: I can say to correct, to enquire, to register, to book in advance and to apply.

227.1 திருத்து (tiruttu) — to correct

Before the new one: say the Tamil for to swallow, then the Tamil for to chew.

You'll want to know: திருத்து

திருத்து — *tiruttu* — "to correct".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

திருத்து (*tiruttu*) is native Dravidian. DEDR 3251 lists Malayalam *tiruttuka*, Kannada *tiddu* and Telugu *diddu*. It is the causative of *tiruntu*, "to be correct".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: tiruttu*
- *Say it: tiruttu*, once more
- *Say it:* say *tiruttu*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for to swallow, then the Tamil for to chew, then say *tiruttu* again

Before you move on

What does திருத்து mean? ("To correct".) Say it once more.

227.2 விசாரி (vicāri) — to enquire, to ask about

Before the new one: say the Tamil for to chew, then the Tamil for to correct.

You'll want to know: விசாரி

விசாரி — *vicāri* — "to enquire, to ask about".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

விசாரி (*vicāri*) is a verb made from Sanskrit *vicāra*, "pondering, enquiry" (CDIAL 11683).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: vicāri*
- *Say it: vicāri*, once more
- *Say it:* say *vicāri*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for to chew, then the Tamil for to correct, then say *vicāri* again

Before you move on

What does **விசாரி** mean? ("To enquire, to ask about".) Say it once more.

227.3 பதிவு செய் (pativu cey) — to register, to record

Before the new one: say the Tamil for to correct, then the Tamil for to enquire.

You'll want to know: பதிவு செய்

பதிவு செய் — *pativu cey* — "to register, to record".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

பதிவு செய் (*pativu cey*) is native: *pativu*, "impression, record", from *pati*, "to be imprinted" (DEDR 3911), and *sey*, "to do" (DEDR 1957): "make a record".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: pativu cey*
- *Say it: pativu cey*, once more
- *Say it:* say *pativu cey*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for to correct, then the Tamil for to enquire, then say *pativu cey* again

Before you move on

What does **பதிவு செய்** mean? ("To register, to record".) Say it once more.

227.4 முன்பதிவு செய் (mun̲pativu cey) — to book in advance, to reserve

Before the new one: say the Tamil for to enquire, then the Tamil for to register.

You'll want to know: முன்பதிவு செய்

முன்பதிவு செய் — *mun̲pativu cey* — "to book in advance, to reserve".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

முன்பதிவு செய் (*mun̲pativu cey*) is native: *mun̲*, "before" (DEDR 5020), *pativu*, "record" (DEDR 3911), and *sey*, "to do" (DEDR 1957): "record in advance".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: mun̲pativu cey*
- *Say it: mun̲pativu cey*, once more
- *Say it:* say *mun̲pativu cey*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for to enquire, then the Tamil for to register, then say *mun̲pativu cey* again

Before you move on

What does முன்பதிவு செய் mean? ("To book in advance, to reserve".) Say it once more.

227.5 விண்ணப்பி (viṇṇappi) — to apply (for a job, a loan)

Before the new one: say the Tamil for to register, then the Tamil for to book in advance.

You'll want to know: விண்ணப்பி

விண்ணப்பி — *viṇṇappi* — "to apply (for a job, a loan)".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

விண்ணப்பி (*viṇṇappi*) is a verb made from *viṇṇappam*, "petition", a well-established loan from Sanskrit *vijñāpana*, "a request, a making known".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: viṇṇappi*
- *Say it: viṇṇappi*, once more
- *Say it:* say *viṇṇappi*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for to register, then the Tamil for to book in advance, then say *viṇṇappi* again

Before you move on

What does விண்ணப்பி mean? ("To apply (for a job, a loan)".) Say it once more.

Chapter 228

To type, To translate, To cancel, To hurry, To love

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say to type, to translate, to cancel, to hurry and to love.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 228: I can say to type, to translate, to cancel, to hurry and to love.*

228.1 தட்டச்சு செய் (taṭṭaccu cey) — to type

> Before the new one: say the Tamil for to book in advance, then the Tamil for to apply.

You'll want to know: தட்டச்சு செய்

தட்டச்சு செய் — *taṭṭaccu cey* — "to type".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

தட்டச்சு செய் (*taṭṭaccu cey*) is a modern coinage from native words: *taṭṭu*, "to tap, to strike", *accu*, "mould, type" (DEDR 47, which lists Malayalam accu and Telugu accu 'print'), and *sey*, "to do" (DEDR 1957). DEDR itself compares *accu*, with a query, to Sanskrit *sañcaka*, "mould", so a link with Indo-Aryan is possible.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: taṭṭaccu cey*
- *Say it: taṭṭaccu cey*, once more
- *Say it:* say *taṭṭaccu cey*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for to book in advance, then the Tamil for to apply, then say *taṭṭaccu cey* again

Before you move on

What does தட்டச்சு செய் mean? ("To type".) Say it once more.

228.2 மொழிபெயர் (mo̲lipeyar) — to translate

Before the new one: say the Tamil for to apply, then the Tamil for to type.

You'll want to know: மொழிபெயர்

மொழிபெயர் — *mo̲lipeyar* — "to translate".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

மொழிபெயர் (*mo̲lipeyar*) is native: *mo̲li*, "language" (DEDR 4989), and *peyar*, "to move, to shift" (DEDR 4409): "move into another language".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: mo̲lipeyar*
- *Say it: mo̲lipeyar*, once more

- *Say it:* say *mo̲lipeyar*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for to apply, then the Tamil for to type, then say *mo̲lipeyar* again

Before you move on

What does மொழிபெயர் mean? (“To translate”.) Say it once more.

228.3 ரத்து செய் (rattu cey) — to cancel

Before the new one: say the Tamil for to type, then the Tamil for to translate.

You’ll want to know: ரத்து செய்

ரத்து செய் — *rattu cey* — “to cancel”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

ரத்து செய் (*rattu cey*) is *rattu*, “cancelled”, a loan from Arabic *radd*, “rejection, cancelling”, through Hindustani, with native *sey*, “to do” (DEDR 1957).

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: rattu cey*
- *Say it: rattu cey*, once more
- *Say it:* say *rattu cey*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for to type, then the Tamil for to translate, then say *rattu cey* again

Before you move on

What does ரத்து செய் mean? (“To cancel”.) Say it once more.

228.4 அவசரப்படு (avacarappaṭu) — to hurry

Before the new one: say the Tamil for to translate, then the Tamil for to cancel.

You’ll want to know: அவசரப்படு

அவசரப்படு — *avacarappaṭu* — “to hurry”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

அவசரப்படு (*avacarappaṭu*) is *avacaram*, “haste”, from Sanskrit *avasara*, “occasion, opportunity” (CDIAL 858), with native *paṭu*, “to undergo” (DEDR 3853).

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: avacarappaṭu*
- *Say it: avacarappaṭu*, once more
- *Say it:* say *avacarappaṭu*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for to translate, then the Tamil for to cancel, then say *avacarappaṭu* again

Before you move on

What does அவசரப்படு mean? (“To hurry”.) Say it once more.

228.5 நேசி (nēci) — to love

Before the new one: say the Tamil for to cancel, then the Tamil for to hurry.

You'll want to know: நேசி

நேசி — *nēci* — "to love".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

நேசி (*nēci*) is a verb made from *nēcam*, "love, affection", from Sanskrit *sneha*, "oiliness, tenderness, love" (CDIAL 13802). Tamil dropped the first *s*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: nēci*
- *Say it: nēci*, once more
- *Say it:* say *nēci*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for to cancel, then the Tamil for to hurry, then say *nēci* again

Before you move on

What does நேசி mean? ("To love".) Say it once more.

Chapter 229

To praise, To scold, To dream, To separate, To throw

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say to praise, to scold, to dream, to separate and to throw.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 229: I can say to praise, to scold, to dream, to separate and to throw.*

229.1 பாராட்டு (pārāṭṭu) — to praise

> Before the new one: say the Tamil for to hurry, then the Tamil for to love.

You'll want to know: பாராட்டு

பாராட்டு — *pārāṭṭu* — "to praise".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

பாராட்டு (*pārāṭṭu*) is native Dravidian. DEDR 4092 lists Malayalam *pārāṭṭuka*, "to extol".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *pārāṭṭu*
- *Say it:* *pārāṭṭu*, once more
- *Say it:* say *pārāṭṭu*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for to hurry, then the Tamil for to love, then say *pārāṭṭu* again

Before you move on

What does பாராட்டு mean? (“To praise”.) Say it once more.

229.2 திட்டு (tiṭṭu) — to scold

Before the new one: say the Tamil for to love, then the Tamil for to praise.

You’ll want to know: திட்டு

திட்டு — *tiṭṭu* — “to scold”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

திட்டு (*tiṭṭu*) is native Dravidian. DEDR 3220 lists Kannada *tiṭṭu*, “to scold” and Telugu *tiṭṭu*.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *tiṭṭu*
- *Say it:* *tiṭṭu*, once more
- *Say it:* say *tiṭṭu*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for to love, then the Tamil for to praise, then say *tiṭṭu* again

Before you move on

What does திட்டு mean? ("To scold".) Say it once more.

229.3 கனவு காண் (kaṉavu kāṇ) — to dream

Before the new one: say the Tamil for to praise, then the Tamil for to scold.

You'll want to know: கனவு காண்

கனவு காண் — *kaṉavu kāṇ* — "to dream".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

கனவு காண் (*kaṉavu kāṇ*) is native: *kaṉavu*, "dream" (DEDR 1407; Malayalam *kanavu*), and *kāṇ*, "to see" (DEDR 1443): Tamil "sees" a dream.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: kaṉavu kāṇ*
- *Say it: kaṉavu kāṇ*, once more
- *Say it:* say *kaṉavu kāṇ*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for to praise, then the Tamil for to scold, then say *kaṉavu kāṇ* again

Before you move on

What does **கனவு காண்** mean? ("To dream".) Say it once more.

229.4 பிரி (piri) — to separate, to part

Before the new one: say the Tamil for to scold, then the Tamil for to dream.

You'll want to know: பிரி

பிரி — *piri* — "to separate, to part".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

பிரி (*piri*) is native Dravidian. DEDR 4176 lists Malayalam *pirikka*, "to sever".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: piri*
- *Say it: piri*, once more
- *Say it:* say *piri*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for to scold, then the Tamil for to dream, then say *piri* again

Before you move on

What does பிரி mean? ("To separate, to part".) Say it once more.

229.5 வீசு (vīcu) — to throw, to fling

Before the new one: say the Tamil for to dream, then the Tamil for to separate.

You'll want to know: வீசு

வீசு — *vīcu* — "to throw, to fling".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

வீசு (*vīcu*) is native Dravidian. DEDR 5450 lists Malayalam *vīcuka*, "to fan, cast", and compares Sanskrit *vīj-*, "to fan" (CDIAL 12043).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *vīcu*
- *Say it:* *vīcu*, once more
- *Say it:* say *vīcu*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for to dream, then the Tamil for to separate, then say *vīcu* again

Before you move on

What does **வீசு** mean? ("To throw, to fling".) Say it once more.

Chapter 230

To imagine, To doubt, To complain, To download, To upload

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say to imagine, to doubt, to complain, to download and to upload.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 230: I can say to imagine, to doubt, to complain, to download and to upload.

230.1 கற்பனை செய் (karpanai cey) — to imagine

Before the new one: say the Tamil for to separate, then the Tamil for to throw.

You'll want to know: கற்பனை செய்

கற்பனை செய் — *karpanai cey* — "to imagine".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

கற்பனை செய் (*karpanai cey*) is *karpanai*, "imagination", a well-established loan from Sanskrit *kalpanā*, "forming, fancy", with native *sey*, "to do" (DEDR 1957).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: kaṟpaṉai cey*
- *Say it: kaṟpaṉai cey*, once more
- *Say it:* say *kaṟpaṉai cey*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for to separate, then the Tamil for to throw, then say *kaṟpaṉai cey* again

Before you move on

What does கற்பனை செய் mean? ("To imagine".) Say it once more.

230.2 சந்தேகப்படு (cantēkappaṭu) — to doubt, to suspect

Before the new one: say the Tamil for to throw, then the Tamil for to imagine.

You'll want to know: சந்தேகப்படு

சந்தேகப்படு — *cantēkappaṭu* — "to doubt, to suspect".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

சந்தேகப்படு (*cantēkappaṭu*) is *cantēkam*, "doubt", from Sanskrit *saṁdeha*, "doubt" (CDIAL 12905), with native *paṭu*, "to undergo" (DEDR 3853).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: cantēkappaṭu*
- *Say it: cantēkappaṭu*, once more
- *Say it:* say *cantēkappaṭu*

- *Recall:* say the Tamil for to throw, then the Tamil for to imagine, then say *cantēkappaṭu* again

Before you move on

What does சந்தேகப்படு mean? ("To doubt, to suspect".) Say it once more.

230.3 குறை சொல் (kuṟai col) — to complain, to find fault

Before the new one: say the Tamil for to imagine, then the Tamil for to doubt.

You'll want to know: குறை சொல்

குறை சொல் — *kuṟai col* — "to complain, to find fault".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

குறை சொல் (*kuṟai col*) is native: *kuṟai*, "defect, deficiency" (DEDR 1851), and *col*, "to say" (DEDR 2855): "speak of the defect".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: kuṟai col*
- *Say it: kuṟai col*, once more
- *Say it:* say *kuṟai col*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for to imagine, then the Tamil for to doubt, then say *kuṟai col* again

Before you move on

What does குறை சொல் mean? ("To complain, to find fault".) Say it once more.

230.4 பதிவிறக்கு (pativiṟakku) — to download

Before the new one: say the Tamil for to doubt, then the Tamil for to complain.

You'll want to know: பதிவிறக்கு

பதிவிறக்கு — *pativiṟakku* — "to download".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

பதிவிறக்கு (*pativiṟakku*) is a modern coinage from native parts: *pativu*, "record" (DEDR 3911), and *iṟakku*, "to bring down", from *iṟaṅku*, "to descend" (DEDR 516).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *pativiṟakku*
- *Say it:* *pativiṟakku*, once more
- *Say it:* say *pativiṟakku*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for to doubt, then the Tamil for to complain, then say *pativiṟakku* again

Before you move on

What does பதிவிறக்கு mean? ("To download".) Say it once more.

230.5 பதிவேற்று (pativēṟṟu) — to upload

Before the new one: say the Tamil for to complain, then the Tamil for to download.

You'll want to know: பதிவேற்று

பதிவேற்று — *pativēṟṟu* — "to upload".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

பதிவேற்று (*pativēṟṟu*) is a modern coinage from native parts: *pativu*, "record" (DEDR 3911), and *ēṟṟu*, "to raise", from *ēṟu*, "to rise" (DEDR 916).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: pativēṟṟu*
- *Say it: pativēṟṟu*, once more
- *Say it:* say *pativēṟṟu*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for to complain, then the Tamil for to download, then say *pativēṟṟu* again

Before you move on

What does பதிவேற்று mean? ("To upload".) Say it once more.

Chapter 231

To faint, To wilt, To warn, To beg, To manage

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say to faint, to wilt, to warn, to beg and to manage.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 231: I can say to faint, to wilt, to warn, to beg and to manage.*

231.1 மயங்கு (mayaṅku) — to faint, to pass out

> Before the new one: say the Tamil for to download, then the Tamil for to upload.

You'll want to know: மயங்கு

மயங்கு — *mayaṅku* — "to faint, to pass out".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

மயங்கு (*mayaṅku*) is native Dravidian. DEDR 4706 lists Malayalam *mayaṅṅuka*, "to be giddy".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: mayaṅku*
- *Say it: mayaṅku*, once more
- *Say it:* say *mayaṅku*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for to download, then the Tamil for to upload, then say *mayaṅku* again

Before you move on

What does மயங்கு mean? ("To faint, to pass out".) Say it once more.

231.2 வாடு (vāṭu) — to wilt, to wither

Before the new one: say the Tamil for to upload, then the Tamil for to faint.

You'll want to know: வாடு

வாடு — *vāṭu* — "to wilt, to wither".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

வாடு (*vāṭu*) is native Dravidian. DEDR 5342 lists Malayalam *vāṭuka*, "to fade, wither".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: vāṭu*
- *Say it: vāṭu*, once more
- *Say it:* say *vāṭu*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for to upload, then the Tamil for to faint, then say *vāṭu* again

Before you move on

What does வாடு mean? ("To wilt, to wither".) Say it once more.

231.3 எச்சரி (eccari) — to warn

Before the new one: say the Tamil for to faint, then the Tamil for to wilt.

You'll want to know: எச்சரி

எச்சரி — *eccari* — "to warn".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

எச்சரி (*eccari*) is native. DEDR 851, the entry for *e̲lu*, "to rise", lists Telugu *eccarincu*, "to remind, to caution": a warning rouses.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: eccari*
- *Say it: eccari*, once more
- *Say it:* say *eccari*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for to faint, then the Tamil for to wilt, then say *eccari* again

Before you move on

What does எச்சரி mean? ("To warn".) Say it once more.

231.4 கெஞ்சு (keñcu) — to beg, to plead

Before the new one: say the Tamil for to wilt, then the Tamil for to warn.

You'll want to know: கெஞ்சு

கெஞ்சு — *keñcu* — "to beg, to plead".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

கெஞ்சு (*keñcu*) is native Dravidian. DEDR 1939 lists Malayalam *keñcuka*, "to beg".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: keñcu*
- *Say it: keñcu*, once more
- *Say it:* say *keñcu*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for to wilt, then the Tamil for to warn, then say *keñcu* again

Before you move on

What does கெஞ்சு mean? ("To beg, to plead".) Say it once more.

231.5 சமாளி (camāḷi) — to manage, to cope with

Before the new one: say the Tamil for to warn, then the Tamil for to beg.

You'll want to know: சமாளி

சமாளி — *camāḷi* — "to manage, to cope with".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

The origin of சமாளி (*camāḷi*) is uncertain. DEDR has no entry for it. It may be Indo-Aryan *sambhāḷ-*, "take care", as in Marathi (CDIAL 12962).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *camāḷi*
- *Say it:* *camāḷi*, once more
- *Say it:* say *camāḷi*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for to warn, then the Tamil for to beg, then say *camāḷi* again

Before you move on

What does சமாளி mean? ("To manage, to cope with".) Say it once more.

Chapter 232

Toothache, Wound, Tablet, Patient, Nurse

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say a toothache, a wound, a tablet, a patient and a nurse.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 232: I can say a toothache, a wound, a tablet, a patient and a nurse.

232.1 பல்வலி (palvali) — a toothache

Before the new one: say the Tamil for to beg, then the Tamil for to manage.

You'll want to know: பல்வலி

பல்வலி — *palvali* — "a toothache".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

பல்வலி (*palvali*) is native: *pal*, "tooth" (DEDR 3986), and *vali*, "pain" (DEDR 5281).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: palvali*
- *Say it: palvali*, once more
- *Say it:* say *palvali*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for to beg, then the Tamil for to manage, then say *palvali* again

Before you move on

What does பல்வலி mean? ("A toothache".) Say it once more.

232.2 காயம் (kāyam) — a wound, an injury

Before the new one: say the Tamil for to manage, then the Tamil for a toothache.

You'll want to know: காயம்

காயம் — *kāyam* — "a wound, an injury".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

The origin of காயம் (*kāyam*), "wound", is uncertain. DEDR does not give this sense, but it lists *kāyam*, "scar", beside *kāy*, "to form a callus, as from a wound" (DEDR 1460), and the two may be one word. Another possible source is Prakrit *ghāya*, "wound" (CDIAL 4460).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: kāyam*
- *Say it: kāyam*, once more
- *Say it:* say *kāyam*

- *Recall:* say the Tamil for to manage, then the Tamil for a toothache, then say *kāyam* again

Before you move on

What does காயம் mean? ("A wound, an injury".) Say it once more.

232.3 மாத்திரை (māttirai) — a tablet, a pill

Before the new one: say the Tamil for a toothache, then the Tamil for a wound.

You'll want to know: மாத்திரை

மாத்திரை — *māttirai* — "a tablet, a pill".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

மாத்திரை (*māttirai*) is a loan from Sanskrit *mātrā*, "measure, minute portion" (CDIAL 10023). A pill is a measured dose.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: māttirai*
- *Say it: māttirai*, once more
- *Say it:* say *māttirai*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for a toothache, then the Tamil for a wound, then say *māttirai* again

Before you move on

What does மாத்திரை mean? ("A tablet, a pill".) Say it once more.

232.4 நோயாளி (nōyāḷi) — a patient

Before the new one: say the Tamil for a wound, then the Tamil for a tablet.

You'll want to know: நோயாளி

நோயாளி — *nōyāḷi* — "a patient".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

நோயாளி (*nōyāḷi*) is native Dravidian (DEDR 3793). It is *nōy*, "disease", with *āḷi*, "person".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: nōyāḷi*
- *Say it: nōyāḷi*, once more
- *Say it:* say *nōyāḷi*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for a wound, then the Tamil for a tablet, then say *nōyāḷi* again

Before you move on

What does நோயாளி mean? ("A patient".) Say it once more.

232.5 செவிலியர் (ceviliyar) — a nurse

Before the new one: say the Tamil for a tablet, then the Tamil for a patient.

You'll want to know: செவிலியர்

செவிலியர் — *ceviliyar* — "a nurse".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

The origin of செவிலியர் (*ceviliyar*) is uncertain. It is built on *cevili*, an old word for a nurse or foster mother, and DEDR has no entry for it.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *ceviliyar*
- *Say it:* *ceviliyar*, once more
- *Say it:* say *ceviliyar*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for a tablet, then the Tamil for a patient, then say *ceviliyar* again

Before you move on

What does செவிலியர் mean? ("A nurse".) Say it once more.

Chapter 233

Every year, Dawn, Day after tomorrow, Day before yesterday, Second

Modes: **voice** (7) **Hands-free start:** all 7 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say every year, dawn, the day after tomorrow, the day before yesterday and a second.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 233: I can say every year, dawn, the day after tomorrow, the day before yesterday and a second.

233.1 ஆண்டுதோறும் (āṇṭutōṟum) — every year, yearly

Before the new one: say the Tamil for a patient, then the Tamil for a nurse.

You'll want to know: ஆண்டுதோறும்

ஆண்டுதோறும் — *āṇṭutōṟum* — "every year, yearly".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

ஆண்டுதோறும் (*āṇṭutōṟum*) is native Dravidian (DEDR 5153). It is *āṇṭu*, "year", with *-tōṟum*, "each, every".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *āṇṭutōṟum*
- *Say it:* *āṇṭutōṟum*, once more
- *Say it:* say *āṇṭutōṟum*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for a patient, then the Tamil for a nurse, then say *āṇṭutōṟum* again

Before you move on

What does ஆண்டுதோறும் mean? ("Every year, yearly".) Say it once more.

233.2 விடியல் (viṭiyal) — dawn, daybreak

Before the new one: say the Tamil for a nurse, then the Tamil for every year.

You'll want to know: விடியல்

விடியல் — *viṭiyal* — "dawn, daybreak".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

விடியல் (*viṭiyal*) is native Dravidian. DEDR 5475 lists Telugu *viḍi*, "clearness". The entry lists *viṭiyal*, "break of day", under *viṭi*, "to dawn".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: viṭiyal*
- *Say it: viṭiyal*, once more
- *Say it:* say *viṭiyal*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for a nurse, then the Tamil for every year, then say *viṭiyal* again

Before you move on

What does விடியல் mean? ("Dawn, daybreak".) Say it once more.

233.3 நாளை மறுநாள் (nāḷai maṟunāḷ) — the day after tomorrow

Before the new one: say the Tamil for every year, then the Tamil for dawn.

You'll want to know: நாளை மறுநாள்

நாளை மறுநாள் — *nāḷai maṟunāḷ* — "the day after tomorrow".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

நாளை மறுநாள் (*nāḷai maṟunāḷ*) is native: *nāḷai*, "tomorrow" (DEDR 3656), and *maṟunāḷ*, "the next day" (DEDR 4766): "the day after tomorrow".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: nāḷai maṟunāḷ*
- *Say it: nāḷai maṟunāḷ*, once more
- *Say it:* say *nāḷai maṟunāḷ*

- *Recall:* say the Tamil for every year, then the Tamil for dawn, then say *nāḷai maṟunāḷ* again

Before you move on

What does நாளை மறுநாள் mean? ("The day after tomorrow".) Say it once more.

233.4 நேற்று முன்தினம் (nēṟṟu muṉtiṉam) — the day before yesterday

Before the new one: say the Tamil for dawn, then the Tamil for the day after tomorrow.

You'll want to know: நேற்று முன்தினம்

நேற்று முன்தினம் — *nēṟṟu muṉtiṉam* — "the day before yesterday".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

நேற்று முன்தினம் (*nēṟṟu muṉtiṉam*) is native *nēṟṟu*, "yesterday", and *muṉtiṉam*, "the day before", from native *muṉ*, "before" (DEDR 5020), and *tiṉam*, "day", from Sanskrit *dina* (CDIAL 6328). DEDR 3758 gives the older Tamil forms *nerunal* and *nerunaṟṟu*, "yesterday"; modern *nēṟṟu* is most likely the shortened form.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *nēṟṟu muṉtiṉam*
- *Say it:* *nēṟṟu muṉtiṉam*, once more
- *Say it:* say *nēṟṟu muṉtiṉam*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for dawn, then the Tamil for the day after tomorrow, then say *nēṟṟu muṉtiṉam* again

Before you move on

What does **நேற்று முன்தினம்** mean? ("The day before yesterday".) Say it once more.

233.5 விநாடி (vināṭi) — a second (of time)

Before the new one: say the Tamil for the day after tomorrow, then the Tamil for the day before yesterday.

You'll want to know: விநாடி

விநாடி — *vināṭi* — "a second (of time)".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

விநாடி (*vināṭi*) is a well-established loan from Sanskrit *vināḍī*, "a sixtieth of a *nāḍī*", the old 24-minute unit, used now for a second.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: vināṭi*
- *Say it: vināṭi*, once more
- *Say it:* say *vināṭi*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for the day after tomorrow, then the Tamil for the day before yesterday, then say *vināṭi* again

Before you move on

What does **விநாடி** mean? ("A second (of time)".) Say it once more.

233.6 Words from chapters 225-228 — a first pass

Say the words for the day before yesterday and a second.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- to taste, to fill, to fold, to take off, to change
- to begin, to touch, to sneeze, to swallow, to chew
- to correct, to enquire, to register, to book in advance, to apply
- to type, to translate, to cancel, to hurry, to love

Before you move on

To taste? (சுவை பார், *cuvai pār.*) To fill? (நிரப்பு, *nirappu.*) To fold? (மடி, *maṭi.*) To take off? (கழற்று, *kaḻaṟṟu.*) To change? (மாற்று, *māṟṟu.*) To begin? (ஆரம்பி, *ārampi.*) To touch? (தொடு, *toṭu.*) To sneeze? (தும்மு, *tummu.*) To swallow? (விழுங்கு, *viḻuṅku.*) To chew? (மெல், *mel.*) To correct? (திருத்து, *tiruttu.*) To enquire? (விசாரி, *vicāri.*) To register? (பதிவு செய், *pativu cey.*) To book in advance? (முன்பதிவு செய், *muṉpativu cey.*) To apply? (விண்ணப்பி, *viṇṇappi.*) To type? (தட்டச்சு செய், *taṭṭaccu cey.*) To translate? (மொழிபெயர், *moḻipeyar.*) To cancel? (ரத்து செய், *rattu cey.*) To hurry? (அவசரப்படு, *avacarappaṭu.*) To love? (நேசி, *nēci.*)

233.7 Words from chapters 229-233 — a second pass

Say the words for to praise and to scold.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- to praise, to scold, to dream, to separate, to throw
- to imagine, to doubt, to complain, to download, to upload
- to faint, to wilt, to warn, to beg, to manage
- a toothache, a wound, a tablet, a patient, a nurse

- every year, dawn, the day after tomorrow, the day before yesterday, a second

Before you move on

To praise? (பாராட்டு, *pārāṭṭu.*) To scold? (திட்டு, *tiṭṭu.*) To dream? (கனவு காண், *kaṉavu kāṇ.*) To separate? (பிரி, *piri.*) To throw? (வீசு, *vīcu.*) To imagine? (கற்பனை செய், *kaṟpaṉai cey.*) To doubt? (சந்தேகப்படு, *cantēkappaṭu.*) To complain? (குறை சொல், *kuṟai col.*) To download? (பதிவிறக்கு, *pativiṟakku.*) To upload? (பதிவேற்று, *pativēṟṟu.*) To faint? (மயங்கு, *mayaṅku.*) To wilt? (வாடு, *vāṭu.*) To warn? (எச்சரி, *eccari.*) To beg? (கெஞ்சு, *keñcu.*) To manage? (சமாளி, *camāḷi.*) A toothache? (பல்வலி, *palvali.*) A wound? (காயம், *kāyam.*) A tablet? (மாத்திரை, *māttirai.*) A patient? (நோயாளி, *nōyāḷi.*) A nurse? (செவிலியர், *ceviliyar.*) Every year? (ஆண்டுதோறும், *āṇṭutōṟum.*) Dawn? (விடியல், *viṭiyal.*) The day after tomorrow? (நாளை மறுநாள், *nāḷai maṟunāḷ.*) The day before yesterday? (நேற்று முன்தினம், *nēṟṟu muṉtiṉam.*) A second? (விநாடி, *viṉāṭi.*)

Chapter 234

Post office, City, Country, Capital city, Crossroads

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say a post office, a city, a country, a capital city and a crossroads.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 234: I can say a post office, a city, a country, a capital city and a crossroads.*

234.1 அஞ்சலகம் (añcalakam) — a post office

> Before the new one: say the Tamil for the day before yesterday, then the Tamil for a second (of time).

You'll want to know: அஞ்சலகம்

அஞ்சலகம் — *añcalakam* — "a post office".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

அஞ்சலகம் (*añcalakam*) is native: *añcal*, "relay, letter post" (DEDR 54, which lists Malayalam añcal and Telugu ance), and *akam*, "house" (DEDR 7): "the post house".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *añcalakam*
- *Say it:* *añcalakam*, once more
- *Say it:* say *añcalakam*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for the day before yesterday, then the Tamil for a second (of time), then say *añcalakam* again

Before you move on

What does அஞ்சலகம் mean? (“A post office”.) Say it once more.

234.2 நகரம் (nakaram) — a city

Before the new one: say the Tamil for a second (of time), then the Tamil for a post office.

You’ll want to know: நகரம்

நகரம் — *nakaram* — “a city”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

நகரம் (*nakaram*) is native Dravidian. DEDR 3568 lists Malayalam *nakar*, “town”. The entry compares Sanskrit *nagara*, “town, city”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *nakaram*
- *Say it:* *nakaram*, once more
- *Say it:* say *nakaram*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for a second (of time), then the Tamil for a post office, then say *nakaram* again

Before you move on

What does நகரம் mean? (“A city”.) Say it once more.

234.3 நாடு (nāṭu) — a country

Before the new one: say the Tamil for a post office, then the Tamil for a city.

You’ll want to know: நாடு

நாடு — *nāṭu* — “a country”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

நாடு (*nāṭu*) is native Dravidian. DEDR 3638 lists Malayalam *nāṭu*, Kannada *nāḍu* and Telugu *nāḍu*.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: nāṭu*
- *Say it: nāṭu*, once more
- *Say it:* say *nāṭu*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for a post office, then the Tamil for a city, then say *nāṭu* again

Before you move on

What does நாடு mean? (“A country”.) Say it once more.

234.4 தலைநகரம் (talainakaram) — a capital city

Before the new one: say the Tamil for a city, then the Tamil for a country.

You'll want to know: தலைநகரம்

தலைநகரம் — *talainakaram* — "a capital city".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

தலைநகரம் (*talainakaram*) is *talai*, "head" (DEDR 3103), and *nakaram*, "city" (DEDR 3568, which compares Sanskrit *nagara*): "the head city".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: talainakaram*
- *Say it: talainakaram*, once more
- *Say it:* say *talainakaram*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for a city, then the Tamil for a country, then say *talainakaram* again

Before you move on

What does தலைநகரம் mean? ("A capital city".) Say it once more.

234.5 நாற்சந்தி (nāṟcanti) — a crossroads

Before the new one: say the Tamil for a country, then the Tamil for a capital city.

You'll want to know: நாற்சந்தி

நாற்சந்தி — *nāṟcanti* — "a crossroads".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

நாற்சந்தி (*nāṟcanti*) is native *nāl*, "four" (DEDR 3655), and *canti*, "junction", from Sanskrit *samidhi* (CDIAL 12913): "the four-way junction".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: nāṟcanti*
- *Say it: nāṟcanti*, once more
- *Say it:* say *nāṟcanti*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for a country, then the Tamil for a capital city, then say *nāṟcanti* again

Before you move on

What does நாற்சந்தி mean? ("A crossroads".) Say it once more.

Chapter 235

Direction, North, South, East, West

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say a direction, north, south, east and west.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 235: I can say a direction, north, south, east and west.

235.1 திசை (ticai) — a direction

Before the new one: say the Tamil for a capital city, then the Tamil for a crossroads.

You'll want to know: திசை

திசை — *ticai* — "a direction".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

திசை (*ticai*) is a well-established loan from Sanskrit *diśā*, "direction, quarter of the sky".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: ticai*
- *Say it: ticai*, once more
- *Say it:* say *ticai*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for a capital city, then the Tamil for a crossroads, then say *ticai* again

Before you move on

What does **திசை** mean? (“A direction”.) Say it once more.

235.2 வடக்கு (vaṭakku) — north

Before the new one: say the Tamil for a crossroads, then the Tamil for a direction.

You’ll want to know: வடக்கு

வடக்கு — *vaṭakku* — “north”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

வடக்கு (*vaṭakku*) is native Dravidian. DEDR 5218 lists Malayalam *vaṭakku*.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: vaṭakku*
- *Say it: vaṭakku*, once more
- *Say it:* say *vaṭakku*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for a crossroads, then the Tamil for a direction, then say *vaṭakku* again

Before you move on

What does **வடக்கு** mean? ("North".) Say it once more.

235.3 தெற்கு (te̲rku) — south

Before the new one: say the Tamil for a direction, then the Tamil for north.

You'll want to know: தெற்கு

தெற்கு — *te̲rku* — "south".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

தெற்கு (*te̲rku*) is native Dravidian. DEDR 3449 lists Malayalam *tekku*, "south".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *te̲rku*
- *Say it:* *te̲rku*, once more
- *Say it:* say *te̲rku*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for a direction, then the Tamil for north, then say *te̲rku* again

Before you move on

What does **தெற்கு** mean? ("South".) Say it once more.

235.4 கிழக்கு (ki̲lakku) — east

Before the new one: say the Tamil for north, then the Tamil for south.

You'll want to know: கிழக்கு

கிழக்கு — *kiḻakku* — "east".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

கிழக்கு (*kiḻakku*) is native Dravidian (DEDR 1619). The entry lists *kiḻakku*, "east, the lowland of the Tamil country", under *kīḻ*, "below".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: kiḻakku*
- *Say it: kiḻakku*, once more
- *Say it:* say *kiḻakku*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for north, then the Tamil for south, then say *kiḻakku* again

Before you move on

What does கிழக்கு mean? ("East".) Say it once more.

235.5 மேற்கு (mēṟku) — west

Before the new one: say the Tamil for south, then the Tamil for east.

You'll want to know: மேற்கு

மேற்கு — *mēṟku* — "west".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

மேற்கு (*mēṟku*) is native Dravidian (DEDR 5086). The entry lists *mēṟku*, "west", under *mē*, "height, high place".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: mēṟku*
- *Say it: mēṟku*, once more
- *Say it:* say *mēṟku*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for south, then the Tamil for east, then say *mēṟku* again

Before you move on

What does மேற்கு mean? ("West".) Say it once more.

Chapter 236

Museum, Lane, Harbour, Fort, Palace

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say a museum, a lane, a harbour, a fort and a palace.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 236: I can say a museum, a lane, a harbour, a fort and a palace.*

236.1 அருங்காட்சியகம் (aruṅkāṭciyakam) — a museum

Before the new one: say the Tamil for east, then the Tamil for west.

You'll want to know: அருங்காட்சியகம்

அருங்காட்சியகம் — *aruṅkāṭciyakam* — "a museum".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

அருங்காட்சியகம் (*aruṅkāṭciyakam*) is a modern coinage from native parts: *aru*, "rare" (DEDR 221), *kāṭci*, "sight, show" (DEDR 1443), and *akam*, "house" (DEDR 7): "the house of rare sights".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: aruṅkāṭciyakam*
- *Say it: aruṅkāṭciyakam*, once more
- *Say it:* say *aruṅkāṭciyakam*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for east, then the Tamil for west, then say *aruṅkāṭciyakam* again

Before you move on

What does அருங்காட்சியகம் mean? ("A museum".) Say it once more.

236.2 சந்து (cantu) — a lane, an alley

Before the new one: say the Tamil for west, then the Tamil for a museum.

You'll want to know: சந்து

சந்து — *cantu* — "a lane, an alley".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

சந்து (*cantu*) is usually traced to Sanskrit *saṁdhi*, "joint, junction" (CDIAL 12913): a lane is a gap between houses.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: cantu*
- *Say it: cantu*, once more
- *Say it:* say *cantu*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for west, then the Tamil for a museum, then say *cantu* again

Before you move on

What does **சந்து** mean? ("A lane, an alley".) Say it once more.

236.3 துறைமுகம் (tu̲raimukam) — a harbour, a port

Before the new one: say the Tamil for a museum, then the Tamil for a lane.

You'll want to know: துறைமுகம்

துறைமுகம் — *tu̲raimukam* — "a harbour, a port".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

துறைமுகம் (*tu̲raimukam*) is native: *tu̲rai*, "harbour, landing place" (DEDR 3370), and *mukam*, "face, front" (DEDR 4889).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: tu̲raimukam*
- *Say it: tu̲raimukam*, once more
- *Say it:* say *tu̲raimukam*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for a museum, then the Tamil for a lane, then say *tu̲raimukam* again

Before you move on

What does **துறைமுகம்** mean? ("A harbour, a port".) Say it once more.

236.4 கோட்டை (kōṭṭai) — a fort

Before the new one: say the Tamil for a lane, then the Tamil for a harbour.

You'll want to know: கோட்டை

கோட்டை — *kōṭṭai* — "a fort".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

கோட்டை (*kōṭṭai*) is native Dravidian. DEDR 2207 lists Malayalam *kōṭṭa*, "fort" and Kannada *kōṭe*. The entry compares Sanskrit *koṭṭa*, "fort".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: kōṭṭai*
- *Say it: kōṭṭai*, once more
- *Say it:* say *kōṭṭai*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for a lane, then the Tamil for a harbour, then say *kōṭṭai* again

Before you move on

What does கோட்டை mean? ("A fort".) Say it once more.

236.5 அரண்மனை (araṇmaṉai) — a palace

Before the new one: say the Tamil for a harbour, then the Tamil for a fort.

You'll want to know: அரண்மனை

அரண்மனை — *araṇmaṉai* — "a palace".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

அரண்மனை (*araṇmaṉai*) is *araṇ*, "defence, fortress", which DEDR 201 traces to Sanskrit *śaraṇa*, "refuge", and native *maṉai*, "house" (DEDR 4776).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: araṇmaṉai*
- *Say it: araṇmaṉai*, once more
- *Say it:* say *araṇmaṉai*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for a harbour, then the Tamil for a fort, then say *araṇmaṉai* again

Before you move on

What does அரண்மனை mean? ("A palace".) Say it once more.

Chapter 237

Especially, Instead, Not only, Together, Carefully

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say especially, instead, not only, together and carefully.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 237: I can say especially, instead, not only, together and carefully.*

237.1 குறிப்பாக (kuṟippāka) — especially, in particular

Before the new one: say the Tamil for a fort, then the Tamil for a palace.

You'll want to know: குறிப்பாக

குறிப்பாக — *kuṟippāka* — "especially, in particular".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

குறிப்பாக (*kuṟippāka*) is native Dravidian (DEDR 1847). It is *kuṟippu*, "a mark, a pointing out", with *-āka*: "pointedly".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: kuṟippāka*
- *Say it: kuṟippāka*, once more
- *Say it:* say *kuṟippāka*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for a fort, then the Tamil for a palace, then say *kuṟippāka* again

Before you move on

What does குறிப்பாக mean? ("Especially, in particular".) Say it once more.

237.2 அதற்குப் பதிலாக (ataṟkup patilāka) — instead

Before the new one: say the Tamil for a palace, then the Tamil for especially.

You'll want to know: அதற்குப் பதிலாக

அதற்குப் பதிலாக — *ataṟkup patilāka* — "instead".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

அதற்குப் பதிலாக (*ataṟkup patilāka*) is native *ataṟku*, "for that" (DEDR 1), and *patil*, "exchange, answer", from Arabic *badal*, "substitute", with *-āka*: "as a substitute for that".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: ataṟkup patilāka*
- *Say it: ataṟkup patilāka*, once more
- *Say it:* say *ataṟkup patilāka*

- *Recall:* say the Tamil for a palace, then the Tamil for especially, then say *atar̲kup patilāka* again

Before you move on

What does அதற்குப் பதிலாக mean? ("Instead".) Say it once more.

237.3 மட்டுமல்லாமல் (maṭṭumallāmal) — not only (... but also)

Before the new one: say the Tamil for especially, then the Tamil for instead.

You'll want to know: மட்டுமல்லாமல்

மட்டுமல்லாமல் — *maṭṭumallāmal* — "not only (... but also)".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

மட்டுமல்லாமல் (*maṭṭumallāmal*) is native: *maṭṭum*, "only" (DEDR 4660), and *allāmal*, "without being", from *al-*, "not to be" (DEDR 234): "not only".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: maṭṭumallāmal*
- *Say it: maṭṭumallāmal*, once more
- *Say it:* say *maṭṭumallāmal*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for especially, then the Tamil for instead, then say *maṭṭumallāmal* again

Before you move on

What does மட்டுமல்லாமல் mean? (“Not only (… but also)”.) Say it once more.

237.4 ஒன்றாக (on̲r̲āka) — together

Before the new one: say the Tamil for instead, then the Tamil for not only.

You’ll want to know: ஒன்றாக

ஒன்றாக — *on̲r̲āka* — “together”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

ஒன்றாக (*on̲r̲āka*) is native Dravidian (DEDR 990). It is *on̲r̲u*, “one”, with *-āka*: “as one”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *on̲r̲āka*
- *Say it:* *on̲r̲āka*, once more
- *Say it:* say *on̲r̲āka*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for instead, then the Tamil for not only, then say *on̲r̲āka* again

Before you move on

What does ஒன்றாக mean? (“Together”.) Say it once more.

237.5 கவனமாக (kavan̲amāka) — carefully

Before the new one: say the Tamil for not only, then the Tamil for together.

You'll want to know: கவனமாக

கவனமாக — *kavaṉamāka* — "carefully".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

கவனமாக (*kavaṉamāka*) is native Dravidian. DEDR 1328 lists Malayalam *kavanam*, "care". It is *kavaṉam*, "care, attention", with *-āka*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: kavaṉamāka*
- *Say it: kavaṉamāka*, once more
- *Say it:* say *kavaṉamāka*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for not only, then the Tamil for together, then say *kavaṉamāka* again

Before you move on

What does **கவனமாக** mean? ("Carefully".) Say it once more.

Chapter 238

Colour, Size, Weight, Healthy, Thin

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say a colour, a size, weight, healthy and thin.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 238: I can say a colour, a size, weight, healthy and thin.

238.1 நிறம் (niṟam) — a colour

Before the new one: say the Tamil for together, then the Tamil for carefully.

You'll want to know: நிறம்

நிறம் — *niṟam* — "a colour".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

நிறம் (*niṟam*) is native Dravidian. DEDR 3680 lists Malayalam *niṟam*, "colour".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: niṟam*
- *Say it: niṟam*, once more
- *Say it:* say *niṟam*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for together, then the Tamil for carefully, then say *niṟam* again

Before you move on

What does நிறம் mean? (“A colour”.) Say it once more.

238.2 அளவு (aḷavu) — a size, an amount

Before the new one: say the Tamil for carefully, then the Tamil for a colour.

You’ll want to know: அளவு

அளவு — *aḷavu* — “a size, an amount”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

அளவு (*aḷavu*) is native Dravidian. DEDR 295 lists Telugu *alavi*, “measure”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: aḷavu*
- *Say it: aḷavu*, once more
- *Say it:* say *aḷavu*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for carefully, then the Tamil for a colour, then say *aḷavu* again

Before you move on

What does அளவு mean? (“A size, an amount”.) Say it once more.

238.3 எடை (eṭai) — weight

Before the new one: say the Tamil for a colour, then the Tamil for a size.

You’ll want to know: எடை

எடை — *eṭai* — “weight”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

எடை (*eṭai*) is native Dravidian (DEDR 851). The entry lists *eṭai*, “weighing, weight”, in the family of *eṭu*, “to lift”: weight is what is lifted.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: eṭai*
- *Say it: eṭai*, once more
- *Say it:* say *eṭai*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for a colour, then the Tamil for a size, then say *eṭai* again

Before you move on

What does எடை mean? (“Weight”.) Say it once more.

238.4 ஆரோக்கியமான (ārōkkiyamāṉa) — healthy

Before the new one: say the Tamil for a size, then the Tamil for weight.

You'll want to know: ஆரோக்கியமான

ஆரோக்கியமான — *ārōkkiyamāṉa* — "healthy".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

ஆரோக்கியமான (*ārōkkiyamāṉa*) is a loan from Sanskrit *ārogya*, "health" (CDIAL 1330). *Ārōkkiyam* takes -*āṉa*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *ārōkkiyamāṉa*
- *Say it:* *ārōkkiyamāṉa*, once more
- *Say it:* say *ārōkkiyamāṉa*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for a size, then the Tamil for weight, then say *ārōkkiyamāṉa* again

Before you move on

What does ஆரோக்கியமான mean? ("Healthy".) Say it once more.

238.5 ஒல்லியான (olliyāṉa) — thin, slim

Before the new one: say the Tamil for weight, then the Tamil for healthy.

You'll want to know: ஒல்லியான

ஒல்லியான — *olliyāṉa* — "thin, slim".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

ஒல்லியான (*olliyāṉa*) is native Dravidian (DEDR 1004). The entry lists *olli*, "a thin person, thinness", under *olku*, "to grow thin"; *-āṉa* makes it "thin".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: olliyāṉa*
- *Say it: olliyāṉa*, once more
- *Say it:* say *olliyāṉa*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for weight, then the Tamil for healthy, then say *olliyāṉa* again

Before you move on

What does **ஒல்லியான** mean? ("Thin, slim".) Say it once more.

Chapter 239

Disappointment, Pride, Satisfaction, Pity, Loneliness

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say disappointment, pride, satisfaction, pity and loneliness.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 239: I can say disappointment, pride, satisfaction, pity and loneliness.

239.1 ஏமாற்றம் (ēmāṟṟam) — disappointment

Before the new one: say the Tamil for healthy, then the Tamil for thin.

You'll want to know: ஏமாற்றம்

ஏமாற்றம் — *ēmāṟṟam* — "disappointment".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

ஏமாற்றம் (*ēmāṟṟam*) is native Dravidian. DEDR 898 lists Telugu *ēmāṟu*, "to be deceived". It is the noun of *ēmāṟu*, "to be let down".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *ēmāṟṟam*
- *Say it:* *ēmāṟṟam*, once more
- *Say it:* say *ēmāṟṟam*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for healthy, then the Tamil for thin, then say *ēmāṟṟam* again

Before you move on

What does ஏமாற்றம் mean? ("Disappointment".) Say it once more.

239.2 பெருமை (perumai) — pride

Before the new one: say the Tamil for thin, then the Tamil for disappointment.

You'll want to know: பெருமை

பெருமை — *perumai* — "pride".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

பெருமை (*perumai*) is native Dravidian (DEDR 4411). It is *peru*, "great", with *-mai*: "greatness".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *perumai*
- *Say it:* *perumai*, once more
- *Say it:* say *perumai*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for thin, then the Tamil for disappointment, then say *perumai* again

Before you move on

What does பெருமை mean? ("Pride".) Say it once more.

239.3 திருப்தி (tirupti) — satisfaction

Before the new one: say the Tamil for disappointment, then the Tamil for pride.

You'll want to know: திருப்தி

திருப்தி — *tirupti* — "satisfaction".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

திருப்தி (*tirupti*) is a loan from Sanskrit *tṛpti*, "satisfaction" (CDIAL 5931).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: tirupti*
- *Say it: tirupti*, once more
- *Say it:* say *tirupti*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for disappointment, then the Tamil for pride, then say *tirupti* again

Before you move on

What does திருப்தி mean? ("Satisfaction".) Say it once more.

239.4 இரக்கம் (irakkam) — pity, compassion

Before the new one: say the Tamil for pride, then the Tamil for satisfaction.

You'll want to know: இரக்கம்

இரக்கம் — *irakkam* — "pity, compassion".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

இரக்கம் (*irakkam*) is native Dravidian. DEDR 473 lists Malayalam *erakkam*, "kindness, pity".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: irakkam*
- *Say it: irakkam*, once more
- *Say it:* say *irakkam*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for pride, then the Tamil for satisfaction, then say *irakkam* again

Before you move on

What does **இரக்கம்** mean? ("Pity, compassion".) Say it once more.

239.5 தனிமை (taṉimai) — loneliness

Before the new one: say the Tamil for satisfaction, then the Tamil for pity.

You'll want to know: தனிமை

தனிமை — *taṉimai* — "loneliness".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

தனிமை (*taṉimai*) is native Dravidian (DEDR 3196). It is *taṉi*, "alone", with *-mai*: "aloneness".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: tan̲imai*
- *Say it: tan̲imai*, once more
- *Say it:* say *tan̲imai*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for satisfaction, then the Tamil for pity, then say *tan̲imai* again

Before you move on

What does தனிமை mean? ("Loneliness".) Say it once more.

Chapter 240

Firm, Round, Square, Sharp, Wonderful

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say firm, round, square, sharp and wonderful.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 240: I can say firm, round, square, sharp and wonderful.

240.1 உறுதியான (uṟutiyāṉa) — firm, sturdy

Before the new one: say the Tamil for pity, then the Tamil for loneliness.

You'll want to know: உறுதியான

உறுதியான — *uṟutiyāṉa* — "firm, sturdy".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

உறுதியான (*uṟutiyāṉa*) is native Dravidian. DEDR 721 lists Malayalam *uṟekka*, "to be firm". It is *uṟuti*, "firmness", with *-āṉa*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *u̱rutiyāṉa*
- *Say it:* *u̱rutiyāṉa*, once more
- *Say it:* say *u̱rutiyāṉa*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for pity, then the Tamil for loneliness, then say *u̱rutiyāṉa* again

Before you move on

What does உறுதியான mean? (“Firm, sturdy”.) Say it once more.

240.2 வட்டமான (vaṭṭamāṉa) — round

Before the new one: say the Tamil for loneliness, then the Tamil for firm.

You’ll want to know: வட்டமான

வட்டமான — *vaṭṭamāṉa* — “round”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

வட்டமான (*vaṭṭamāṉa*) is *vaṭṭam*, “circle”, usually traced to Sanskrit *vṛtta*, “rounded” (CDIAL 12069), with *-āṉa*.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *vaṭṭamāṉa*
- *Say it:* *vaṭṭamāṉa*, once more
- *Say it:* say *vaṭṭamāṉa*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for loneliness, then the Tamil for firm, then say *vaṭṭamāṉa* again

Before you move on

What does **வட்டமான** mean? (“Round”.) Say it once more.

240.3 சதுரமான (caturamāṉa) — square

Before the new one: say the Tamil for firm, then the Tamil for round.

You’ll want to know: சதுரமான

சதுரமான — *caturamāṉa* — “square”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

சதுரமான (*caturamāṉa*) is *caturam*, “square”, a well-established loan from Sanskrit *caturasra*, “four-cornered”, with *-āṉa*.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: caturamāṉa*
- *Say it: caturamāṉa*, once more
- *Say it:* say *caturamāṉa*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for firm, then the Tamil for round, then say *caturamāṉa* again

Before you move on

What does **சதுரமான** mean? (“Square”.) Say it once more.

240.4 கூர்மையான (kūrmaiyāṉa) — sharp

Before the new one: say the Tamil for round, then the Tamil for square.

You'll want to know: கூர்மையான

கூர்மையான — *kūrmaiyāṉa* — "sharp".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

கூர்மையான (*kūrmaiyāṉa*) is native Dravidian. DEDR 1898 lists Malayalam *kūr*, "sharpness".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: kūrmaiyāṉa*
- *Say it: kūrmaiyāṉa*, once more
- *Say it:* say *kūrmaiyāṉa*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for round, then the Tamil for square, then say *kūrmaiyāṉa* again

Before you move on

What does **கூர்மையான** mean? ("Sharp".) Say it once more.

240.5 அருமையான (arumaiyāṉa) — wonderful, excellent

Before the new one: say the Tamil for square, then the Tamil for sharp.

You'll want to know: அருமையான

அருமையான — *arumaiyāṉa* — "wonderful, excellent".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

அருமையான (*arumaiyāṉa*) is native Dravidian. DEDR 221 lists Malayalam *aruma*, "rarity". It is *arumai*, "rareness, excellence", with *-āṉa*: what is rare is precious.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: arumaiyāṉa*
- *Say it: arumaiyāṉa*, once more
- *Say it:* say *arumaiyāṉa*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for square, then the Tamil for sharp, then say *arumaiyāṉa* again

Before you move on

What does அருமையான mean? ("Wonderful, excellent".) Say it once more.

Chapter 241

Ordinary, Rare, Equal, Rough, Lukewarm

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say ordinary, rare, equal, rough and lukewarm.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 241: I can say ordinary, rare, equal, rough and lukewarm.*

241.1 சாதாரணமான (cātāraṇamāṉa) — ordinary, normal

Before the new one: say the Tamil for sharp, then the Tamil for wonderful.

You'll want to know: சாதாரணமான

சாதாரணமான — *cātāraṇamāṉa* — "ordinary, normal".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

சாதாரணமான (*cātāraṇamāṉa*) is *cātāraṇam*, a well-established loan from Sanskrit *sādhāraṇa*, "common, general", with *-āṉa*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *cātāraṇamāṉa*
- *Say it:* *cātāraṇamāṉa*, once more
- *Say it:* say *cātāraṇamāṉa*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for sharp, then the Tamil for wonderful, then say *cātāraṇamāṉa* again

Before you move on

What does சாதாரணமான mean? ("Ordinary, normal".) Say it once more.

241.2 அபூர்வமான (apūrvamāṉa) — rare

Before the new one: say the Tamil for wonderful, then the Tamil for ordinary.

You'll want to know: அபூர்வமான

அபூர்வமான — *apūrvamāṉa* — "rare".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

அபூர்வமான (*apūrvamāṉa*) is a loan from Sanskrit *apūrva*, "unprecedented" (CDIAL 494). *Apūrvam* takes *-āṉa*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *apūrvamāṉa*
- *Say it:* *apūrvamāṉa*, once more
- *Say it:* say *apūrvamāṉa*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for wonderful, then the Tamil for ordinary, then say *apūrvamāṉa* again

Before you move on

What does அபூர்வமான mean? (“Rare”.) Say it once more.

241.3 சமமான (camamāṉa) — equal

Before the new one: say the Tamil for ordinary, then the Tamil for rare.

You’ll want to know: சமமான

சமமான — *camamāṉa* — “equal”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

சமமான (*camamāṉa*) is a loan from Sanskrit *sama*, “equal, alike” (CDIAL 13173). *Camam* takes *-āṉa*.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: camamāṉa*
- *Say it: camamāṉa*, once more
- *Say it:* say *camamāṉa*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for ordinary, then the Tamil for rare, then say *camamāṉa* again

Before you move on

What does சமமான mean? (“Equal”.) Say it once more.

241.4 கரடுமுரடான (karaṭumuraṭāṉa) — rough, uneven

Before the new one: say the Tamil for rare, then the Tamil for equal.

You'll want to know: கரடுமுரடான

கரடுமுரடான — *karaṭumuraṭāṉa* — "rough, uneven".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

கரடுமுரடான (*karaṭumuraṭāṉa*) is native Dravidian. DEDR 1265 lists Kannada *karaḍu*, "rough, uneven". *Karaṭu*, "roughness", is doubled with a rhyming partner, *muraṭu*. The entry compares Sanskrit *karkaśa*, "rough, harsh".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: karaṭumuraṭāṉa*
- *Say it: karaṭumuraṭāṉa*, once more
- *Say it:* say *karaṭumuraṭāṉa*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for rare, then the Tamil for equal, then say *karaṭumuraṭāṉa* again

Before you move on

What does **கரடுமுரடான** mean? ("Rough, uneven".) Say it once more.

241.5 வெதுவெதுப்பான (vetuvetuppāṉa) — lukewarm

Before the new one: say the Tamil for equal, then the Tamil for rough.

You'll want to know: வெதுவெதுப்பான

வெதுவெதுப்பான — *vetuvetuppāṉa* — "lukewarm".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

வெதுவெதுப்பான (*vetuvetuppāṉa*) is native Dravidian (DEDR 5517). The entry lists *vetumpu*, "to become warm", under *vē*, "to burn, to be hot"; the doubled *vetuvetu-* makes it "mildly warm".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: vetuvetuppāṉa*
- *Say it: vetuvetuppāṉa*, once more
- *Say it:* say *vetuvetuppāṉa*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for equal, then the Tamil for rough, then say *vetuvetuppāṉa* again

Before you move on

What does வெதுவெதுப்பான mean? ("Lukewarm".) Say it once more.

Chapter 242

Clothing, Trousers, Pocket, Button, Blouse

Modes: **voice** (7) **Hands-free start:** all 7 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say clothing, trousers, a pocket, a button and a blouse.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 242: I can say clothing, trousers, a pocket, a button and a blouse.

242.1 ஆடை (āṭai) — clothing, a garment

Before the new one: say the Tamil for rough, then the Tamil for lukewarm.

You'll want to know: ஆடை

ஆடை — *āṭai* — "clothing, a garment".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

The origin of ஆடை (*āṭai*) is uncertain. DEDR has no entry for it.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *āṭai*
- *Say it:* *āṭai*, once more
- *Say it:* say *āṭai*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for rough, then the Tamil for lukewarm, then say *āṭai* again

Before you move on

What does ஆடை mean? ("Clothing, a garment".) Say it once more.

242.2 கால்சட்டை (kālcaṭṭai) — trousers

Before the new one: say the Tamil for lukewarm, then the Tamil for clothing.

You'll want to know: கால்சட்டை

கால்சட்டை — *kālcaṭṭai* — "trousers".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

கால்சட்டை (*kālcaṭṭai*) is native: *kāl*, "leg" (DEDR 1479), and *caṭṭai*, "jacket, garment" (DEDR 2310): "the leg garment".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *kālcaṭṭai*
- *Say it:* *kālcaṭṭai*, once more
- *Say it:* say *kālcaṭṭai*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for lukewarm, then the Tamil for clothing, then say *kālcaṭṭai* again

Before you move on

What does **கால்சட்டை** mean? ("Trousers".) Say it once more.

242.3 சட்டைப்பை (caṭṭaippai) — a pocket

Before the new one: say the Tamil for clothing, then the Tamil for trousers.

You'll want to know: சட்டைப்பை

சட்டைப்பை — *caṭṭaippai* — "a pocket".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

சட்டைப்பை (*caṭṭaippai*) is native: *caṭṭai*, "shirt" (DEDR 2310), and *pai*, "bag" (DEDR 4450): "the shirt bag".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *caṭṭaippai*
- *Say it:* *caṭṭaippai*, once more
- *Say it:* say *caṭṭaippai*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for clothing, then the Tamil for trousers, then say *caṭṭaippai* again

Before you move on

What does **சட்டைப்பை** mean? ("A pocket".) Say it once more.

242.4 பொத்தான் (pottāṉ) — a button

Before the new one: say the Tamil for trousers, then the Tamil for a pocket.

You'll want to know: பொத்தான்

பொத்தான் — *pottāṉ* — "a button".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

பொத்தான் (*pottāṉ*) is a loan from Portuguese *botão*, "button".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *pottāṉ*
- *Say it:* *pottāṉ*, once more
- *Say it:* say *pottāṉ*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for trousers, then the Tamil for a pocket, then say *pottāṉ* again

Before you move on

What does பொத்தான் mean? ("A button".) Say it once more.

242.5 ரவிக்கை (ravikkai) — a blouse (worn with a sari)

Before the new one: say the Tamil for a pocket, then the Tamil for a button.

You'll want to know: ரவிக்கை

ரவிக்கை — *ravikkai* — "a blouse (worn with a sari)".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

ரவிக்கை (*ravikkai*) is native Dravidian. DEDR 5163 lists Kannada *ravike*, "bodice".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: ravikkai*
- *Say it: ravikkai*, once more
- *Say it:* say *ravikkai*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for a pocket, then the Tamil for a button, then say *ravikkai* again

Before you move on

What does ரவிக்கை mean? ("A blouse (worn with a sari)".) Say it once more.

242.6 Words from chapters 234-237 — a first pass

Say the words for a button and a blouse.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- a post office, a city, a country, a capital city, a crossroads
- a direction, north, south, east, west
- a museum, a lane, a harbour, a fort, a palace
- especially, instead, not only, together, carefully

Before you move on

A post office? (அஞ்சலகம், *añcalakam.*) A city? (நகரம், *nakaram.*) A country? (நாடு, *nāṭu.*) A capital city? (தலைநகரம், *talainakaram.*) A crossroads? (நாற்சந்தி, *nāṟcanti.*) A direction? (திசை, *ticai.*) North? (வடக்கு, *vaṭakku.*)

South? (தெற்கு, *terku.*) East? (கிழக்கு, *kiḻakku.*) West? (மேற்கு, *mēṟku.*) A museum? (அருங்காட்சியகம், *aruṅkāṭciyakam.*) A lane? (சந்து, *cantu.*) A harbour? (துறைமுகம், *tuṟaimukam.*) A fort? (கோட்டை, *kōṭṭai.*) A palace? (அரண்மனை, *araṇmaṉai.*) Especially? (குறிப்பாக, *kuṟippāka.*) Instead? (அதற்குப் பதிலாக, *ataṟkup patilāka.*) Not only? (மட்டுமல்லாமல், *maṭṭumallāmal.*) Together? (ஒன்றாக, *oṉṟāka.*) Carefully? (கவனமாக, *kavaṉamāka.*)

242.7 Words from chapters 238-242 — a second pass

Say the words for a colour and a size.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- a colour, a size, weight, healthy, thin
- disappointment, pride, satisfaction, pity, loneliness
- firm, round, square, sharp, wonderful
- ordinary, rare, equal, rough, lukewarm
- clothing, trousers, a pocket, a button, a blouse

Before you move on

A colour? (நிறம், *niṟam.*) A size? (அளவு, *aḷavu.*) Weight? (எடை, *eṭai.*) Healthy? (ஆரோக்கியமான, *ārōkkiyamāṉa.*) Thin? (ஒல்லியான, *olliyāṉa.*) Disappointment? (ஏமாற்றம், *ēmāṟṟam.*) Pride? (பெருமை, *perumai.*) Satisfaction? (திருப்தி, *tirupti.*) Pity? (இரக்கம், *irakkam.*) Loneliness? (தனிமை, *taṉimai.*) Firm? (உறுதியான, *uṟutiyāṉa.*) Round? (வட்டமான, *vaṭṭamāṉa.*) Square? (சதுரமான, *caturamāṉa.*) Sharp? (கூர்மையான, *kūrmaiyāṉa.*) Wonderful? (அருமையான, *arumaiyāṉa.*) Ordinary? (சாதாரணமான, *cātāraṇamāṉa.*) Rare? (அபூர்வமான, *apūrvamāṉa.*) Equal? (சமமான, *camamāṉa.*)

Rough? (கரடுமுரடான, *karaṭumuraṭāṉa.*) Lukewarm? (வெதுவெதுப்பான, *vetuvetuppāṉa.*) Clothing? (ஆடை, *āṭai.*) Trousers? (கால்சட்டை, *kālcaṭṭai.*) A pocket? (சட்டைப்பை, *caṭṭaippai.*) A button? (பொத்தான், *pottāṉ.*) A blouse? (ரவிக்கை, *ravikkai.*)

Chapter 243

Wheat, Potato, Aubergine, Fragrance, Cucumber

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say wheat, a potato, an aubergine, a fragrance and a cucumber.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 243: I can say wheat, a potato, an aubergine, a fragrance and a cucumber.

243.1 கோதுமை (kōtumai) — wheat

Before the new one: say the Tamil for a button, then the Tamil for a blouse (worn with a sari).

You'll want to know: கோதுமை

கோதுமை — *kōtumai* — "wheat".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

கோதுமை (*kōtumai*) is a loan from Sanskrit *godhūma*, "wheat" (CDIAL 4287).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: kōtumai*
- *Say it: kōtumai*, once more
- *Say it:* say *kōtumai*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for a button, then the Tamil for a blouse (worn with a sari), then say *kōtumai* again

Before you move on

What does கோதுமை mean? ("Wheat".) Say it once more.

243.2 உருளைக்கிழங்கு (uruḷaikkiḻaṅku) — a potato

Before the new one: say the Tamil for a blouse (worn with a sari), then the Tamil for wheat.

You'll want to know: உருளைக்கிழங்கு

உருளைக்கிழங்கு — *uruḷaikkiḻaṅku* — "a potato".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

உருளைக்கிழங்கு (*uruḷaikkiḻaṅku*) is native: *uruḷai*, "anything that rolls, a ball" (DEDR 664), and *kiḻaṅku*, "edible root, tuber" (DEDR 1578, which lists Malayalam kiḻaṅṅu): "the round tuber".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: uruḷaikkiḻaṅku*
- *Say it: uruḷaikkiḻaṅku*, once more
- *Say it:* say *uruḷaikkiḻaṅku*

- *Recall:* say the Tamil for a blouse (worn with a sari), then the Tamil for wheat, then say *uruḷaikkiḻaṅku* again

Before you move on

What does **உருளைக்கிழங்கு** mean? ("A potato".) Say it once more.

243.3 கத்தரிக்காய் (kattarikkāy) — an aubergine, a brinjal

Before the new one: say the Tamil for wheat, then the Tamil for a potato.

You'll want to know: கத்தரிக்காய்

கத்தரிக்காய் — *kattarikkāy* — "an aubergine, a brinjal".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

கத்தரிக்காய் (*kattarikkāy*) is *kattari*, the name of the plant, and native *kāy*, "unripe fruit, vegetable" (DEDR 1459, which compares Indo-Aryan **kacca*, "raw"). The origin of *kattari* is uncertain; DEDR has no entry for it.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: kattarikkāy*
- *Say it: kattarikkāy*, once more
- *Say it:* say *kattarikkāy*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for wheat, then the Tamil for a potato, then say *kattarikkāy* again

Before you move on

What does **கத்தரிக்காய்** mean? ("An aubergine, a brinjal".) Say it once more.

243.4 வாசனை (vācaṉai) — a fragrance, a smell

Before the new one: say the Tamil for a potato, then the Tamil for an aubergine.

You'll want to know: வாசனை

வாசனை — *vācaṉai* — "a fragrance, a smell".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

வாசனை (*vācaṉai*) is a loan from Sanskrit *vāsanā*, "scenting", built on *vāsa*, "perfume" (CDIAL 11592).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: vācaṉai*
- *Say it: vācaṉai*, once more
- *Say it:* say *vācaṉai*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for a potato, then the Tamil for an aubergine, then say *vācaṉai* again

Before you move on

What does **வாசனை** mean? ("A fragrance, a smell".) Say it once more.

243.5 வெள்ளரிக்காய் (veḷḷarikkāy) — a cucumber

Before the new one: say the Tamil for an aubergine, then the Tamil for a fragrance.

You'll want to know: வெள்ளரிக்காய்

வெள்ளரிக்காய் — *veḷḷarikkāy* — "a cucumber".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

வெள்ளரிக்காய் (*veḷḷarikkāy*) is native: *veḷḷari*, "cucumber" (DEDR 5504, which lists Malayalam veḷḷari), and *kāy*, "unripe fruit, vegetable" (DEDR 1459, which compares Indo-Aryan **kacca*, "raw").

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: veḷḷarikkāy*
- *Say it: veḷḷarikkāy*, once more
- *Say it:* say *veḷḷarikkāy*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for an aubergine, then the Tamil for a fragrance, then say *veḷḷarikkāy* again

Before you move on

What does வெள்ளரிக்காய் mean? ("A cucumber".) Say it once more.

Chapter 244

Postage stamp, Parcel, Form, Document, Passport

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say a postage stamp, a parcel, a form, a document and a passport.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 244: I can say a postage stamp, a parcel, a form, a document and a passport.

244.1 அஞ்சல் தலை (añcal talai) — a postage stamp

Before the new one: say the Tamil for a fragrance, then the Tamil for a cucumber.

You'll want to know: அஞ்சல் தலை

அஞ்சல் தலை — *añcal talai* — "a postage stamp".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

அஞ்சல் தலை (*añcal talai*) is native: *añcal*, "letter post" (DEDR 54), and *talai*, "head" (DEDR 3103). Early stamps carried the ruler's head, so a stamp became "the post head".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: añcal talai*
- *Say it: añcal talai*, once more
- *Say it:* say *añcal talai*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for a fragrance, then the Tamil for a cucumber, then say *añcal talai* again

Before you move on

What does அஞ்சல் தலை mean? ("A postage stamp".) Say it once more.

244.2 பொட்டலம் (poṭṭalam) — a parcel, a packet

Before the new one: say the Tamil for a cucumber, then the Tamil for a postage stamp.

You'll want to know: பொட்டலம்

பொட்டலம் — *poṭṭalam* — "a parcel, a packet".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

பொட்டலம் (*poṭṭalam*) probably comes from Prakrit *poṭṭala*, "bundle" (CDIAL 8396), also in late Sanskrit. DEDR has no entry for it.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: poṭṭalam*
- *Say it: poṭṭalam*, once more
- *Say it:* say *poṭṭalam*

- *Recall:* say the Tamil for a cucumber, then the Tamil for a postage stamp, then say *poṭṭalam* again

Before you move on

What does பொட்டலம் mean? (“A parcel, a packet”.) Say it once more.

244.3 படிவம் (paṭivam) — a form (to fill in)

Before the new one: say the Tamil for a postage stamp, then the Tamil for a parcel.

You’ll want to know: படிவம்

படிவம் — *paṭivam* — “a form (to fill in)”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

The origin of படிவம் (*paṭivam*) is uncertain. It is a modern word for an official form, and DEDR has no entry for it.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: paṭivam*
- *Say it: paṭivam*, once more
- *Say it:* say *paṭivam*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for a postage stamp, then the Tamil for a parcel, then say *paṭivam* again

Before you move on

What does படிவம் mean? (“A form (to fill in)”.) Say it once more.

244.4 ஆவணம் (āvaṇam) — a document

Before the new one: say the Tamil for a parcel, then the Tamil for a form.

You'll want to know: ஆவணம்

ஆவணம் — *āvaṇam* — "a document".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

The origin of **ஆவணம்** (*āvaṇam*) is uncertain. It is an old word for a written deed, and DEDR has no entry for it.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *āvaṇam*
- *Say it:* *āvaṇam*, once more
- *Say it:* say *āvaṇam*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for a parcel, then the Tamil for a form, then say *āvaṇam* again

Before you move on

What does **ஆவணம்** mean? ("A document".) Say it once more.

244.5 கடவுச்சீட்டு (kaṭavuccīṭṭu) — a passport

Before the new one: say the Tamil for a form, then the Tamil for a document.

You'll want to know: கடவுச்சீட்டு

கடவுச்சீட்டு — *kaṭavuccīṭṭu* — "a passport".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

கடவுச்சீட்டு (*kaṭavuccīṭṭu*) is a modern coinage: native *kaṭavu*, "passing, way through", from *kaṭa*, "to cross" (DEDR 1109), and *cīṭṭu*, "ticket, slip": "the crossing ticket". The origin of *cīṭṭu* is uncertain.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: kaṭavuccīṭṭu*
- *Say it: kaṭavuccīṭṭu*, once more
- *Say it:* say *kaṭavuccīṭṭu*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for a form, then the Tamil for a document, then say *kaṭavuccīṭṭu* again

Before you move on

What does கடவுச்சீட்டு mean? ("A passport".) Say it once more.

Chapter 245

Load, Voice, Conversation, Man, Woman

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say a load, a voice, a conversation, a man and a woman.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 245: I can say a load, a voice, a conversation, a man and a woman.*

245.1 சுமை (cumai) — a load, a burden

Before the new one: say the Tamil for a document, then the Tamil for a passport.

You'll want to know: சுமை

சுமை — *cumai* — "a load, a burden".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

சுமை (*cumai*) is native Dravidian. DEDR 2677 lists Malayalam *cuma*, "burden, load". It is the noun of *cuma*, "to bear, to carry a load".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: cumai*
- *Say it: cumai*, once more
- *Say it:* say *cumai*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for a document, then the Tamil for a passport, then say *cumai* again

Before you move on

What does சுமை mean? (“A load, a burden”.) Say it once more.

245.2 குரல் (kural) — a voice

Before the new one: say the Tamil for a passport, then the Tamil for a load.

You’ll want to know: குரல்

குரல் — *kural* — “a voice”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

குரல் (*kural*) is native Dravidian. DEDR 1774 lists Malayalam *kural*, “voice” and Kannada *koral*.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: kural*
- *Say it: kural*, once more
- *Say it:* say *kural*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for a passport, then the Tamil for a load, then say *kural* again

Before you move on

What does குரல் mean? (“A voice”.) Say it once more.

245.3 உரையாடல் (uraiyāṭal) — a conversation

Before the new one: say the Tamil for a load, then the Tamil for a voice.

You’ll want to know: உரையாடல்

உரையாடல் — *uraiyāṭal* — “a conversation”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

உரையாடல் (*uraiyāṭal*) is native: *urai*, “to speak, to tell” (DEDR 648), and *āṭal*, “doing, saying” (DEDR 347): “the saying back and forth”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: uraiyāṭal*
- *Say it: uraiyāṭal*, once more
- *Say it:* say *uraiyāṭal*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for a load, then the Tamil for a voice, then say *uraiyāṭal* again

Before you move on

What does உரையாடல் mean? (“A conversation”.) Say it once more.

245.4 ஆண் (āṇ) — a man, male

Before the new one: say the Tamil for a voice, then the Tamil for a conversation.

You'll want to know: ஆண்

ஆண் — *āṇ* — "a man, male".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

ஆண் (*āṇ*) is native Dravidian. DEDR 399 lists Malayalam *āṇ*, "male" and Kannada *āṇ*. The same entry holds the everyday word for "person".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *āṇ*
- *Say it:* *āṇ*, once more
- *Say it:* say *āṇ*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for a voice, then the Tamil for a conversation, then say *āṇ* again

Before you move on

What does ஆண் mean? ("A man, male".) Say it once more.

245.5 பெண் (peṇ) — a woman, female

Before the new one: say the Tamil for a conversation, then the Tamil for a man.

You'll want to know: பெண்

பெண் — *peṇ* — "a woman, female".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

பெண் (*peṇ*) is native Dravidian. DEDR 4395 lists Malayalam *peṇ*, "girl, woman" and Kannada *peṇ*. The entry compares Sanskrit *pṛṇākā*, "young female (of deer)".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: peṇ*
- *Say it: peṇ*, once more
- *Say it:* say *peṇ*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for a conversation, then the Tamil for a man, then say *peṇ* again

Before you move on

What does பெண் mean? ("A woman, female".) Say it once more.

Chapter 246

Celebration, Firecrackers, Culture, Habit, Tradition

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say celebration, firecrackers, culture, a habit and tradition.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 246: I can say celebration, firecrackers, culture, a habit and tradition.*

246.1 கொண்டாட்டம் (koṇṭāṭṭam) — celebration, festivities

Before the new one: say the Tamil for a man, then the Tamil for a woman.

You'll want to know: கொண்டாட்டம்

கொண்டாட்டம் — *koṇṭāṭṭam* — "celebration, festivities".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

கொண்டாட்டம் (*koṇṭāṭṭam*) is the noun of *koṇṭāṭu*, "to celebrate", usually analysed as native *koṇṭu*, "having taken", from *koḷ* (DEDR 2151), and *āṭu*, "to dance, to play" (DEDR 347).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: koṇṭāṭṭam*
- *Say it: koṇṭāṭṭam*, once more
- *Say it:* say *koṇṭāṭṭam*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for a man, then the Tamil for a woman, then say *koṇṭāṭṭam* again

Before you move on

What does கொண்டாட்டம் mean? ("Celebration, festivities".) Say it once more.

246.2 பட்டாசு (paṭṭācu) — firecrackers

Before the new one: say the Tamil for a woman, then the Tamil for celebration.

You'll want to know: பட்டாசு

பட்டாசு — *paṭṭācu* — "firecrackers".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

The origin of பட்டாசு (*paṭṭācu*) is uncertain. DEDR has no entry for it; it is often compared with Hindustani *paṭākhā*, "firecracker".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: paṭṭācu*
- *Say it: paṭṭācu*, once more
- *Say it:* say *paṭṭācu*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for a woman, then the Tamil for celebration, then say *paṭṭācu* again

Before you move on

What does பட்டாசு mean? ("Firecrackers".) Say it once more.

246.3 கலாச்சாரம் (kalāccāram) — culture

Before the new one: say the Tamil for celebration, then the Tamil for firecrackers.

You'll want to know: கலாச்சாரம்

கலாச்சாரம் — *kalāccāram* — "culture".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

கலாச்சாரம் (*kalāccāram*) is a modern coinage from Sanskrit *kalā*, "art" (CDIAL 2927), and *ācāra*, "conduct, custom" (CDIAL 1071). Which way *kalā* travelled is debated: CDIAL takes it from Dravidian, while DEDR files the native Tamil word for "art" under the verb "to learn" (DEDR 1297) and only compares *kalā*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: kalāccāram*
- *Say it: kalāccāram*, once more
- *Say it:* say *kalāccāram*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for celebration, then the Tamil for firecrackers, then say *kalāccāram* again

Before you move on

What does **கலாச்சாரம்** mean? ("Culture".) Say it once more.

246.4 பழக்கம் (paḻakkam) — a habit, a custom

Before the new one: say the Tamil for firecrackers, then the Tamil for culture.

You'll want to know: பழக்கம்

பழக்கம் — *paḻakkam* — "a habit, a custom".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

பழக்கம் (*paḻakkam*) is native Dravidian. DEDR 4000 lists Malayalam *paḻakuka*, "to be accustomed". It is the noun of *paḻaku*, "to become used to".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: paḻakkam*
- *Say it: paḻakkam*, once more
- *Say it:* say *paḻakkam*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for firecrackers, then the Tamil for culture, then say *paḻakkam* again

Before you move on

What does பழக்கம் mean? ("A habit, a custom".) Say it once more.

246.5 பாரம்பரியம் (pārampariyam) — tradition, heritage

Before the new one: say the Tamil for culture, then the Tamil for a habit.

You'll want to know: பாரம்பரியம்

பாரம்பரியம் — *pārampariyam* — "tradition, heritage".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

பாரம்பரியம் (*pārampariyam*) is a well-established loan from Sanskrit *pāramparya*, "succession, handing down", built on *paramparā*, "an unbroken series".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *pārampariyam*
- *Say it:* *pārampariyam*, once more
- *Say it:* say *pārampariyam*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for culture, then the Tamil for a habit, then say *pārampariyam* again

Before you move on

What does பாரம்பரியம் mean? ("Tradition, heritage".) Say it once more.

Chapter 247

Sparrow, Eagle, Puppy, Squirrel, Worm

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say a sparrow, an eagle, a puppy, a squirrel and a worm.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 247: I can say a sparrow, an eagle, a puppy, a squirrel and a worm.*

247.1 குருவி (kuruvi) — a sparrow

> Before the new one: say the Tamil for a habit, then the Tamil for tradition.

You'll want to know: குருவி

குருவி — *kuruvi* — "a sparrow".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

குருவி (*kuruvi*) is native Dravidian. DEDR 1793 lists Malayalam *kuruvi*, "sparrow" and Kannada *gubbi*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: kuruvi*
- *Say it: kuruvi*, once more
- *Say it:* say *kuruvi*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for a habit, then the Tamil for tradition, then say *kuruvi* again

Before you move on

What does குருவி mean? ("A sparrow".) Say it once more.

247.2 கழுகு (ka̲luku) — an eagle

Before the new one: say the Tamil for tradition, then the Tamil for a sparrow.

You'll want to know: கழுகு

கழுகு — *ka̲luku* — "an eagle".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

கழுகு (*ka̲luku*) is native Dravidian. DEDR 1362 lists Malayalam *ka̲luku*, "eagle, vulture".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: ka̲luku*
- *Say it: ka̲luku*, once more
- *Say it:* say *ka̲luku*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for tradition, then the Tamil for a sparrow, then say *ka̲luku* again

Before you move on

What does கழுகு mean? (“An eagle”.) Say it once more.

247.3 நாய்க்குட்டி (nāykkuṭṭi) — a puppy

Before the new one: say the Tamil for a sparrow, then the Tamil for an eagle.

You’ll want to know: நாய்க்குட்டி

நாய்க்குட்டி — *nāykkuṭṭi* — “a puppy”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

நாய்க்குட்டி (*nāykkuṭṭi*) is native: *nāy*, “dog” (DEDR 3650), and *kuṭṭi*, “the young of an animal” (DEDR 1670, which lists Malayalam kuṭṭi).

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: nāykkuṭṭi*
- *Say it: nāykkuṭṭi*, once more
- *Say it:* say *nāykkuṭṭi*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for a sparrow, then the Tamil for an eagle, then say *nāykkuṭṭi* again

Before you move on

What does நாய்க்குட்டி mean? (“A puppy”.) Say it once more.

247.4 அணில் (aṇil) — a squirrel

Before the new one: say the Tamil for an eagle, then the Tamil for a puppy.

You'll want to know: அணில்

அணில் — *aṇil* — "a squirrel".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

அணில் (*aṇil*) is native Dravidian. DEDR 2315 lists Malayalam *aṇil*, "squirrel" and Kannada *aṇil*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: aṇil*
- *Say it: aṇil*, once more
- *Say it:* say *aṇil*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for an eagle, then the Tamil for a puppy, then say *aṇil* again

Before you move on

What does அணில் mean? ("A squirrel".) Say it once more.

247.5 புழு (pu̲lu) — a worm

Before the new one: say the Tamil for a puppy, then the Tamil for a squirrel.

You'll want to know: புழு

புழு — *pu̲lu* — "a worm".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

புழு (*pu̲lu*) is native Dravidian. DEDR 4312 lists Malayalam *pu̲lu*, "worm, maggot" and Kannada *pu̲lu*. The entry compares Sanskrit *pīlu*, "worm" (CDIAL 8240).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: pu̲lu*
- *Say it: pu̲lu*, once more
- *Say it:* say *pu̲lu*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for a puppy, then the Tamil for a squirrel, then say *pu̲lu* again

Before you move on

What does புழு mean? ("A worm".) Say it once more.

Chapter 248

Drought, Earthquake, Nature, Rock, Fire

Modes: **voice** (7) **Hands-free start:** all 7 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say a drought, an earthquake, nature, a rock and fire.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 248: I can say a drought, an earthquake, nature, a rock and fire.

248.1 வறட்சி (vaṟaṭci) — a drought

Before the new one: say the Tamil for a squirrel, then the Tamil for a worm.

You'll want to know: வறட்சி

வறட்சி — *vaṟaṭci* — "a drought".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

வறட்சி (*vaṟaṭci*) is native Dravidian. DEDR 5320 lists Malayalam *vaṟu*, "dry" and Telugu *vaṟapu*, "drought". It comes from *vaṟa*, "to dry up".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: va̲ṟaṭci*
- *Say it: va̲ṟaṭci*, once more
- *Say it:* say *va̲ṟaṭci*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for a squirrel, then the Tamil for a worm, then say *va̲ṟaṭci* again

Before you move on

What does **வறட்சி** mean? (“A drought”.) Say it once more.

248.2 நிலநடுக்கம் (nilanaṭukkam) — an earthquake

Before the new one: say the Tamil for a worm, then the Tamil for a drought.

You’ll want to know: நிலநடுக்கம்

நிலநடுக்கம் — *nilanaṭukkam* — “an earthquake”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

நிலநடுக்கம் (*nilanaṭukkam*) is native: *nilam*, “ground, land” (DEDR 3676, which lists Malayalam nilam), and *naṭukkam*, “trembling” (DEDR 3585): “the shaking of the ground”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: nilanaṭukkam*
- *Say it: nilanaṭukkam*, once more
- *Say it:* say *nilanaṭukkam*

- *Recall:* say the Tamil for a worm, then the Tamil for a drought, then say *nilanaṭukkam* again

Before you move on

What does நிலநடுக்கம் mean? ("An earthquake".) Say it once more.

248.3 இயற்கை (iya̲rkai) — nature

Before the new one: say the Tamil for a drought, then the Tamil for an earthquake.

You'll want to know: இயற்கை

இயற்கை — *iya̲rkai* — "nature".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

இயற்கை (*iya̲rkai*) is native Dravidian, built on *iyal*, "to be fitting; nature, quality" (DEDR 471), which gives Malayalam iyaluka.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: iya̲rkai*
- *Say it: iya̲rkai*, once more
- *Say it:* say *iya̲rkai*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for a drought, then the Tamil for an earthquake, then say *iya̲rkai* again

Before you move on

What does இயற்கை mean? ("Nature".) Say it once more.

248.4 பாறை (pāṟai) — a rock

Before the new one: say the Tamil for an earthquake, then the Tamil for nature.

You'll want to know: பாறை

பாறை — *pāṟai* — "a rock".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

பாறை (*pāṟai*) is native Dravidian. DEDR 4121 lists Malayalam *pāṟa*, "rock".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: pāṟai*
- *Say it: pāṟai*, once more
- *Say it:* say *pāṟai*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for an earthquake, then the Tamil for nature, then say *pāṟai* again

Before you move on

What does பாறை mean? ("A rock".) Say it once more.

248.5 நெருப்பு (neruppu) — fire

Before the new one: say the Tamil for nature, then the Tamil for a rock.

You'll want to know: நெருப்பு

நெருப்பு — *neruppu* — "fire".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

நெருப்பு (*neruppu*) is native Dravidian. DEDR 2929 lists Malayalam *nerippu*, "fire" and Telugu *nippu*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: neruppu*
- *Say it: neruppu*, once more
- *Say it:* say *neruppu*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for nature, then the Tamil for a rock, then say *neruppu* again

Before you move on

What does நெருப்பு mean? ("Fire".) Say it once more.

248.6 Words from chapters 243-245 — a first pass

Say the words for a rock and fire.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- wheat, a potato, an aubergine, a fragrance, a cucumber
- a postage stamp, a parcel, a form, a document, a passport
- a load, a voice, a conversation, a man, a woman

Before you move on

Wheat? (கோதுமை, *kōtumai*.) A potato? (உருளைக்கிழங்கு, *uruḷaikkiḻaṅku*.) An aubergine? (கத்தரிக்காய், *kattarikkāy*.) A

fragrance? (வாசனை, *vācaṉai.*) A cucumber? (வெள்ளரிக்காய், *veḷḷarikkāy.*) A postage stamp? (அஞ்சல் தலை, *añcal talai.*) A parcel? (பொட்டலம், *poṭṭalam.*) A form? (படிவம், *paṭivam.*) A document? (ஆவணம், *āvaṇam.*) A passport? (கடவுச்சீட்டு, *kaṭavuccīṭṭu.*) A load? (சுமை, *cumai.*) A voice? (குரல், *kural.*) A conversation? (உரையாடல், *uraiyāṭal.*) A man? (ஆண், *āṇ.*) A woman? (பெண், *peṇ.*)

248.7 Words from chapters 246-248 — a second pass

Say the words for celebration and firecrackers.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- celebration, firecrackers, culture, a habit, tradition
- a sparrow, an eagle, a puppy, a squirrel, a worm
- a drought, an earthquake, nature, a rock, fire

Before you move on

Celebration? (கொண்டாட்டம், *koṇṭāṭṭam.*) Firecrackers? (பட்டாசு, *paṭṭācu.*) Culture? (கலாச்சாரம், *kalāccāram.*) A habit? (பழக்கம், *paḻakkam.*) Tradition? (பாரம்பரியம், *pārampariyam.*) A sparrow? (குருவி, *kuruvi.*) An eagle? (கழுகு, *kaḻuku.*) A puppy? (நாய்க்குட்டி, *nāykkuṭṭi.*) A squirrel? (அணில், *aṇil.*) A worm? (புழு, *puḻu.*) A drought? (வறட்சி, *vaṟaṭci.*) An earthquake? (நிலநடுக்கம், *nilanaṭukkam.*) Nature? (இயற்கை, *iyaṟkai.*) A rock? (பாறை, *pāṟai.*) Fire? (நெருப்பு, *neruppu.*)

Chapter 249

Game, Football, Cricket, Chess, Competition

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say a game, football, cricket, chess and a competition.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 249: I can say a game, football, cricket, chess and a competition.

249.1 விளையாட்டு (viḷaiyāṭṭu) — a game, a sport

Before the new one: say the Tamil for a rock, then the Tamil for fire.

You'll want to know: விளையாட்டு

விளையாட்டு — *viḷaiyāṭṭu* — "a game, a sport".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

விளையாட்டு (*viḷaiyāṭṭu*) is native Dravidian. DEDR 5438 lists Malayalam *viḷay-āṭṭu*, "play, sport". It is the noun of *viḷaiyāṭu*, "to play". DEDR compares, with a query, Sanskrit *vilāsa*, "play".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: viḷaiyāṭṭu*
- *Say it: viḷaiyāṭṭu*, once more
- *Say it:* say *viḷaiyāṭṭu*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for a rock, then the Tamil for fire, then say *viḷaiyāṭṭu* again

Before you move on

What does விளையாட்டு mean? (“A game, a sport”.) Say it once more.

249.2 கால்பந்து (kālpantu) — football

Before the new one: say the Tamil for fire, then the Tamil for a game.

You’ll want to know: கால்பந்து

கால்பந்து — *kālpantu* — “football”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

கால்பந்து (*kālpantu*) is native: *kāl*, “foot, leg” (DEDR 1479), and *pantu*, “ball” (DEDR 3925): “foot ball”, modelled on the English.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: kālpantu*
- *Say it: kālpantu*, once more
- *Say it:* say *kālpantu*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for fire, then the Tamil for a game, then say *kālpantu* again

Before you move on

What does **கால்பந்து** mean? (“Football”.) Say it once more.

249.3 கிரிக்கெட் (kiriket) — cricket

Before the new one: say the Tamil for a game, then the Tamil for football.

You’ll want to know: கிரிக்கெட்

கிரிக்கெட் — *kiriket* — “cricket”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

கிரிக்கெட் (*kiriket*) is a loan from English *cricket*, with the vowels Tamil places between consonants.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: kiriket*
- *Say it: kiriket*, once more
- *Say it:* say *kiriket*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for a game, then the Tamil for football, then say *kiriket* again

Before you move on

What does **கிரிக்கெட்** mean? (“Cricket”.) Say it once more.

249.4 சதுரங்கம் (cataraṅkam) — chess

Before the new one: say the Tamil for football, then the Tamil for cricket.

You'll want to know: சதுரங்கம்

சதுரங்கம் — *catarańkam* — "chess".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

சதுரங்கம் (*catarańkam*) is a loan from Sanskrit *caturańga*, "having four parts", a name for chess after the four arms of an army (CDIAL 4596).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: catarańkam*
- *Say it: catarańkam*, once more
- *Say it:* say *catarańkam*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for football, then the Tamil for cricket, then say *catarańkam* again

Before you move on

What does **சதுரங்கம்** mean? ("Chess".) Say it once more.

249.5 போட்டி (pōṭṭi) — a competition, a match

Before the new one: say the Tamil for cricket, then the Tamil for chess.

You'll want to know: போட்டி

போட்டி — *pōṭṭi* — "a competition, a match".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

போட்டி (*pōṭṭi*) is native Dravidian. DEDR 4583 lists Kannada *pōṭi*, "competition" and Telugu *pōṭi*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *pōṭṭi*
- *Say it:* *pōṭṭi*, once more
- *Say it:* say *pōṭṭi*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for cricket, then the Tamil for chess, then say *pōṭṭi* again

Before you move on

What does போட்டி mean? ("A competition, a match".) Say it once more.

Chapter 250

Tent, Swing, Banyan tree, Pair of scales, Straw

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say a tent, a swing, a banyan tree, a pair of scales and straw.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 250: I can say a tent, a swing, a banyan tree, a pair of scales and straw.*

250.1 கூடாரம் (kūṭāram) — a tent

Before the new one: say the Tamil for chess, then the Tamil for a competition.

You'll want to know: கூடாரம்

கூடாரம் — *kūṭāram* — "a tent".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

கூடாரம் (*kūṭāram*) is a South Indian word: DEDR 1881 lists Malayalam kūṭāram, Kannada guḍāra and Telugu guḍāramu. DEDR also compares Sanskrit (lexicons) *kuṭaru* and Prakrit *guḍḍara*, "tent", so which way the word travelled is uncertain.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: kūṭāram*
- *Say it: kūṭāram*, once more
- *Say it:* say *kūṭāram*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for chess, then the Tamil for a competition, then say *kūṭāram* again

Before you move on

What does கூடாரம் mean? ("A tent".) Say it once more.

250.2 ஊஞ்சல் (ūñcal) — a swing

Before the new one: say the Tamil for a competition, then the Tamil for a tent.

You'll want to know: ஊஞ்சல்

ஊஞ்சல் — *ūñcal* — "a swing".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

ஊஞ்சல் (*ūñcal*) is native Dravidian. DEDR 731 lists Malayalam *ūñcal*, "swing" and Kannada *uyyāle*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: ūñcal*
- *Say it: ūñcal*, once more
- *Say it:* say *ūñcal*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for a competition, then the Tamil for a tent, then say *ūñcal* again

Before you move on

What does **ஊஞ்சல்** mean? ("A swing".) Say it once more.

250.3 ஆலமரம் (ālamaram) — a banyan tree

Before the new one: say the Tamil for a tent, then the Tamil for a swing.

You'll want to know: ஆலமரம்

ஆலமரம் — *ālamaram* — "a banyan tree".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

ஆலமரம் (*ālamaram*) is native: *āl*, "banyan" (DEDR 382, which lists Malayalam āl and Kannada āla), and *maram*, "tree".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *ālamaram*
- *Say it:* *ālamaram*, once more
- *Say it:* say *ālamaram*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for a tent, then the Tamil for a swing, then say *ālamaram* again

Before you move on

What does **ஆலமரம்** mean? ("A banyan tree".) Say it once more.

250.4 தராசு (tarācu) — a pair of scales, a balance

Before the new one: say the Tamil for a swing, then the Tamil for a banyan tree.

You'll want to know: தராசு

தராசு — *tarācu* — "a pair of scales, a balance".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

தராசு (*tarācu*) is a loan from Persian *tarāzū*, "balance, scales", which reached Tamil through Hindustani.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: tarācu*
- *Say it: tarācu*, once more
- *Say it:* say *tarācu*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for a swing, then the Tamil for a banyan tree, then say *tarācu* again

Before you move on

What does **தராசு** mean? ("A pair of scales, a balance".) Say it once more.

250.5 வைக்கோல் (vaikkōl) — straw, hay

Before the new one: say the Tamil for a banyan tree, then the Tamil for a pair of scales.

You'll want to know: வைக்கோல்

வைக்கோல் — *vaikkōl* — "straw, hay".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

வைக்கோல் (*vaikkōl*) is native Dravidian. DEDR 5553 lists Malayalam *vai-kkōl*, "straw". The first part, *vai*, is itself "paddy straw".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: vaikkōl*
- *Say it: vaikkōl*, once more
- *Say it:* say *vaikkōl*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for a banyan tree, then the Tamil for a pair of scales, then say *vaikkōl* again

Before you move on

What does **வைக்கோல்** mean? ("Straw, hay".) Say it once more.

Chapter 251

Total, List, Thing, Sale, Employer

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say the total, a list, a thing, a sale and an employer.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 251: I can say the total, a list, a thing, a sale and an employer.*

251.1 மொத்தம் (mottam) — the total

> Before the new one: say the Tamil for a pair of scales, then the Tamil for straw.

You'll want to know: மொத்தம்

மொத்தம் — *mottam* — "the total".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

மொத்தம் (*mottam*) is native Dravidian. DEDR 5119 lists Malayalam *mottam*, "whole, total" and Telugu *mottamu*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: mottam*
- *Say it: mottam*, once more
- *Say it:* say *mottam*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for a pair of scales, then the Tamil for straw, then say *mottam* again

Before you move on

What does மொத்தம் mean? ("The total".) Say it once more.

251.2 பட்டியல் (paṭṭiyal) — a list

Before the new one: say the Tamil for straw, then the Tamil for the total.

You'll want to know: பட்டியல்

பட்டியல் — *paṭṭiyal* — "a list".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

The origin of பட்டியல் (*paṭṭiyal*) is uncertain. DEDR has no entry for it in this sense; one account links it to Sanskrit *paṭṭa*, "slab, tablet" (CDIAL 7699).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: paṭṭiyal*
- *Say it: paṭṭiyal*, once more
- *Say it:* say *paṭṭiyal*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for straw, then the Tamil for the total, then say *paṭṭiyal* again

Before you move on

What does பட்டியல் mean? ("A list".) Say it once more.

251.3 பொருள் (poruḷ) — a thing, an item

Before the new one: say the Tamil for the total, then the Tamil for a list.

You'll want to know: பொருள்

பொருள் — *poruḷ* — "a thing, an item".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

பொருள் (*poruḷ*) is native Dravidian. DEDR 4544 lists Malayalam *poruḷ*, "riches, meaning".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: poruḷ*
- *Say it: poruḷ*, once more
- *Say it:* say *poruḷ*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for the total, then the Tamil for a list, then say *poruḷ* again

Before you move on

What does பொருள் mean? ("A thing, an item".) Say it once more.

251.4 விற்பனை (vi̱rpa̱nai) — a sale

Before the new one: say the Tamil for a list, then the Tamil for a thing.

You'll want to know: விற்பனை

விற்பனை — *viṟpaṉai* — "a sale".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

விற்பனை (*viṟpaṉai*) is native Dravidian. DEDR 5421 lists Malayalam *vilpana*, "sale" and Kannada *bil*, "to sell". It comes from *vil*, "to sell".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: viṟpaṉai*
- *Say it: viṟpaṉai*, once more
- *Say it:* say *viṟpaṉai*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for a list, then the Tamil for a thing, then say *viṟpaṉai* again

Before you move on

What does விற்பனை mean? ("A sale".) Say it once more.

251.5 முதலாளி (mutalāḷi) — an employer, a boss

Before the new one: say the Tamil for a thing, then the Tamil for a sale.

You'll want to know: முதலாளி

முதலாளி — *mutalāḷi* — "an employer, a boss".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

முதலாளி (*mutalāḷi*) is native: *mutal*, "capital, principal sum" (DEDR 4950), and *āḷi*, "one who holds" (DEDR 399): "the holder of the capital".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: mutalāḷi*
- *Say it: mutalāḷi*, once more
- *Say it:* say *mutalāḷi*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for a thing, then the Tamil for a sale, then say *mutalāḷi* again

Before you move on

What does முதலாளி mean? ("An employer, a boss".) Say it once more.

Chapter 252

Mark, University, Education, Mathematics, Science

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say a mark, a university, education, mathematics and science.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 252: I can say a mark, a university, education, mathematics and science.

252.1 மதிப்பெண் (matippeṇ) — a mark, a score

Before the new one: say the Tamil for a sale, then the Tamil for an employer.

You'll want to know: மதிப்பெண்

மதிப்பெண் — *matippeṇ* — "a mark, a score".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

மதிப்பெண் (*matippeṇ*) is *matippu*, "value, worth", and native *eṇ*, "number" (DEDR 793): "the value number". The origin of *matippu* is uncertain.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: matippeṇ*
- *Say it: matippeṇ*, once more
- *Say it:* say *matippeṇ*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for a sale, then the Tamil for an employer, then say *matippeṇ* again

Before you move on

What does மதிப்பெண் mean? ("A mark, a score".) Say it once more.

252.2 பல்கலைக்கழகம் (palkalaikkaḻakam) — a university

Before the new one: say the Tamil for an employer, then the Tamil for a mark.

You'll want to know: பல்கலைக்கழகம்

பல்கலைக்கழகம் — *palkalaikkaḻakam* — "a university".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

பல்கலைக்கழகம் (*palkalaikkaḻakam*) is *pal*, "many" (DEDR 3987), *kalai*, "arts and learning", and *kaḻakam*, "assembly, college" (DEDR 1345): "the college of many arts". *Pal* and *kaḻakam* are native. DEDR files *kalai* under *kal*, "to learn" (DEDR 1297), but compares Sanskrit *kalā*, "art"; many treat it as a loan.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: palkalaikkaḻakam*
- *Say it: palkalaikkaḻakam*, once more

- *Say it:* say *palkalaikka̲lakam*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for an employer, then the Tamil for a mark, then say *palkalaikka̲lakam* again

Before you move on

What does பல்கலைக்கழகம் mean? (“A university”.) Say it once more.

252.3 கல்வி (kalvi) — education

Before the new one: say the Tamil for a mark, then the Tamil for a university.

You’ll want to know: கல்வி

கல்வி — *kalvi* — “education”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

கல்வி (*kalvi*) is native Dravidian. DEDR 1297 lists Malayalam *kalkka*, “to learn”. It comes from *kal*, “to learn”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: kalvi*
- *Say it: kalvi*, once more
- *Say it:* say *kalvi*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for a mark, then the Tamil for a university, then say *kalvi* again

Before you move on

What does கல்வி mean? (“Education”.) Say it once more.

252.4 கணிதம் (kaṇitam) — mathematics

Before the new one: say the Tamil for a university, then the Tamil for education.

You'll want to know: கணிதம்

கணிதம் — *kaṇitam* — "mathematics".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

கணிதம் (*kaṇitam*) is a loan from Sanskrit *gaṇita*, "counted, calculated" (CDIAL 3996).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: kaṇitam*
- *Say it: kaṇitam*, once more
- *Say it:* say *kaṇitam*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for a university, then the Tamil for education, then say *kaṇitam* again

Before you move on

What does **கணிதம்** mean? ("Mathematics".) Say it once more.

252.5 அறிவியல் (a̱riviyal) — science

Before the new one: say the Tamil for education, then the Tamil for mathematics.

You'll want to know: அறிவியல்

அறிவியல் — *a̱riviyal* — "science".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

அறிவியல் (*a̲riviyal*) is native: *a̲rivu*, "knowledge" (DEDR 314), and *iyal*, "nature, a field of study" (DEDR 471): "the study of knowledge".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *a̲riviyal*
- *Say it:* *a̲riviyal*, once more
- *Say it:* say *a̲riviyal*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for education, then the Tamil for mathematics, then say *a̲riviyal* again

Before you move on

What does அறிவியல் mean? ("Science".) Say it once more.

Chapter 253

Artist, Officer, Judge, Pension, Certificate

Modes: **voice** (7) **Hands-free start:** all 7 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say an artist, an officer, a judge, a pension and a certificate.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 253: I can say an artist, an officer, a judge, a pension and a certificate.

253.1 கலைஞர் (kalaiñar) — an artist

Before the new one: say the Tamil for mathematics, then the Tamil for science.

You'll want to know: கலைஞர்

கலைஞர் — *kalaiñar* — "an artist".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

கலைஞர் (*kalaiñar*) is *kalai*, "arts and learning", with the respectful ending *-ñar*, "one who". DEDR files *kalai* under *kal*, "to learn" (DEDR 1297), but compares Sanskrit *kalā*, "art"; many treat it as a loan.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: kalaiñar*
- *Say it: kalaiñar*, once more
- *Say it:* say *kalaiñar*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for mathematics, then the Tamil for science, then say *kalaiñar* again

Before you move on

What does **கலைஞர்** mean? ("An artist".) Say it once more.

253.2 அதிகாரி (atikāri) — an officer, an official

Before the new one: say the Tamil for science, then the Tamil for an artist.

You'll want to know: அதிகாரி

அதிகாரி — *atikāri* — "an officer, an official".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

அதிகாரி (*atikāri*) is a well-established loan from Sanskrit *adhikārin*, "one in authority".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: atikāri*
- *Say it: atikāri*, once more
- *Say it:* say *atikāri*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for science, then the Tamil for an artist, then say *atikāri* again

Before you move on

What does அதிகாரி mean? ("An officer, an official".) Say it once more.

253.3 நீதிபதி (nītipati) — a judge

Before the new one: say the Tamil for an artist, then the Tamil for an officer.

You'll want to know: நீதிபதி

நீதிபதி — *nītipati* — "a judge".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

நீதிபதி (*nītipati*) is built from Sanskrit *nīti*, "right conduct, justice" (CDIAL 7546), and *pati*, "master" (CDIAL 7727): "the master of justice".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: nītipati*
- *Say it: nītipati*, once more
- *Say it:* say *nītipati*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for an artist, then the Tamil for an officer, then say *nītipati* again

Before you move on

What does நீதிபதி mean? ("A judge".) Say it once more.

253.4 ஓய்வூதியம் (ōyvūtiyam) — a pension

Before the new one: say the Tamil for an officer, then the Tamil for a judge.

You'll want to know: ஓய்வூதியம்

ஓய்வூதியம் — *ōyvūtiyam* — "a pension".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

ஓய்வூதியம் (*ōyvūtiyam*) is a modern coinage: native *ōyvu*, "rest" (DEDR 1057), and *ūtiyam*, "pay", which DEDR 609 lists, with a query, as "profit, benefit", beside a verb meaning "to help": "rest pay".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *ōyvūtiyam*
- *Say it:* *ōyvūtiyam*, once more
- *Say it:* say *ōyvūtiyam*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for an officer, then the Tamil for a judge, then say *ōyvūtiyam* again

Before you move on

What does **ஓய்வூதியம்** mean? ("A pension".) Say it once more.

253.5 சான்றிதழ் (cāṉṟitaḻ) — a certificate

Before the new one: say the Tamil for a judge, then the Tamil for a pension.

You'll want to know: சான்றிதழ்

சான்றிதழ் — *cāṉṟitaḻ* — "a certificate".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

சான்றிதழ் (*cāṉṟiṭaḻ*) is a modern coinage: *cāṉṟu*, "proof, witness", and native *iṭaḻ*, "leaf, petal" (DEDR 459): "a leaf of proof". The origin of *cāṉṟu* is uncertain.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: cāṉṟiṭaḻ*
- *Say it: cāṉṟiṭaḻ*, once more
- *Say it:* say *cāṉṟiṭaḻ*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for a judge, then the Tamil for a pension, then say *cāṉṟiṭaḻ* again

Before you move on

What does சான்றிதழ் mean? ("A certificate".) Say it once more.

253.6 Words from chapters 249-250 — a first pass

Say the words for a pension and a certificate.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- a game, football, cricket, chess, a competition
- a tent, a swing, a banyan tree, a pair of scales, straw

Before you move on

A game? (விளையாட்டு, *viḷaiyāṭṭu.*) Football? (கால்பந்து, *kālpantu.*) Cricket? (கிரிக்கெட், *kiriket.*) Chess? (சதுரங்கம், *caturaṅkam.*) A competition? (போட்டி, *pōṭṭi.*) A tent? (கூடாரம்,

kūṭāram.) A swing? (ஊஞ்சல், *ūñcal.*) A banyan tree? (ஆலமரம், *ālamaram.*) A pair of scales? (தராசு, *tarācu.*) Straw? (வைக்கோல், *vaikkōl.*)

253.7 Words from chapters 251-253 — a second pass

Say the words for the total and a list.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- the total, a list, a thing, a sale, an employer
- a mark, a university, education, mathematics, science
- an artist, an officer, a judge, a pension, a certificate

Before you move on

The total? (மொத்தம், *mottam.*) A list? (பட்டியல், *paṭṭiyal.*) A thing? (பொருள், *poruḷ.*) A sale? (விற்பனை, *viṟpaṉai.*) An employer? (முதலாளி, *mutalāḷi.*) A mark? (மதிப்பெண், *matippeṇ.*) A university? (பல்கலைக்கழகம், *palkalaikkaḻakam.*) Education? (கல்வி, *kalvi.*) Mathematics? (கணிதம், *kaṇitam.*) Science? (அறிவியல், *aṟiviyal.*) An artist? (கலைஞர், *kalaiñar.*) An officer? (அதிகாரி, *atikāri.*) A judge? (நீதிபதி, *nītipati.*) A pension? (ஓய்வூதியம், *ōyvūtiyam.*) A certificate? (சான்றிதழ், *cāṉṟitaḻ.*)

Chapter 254

To borrow, To pay, To choose, To enter, To exit

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say to borrow, to pay, to choose, to enter and to exit.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 254: I can say to borrow, to pay, to choose, to enter and to exit.*

254.1 கடன் வாங்கு (kaṭaṉ vāṅku) — to borrow

> Before the new one: say the Tamil for a pension, then the Tamil for a certificate.

You'll want to know: கடன் வாங்கு

கடன் வாங்கு — *kaṭaṉ vāṅku* — "to borrow".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

கடன் வாங்கு (*kaṭaṉ vāṅku*) is native: *kaṭaṉ*, "debt, loan" (DEDR 1113, which lists Kannada kaḍa), and *vāṅku*, "to receive, to take" (DEDR 5336): "take a loan".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: kaṭaṉ vāṅku*
- *Say it: kaṭaṉ vāṅku*, once more
- *Say it:* say *kaṭaṉ vāṅku*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for a pension, then the Tamil for a certificate, then say *kaṭaṉ vāṅku* again

Before you move on

What does **கடன் வாங்கு** mean? ("To borrow".) Say it once more.

254.2 செலுத்து (celuttu) — to pay

Before the new one: say the Tamil for a certificate, then the Tamil for to borrow.

You'll want to know: செலுத்து

செலுத்து — *celuttu* — "to pay".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

செலுத்து (*celuttu*) is native Dravidian. DEDR 2781 lists Malayalam *celuttuka*, "to pay". It is the causative of *cel*, "to go": "make the money go".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: celuttu*
- *Say it: celuttu*, once more
- *Say it:* say *celuttu*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for a certificate, then the Tamil for to borrow, then say *celuttu* again

Before you move on

What does செலுத்து mean? ("To pay".) Say it once more.

254.3 தேர்ந்தெடு (tērnteṭu) — to choose

Before the new one: say the Tamil for to borrow, then the Tamil for to pay.

You'll want to know: தேர்ந்தெடு

தேர்ந்தெடு — *tērnteṭu* — "to choose".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

தேர்ந்தெடு (*tērnteṭu*) is native: *tērntu*, "having examined, having chosen", from *tēr* (DEDR 3419), and *eṭu*, "to take up" (DEDR 851): "examine and take".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: tērnteṭu*
- *Say it: tērnteṭu*, once more
- *Say it:* say *tērnteṭu*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for to borrow, then the Tamil for to pay, then say *tērnteṭu* again

Before you move on

What does தேர்ந்தெடு mean? ("To choose".) Say it once more.

254.4 நுழை (nuḻai) — to enter

Before the new one: say the Tamil for to pay, then the Tamil for to choose.

You'll want to know: நுழை

நுழை — *nuḻai* — "to enter".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

நுழை (*nuḻai*) is native Dravidian. DEDR 3714 lists Malayalam *nuḻayuka*, "to creep through".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: nuḻai*
- *Say it: nuḻai*, once more
- *Say it:* say *nuḻai*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for to pay, then the Tamil for to choose, then say *nuḻai* again

Before you move on

What does நுழை mean? ("To enter".) Say it once more.

254.5 வெளியேறு (veḷiyēṟu) — to exit, to go out

Before the new one: say the Tamil for to choose, then the Tamil for to enter.

You'll want to know: வெளியேறு

வெளியேறு — *veḷiyēṟu* — "to exit, to go out".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

வெளியேறு (*veḷiyēṟu*) is native: *veḷi*, "outside" (DEDR 5498), and *ēṟu*, "to rise, to go up" (DEDR 916): "rise to the outside".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *veḷiyēṟu*
- *Say it:* *veḷiyēṟu*, once more
- *Say it:* say *veḷiyēṟu*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for to choose, then the Tamil for to enter, then say *veḷiyēṟu* again

Before you move on

What does வெளியேறு mean? ("To exit, to go out".) Say it once more.

Chapter 255

To breathe, To recover, To swell, To wake, To brush one's teeth

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say to breathe, to recover, to swell, to wake and to brush one's teeth.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 255: I can say to breathe, to recover, to swell, to wake and to brush one's teeth.*

255.1 சுவாசி (cuvāci) — to breathe

> Before the new one: say the Tamil for to enter, then the Tamil for to exit.

You'll want to know: சுவாசி

சுவாசி — *cuvāci* — "to breathe".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

சுவாசி (*cuvāci*) is a verb made from Sanskrit *śvāsa*, "breath, breathing" (CDIAL 12769).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: cuvāci*
- *Say it: cuvāci*, once more
- *Say it:* say *cuvāci*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for to enter, then the Tamil for to exit, then say *cuvāci* again

Before you move on

What does சுவாசி mean? ("To breathe".) Say it once more.

255.2 குணமாகு (kuṇamāku) — to recover, to get well

Before the new one: say the Tamil for to exit, then the Tamil for to breathe.

You'll want to know: குணமாகு

குணமாகு — *kuṇamāku* — "to recover, to get well".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

குணமாகு (*kuṇamāku*) is *kuṇam*, "good quality, health", from Sanskrit *guṇa*, "quality" (CDIAL 4190), and native *āku*, "to become" (DEDR 333): "become well".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: kuṇamāku*
- *Say it: kuṇamāku*, once more
- *Say it:* say *kuṇamāku*

- *Recall:* say the Tamil for to exit, then the Tamil for to breathe, then say *kuṇamāku* again

Before you move on

What does குணமாகு mean? (“To recover, to get well”.) Say it once more.

255.3 வீங்கு (vīṅku) — to swell

Before the new one: say the Tamil for to breathe, then the Tamil for to recover.

You’ll want to know: வீங்கு

வீங்கு — *vīṅku* — “to swell”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

வீங்கு (*vīṅku*) is native Dravidian. DEDR 5448 lists Malayalam *vīṅṅuka*, “to swell” and Kannada *bīgu*.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *vīṅku*
- *Say it:* *vīṅku*, once more
- *Say it:* say *vīṅku*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for to breathe, then the Tamil for to recover, then say *vīṅku* again

Before you move on

What does வீங்கு mean? (“To swell”.) Say it once more.

255.4 எழுப்பு (eḻuppu) — to wake (someone) up

Before the new one: say the Tamil for to recover, then the Tamil for to swell.

You'll want to know: எழுப்பு

எழுப்பு — *eḻuppu* — "to wake (someone) up".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

எழுப்பு (*eḻuppu*) is native Dravidian. DEDR 851 lists Malayalam *eḻuka*, "to rise". It is the causative of *eḻu*, "to rise": "make rise".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *eḻuppu*
- *Say it:* *eḻuppu*, once more
- *Say it:* say *eḻuppu*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for to recover, then the Tamil for to swell, then say *eḻuppu* again

Before you move on

What does எழுப்பு mean? ("To wake (someone) up".) Say it once more.

255.5 பல் துலக்கு (pal tulakku) — to brush one's teeth

Before the new one: say the Tamil for to swell, then the Tamil for to wake.

You'll want to know: பல் துலக்கு

பல் துலக்கு — *pal tulakku* — "to brush one's teeth".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

பல் துலக்கு (*pal tulakku*) is native: *pal*, "tooth" (DEDR 3986), and *tulakku*, "to polish, to make shine" (DEDR 3360).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: pal tulakku*
- *Say it: pal tulakku*, once more
- *Say it:* say *pal tulakku*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for to swell, then the Tamil for to wake, then say *pal tulakku* again

Before you move on

What does பல் துலக்கு mean? ("To brush one's teeth".) Say it once more.

Chapter 256

To accept, To follow, To miss, To erase, To print

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say to accept, to follow, to miss, to erase and to print.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 256: I can say to accept, to follow, to miss, to erase and to print.*

256.1 ஏற்றுக்கொள் (ēr̲r̲ukkoḷ) — to accept

> Before the new one: say the Tamil for to wake, then the Tamil for to brush one's teeth.

You'll want to know: ஏற்றுக்கொள்

ஏற்றுக்கொள் — *ēr̲r̲ukkoḷ* — "to accept".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

ஏற்றுக்கொள் (*ēr̲r̲ukkoḷ*) is native: *ēr̲r̲u*, "having raised", from *ēr̲u*, "to rise" (DEDR 916), and *koḷ*, "to take" (DEDR 2151): "raise and take up".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *ēr̲r̲ukkoḷ*
- *Say it:* *ēr̲r̲ukkoḷ*, once more
- *Say it:* say *ēr̲r̲ukkoḷ*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for to wake, then the Tamil for to brush one's teeth, then say *ēr̲r̲ukkoḷ* again

Before you move on

What does ஏற்றுக்கொள் mean? ("To accept".) Say it once more.

256.2 பின்பற்று (pin̲par̲r̲u) — to follow (rules, directions)

Before the new one: say the Tamil for to brush one's teeth, then the Tamil for to accept.

You'll want to know: பின்பற்று

பின்பற்று — *pin̲par̲r̲u* — "to follow (rules, directions)".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

பின்பற்று (*pin̲par̲r̲u*) is native: *pin̲*, "behind, after" (DEDR 4205), and *par̲r̲u*, "to hold, to cling to" (DEDR 4034): "hold on from behind".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *pin̲par̲r̲u*
- *Say it:* *pin̲par̲r̲u*, once more
- *Say it:* say *pin̲par̲r̲u*

- *Recall:* say the Tamil for to brush one's teeth, then the Tamil for to accept, then say *piṉpaṟṟu* again

Before you move on

What does பின்பற்று mean? ("To follow (rules, directions)".) Say it once more.

256.3 தவறவிடு (tavaṟaviṭu) — to miss (a bus, a chance)

Before the new one: say the Tamil for to accept, then the Tamil for to follow.

You'll want to know: தவறவிடு

தவறவிடு — *tavaṟaviṭu* — "to miss (a bus, a chance)".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

தவறவிடு (*tavaṟaviṭu*) is native: *tavaṟa*, "failing, missing", from *tavaṟu*, "to slip, to fail" (DEDR 3071), and *viṭu*, "to let go" (DEDR 5393).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: tavaṟaviṭu*
- *Say it: tavaṟaviṭu*, once more
- *Say it:* say *tavaṟaviṭu*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for to accept, then the Tamil for to follow, then say *tavaṟaviṭu* again

Before you move on

What does தவறவிடு mean? (“To miss (a bus, a chance)”.) Say it once more.

256.4 அழி (a̲li) — to erase, to delete

Before the new one: say the Tamil for to follow, then the Tamil for to miss.

You’ll want to know: அழி

அழி — *a̲li* — “to erase, to delete”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

அழி (*a̲li*) is native Dravidian. DEDR 277 lists Malayalam *a̲liyuka*, “to be destroyed” and Kannada *a̲li*.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *a̲li*
- *Say it:* *a̲li*, once more
- *Say it:* say *a̲li*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for to follow, then the Tamil for to miss, then say *a̲li* again

Before you move on

What does அழி mean? (“To erase, to delete”.) Say it once more.

256.5 அச்சிடு (acciṭu) — to print

Before the new one: say the Tamil for to miss, then the Tamil for to erase.

You'll want to know: அச்சிடு

அச்சிடு — *acciṭu* — "to print".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

அச்சிடு (*acciṭu*) is native: *accu*, "mould, type" (DEDR 47, which lists Malayalam accu and Kannada accu), and *iṭu*, "to put" (DEDR 442): "put into type". DEDR itself compares *accu*, with a query, to Sanskrit *sañcaka*, "mould", so a link with Indo-Aryan is possible.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: acciṭu*
- *Say it: acciṭu*, once more
- *Say it:* say *acciṭu*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for to miss, then the Tamil for to erase, then say *acciṭu* again

Before you move on

What does அச்சிடு mean? ("To print".) Say it once more.

Chapter 257

To hate, To be surprised, To feel shy, To be jealous, To kiss

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say to hate, to be surprised, to feel shy, to be jealous and to kiss.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 257: I can say to hate, to be surprised, to feel shy, to be jealous and to kiss.*

257.1 வெறு (ve̱ru) — to hate

> Before the new one: say the Tamil for to erase, then the Tamil for to print.

You'll want to know: வெறு

வெறு — *ve̱ru* — "to hate".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

வெறு (*ve̱ru*) is native Dravidian. DEDR 5512 lists Malayalam *ve̱rukka*, "to loathe, to hate".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *veṟu*
- *Say it:* *veṟu*, once more
- *Say it:* say *veṟu*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for to erase, then the Tamil for to print, then say *veṟu* again

Before you move on

What does வெறு mean? (“To hate”.) Say it once more.

257.2 ஆச்சரியப்படு (āccariyappaṭu) — to be surprised

Before the new one: say the Tamil for to print, then the Tamil for to hate.

You’ll want to know: ஆச்சரியப்படு

ஆச்சரியப்படு — *āccariyappaṭu* — “to be surprised”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

ஆச்சரியப்படு (*āccariyappaṭu*) is *āccariyam*, “wonder”, from Sanskrit *āścarya*, “wonderful” (CDIAL 1464), with native *paṭu*, “to undergo” (DEDR 3853): “undergo wonder”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *āccariyappaṭu*
- *Say it:* *āccariyappaṭu*, once more
- *Say it:* say *āccariyappaṭu*

- *Recall:* say the Tamil for to print, then the Tamil for to hate, then say *āccariyappaṭu* again

Before you move on

What does ஆச்சரியப்படு mean? ("To be surprised".) Say it once more.

257.3 வெட்கப்படு (veṭkappaṭu) — to feel shy, to be embarrassed

Before the new one: say the Tamil for to hate, then the Tamil for to be surprised.

You'll want to know: வெட்கப்படு

வெட்கப்படு — *veṭkappaṭu* — "to feel shy, to be embarrassed".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

வெட்கப்படு (*veṭkappaṭu*) is native: *veṭkam*, "shyness, shame" (DEDR 5500), and *paṭu*, "to undergo" (DEDR 3853).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: veṭkappaṭu*
- *Say it: veṭkappaṭu*, once more
- *Say it:* say *veṭkappaṭu*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for to hate, then the Tamil for to be surprised, then say *veṭkappaṭu* again

Before you move on

What does வெட்கப்படு mean? ("To feel shy, to be embarrassed".) Say it once more.

257.4 பொறாமைப்படு (poṟāmaippaṭu) — to be jealous

Before the new one: say the Tamil for to be surprised, then the Tamil for to feel shy.

You'll want to know: பொறாமைப்படு

பொறாமைப்படு — *poṟāmaippaṭu* — "to be jealous".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

பொறாமைப்படு (*poṟāmaippaṭu*) is native: *poṟāmai*, "envy", literally "not bearing", from *poṟu*, "to bear" (DEDR 4565), and *paṭu*, "to undergo" (DEDR 3853).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: poṟāmaippaṭu*
- *Say it: poṟāmaippaṭu*, once more
- *Say it:* say *poṟāmaippaṭu*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for to be surprised, then the Tamil for to feel shy, then say *poṟāmaippaṭu* again

Before you move on

What does பொறாமைப்படு mean? ("To be jealous".) Say it once more.

257.5 முத்தமிடு (muttamiṭu) — to kiss

Before the new one: say the Tamil for to feel shy, then the Tamil for to be jealous.

You'll want to know: முத்தமிடு

முத்தமிடு — *muttamiṭu* — "to kiss".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

முத்தமிடு (*muttamiṭu*) is native: *muttam*, "kiss" (DEDR 4960, which lists Malayalam muttam and Telugu muddu), and *iṭu*, "to put" (DEDR 442): "put a kiss".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: muttamiṭu*
- *Say it: muttamiṭu*, once more
- *Say it:* say *muttamiṭu*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for to feel shy, then the Tamil for to be jealous, then say *muttamiṭu* again

Before you move on

What does முத்தமிடு mean? ("To kiss".) Say it once more.

Chapter 258

To melt, To pick, To bark, To comfort, To shake hands

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say to melt, to pick, to bark, to comfort and to shake hands.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 258: I can say to melt, to pick, to bark, to comfort and to shake hands.

258.1 உருகு (uruku) — to melt

Before the new one: say the Tamil for to be jealous, then the Tamil for to kiss.

You'll want to know: உருகு

உருகு — *uruku* — "to melt".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

உருகு (*uruku*) is native Dravidian. DEDR 661 lists Malayalam *urukuka*, "to melt" and Telugu *ukku*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *uruku*
- *Say it:* *uruku*, once more
- *Say it:* say *uruku*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for to be jealous, then the Tamil for to kiss, then say *uruku* again

Before you move on

What does உருகு mean? (“To melt”.) Say it once more.

258.2 பறி (pa̲ri) — to pick, to pluck

Before the new one: say the Tamil for to kiss, then the Tamil for to melt.

You’ll want to know: பறி

பறி — *pa̲ri* — “to pick, to pluck”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

பறி (*pa̲ri*) is native Dravidian. DEDR 4027 lists Malayalam *pa̲rikka*, “to pluck” and Kannada *pa̲ri*.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *pa̲ri*
- *Say it:* *pa̲ri*, once more
- *Say it:* say *pa̲ri*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for to kiss, then the Tamil for to melt, then say *pa̲ri* again

Before you move on

What does பறி mean? (“To pick, to pluck”.) Say it once more.

258.3 குரை (kurai) — to bark

Before the new one: say the Tamil for to melt, then the Tamil for to pick.

You’ll want to know: குரை

குரை — *kurai* — “to bark”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

குரை (*kurai*) is native Dravidian. DEDR 1796 lists Malayalam *kura*, “barking”, and compares Sanskrit *kurkura*, “dog” (CDIAL 3329).

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: kurai*
- *Say it: kurai*, once more
- *Say it:* say *kurai*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for to melt, then the Tamil for to pick, then say *kurai* again

Before you move on

What does குரை mean? (“To bark”.) Say it once more.

258.4 தேற்று (tēr̲r̲u) — to comfort, to console

Before the new one: say the Tamil for to pick, then the Tamil for to bark.

You'll want to know: தேற்று

தேற்று — *tēṟṟu* — "to comfort, to console".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

தேற்று (*tēṟṟu*) is native Dravidian. DEDR 3471 lists Malayalam *tēṟuka*, "to become clear". It is the causative of *tēṟu*, "to be comforted, to recover": "make someone recover".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: tēṟṟu*
- *Say it: tēṟṟu*, once more
- *Say it:* say *tēṟṟu*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for to pick, then the Tamil for to bark, then say *tēṟṟu* again

Before you move on

What does தேற்று mean? ("To comfort, to console".) Say it once more.

258.5 கை குலுக்கு (kai kulukku) — to shake hands

Before the new one: say the Tamil for to bark, then the Tamil for to comfort.

You'll want to know: கை குலுக்கு

கை குலுக்கு — *kai kulukku* — "to shake hands".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

கை குலுக்கு (*kai kulukku*) is native: *kai*, "hand" (DEDR 2023), and *kulukku*, "to shake up and down" (DEDR 1806, which lists Malayalam kulukkuka).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: kai kulukku*
- *Say it: kai kulukku*, once more
- *Say it:* say *kai kulukku*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for to bark, then the Tamil for to comfort, then say *kai kulukku* again

Before you move on

What does **கை குலுக்கு** mean? ("To shake hands".) Say it once more.

Chapter 259

To take a photo, To act, To enjoy, To repair, To tidy up

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say to take a photo, to act, to enjoy, to repair and to tidy up.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 259: I can say to take a photo, to act, to enjoy, to repair and to tidy up.*

259.1 படம் எடு (paṭam eṭu) — to take a photo

> Before the new one: say the Tamil for to comfort, then the Tamil for to shake hands.

You'll want to know: படம் எடு

படம் எடு — *paṭam eṭu* — "to take a photo".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

படம் எடு (*paṭam eṭu*) is *paṭam*, "picture", from Sanskrit *paṭa*, "cloth", once the painted cloth of a picture (CDIAL 7692), with native *eṭu*, "to take up" (DEDR 851).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: paṭam eṭu*
- *Say it: paṭam eṭu*, once more
- *Say it:* say *paṭam eṭu*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for to comfort, then the Tamil for to shake hands, then say *paṭam eṭu* again

Before you move on

What does படம் எடு mean? (“To take a photo”.) Say it once more.

259.2 நடி (naṭi) — to act (in a play or film)

Before the new one: say the Tamil for to shake hands, then the Tamil for to take a photo.

You’ll want to know: நடி

நடி — *naṭi* — “to act (in a play or film)”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

நடி (*naṭi*) is a verb made from Sanskrit *naṭa*, “actor, dancer” (CDIAL 6933).

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: naṭi*
- *Say it: naṭi*, once more
- *Say it:* say *naṭi*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for to shake hands, then the Tamil for to take a photo, then say *naṭi* again

Before you move on

What does நடி mean? ("To act (in a play or film)".) Say it once more.

259.3 ரசி (raci) — to enjoy, to appreciate

Before the new one: say the Tamil for to take a photo, then the Tamil for to act.

You'll want to know: ரசி

ரசி — *raci* — "to enjoy, to appreciate".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

ரசி (*raci*) is a verb made from Sanskrit *rasa*, "juice, taste, relish" (CDIAL 10650).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: raci*
- *Say it: raci*, once more
- *Say it:* say *raci*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for to take a photo, then the Tamil for to act, then say *raci* again

Before you move on

What does ரசி mean? ("To enjoy, to appreciate".) Say it once more.

259.4 பழுது பார் (paḻutu pār) — to repair

Before the new one: say the Tamil for to act, then the Tamil for to enjoy.

You'll want to know: பழுது பார்

பழுது பார் — *paḻutu pār* — "to repair".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

பழுது பார் (*paḻutu pār*) is native: *paḻutu*, "damage" (DEDR 4110), and *pār*, "to see to" (DEDR 4091): "see to the damage".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: paḻutu pār*
- *Say it: paḻutu pār*, once more
- *Say it:* say *paḻutu pār*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for to act, then the Tamil for to enjoy, then say *paḻutu pār* again

Before you move on

What does பழுது பார் mean? ("To repair".) Say it once more.

259.5 ஒழுங்குபடுத்து (oḻuṅkupaṭuttu) — to tidy up, to arrange

Before the new one: say the Tamil for to enjoy, then the Tamil for to repair.

You'll want to know: ஒழுங்குபடுத்து

ஒழுங்குபடுத்து — *oḻuṅkupaṭuttu* — "to tidy up, to arrange".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

ஒழுங்குபடுத்து (*oḻuṅkupaṭuttu*) is native: *oḻuṅku*, "order, regularity" (DEDR 1011), and *paṭuttu*, "to make", the causative of *paṭu* (DEDR 3853): "put into order".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: o̲luṅkupaṭuttu*
- *Say it: o̲luṅkupaṭuttu*, once more
- *Say it:* say *o̲luṅkupaṭuttu*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for to enjoy, then the Tamil for to repair, then say *o̲luṅkupaṭuttu* again

Before you move on

What does ஒழுங்குபடுத்து mean? ("To tidy up, to arrange".) Say it once more.

Chapter 260

To increase, To spread, To sink, To float, To squeeze

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say to increase, to spread, to sink, to float and to squeeze.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 260: I can say to increase, to spread, to sink, to float and to squeeze.

260.1 அதிகரி (atikari) — to increase, to go up

Before the new one: say the Tamil for to repair, then the Tamil for to tidy up.

You'll want to know: அதிகரி

அதிகரி — *atikari* — "to increase, to go up".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

அதிகரி (*atikari*) is a verb made from Sanskrit *adhika*, "additional, more" (CDIAL 250).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: atikari*
- *Say it: atikari*, once more
- *Say it:* say *atikari*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for to repair, then the Tamil for to tidy up, then say *atikari* again

Before you move on

What does அதிகரி mean? ("To increase, to go up".) Say it once more.

260.2 பரவு (paravu) — to spread (of news, disease, fire)

Before the new one: say the Tamil for to tidy up, then the Tamil for to increase.

You'll want to know: பரவு

பரவு — *paravu* — "to spread (of news, disease, fire)".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

பரவு (*paravu*) is native Dravidian. DEDR 3949 lists Malayalam *parakka*, "to spread".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: paravu*
- *Say it: paravu*, once more
- *Say it:* say *paravu*

- *Recall:* say the Tamil for to tidy up, then the Tamil for to increase, then say *paravu* again

Before you move on

What does பரவு mean? (“To spread (of news, disease, fire)”.) Say it once more.

260.3 மூழ்கு (mūḻku) — to sink, to drown

Before the new one: say the Tamil for to increase, then the Tamil for to spread.

You’ll want to know: மூழ்கு

மூழ்கு — *mūḻku* — “to sink, to drown”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

மூழ்கு (*mūḻku*) is native Dravidian. DEDR 4993 lists Malayalam *muḻukuka*, “to sink” and Kannada *muḻugu*.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: mūḻku*
- *Say it: mūḻku*, once more
- *Say it:* say *mūḻku*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for to increase, then the Tamil for to spread, then say *mūḻku* again

Before you move on

What does மூழ்கு mean? (“To sink, to drown”.) Say it once more.

260.4 மித (mita) — to float

Before the new one: say the Tamil for to spread, then the Tamil for to sink.

You'll want to know: மித

மித — *mita* — "to float".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

மித (*mita*) is native Dravidian: DEDR 4841 lists it, with a query, among words for "top, height, upon": to float is to stay on top.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: mita*
- *Say it: mita*, once more
- *Say it:* say *mita*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for to spread, then the Tamil for to sink, then say *mita* again

Before you move on

What does மித mean? ("To float".) Say it once more.

260.5 பிழி (pi̲li) — to squeeze, to wring out

Before the new one: say the Tamil for to sink, then the Tamil for to float.

You'll want to know: பிழி

பிழி — *pi̲li* — "to squeeze, to wring out".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

பிழி (*pi̲li*) is native Dravidian. DEDR 4183 lists Malayalam *pi̲liyuka*, "to wring out" and Kannada *pi̲li*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: pi̲li*
- *Say it: pi̲li*, once more
- *Say it:* say *pi̲li*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for to sink, then the Tamil for to float, then say *pi̲li* again

Before you move on

What does பிழி mean? ("To squeeze, to wring out".) Say it once more.

Chapter 261

Diabetes, Exercise, Yoga, Itch, Dizziness

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say diabetes, exercise, yoga, an itch and dizziness.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 261: I can say diabetes, exercise, yoga, an itch and dizziness.*

261.1 சர்க்கரை நோய் (carkkarai nōy) — diabetes

Before the new one: say the Tamil for to float, then the Tamil for to squeeze.

You'll want to know: சர்க்கரை நோய்

சர்க்கரை நோய் — *carkkarai nōy* — "diabetes".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

சர்க்கரை நோய் (*carkkarai nōy*) is *carkkarai*, "sugar", from Sanskrit *śarkarā*, "candied sugar" (CDIAL 12338), and native *nōy*, "illness, pain" (DEDR 3793): "sugar illness".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: carkkarai nōy*
- *Say it: carkkarai nōy*, once more
- *Say it:* say *carkkarai nōy*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for to float, then the Tamil for to squeeze, then say *carkkarai nōy* again

Before you move on

What does சர்க்கரை நோய் mean? (“Diabetes”.) Say it once more.

261.2 உடற்பயிற்சி (uṭaṟpayiṟci) — exercise

Before the new one: say the Tamil for to squeeze, then the Tamil for diabetes.

You’ll want to know: உடற்பயிற்சி

உடற்பயிற்சி — *uṭaṟpayiṟci* — “exercise”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

உடற்பயிற்சி (*uṭaṟpayiṟci*) is native: *uṭal*, “body” (DEDR 586), and *payiṟci*, “practice, training” (DEDR 3942): “body training”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: uṭaṟpayiṟci*
- *Say it: uṭaṟpayiṟci*, once more
- *Say it:* say *uṭaṟpayiṟci*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for to squeeze, then the Tamil for diabetes, then say *uṭaṟpayiṟci* again

Before you move on

What does உடற்பயிற்சி mean? ("Exercise".) Say it once more.

261.3 யோகா (yōkā) — yoga

Before the new one: say the Tamil for diabetes, then the Tamil for exercise.

You'll want to know: யோகா

யோகா — *yōkā* — "yoga".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

யோகா (*yōkā*) is Sanskrit *yoga*, "yoking, joining" (CDIAL 10526), in the form with final *-ā* used in Hindi and English.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *yōkā*
- *Say it:* *yōkā*, once more
- *Say it:* say *yōkā*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for diabetes, then the Tamil for exercise, then say *yōkā* again

Before you move on

What does யோகா mean? ("Yoga".) Say it once more.

261.4 அரிப்பு (arippu) — an itch

Before the new one: say the Tamil for exercise, then the Tamil for yoga.

You'll want to know: அரிப்பு

அரிப்பு — *arippu* — "an itch".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

அரிப்பு (*arippu*) is native Dravidian. DEDR 214 lists Malayalam *arikka*, "to itch". It is the noun of *ari*, "to itch".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: arippu*
- *Say it: arippu*, once more
- *Say it:* say *arippu*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for exercise, then the Tamil for yoga, then say *arippu* again

Before you move on

What does அரிப்பு mean? ("An itch".) Say it once more.

261.5 தலைச்சுற்றல் (talaiccuṟṟal) — dizziness

Before the new one: say the Tamil for yoga, then the Tamil for an itch.

You'll want to know: தலைச்சுற்றல்

தலைச்சுற்றல் — *talaiccuṟṟal* — "dizziness".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

தலைச்சுற்றல் (*talaiccuṟṟal*) is native: *talai*, "head" (DEDR 3103), and *cuṟṟal*, "spinning", from *cuṟṟu*, "to revolve" (DEDR 2715): "head spinning".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: talaiccu̲r̲ral*
- *Say it: talaiccu̲r̲ral*, once more
- *Say it:* say *talaiccu̲r̲ral*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for yoga, then the Tamil for an itch, then say *talaiccu̲r̲ral* again

Before you move on

What does **தலைச்சுற்றல்** mean? ("Dizziness".) Say it once more.

Chapter 262

Now and then, Every week, Late, Finally, These days

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (7) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 7 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say now and then, every week, late, finally and these days.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 262: I can say now and then, every week, late, finally and these days.*

262.1 அவ்வப்போது (avvappōtu) — now and then, occasionally

Before the new one: say the Tamil for an itch, then the Tamil for dizziness.

You'll want to know: அவ்வப்போது

அவ்வப்போது — *avvappōtu* — "now and then, occasionally".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

அவ்வப்போது (*avvappōtu*) is native: *a-*, "that" (DEDR 1), doubled, and *pōtu*, "time" (DEDR 4559): "at that time and that time".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: avvappōtu*
- *Say it: avvappōtu*, once more
- *Say it:* say *avvappōtu*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for an itch, then the Tamil for dizziness, then say *avvappōtu* again

Before you move on

What does அவ்வப்போது mean? ("Now and then, occasionally".) Say it once more.

262.2 வாரந்தோறும் (vārantōṟum) — every week

Before the new one: say the Tamil for dizziness, then the Tamil for now and then.

You'll want to know: வாரந்தோறும்

வாரந்தோறும் — *vārantōṟum* — "every week".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

வாரந்தோறும் (*vārantōṟum*) is *vāram*, "week", from Sanskrit *vāra*, "day of the week" (CDIAL 11547), and native *tōṟum*, "each, every" (DEDR 3566).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: vārantōṟum*
- *Say it: vārantōṟum*, once more
- *Say it:* say *vārantōṟum*

- *Recall:* say the Tamil for dizziness, then the Tamil for now and then, then say *vārantō̲rum* again

Before you move on

What does **வாரந்தோறும்** mean? (“Every week”.) Say it once more.

262.3 தாமதமாக (tāmatamāka) — late

Before the new one: say the Tamil for now and then, then the Tamil for every week.

You’ll want to know: தாமதமாக

தாமதமாக — *tāmatamāka* — “late”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

தாமதமாக (*tāmatamāka*) is *tāmatam*, “delay”, usually traced to Sanskrit *tāmasa*, “dark, dull” (CDIAL 5775), with native *āka*, “as”, from *āku*, “to become” (DEDR 333).

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: tāmatamāka*
- *Say it: tāmatamāka*, once more
- *Say it:* say *tāmatamāka*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for now and then, then the Tamil for every week, then say *tāmatamāka* again

Before you move on

What does **தாமதமாக** mean? (“Late”.) Say it once more.

262.4 கடைசியாக (kaṭaiciyāka) — finally, at last

Before the new one: say the Tamil for every week, then the Tamil for late.

You'll want to know: கடைசியாக

கடைசியாக — *kaṭaiciyāka* — "finally, at last".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

கடைசியாக (*kaṭaiciyāka*) is native: *kaṭaici*, "the end, the last" (DEDR 1109), and *āka*, "as", from *āku*, "to become" (DEDR 333).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: kaṭaiciyāka*
- *Say it: kaṭaiciyāka*, once more
- *Say it:* say *kaṭaiciyāka*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for every week, then the Tamil for late, then say *kaṭaiciyāka* again

Before you move on

What does **கடைசியாக** mean? ("Finally, at last".) Say it once more.

262.5 இப்போதெல்லாம் (ippōtellām) — these days, nowadays

Before the new one: say the Tamil for late, then the Tamil for finally.

You'll want to know: இப்போதெல்லாம்

இப்போதெல்லாம் — *ippōtellām* — "these days, nowadays".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

இப்போதெல்லாம் (*ippōtellām*) is native: *ippōtu*, "now", from *i-*, "this" (DEDR 410), and *pōtu*, "time" (DEDR 4559), with *ellām*, "all" (DEDR 844): "all these times".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: ippōtellām*
- *Say it: ippōtellām*, once more
- *Say it:* say *ippōtellām*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for late, then the Tamil for finally, then say *ippōtellām* again

Before you move on

What does இப்போதெல்லாம் mean? ("These days, nowadays".) Say it once more.

262.6 Words from chapters 254-257 — a first pass

Say the words for finally and these days.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- to borrow, to pay, to choose, to enter, to exit
- to breathe, to recover, to swell, to wake, to brush one's teeth
- to accept, to follow, to miss, to erase, to print

- to hate, to be surprised, to feel shy, to be jealous, to kiss

Before you move on

To borrow? (கடன் வாங்கு, *kaṭaṉ vāṅku.*) To pay? (செலுத்து, *celuttu.*) To choose? (தேர்ந்தெடு, *tērnteṭu.*) To enter? (நுழை, *nuḻai.*) To exit? (வெளியேறு, *veḷiyēṟu.*) To breathe? (சுவாசி, *cuvāci.*) To recover? (குணமாகு, *kuṇamāku.*) To swell? (வீங்கு, *vīṅku.*) To wake? (எழுப்பு, *eḻuppu.*) To brush one's teeth? (பல் துலக்கு, *pal tulakku.*) To accept? (ஏற்றுக்கொள், *ēṟṟukkoḷ.*) To follow? (பின்பற்று, *piṉpaṟṟu.*) To miss? (தவறவிடு, *tavaṟaviṭu.*) To erase? (அழி, *aḻi.*) To print? (அச்சிடு, *acciṭu.*) To hate? (வெறு, *veṟu.*) To be surprised? (ஆச்சரியப்படு, *āccariyappaṭu.*) To feel shy? (வெட்கப்படு, *veṭkappaṭu.*) To be jealous? (பொறாமைப்படு, *poṟāmaippaṭu.*) To kiss? (முத்தமிடு, *muttamiṭu.*)

262.7 Words from chapters 258-262 — a second pass

Say the words for to melt and to pick.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- to melt, to pick, to bark, to comfort, to shake hands
- to take a photo, to act, to enjoy, to repair, to tidy up
- to increase, to spread, to sink, to float, to squeeze
- diabetes, exercise, yoga, an itch, dizziness
- now and then, every week, late, finally, these days

Before you move on

To melt? (உருகு, *uruku.*) To pick? (பறி, *paṟi.*) To bark? (குரை, *kurai.*) To comfort? (தேற்று, *tēṟṟu.*) To shake hands? (கை குலுக்கு, *kai kulukku.*) To take a photo? (படம் எடு, *paṭam eṭu.*)

To act? (நடி, *naṭi.*) To enjoy? (ரசி, *raci.*) To repair? (பழுது பார், *paḻutu pār.*) To tidy up? (ஒழுங்குபடுத்து, *oḻuṅkupaṭuttu.*) To increase? (அதிகரி, *atikari.*) To spread? (பரவு, *paravu.*) To sink? (மூழ்கு, *mūḻku.*) To float? (மித, *mita.*) To squeeze? (பிழி, *piḻi.*) Diabetes? (சர்க்கரை நோய், *carkkarai nōy.*) Exercise? (உடற்பயிற்சி, *uṭaṟpayiṟci.*) Yoga? (யோகா, *yōkā.*) An itch? (அரிப்பு, *arippu.*) Dizziness? (தலைச்சுற்றல், *talaiccuṟṟal.*) Now and then? (அவ்வப்போது, *avvappōtu.*) Every week? (வாரந்தோறும், *vārantōṟum.*) Late? (தாமதமாக, *tāmatamāka.*) Finally? (கடைசியாக, *kaṭaiciyāka.*) These days? (இப்போதெல்லாம், *ippōtellām.*)

Chapter 263

Traffic, Footpath, Aeroplane, Airport, Ship

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say traffic, a footpath, an aeroplane, an airport and a ship.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 263: I can say traffic, a footpath, an aeroplane, an airport and a ship.

263.1 போக்குவரத்து (pōkkuvarattu) — traffic; transport

Before the new one: say the Tamil for finally, at last, then the Tamil for these days, nowadays.

You'll want to know: போக்குவரத்து

போக்குவரத்து — *pōkkuvarattu* — "traffic; transport".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

போக்குவரத்து (*pōkkuvarattu*) is native: *pōkku*, "going", from *pō*, "to go" (DEDR 4572), and *varattu*, "coming in" (DEDR 5270): "goings and comings".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: pōkkuvarattu*
- *Say it: pōkkuvarattu*, once more
- *Say it:* say *pōkkuvarattu*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for finally, at last, then the Tamil for these days, nowadays, then say *pōkkuvarattu* again

Before you move on

What does போக்குவரத்து mean? ("Traffic; transport".) Say it once more.

263.2 நடைபாதை (naṭaipātai) — a footpath, a pavement

Before the new one: say the Tamil for these days, nowadays, then the Tamil for traffic; transport.

You'll want to know: நடைபாதை

நடைபாதை — *naṭaipātai* — "a footpath, a pavement".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

நடைபாதை (*naṭaipātai*) is native *naṭai*, "walking" (DEDR 3582), and *pātai*, "path", probably from Sanskrit *patha* (CDIAL 7743): "the walking path".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: naṭaipātai*
- *Say it: naṭaipātai*, once more
- *Say it:* say *naṭaipātai*

- *Recall:* say the Tamil for these days, nowadays, then the Tamil for traffic; transport, then say *naṭaipātai* again

Before you move on

What does நடைபாதை mean? (“A footpath, a pavement”.) Say it once more.

263.3 விமானம் (vimāṉam) — an aeroplane

Before the new one: say the Tamil for traffic; transport, then the Tamil for a footpath.

You’ll want to know: விமானம்

விமானம் — *vimāṉam* — “an aeroplane”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

விமானம் (*vimāṉam*) is a loan from Sanskrit *vimāna*, “a chariot of the gods” (CDIAL 11823), reused for the aeroplane.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: vimāṉam*
- *Say it: vimāṉam*, once more
- *Say it:* say *vimāṉam*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for traffic; transport, then the Tamil for a footpath, then say *vimāṉam* again

Before you move on

What does விமானம் mean? (“An aeroplane”.) Say it once more.

263.4 விமான நிலையம் (vimāṉa nilaiyam) — an airport

Before the new one: say the Tamil for a footpath, then the Tamil for an aeroplane.

You'll want to know: விமான நிலையம்

விமான நிலையம் — *vimāṉa nilaiyam* — "an airport".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

விமான நிலையம் (*vimāṉa nilaiyam*) is *vimāṉam*, "aeroplane", from Sanskrit *vimāna* (CDIAL 11823), and native *nilaiyam*, "station", from *nil*, "to stand" (DEDR 3675).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: vimāṉa nilaiyam*
- *Say it: vimāṉa nilaiyam*, once more
- *Say it:* say *vimāṉa nilaiyam*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for a footpath, then the Tamil for an aeroplane, then say *vimāṉa nilaiyam* again

Before you move on

What does விமான நிலையம் mean? ("An airport".) Say it once more.

263.5 கப்பல் (kappal) — a ship

Before the new one: say the Tamil for an aeroplane, then the Tamil for an airport.

You'll want to know: கப்பல்

கப்பல் — *kappal* — "a ship".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

கப்பல் (*kappal*) is native Dravidian. DEDR 1219 lists Malayalam *kappal*, "ship" and Telugu *kappali*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: kappal*
- *Say it: kappal*, once more
- *Say it:* say *kappal*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for an aeroplane, then the Tamil for an airport, then say *kappal* again

Before you move on

What does **கப்பல்** mean? ("A ship".) Say it once more.

Chapter 264

Opposite, Between, Way, Land, Valley

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say opposite, between, a way, land and a valley.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 264: I can say opposite, between, a way, land and a valley.*

264.1 எதிரே (etirē) — opposite

Before the new one: say the Tamil for an airport, then the Tamil for a ship.

You'll want to know: எதிரே

எதிரே — *etirē* — "opposite".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

எதிரே (*etirē*) is native Dravidian. DEDR 795 lists Malayalam *etir*, "opposite" and Telugu *eduru*. *-ē* adds emphasis: "right opposite".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: etirē*
- *Say it: etirē*, once more
- *Say it:* say *etirē*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for an airport, then the Tamil for a ship, then say *etirē* again

Before you move on

What does **எதிரே** mean? (“Opposite”.) Say it once more.

264.2 இடையில் (iṭaiyil) — between

Before the new one: say the Tamil for a ship, then the Tamil for opposite.

You’ll want to know: இடையில்

இடையில் — *iṭaiyil* — “between”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

இடையில் (*iṭaiyil*) is native Dravidian. DEDR 448 lists Malayalam *iṭa*, “interval, middle” and Kannada *eḍe*. It is *iṭai*, “middle, interval”, with *-il*, “in”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: iṭaiyil*
- *Say it: iṭaiyil*, once more
- *Say it:* say *iṭaiyil*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for a ship, then the Tamil for opposite, then say *iṭaiyil* again

Before you move on

What does இடையில் mean? ("Between".) Say it once more.

264.3 வழி (va̲li) — a way, a route

Before the new one: say the Tamil for opposite, then the Tamil for between.

You'll want to know: வழி

வழி — *va̲li* — "a way, a route".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

வழி (*va̲li*) is native Dravidian. DEDR 5297 lists Malayalam *va̲li*, "way, road" and Kannada *ba̲li*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *va̲li*
- *Say it:* *va̲li*, once more
- *Say it:* say *va̲li*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for opposite, then the Tamil for between, then say *va̲li* again

Before you move on

What does வழி mean? ("A way, a route".) Say it once more.

264.4 நிலம் (nilam) — land, the ground

Before the new one: say the Tamil for between, then the Tamil for a way.

You'll want to know: நிலம்

நிலம் — *nilam* — "land, the ground".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

நிலம் (*nilam*) is native Dravidian. DEDR 3676 lists Malayalam *nilam*, "ground" and Kannada *nela*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: nilam*
- *Say it: nilam*, once more
- *Say it:* say *nilam*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for between, then the Tamil for a way, then say *nilam* again

Before you move on

What does நிலம் mean? ("Land, the ground".) Say it once more.

264.5 பள்ளத்தாக்கு (paḷḷattākku) — a valley

Before the new one: say the Tamil for a way, then the Tamil for land.

You'll want to know: பள்ளத்தாக்கு

பள்ளத்தாக்கு — *paḷḷattākku* — "a valley".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

பள்ளத்தாக்கு (*paḷḷattākku*) is native, built on *paḷḷam*, "low land, valley" (DEDR 4016, which lists Malayalam paḷḷam and Telugu pallamu).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: paḷḷattākku*
- *Say it: paḷḷattākku*, once more
- *Say it:* say *paḷḷattākku*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for a way, then the Tamil for land, then say *paḷḷattākku* again

Before you move on

What does பள்ளத்தாக்கு mean? ("A valley".) Say it once more.

Chapter 265

District, Hut, Tower, Prison, World

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say a district, a hut, a tower, a prison and the world.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 265: I can say a district, a hut, a tower, a prison and the world.*

265.1 மாவட்டம் (māvaṭṭam) — a district

> Before the new one: say the Tamil for land, then the Tamil for a valley.

You'll want to know: மாவட்டம்

மாவட்டம் — *māvaṭṭam* — "a district".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

மாவட்டம் (*māvaṭṭam*) is *mā*, "great", and *vaṭṭam*, "circle", usually traced to Sanskrit *vṛtta*, "rounded" (CDIAL 12069): "the great circle".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: māvaṭṭam*
- *Say it: māvaṭṭam*, once more
- *Say it:* say *māvaṭṭam*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for land, then the Tamil for a valley, then say *māvaṭṭam* again

Before you move on

What does மாவட்டம் mean? ("A district".) Say it once more.

265.2 குடிசை (kuṭicai) — a hut

Before the new one: say the Tamil for a valley, then the Tamil for a district.

You'll want to know: குடிசை

குடிசை — *kuṭicai* — "a hut".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

குடிசை (*kuṭicai*) is native Dravidian. DEDR 1655 lists Malayalam *kuṭi*, "house, hut" and Telugu *guḍise*. It is built on *kuṭi*, "dwelling". The entry compares Sanskrit *kuṭi*, "hut" (CDIAL 3232).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: kuṭicai*
- *Say it: kuṭicai*, once more
- *Say it:* say *kuṭicai*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for a valley, then the Tamil for a district, then say *kuṭicai* again

Before you move on

What does குடிசை mean? ("A hut".) Say it once more.

265.3 கோபுரம் (kōpuram) — a tower, a temple gateway tower

Before the new one: say the Tamil for a district, then the Tamil for a hut.

You'll want to know: கோபுரம்

கோபுரம் — *kōpuram* — "a tower, a temple gateway tower".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

கோபுரம் (*kōpuram*) is a well-established loan from Sanskrit *gopura*, "town gate".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: kōpuram*
- *Say it: kōpuram*, once more
- *Say it:* say *kōpuram*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for a district, then the Tamil for a hut, then say *kōpuram* again

Before you move on

What does கோபுரம் mean? ("A tower, a temple gateway tower".) Say it once more.

265.4 சிறை (ciṟai) — a prison

Before the new one: say the Tamil for a hut, then the Tamil for a tower.

You'll want to know: சிறை

சிறை — *ciṟai* — "a prison".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

சிறை (*ciṟai*) is native Dravidian. DEDR 1980 lists Telugu *ceṟa*, "prison". The entry glosses the Tamil verb as "to restrain, to imprison".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *ciṟai*
- *Say it:* *ciṟai*, once more
- *Say it:* say *ciṟai*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for a hut, then the Tamil for a tower, then say *ciṟai* again

Before you move on

What does **சிறை** mean? ("A prison".) Say it once more.

265.5 உலகம் (ulakam) — the world

Before the new one: say the Tamil for a tower, then the Tamil for a prison.

You'll want to know: உலகம்

உலகம் — *ulakam* — "the world".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

உலகம் (*ulakam*) is a loan from Sanskrit *loka*, “free space, the world” (CDIAL 11119).

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: ulakam*
- *Say it: ulakam*, once more
- *Say it:* say *ulakam*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for a tower, then the Tamil for a prison, then say *ulakam* again

Before you move on

What does **உலகம்** mean? (“The world”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 266

Easily, On purpose, By chance, Luckily, Reason

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say easily, on purpose, by chance, luckily and a reason.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 266: I can say easily, on purpose, by chance, luckily and a reason.*

266.1 எளிதாக (eḷitāka) — easily

> Before the new one: say the Tamil for a prison, then the Tamil for the world.

You'll want to know: எளிதாக

எளிதாக — *eḷitāka* — "easily".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

எளிதாக (*eḷitāka*) is native: *eḷitu*, "what is easy", from *eḷi*, "easy" (DEDR 855), and *āka*, "as" (DEDR 333).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *eḷitāka*
- *Say it:* *eḷitāka*, once more
- *Say it:* say *eḷitāka*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for a prison, then the Tamil for the world, then say *eḷitāka* again

Before you move on

What does **எளிதாக** mean? (“Easily”.) Say it once more.

266.2 வேண்டுமென்றே (vēṇṭumeṉṟē) — on purpose, deliberately

Before the new one: say the Tamil for the world, then the Tamil for easily.

You’ll want to know: வேண்டுமென்றே

வேண்டுமென்றே — *vēṇṭumeṉṟē* — “on purpose, deliberately”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

வேண்டுமென்றே (*vēṇṭumeṉṟē*) is native: *vēṇṭum*, “it is wanted” (DEDR 5528), and *eṉṟu*, “saying”, from *eṉ*, “to say” (DEDR 868), with emphatic *-ē*: “saying ’it is wanted’”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *vēṇṭumeṉṟē*
- *Say it:* *vēṇṭumeṉṟē*, once more
- *Say it:* say *vēṇṭumeṉṟē*

- *Recall:* say the Tamil for the world, then the Tamil for easily, then say *vēṇṭumenṟē* again

Before you move on

What does வேண்டுமென்றே mean? (“On purpose, deliberately”.) Say it once more.

266.3 தற்செயலாக (tarceyalāka) — by chance

Before the new one: say the Tamil for easily, then the Tamil for on purpose.

You’ll want to know: தற்செயலாக

தற்செயலாக — *tarceyalāka* — “by chance”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

தற்செயலாக (*tarceyalāka*) is native: *tan*, “of itself” (DEDR 3196), *ceyal*, “action”, from *cey*, “to do” (DEDR 1957), and *āka*, “as”: “as its own action”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: tarceyalāka*
- *Say it: tarceyalāka*, once more
- *Say it:* say *tarceyalāka*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for easily, then the Tamil for on purpose, then say *tarceyalāka* again

Before you move on

What does தற்செயலாக mean? (“By chance”.) Say it once more.

266.4 அதிர்ஷ்டவசமாக (atirṣṭavacamāka) — luckily, fortunately

Before the new one: say the Tamil for on purpose, then the Tamil for by chance.

You'll want to know: அதிர்ஷ்டவசமாக

அதிர்ஷ்டவசமாக — *atirṣṭavacamāka* — "luckily, fortunately".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

அதிர்ஷ்டவசமாக (*atirṣṭavacamāka*) is built from Sanskrit *adṛṣṭa*, "unseen; fate" (CDIAL 238), and *vaśa*, "power" (CDIAL 11430), with native *āka*, "as": "by the power of fate".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: atirṣṭavacamāka*
- *Say it: atirṣṭavacamāka*, once more
- *Say it:* say *atirṣṭavacamāka*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for on purpose, then the Tamil for by chance, then say *atirṣṭavacamāka* again

Before you move on

What does அதிர்ஷ்டவசமாக mean? ("Luckily, fortunately".) Say it once more.

266.5 காரணம் (kāraṇam) — a reason, a cause

Before the new one: say the Tamil for by chance, then the Tamil for luckily.

You'll want to know: காரணம்

காரணம் — *kāraṇam* — "a reason, a cause".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

காரணம் (*kāraṇam*) is a loan from Sanskrit *kāraṇa*, "cause" (CDIAL 3057).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: kāraṇam*
- *Say it: kāraṇam*, once more
- *Say it:* say *kāraṇam*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for by chance, then the Tamil for luckily, then say *kāraṇam* again

Before you move on

What does **காரணம்** mean? ("A reason, a cause".) Say it once more.

Chapter 267

Fat, Important, Urgent, Crowded, Easy

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say fat, important, urgent, crowded and easy.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 267: I can say fat, important, urgent, crowded and easy.*

267.1 குண்டான (kuṇṭāṉa) — fat, plump

> Before the new one: say the Tamil for luckily, then the Tamil for a reason.

You'll want to know: குண்டான

குண்டான — *kuṇṭāṉa* — "fat, plump".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

குண்டான (*kuṇṭāṉa*) is native: *kuṇṭu*, "ball, anything round and heavy" (DEDR 1695, which lists Kannada guṇḍu and Telugu guṇḍu), with *-āṉa*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *kuṇṭāṉa*
- *Say it:* *kuṇṭāṉa*, once more
- *Say it:* say *kuṇṭāṉa*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for luckily, then the Tamil for a reason, then say *kuṇṭāṉa* again

Before you move on

What does குண்டான mean? (“Fat, plump”.) Say it once more.

267.2 முக்கியமான (mukkiyamāṉa) — important

Before the new one: say the Tamil for a reason, then the Tamil for fat.

You’ll want to know: முக்கியமான

முக்கியமான — *mukkiyamāṉa* — “important”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

முக்கியமான (*mukkiyamāṉa*) is *mukkiyam*, “importance”, from Sanskrit *mukhya*, “chief” (CDIAL 10174), with *-āṉa*.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *mukkiyamāṉa*
- *Say it:* *mukkiyamāṉa*, once more
- *Say it:* say *mukkiyamāṉa*

- *Recall:* say the Tamil for a reason, then the Tamil for fat, then say *mukkiyamāṉa* again

Before you move on

What does **முக்கியமான** mean? (“Important”.) Say it once more.

267.3 அவசரமான (avacaramāṉa) — urgent

Before the new one: say the Tamil for fat, then the Tamil for important.

You’ll want to know: அவசரமான

அவசரமான — *avacaramāṉa* — “urgent”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

அவசரமான (*avacaramāṉa*) is *avacaram*, “urgency”, from Sanskrit *avasara*, “occasion” (CDIAL 858), with *-āṉa*.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: avacaramāṉa*
- *Say it: avacaramāṉa*, once more
- *Say it:* say *avacaramāṉa*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for fat, then the Tamil for important, then say *avacaramāṉa* again

Before you move on

What does **அவசரமான** mean? (“Urgent”.) Say it once more.

267.4 நெரிசலான (nericalāṉa) — crowded, congested

Before the new one: say the Tamil for important, then the Tamil for urgent.

You'll want to know: நெரிசலான

நெரிசலான — *nericalāṉa* — "crowded, congested".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

நெரிசலான (*nericalāṉa*) is native: *nerical*, "crowding", from *neri*, "to be crowded together" (DEDR 3770), with *-āṉa*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: nericalāṉa*
- *Say it: nericalāṉa*, once more
- *Say it:* say *nericalāṉa*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for important, then the Tamil for urgent, then say *nericalāṉa* again

Before you move on

What does நெரிசலான mean? ("Crowded, congested".) Say it once more.

267.5 எளிதான (eḷitāṉa) — easy

Before the new one: say the Tamil for urgent, then the Tamil for crowded.

You'll want to know: எளிதான

எளிதான — *eḷitāṉa* — "easy".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

எளிதான (*eḷitāṉa*) is native: *eḷitu*, "what is easy", from *eḷi*, "easy" (DEDR 855, which lists Malayalam eḷutu), with *-āṉa*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: eḷitāṉa*
- *Say it: eḷitāṉa*, once more
- *Say it:* say *eḷitāṉa*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for urgent, then the Tamil for crowded, then say *eḷitāṉa* again

Before you move on

What does எளிதான mean? ("Easy".) Say it once more.

Chapter 268

Enthusiasm, Confusion, Smile, Gentle, Honest

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say enthusiasm, confusion, a smile, gentle and honest.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 268: I can say enthusiasm, confusion, a smile, gentle and honest.*

268.1 உற்சாகம் (u̱rcākam) — enthusiasm, excitement

Before the new one: say the Tamil for crowded, then the Tamil for easy.

You'll want to know: உற்சாகம்

உற்சாகம் — *u̱rcākam* — "enthusiasm, excitement".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

உற்சாகம் (*u̱rcākam*) is a loan from Sanskrit *utsāha*, "power, joy" (CDIAL 1882).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *u̲rcākam*
- *Say it:* *u̲rcākam*, once more
- *Say it:* say *u̲rcākam*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for crowded, then the Tamil for easy, then say *u̲rcākam* again

Before you move on

What does உற்சாகம் mean? (“Enthusiasm, excitement”.) Say it once more.

268.2 குழப்பம் (ku̲lappam) — confusion

Before the new one: say the Tamil for easy, then the Tamil for enthusiasm.

You’ll want to know: குழப்பம்

குழப்பம் — *ku̲lappam* — “confusion”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

குழப்பம் (*ku̲lappam*) is native Dravidian. DEDR 1817 lists Kannada *ku̲la*, “confusion”. It comes from *ku̲lampu*, “to be stirred up, confused”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *ku̲lappam*
- *Say it:* *ku̲lappam*, once more
- *Say it:* say *ku̲lappam*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for easy, then the Tamil for enthusiasm, then say *ku̲lappam* again

Before you move on

What does குழப்பம் mean? ("Confusion".) Say it once more.

268.3 புன்னகை (pun̲n̲akai) — a smile

Before the new one: say the Tamil for enthusiasm, then the Tamil for confusion.

You'll want to know: புன்னகை

புன்னகை — *pun̲n̲akai* — "a smile".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

புன்னகை (*pun̲n̲akai*) is native: *pun̲*, "small, slight" (DEDR 4301), and *nakai*, "laughter, smile" (DEDR 3569): "a small laugh".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *pun̲n̲akai*
- *Say it:* *pun̲n̲akai*, once more
- *Say it:* say *pun̲n̲akai*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for enthusiasm, then the Tamil for confusion, then say *pun̲n̲akai* again

Before you move on

What does புன்னகை mean? ("A smile".) Say it once more.

268.4 கனிவான (kan̲ivān̲a) — gentle, kind

Before the new one: say the Tamil for confusion, then the Tamil for a smile.

You'll want to know: கனிவான

கனிவான — *kaṉivāṉa* — "gentle, kind".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

கனிவான (*kaṉivāṉa*) is native: *kaṉivu*, "ripeness, compassion" (DEDR 1408, which lists Kannada kani 'pity'), with *-āṉa*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: kaṉivāṉa*
- *Say it: kaṉivāṉa*, once more
- *Say it:* say *kaṉivāṉa*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for confusion, then the Tamil for a smile, then say *kaṉivāṉa* again

Before you move on

What does **கனிவான** mean? ("Gentle, kind".) Say it once more.

268.5 நேர்மையான (nērmaiyāṉa) — honest

Before the new one: say the Tamil for a smile, then the Tamil for gentle.

You'll want to know: நேர்மையான

நேர்மையான — *nērmaiyāṉa* — "honest".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

நேர்மையான (*nērmaiyāṉa*) is native: *nērmai*, "straightness, honesty" (DEDR 3772, which lists Malayalam nēr), with *-āṉa*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *nērmaiyāṉa*
- *Say it:* *nērmaiyāṉa*, once more
- *Say it:* say *nērmaiyāṉa*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for a smile, then the Tamil for gentle, then say *nērmaiyāṉa* again

Before you move on

What does நேர்மையான mean? ("Honest".) Say it once more.

Chapter 269

Best, Different, Boring, Simple, Comfortable

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say best, different, boring, simple and comfortable.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 269: I can say best, different, boring, simple and comfortable.

269.1 சிறந்த (ciṟanta) — best, finest

Before the new one: say the Tamil for gentle, then the Tamil for honest.

You'll want to know: சிறந்த

சிறந்த — *ciṟanta* — "best, finest".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

சிறந்த (*ciṟanta*) is native Dravidian. DEDR 2589 lists Malayalam *ciṟakka*, "to be glorious". It is a participle of *ciṟa*, "to be eminent, to excel".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: ci̱ranta*
- *Say it: ci̱ranta*, once more
- *Say it:* say *ci̱ranta*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for gentle, then the Tamil for honest, then say *ci̱ranta* again

Before you move on

What does **சிறந்த** mean? (“Best, finest”.) Say it once more.

269.2 வித்தியாசமான (vittiyācamāṉa) — different, unusual

Before the new one: say the Tamil for honest, then the Tamil for best.

You’ll want to know: வித்தியாசமான

வித்தியாசமான — *vittiyācamāṉa* — “different, unusual”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

வித்தியாசமான (*vittiyācamāṉa*) is *vittiyācam*, “difference”, a well-established loan from Sanskrit *vyatyāsa*, “inversion, contrast”, with *-āṉa*.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: vittiyācamāṉa*
- *Say it: vittiyācamāṉa*, once more
- *Say it:* say *vittiyācamāṉa*

- *Recall:* say the Tamil for honest, then the Tamil for best, then say *vittiyācamāṉa* again

Before you move on

What does **வித்தியாசமான** mean? ("Different, unusual".) Say it once more.

269.3 சலிப்பான (calippāṉa) — boring

Before the new one: say the Tamil for best, then the Tamil for different.

You'll want to know: சலிப்பான

சலிப்பான — *calippāṉa* — "boring".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

சலிப்பான (*calippāṉa*) is native: *calippu*, "weariness" (DEDR 2371, which lists Malayalam calippu), with *-āṉa*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: calippāṉa*
- *Say it: calippāṉa*, once more
- *Say it:* say *calippāṉa*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for best, then the Tamil for different, then say *calippāṉa* again

Before you move on

What does **சலிப்பான** mean? ("Boring".) Say it once more.

269.4 எளிய (eḷiya) — simple, easy

Before the new one: say the Tamil for different, then the Tamil for boring.

You'll want to know: எளிய

எளிய — *eḷiya* — "simple, easy".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

எளிய (*eḷiya*) is native Dravidian. DEDR 855 lists Malayalam *eḷutu*, "easy". It comes from *eḷi*, "easy".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *eḷiya*
- *Say it:* *eḷiya*, once more
- *Say it:* say *eḷiya*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for different, then the Tamil for boring, then say *eḷiya* again

Before you move on

What does எளிய mean? ("Simple, easy".) Say it once more.

269.5 வசதியான (vacatiyāṉa) — comfortable, convenient

Before the new one: say the Tamil for boring, then the Tamil for simple.

You'll want to know: வசதியான

வசதியான — *vacatiyāṉa* — "comfortable, convenient".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

வசதியான (*vacatiyāṉa*) is *vacati*, "comfort, means", usually traced to Sanskrit *vasati*, "dwelling, abode", with *-āṉa*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: vacatiyāṉa*
- *Say it: vacatiyāṉa*, once more
- *Say it:* say *vacatiyāṉa*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for boring, then the Tamil for simple, then say *vacatiyāṉa* again

Before you move on

What does வசதியான mean? ("Comfortable, convenient".) Say it once more.

Chapter 270

Handkerchief, Earring, Chain, Chapati, Puri

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say a handkerchief, an earring, a chain, a chapati and a puri.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 270: I can say a handkerchief, an earring, a chain, a chapati and a puri.

270.1 கைக்குட்டை (kaikkuṭṭai) — a handkerchief

Before the new one: say the Tamil for simple, then the Tamil for comfortable.

You'll want to know: கைக்குட்டை

கைக்குட்டை — *kaikkuṭṭai* — "a handkerchief".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

கைக்குட்டை (*kaikkuṭṭai*) is native: *kai*, "hand" (DEDR 2023), and *kuṭṭai*, "kerchief, strip of cloth" (DEDR 1681, which lists Telugu guḍḍa 'cloth').

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: kaikkuṭṭai*
- *Say it: kaikkuṭṭai*, once more
- *Say it:* say *kaikkuṭṭai*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for simple, then the Tamil for comfortable, then say *kaikkuṭṭai* again

Before you move on

What does கைக்குட்டை mean? ("A handkerchief".) Say it once more.

270.2 தோடு (tōṭu) — an earring

Before the new one: say the Tamil for comfortable, then the Tamil for a handkerchief.

You'll want to know: தோடு

தோடு — *tōṭu* — "an earring".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

தோடு (*tōṭu*) is native Dravidian. DEDR 3545 lists Malayalam *tōṭa*, "ear-ring".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: tōṭu*
- *Say it: tōṭu*, once more
- *Say it:* say *tōṭu*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for comfortable, then the Tamil for a handkerchief, then say *tōṭu* again

Before you move on

What does **தோடு** mean? ("An earring".) Say it once more.

270.3 சங்கிலி (caṅkili) — a chain, a necklace

Before the new one: say the Tamil for a handkerchief, then the Tamil for an earring.

You'll want to know: சங்கிலி

சங்கிலி — *caṅkili* — "a chain, a necklace".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

சங்கிலி (*caṅkili*) is a loan from Sanskrit *śṛṅkhala*, "chain" (CDIAL 12580).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: caṅkili*
- *Say it: caṅkili*, once more
- *Say it:* say *caṅkili*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for a handkerchief, then the Tamil for an earring, then say *caṅkili* again

Before you move on

What does **சங்கிலி** mean? ("A chain, a necklace".) Say it once more.

270.4 சப்பாத்தி (cappāṭṭi) — a chapati

Before the new one: say the Tamil for an earring, then the Tamil for a chain.

You'll want to know: சப்பாத்தி

சப்பாத்தி — *cappātti* — "a chapati".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

சப்பாத்தி (*cappātti*) is a loan from Hindustani *capātī*, the flat bread of North India.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: cappātti*
- *Say it: cappātti*, once more
- *Say it:* say *cappātti*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for an earring, then the Tamil for a chain, then say *cappātti* again

Before you move on

What does சப்பாத்தி mean? ("A chapati".) Say it once more.

270.5 பூரி (pūri) — a puri, a puffed fried bread

Before the new one: say the Tamil for a chain, then the Tamil for a chapati.

You'll want to know: பூரி

பூரி — *pūri* — "a puri, a puffed fried bread".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

பூரி (*pūri*) is a loan from Hindustani *pūrī*, which goes back to Sanskrit *pūrikā*, "a cake" (CDIAL 8331).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: pūri*
- *Say it: pūri*, once more
- *Say it:* say *pūri*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for a chain, then the Tamil for a chapati, then say *pūri* again

Before you move on

What does பூரி mean? ("A puri, a puffed fried bread".) Say it once more.

Chapter 271

Coriander, Curry leaves, Apple, Orange, Papaya

Modes: **voice** (7) **Hands-free start:** all 7 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say coriander, curry leaves, an apple, an orange and a papaya.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 271: I can say coriander, curry leaves, an apple, an orange and a papaya.

271.1 கொத்தமல்லி (kottamalli) — coriander

Before the new one: say the Tamil for a chapati, then the Tamil for a puri.

You'll want to know: கொத்தமல்லி

கொத்தமல்லி — *kottamalli* — "coriander".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

The origin of கொத்தமல்லி (*kottamalli*) is uncertain. It is usually compared with Sanskrit *kustumbarī*, "coriander" (CDIAL 3380), which CDIAL itself takes as non-Aryan.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: kottamalli*
- *Say it: kottamalli*, once more
- *Say it:* say *kottamalli*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for a chapati, then the Tamil for a puri, then say *kottamalli* again

Before you move on

What does கொத்தமல்லி mean? ("Coriander".) Say it once more.

271.2 கறிவேப்பிலை (kaṟivēppilai) — curry leaves

Before the new one: say the Tamil for a puri, then the Tamil for coriander.

You'll want to know: கறிவேப்பிலை

கறிவேப்பிலை — *kaṟivēppilai* — "curry leaves".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

கறிவேப்பிலை (*kaṟivēppilai*) is native: *kaṟi*, "curry, vegetables" (DEDR 1391), and *vēppilai*, "neem leaf" (DEDR 5531): "the curry neem-leaf".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: kaṟivēppilai*
- *Say it: kaṟivēppilai*, once more
- *Say it:* say *kaṟivēppilai*

- *Recall:* say the Tamil for a puri, then the Tamil for coriander, then say *kaṟivēppilai* again

Before you move on

What does **கறிவேப்பிலை** mean? ("Curry leaves".) Say it once more.

271.3 ஆப்பிள் (āppiḷ) — an apple

Before the new one: say the Tamil for coriander, then the Tamil for curry leaves.

You'll want to know: ஆப்பிள்

ஆப்பிள் — *āppiḷ* — "an apple".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

ஆப்பிள் (*āppiḷ*) is a loan from English *apple*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *āppiḷ*
- *Say it:* *āppiḷ*, once more
- *Say it:* say *āppiḷ*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for coriander, then the Tamil for curry leaves, then say *āppiḷ* again

Before you move on

What does **ஆப்பிள்** mean? ("An apple".) Say it once more.

271.4 ஆரஞ்சு (ārañcu) — an orange

Before the new one: say the Tamil for curry leaves, then the Tamil for an apple.

You'll want to know: ஆரஞ்சு

ஆரஞ்சு — *ārañcu* — "an orange".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

ஆரஞ்சு (*ārañcu*) is a loan from English *orange*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *ārañcu*
- *Say it:* *ārañcu*, once more
- *Say it:* say *ārañcu*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for curry leaves, then the Tamil for an apple, then say *ārañcu* again

Before you move on

What does ஆரஞ்சு mean? ("An orange".) Say it once more.

271.5 பப்பாளி (pappāḷi) — a papaya

Before the new one: say the Tamil for an apple, then the Tamil for an orange.

You'll want to know: பப்பாளி

பப்பாளி — *pappāḷi* — "a papaya".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

பப்பாளி (*pappāḷi*) goes back to *papaya*, a Caribbean name for the fruit, which the Portuguese and Spanish carried to Asia. The exact path into Tamil is uncertain.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: pappāḷi*
- *Say it: pappāḷi*, once more
- *Say it:* say *pappāḷi*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for an apple, then the Tamil for an orange, then say *pappāḷi* again

Before you move on

What does பப்பாளி mean? ("A papaya".) Say it once more.

271.6 Words from chapters 263-266 — a first pass

Say the words for an orange and a papaya.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- traffic; transport, a footpath, an aeroplane, an airport, a ship
- opposite, between, a way, land, a valley
- a district, a hut, a tower, a prison, the world
- easily, on purpose, by chance, luckily, a reason

Before you move on

Traffic; transport? (போக்குவரத்து, *pōkkuvarattu.*) A footpath? (நடைபாதை, *naṭaipātai.*) An aeroplane? (விமானம், *vimāṉam.*) An airport? (விமான நிலையம், *vimāṉa nilaiyam.*) A ship? (கப்பல், *kappal.*) Opposite? (எதிரே, *etirē.*) Between? (இடையில், *iṭaiyil.*) A way? (வழி, *vaḻi.*) Land? (நிலம், *nilam.*) A valley? (பள்ளத்தாக்கு, *paḷḷattākku.*) A district? (மாவட்டம், *māvaṭṭam.*) A hut? (குடிசை, *kuṭicai.*) A tower? (கோபுரம், *kōpuram.*) A prison? (சிறை, *ciṟai.*) The world? (உலகம், *ulakam.*) Easily? (எளிதாக, *eḷitāka.*) On purpose? (வேண்டுமென்றே, *vēṇṭumeṉṟē.*) By chance? (தற்செயலாக, *taṟceyalāka.*) Luckily? (அதிர்ஷ்டவசமாக, *atirṣṭavacamāka.*) A reason? (காரணம், *kāraṇam.*)

271.7 Words from chapters 267-271 — a second pass

Say the words for fat and important.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- fat, important, urgent, crowded, easy
- enthusiasm, confusion, a smile, gentle, honest
- best, different, boring, simple, comfortable
- a handkerchief, an earring, a chain, a chapati, a puri
- coriander, curry leaves, an apple, an orange, a papaya

Before you move on

Fat? (குண்டான, *kuṇṭāṉa.*) Important? (முக்கியமான, *mukkiyamāṉa.*) Urgent? (அவசரமான, *avacaramāṉa.*) Crowded? (நெரிசலான, *nericalāṉa.*) Easy? (எளிதான, *eḷitāṉa.*) Enthusiasm? (உற்சாகம், *uṟcākam.*) Confusion? (குழப்பம்,

kuṉappam.) A smile? (புன்னகை, *puṉṉakai.*) Gentle? (கனிவான, *kaṉivāṉa.*) Honest? (நேர்மையான, *nērmaiyāṉa.*) Best? (சிறந்த, *ciṟanta.*) Different? (வித்தியாசமான, *vittiyācamāṉa.*) Boring? (சலிப்பான, *calippāṉa.*) Simple? (எளிய, *eḷiya.*) Comfortable? (வசதியான, *vacatiyāṉa.*) A handkerchief? (கைக்குட்டை, *kaikkuṭṭai.*) An earring? (தோடு, *tōṭu.*) A chain? (சங்கிலி, *caṅkili.*) A chapati? (சப்பாத்தி, *cappātti.*) A puri? (பூரி, *pūri.*) Coriander? (கொத்தமல்லி, *kottamalli.*) Curry leaves? (கறிவேப்பிலை, *kaṟivēppilai.*) An apple? (ஆப்பிள், *āppiḷ.*) An orange? (ஆரஞ்சு, *ārañcu.*) A papaya? (பப்பாளி, *pappāḷi.*)

Chapter 272

Identity card, Tax, Application, Photograph, Copy

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say an identity card, a tax, an application, a photograph and a copy.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 272: I can say an identity card, a tax, an application, a photograph and a copy.*

272.1 அடையாள அட்டை (aṭaiyāḷa aṭṭai) — an identity card

Before the new one: say the Tamil for an orange, then the Tamil for a papaya.

You'll want to know: அடையாள அட்டை

அடையாள அட்டை — *aṭaiyāḷa aṭṭai* — "an identity card".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

அடையாள அட்டை (*aṭaiyāḷa aṭṭai*) is native: *aṭaiyāḷam*, "mark, sign" (DEDR 89, which lists Malayalam aṭayāḷam), and *aṭṭai*, "cardboard" (DEDR 98): "the sign card".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: aṭaiyāḷa aṭṭai*
- *Say it: aṭaiyāḷa aṭṭai*, once more
- *Say it:* say *aṭaiyāḷa aṭṭai*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for an orange, then the Tamil for a papaya, then say *aṭaiyāḷa aṭṭai* again

Before you move on

What does அடையாள அட்டை mean? ("An identity card".) Say it once more.

272.2 வரி (vari) — a tax; a line (of text)

Before the new one: say the Tamil for a papaya, then the Tamil for an identity card.

You'll want to know: வரி

வரி — *vari* — "a tax; a line (of text)".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

வரி (*vari*) is native Dravidian. DEDR 5263 lists Malayalam *vara*, "line" and Kannada *bare*, "writing, lines". The entry glosses "line" and "to write"; the sense "tax" is probably the line in a register.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: vari*
- *Say it: vari*, once more
- *Say it:* say *vari*

- *Recall:* say the Tamil for a papaya, then the Tamil for an identity card, then say *vari* again

Before you move on

What does **வரி** mean? ("A tax; a line (of text)".) Say it once more.

272.3 விண்ணப்பம் (viṇṇappam) — an application

Before the new one: say the Tamil for an identity card, then the Tamil for a tax; a line.

You'll want to know: விண்ணப்பம்

விண்ணப்பம் — *viṇṇappam* — "an application".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

விண்ணப்பம் (*viṇṇappam*) is a well-established loan from Sanskrit *vijñāpana*, "a request, a making known".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: viṇṇappam*
- *Say it: viṇṇappam*, once more
- *Say it:* say *viṇṇappam*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for an identity card, then the Tamil for a tax; a line, then say *viṇṇappam* again

Before you move on

What does **விண்ணப்பம்** mean? ("An application".) Say it once more.

272.4 புகைப்படம் (pukaippaṭam) — a photograph

Before the new one: say the Tamil for a tax; a line, then the Tamil for an application.

You'll want to know: புகைப்படம்

புகைப்படம் — *pukaippaṭam* — "a photograph".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

புகைப்படம் (*pukaippaṭam*) is native *pukai*, "smoke" (DEDR 4240), and *paṭam*, "picture", from Sanskrit *paṭa*, "cloth" (CDIAL 7692): "smoke picture". Why "smoke" is not certain.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: pukaippaṭam*
- *Say it: pukaippaṭam*, once more
- *Say it:* say *pukaippaṭam*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for a tax; a line, then the Tamil for an application, then say *pukaippaṭam* again

Before you move on

What does புகைப்படம் mean? ("A photograph".) Say it once more.

272.5 நகல் (nakal) — a copy, a photocopy

Before the new one: say the Tamil for an application, then the Tamil for a photograph.

You'll want to know: நகல்

நகல் — *nakal* — "a copy, a photocopy".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

நகல் (*nakal*) is a loan from Arabic *naql*, "copy, transcript", which reached Tamil through Hindustani.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: nakal*
- *Say it: nakal*, once more
- *Say it:* say *nakal*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for an application, then the Tamil for a photograph, then say *nakal* again

Before you move on

What does நகல் mean? ("A copy, a photocopy".) Say it once more.

Chapter 273

Person, Parents, Sibling, Twins, Brother-in-law

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say a person, parents, a sibling, twins and a brother-in-law.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 273: I can say a person, parents, a sibling, twins and a brother-in-law.

273.1 ஆள் (āḷ) — a person

Before the new one: say the Tamil for a photograph, then the Tamil for a copy.

You'll want to know: ஆள்

ஆள் — *āḷ* — "a person".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

ஆள் (*āḷ*) is native Dravidian. DEDR 399 lists Malayalam *āḷ*, "a person" and Kannada *āḷ*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *āḷ*
- *Say it:* *āḷ*, once more
- *Say it:* say *āḷ*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for a photograph, then the Tamil for a copy, then say *āḷ* again

Before you move on

What does ஆள் mean? (“A person”.) Say it once more.

273.2 பெற்றோர் (perrōr) — parents

Before the new one: say the Tamil for a copy, then the Tamil for a person.

You’ll want to know: பெற்றோர்

பெற்றோர் — *perrōr* — “parents”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

பெற்றோர் (*perrōr*) is native: “those who bore”, from *peru*, “to get, to bear (a child)” (DEDR 4422, which lists Malayalam peruka).

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *perrōr*
- *Say it:* *perrōr*, once more
- *Say it:* say *perrōr*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for a copy, then the Tamil for a person, then say *perrōr* again

Before you move on

What does **பெற்றோர்** mean? (“Parents”.) Say it once more.

273.3 உடன்பிறந்தவர் (uṭaṉpiṟantavar) — a sibling

Before the new one: say the Tamil for a person, then the Tamil for parents.

You’ll want to know: உடன்பிறந்தவர்

உடன்பிறந்தவர் — *uṭaṉpiṟantavar* — “a sibling”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

உடன்பிறந்தவர் (*uṭaṉpiṟantavar*) is native: *uṭaṉ*, “together with” (DEDR 945), and *piṟantavar*, “one who was born”, from *piṟa*, “to be born” (DEDR 4422): “one born together with you”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: uṭaṉpiṟantavar*
- *Say it: uṭaṉpiṟantavar*, once more
- *Say it:* say *uṭaṉpiṟantavar*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for a person, then the Tamil for parents, then say *uṭaṉpiṟantavar* again

Before you move on

What does **உடன்பிறந்தவர்** mean? (“A sibling”.) Say it once more.

273.4 இரட்டையர் (iraṭṭaiyar) — twins

Before the new one: say the Tamil for parents, then the Tamil for a sibling.

You'll want to know: இரட்டையர்

இரட்டையர் — *iraṭṭaiyar* — "twins".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

இரட்டையர் (*iraṭṭaiyar*) is native Dravidian. DEDR 474 lists Malayalam *raṇṭu*, "two" and Telugu *reṇḍu*. The entry lists *iraṭṭai*, "pair", and *iraṭṭaiyar*, "twins", under the word for "two".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: iraṭṭaiyar*
- *Say it: iraṭṭaiyar*, once more
- *Say it:* say *iraṭṭaiyar*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for parents, then the Tamil for a sibling, then say *iraṭṭaiyar* again

Before you move on

What does இரட்டையர் mean? ("Twins".) Say it once more.

273.5 மைத்துனன் (maittuṉaṉ) — a brother-in-law

Before the new one: say the Tamil for a sibling, then the Tamil for twins.

You'll want to know: மைத்துனன்

மைத்துனன் — *maittuṉaṉ* — "a brother-in-law".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

மைத்துனன் (*maittuṉaṉ*) is a loan from Sanskrit *maithuna*, "paired, coupled" (CDIAL 10341); DEDR App. 53 traces the kinship sense through Prakrit.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: maittuṉaṉ*
- *Say it: maittuṉaṉ*, once more
- *Say it:* say *maittuṉaṉ*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for a sibling, then the Tamil for twins, then say *maittuṉaṉ* again

Before you move on

What does **மைத்துனன்** mean? ("A brother-in-law".) Say it once more.

Chapter 274

Music, Song, Story, God, Animal

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say music, a song, a story, God and an animal.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 274: I can say music, a song, a story, God and an animal.*

274.1 இசை (icai) — music

Before the new one: say the Tamil for twins, then the Tamil for a brother-in-law.

You'll want to know: இசை

இசை — *icai* — "music".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

இசை (*icai*) is native Dravidian. DEDR 470 lists Malayalam *ica*, "song, music". The entry glosses the Tamil verb *icai* as "to sound, to sing".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: icai*
- *Say it: icai*, once more
- *Say it:* say *icai*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for twins, then the Tamil for a brother-in-law, then say *icai* again

Before you move on

What does இசை mean? (“Music”.) Say it once more.

274.2 பாடல் (pāṭal) — a song

Before the new one: say the Tamil for a brother-in-law, then the Tamil for music.

You’ll want to know: பாடல்

பாடல் — *pāṭal* — “a song”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

பாடல் (*pāṭal*) is native Dravidian. DEDR 4065 lists Malayalam *pāṭuka*, “to sing”, Kannada *pāḍu* and Telugu *pāḍu*. It is the noun of *pāṭu*, “to sing”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: pāṭal*
- *Say it: pāṭal*, once more
- *Say it:* say *pāṭal*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for a brother-in-law, then the Tamil for music, then say *pāṭal* again

Before you move on

What does பாடல் mean? (“A song”.) Say it once more.

274.3 கதை (katai) — a story

Before the new one: say the Tamil for music, then the Tamil for a song.

You’ll want to know: கதை

கதை — *katai* — “a story”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

கதை (*katai*) is a loan from Sanskrit *kathā*, “conversation, story” (CDIAL 2704).

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: katai*
- *Say it: katai*, once more
- *Say it:* say *katai*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for music, then the Tamil for a song, then say *katai* again

Before you move on

What does **கதை** mean? (“A story”.) Say it once more.

274.4 கடவுள் (kaṭavuḷ) — God, a god

Before the new one: say the Tamil for a song, then the Tamil for a story.

You'll want to know: கடவுள்

கடவுள் — *kaṭavuḷ* — "God, a god".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

கடவுள் (*kaṭavuḷ*) is native: DEDR 1109 lists it under *kaṭa*, "to pass beyond", glossing it "god (who transcends speech and mind)".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: kaṭavuḷ*
- *Say it: kaṭavuḷ*, once more
- *Say it:* say *kaṭavuḷ*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for a song, then the Tamil for a story, then say *kaṭavuḷ* again

Before you move on

What does **கடவுள்** mean? ("God, a god".) Say it once more.

274.5 விலங்கு (vilaṅku) — an animal

Before the new one: say the Tamil for a story, then the Tamil for God.

You'll want to know: விலங்கு

விலங்கு — *vilaṅku* — "an animal".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

விலங்கு (*vilaṅku*) is usually explained as native *vilaṅku*, "to lie across" (DEDR 5423): an animal's body lies crosswise, unlike a person's.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: vilaṅku*
- *Say it: vilaṅku*, once more
- *Say it:* say *vilaṅku*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for a story, then the Tamil for God, then say *vilaṅku* again

Before you move on

What does விலங்கு mean? ("An animal".) Say it once more.

Chapter 275

Feather, Tail, Nest, Plant, Creeper

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say a feather, a tail, a nest, a plant and a creeper.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 275: I can say a feather, a tail, a nest, a plant and a creeper.*

275.1 இறகு (iṟaku) — a feather

Before the new one: say the Tamil for God, then the Tamil for an animal.

You'll want to know: இறகு

இறகு — *iṟaku* — "a feather".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

இறகு (*iṟaku*) is native Dravidian. DEDR 2591 lists Malayalam *iṟaku*, "wing" and Telugu *ṟekka*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: iṟaku*
- *Say it: iṟaku*, once more
- *Say it:* say *iṟaku*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for God, then the Tamil for an animal, then say *iṟaku* again

Before you move on

What does இறகு mean? (“A feather”.) Say it once more.

275.2 வால் (vāl) — a tail

Before the new one: say the Tamil for an animal, then the Tamil for a feather.

You’ll want to know: வால்

வால் — *vāl* — “a tail”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

வால் (*vāl*) is an early loan from Indo-Aryan *vāla*, “tail, hair” (CDIAL 11572). DEDR lists it in its appendix of such loans (DEDR App. 57), with Malayalam vāl and Telugu vālamu.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: vāl*
- *Say it: vāl*, once more
- *Say it:* say *vāl*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for an animal, then the Tamil for a feather, then say *vāl* again

Before you move on

What does வால் mean? (“A tail”.) Say it once more.

275.3 கூடு (kūṭu) — a nest

Before the new one: say the Tamil for a feather, then the Tamil for a tail.

You’ll want to know: கூடு

கூடு — *kūṭu* — “a nest”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

கூடு (*kūṭu*) is native Dravidian. DEDR 1883 lists Malayalam *kūṭu*, “nest, cage” and Kannada *gūḍu*. The entry compares Sanskrit *kūṭa*, “trap” (CDIAL 3397).

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: kūṭu*
- *Say it: kūṭu*, once more
- *Say it:* say *kūṭu*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for a feather, then the Tamil for a tail, then say *kūṭu* again

Before you move on

What does கூடு mean? (“A nest”.) Say it once more.

275.4 செடி (ceṭi) — a plant

Before the new one: say the Tamil for a tail, then the Tamil for a nest.

You'll want to know: செடி

செடி — *ceṭi* — "a plant".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

செடி (*ceṭi*) is native Dravidian. DEDR 1941 lists Malayalam *ceṭi*, "shrub" and Telugu *ceṭṭu*, "tree, plant".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: ceṭi*
- *Say it: ceṭi*, once more
- *Say it:* say *ceṭi*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for a tail, then the Tamil for a nest, then say *ceṭi* again

Before you move on

What does செடி mean? ("A plant".) Say it once more.

275.5 கொடி (koṭi) — a creeper, a vine; a flag

Before the new one: say the Tamil for a nest, then the Tamil for a plant.

You'll want to know: கொடி

கொடி — *koṭi* — "a creeper, a vine; a flag".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

கொடி (*koṭi*) is native in both senses: *koṭi*, "creeper" (DEDR 2050, which lists Malayalam koṭi), and *koṭi*, "banner, flag" (DEDR 2049).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: koṭi*
- *Say it: koṭi*, once more
- *Say it:* say *koṭi*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for a nest, then the Tamil for a plant, then say *koṭi* again

Before you move on

What does கொடி mean? ("A creeper, a vine; a flag".) Say it once more.

Chapter 276

Darkness, Shade, Machine, Sofa, Screwdriver

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say darkness, shade, a machine, a sofa and a screwdriver.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 276: I can say darkness, shade, a machine, a sofa and a screwdriver.

276.1 இருட்டு (iruṭṭu) — darkness

Before the new one: say the Tamil for a plant, then the Tamil for a creeper.

You'll want to know: இருட்டு

இருட்டு — *iruṭṭu* — "darkness".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

இருட்டு (*iruṭṭu*) is native Dravidian. DEDR 2552 lists Malayalam *iruṭṭu*, "darkness" and Telugu *irulu*. The same entry holds *iravu*, "night".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: iruṭṭu*
- *Say it: iruṭṭu*, once more
- *Say it:* say *iruṭṭu*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for a plant, then the Tamil for a creeper, then say *iruṭṭu* again

Before you move on

What does இருட்டு mean? (“Darkness”.) Say it once more.

276.2 நிழல் (nil̲al) — shade, a shadow

Before the new one: say the Tamil for a creeper, then the Tamil for darkness.

You’ll want to know: நிழல்

நிழல் — *nil̲al* — “shade, a shadow”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

நிழல் (*nil̲al*) is native Dravidian. DEDR 3679 lists Malayalam *nil̲al*, “shadow” and Kannada *nel̲al*.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: nil̲al*
- *Say it: nil̲al*, once more
- *Say it:* say *nil̲al*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for a creeper, then the Tamil for darkness, then say *nil̲al* again

Before you move on

What does நிழல் mean? ("Shade, a shadow".) Say it once more.

276.3 இயந்திரம் (iyantiram) — a machine

Before the new one: say the Tamil for darkness, then the Tamil for shade.

You'll want to know: இயந்திரம்

இயந்திரம் — *iyantiram* — "a machine".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

இயந்திரம் (*iyantiram*) is a loan from Sanskrit *yantra*, "any implement or contrivance" (CDIAL 10412).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: iyantiram*
- *Say it: iyantiram*, once more
- *Say it:* say *iyantiram*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for darkness, then the Tamil for shade, then say *iyantiram* again

Before you move on

What does இயந்திரம் mean? ("A machine".) Say it once more.

276.4 சோபா (cōpā) — a sofa

Before the new one: say the Tamil for shade, then the Tamil for a machine.

You'll want to know: சோபா

சோபா — *cōpā* — "a sofa".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

சோபா (*cōpā*) is a loan from English *sofa*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *cōpā*
- *Say it:* *cōpā*, once more
- *Say it:* say *cōpā*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for shade, then the Tamil for a machine, then say *cōpā* again

Before you move on

What does சோபா mean? ("A sofa".) Say it once more.

276.5 திருப்புளி (tiruppuḷi) — a screwdriver

Before the new one: say the Tamil for a machine, then the Tamil for a sofa.

You'll want to know: திருப்புளி

திருப்புளி — *tiruppuḷi* — "a screwdriver".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

திருப்புளி (*tiruppuḷi*) is native: *tiruppu*, "to turn" (DEDR 3246), and *uḷi*, "chisel" (DEDR 699): "the turning chisel".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: tiruppuḷi*
- *Say it: tiruppuḷi*, once more
- *Say it:* say *tiruppuḷi*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for a machine, then the Tamil for a sofa, then say *tiruppuḷi* again

Before you move on

What does திருப்புளி mean? ("A screwdriver".) Say it once more.

Chapter 277

Team, Victory, Defeat, Hobby, Opinion

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say a team, victory, defeat, a hobby and an opinion.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 277: I can say a team, victory, defeat, a hobby and an opinion.*

277.1 குழு (kuḻu) — a team, a group

Before the new one: say the Tamil for a sofa, then the Tamil for a screwdriver.

You'll want to know: குழு

குழு — *kuḻu* — "a team, a group".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

குழு (*kuḻu*) is native Dravidian. DEDR 1821 lists Kannada *guṇḍu*, "crowd, heap".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: kuḻu*
- *Say it: kuḻu*, once more
- *Say it:* say *kuḻu*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for a sofa, then the Tamil for a screwdriver, then say *kuḻu* again

Before you move on

What does குழு mean? ("A team, a group".) Say it once more.

277.2 வெற்றி (verṟi) — victory, a win

Before the new one: say the Tamil for a screwdriver, then the Tamil for a team.

You'll want to know: வெற்றி

வெற்றி — *verṟi* — "victory, a win".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

வெற்றி (*verṟi*) is native Dravidian. DEDR 5493 lists Malayalam *verṟi*, "victory". It comes from *vel*, "to conquer".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: verṟi*
- *Say it: verṟi*, once more
- *Say it:* say *verṟi*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for a screwdriver, then the Tamil for a team, then say *verṟi* again

Before you move on

What does **வெற்றி** mean? ("Victory, a win".) Say it once more.

277.3 தோல்வி (tōlvi) — defeat, a loss

Before the new one: say the Tamil for a team, then the Tamil for victory.

You'll want to know: தோல்வி

தோல்வி — *tōlvi* — "defeat, a loss".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

தோல்வி (*tōlvi*) is native Dravidian. DEDR 3558 lists Malayalam *tōlka*, "to be defeated" and Kannada *sōl*. It comes from *tōl*, "to be defeated".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: tōlvi*
- *Say it: tōlvi*, once more
- *Say it:* say *tōlvi*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for a team, then the Tamil for victory, then say *tōlvi* again

Before you move on

What does **தோல்வி** mean? ("Defeat, a loss".) Say it once more.

277.4 பொழுதுபோக்கு (poḻutupōkku) — a hobby, a pastime

Before the new one: say the Tamil for victory, then the Tamil for defeat.

You'll want to know: பொழுதுபோக்கு

பொழுதுபோக்கு — *poḻutupōkku* — "a hobby, a pastime".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

பொழுதுபோக்கு (*poḻutupōkku*) is native: *poḻutu*, "time" (DEDR 4559), and *pōkku*, "passing", from *pō*, "to go" (DEDR 4572): "a passing of time".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: poḻutupōkku*
- *Say it: poḻutupōkku*, once more
- *Say it:* say *poḻutupōkku*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for victory, then the Tamil for defeat, then say *poḻutupōkku* again

Before you move on

What does பொழுதுபோக்கு mean? ("A hobby, a pastime".) Say it once more.

277.5 கருத்து (karuttu) — an opinion, a view

Before the new one: say the Tamil for defeat, then the Tamil for a hobby.

You'll want to know: கருத்து

கருத்து — *karuttu* — "an opinion, a view".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

கருத்து (*karuttu*) is native Dravidian. DEDR 1283 lists Malayalam *karutuka*, "to think". It comes from *karutu*, "to intend, to consider".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: karuttu*
- *Say it: karuttu*, once more
- *Say it:* say *karuttu*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for defeat, then the Tamil for a hobby, then say *karuttu* again

Before you move on

What does **கருத்து** mean? ("An opinion, a view".) Say it once more.

Chapter 278

Sugarcane, Okra, Peanut, Watermelon, Murukku

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say sugarcane, okra, a peanut, a watermelon and murukku.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 278: I can say sugarcane, okra, a peanut, a watermelon and murukku.*

278.1 கரும்பு (karumpu) — sugarcane

> Before the new one: say the Tamil for a hobby, then the Tamil for an opinion.

You'll want to know: கரும்பு

கரும்பு — *karumpu* — "sugarcane".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

கரும்பு (*karumpu*) is native Dravidian. DEDR 1288 lists Malayalam *karimpu*, Kannada *kabbu* and Tulu *karmbu*, all "sugarcane".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: karumpu*
- *Say it: karumpu*, once more
- *Say it:* say *karumpu*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for a hobby, then the Tamil for an opinion, then say *karumpu* again

Before you move on

What does **கரும்பு** mean? ("Sugarcane".) Say it once more.

278.2 வெண்டைக்காய் (veṇṭaikkāy) — okra, ladies' finger

Before the new one: say the Tamil for an opinion, then the Tamil for sugarcane.

You'll want to know: வெண்டைக்காய்

வெண்டைக்காய் — *veṇṭaikkāy* — "okra, ladies' finger".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

வெண்டைக்காய் (*veṇṭaikkāy*) is *veṇṭai*, the name of the plant, and native *kāy*, "unripe fruit, vegetable" (DEDR 1459, which compares Indo-Aryan **kacca*, "raw"). The origin of *veṇṭai* is uncertain; DEDR has no entry for it.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: veṇṭaikkāy*
- *Say it: veṇṭaikkāy*, once more
- *Say it:* say *veṇṭaikkāy*

- *Recall:* say the Tamil for an opinion, then the Tamil for sugarcane, then say *veṇṭaikkāy* again

Before you move on

What does வெண்டைக்காய் mean? ("Okra, ladies' finger".) Say it once more.

278.3 நிலக்கடலை (nilakkaṭalai) — a peanut, a groundnut

Before the new one: say the Tamil for sugarcane, then the Tamil for okra.

You'll want to know: நிலக்கடலை

நிலக்கடலை — *nilakkaṭalai* — "a peanut, a groundnut".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

நிலக்கடலை (*nilakkaṭalai*) is native: *nilam*, "ground" (DEDR 3676), and *kaṭalai*, "Bengal gram" (DEDR 1120, which lists Kannada kaḍale): "the ground gram", since the nut ripens underground.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: nilakkaṭalai*
- *Say it: nilakkaṭalai*, once more
- *Say it:* say *nilakkaṭalai*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for sugarcane, then the Tamil for okra, then say *nilakkaṭalai* again

Before you move on

What does நிலக்கடலை mean? ("A peanut, a groundnut".) Say it once more.

278.4 தர்பூசணி (tarpūcaṇi) — a watermelon

Before the new one: say the Tamil for okra, then the Tamil for a peanut.

You'll want to know: தர்பூசணி

தர்பூசணி — *tarpūcaṇi* — "a watermelon".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

தர்பூசணி (*tarpūcaṇi*) is usually explained as Persian *tarbuz*, "watermelon", which reached Tamil through Hindustani, blended with Tamil *pūcaṇi*, "pumpkin".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: tarpūcaṇi*
- *Say it: tarpūcaṇi*, once more
- *Say it:* say *tarpūcaṇi*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for okra, then the Tamil for a peanut, then say *tarpūcaṇi* again

Before you move on

What does தர்பூசணி mean? ("A watermelon".) Say it once more.

278.5 முறுக்கு (mu̲rukku) — murukku (a crunchy spiral snack)

Before the new one: say the Tamil for a peanut, then the Tamil for a watermelon.

You'll want to know: முறுக்கு

முறுக்கு — *mu̲rukku* — "murukku (a crunchy spiral snack)".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

முறுக்கு (*mu̲rukku*) is native Dravidian. DEDR 5012 lists Malayalam *mu̲rukuka*, "to be twisted" and Kannada *mu̲ruku*. Its Malayalam *mu̲rukku* is glossed "a twisted cake", from "to twist".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *mu̲rukku*
- *Say it:* *mu̲rukku*, once more
- *Say it:* say *mu̲rukku*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for a peanut, then the Tamil for a watermelon, then say *mu̲rukku* again

Before you move on

What does முறுக்கு mean? ("Murukku (a crunchy spiral snack)".) Say it once more.

Chapter 279

Worker, Meeting, Manager, Engineer, Lawyer

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say a worker, a meeting, a manager, an engineer and a lawyer.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 279: I can say a worker, a meeting, a manager, an engineer and a lawyer.

279.1 தொழிலாளி (to̲lilāḷi) — a worker, a labourer

Before the new one: say the Tamil for a watermelon, then the Tamil for murukku.

You'll want to know: தொழிலாளி

தொழிலாளி — *to̲lilāḷi* — "a worker, a labourer".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

தொழிலாளி (*to̲lilāḷi*) is native: *to̲lil*, "work, occupation" (DEDR 3524), and *āḷi*, "one who does", from *āḷ*, "person" (DEDR 399).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: toḻilāḷi*
- *Say it: toḻilāḷi*, once more
- *Say it:* say *toḻilāḷi*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for a watermelon, then the Tamil for murukku, then say *toḻilāḷi* again

Before you move on

What does தொழிலாளி mean? ("A worker, a labourer".) Say it once more.

279.2 கூட்டம் (kūṭṭam) — a meeting; a crowd

Before the new one: say the Tamil for murukku, then the Tamil for a worker.

You'll want to know: கூட்டம்

கூட்டம் — *kūṭṭam* — "a meeting; a crowd".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

கூட்டம் (*kūṭṭam*) is native Dravidian. DEDR 1882 lists Malayalam *kūṭuka*, "to come together" and Kannada *kūḍu*. It comes from *kūṭu*, "to come together, to assemble".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: kūṭṭam*
- *Say it: kūṭṭam*, once more
- *Say it:* say *kūṭṭam*

- *Recall:* say the Tamil for murukku, then the Tamil for a worker, then say *kūṭṭam* again

Before you move on

What does **கூட்டம்** mean? (“A meeting; a crowd”.) Say it once more.

279.3 மேலாளர் (mēlāḷar) — a manager

Before the new one: say the Tamil for a worker, then the Tamil for a meeting; a crowd.

You’ll want to know: மேலாளர்

மேலாளர் — *mēlāḷar* — “a manager”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

மேலாளர் (*mēlāḷar*) is native: *mēl*, “what is above” (DEDR 5086), and *āḷar*, “persons”, from *āḷ* (DEDR 399): “the one above”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: mēlāḷar*
- *Say it: mēlāḷar*, once more
- *Say it:* say *mēlāḷar*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for a worker, then the Tamil for a meeting; a crowd, then say *mēlāḷar* again

Before you move on

What does **மேலாளர்** mean? (“A manager”.) Say it once more.

279.4 பொறியாளர் (poṟiyāḷar) — an engineer

Before the new one: say the Tamil for a meeting; a crowd, then the Tamil for a manager.

You'll want to know: பொறியாளர்

பொறியாளர் — *poṟiyāḷar* — "an engineer".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

பொறியாளர் (*poṟiyāḷar*) is *poṟi*, "machine, contrivance", and native *āḷar*, "persons", from *āḷ* (DEDR 399): "machine person". DEDR has *poṟi* only as "mark, impression", so the origin of the "machine" sense is uncertain.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: poṟiyāḷar*
- *Say it: poṟiyāḷar*, once more
- *Say it:* say *poṟiyāḷar*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for a meeting; a crowd, then the Tamil for a manager, then say *poṟiyāḷar* again

Before you move on

What does பொறியாளர் mean? ("An engineer".) Say it once more.

279.5 வழக்கறிஞர் (vaḻakkaṟiñar) — a lawyer

Before the new one: say the Tamil for a manager, then the Tamil for an engineer.

You'll want to know: வழக்கறிஞர்

வழக்கறிஞர் — *va̲lakka̲ri̲ñar* — "a lawyer".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

வழக்கறிஞர் (*va̲lakka̲ri̲ñar*) is native: *va̲lakku*, "lawsuit, custom" (DEDR 5292, which lists Malayalam va̲lakku), and *a̲ri̲ñar*, "those who know", from *a̲ri̲*, "to know" (DEDR 314): "one who knows lawsuits".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: va̲lakka̲ri̲ñar*
- *Say it: va̲lakka̲ri̲ñar*, once more
- *Say it:* say *va̲lakka̲ri̲ñar*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for a manager, then the Tamil for an engineer, then say *va̲lakka̲ri̲ñar* again

Before you move on

What does **வழக்கறிஞர்** mean? ("A lawyer".) Say it once more.

Chapter 280

Government, Rule, Fine, Complaint, Athlete

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (7) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 7 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say the government, a rule, a fine, a complaint and an athlete.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 280: I can say the government, a rule, a fine, a complaint and an athlete.*

280.1 அரசு (aracu) — the government

> Before the new one: say the Tamil for an engineer, then the Tamil for a lawyer.

You'll want to know: அரசு

அரசு — *aracu* — "the government".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

அரசு (*aracu*) is a loan from Sanskrit *rājan*, "king" (CDIAL 10679). DEDR 201 gives this source, and lists Malayalam aracu and Kannada arasu.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *aracu*
- *Say it:* *aracu*, once more
- *Say it:* say *aracu*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for an engineer, then the Tamil for a lawyer, then say *aracu* again

Before you move on

What does **அரசு** mean? ("The government".) Say it once more.

280.2 விதி (viti) — a rule

Before the new one: say the Tamil for a lawyer, then the Tamil for the government.

You'll want to know: விதி

விதி — *viti* — "a rule".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

விதி (*viti*) is a loan from Sanskrit *vidhi*, "rule; fate" (CDIAL 11755).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *viti*
- *Say it:* *viti*, once more
- *Say it:* say *viti*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for a lawyer, then the Tamil for the government, then say *viti* again

Before you move on

What does **விதி** mean? ("A rule".) Say it once more.

280.3 அபராதம் (aparātam) — a fine, a penalty

Before the new one: say the Tamil for the government, then the Tamil for a rule.

You'll want to know: அபராதம்

அபராதம் — *aparātam* — "a fine, a penalty".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

அபராதம் (*aparātam*) is a loan from Sanskrit *aparādha*, "offence" (CDIAL 439).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: aparātam*
- *Say it: aparātam*, once more
- *Say it:* say *aparātam*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for the government, then the Tamil for a rule, then say *aparātam* again

Before you move on

What does **அபராதம்** mean? ("A fine, a penalty".) Say it once more.

280.4 புகார் (pukār) — a complaint

Before the new one: say the Tamil for a rule, then the Tamil for a fine.

You'll want to know: புகார்

புகார் — *pukār* — "a complaint".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

புகார் (*pukār*) is a loan from Hindustani *pukār*, "a call, an outcry", which goes back to Indo-Aryan *pukkār*, "shout" (CDIAL 8246).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: pukār*
- *Say it: pukār*, once more
- *Say it:* say *pukār*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for a rule, then the Tamil for a fine, then say *pukār* again

Before you move on

What does புகார் mean? ("A complaint".) Say it once more.

280.5 வீரர் (vīrar) — an athlete, a sportsperson; a hero, a warrior

Before the new one: say the Tamil for a fine, then the Tamil for a complaint.

You'll want to know: வீரர்

வீரர் — *vīrar* — "an athlete, a sportsperson; a hero, a warrior".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

வீரர் (*vīrar*) is *vīrar*, "heroes", from Sanskrit *vīra*, "man, hero" (CDIAL 12056), with the respectful plural *-ar*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *vīrar*
- *Say it:* *vīrar*, once more
- *Say it:* say *vīrar*
- *Recall:* say the Tamil for a fine, then the Tamil for a complaint, then say *vīrar* again

Before you move on

What does **வீரர்** mean? ("An athlete, a sportsperson; a hero, a warrior".) Say it once more.

280.6 Words from chapters 272-275 — a first pass

Say the words for a complaint and an athlete.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- an identity card, a tax; a line, an application, a photograph, a copy
- a person, parents, a sibling, twins, a brother-in-law
- music, a song, a story, God, an animal
- a feather, a tail, a nest, a plant, a creeper

Before you move on

An identity card? (**அடையாள அட்டை**, *aṭaiyāḷa aṭṭai.*) A tax; a line? (**வரி**, *vari.*) An application? (**விண்ணப்பம்**, *viṇṇappam.*) A photograph? (**புகைப்படம்**, *pukaippaṭam.*) A copy? (**நகல்**, *nakal.*) A person? (**ஆள்**, *āḷ.*) Parents? (**பெற்றோர்**, *peṟṟōr.*) A sibling?

(உடன்பிறந்தவர், *uṭaṉpiṟantavar.*) Twins? (இரட்டையர், *iraṭṭaiyar.*) A brother-in-law? (மைத்துனன், *maittuṉaṉ.*) Music? (இசை, *icai.*) A song? (பாடல், *pāṭal.*) A story? (கதை, *katai.*) God? (கடவுள், *kaṭavuḷ.*) An animal? (விலங்கு, *vilaṅku.*) A feather? (இறகு, *iṟaku.*) A tail? (வால், *vāl.*) A nest? (கூடு, *kūṭu.*) A plant? (செடி, *ceṭi.*) A creeper? (கொடி, *koṭi.*)

280.7 Words from chapters 276-280 — a second pass

Say the words for darkness and shade.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- darkness, shade, a machine, a sofa, a screwdriver
- a team, victory, defeat, a hobby, an opinion
- sugarcane, okra, a peanut, a watermelon, murukku
- a worker, a meeting; a crowd, a manager, an engineer, a lawyer
- the government, a rule, a fine, a complaint, an athlete

Before you move on

Darkness? (இருட்டு, *iruṭṭu.*) Shade? (நிழல், *niḻal.*) A machine? (இயந்திரம், *iyantiram.*) A sofa? (சோபா, *cōpā.*) A screwdriver? (திருப்புளி, *tiruppuḷi.*) A team? (குழு, *kuḻu.*) Victory? (வெற்றி, *veṟṟi.*) Defeat? (தோல்வி, *tōlvi.*) A hobby? (பொழுதுபோக்கு, *poḻutupōkku.*) An opinion? (கருத்து, *karuttu.*) Sugarcane? (கரும்பு, *karumpu.*) Okra? (வெண்டைக்காய், *veṇṭaikkāy.*) A peanut? (நிலக்கடலை, *nilakkaṭalai.*) A watermelon? (தர்பூசணி, *tarpūcaṇi.*) Murukku? (முறுக்கு, *muṟukku.*) A worker? (தொழிலாளி, *toḻilāḷi.*) A meeting; a crowd? (கூட்டம், *kūṭṭam.*) A manager? (மேலாளர், *mēlāḷar.*) An engineer? (பொறியாளர், *poṟiyāḷar.*) A lawyer? (வழக்கறிஞர், *vaḻakkaṟiñar.*) The government? (அரசு, *aracu.*) A rule? (விதி,

viti.) A fine? (அபராதம், *aparātam.*) A complaint? (புகார், *pukār.*) An athlete? (வீரர், *vīrar.*)

The Tamil script — a reference

A **reference**, not a chapter — a place to look things up. You are *not* meant to read this before the lessons: the lessons teach reading through real words, introducing each letter as a word needs it. This page just gathers the system in one spot.

How the Tamil script works (the three facts the lessons teach)

1. **Consonants carry a built-in "a".** க = "ka," ம = "ma," ர = "ra." You never write the short *a* — it's already there.
2. **A vowel sign changes that built-in vowel.** Hooked onto a consonant, it swaps the *a* for another vowel — க ka + ி gives கி ki. The signs are ா = ā (கா = kā) · ி = i (கி = ki) · ீ = ī · ு = u · ூ = ū · ெ = e · ே = ē · ை = ai · ொ = o · ோ = ō · ௌ = au.
3. **A *puḷḷi* (the dot, ்) removes the built-in vowel.** க் = bare "k." A vowel-less consonant then leans into the next (க் + க → க்க, a held "kk").

Independent vowels (word-initial)

When a word *starts* with a vowel, a full vowel letter is used: அ a · ஆ ā · இ i · ஈ ī · உ u · ஊ ū · எ e · ஏ ē · ஐ ai · ஒ o · ஓ ō · ஔ au.

What makes Tamil distinctive

- **Three *n*'s, three *l*'s, two *r*'s.** Tamil *writes* the place of articulation: dental ந / alveolar ன / retroflex ண; ல ள ழ; ர ற.

English fuses each set into one letter and never notices; in Tamil they are distinct and can change meaning.

- **One letter, several sounds.** Tamil marks no voicing or aspiration: க can be *k*, *g*, or *h*; ச can be *s* or *ch* — **position** decides. The alphabet is small; the exact sound is read from context, picked up by ear.
- **No Sanskrit-only letters in the core set.** Classical Tamil gets by with 18 consonants; a handful of *grantha* letters (ஜ ja, ஷ ṣa, ஸ sa, ஹ ha) are added only to spell loanwords.

Tamil in the Dravidian family

Dravidian is a language family entirely separate from Indo-European (English, Latin, Sanskrit). Tamil is its oldest-attested member and the most protective of its native word-stock; its sisters — **Malayalam** (closest), then **Kannada** and **Telugu** — share the grammar and many roots but borrowed far more freely from Sanskrit. The lessons trace, word by word, which Tamil words are home-grown and which the sisters replaced (*vaṇakkam* vs. *namaskāra*; *naṉṟi* vs. *dhanyavāda*).

Glossary

This glossary collects every word and phrase taught in the book. Pronunciation appears when it differs from the written form; chapter numbers show where each entry is introduced.

-ஐ *-ai*
the accusative suffix -ai, which marks the one the verb is done to
Introduced in Chapter 86.

-உக்கு *-ukku*
the dative suffix -ukku, 'to / for,' including its two surface forms and irregular enakku
Introduced in Chapter 6.

... என்று நினைக்கிறேன் *… eṉṟu niṉaikkiṟēṉ*
giving an opinion — I think that …
Introduced in Chapter 77.

aaru eezhu ettu onpatu pattu
hear and say six to ten before meeting their written forms
Introduced in Chapter 7.

ஆச்சரியம் *āccariyam*
surprise
Introduced in Chapter 210.

ஆச்சரியப்படு *āccariyappaṭu*
to be surprised
Introduced in Chapter 257.

அச்சிடு *acciṭu*
to print
Introduced in Chapter 256.

அசிங்கமான *aciṅkamāṉa*
ugly
Introduced in Chapter 212.

அதனால் *adaṉāl*
because of that, so
Introduced in Chapter 78.

அது *adu*
that one — the thing over there
Introduced in Chapter 40.

ஐந்தாவது *aindāvadu*
fifth — the ending working on a number you already count with
Introduced in Chapter 82.

அகலமான *akalamāṉa*
wide
Introduced in Chapter 148.

அகராதி *akarāti*
a dictionary
Introduced in Chapter 215.

ஆகட்டும் *ākaṭṭum*
let it be so
Introduced in Chapter 56.

ஆகாயம் *ākāyam*
the sky
Introduced in Chapter 51.

ஆள் *āḷ*
a person
Introduced in Chapter 273.

அலை *alai*
a wave
Introduced in Chapter 128.

அழை *aḻai*
to call, to invite
Introduced in Chapter 154.

அழைப்பு *aḻaippu*
an invitation, a call
Introduced in Chapter 98.

அழகான *aḻakāṉa*
beautiful
Introduced in Chapter 143.

ஆழமான *āḻamāṉa*
deep
Introduced in Chapter 148.

ஆலமரம் *ālamaram*
a banyan tree
Introduced in Chapter 250.

அலமாரி *alamāri*
a cupboard
Introduced in Chapter 213.

அலங்கரி *alaṅkari*
to decorate
Introduced in Chapter 165.

அளவு *aḷavu*
a size, an amount
Introduced in Chapter 238.

அழி *aḻi*
to erase, to delete
Introduced in Chapter 256.

அழிப்பான் *aḻippāṉ*
an eraser, a rubber
Introduced in Chapter 221.

அல்லது *alladu*
or
Introduced in Chapter 76.

அழு *aḻu*
to cry
Introduced in Chapter 72.

அழுகை *aḻukai*
crying
Introduced in Chapter 90.

அழுக்கான *aḻukkāṉa*
dirty
Introduced in Chapter 145.

அழுத்து *aḻuttu*
to press
Introduced in Chapter 196.

அலுவலகம் *aluvalakam*
an office
Introduced in Chapter 115.

ஆம் *ām*
yes (ām)
Introduced in Chapter 1.

ஆம் / இல்லை / சரி *ām / illai / sari*
answering in Tamil — the five words in use, and the two habits behind them
Introduced in Chapter 1.

ஆமை *āmai*
a tortoise
Introduced in Chapter 130.

அமைதி *amaiti*
calm, peace, quiet
Introduced in Chapter 89.

அம்மி *ammi*
a grinding stone
Introduced in Chapter 190.

ஆண் *āṇ*
a man, male
Introduced in Chapter 245.

அணை *aṇai*
to put out; to hug
Introduced in Chapter 157.

ஆனால் *āṉāl*
but
Introduced in Chapter 76.

ஆனாலும் *āṉālum*
however, even so
Introduced in Chapter 176.

அன்பு *aṉbu*
affection
Introduced in Chapter 49.

அஞ்சல் தலை *añcal talai*
a postage stamp
Introduced in Chapter 244.

அஞ்சலகம் *añcalakam*
a post office
Introduced in Chapter 234.

ஆண்டு *āṇḍu*
a year
Introduced in Chapter 73.

அங்கே *aṅgē*
there — where I am not
Introduced in Chapter 40.

அணி *aṇi*
to wear
Introduced in Chapter 154.

ஆணி *āṇi*
a nail (to hammer)
Introduced in Chapter 135.

அணில் *aṇil*
a squirrel
Introduced in Chapter 247.

ஆங்கிலம் *āṅkilam*
English, the language
Introduced in Chapter 104.

அன்பளிப்பு *aṉpaḷippu*
a gift given with affection
Introduced in Chapter 99.

ஆந்தை *āntai*
an owl
Introduced in Chapter 131.

ஆண்டுதோறும் *āṇṭutōṟum*
every year, yearly
Introduced in Chapter 233.

அனுமதி *aṉumati*
permission
Introduced in Chapter 63.

அனுபவம் *aṉupavam*
an experience
Introduced in Chapter 177.

அனுப்பு *anuppu*
to send
Introduced in Chapter 151.

அபராதம் *aparātam*
a fine, a penalty
Introduced in Chapter 280.

ஆபத்தான *āpattāṉa*
dangerous
Introduced in Chapter 149.

அப்பா அம்மா அண்ணன் தம்பி அக்கா தங்கை *appā ammā aṇṇaṉ tambi akkā tangai*
father, mother, and FOUR sibling words — Tamil splits "brother"/"sister" by age, where Spanish/French use just one word each
Introduced in Chapter 12.

அப்படியே *appaḍiyē*
just so
Introduced in Chapter 47.

அப்படித்தான் *appaṭittāṉ*
that's how it is
Introduced in Chapter 97.

அப்படியா? *appaṭiyā?*
is that so?
Introduced in Chapter 96.

அப்படியானால் *appaṭiyāṉāl*
in that case
Introduced in Chapter 207.

ஆப்பிள் *āppiḷ*
an apple
Introduced in Chapter 271.

அப்போது *appōdu*
then, at that time
Introduced in Chapter 79.

அப்புறம் பார்க்கலாம் *appuṟam pārkkalām*
see you later
Introduced in Chapter 107.

அபூர்வமான *apūrvamāṉa*
rare
Introduced in Chapter 241.

அரசு *aracu*
the government
Introduced in Chapter 280.

அரை *arai*
to grind
Introduced in Chapter 161.

அறை *aṟai*
room — and the letter ற, the hard r that is not the r you think it is
Introduced in Chapter 35.

ஆரம்பி *ārampi*
to begin
Introduced in Chapter 226.

ஆரஞ்சு *ārañcu*
an orange
Introduced in Chapter 271.

அரண்மனை *araṇmaṉai*
a palace
Introduced in Chapter 236.

ஆறாவது *āṟāvadu*
sixth — the ending working on a number you already count with
Introduced in Chapter 83.

அரிப்பு *arippu*
an itch
Introduced in Chapter 261.

அறிவிப்பு *aṟivippu*
a notice, an announcement
Introduced in Chapter 160.

அறிவியல் *aṟiviyal*
science
Introduced in Chapter 252.

அறிவு *aṟivu*
knowledge
Introduced in Chapter 208.

ஆரோக்கியமான *ārōkkiyamāṉa*
healthy
Introduced in Chapter 238.

அர்த்தம் *arttam*
meaning
Introduced in Chapter 93.

அருகில் *arukil*
near, close by
Introduced in Chapter 113.

அருமையான *arumaiyāṉa*
wonderful, excellent
Introduced in Chapter 240.

அருங்காட்சியகம் *aruṅkāṭciyakam*
a museum
Introduced in Chapter 236.

அறுவடை *aṟuvaṭai*
the harvest
Introduced in Chapter 64.

அருவி *aruvi*
a waterfall
Introduced in Chapter 140.

ஆசிரியர் *āsiriyar*
a teacher
Introduced in Chapter 46.

ஆடை *āṭai*
clothing, a garment
Introduced in Chapter 242.

அடையாள அட்டை *aṭaiyāḷa aṭṭai*
an identity card
Introduced in Chapter 272.

அதற்குப் பதிலாக *ataṟkup patilāka*
instead
Introduced in Chapter 237.

அடடா *aṭaṭā*
oh dear!, wow!
Introduced in Chapter 96.

அதே *atē*
the same, that very one
Introduced in Chapter 95.

அதிகரி *atikari*
to increase, to go up
Introduced in Chapter 260.

அதிகாரி *atikāri*
an officer, an official
Introduced in Chapter 253.

அடிக்கடி *aṭikkaṭi*
often
Introduced in Chapter 171.

அதிர்ஷ்டவசமாக *atirṣṭavacamāka*
luckily, fortunately
Introduced in Chapter 266.

அத்தை *attai*
aunt, the father's sister
Introduced in Chapter 101.

ஆட்டோ *āṭṭō*
an auto-rickshaw
Introduced in Chapter 174.

ஆடு *āṭu*
a goat
Introduced in Chapter 58.

அடுப்பு *aṭuppu*
a stove
Introduced in Chapter 118.

அடுத்த *aṭutta*
next, coming
Introduced in Chapter 159.

அதுவரை *atuvarai*
until then
Introduced in Chapter 203.

அவசரமான *avacaramāṉa*
urgent
Introduced in Chapter 267.

அவசரப்படு *avacarappaṭu*
to hurry
Introduced in Chapter 228.

அவன் / அவள் *avaṉ / avaḷ*
he and she, the familiar pair the respectful word was built out of
Introduced in Chapter 85.

ஆவணம் *āvaṇam*
a document
Introduced in Chapter 244.

அவர் *avar*
that person — the far half of a pointing system whose pattern you were given without the words
Introduced in Chapter 37.

அவர்கள் *avarkaḷ*
they — the respectful word with the plural ending you have been saying since chapter two
Introduced in Chapter 85.

அவ்வப்போது *avvappōtu*
now and then, occasionally
Introduced in Chapter 262.

சக ஊழியர் *caka ūḻiyar*
a colleague
Introduced in Chapter 192.

சக்கரம் *cakkaram*
a wheel
Introduced in Chapter 221.

சளி *caḷi*
a cold, a runny nose
Introduced in Chapter 87.

சலிப்பான *calippāṉa*
boring
Introduced in Chapter 269.

சமை *camai*
to cook
Introduced in Chapter 150.

சமையலறை *camaiyalaṟai*
a kitchen
Introduced in Chapter 173.

சமாளி *camāḷi*
to manage, to cope with
Introduced in Chapter 231.

சமமான *camamāṉa*
equal
Introduced in Chapter 241.

சமாதானம் செய் *camātāṉam cey*
to make peace, to calm someone down
Introduced in Chapter 166.

சமீபத்தில் *camīpattil*
recently
Introduced in Chapter 158.

சாம்பல் *cāmpal*
grey; ash
Introduced in Chapter 150.

சம்பளம் *campaḷam*
a salary
Introduced in Chapter 222.

சாம்பார் *cāmpār*
sambar, a lentil and vegetable stew
Introduced in Chapter 183.

சம்பாதி *campāti*
to earn
Introduced in Chapter 197.

சங்கிலி *caṅkili*
a chain, a necklace
Introduced in Chapter 270.

சன்னல் *caṉṉal*
a window
Introduced in Chapter 173.

சான்றிதழ் *cāṉṟitaḻ*
a certificate
Introduced in Chapter 253.

சந்தை *cantai*
a market
Introduced in Chapter 115.

சண்டை போடு *caṇṭai pōṭu*
to quarrel, to fight
Introduced in Chapter 198.

சந்தேகப்படு *cantēkappaṭu*
to doubt, to suspect
Introduced in Chapter 230.

சந்து *cantu*
a lane, an alley
Introduced in Chapter 236.

சப்பாத்தி *cappātti*
a chapati
Introduced in Chapter 270.

சாப்பிட்டீர்களா? *cāppiṭṭīrkaḷā?*
have you eaten?
Introduced in Chapter 108.

சாப்பிடுங்கள் *cāppiṭuṅkaḷ*
please eat
Introduced in Chapter 98.

சரிபார் *caripār*
to check
Introduced in Chapter 163.

சரிதான் *caritāṉ*
that's right
Introduced in Chapter 96.

சரியாக *cariyāka*
exactly, correctly
Introduced in Chapter 95.

சர்க்கரை நோய் *carkkarai nōy*
diabetes
Introduced in Chapter 261.

சாதாரணமான *cātāraṇamāṉa*
ordinary, normal
Introduced in Chapter 241.

சதுரங்கம் *cataraṅkam*
chess
Introduced in Chapter 249.

சட்னி *caṭṉi*
a chutney
Introduced in Chapter 183.

சட்டைப்பை *caṭṭaippai*
a pocket
Introduced in Chapter 242.

சத்தமாக *cattamāka*
loudly
Introduced in Chapter 92.

சட்டி *caṭṭi*
a pan, a cooking pot
Introduced in Chapter 182.

சதுரமான *caturamāṉa*
square
Introduced in Chapter 240.

சாவி *cāvi*
a key
Introduced in Chapter 119.

சேகரி *cēkari*
to collect, to gather
Introduced in Chapter 200.

சேலை *cēlai*
a sari
Introduced in Chapter 121.

செலவு *celavu*
an expense, a cost
Introduced in Chapter 222.

செல்லப்பெயர் *cellappeyar*
a pet name, a nickname
Introduced in Chapter 103.

செல்லப்பிராணி *cellappirāṇi*
a pet
Introduced in Chapter 187.

செலுத்து *celuttu*
to pay
Introduced in Chapter 254.

சேர் *cēr*
to join, to reach
Introduced in Chapter 153.

செடி *ceṭi*
a plant
Introduced in Chapter 275.

செவிலியர் *ceviliyar*
a nurse
Introduced in Chapter 232.

செயலி *ceyali*
an app
Introduced in Chapter 189.

செய்தி *ceyti*
news; a message
Introduced in Chapter 185.

சித்திரை வைகாசி ஆனி ஆடி ஆவணி புரட்டாசி ஐப்பசி கார்த்திகை மார்கழி தை மாசி பங்குனி *Chithirai Vaikāsi Āṉi Āḍi Āvaṇi Puraṭṭāsi Aippasi Kārthigai Mārgazhi Thai Māsi Panguṉi*
the twelve months of the Tamil solar calendar — Tamil's OWN calendar, distinct from both the Gregorian and Hindu lunisolar systems
Introduced in Chapter 16.

சில நேரங்களில் *cila nēraṅkaḷil*
sometimes
Introduced in Chapter 171.

சிலந்தி *cilanti*
a spider
Introduced in Chapter 141.

சில்லறை *cillaṟai*
small change
Introduced in Chapter 191.

சிங்கம் *ciṅkam*
a lion
Introduced in Chapter 129.

சிறை *ciṟai*
a prison
Introduced in Chapter 265.

சீரகம் *cīrakam*
cumin
Introduced in Chapter 139.

சிறந்த *ciṟanta*
best, finest
Introduced in Chapter 269.

சீருடை *cīruṭai*
a uniform
Introduced in Chapter 221.

சிறுத்தை *ciṟuttai*
a leopard
Introduced in Chapter 187.

சித்தப்பா *cittappā*
the father's younger brother
Introduced in Chapter 101.

சீட்டு *cīṭṭu*
a ticket; a slip of paper
Introduced in Chapter 216.

சோகம் *cōkam*
sadness, grief
Introduced in Chapter 89.

சோம்பேறி *cōmpēṟi*
lazy; a lazy person
Introduced in Chapter 147.

சோபா *cōpā*
a sofa
Introduced in Chapter 276.

சோப்பு *cōppu*
soap
Introduced in Chapter 120.

சோர்வு *cōrvu*
weariness, fatigue
Introduced in Chapter 87.

சுமை *cumai*
a load, a burden
Introduced in Chapter 245.

சுற்று *cuṟṟu*
to go around, to wander
Introduced in Chapter 162.

சுற்றுலா *cuṟṟulā*
a tour, a sightseeing trip
Introduced in Chapter 205.

சுறுசுறுப்பான *cuṟucuṟuppāṉa*
active, energetic
Introduced in Chapter 180.

சூடான *cūṭāṉa*
hot
Introduced in Chapter 144.

சுதந்திரம் *cutantiram*
freedom
Introduced in Chapter 208.

சுத்தமான *cuttamāṉa*
clean
Introduced in Chapter 145.

சுத்தியல் *cuttiyal*
a hammer
Introduced in Chapter 135.

சூடு *cūṭu*
heat; hot
Introduced in Chapter 91.

சுவாசி *cuvāci*
to breathe
Introduced in Chapter 255.

சுவை பார் *cuvai pār*
to taste
Introduced in Chapter 225.

சுவையான *cuvaiyāṉa*
tasty
Introduced in Chapter 178.

சுவாரசியமான *cuvāraciyamāṉa*
interesting
Introduced in Chapter 180.

சுயநலமான *cuyanalamāṉa*
selfish
Introduced in Chapter 212.

எச்சரி *eccari*
to warn
Introduced in Chapter 231.

எடு *eḍu*
to take, to pick up — one vowel away from **இடு**, "to put," and pointing the opposite way
Introduced in Chapter 34.

ஏழை *ēḻai*
poor
Introduced in Chapter 146.

ஏழாவது *ēḻāvadu*
seventh — the ending working on a number you already count with
Introduced in Chapter 83.

எலி *eli*
a rat, a mouse
Introduced in Chapter 130.

எளிதாக *eḷitāka*
easily
Introduced in Chapter 266.

எளிதான *eḷitāṉa*
easy
Introduced in Chapter 267.

எளிய *eḷiya*
simple, easy
Introduced in Chapter 269.

எல்லாம் *ellām*
everything, all
Introduced in Chapter 181.

எழு *eḻu*
to get up, to rise
Introduced in Chapter 71.

எழுது *e̱ludu*
to write — carrying ழ, the retroflex glide Tamil and Malayalam kept and their sisters gave up
Introduced in Chapter 33.

எலும்பு *elumbu*
a bone
Introduced in Chapter 55.

எலுமிச்சை *elumiccai*
a lemon
Introduced in Chapter 139.

எழுப்பு *e̱luppu*
to wake (someone) up
Introduced in Chapter 255.

எழுதுங்கள் *e̱luturṅkaḷ*
please write it
Introduced in Chapter 94.

ஏமாற்றம் *ēmā̱ṟṟam*
disappointment
Introduced in Chapter 239.

ஏமாற்று *ēmā̱ṟṟu*
to cheat, to deceive
Introduced in Chapter 198.

எண் *eṇ*
a number (phone, house, account)
Introduced in Chapter 185.

என் *eṉ*
my
Introduced in Chapter 2.

ஏன் *ēṉ*
why
Introduced in Chapter 78.

ஏன் இல்லை? *ēṉ illai?*
why not?
Introduced in Chapter 97.

என் பெயர் ... *eṉ peyar …*
my name is… (with no “is”)
Introduced in Chapter 2.

எனக்குத் தமிழ் தெரியும் *enakkut tami̱l teriyum*
’I know Tamil’ — built with no subject, because knowing happens TO you
Introduced in Chapter 6.

ஏனென்றால் *ēṉeṉṟāl*
because
Introduced in Chapter 78.

எங்கே *eṅgē*
where? — asking about a place
Introduced in Chapter 40.

ஏணி *ēṇi*
a ladder
Introduced in Chapter 135.

என்ன *eṉṉa*
what
Introduced in Chapter 2.

என்ன சொன்னீர்கள்? *eṉṉa coṉṉīrkaḷ?*
what did you say?
Introduced in Chapter 94.

என்ன விசேஷம்? *eṉṉa vicēṣam?*
what's new?
Introduced in Chapter 108.

என்னை / உன்னை *eṉṉai / uṉṉai*
me and you as the one it is done to, standing on the same changed body the dative already used
Introduced in Chapter 86.

எண்ணெய் *eṇṇey*
oil
Introduced in Chapter 59.

எண்ணு *eṇṇu*
to count
Introduced in Chapter 154.

எப்படி *eppaḍi*
how
Introduced in Chapter 3.

எப்படி இருக்கீங்க? *eppaṭi irukkīṅka?*
how are you? (spoken)
Introduced in Chapter 108.

எப்படிச் சொல்வது? *eppaṭic colvatu?*
how do you say it?
Introduced in Chapter 93.

எப்போது *eppōdu*
when?
Introduced in Chapter 79.

எப்போதும் *eppōtum*
always
Introduced in Chapter 171.

எரி *eri*
to burn
Introduced in Chapter 157.

ஏரி *ēri*
a lake
Introduced in Chapter 126.

ஏற்கனவே *ēṟkaṉavē*
already
Introduced in Chapter 158.

ஏற்றுக்கொள் *ēṟṟukkoḷ*
to accept
Introduced in Chapter 256.

ஏறு *ēṟu*
to climb, to get on
Introduced in Chapter 153.

எருமை *erumai*
a buffalo
Introduced in Chapter 128.

எறும்பு *eṟumpu*
an ant
Introduced in Chapter 131.

எடை *eṭai*
weight
Introduced in Chapter 238.

எதிரே *etirē*
opposite
Introduced in Chapter 264.

எதிர்காலம் *etirkālam*
the future
Introduced in Chapter 172.

எதிர்பார் *etirpār*
to expect, to look forward to
Introduced in Chapter 159.

எட்டாவது *eṭṭāvadu*
eighth — the ending working on a number you already count with
Introduced in Chapter 83.

எவ்வளவு *evvaḷavu*
how much — the question for things Tamil does not count one by one
Introduced in Chapter 39.

இசை *icai*
music
Introduced in Chapter 274.

இடது *iḍadu*
the left side
Introduced in Chapter 66.

இது *idu*
this one — the thing near me
Introduced in Chapter 40.

இழ *i̲la*
to lose
Introduced in Chapter 196.

இலை *ilai*
a leaf
Introduced in Chapter 126.

இளைய *iḷaiya*
young, younger
Introduced in Chapter 147.

இளஞ்சிவப்பு *iḷañcivappu*
pink
Introduced in Chapter 211.

இளநீர் *iḷanīr*
tender coconut water
Introduced in Chapter 214.

இலவசம் *ilavacam*
free of charge
Introduced in Chapter 178.

இல்லை *illai*
no / there isn't (illai — the negative)
Introduced in Chapter 1.

இல்லவே இல்லை *illavē illai*
not at all
Introduced in Chapter 96.

இல்லாவிட்டால் *illāviṭṭāl*
otherwise, if not
Introduced in Chapter 176.

இழு *i̲lu*
to pull
Introduced in Chapter 155.

இணையம் *iṇaiyam*
the internet
Introduced in Chapter 216.

இணையதளம் *iṇaiyataḷam*
a website
Introduced in Chapter 189.

இஞ்சி *iñci*
ginger
Introduced in Chapter 124.

இங்கே *iṅgē*
here — where I am
Introduced in Chapter 40.

இனிமையான *iṉimaiyāṉa*
pleasant, sweet (of a voice or manner)
Introduced in Chapter 211.

இனிமேல் *iṉimēl*
from now on
Introduced in Chapter 159.

இனிய இரவு *iṉiya iravu*
"good night" — fully native Dravidian, "sweet/pleasant night," unlike Hindi, Kannada, Telugu, and Malayalam's shared Sanskrit-descended śubha rātri phrase; Tamil breaks the pattern this arc found in every other language
Introduced in Chapter 25.

இனிய பயணம் *iṉiya payaṇam*
have a good journey
Introduced in Chapter 107.

இன்னொரு முறை *iṉṉoru muṟai*
one more time
Introduced in Chapter 94.

இன்னும் *iṉṉum*
still, yet
Introduced in Chapter 62.

இன்னும் இல்லை *iṉṉum illai*
not yet
Introduced in Chapter 95.

இன்றிரவு *iṉṟiravu*
tonight
Introduced in Chapter 172.

இன்று *iṉṟu*
today
Introduced in Chapter 73.

இப்போது *ippōdu*
now
Introduced in Chapter 48.

இப்போதெல்லாம் *ippōtellām*
these days, nowadays
Introduced in Chapter 262.

இறைச்சி *iṟaicci*
meat
Introduced in Chapter 122.

இரக்கம் *irakkam*
pity, compassion
Introduced in Chapter 239.

இறகு *iṟaku*
a feather
Introduced in Chapter 275.

இரண்டாவது *iraṇḍāvadu*
second — and the ending that makes every other ordinal in the language
Introduced in Chapter 82.

இறங்கு *iṟaṅku*
to get down, to get off
Introduced in Chapter 153.

இரட்டையர் *iraṭṭaiyar*
twins
Introduced in Chapter 273.

இரத்தம் *irattam*
blood
Introduced in Chapter 169.

இரவு *iravu*
"night" — native Dravidian, already used standalone inside "midnight" (naḷḷiravu); a Sanskrit loan alternative, rāttiri, also exists — and per at least one dictionary source, rāttiri may actually be the MORE common word in everyday spoken Tamil, the opposite direction from **நாள்**'s story last lesson
Introduced in Chapter 24.

இரவு உணவு *iravu uṇavu*
dinner
Introduced in Chapter 184.

இரு *iru*
to be, to exist, to stay — and the three-piece machine every Tamil verb is built on
Introduced in Chapter 32.

இறுக்கமான *iṟukkamāṉa*
tight
Introduced in Chapter 209.

இருமல் *irumal*
a cough
Introduced in Chapter 87.

இருந்தாலும் *iruntālum*
even though, although
Introduced in Chapter 176.

இருட்டு *iruṭṭu*
darkness
Introduced in Chapter 276.

இடையில் *iṭaiyil*
between
Introduced in Chapter 264.

இதயம் *itayam*
the heart
Introduced in Chapter 169.

இடி *iṭi*
thunder
Introduced in Chapter 127.

இட்லி *iṭli*
an idli, a steamed rice cake
Introduced in Chapter 125.

இடுப்பு *iṭuppu*
the waist, the hip
Introduced in Chapter 169.

இதுவரை *ituvarai*
until now, so far
Introduced in Chapter 203.

இவர் *ivar*
this person, spoken of with respect — the near end of Tamil's இ / அ / எ pointing system
Introduced in Chapter 37.

இவர் என் நண்பர் *ivar eṉ naṇbar*
"this is my friend" — three words, no verb, and a choice of ending that says how you regard them
Introduced in Chapter 37.

இயக்கு *iyakku*
to operate, to run (a machine)
Introduced in Chapter 167.

இயந்திரம் *iyantiram*
a machine
Introduced in Chapter 276.

இயற்கை *iyaṟkai*
nature
Introduced in Chapter 248.

காசாளர் *kācāḷar*
a cashier
Introduced in Chapter 191.

கசப்பு *kacappu*
bitter
Introduced in Chapter 146.

கடை *kaḍai*
a shop
Introduced in Chapter 68.

கதவு *kadavu*
door — Tamil's everyday word is its own, while the Sanskrit one stayed in books
Introduced in Chapter 35.

காது *kādu*
an ear
Introduced in Chapter 45.

காகிதம் *kāgitam*
paper
Introduced in Chapter 120.

கை குலுக்கு *kai kulukku*
to shake hands
Introduced in Chapter 258.

கைக்குட்டை *kaikkuṭṭai*
a handkerchief
Introduced in Chapter 270.

கைப்பேசி *kaippēci*
a mobile phone
Introduced in Chapter 134.

கையெழுத்து *kaiyeḻuttu*
a signature; handwriting
Introduced in Chapter 105.

கையுறை *kaiyuṟai*
a glove
Introduced in Chapter 137.

காக்கை *kākkai*
a crow
Introduced in Chapter 58.

கால அட்டவணை *kāla aṭṭavaṇai*
a timetable
Introduced in Chapter 160.

கலாச்சாரம் *kalāccāram*
culture
Introduced in Chapter 246.

காலை *kālai*
morning (kālai) — Wiktionary itself HEDGES the etymology ("possibly from Sanskrit काल्य/kālya"), not a confirmed Dravidian root; genuinely uncertain, unlike Kannada's confidently-native or Telugu's confidently-Sanskrit morning-words; **பகல்** (already met, TA-C17, "daytime") is Wiktionary's own listed coordinate term; **அதிகாலை** ("early dawn") is a transparent ati-+kālai compound
Introduced in Chapter 26.

காளை *kāḷai*
a bull
Introduced in Chapter 187.

காலை உணவு *kālai uṇavu*
breakfast
Introduced in Chapter 184.

காலை வணக்கம் *kālai vaṇakkam*
good morning (kālai vaṇakkam), literally "morning greetings" — a transparent compound of **காலை** (already met, TA-C26) + **வணக்கம்** (already met, TA-C01, "reverence, homage"); confirmed via TWO independently-fetched sources as the standard, formal greeting, used from sunrise until around 11 AM; NOT a śubha-equivalent construction, breaking the pattern its neighbours share; a WebSearch summary's claim that a Sanskrit-borrowed "suprabhatham" is a casual alternative could NOT be traced to either directly-fetched source and is therefore not asserted here
Introduced in Chapter 29.

கலைஞர் *kalaiñar*
an artist
Introduced in Chapter 253.

களைப்பு *kaḷaippu*
tiredness
Introduced in Chapter 87.

காலக்கெடு *kālakkeṭu*
a deadline
Introduced in Chapter 203.

கலக்கு *kalakku*
to mix, to stir
Introduced in Chapter 161.

களம் *kaḷam*
a threshing floor
Introduced in Chapter 64.

கழற்று *kaḻaṟṟu*
to take off (clothes, shoes)
Introduced in Chapter 225.

கால்சட்டை *kālcaṭṭai*
trousers
Introduced in Chapter 242.

கழி *kaḻi*
to spend (time)
Introduced in Chapter 158.

கழிப்பறை *kaḻippaṟai*
a toilet
Introduced in Chapter 173.

காலியான *kāliyāṉa*
empty
Introduced in Chapter 209.

கல்லூரி *kallūri*
a college
Introduced in Chapter 105.

கால்பந்து *kālpantu*
football
Introduced in Chapter 249.

கழுகு *kaḻuku*
an eagle
Introduced in Chapter 247.

காலுறை *kāluṟai*
a sock
Introduced in Chapter 137.

கழுதை *kaḻutai*
a donkey
Introduced in Chapter 141.

கழுத்து *kaḻuttu*
the neck
Introduced in Chapter 55.

கழுவு *kaḻuvu*
to wash
Introduced in Chapter 71.

கல்வி *kalvi*
education
Introduced in Chapter 252.

கண் *kaṇ*
an eye
Introduced in Chapter 45.

கனல் *kaṉal*
an ember
Introduced in Chapter 57.

கனமான *kaṉamāṉa*
heavy
Introduced in Chapter 144.

கணவர் *kaṇavar*
a husband
Introduced in Chapter 100.

கனவு காண் *kaṉavu kāṇ*
to dream
Introduced in Chapter 229.

கணினி *kaṇiṉi*
a computer
Introduced in Chapter 134.

கணிதம் *kaṇitam*
mathematics
Introduced in Chapter 252.

கனிவான *kaṉivāṉa*
gentle, kind
Introduced in Chapter 268.

கன்னம் *kaṉṉam*
a cheek
Introduced in Chapter 142.

கண்ணாடி *kaṇṇāṭi*
a mirror; glasses
Introduced in Chapter 120.

கண்ணீர் *kaṇṇīr*
tears
Introduced in Chapter 90.

கன்று *kaṉṟu*
a calf
Introduced in Chapter 187.

கண்டிப்பாக *kaṇṭippāka*
definitely
Introduced in Chapter 97.

கண்டுபிடி *kaṇṭupiṭi*
to find
Introduced in Chapter 156.

கணுக்கால் *kaṇukkāl*
an ankle
Introduced in Chapter 169.

காபி *kāpi*
coffee
Introduced in Chapter 125.

கப்பல் *kappal*
a ship
Introduced in Chapter 263.

காப்பாற்று *kāppāṟṟu*
to save, to rescue
Introduced in Chapter 157.

கார் *kār*
a car
Introduced in Chapter 174.

காரம் *kāram*
spicy
Introduced in Chapter 146.

காரணம் *kāraṇam*
a reason, a cause
Introduced in Chapter 266.

கரண்டி *karaṇṭi*
a spoon
Introduced in Chapter 118.

கரடி *karaṭi*
a bear
Introduced in Chapter 129.

கரடுமுரடான *karaṭumuraṭāṉa*
rough, uneven
Introduced in Chapter 241.

கறிவேப்பிலை *kaṟivēppilai*
curry leaves
Introduced in Chapter 271.

கற்பனை செய் *kaṟpaṉai cey*
to imagine
Introduced in Chapter 230.

கற்பி *kaṟpi*
to teach
Introduced in Chapter 151.

காற்று *kāṟṟu*
the wind
Introduced in Chapter 57.

கற்றுக்கொள் *kaṟṟukkoḷ*
to learn
Introduced in Chapter 156.

கரும்பலகை *karumpalakai*
a blackboard
Introduced in Chapter 221.

கரும்பு *karumpu*
sugarcane
Introduced in Chapter 278.

கருப்பு வெள்ளை சிவப்பு நீலம் *karuppu veḷḷai sivappu nīlam*
black, white, red, blue — three native Tamil colors, and one Sanskrit loan
Introduced in Chapter 11.

கருத்து *karuttu*
an opinion, a view
Introduced in Chapter 277.

கருவி *karuvi*
a tool
Introduced in Chapter 117.

கட *kaṭa*
to cross
Introduced in Chapter 162.

கதை *katai*
a story
Introduced in Chapter 274.

கடைசியாக *kaṭaiciyāka*
finally, at last
Introduced in Chapter 262.

கடைக்காரர் *kaṭaikkārar*
a shopkeeper
Introduced in Chapter 191.

கடல் *kaṭal*
the sea
Introduced in Chapter 125.

காதல் *kātal*
romantic love
Introduced in Chapter 186.

காதலன் *kātalaṉ*
a boyfriend, a (male) lover
Introduced in Chapter 186.

காதலி *kātali*
a girlfriend, a (female) lover
Introduced in Chapter 186.

கடமை *kaṭamai*
a duty
Introduced in Chapter 208.

கடன் வாங்கு *kaṭaṉ vāṅku*
to borrow
Introduced in Chapter 254.

கடற்கரை *kaṭaṟkarai*
a beach
Introduced in Chapter 115.

கடவுச்சீட்டு *kaṭavuccīṭṭu*
a passport
Introduced in Chapter 244.

கடவுச்சொல் *kaṭavuccol*
a password
Introduced in Chapter 216.

கடவுள் *kaṭavuḷ*
God, a god
Introduced in Chapter 274.

கடிகாரம் *kaṭikāram*
a clock
Introduced in Chapter 121.

கடினமான *kaṭiṉamāṉa*
hard, difficult
Introduced in Chapter 145.

கடிதம் *kaṭitam*
a letter (to post)
Introduced in Chapter 215.

கட்டைவிரல் *kaṭṭaiviral*
a thumb
Introduced in Chapter 143.

கட்டணம் *kaṭṭaṇam*
a fee, a charge
Introduced in Chapter 215.

கத்தரிக்காய் *kattarikkāy*
an aubergine, a brinjal
Introduced in Chapter 243.

கத்தரிக்கோல் *kattarikkōl*
scissors
Introduced in Chapter 135.

கத்தி *katti*
a knife
Introduced in Chapter 54.

கட்டில் *kaṭṭil*
a bed
Introduced in Chapter 70.

காத்திருங்கள் *kāttiruṅkaḷ*
please wait
Introduced in Chapter 92.

கட்டிடம் *kaṭṭiṭam*
a building
Introduced in Chapter 205.

கட்டு *kaṭṭu*
to tie, to build
Introduced in Chapter 155.

கத்து *kattu*
to shout
Introduced in Chapter 154.

காட்டுங்கள் *kāṭṭuṅkaḷ*
please show me
Introduced in Chapter 93.

காடு *kāṭu*
a forest
Introduced in Chapter 126.

கடுகு *kaṭuku*
mustard seed
Introduced in Chapter 138.

காவல் நிலையம் *kāval nilaiyam*
a police station
Introduced in Chapter 205.

கவலை *kavalai*
worry, anxiety
Introduced in Chapter 89.

கவலைப்படாதீர்கள் *kavalaippaṭātīrkaḷ*
don't worry
Introduced in Chapter 99.

காவலர் *kāvalar*
a police officer
Introduced in Chapter 192.

கவனமாக *kavaṉamāka*
carefully
Introduced in Chapter 237.

கவனி *kavaṉi*
to pay attention, to notice
Introduced in Chapter 164.

காயம் *kāyam*
a wound, an injury
Introduced in Chapter 232.

காய்ச்சல் *kāyccal*
a fever
Introduced in Chapter 61.

கயிறு *kayiṟu*
a rope
Introduced in Chapter 60.

காய்கறி *kāykaṟi*
vegetables
Introduced in Chapter 123.

காய்ந்த *kāynta*
dry
Introduced in Chapter 148.

கேள் *kēḷ*
to ask — and to hear, because Tamil gives both jobs to one verb, whose stem changes shape before the beads
Introduced in Chapter 34.

கேலி செய் *kēli cey*
to tease, to make fun of
Introduced in Chapter 198.

கேமரா *kēmarā*
a camera
Introduced in Chapter 220.

கெஞ்சு *keñcu*
to beg, to plead
Introduced in Chapter 231.

கேட்கவில்லை *kēṭkavillai*
I did not hear it
Introduced in Chapter 93.

கெட்ட *keṭṭa*
bad
Introduced in Chapter 143.

கெட்டுப்போன *keṭṭuppōṉa*
spoiled, gone off
Introduced in Chapter 209.

கிளை *kiḷai*
a branch
Introduced in Chapter 52.

கிழக்கு *kiḻakku*
east
Introduced in Chapter 235.

கிளம்பலாமா? *kiḷampalāmā?*
shall we leave?
Introduced in Chapter 107.

கீழே *kīḻē*
down, below
Introduced in Chapter 66.

கிளி *kiḷi*
a parrot
Introduced in Chapter 131.

கிழி *kiḻi*
to tear
Introduced in Chapter 196.

கிள்ளு *kiḷḷu*
to pinch, to nip off
Introduced in Chapter 200.

கிண்ணம் *kiṇṇam*
a bowl
Introduced in Chapter 54.

கீரை *kīrai*
leafy greens
Introduced in Chapter 139.

கிராமம் *kirāmam*
a village
Introduced in Chapter 53.

கிரிக்கெட் *kiriket*
cricket
Introduced in Chapter 249.

கிட்டத்தட்ட *kiṭṭattaṭṭa*
almost, nearly
Introduced in Chapter 207.

கொசு *kocu*
a mosquito
Introduced in Chapter 132.

கோலம் *kōlam*
the design at a doorway
Introduced in Chapter 50.

கோழி *kōḻi*
a hen
Introduced in Chapter 58.

கொண்டாட்டம் *koṇṭāṭṭam*
celebration, festivities
Introduced in Chapter 246.

கொண்டாடு *koṇṭāṭu*
to celebrate
Introduced in Chapter 165.

கொண்டு வா *koṇṭu vā*
to bring
Introduced in Chapter 195.

கோபம் *kōpam*
anger
Introduced in Chapter 72.

கோப்பை *kōppai*
a cup
Introduced in Chapter 118.

கோபுரம் *kōpuram*
a tower, a temple gateway tower
Introduced in Chapter 265.

கொடி *koṭi*
a creeper, a vine; a flag
Introduced in Chapter 275.

கொதி *koti*
to boil (of liquids)
Introduced in Chapter 161.

கோட்டை *kōṭṭai*
a fort
Introduced in Chapter 236.

கொத்தமல்லி *kottamalli*
coriander
Introduced in Chapter 271.

கொத்தனார் *kottaṉār*
a mason, a bricklayer
Introduced in Chapter 224.

கொட்டாவி விடு *koṭṭāvi viṭu*
to yawn
Introduced in Chapter 168.

கொடு *koṭu*
give
Introduced in Chapter 42.

கோதுமை *kōtumai*
wheat
Introduced in Chapter 243.

கோயில் *kōyil*
a temple
Introduced in Chapter 114.

கொய்யா *koyyā*
a guava
Introduced in Chapter 139.

குடி *kuḍi*
drink
Introduced in Chapter 65.

குகை *kukai*
a cave
Introduced in Chapter 175.

குளம் *kuḷam*
a pond
Introduced in Chapter 126.

குழம்பு *kuḻambu*
a curry, a gravy
Introduced in Chapter 121.

குழந்தை *kuḻandai*
child
Introduced in Chapter 43.

குழந்தைகள் *kuḻantaikaḷ*
children
Introduced in Chapter 100.

குழந்தைப் பருவம் *kuḻantaip paruvam*
childhood
Introduced in Chapter 203.

குழப்பம் *kuḻappam*
confusion
Introduced in Chapter 268.

குழாய் *kuḻāy*
a tap, a pipe
Introduced in Chapter 182.

குளி *kuḷi*
to bathe
Introduced in Chapter 153.

குளிர்சாதனப் பெட்டி *kuḷircātaṉap peṭṭi*
a refrigerator
Introduced in Chapter 182.

குளிர்ந்த *kuḷirnta*
cold
Introduced in Chapter 144.

குளியலறை *kuḷiyalaṟai*
a bathroom
Introduced in Chapter 173.

குழு *kuḻu*
a team, a group
Introduced in Chapter 277.

குணம் *kuṇam*
character, nature (of a person)
Introduced in Chapter 210.

குணமாகு *kuṇamāku*
to recover, to get well
Introduced in Chapter 255.

குன்று *kuṉṟu*
a hill
Introduced in Chapter 140.

குண்டான *kuṇṭāṉa*
fat, plump
Introduced in Chapter 267.

குப்பை *kuppai*
rubbish, garbage
Introduced in Chapter 213.

குப்பி *kuppi*
a bottle
Introduced in Chapter 136.

குரை *kurai*
to bark
Introduced in Chapter 258.

கூரை *kūrai*
a roof
Introduced in Chapter 70.

குறை சொல் *kuṟai col*
to complain, to find fault
Introduced in Chapter 230.

குறைவு *kuṟaivu*
a shortage, less than there should be
Introduced in Chapter 56.

குரல் *kural*
a voice
Introduced in Chapter 245.

குரங்கு *kuraṅku*
a monkey
Introduced in Chapter 129.

குறிப்பாக *kuṟippāka*
especially, in particular
Introduced in Chapter 237.

குறிப்பேடு *kuṟippēṭu*
a notebook
Introduced in Chapter 184.

கூர்மையான *kūrmaiyāṉa*
sharp
Introduced in Chapter 240.

குறுகிய *kuṟukiya*
narrow
Introduced in Chapter 148.

குறும்பான *kuṟumpāṉa*
naughty, mischievous
Introduced in Chapter 180.

குறுஞ்செய்தி *kuṟuñceyti*
a text message
Introduced in Chapter 185.

குருவி *kuruvi*
a sparrow
Introduced in Chapter 247.

குடை *kuṭai*
an umbrella
Introduced in Chapter 60.

கூடை *kūṭai*
a basket
Introduced in Chapter 54.

கூடம் *kūṭam*
a hall, a living room
Introduced in Chapter 206.

கூடாரம் *kūṭāram*
a tent
Introduced in Chapter 250.

குதி *kuti*
to jump
Introduced in Chapter 152.

குடிசை *kuṭicai*
a hut
Introduced in Chapter 265.

குடிபெயர் *kuṭipeyar*
to move house, to relocate
Introduced in Chapter 197.

குதிரை *kutirai*
a horse
Introduced in Chapter 128.

குடியுங்கள் *kuṭiyuṅkaḷ*
please drink
Introduced in Chapter 99.

குட்டையான *kuṭṭaiyāṉa*
short
Introduced in Chapter 143.

கூட்டம் *kūṭṭam*
a meeting; a crowd
Introduced in Chapter 279.

கூடு *kūṭu*
a nest
Introduced in Chapter 275.

குடும்பம் *kuṭumbam*
family
Introduced in Chapter 43.

குடும்பப் பெயர் *kuṭumpap peyar*
a family name
Introduced in Chapter 103.

குயவர் *kuyavar*
a potter
Introduced in Chapter 224.

லேசான *lēcāṉa*
light (in weight)
Introduced in Chapter 144.

மசூதி *macūti*
a mosque
Introduced in Chapter 206.

மாதம் *mādam*
a month
Introduced in Chapter 73.

மகிழ்ச்சி *magi̱lcci*
joy / pleased to meet you
Introduced in Chapter 2.

மைதானம் *maitāṉam*
a playground, a sports ground
Introduced in Chapter 206.

மைத்துனன் *maittuṉaṉ*
a brother-in-law
Introduced in Chapter 273.

மகள் *makaḷ*
daughter
Introduced in Chapter 43.

மகன் *makaṉ*
son
Introduced in Chapter 43.

மலை *malai*
a hill
Introduced in Chapter 53.

மாலை *mālai*
evening (mālai) — a genuine HOMONYM: Wiktionary lists TWO separate etymologies for this exact spelling — "garland/necklace" (possibly a Dravidian word BORROWED INTO Sanskrit as माला/mālā, a reverse-direction loan) and, unrelated, "evening" (compared to **மால்**, Proto-Dravidian *mā*/māl, whose senses include "**கருமை**," darkness); confidently native for the evening sense, unlike TA-C26's uncertain **காலை**, though the exact semantic mechanism ("evening" ← "darkness" specifically) isn't spelled out with full certainty by the source
Introduced in Chapter 27.

மாலை வணக்கம் *mālai vaṇakkam*
good evening (mālai vaṇakkam), literally "evening greetings" — the SAME compositional pattern as TA-C29's kālai vaṇakkam: **மாலை** (already met, TA-C27, "evening") + **வணக்கம்** (already met, TA-C01); confirmed via TWO independently-fetched sources (talkpal.ai, preply.com — same practical-content tier as TA-C29's sources) as real and used from afternoon/late-afternoon through nightfall, one labeling it formal; no śubha-equivalent word here either, consistent with TA-C29's finding, not just assumed to carry over automatically
Introduced in Chapter 30.

மலர் *malar*
a flower
Introduced in Chapter 50.

மலிவான *malivāṉa*
cheap
Introduced in Chapter 178.

மல்லிகை *mallikai*
jasmine
Introduced in Chapter 188.

மாமா *māmā*
uncle, the mother's brother
Introduced in Chapter 101.

மாமனார் *māmaṉār*
a father-in-law
Introduced in Chapter 186.

மாமியார் *māmiyār*
a mother-in-law
Introduced in Chapter 102.

மாம்பழம் *māmpaḻam*
a mango
Introduced in Chapter 123.

மண் *maṇ*
soil, earth
Introduced in Chapter 126.

மான் *māṉ*
a deer
Introduced in Chapter 129.

மனைவி *maṉaivi*
a wife
Introduced in Chapter 100.

மணல் *maṇal*
sand
Introduced in Chapter 57.

மனம் *maṉam*
the mind, the heart
Introduced in Chapter 210.

மணமகள் *maṇamakaḷ*
a bride
Introduced in Chapter 217.

மணமகன் *maṇamakaṉ*
a bridegroom
Introduced in Chapter 217.

மாணவன் *māṇavaṉ*
a student
Introduced in Chapter 46.

மணி *maṇi*
hour — Tamil's OWN dictionaries treat this as a native Dravidian "bell" word, most likely NOT Kannada/Telugu/Hindi's Sanskrit ghaṇṭā, and a probable homophone trap with an unrelated Sanskrit "gem" word spelled the same way
Introduced in Chapter 18.

மணிக்கட்டு *maṇikkaṭṭu*
a wrist
Introduced in Chapter 142.

மன்னிக்கவும் *maṉṉikkavum*
please forgive (maṉṉikkavum — a formal/written polite request, from **மன்னி** maṉṉi "to forgive")
Introduced in Chapter 9.

மன்னித்துவிடுங்கள் *maṉṉittuviṭuṅkaḷ*
please forgive me
Introduced in Chapter 99.

மற *maṟa*
to forget
Introduced in Chapter 152.

மறை *maṟai*
to hide
Introduced in Chapter 157.

மரம் *maram*
a tree
Introduced in Chapter 52.

மரியாதை *mariyādai*
respect
Introduced in Chapter 49.

மார்பு *mārpu*
the chest
Introduced in Chapter 133.

மற்றது *maṟṟadu*
the other one
Introduced in Chapter 80.

மாற்று *māṟṟu*
to change
Introduced in Chapter 225.

மறு *maṟu*
to refuse, to deny
Introduced in Chapter 199.

மருமகள் *marumakaḷ*
a daughter-in-law
Introduced in Chapter 102.

மருமகன் *marumakaṉ*
a son-in-law
Introduced in Chapter 102.

மருந்துக்கடை *maruntukkaṭai*
a pharmacy
Introduced in Chapter 204.

மறுபடியும் *maṟupaṭiyum*
again
Introduced in Chapter 92.

மருத்துவமனை *maruttuvamaṉai*
a hospital
Introduced in Chapter 88.

மருத்துவர் *maruttuvar*
a doctor
Introduced in Chapter 46.

மடி *maṭi*
to fold
Introduced in Chapter 225.

மாடி *māṭi*
an upper floor, a storey
Introduced in Chapter 205.

மதிப்பெண் *matippeṇ*
a mark, a score
Introduced in Chapter 252.

மதிய உணவு *matiya uṇavu*
lunch
Introduced in Chapter 184.

மதிய வணக்கம் *matiya vaṇakkam*
good afternoon (matiya vaṇakkam), confirmed by two sources for roughly noon to 4 PM, while a third source does not teach a separate afternoon greeting
Introduced in Chapter 31.

மாத்திரை *māttirai*
a tablet, a pill
Introduced in Chapter 232.

மட்டும் *maṭṭum*
only
Introduced in Chapter 62.

மட்டுமல்லாமல் *maṭṭumallāmal*
not only (… but also)
Introduced in Chapter 237.

மாதுளை *mātuḷai*
a pomegranate
Introduced in Chapter 140.

மாவட்டம் *māvaṭṭam*
a district
Introduced in Chapter 265.

மாவு *māvu*
flour; batter
Introduced in Chapter 214.

மயங்கு *mayaṅku*
to faint, to pass out
Introduced in Chapter 231.

மயில் *mayil*
a peacock
Introduced in Chapter 131.

மேகம் *mēkam*
a cloud
Introduced in Chapter 51.

மெல் *mel*
to chew
Introduced in Chapter 226.

மேலாளர் *mēlāḷar*
a manager
Introduced in Chapter 279.

மேலே *mēlē*
up, above
Introduced in Chapter 66.

மெழுகுவர்த்தி *me̱lukuvartti*
a candle
Introduced in Chapter 189.

மேலும் *mēlum*
moreover, furthermore
Introduced in Chapter 176.

மென்மையான *me̱nmaiyā̱na*
soft
Introduced in Chapter 145.

மேற்கு *mē̱rku*
west
Introduced in Chapter 235.

மேசை *mēsai*
a table
Introduced in Chapter 70.

மெத்தை *mettai*
a mattress
Introduced in Chapter 134.

மெதுவாக *metuvāka*
slowly
Introduced in Chapter 92.

மீசை *mīcai*
a moustache
Introduced in Chapter 201.

மிக்க நன்றி *mikka nan̲r̲i*
thank you very much
Introduced in Chapter 49.

மிளகாய் *milakāy*
a chilli
Introduced in Chapter 124.

மிளகு *miḷaku*
pepper
Introduced in Chapter 138.

மீன் *mīn̲*
a fish
Introduced in Chapter 122.

மீனவர் *mīn̲avar*
a fisherman
Introduced in Chapter 224.

மின்சாரம் *min̲cāram*
electricity
Introduced in Chapter 213.

மீண்டும் சந்திப்போம் *mīṇḍum sandippōm*
we'll meet again
Introduced in Chapter 4.

மின்னல் *min̲n̲al*
lightning
Introduced in Chapter 127.

மின்னஞ்சல் *min̲n̲añcal*
an email
Introduced in Chapter 185.

மீண்டும் வாருங்கள் *mīṇṭum vāruṅkaḷ*
please come again
Introduced in Chapter 107.

மின்விசிறி *miṉviciṟi*
an electric fan
Introduced in Chapter 135.

மிருகக்காட்சிசாலை *mirukakkāṭcicālai*
a zoo
Introduced in Chapter 175.

மித *mita*
to float
Introduced in Chapter 260.

மிதிவண்டி *mitivaṇṭi*
a bicycle
Introduced in Chapter 174.

மோசமான *mōcamāṉa*
terrible, awful
Introduced in Chapter 181.

மொழி *moḻi*
a language
Introduced in Chapter 104.

மொழிபெயர் *moḻipeyar*
to translate
Introduced in Chapter 228.

மோர் *mōr*
buttermilk
Introduced in Chapter 214.

மோதிரம் *mōtiram*
a ring
Introduced in Chapter 137.

மொத்தம் *mottam*
the total
Introduced in Chapter 251.

மூடு *mūḍu*
close, shut
Introduced in Chapter 65.

முகம் *mukam*
the face
Introduced in Chapter 132.

முகவரி *mukavari*
an address
Introduced in Chapter 104.

முக்கியமான *mukkiyamāṉa*
important
Introduced in Chapter 267.

மூக்கு *mūkku*
a nose
Introduced in Chapter 45.

முள் *muḷ*
a thorn
Introduced in Chapter 188.

மூலை *mūlai*
a corner
Introduced in Chapter 116.

மூளை *mūḷai*
the brain
Introduced in Chapter 170.

முழங்கை *muḻaṅkai*
an elbow
Introduced in Chapter 142.

முழங்கால் *muḻaṅkāl*
a knee
Introduced in Chapter 133.

மூழ்கு *mūḻku*
to sink, to drown
Introduced in Chapter 260.

முன்பு *muṉbu*
before, earlier
Introduced in Chapter 73.

மூங்கில் *mūṅkil*
bamboo
Introduced in Chapter 219.

முன்கூட்டியே *muṉkūṭṭiyē*
in advance, beforehand
Introduced in Chapter 172.

முன்னால் *muṉṉāl*
in front
Introduced in Chapter 113.

முன்பதிவு செய் *muṉpativu cey*
to book in advance, to reserve
Introduced in Chapter 227.

மூன்றாவது *mūṉṟāvadu*
third — the ending working on a number you already count with
Introduced in Chapter 82.

முறுக்கு *muṟukku*
murukku (a crunchy spiral snack)
Introduced in Chapter 278.

முதல் *mutal*
first — the one word in the set you already had, hidden inside the word for first of all
Introduced in Chapter 82.

முதலை *mutalai*
a crocodile
Introduced in Chapter 218.

முதலாளி *mutalāḷi*
an employer, a boss
Introduced in Chapter 251.

முதலாவது *mutalāvadu*
first, with the ending on it — the exception is the stem, not the rule
Introduced in Chapter 82.

முதலில் *mutalil*
first of all
Introduced in Chapter 62.

முடி *muṭi*
hair
Introduced in Chapter 133.

மூடி *mūṭi*
a lid
Introduced in Chapter 182.

முடிதிருத்துபவர் *muṭitiruttupavar*
a barber
Introduced in Chapter 224.

முடிவு செய் *muṭivu cey*
to decide
Introduced in Chapter 159.

முடியும் *muṭiyum*
can, it is possible
Introduced in Chapter 116.

முட்டை *muṭṭai*
an egg
Introduced in Chapter 122.

முட்டாள் *muṭṭāḷ*
a fool; foolish
Introduced in Chapter 211.

முத்தமிடு *muttamiṭu*
to kiss
Introduced in Chapter 257.

முதுகு *mutuku*
the back
Introduced in Chapter 55.

மூடுபனி *mūṭupaṉi*
fog, mist
Introduced in Chapter 219.

முயல் *muyal*
a rabbit
Introduced in Chapter 129.

முயற்சி செய் *muyaṟci cey*
to try
Introduced in Chapter 195.

நட *naḍa*
walk
Introduced in Chapter 65.

நதி *nadi*
a river
Introduced in Chapter 53.

நகைச்சுவையான *nakaiccuvaiyāṉa*
funny, humorous
Introduced in Chapter 180.

நகல் *nakal*
a copy, a photocopy
Introduced in Chapter 272.

நகம் *nakam*
a nail
Introduced in Chapter 55.

நகர் *nakar*
to move, to shift
Introduced in Chapter 162.

நகரம் *nakaram*
a city
Introduced in Chapter 234.

நாக்கு *nākku*
the tongue
Introduced in Chapter 132.

நாள் *nāḷ*
"day" — Tamil's everyday, native Dravidian word, already met inside "tomorrow"; unlike Kannada's dina, Telugu's rōju, and Malayalam's divasam, Tamil's plain day-word is NOT a loanword at all — நாள் just is the everyday word, no Sanskrit or Persian substitute doing that job
Introduced in Chapter 23.

நாளை மறுநாள் *nāḷai maṟunāḷ*
the day after tomorrow
Introduced in Chapter 233.

நாளை பார்க்கலாம் *nāḷai pārkkalām*
see you tomorrow
Introduced in Chapter 4.

நலம் *nalam*
well, wellness, good — and the reply "nāṉ nalamāga irukkiṟēṉ"
Introduced in Chapter 3.

நாளிதழ் *nāḷitaḻ*
a newspaper
Introduced in Chapter 216.

நல்ல *nalla*
good
Introduced in Chapter 41.

நல்லா இருக்கீங்களா? *nallā irukkīṅkaḷā?*
are you well? (spoken)
Introduced in Chapter 108.

நல்வரவு *nalvaravu*
welcome (formal)
Introduced in Chapter 99.

நாம் / நாங்கள் *nām / nāṅgaḷ*
the two words for we — one that takes the listener in and one that leaves them out
Introduced in Chapter 85.

நம்பிக்கை *nambikkai*
trust
Introduced in Chapter 63.

நம்பு *nampu*
to believe
Introduced in Chapter 199.

நான் *nāṉ*
I
Introduced in Chapter 3.

நான் தமிழ் பேசுகிறேன் *nāṉ tamiḻ pēsugiṟēṉ*
I speak Tamil
Introduced in Chapter 5.

நான் உள்ளே வரலாமா? *nāṉ uḷḷē varalāmā?*
may I come in? — asking permission, and granting it
Introduced in Chapter 75.

நனைந்த *naṉainta*
wet
Introduced in Chapter 148.

நாணயம் *nāṇayam*
a coin
Introduced in Chapter 222.

நண்பன் *naṇbaṉ*
friend — one word with three endings for man, woman and respect, and a root meaning "close"
Introduced in Chapter 37.

நான்காவது *nāṉkāvadu*
fourth — the ending working on a number you already count with
Introduced in Chapter 82.

நண்பகல் நள்ளிரவு *naṇpakal naḷḷiravu*
noon and midnight — NO Sanskrit here at all (unlike Kannada/Telugu); both trace to the same old "middle" root, **நள்** (naḷ), but Tamil ALSO keeps fully transparent synonyms built on **நடு**, the everyday word for "middle"
Introduced in Chapter 17.

நன்றாக *naṉṟāka*
well, fine
Introduced in Chapter 91.

நன்றி *naṉṟi*
thank you (nanri — "goodness, gratitude")
Introduced in Chapter 1.

நாற்சந்தி *nāṟcanti*
a crossroads
Introduced in Chapter 234.

நரி *nari*
a fox
Introduced in Chapter 130.

நாற்காலி *nāṟkāli*
chair — a word you can take apart into "four" and "leg," and the thing a guest is offered
Introduced in Chapter 35.

நறுக்கு *naṟukku*
to chop
Introduced in Chapter 194.

நடைபாதை *naṭaipātai*
a footpath, a pavement
Introduced in Chapter 263.

நடனமாடு *naṭaṉamāṭu*
to dance
Introduced in Chapter 165.

நட்சத்திரம் *naṭcattiram*
a star
Introduced in Chapter 127.

நடி *naṭi*
to act (in a play or film)
Introduced in Chapter 259.

நடிகர் *naṭikar*
an actor
Introduced in Chapter 193.

நாட்காட்டி *nāṭkāṭṭi*
a calendar
Introduced in Chapter 172.

நட்பான *naṭpāṉa*
friendly
Introduced in Chapter 211.

நட்பு *naṭpu*
friendship
Introduced in Chapter 186.

நாடு *nāṭu*
a country
Introduced in Chapter 234.

நடுக்கம் *naṭukkam*
shivering, trembling
Introduced in Chapter 89.

நடுவில் *naṭuvil*
in the middle
Introduced in Chapter 114.

நாய், பூனை *nāy, pūnai*
dog and cat — நாய் is THE solid, ancient, undisputed Dravidian root behind Kannada/Malayalam's dog-words too, the honest opposite of the tangled dog-words of Spanish, Hindi, and English; பூனை is Tamil's everyday cat-word, one of (at least) three genuinely separate Dravidian cat-word families
Introduced in Chapter 21.

நாய்க்குட்டி *nāykkuṭṭi*
a puppy
Introduced in Chapter 247.

நேசி *nēci*
to love
Introduced in Chapter 228.

நெல் *nel*
paddy
Introduced in Chapter 64.

நேராக *nērāka*
straight ahead
Introduced in Chapter 113.

நேரம் *nēram*
time
Introduced in Chapter 48.

நேரமாகிவிட்டது *nēramākiviṭṭatu*
it has got late
Introduced in Chapter 106.

நெரிசலான *nericalāṉa*
crowded, congested
Introduced in Chapter 267.

நேர்காணல் *nērkāṇal*
an interview
Introduced in Chapter 223.

நேர்மையான *nērmaiyāṉa*
honest
Introduced in Chapter 268.

நெற்றி *neṟṟi*
the forehead
Introduced in Chapter 201.

நேற்று *nēṟṟu*
yesterday
Introduced in Chapter 73.

நேற்று முன்தினம் *nēṟṟu muṉtiṉam*
the day before yesterday
Introduced in Chapter 233.

நெருப்பு *neruppu*
fire
Introduced in Chapter 248.

நெய் *ney*
ghee
Introduced in Chapter 59.

நீ / நீங்கள் *nī / nīṅgaḷ*
you (familiar / respectful)
Introduced in Chapter 2.

நீச்சல் குளம் *nīccal kuḷam*
a swimming pool
Introduced in Chapter 206.

நிச்சயமாக *niccayamāka*
certainly
Introduced in Chapter 47.

நிச்சயதார்த்தம் *niccayatārttam*
an engagement (betrothal)
Introduced in Chapter 217.

நிகழ்ச்சி *nikaḻcci*
a programme, an event
Introduced in Chapter 220.

நிலா *nilā*
the moon
Introduced in Chapter 51.

நிலையம் *nilaiyam*
a station
Introduced in Chapter 69.

நிலக்கடலை *nilakkaṭalai*
a peanut, a groundnut
Introduced in Chapter 278.

நிழல் *niḻal*
shade, a shadow
Introduced in Chapter 276.

நிலம் *nilam*
land, the ground
Introduced in Chapter 264.

நீளமான *nīḷamāṉa*
long
Introduced in Chapter 143.

நிலநடுக்கம் *nilanaṭukkam*
an earthquake
Introduced in Chapter 248.

நினை *ninai*
to think — and, with no second word, to remember, because Tamil files thinking and recalling under one verb
Introduced in Chapter 33.

நினைவூட்டு *niṉaivūṭṭu*
to remind
Introduced in Chapter 197.

நீங்கள் எப்படி இருக்கிறீர்கள்? *nīṅgaḷ eppaḍi irukkiṟīrgaḷ?*
how are you? (respectful)
Introduced in Chapter 3.

நீந்து *nīntu*
to swim
Introduced in Chapter 152.

நிறைந்த *niṟainta*
full
Introduced in Chapter 209.

நிறைய *niṟaiya*
a lot
Introduced in Chapter 56.

நிறம் *niṟam*
a colour
Introduced in Chapter 238.

நிரப்பு *nirappu*
to fill
Introduced in Chapter 225.

நிறுத்து *niṟuttu*
stop
Introduced in Chapter 65.

நிறுவனம் *niṟuvaṉam*
a company, an organisation
Introduced in Chapter 223.

நீதிபதி *nītipati*
a judge
Introduced in Chapter 253.

நீட்டு *nīṭṭu*
to stretch out, to extend
Introduced in Chapter 168.

நோக்கம் *nōkkam*
a purpose, an aim
Introduced in Chapter 177.

நோயாளி *nōyāḷi*
a patient
Introduced in Chapter 232.

நுழை *nu̲lai*
to enter
Introduced in Chapter 254.

நூலகம் *nūlakam*
a library
Introduced in Chapter 115.

நூற்றாண்டு *nū̲rrāṇṭu*
a century
Introduced in Chapter 203.

ஓடு *ōḍu*
to run
Introduced in Chapter 71.

ஒல்லியான *olliyā̲na*
thin, slim
Introduced in Chapter 238.

ஒழுக்கமான *o̲lukkamā̲na*
well-behaved, disciplined
Introduced in Chapter 212.

ஒழுங்குபடுத்து *o̲luṅkupaṭuttu*
to tidy up, to arrange
Introduced in Chapter 259.

ஓநாய் *ōnāy*
a wolf
Introduced in Chapter 187.

ஒன்பதாவது *o̲npadāvadu*
ninth — the ending working on a number you already count with
Introduced in Chapter 83.

ஒன்றாக *o̲nṟāka*
together
Introduced in Chapter 237.

onru irantu muunru naanku aintu
hear and say one to five before meeting their written forms
Introduced in Chapter 7.

ஒன்றுமில்லை *o̲nṟumillai*
nothing, it's nothing
Introduced in Chapter 95.

ஒப்படை *oppaṭai*
to hand over, to hand in
Introduced in Chapter 164.

ஒப்பிடு *oppiṭu*
to compare
Introduced in Chapter 199.

ஒரு *oru*
a, one — the form **ஒன்று** takes when it stands in front of a noun
Introduced in Chapter 39.

ஒரு காலத்தில் *oru kālattil*
once, at one time
Introduced in Chapter 158.

ஒரு நிமிடம் *oru nimiṭam*
one minute, a moment
Introduced in Chapter 92.

ஒருபோதும் *orupōtum*
never (with a negative verb)
Introduced in Chapter 171.

ஒருவேளை *oruvēḷai*
perhaps
Introduced in Chapter 47.

ஓடை *ōṭai*
a stream, a brook
Introduced in Chapter 175.

ஒட்டகச்சிவிங்கி *oṭṭakacciviṅki*
a giraffe
Introduced in Chapter 218.

ஒட்டகம் *ottakam*
a camel
Introduced in Chapter 142.

ஒட்டு *oṭṭu*
to stick, to paste
Introduced in Chapter 167.

ஓட்டு *ōṭṭu*
to drive
Introduced in Chapter 195.

ஒத்துக்கொள் *ottukkoḷ*
to agree, to admit
Introduced in Chapter 199.

ஓட்டுநர் *ōṭṭunar*
a driver
Introduced in Chapter 192.

ஒவ்வாமை *ovvāmai*
an allergy
Introduced in Chapter 170.

ஓய்வு *ōyvu*
rest
Introduced in Chapter 87.

ஓய்வூதியம் *ōyvūtiyam*
a pension
Introduced in Chapter 253.

பசை *pacai*
glue
Introduced in Chapter 189.

பச்சை, மஞ்சள் *paccai mañcaḷ*
green and yellow — paccai is the pan-Dravidian *pac- word already met in Kannada, Telugu, and Malayalam; manjal ("yellow, turmeric") is a separate native Dravidian root, matching Malayalam's mañña/mañña̱ḷ closely — and Tamil dictionaries also record a rarer, less-commonly-used pacuppu ("greenish yellow"), a genuine doublet of paccai itself, echoing Telugu's pattern in miniature*
Introduced in Chapter 22.

படி *paḍi*
to read, to study — and the reason this book writes it paḍi with a d when the letter is ட
Introduced in Chapter 33.

பை *pai*
a bag
Introduced in Chapter 68.

பையன் *paiya̱n*
a boy; a son
Introduced in Chapter 100.

பகிர் *pakir*
to share
Introduced in Chapter 163.

பக்கத்து வீட்டுக்காரர் *pakkattu vīṭṭukkārar*
a neighbour
Introduced in Chapter 103.

பல் *pal*
a tooth
Introduced in Chapter 45.

பால் *pāl*
milk — one syllable, inherited whole, and the word that shows Kannada turning p into h
Introduced in Chapter 36.

பல் துலக்கு *pal tulakku*
to brush one's teeth
Introduced in Chapter 255.

பால் வேண்டுமா, அல்லது தேநீர் வேண்டுமா? *pāl vēṇḍumā, alladu tēnīr vēṇḍumā?*
offering somebody a choice between two things
Introduced in Chapter 76.

பல *pala*
many, several
Introduced in Chapter 181.

பழச்சாறு *paḻaccāṟu*
fruit juice
Introduced in Chapter 214.

பாலைவனம் *pālaivaṉam*
a desert
Introduced in Chapter 175.

பழைய *paḻaiya*
old — of a thing, not of a person
Introduced in Chapter 41.

பழக்கம் *paḻakkam*
a habit, a custom
Introduced in Chapter 246.

பழகு *paḻaku*
to get to know, to mix with (people)
Introduced in Chapter 165.

பழம் *paḻam*
a fruit
Introduced in Chapter 44.

பாலம் *pālam*
a bridge
Introduced in Chapter 114.

பலாப்பழம் *palāppaḻam*
a jackfruit
Introduced in Chapter 139.

பலவீனமான *palavīṉamāṉa*
weak
Introduced in Chapter 212.

பல்கலைக்கழகம் *palkalaikkaḻakam*
a university
Introduced in Chapter 252.

பள்ளத்தாக்கு *paḷḷattākku*
a valley
Introduced in Chapter 264.

பள்ளி *paḷḷi*
a school
Introduced in Chapter 105.

பல்பொருள் அங்காடி *palporuḷ aṅkāṭi*
a supermarket
Introduced in Chapter 204.

பல்துலக்கி *paltulakki*
a toothbrush
Introduced in Chapter 213.

பழுப்பு *paḻuppu*
brown
Introduced in Chapter 211.

பழுத்த *paḻutta*
ripe
Introduced in Chapter 178.

பழுது பார் *paḻutu pār*
to repair
Introduced in Chapter 259.

பல்வலி *palvali*
a toothache
Introduced in Chapter 232.

பாம்பு *pāmpu*
a snake
Introduced in Chapter 130.

பானை *pāṉai*
a clay pot
Introduced in Chapter 190.

பணக்கார *paṇakkāra*
rich
Introduced in Chapter 146.

பணம் *paṇam*
money
Introduced in Chapter 68.

பணப்பை *paṇappai*
a purse, a wallet
Introduced in Chapter 136.

பனி *paṉi*
dew, frost, snow
Introduced in Chapter 127.

பனிக்கட்டி *paṉikkaṭṭi*
ice
Introduced in Chapter 184.

பணிவு *paṇivu*
humility
Introduced in Chapter 63.

பண்ணை *paṇṇai*
a farm
Introduced in Chapter 175.

பன்றி *paṉṟi*
a pig
Introduced in Chapter 141.

பந்து *pantu*
a ball
Introduced in Chapter 136.

பப்பாளி *pappāḷi*
a papaya
Introduced in Chapter 271.

பார் *pār*
to see, to look — and the doubled consonant that sorts every Tamil verb into strong or weak
Introduced in Chapter 32.

பற *paṟa*
to fly
Introduced in Chapter 152.

பாறை *pāṟai*
a rock
Introduced in Chapter 248.

பாரம்பரியம் *pārampariyam*
tradition, heritage
Introduced in Chapter 246.

பாராட்டு *pārāṭṭu*
to praise
Introduced in Chapter 229.

பறவை *paṟavai*
a bird
Introduced in Chapter 58.

பரவாயில்லை *paravāyillai*
it's okay / no problem / you're welcome
Introduced in Chapter 3.

பரவு *paravu*
to spread (of news, disease, fire)
Introduced in Chapter 260.

பறி *paṟi*
to pick, to pluck
Introduced in Chapter 258.

பரிசு *paricu*
a gift, a prize
Introduced in Chapter 98.

பரிமாறு *parimāṟu*
to serve (food)
Introduced in Chapter 163.

பற்பசை *paṟpacai*
toothpaste
Introduced in Chapter 213.

பார்த்துக்கொள்ளுங்கள் *pārttukkoḷḷuṅkaḷ*
take care
Introduced in Chapter 106.

பருப்பு *paruppu*
lentils, dal
Introduced in Chapter 121.

பார்வையாளர் *pārvaiyāḷar*
a spectator, a viewer
Introduced in Chapter 193.

பசி *pasi*
hunger
Introduced in Chapter 61.

பசிக்கிறது *pasikkiṟatu*
(I) am hungry
Introduced in Chapter 90.

பசு *pasu*
a cow
Introduced in Chapter 58.

பாதை *pātai*
a path
Introduced in Chapter 53.

பாடகர் *pāṭakar*
a singer
Introduced in Chapter 193.

படகு *paṭaku*
a boat
Introduced in Chapter 174.

பாடல் *pāṭal*
a song
Introduced in Chapter 274.

பாடம் *pāṭam*
a lesson; a school subject
Introduced in Chapter 223.

படம் எடு *paṭam eṭu*
to take a photo
Introduced in Chapter 259.

பதற்றம் *patarṟam*
nervousness, tension
Introduced in Chapter 89.

படி *paṭi*
read
Introduced in Chapter 42.

படிக்கட்டு *paṭikkaṭṭu*
stairs, steps
Introduced in Chapter 204.

பதில் *patil*
an answer
Introduced in Chapter 138.

பதினொன்று — இருபது *patiṉoṉṟu — irupathu*
11-20 — additive "ten-echo" compounds for the teens, then **இருபது** (20), transparently "two-tens" — closing out the arc: all four Dravidian languages build twenty compositionally, unlike Sanskrit, Latin, or Arabic's opaque special words
Introduced in Chapter 20.

பதினொன்றாவது *patiṉoṉṟāvadu*
eleventh — proof the ending was never a fact about one to ten
Introduced in Chapter 83.

படிவம் *paṭivam*
a form (to fill in)
Introduced in Chapter 244.

பதிவேற்று *pativēṟṟu*
to upload
Introduced in Chapter 230.

பதிவிறக்கு *pativiṟakku*
to download
Introduced in Chapter 230.

பதிவு செய் *pativu cey*
to register, to record
Introduced in Chapter 227.

பட்டாசு *paṭṭācu*
firecrackers
Introduced in Chapter 246.

பட்டம் *paṭṭam*
a kite
Introduced in Chapter 136.

பட்டாம்பூச்சி *paṭṭāmpūcci*
a butterfly
Introduced in Chapter 218.

பத்தாவது *pattāvadu*
tenth — the ending working on a number you already count with
Introduced in Chapter 83.

பாட்டி *pāṭṭi*
a grandmother
Introduced in Chapter 101.

பாத்திரம் *pāttiram*
a vessel, a pot
Introduced in Chapter 118.

பத்திரமாக *pattiramāka*
safely
Introduced in Chapter 106.

பட்டியல் *paṭṭiyal*
a list
Introduced in Chapter 251.

பாடு *pāṭu*
to sing
Introduced in Chapter 150.

பாதுகாப்பான *pātukāppāṉa*
safe
Introduced in Chapter 149.

படுக்கையறை *paṭukkaiyaṟai*
a bedroom
Introduced in Chapter 173.

பாவாடை *pāvāṭai*
a skirt
Introduced in Chapter 121.

பாய் *pāy*
a mat
Introduced in Chapter 54.

பயம் *payam*
fear
Introduced in Chapter 72.

பயணம் *payaṇam*
a journey
Introduced in Chapter 48.

பயணி *payaṇi*
a passenger, a traveller
Introduced in Chapter 174.

பயன்படுத்து *payaṉpaṭuttu*
to use
Introduced in Chapter 195.

பயனுள்ள *payaṉuḷḷa*
useful
Introduced in Chapter 179.

பயிர் *payir*
a standing crop
Introduced in Chapter 64.

பயிற்சி செய் *payiṟci cey*
to practise
Introduced in Chapter 164.

பயிற்சியாளர் *payiṟciyāḷar*
a coach, a trainer
Introduced in Chapter 193.

பெண் *peṇ*
a woman, female
Introduced in Chapter 245.

பேனா *pēṉā*
a pen
Introduced in Chapter 120.

பென்சில் *peṉcil*
a pencil
Introduced in Chapter 215.

பேரம் பேசு *pēram pēcu*
to bargain
Introduced in Chapter 163.

பேரன் *pēraṉ*
a grandson
Introduced in Chapter 103.

பெரிய *periya*
big
Introduced in Chapter 41.

பெரியம்மா *periyammā*
the big mother (an elder aunt)
Introduced in Chapter 102.

பெரியப்பா *periyappā*
the father's elder brother
Introduced in Chapter 102.

பெற்றோர் *peṟṟōr*
parents
Introduced in Chapter 273.

பெருக்கு *perukku*
to sweep
Introduced in Chapter 156.

பெருமை *perumai*
pride
Introduced in Chapter 239.

பேருந்து *pērundu*
a bus
Introduced in Chapter 69.

பெருந்தன்மையான *peruntaṉmaiyāṉa*
generous, big-hearted
Introduced in Chapter 212.

பேசு *pēsu*
to speak
Introduced in Chapter 5.

பெட்டி *peṭṭi*
a box
Introduced in Chapter 54.

பேத்தி *pētti*
a granddaughter
Introduced in Chapter 103.

பெயர் *peyar*
name
Introduced in Chapter 2.

பிசை *picai*
to knead
Introduced in Chapter 194.

பிடி *piḍi*
to catch, to hold — and so, in **பிடிக்கும்**, to please, with the liker pushed into the dative
Introduced in Chapter 34.

பிழி *piḻi*
to squeeze, to wring out
Introduced in Chapter 260.

பின்னால் *piṉṉāl*
behind
Introduced in Chapter 113.

பின்பற்று *piṉpaṟṟu*
to follow (rules, directions)
Introduced in Chapter 256.

பிரச்சினை *piracciṉai*
a problem
Introduced in Chapter 177.

பிறகு *piṟaku*
afterwards
Introduced in Chapter 48.

பிறந்தநாள் *piṟantanāḷ*
a birthday
Introduced in Chapter 104.

பிரபலமான *pirapalamāṉa*
famous
Introduced in Chapter 149.

பிரார்த்தனை செய் *pirārttaṉai cey*
to pray
Introduced in Chapter 198.

பிரி *piri*
to separate, to part
Introduced in Chapter 229.

பிற்பகல் *piṟpakal*
afternoon (piṟpakal) — a transparent compound, **பின்** (piṉ, "after") + **நண்பகல்**'s own **பகல்** ("daytime"), with **பின்** surfacing as **பிற்**- before **ப**, a SIMILAR kind of consonant sandhi to the one already taught in TA-C17 (**நள்**→**நண்**) — though Wiktionary itself does not discuss the sandhi mechanism, and the two changes move in different phonetic directions (nasal→stop vs. lateral→nasal), so this is the lesson's own analysis, not a sourced claim; Wiktionary-listed formal register; a real, citable overlap worth flagging honestly: Wiktionary's OWN afternoon-word page ALSO lists **நடுப்பகல்** as a synonym, even though TA-C17 established **நடுப்பகல்** as a synonym of NOON specifically; also related but distinct: **மதியம்**, a Sanskrit tatsama (from madhya, "middle") meaning "noon," a synonym of **நண்பகல்** — NOT specifically "afternoon," despite an unverified WebSearch claim that matiyam "originally meant moon," which does not appear anywhere on its actual Wiktionary page and is therefore not asserted here
Introduced in Chapter 28.

பிடித்தமான *piṭittamāṉa*
favourite
Introduced in Chapter 181.

பிடிவாதமான *piṭivātamāṉa*
stubborn
Introduced in Chapter 180.

போ *pō*
to go (and vā, to come)
Introduced in Chapter 4.

போ *pō*
to go — the same three-slot verb with the middle bead swapped for past, present or future
Introduced in Chapter 32.

போதும் *pōdum*
that is enough
Introduced in Chapter 47.

போகலாம் *pōkalām*
let's go
Introduced in Chapter 106.

போக்குவரத்து *pōkkuvarattu*
traffic; transport
Introduced in Chapter 263.

பொழுதுபோக்கு *poḻutupōkku*
a hobby, a pastime
Introduced in Chapter 277.

பொம்மை *pommai*
a doll, a toy
Introduced in Chapter 136.

போன *pōṉa*
last, previous
Introduced in Chapter 158.

பொங்கல் *poṅkal*
pongal, a rice and lentil dish
Introduced in Chapter 183.

பொறாமை *poṟāmai*
jealousy
Introduced in Chapter 210.

பொறாமைப்படு *poṟāmaippaṭu*
to be jealous
Introduced in Chapter 257.

பொரி *pori*
to deep-fry
Introduced in Chapter 194.

பொரியல் *poriyal*
a dry stir-fried vegetable dish
Introduced in Chapter 183.

பொறியாளர் *poṟiyāḷar*
an engineer
Introduced in Chapter 279.

பொருள் *poruḷ*
a thing, an item
Introduced in Chapter 251.

பொறுத்துக்கொள் *poṟuttukkoḷ*
to put up with, to tolerate
Introduced in Chapter 166.

போர்வை *pōrvai*
a blanket
Introduced in Chapter 119.

பொட்டலம் *poṭṭalam*
a parcel, a packet
Introduced in Chapter 244.

பொத்தான் *pottāṉ*
a button
Introduced in Chapter 242.

போட்டி *pōṭṭi*
a competition, a match
Introduced in Chapter 249.

போடு *pōṭu*
to put, to drop
Introduced in Chapter 155.

பொதுவாக *poṭuvāka*
in general, generally
Introduced in Chapter 207.

பொய் சொல் *poy col*
to tell a lie
Introduced in Chapter 198.

போய் வருகிறேன் *pōy varugiṟēṉ*
goodbye (lit. “I’ll go and come back”)
Introduced in Chapter 4.

பொய்யான *poyyāṉa*
false
Introduced in Chapter 149.

பூச்சி *pūcci*
an insect
Introduced in Chapter 141.

பூசு *pūcu*
to paint (a wall), to coat, to smear on
Introduced in Chapter 200.

புடவை *puḍavai*
a sari
Introduced in Chapter 67.

புதிய *pudiya*
new
Introduced in Chapter 41.

புகை *pukai*
smoke
Introduced in Chapter 57.

புகைப்படம் *pukaippaṭam*
a photograph
Introduced in Chapter 272.

புகார் *pukār*
a complaint
Introduced in Chapter 280.

புல் *pul*
grass
Introduced in Chapter 64.

புலி *puli*
a tiger
Introduced in Chapter 128.

புளி *puḷi*
tamarind
Introduced in Chapter 138.

புளிப்பு *puḷippu*
sour
Introduced in Chapter 146.

புழு *puḻu*
a worm
Introduced in Chapter 247.

பூங்கா *pūṅkā*
a park
Introduced in Chapter 114.

புன்னகை *puṉṉakai*
a smile
Introduced in Chapter 268.

பூண்டு *pūṇṭu*
garlic
Introduced in Chapter 124.

புறா *puṟā*
a pigeon
Introduced in Chapter 131.

புறப்படு *puṟappaḍu*
to set out
Introduced in Chapter 48.

புரி *puri*
to be understood, to become clear — so the understander is not the subject but sits in the dative, as with **தெரி**
Introduced in Chapter 33.

பூரி *pūri*
a puri, a puffed fried bread
Introduced in Chapter 270.

புரியவில்லை *puriyavillai*
I don't understand
Introduced in Chapter 94.

புத்தகம் *puttakam*
a book
Introduced in Chapter 44.

புத்தாண்டு *puttāṇṭu*
the New Year
Introduced in Chapter 202.

புத்திசாலி *putticāli*
clever; a clever person
Introduced in Chapter 147.

பூட்டு *pūṭṭu*
a lock
Introduced in Chapter 119.

புயல் *puyal*
a storm
Introduced in Chapter 127.

ரசி *raci*
to enjoy, to appreciate
Introduced in Chapter 259.

ரசீது *racītu*
a receipt
Introduced in Chapter 160.

ரகசியம் *rakaciyam*
a secret
Introduced in Chapter 208.

ரசம் *rasam*
rasam
Introduced in Chapter 122.

ரத்து செய் *rattu cey*
to cancel
Introduced in Chapter 228.

ரவிக்கை *ravikkai*
a blouse (worn with a sari)
Introduced in Chapter 242.

ரயில் *rayil*
a train
Introduced in Chapter 69.

ரொம்ப நாளாச்சு *rompa nāḷāccu*
it's been a long time
Introduced in Chapter 108.

ரொட்டி *roṭṭi*
bread
Introduced in Chapter 214.

ரூபாய் *rūpāy*
a rupee
Introduced in Chapter 222.

சாலை *sālai*
a road
Introduced in Chapter 69.

சந்தோஷம் *santōṣam*
gladness
Introduced in Chapter 49.

சாப்பிடு *sāppiḍu*
to eat — a verb Tamil assembled from a noun plus a light verb, alongside the inherited eat-word it kept
Introduced in Chapter 32.

சரி *sari*
okay / alright / correct (sari)
Introduced in Chapter 1.

சர்க்கரை *sarkkarai*
sugar
Introduced in Chapter 59.

சட்டை *saṭṭai*
a shirt
Introduced in Chapter 67.

சேறு *sēṟu*
mud
Introduced in Chapter 57.

செருப்பு *seruppu*
a sandal, footwear
Introduced in Chapter 67.

சீக்கிரம் *sīkkiram*
soon
Introduced in Chapter 62.

சீப்பு *sīppu*
a comb
Introduced in Chapter 60.

சிரி *siri*
to laugh
Introduced in Chapter 72.

சிரிப்பு *sirippu*
laughter
Introduced in Chapter 90.

சிறிது *siṟitu*
a little
Introduced in Chapter 56.

சிறிய *siṟiya*
small
Introduced in Chapter 41.

சொல் *sol*
to say, to tell
Introduced in Chapter 77.

solluṅgaḷ
please tell me
Introduced in Chapter 8.

சொந்தம் *sontham*
one's own; a relative
Introduced in Chapter 8.

சுகம் *sugam*
wellbeing, ease — the Sanskrit word Tamil did take in, sitting beside the native **நலம்** it never dropped
Introduced in Chapter 38.

சூரியன் *sūriyaṉ*
the sun
Introduced in Chapter 51.

சுவர் *suvar*
a wall
Introduced in Chapter 70.

தச்சர் *taccar*
a carpenter
Introduced in Chapter 193.

தைரியமான *tairiyamāṉa*
brave
Introduced in Chapter 147.

தையல்காரர் *taiyalkārar*
a tailor
Introduced in Chapter 191.

தாகம் *tākam*
thirst
Introduced in Chapter 61.

தகவல் *takaval*
information
Introduced in Chapter 208.

தக்காளி *takkāḷi*
a tomato
Introduced in Chapter 124.

தலை கை *talai kai*
head and hand — both native Dravidian words, unlike Hindi's Sanskrit-descended pair
Introduced in Chapter 13.

தலைச்சுற்றல் *talaiccuṟṟal*
dizziness
Introduced in Chapter 261.

தலைக்கவசம் *talaikkavacam*
a helmet
Introduced in Chapter 221.

தலைநகரம் *talainakaram*
a capital city
Introduced in Chapter 234.

தலைவலி *talaivali*
a headache
Introduced in Chapter 88.

தலையணை *talaiyaṇai*
a pillow
Introduced in Chapter 119.

தளர்வான *taḷarvāṉa*
loose
Introduced in Chapter 209.

தளிர் *taḷir*
a tender shoot
Introduced in Chapter 52.

தள்ளு *taḷḷu*
to push
Introduced in Chapter 155.

தள்ளுபடி *taḷḷupaṭi*
a discount
Introduced in Chapter 222.

தழும்பு *taḻumpu*
a scar
Introduced in Chapter 170.

தாமரை *tāmarai*
a lotus
Introduced in Chapter 188.

தாமதம் *tāmatam*
a delay
Introduced in Chapter 171.

தாமதமாக *tāmatamāka*
late
Introduced in Chapter 262.

தமிழில் *tamiḻil*
in Tamil
Introduced in Chapter 93.

டம்ளர் *ṭamḷar*
a tumbler, a drinking glass
Introduced in Chapter 182.

தனிமை *taṉimai*
loneliness
Introduced in Chapter 239.

தனியாக *taṉiyāka*
alone
Introduced in Chapter 90.

தங்கு *taṅku*
to stay (overnight)
Introduced in Chapter 162.

தண்ணீர் அரிசி சாதம் *taṇṇīr arisi sātam*
water, and rice — the actual staple food here, not bread — with a widely-cited (if not fully certain) link from arisi to the English word "rice" itself
Introduced in Chapter 15.

தபால்காரர் *tapālkārar*
a postman
Introduced in Chapter 192.

தராசு *tarācu*
a pair of scales, a balance
Introduced in Chapter 250.

தரை *tarai*
the floor
Introduced in Chapter 70.

தற்செயலாக *taṟceyalāka*
by chance
Introduced in Chapter 266.

தர்பூசணி *tarpūcaṇi*
a watermelon
Introduced in Chapter 278.

தாடி *tāṭi*
a beard
Introduced in Chapter 201.

தடிமனான *taṭimaṉāṉa*
thick
Introduced in Chapter 181.

தாத்தா *tāttā*
a grandfather
Introduced in Chapter 101.

தட்டச்சு செய் *taṭṭaccu cey*
to type
Introduced in Chapter 228.

தட்டு *taṭṭu*
a plate
Introduced in Chapter 118.

தவளை *tavaḷai*
a frog
Introduced in Chapter 130.

தவறவிடு *tavaṟaviṭu*
to miss (a bus, a chance)
Introduced in Chapter 256.

தவறு *tavaṟu*
a mistake — the noun that lets you finish an apology, and the same word as the verb "to slip"
Introduced in Chapter 36.

தவிர் *tavir*
to avoid
Introduced in Chapter 197.

தயக்கம் *tayakkam*
hesitancy
Introduced in Chapter 63.

தயார் செய் *tayār cey*
to prepare
Introduced in Chapter 163.

தயவுசெய்து *tayavu seytu*
please (tayavu seytu — "do the kindness," from **தயவு** tayavu "compassion/grace")
Introduced in Chapter 8.

தயிர் *tayir*
curd
Introduced in Chapter 59.

தேதி *tēdi*
a date — and the second ordinal ending, the one a calendar uses
Introduced in Chapter 83.

தெளிவான *teḷivāṉa*
clear
Introduced in Chapter 179.

தேன் *tēṉ*
honey
Introduced in Chapter 124.

தேனீ *tēṉī*
a bee
Introduced in Chapter 218.

தேநீர் *tēnīr*
tea — a borrowed syllable welded onto the **நீர்** that is already inside **தண்ணீர்**
Introduced in Chapter 36.

தேநீர் / தேநீரை *tēnīr / tēnīrai*
the ending a person must have and a thing can do without — and the line Tamil draws where Spanish draws it too
Introduced in Chapter 86.

தேங்காய் *tēṅkāy*
a coconut
Introduced in Chapter 123.

தென்னைமரம் *teṉṉaimaram*
a coconut palm
Introduced in Chapter 188.

தென்றல் *teṉṟal*
a gentle breeze
Introduced in Chapter 219.

தேர்ச்சி பெறு *tērcci peṟu*
to pass (an exam)
Introduced in Chapter 164.

தெரி *teri*
to know, to be apparent — the verb that takes no person ending, because knowing happens to you
Introduced in Chapter 32.

தெரியாது *teriyātu*
(I) don't know
Introduced in Chapter 96.

தெற்கு *teṟku*
south
Introduced in Chapter 235.

தேர்ந்தெடு *tērnteṭu*
to choose
Introduced in Chapter 254.

தேற்று *tēṟṟu*
to comfort, to console
Introduced in Chapter 258.

தெரு *teru*
a street
Introduced in Chapter 114.

தேர்வு *tērvu*
an exam
Introduced in Chapter 138.

தேடு *tēṭu*
to look for
Introduced in Chapter 151.

தேவையில்லை *tēvaiyillai*
there is no need
Introduced in Chapter 56.

தேவாலயம் *tēvālayam*
a church
Introduced in Chapter 206.

திங்கள்–ஞாயிறு *thiṅgaḷ–ñāyiṟu*
the seven weekdays — a mix of Tamil's OWN planet-words and Sanskrit borrowings
Introduced in Chapter 10.

திசை *ticai*
a direction
Introduced in Chapter 235.

தீபாவளி *tīpāvaḷi*
Deepavali, the festival of lights
Introduced in Chapter 202.

தீப்பெட்டி *tīppeṭṭi*
a matchbox
Introduced in Chapter 190.

திற *tiṟa*
open
Introduced in Chapter 65.

திரை *tirai*
a screen
Introduced in Chapter 189.

திரைச்சீலை *tiraiccīlai*
a curtain
Introduced in Chapter 134.

திரைப்படம் *tiraippaṭam*
a film, a movie
Introduced in Chapter 220.

திரையரங்கம் *tiraiyaraṅkam*
a cinema
Introduced in Chapter 205.

திறமை *tiṟamai*
a skill, talent
Introduced in Chapter 116.

திராட்சை *tirāṭcai*
grapes
Introduced in Chapter 140.

திருமணம் *tirumaṇam*
a wedding, marriage
Introduced in Chapter 104.

திரும்பு *tirumpu*
to turn, to return
Introduced in Chapter 153.

திருப்பம் *tiruppam*
a turn
Introduced in Chapter 116.

திருப்பிக் கொடு *tiruppik koṭu*
to give back
Introduced in Chapter 195.

திருப்புளி *tiruppuḷi*
a screwdriver
Introduced in Chapter 276.

திருப்தி *tirupti*
satisfaction
Introduced in Chapter 239.

திருத்து *tiruttu*
to correct
Introduced in Chapter 227.

திருவிழா *tiruviḻā*
a temple festival
Introduced in Chapter 202.

தீர்வு *tīrvu*
a solution
Introduced in Chapter 177.

திடீரென்று *tiṭīreṉṟu*
suddenly
Introduced in Chapter 172.

திட்டம் *tiṭṭam*
a plan
Introduced in Chapter 159.

திட்டு *tiṭṭu*
to scold
Introduced in Chapter 229.

தீவு *tīvu*
an island
Introduced in Chapter 141.

தோசை *tōcai*
a dosa, a thin pancake
Introduced in Chapter 125.

தோல் *tōl*
the skin
Introduced in Chapter 133.

தோள் *tōḷ*
a shoulder
Introduced in Chapter 133.

தொலைக்காட்சி *tolaikkāṭci*
a television
Introduced in Chapter 134.

தொழில் *toḻil*
an occupation, a trade
Introduced in Chapter 105.

தொழிலாளி *toḻilāḷi*
a worker, a labourer
Introduced in Chapter 279.

தொழிற்சாலை *toḻiṟcālai*
a factory
Introduced in Chapter 223.

தோல்வி *tōlvi*
defeat, a loss
Introduced in Chapter 277.

தொங்கு *toṅku*
to hang (intransitive), to dangle
Introduced in Chapter 167.

தொண்டை *toṇṭai*
the throat
Introduced in Chapter 169.

தோண்டு *tōṇṭu*
to dig
Introduced in Chapter 168.

தொப்பி *toppi*
a cap, a hat
Introduced in Chapter 67.

தொற்று *toṟṟu*
an infection
Introduced in Chapter 170.

தொடர் *toṭar*
to continue
Introduced in Chapter 167.

தொடர்பு கொள் *toṭarpu koḷ*
to contact, to get in touch
Introduced in Chapter 197.

தோட்டம் *tōṭṭam*
a garden
Introduced in Chapter 116.

தொட்டி *toṭṭi*
a tank, a tub
Introduced in Chapter 190.

தொடு *toṭu*
to touch
Introduced in Chapter 226.

தோடு *tōṭu*
an earring
Introduced in Chapter 270.

தூக்கம் *tūkkam*
sleep
Introduced in Chapter 61.

தூக்கம் வருகிறது *tūkkam varukiṟatu*
(I) am sleepy
Introduced in Chapter 91.

தூக்கு *tūkku*
to lift
Introduced in Chapter 162.

தும்மு *tummu*
to sneeze
Introduced in Chapter 226.

தூங்கு *tūṅgu*
to sleep
Introduced in Chapter 71.

துணி *tuṇi*
cloth
Introduced in Chapter 44.

துணிக்கடை *tuṇikkaṭai*
a clothes shop
Introduced in Chapter 204.

துண்டு *tuṇṭu*
a towel; a piece
Introduced in Chapter 119.

துறைமுகம் *tuṟaimukam*
a harbour, a port
Introduced in Chapter 236.

தூரம் *tūram*
distance; far
Introduced in Chapter 113.

துடை *tuṭai*
to wipe
Introduced in Chapter 156.

துடைப்பம் *tuṭaippam*
a broom
Introduced in Chapter 60.

துவை *tuvai*
to wash (clothes)
Introduced in Chapter 155.

உடம்பு *uḍambu*
body — the noun in the everyday Tamil way of asking after someone's health
Introduced in Chapter 38.

உதவு *udavu*
to help, to be of use — a native word where three sisters and Hindi all reach for Sanskrit instead
Introduced in Chapter 34.

உலகம் *ulakam*
the world
Introduced in Chapter 265.

உள்ளங்கை *uḷḷaṅkai*
the palm of the hand
Introduced in Chapter 201.

உள்ளே *uḷḷē*
inside, in
Introduced in Chapter 66.

உள்ளூர் *uḷḷūr*
local
Introduced in Chapter 179.

உழு *uḻu*
to plough
Introduced in Chapter 168.

உனக்கு எத்தனை வயது ஆகிறது? *unakku ettanai vayathu aakirathu?*
how old are you? — literally "to you how many years is becoming?"; the SAME Sanskrit vayas word as Kannada/Telugu/Malayalam; Tamil actually spans BOTH grammatical shapes seen so far, from a plain possessive in casual speech to this more formal dative+verb construction
Introduced in Chapter 19.

உணர் *uṇar*
to feel
Introduced in Chapter 196.

உணர்ச்சி *uṇarcci*
a feeling, an emotion
Introduced in Chapter 179.

உணவகம் *uṇavakam*
a restaurant
Introduced in Chapter 204.

உணவு *uṇavu*
food — the noun standing on **உண்**, the older eating verb behind **சாப்பிடு**'s everyday one
Introduced in Chapter 36.

ஊஞ்சல் *ūñcal*
a swing
Introduced in Chapter 250.

உங்கள் பெயர் என்ன? *uṅgaḷ peyar eṉṉa?*
what's your name?
Introduced in Chapter 2.

உண்மை *uṇmai*
the truth
Introduced in Chapter 47.

உண்மையா? *uṇmaiyā?*
really? is it true?
Introduced in Chapter 95.

உண்மையான *uṇmaiyāṉa*
true
Introduced in Chapter 149.

உண்மையில் *uṇmaiyil*
actually, in fact
Introduced in Chapter 207.

உப்பு *uppu*
salt
Introduced in Chapter 44.

உப்புமா *uppumā*
upma, a semolina dish
Introduced in Chapter 183.

ஊர் *ūr*
town, village — where you are from, which a Tamil introduction asks for, and the -ore in Bangalore
Introduced in Chapter 37.

ஊற வை *ūṟa vai*
to soak
Introduced in Chapter 196.

உறை *uṟai*
an envelope; a cover
Introduced in Chapter 215.

உரையாடல் *uraiyāṭal*
a conversation
Introduced in Chapter 245.

உறவினர் *uṟaviṉar*
a relative
Introduced in Chapter 100.

உற்சாகம் *uṟcākam*
enthusiasm, excitement
Introduced in Chapter 268.

உரி *uri*
to peel
Introduced in Chapter 194.

உரிமை *urimai*
a right
Introduced in Chapter 117.

உறிஞ்சு *uṟiñcu*
to suck, to sip through a straw
Introduced in Chapter 200.

ஊற்று *ūṟṟu*
to pour
Introduced in Chapter 194.

ஊறுகாய் *ūṟukāy*
a pickle
Introduced in Chapter 140.

உருகு *uruku*
to melt
Introduced in Chapter 258.

உருளைக்கிழங்கு *uruḷaikkiḻaṅku*
a potato
Introduced in Chapter 243.

உறுதியான *uṟutiyāṉa*
firm, sturdy
Introduced in Chapter 240.

உருட்டு *uruṭṭu*
to roll (something)
Introduced in Chapter 167.

ஊசி *ūsi*
a needle
Introduced in Chapter 60.

ஊதா *ūtā*
purple
Introduced in Chapter 150.

உடை *uṭai*
to break
Introduced in Chapter 151.

உடைமை *uṭaimai*
a possession
Introduced in Chapter 117.

உடல்நலம் *uṭalnalam*
health
Introduced in Chapter 88.

உடனே *uṭaṉē*
at once
Introduced in Chapter 62.

உடன்பிறந்தவர் *uṭaṉpiṟantavar*
a sibling
Introduced in Chapter 273.

உதாரணமாக *utāraṇamāka*
for example
Introduced in Chapter 176.

உடற்பயிற்சி *uṭaṟpayiṟci*
exercise
Introduced in Chapter 261.

உதடு *utaṭu*
a lip
Introduced in Chapter 55.

உட்கார் *uṭkār*
sit
Introduced in Chapter 42.

ஊது *ūtu*
to blow
Introduced in Chapter 157.

உயரமான *uyaramāṉa*
tall
Introduced in Chapter 144.

வா *vā*
come
Introduced in Chapter 42.

வா *vā*
to come — the word you say it by is **வா**, but the beads attach to a different shape, **வரு-**
Introduced in Chapter 32.

வாசனை *vācaṉai*
a fragrance, a smell
Introduced in Chapter 243.

வசதியான *vacatiyāṉa*
comfortable, convenient
Introduced in Chapter 269.

வை *vai*
to put, to keep
Introduced in Chapter 151.

வைக்கோல் *vaikkōl*
straw, hay
Introduced in Chapter 250.

வகுப்பு *vakuppu*
a class
Introduced in Chapter 137.

வால் *vāl*
a tail
Introduced in Chapter 275.

வாழ் *vāḻ*
to live, to flourish
Introduced in Chapter 5.

வலது *valadu*
the right side
Introduced in Chapter 66.

வளை *vaḷai*
to bend
Introduced in Chapter 200.

வாழைப்பழம் *vāḻaippaḻam*
a banana
Introduced in Chapter 123.

வளையல் *vaḷaiyal*
a bangle
Introduced in Chapter 137.

வழக்கமாக *vaḻakkamāka*
usually, as usual
Introduced in Chapter 207.

வழக்கறிஞர் *vaḻakkaṟiñar*
a lawyer
Introduced in Chapter 279.

வளர் *vaḷar*
to grow
Introduced in Chapter 154.

வலி *vali*
pain
Introduced in Chapter 61.

வழி *vaḻi*
a way, a route
Introduced in Chapter 264.

வாளி *vāḷi*
a bucket
Introduced in Chapter 120.

வல்லமை *vallamai*
ability, strength
Introduced in Chapter 117.

வாழ்த்து *vāḻttu*
a good wish
Introduced in Chapter 49.

வாழ்த்துகள் *vāḻttukaḷ*
congratulations, good wishes
Introduced in Chapter 98.

வழுக்கு *vaḻukku*
to slip
Introduced in Chapter 168.

வணக்கம் *vaṇakkam*
hello / greetings (vaṇakkam — “reverence, homage”)
Introduced in Chapter 1.

வணங்கு *vaṇaṅku*
to worship, to bow to
Introduced in Chapter 165.

வானவில் *vāṉavil*
a rainbow
Introduced in Chapter 219.

வண்டி *vaṇḍi*
a vehicle, a cart
Introduced in Chapter 69.

வாங்கு *vāṅgu*
to buy, to get
Introduced in Chapter 68.

வானிலை *vāṉilai*
weather — most likely a NATIVE Dravidian compound, unlike Kannada/Telugu/Malayalam's Sanskrit compounds: vaanam ("sky") + nilai ("state, standing")
Introduced in Chapter 20.

வங்கி *vaṅki*
a bank
Introduced in Chapter 115.

வானொலி *vāṉoli*
the radio
Introduced in Chapter 220.

வாந்தி *vānti*
vomiting, nausea
Introduced in Chapter 88.

வார இறுதி *vāra iṟuti*
a weekend
Introduced in Chapter 202.

வரை *varai*
up to, until
Introduced in Chapter 202.

வரைபடம் *varaipaṭam*
a map
Introduced in Chapter 216.

வாரந்தோறும் *vārantōṟum*
every week
Introduced in Chapter 262.

வறட்சி *vaṟaṭci*
a drought
Introduced in Chapter 248.

வரவேற்பு *varavēṟpu*
a welcome
Introduced in Chapter 50.

வரி *vari*
a tax; a line (of text)
Introduced in Chapter 272.

வரிசை *varicai*
a queue, a row
Introduced in Chapter 185.

வரிக்குதிரை *varikkutirai*
a zebra
Introduced in Chapter 218.

வறு *vaṟu*
to fry, to roast
Introduced in Chapter 161.

வாருங்கள் *vāruṅkaḷ*
please come (in)
Introduced in Chapter 98.

வருத்தம் *varuttam*
sorrow, regret
Introduced in Chapter 72.

வாசல் *vāsal*
a doorway
Introduced in Chapter 50.

வசந்த காலம் கோடைக் காலம் மழைக் காலம் குளிர் காலம் *vasantha kaalam kodai kaalam mazhai kaalam kulir kaalam*
spring, summer, monsoon, winter — and the honest note that the REAL locally central season is the rains, not a Western four-way split
Introduced in Chapter 14.

வடை *vaṭai*
a vadai, a savoury doughnut
Introduced in Chapter 125.

வாடகை *vāṭakai*
rent; a fare
Introduced in Chapter 160.

வடக்கு *vaṭakku*
north
Introduced in Chapter 235.

வாடிக்கையாளர் *vāṭikkaiyāḷar*
a customer
Introduced in Chapter 191.

வட்டமான *vaṭṭamāṉa*
round
Introduced in Chapter 240.

வாத்து *vāttu*
a duck
Introduced in Chapter 142.

வாடு *vāṭu*
to wilt, to wither
Introduced in Chapter 231.

வாய் *vāy*
the mouth
Introduced in Chapter 132.

வயல் *vayal*
a paddy field
Introduced in Chapter 53.

வயதான *vayatāṉa*
old (of people)
Introduced in Chapter 147.

வயிற்றுப்போக்கு *vayiṟṟuppōkku*
diarrhoea
Introduced in Chapter 170.

வயிற்றுவலி *vayiṟṟuvali*
a stomach ache
Introduced in Chapter 201.

வயிறு *vayiṟu*
the stomach
Introduced in Chapter 45.

வாய்ப்பு *vāyppu*
a chance, an opportunity
Introduced in Chapter 117.

வேகமான *vēkamāṉa*
fast
Introduced in Chapter 145.

வெல் *vel*
to win
Introduced in Chapter 156.

வேலை செய் *vēlai sey*
to work (lit. "work-do")
Introduced in Chapter 5.

வெளிநாட்டு *veḷināṭṭu*
foreign
Introduced in Chapter 179.

வெளியே *veḷiyē*
outside, out
Introduced in Chapter 66.

வெளியேறு *veḷiyēṟu*
to exit, to go out
Introduced in Chapter 254.

வெல்லம் *vellam*
jaggery
Introduced in Chapter 59.

வெள்ளம் *veḷḷam*
a flood
Introduced in Chapter 219.

வெள்ளரிக்காய் *veḷḷarikkāy*
a cucumber
Introduced in Chapter 243.

வேண்டுகோள் *vēṇḍukōḷ*
a request
Introduced in Chapter 63.

வேண்டும் *vēṇḍum*
want, need — another verb Tamil builds with no subject at all
Introduced in Chapter 39.

வெங்காயம் *veṅkāyam*
an onion
Introduced in Chapter 123.

வெண்ணெய் *veṇṇey*
butter
Introduced in Chapter 122.

வெண்டைக்காய் *veṇṭaikkāy*
okra, ladies' finger
Introduced in Chapter 278.

வேண்டுமென்றே *vēṇṭumeṉṟē*
on purpose, deliberately
Introduced in Chapter 266.

வேப்பமரம் *vēppamaram*
a neem tree
Introduced in Chapter 188.

வேர் *vēr*
a root
Introduced in Chapter 52.

வெற்றி *verṟi*
victory, a win
Introduced in Chapter 277.

வெற்றிலை *verṟilai*
betel leaf
Introduced in Chapter 50.

வெறு *veṟu*
to hate
Introduced in Chapter 257.

வெடி *veṭi*
to burst, to explode
Introduced in Chapter 166.

வெட்கம் *veṭkam*
shyness, shame
Introduced in Chapter 210.

வெட்கப்படு *veṭkappaṭu*
to feel shy, to be embarrassed
Introduced in Chapter 257.

வேட்டி *vēṭṭi*
a veshti, the cloth a man wraps at the waist
Introduced in Chapter 67.

வெட்டு *veṭṭu*
to cut
Introduced in Chapter 150.

வெதுவெதுப்பான *vetuvetuppāṉa*
lukewarm
Introduced in Chapter 241.

வெயில் *veyil*
sunshine, the heat of the sun
Introduced in Chapter 91.

விசைப்பலகை *vicaippalakai*
a keyboard
Introduced in Chapter 220.

விசாரி *vicāri*
to enquire, to ask about
Introduced in Chapter 227.

வீசு *vīcu*
to throw, to fling
Introduced in Chapter 229.

விடை *viḍai*
leave to depart — the noun for taking your leave, from the same root as **வீடு**
Introduced in Chapter 38.

வீடு *vīḍu*
house, home — the word behind the door you say **வணக்கம்** at, and a v where Kannada says b
Introduced in Chapter 35.

வில் *vil*
to sell
Introduced in Chapter 161.

விழா *viḻā*
a festival, a function, a ceremony
Introduced in Chapter 217.

விலை *vilai*
a price
Introduced in Chapter 68.

விலை எவ்வளவு? *vilai evvaḷavu?*
how much does it cost? — asking a price, and checking the answer
Introduced in Chapter 80.

விளைவு *viḷaivu*
a result, a consequence
Introduced in Chapter 177.

விளையாடு *viḷaiyāḍu*
to play
Introduced in Chapter 71.

விளையாட்டு *viḷaiyāṭṭu*
a game, a sport
Introduced in Chapter 249.

விலையுயர்ந்த *vilaiyuyarnta*
expensive
Introduced in Chapter 178.

விளக்கேற்று *viḷakkēṟṟu*
to light a lamp
Introduced in Chapter 166.

விளக்கு *viḷakku*
a lamp
Introduced in Chapter 44.

விளம்பரம் *viḷamparam*
an advert
Introduced in Chapter 160.

விலங்கு *vilaṅku*
an animal
Introduced in Chapter 274.

விழு *viḻu*
to fall
Introduced in Chapter 152.

விழுங்கு *viḻuṅku*
to swallow
Introduced in Chapter 226.

விமான நிலையம் *vimāṉa nilaiyam*
an airport
Introduced in Chapter 263.

விமானம் *vimāṉam*
an aeroplane
Introduced in Chapter 263.

விநாடி *vināṭi*
a second (of time)
Introduced in Chapter 233.

வீங்கு *vīṅku*
to swell
Introduced in Chapter 255.

விண்மீன் *viṇmīṉ*
a star
Introduced in Chapter 51.

விஞ்ஞானி *viññāṉi*
a scientist
Introduced in Chapter 224.

விண்ணப்பம் *viṇṇappam*
an application
Introduced in Chapter 272.

விண்ணப்பி *viṇṇappi*
to apply (for a job, a loan)
Introduced in Chapter 227.

விரல் *viral*
a finger
Introduced in Chapter 132.

வீரர் *vīrar*
an athlete, a sportsperson; a hero, a warrior
Introduced in Chapter 280.

விற்பனை *viṟpaṉai*
a sale
Introduced in Chapter 251.

விருந்தாளி *viruntāḷi*
a guest
Introduced in Chapter 46.

விருந்து *viruntu*
a feast, a party
Introduced in Chapter 217.

விதை *vitai*
a seed
Introduced in Chapter 52.

விடைபெறுகிறேன் *viṭaipeṟukiṟēṉ*
I take my leave
Introduced in Chapter 107.

விதி *viti*
a rule
Introduced in Chapter 280.

விடியல் *viṭiyal*
dawn, daybreak
Introduced in Chapter 233.

வித்தியாசமான *vittiyācamāṉa*
different, unusual
Introduced in Chapter 269.

வீட்டுப்பாடம் *vīṭṭuppāṭam*
homework
Introduced in Chapter 223.

விடுமுறை *viṭumuṟai*
a holiday
Introduced in Chapter 106.

விவரி *vivari*
to describe, to explain
Introduced in Chapter 164.

விவசாயி *vivasāyi*
a farmer
Introduced in Chapter 46.

விவாதி *vivāti*
to discuss, to debate
Introduced in Chapter 199.

வியாபாரி *viyāpāri*
a trader, a merchant
Introduced in Chapter 192.

வியர்வை *viyarvai*
sweat
Introduced in Chapter 88.

யானை *yāṉai*
an elephant
Introduced in Chapter 128.

யார் *yār*
who? — asking about a person
Introduced in Chapter 40.

யோசனை *yōcaṉai*
an idea, a suggestion
Introduced in Chapter 190.

யோசி *yōci*
to consider, to think something over
Introduced in Chapter 166.

யோகா *yōkā*
yoga
Introduced in Chapter 261.

Review Questions

Try these without looking ahead. Every prompt comes from the same canonical lesson data as its chapter. Answers begin in the next section.

Chapter 4

4.1 *Tamil's curves — the writing surface leaves a trace*
What writing surface is usually linked to Tamil's rounded shapes?

Chapter 84

84.1 *(reading) — six words, counted in shapes*
Which word is the house?

84.2 *(reading) — six lines, and a question that ends where it asks*
Where does the question word sit in the Tamil question?

84.3 *(reading) — the first passage*
What word does Tamil leave out of வீடு பெரிய?

Answer Key

The first response is the canonical display answer. When a question accepts other authored forms, they appear underneath.

Chapter 4

4.1 *Tamil's curves — the writing surface leaves a trace*
Answer: palm leaves
Also accepted: palm leaf; leaves of palm

Chapter 84

84.1 *(reading) — six words, counted in shapes*
Answer: veedu
Also accepted: வீடு; house

84.2 *(reading) — six lines, and a question that ends where it asks*
Answer: at the end
Also accepted: last; end

84.3 *(reading) — the first passage*
Answer: is
Also accepted: the verb is; to be

Index

Look up an English meaning, a dedicated language topic, or a chapter topic. Each linked reference opens the chapter where the material is introduced; the focus labels name only explicitly typed lesson sections.

0–9

11-20 — additive “ten-echo” compounds for the teens, then இருபது (20), transparently “two-tens” — closing out the arc: all four Dravidian languages build twenty compositionally, unlike Sanskrit, Latin, or Arabic’s opaque special words பதினொன்று — இருபது (patin̲on̲d̲ru — irupathu)
explicit focus: etymology, usage and culture; Chapter 20, p. 179

A

a bag பை (pai)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 68, p. 517

a ball பந்து (pantu)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 136, p. 979

a banana வாழைப்பழம் (vāl̲aippal̲am)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 123, p. 899

a bangle வளையல் (vaḷaiyal)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 137, p. 985

a bank வங்கி (vaṅki)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 115, p. 849

a banyan tree ஆலமரம் (ālamaram)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 250, p. 1685

a barber முடிதிருத்துபவர் (muṭitiruttupavar)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 224, p. 1525

a basket கூடை (kūṭai)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 54, p. 413

a bathroom குளியலறை (kuḷiyalaṟai)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 173, p. 1209

a beach கடற்கரை (kaṭaṟkarai)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 115, p. 849

a bear கரடி (karaṭi)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 129, p. 935

a beard தாடி (tāṭi)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 201, p. 1381

a bed கட்டில் (kaṭṭil)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 70, p. 533

a bedroom படுக்கையறை (paṭukkaiyaṟai)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 173, p. 1209

a bee தேனீ (tēṉī)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 218, p. 1487

a bicycle மிதிவண்டி (mitivaṇṭi)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 174, p. 1215

a bird பறவை (paṟavai)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 58, p. 439

a birthday பிறந்தநாள் (piṟantanāḷ)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 104, p. 775

a blackboard கரும்பலகை (karumpalakai)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 221, p. 1507

a blanket போர்வை (pōrvai)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 119, p. 873

a blouse (worn with a sari) ரவிக்கை (ravikkai)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 242, p. 1635

a boat படகு (paṭaku)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 174, p. 1215

a bone எலும்பு (elumbu)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 55, p. 419

a book புத்தகம் (puttakam)
Chapter 44, p. 349

a bottle குப்பி (kuppi)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 136, p. 979

a bowl கிண்ணம் (kiṇṇam)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 54, p. 413

a box பெட்டி (peṭṭi)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 54, p. 413

a boy; a son பையன் (paiyaṉ)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 100, p. 751

a boyfriend, a (male) lover காதலன் (kātalaṉ)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 186, p. 1289

a branch கிளை (kiḷai)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 52, p. 401
a bride மணமகள் (maṇamakaḷ)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 217, p. 1481
a bridegroom மணமகன் (maṇamakaṉ)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 217, p. 1481
a bridge பாலம் (pālam)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 114, p. 843
a broom துடைப்பம் (tuṭaippam)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 60, p. 453
a brother-in-law மைத்துனன் (maittuṉaṉ)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 273, p. 1827
a bucket வாளி (vāḷi)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 120, p. 879
a buffalo எருமை (erumai)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 128, p. 929
a building கட்டிடம் (kaṭṭiṭam)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 205, p. 1407
a bull காளை (kāḷai)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 187, p. 1295
a bus பேருந்து (pērundu)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 69, p. 525
a butterfly பட்டாம்பூச்சி (paṭṭāmpūcci)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 218, p. 1487
a button பொத்தான் (pottāṉ)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 242, p. 1635
a calendar நாட்காட்டி (nāṭkāṭṭi)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 172, p. 1203
a calf கன்று (kaṉṟu)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 187, p. 1295
a camel ஒட்டகம் (ottakam)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 142, p. 1017
a camera கேமரா (kēmarā)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 220, p. 1499
a candle மெழுகுவர்த்தி (meḻukuvartti)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 189, p. 1309
a cap, a hat தொப்பி (toppi)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 67, p. 509
a capital city தலைநகரம் (talainakaram)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 234, p. 1587
a car கார் (kār)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 174, p. 1215

a carpenter தச்சர் (taccar)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 193, p. 1333

a cashier காசாளர் (kācāḷar)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 191, p. 1321

a cave குகை (kukai)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 175, p. 1221

a century நூற்றாண்டு (nūṟṟāṇṭu)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 203, p. 1395

a certificate சான்றிதழ் (cāṉṟitaḻ)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 253, p. 1703

a chain, a necklace சங்கிலி (caṅkili)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 270, p. 1807

a chance, an opportunity வாய்ப்பு (vāyppu)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 117, p. 861

a chapati சப்பாத்தி (cappātti)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 270, p. 1807

a cheek கன்னம் (kaṉṉam)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 142, p. 1017

a chilli மிளகாய் (milakāy)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 124, p. 905

a church தேவாலயம் (tēvālayam)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 206, p. 1413

a chutney சட்னி (caṭṇi)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 183, p. 1271

a cinema திரையரங்கம் (tiraiyaraṅkam)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 205, p. 1407

a city நகரம் (nakaram)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 234, p. 1587

a class வகுப்பு (vakuppu)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 137, p. 985

a clay pot பானை (pāṉai)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 190, p. 1315

a clock கடிகாரம் (kaṭikāram)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 121, p. 885

a clothes shop துணிக்கடை (tuṇikkaṭai)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 204, p. 1401

a cloud மேகம் (mēkam)
Chapter 51, p. 395

a coach, a trainer பயிற்சியாளர் (payiṟciyāḷar)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 193, p. 1333

a coconut தேங்காய் (tēṅkāy)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 123, p. 899

a coconut palm தென்னைமரம் (tenn̲aimaram)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 188, p. 1303

a coin நாணயம் (nāṇayam)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 222, p. 1513

a cold, a runny nose சளி (caḷi)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 87, p. 673

a colleague சக ஊழியர் (caka ūl̲iyar)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 192, p. 1327

a college கல்லூரி (kallūri)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 105, p. 781

a colour நிறம் (nir̲am)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 238, p. 1611

a comb சீப்பு (sīppu)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 60, p. 453

a company, an organisation நிறுவனம் (nir̲uvan̲am)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 223, p. 1519

a competition, a match போட்டி (pōṭṭi)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 249, p. 1679

a complaint புகார் (pukār)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 280, p. 1869

a computer கணினி (kaṇin̲i)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 134, p. 967

a conversation உரையாடல் (uraiyāṭal)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 245, p. 1655

a copy, a photocopy நகல் (nakal)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 272, p. 1821

a corner மூலை (mūlai)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 116, p. 855

a cough இருமல் (irumal)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 87, p. 673

a country நாடு (nāṭu)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 234, p. 1587

a cow பசு (pasu)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 58, p. 439

a creeper, a vine; a flag கொடி (koṭi)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 275, p. 1839

a crocodile முதலை (mutalai)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 218, p. 1487

a crossroads நாற்சந்தி (nār̲canti)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 234, p. 1587

a crow காக்கை (kākkai)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 58, p. 439

a cucumber வெள்ளரிக்காய் (veḷḷarikkāy)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 243, p. 1643
a cup கோப்பை (kōppai)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 118, p. 867
a cupboard அலமாரி (alamāri)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 213, p. 1457
a curry, a gravy குழம்பு (kuḻambu)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 121, p. 885
a curtain திரைச்சீலை (tiraiccīlai)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 134, p. 967
a customer வாடிக்கையாளர் (vāṭikkaiyāḷar)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 191, p. 1321
a date — and the second ordinal ending, the one a calendar uses தேதி (tēdi)
explicit focus: grammar, etymology; Chapter 83, p. 631
a daughter-in-law மருமகள் (marumakaḷ)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 102, p. 763
a deadline காலக்கெடு (kālakkeṭu)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 203, p. 1395
a deer மான் (māṉ)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 129, p. 935
a delay தாமதம் (tāmatam)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 171, p. 1197
a desert பாலைவனம் (pālaivaṉam)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 175, p. 1221
a dictionary அகராதி (akarāti)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 215, p. 1469
a direction திசை (ticai)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 235, p. 1593
a discount தள்ளுபடி (taḷḷupaṭi)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 222, p. 1513
a district மாவட்டம் (māvaṭṭam)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 265, p. 1777
a doctor மருத்துவர் (maruttuvar)
Chapter 46, p. 361
a document ஆவணம் (āvaṇam)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 244, p. 1649
a doll, a toy பொம்மை (pommai)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 136, p. 979
a donkey கழுதை (kaḻutai)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 141, p. 1011
a doorway வாசல் (vāsal)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 50, p. 389

a dosa, a thin pancake தோசை (tōcai)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 125, p. 911

a driver ஓட்டுநர் (ōṭṭunar)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 192, p. 1327

a drought வறட்சி (vaṟaṭci)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 248, p. 1673

a dry stir-fried vegetable dish பொரியல் (poriyal)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 183, p. 1271

a duck வாத்து (vāttu)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 142, p. 1017

a duty கடமை (kaṭamai)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 208, p. 1425

a factory தொழிற்சாலை (toḻiṟcālai)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 223, p. 1519

a family name குடும்பப் பெயர் (kuṭumpap peyar)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 103, p. 769

a farm பண்ணை (paṇṇai)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 175, p. 1221

a farmer விவசாயி (vivasāyi)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 46, p. 361

a father-in-law மாமனார் (māmaṉār)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 186, p. 1289

a feast, a party விருந்து (viruntu)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 217, p. 1481

a feather இறகு (iṟaku)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 275, p. 1839

a fee, a charge கட்டணம் (kaṭṭaṇam)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 215, p. 1469

a feeling, an emotion உணர்ச்சி (uṇarcci)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 179, p. 1247

a festival, a function, a ceremony விழா (viḻā)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 217, p. 1481

a fever காய்ச்சல் (kāyccal)
Chapter 61, p. 461

a film, a movie திரைப்படம் (tiraippaṭam)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 220, p. 1499

a fine, a penalty அபராதம் (aparātam)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 280, p. 1869

a finger விரல் (viral)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 132, p. 955

a fish மீன் (mīṉ)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 122, p. 893

a fisherman மீனவர் (mīṉavar)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 224, p. 1525

a flood வெள்ளம் (veḷḷam)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 219, p. 1493

a flower மலர் (malar)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 50, p. 389

a fool; foolish முட்டாள் (muṭṭāḷ)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 211, p. 1443

a footpath, a pavement நடைபாதை (naṭaipātai)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 263, p. 1765

a forest காடு (kāṭu)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 126, p. 917

a form (to fill in) படிவம் (paṭivam)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 244, p. 1649

a fort கோட்டை (kōṭṭai)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 236, p. 1599

a fox நரி (nari)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 130, p. 941

a fragrance, a smell வாசனை (vācaṉai)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 243, p. 1643

a frog தவளை (tavaḷai)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 130, p. 941

a fruit பழம் (paḻam)
Chapter 44, p. 349

a game, a sport விளையாட்டு (viḷaiyāṭṭu)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 249, p. 1679

a garden தோட்டம் (tōṭṭam)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 116, p. 855

a gentle breeze தென்றல் (teṉṟal)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 219, p. 1493

a gift, a prize பரிசு (paricu)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 98, p. 739

a gift given with affection அன்பளிப்பு (aṉpaḷippu)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 99, p. 745

a giraffe ஒட்டகச்சிவிங்கி (oṭṭakacciviṅki)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 218, p. 1487

a girlfriend, a (female) lover காதலி (kātali)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 186, p. 1289

a glove கையுறை (kaiyuṟai)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 137, p. 985

a goat ஆடு (āṭu)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 58, p. 439

a good wish வாழ்த்து (vāḻttu)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 49, p. 383

a granddaughter பேத்தி (pētti)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 103, p. 769

a grandfather தாத்தா (tāttā)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 101, p. 757

a grandmother பாட்டி (pāṭṭi)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 101, p. 757

a grandson பேரன் (pēraṉ)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 103, p. 769

a grinding stone அம்மி (ammi)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 190, p. 1315

a guava கொய்யா (koyyā)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 139, p. 997

a guest விருந்தாளி (viruntāḷi)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 46, p. 361

a habit, a custom பழக்கம் (paḻakkam)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 246, p. 1661

a hall, a living room கூடம் (kūṭam)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 206, p. 1413

a hammer சுத்தியல் (cuttiyal)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 135, p. 973

a handkerchief கைக்குட்டை (kaikkuṭṭai)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 270, p. 1807

a harbour, a port துறைமுகம் (tuṟaimukam)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 236, p. 1599

a headache தலைவலி (talaivali)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 88, p. 679

a helmet தலைக்கவசம் (talaikkavacam)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 221, p. 1507

a hen கோழி (kōḻi)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 58, p. 439

a hill குன்று (kuṉṟu)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 140, p. 1005

a hill மலை (malai)
Chapter 53, p. 407

a hobby, a pastime பொழுதுபோக்கு (poḻutupōkku)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 277, p. 1851

a holiday விடுமுறை (viṭumuṟai)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 106, p. 787

a horse குதிரை (kutirai)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 128, p. 929

a hospital மருத்துவமனை (maruttuvamaṉai)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 88, p. 679

a husband கணவர் (kaṇavar)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 100, p. 751

a hut குடிசை (kuṭicai)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 265, p. 1777

a jackfruit பலாப்பழம் (palāppaḻam)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 139, p. 997

a journey பயணம் (payaṇam)
Chapter 48, p. 375

a judge நீதிபதி (nītipati)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 253, p. 1703

a key சாவி (cāvi)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 119, p. 873

a keyboard விசைப்பலகை (vicaippalakai)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 220, p. 1499

a kitchen சமையலறை (camaiyalaṟai)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 173, p. 1209

a kite பட்டம் (paṭṭam)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 136, p. 979

a knee முழங்கால் (muḻaṅkāl)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 133, p. 961

a knife கத்தி (katti)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 54, p. 413

a ladder ஏணி (ēṇi)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 135, p. 973

a lake ஏரி (ēri)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 126, p. 917

a lamp விளக்கு (viḷakku)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 44, p. 349

a lane, an alley சந்து (cantu)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 236, p. 1599

a language மொழி (moḻi)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 104, p. 775

a lawyer வழக்கறிஞர் (vaḻakkaṟiñar)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 279, p. 1863

a leaf இலை (ilai)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 126, p. 917

a lemon எலுமிச்சை (elumiccai)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 139, p. 997

a leopard சிறுத்தை (ciṟuttai)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 187, p. 1295

a lesson; a school subject பாடம் (pāṭam)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 223, p. 1519
a letter (to post) கடிதம் (kaṭitam)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 215, p. 1469
a library நூலகம் (nūlakam)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 115, p. 849
a lid மூடி (mūṭi)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 182, p. 1265
a lion சிங்கம் (ciṅkam)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 129, p. 935
a lip உதடு (utaṭu)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 55, p. 419
a list பட்டியல் (paṭṭiyal)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 251, p. 1691
a little சிறிது (si‍ṟitu)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 56, p. 427
a load, a burden சுமை (cumai)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 245, p. 1655
a lock பூட்டு (pūṭṭu)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 119, p. 873
a lot நிறைய (ni‍ṟaiya)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 56, p. 427
a lotus தாமரை (tāmarai)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 188, p. 1303
a machine இயந்திரம் (iyantiram)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 276, p. 1845
a man, male ஆண் (āṇ)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 245, p. 1655
a manager மேலாளர் (mēlāḷar)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 279, p. 1863
a mango மாம்பழம் (māmpa‍ḻam)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 123, p. 899
a map வரைபடம் (varaipaṭam)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 216, p. 1475
a mark, a score மதிப்பெண் (matippeṇ)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 252, p. 1697
a market சந்தை (cantai)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 115, p. 849
a mason, a bricklayer கொத்தனார் (kottana‍ār)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 224, p. 1525
a mat பாய் (pāy)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 54, p. 413

a matchbox தீப்பெட்டி (tīppeṭṭi)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 190, p. 1315
a mattress மெத்தை (mettai)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 134, p. 967
a meeting; a crowd கூட்டம் (kūṭṭam)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 279, p. 1863
a mirror; glasses கண்ணாடி (kaṇṇāṭi)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 120, p. 879
a mistake — the noun that lets you finish an apology, and the same word as the verb "to slip" தவறு (tavaṟu)
explicit focus: script, etymology; Chapter 36, p. 283
a mobile phone கைப்பேசி (kaippēci)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 134, p. 967
a monkey குரங்கு (kuraṅku)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 129, p. 935
a month மாதம் (mādam)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 73, p. 559
a mosque மசூதி (macūti)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 206, p. 1413
a mosquito கொசு (kocu)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 132, p. 955
a mother-in-law மாமியார் (māmiyār)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 102, p. 763
a moustache மீசை (mīcai)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 201, p. 1381
a museum அருங்காட்சியகம் (aruṅkāṭciyakam)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 236, p. 1599
a nail நகம் (nakam)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 55, p. 419
a nail (to hammer) ஆணி (āṇi)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 135, p. 973
a needle ஊசி (ūsi)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 60, p. 453
a neem tree வேப்பமரம் (vēppamaram)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 188, p. 1303
a neighbour பக்கத்து வீட்டுக்காரர் (pakkattu vīṭṭukkārar)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 103, p. 769
a nest கூடு (kūṭu)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 275, p. 1839
a newspaper நாளிதழ் (nāḷitaḻ)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 216, p. 1475
a nose மூக்கு (mūkku)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 45, p. 355

a notebook குறிப்பேடு (kuṟippēṭu)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 184, p. 1277

a notice, an announcement அறிவிப்பு (aṟivippu)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 160, p. 1129

a number (phone, house, account) எண் (eṇ)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 185, p. 1283

a nurse செவிலியர் (ceviliyar)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 232, p. 1573

a, one — the form ஒன்று takes when it stands in front of a noun ஒரு (oru)
explicit focus: script, grammar, etymology; Chapter 39, p. 313

a paddy field வயல் (vayal)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 53, p. 407

a pair of scales, a balance தராசு (tarācu)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 250, p. 1685

a palace அரண்மனை (araṇmaṉai)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 236, p. 1599

a pan, a cooking pot சட்டி (caṭṭi)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 182, p. 1265

a papaya பப்பாளி (pappāḷi)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 271, p. 1813

a parcel, a packet பொட்டலம் (poṭṭalam)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 244, p. 1649

a park பூங்கா (pūṅkā)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 114, p. 843

a parrot கிளி (kiḷi)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 131, p. 949

a passenger, a traveller பயணி (payaṇi)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 174, p. 1215

a passport கடவுச்சீட்டு (kaṭavuccīṭṭu)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 244, p. 1649

a password கடவுச்சொல் (kaṭavuccol)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 216, p. 1475

a path பாதை (pātai)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 53, p. 407

a patient நோயாளி (nōyāḷi)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 232, p. 1573

a peacock மயில் (mayil)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 131, p. 949

a peanut, a groundnut நிலக்கடலை (nilakkaṭalai)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 278, p. 1857

a pen பேனா (pēṉā)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 120, p. 879

a pencil பென்சில் (pe͟ncil)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 215, p. 1469

a pension ஓய்வூதியம் (ōyvūtiyam)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 253, p. 1703

a person ஆள் (āḷ)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 273, p. 1827

a pet செல்லப்பிராணி (cellappirāṇi)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 187, p. 1295

a pet name, a nickname செல்லப்பெயர் (cellappeyar)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 103, p. 769

a pharmacy மருந்துக்கடை (maruntukkaṭai)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 204, p. 1401

a photograph புகைப்படம் (pukaippaṭam)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 272, p. 1821

a pickle ஊறுகாய் (ūr̲ukāy)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 140, p. 1005

a pig பன்றி (pan̲̲ri)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 141, p. 1011

a pigeon புறா (pur̲ā)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 131, p. 949

a pillow தலையணை (talaiyaṇai)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 119, p. 873

a plan திட்டம் (tiṭṭam)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 159, p. 1123

a plant செடி (ceṭi)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 275, p. 1839

a plate தட்டு (taṭṭu)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 118, p. 867

a playground, a sports ground மைதானம் (maitāṉam)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 206, p. 1413

a pocket சட்டைப்பை (caṭṭaippai)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 242, p. 1635

a police officer காவலர் (kāvalar)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 192, p. 1327

a police station காவல் நிலையம் (kāval nilaiyam)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 205, p. 1407

a pomegranate மாதுளை (mātuḷai)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 140, p. 1005

a pond குளம் (kuḷam)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 126, p. 917

a possession உடைமை (uṭaimai)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 117, p. 861

a post office அஞ்சலகம் (añcalakam)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 234, p. 1587

a postage stamp அஞ்சல் தலை (añcal talai)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 244, p. 1649

a postman தபால்காரர் (tapālkārar)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 192, p. 1327

a potato உருளைக்கிழங்கு (uruḷaikkiḻaṅku)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 243, p. 1643

a potter குயவர் (kuyavar)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 224, p. 1525

a price விலை (vilai)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 68, p. 517

a prison சிறை (ciṟai)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 265, p. 1777

a problem பிரச்சினை (piracciṉai)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 177, p. 1233

a programme, an event நிகழ்ச்சி (nikaḻcci)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 220, p. 1499

a puppy நாய்க்குட்டி (nāykkuṭṭi)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 247, p. 1667

a puri, a puffed fried bread பூரி (pūri)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 270, p. 1807

a purpose, an aim நோக்கம் (nōkkam)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 177, p. 1233

a purse, a wallet பணப்பை (paṇappai)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 136, p. 979

a queue, a row வரிசை (varicai)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 185, p. 1283

a rabbit முயல் (muyal)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 129, p. 935

a rainbow வானவில் (vāṉavil)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 219, p. 1493

a rat, a mouse எலி (eli)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 130, p. 941

a reason, a cause காரணம் (kāraṇam)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 266, p. 1783

a receipt ரசீது (racītu)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 160, p. 1129

a refrigerator குளிர்சாதனப் பெட்டி (kuḷircātaṉap peṭṭi)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 182, p. 1265

a relative உறவினர் (uṟaviṉar)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 100, p. 751

a request வேண்டுகோள் (vēṇḍukōḷ)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 63, p. 473

a restaurant உணவகம் (uṇavakam)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 204, p. 1401

a result, a consequence விளைவு (viḷaivu)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 177, p. 1233

a right உரிமை (urimai)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 117, p. 861

a ring மோதிரம் (mōtiram)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 137, p. 985

a river நதி (nadi)
Chapter 53, p. 407

a road சாலை (sālai)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 69, p. 525

a rock பாறை (pāṟai)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 248, p. 1673

a roof கூரை (kūrai)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 70, p. 533

a root வேர் (vēr)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 52, p. 401

a rope கயிறு (kayiṟu)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 60, p. 453

a rule விதி (viti)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 280, p. 1869

a rupee ரூபாய் (rūpāy)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 222, p. 1513

a salary சம்பளம் (campaḷam)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 222, p. 1513

a sale விற்பனை (viṟpaṉai)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 251, p. 1691

a sandal, footwear செருப்பு (seruppu)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 67, p. 509

a sari சேலை (cēlai)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 121, p. 885

a sari புடவை (puḍavai)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 67, p. 509

a scar தழும்பு (taḻumpu)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 170, p. 1191

a school பள்ளி (paḷḷi)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 105, p. 781

a scientist விஞ்ஞானி (viññāṉi)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 224, p. 1525

a screen திரை (tirai)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 189, p. 1309
a screwdriver திருப்புளி (tiruppuḷi)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 276, p. 1845
a second (of time) விநாடி (vināṭi)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 233, p. 1579
a secret ரகசியம் (rakaciyam)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 208, p. 1425
a seed விதை (vitai)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 52, p. 401
a ship கப்பல் (kappal)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 263, p. 1765
a shirt சட்டை (saṭṭai)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 67, p. 509
a shop கடை (kaḍai)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 68, p. 517
a shopkeeper கடைக்காரர் (kaṭaikkārar)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 191, p. 1321
a shortage, less than there should be குறைவு (kuṟaivu)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 56, p. 427
a shoulder தோள் (tōḷ)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 133, p. 961
a sibling உடன்பிறந்தவர் (uṭaṉpiṟantavar)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 273, p. 1827
a signature; handwriting கையெழுத்து (kaiyeḻuttu)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 105, p. 781
a singer பாடகர் (pāṭakar)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 193, p. 1333
a size, an amount அளவு (aḷavu)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 238, p. 1611
a skill, talent திறமை (tiṟamai)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 116, p. 855
a skirt பாவாடை (pāvāṭai)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 121, p. 885
a smile புன்னகை (puṉṉakai)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 268, p. 1795
a snake பாம்பு (pāmpu)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 130, p. 941
a sock காலுறை (kāluṟai)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 137, p. 985
a sofa சோபா (cōpā)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 276, p. 1845

a solution தீர்வு (tīrvu)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 177, p. 1233

a son-in-law மருமகன் (marumakaṉ)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 102, p. 763

a song பாடல் (pāṭal)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 274, p. 1833

a sparrow குருவி (kuruvi)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 247, p. 1667

a spectator, a viewer பார்வையாளர் (pārvaiyāḷar)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 193, p. 1333

a spider சிலந்தி (cilanti)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 141, p. 1011

a spoon கரண்டி (karaṇṭi)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 118, p. 867

a squirrel அணில் (aṇil)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 247, p. 1667

a standing crop பயிர் (payir)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 64, p. 479

a star நட்சத்திரம் (naṭcattiram)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 127, p. 923

a star விண்மீன் (viṇmīṉ)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 51, p. 395

a station நிலையம் (nilaiyam)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 69, p. 525

a stomach ache வயிற்றுவலி (vayiṟṟuvali)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 201, p. 1381

a storm புயல் (puyal)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 127, p. 923

a story கதை (katai)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 274, p. 1833

a stove அடுப்பு (aṭuppu)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 118, p. 867

a stream, a brook ஓடை (ōṭai)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 175, p. 1221

a street தெரு (teru)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 114, p. 843

a student மாணவன் (māṇavaṉ)
Chapter 46, p. 361

a supermarket பல்பொருள் அங்காடி (palporuḷ aṅkāṭi)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 204, p. 1401

a swimming pool நீச்சல் குளம் (nīccal kuḷam)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 206, p. 1413

a swing ஊஞ்சல் (ūñcal)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 250, p. 1685

a table மேசை (mēsai)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 70, p. 533

a tablet, a pill மாத்திரை (māttirai)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 232, p. 1573

a tail வால் (vāl)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 275, p. 1839

a tailor தையல்காரர் (taiyalkārar)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 191, p. 1321

a tank, a tub தொட்டி (toṭṭi)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 190, p. 1315

a tap, a pipe குழாய் (kuḻāy)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 182, p. 1265

a tax; a line (of text) வரி (vari)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 272, p. 1821

a teacher ஆசிரியர் (āsiriyar)
Chapter 46, p. 361

a team, a group குழு (kuḻu)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 277, p. 1851

a television தொலைக்காட்சி (tolaikkāṭci)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 134, p. 967

a temple கோயில் (kōyil)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 114, p. 843

a temple festival திருவிழா (tiruviḻā)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 202, p. 1387

a tender shoot தளிர் (taḷir)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 52, p. 401

a tent கூடாரம் (kūṭāram)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 250, p. 1685

a text message குறுஞ்செய்தி (kuṟuñceyti)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 185, p. 1283

a thing, an item பொருள் (poruḷ)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 251, p. 1691

a thorn முள் (muḷ)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 188, p. 1303

a threshing floor களம் (kaḷam)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 64, p. 479

a thumb கட்டைவிரல் (kaṭṭaiviral)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 143, p. 1023

a ticket; a slip of paper சீட்டு (cīṭṭu)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 216, p. 1475

a tiger புலி (puli)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 128, p. 929

a timetable கால அட்டவணை (kāla aṭṭavaṇai)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 160, p. 1129

A Timetable, a Notice, the Rent, an Advert, a Receipt
chapter topic; Chapter 160, p. 1129

a toilet கழிப்பறை (kaḻippaṟai)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 173, p. 1209

a tomato தக்காளி (takkāḷi)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 124, p. 905

a tool கருவி (karuvi)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 117, p. 861

a tooth பல் (pal)
Chapter 45, p. 355

a toothache பல்வலி (palvali)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 232, p. 1573

a toothbrush பல்துலக்கி (paltulakki)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 213, p. 1457

a tortoise ஆமை (āmai)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 130, p. 941

a tour, a sightseeing trip சுற்றுலா (cuṟṟulā)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 205, p. 1407

a towel; a piece துண்டு (tuṇṭu)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 119, p. 873

a tower, a temple gateway tower கோபுரம் (kōpuram)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 265, p. 1777

a trader, a merchant வியாபாரி (viyāpāri)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 192, p. 1327

a train ரயில் (rayil)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 69, p. 525

A Tree
chapter topic; Chapter 52, p. 401

a tree மரம் (maram)
Chapter 52, p. 401

a tumbler, a drinking glass டம்ளர் (ṭamḷar)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 182, p. 1265

a turn திருப்பம் (tiruppam)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 116, p. 855

a uniform சீருடை (cīruṭai)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 221, p. 1507

a university பல்கலைக்கழகம் (palkalaikkaḻakam)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 252, p. 1697

a vadai, a savoury doughnut வடை (vaṭai)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 125, p. 911

a valley பள்ளத்தாக்கு (paḷḷattākku)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 264, p. 1771

a vehicle, a cart வண்டி (vaṇḍi)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 69, p. 525

a veshti, the cloth a man wraps at the waist வேட்டி (vēṭṭi)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 67, p. 509

a vessel, a pot பாத்திரம் (pāttiram)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 118, p. 867

a village கிராமம் (kirāmam)
Chapter 53, p. 407

a voice குரல் (kural)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 245, p. 1655

a wall சுவர் (suvar)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 70, p. 533

a waterfall அருவி (aruvi)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 140, p. 1005

a watermelon தர்பூசணி (tarpūcaṇi)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 278, p. 1857

a wave அலை (alai)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 128, p. 929

a way, a route வழி (va̲li)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 264, p. 1771

a website இணையதளம் (iṇaiyataḷam)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 189, p. 1309

a wedding, marriage திருமணம் (tirumaṇam)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 104, p. 775

a weekend வார இறுதி (vāra i̲ṟuti)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 202, p. 1387

a welcome வரவேற்பு (varavē̲rpu)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 50, p. 389

a wheel சக்கரம் (cakkaram)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 221, p. 1507

a wife மனைவி (ma̲naivi)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 100, p. 751

a window சன்னல் (ca̲n̲nal)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 173, p. 1209

a wolf ஓநாய் (ōnāy)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 187, p. 1295

a woman, female பெண் (peṇ)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 245, p. 1655

a worker, a labourer தொழிலாளி (to̲ilāḷi)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 279, p. 1863

a worm புழு (pu̲lu)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 247, p. 1667

a wound, an injury காயம் (kāyam)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 232, p. 1573

a wrist மணிக்கட்டு (maṇikkaṭṭu)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 142, p. 1017

a year ஆண்டு (āṇḍu)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 73, p. 559

a zebra வரிக்குதிரை (varikkutirai)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 218, p. 1487

a zoo மிருகக்காட்சிசாலை (mirukakkāṭcicālai)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 175, p. 1221

Ability, Right, Chance, Tool, Possession
chapter topic; Chapter 117, p. 861

ability, strength வல்லமை (vallamai)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 117, p. 861

active, energetic சுறுசுறுப்பான (cu̲ru̲cu̲ruppā̲na)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 180, p. 1253

Active, Naughty, Stubborn, Funny, Interesting
chapter topic; Chapter 180, p. 1253

actually, in fact உண்மையில் (uṇmaiyil)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 207, p. 1419

affection அன்பு (a̲nbu)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 49, p. 383

Afternoon
chapter topic; Chapter 28, p. 219

afternoon (pir̲pakal) — a transparent compound, பின் (pin̲, "after") + நண்பகல்'s own பகல் ("daytime"), with பின் surfacing as பிற்- before ப, a SIMILAR kind of consonant sandhi to the one already taught in TA-C17 (நள்→நண்) — though Wiktionary itself does not discuss the sandhi mechanism, and the two changes move in different phonetic directions (nasal→stop vs. lateral→nasal), so this is the lesson's own analysis, not a sourced claim; Wiktionary-listed formal register; a real, citable overlap worth flagging honestly: Wiktionary's OWN afternoon-word page ALSO lists நடுப்பகல் as a synonym, even though TA-C17 established நடுப்பகல் as a synonym of NOON specifically; also related but distinct: மதியம், a Sanskrit tatsama (from madhya, "middle") meaning "noon," a synonym of நண்பகல் — NOT specifically "afternoon," despite an unverified WebSearch claim that matiyam "originally meant moon," which does not appear anywhere on its actual Wiktionary page and is therefore not asserted here பிற்பகல் (pir̲pakal)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 28, p. 219

afterwards பிறகு (pir̲aku)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 48, p. 375

again மறுபடியும் (mar̲upaṭiyum)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 92, p. 703

All the Way Up, and On a Calendar
chapter topic; Chapter 83, p. 631

Allergy, Infection, Scar, Diarrhoea, Brain
chapter topic; Chapter 170, p. 1191

almost, nearly கிட்டத்தட்ட (kiṭṭattaṭṭa)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 207, p. 1419

alone தனியாக (tan̲iyāka)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 90, p. 691

already ஏற்கனவே (ēr̲kan̲avē)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 158, p. 1117

always எப்போதும் (eppōtum)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 171, p. 1197

an actor நடிகர் (naṭikar)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 193, p. 1333

an address முகவரி (mukavari)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 104, p. 775

an advert விளம்பரம் (viḷamparam)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 160, p. 1129

an aeroplane விமானம் (vimān̲am)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 263, p. 1765

an airport விமான நிலையம் (vimāṉa nilaiyam)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 263, p. 1765

an allergy ஒவ்வாமை (ovvāmai)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 170, p. 1191

an animal விலங்கு (vilaṅku)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 274, p. 1833

an ankle கணுக்கால் (kaṇukkāl)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 169, p. 1183

an answer பதில் (patil)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 138, p. 991

an ant எறும்பு (eṟumpu)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 131, p. 949

an app செயலி (ceyali)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 189, p. 1309

an apple ஆப்பிள் (āppiḷ)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 271, p. 1813

an application விண்ணப்பம் (viṇṇappam)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 272, p. 1821

an artist கலைஞர் (kalaiñar)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 253, p. 1703

an athlete, a sportsperson; a hero, a warrior வீரர் (vīrar)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 280, p. 1869

an aubergine, a brinjal கத்தரிக்காய் (kattarikkāy)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 243, p. 1643

an auto-rickshaw ஆட்டோ (āṭṭō)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 174, p. 1215

an eagle கழுகு (kaḻuku)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 247, p. 1667

an ear காது (kādu)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 45, p. 355

an earring தோடு (tōṭu)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 270, p. 1807

an earthquake நிலநடுக்கம் (nilanaṭukkam)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 248, p. 1673

an egg முட்டை (muṭṭai)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 122, p. 893

an elbow முழங்கை (muḻaṅkai)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 142, p. 1017

an electric fan மின்விசிறி (miṉviciṟi)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 135, p. 973

an elephant யானை (yāṉai)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 128, p. 929

an email மின்னஞ்சல் (min̲n̲añcal)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 185, p. 1283

an ember கனல் (kan̲al)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 57, p. 433

an employer, a boss முதலாளி (mutalāḷi)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 251, p. 1691

an engagement (betrothal) நிச்சயதார்த்தம் (niccayatārttam)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 217, p. 1481

an engineer பொறியாளர் (po̲riyāḷar)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 279, p. 1863

an envelope; a cover உறை (u̲rai)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 215, p. 1469

an eraser, a rubber அழிப்பான் (a̲lippān̲)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 221, p. 1507

an exam தேர்வு (tērvu)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 138, p. 991

an expense, a cost செலவு (celavu)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 222, p. 1513

an experience அனுபவம் (an̲upavam)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 177, p. 1233

an eye கண் (kaṇ)
Chapter 45, p. 355

an idea, a suggestion யோசனை (yōcan̲ai)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 190, p. 1315

an identity card அடையாள அட்டை (aṭaiyāḷa aṭṭai)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 272, p. 1821

an idli, a steamed rice cake இட்லி (iṭli)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 125, p. 911

an infection தொற்று (to̲r̲ru)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 170, p. 1191

an insect பூச்சி (pūcci)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 141, p. 1011

an interview நேர்காணல் (nērkāṇal)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 223, p. 1519

an invitation, a call அழைப்பு (a̲l̲aippu)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 98, p. 739

an island தீவு (tīvu)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 141, p. 1011

an itch அரிப்பு (arippu)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 261, p. 1751

an occupation, a trade தொழில் (to̲l̲il)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 105, p. 781

an office அலுவலகம் (aluvalakam)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 115, p. 849

an officer, an official அதிகாரி (atikāri)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 253, p. 1703

an onion வெங்காயம் (veṅkāyam)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 123, p. 899

an opinion, a view கருத்து (karuttu)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 277, p. 1851

an orange ஆரஞ்சு (ārañcu)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 271, p. 1813

an owl ஆந்தை (āntai)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 131, p. 949

an umbrella குடை (kuṭai)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 60, p. 453

an upper floor, a storey மாடி (māṭi)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 205, p. 1407

And, and Also
chapter topic; Chapter 74, p. 567

ி and நன்றி — replace the vowel, then hear *ndr*
script and writing topic; explicit focus: pronunciation, script; Chapter 13, p. 123

anger கோபம் (kōpam)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 72, p. 549

Ankle, Waist, Throat, Heart, Blood
chapter topic; Chapter 169, p. 1183

answering in Tamil — the five words in use, and the two habits behind them ஆம் / இல்லை / சரி (ām / illai / sari)
explicit focus: grammar, etymology; Chapter 1, p. 1

are you well? (spoken) நல்லா இருக்கீங்களா? (nallā irukkīṅkaḷā?)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 108, p. 799

Around the Yard
chapter topic; Chapter 58, p. 439

Arriving at a House
chapter topic; Chapter 35, p. 271

Artist, Officer, Judge, Pension, Certificate
chapter topic; Chapter 253, p. 1703

Asking for What You Want
chapter topic; Chapter 39, p. 313

Asking Someone's Age
chapter topic; Chapter 19, p. 169

Asking Well
chapter topic; Chapter 63, p. 473

at once உடனே (uṭaṉē)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 62, p. 467

At the Doorway
chapter topic; Chapter 50, p. 389
At the Hospital
chapter topic; Chapter 88, p. 679
At the Shop
chapter topic; Chapter 68, p. 517
aunt, the father's sister அத்தை (attai)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 101, p. 757

B

bad கெட்ட (keṭṭa)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 143, p. 1023
bamboo மூங்கில் (mūṅkil)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 219, p. 1493
Bamboo, Rainbow, Fog, Gentle breeze, Flood
chapter topic; Chapter 219, p. 1493
beautiful அழகான (aḻakāṉa)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 143, p. 1023
because ஏனென்றால் (ēṉeṉṟāl)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 78, p. 597
because of that, so அதனால் (adaṉāl)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 78, p. 597
before, earlier முன்பு (muṉbu)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 73, p. 559
before the noun, unchanged — five words, one rule
grammar topic; explicit focus: grammar; Chapter 41, p. 329
behind பின்னால் (piṉṉāl)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 113, p. 837
Best, Different, Boring, Simple, Comfortable
chapter topic; Chapter 269, p. 1801
best, finest சிறந்த (ciṟanta)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 269, p. 1801
betel leaf வெற்றிலை (veṟṟilai)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 50, p. 389
between இடையில் (iṭaiyil)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 264, p. 1771
big பெரிய (periya)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 41, p. 329
bitter கசப்பு (kacappu)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 146, p. 1041
Bitter, Sour, Spicy, Rich, Poor
chapter topic; Chapter 146, p. 1041

black, white, red, blue — three native Tamil colors, and one Sanskrit loan கருப்பு வெள்ளை சிவப்பு நீலம் (karuppu veḷḷai sivappu nīlam)
explicit focus: etymology, usage and culture; Chapter 11, p. 115

blood இரத்தம் (irattam)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 169, p. 1183

Boat, Bicycle, Car, Auto-rickshaw, Passenger
chapter topic; Chapter 174, p. 1215

Body Parts
chapter topic; Chapter 13, p. 123

body — the noun in the everyday Tamil way of asking after someone's health உடம்பு (uḍambu)
explicit focus: pronunciation, script, grammar, etymology; Chapter 38, p. 305

boring சலிப்பான (calippāṉa)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 269, p. 1801

Bottle, Ball, Kite, Doll, Purse
chapter topic; Chapter 136, p. 979

brave தைரியமான (tairiyamāṉa)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 147, p. 1047

bread ரொட்டி (roṭṭi)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 214, p. 1463

breakfast காலை உணவு (kālai uṇavu)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 184, p. 1277

Bride, Bridegroom, Engagement, Feast, Festival
chapter topic; Chapter 217, p. 1481

brown பழுப்பு (paḻuppu)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 211, p. 1443

but ஆனால் (āṉāl)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 76, p. 581

But, and Or
chapter topic; Chapter 76, p. 581

butter வெண்ணெய் (veṇṇey)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 122, p. 893

buttermilk மோர் (mōr)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 214, p. 1463

Buttermilk, Fruit juice, Tender coconut water, Flour, Bread
chapter topic; Chapter 214, p. 1463

by chance தற்செயலாக (taṟceyalāka)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 266, p. 1783

C

calm, peace, quiet அமைதி (amaiti)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 89, p. 685
Camel, Duck, Cheek, Wrist, Elbow
chapter topic; Chapter 142, p. 1017
can, it is possible முடியும் (muṭiyum)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 116, p. 855
carefully கவனமாக (kavaṉamāka)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 237, p. 1605
celebration, festivities கொண்டாட்டம் (koṇṭāṭṭam)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 246, p. 1661
Celebration, Firecrackers, Culture, Habit, Tradition
chapter topic; Chapter 246, p. 1661
Century, Until now, Deadline, Until then, Childhood
chapter topic; Chapter 203, p. 1395
certainly நிச்சயமாக (niccayamāka)
Chapter 47, p. 369
chair — a word you can take apart into "four" and "leg," and the thing a guest is offered நாற்காலி (nāṟkāli)
explicit focus: script, etymology; Chapter 35, p. 271
character, nature (of a person) குணம் (kuṇam)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 210, p. 1437
cheap மலிவான (malivāṉa)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 178, p. 1239
chess சதுரங்கம் (cataraṅkam)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 249, p. 1679
child குழந்தை (kuḻandai)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 43, p. 343
childhood குழந்தைப் பருவம் (kuḻantaip paruvam)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 203, p. 1395
children குழந்தைகள் (kuḻantaikaḷ)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 100, p. 751
Children, Husbands, Wives
chapter topic; Chapter 100, p. 751
Church, Mosque, Hall, Playground, Swimming pool
chapter topic; Chapter 206, p. 1413
clean சுத்தமான (cuttamāṉa)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 145, p. 1035
clear தெளிவான (teḷivāṉa)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 179, p. 1247
clever; a clever person புத்திசாலி (putticāli)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 147, p. 1047

Clock, Skirt, Sari, Lentils, Curry
chapter topic; Chapter 121, p. 885

close, shut மூடு (mūḍu)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 65, p. 487

cloth துணி (tuṇi)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 44, p. 349

clothing, a garment ஆடை (āṭai)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 242, p. 1635

Clothing, Trousers, Pocket, Button, Blouse
chapter topic; Chapter 242, p. 1635

coffee காபி (kāpi)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 125, p. 911

cold குளிர்ந்த (kuḷirnta)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 144, p. 1029

Colour, Size, Weight, Healthy, Thin
chapter topic; Chapter 238, p. 1611

Colours
chapter topic; Chapter 11, p. 115

come வா (vā)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 42, p. 337

Come, Eat, Drink
chapter topic; Chapter 98, p. 739

comfortable, convenient வசதியான (vacatiyāṉa)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 269, p. 1801

confusion குழப்பம் (kuḻappam)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 268, p. 1795

congratulations, good wishes வாழ்த்துகள் (vāḻttukaḷ)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 98, p. 739

coriander கொத்தமல்லி (kottamalli)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 271, p. 1813

Coriander, Curry leaves, Apple, Orange, Papaya
chapter topic; Chapter 271, p. 1813

Courtesy
chapter topic; Chapter 49, p. 383

cricket கிரிக்கெட் (kiriket)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 249, p. 1679

crowded, congested நெரிசலான (nericalāṉa)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 267, p. 1789

crying அழுகை (aḻukai)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 90, p. 691

culture கலாச்சாரம் (kalāccāram)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 246, p. 1661

cumin சீரகம் (cīrakam)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 139, p. 997
Cumin, Leafy greens, Jackfruit, Guava, Lemon
chapter topic; Chapter 139, p. 997
Cupboard, Electricity, Rubbish, Toothpaste, Toothbrush
chapter topic; Chapter 213, p. 1457
curd தயிர் (tayir)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 59, p. 447
curry leaves கறிவேப்பிலை (kaṟivēppilai)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 271, p. 1813
Curtain, Mattress, Television, Mobile phone, Computer
chapter topic; Chapter 134, p. 967

D

dangerous ஆபத்தான (āpattāṉa)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 149, p. 1061
darkness இருட்டு (iruṭṭu)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 276, p. 1845
Darkness, Shade, Machine, Sofa, Screwdriver
chapter topic; Chapter 276, p. 1845
Dative Case and Dative Subjects
chapter topic; Chapter 6, p. 51
daughter மகள் (makaḷ)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 43, p. 343
dawn, daybreak விடியல் (viṭiyal)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 233, p. 1579
Day
chapter topic; Chapter 23, p. 195
“day” — Tamil’s everyday, native Dravidian word, already met inside “tomorrow”; unlike Kannada’s dina, Telugu’s rōju, and Malayalam’s divasam, Tamil’s plain day-word is NOT a loanword at all — நாள் just is the everyday word, no Sanskrit or Persian substitute doing that job நாள் (nāḷ)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 23, p. 195
Days of the Week
chapter topic; Chapter 10, p. 105
deep ஆழமான (āḻamāṉa)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 148, p. 1053
Deep, Wide, Narrow, Dry, Wet
chapter topic; Chapter 148, p. 1053
Deepavali, the festival of lights தீபாவளி (tīpāvaḷi)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 202, p. 1387

defeat, a loss தோல்வி (tōlvi)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 277, p. 1851
definitely கண்டிப்பாக (kaṇṭippāka)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 97, p. 735
Definitely, and Why Not
chapter topic; Chapter 97, p. 735
Describing Things
chapter topic; Chapter 41, p. 329
Desert, Cave, Stream, Farm, Zoo
chapter topic; Chapter 175, p. 1221
dew, frost, snow பனி (paṉi)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 127, p. 923
diabetes சர்க்கரை நோய் (carkkarai nōy)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 261, p. 1751
Diabetes, Exercise, Yoga, Itch, Dizziness
chapter topic; Chapter 261, p. 1751
diarrhoea வயிற்றுப்போக்கு (vayiṟṟuppōkku)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 170, p. 1191
different, unusual வித்தியாசமான (vittiyācamāṉa)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 269, p. 1801
dinner இரவு உணவு (iravu uṇavu)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 184, p. 1277
Direction, North, South, East, West
chapter topic; Chapter 235, p. 1593
dirty அழுக்கான (aḻukkāṉa)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 145, p. 1035
disappointment ஏமாற்றம் (ēmāṟṟam)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 239, p. 1617
Disappointment, Pride, Satisfaction, Pity, Loneliness
chapter topic; Chapter 239, p. 1617
Discount, Rupee, Coin, Expense, Salary
chapter topic; Chapter 222, p. 1513
distance; far தூரம் (tūram)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 113, p. 837
District, Hut, Tower, Prison, World
chapter topic; Chapter 265, p. 1777
dizziness தலைச்சுற்றல் (talaiccuṟṟal)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 261, p. 1751
Dog and Cat
chapter topic; Chapter 21, p. 185

dog and cat — நாய் is THE solid, ancient, undisputed Dravidian root behind Kannada/Malayalam's dog-words too, the honest opposite of the tangled dog-words of Spanish, Hindi, and English; பூனை is Tamil's everyday cat-word, one of (at least) three genuinely separate Dravidian cat-word families நாய், பூனை (nāy, pūnai)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 21, p. 185
Doing, and Undoing
chapter topic; Chapter 65, p. 487
don't worry கவலைப்படாதீர்கள் (kavalaippaṭātīrkaḷ)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 99, p. 745
door — Tamil's everyday word is its own, while the Sanskrit one stayed in books கதவு (kadavu)
explicit focus: script, etymology; Chapter 35, p. 271
down, below கீழே (kīḻē)
explicit focus: pronunciation, etymology; Chapter 66, p. 497
drink குடி (kuḍi)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 65, p. 487
Drought, Earthquake, Nature, Rock, Fire
chapter topic; Chapter 248, p. 1673
dry காய்ந்த (kāynta)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 148, p. 1053

E

easily எளிதாக (eḷitāka)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 266, p. 1783
Easily, On purpose, By chance, Luckily, Reason
chapter topic; Chapter 266, p. 1783
east கிழக்கு (kiḻakku)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 235, p. 1593
easy எளிதான (eḷitāṉa)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 267, p. 1789
education கல்வி (kalvi)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 252, p. 1697
eighth — the ending working on a number you already count with எட்டாவது (eṭṭāvadu)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 83, p. 631
Elders and In-Laws
chapter topic; Chapter 102, p. 763
Electric fan, Scissors, Hammer, Nail, Ladder
chapter topic; Chapter 135, p. 973

electricity மின்சாரம் (miṉcāram)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 213, p. 1457
eleventh — proof the ending was never a fact about one to ten பதினொன்றாவது (patiṉoṉṟāvadu)
explicit focus: grammar, etymology; Chapter 83, p. 631
empty காலியான (kāliyāṉa)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 209, p. 1431
English, the language ஆங்கிலம் (āṅkilam)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 104, p. 775
Enthusiasm, Confusion, Smile, Gentle, Honest
chapter topic; Chapter 268, p. 1795
enthusiasm, excitement உற்சாகம் (uṟcākam)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 268, p. 1795
equal சமமான (camamāṉa)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 241, p. 1629
especially, in particular குறிப்பாக (kuṟippāka)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 237, p. 1605
Especially, Instead, Not only, Together, Carefully
chapter topic; Chapter 237, p. 1605
even though, although இருந்தாலும் (iruntālum)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 176, p. 1227
Evening
chapter topic; Chapter 27, p. 213
evening (mālai) — a genuine HOMONYM: Wiktionary lists TWO separate etymologies for this exact spelling — "garland/necklace" (possibly a Dravidian word BORROWED INTO Sanskrit as माला/mālā, a reverse-direction loan) and, unrelated, "evening" (compared to மால், Proto-Dravidian *mā*/māl, whose senses include "கருமை," darkness); confidently native for the evening sense, unlike TA-C26's uncertain காலை, though the exact semantic mechanism ("evening" ← "darkness" specifically) isn't spelled out with full certainty by the source மாலை (mālai)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 27, p. 213
every week வாரந்தோறும் (vārantōṟum)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 262, p. 1757
Every year, Dawn, Day after tomorrow, Day before yesterday, Second
chapter topic; Chapter 233, p. 1579
every year, yearly ஆண்டுதோறும் (āṇṭutōṟum)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 233, p. 1579
everything, all எல்லாம் (ellām)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 181, p. 1259

exactly, correctly சரியாக (cariyāka)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 95, p. 723
Exactly, Really, Nothing
chapter topic; Chapter 95, p. 723
Exam, Answer, Tamarind, Pepper, Mustard seed
chapter topic; Chapter 138, p. 991
exercise உடற்பயிற்சி (uṭaṟpayiṟci)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 261, p. 1751
expensive விலையுயர்ந்த (vilaiyuyarnta)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 178, p. 1239

F

false பொய்யான (poyyāṉa)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 149, p. 1061
Family
chapter topic; Chapter 12, p. 119
family குடும்பம் (kuṭumbam)
Chapter 43, p. 343
famous பிரபலமான (pirapalamāṉa)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 149, p. 1061
Famous, Dangerous, Safe, True, False
chapter topic; Chapter 149, p. 1061
Farewells
chapter topic; Chapter 4, p. 35
fast வேகமான (vēkamāṉa)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 145, p. 1035
Fat, Important, Urgent, Crowded, Easy
chapter topic; Chapter 267, p. 1789
fat, plump குண்டான (kuṇṭāṉa)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 267, p. 1789
Father-in-law, Boyfriend, Girlfriend, Romantic love, Friendship
chapter topic; Chapter 186, p. 1289
father, mother, and FOUR sibling words — Tamil splits "brother"/"sister" by age, where Spanish/French use just one word each அப்பா அம்மா அண்ணன் தம்பி அக்கா தங்கை (appā ammā aṇṇaṉ tambi akkā tangai)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 12, p. 119
favourite பிடித்தமான (piṭittamāṉa)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 181, p. 1259
Favourite, Terrible, Many, Everything, Thick
chapter topic; Chapter 181, p. 1259

fear பயம் (payam)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 72, p. 549
Feather, Tail, Nest, Plant, Creeper
chapter topic; Chapter 275, p. 1839
fifth — the ending working on a number you already count with ஐந்தாவது (aindāvadu)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 82, p. 621
finally, at last கடைசியாக (kaṭaiciyāka)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 262, p. 1757
fire நெருப்பு (neruppu)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 248, p. 1673
firecrackers பட்டாசு (paṭṭācu)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 246, p. 1661
Firm, Round, Square, Sharp, Wonderful
chapter topic; Chapter 240, p. 1623
firm, sturdy உறுதியான (u̱rutiyāṉa)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 240, p. 1623
first of all முதலில் (mutalil)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 62, p. 467
first — the one word in the set you already had, hidden inside the word for first of all முதல் (mutal)
explicit focus: etymology, family and cognates; Chapter 82, p. 621
first, with the ending on it — the exception is the stem, not the rule முதலாவது (mutalāvadu)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 82, p. 621
Fisherman, Potter, Barber, Mason, Scientist
chapter topic; Chapter 224, p. 1525
Five familiar words — now in Tamil script
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script, writing; Chapter 7, p. 67
Five numerals — hide, then write
script and writing topic; explicit focus: writing; Chapter 7, p. 67
flour; batter மாவு (māvu)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 214, p. 1463
fog, mist மூடுபனி (mūṭupaṉi)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 219, p. 1493
food — the noun standing on உண், the older eating verb behind சாப்பிடு's everyday one உணவு (uṇavu)
explicit focus: pronunciation, script, etymology; Chapter 36, p. 283
football கால்பந்து (kālpantu)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 249, p. 1679
for example உதாரணமாக (utāraṇamāka)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 176, p. 1227

Forehead, Beard, Moustache, Palm of the hand, Stomach ache
chapter topic; Chapter 201, p. 1381
foreign வெளிநாட்டு (veḷināṭṭu)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 179, p. 1247
Four Verbs Between People
chapter topic; Chapter 34, p. 261
Four Verbs of the Mind
chapter topic; Chapter 33, p. 249
fourth — the ending working on a number you already count with நான்காவது (nāṉkāvadu)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 82, p. 621
Fox, Snake, Rat, Frog, Tortoise
chapter topic; Chapter 130, p. 941
free of charge இலவசம் (ilavacam)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 178, p. 1239
freedom சுதந்திரம் (cutantiram)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 208, p. 1425
friend — one word with three endings for man, woman and respect, and a root meaning "close" நண்பன் (naṇbaṉ)
explicit focus: pronunciation, script, etymology; Chapter 37, p. 293
friendly நட்பான (naṭpāṉa)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 211, p. 1443
friendship நட்பு (naṭpu)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 186, p. 1289
from now on இனிமேல் (iṉimēl)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 159, p. 1123
fruit juice பழச்சாறு (paḻaccāṟu)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 214, p. 1463
full நிறைந்த (niṟainta)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 209, p. 1431
funny, humorous நகைச்சுவையான (nakaiccuvaiyāṉa)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 180, p. 1253
Future, Tonight, Suddenly, In advance, Calendar
chapter topic; Chapter 172, p. 1203

G

Game, Football, Cricket, Chess, Competition
chapter topic; Chapter 249, p. 1679
Garden, Corner, Turn, Can, Skill
chapter topic; Chapter 116, p. 855
garlic பூண்டு (pūṇṭu)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 124, p. 905

generous, big-hearted பெருந்தன்மையான (peruntaṉmaiyāṉa)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 212, p. 1451

gentle, kind கனிவான (kaṉivāṉa)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 268, p. 1795

Getting There
chapter topic; Chapter 69, p. 525

ghee நெய் (ney)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 59, p. 447

Gifts, Welcomes, Apologies
chapter topic; Chapter 99, p. 745

ginger இஞ்சி (iñci)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 124, p. 905

Giraffe, Zebra, Crocodile, Butterfly, Bee
chapter topic; Chapter 218, p. 1487

give கொடு (koṭu)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 42, p. 337

giving an opinion — I think that ... ... என்று நினைக்கிறேன் (... eṉru niṉaikkiṟēṉ)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 77, p. 589

gladness சந்தோஷம் (santōṣam)
Chapter 49, p. 383

glue பசை (pacai)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 189, p. 1309

Glue, Candle, Website, App, Screen
chapter topic; Chapter 189, p. 1309

God, a god கடவுள் (kaṭavuḷ)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 274, p. 1833

good நல்ல (nalla)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 41, p. 329

Good Afternoon
chapter topic; Chapter 31, p. 231

good afternoon (matiya vaṇakkam), confirmed by two sources for roughly noon to 4 PM, while a third source does not teach a separate afternoon greeting மதிய வணக்கம் (matiya vaṇakkam)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 31, p. 231

Good Evening
chapter topic; Chapter 30, p. 227

good evening (mālai vaṇakkam), literally "evening greetings" — the SAME compositional pattern as TA-C29's kālai vaṇakkam: மாலை (already met, TA-C27, "evening") + வணக்கம் (already met, TA-C01); confirmed via TWO independently-fetched sources (talkpal.ai, preply.com — same practical-content tier as TA-C29's sources) as real and used from afternoon/ late-afternoon through nightfall, one labeling it formal; no śubha-equivalent word here either, consistent with TA-C29's finding, not just assumed to carry over automatically மாலை வணக்கம் (mālai vaṇakkam)
explicit focus: etymology, usage and culture; Chapter 30, p. 227
Good Morning
chapter topic; Chapter 29, p. 223
good morning (kālai vaṇakkam), literally "morning greetings" — a transparent compound of காலை (already met, TA-C26) + வணக்கம் (already met, TA-C01, "reverence, homage"); confirmed via TWO independently-fetched sources as the standard, formal greeting, used from sunrise until around 11 AM; NOT a śubha-equivalent construction, breaking the pattern its neighbours share; a WebSearch summary's claim that a Sanskrit-borrowed "suprabhatham" is a casual alternative could NOT be traced to either directly-fetched source and is therefore not asserted here காலை வணக்கம் (kālai vaṇakkam)
explicit focus: etymology, usage and culture; Chapter 29, p. 223
Good Night
chapter topic; Chapter 25, p. 205
"good night" — fully native Dravidian, "sweet/pleasant night," unlike Hindi, Kannada, Telugu, and Malayalam's shared Sanskrit-descended śubha rātri phrase; Tamil breaks the pattern this arc found in every other language இனிய இரவு (iṉiya iravu)
explicit focus: etymology, usage and culture; Chapter 25, p. 205
goodbye (lit. "I'll go and come back") போய் வருகிறேன் (pōy varugiṟēṉ)
explicit focus: grammar, etymology; Chapter 4, p. 35
Government, Rule, Fine, Complaint, Athlete
chapter topic; Chapter 280, p. 1869
Grandchildren, Neighbours, Names
chapter topic; Chapter 103, p. 769
Grandparents, Aunts and Uncles
chapter topic; Chapter 101, p. 757
grapes திராட்சை (tirāṭcai)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 140, p. 1005

Grapes, Pomegranate, Pickle, Waterfall, Hill
chapter topic; Chapter 140, p. 1005
grass புல் (pul)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 64, p. 479
Green and Yellow
chapter topic; Chapter 22, p. 191
green and yellow — paccai is the pan-Dravidian *pac- word already met in Kannada, Telugu, and Malayalam; manjal ("yellow, turmeric") is a separate native Dravidian root, matching Malayalam's mañña/mañña̱l closely — and Tamil dictionaries also record a rarer, less-commonly-used pacuppu ("greenish yellow"), a genuine doublet of paccai itself, echoing Telugu's pattern in miniature* பச்சை, மஞ்சள் (paccai mañcaḷ)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 22, p. 191
Greetings
chapter topic; Chapter 1, p. 1
Greetings People Actually Say
chapter topic; Chapter 108, p. 799
grey; ash சாம்பல் (cāmpal)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 150, p. 1067

H

hair முடி (muṭi)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 133, p. 961
Handkerchief, Earring, Chain, Chapati, Puri
chapter topic; Chapter 270, p. 1807
hard, difficult கடினமான (kaṭiṉamāṉa)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 145, p. 1035
have a good journey இனிய பயணம் (iṉiya payaṇam)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 107, p. 793
have you eaten? சாப்பிட்டீர்களா*?* (cāppiṭṭīrkaḷā?)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 108, p. 799
he and she, the familiar pair the respectful word was built out of அவன் / அவள் (avaṉ / avaḷ)
explicit focus: grammar, etymology; Chapter 85, p. 651
head and hand — both native Dravidian words, unlike Hindi's Sanskrit-descended pair தலை கை (talai kai)
Chapter 13, p. 123
health உடல்நலம் (uṭalnalam)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 88, p. 679

healthy ஆரோக்கியமான (ārōkkiyamāṉa)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 238, p. 1611
hear and say one to five before meeting their written forms *onru irantu muunru naanku aintu*
explicit focus: pronunciation; Chapter 7, p. 67
hear and say six to ten before meeting their written forms *aaru eezhu ettu onpatu pattu*
explicit focus: pronunciation, etymology, usage and culture; Chapter 7, p. 67
Heard numbers — write without a model
script and writing topic; explicit focus: writing; Chapter 7, p. 67
heat; hot சூடு (cūṭu)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 91, p. 697
heavy கனமான (kaṉamāṉa)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 144, p. 1029
hello / greetings (vaṇakkam — "reverence, homage") வணக்கம் (vaṇakkam)
explicit focus: pronunciation, writing, etymology, usage and culture; Chapter 1, p. 1
Helmet, Wheel, Blackboard, Eraser, Uniform
chapter topic; Chapter 221, p. 1507
here — where I am இங்கே (iṅgē)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 40, p. 321
hesitancy தயக்கம் (tayakkam)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 63, p. 473
homework வீட்டுப்பாடம் (vīṭṭuppāṭam)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 223, p. 1519
honest நேர்மையான (nērmaiyāṉa)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 268, p. 1795
honey தேன் (tēṉ)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 124, p. 905
hot சூடான (cūṭāṉa)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 144, p. 1029
hour — Tamil's OWN dictionaries treat this as a native Dravidian "bell" word, most likely NOT Kannada/Telugu/Hindi's Sanskrit ghaṇṭā, and a probable homophone trap with an unrelated Sanskrit "gem" word spelled the same way மணி (maṇi)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 18, p. 159
house, home — the word behind the door you say வணக்கம் at, and a v where Kannada says b வீடு (vīḍu)
explicit focus: script, etymology; Chapter 35, p. 271
how எப்படி (eppaḍi)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 3, p. 27

How Are You?
chapter topic; Chapter 3, p. 27
how are you? (respectful) நீங்கள் எப்படி இருக்கிறீர்கள்? (nīṅgaḷ eppaḍi irukkiṟīrgaḷ?)
explicit focus: grammar, etymology; Chapter 3, p. 27
how are you? (spoken) எப்படி இருக்கீங்க? (eppaṭi irukkīṅka?)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 108, p. 799
How Do You Say It?
chapter topic; Chapter 93, p. 711
how do you say it? எப்படிச் சொல்வது? (eppaṭic colvatu?)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 93, p. 711
How It Feels
chapter topic; Chapter 72, p. 549
How Much
chapter topic; Chapter 56, p. 427
how much does it cost? — asking a price, and checking the answer விலை எவ்வளவு? (vilai evvaḷavu?)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 80, p. 611
how much — the question for things Tamil does not count one by one எவ்வளவு (evvaḷavu)
explicit focus: script, grammar; Chapter 39, p. 313
how old are you? — literally "to you how many years is becoming?"; the SAME Sanskrit vayas word as Kannada/ Telugu/Malayalam; Tamil actually spans BOTH grammatical shapes seen so far, from a plain possessive in casual speech to this more formal dative+verb construction உனக்கு எத்தனை வயது ஆகிறது? (unakku ettanai vayathu aakirathu?)
Chapter 19, p. 169
How the Body Feels
chapter topic; Chapter 61, p. 461
however, even so ஆனாலும் (āṉālum)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 176, p. 1227
However, Even though, Moreover, For example, Otherwise
chapter topic; Chapter 176, p. 1227
humility பணிவு (paṇivu)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 63, p. 473
hunger பசி (pasi)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 61, p. 461

I

I நான் (nāṉ)
explicit focus: grammar, etymology; Chapter 3, p. 27

i- / a- / e- — six words, one machine
grammar topic; explicit focus: grammar; Chapter 40, p. 321

(I) am hungry பசிக்கிறது (pasikkiṟatu)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 90, p. 691

(I) am sleepy தூக்கம் வருகிறது (tūkkam varukiṟatu)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 91, p. 697

I did not hear it கேட்கவில்லை (kēṭkavillai)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 93, p. 711

(I) don't know தெரியாது (teriyātu)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 96, p. 729

I don't understand புரியவில்லை (puriyavillai)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 94, p. 717

'I know Tamil' — built with no subject, because knowing happens TO you எனக்குத் தமிழ் தெரியும் (enakkut tamiḻ teriyum)
explicit focus: grammar; Chapter 6, p. 51

I speak Tamil நான் தமிழ் பேசுகிறேன் (nāṉ tamiḻ pēsugiṟēṉ)
explicit focus: grammar, etymology; Chapter 5, p. 43

I take my leave விடைபெறுகிறேன் (viṭaiperukiṟēṉ)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 107, p. 793

ice பனிக்கட்டி (paṉikkaṭṭi)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 184, p. 1277

Ice, Breakfast, Lunch, Dinner, Notebook
chapter topic; Chapter 184, p. 1277

Idea, Matchbox, Clay pot, Grinding stone, Tank
chapter topic; Chapter 190, p. 1315

Identity card, Tax, Application, Photograph, Copy
chapter topic; Chapter 272, p. 1821

Idli, Dosa, Vadai, Coffee, Sea
chapter topic; Chapter 125, p. 911

important முக்கியமான (mukkiyamāṉa)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 267, p. 1789

in advance, beforehand முன்கூட்டியே (muṉkūṭṭiyē)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 172, p. 1203

in front முன்னால் (muṉṉāl)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 113, p. 837

in general, generally பொதுவாக (poṭuvāka)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 207, p. 1419

in Tamil தமிழில் (tamiḻil)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 93, p. 711

in that case அப்படியானால் (appaṭiyāṉāl)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 207, p. 1419

In that case, Almost, Actually, In general, Usually
chapter topic; Chapter 207, p. 1419

In the Kitchen
chapter topic; Chapter 59, p. 447
in the middle நடுவில் (naṭuvil)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 114, p. 843
In the middle, Street, Bridge, Park, Temple
chapter topic; Chapter 114, p. 843
information தகவல் (takaval)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 208, p. 1425
inside, in உள்ளே (uḷḷē)
explicit focus: etymology, usage and culture; Chapter 66, p. 497
instead அதற்குப் பதிலாக (ataṟkup patilāka)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 237, p. 1605
interesting சுவாரசியமான (cuvāraciyamāṉa)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 180, p. 1253
Internet, Password, Newspaper, Ticket, Map
chapter topic; Chapter 216, p. 1475
Interview, Company, Factory, Lesson, Homework
chapter topic; Chapter 223, p. 1519
Introducing Yourself
chapter topic; Chapter 2, p. 17
is that so? அப்படியா? (appaṭiyā?)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 96, p. 729
Island, Insect, Spider, Pig, Donkey
chapter topic; Chapter 141, p. 1011
it has got late நேரமாகிவிட்டது (nēramākiviṭṭatu)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 106, p. 787
it's been a long time ரொம்ப நாளாச்சு (rompa nāḷāccu)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 108, p. 799
it's okay / no problem / you're welcome பரவாயில்லை (paravāyillai)
explicit focus: grammar, etymology; Chapter 3, p. 27

J

jaggery வெல்லம் (vellam)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 59, p. 447
jasmine மல்லிகை (mallikai)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 188, p. 1303
jealousy பொறாமை (poṟāmai)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 210, p. 1437
joy / pleased to meet you மகிழ்ச்சி (magiḻcci)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 2, p. 17

just so அப்படியே (appaḍiyē)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 47, p. 369

K

Keeping Well, and Leaving
chapter topic; Chapter 38, p. 305
Key, Lock, Towel, Pillow, Blanket
chapter topic; Chapter 119, p. 873
Keyboard, Camera, Radio, Programme, Film
chapter topic; Chapter 220, p. 1499
Kitchen, Bathroom, Bedroom, Toilet, Window
chapter topic; Chapter 173, p. 1209
knowledge அறிவு (aṟivu)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 208, p. 1425
Knowledge, Duty, Freedom, Information, Secret
chapter topic; Chapter 208, p. 1425

L

Lake, Pond, Forest, Leaf, Soil
chapter topic; Chapter 126, p. 917
land, the ground நிலம் (nilam)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 264, p. 1771
Language, Wedding, Birthday
chapter topic; Chapter 104, p. 775
last, previous போன (pōṉa)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 158, p. 1117
late தாமதமாக (tāmatamāka)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 262, p. 1757
laughter சிரிப்பு (sirippu)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 90, p. 691
Laughter and Tears
chapter topic; Chapter 90, p. 691
lazy; a lazy person சோம்பேறி (cōmpēṟi)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 147, p. 1047
leafy greens கீரை (kīrai)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 139, p. 997
leave to depart — the noun for taking your leave, from the same root as வீடு விடை (viḍai)
explicit focus: script, etymology; Chapter 38, p. 305

lentils, dal பருப்பு (paruppu)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 121, p. 885
let it be so ஆகட்டும் (ākaṭṭum)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 56, p. 427
let's go போகலாம் (pōkalām)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 106, p. 787
Letters From Counting
chapter topic; Chapter 111, p. 821
Letters From Days, Towns and Gladness
chapter topic; Chapter 112, p. 827
Letters From You and Your Name
chapter topic; Chapter 110, p. 813
Letters From Your First Words
chapter topic; Chapter 109, p. 807
Library, Bank, Market, Beach, Office
chapter topic; Chapter 115, p. 849
light (in weight) லேசான (lēcāṉa)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 144, p. 1029
lightning மின்னல் (miṉṉal)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 127, p. 923
Lion, Bear, Monkey, Rabbit, Deer
chapter topic; Chapter 129, p. 935
Load, Voice, Conversation, Man, Woman
chapter topic; Chapter 245, p. 1655
local உள்ளூர் (uḷḷūr)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 179, p. 1247
loneliness தனிமை (taṉimai)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 239, p. 1617
long நீளமான (nīḷamāṉa)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 143, p. 1023
loose தளர்வான (taḷarvāṉa)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 209, p. 1431
loudly சத்தமாக (cattamāka)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 92, p. 703
luckily, fortunately அதிர்ஷ்டவசமாக (atirṣṭavacamāka)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 266, p. 1783
lukewarm வெதுவெதுப்பான (vetuvetuppāṉa)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 241, p. 1629
lunch மதிய உணவு (matiya uṇavu)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 184, p. 1277

M

many, several பல (pala)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 181, p. 1259
Mark, University, Education, Mathematics, Science
chapter topic; Chapter 252, p. 1697
mathematics கணிதம் (kaṇitam)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 252, p. 1697
may I come in? — asking permission, and granting it நான் உள்ளே வரலாமா? (nāṉ uḷḷē varalāmā?)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 75, p. 573
me and you as the one it is done to, standing on the same changed body the dative already used என்னை / உன்னை (eṉṉai / uṉṉai)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 86, p. 663
meaning அர்த்தம் (arttam)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 93, p. 711
meat இறைச்சி (iṟaicci)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 122, p. 893
milk — one syllable, inherited whole, and the word that shows Kannada turning p into h பால் (pāl)
explicit focus: script, etymology; Chapter 36, p. 283
Mind, Character, Jealousy, Shyness, Surprise
chapter topic; Chapter 210, p. 1437
Mirror, Soap, Bucket, Pen, Paper
chapter topic; Chapter 120, p. 879
money பணம் (paṇam)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 68, p. 517
More Everyday Verbs
chapter topic; Chapter 42, p. 337
More of the Body
chapter topic; Chapter 45, p. 355
moreover, furthermore மேலும் (mēlum)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 176, p. 1227
Morning
chapter topic; Chapter 26, p. 211

morning (kālai) — Wiktionary itself HEDGES the etymology ("possibly from Sanskrit काल्य/kālya"), not a confirmed Dravidian root; genuinely uncertain, unlike Kannada's confidently-native or Telugu's confidently-Sanskrit morning-words; பகல் (already met, TA-C17, "daytime") is Wiktionary's own listed coordinate term; அதிகாலை ("early dawn") is a transparent ati-+kālai compound காலை (kālai)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 26, p. 211

Mosquito, Face, Mouth, Tongue, Finger
chapter topic; Chapter 132, p. 955

mud சேறு (sēṟu)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 57, p. 433

murukku (a crunchy spiral snack) முறுக்கு (muṟukku)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 278, p. 1857

Museum, Lane, Harbour, Fort, Palace
chapter topic; Chapter 236, p. 1599

music இசை (icai)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 274, p. 1833

Music, Song, Story, God, Animal
chapter topic; Chapter 274, p. 1833

mustard seed கடுகு (kaṭuku)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 138, p. 991

my என் (eṉ)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 2, p. 17

my name is... (with no "is") என் பெயர் … (eṉ peyar …)
explicit focus: grammar, etymology; Chapter 2, p. 17

N

name பெயர் (peyar)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 2, p. 17

narrow குறுகிய (kuṟukiya)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 148, p. 1053

nature இயற்கை (iyaṟkai)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 248, p. 1673

naughty, mischievous குறும்பான (kuṟumpāṉa)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 180, p. 1253

near, close by அருகில் (arukil)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 113, p. 837

nervousness, tension பதற்றம் (pataṟṟam)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 89, p. 685

never (with a negative verb) ஒருபோதும் (orupōtum)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 171, p. 1197
new புதிய (pudiya)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 41, p. 329
news; a message செய்தி (ceyti)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 185, p. 1283
next, coming அடுத்த (aṭutta)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 159, p. 1123
Next, From Now On, a Plan, To Decide, To Expect
chapter topic; Chapter 159, p. 1123
Night
chapter topic; Chapter 24, p. 201
"night" — native Dravidian, already used standalone inside "midnight" (naḷḷiravu); a Sanskrit loan alternative, rāttiri, also exists — and per at least one dictionary source, rāttiri may actually be the MORE common word in everyday spoken Tamil, the opposite direction from நாள்'s story last lesson இரவு (iravu)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 24, p. 201
Night words — a register hypothesis and a semantic boundary
grammar topic; explicit focus: usage and culture; Chapter 24, p. 201
ninth — the ending working on a number you already count with ஒன்பதாவது (oṉpadāvadu)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 83, p. 631
no / there isn't (illai — the negative) இல்லை (illai)
explicit focus: pronunciation, grammar, etymology; Chapter 1, p. 1
Noon and Midnight
chapter topic; Chapter 17, p. 153
noon and midnight — NO Sanskrit here at all (unlike Kannada/Telugu); both trace to the same old "middle" root, நள் (naḷ), but Tamil ALSO keeps fully transparent synonyms built on நடு, the everyday word for "middle" நண்பகல் நள்ளிரவு (naṇpakal naḷḷiravu)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 17, p. 153
Noon or afternoon? — let the sources keep their blur
etymology topic; explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 28, p. 219
north வடக்கு (vaṭakku)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 235, p. 1593
not at all இல்லவே இல்லை (illavē illai)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 96, p. 729
Not at All, Is That So?
chapter topic; Chapter 96, p. 729
Not Feeling Well
chapter topic; Chapter 87, p. 673

not only (... but also) மட்டுமல்லாமல் (maṭṭumallāmal)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 237, p. 1605
not yet இன்னும் இல்லை (in̲n̲um illai)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 95, p. 723
nothing, it's nothing ஒன்றுமில்லை (on̲rumillai)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 95, p. 723
now இப்போது (ippōdu)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 48, p. 375
Now and then, Every week, Late, Finally, These days
chapter topic; Chapter 262, p. 1757
now and then, occasionally அவ்வப்போது (avvappōtu)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 262, p. 1757
Numbers Eleven to Twenty and Weather
chapter topic; Chapter 20, p. 179
Numbers One to Ten
chapter topic; Chapter 7, p. 67

O

offering somebody a choice between two things பால் வேண்டுமா, அல்லது தேநீர் வேண்டுமா? (pāl vēṇḍumā, alladu tēnīr vēṇḍumā?)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 76, p. 581
often அடிக்கடி (aṭikkaṭi)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 171, p. 1197
Often, Sometimes, Always, Never, Delay
chapter topic; Chapter 171, p. 1197
oh dear!, wow! அடடா (aṭaṭā)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 96, p. 729
oil எண்ணெய் (eṇṇey)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 59, p. 447
okay / alright / correct (sari) சரி (sari)
explicit focus: pronunciation, grammar, etymology; Chapter 1, p. 1
okra, ladies' finger வெண்டைக்காய் (veṇṭaikkāy)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 278, p. 1857
old — of a thing, not of a person பழைய (pa̲laiya)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 41, p. 329
old (of people) வயதான (vayatāna)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 147, p. 1047
on purpose, deliberately வேண்டுமென்றே (vēṇṭumen̲n̲rē)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 266, p. 1783
once, at one time ஒரு காலத்தில் (oru kālattil)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 158, p. 1117

ோ — one character, met inside words you already say
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script, writing; Chapter 7, p. 67
ா — one character, met inside words you already say
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script, writing; Chapter 10, p. 105
ை — one character, met inside words you already say
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script, writing; Chapter 17, p. 153
ே — one character, met inside words you already say
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script, writing; Chapter 19, p. 169
One heard request — write it
script and writing topic; explicit focus: writing; Chapter 8, p. 85
one minute, a moment ஒரு நிமிடம் (oru nimiṭam)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 92, p. 703
one more time இன்னொரு முறை (iṉṉoru muṟai)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 94, p. 717
one's own; a relative சொந்தம் (sontham)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 8, p. 85
One, the Other, and the Price
chapter topic; Chapter 80, p. 611
only மட்டும் (maṭṭum)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 62, p. 467
Only and Still
chapter topic; Chapter 62, p. 467
open திற (tiṟa)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 65, p. 487
opposite எதிரே (etirē)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 264, p. 1771
Opposite, Between, Way, Land, Valley
chapter topic; Chapter 264, p. 1771
or அல்லது (alladu)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 76, p. 581
ordinary, normal சாதாரணமான (cātāraṇamāṉa)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 241, p. 1629
Ordinary, Rare, Equal, Rough, Lukewarm
chapter topic; Chapter 241, p. 1629
otherwise, if not இல்லாவிட்டால் (illāviṭṭāl)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 176, p. 1227
outside, out வெளியே (veḷiyē)
explicit focus: etymology, usage and culture; Chapter 66, p. 497
Overhead
chapter topic; Chapter 51, p. 395

P

paddy நெல் (nel)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 64, p. 479
pain வலி (vali)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 61, p. 461
paper காகிதம் (kāgitam)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 120, p. 879
parents பெற்றோர் (perṟōr)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 273, p. 1827
Parrot, Pigeon, Owl, Peacock, Ant
chapter topic; Chapter 131, p. 949
Pencil, Dictionary, Fee, Letter, Envelope
chapter topic; Chapter 215, p. 1469
pepper மிளகு (miḷaku)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 138, p. 991
perhaps ஒருவேளை (oruvēḷai)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 47, p. 369
permission அனுமதி (aṉumati)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 63, p. 473
Person, Parents, Sibling, Twins, Brother-in-law
chapter topic; Chapter 273, p. 1827
Pet, Bull, Calf, Wolf, Leopard
chapter topic; Chapter 187, p. 1295
pink இளஞ்சிவப்பு (iḷañcivappu)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 211, p. 1443
pity, compassion இரக்கம் (irakkam)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 239, p. 1617
Pleasant, Friendly, Fool, Pink, Brown
chapter topic; Chapter 211, p. 1443
pleasant, sweet (of a voice or manner) இனிமையான (iṉimaiyāṉa)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 211, p. 1443
Please
chapter topic; Chapter 8, p. 85
please come again மீண்டும் வாருங்கள் (mīṇṭum vāruṅkaḷ)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 107, p. 793
please come (in) வாருங்கள் (vāruṅkaḷ)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 98, p. 739
please drink குடியுங்கள் (kuṭiyuṅkaḷ)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 99, p. 745
please eat சாப்பிடுங்கள் (cāppiṭuṅkaḷ)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 98, p. 739

please forgive (manṉikkavum — a formal/written polite request, from மன்னி manṉi "to forgive") மன்னிக்கவும் (maṉṉikkavum)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 9, p. 99

please forgive me மன்னித்துவிடுங்கள் (maṉṉittuviṭuṅkaḷ)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 99, p. 745

please show me காட்டுங்கள் (kāṭṭuṅkaḷ)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 93, p. 711

please (tayavu seytu — "do the kindness," from தயவு tayavu "compassion/grace") தயவுசெய்து (tayavu seytu)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 8, p. 85

please tell me *solluṅgaḷ*
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 8, p. 85

please wait காத்திருங்கள் (kāttiruṅkaḷ)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 92, p. 703

please write it எழுதுங்கள் (eḻutuṅkaḷ)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 94, p. 717

Pointing, and Asking
chapter topic; Chapter 40, p. 321

Police officer, Driver, Postman, Trader, Colleague
chapter topic; Chapter 192, p. 1327

pongal, a rice and lentil dish பொங்கல் (poṅkal)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 183, p. 1271

Pongal, Upma, Sambar, Chutney, Dry stir-fried vegetable dish
chapter topic; Chapter 183, p. 1271

poor ஏழை (ēḻai)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 146, p. 1041

Post office, City, Country, Capital city, Crossroads
chapter topic; Chapter 234, p. 1587

Postage stamp, Parcel, Form, Document, Passport
chapter topic; Chapter 244, p. 1649

pride பெருமை (perumai)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 239, p. 1617

purple ஊதா (ūtā)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 150, p. 1067

Purple, Grey, To sing, To cook, To cut
chapter topic; Chapter 150, p. 1067

Q

Queue, Number, Text message, News, Email
chapter topic; Chapter 185, p. 1283

R

rare அபூர்வமான (apūrvamāṉa)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 241, p. 1629

rasam ரசம் (rasam)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 122, p. 893

Rasam, Butter, Egg, Fish, Meat
chapter topic; Chapter 122, p. 893

read படி (paṭi)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 42, p. 337

Reading — Words, Lines, and a First Passage
chapter topic; Chapter 84, p. 641

really? is it true? உண்மையா*?* (uṇmaiyā?)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 95, p. 723

recently சமீபத்தில் (camīpattil)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 158, p. 1117

Recently, Already, Last, Once, To Spend (Time)
chapter topic; Chapter 158, p. 1117

Refrigerator, Tap, Tumbler, Pan, Lid
chapter topic; Chapter 182, p. 1265

rent; a fare வாடகை (vāṭakai)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 160, p. 1129

respect மரியாதை (mariyādai)
Chapter 49, p. 383

rest ஓய்வு (ōyvu)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 87, p. 673

Result, Problem, Solution, Purpose, Experience
chapter topic; Chapter 177, p. 1233

rich பணக்கார (paṇakkāra)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 146, p. 1041

Ring, Bangle, Sock, Glove, Class
chapter topic; Chapter 137, p. 985

ripe பழுத்த (paḻutta)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 178, p. 1239

romantic love காதல் (kātal)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 186, p. 1289

room — and the letter ற, the hard r that is not the r you think it is அறை (aṟai)
explicit focus: pronunciation, script, etymology; Chapter 35, p. 271

rough, uneven கரடுமுரடான (karaṭumuraṭāṉa)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 241, p. 1629

round வட்டமான (vaṭṭamāṉa)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 240, p. 1623

rubbish, garbage குப்பை (kuppai)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 213, p. 1457

S

Sad, Worried, Calm
chapter topic; Chapter 89, p. 685
sadness, grief சோகம் (cōkam)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 89, p. 685
safe பாதுகாப்பான (pātukāppāṉa)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 149, p. 1061
safely பத்திரமாக (pattiramāka)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 106, p. 787
salt உப்பு (uppu)
Chapter 44, p. 349
sambar, a lentil and vegetable stew சாம்பார் (cāmpār)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 183, p. 1271
sand மணல் (maṇal)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 57, p. 433
satisfaction திருப்தி (tirupti)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 239, p. 1617
Saying, and Thinking
chapter topic; Chapter 77, p. 589
science அறிவியல் (aṟiviyal)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 252, p. 1697
scissors கத்தரிக்கோல் (kattarikkōl)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 135, p. 973
Seasons
chapter topic; Chapter 14, p. 131
second — and the ending that makes every other ordinal in the language இரண்டாவது (iraṇṭāvadu)
explicit focus: grammar, etymology; Chapter 82, p. 621
See You Later
chapter topic; Chapter 107, p. 793
see you later அப்புறம் பார்க்கலாம் (appuṟam pārkkalām)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 107, p. 793
see you tomorrow நாளை பார்க்கலாம் (nāḷai pārkkalām)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 4, p. 35
selfish சுயநலமான (cuyanalamāṉa)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 212, p. 1451
Setting Out
chapter topic; Chapter 48, p. 375

seventh — the ending working on a number you already count with ஏழாவது (ēḻāvadu)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 83, p. 631

shade, a shadow நிழல் (niḻal)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 276, p. 1845

shall we leave? கிளம்பலாமா? (kiḷampalāmā?)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 107, p. 793

sharp கூர்மையான (kūrmaiyāṉa)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 240, p. 1623

shivering, trembling நடுக்கம் (naṭukkam)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 89, p. 685

Shopkeeper, Customer, Cashier, Tailor, Small change
chapter topic; Chapter 191, p. 1321

short குட்டையான (kuṭṭaiyāṉa)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 143, p. 1023

Short Replies
chapter topic; Chapter 47, p. 369

Shoulder, Chest, Knee, Hair, Skin
chapter topic; Chapter 133, p. 961

shyness, shame வெட்கம் (veṭkam)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 210, p. 1437

Signature, Work, School
chapter topic; Chapter 105, p. 781

simple, easy எளிய (eḷiya)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 269, p. 1801

sit உட்கார் (uṭkār)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 42, p. 337

Six to ten — family resemblances and one Kannada shift
etymology topic; explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 7, p. 67

Six to ten — now in Tamil script
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script, writing; Chapter 7, p. 67

sixth — the ending working on a number you already count with ஆறாவது (āṟāvadu)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 83, p. 631

sleep தூக்கம் (tūkkam)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 61, p. 461

slowly மெதுவாக (metuvāka)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 92, p. 703

Slowly, Again, Louder
chapter topic; Chapter 92, p. 703

small சிறிய (siṟiya)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 41, p. 329

small change சில்லறை (cillaṟai)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 191, p. 1321
smoke புகை (pukai)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 57, p. 433
soap சோப்பு (cōppu)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 120, p. 879
soft மென்மையான (meṉmaiyāṉa)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 145, p. 1035
Soft, Hard, Clean, Dirty, Fast
chapter topic; Chapter 145, p. 1035
soil, earth மண் (maṇ)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 126, p. 917
Solluṅgaḷ — hide, then write
script and writing topic; explicit focus: writing; Chapter 8, p. 85
sometimes சில நேரங்களில் (cila nēraṅkaḷil)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 171, p. 1197
son மகன் (makaṉ)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 43, p. 343
soon சீக்கிரம் (sīkkiram)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 62, p. 467
sorrow, regret வருத்தம் (varuttam)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 72, p. 549
Sorry
chapter topic; Chapter 9, p. 99
sour புளிப்பு (puḷippu)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 146, p. 1041
south தெற்கு (teṟku)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 235, p. 1593
Sparrow, Eagle, Puppy, Squirrel, Worm
chapter topic; Chapter 247, p. 1667
Spectator, Actor, Singer, Coach, Carpenter
chapter topic; Chapter 193, p. 1333
spicy காரம் (kāram)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 146, p. 1041
Spoiled, Full, Empty, Tight, Loose
chapter topic; Chapter 209, p. 1431
spoiled, gone off கெட்டுப்போன (keṭṭuppōṉa)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 209, p. 1431
spring, summer, monsoon, winter — and the honest note that the REAL locally central season is the rains, not a Western four-way split வசந்த காலம் கோடைக் காலம் மழைக் காலம் குளிர் காலம் (vasantha kaalam kodai kaalam mazhai kaalam kulir kaalam)
explicit focus: usage and culture; Chapter 14, p. 131

square சதுரமான (caturamāṉa)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 240, p. 1623
Stairs, Pharmacy, Restaurant, Supermarket, Clothes shop
chapter topic; Chapter 204, p. 1401
stairs, steps படிக்கட்டு (paṭikkaṭṭu)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 204, p. 1401
Star, Dew, Thunder, Lightning, Storm
chapter topic; Chapter 127, p. 923
still, yet இன்னும் (iṉṉum)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 62, p. 467
stop நிறுத்து (niṟuttu)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 65, p. 487
Stove, Vessel, Plate, Cup, Spoon
chapter topic; Chapter 118, p. 867
straight ahead நேராக (nērāka)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 113, p. 837
Straight ahead, Near, Distance, Behind, In front
chapter topic; Chapter 113, p. 837
straw, hay வைக்கோல் (vaikkōl)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 250, p. 1685
stubborn பிடிவாதமான (piṭivātamāṉa)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 180, p. 1253
suddenly திடீரென்று (tiṭīreṉṟu)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 172, p. 1203
sugar சர்க்கரை (sarkkarai)
Chapter 59, p. 447
sugarcane கரும்பு (karumpu)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 278, p. 1857
Sugarcane, Okra, Peanut, Watermelon, Murukku
chapter topic; Chapter 278, p. 1857
Sun, Heat, and Sleep
chapter topic; Chapter 91, p. 697
sunshine, the heat of the sun வெயில் (veyil)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 91, p. 697
surprise ஆச்சரியம் (āccariyam)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 210, p. 1437
sweat வியர்வை (viyarvai)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 88, p. 679

T

take care பார்த்துக்கொள்ளுங்கள் (pārttukkoḷḷuṅkaḷ)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 106, p. 787

Take Care, Go Safely
chapter topic; Chapter 106, p. 787
tall உயரமான (uyaramāṉa)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 144, p. 1029
Tall, Hot, Cold, Heavy, Light
chapter topic; Chapter 144, p. 1029
tamarind புளி (puḷi)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 138, p. 991
Tamil Months
chapter topic; Chapter 16, p. 143
Tamil's curves — the writing surface leaves a trace
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script; Chapter 4, p. 35
tasty சுவையான (cuvaiyāṉa)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 178, p. 1239
Tasty, Cheap, Expensive, Free of charge, Ripe
chapter topic; Chapter 178, p. 1239
tea — a borrowed syllable welded onto the நீர் that is already inside தண்ணீர் தேநீர் (tēnīr)
explicit focus: script, etymology; Chapter 36, p. 283
Team, Victory, Defeat, Hobby, Opinion
chapter topic; Chapter 277, p. 1851
tears கண்ணீர் (kaṇṇīr)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 90, p. 691
Telling Time
chapter topic; Chapter 18, p. 159
tender coconut water இளநீர் (iḷanīr)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 214, p. 1463
Tent, Swing, Banyan tree, Pair of scales, Straw
chapter topic; Chapter 250, p. 1685
tenth — the ending working on a number you already count with பத்தாவது (pattāvadu)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 83, p. 631
terrible, awful மோசமான (mōcamāṉa)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 181, p. 1259
thank you (naṉṟi — "goodness, gratitude") நன்றி (naṉṟi)
explicit focus: pronunciation, grammar, etymology; Chapter 1, p. 1
thank you very much மிக்க நன்றி (mikka naṉṟi)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 49, p. 383
that is enough போதும் (pōdum)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 47, p. 369
that one — the thing over there அது (adu)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 40, p. 321

that person — the far half of a pointing system whose pattern you were given without the words அவர் (avar)
explicit focus: grammar, etymology; Chapter 37, p. 293

that's how it is அப்படித்தான் (appaṭittāṉ)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 97, p. 735

that's right சரிதான் (caritāṉ)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 96, p. 729

the accusative suffix -ai, which marks the one the verb is done to -ஐ (-ai)
explicit focus: grammar, etymology; Chapter 86, p. 663

the back முதுகு (mutuku)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 55, p. 419

the big mother (an elder aunt) பெரியம்மா (periyammā)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 102, p. 763

the brain மூளை (mūḷai)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 170, p. 1191

the chest மார்பு (mārpu)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 133, p. 961

The Core Verbs
chapter topic; Chapter 32, p. 237

the dative suffix -ukku, 'to / for,' including its two surface forms and irregular enakku -உக்கு (-ukku)
explicit focus: grammar, etymology; Chapter 6, p. 51

the day after tomorrow நாளை மறுநாள் (nāḷai maṟunāḷ)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 233, p. 1579

the day before yesterday நேற்று முன்தினம் (nēṟṟu muṉtiṉam)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 233, p. 1579

the design at a doorway கோலம் (kōlam)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 50, p. 389

◌் — the dot that leaves both letters visible
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script; Chapter 7, p. 67

◌் — the dot that takes the vowel away
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script, writing; Chapter 18, p. 159

the ending a person must have and a thing can do without — and the line Tamil draws where Spanish draws it too தேநீர் / தேநீரை (tēnīr / tēnīrai)
explicit focus: grammar, etymology, family and cognates; Chapter 86, p. 663

the face முகம் (mukam)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 132, p. 955

the father's elder brother பெரியப்பா (periyappā)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 102, p. 763

the father's younger brother சித்தப்பா (cittappā)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 101, p. 757

The First Verbs
chapter topic; Chapter 5, p. 43
ி — the first vowel sign
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script, writing; Chapter 19, p. 169
the floor தரை (tarai)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 70, p. 533
the forehead நெற்றி (ne̱rri)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 201, p. 1381
the future எதிர்காலம் (etirkālam)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 172, p. 1203
the government அரசு (aracu)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 280, p. 1869
The Harvest
chapter topic; Chapter 64, p. 479
the harvest அறுவடை (a̱ruvaṭai)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 64, p. 479
the heart இதயம் (itayam)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 169, p. 1183
The Household
chapter topic; Chapter 43, p. 343
the internet இணையம் (iṇaiyam)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 216, p. 1475
The Land
chapter topic; Chapter 53, p. 407
the left side இடது (iḍadu)
explicit focus: etymology, usage and culture; Chapter 66, p. 497
ீ — the long i on நீ
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script, writing; Chapter 110, p. 813
ோ — the long u on மூன்று
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script, writing; Chapter 111, p. 821
the mind, the heart மனம் (ma̱nam)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 210, p. 1437
the moon நிலா (nilā)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 51, p. 395
the mouth வாய் (vāy)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 132, p. 955
the neck கழுத்து (ka̱luttu)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 55, p. 419
the New Year புத்தாண்டு (puttāṇṭu)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 202, p. 1387
The One It Is Done To
chapter topic; Chapter 86, p. 663

the other one மற்றது (marṟradu)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 80, p. 611

the palm of the hand உள்ளங்கை (uḷḷaṅkai)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 201, p. 1381

The People Not Here
chapter topic; Chapter 85, p. 651

the radio வானொலி (vāṉoli)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 220, p. 1499

The Rest of You
chapter topic; Chapter 55, p. 419

the right side வலது (valadu)
explicit focus: usage and culture; Chapter 66, p. 497

The Room You Are In
chapter topic; Chapter 70, p. 533

the same, that very one அதே (atē)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 95, p. 723

the sea கடல் (kaṭal)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 125, p. 911

the seven weekdays — a mix of Tamil's OWN planet-words and Sanskrit borrowings திங்கள்–ஞாயிறு (thiṅgaḷ–ñāyiṟu)
explicit focus: grammar, usage and culture; Chapter 10, p. 105

ெ — the short e in பெயர்
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script, writing; Chapter 110, p. 813

ை — the sign that ends இல்லை
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script, writing; Chapter 109, p. 807

the skin தோல் (tōl)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 133, p. 961

the sky ஆகாயம் (ākāyam)
Chapter 51, p. 395

the stomach வயிறு (vayiṟu)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 45, p. 355

the sun சூரியன் (sūriyaṉ)
Chapter 51, p. 395

the throat தொண்டை (toṇṭai)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 169, p. 1183

the tongue நாக்கு (nākku)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 132, p. 955

the total மொத்தம் (mottam)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 251, p. 1691

the truth உண்மை (uṇmai)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 47, p. 369

the twelve months of the Tamil solar calendar — Tamil's OWN calendar, distinct from both the Gregorian and Hindu lunisolar systems சித்திரை வைகாசி ஆனி ஆடி ஆவணி புரட்டாசி ஐப்பசி கார்த்திகை மார்கழி தை மாசி பங்குனி (Chithirai Vaikāsi Āṉi Āḍi Āvaṇi Puraṭṭāsi Aippasi Kārthigai Mārgazhi Thai Māsi Panguṉi)
explicit focus: etymology, usage and culture; Chapter 16, p. 143

the two words for we — one that takes the listener in and one that leaves them out நாம் / நாங்கள் (nām / nāṅgaḷ)
explicit focus: grammar, etymology; Chapter 85, p. 651

the waist, the hip இடுப்பு (iṭuppu)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 169, p. 1183

the wind காற்று (kāṟṟu)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 57, p. 433

the world உலகம் (ulakam)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 265, p. 1777

then, at that time அப்போது (appōdu)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 79, p. 605

there is no need தேவையில்லை (tēvaiyillai)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 56, p. 427

there — where I am not அங்கே (aṅgē)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 40, p. 321

these days, nowadays இப்போதெல்லாம் (ippōtellām)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 262, p. 1757

they — the respectful word with the plural ending you have been saying since chapter two அவர்கள் (avarkaḷ)
explicit focus: grammar, etymology; Chapter 85, p. 651

thick தடிமனான (taṭimaṉāṉa)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 181, p. 1259

thin, slim ஒல்லியான (olliyāṉa)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 238, p. 1611

Things in the House
chapter topic; Chapter 54, p. 413

Things People Make
chapter topic; Chapter 60, p. 453

Things You Ask For
chapter topic; Chapter 44, p. 349

third — the ending working on a number you already count with மூன்றாவது (mūṉṟāvadu)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 82, p. 621

thirst தாகம் (tākam)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 61, p. 461

“this is my friend” — three words, no verb, and a choice of ending that says how you regard them இவர் என் நண்பர் (ivar en̲ naṇbar)
explicit focus: script, usage and culture; Chapter 37, p. 293

this one — the thing near me இது (idu)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 40, p. 321

this person, spoken of with respect — the near end of Tamil’s இ / அ / எ pointing system இவர் (ivar)
explicit focus: script, grammar; Chapter 37, p. 293

Thorn, Lotus, Jasmine, Neem tree, Coconut palm
chapter topic; Chapter 188, p. 1303

Three heard numbers — write their numerals
script and writing topic; explicit focus: writing; Chapter 7, p. 67

Through the Day
chapter topic; Chapter 71, p. 541

Thumb, Bad, Beautiful, Long, Short
chapter topic; Chapter 143, p. 1023

thunder இடி (iṭi)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 127, p. 923

tight இறுக்கமான (ir̲ukkamāṉa)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 209, p. 1431

time நேரம் (nēram)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 48, p. 375

tiredness களைப்பு (kaḷaippu)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 87, p. 673

to accept ஏற்றுக்கொள் (ēr̲r̲ukkoḷ)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 256, p. 1721

To accept, To follow, To miss, To erase, To print
chapter topic; Chapter 256, p. 1721

to act (in a play or film) நடி (naṭi)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 259, p. 1739

to agree, to admit ஒத்துக்கொள் (ottukkoḷ)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 199, p. 1369

to apply (for a job, a loan) விண்ணப்பி (viṇṇappi)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 227, p. 1543

to ask — and to hear, because Tamil gives both jobs to one verb, whose stem changes shape before the beads கேள் (kēḷ)
explicit focus: script, etymology, usage and culture; Chapter 34, p. 261

to avoid தவிர் (tavir)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 197, p. 1357

to bargain பேரம் பேசு (pēram pēcu)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 163, p. 1147

to bark குரை (kurai)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 258, p. 1733
to bathe குளி (kuḷi)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 153, p. 1085
to be jealous பொறாமைப்படு (poṟāmaippaṭu)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 257, p. 1727
to be surprised ஆச்சரியப்படு (āccariyappaṭu)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 257, p. 1727
to be, to exist, to stay — and the three-piece machine every Tamil verb is built on இரு (iru)
explicit focus: pronunciation, grammar; Chapter 32, p. 237
to be understood, to become clear — so the understander is not the subject but sits in the dative, as with தெரி புரி (puri)
explicit focus: script, grammar, etymology; Chapter 33, p. 249
to beg, to plead கெஞ்சு (keñcu)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 231, p. 1567
to begin ஆரம்பி (ārampi)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 226, p. 1537
To begin, To touch, To sneeze, To swallow, To chew
chapter topic; Chapter 226, p. 1537
to believe நம்பு (nampu)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 199, p. 1369
To believe, To agree, To refuse, To discuss, To compare
chapter topic; Chapter 199, p. 1369
to bend வளை (vaḷai)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 200, p. 1375
to blow ஊது (ūtu)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 157, p. 1109
to boil (of liquids) கொதி (koti)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 161, p. 1135
to book in advance, to reserve முன்பதிவு செய் (muṉpativu cey)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 227, p. 1543
to borrow கடன் வாங்கு (kaṭaṉ vāṅku)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 254, p. 1709
To borrow, To pay, To choose, To enter, To exit
chapter topic; Chapter 254, p. 1709
to break உடை (uṭai)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 151, p. 1073
To break, To put, To send, To look for, To teach
chapter topic; Chapter 151, p. 1073
to breathe சுவாசி (cuvāci)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 255, p. 1715

To breathe, To recover, To swell, To wake, To brush one's teeth
chapter topic; Chapter 255, p. 1715

to bring கொண்டு வா (koṇṭu vā)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 195, p. 1345

To bring, To give back, To drive, To use, To try
chapter topic; Chapter 195, p. 1345

to brush one's teeth பல் துலக்கு (pal tulakku)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 255, p. 1715

to burn எரி (eri)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 157, p. 1109

to burst, to explode வெடி (veṭi)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 166, p. 1165

to buy, to get வாங்கு (vāṅgu)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 68, p. 517

to call, to invite அழை (aḻai)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 154, p. 1091

to cancel ரத்து செய் (rattu cey)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 228, p. 1549

to catch, to hold — and so, in பிடிக்கும், to please, with the liker pushed into the dative பிடி (piḍi)
explicit focus: grammar, etymology; Chapter 34, p. 261

to celebrate கொண்டாடு (koṇṭāṭu)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 165, p. 1159

to change மாற்று (māṟṟu)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 225, p. 1531

to cheat, to deceive ஏமாற்று (ēmāṟṟu)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 198, p. 1363

to check சரிபார் (caripār)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 163, p. 1147

to chew மெல் (mel)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 226, p. 1537

to choose தேர்ந்தெடு (tērnteṭu)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 254, p. 1709

to chop நறுக்கு (naṟukku)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 194, p. 1339

To climb, To get down, To turn, To join, To bathe
chapter topic; Chapter 153, p. 1085

to climb, to get on ஏறு (ēṟu)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 153, p. 1085

to collect, to gather சேகரி (cēkari)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 200, p. 1375

to come — the word you say it by is வா, but the beads attach to a different shape, வரு- வா (vā)
explicit focus: grammar, etymology; Chapter 32, p. 237

to comfort, to console தேற்று (tēr̲r̲u)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 258, p. 1733

to compare ஒப்பிடு (oppiṭu)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 199, p. 1369

to complain, to find fault குறை சொல் (kur̲ai col)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 230, p. 1561

to consider, to think something over யோசி (yōci)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 166, p. 1165

to contact, to get in touch தொடர்பு கொள் (toṭarpu koḷ)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 197, p. 1357

to continue தொடர் (toṭar)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 167, p. 1171

To continue, To operate, To stick, To hang, To roll
chapter topic; Chapter 167, p. 1171

to cook சமை (camai)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 150, p. 1067

to correct திருத்து (tiruttu)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 227, p. 1543

To correct, To enquire, To register, To book in advance, To apply
chapter topic; Chapter 227, p. 1543

to count எண்ணு (eṇṇu)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 154, p. 1091

to cross கட (kaṭa)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 162, p. 1141

To cross, To stay, To go around, To move, To lift
chapter topic; Chapter 162, p. 1141

to cry அழு (a̲lu)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 72, p. 549

to cut வெட்டு (veṭṭu)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 150, p. 1067

to dance நடனமாடு (naṭan̲amāṭu)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 165, p. 1159

to decide முடிவு செய் (muṭivu cey)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 159, p. 1123

to decorate அலங்கரி (alaṅkari)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 165, p. 1159

to deep-fry பொரி (pori)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 194, p. 1339

to describe, to explain விவரி (vivari)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 164, p. 1153

To describe, To hand over, To practise, To pass, To pay attention
chapter topic; Chapter 164, p. 1153
to dig தோண்டு (tōṇṭu)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 168, p. 1177
to discuss, to debate விவாதி (vivāti)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 199, p. 1369
to doubt, to suspect சந்தேகப்படு (cantēkappaṭu)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 230, p. 1561
to download பதிவிறக்கு (pativiṟakku)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 230, p. 1561
to dream கனவு காண் (kaṉavu kāṇ)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 229, p. 1555
to drive ஓட்டு (ōṭṭu)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 195, p. 1345
to earn சம்பாதி (campāti)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 197, p. 1357
to eat — a verb Tamil assembled from a noun plus a light verb, alongside the inherited eat-word it kept சாப்பிடு (sāppiṭu)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 32, p. 237
to enjoy, to appreciate ரசி (raci)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 259, p. 1739
to enquire, to ask about விசாரி (vicāri)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 227, p. 1543
to enter நுழை (nuḻai)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 254, p. 1709
to erase, to delete அழி (aḻi)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 256, p. 1721
to exit, to go out வெளியேறு (veḷiyēṟu)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 254, p. 1709
to expect, to look forward to எதிர்பார் (etirpār)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 159, p. 1123
to faint, to pass out மயங்கு (mayaṅku)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 231, p. 1567
To faint, To wilt, To warn, To beg, To manage
chapter topic; Chapter 231, p. 1567
to fall விழு (viḻu)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 152, p. 1079
to feel உணர் (uṇar)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 196, p. 1351
to feel shy, to be embarrassed வெட்கப்படு (veṭkappaṭu)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 257, p. 1727
to fill நிரப்பு (nirappu)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 225, p. 1531

to find கண்டுபிடி (kaṇṭupiṭi)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 156, p. 1103
to float மித (mita)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 260, p. 1745
to fly பற (paṟa)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 152, p. 1079
to fold மடி (maṭi)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 225, p. 1531
to follow (rules, directions) பின்பற்று (piṉparṟu)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 256, p. 1721
to forget மற (maṟa)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 152, p. 1079
To forget, To jump, To swim, To fly, To fall
chapter topic; Chapter 152, p. 1079
to fry, to roast வறு (vaṟu)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 161, p. 1135
to get down, to get off இறங்கு (iṟaṅku)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 153, p. 1085
To get to know, To celebrate, To decorate, To dance, To worship
chapter topic; Chapter 165, p. 1159
to get to know, to mix with (people) பழகு (paḻaku)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 165, p. 1159
to get up, to rise எழு (eḻu)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 71, p. 541
to give back திருப்பிக் கொடு (tiruppik koṭu)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 195, p. 1345
to go (and vā, to come) போ (pō)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 4, p. 35
to go around, to wander சுற்று (cuṟṟu)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 162, p. 1141
to go — the same three-slot verb with the middle bead swapped for past, present or future போ (pō)
explicit focus: grammar, etymology; Chapter 32, p. 237
to grind அரை (arai)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 161, p. 1135
to grow வளர் (vaḷar)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 154, p. 1091
to hand over, to hand in ஒப்படை (oppaṭai)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 164, p. 1153
to hang (intransitive), to dangle தொங்கு (toṅku)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 167, p. 1171
to hate வெறு (veṟu)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 257, p. 1727

To hate, To be surprised, To feel shy, To be jealous, To kiss
chapter topic; Chapter 257, p. 1727
to help, to be of use — a native word where three sisters and Hindi all reach for Sanskrit instead உதவு (udavu)
explicit focus: script, etymology; Chapter 34, p. 261
to hide மறை (maṟai)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 157, p. 1109
To hide, To save, To blow, To burn, To put out
chapter topic; Chapter 157, p. 1109
to hurry அவசரப்படு (avacarappaṭu)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 228, p. 1549
to imagine கற்பனை செய் (kaṟpaṉai cey)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 230, p. 1561
To imagine, To doubt, To complain, To download, To upload
chapter topic; Chapter 230, p. 1561
to increase, to go up அதிகரி (atikari)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 260, p. 1745
To increase, To spread, To sink, To float, To squeeze
chapter topic; Chapter 260, p. 1745
to join, to reach சேர் (cēr)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 153, p. 1085
to jump குதி (kuti)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 152, p. 1079
to kiss முத்தமிடு (muttamiṭu)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 257, p. 1727
to knead பிசை (picai)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 194, p. 1339
to know, to be apparent — the verb that takes no person ending, because knowing happens to you தெரி (teri)
explicit focus: grammar; Chapter 32, p. 237
to laugh சிரி (siri)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 72, p. 549
to learn கற்றுக்கொள் (kaṟṟukkoḷ)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 156, p. 1103
to lift தூக்கு (tūkku)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 162, p. 1141
to light a lamp விளக்கேற்று (viḷakkēṟṟu)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 166, p. 1165
To light a lamp, To burst, To put up with, To make peace, To consider
chapter topic; Chapter 166, p. 1165
to live, to flourish வாழ் (vāḻ)
explicit focus: grammar, etymology; Chapter 5, p. 43

to look for தேடு (tēṭu)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 151, p. 1073
to lose இழ (il̲a)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 196, p. 1351
to love நேசி (nēci)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 228, p. 1549
to make peace, to calm someone down சமாதானம் செய் (camātān̲am cey)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 166, p. 1165
to manage, to cope with சமாளி (camāḷi)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 231, p. 1567
to melt உருகு (uruku)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 258, p. 1733
To melt, To pick, To bark, To comfort, To shake hands
chapter topic; Chapter 258, p. 1733
to miss (a bus, a chance) தவறவிடு (tava̲raviṭu)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 256, p. 1721
to mix, to stir கலக்கு (kalakku)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 161, p. 1135
to move house, to relocate குடிபெயர் (kuṭipeyar)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 197, p. 1357
to move, to shift நகர் (nakar)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 162, p. 1141
to operate, to run (a machine) இயக்கு (iyakku)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 167, p. 1171
to paint (a wall), to coat, to smear on பூசு (pūcu)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 200, p. 1375
to pass (an exam) தேர்ச்சி பெறு (tērcci pe̲ru)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 164, p. 1153
to pay செலுத்து (celuttu)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 254, p. 1709
to pay attention, to notice கவனி (kava̲ni)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 164, p. 1153
to peel உரி (uri)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 194, p. 1339
to pick, to pluck பறி (pa̲ri)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 258, p. 1733
To pinch, To bend, To paint, To collect, To suck
chapter topic; Chapter 200, p. 1375
to pinch, to nip off கிள்ளு (kiḷḷu)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 200, p. 1375
to play விளையாடு (viḷaiyāḍu)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 71, p. 541

to plough உழு (u̲lu)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 168, p. 1177
To plough, To dig, To stretch out, To slip, To yawn
chapter topic; Chapter 168, p. 1177
to pour ஊற்று (ūr̲ru)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 194, p. 1339
To pour, To chop, To peel, To deep-fry, To knead
chapter topic; Chapter 194, p. 1339
to practise பயிற்சி செய் (payi̲rci cey)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 164, p. 1153
to praise பாராட்டு (pārāṭṭu)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 229, p. 1555
To praise, To scold, To dream, To separate, To throw
chapter topic; Chapter 229, p. 1555
to pray பிரார்த்தனை செய் (pirārttana̲i cey)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 198, p. 1363
To pray, To cheat, To tell a lie, To quarrel, To tease
chapter topic; Chapter 198, p. 1363
to prepare தயார் செய் (tayār cey)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 163, p. 1147
To prepare, To serve, To share, To bargain, To check
chapter topic; Chapter 163, p. 1147
to press அழுத்து (a̲luttu)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 196, p. 1351
to print அச்சிடு (acciṭu)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 256, p. 1721
to pull இழு (i̲lu)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 155, p. 1097
to push தள்ளு (taḷ̲lu)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 155, p. 1097
To push, To pull, To put, To tie, To wash
chapter topic; Chapter 155, p. 1097
to put out; to hug அணை (aṇai)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 157, p. 1109
to put, to drop போடு (pōṭu)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 155, p. 1097
to put, to keep வை (vai)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 151, p. 1073
to put up with, to tolerate பொறுத்துக்கொள் (po̲ruttukkoḷ)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 166, p. 1165
to quarrel, to fight சண்டை போடு (caṇṭai pōṭu)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 198, p. 1363

to read, to study — and the reason this book writes it paḍi with a d when the letter is ட படி (paḍi)
explicit focus: script, etymology; Chapter 33, p. 249

to recover, to get well குணமாகு (kuṇamāku)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 255, p. 1715

to refuse, to deny மறு (maṟu)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 199, p. 1369

to register, to record பதிவு செய் (pativu cey)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 227, p. 1543

to remind நினைவூட்டு (niṉaivūṭṭu)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 197, p. 1357

To remind, To earn, To avoid, To move house, To contact
chapter topic; Chapter 197, p. 1357

to repair பழுது பார் (paḻutu pār)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 259, p. 1739

to roll (something) உருட்டு (uruṭṭu)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 167, p. 1171

to run ஓடு (ōḍu)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 71, p. 541

to save, to rescue காப்பாற்று (kāppāṟṟu)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 157, p. 1109

to say, to tell சொல் (sol)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 77, p. 589

to scold திட்டு (tiṭṭu)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 229, p. 1555

to see, to look — and the doubled consonant that sorts every Tamil verb into strong or weak பார் (pār)
explicit focus: grammar; Chapter 32, p. 237

to sell வில் (vil)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 161, p. 1135

To sell, To boil, To fry, To grind, To mix
chapter topic; Chapter 161, p. 1135

to send அனுப்பு (anuppu)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 151, p. 1073

to separate, to part பிரி (piri)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 229, p. 1555

to serve (food) பரிமாறு (parimāṟu)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 163, p. 1147

to set out புறப்படு (puṟappaḍu)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 48, p. 375

to shake hands கை குலுக்கு (kai kulukku)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 258, p. 1733

to share பகிர் (pakir)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 163, p. 1147

to shout கத்து (kattu)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 154, p. 1091

to sing பாடு (pāṭu)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 150, p. 1067

to sink, to drown மூழ்கு (mūḻku)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 260, p. 1745

to sleep தூங்கு (tūṅgu)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 71, p. 541

to slip வழுக்கு (vaḻukku)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 168, p. 1177

to sneeze தும்மு (tummu)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 226, p. 1537

to soak ஊற வை (ūṟa vai)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 196, p. 1351

to speak பேசு (pēsu)
explicit focus: grammar, etymology; Chapter 5, p. 43

to spend (time) கழி (kaḻi)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 158, p. 1117

to spread (of news, disease, fire) பரவு (paravu)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 260, p. 1745

to squeeze, to wring out பிழி (piḻi)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 260, p. 1745

to stay (overnight) தங்கு (taṅku)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 162, p. 1141

to stick, to paste ஒட்டு (oṭṭu)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 167, p. 1171

to stretch out, to extend நீட்டு (nīṭṭu)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 168, p. 1177

to suck, to sip through a straw உறிஞ்சு (uṟiñcu)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 200, p. 1375

to swallow விழுங்கு (viḻuṅku)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 226, p. 1537

to sweep பெருக்கு (perukku)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 156, p. 1103

to swell வீங்கு (vīṅku)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 255, p. 1715

to swim நீந்து (nīntu)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 152, p. 1079

to take a photo படம் எடு (paṭam eṭu)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 259, p. 1739

To take a photo, To act, To enjoy, To repair, To tidy up
chapter topic; Chapter 259, p. 1739

to take off (clothes, shoes) கழற்று (kaḻarṟu)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 225, p. 1531

to take, to pick up — one vowel away from இடு, "to put," and pointing the opposite way எடு (eḍu)
explicit focus: script, etymology; Chapter 34, p. 261

to taste சுவை பார் (cuvai pār)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 225, p. 1531

To taste, To fill, To fold, To take off, To change
chapter topic; Chapter 225, p. 1531

to teach கற்பி (kaṟpi)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 151, p. 1073

to tear கிழி (kiḻi)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 196, p. 1351

To tear, To lose, To press, To feel, To soak
chapter topic; Chapter 196, p. 1351

to tease, to make fun of கேலி செய் (kēli cey)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 198, p. 1363

to tell a lie பொய் சொல் (poy col)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 198, p. 1363

to think — and, with no second word, to remember, because Tamil files thinking and recalling under one verb நினை (ninai)
explicit focus: script, grammar, etymology; Chapter 33, p. 249

to throw, to fling வீசு (vīcu)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 229, p. 1555

to tidy up, to arrange ஒழுங்குபடுத்து (oḻuṅkupaṭuttu)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 259, p. 1739

to tie, to build கட்டு (kaṭṭu)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 155, p. 1097

to touch தொடு (toṭu)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 226, p. 1537

to translate மொழிபெயர் (moḻipeyar)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 228, p. 1549

to try முயற்சி செய் (muyaṟci cey)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 195, p. 1345

to turn, to return திரும்பு (tirumpu)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 153, p. 1085

to type தட்டச்சு செய் (taṭṭaccu cey)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 228, p. 1549

To type, To translate, To cancel, To hurry, To love
chapter topic; Chapter 228, p. 1549

to upload பதிவேற்று (pativēr̲r̲u)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 230, p. 1561
to use பயன்படுத்து (payaṉpaṭuttu)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 195, p. 1345
to wake (someone) up எழுப்பு (el̲uppu)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 255, p. 1715
to warn எச்சரி (eccari)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 231, p. 1567
to wash கழுவு (kal̲uvu)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 71, p. 541
to wash (clothes) துவை (tuvai)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 155, p. 1097
to wear அணி (aṇi)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 154, p. 1091
To wear, To call, To grow, To count, To shout
chapter topic; Chapter 154, p. 1091
to wilt, to wither வாடு (vāṭu)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 231, p. 1567
to win வெல் (vel)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 156, p. 1103
to wipe துடை (tuṭai)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 156, p. 1103
To wipe, To sweep, To learn, To win, To find
chapter topic; Chapter 156, p. 1103
to work (lit. "work-do") வேலை செய் (vēlai sey)
explicit focus: grammar, etymology; Chapter 5, p. 43
to worship, to bow to வணங்கு (vaṇaṅku)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 165, p. 1159
to write — carrying ழ, the retroflex glide Tamil and Malayalam kept and their sisters gave up எழுது (el̲udu)
explicit focus: pronunciation, script, etymology; Chapter 33, p. 249
to yawn கொட்டாவி விடு (koṭṭāvi viṭu)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 168, p. 1177
today இன்று (in̲r̲u)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 73, p. 559
Today, Yesterday, and the Year
chapter topic; Chapter 73, p. 559
together ஒன்றாக (on̲r̲āka)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 237, p. 1605
Tomato, Chilli, Ginger, Garlic, Honey
chapter topic; Chapter 124, p. 905
tonight இன்றிரவு (in̲r̲iravu)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 172, p. 1203

Toothache, Wound, Tablet, Patient, Nurse
chapter topic; Chapter 232, p. 1573
toothpaste பற்பசை (paṟpacai)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 213, p. 1457
Total, List, Thing, Sale, Employer
chapter topic; Chapter 251, p. 1691
Tour, Cinema, Building, Upper floor, Police station
chapter topic; Chapter 205, p. 1407
town, village — where you are from, which a Tamil introduction asks for, and the -ore in Bangalore ஊர் (ūr)
explicit focus: script, grammar, etymology; Chapter 37, p. 293
tradition, heritage பாரம்பரியம் (pārampariyam)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 246, p. 1661
Traffic, Footpath, Aeroplane, Airport, Ship
chapter topic; Chapter 263, p. 1765
traffic; transport போக்குவரத்து (pōkkuvarattu)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 263, p. 1765
trousers கால்சட்டை (kālcaṭṭai)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 242, p. 1635
true உண்மையான (uṇmaiyāṉa)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 149, p. 1061
trust நம்பிக்கை (nambikkai)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 63, p. 473
twins இரட்டையர் (iraṭṭaiyar)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 273, p. 1827
Two Tamils
chapter topic; Chapter 81, p. 617
Two to five — one family in four regional coats
etymology topic; explicit focus: pronunciation, etymology; Chapter 7, p. 67

U

ugly அசிங்கமான (aciṅkamāṉa)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 212, p. 1451
-ukku, -ku, -ge, -ikku — the family shows its bones
grammar topic; explicit focus: script, grammar; Chapter 6, p. 51
uncle, the mother's brother மாமா (māmā)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 101, p. 757
until now, so far இதுவரை (ituvarai)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 203, p. 1395
until then அதுவரை (atuvarai)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 203, p. 1395

up, above மேலே (mēlē)
explicit focus: etymology, usage and culture; Chapter 66, p. 497
up to, until வரை (varai)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 202, p. 1387
upma, a semolina dish உப்புமா (uppumā)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 183, p. 1271
urgent அவசரமான (avacaramāṉa)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 267, p. 1789
useful பயனுள்ள (payaṉuḷḷa)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 179, p. 1247
Useful, Local, Foreign, Clear, Feeling
chapter topic; Chapter 179, p. 1247
usually, as usual வழக்கமாக (vaḻakkamāka)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 207, p. 1419

V

vegetables காய்கறி (kāykaṟi)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 123, p. 899
Vegetables, Banana, Mango, Coconut, Onion
chapter topic; Chapter 123, p. 899
victory, a win வெற்றி (veṟṟi)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 277, p. 1851
vomiting, nausea வாந்தி (vānti)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 88, p. 679

W

walk நட (naḍa)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 65, p. 487
want, need — another verb Tamil builds with no subject at all வேண்டும் (vēṇḍum)
explicit focus: pronunciation, script, grammar, etymology; Chapter 39, p. 313
Water and Rice
chapter topic; Chapter 15, p. 137
water, and rice — the actual staple food here, not bread — with a widely-cited (if not fully certain) link from arisi to the English word "rice" itself தண்ணீர் அரிசி சாதம் (taṇṇīr arisi sātam)
explicit focus: usage and culture; Chapter 15, p. 137
Wave, Buffalo, Horse, Elephant, Tiger
chapter topic; Chapter 128, p. 929

we'll meet again மீண்டும் சந்திப்போம் (mīṇḍum sandippōm)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 4, p. 35

weak பலவீனமான (palavīn̲amān̲a)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 212, p. 1451

Weak, Selfish, Generous, Well-behaved, Ugly
chapter topic; Chapter 212, p. 1451

weariness, fatigue சோர்வு (cōrvu)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 87, p. 673

weather — most likely a NATIVE Dravidian compound, unlike Kannada/Telugu/Malayalam's Sanskrit compounds: vaanam ("sky") + nilai ("state, standing") வானிலை (vān̲ilai)
Chapter 20, p. 179

Weekend, Up to, Temple festival, Deepavali, New Year
chapter topic; Chapter 202, p. 1387

weight எடை (eṭai)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 238, p. 1611

welcome (formal) நல்வரவு (nalvaravu)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 99, p. 745

well-behaved, disciplined ஒழுக்கமான (oḻukkamān̲a)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 212, p. 1451

well, fine நன்றாக (nan̲n̲rāka)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 91, p. 697

well, wellness, good — and the reply "nān̲ nalamāga irukkir̲ēn̲" நலம் (nalam)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 3, p. 27

wellbeing, ease — the Sanskrit word Tamil did take in, sitting beside the native நலம் it never dropped சுகம் (sugam)
explicit focus: script, grammar, etymology; Chapter 38, p. 305

west மேற்கு (mēr̲ku)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 235, p. 1593

wet நனைந்த (nan̲ainta)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 148, p. 1053

what என்ன (en̲n̲a)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 2, p. 17

what did you say? என்ன சொன்னீர்கள்? (en̲n̲a con̲n̲īrkaḷ?)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 94, p. 717

what's new? என்ன விசேஷம்? (en̲n̲a vicēṣam?)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 108, p. 799

what's your name? உங்கள் பெயர் என்ன? (uṅgaḷ peyar en̲n̲a?)
explicit focus: grammar, etymology; Chapter 2, p. 17

What You Are Offered
chapter topic; Chapter 36, p. 283

What You Wear
chapter topic; Chapter 67, p. 509
wheat கோதுமை (kōtumai)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 243, p. 1643
Wheat, Potato, Aubergine, Fragrance, Cucumber
chapter topic; Chapter 243, p. 1643
When
chapter topic; Chapter 79, p. 605
when? எப்போது (eppōdu)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 79, p. 605
When You Are Lost
chapter topic; Chapter 94, p. 717
where? — asking about a place எங்கே (eṅgē)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 40, p. 321
Which One in the Line
chapter topic; Chapter 82, p. 621
Which Way
chapter topic; Chapter 66, p. 497
who? — asking about a person யார் (yār)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 40, p. 321
Who Somebody Is
chapter topic; Chapter 46, p. 361
why ஏன் (ēṉ)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 78, p. 597
Why, and Because
chapter topic; Chapter 78, p. 597
why not? ஏன் இல்லை? (ēṉ illai?)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 97, p. 735
wide அகலமான (akalamāṉa)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 148, p. 1053
Wind and Fire
chapter topic; Chapter 57, p. 433
wonderful, excellent அருமையான (arumaiyāṉa)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 240, p. 1623
Worker, Meeting, Manager, Engineer, Lawyer
chapter topic; Chapter 279, p. 1863
worry, anxiety கவலை (kavalai)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 89, p. 685

Y

yes (ām) ஆம் (ām)
explicit focus: pronunciation, grammar, etymology; Chapter 1, p. 1

Yes or No
chapter topic; Chapter 75, p. 573
yesterday நேற்று (nēr̲ru)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 73, p. 559
yoga யோகா (yōkā)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 261, p. 1751
you (familiar / respectful) நீ / நீங்கள் (nī / nīṅgaḷ)
explicit focus: grammar, etymology; Chapter 2, p. 17
Young, Old, Clever, Lazy, Brave
chapter topic; Chapter 147, p. 1047
young, younger இளைய (iḷaiya)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 147, p. 1047
Your age what? / To you how many years becomes?
grammar topic; explicit focus: grammar; Chapter 19, p. 169
Your Town, Your Friend
chapter topic; Chapter 37, p. 293

Other

அ — one character, met inside words you already say
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script, writing; Chapter 15, p. 137
ஆ — one character, met inside words you already say
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script, writing; Chapter 16, p. 143
-ஆ — the question you can build yourself
grammar topic; explicit focus: grammar; Chapter 75, p. 573
ஆனால் — three shapes, all of them old
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script; Chapter 76, p. 581
ஆனால் / ஆனா — the two Tamils
grammar topic; explicit focus: grammar; Chapter 81, p. 617
ஆம் — writing a word that starts with a vowel
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script; Chapter 16, p. 143
ஆம், இல்லை — and the answer Tamil likes better
grammar topic; explicit focus: grammar; Chapter 75, p. 573
இ — the letter that opens இல்லை
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script, writing; Chapter 109, p. 807
இன்று — a word that opens on a vowel
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script; Chapter 73, p. 559
இருக்கிறீர்கள் — the last sign, and the whole question
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script; Chapter 31, p. 231
இல்லை — a vowel in front, a vowel sign behind
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script; Chapter 18, p. 159
உ — the letter behind a sign you have used for chapters
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script, writing; Chapter 8, p. 85

-உக்கு — one carriage in a suffix train
grammar topic; explicit focus: grammar; Chapter 6, p. 51
உணவு — the same vowel, twice, two ways
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script; Chapter 36, p. 283
-உம் on its own — "also", "too"
grammar topic; explicit focus: grammar; Chapter 74, p. 567
-உம் ... -உம் — how Tamil says "and"
grammar topic; explicit focus: grammar; Chapter 74, p. 567
-உம் ... -உம் இல்லை — neither one nor the other
grammar topic; explicit focus: grammar; Chapter 74, p. 567
-உம் போது — when one thing happens, so does another
grammar topic; explicit focus: grammar; Chapter 79, p. 605
�உள — the letter that opens ஊர்
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script, writing; Chapter 112, p. 827
ஊர் — the long partner
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script; Chapter 37, p. 293
எ — one character, met inside words you already say
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script, writing; Chapter 8, p. 85
என் — the third vowel that opens a word
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script; Chapter 21, p. 185
என்று (enṟu) — the end of a quotation
grammar topic; explicit focus: grammar; Chapter 77, p. 589
என்று / -ன்னு — which one you are being taught
grammar topic; explicit focus: grammar; Chapter 81, p. 617
எப்படி — the retroflex stop
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script; Chapter 29, p. 223
எப்போது — the doubled letter, read across a seam
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script; Chapter 79, p. 605
ஏ — the letter that opens ஏழு
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script, writing; Chapter 111, p. 821
ஏன் — the shortest question in the book
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script; Chapter 78, p. 597
ஏழு — hide, then write
script and writing topic; explicit focus: writing; Chapter 7, p. 67
ஐ — the letter that opens ஐந்து
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script, writing; Chapter 111, p. 821
ஒ — the letter that opens ஒரு
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script, writing; Chapter 112, p. 827
ஒன்று — the letter under both shapes of "one"
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script; Chapter 39, p. 313
ஒன்று ... மற்றது — one here, the other there
grammar topic; explicit focus: grammar; Chapter 80, p. 611

ஓ — the letter behind a sign you already read
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script; Chapter 71, p. 541
க — the letter that is three bowls
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script, writing; Chapter 13, p. 123
-க்காக — what a thing is for
grammar topic; explicit focus: grammar; Chapter 78, p. 597
கடை — a sign that wraps the letter
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script; Chapter 68, p. 517
குடி — a word with nothing new in it
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script; Chapter 65, p. 487
ங — the nasal before the க in நீங்கள்
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script, writing; Chapter 110, p. 813
ச — one character, met inside words you already say
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script, writing; Chapter 12, p. 119
சொ — one new sign in a familiar request
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script, writing; Chapter 8, p. 85
சட்டை — what a doubled letter looks like
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script; Chapter 67, p. 509
சரி — one letter, several sounds
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script; Chapter 19, p. 169
சரியா — a question you can see
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script; Chapter 75, p. 573
சொல் — a sign on both sides of one letter
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script; Chapter 77, p. 589
சொல்லுங்கள் — one visible copy
script and writing topic; explicit focus: writing; Chapter 8, p. 85
ஞ — the letter that opens ஞாயிறு
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script, writing; Chapter 112, p. 827
ட — one character, met inside words you already say
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script, writing; Chapter 14, p. 131
ண — the first of three n's
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script, writing; Chapter 6, p. 51
த — one character, met inside words you already say
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script, writing; Chapter 18, p. 159
தமிழ் — the letter the language is named for
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script; Chapter 33, p. 249
தயவுசெய்து or -உங்கள்? — politeness in phrase or verb
grammar topic; explicit focus: script, usage and culture; Chapter 8, p. 85
ந — the third n, and the only one built from uprights
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script, writing; Chapter 8, p. 85
ந, ன, ண — three stops on one tongue-map
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script; Chapter 6, p. 51

ந, ன, ற — the letter bodies inside நன்றி
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script; Chapter 10, p. 105

நீங்கள் — two old promises, paid
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script; Chapter 27, p. 213

நடுப்பகல் and நடு இரவு — the transparent twins
etymology topic; explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 17, p. 153

நான் — the sign that stands after
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script; Chapter 25, p. 205

நன்றி — a native family word with a register edge
etymology topic; explicit focus: etymology, usage and culture; Chapter 1, p. 1

நல்ல இரவு and இரவு வணக்கம் — old roots recombined
etymology topic; explicit focus: script; Chapter 25, p. 205

நாள் and தினம் — everyday native, formal borrowed
etymology topic; Chapter 23, p. 195

ன — the second n, and how to tell it from ண
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script, writing; Chapter 7, p. 67

ப — one character, met inside words you already say
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script, writing; Chapter 6, p. 51

போ — one sign, two marks
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script; Chapter 35, p. 271

பேசு — the long partner of ெ
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script; Chapter 34, p. 261

பயம் — a word with no vowel signs
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script; Chapter 72, p. 549

பெயர் — a sign that waits on the left
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script; Chapter 23, p. 195

பாலும் — an ending you can now see
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script; Chapter 74, p. 567

ம and ண — a loop, and a curled tongue
script and writing topic; explicit focus: pronunciation, script; Chapter 6, p. 51

ம — upright on the left, curve on the right
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script, writing; Chapter 16, p. 143

மேசை — two front-hanging signs in one word
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script; Chapter 70, p. 533

மணி — hour or jewel? Context decides
etymology topic; explicit focus: script, grammar, etymology; Chapter 18, p. 159

மதிய — the greeting takes a different root
etymology topic; explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 31, p. 231

மன்னிக்கவும் — formal forgiveness and a doubled n
grammar topic; explicit focus: script, usage and culture; Chapter 9, p. 99

மூன்று — the fourth corner of the u-family
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script; Chapter 38, p. 305

மற்றது — **a doubling you have read twice before**
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script; Chapter 80, p. 611
மேலே — **the same sign twice**
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script; Chapter 66, p. 497
ய — **one character, met inside words you already say**
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script, writing; Chapter 20, p. 179
ர — **one character, met inside words you already say**
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script, writing; Chapter 13, p. 123
ற — **the last of the family, and the one that drops below the line**
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script, writing; Chapter 10, p. 105
ல — **one character, met inside words you already say**
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script, writing; Chapter 9, p. 99
ள — **the l at the end of நீங்கள்**
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script, writing; Chapter 110, p. 813
ழ — **one character, met inside words you already say**
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script, writing; Chapter 11, p. 115
வ and க — **the vowel inside each consonant**
script and writing topic; explicit focus: pronunciation, script, grammar; Chapter 5, p. 43
வ — **one spiral, one motion**
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script, writing; Chapter 6, p. 51
வ (va) — **copy one visible shape with help**
script and writing topic; explicit focus: writing; Chapter 1, p. 1
வணக்கம் — **one bow, two lexical loyalties**
etymology topic; explicit focus: etymology, usage and culture; Chapter 1, p. 1
வணக்கம் — **the first whole written word**
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script; Chapter 8, p. 85
வண்டி — **a dot joining two letters**
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script; Chapter 69, p. 525
ஷ — **the letter inside சந்தோஷம்**
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script, writing; Chapter 112, p. 827
ஸ — **the letter inside நமஸ்காரம்**
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script, writing; Chapter 109, p. 807
க · உ · ஙூ — **three numeral shapes**
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script, writing; Chapter 7, p. 67
க உ ஙூ ச ரூ — **one visible copy**
script and writing topic; explicit focus: writing; Chapter 7, p. 67
ச · ரூ — **finish the first five numerals**
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script, writing; Chapter 7, p. 67
சூ · எ · அ — **three more numeral shapes**
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script, writing; Chapter 7, p. 67
சூ எ அ கூ ஔ — **one supported copy**
script and writing topic; explicit focus: writing; Chapter 7, p. 67
கூ · ஔ — **nine and ten**
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script, writing; Chapter 7, p. 67